The Everyday AI Collection

234 step-by-step guides for real, everyday tasks

Staying safe · Money & admin · Home & family · Photos, video & music · Learning & getting started · Work & email · Understand anything · Automate the boring bits

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Before you start — what this is, honestly

This is an updated edition. It was rebuilt from our current guides on the date shown on the cover: more guides per topic, retired guides removed, and every step taken from the latest version of each guide.

This collection is free, and every guide in it is also free on our website. This file just gathers them in one place, in reading order, so you can print it, keep it on your phone, or read it offline. Our website has no paywall either — every guide links back to its online page, which is always the newer version.

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Apps change. Buttons move and menus get renamed. If a step does not match what you see, the guide's online version is the newer one — the link is under every title.

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Staying safe

How to check if a suspicious message is a scam by pasting it into an AI

6 steps · Read online

> **In short:** Paste a sketchy message into any AI assistant — ChatGPT, Gemini, Claude, Copilot, or Le Chat — and ask it to flag the red flags. You'll get a second opinion in under a minute, but never paste real passwords, and always verify with the company first.

Scam messages have gotten good. They use real company logos, your real name, sometimes even your real address. Before you click anything, copy the message into an AI assistant and ask for a second pair of eyes. This guide walks you through that in six steps — even if you've never used an AI assistant before. One honest warning up front: the AI is a useful first check, not a verdict, and it cannot actually click the link or call the company for you. You still have to do that part.

Before you start

- An AI assistant you can sign into — ChatGPT, Gemini, Claude, Microsoft Copilot, and Le Chat all work, and their free plans are fine for this.
- The suspicious message itself, ready to copy (an email, a text, a chat screenshot, or a DM).
- About 5 minutes in total.
- Important: never paste real passwords, full card numbers, or government ID numbers, even if the message contains them — Step 2 shows you how to handle that.

Step 1 — Open a fresh chat in any AI assistant

Open the website or app of any AI assistant — ChatGPT, Gemini, Claude, Microsoft Copilot, Le Chat, or whichever you already use. Start a brand-new conversation rather than dropping the message into an older thread. On a phone, the app icon usually looks like a small chat bubble or a starry logo. On a computer, just go to the assistant's homepage and click into the empty chat box. A clean thread means the AI won't get distracted by older context and will focus entirely on your message. If you don't already have an account, the free sign-up usually takes under a minute and only needs an email address. 💬 Example: open ChatGPT, Gemini, Claude, Microsoft Copilot, or Le Chat — whichever one you already have an account on. You'll know it worked when you see an empty chat box with a placeholder like "Message…" or "Ask anything" and a send button (often an arrow or paper-plane icon).

Step 2 — Redact personal details before you paste

Before you copy the message, take 30 seconds to hide any sensitive bits it contains. Cover real passwords, full credit card numbers, your Social Security or national ID number, your home address, and any one-time login codes. A quick search-and-replace in any notes app works fine. Think of it like covering your hand on a debit-card PIN pad at the store — the AI doesn't need those details to spot a scam, and fewer real numbers in the chat mean less risk if your account is ever hacked. If the message has no personal details at all, you can skip ahead to Step 3. Example: turn "my SSN is 123-45-6789, please call 555-0123" into "my SSN is [REDACTED], please call [REDACTED]". You'll know it worked when the message still reads naturally but no real numbers, codes, or addresses remain.

Step 3 — Paste the message and ask the AI to flag red flags

Tap or click inside the empty chat box and paste the redacted message. Then add a short prompt asking the assistant to look at it as if it were a security expert. Press the send button (usually an arrow ↗ or paper-plane icon, but apps vary). After a few seconds the AI will start typing a reply — usually a short list of warning signs plus a one-line verdict like "this looks like a phishing attempt" (a fake message designed to steal your login or money) or "this appears legitimate, but verify the sender". If nothing appears after a few seconds, look for a small "stop" or square icon — the response sometimes needs a moment to begin. Apps change often, so if your screen looks a little different, just look for any button that submits your message. Example: "Here's a message I just received. Can you act as a security expert and tell me whether it looks like a scam? List the specific red flags you see, and tell me whether I should click any links in it. Message: [paste here]" You'll know it worked when you see a written response that names specific warning signs, such as urgency, suspicious links, an odd sender, or requests for personal info.

Step 4 — Read the AI's answer with a critical eye

Treat the AI's reply like a friend's opinion, not a doctor's diagnosis. Read each red flag it names and ask yourself: does this actually match the message I received? Many scams lean on urgency ("act in the next 24 hours"), impersonate a brand you trust, include a link that almost looks right, ask you to click or log in, or demand payment in gift cards or cryptocurrency. If the AI flags something that isn't actually in your message, ignore that point — assistants sometimes guess wrong, and you are still the expert on your own inbox. Conversely, if something feels off to you but the AI didn't mention it, trust your gut and move to the next step. Be especially wary if the AI says "this looks fine" but the message asks you to click a link, send money, or share a code — that's the moment to get a second human opinion. Example: if the AI says "the sender domain doesn't match the company", check that yourself — does the "from" address really end in the company's real website, or in something like "support-service.example.com"? You'll know it

worked when you can repeat back, in your own words, two or three specific reasons the AI gave for its verdict.

Step 5 — Verify any links or sender names yourself

Don't click anything yet. If the message contains a link, hover over it on a computer or long-press it on a phone — you'll see the real destination. Real companies use their own short domain (the brand's actual homepage), while scam links often hide behind words like "secure-login" or "verify-account" on a totally different address. The simple rule: if the link doesn't end on the brand's real site, it's almost certainly fake. If the message claims to be from a person you know, contact that person through a channel you already trust — a phone call or a separate chat — and never reply to the suspicious message itself. If it claims to be from a company like your bank, look up the official number on their real website (type the address yourself, don't use any number inside the message) and ask them directly. 💬 Example: a "USPS" tracking link points to `usps-tracking.example.com/pay-now` — that is NOT usps.com, so it's a fake. You'll know it worked when you have either confirmed the message is genuine through a trusted channel, or you've concluded it's a scam.

Step 6 — Decide what to do, and don't act in a rush

Now choose one of three actions. If it's a scam: delete it, block the sender, and — if it pretended to be a company — report it to that company through their real website. If it's genuine but unexpected: still don't click links inside it; go to the company's real site yourself and log in there. If you're not sure: leave it alone for an hour, then re-read it cold; urgency is the scammer's favorite tool, and a slow second look usually reveals more. Tell a friend or family member if you're worried — a second human pair of eyes still catches things AI misses, especially with voice or video scams. The whole point of using an AI here is to slow down, not to rush. 💬 Example: text a family member — "Hey, I just got a weird message about my Amazon account, does this sound legit to you? [paste]" You'll know it worked when you take one concrete action in the next few minutes — delete, report, or verify through a trusted channel — instead of leaving the message sitting unread in your inbox.

Common mistakes

- **Pasting real passwords or full card numbers.** The AI doesn't need them, and storing them in a chat creates risk if your account is ever hacked. Fix: redact first (Step 2), or describe the message in your own words instead of pasting it.
- **Trusting the AI's verdict without checking.** AI assistants sometimes miss obvious scams or flag clean messages by mistake. Fix: always cross-check the specific red flags it names against the actual message (Step 4) and verify with the real company (Step 5).

- **Clicking the suspicious link "just to see what happens".** That's exactly what the scammer wants. Fix: hover or long-press to read the real URL, and never log in through a link inside an unexpected message — go to the company's website yourself.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** the next time a "your package couldn't be delivered" text or a "your account will be locked" email lands, you can get a clear second opinion in under a minute instead of guessing whether to tap it.
- **For your business or work:** if you handle invoices or vendor payments, this same 5-minute check on unusual payment-change requests can stop a business email compromise (a scam where a criminal impersonates a vendor or boss to redirect a payment) — one of the most expensive scams going.
- **If you're just getting started:** pick the AI assistant you already use, bookmark this guide, and try it the next time something feels even slightly off. Practice on a junk email first if you want to build confidence.

Try it now

Find one message in your inbox you've been unsure about, redact any personal details, paste it into your AI assistant, and ask it to flag the red flags. Five minutes, one fresh chat, one safer decision.

How to Spot an AI Scam Call, Fake Email, or Deepfake Voice Today

6 steps · Read online

> **In short:** AI scams now sound like your family, write like a real person, and spoof your bank's phone number. A five-second pause plus one private family word catches almost all of them — here's how to set both up today.

By the end of this guide you'll know how to recognize the three most common AI scams circulating right now, what one-second check stops each one, and what to do the moment you realize something is wrong. This is written for anyone who uses a phone and email — no tech background needed, and nothing here requires buying or installing anything.

Before you start

- A phone (mobile or landline) and an email account you check regularly.
- About 10 minutes total, mostly to set up one protection you can use for years.
- One or two trusted people — a family member or close friend — for the family safe-word step.

Step 1 — Listen for the giveaway in a "family emergency" voice call

When someone calls claiming to be a relative in trouble, the very first move is to **hang up** and dial that person's number yourself — the one already saved in your phone. What you'll usually see on screen is a familiar name on the caller ID, sometimes with a stranger's voice asking "guess who this is?" to make you fill in the blank yourself. After you hang up and redial, a real relative will answer or call you back; a scam line often disconnects, plays a generic voicemail, or doesn't ring at all. If your caller ID shows nothing or a random number, the same rule applies — never continue the call. Voice cloning (an AI that copies someone's voice from a few seconds of audio) is good enough now that even adult children of the "caller" can't tell the difference in the first few seconds. Example: "Grandma, it's me, I was in an accident, please send money" → hang up → dial your grandchild's saved number. You'll know it worked when the real person answers your second call and confirms they never phoned you.

Step 2 — Catch a fake customer-service agent

Any time someone calls YOU about a problem with your account — bank, phone, delivery, internet — hang up and call the company back using the number printed on your last statement or shown on the company's official site. What you'll usually see in the original call is an "agent" who already knows your name, the last four digits of your card, or recent transactions; the voice

sounds professional and there's often office noise in the background to feel legit. A real company will let you hang up and call back; a scammer will push you to "stay on the line" or refuse to give you a number you can verify. If the caller insists they can't take a callback because the case is "time-sensitive," that's actually the biggest giveaway. 💬 Example: "Hi, this is Maria from your bank's fraud department" → hang up → look up the bank's number on your statement → dial it yourself. You'll know it worked when the real company's recorded greeting answers and the human you reach has no record of the previous call.

Step 3 — Spot the AI-written phishing email

Before clicking any link in a message that asks you to act, **hover over the sender's address and any link** to see where they actually point. What you'll see is an email that looks like it came from a delivery company, a streaming service, or your bank — the wording is fluent, friendly, and free of the typos that old scams used to have; there's often a small urgency like "act within 24 hours" to nudge you past thinking. Hovering reveals a different domain — something like `usps-tracking.example.com/pay-now` instead of a real postal address, or a long random-looking string of letters. On a phone you can long-press a link to preview it; if you can't tell where it goes, don't tap. AI-written phishing is convincing because the grammar is now perfect — the giveaway is no longer the spelling, it's the destination. 💬 Example: "Your package is held at customs, pay a small fee to release it" → hover the link → see it points to a domain you've never heard of → delete. You'll know it worked when you can name the actual destination of the link before deciding whether to click.

Step 4 — Use the one-second check that works for all three

When any message or call feels urgent, scary, or too lucky to be true, pause for five seconds and ask yourself one question: **"Would I be in trouble if I did nothing for the next ten minutes?"** What you'll notice in those five seconds is your own hands wanting to act fast — and the caller or email pushing you to "do it now." Most scams collapse under a ten-minute pause: the "agent" hangs up and moves on, the email can sit unread overnight, and your "grandchild" is still safe wherever they actually are. Some scams add a fake countdown timer to fight this exact habit; remember that a real emergency from a real company will still be a real emergency ten minutes from now, and a real loved one will understand a short wait. 💬 Example: "Pay this fee now or your account closes in five minutes" → pause → ask the ten-minute question → almost always the answer is no. You'll know it worked when the urgency melts away and you make your next move from calm instead of panic.

Step 5 — Set up a family safe word today

Pick one unusual word with one or two people you trust, and agree that any "emergency" call must include this word before any money moves. A short group chat, a text, or even an in-

person conversation is enough — no app or password manager needed. What this gives you is a private test that even a perfect voice clone can't pass: the scammer simply doesn't know your word, and your real relative does. If your family is scattered, agree on a private question with a private answer instead — "what did we name the cat at grandma's house?" works better than a single word when kids are involved. Write the word down once, share it with the people who need it, and don't post it anywhere online. 💬 Example: Text your sister: "If anyone calls saying they're me and needs money, ask them for our safe word. The word is platypus." You'll know it worked when at least two people in your circle can recite the word without looking it up.

Step 6 — Know what to do in the moment you realize it's a scam

Hang up, close the email, or stop replying — and then **report it**, even if you didn't lose a cent. Your heart will still be beating fast, the "agent" will be gone, and the email will still be sitting in your inbox; that's normal. Reporting helps block the next person, and in the US you can forward phishing emails to reportphishing@apwg.org and file a report at the FTC's reportfraud.ftc.gov, or with the FBI's Internet Crime Complaint Center at ic3.gov. If you DID send money or share a one-time code, call your bank's fraud line immediately — the number on the back of your card — and ask for a recall; speed matters more than embarrassment here. 💬 Example: Realized mid-call that the "bank agent" was fake → hung up → called the number on my debit card → told them what happened → account flagged for monitoring. You'll know it worked when the call is over, you've told one official channel, and your accounts and passwords are unchanged.

Common mistakes

- **Trusting caller ID.** Scammers can spoof any name or number. The display showing "Daughter" or "Your Bank" proves nothing — hang up and dial back on a number you saved yourself.
- **Acting on the "ten-minute countdown."** That timer is part of the scam. Real companies and real family emergencies don't disappear while you take a breath; pausing is always safe.
- **Sharing a one-time code "to verify yourself."** No legitimate company will ever ask for a code they just sent you. The instant someone asks for that string of numbers, the conversation is a scam — full stop.
- **Skipping the family safe word because "it'll never happen to us."** The setup takes one minute today and saves potentially life-changing money later. Treat it like a smoke detector: boring to install, priceless when it goes off.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** the next time your phone rings with a panicked voice, you'll know to hang up first and call back on a number you trust — instead of sending money in the first thirty seconds.
- **For your business or work:** any team that handles invoices, supplier emails, or wire transfers should adopt a private code word the same way families do; deepfake voice scams have already hit finance and HR departments, not just grandmothers.
- **If you're just getting started:** do just one thing today — text one person in your family the safe word from Step 5. That single message is more protection than any antivirus app on your phone.

Try it now

Right now, open your messaging app and text one trusted person: *"If I ever call you in a panic and ask for money or codes, ask me for our safe word. The word is [pick something unusual, like 'platypus' or 'silver-spoon']."* That one text takes under two minutes and is the single highest-value defense in this whole guide.

Turn Off AI Chat History and Data Saving in ChatGPT, Claude, and Gemini

6 steps · Read online

> **In short:** You can stop ChatGPT, Claude, and Gemini from using your conversations to train future AI models by flipping a privacy toggle in each service's settings — but the exact menu names change often, and turning off training does not erase the conversations those companies have already saved.

By default, ChatGPT, Claude, and Gemini save your chats and may use them to train future versions of themselves. This guide shows you how to switch that off in each service — on web and mobile — and explains what each toggle actually changes, and what it quietly does not.

Before you start

- A free or paid **personal** account on each AI service you want to adjust. Work or school accounts are usually managed by your employer and may not let you change these settings.
- A web browser is the easiest place to do this. Phone apps work too, but menus shift around more often.
- Set aside about **15 minutes total** — roughly five minutes per service.
- Make sure you are signed in to each service before you begin, so the settings actually save.

Step 1 — Open ChatGPT's Data Controls

Go to **chatgpt.com** in a browser and sign in if you are not already. Click your **profile picture or initials** in the top-right corner — a small menu appears. Look for an option like **Settings** (sometimes shown as a gear icon ⚙) and click it. In the Settings panel that opens on the left side of the page, look for a section called **Data Controls** and click that. If your screen looks different, try a section called **Privacy** instead — older versions used that name.

If you are on a phone, tap the **two lines or three dots** in the top corner of the ChatGPT app, then tap your name at the top of the menu that slides up. The same Settings → Data Controls path should appear.

You'll know it worked when you see a list of toggles — look for ones mentioning "Improve", "training", or "history".

Step 2 — Turn off ChatGPT's training toggle

On the Data Controls page, find the toggle labeled something like **"Improve model for everyone"** or **"Chat history & training"** — the exact label changes often, so read each

toggle's description. Click the toggle so it slides to the **off** position (it usually turns gray or loses its color). You may see a small popup asking you to confirm — click **Confirm** or **Save**. The page may refresh, or you may need to close and reopen it for the change to show.

If you do not see a training toggle at all, your account may be on a plan or in a region where the option is hidden. In that case, leave the page and check back in a few weeks — settings are added over time.

You'll know it worked when the toggle stays gray (off) after a page refresh and no longer shows an "on" indicator. Even after turning this off, OpenAI may still keep your most recent chats for up to 30 days for safety monitoring — so avoid pasting anything truly sensitive in the meantime.

Step 3 — Open Claude's privacy settings

Go to **claude.ai** and sign in. Click your **profile picture or initials** — usually the bottom-left on web or the top-right on mobile. From the menu that pops up, choose **Settings**. Inside Settings, look for a tab or section called **Privacy**, **Account**, or **Profile** — the exact name varies. Within that section, hunt for a toggle that mentions **"help improve Claude"** or **"use my chats for training"**.

On the Claude mobile app, the same path usually works: tap your **profile icon**, then **Settings**, then look for the privacy section. If your app opens straight into a chat, look for a **gear icon** ⚙ in the top corner instead.

You'll know it worked when you see a privacy section with at least one on/off toggle related to training or improving the assistant.

Step 4 — Turn off Claude's training toggle

Click the toggle next to **"Help improve Claude"** (or whichever similar phrase appears on your screen) so it slides to the **off** position. Some users see a confirmation popup — accept it. The change usually saves instantly without a separate Save button, but if you see one, click it.

A few honest notes here. On some free Claude accounts, the option to opt out of training may be limited or unavailable — Anthropic has updated this policy more than once. If you do not see the toggle at all, check whether you are signed in with a **work or school email**; those accounts are managed by an admin and cannot be changed here. If you pay for Claude, you may see the toggle in a slightly different place — the same Settings area, but possibly under a **Privacy** sub-tab.

You'll know it worked when the toggle is gray and stays gray after you refresh the page. If the setting does not seem to stick, sign out, sign back in, and check again — sometimes it takes a moment to sync.

Step 5 — Open Gemini's activity controls

Gemini handles this a little differently because it lives inside your Google account. Go to **gemini.google.com** or open the Gemini app. Click your **profile picture** in the top corner. Look for **Settings** or **Activity** — on the web, you may see a direct link labeled **"Gemini Apps Activity"** that takes you straight into your Google account controls. Click it.

On mobile, tap your **profile picture** in the top corner of the Gemini app, then look for **Gemini Apps Activity** in the menu that appears. If it is not there, your app version may have moved it — try searching your phone's settings app for **"Gemini"** instead, or open **myactivity.google.com** in a browser.

You'll know it worked when a Google page opens showing a toggle labeled **"Gemini Apps Activity"** and a short description of what it does.

Step 6 — Turn off Gemini's Apps Activity

On the Gemini Apps Activity page, click the toggle at the top so it switches to **off**. A small confirmation panel may pop up explaining what will change — read it, then confirm. You may also see a separate option to **delete past activity**; if you want a clean slate, click that too and follow the prompts.

This single Google toggle covers the Gemini web app, the Gemini mobile app, and any other place Gemini saves your chats to your Google account. Disabling it does not delete your past conversations automatically — you need to do that separately if you want them gone. And remember: turning off Gemini Apps Activity does not affect your Google Search history or YouTube history, which are controlled by separate toggles.

You'll know it worked when the toggle is off and a line of text confirms activity is paused. You can verify by starting a new chat, then returning to this page — the activity should not appear there.

Common mistakes

- **Looking for a "delete my data" button.** None of these toggles erase what the company already has on file. If you want old chats removed, each service has a separate **Delete** or **Clear conversations** option — and even then, companies often keep copies for legal or safety reasons for a while.
- **Assuming one toggle fixes everything.** In Gemini especially, there are **multiple** Google activity controls. Turning off Gemini Apps Activity does not affect Search history, YouTube history, or other Google products. Check each one separately if you care about all of them.

- **Trusting the toggle forever.** Companies update their settings and policies regularly. The opt-out you flipped today may quietly disappear or change meaning in six months — set a calendar reminder every few months to come back and check.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** Turning these off is a good habit if you ever paste anything personal into an AI chat — names, addresses, health questions, work emails. It does not make you invisible, but it stops your words from being used to teach the next model.
- **For your business or work:** If you handle customer data, contracts, or anything confidential, do not rely on these toggles alone. Many companies explicitly say opt-outs do not cover legal requests or internal abuse detection. Use a separate AI account with synthetic data, or stick to enterprise plans that promise stronger privacy.
- **If you're just getting started:** Pick the service you use the most, open its settings, and turn off the training toggle right now. That single move is the most useful thing you can do today — you can come back for the other two later.

Try it now

Open the AI assistant you used most recently, click your profile picture, find the privacy or data settings, and turn off the training toggle. It takes about a minute, and you'll see exactly what your settings look like today.

What You Should Never Share With an AI Assistant: A Privacy Guide

6 steps · Read online

By the end of this guide you'll know the three buckets of personal data that belong strictly offline, how to spot any of those details in your chat history, and what to do if you've already let an AI see them. It's written for anyone who chats with tools like ChatGPT, Gemini, Claude or Copilot.

Before you start

- A device with internet access (phone, tablet or computer).
- An account on at least one AI assistant (e.g., ChatGPT, Gemini, Claude – the free tier is enough).
- About 5 minutes of uninterrupted time.

Step 1 — Spot the three privacy buckets

Open the AI assistant you use most and start a fresh conversation. On screen you'll see a blank text box waiting for your prompt, and a "Send" button on the right. When you type, the assistant will start generating a reply beneath your prompt. If the layout looks different, look for a field that says "Ask anything" or a similar text-input area. 💬 Example: "What types of personal information should I never share with you?" You'll know it worked when the assistant lists three groups such as (1) identifiers (name, address, ID numbers), (2) financial details (bank accounts, credit-card numbers), and (3) health or biometric data.

Step 2 — Scan your recent chats for those buckets

Go to the chat-history screen – usually accessed by tapping a clock-icon or a menu labeled "History". You'll see a list of past conversations, each summarized by its first line. Selecting a conversation opens the full exchange, where you can scroll through every message you sent. If you don't see a clock-icon, look for a three-line menu and choose "Recent chats" instead. 💬 Example: type "Show me my last five messages" (many assistants support a simple request like this). You'll know it worked when the assistant displays the recent prompts you entered, giving you a chance to review them.

Step 3 — Delete or redact any message that contains private info

In the opened conversation locate the message that holds an identifier, financial detail or health data. Most assistants let you tap and hold the message, revealing options such as "Delete" or "Remove". Choose "Delete" and confirm when a pop-up asks "Are you sure?". If the option isn't

obvious, look for a trash-can icon or a “Clear” button at the bottom of the chat. 💬 Example: after selecting the message, type “Delete this message”. You’ll know it worked when the message disappears from the chat view and the history no longer shows that content.

Step 4 — Turn off chat-history saving (if your plan allows)

Open the settings panel – usually reached by tapping your profile picture or a gear-shaped icon in the top-right corner. The settings screen will list toggles like “Save chat history” or “Conversation storage”. Switch the toggle off; a brief note may appear saying the change applies to future chats only. On a free plan some assistants only let you “clear history” rather than disable it permanently, so look for a button that says “Clear all chats”. 💬 Example: “Turn off chat history”. You’ll know it worked when the toggle changes color or moves to the “off” position, and the app confirms “Your chats will not be saved”.

Step 5 — Verify that nothing sensitive is being stored

Start a new conversation and type a harmless query such as “What’s the capital of the US?”. The assistant will reply below the prompt. Then open the history again and check that only this new, non-personal question appears. If older, private messages still show up, repeat Steps 2–4 for any that remain. 💬 Example: “Show my recent chats”. You’ll know it worked when the list only contains the recent, innocuous question you just asked.

Step 6 — Request a full data-deletion if you think something slipped through

If you suspect you shared something the assistant cannot delete yourself (for example a piece of text buried deep in a long conversation), look for a “Help” or “Support” link in the settings menu. Most providers have a contact form or email address labeled “Data-privacy request”. Send a short message stating “Please delete all personal data associated with my account [your email]”. On some platforms you may need to verify your identity first. 💬 Example: “Dear Support, please remove any personal identifiers from my account.” You’ll know it worked when you receive a confirmation email or a system message saying “Your request has been received”.

Common mistakes

- **Sharing full addresses or ID numbers:** If you copy-paste your home address, the assistant now knows a location you might not want stored. Fix it by deleting the message and turning off history as shown in Steps 3–4.
- **Posting bank or credit-card numbers:** Even a partial number can be used for fraud. Remove the message immediately and contact your bank to monitor for any unusual activity.

- **Assuming the assistant deletes data for you:** Deleting a message only removes it from your view; the provider may still keep a copy on its servers. Always use the built-in "Clear all chats" option or submit a formal deletion request (Step 6).

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** You can safely ask an AI to brainstorm a grocery list without worrying that your phone number or home address is being stored forever.
- **For your business or work:** Confidential client numbers and contract figures stay out of the AI's training data, reducing the risk of accidental leaks.
- **If you're just getting started:** The easiest first move is to turn off chat-history saving – it's a single toggle that protects all future conversations.

Try it now

Open the AI assistant you use most, find the settings gear, and toggle **off** the "Save chat history" option. In under two minutes you'll have taken a solid step toward keeping your private information out of AI-generated archives.

How to Spot a Phishing Email or Scam Text Before You Click

6 steps · Read online

> **In short:** Copy any suspicious email or scam text into an AI assistant with a short "fraud detector" prompt, and it lists the red flags — fake urgency, off-brand sender addresses, sketchy links — so you can decide whether to delete, block, or report the message before you click anything.

That pang of "wait, something feels off" you get when a strange email or text arrives — the AI can confirm it (or calm you down) in about 30 seconds. This guide shows you exactly what to type, and how to read the answer so you don't miss the warning signs. It works with ChatGPT, Gemini, Claude, Copilot, Le Chat, DeepSeek, or any other assistant you already use. One honest note up front: an AI can spot a lot, but it can't actually click the link for you or verify whether a sender is real — the final "yes" or "no" is still your call.

Before you start

- An account on any AI assistant you already use (free versions work fine — ChatGPT, Gemini, Claude, Microsoft Copilot, Le Chat, or DeepSeek all do this).
- The suspicious message itself, opened on your screen but with no links tapped or replies sent.
- Roughly 2 minutes.

Step 1 — Read the message calmly before doing anything

Open the suspicious email or text, and do exactly one thing: read it top to bottom with your finger off the mouse. Glance for three things — a sender or number you don't recognize, a tone that pushes you to act NOW, and any link you weren't expecting. You'll see the message exactly as you normally would; nothing changes yet. 💬 Example: if it's "Your package is delayed, confirm here: bit.ly/x9zq", just read the words. Don't tap the link. If it looks different: in some messaging apps long-pressing a link shows a small URL preview — that's actually useful, but still don't open it. Reading is the goal here. You'll know it worked when you can describe the message in one short sentence without having clicked anything.

Step 2 — Open any AI assistant you already use

On your phone or laptop, open the AI assistant app or website where you already have an account. No special "fraud tool" is needed — every general-purpose assistant can do this job. You'll see an empty chat box, usually labeled "Message", "Ask anything", or similar. If it looks different: every assistant has its own empty state, but the chat box is almost always in the middle

of the screen on desktop or at the bottom on mobile. If you're stuck, start a "New chat". You'll know it worked when you see a blinking cursor and a send button, ready for you to type.

Step 3 — Paste in a "fraud detector" prompt first

Before pasting the suspicious message, give the AI a one-line role instruction. Type it into the chat box and hit send. The AI will respond with a short confirmation — usually something like "Sure, paste it in" — that primes it to focus on fraud patterns instead of generic advice. This single line is what turns a normal chat into a fraud check. Example: "Act as a fraud detector. Read the message I'm pasting next and list every red flag you can see, then tell me clearly whether it's safe to reply, click any link, or open any attachment. If you're not sure, say so." If it looks different: some assistants reply with a longer setup paragraph — that's fine; what matters is that it now knows to focus on scams. You'll know it worked when the AI answers something like "Got it — paste the message" or asks a clarifying question.

Step 4 — Paste the full suspicious message, then send

Highlight the entire message — sender name, subject line, body, and the link text — but leave out your own name, address, or any account numbers if they appear, since the AI doesn't need them to spot trouble. Paste it into the chat box and hit send. The AI now has the raw text and starts analyzing it. If it looks different: if the message is unusually long (a fake invoice, say), you can paste a trimmed version — but keep the opening sentence and any links exactly as written, because that's where the red flags usually live. Example of what to paste: "From: Amazon Support <> — Dear customer, your account has been suspended due to unusual activity. Click here to verify: hhtp://amaz0n-secure.example.com/login — please respond within 24 hours." You'll know it worked when the AI starts replying with a bulleted list of specific things it spotted — usually 4 to 8 items.

Step 5 — Read the red flags and trust the obvious ones

The AI's reply is usually a checklist: things like "the sender domain doesn't match Amazon," "the URL uses a zero instead of an 'o'," "the message creates urgency with a 24-hour deadline," or "the greeting is generic (no real name)." Read each one and ask yourself, "Does this match what I'm seeing on my screen?" You'll start to see a pattern you can recognize next time without any help. Example of an AI answer: "Red flags: sender domain is amaz0n-support.example.com, not amazon.com; the link is 'hhtp' (typo) and uses a zero in 'amaz0n'; urgency tactic ('within 24 hours'); generic greeting. Verdict: do NOT click, do NOT reply. Report and delete." If it looks different: the AI might use softer words ("likely a phishing attempt", "this looks suspicious"). That's the same meaning. If it ever says "I'm not certain", take that seriously and lean toward treating the message as a scam. You'll know it worked when you can name at least three specific reasons the message is suspicious and explain them out loud.

Step 6 — Decide, then report and delete

Once the AI gives its verdict, decide based on the strength of the red flags. If even one major red flag is present — a sketchy sender domain, pressure to act NOW, or a request for passwords or payment — don't click and don't reply. Use the email or messaging app's built-in "Report phishing" or "Report junk" option if you can find it, then delete the message. The dangerous message is gone from your screen and flagged to the platform. 💬 Example of a good follow-up question to the AI: "Can you explain in one sentence what an 'urgency tactic' means, so I know what to look for next time?" If it looks different: Gmail, Outlook, Apple Mail, and most phone carriers all have a Report button, usually under a "⋯" three-dot menu or near "Mark as" / "Move to". If you can't find the report option, deleting is good enough — what matters is that you don't reply. You'll know it worked when the message is no longer in your inbox, you've flagged it to your email or carrier, and you haven't tapped the link.

Common mistakes

- Replying to the scammer just to ask "is this real?" — replying confirms your address is live, and more scam messages follow. Delete and report instead.
- Trusting the AI without reading the explanation — AI can miss things. If the message "feels" off but the AI says it's fine, trust your gut and don't click. The AI is a second opinion, not a final one.
- Pasting personal details along with the message — your name, address, and account numbers aren't needed to spot red flags; trim them out before pasting, because anything you send into a chat is processed by that service.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** A 30-second check before clicking unknown links saves you from stolen passwords, drained bank accounts, and long phone calls with your bank. It becomes a habit that protects you on autopilot.
- **For your work:** Make this your default first step before forwarding suspicious work emails to IT. You'll often catch obvious scams that IT would have flagged anyway — which saves everyone time and earns you a reputation as the careful one on the team.
- **If you're just getting started:** Try it on the very next weird message you receive. You don't need to be perfect — you only need to slow down for 30 seconds before you click.

Try it now

The next time an email or text feels off, copy it into your AI assistant with the prompt from Step 3, paste the full message from Step 4, and read the red flags from Step 5 before you tap anything. The whole check takes about half a minute.

How to Spot AI Scams, Deepfakes, and Fake Content

5 steps · Read online

> **In short:** AI-generated content is getting more convincing, but you can still protect yourself by verifying through independent channels and staying calm when messages create urgency.

By the end of this guide, you will know how to identify AI-generated images, synthetic voices, and deceptive messages before they trick you. This practical guide is designed to help anyone navigate the internet safely, without needing a degree in computer science. While these tips are powerful, remember that AI technology is always evolving. No single method is 100% foolproof, so staying updated and critically evaluating content is your best defense. This guide teaches you to be observant, but it cannot make decisions for you about the trustworthiness of a source.

Before you start

- **A device with internet access:** This could be your mobile phone, tablet, or computer.
- **About 10-15 minutes of your time:** Enough to read through the guide and try a few observations.
- **An observant and calm mindset:** AI changes quickly, so ongoing vigilance and a cool head are your best tools against deception.
- **No special apps or accounts needed:** We'll focus entirely on using your natural observation skills and everyday verification methods.

Step 1 — Spot visual "glitches" in photos

AI image generators are computer programs that create pictures based on text descriptions, much like a highly skilled digital painter who has studied millions of real photos. While they're incredibly talented, older versions of these programs often struggle with fine details, and examining photos closely can sometimes reveal inconsistencies.

When you see a photo that feels "off," your first action should be to zoom in and closely examine the specific details. You'll usually see the image take up more of your screen as you zoom. Once magnified, check areas like hands, feet, accessories, clothing, and backgrounds for subtle errors. You'll know it worked when you can clearly see distorted features, strange shadows, or illogical elements in the image.

💬 Example: You see a photo of a well-known person in an unusual situation. Zoom in on their hands and face. If you notice anything unusual — extra fingers, distorted features, or inconsistent lighting — investigate further before sharing or believing it.

Note: Modern AI generators have improved dramatically, so these artifacts are becoming less common. When in doubt, verify the image through a reverse image search or other means.

Step 2 — Identify "deepfake" video clues

A **deepfake** is a video where a person's face or body has been digitally altered or even completely swapped using smart computer systems. Think of it like a sophisticated digital mask that moves in real time, trying to perfectly mimic a real person. While detection is getting harder as the technology improves, there are still some things to watch for.

Start by playing the suspicious video, then pause it frequently to get a good look at specific frames. As you play the video, you'll see the frames move, and then when you pause, a still image will appear, allowing you to scrutinize the facial areas without the distraction of constant motion. You'll know it worked when you spot any inconsistencies in how the face blends with the hair, unusual lighting, or areas that look slightly blurred or distorted.

💬 Example: You receive an urgent video message from your company's director asking for an immediate fund transfer. Pause the video and look closely at their jawline, neck, and hairline. If you notice anything unusual — a fuzzy outline, unusual shadows, or lip movements that don't quite match the audio — treat it as suspicious and verify through another channel before acting.

Note: High-quality deepfakes are increasingly difficult to spot with the naked eye. If a video requests money or sensitive information, always verify through a separate, trusted method.

Step 3 — Listen for voice cloning issues

Voice cloning is technology that takes a short recording of a real person's voice and then uses a computer to make them say entirely new things. Imagine it like a high-tech text-to-speech tool that can perfectly imitate your friend, child, or colleague. Modern voice cloning can be very convincing, so the best protection is not relying on voice alone.

When you receive a suspicious call or audio message, listen intently to the speaker's voice, paying close attention to their tone and speech patterns. You'll hear the words being spoken and can analyze how natural or unnatural they sound. If you are on a call, try to get to a quiet place or use headphones if available to reduce background noise. If anything feels slightly off — an unusual tone, unexpected phrasing, or a request that feels out of character — take that as a signal to verify through other means.

💬 Example: You receive an urgent phone call from a friend asking for financial help. The voice sounds exactly like them, but the request is unusual or the tone feels strange in context. This is a red flag. Hang up immediately and call them back on their usual, trusted number to verify.

Step 4 — Verify suspicious messages using a second channel

Deceptive messages often leverage AI to write highly convincing, personalized emails or text messages, making them a potent form of automated scamming. The golden rule of online safety is simple: never use the contact details provided *within* a suspicious message to verify its authenticity, as these will likely lead you directly to the scammer.

Your action is to deliberately step away from the original message and initiate contact through a different, independently verified method. You'll see the original message on your screen (email, SMS, social media), which might contain urgent requests or "updated" details. By using an independent contact, you avoid giving the scammer direct access. If the request was via email, for instance, don't reply to that email. Instead, find a trusted phone number from a previous bill or the company's official website. You'll know it worked when the person on the other end confirms (or denies) the request, using a contact method you initiated and trust, separate from the potentially fake one.

💬 Example: A supplier sends an email with "updated bank details" for a payment, urging you to use the new account. Do not reply to that email or call the phone number listed in its signature. Instead, find the phone number from your original paper contract or the supplier's official website and call them directly to confirm the change.

Step 5 — Look for generic or overly perfect text

AI-generated text can often be identified not by obvious errors, but by its *perfection* – or lack of human nuance. These **AI-written texts** might be overly formal, incredibly verbose, repetitive in their phrasing, or simply too generic to sound like genuine human communication. They lack the quirks, emotional inflections, and subtle imperfections that make human writing unique.

Your action is to read the message or article carefully, paying close attention to its style, flow, and word choice. As you read, you'll be evaluating the tone and identifying any unusual patterns. This applies whether you're looking at an email, a social media post, an online article, or even a review. If the text reads like it was written by a robot trying to sound human, it's a good clue. You'll know it worked when the writing feels unnaturally smooth, free of human quirks or slang, or uses overly formal language for a casual situation.

💬 Example: You receive an email from a supposed friend, but it uses overly formal language like "Furthermore, I require immediate assistance" rather than their usual casual style, and every sentence is perfectly structured without any contractions or slang. This unnatural perfection suggests AI involvement.

Common mistakes

- **Trusting "official" branding:** Scammers can easily use AI to copy company logos, official-looking fonts, and professional language. The mistake is to assume legitimacy based on appearance. **The fix:** Always focus on the *action* they are asking you to take (like clicking a suspicious link or sending money), rather than how professional or authentic the message looks.
- **Panicking and acting too fast:** AI scams are designed to create urgency or fear, making you feel pressured to act without thinking. **The fix:** If a message demands immediate action, take a deep breath and pause. Time is always on your side when it comes to verifying facts and protecting yourself.
- **Missing the full context:** Sometimes a small snippet of an image, video, or audio can be shared out of its original context, making it seem suspicious when it's actually harmless. **The fix:** Always try to find the original source or the wider story if something looks questionable. Search online for the image or video to see where it first appeared and what the original context was.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** You can protect your family from distressing phone scams by realizing that a familiar voice on the phone might not always belong to the person you expect. Using these observation skills helps you verify crucial information before making hasty decisions, keeping your loved ones safe from emotional and financial exploitation.
- **For your business or work:** Safeguarding your company's assets and reputation becomes easier. You'll be better equipped to detect phishing emails, fraudulent invoices, or deepfake video calls that could lead to significant financial loss or data breaches. Protecting your team and clients from sophisticated AI-powered deception is vital for maintaining trust and security.
- **If you're just getting started:** The most important takeaway is to cultivate a healthy dose of skepticism about content you encounter online, especially if it elicits a strong emotional response or demands urgent action. Start by simply pausing and asking yourself, "Does this feel real?" before you click, reply, or share.

Try it now

Next time you're scrolling through social media or checking your emails, pause when you see an image, video, or message that looks a little too good to be true, or surprisingly out of character. Apply one of the quick checks from this guide – perhaps zoom in on a photo, or read a message aloud to detect robotic tones.

Conclusion

Staying informed and vigilant is your strongest defense against the evolving landscape of AI-driven scams and misinformation. By learning to recognize potential red flags in AI-generated content, you empower yourself and those around you to navigate the digital world with greater confidence and security. Always remember to question, verify, and trust your instincts when something feels off.

How to Spot a Deepfake Video or Voice Clone Before You Share It

5 steps · Read online

> **In short:** Look at the eyes, mouth and face edges for small glitches; listen for flat, robotic speech; check who sent it and what it asks. If anything feels off, don't forward it — verify with the real person through a trusted channel first.

A short clip of a public figure saying something outrageous lands in your family group chat. A frantic voicemail from your "boss" asks for gift cards. None of these are obviously fake, and that's exactly the point. A **deepfake** is a video, image or audio clip made with AI to look or sound like a real person who never actually said or did the thing, and **voice cloning** (reproducing someone's voice convincingly from a short audio sample) is now easy and cheap. The good news: a few careful seconds of looking is usually enough to catch the most common giveaways. Even so, no single check is perfect, so your final safety net is always verifying with the real person before you share.

Before you start

- The clip itself (saved to your phone or laptop, or a link in a message)
- A web browser (for the reverse image check in Step 4)
- About 2–3 minutes per clip
- No account, no app, no paid plan needed

Step 1 — Watch the face for small glitches

Pause the video and study the face for about 10 seconds. Focus on the **eyes, the edges of the face, and the mouth**. Common giveaways: eyes that don't quite blink in time; glasses that seem to slide or warp when the head turns; teeth that blur into a single white block when the mouth moves; a face outline that looks soft or "painted" where it meets the hair and background; lighting on the face that doesn't match the rest of the scene. If you can't pause or zoom, slow playback to 0.5x and look again. On a phone, tap the screen to bring up the playback speed option — it's usually a small "1x" button near the timeline. You'll know it worked when you spot at least one thing that feels off — or, just as usefully, confirm the face looks natural.

Step 2 — Listen to the voice for flat delivery

Close your eyes for a moment and just listen. Real human speech has small imperfections: a quick breath, a half-stutter, a sentence that gets quieter when the speaker is unsure. AI-generated voices (TTS, short for text-to-speech — software that turns written words into spoken audio) tend to be too clean, too even in volume, and oddly flat in emotion. Listen for sentences

with no breath at all, words that all sit on the same pitch, or a tone that doesn't match the situation (someone supposedly panicking, but the voice sounds calm and steady). On a phone, plug in headphones so background hiss doesn't mask the small tells. You'll know it worked when you can tell whether the voice feels human or **synthesized** (made by a computer, not a real person).

Step 3 — Read the message around the clip

Before you forward anything, stop and read the context. Who sent it? Is it really them, or just a forwarded link from someone you trust? What does the clip ask you to do — donate money, click a link, send a code, stay quiet about something? Most scams lean on **urgency, secrecy or big emotional claims**: "send this in the next hour", "don't tell anyone", "this is huge." Those are the same red flags as any scam, and they're a strong reason to slow down. If you can't answer "who, what, and why" from the message alone, that's already a signal. You'll know it worked when you have a clear answer to those three questions — or a clear reason to be suspicious.

Step 4 — Run a quick source check

Take a screenshot of the person's face in the video (or use the platform's "save image" option). Open a reverse image search (commonly available on **Google Images**, **TinEye** or **Yandex Images** — no account needed) and upload the picture. Look for earlier appearances of the same face. If the face is supposed to be a public figure but the search shows nothing, or if older photos don't match the person in the clip, treat it as a likely fake. If the clip is supposedly a private person, send a quick message to that person on a channel you already had before the clip — not the one the clip came from — and ask if they really sent it. 💬 Example: "Hey, I got a voice note from someone claiming to be you asking about gift cards. Did you actually send it? Just checking." You'll know it worked when you can either confirm the source or decide it isn't worth the risk.

Step 5 — Decide what to do next

If any of the checks above raised doubt, the safest move is simple: **don't share it**. Reposting a fake — even with a "this might be fake" caveat — still spreads the original. Tell the person who sent it, politely, that you couldn't verify it, and ask them where they got it. If the clip claims to be a real person you know, give them a heads-up that someone may be using their face or voice. If the clip is a scam attempt, report it to the platform where you saw it, and if money or account access was involved, contact your bank or the company being impersonated directly. You'll know it worked when you stop and think before tapping "forward."

Common mistakes

- **Trusting the "share if you agree" framing.** If a clip is trying to get you to forward it before you've checked, that's the scam working. Slow down — the share button can wait 30 seconds.
- **Assuming a friend's name means a friend sent it.** Accounts get hacked and contacts get **spoofed** (a message made to look like it came from someone you know). Verify through a separate channel before trusting.
- **Relying on a single "AI detection" app.** No consumer app is reliable enough to be your only check, and some detection tools themselves are scams. Your eyes, ears and a quick source check beat any single app.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** Treat any unexpected video or voice message that asks for money, codes, or secrecy as a scam until proven otherwise. A two-minute check protects your bank account and your reputation.
- **For your work:** If a "colleague" sends an unusual request by voice or video, especially one involving wire transfers or credentials, confirm it through a known channel like a phone call or in-person chat before acting.
- **If you're just getting started:** Save this page and use it as a checklist the next time a clip makes you feel strongly — good or bad. Strong feelings are exactly what fake clips are designed to trigger.

Try it now

Pick one short video you saw recently that made you feel a strong reaction. Spend two minutes running Steps 1, 2 and 4 on it. Even if it turns out to be real, the practice makes the next check faster and easier.

Money & admin

Build a Simple Personal Budget Spreadsheet Using Any AI Assistant

7 steps · Read online

By the end of this guide, you'll have a working monthly budget in Excel, Google Sheets, or Apple Numbers — even if you've never built a spreadsheet before. You'll simply ask an AI assistant (think of it as a chat-style helper that writes things for you) to design the structure, then copy the result into your favorite spreadsheet app. No formulas memorising, no finance jargon, no fuss.

Before you start

- An account with any AI assistant. ChatGPT, Gemini, Claude, Copilot, Le Chat, and DeepSeek all work for this task — pick whichever you already have. Most have a free tier.
- A free spreadsheet app: Microsoft Excel (often pre-installed on Windows), Apple Numbers (on Mac), or Google Sheets (free in any browser at sheets.new).
- About 15 minutes the first time. A bit less once you've done it.

Step 1 — Open your AI assistant

Visit the website of your chosen AI assistant in a browser tab, or open its app on your phone. Sign in if needed. You'll see a chat box — usually a large text field at the bottom of the screen with placeholder text like "Message ChatGPT" or "Ask Gemini" inside it. If you don't have an account yet, look for a "Sign up" or "Get started" button; sign-up usually takes under a minute with an email address. Once you're in, the chat sits quietly waiting — the AI won't reply until you send something in Step 2. If your assistant offers a model selector (a small drop-down at the top of the chat), the default option is fine for budget work; no need to change it.

You'll know it worked when you can see the empty chat box and your cursor is blinking inside it.

Step 2 — Send the budget prompt

Click inside the chat box and type (or paste) your request. Press Enter, or tap the small upward-pointing paper-plane icon ➤ next to the box, to send. Within a few seconds, the AI starts typing a reply, and a budget table usually appears — complete with column headers like "Category", "Planned", "Actual", and a few sample rows. Some assistants (ChatGPT, Gemini, Claude) also offer a downloadable spreadsheet file; look for a small spreadsheet icon or "Download" link above the reply. If you see a paperclip 📎 icon for attachments, ignore it; you don't need to upload anything.

💬 Example: "Design a simple monthly budget spreadsheet for a single person earning a regular salary. Include columns for Category (Rent, Groceries, Transport, Utilities, Entertainment, Savings, Other), Planned amount, Actual amount, and Difference. Add 2 example rows per category. Keep it under 20 rows total."

You'll know it worked when the AI replies with a clearly formatted table — or a downloadable file link.

Step 3 — Check what the AI produced

Read the reply slowly. You'll usually see one of three things: (a) a neat table with rows and columns inside the chat, (b) a downloadable spreadsheet file, or (c) plain text describing the layout. Look for sensible categories (housing, food, transport, savings), clear column headers, and at least one mention of a formula — typically a "Difference" or "Total" column that subtracts one number from another. If the response feels too complex (mentions macros, pivot tables, or technical jargon), just reply asking for a simpler version. If the AI gave you plain text instead of a table, ask it to "format that as a table" in the same chat — it usually complies in one reply. Don't worry if the numbers are placeholders; you'll swap them for your own in Step 6.

You'll know it worked when you can clearly see columns, rows, and at least one total or formula reference in the reply.

Step 4 — Open your spreadsheet app

Switch to (or open) your spreadsheet app: Excel on Windows, Numbers on Mac, or Google Sheets in any browser (sheets.new is the fastest way to start). You'll land on a blank grid — columns labeled A, B, C across the top, rows numbered 1, 2, 3 down the side. In Google Sheets, click the colorful "+" button to start a new blank spreadsheet. In Excel, choose "Blank workbook". If spreadsheets are new to you, know this: each little rectangle is called a "cell", and you click one to type into it. The cursor blinks in the top-left cell (A1), waiting for your first entry.

You'll know it worked when you see an empty grid of cells ready to receive your budget.

Step 5 — Copy the AI's table into your spreadsheet

If the AI gave you a downloadable file, click "Download" and open it in Excel or Google Sheets — it lands as a ready-to-edit spreadsheet, and you can skip straight to Step 6. If the AI gave you a table inside the chat, click the small "Copy" icon that appears when you hover over the table (or highlight the text manually, then press Ctrl+C on Windows or Cmd+C on Mac). Click cell A1 in your empty spreadsheet and paste with Ctrl+V or Cmd+V. The categories and column headers appear neatly in row 1, with example data filling the rows below. If the paste comes out as one

long paragraph instead of a grid, undo with Ctrl+Z and try Ctrl+Shift+V instead — most apps offer a "paste as plain text" option that cleans up the formatting.

You'll know it worked when the AI's budget rows are sitting in your spreadsheet, ready to edit.

Step 6 — Add your real numbers and a totals row

Click each cell in the "Actual" or "Amount" column and type your own real spending for the past month — rough estimates are fine if you don't have receipts handy. Then click an empty cell directly below your last row and type a label like "Total". In the cell next to it (one column to the right), type =SUM(B2:B10), replacing B2 and B10 with the first and last row numbers of your actual data. Press Enter, and that cell instantly shows the sum. If your spreadsheet puts amounts in column C or D instead, change the letter to match. If you see #REF! or #VALUE! instead of a number, double-check the formula and the range — usually one cell was empty or the letters don't line up with your data.

You'll know it worked when the Total cell shows a single dollar figure that updates automatically as you change any of the amounts above it.

Step 7 — Save the file and make it yours

Save your file: in Google Sheets, click the title at the top-left to rename it (it saves automatically); in Excel, press Ctrl+S. From here, you can add new categories by typing into new rows, duplicate the sheet for a new month (look for a small "+" at the bottom of the screen), or come back to the AI assistant for more formulas like =AVERAGE() to see your typical weekly grocery spend. Try one small change right now — edit a number and watch the Total update. That single moment is when spreadsheets start to feel less like a chore and more like a quiet little superpower.

You'll know it worked when you've saved a file with your name on it, full of your real numbers, and the totals update themselves whenever you change anything.

Common mistakes

- **Asking for "the best budget spreadsheet".** There's no universal best, and the AI may invent complex features you don't need. Stick to simple columns (Category, Planned, Actual, Difference) and add complexity later only if you genuinely want it.
- **Pasting a screenshot of the AI's table into your spreadsheet app.** Most apps treat images as pictures, not data — so the cells stay empty. Use copy-and-paste from the text table, or download the file the AI offers.
- **Trusting the AI's placeholder numbers as personal advice.** The example figures are made up to show structure, not to recommend how you should spend. Replace them

with your own real spending, and treat any rule-of-thumb percentages the AI mentions as a starting point rather than gospel.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** A 10-minute weekly glance at your "Actual" column tells you where your money actually goes — usually a few small surprises (daily coffees, ride-shares, app subscriptions) you can adjust without much pain.
- **For your business or work:** The same template scales to a side-project budget, a freelance invoice tracker, or a small team's monthly expenses — just rename the categories.
- **If you're just getting started:** Open one AI assistant, paste the prompt from Step 2, and download whatever it gives you. Don't try to perfect it. A rough budget you actually use beats a perfect one gathering dust in a folder.

Try it now

Open your favorite AI assistant right now, paste the prompt from Step 2, and download the spreadsheet it produces. Spend two minutes renaming one column to something that matters to you — "Coffee", "Rent", "Dog walk" — and you're already further along than most people ever get.

Decode Any Confusing Phone, Internet, or Medical Bill in 10 Minutes

7 steps · Read online

> **In short:** You don't need an accounting degree to question a bill. Copy the line items into any AI assistant, ask it to flag anything unusual, and use that short list to decide what to push back on. No app, no signup, no jargon.

Bills use jargon to make you give up and pay. This guide shows a calm way to read any bill with an AI as your second pair of eyes, so you pay only what you actually owe. It works for phone, internet, and medical statements alike, and you don't have to finish it in one sitting.

Before you start

- **One bill you want to understand** — paper, PDF, or a photo on your phone.
- **Any AI assistant in a browser or app** — ChatGPT, Claude, Gemini, Copilot, or another you already use. The free tier is enough.
- **About 10 minutes**, in one go or split across two short breaks.
- **A pen or note app** to mark up the line items as you go.

Step 1 — Find a quiet 10 minutes and put the bill in front of you

Sit down with the bill, your phone or laptop, and a piece of paper. Don't try to read it on the bus or while cooking — line items blur into each other when you're distracted. If the bill is paper, snap a clear photo so you have a digital copy to work with. If it's already a PDF in your email, open it on the same device you'll use for the AI assistant, so you can copy text straight from it.
💬 Example: a small note on your paper — "Today's goal: figure out what each line means and which ones look off." You'll know it worked when the bill is on screen, your AI tab is open next to it, and you've got a clear few minutes ahead.

Step 2 — Strip out personal details before you share anything

Before any line goes near an AI, remove identifying information — your full name, address, account number, payment card digits, and any claim or policy number. Scribble them out on paper, or cover them with rectangles in a free phone app. The AI only needs the line items, amounts, and dates. Personal details do not help and create unnecessary risk if a screenshot ever ends up in the wrong place. 💬 Example: keep visible — "$84.50 — Base Plan — Sept 3 to Oct 2". Black out everything else. You'll know it worked when the version you're about to share looks like a generic sample, with no name or number pointing back to you.

Step 3 — Paste the bill and ask one focused question

Copy the cleaned-up line items and paste them into your AI assistant. Then ask one specific question, not five. The best request is short and direct: "Look at these charges. Which ones look unusual, and what should I ask the company about each one?" That single sentence turns the assistant into a checklist-maker instead of a general explainer. If your first try produces a wall of text, reply "shorten to a bulleted list under 200 words" and it will reset. 💬 Example prompt to copy: "Here are the line items from my phone bill. For each charge, tell me: (1) what it usually means, (2) whether it's normal or worth questioning, (3) one question I should ask the provider." You'll know it worked when the assistant gives you a list where each charge has a small label — like "normal," "worth asking," or "likely duplicate."

Step 4 — Read the response like a checklist, not a verdict

The AI's reply is a starting point, not a final answer. Treat each line like a Post-it note: green means "I understand this and it matches my plan," yellow means "I want a human to explain it," and red means "I want this removed or credited." Don't argue with the bill yet — your only job here is to mark each charge. If the assistant flags something it can't identify, write "?" and move on; the next step is where you check those yourself. 💬 Example: mark "monthly plan $40" green, "regulatory fee $3.20" yellow (you don't know if it's accurate), and "international roaming $27" red (you didn't travel). You'll know it worked when you can count the yellow and red marks on one hand and feel ready to look them up.

Step 5 — Double-check the suspicious lines with the company itself

For every yellow or red mark, search the provider's official help pages for the exact phrase. Type the term in quotes — for example, `"universal service fund"` or `"device installment"` — and read the company's own definition. This second pass protects you from a confident-but-wrong AI answer. Most bills also have a phone number, chat, or "contact us" page; note the one you'll use so it's ready when you need it. 💬 Example search: type `"administrative fee"` plus the company's name into your browser to see how they explain the charge in their own words. You'll know it worked when every red and yellow line has either a clear explanation in your own words or a one-sentence question written next to it.

Step 6 — Send one short, polite message with a single focused question

Now write to the company. Keep it short, polite, and focused on one line item per message — not the whole bill. Front-load the question: "I'm reviewing my October bill and noticed a $27 charge labeled 'international roaming' for dates I didn't travel. Can you confirm what triggered this and which dates it covers?" Include the bill date and exact amount. If they answer clearly, decide whether to accept it, ask for a credit, or escalate. 💬 Example message you can adapt: "Hi, on

bill dated 3 October, line 'Equipment Fee — $12.00' appeared for the first time. I don't recall being notified about a new charge. Can you explain what this covers and the start date? Thank you." You'll know it worked when you get a specific answer — not a copy-paste paragraph — that either makes sense or gives you grounds to escalate.

Step 7 — Decide your next move based on what they say

If the answer resolves it, mark it green and move to the next yellow. If it's a copy-paste non-answer, reply once more asking for a specific date or reference number. If the charge turns out to be wrong, ask politely for written confirmation of the credit and how it will appear on your next bill. For medical bills especially, many regions have a patient advocate or billing hotline whose job is to translate line items. Save your email thread in case you need it later. 💬 Example closing reply — "Thanks. Could you confirm the credit amount in writing and the date it will appear on my next statement?" You'll know it worked when every flagged line is now green, yellow (waiting on the company), or removed — and you have a paper trail for each.

Common mistakes

- **Pasting a bill with your name, address, or account number still visible.** The fix: redact first, always. The AI only needs the line items and amounts to do this job.
- **Asking the AI ten questions at once.** The fix: one focused thing, then a follow-up. Shorter prompts give shorter, more useful answers.
- **Treating the AI's answer as proof of a billing error.** The fix: check the company's own help pages or a previous bill before you push back. The assistant can misread a code as a charge.
- **Sending a long, angry email with every yellow line at once.** The fix: one focused question per email gets a real answer; a wall of complaints gets a template.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** any time a bill arrives — phone, internet, streaming, utilities, medical — you can run it through this 10-minute routine and decide what to question, instead of paying on autopilot.
- **For your business or work:** the same habit works for vendor invoices, software subscriptions, and freelancer contracts. The AI is a triage nurse, not a doctor; the human on the other end still confirms.
- **If you're just getting started:** start with the bill that's been bugging you the longest. Even if you only save a small amount, the next bill will feel easier to read.

Try it now

Grab the most recent bill sitting on your kitchen counter, snap a photo, scribble out your name and account number, and paste the line items into any AI assistant with the prompt from Step 3. Ten minutes from now, you'll have a checklist — and a clearer head.

How to read and summarize a long lease or insurance policy with Gemini

6 steps · Read online

> **In short:** You can upload a long lease or insurance PDF to Google Gemini and ask for a plain-English summary that highlights the clauses you actually need to read before signing. The free version handles most everyday documents, and you don't need any technical skill.

A 40-page lease or a 25-page insurance policy is the kind of thing most people skim, sign, and regret later. Gemini can read the whole document for you, pull out the parts that cost money or restrict what you can do, and explain the legal-sounding words in everyday language. This guide walks through that process step by step, whether you're moving into a new apartment, choosing a health plan, or reviewing a contract your employer sent over. Gemini can give you a strong first pass — but remember, it's not a lawyer, and for big decisions the original document still matters.

Before you start

- **A Google account.** If you use Gmail or YouTube, you already have one.
- **A browser or the Gemini app.** On a computer, open any web browser. On a phone, install the Gemini app from your app store if you don't have it yet.
- **The PDF file.** Save the lease or insurance document to your phone or computer so you can find it quickly. If it's a paper document, scan it to PDF first — most phone camera apps can do this.
- **About 10 to 15 minutes.** That's all it takes to go from a confusing PDF to a clear summary.
- **Free or paid plan.** The free version of Gemini handles most everyday documents well. Some advanced features — like reading very long files or uploading many files at once — may require a paid plan; Gemini will tell you if it hits a limit.

Step 1 — Open Gemini and start a fresh chat

In your browser, go to **gemini.google.com** and sign in with your Google account if prompted. If you're on a phone, open the **Gemini app** instead. You'll see a clean chat window with a message box near the bottom and your Google profile picture in the corner. Click or tap inside the message box so the cursor blinks — that's how you know you're ready to type. Starting a new chat, rather than reopening an old one, keeps the document summary focused and easier to find later.

*If you don't see a chat box, look for a button labeled **"New chat"** or a **pencil icon** somewhere on the page.*

You'll know it worked when you see an empty message box with a blinking cursor, and your Google account name or avatar visible somewhere on screen.

Step 2 — Upload your PDF

Next to the message box, look for an icon that looks like a **paperclip**, a **"+"**, or the words **"Upload"** or **"Files"**. Click or tap it. A file picker will open — the same window you use to attach files to an email. Navigate to wherever you saved the PDF (your Downloads folder, Files app, or Google Drive), select the lease or insurance document, and confirm. The file will start uploading, which usually takes a few seconds for a normal-sized PDF. When it's done, you'll see the file name appear in the chat as a small chip or attachment.

*If the icon names don't match, try the **"+" or plus button** — most chat interfaces tuck uploads there.*

You'll know it worked when the filename shows up in the conversation as an attachment and the message box is ready for your first question.

Step 3 — Ask for a plain-English summary

Now type your first message. Be specific about what you want — vague prompts give vague answers. Ask Gemini to summarize the document in everyday words, and tell it which topics matter to you (money, rules, deadlines, restrictions). Press **Enter** or tap **Send**. Gemini will read through the PDF and write back a structured response. Don't worry if it takes 10–20 seconds — that's normal for long documents. Read the summary carefully, but remember it's a starting point, not the final word on what the contract means.

Example: *"Please summarize this lease in plain English. I want to know what I have to pay each month, what I'm not allowed to do, what happens if I break the rules, and how I can end the lease."*

You'll know it worked when Gemini returns a summary that mentions specific dollar amounts, dates, or rules from your document — not generic advice about leases in general.

Step 4 — Ask Gemini to flag the high-stakes clauses

A summary is useful, but the real value is knowing which sections could cost you the most money or get you in trouble. Send a second message asking Gemini to point out the parts you should read closely. The clearer you are about what "high-stakes" means to you (money?

termination? liability? privacy?), the more useful the list will be. If the list feels too long, ask Gemini to rank the top three so you don't have to chase every detail.

Example: *"Which clauses in this document could cost me the most money or cause the biggest problems if something goes wrong? List them and quote the key sentence from each one if you can."*

You'll know it worked when you see specific clause names, dollar amounts, or quoted phrases from your actual document — not generic warnings about "all contracts".

Step 5 — Ask follow-up questions about any confusing term

If a clause still doesn't make sense, copy a sentence from it and ask Gemini to explain it like you're twelve years old. This is the part most people skip, and it's often the most valuable — a single confusing phrase ("indemnify and hold harmless," "actual cash value," "joint and several liability") can hide thousands of dollars in real-world consequences. If Gemini's explanation still feels too formal, ask again in simpler words. You can keep asking as many follow-ups as you want in the same chat.

Example: *"What does 'indemnify and hold harmless' mean in everyday language? And does this clause apply to me as the renter, or only to the landlord?"*

You'll know it worked when you can explain the term to a friend in one short sentence, in your own words.

Step 6 — Save the summary somewhere you can find it

Once you have a summary and a list of important clauses worth re-reading, copy the key parts into a notes app, an email to yourself, or a simple document. Don't rely on the Gemini chat history alone — those conversations can be hard to find weeks later, and uploads sometimes expire. A short note with the date, the document name, the three biggest risks, and any open questions you still have is usually enough. If you sign the document, attach or link your notes so future-you knows what you agreed to.

If you'd rather skip the copy-paste, take a screenshot of the summary and save it to your phone. It's not searchable later, but it's better than nothing.

You'll know it worked when you can open your notes app right now and see, at a glance, the three most important things you learned from the document.

Common mistakes

- **Asking "summarize this" with no direction.** Gemini will give you a generic overview that misses what you actually care about. Tell it which topics matter: money, deadlines, restrictions, termination, who pays for what.
- **Treating the summary as the final answer.** Gemini is a starting point, not a lawyer or insurance advisor. For big decisions — a house, a surgery, a long business contract — re-read the original document or talk to a professional before you sign.
- **Uploading a scanned image instead of a real PDF.** If your document is just photos of pages, Gemini may not be able to read the text inside. Open the file and try to select a sentence; if you can't highlight any words, it's an image scan, not a text PDF, and you'll need a higher-quality scan with selectable text.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** Before you sign a lease, an insurance renewal, or a phone plan, you can spend ten minutes with Gemini and walk away knowing what you're actually agreeing to — instead of finding out the hard way when a fee shows up.
- **For your business or work:** Vendor contracts, freelance agreements, and client terms of service are exactly the kind of long PDFs that benefit from a quick AI pass before you forward them to legal or a partner.
- **If you're just getting started:** Pick one document you already have sitting in your email — a recent subscription, an old lease, even a saved terms-of-service page — and run it through Steps 1 to 3 today. Ten minutes, one real document, no risk.

Try it now

Open gemini.google.com (or the Gemini app), upload any PDF you already have — even an old utility bill or a saved terms-of-service page — and ask for a plain-English summary in the next two minutes. You'll know the whole flow works when you see your first AI-written summary of a real document, and you can scroll back through the conversation to find it again.

How to Set Reminders with Alexa on Your Echo for Bills, Birthdays and Errands

6 steps · Read online

> **In short:** You can ask your Echo to remind you of bills, birthdays and errands by saying a task, a day and a time, then check and cancel those reminders later. Reminders only ring if your Echo is online, and the exact features may vary with your Alexa+ access and region.

This guide shows you how to build reminders that repeat, add a heads-up before a big date, and confirm or cancel them when plans change. It's for people who already talk to Alexa on an Echo speaker and want their reminders to work for the rest of the month and year, not just for the next hour.

Before you start

- An Amazon account, and an Echo device linked to it, with Alexa already answering your voice.
- The Alexa app on your phone, signed in to the same account. You'll use it to review your reminders.
- Alexa+ access. Availability can vary, and it may depend on your region or on a paid plan, so check Amazon's official Alexa+ page for current details.
- About 15 minutes. You already know how to start a conversation, so we'll skip straight to reminders.

Step 1 — Set a reminder with a task, a day and a time

Say the wake word, then speak one complete sentence that names the task, the day and the time. Speak clearly and pause for a second when you finish. Your Echo's light ring usually lights up to show it's listening. Once it understands you, Alexa replies by voice and the reminder is saved to your account, so it will fire on that day at that time. If the reminder doesn't appear in the Alexa app later, the sentence may have been misheard; try again with fewer words. If your Echo doesn't respond at all, check that it's connected to Wi-Fi and that the mute button isn't on.

💬 Example: "Remind me to call my mom on [day of the week] at [time]."

You'll know it worked when Alexa confirms the reminder out loud and you can see it in the Alexa app's reminders list.

Step 2 — Make a bill reminder that repeats

Bills come back every month, so the reminder should repeat too. Say the task, the amount of days you want, and the word "every." Alexa's wording for repeating items can differ slightly between versions, so if it asks a follow-up question, answer it with a short phrase like the day of the month. This is the basic repeat pattern: a task, a frequency, and a time. Remember that a reminder is only a nudge; it doesn't pay the bill for you, and it can't see your bank balance. Keep your payment schedule in your own bank or service app.

Example: "Remind me to pay the [utility company] bill every month on the [day number] at [time]."

You'll know it worked when Alexa repeats back the monthly schedule and the reminder shows a repeat in the Alexa app.

Step 3 — Add an early heads-up for a birthday

A birthday reminder is more useful when it arrives a day early, so you have time to buy a card. Say both moments in one sentence: the birthday date and the earlier reminder. Alexa may create two separate reminders, or one reminder with a lead time, depending on how it parses your words. Either way is fine, as long as you check both in the next step. If Alexa only sets one reminder, say a second sentence that starts with "remind me" and names the earlier day.

Example: "Remind me that [person's name] has a birthday on [month and day], and remind me one day before at [time]."

You'll know it worked when Alexa confirms the birthday reminder and the earlier one appears as a separate entry in the reminders list.

Step 4 — Check every reminder in the Alexa app

Open the Alexa app on your phone and look for a reminders section. It's often in a menu or under a tab labeled something like "More" or a calendar-style icon, but menu names change, so search the app for the word "reminders" if you can't find it quickly. Scroll through the list and compare each entry to what you meant. Check the task, the day, the time and whether it repeats. If something is missing, say it again to your Echo. If a reminder is wrong, don't worry; the next steps show you how to fix it.

Example: "Show me all of my reminders for this week."

You'll know it worked when you can read each reminder in the app and match it to what you asked for.

Step 5 — Change a reminder when plans shift

Plans change, so reminders need to change too. Say what you want to move, the old time and the new time. Alexa should confirm the change out loud. Many people find it easier to make the change in a single sentence rather than canceling and rebuilding. If Alexa asks which reminder you mean, answer with the task name, because it may hear two similar items.

- Example: "Move my reminder to [task name] from [old time] to [new time]."

You'll know it worked when the reminder's time in the Alexa app matches your new time.

Step 6 — Cancel a reminder you no longer need

When an errand is done or a bill has been paid for good, cancel the reminder so it doesn't ring again. Say the task name and ask Alexa to cancel it. For a repeating reminder, Alexa may ask whether you want to cancel just the next one or the whole series, so answer clearly. You can also delete it in the Alexa app's reminders list. If the reminder still rings after you cancel it, close the app, reopen it, and check the list again. Sometimes the app needs a refresh before the change shows up.

- Example: "Cancel my reminder to [task name]."

You'll know it worked when the reminder is gone from the Alexa app's list and Alexa confirms the cancellation.

Common mistakes

- **Mistake: saying the task without a day or time.** Alexa may set a vague reminder or ask a question. *Fix:* always end your sentence with a day and a clock time, like "on Friday at 9 a.m."
- **Mistake: canceling only the next repeat when you meant the whole series.** The bill keeps reminding you forever. *Fix:* when Alexa asks which one you mean, say "all of them" or "the whole series," then check the app.
- **Mistake: assuming Alexa pays bills or tracks deadlines for you.** A reminder is only a nudge, and Alexa can't see your bank account. *Fix:* pay the bill in your bank or service's own app, and use the reminder as a prompt to do it.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** A reminder for the monthly water or internet bill, plus an early heads-up for a family birthday, can save you a late fee and a last-minute gift scramble.
- **For your business or work:** Repeating reminders for weekly errands like supply pickups or a recurring call can keep small tasks from slipping, as long as you check the Alexa app once in a while.

- **If you want to go further:** Try grouping related reminders with a shared phrase, like "errands," so you can ask for the whole group at once. This tests whether Alexa keeps the group together. Check the results before you rely on it.

Try it now

Pick one real errand you have this week. Say your Echo a single sentence that includes the task, the day and the time, for example: "Remind me to pick up [item] on [day] at [time]." Then open the Alexa app and check that it appears in your reminders list.

How to Decode a Confusing Medical Bill with AI

5 steps · Read online

> **In short:** Paste an itemized medical bill or insurance statement into any AI assistant and ask it to translate the jargon, list every charge, and flag anything that looks off — in plain English. The AI explains; it cannot dispute a bill or make medical decisions.

A medical bill arrives in the mail, or an Explanation of Benefits (EOB) shows up in your insurer's portal, and within five lines you've hit "CPT 99213", "allowed amount", and a number that doesn't match what you expected to pay. This guide walks you through using an AI assistant to turn that wall of codes and figures into a plain-English breakdown you can actually read — no medical or insurance background needed.

Before you start

- **The document itself**: an itemized medical bill, an EOB from your insurer, or both. Paper, PDF, or a photo on your phone all work.
- **An AI assistant**: any major one will do — ChatGPT, Gemini, Claude, Copilot, Le Chat, or DeepSeek. Free versions are usually enough for a single bill; longer documents may need a paid plan with a bigger context window (the amount of text the AI can read at one time).
- **A second screen is helpful but optional**: phone for the bill, laptop for the AI, or two browser tabs side by side.
- **About 15 minutes** for your first bill. You'll get faster on the second one.
- **Important limit**: AI can explain what a charge means. It cannot file an appeal, call your insurer, or tell you whether a procedure was medically necessary. Treat its output as a translation, not a verdict.

Step 1 — Make the bill digital

If your bill is on paper, you need it as text the AI can read. Open any free scanning app on your phone — most phones have one built in (look in your camera or notes app for a "scan document" option). Lay the bill flat, line up the corners in the camera frame, and snap. The app saves it as a PDF with selectable text. Already have a PDF in email or your insurer's portal? Just download it to your phone or computer. **If it looks different**: if you don't see a built-in scanner, search your app store for "free document scanner" — any top result works fine. You can also type the charges out by hand, though that's slower. Example: "Scan the front and back of the bill into one PDF named 'bill-jan2026.pdf'." You'll know it worked when the bill opens on your screen and you can highlight the words with your cursor — or, on a phone, long-press a word and see it selected.

Step 2 — Strip out personal details

Before you paste anything into an AI, take 60 seconds to remove identifying numbers. On a paper bill, use a marker or your finger to cover your full Social Security Number, member ID, and any bank or card numbers. On a PDF, print and mark it up, or copy the body text into a notes app and delete those numbers by hand. **If it looks different**: a quick rule of thumb — leave your name and the provider's name (the AI needs them for context), but remove any number that looks like an account, policy, or government ID. Some bills also print diagnosis codes that are very specific to your health; if that makes you uneasy, swap them for a generic description like "knee injury" before pasting. Example: "Black out my SSN, member ID, and the last four digits of my card before pasting." You'll know it worked when a stranger could read the document and follow it, but no one could use it to impersonate you or pull up your records.

Step 3 — Paste it in and ask for a plain-English summary

Open your AI assistant in a browser or app and start a new conversation. Paste the cleaned-up bill or EOB into the message field near the bottom of the screen. The message field is often labeled something like "Message" or "Ask anything," though your app may use different words — look for the long text box with a blinking cursor, just above or beside a send button. Ask the AI to explain it, and keep your first prompt simple — one request, one paragraph. **If it looks different**: if the document is very long and the AI says it was cut off, split it into two messages — first half in one prompt, second half in the next — and tell it to combine the analysis. Example: "Here's my itemized bill from a clinic visit. In plain English, please list every charge, what each one was for, what my insurance paid, and what I still owe. Flag anything that looks unusual." You'll know it worked when the AI gives you a structured answer — usually a short list of charges in everyday language, followed by a total or a clear note that it couldn't calculate one.

Step 4 — Ask follow-up questions about specific terms

Now zoom in. Pick any line you don't understand — a procedure code, a phrase like "allowed amount" or "patient responsibility", a charge that surprises you — and ask the AI about it. This is where the chat format really helps: you don't have to ask everything at once. **If it looks different**: if the AI's reply is too generic, paste the exact line back and ask about that one item only. Still vague? Try rephrasing — instead of "explain this", try "in one sentence, what does a 99213 CPT code usually mean, and roughly how much does it cost without insurance?" And if every line on the bill actually looks clear to you already, still ask the AI to flag any codes or charges it thinks are worth questioning — a fresh pair of eyes often catches something you skimmed past. Example: "On line 4 it says 'CPT 99213, allowed amount $84.20, patient owes $25'. What is a 99213, what does 'allowed amount' mean, and why is the patient share $25?" You'll know it worked when the AI names the procedure in plain words, explains each money

term, and tells you roughly how the numbers relate — usually with a note that exact prices vary by region and plan.

Step 5 — Sanity-check the totals and spot anything odd

Before you trust any of this, do your own quick math. The AI is good at explaining, but it can mis-add numbers or invent a percentage that wasn't in the original. Open your bill or EOB in another tab, grab a calculator (your phone has one), and add the charges yourself. Compare that to the AI's total. **If it looks different**: if the totals don't match, paste the raw lines back and ask it to re-add — most assistants catch their mistake on the second try. If the gap is large, treat the bill, not the AI, as the source of truth, and call the number on the bill to ask about it.
Example: "Please re-add every line on this bill and confirm the total. I'm getting $342.10 when I add it by hand but your last answer said $298.50." You'll know it worked when either the AI corrects itself and the new total matches yours, or it points to a specific line it had missed — and you've decided what to do with the gap.

Common mistakes

- **Pasting a bill with sensitive numbers still in it.** Even well-known assistants log conversations to improve their models. Strip SSNs, member IDs, and card digits first — Step 2 takes a minute and prevents a much bigger headache later.
- **Treating the AI's "this looks normal" as proof.** AI assistants can sound confident even when they're guessing. Use their output as a starting point, then confirm any big charge by calling the provider's billing line — the number is almost always at the top of the statement.
- **Asking the AI whether a charge is fair.** That's a judgment call that depends on your plan, your region, and the specific service. The AI can explain what a code is; only your insurer can tell you whether it should have been covered. For disputes, start with the provider's billing department, and if you want formal help, contact your state or country's insurance ombudsman.
- **Uploading a blurry photo of the bill.** If the AI keeps saying "I can't read this", re-scan in good light with the page flat. Bad input always produces bad output.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** the next time a confusing statement shows up, you'll spend 15 minutes instead of an afternoon figuring out what you actually owe — and you'll know exactly which line to call about if something looks wrong.
- **For your business or work:** if you run a small team, you can use the same workflow to help employees decode their first bills after a new benefits plan kicks in. It won't replace HR, but it cuts down on "what does this mean?" emails.

- **If you're just getting started:** try it first on an old, already-paid bill you no longer need to act on. You'll learn how the assistant responds without any pressure — and you'll have a much easier time when a real, current bill arrives.

Try it now

Pick any old medical bill or EOB you can find — even one you already paid. Strip the sensitive numbers, paste the rest into your favorite AI assistant, and ask: "Explain every line in plain English and tell me what I might want to question." That single two-minute ask is the whole skill.

How to Read Through Insurance Policies and Bank Contracts with Claude

6 steps · Read online

> **In short:** Paste any insurance policy, loan agreement, or bank contract into Claude and ask for a plain-English summary. Claude will flag hidden fees, exclusions, and tricky clauses — but it cannot replace a lawyer, and very long documents may need to be split into parts.

Insurance policies and bank contracts are written in a style called *legalese* — language that sounds official but is designed to be hard to read. A 30-page home insurance PDF often hides the answer to "am I actually covered if my pipe bursts?" in paragraph 47. Claude can read that whole document in seconds and explain it like a friend would over coffee. Here's how to use it without losing the details that matter.

Before you start

- A free Claude account at **claude.com** (the free plan is enough for short documents; very long contracts may need a paid plan with a bigger file upload).
- The contract or policy you want to read — either as a PDF file on your device, or as text you can copy from your email.
- About 10–15 minutes for your first try.
- A quiet moment. You'll want to actually read Claude's summary, not just skim it.

Step 1 — Open a fresh chat with Claude

Go to **claude.com** and log in. Click **"New chat"** at the top-left of the screen. A blank conversation box opens. Starting fresh matters because Claude remembers the previous conversation — and you don't want yesterday's homework question mixed up with today's insurance policy. If you're on the phone app, tap the **pencil or "New chat" icon** instead; if you can't find it, look for a button like **"Start new conversation"**. 💬 Example: there is nothing to type yet — just open the chat. You'll know it worked when you see an empty message box with a **paperclip icon** (for attaching files) and a **send arrow**.

Step 2 — Attach the document (or paste the text)

Click the **paperclip icon** 📎 to the left of the message box, then choose your file (PDF, Word, or a photo of a printed page usually works). If your contract is already open in another window, you can also simply copy the text — **Ctrl+C** on Windows or ⌘+**C** on Mac — and paste it straight into the chat box with **Ctrl+V** or ⌘+**V**. After you attach or paste, you'll see a small file thumbnail or a chunk of text appear in the box. If you don't see a paperclip, look for a **"+"**

button or an **upload icon** instead — apps change the icon from time to time. 💬 Example: a PDF named `home-insurance-2026.pdf` shows up as a thumbnail before you send. You'll know it worked when Claude replies that it has read the document and is ready for your question.

Step 3 — Ask for a plain-English summary first

Before asking tricky questions, ask Claude to give you the basics. A good first prompt tells Claude who you are and what kind of document it is. Type a short message in the box, then press **Enter** or tap the **send arrow**. Claude will write a multi-paragraph reply covering the main points. If the reply is too short or too long, follow up with "Can you go deeper on the parts a normal person would care about?" 💬 Example: "I'm a homeowner, not a lawyer. Please summarize this home insurance policy in plain English. Cover: what am I covered for, what am I NOT covered for, my deductible, and anything that could void my coverage. Keep it under 400 words." You'll know it worked when Claude's reply lists the key sections in everyday language, with no big unexplained words.

Step 4 — Ask Claude to flag the "gotcha" clauses

Now for the part that saves real money. Many contracts include clauses (sentences or whole sections) that limit what the company has to pay you — things like "we only cover damage from sudden events, not gradual wear." Type a follow-up question in the same chat. Claude uses what it already read, so you don't need to re-upload anything. If the reply feels vague, add "Give me at least five specific examples." 💬 Example: "Now read it again like a skeptical friend. List every clause that could limit my payout or surprise me. For each one, quote the original wording, then explain what it actually means in plain English." You'll know it worked when Claude gives you a bulleted list with both the original sentence and a plain translation — those are the spots to read twice in the real document.

Step 5 — Compare two offers side by side (optional but powerful)

If you're choosing between two insurance quotes or loan offers, open a second chat (back to **"New chat"**) and upload both documents — or paste both into the same chat one after the other. Then ask Claude to compare them on the points that matter to you. Claude reads both files in seconds and builds a comparison. Be specific about what you want to compare, because "which is better?" is too vague to answer well. 💬 Example: "I've pasted two home loan offers below. Compare them on: total interest paid over 5 years, early-repayment penalties, fixed vs variable rate, and any hidden fees. Show your work in a simple table." You'll know it worked when Claude produces a clean table or side-by-side list — and you can spot the better deal in about a minute.

Step 6 — Save the summary where you'll actually find it

Claude's replies disappear if you lose the browser tab. Before you close the chat, copy the most useful reply (the summary, the gotcha list, or the comparison) into a notes app, email it to yourself, or take a screenshot. On a computer, click and drag to highlight the reply, then **Ctrl+C** / ⌘**+C**. On a phone, long-press the text and choose **"Copy"** or **"Share"**. Saving this now means you don't have to ask Claude again six months later when you actually need the info. 💬 Example: paste into a note titled `home-insurance-summary-2026` so future-you can find it. You'll know it worked when you can close Claude, reopen your notes app, and see the summary waiting for you.

Common mistakes

- **Pasting only the first page.** Insurance policies often hide the most important exclusions near the end. If the file is long, upload the whole PDF instead of copying a paragraph.
- **Trusting the summary without checking the originals.** Claude is helpful, but it can occasionally miss a clause or misread a number. Always open the real document and confirm any decision that affects money or coverage.
- **Asking vague questions like "is this a good deal?"** Claude needs specifics to compare well. Name the criteria (fees, interest rate, coverage limits, cancellation terms) so the answer is useful.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** Reading a car insurance renewal no longer means an hour of squinting. Ten minutes with Claude gets you the parts that matter before you sign.
- **For your business or work:** Comparing supplier contracts or client terms of service becomes a 15-minute task instead of an afternoon — useful for freelancers and small-business owners who don't have legal staff on call.
- **If you're just getting started:** Pick one document you've been meaning to read — a bank fee schedule, a phone plan, an old insurance renewal — and run it through Steps 2 and 3 today. The habit starts there.

Try it now

Find one PDF or email attachment from your bank, insurer, or phone company that you've been avoiding. Open a new Claude chat, upload it, and paste this prompt: *"I'm not a lawyer. Summarize this in plain English, then list the three things in here that could cost me money if I don't know about them."* Read the reply once, then decide whether the document deserves a closer look — that one minute of friction-free reading is the whole point.

Home & family

Plan a Family Weekend Getaway with DeepSeek: A Step-by-Step Guide

7 steps · Read online

> **In short:** DeepSeek can draft a full weekend itinerary for your family — kid-friendly activities, meal stops, rough travel times — in under five minutes. It does the brainstorming and structuring; you still book the hotels, tickets and restaurants yourself.

Picture this: it's a Wednesday evening, the kids are finally asleep, and you're trying to figure out where to go this Saturday and Sunday. DeepSeek — the free AI chatbot from the Chinese AI lab DeepSeek — can act like a brainstorming travel buddy. Tell it who is coming, where you're starting from, and how much you want to spend, and it returns a tidy day-by-day plan you can actually use.

Before you start

- A free DeepSeek account (sign up at deepseek.com with an email address — no payment needed for the chat feature).
- The DeepSeek mobile app, or any web browser on a phone or computer.
- About 15–20 minutes, mostly waiting for the AI to type.
- Optional but useful: a notes app on your phone (Apple Notes, Google Keep, etc.) so you can save the final plan.

Step 1 — Open DeepSeek and start a new chat

Open the DeepSeek app or go to **deepseek.com** in your browser. Sign in with the account you just created. You'll see a clean chat screen with a text box at the bottom — it's intentionally simple, looking similar to most messaging apps. Tap that text box once, and your keyboard slides up, ready for typing. If you've used DeepSeek before, look for a small **"New Chat"** icon (often a pencil or plus sign) at the top of the screen so you start with a blank conversation. Starting fresh matters — the AI will remember earlier messages in the same chat and may get confused by leftovers from old trips.

💬 Example: just type the word **"Hi"** for now to make sure the box works.

You'll know it worked when a response starts streaming in within a few seconds.

Step 2 — Tell DeepSeek the basics of your trip

In the chat box, write a short paragraph that names the essentials: who's going, where you're starting from, the weekend dates, and what kind of trip you want (relaxing, active, food-focused,

somewhere new). The more concrete you are here, the better the plan will be. Press **Enter** or tap the send arrow. DeepSeek usually replies in a few seconds — it does not browse the live web for this kind of question, so it won't know current hotel prices, but it will use its general knowledge of cities, neighborhoods and family activities. Think of this message like giving a friend the brief before they make suggestions.

Example: *"We're a family of four — two adults, a 7-year-old and a 10-year-old — based in Chicago. We want to drive somewhere within 3 hours for the weekend of 14–15 June. We love outdoorsy stuff and kid-friendly museums. Budget is medium."*

You'll know it worked when DeepSeek writes back with one or two clarifying questions or an early outline of ideas.

Step 3 — Ask for a day-by-day itinerary

Now ask for the structured plan you actually came for. Be specific that you want a **day-by-day** schedule, **kid-friendly** activities, and **rough travel times** between stops. Press send and let it write. You'll see the answer appear paragraph by paragraph — the response can be quite long for this kind of request, so give it a moment to finish. If the answer is heading the wrong direction (too many hikes, only adult restaurants), you don't need to start over — just tell it what to change in the next step. If you ever want a shorter summary, type "summarize that" and it will condense the plan into a few lines.

Example: *"Please make a day-by-day itinerary for Saturday and Sunday. For each day, give me morning, midday and afternoon activities that work for kids aged 7 and 10. Add rough drive times between stops."*

You'll know it worked when you see a clearly labeled "Saturday" and "Sunday" section with specific times or blocks.

Step 4 — Add meals, budget notes and a backup plan

The first plan is usually solid but a bit bare on food and money. Send a follow-up message in the same chat asking for restaurant suggestions that welcome kids, an estimated cost for the day, and a simple rainy-day backup. DeepSeek keeps the whole conversation in mind, so it builds on what it just suggested. Watch for the reply to come in the same chat window — no need to refresh or start a new thread. If it suggests a fancy tasting-menu place, just say "make meals more casual, kid menus only" and it will revise. This step turns a generic plan into one that fits your actual family instead of an imagined one.

Example: *"Add lunch and dinner suggestions for each day — nothing too fancy, kids need to see familiar food on the menu. Estimate the total daily cost for our family of four, and give me*

a backup indoor plan in case it rains."

You'll know it worked when the new reply includes named restaurants or food types, a rough dollar figure per day, and an alternative activity for each day.

Step 5 — Refine the plan with focused follow-ups

This is where DeepSeek really earns its keep: you can keep tweaking the same plan without starting over. Ask narrow questions like "is there a shorter drive option?" or "swap the museum for something more outdoorsy." Press send after each question and read the reply before sending the next one — the chat history stays short, so you don't have to scroll far. If the assistant suggests something you don't recognize (a town name, a small park, a museum), quickly search it on your phone to confirm it's real and open on your dates. AI sometimes invents place names that sound convincing but don't actually exist, especially for lesser-known spots.

Example: *"Swap the Sunday morning museum for an outdoor activity — the kids get restless indoors. Also, can you suggest a town within 2 hours of Chicago instead of 3?"*

You'll know it worked when the revised plan reflects every change you asked for, in the same chat thread, with no contradictions from earlier suggestions.

Step 6 — Save the plan outside the chat

Once the plan looks good, get it out of the chat window — old chats can disappear after app updates, and you don't want to lose your weekend to a glitch. Tap and hold inside the answer (on mobile) or highlight it (on desktop) and choose **Copy**. Then paste the whole thing into a notes app, a Google Doc, or your family's group chat. If the plan is very long, copy it in two parts to avoid truncation. Some versions of DeepSeek also show a small **share icon** near a message — that creates a link you can send to your partner. Either way, the goal is simple: by the end of this step, the plan lives somewhere you can read it on Saturday morning without opening the AI again.

Example: copy the final plan, then paste it into a new note titled **"Family weekend — 14/15 June"**.

You'll know it worked when you can open your notes app and read the full itinerary without going back to DeepSeek.

Step 7 — Check the key details before you go

DeepSeek can't book anything, see live prices, or know if a museum is closed for renovations — so the last step is yours. Spend ten minutes verifying the big things: opening hours for any ticketed attraction, the restaurant is still serving on those dates, drive times on Google Maps, and

the weather forecast. If something is closed or sold out, ask DeepSeek in the same chat for a swap ("the aquarium is closed Sunday, what else works for kids that age?"). This quick check is the difference between a smooth weekend and showing up at a locked gate with tired kids.

💬 Example: type *"Quick check — can you remind me of the backup plan for Sunday if it rains? I want it in one short list."*

You'll know it worked when you have a confirmed plan in your notes, real opening hours in your calendar, and a fallback ready in case anything changes on the day.

Common mistakes

- **Asking a question that's too vague.** "Plan me a trip" gets a generic answer that doesn't fit your family. Always include the family size, ages of kids, starting city, dates and budget in the first message.
- **Trusting every place name without checking.** DeepSeek knows a lot, but it can invent small museums or restaurants that sound real. Google each venue before you drive there, especially for places you've never heard of.
- **Forgetting to mention budget.** Without a budget signal, the plan may lean toward expensive tasting menus and pricey hotels. Say "low", "medium" or "high" up front, and add a number if you have one in mind — it changes the suggestions a lot.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** the same prompt style works for any weekend — birthday parties, day trips, visiting friends in another city. Once you have the rhythm, planning takes minutes instead of evenings.
- **For your business or work:** if you ever run team off-sites or client visits, you can paste the same brief and ask for a more grown-up version — swap "kids" for "teammates", "budget" for "company card", and the structure stays useful.
- **If you're just getting started:** the easiest first move is to ask DeepSeek for a one-day plan for *this* coming weekend, even if you don't take it. The practice of writing a clear brief is the actual skill — the trip is a bonus.

Try it now

Open DeepSeek, paste the exact prompt from Step 2 with your own city and dates, and see what it comes back with in under a minute. That's the whole skill: one good paragraph of context, and a useful plan follows.

How to plan a simple weekly meal prep with one AI-made grocery list

7 steps · Read online

> **In short:** In a short chat, you can get a five-day meal plan, one combined grocery list, and a prep checklist built for your household. The key limit: the assistant doesn't know what's in your fridge or what's on sale, so you must check its quantities and adjust them.

Meal prep means cooking some of your food ahead of time so weekday dinners and lunches take less effort. This guide is for anyone who already chats with an AI assistant and wants to turn that habit into a weekly routine. By the end, you'll have a plan, a single shopping list, and a prep checklist you can reuse every week.

Before you start

- **An AI chat assistant** you already use to send messages. Any chat tool works the same way for this method.
- **A notes app or a sheet of paper** to save your final plan and list.
- **About 30 to 40 minutes** for the first run. Later weeks take much less, because you'll reuse your template.
- **Your household details**: how many people eat, how much time you have to cook, and any foods nobody eats.

Step 1 — Write down your household's rules

Before you ask for any plan, collect the facts the assistant needs. Open a new chat and type your details in one message, in plain sentences. Include how many people you're feeding, how many nights you want prepped meals, how much cooking time you can spare on the prep day, and what is off limits (allergies, dislikes, foods your kids won't eat). Mention any equipment you have, like a slow cooker or only one large pan.

When you send the message, the assistant usually replies by restating your rules or asking a follow-up question. That confirms it understood. If it doesn't restate anything, your message may have been too long; split it into two messages.

💬 Example: "We are a household of [number] people. Plan five dinners for [number] nights. We have about [number] hours to cook on Sunday. No peanuts, and nobody likes mushrooms. We only have one oven and a slow cooker."

You'll know it worked when the assistant repeats your constraints back to you or asks a clarifying question about them.

Step 2 — Ask for a five-day plan

Now ask for the meal plan itself. Good plans repeat ingredients across days, because that keeps the shopping list short and reduces waste. Ask the assistant to reuse ingredients on purpose and to vary the flavors so you don't eat the same dish five times.

A common result is a list of five dinners with a short note about which ingredients appear more than once. If the plan includes foods you already said you avoid, reply with a correction, and it will usually revise the whole plan rather than just one line.

💬 Example: "Using the rules above, make a five-night dinner plan. Reuse at least two ingredients across the week, keep the cooking to one pot or one oven tray per night, and label which items are cooked on prep day versus cooked fresh."

You'll know it worked when you see five named dinners and a note showing which ingredients repeat.

Step 3 — Turn the plan into one grocery list

This is where a multi-step prompt pays off. Because the assistant can see the plan you just approved in the same chat, you don't need to paste it again. Ask it to convert the meals into one combined list, with quantities added up across all five dinners, grouped by store section (produce, meat, dairy, dry goods, and so on).

Tell it to subtract anything you already have. This is important: the assistant can't check your pantry, so it will only do this correctly if you list what's on hand. Expect the quantities to be estimates. Treat them as a starting point, not a guarantee.

💬 Example: "Make one grocery list for all five dinners. Add up the quantities, group items by store section, and leave out [pantry item] and [pantry item] since I already have them."

You'll know it worked when the list is grouped by section and each item appears once, with a combined amount.

Step 4 — Save a reusable template

The real time-saver is keeping the instructions you just wrote, so next week you can paste them in rather than start over. Copy your household rules and your best prompt into a note, and name the note something clear like "Weekly meal prep template." Update only the parts that change, such as the number of nights or any new dislikes.

Many chat tools also let you save reusable instructions or start a project for recurring work, but menus vary by app and change over time. If you don't see such a feature, a plain note works just as well, so use that.

💬 Example: "Meal prep template: household of [number] people, [number] dinners, [number] hours to cook on Sunday, no [food you avoid]. Plan dinners, reuse ingredients, then give one grouped grocery list."

You'll know it worked when you have a saved note you can copy and paste into a new chat in under a minute.

Step 5 — Create a Sunday prep checklist

A list of groceries doesn't tell you what to do first. Ask the assistant for a prep order that fits the time you actually have. Good checklists put long-cooking items first (like a roast or a pot of grains), then chopping, then cooling and storing. Ask it to estimate how long each block takes, then compare that to your real hours.

Ask it to add storage notes too: which containers to use, and which cooked foods should go in the fridge versus the freezer. For specific food-safety timing, check your local food-safety guidance, because the assistant may be wrong or out of date.

💬 Example: "Create a prep-day checklist for about [number] hours. Put long-cooking items first, then chopping, then cooling and storing. Show the estimated time for each step, and list which items go in the fridge and which go in the freezer."

You'll know it worked when you get a numbered checklist with time estimates that add up to roughly the hours you have.

Step 6 — Check the answer before you shop

Never trust a plan without a quick review. Read through the list and ask yourself three questions: Does each dinner fit the cooking time? Do the quantities look right for your household size? Are any allergy or dislike items hiding inside a sauce or a packaged ingredient?

If something is off, reply with a specific correction instead of starting over. The assistant usually keeps the rest of the plan and adjusts only what you flagged, though it may also change other lines, so recheck the full list.

💬 Example: "Dinner three uses a whole bunch of cilantro for [number] people. Please cut that to one small bunch and update the grocery list to match."

You'll know it worked when the revised list reflects your correction and nothing you already approved has disappeared.

Step 7 — Move the final list where you shop

Copy the finished grocery list into your notes app or a plain text message to yourself. Plain text is the safest format, because it pastes cleanly into most shopping apps. If the copy looks messy with extra symbols, delete them by hand. Keep the section headings so the list stays organized in the store.

Finally, put the prep checklist and the template note in the same folder, so next week's planning starts from one place.

💬 Example: "Reformat the final grocery list as plain text with one item per line, keeping the store-section headings."

You'll know it worked when your list is ready to paste into a shopping app or read from your phone in the store.

Common mistakes

- **Trusting the quantities blindly.** The assistant can't see your fridge, the store's stock, or package sizes. Fix this by reviewing amounts against what you actually buy, and by listing pantry items in Step 3.
- **Asking for everything in one giant message.** Long, tangled requests produce muddled plans. Fix this by working through the steps in order, one request at a time.
- **Skipping the check.** A plan can look polished and still include a food someone avoids. Fix this with the three questions in Step 6 before you shop.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** Plan one week of dinners in about 30 minutes on a weekend, then reuse your saved template each week to make it faster.
- **For your business or work:** If you cook for a team, a small office, or a daycare, the same method works. Change the household rules to match the number of servings and the kitchen you have.
- **If you want to go further:** Ask the assistant to build your template as a series of questions it asks you each week, so you only answer what changed. Test it once before you rely on it.

One honest limit: the assistant can draft the plan and the list, but it can't check your pantry, read store shelves, or buy anything for you. You still do the final review and the shopping.

Try it now

Open a new chat and send the household-rules message from Step 1, filling in your own numbers. Then ask for just the five-dinner plan. That's a complete first run, and you'll have something to build on next week.

Create a soothing bedtime story routine with Alexa

7 steps · Read online

Imagine tucking your child into bed and simply saying, “Alexa, start bedtime story.” In just a few minutes, you can set up a gentle routine that Alexa will read aloud each night, complete with a soothing voice and soft background sounds. Once it’s saved, you can use it every evening with a single voice command, creating a lovely ritual for your family.

Before you start

- An **Amazon account** (free).
- The **Alexa app** installed on your phone or tablet (free).
- A **device with Alexa** (like an Echo Dot, Echo Show, or similar).
- Access to a **bedtime story skill or content** (many free options are available; some specific premium content may require a paid subscription like Audible or Amazon Music Unlimited).
- Roughly **10-15 minutes** to set up.

Step 1 — Open the Alexa app and find Routines

First, open the **Alexa app** on your phone or tablet. When it loads, you’ll typically see the home screen with various cards and information. Look at the bottom of the screen for a navigation bar with several icons. Tap the icon that looks like **three horizontal lines** or a **square 'More' button** in the bottom-right corner. This will open a menu. On the next screen, find and tap the word **Routines**. Routines are like your personal scripts for Alexa, telling her to perform a series of actions based on a trigger.

If it looks different: If you don't see "More" or three lines, look for a 'Settings' gear icon, or a menu icon that looks like nine dots or a hamburger menu. The goal is to find the main menu where 'Routines' is listed.

💬 Example: Tap `More` → `Routines`.

You'll know it worked when you see a screen titled "Routines" with a large "Create Routine" or "Add a Routine" button.

Step 2 — Create and name your routine

Now you're on the Routines screen, tap the **+ Create Routine** or **Add a Routine** button. The app will then present you with options to build your new routine. The first thing to do is give it a simple, memorable name. Look for a field labeled "Enter routine name" or "Routine name." This name is just for you to keep your routines organized.

If it looks different: The button might be a plus (+) icon in the top-right corner, or simply "New Routine." Tap it to begin.

Example: Type `Bedtime Story` into the name field.

You'll know it worked when your chosen name appears in the designated field, and you see options to set "When this happens" and "Add action."

Step 3 — Set the voice command (trigger)

Next, you need to tell Alexa what phrase you'll say to start this routine. Under the section labeled **When this happens**, tap the + or **Add** button. From the list of trigger options, tap **Voice**. A new screen will appear where you can type your preferred phrase. This phrase is your "voice trigger" – the specific command Alexa will listen for to activate your routine. Keep it simple and easy to remember for everyone who might use it.

If it looks different: Instead of "Voice," you might see an option like "Phrase" or "Custom command." Select that to type your phrase.

Example: Type `start bedtime story`.

You'll know it worked when your chosen phrase is displayed under "When this happens" on the routine creation screen.

Step 4 — Add the bedtime story action

Now it's time to add the actual story. Under the **Add action** section, tap the + or **Add** button. You'll see a list of actions Alexa can perform. Since we want a story, we'll choose a content-playing option. Tap on **Skills** or **Music & Audio**. If you choose Skills, you can search for a specific bedtime story skill (many are free). If you choose Music & Audio, you can type "bedtime story" and Alexa will find suitable content from your linked services or free options. Select your preferred story source.

If it looks different: Look for categories like "Play," "Entertainment," or "Listen" if "Skills" or "Music & Audio" aren't immediately visible.

Example: Tap `Skills` → search for `bedtime stories` → select a skill like `Kids Bedtime Stories` and tap `Add`.

You'll know it worked when the selected story skill or music command appears in the list under "Add action."

Step 5 — Customize Alexa's voice for the routine

You can give your bedtime story a calm, consistent voice. While still on the routine setup screen, scroll down and look for an option called **Alexa's Voice** (or sometimes "Speaking Style" or just "Voice"). Tap on this to see the available voices. Choose one that sounds soothing, like "Matthew" or "Emma," or another voice if your app offers more options. This setting ensures Alexa uses this particular voice for all the speaking actions within this routine.

If it looks different: The option might be labeled "Choose Alexa's voice" or "Voice Settings" within the routine.

- Example: Tap `Alexa's Voice` and choose `Matthew`.

You'll know it worked when the name of the voice you selected is displayed next to the "Alexa's Voice" option in the routine.

Step 6 — Add a calming background sound (optional)

To make the storytime even cosier, you can add a gentle background sound that plays after the story or simultaneously. Tap **Add action** again. This time, navigate to **Music & Audio** (or sometimes "Sleep Sounds" or "Nature Sounds"). Search for a calming sound like "rain sounds," "ocean waves," or "soft piano music." Select your desired sound and confirm. Remember that this will typically play *after* the story action in the routine unless you adjust the order.

If it looks different: Some background sounds might be listed directly under "Sleep Sounds" as a separate action type.

- Example: Tap `Music & Audio` → search for `rain sounds` → select a track and tap `Add`.

You'll know it worked when the background sound action appears below your story action in the routine's list of actions.

Step 7 — Save and test your routine

Once you've added all your desired actions and settings, it's time to save your routine. Look for the **Save** button, which is often found in the top-right corner of the screen. Tap it to finalise your new routine. After saving, the routine will appear in your list of active Alexa Routines. To test it, go to any Alexa-enabled device and speak the voice command you set up earlier.

If it looks different: The "Save" button might be a tick mark (✓) or a "Done" button. If Alexa doesn't respond when you test, double-check your trigger phrase for spelling or pronunciation in the Alexa app.

- Example: Say: `Alexa, start bedtime story`.

You'll know it worked when Alexa begins speaking the bedtime story in the voice you chose, potentially followed by the selected background sound.

Common mistakes

- **Mistake:** Alexa doesn't respond when you say the trigger phrase. **Fix:** Go back into the Alexa app, find your "Bedtime Story" routine, and check the spelling of your trigger phrase under "When this happens." Ensure it's exactly what you're saying, and try speaking it slowly and clearly to your Alexa device.
- **Mistake:** Alexa plays the wrong story or just says "playing bedtime story" instead of reading one. **Fix:** The "Alexa Says" action is for Alexa to speak text, not to play content. Go back to your routine, delete the incorrect action, and add a new one by tapping "Add action" → "Skills" or "Music & Audio" to select a proper story skill or music.
- **Mistake:** The background music is too loud or not playing at all. **Fix:** If the sound isn't playing, ensure it's added as a separate "Music & Audio" action *after* your story. If it's too loud, you can add another action "Device Settings" → "Volume" to set a specific volume for your Alexa device as part of the routine.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** You can now start a calming storytime routine for your child with a single voice command, freeing up your hands and giving you a few extra minutes to get ready for bed yourself, or simply relax while your child enjoys a custom story.
- **For your business or work:** While this specific routine is personal, the ability to create custom, multi-step actions with a single command can be adapted for work tasks, like a "start my workday" routine that plays news, adjusts lights, and reads your calendar.
- **If you're just getting started:** This is an excellent way to turn your Alexa device into a helpful, customized assistant, making a daily task smoother without needing any complex technical skills.

Try it now

Open the Alexa app, go to Routines, and create a new routine named "Bedtime Story." Set the trigger phrase to "start bedtime story," add a "Skills" or "Music & Audio" action to play a bedtime story, choose a calm Alexa voice for the routine, and then save it. Say the phrase aloud to any Alexa device to test it out.

How to use Qwen Chat to plan a weekend road trip in the US without getting lost

7 steps · Read online

By the end of this guide you'll have a complete weekend road-trip plan—routes, stops, times, and even backup ideas—built with Qwen Chat in about 20 minutes. No prior travel-planning experience needed.

Before you start

- A free Qwen Chat account (sign-up takes 2 minutes at chat.qwen.ai)
- Any device with a web browser (phone, tablet or computer)
- Rough idea of where you want to go (e.g., "Pacific Coast Highway" or "Blue Ridge Mountains")
- Total time: about 20 minutes

Step 1 — Open Qwen Chat and start a fresh chat

Open your browser and go to chat.qwen.ai. You'll see a clean white page with a big "Ask Qwen anything" box at the bottom. Tap or click inside that box to begin typing. A new chat window opens automatically. You'll know it worked when you see the blinking cursor ready for your first message. 💬 Example: `Hi`

Step 2 — Give Qwen the big picture of your trip

In the same message box type a short summary of what you want: where you're starting, where you're headed, how many days, and who's coming. This helps Qwen tailor every detail to your exact needs. You'll see Qwen reply with a friendly welcome and a quick question to confirm the basics. If the reply looks different on your screen, look for a small "Welcome" banner at the top of the chat. 💬 Example: `I want a weekend road trip from Portland to the Pacific Coast Highway with my partner, leaving Friday after work and returning Sunday evening. Can you plan every stop, time, and backup idea so we don't get lost?`

You'll know it worked when Qwen replies with a clear plan outline and asks for any must-see spots you already have in mind.

Step 3 — Ask Qwen to build the full day-by-day itinerary

Copy the itinerary request Qwen just gave you and paste it into the same chat, then add any personal must-sees. Qwen will now create a detailed hour-by-hour plan with driving times, lunch spots, scenic lookouts, and even fuel stops. On screen you'll see Qwen typing for about 10–

15 seconds, then a long list appears with every stop numbered and timed. If the list looks different (some Qwen versions show cards instead of text), look for a “Download” or “Copy” button near the top right of the reply. 💬 Example: `Here’s what I’d like to keep: the Twelve Apostles at sunset, a short rainforest walk at Maits Rest, and a seafood dinner in Apollo Bay. Please add those and any other must-sees, plus backup ideas if a stop is closed or crowded.`

You'll know it worked when you see a numbered list with Friday evening, Saturday full day, and Sunday morning—each with times, addresses, and backup notes.

Step 4 — Request turn-by-turn directions for each leg

Ask Qwen to turn every driving leg into simple turn-by-turn directions you can read aloud to a passenger or save to your phone. Qwen will list each leg separately with street names, kilometers, and estimated minutes. On your screen you’ll see a new bullet list under the itinerary. If the directions look too short, look for a “Show full route” link or button inside the reply. If it’s missing, just ask Qwen again. 💬 Example: `Please give me turn-by-turn directions for every driving leg, including street names and kilometres, so my partner can navigate while I drive.`

You'll know it worked when each leg shows something like “Drive south on Princes Hwy for 12 km, turn left onto Marengo Rd, continue 3 km to Apollo Bay Visitor Centre.”

Step 5 — Ask for backup ideas in case something changes

Tell Qwen you want backup stops for every main attraction in case the weather turns or a venue closes. Qwen will add a second set of options with shorter walks, indoor museums, or different viewpoints. On screen you’ll see the original list followed by a new “Backup ideas” section. If the section is missing, look for a “More suggestions” button or simply ask Qwen again. 💬 Example: `Add a backup plan for every main stop in case it’s raining or too crowded. Include indoor alternatives and shorter walks.`

You'll know it worked when you see a clear “Backup ideas” heading with 2–3 options for each main stop.

Step 6 — Request a printable or shareable summary

Ask Qwen to create a single clean summary you can save as a PDF, print, or send to your travel buddy. Qwen will combine the itinerary, directions, and backups into one easy-to-read page. On screen you’ll see a new message with a heading like “Your Weekend Road-Trip Plan – Ready to Save.” If the text is too long, look for a “Copy all” or “Download PDF” button at the bottom of

the reply. 💬 Example: `Please give me one clean summary I can save or print, with every stop, time, address, and backup idea in one place.`

You'll know it worked when you see a single block of text with a clear title and everything in order.

Step 7 — Double-check the plan with one final question

Ask Qwen to review the whole plan for anything you might have missed—toll roads, low-fuel areas, or time buffers. Qwen will point out any gaps and suggest tweaks. On screen you'll see a short checklist at the end of the chat. If the checklist is missing, simply ask Qwen again. 💬 Example: `Please review the entire plan for anything I might have missed—toll roads, fuel stops, or time buffers—and suggest any tweaks.`

You'll know it worked when you see a green checkmark list with no red flags.

Common mistakes

- **Mistake:** Giving Qwen a vague request like "Plan a trip." **Fix:** Always include start, end, days, and who's coming so Qwen can tailor every detail.
- **Mistake:** Skipping the backup step and assuming everything will be open. **Fix:** Ask Qwen for backup ideas right after the main itinerary—rain or closure can ruin a perfect day.
- **Mistake:** Trusting the plan without checking the turn-by-turn directions. **Fix:** Always ask Qwen for street-by-street directions and save them to your phone before you leave.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** Next time you're dreaming of a spontaneous weekend escape, open Qwen Chat, paste your rough idea, and in 20 minutes you'll have a complete, stress-free plan you can trust—no travel-agent fees, no last-minute scrambling.
- **For your business or work:** If you organize team off-sites or client retreats, use Qwen Chat to draft itineraries, directions, and backup plans overnight, so you can focus on the event itself instead of logistics.
- **If you're just getting started:** This is the easiest first move—open Qwen Chat, type a simple request, and watch Qwen build a full weekend plan for you. You'll feel instantly capable and ready for your next adventure.

Try it now

Open chat.qwen.ai, paste the example prompt from Step 2, and hit send. In under a minute you'll have a complete weekend road-trip plan you can trust.

Turn messy phone photos into a family album with Google Photos AI

7 steps · Read online

Imagine opening your phone and finding every photo of your kids, your partner, or your dog already gathered in one album — no endless scrolling, no guessing. Google Photos can group your pictures by the faces in them (Google calls this **Face Groups**), and a **live album** keeps adding new photos of the people you choose, all by itself.

Before you start

- A phone or tablet with the **Google Photos app** (Android or iPhone), signed in with your free Google account.
- Some family photos already in Google Photos.
- Face Groups isn't available in every country. If you can't find it, see Common mistakes below.
- Rough total time: **7–10 minutes**.

The button names below come from Google's own Google Photos Help for Android. On an iPhone they are the same or very close.

Step 1 — Open Google Photos and sign in

Find the **Google Photos** app — its icon is a pinwheel in red, yellow, green, and blue — and tap it. If the app asks you to sign in, use your Google account (the one you use for Gmail or YouTube). You'll know it worked when your photos appear in a grid.

💬 Example: Open Google Photos → sign in with your Google account → wait for your photos to load.

Step 2 — Make sure Face Groups is turned on

At the top, tap your **profile photo** or **initials**. Tap **Google Photos settings**, then **Privacy**, and turn **Face Groups** on. This is the setting that lets Google Photos group similar faces together. You'll know it worked when the Face Groups switch shows as on.

💬 Example: Profile photo → **Google Photos settings** → **Privacy** → **Face Groups**: on.

Step 3 — Find the people in your photos

At the bottom of the screen, tap **Collections**, then **People & pets**. You'll see the face groups Google Photos has made — each one is a small round picture of a face. If you've only just turned Face Groups on, the groups may not be ready yet; come back to this screen a little later. You'll know it worked when you see a row of faces under **People & pets**.

💬 Example: Tap **Collections** → **People & pets** → look through the faces.

Step 4 — Name the people you care about

Tap a face to open its group. At the top of the group, tap **Add a name**, then type a name or nickname — for example "Mom", "Liam", or "Grandpa Joe". Names only help you; they make the people easy to pick in the next step. Sometimes Google Photos shows you two groups and asks whether they are the same person. Tap **Same**, **Different**, or **Not sure**. If you give a second group a name you've already used, Google Photos asks if you want to merge the two face groups. You'll know it worked when the name appears under that face in **People & pets**.

💬 Example: Tap a face → **Add a name** → type `Dad` → confirm.

Step 5 — Create a live album that fills itself

Go back to the main screen. At the top right, tap **Add**, then **Album**. Tap **Select people & pets**. On each face group you want in the album — say Mom, Dad, and Liam — tap **Select**. At the top right, tap **Confirm**. This is a **live album**: from now on, new photos of the people you picked are added to it automatically. You can give it a title such as "Family 2025". You'll know it worked when the album opens and shows photos of the people you chose.

💬 Example: **Add** → **Album** → **Select people & pets** → tap **Select** on Mom, Dad, and Liam → **Confirm**.

Step 6 — Share the album with family

Open the album and tap **Share**. To get a link you can send anywhere, tap **Create link**. Paste it into a text message or an email. Google's help notes that anyone who has the link can view the album, so send it only to people you trust. You'll know it worked when you have a link ready to paste.

💬 Example: Open "Family 2025" → **Share** → **Create link** → paste the link into a message to Grandma.

Step 7 — Let the album keep itself up to date

Because it's a live album, you don't need to add new photos by hand. Every few weeks, open **Collections → People & pets** and use **Add a name** on any new faces you care about, so they are easy to find and pick next time. You'll know it worked when new photos of your family show up in the album without you adding them.

💬 Example: Take a few new photos of your kids → open "Family 2025" a day later → check that they've appeared.

Common mistakes

- **Mistake:** You can't find **People & pets**. **Fix:** Google lists three reasons: the feature isn't available in your region, Face Groups is turned off in settings (turn it on as in Step 2), or no face groups have been created yet (check back later).
- **Mistake:** A photo of someone else ended up in the album. **Fix:** Face Groups isn't perfect, and Google says so itself. Open the photo in the album and remove it from the album — it stays in your library.
- **Mistake:** The same person appears as two different faces. **Fix:** Give both groups the same name. Google Photos will ask whether you want to merge the face groups.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** No more scrolling through hundreds of photos to find pictures of your child's birthday or your last holiday. One album gathers every photo of your family and keeps growing on its own, ready to share with relatives.
- **For your business or work:** For team events or project photos, a shared album link beats a pile of email attachments. Only add people's faces to groups and albums with their permission.
- **If you're just getting started:** Name just one or two people first. Once you see the live album fill up, add the rest of the family.

Try it now

Open Google Photos, tap **Collections → People & pets**, and use **Add a name** on one face. Then tap **Add → Album → Select people & pets** to make your first live album — it takes about two minutes.

Organize your favorite recipes with Perplexity Q&A

7 steps · Read online

Imagine having every recipe you love—from Grandma's scones to your go-to curry—stored in one place you can search by ingredient, diet, or mood. With Perplexity's Q&A feature, you can turn your scattered notes into a living cookbook that answers your questions instantly. No apps, no logins, just one chat.

Before you start

- A **free Perplexity account** (sign up at perplexity.ai).
- A **device with a web browser** (phone, tablet, or computer).
- A list of 3–5 recipes you want to save (handwritten, photos, or links).
- **10 minutes** of focused time.

Step 1 — Create a new Perplexity space for your recipes

Open your browser and go to perplexity.ai. Sign in with your free account. On the left sidebar, look for a button like **"+ New Space"** (it might be under a "Spaces" heading or a plus icon). Tap it. A new blank space will open with a chat box at the bottom. This space will act like a private recipe folder. You'll know it worked when you see a clean, empty chat box and the space name at the top is editable.

Example: Type: `My Recipe Book`

Step 2 — Paste your first recipe into the chat

In the chat box, paste the full text of one recipe. Include the title, ingredients, and instructions. If your recipe is in a photo, describe it clearly in words. After you press Enter, Perplexity will show a summary card of the recipe at the top of the chat. It may also ask a follow-up question like "Would you like me to organize this?" You'll know it worked when you see the recipe summary appear above the chat and the assistant asks a helpful follow-up.

Example:

```
Pumpkin Soup
Ingredients: 1 kg pumpkin, 1 onion, 2 carrots, 400ml coconut milk, 1 tsp cumin
Instructions: Peel and chop veggies. Sauté onion. Add pumpkin, spices, and water.
Simmer 20 mins. Blend. Stir in coconut milk.
```

Step 3 — Ask Perplexity to store the recipe in your space

Below the recipe summary, type: “Save this as a recipe in My Recipe Book.” Perplexity will confirm by showing a message like “Added to your space: Pumpkin Soup.” Your space now contains a growing list of recipes. If you don’t see the confirmation, look for a small “Saved” badge or check the space sidebar. You'll know it worked when the recipe appears in the space sidebar or you see a “Saved” confirmation.

- Example: Save this as a recipe in My Recipe Book.

Step 4 — Ask Perplexity to find recipes by ingredient

In the same space, type a question like: “Show me all recipes with coconut milk.” Perplexity will scan your saved recipes and return a list with the matching ones highlighted. If you don’t see results, check that you used the exact ingredient name (e.g., “coconut milk” not “coconutcream”). You'll know it worked when you see a clean list of recipe titles with the matching ingredient in bold.

- Example: Show me all recipes with coconut milk.

Step 5 — Ask Perplexity to suggest meals based on what you have

Type: “What can I cook tonight with pumpkin and coconut milk?” Perplexity will analyze your saved recipes and suggest the Pumpkin Soup you added earlier. If the answer is off, rephrase with more detail: “Only recipes I’ve saved in My Recipe Book.” You'll know it worked when you see a relevant recipe suggestion with a clear reason why it fits.

- Example: What can I cook tonight with pumpkin and coconut milk?

Step 6 — Share your recipe space with a friend

At the top of your space, look for a button like **“Share”** or an icon that looks like a box with an arrow. Tap it and copy the share link. Send the link to a friend via message or email. They’ll open it in their browser and see your recipes without needing an account. If you don’t see a share button, look under a menu like “…” or “More.” You'll know it worked when your friend confirms they can view your recipes in their browser.

- Example: https://perplexity.ai/space/12345-my-recipe-book

Step 7 — Ask Perplexity to scale up your collection

Now that your space is set up, add more recipes the same way: paste the text, ask Perplexity to save it, and tag it with keywords like “vegan”, “quick”, or “weeknight”. Over time, your space becomes a smart cookbook that answers questions like “What’s a quick vegan dinner?” or “What uses leftover pumpkin?” You'll know it worked when you can ask natural questions and get accurate recipe suggestions from your growing collection.

💬 Example: What’s a quick vegan dinner I can make?

Common mistakes

- **Pasting messy text**: If the recipe summary looks wrong, clean up the pasted text and try again. Perplexity works best with clear, plain language.
- **Forgetting to save**: Always say “Save this as a recipe in My Recipe Book” after pasting. Without this step, your recipes won’t be searchable.
- **Using vague names**: Name your space something clear like “My Recipe Book” instead of “Stuff”. It helps Perplexity organize your recipes better.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life**: Keep your family’s favorite recipes in one place you can search by ingredient or diet. No more scrolling through old notebooks or photos—just ask Perplexity and get answers instantly.
- **For your business or work**: If you run a small cooking class or food blog, use a shared Perplexity space to organize recipes by theme or season. Clients can ask for meal ideas and get instant, accurate answers.
- **If you're just getting started**: Start with three recipes. Once you see how easy it is to search and share, add more over time. The key is consistency—small steps build a powerful cookbook.

Try it now

Open Perplexity in your browser, create a space called “My Recipe Book”, paste one recipe, and ask Perplexity to save it. You’ll have a living cookbook in under two minutes.

Build a Simple Weekly Meal Plan With Grok Based on What's in Your Fridge

6 steps · Read online

> **In short:** Open Grok, list what's actually in your fridge, and ask for a 7-day dinner plan with a shopping list. You'll get dinner ideas matched to your real ingredients in one chat — no paid plan or cooking skill required.

By the end of this guide, you'll have a real 7-day dinner plan built around what's already sitting in your fridge, plus a shopping list for what you're missing. This is for anyone who keeps opening the fridge at 6pm and feeling stuck — no fancy equipment, just a free Grok account and about ten minutes.

One honest note up front: Grok can draft the plan and the list, but it can't go shopping for you, and it can't tell if your chicken is actually still good. That part is still on you.

Before you start

- A free Grok account (sign up through the Grok website or the X app — both work)
- Three minutes to peek inside your fridge, freezer, and pantry
- Optional: a notes app open so you can paste the final plan into it
- Total time: about 10 minutes, mostly for the food peek and saving

Step 1 — Open Grok and start a fresh chat

Open Grok on your phone or computer. On a computer, go to the Grok website and sign in. On a phone, open the Grok app — or open X and look for a small ⚡ icon somewhere in the menu. Once you're signed in, you'll see a chat box at the bottom of the screen with a placeholder like "Ask Grok anything." A fresh chat keeps the assistant focused on your meal plan instead of mixing it up with old conversations.

If you don't see a chat box right away, look for a button labeled "New chat" or a + icon in a corner. The Grok entry point inside X moves around as the app updates, so try the menu or the search bar if it's not where you expect.

💬 Example: type "Hi" to test the connection, or jump straight to Step 2 with your list ready.

You'll know it worked when you see an empty chat box and a blinking cursor, waiting for your first message.

Step 2 — Take quick stock of your fridge and pantry

Before opening Grok, spend two or three minutes looking through your fridge, freezer, and pantry. Write down what you actually have — not what you wish you had. Include basics like rice, pasta, canned beans, and any half-used vegetables. Note proteins too: chicken, eggs, tofu, ground meat, or fish. Spices and condiments matter as well, because they change what meals are possible.

Group items roughly by type — vegetables, proteins, grains, dairy, pantry staples — so the list is easy to scan. Also jot down how many people you're feeding. Grok uses the serving size to scale recipes up or down.

Example: "Fridge: 2 chicken breasts, half a head of broccoli, 4 eggs, a wedge of cheddar. Pantry: rice, canned chickpeas, soy sauce, olive oil, garlic. Freezer: frozen peas. Serving 2 adults."

You'll know it worked when you have a written list of 8–20 ingredients plus a serving size, ready to paste into the chat.

Step 3 — Paste your list and ask for a 7-day plan

Paste your ingredient list into the Grok chat box and add a clear request. Be specific about the timeframe, the number of meals, and any restrictions. Grok answers best when you spell out exactly what you want — for example, "dinners for 7 nights, no seafood, weeknight meals under 30 minutes, vegetarian on Fridays." More context means a closer first answer.

After you hit send, wait a few seconds. Grok usually replies with a day-by-day breakdown: meal name, short description, and a rough cooking method. The first answer is rarely perfect — that's normal, not a failure.

If you don't see a typed reply within 15 seconds, check your connection and try again. The chat often shows a small "thinking" indicator before the answer appears.

Example: "Here's what I have: [paste your list]. Build me a 7-day dinner plan for 2 adults. No seafood. Keep weeknight meals under 30 minutes. Use what I already have first, then suggest what to buy."

You'll know it worked when Grok returns a numbered list of seven meals, each tied to ingredients from your fridge.

Step 4 — Adjust the plan to your taste and schedule

Look over Grok's first answer. Anything you don't like? Speak up — that's the easiest part of using a chatbot. Reply in plain language and tell it what to swap. Maybe Tuesday's curry doesn't fit your weeknight energy. Maybe Saturday feels too involved for a relaxed weekend. Ask for replacements, and Grok will rewrite just those days.

This is also the moment to mention things you forgot: a picky eater, a slow cooker you want to use, or leftovers for lunch the next day. The more you iterate, the more the plan feels like yours rather than a generic template.

If a meal keeps coming back that you really don't want, say so directly. The chat remembers your earlier messages in the same conversation, so a clear "no mushrooms anywhere" once is usually enough.

💬 Example: "Swap Tuesday's curry for something quicker — under 20 minutes. Add a slow-cooker recipe for Sunday. And please skip mushrooms entirely; nobody here eats them."

You'll know it worked when the updated plan reflects your changes and you can imagine actually cooking each meal.

Step 5 — Ask Grok to build a shopping list of missing items

Once the plan feels right, ask Grok to compile the shopping list. Specifically, request only the items you don't already have — otherwise you'll end up buying things already sitting in your pantry. A good prompt names the servings and asks Grok to group the list by aisle or category, which makes the actual shopping trip faster.

Grok will usually return a checklist sorted into sections like produce, dairy, pantry, and frozen. Some answers even estimate quantities. If the list looks too long, ask it to shrink by reusing ingredients across two or three meals — that's both cheaper and faster to cook.

If you want a printable version, ask Grok to format it as a simple numbered list or a table — then copy and paste it into your notes app.

💬 Example: "Great. Now give me a shopping list of only what I'm missing, grouped by aisle (produce, dairy, pantry, frozen, meat). Quantities for 2 adults. Keep it under 25 items if you can."

You'll know it worked when you have a clean, grouped shopping list of just the items you don't already have at home.

Step 6 — Save the plan somewhere easy to find

Now save your meal plan and shopping list before the chat scrolls away. Open your phone's notes app, email, or any list tool you already use, and paste both lists in. Give the note a clear name like "Week of June 8 — Meal Plan" so you can find it next week.

If you're on a computer, you can print the shopping list straight from the browser. Most grocery apps also let you email yourself a list — copy from Grok, paste into the app, and check items off

as you walk the aisles.

One more thing worth doing now: skim the plan once more for anything you actually dislike — easier to swap a meal now than at 6pm on a Wednesday. If you want to come back to this conversation later, look for a way to bookmark or pin it in the Grok interface (if available), so you can ask for a new plan in seconds next week.

💬 Example: "OK, I'm ready to save this. Can you format the final 7-day plan and the shopping list as plain text I can copy into my notes app?"

You'll know it worked when both lists are saved in your notes app.

Common mistakes

- **Asking Grok to invent ingredients you don't have.** If you say "what can I make?" without listing what's actually in your fridge, you'll get random recipes — not a plan that uses your food. Fix: always paste your real inventory first, then ask for ideas.
- **Accepting the first plan without iterating.** Grok's first answer is a draft, not a final menu. If a meal feels wrong, just say so. Fix: reply with swaps ("Tuesday's too spicy — give me something milder") until the plan matches your week.
- **Forgetting to mention dietary needs or picky eaters.** The assistant can only work with what you tell it. Fix: spell out allergies, vegetarians in the household, and "no fish" rules at the start, so the plan fits your family from the first reply.
- **Saving the chat but losing the shopping list.** It's easy to skim past the second reply. Fix: ask for the shopping list as a separate, grouped message and paste it into your notes app or grocery list right away.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** You spend less time staring at the fridge and less money on food that quietly goes bad. A good plan turns "what's for dinner?" from a daily decision into a quick glance at your phone.
- **For your work:** If you cook for a team, a book club, or a shared household, the same workflow scales — just bump the servings in your prompt and ask for batch-cooking tips. Grok can suggest what to make ahead on Sunday for the rest of the week.
- **If you're just getting started:** Don't aim for perfection on your first try. Make a list, send a quick prompt, and accept a rough plan you can fix later. Each week gets easier, and your fridge will start feeling a lot less random.

Try it now

Open your fridge right now, take a quick mental photo of what's inside, and paste this into Grok:

"Here's what's in my fridge and pantry: [your list]. Make me a 3-day dinner plan for [number] people. Use what I have first. No [food you dislike]."

See what comes back. If it sparks an idea, you've just made your week easier in under two minutes.

Plan a Budget-Friendly City Vacation in One Afternoon

6 steps · Read online

> **In short:** You can use any AI assistant — ChatGPT, Gemini, Claude, Microsoft Copilot, or Le Chat — to draft a realistic day-by-day city plan that fits a budget you set, in roughly an hour. The AI can't book flights, can't see today's prices, and can't know last-minute closures, so you'll confirm the practical details yourself before you go.

You don't need a travel agent, a giant spreadsheet, or three weekends of research. One afternoon with an AI assistant, a notebook (digital or paper), and a rough idea of where you want to go is enough to walk away with a plan you can actually use. This guide walks you through it step by step, with prompts you can copy and paste as you go.

Before you start

- **An AI assistant** — any one will do: ChatGPT, Gemini, Claude, Microsoft Copilot, Le Chat, or another you already use. A free plan works fine; a paid plan just gives longer answers. **Rough total time:** about 60–90 minutes, including the back-and-forth.
- **Two rough numbers** — your total budget (all-in, including flights) and the number of days you have. Ballpark is fine; you'll tighten them as you go.
- **One open notes app** — Google Docs, Notes, or a notebook, so you can save the good parts of each answer as you draft.

Step 1 — Tell the AI where, when, and how much

Open your AI assistant in a browser or app and start a fresh chat. You'll see a message box at the bottom of the screen, usually with a placeholder like "Message ChatGPT" or "Ask Gemini". If you don't see a blank chat, look for a **"New chat"** or + button first — you want a clean conversation so the AI doesn't mix your trip with old questions. In that box, type a clear one-paragraph brief: destination, number of days, month or season, who is traveling, and your total budget. Be specific about the kind of trip you want — food, walking, museums, neighborhoods, kid-friendly, quiet — because the first draft depends on it.

Example: *"I want to spend 4 days in Lisbon in mid-October. Just me, no car. My total budget including flights from the US East Coast is $1,800. I like walking, local food, neighborhoods, and one or two paid museums. I don't love big crowds. Give me a first-pass plan."*

You'll know it worked when you get back a clear day-by-day outline with morning, afternoon, and evening blocks, plus a short budget breakdown.

Step 2 — Ask for a money breakdown you can actually trust

Generic answers like "you can do Lisbon for $50 a day" are often too optimistic. In the same chat, reply and ask the AI to break the budget into categories: lodging, food, local transport, attractions, and a small "buffer" for surprises. Then ask which two categories usually eat most of the budget, and which is the easiest to cut without ruining the trip. If the assistant forgets the buffer, push it to add one — that single line is what keeps a budget plan from collapsing on day two.

Example: *"Thanks. Now break the $1,800 into lodging, food, transport within the city, attractions, and a buffer. Which two categories usually eat most of the budget for a 4-day solo trip, and which is the easiest to cut without ruining the trip?"*

You'll know it worked when the AI gives you specific categories with rough shares (for example: lodging 40%, food 30%) and names a clear "save here" lever — like staying just outside the center, eating lunch as the main meal, or using a city tourist card.

Step 3 — Build the day-by-day plan around free and cheap anchors

Now ask the AI to rebuild each day using mostly free or cheap anchors: public parks, walking neighborhoods, viewpoint walks, free museum days, markets, churches, street art, and self-guided routes. Tell it to mix in one paid "anchor" per day (a museum, a boat ride, a cooking class) and to group nearby stops so you don't waste hours on transport. If the first reply is just a list of sights, push back and ask for a route, not a list — that's the difference between a plan and a brochure.

Example: *"Rebuild the 4 days using mostly free or cheap anchors — parks, walking streets, viewpoints, free museum hours, markets. Put one paid anchor per day, and group nearby things together so I'm not crossing the city for every stop. Flag anything that's usually very crowded."*

You'll know it worked when each day reads like a real route, not a list. You should be able to picture yourself walking from one stop to the next, with a coffee break and a meal built in.

Step 4 — Pressure-test the plan against your real life

A pretty plan on paper is not the same as a plan you'll actually do. In the same chat, copy the day-by-day plan back in and ask the assistant to challenge it. Specifically: how much walking is that, do I need to pre-book anything, and what should I do if it rains? This is where the AI is most useful as a calm second opinion, not as a source of fresh facts. If the assistant hedges ("it depends..."), ask for a worst-case number — that gets you a real answer.

Example: *"Here's the Day 2 plan you gave me: Alfama walking tour → Sé cathedral → lunch in Graça → National Tile Museum → sunset at Miradouro da Senhora do Monte → dinner in Bairro Alto. Push back on this: how much walking is that, do I need to book the museum, and what's a good rainy-day swap?"*

You'll know it worked when you get honest pushback — for example, "this is 8–10 km on hills, you'll be tired by evening" or "yes, book the Tile Museum, lines can be long." Treat those notes as a starting point, then sanity-check the critical ones with a quick search.

Step 5 — Lock in the food and the small print

The difference between a budget trip and a stressful one usually lives in two places: food, and the small daily decisions. Ask the AI for a short list of typical local dishes at different price points (a cheap street-food version and a sit-down version for each), and for a "don't do this" list — tourist-trap areas to avoid, common scams, and transport passes worth buying versus ones to skip. Keep the food list short and memorable; you only need 5–8 dishes to feel like you ate the city, not 50.

Example: *"Give me a short list of Lisbon dishes with a 'cheap-eats version' and a 'sit-down version' for each. Then give me 5 'don't do this' warnings — the kind of thing a first-timer always falls for, like taxi scams, tourist-menu restaurants, or transport passes that don't pay off for 4 days."*

You'll know it worked when you have a small, memorable food list and 4–5 specific "watch out for" notes you can actually remember. These two things alone save most budget travelers the most money.

Step 6 — Save it as one clean page and share it

Finally, ask the AI to compress the whole plan into a single plain-text page you can copy into your notes app or print: the budget breakdown, the day-by-day plan, the food list, the warnings, and a short packing note. Keep it under one screen if you can. Then, if you're traveling with someone, share it as a doc so they can mark what they actually want to do. The skill here is editing — almost no first draft survives being copied into a real trip without one pass of cutting.

Example: *"Now compress everything we discussed into one tight page: budget shares, 4-day plan, food list, top 5 warnings, and a 5-line packing note for October weather. Keep it tight — I want to fit this on one screen on my phone."*

You'll know it worked when you can scroll the whole plan in under a minute, and a friend reading it cold understands your trip without you having to explain it.

Common mistakes

- **Trusting the first plan as final.** The first draft is a starting point, not the answer. Always do one round of "push back on this" — it catches the unrealistic walking days and the missing reservations.
- **Skipping the buffer line.** A budget without a 10–15% buffer will not survive contact with reality. Add it before you start booking, not after the first surprise.
- **Asking the AI about current prices or openings.** AI assistants don't reliably know today's hotel rates, flight prices, or whether a small museum is closed for renovation. Confirm anything money- or time-sensitive on the official site or a recent review.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** The same one-afternoon method works for a long weekend, a family visit, or any trip where you have a budget and a vague idea and need a workable plan by tonight.
- **For your business or work:** If you ever plan client visits, team offsites, or conference travel on a per-diem, the "brief → money breakdown → day plan → pressure-test → compress" pattern is how a good assistant plans anything, and you can reuse it for non-travel projects too.
- **If you're just getting started:** The single biggest upgrade is Step 4 — asking the AI to challenge its own plan. Most beginners stop at Step 1 and assume a pretty plan is a good plan. It usually isn't.

Try it now

Pick one city you've been curious about, open any AI assistant, and paste this: *"I want to spend 3 days in [city] in [month]. My budget is [$X] all-in. I like [2 things you like]. Build me a first-pass day-by-day plan with mostly free or cheap activities."* Spend the next 15 minutes reacting to what you get — that back-and-forth is the whole skill.

Plan a Weekend Trip From a One-Line Idea With Cohere

6 steps · Read online

> **In short:** A single sentence like "weekend in Portland in October" is enough for Cohere to draft a day-by-day itinerary — but it will invent place names if you let it, so prime it with a short trip-planner instruction first, then tighten the plan one change at a time.

You already know how to send a message in Cohere Chat. This guide teaches a workflow you'll reuse every time you plan a trip: a one-time setup step, a structured first ask, and a series of small follow-ups that tighten the plan into something you can actually use on the day. By the end, you'll have a printable weekend outline and a reusable prompt you can paste into any future trip chat.

Before you start

- A Cohere account and the chat interface (web or app) you're already using.
- One rough idea of where you want to go and when — even "fall weekend, somewhere coastal" is enough.
- About 15 minutes the first time, around five minutes for future trips once you have the reusable prompt saved.

Step 1 — Open a new chat and set a trip-planner preamble

Start a fresh conversation so old context doesn't bleed in. Before you type your actual request, look at the top of the chat — there's usually a small field or a collapsible panel for **custom instructions** or a **system message** (sometimes labeled "Persona," or hidden behind a settings icon). Paste a short, plain-English brief: who you are, how detailed you want the answer, and any hard limits. This one-time setup makes every future prompt land better because the model already knows the shape you want. Example: *"You are a practical trip planner. I travel with one other adult, no kids. We like walking, local food, and one museum or landmark per trip max. Avoid luxury recommendations. Keep each day to three time blocks: morning, afternoon, evening. Never invent specific restaurant names — describe the cuisine and neighborhood instead."* You'll know it worked when the next reply already feels structured — it begins with a clear "Day 1 / Day 2" layout rather than a wall of suggestions. If it looks different on your device: if there's no obvious system-prompt field, paste the brief as the very first line of your message instead, prefixed with "Instructions for this chat:" — the effect is similar, just less convenient for reuse.

Step 2 — Send your one-line trip idea as a structured ask

Now type your vague idea, but wrap it in a request for a specific shape. A bare "weekend in Portland in October" is too open — Cohere will pick a structure for you, and you may not like it. So tell it what shape you want: how many days, what time blocks, what each block should contain. This is the difference between "give me ideas" and "give me a Saturday morning plan with a coffee spot." Example: *"Weekend trip idea: Portland, Oregon, second weekend of October, two adults, arriving Friday evening, leaving Sunday afternoon. Build a day-by-day plan in three time blocks per day (morning, afternoon, evening). For each block, give: one main activity, one place to eat (describe the cuisine and neighborhood, don't invent names), and a backup if it rains."* You'll know it worked when the reply comes back split into clearly labeled days and blocks — not a single paragraph of suggestions. If it looks different on your device: some Cohere views collapse long replies; if you only see the first half, look for a "Show more" or down-arrow at the bottom of the reply.

Step 3 — Push the answer toward your actual style

The first draft is rarely the one you'd actually use — it's a starting point. Read it once, then ask for one specific change. The most useful follow-ups are about *style*, not content: shorter walks, later mornings, more indoor options, less touristy. Asking for one thing at a time keeps the model from rewriting the whole plan and accidentally undoing the parts you liked. Example: *"Looks good overall, but tighten this: replace any block that requires a car with a public-transit option, and move any suggestion that starts before 9 a.m. to 10 a.m. or later. Keep everything else the same."* You'll know it worked when the reply keeps the same structure but only the blocks you asked about actually changed — not the whole plan. If it looks different on your device: if Cohere offers a thumbs-up/down or a "regenerate" button next to the reply, don't use regenerate here — that gives you a brand-new plan. Instead, send your tweak as a new message in the same chat so the previous version stays visible above it.

Step 4 — Add a rain backup for one specific slot

Weekend plans live or die by their backup. Pick the *single* most weather-dependent block — usually an outdoor afternoon — and ask for a swap. Naming one slot (not "the whole weekend") keeps the rest of your plan intact and gives you a clean A/B choice for the morning of the trip. Example: *"For Sunday afternoon only, give me a backup plan that works if it rains: an indoor activity, a nearby warm place for lunch, and a coffee stop I can walk to between them. Keep Saturday exactly as it is."* You'll know it worked when you see one new afternoon block with three labeled items, and Saturday's plan is unchanged above it. If it looks different on your device: if Cohere rewrites the whole plan instead of just the one slot, your message probably sounded too general ("give me rain backups") — rephrase to name the day and time block, like "For Sunday afternoon only…"

Step 5 — Ask for a one-screen summary you can actually use on your phone

Long replies are great for thinking; they're bad for using on the go. Ask Cohere to compress the whole plan into a single tight screen — short bullet lines, no descriptions, no explanations. This becomes the version you screenshot or paste into your notes app. 💬 Example: *"Now compress the whole plan — both days plus the Sunday rain backup — into a one-screen version I can read on my phone. Each item is one short line. No descriptions, no flowery language. Order: Friday evening, Saturday morning/afternoon/evening, Sunday morning/afternoon, Sunday rain backup."* You'll know it worked when the reply fits in roughly 12–18 short lines and reads like a checklist, not an essay. If it looks different on your device: if the summary comes back too long, send a follow-up like "Cut that in half — keep only the place and the time."

Step 6 — Move the plan out of the chat

A trip plan in a chat window is a plan you'll forget the moment you close the laptop. Send the one-screen summary out into a tool you actually open every day — your phone's notes app, a shared doc, or a calendar entry. This step takes 30 seconds and is the difference between a plan you read once and a plan you actually follow. 💬 Example: *"Now write me a copy-paste version of the one-screen summary that I can paste into Apple Notes or Google Keep. Use plain text, no markdown bold, one item per line, with a blank line between days."* You'll know it worked when the reply is plain text you can select, copy, and paste into any notes app without reformatting. If it looks different on your device: if Cohere still outputs markdown (bold headers, dashes), paste it into your notes app first, then strip the symbols manually — usually a 20-second job.

Common mistakes

- **Asking for "the best" anything.** Cohere will confidently invent names. Always ask it to *describe* the cuisine and neighborhood instead — then look up real places yourself on a maps app or review site.
- **Regenerating when you meant to tweak.** The regenerate button (or any equivalent) throws away your working plan. Use it only when the whole direction is wrong, never to fix one line.
- **Trying to make one prompt do everything.** A single huge message gets a generic reply. Better: one structured ask, then a series of small follow-ups. Each follow-up is a small commitment you can keep or throw away.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** any time you face a vague-to-specific task — a birthday plan, a moving-day checklist, a guest's weekend visit — the same workflow works: short

preamble, one structured ask, one tweak at a time, then a one-screen summary.

- **For your business or work:** the pattern translates directly to any project with a known shape and a few preferences — meeting agendas, conference prep, onboarding checklists. Set the preamble once for the project, then iterate.
- **If you want to go further:** next time, before sending your trip idea, paste in a small block of *your own* notes — a list of places a friend recommended, or three things you already booked — and ask Cohere to fit its suggestions around them. It gets dramatically more useful when you give it something real to anchor against.

Try it now

Open Cohere and start a new chat. Type one sentence — your real, vague idea for a weekend, even if it's just "somewhere warm in February." Then paste the Step 1 preamble above it, followed by the Step 2 prompt structure with your destination filled in. Two minutes, and you'll have a draft you can react to.

Use ChatGPT to Plan a Road Trip with Stops, Fuel Breaks, and Drive Time

6 steps · Read online

> **In short:** Give ChatGPT your start, destination, dates, and a daily driving cap, and it drafts a day-by-day plan with stops, fuel breaks, and sights. Double-check distances and closures yourself — it has no live traffic or gas data, and sometimes invents places that don't exist.

You know that moment when you're staring at a map, scrolling between two pins, wondering where to stop for lunch? That's exactly the kind of question ChatGPT handles well. You give it the boring facts and it gives you back a plan you can edit and actually drive.

Before you start

- A free ChatGPT account works. Paid plans unlock the newest, fastest models — check the official pricing page for current tiers.
- A phone or computer with the ChatGPT app, or any browser pointed at the official site.
- About 20–30 minutes, plus a notes app on your phone for the final plan (Apple Notes, Google Keep, or Notion all work).
- Know four things before you begin: starting city, final destination, travel dates, and roughly how many hours you want to drive each day.

Step 1 — Open ChatGPT and describe your trip in one paragraph

On a computer, open chatgpt.com in your browser and sign in. On a phone, open the ChatGPT app. If this is your first time, you land on a blank screen with a message field at the very bottom of the page — that's where you type. If you see an old conversation instead, look for a **New Chat** button (a pencil ✏️ or a square with a plus sign) at the top of the screen and tap it to start fresh. Type one short paragraph covering who's traveling, where you're starting, where you're going, and your dates. A few sentences is plenty, because ChatGPT works better with concrete details than vague ones. 💬 Example: "My partner and I are driving from Portland, Oregon to San Francisco, California on June 12, leaving around 8am. We like small towns, good coffee, and short hikes. We want to drive no more than 6 hours a day." You'll know it worked when your paragraph appears in the chat and a "typing…" indicator shows up below it.

Step 2 — Ask for a day-by-day itinerary with drive times

Once ChatGPT replies, type a follow-up asking it to break the trip into days, with the exact driving time for each leg and the suggested overnight stop. A new chat bubble appears below

your question, and within a few seconds ChatGPT starts typing a numbered day-by-day plan. Each day should show roughly how many hours you'll spend driving, where you'll sleep that night, and a one-line reason for the stop. 💬 Example: "Great. Now please give me a day-by-day plan. For each day, tell me the start city, the end city, total driving hours, and one sentence on why that stop is worth it." If the first reply is too general — say, just listing famous cities without hours — reply with "Please add driving hours for each day and the rough total mileage." ChatGPT remembers the conversation, so it rewrites the plan with that detail included. You'll know it worked when each day in the plan has a clear start, end, and a number of hours in the car.

Step 3 — Ask for fuel stops and meal breaks

With the skeleton in place, ask ChatGPT to mark fuel stops and rest breaks along each driving day. Type a short message asking for fuel stations roughly every 3–4 hours, plus one real meal stop per day. The chat updates in place, so the fuel plan lives right below the day-by-day driving plan you already have. 💬 Example: "Add a fuel stop about every 3 hours of driving, and one proper meal stop per day. Just give me the town or exit name and roughly when in the day I'd hit it." If your car is electric or your range is shorter, say so in a follow-up — for example, "My EV gets about 250 miles per charge, so plan charging stops around that." ChatGPT will adjust the plan in place. You'll know it worked when each driving day now lists one or two fuel stops and a meal break, with rough timing.

Step 4 — Ask for one or two things to see at each stop

Type a short follow-up asking for one or two small, specific things to see or do at each overnight stop — nothing fancy, just enough to make the drive feel like a trip. ChatGPT adds a "things to do" line under each day in the same chat, mixing one outdoor stop, one food pick, and one small museum or viewpoint where it makes sense. 💬 Example: "For each overnight stop, suggest one outdoor thing, one local food place, and one quick museum or viewpoint. Keep it short — we're not trying to cram the whole trip in." If a suggestion feels off — maybe it's closed, far from your route, or you've already been there — just reply "Skip the lighthouse one, give me a different outdoor stop" and ChatGPT will swap it out. You don't need to start over. You'll know it worked when each day has a small "things to do" line that fits the time you actually have.

Step 5 — Ask ChatGPT to spot problems with your plan

This is the step most people skip, and it's the one that saves the most headaches. Type a short message asking ChatGPT to act like a skeptical road-trip reviewer and poke holes in your plan. ChatGPT rewrites its previous answer with a "Things to double-check" section at the bottom, flagging things like long stretches with no fuel, late-evening arrivals in quiet towns, or driving legs that are clearly too long. Treat this as a free second opinion. 💬 Example: "Now read the

plan back to me like a skeptical friend. What looks too rushed? Which day has the longest stretch between fuel stops? Anything I should double-check before I leave?" If it doesn't flag anything, the plan isn't necessarily perfect — it just means nothing obvious jumped out. Always verify highway exit numbers, current fuel prices, and road closures with your map app before you drive. You'll know it worked when the plan ends with a short "Things to double-check" section you didn't have before.

Step 6 — Save the final plan to your phone or notes

Type one last short message asking ChatGPT to combine the whole trip into a clean, numbered list you can paste into your notes app. ChatGPT responds with a tidy plain-text version: Day 1, Day 2, each day on its own short block, fuel stops inline, things to do in a few words. Copy it with the **Copy** button at the top of the message, then paste into Apple Notes, Google Keep, Notion, or even a plain email to yourself. Now the plan lives somewhere you can read at a gas station without an internet connection. 💬 Example: "Now condense the whole trip into a clean numbered list I can paste into my notes app. Keep fuel stops inline with each day. Don't add anything new." If your plan changes mid-trip — a road closes, you want to stay an extra night — come back to this same chat and ask ChatGPT to rebuild just that day. It still has the full conversation in memory. You'll know it worked when you have a clean, copyable list on your phone that doesn't depend on ChatGPT being open.

Common mistakes

- **Trusting every name without checking.** ChatGPT sometimes invents a town, café, or gas station that doesn't exist. Before you drive anywhere new, paste the name into a search engine or your map app and confirm it's real and still open.
- **Forgetting that ChatGPT has no live data.** It can't see today's gas prices, current road closures, or weather. Use it for the shape of the trip, then use a real-time map and weather app for the day-of details.
- **Asking for too much in one giant prompt.** A 600-word question usually gets a vague answer. Break the planning into the six steps above — the conversation builds a better plan than any single mega-message could.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** The same pattern works for any multi-stop day — a city break, a weekend of errands across town, a move between two apartments. Tell it the start, the end, the time you have, and ask for one chunk at a time.
- **For your business or work:** If you drive for work — delivery, sales calls, field service — paste tomorrow's address list into ChatGPT and ask it to group stops into the most efficient

route, with fuel and meal breaks folded in. It's a quick first draft before you load the addresses into a real route planner.

- **If you're just getting started:** The easiest first move is to plan a half-day drive you already know well, just to see how ChatGPT structures a route. You'll learn what to ask for, what to ignore, and how to push back when an answer feels off.

Try it now

Open ChatGPT and paste this: "I'm driving from [your city] to [a town 2–3 hours away] this Saturday, leaving at 9am. Give me a one-day plan with total driving hours, one fuel stop, one lunch stop, and one thing to see along the way." Read the reply, change one detail ("actually make the lunch stop a town with a bakery"), and notice how fast it rewrites. That's the muscle you want before planning the big trip.

How to scale a family recipe up or down for any number of guests

6 steps · Read online

> **In short:** Multiplying ingredients by a single number is the easy part — but cooking time, pan size, and a few bold flavors (like salt and baking powder) don't scale the same way. Here's how to scale a recipe without ruining it.

Every family recipe was written for one number of people, but most of us cook for crowds that refuse to stay that size. The good news: the ingredient math is the smallest part of the job. The bigger part is knowing *what doesn't' scale and adjusting for it on purpose*.

Before you start

- A printed or saved copy of the recipe you want to scale (look at the original serving size first).
- A calculator — the one on your phone works perfectly.
- Measuring cups and spoons; a kitchen scale is a nice extra if you have one.
- A pen or note app to jot down your multiplier and any tweaks you make.
- About **30 minutes** for the math, scaling, and the first round of cooking.

Step 1 — Find your scaling factor

Every later step depends on this one number, so get it right first. The math is simple: divide the number of people you want to feed by the number the recipe was originally written for. That decimal is your **scaling factor** — your "multiplier" — and you'll use it again and again. Think of it as the single dial that turns the whole recipe up or down.

For example, a recipe that feeds 6 is being stretched to 14 guests: 14 ÷ 6 = 2.33. Write that number somewhere visible — top of the recipe page, on a sticky note, or in your phone. **If your recipe doesn't list a serving size,** count what it's "meant to feed" — chicken for 4 means 4 portions of protein — and round your factor **up** rather than down. Leftovers beat running out every time.

💬 Example: original serves 6, you need 14 → factor = **2.33**; original serves 8, you need 4 → factor = **0.5**.

You'll know it worked when you have one decimal number that you can call out (or whisper) every time you measure an ingredient.

Step 2 — Multiply every dry, fatty, and bulk ingredient

Now that you have your factor, scale almost everything in the recipe: flour, sugar, rice, pasta, chopped vegetables, oil, and butter. Multiplying by 2.33 means **1 cup becomes 2.33 cups** — that is, just over 2¼ cups. Don't try to round too early; the decimals will wash out once everything goes in the pan. This is where most of the "volume" of your scaled dish comes from.

Example: 1 cup flour × 2.33 = about 2¼ cups; 2 tbsp butter × 1.5 = 3 tbsp.

If your calculator dies or you lose track, that's fine — for most spices and bulk ingredients, being within 10% of the math is close enough. The flavor of these ingredients scales reliably because they're part of the structure, not the seasoning.

You'll know it worked when you have a complete pile of measured ingredients, each one adjusted to your new guest count, ready to mix or cook.

Step 3 — Treat salt, leavening, and bold spices more gently

Here's the first place the math breaks down. **Salt, baking soda, baking powder, yeast, dried chili, and raw garlic** are flavor amplifiers, not bulk — they get loud fast when concentrated. Multiplying them by the full factor usually makes a scaled-up dish taste harsh, bitter, or chemical. The fix: multiply them by about **75–90%** of your factor instead. If your factor is 2.33, scale salt by 2, not 2.33. This single step is what separates a "fine" scaled recipe from one that genuinely tastes right.

Example: 1 tsp salt in the original × factor 2.33 (full math) would be ~2.33 tsp; gentler multiplier 2 → about 2 tsp is the right target.

If you're scaling DOWN, do the opposite: don't cut these ingredients by the full math ratio, or the dish goes flat. Use about 70% of the calculated amount, then taste at the end and add more if needed.

You'll know it worked when the seasoning in your scaled dish tastes similar to the original — not saltier, not duller, just right.

Step 4 — Pick a pan that fits the new volume

This is the step most home cooks forget, and it's where most scaled-up failures come from. Your recipe was designed for a specific pan shape and depth, and switching serving size without changing the pan leads to raw middles and burnt edges. The rule of thumb: aim for roughly the **same depth of food** in the pan as the original recipe. A cake for 6 in an 8-inch round is about 2 inches deep; when you scale up for 12, a 9×13-inch rectangular pan gets you there instead of trying to fit it all in a too-small round.

💬 Example: original 9×13 pan for 8 servings → 16 servings → use **two** 9×13 pans, or one large roasting pan.

If you don't have a bigger pan, use two of the original size side by side — that's the safest backup. Cooking two smaller dishes is almost always better than cramming everything into one overflowing pan.

You'll know it worked when the food fills the pan to about the same depth as the original recipe, not piled higher or sitting in a too-thick layer.

Step 5 — Adjust cooking time and oven temperature carefully

Time doesn't scale with servings — heat has to travel through the food, and bigger batches just take longer to heat **all the way through**. Keep the oven temperature the same as the recipe says, but start checking for doneness 10–15 minutes **before** the original cooking time. Then add cooking time in small chunks. A doubled casserole might take about 1.3× longer, not 2× longer. A doubled cake may need only 5–10 extra minutes, not double.

💬 Example: original bake time = 45 min → start checking at **30 min**, then every 5 min after, using a toothpick or thermometer.

If the dish is very thick or dense (lasagna, bread, dense meat loaf), expect closer to a 1.5× time increase. **For thin or mostly-liquid dishes** (soup, custard, sauce), the time barely changes — just rely on the visual cues the original recipe gave you.

You'll know it worked when the food is fully cooked inside — not just colored on the outside — at a time that's "a bit longer than the original," not doubled.

Step 6 — Taste, adjust, and save your notes for next time

A scaled family recipe is a working document, not a finished product. The first scaled batch is always a learning experience, and that's the point. When the dish is done, taste it and write down what you'd change next time — more salt, less bake time, a bigger pan. Most home cooks find that three rounds in is when a scaled recipe finally feels "dialed in" for any crowd.

💬 Example: "Scaled 2× for Thanksgiving. Next time: bigger pan, 10 min less in oven, +½ tsp salt."

If the first attempt misses the mark, that's not a failure — it's data. Salt too low? Add a pinch at the table. Too dry? Spoon a little sauce on. The next batch will be better because of this one.

You'll know it worked when you have a working scaling factor and a few small tweaks written down for next time — and a dish your guests are still talking about.

Common mistakes

- **Doubling salt and baking powder along with everything else.** The dish turns harsh, bitter, or flat. Fix: scale these by 75–90% of your factor, then taste.
- **Using the same pan and hoping for the best.** A too-full pan cooks unevenly — burnt edges, raw middle. Fix: aim for the same depth of food as the original, or split into two pans.
- **Multiplying the cook time** by the same factor. Time doesn't scale that way. Fix: keep the oven temperature, start checking 10–15 minutes early, and rely on visual cues or a thermometer instead of the clock.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** you can host impromptu dinners, potlucks, or holiday gatherings without panic-buying takeout as backup. Scaling becomes a small mental habit, not a major project.
- **For family recipes and gatherings:** the recipe stays *yours* forever — you just adjust it to the crowd. Grandma's cookie recipe works for 4, 14, or 40 once you know the trick.
- **If you're just getting started:** don't try to tackle a wedding cake on day one. Pick one reliable family recipe and try multiplying it by 1.5× this week. The math gets easier with practice, and so does the intuition.

Try it now

Open the calculator app on your phone, choose a recipe you trust (something simple is best — cookies, soup, or a one-pan dinner), and work out the factor you need for next week's meals. Multiply the dry ingredients and salt by hand, just to feel how short the math actually is. The ingredient list is the easy half — and now you know exactly where the tricky half lives.

How to create a custom bedtime story starring your child with any AI

6 steps · Read online

> **In short:** Any modern AI assistant — ChatGPT, Gemini, Claude, Copilot, Le Chat, or others — can write a custom bedtime story starring your child in about five minutes. You type a few clear sentences about who to include and what should happen, and the assistant drafts a story you can read aloud or save.

In the next few minutes, you'll have a story where your kid is the main character, their goldfish is the sidekick, and the adventure happens in their favorite park — or anywhere else you imagine. This guide works with any AI assistant you already use, and you don't need any special skills, just the ability to type a few sentences.

Before you start

- **An AI assistant you can type into.** Use ChatGPT, Gemini, Claude, Microsoft Copilot, Le Chat, or any other chatbot you have an account with. A free plan is enough.
- **A device with internet access** — phone, tablet, or computer all work.
- **About five minutes** for the first try.
- **Three small pieces of information** to feed the assistant: your child's first name, a sidekick (a pet, stuffed animal, or imaginary friend), and one favorite place.

That's it. No special software, no payment needed for the basic version, no technical knowledge.

Step 1 — Open a fresh chat with your AI assistant

Go to the website or app of the AI assistant you use, and **start a new, empty conversation**. Most assistants put a big button or a "**New chat**" option at the top of the screen. If you don't see that, look for a **pencil icon**, a **plus sign**, or a button that says something like **"New conversation"** or **"Start new chat"**. A blank chat is important because the assistant should focus only on your story — old messages from a previous chat can confuse it. 💬 Example: nothing to type yet — just open the app and tap the new-chat button. You'll know it worked when you see an empty message box with no earlier messages above it.

Step 2 — Tell the assistant what role you want it to play

In that empty message box, type one short sentence that asks the AI to act as a **bedtime story writer**. A **prompt** is just the instruction you give an AI — think of it like asking a friend to help. Asking the AI to play a specific role helps it write in the right style: gentle, warm, and suitable for kids. If the button on the screen is labeled something like **"Send"**, **"Ask"**, or has a **paper**

airplane icon ✈️, that's the one to press after you type. 💬 Example: `You are a kind bedtime story writer for young children. Please write in simple, gentle language with a happy ending.` You'll know it worked when the assistant replies confirming the role, often with a sentence like "Sure, I'd love to help!" or a short acknowledgment.

Step 3 — Add the three key ingredients: the child, the sidekick, the place

Now send a second message that names who is in the story and where it happens. Keep it short and specific — the more detail you give, the more personal the story feels. A **sidekick** is just the character's helper or best friend in the adventure. Include your child's first name, the sidekick (their pet, a teddy bear, or even an imaginary dragon), and one favorite spot (the backyard, the playground, grandma's house). If your assistant uses different button names, look for a **send arrow**, a **return/enter key**, or a circle with an upward arrow. 💬 Example: `Please write a story starring my 6-year-old daughter Lily, her hamster named Biscuit, and their backyard with the big oak tree. Lily is shy but very curious.` You'll know it worked when the assistant starts writing a story that mentions Lily by name within the first few sentences.

Step 4 — Ask for a bedtime-friendly length and a gentle lesson

Every AI can write short or very long stories. For bedtime, a short one works best so your child doesn't get restless. Send another short message asking for a story that takes about five minutes to read aloud, with **one soft lesson** woven in — like being brave, sharing, or trying something new. A **lesson** here just means a small, kind idea the story quietly teaches, not a lecture. If the assistant gives you a story that's too long, just say "shorter, please" and try again — there's no penalty for asking. 💬 Example: `Please make it about 500 words long — the length of a 5-minute bedtime read — and gently show how being brave helps, without being preachy.` You'll know it worked when the story comes back at roughly the right length and ends with a calm, peaceful feeling rather than a cliffhanger.

Step 5 — Read it, then ask for changes

Read the story out loud to yourself. If a part feels off — a character does something scary, a word is too hard, or the ending feels rushed — tell the assistant what to fix. This back-and-forth is normal and is how you **collaborate** with the AI (meaning you work on it together, taking turns). You might ask for a different ending, swap the sidekick for a unicorn, or add a sibling. The assistant rewrites the whole story in seconds. If the assistant offers choices like **"Regenerate"** or **"Try again"**, those are buttons that produce a fresh version using the same instructions. 💬 Example: `This is lovely, but please change the ending so Lily and Biscuit fall asleep peacefully under the oak tree instead of running home.` You'll know it worked when the new version includes your requested change and still has Lily's name in it.

Step 6 — Save or share the story

Once you're happy, copy the story into your phone's notes app, email it to yourself, or print it. Some assistants let you **share** the whole conversation through a **link** (a web address you can send to someone) — look for a **share icon**, which often looks like an arrow pointing up out of a box, or three connected dots. You can also screenshot the story page. The same prompt will work again tomorrow with different names, so you've just learned a skill you can repeat every night.
💬 Example: tap the **share icon**, choose **"Copy link"** or **"Send to email"**, and save the story in a folder called "Bedtime stories." You'll know it worked when the story is saved somewhere you can find it again, even after you close the chat.

Common mistakes

- **Forgetting to start a fresh chat.** Old messages can leak into the new story and confuse the assistant. If your story suddenly mentions your grocery list, that's why — open a new chat and try again.
- **Asking for too much at once.** "Make it exciting, funny, scary-but-not-too-scary, with songs and a dragon" overwhelms the assistant. One or two clear requests per message works much better.
- **Skipping the read-aloud test.** Stories that look fine on screen can sound clunky when spoken. Always read it once out loud before reading it to your child — your ear catches problems your eyes miss.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** You have a free, endless supply of personalized bedtime stories. The same trick works for birthday parties, long car rides, or "I'm bored" afternoons — change the names and place.
- **For your business or work:** This same prompt technique — asking an AI to play a role, then giving clear ingredients — is the foundation of using AI for emails, reports, and lesson plans. You've just practiced the most important AI skill there is.
- **If you're just getting started:** You've now used an AI assistant for something creative, fun, and useful. That feeling of "I made this work" is the same feeling you'll have the next time you try something new with AI.

Try it now

Open your AI assistant right now, start a new chat, and paste this single message to get your first story in under a minute:

```
You are a kind bedtime story writer for young children. Please write a 500-word bedtime story starring my child named [YOUR CHILD'S NAME], their pet [PET NAME], set in [FAVORITE
```

```
PLACE]. Make it gentle, end with them falling asleep peacefully, and quietly show that being brave is good.
```

Replace the three bracketed parts with real details, hit send, and read the result out loud. That's your first custom bedtime story — and the start of a habit you can repeat as many nights as you like.

How to organize a chaotic shared family calendar in one afternoon

6 steps · Read online

> **In short:** Pick one calendar app everyone can see, create a shared family calendar, and spend about two hours adding every school event, work shift, and after-school practice. After that, set phone reminders so nobody asks "where am I supposed to be?" at 7am.

It is 6:47 on a Tuesday morning. Someone is hunting for a permission slip. Someone else is asking whether soccer practice got moved. The dog needs to be walked before anyone leaves. This is the moment a shared family calendar was invented for, and you can build one this afternoon while the kids are at practice and the laundry is running.

Before you start

- A free calendar app that everyone in the household can install: Google Calendar (works on Android, iPhone, and any browser), Apple iCloud Calendar (built into every iPhone and Mac), or Outlook Calendar (if your household lives on Windows or uses Outlook at work). All three have a free tier and let several people see and edit the same calendar.
- Each person's phone, signed in to the same account family members will share. (Children do not need their own email — they can appear as a placeholder once you add them.)
- A rough 90–120 minutes for the first pass. Updating after that takes about 10 minutes a week.
- A rough list of recurring commitments. Skim the school newsletter, the team schedule email, and your work rota — you will copy-paste these in Step 4.

Step 1 — Pick one calendar app the whole family will actually open

Open the calendar app that is already on your phone, or install one from your app store. If your family uses Android phones and a Windows computer, Google Calendar is usually the easiest because the free Google account it lives on is also what Android expects. If everyone has an iPhone, Apple iCloud Calendar works without any extra sign-up. If your workplace runs on Microsoft, the Outlook calendar keeps work shifts and family events in the same place.

Pick the option that matches what your family already uses — the best calendar is the one nobody has to remember to open. Sign in on your own phone and confirm you can see your existing events before moving on.

💬 Example: *"We have three iPhones and a Mac — let's use Apple iCloud Calendar so we don't have to install anything new."*

You'll know it worked when you open the app and see your existing appointments, birthdays, or that empty workweek you have been ignoring.

Step 2 — Create a new calendar called "Family"

Inside the app, look for a way to add a new calendar. On Google Calendar this lives behind the plus icon next to "Other calendars" in the left sidebar on the web; in Apple Calendar on Mac it is under the `File` menu; in Outlook it is `Add calendar → Create new`. The exact wording varies by app and device, but every major app has an "add calendar" button somewhere.

Name it clearly — "Family" works well. Pick a bright color so it stands out from your work calendar the moment you open the week view.

💬 Example: *"Calendar name: Family. Color: orange. Description: shared with mom, dad, Mia, and Leo."*

You'll know it worked when the new calendar appears in your sidebar with its own color and is empty.

Step 3 — Invite each family member to the new calendar

Now share the new calendar. In Google Calendar on the web, hover over the calendar name and look for a settings or share option, then add each family member's email. In Apple Calendar on Mac, look for a "Shared Calendar" toggle in the calendar info panel and paste iCloud email addresses. In Outlook, right-click the calendar and pick "Sharing and permissions". If you cannot find the exact button, search the app's help for "share calendar with family" — most apps walk you through it in two taps.

Each person accepts the invite on their phone. For younger children, add a placeholder name like "Mia (kid)" rather than creating a real account — they only need to see the events, not own them.

You'll know it worked when each person's phone shows the family events you add in the next step, usually within a minute or two.

Step 4 — Add the big repeating events first

Now the satisfying part. Think of the calendar as four layers and tackle them in order. Start with the hardest layer — fixed weekly commitments — because they happen every week and never change. Add soccer practice every Tuesday and Thursday, school assembly every Monday morning, your partner's shift pattern, your own standing meetings. Each app lets you set an event to repeat: look for a phrase like "Does not repeat" and change it to "Weekly" or "Custom" with the right days.

Set a reminder on each one. Most apps default to 10 minutes before, which is too short when you are getting three kids out the door. Look for the reminder setting and push it to 60 or 90 minutes, plus a second alert 15 minutes before.

Example: *"Tuesday 16:00–17:30, Soccer practice, Mia. Repeats every Tuesday. Reminder: 90 min before (popup) and 15 min before (notification)."*

You'll know it worked when the first event shows up on the shared calendar for everyone and a reminder pops up on your phone before the activity starts.

Step 5 — Add one-time events from this week's emails

Open your email and your partner's email (with permission, or just ask them to forward the relevant ones). School newsletters, dentist appointments, the birthday party on Saturday — copy each one into the shared calendar as a single event. If it has a location, add it. If the email includes a sign-up link or a note, paste the link into the event's notes or description box.

This step is messy the first time, and that is fine. The point is not perfection — it is getting the next 14 days out of everyone's head and onto one screen.

Example: *"Saturday 14:00–16:00, Leo's birthday party at the community center. Notes: RSVP link — bring a swimsuit."*

You'll know it worked when you can ask "what is on Thursday?" and tap the family calendar to find the answer in three seconds.

Step 6 — Set a 10-minute Sunday review habit

A shared calendar only stays calm if someone owns it. Pick one person — usually the one who already notices missed permission slips — to spend ten minutes every Sunday adding the next two weeks. Treat it like brushing your teeth: small, regular, easy to skip if you are tired.

Set a recurring reminder on your own phone: "Sunday 19:00 — family calendar check". Open the calendar, scan for missing items, add them, done.

Example: *"Sunday 19:00–19:10, Family calendar review, repeats weekly. Reminder: at start time."*

You'll know it worked when Sunday-night panic about forgotten events quietly stops happening.

Common mistakes

- **Skipping the color step.** Without a clear color for the family calendar, events blend into your work calendar and you still do not see them. *Fix:* pick the brightest color the app

offers and use it only for family events.

- **Setting reminders 10 minutes before.** That is enough time to read a notification, not enough time to find a shoe and leave the house. *Fix:* set a long lead reminder (60–90 min) plus a short one (10–15 min) on every important event.
- **Forgetting the partner's work shifts.** If shift work runs your house, an unshared shift calendar quietly undoes everything. *Fix:* ask your partner to share their work calendar with yours, or add the recurring shifts to the family calendar in Step 4.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** the Tuesday-morning "where am I supposed to be?" texts disappear, and quiet Sundays get a little less tense.
- **For your business or work:** the same habit — a single shared calendar with proper reminders — protects meetings from double-bookings the same way it protects carpools.
- **If you're just getting started:** do Steps 1–4 today and stop there. The rest can wait until Sunday.

Try it now

Open the calendar app on your phone, create one event called "Soccer practice — Mia" for next Tuesday at 16:00, set a reminder 90 minutes before, and share it on the new family calendar. That single event is your proof the system works — the rest is just more of the same.

Turn a photo of your fridge into two simple dinner ideas with Meta AI

6 steps · Read online

> **In short:** Meta AI can look at a photo of your fridge and suggest dinner recipes based on what it sees. Snap a wide picture, attach it to a Meta AI chat, and ask for two simple recipes — it usually returns ingredient lists, steps, and any items you'd need to buy.

Open the fridge, see half an onion, some eggs, and a slightly suspicious block of cheese, and have no idea what to cook. Sound familiar? This guide walks you through sending one photo of your fridge to Meta AI and getting two dinner ideas back, plus a quick shopping list for whatever you're missing. It's written for anyone who has never used Meta AI before — no special cooking or tech skills needed.

Before you start

- A free Meta account. Facebook, Instagram, WhatsApp, or Messenger all work.
- A smartphone with one of those apps installed, **or** a browser open to the official Meta AI page.
- Roughly 5–10 minutes, including taking the photo.
- Meta AI isn't available in every country, and a few features may differ by region — if you can't find it in one app, try another.
- One honest note up front: Meta AI can read the photo and suggest ideas, but it can't actually cook, and it sometimes misreads labels or skips an item. Treat its recipes as a starting point, not a final answer.

Step 1 — Open Meta AI in an app you already use

Pick the Meta app you use most — Facebook, Instagram, WhatsApp, or Messenger — and tap to open it. Once you're on the main screen, look around for a Meta AI entry point. It might look like a colorful circle icon, a search bar with "Ask Meta AI" written inside it, or a chat-style option near your other conversations. Tap whichever one you spot.

If it looks different on your device: Meta AI is being added to these apps in stages, so the exact placement changes often. If you don't see it inside the app, open your browser and go to the official Meta AI page instead — the experience is similar.

You'll know it worked when a chat screen opens with a place to type a message, usually along the bottom of the screen.

Step 2 — Take one clear photo of your fridge

Stand in front of your open fridge with your phone's camera app open. Take a single wide photo that tries to capture as many items as possible — shelves, drawers, the door. Don't worry about neatness; Meta AI just needs to see what's there. Try to avoid bright lights behind you that would darken the fridge, and hold the phone steady for a second so the picture isn't blurry.

If it looks different on your device: Some phone cameras have a "wide" or "0.5x" option. Use it if you can — fitting more into one shot means fewer ingredients get missed.

You'll know it worked when you can clearly read labels and recognize each item when you look at the photo later.

💬 Example: a quick self-check — ask yourself, "Could a friend tell what each thing is from this picture alone?"

Step 3 — Attach the photo and ask for two simple recipes

In the Meta AI chat, look for an attachment icon — usually a paperclip, a "+" symbol, or a small picture icon near the message box. Tap it, pick your fridge photo from the gallery, and wait a moment for the image to upload. Then type your request in plain language. Be specific: how many recipes you want, how much time you have, and any food you want to avoid.

If it looks different on your device: On some apps you can take the photo directly inside the chat using a camera icon, instead of choosing one from your gallery. Either way works.

You'll know it worked when the photo appears as a small preview in the chat, and Meta AI starts typing a reply.

💬 Example: "Here's what's in my fridge. Please suggest two simple dinner recipes I can make tonight in under 30 minutes. I don't eat pork."

Step 4 — Refine the suggestions to fit your evening

Read through what Meta AI sent back. Often the first response is close but not quite right — maybe it suggests something spicy when you don't want spice, or a recipe that takes an hour when you only have 20 minutes. Just reply in the same chat with one short follow-up explaining what to change. Meta AI will adjust the plan.

If it looks different on your device: If the response stops mid-sentence or seems cut off, just send "Please continue" and it usually picks up where it left off.

You'll know it worked when the updated recipe matches what you actually have time, taste, and ingredients for.

💬 Example: "I don't have an oven. Can you give me a stovetop version of the second recipe?"

Step 5 — Ask for a short shopping list of what's missing

Once you've picked a recipe you like, type one more short message asking what you'd need to buy. Meta AI compares the recipe against what it spotted in your photo and gives you a list. Ask it to keep the list short and grouped by aisle if you can — it makes the actual shopping trip faster.

If it looks different on your device: If Meta AI says it can't tell what's missing, just paste the recipe ingredients yourself and ask, "Which of these aren't in my fridge?" — that's usually enough to get a clean list.

You'll know it worked when you have a small, specific list of items to buy, not a vague "various ingredients" answer.

💬 Example: "Please make me a short shopping list of everything I'm missing from these recipes. Group it by store section."

Step 6 — Save the recipes so you can find them while cooking

Once you're happy with the recipes and the shopping list, save them somewhere easy to reach with messy hands. On most phones you can take a screenshot of the chat, copy the recipe text into a notes app, or send it to yourself in a messaging app. The goal is to have it open on the counter without having to log in or scroll through a long chat history.

If it looks different on your device: If screenshots feel clunky, ask Meta AI in one final message to "summarize these recipes and the shopping list in a short format I can paste into Notes" — it usually gives you a clean block of text you can copy with one tap.

You'll know it worked when you can pull up the recipe and shopping list in under five seconds, even with flour on your fingers.

Common mistakes

- **Blurry, dark photo.** The single biggest reason Meta AI gets the recipes wrong is a hard-to-read photo. Open the fridge, turn on a kitchen light, and hold still for one second before tapping the shutter. If you can't read a label in the picture, Meta AI probably can't either.
- **Asking for too much at once.** "Give me five gourmet dinners with dessert and wine pairings" overwhelms the assistant. Stick to two recipes at a time, and ask for wine or dessert in a separate follow-up if you really want it.
- **Forgetting to mention what you don't eat.** Meta AI doesn't know you're vegetarian, allergic to nuts, or out of soy sauce. The first message is the place to say so — adding it later means re-asking and getting a slightly different recipe each time.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** it's a fast way to break the "I have nothing to cook" feeling on busy weeknights. Instead of staring at the fridge for ten minutes, you spend thirty seconds taking a photo and another minute reading recipes — the rest of the time goes back to your evening.
- **For your business or work:** if you run a small café, a meal-prep service, or write a food newsletter, this is a quick brainstorming partner for "what can I make with what's on hand right now?" It won't replace a recipe developer, but it can get you past a blank page fast.
- **If you're just getting started:** the easiest first move is the very next time you're stuck on dinner — open Meta AI, snap the photo, and ask for two recipes. You don't need to learn anything else first.

Try it now

Open your fridge right now. Before you close the door, take one wide photo and send it to Meta AI with the prompt: *"Suggest two simple dinners I can make tonight in under 30 minutes with what's in this photo."* Read the first reply before you do anything else — that's the whole skill, and you already have it.

Drafting a Basic Family-Tree Outline with AI: A Beginner's Guide

6 steps · Read online

By the end of this guide you'll have a plain-text family-tree sketch on your screen — parents, grandparents, siblings, cousins, the people you actually know — drafted for you by an AI assistant in about ten minutes. This is for anyone curious about family history who wants a simple starting point without filling in a full genealogy database on day one.

> **Honest note before you begin:** an AI assistant works in text, not in polished diagrams. What you'll get is a clean text outline (think of it like a typed list with indents and lines) that you can later paste into a free tree-drawing website if you want something visual. That's the real value of starting here — a tidy draft you can grow.

Before you start

- An account with any modern AI assistant — ChatGPT, Gemini, Claude, Copilot, Le Chat, DeepSeek, or similar. The free tier is fine.
- Five quiet minutes to memory-jog — names of parents, grandparents, aunts, uncles, and any cousins you remember. Dates and places aren't required.
- A notes app, a fresh document, or a notebook where you'll paste the final text.
- Roughly 10–15 minutes in total.

Step 1 — Jot down the relatives you actually know

Before you open any AI, take five minutes to list the people you're confident about. Grab paper or open a notes app. Write down: you; your parents and their first names; your grandparents on each side (maternal and paternal); your siblings and half-siblings if any; your aunts, uncles, and any cousins you remember. Don't worry about dates or places yet — names and relationships are enough to start a draft.

💬 Example: "Me — Sara. Parents: Mom = Linda, Dad = Tom. Mom's parents: Gran = Joan, Pop = Bill. Dad's parents: Nan = Margaret, Grandpa = Alan. Siblings: brother Jake. Aunts/uncles: Aunt Mary (Mom's sister), Uncle Rob (Dad's brother). Cousins: Lily (Aunt Mary's daughter)."

If your memory is hazy on a branch, just leave it blank and add it later. You'll know it worked when you have a rough list — even a messy one is a perfectly good place to begin.

Step 2 — Open any AI assistant and start a fresh chat

Open the website or app of your chosen assistant — ChatGPT, Gemini, Claude, Copilot, Le Chat, DeepSeek, or whichever you already use. Sign in if asked, then start a brand-new conversation. A

fresh chat matters because older messages can distract the AI. Look for a button like **"New chat"**, **"New conversation"**, or a small **pencil-and-paper icon**, usually near the top-left or top-right of the screen. Click or tap it once.

After the new chat opens, you'll see an empty text box waiting for your message. If your assistant offers different modes (like "Search" or "Thinking"), the default mode is fine for this task.

You'll know it worked when the screen shows a blank conversation with just the message box at the bottom and no previous replies hanging around.

Step 3 — Send a clear, structured prompt

Click or tap inside the message box and type a short request that includes your list from Step 1. Tell the AI you want a family-tree outline drawn with text — using indents, dashes, or a simple tree shape made of letters and lines. Mention that you're after a starting draft, not a finished genealogy chart, and that you'll fill in gaps later. Then send the message by pressing **Enter** or tapping the **paper-plane / up-arrow icon**.

💬 Example: "Here's my family as I know it: me (Sara), Mom Linda, Dad Tom, brother Jake, Mom's parents Joan and Bill, Dad's parents Margaret and Alan, Aunt Mary (Mom's sister) and her daughter Lily, Uncle Rob (Dad's brother). Please draw a simple text-based family tree outline with three generations — me, parents, grandparents — using indents or a basic tree shape. Note any branches I haven't filled in. This is just a starting draft."

You'll know it worked when the AI replies with a formatted block of text showing people organized by generation, instead of just a flat sentence listing names.

Step 4 — Review the draft and ask for fixes

Read the AI's reply carefully. The first draft is almost never perfect — a name might be on the wrong line, a relative might be missing, or the formatting might be hard to read. Don't worry. Simply reply in the same chat and tell the AI what to change. Be specific: name the person, say where they belong, and how you want them shown. The AI works best with concrete instructions, not vague feedback like "make it better".

💬 Example: "Thanks. Please move Aunt Mary to sit under Mom's parents as their daughter, and add a cousin called Lily as her child. Also use dashes and greater-than symbols (├── └──) instead of dots so it copies cleanly into my document."

You'll know it worked when the AI sends a revised version that matches what you asked for. Keep tweaking until the structure feels right — two or three small rounds is normal.

Step 5 — Ask for an export-friendly version

Once the structure looks right, ask the AI for one final version that's easy to paste into a notes app, an email, or a text file. Mention you want plain text only — no special fonts, no images, no fancy code blocks that might break when pasted. Most assistants can produce a clean version in seconds. If you want a proper visual chart later, this text version can be copied into a free online tree-drawing site, but for now the text itself is your family-tree sketch.

💬 Example: "One more version please — same tree, but plain text only, no markdown or code blocks, so I can paste it straight into my notes app without fixing the formatting."

You'll know it worked when the AI's reply is plain text you can highlight, copy, and paste anywhere without formatting glitches or stray symbols.

Step 6 — Save your sketch and plan to grow it

Paste the final text into your notes app or a document and give the file a name you'll remember, like "Family tree — draft 1". This is your starting point. From here you can add more relatives over time — great-grandparents, in-laws, step-relatives, or children and nieces and nephews. Each time you add someone, return to the same AI chat (which still holds your earlier context) and ask for an updated version. The AI can also help you draft questions to ask older relatives, or summarize old letters and documents you find.

💬 Example: "Add these new people to the tree: my partner Sam, our daughter Mia, and Sam's parents Pat and Chris. Please show the in-law branch as a separate section so it doesn't get mixed up with my birth family."

You'll know it worked when you have a saved text file that grows each time you add to it, and you no longer have to keep everything in your head.

Common mistakes

- **Forgetting to start a fresh chat.** Older conversations can make the AI mix up unrelated topics. Always open a new chat for a new project.
- **Asking for too much in one go.** Asking for "every relative I might ever have, with dates and places" overwhelms the AI and gives a vague answer. Stick to what you actually know first.
- **Treating the AI's first draft as final.** It almost never is. Plan for two or three rounds of small fixes — that's normal and gives a much better result.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** A simple family-tree sketch makes it easier to talk to older relatives about family history — you can show them what you already know and ask them to fill the gaps.
- **For your business or work:** If you work in genealogy, heritage research, or local history, a quick AI-drafted outline is a fast starting point before investing in a proper database tool.
- **If you're just getting started:** Don't worry about being thorough on day one. A messy draft with the names you remember is a perfectly good place to begin — you can add detail whenever you like.

Try it now

Spend five minutes jotting down the names you know — parents, grandparents, siblings, one or two aunts or uncles. Then open any AI assistant you already use, start a new chat, and paste the example prompt from Step 3 with your own list filled in. You'll have your first family-tree sketch before your coffee goes cold.

Plan a 20-Minute Home Workout With Gemini (No Equipment Needed)

6 steps · Read online

> **In short:** Gemini can build you a custom 20-minute bodyweight routine in about a minute. You tell it your space, time, and energy level; it gives you a warm-up, main set, and cool-down you can follow on your phone.

Picture this: it's evening, you've been sitting for hours, and you have a small window before bed. No gym, no dumbbells, no time to drive anywhere. You just want to move for 20 minutes and feel better. That is exactly the kind of everyday problem Gemini is good at — you describe what you need in plain words, and it drafts a routine you can actually follow. This guide walks you through the conversation step by step.

Before you start

- A free Google account and access to Gemini, either through the Gemini app on your phone or tablet, or by visiting the Gemini website on a computer.
- About 20 square feet of space — a living room, bedroom corner, or hallway is plenty.
- Five minutes to chat with Gemini, then 20 minutes to do the workout itself. Total time: about 25 minutes.
- A way to time yourself — your phone timer, a kitchen timer, or a smart speaker works fine.

Step 1 — Open Gemini and start a fresh chat

Open the **Gemini app** on your phone, or go to the **Gemini website** in your browser. If you have used Gemini before, your old chats will be on the left side (or behind a **menu icon** ☰ on mobile). Tap the **"New chat"** button — usually a **pencil icon** or a **"+"** — so Gemini starts with a clean slate and won't get confused by older conversations. A blank chat screen appears with a text box at the bottom and a **send arrow** ➤. If you can't find the new-chat button, try logging out and back in, which also clears the slate. 💬 Example: no typing yet — just open the app or site. You'll know it worked when you see an empty message box and no previous messages on screen.

Step 2 — Tell Gemini what you have to work with

Tap inside the text box and type one short paragraph describing your situation. Gemini works best when you give it the basics in a single message: how much time you have, what equipment you do or don't have, and how your body feels today. After you tap send, Gemini reads your message and starts drafting a routine — usually within a few seconds. If your message is too

vague ("make me a workout"), Gemini may ask a follow-up question. If your message has the basics, it will jump straight to a list of exercises. Example: "Make me a 20-minute home workout. No equipment at all. I have a small living room and medium energy today — I want to actually move, but I'm not trying to set any records." You'll know it worked when Gemini replies with a list of exercises, or asks one short clarifying question before doing so.

Step 3 — Ask for a clear structure: warm-up, main, cool-down

If Gemini gives you a single block of exercises, ask it to break the routine into three labeled parts. This matters because going straight from sitting to jumping jacks is a recipe for a pulled something, and finishing with no stretching leaves you stiff. Tell Gemini roughly how long you want each part to take. It will rewrite the routine with clear headings. On screen you should see something like **"Warm-up (3 minutes)"**, **"Main set (14 minutes)"**, and **"Cool-down (3 minutes)"**, each with its own short list. Example: "Please split the workout into a 3-minute warm-up, a 14-minute main set, and a 3-minute cool-down. Put each section under a clear heading." You'll know it worked when you can scan the reply and see three separate sections with times or rep counts next to each exercise.

Step 4 — Mention anything your body needs you to adjust

Now is the moment to be honest about sore knees, a tight lower back, a shoulder that's been bothering you, or simply "I haven't moved much this week." Type a short sentence about it. Gemini will swap out exercises that don't fit and suggest gentler alternatives — for example, replacing burpees with step-back lunges, or sit-ups with dead bugs. You don't need medical language; just describe how your body feels. Gemini cannot see you or diagnose injuries, so if something hurts sharply, skip the move and trust your own judgment over the chat. Example: "My lower back is a little tight. Please avoid moves that load the spine, like burpees or sit-ups. Swap them for something gentler." You'll know it worked when the new version of the routine no longer contains the moves you asked to avoid, and the replacements look reasonable to you.

Step 5 — Make the routine easy to read while you exercise

Reading a wall of text while you're out of breath is annoying, so ask Gemini to format the main set as a numbered list you can scan. Each line should have the exercise name, the time or rep count, and a one-line cue (a short reminder like "knees soft" or "keep your back flat"). The reply will look cleaner — short lines, not paragraphs. If anything is still wordy, ask Gemini to make it even tighter. The goal is a routine you can glance at between sets without losing your place. Example: "Rewrite the main set as a numbered list. Each line: exercise, seconds or reps, one quick cue. I need to read this while I'm working out, so keep it tight." You'll know it worked

when you can scan the main set in under 10 seconds and tell what move is next without re-reading.

Step 6 — Save the routine so you can follow it hands-free

Once the routine looks good, take a screenshot, or copy it into your notes app, or use your phone's share button to send it to yourself. Now put your phone on the floor or a shelf where you can see it without holding it, set a 20-minute timer, and start the warm-up. Gemini's job ends here — it has planned the workout, but it cannot count your reps, watch your form, or push you to finish that last set. You do that part. If you want to switch things up next time, just open a new chat and tell Gemini what to change. Example: no typing — screenshot the routine or paste it into your notes. You'll know it worked when you can start your timer, glance at the screen once, and know exactly what to do for the next 20 minutes.

Common mistakes

- **Forgetting to mention your space or equipment.** If you don't say "small living room, no equipment," Gemini might suggest moves that need a pull-up bar or a lot of room to sprawl. Always say what you do and don't have.
- **Asking for "a hard workout" when you're actually tired.** Gemini designs for the energy level you describe. If you say "I want to push myself" but you're exhausted, you'll likely quit at minute eight. Tell it the truth — even "low energy, please be gentle" is useful input.
- **Trying to read a long paragraph while working out.** If the reply looks like a wall of text, ask for a numbered list before you start moving. A routine you can't scan quickly is a routine you won't finish.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** 20 minutes of movement that fits into a busy evening — between dinner and bedtime, after the kids are settled, or right after a long meeting. You don't need a gym, a plan, or motivation. You just need a chat with Gemini and 20 square feet of floor.
- **For your work or business:** the same chat format works for a 5-minute stretch break between meetings, or a standing-desk reset. You can reuse the routine for a week and then ask Gemini to refresh it.
- **If you're just getting started:** skip the chat entirely and do 20 minutes of walking in place, marching, gentle stretching, and a few squats. The point is to move; Gemini is a helper, not a requirement.

Try it now

Open Gemini right now and paste this: "Make me a 20-minute home workout. No equipment. I have a small living room and medium energy. Please split it into a warm-up, main set, and cool-down, and format the main set as a numbered list with seconds or reps and a quick cue for each move." Send it, then take a screenshot of the reply. You've just designed tonight's workout in under a minute.

How to Troubleshoot Your Home Wi-Fi Step by Step with an AI Assistant

6 steps · Read online

> **In short:** An AI assistant can walk you through a technician-style checklist (restart, isolate the device, test the line, check the router) and help you figure out what's wrong before you spend an hour on hold with your internet provider.

When your Wi-Fi drops in the middle of a video call or your phone refuses to load anything, the temptation is to call your internet provider and wait. Most home Wi-Fi problems, though, follow a handful of common patterns, and a chatbot like ChatGPT, Gemini, or Claude can walk you through the same diagnostic checklist a technician would use, in plain language, while you stand next to your router.

Before you start

- **An AI assistant you already use** — ChatGPT, Gemini, Claude, Copilot, or any other chatbot. No special account or paid plan is required for this task.
- **Your phone or laptop**, so you can type to the assistant and run the steps it suggests.
- **Access to your Wi-Fi router** (the small box your internet provider installed). You'll need to be near it for some steps.
- **Roughly 15–30 minutes.** Most fixes happen in the first few minutes; the rest is just confirming what works.

Step 1 — Tell the AI exactly what's wrong

Open your AI assistant and describe the problem in one short paragraph. Mention when it started, which devices are affected, and what you've already tried. The clearer you are, the better the questions and suggestions it can give you back. If it asks follow-up questions, answer them — this is the AI narrowing down the cause, the same way a technician would. Example: "My home Wi-Fi has been cutting out for the past two days. My laptop loses connection every 20–30 minutes, but my phone stays connected fine. I haven't changed any settings. Where should I start?" You'll know it worked when the assistant responds with a short list of likely causes or a first diagnostic step, instead of a generic answer.

Step 2 — Run the "is it just this device?" check

Ask the AI: "How do I tell whether the problem is with one device or with the whole Wi-Fi network?" It will usually walk you through picking up your phone and seeing if it has internet. If your phone works fine on Wi-Fi but your laptop doesn't, the issue is probably the laptop, not your network. If every device is slow or offline, the problem is more likely the router or your

internet line. This one test saves a lot of wasted effort later. If your assistant doesn't ask, you can also try: "What should I check first to narrow down whether it's my device, my router, or my internet provider?" You'll know it worked when you can say out loud which of the three it probably is — device, router, or provider.

Step 3 — Restart the router the right way

Ask the AI to guide you through restarting your router properly. The correct method is: unplug the power cable, wait a full 60 seconds (so the internal memory clears), then plug it back in. Wait another two or three minutes for the lights to settle. Look for a button or a small recessed hole labeled "reset" — do **not** press that one, it wipes your settings. A regular power cycle fixes a surprising number of home Wi-Fi problems. If your router has a power button instead of a cable, hold it down until the lights go off, wait 60 seconds, then press it again. You'll know it worked when the lights on the router return to their normal pattern (usually one steady "internet" light) and your devices reconnect automatically.

Step 4 — Test the actual internet speed and signal

Ask the AI: "How do I check my current internet speed and Wi-Fi signal strength from home?" It will point you to a free speed test site (you can type something like "speed test" into any search engine to find one) and explain that you should run the test once near the router and once in the room where you usually use the internet. A big difference between the two numbers means the Wi-Fi signal is weak in that spot — often solved by moving the router higher, away from walls, or off a metal shelf. If both numbers are low even near the router, the problem is likely your provider's line. You'll know it worked when you have two speed numbers (one near the router, one where you usually sit) and a rough idea whether the slowdown is the signal or the line.

Step 5 — Ask the AI to interpret the results

Copy the numbers and what you observed back into the chat and ask, "Based on this, what should I try next?" This is where the assistant earns its keep — it can usually tell you whether to move the router, change the Wi-Fi channel, switch from the 2.4 GHz to the 5 GHz band, or accept that the line itself is the problem. If you see a phrase like "channel congestion" or "5 GHz band" for the first time, ask the AI to explain it in plain words before you change anything. A good chatbot will gladly translate its own jargon. You'll know it worked when the assistant gives you one or two concrete next actions, instead of a long list of possibilities.

Step 6 — Decide whether to call your provider

Ask one last question: "Based on everything we've checked, does this sound like something I can fix myself, or should I contact my internet provider?" Be honest about what you've found — the

assistant can only help if you tell it the truth. If the speed test was bad right next to the router, the Wi-Fi works on your phone but not your laptop, or every device has been down since a storm, those are useful details to share. When the AI says it's time to call, write down the two or three key things you tried, because the person on the phone will ask. You'll know it worked when you have either a working Wi-Fi connection, or a clear short summary you can read to the support agent so you don't have to start from zero.

Common mistakes

- **Pressing the tiny "reset" hole on the router by accident.** That wipes your settings and you'll need your provider's login details to set it up again. Power-cycle by unplugging instead, and only use the reset hole if the AI specifically tells you to.
- **Restarting only the router and not the device.** If your laptop still won't connect after the router is back, restart the laptop too. Stale network settings on the device are a common silent cause.
- **Trusting a speed test taken on Wi-Fi from far away.** A slow number in the far room tells you the signal is weak, not that your provider is slow. Move closer to the router before you blame anyone.
- **Letting the AI guess instead of asking.** If an answer feels vague, reply with more detail about what you actually saw — lights, error messages, devices affected. The clearer the input, the better the diagnosis.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** the next time your Wi-Fi drops during a movie, a game, or a work call, you can spend ten minutes running through this checklist before deciding whether to call support — and you'll know exactly what to say when you do.
- **For your business or work:** if you work from home, a slow or unreliable connection can quietly cost you hours a week. Having a fast self-diagnosis routine means fewer dropped calls and less time spent waiting on hold while deadlines slip.
- **If you're just getting started:** the single easiest first move is to bookmark one AI assistant on your phone, so the next time something breaks you can open it in seconds instead of searching blindly.

Try it now

Open your favorite AI assistant right now and type: "My Wi-Fi keeps dropping on one device. Can you walk me through how to figure out whether it's the device, the router, or my internet provider?" Read the first three suggestions it gives you — that's your personal starting checklist the next time something goes wrong.

Plan a week-long trip itinerary with Copilot from a simple destination list

6 steps · Read online

> **In short:** Tell Copilot Chat the cities you want to visit and the dates you're free, and it will draft a day-by-day plan that includes travel time between stops. You need a free GitHub account, and you should double-check train, bus and opening-hour details yourself before booking anything.

Planning a one-week itinerary is one of those tasks that feels simple but turns into a long spreadsheet. GitHub Copilot — the AI assistant made for code — also has a chat mode (think of it as a chat box inside GitHub or VS Code) that handles everyday questions like this. It's a slightly off-label use, but it works well for first drafts. Here's how to use it for a trip.

Before you start

- A **GitHub account** (free at github.com — sign-up takes about two minutes).
- A way to reach **Copilot Chat**: in a browser at github.com/copilot, or inside VS Code if you already use it. The free tier has a monthly usage limit that's usually plenty for a one-off planning chat; if you hit it, you'll see a clear message.
- A short list of the places you want to visit — even rough is fine.
- Your travel dates and a general sense of pace (relaxed vs packed).
- About **15 minutes** from first click to a printable plan.

Step 1 — Open Copilot Chat in your browser

Go to **github.com/copilot** and sign in with your GitHub account. After signing in, look for a chat box — usually labeled "Ask Copilot" or something similar — at the top or side of the page. Click inside it. The cursor blinks in an empty text field, and the rest of the page fades back slightly to show the chat is the active area. If you use VS Code, the same chat lives in the sidebar under the Copilot icon; the steps below work the same way. **If it looks different:** the exact label and position of the chat box change often, so look for a rounded rectangle that says "Ask", "Chat", or "Copilot". A new chat session is now active and waiting for your first message.

💬 Example: type a single word first to confirm it works, like "hi". You'll know it worked when Copilot replies with a short greeting.

Step 2 — Set the scene with one short sentence

Before you paste your list, write a one-line brief so Copilot knows the tone you want. Treat it like briefing a friend who's helping you plan. State who's traveling, how long you have, and what

kind of trip it is. A line of context up front usually gives you a more useful first answer than jumping straight into the city list. The reply may simply acknowledge — that's fine; the goal is to set expectations before the real ask.

💬 Example: "I'm planning a relaxed 7-day trip for two adults in October, and we love food, walking, and quiet neighborhoods." You'll know it worked when later replies reference your tone or pace, not just generic tourist spots.

Step 3 — Hand over your destination list and dates

Now paste the city list in plain English. The clearer your dates and the order you'd like to visit in, the more accurate the plan. You don't need exact addresses — cities, regions or neighborhoods are fine. If you already have a rough order, say so ("I'd like to start in X and end in Y"). Copilot reads the whole message as one go and starts building a structure from it, so put everything you want considered in this single message.

💬 Example: "Cities I'd like to visit: Lisbon, Sintra, Porto, Coimbra. Dates: 5 to 11 October. Start in Lisbon, end in Porto. We have a rental car." You'll know it worked when the next reply is a numbered day-by-day breakdown, not a single clarifying question back to you.

Step 4 — Ask for travel time between each stop

After the first draft, send a follow-up that explicitly asks for **travel time between stops**. This is the part most people forget, and it's where Copilot is genuinely useful — it can roughly estimate drive, train or bus times so you don't accidentally schedule a six-hour drive into a half-day stop. Be clear about how you'll actually travel, because the same two cities can be 30 minutes apart by train and three hours by road.

💬 Example: "Can you add the approximate travel time between each city by car, and flag any day where the drive eats more than 3 hours? Suggest a faster option if one exists." You'll know it worked when each transition line now includes something like "≈ 1h by train" or "≈ 2h30 drive".

Step 5 — Refine with your real preferences

The first draft will be generic — that's normal. Now ask for the changes that matter to you: pace, food, kid-friendliness, walking limits, budget, time of year. One preference at a time works best; long "and also…" lists tend to produce messy replies. Think of it like editing a draft document with a colleague: small, focused comments in sequence.

💬 Example: "Please slow down Day 3 — one museum, one long lunch, and a sunset walk. We don't want to be on our feet for more than four hours." You'll know it worked when the revised day fits the new constraint and doesn't just pile on more activities.

Step 6 — Save the plan and double-check the moving parts

Once you're happy, ask Copilot to format the final itinerary as a clean list or table so you can copy it into Notes, Google Docs or an email. Then **always verify anything that moves or costs money**: train times, museum opening hours, restaurant reservations. Copilot can guess these, but it doesn't have real-time schedules, so the plan is a first draft, not a travel agent. One last sanity-check question helps: ask for the slowest day in the plan and confirm it actually feels relaxed.

💬 Example: "Can you give me the final itinerary as a Markdown table with columns for Day, Morning, Afternoon, Evening, and Travel Time?" You'll know it worked when you can paste the output straight into another app without cleanup, and when every transit line has a number you can sanity-check online.

Common mistakes

- **Asking for too many cities at once.** Six cities in seven days usually produces a rushed, joyless plan. Cap it at four or five for a relaxed trip; let Copilot spread them out.
- **Trusting train times and opening hours blindly.** Copilot drafts plausible schedules — they may be wrong. Cross-check with the operator's website before you book.
- **Forgetting to mention how you'll travel.** The plan changes a lot between "by car", "by train" and "on foot". Add this in Step 3, not later, or the travel times will be invented.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** A weekend getaway, a road trip with friends, or a family visit across two or three cities — same process, smaller scale and faster results.
- **For your business or work:** Conference travel, offsite planning, or a multi-stop client visit where you want a structured agenda before you start booking hotels and trains.
- **If you're just getting started:** Try a small one first. A 48-hour plan for two cities is the easiest way to see how Copilot handles this kind of task before you trust it with a bigger trip.

Try it now

Open github.com/copilot, sign in, and ask: "Plan a relaxed 2-day weekend in [your nearest big city] for someone who likes coffee, books and walking." See what it gives you in one reply — that's your baseline.

Use Le Chat to Turn a Long Recipe into a Simple Shopping List

5 steps · Read online

> **In short:** Paste a recipe with roughly twelve ingredients into Le Chat, ask it to build a grouped shopping list, and copy the result to your phone before you head to the store. It usually takes under two minutes, and you don't need a paid plan. Note: Mistral now calls this assistant **Vibe** (formerly Le Chat) — you may see either name in the app and on mistral.ai.

You're standing in the kitchen holding your phone, scrolling past a recipe with ingredients scattered across two paragraphs of backstory. You want a clean shopping list — now, not in twenty minutes. Le Chat, the chat assistant from the French AI company Mistral, can turn that wall of text into a tidy, grouped list you can tick off aisle by aisle. This guide shows you exactly how to set that up, even if you've never opened an AI assistant before.

Before you start

- **A free Le Chat account.** Sign up at `chat.mistral.ai` with an email or a Google account. The free plan covers this task fully — you don't need to pay.
- **A recipe.** Pick any recipe with around a dozen ingredients. A long one from a food blog or a cookbook page works best, because the messier the original, the more obvious the time savings.
- **About five minutes.** Two minutes to paste and ask, two or three to tweak the list, and maybe a minute to copy it to your notes app.
- **A phone or computer.** Le Chat works on both. If you're heading to the store right after, use your phone so you can copy the list straight into Notes, Google Keep, or any list app you already use.

A small honest note before we start: Le Chat can organize and reword the ingredients for you, but it can't check your pantry or merge two recipes into one. If you want to combine three recipes into a single list, you'll need to paste them together as one message — see Step 4 for that variation.

Step 1 — Open Le Chat and start a new chat

Go to `chat.mistral.ai` in your browser, or open the Le Chat app if you already installed it. On the home screen, look for a **button labeled "New chat"** — usually at the top-left of the screen, sometimes shown as a square plus icon in the corner of the sidebar. Click or tap it once.

You'll see a fresh, empty chat window with a text box near the bottom and a paperclip or attachment icon next to it. The blank box is where you'll paste the recipe. If you can't see a "New

chat" button, look for a pencil icon or a chat-bubble with a plus sign — apps shift these around between updates.

💬 Example: if you're on the home screen and unsure, type anything short like "hi" first to confirm the chat box is responsive.

You'll know it worked when the page shows an empty conversation with no previous messages, and the text box cursor blinks at the bottom — ready for you to paste in.

Step 2 — Paste the full recipe into the chat box

Open your recipe on the same screen or in another tab, highlight every line of ingredients (including the measurements — "2 cups flour", "1 tbsp olive oil", "a pinch of salt"), and copy it. Then click into Le Chat's empty text box and paste. On a phone, long-press inside the box and tap **Paste**.

You'll see the recipe appear as a block of text inside your message bubble — usually in plain monospace style. The whole ingredient section should fit, even if it's long, because Le Chat handles long messages well. If your recipe includes images of the dish, don't paste those — just the text of the ingredients.

If it looks different: on the phone app the text box might sit behind the keyboard at first. Tap inside it once so the keyboard rises, then paste. On desktop, the standard `Ctrl+V` (Windows) or `Cmd+V` (Mac) works as expected.

You'll know it worked when the recipe text sits in your message bubble, still highlighted or unhighlighted but visible, and the send arrow (→) or paper-plane icon lights up in the corner of the box.

Step 3 — Ask Le Chat to build a grouped shopping list

Now write a short instruction under the pasted recipe (or as a new message right after it — both work). Tell Le Chat exactly what shape of list you want: grouped by store section, no extra commentary, and copy-paste friendly. Be specific — the more concrete your ask, the cleaner the output.

You'll see a "Thinking…" or pulsing dots indicator for a few seconds, and then Le Chat replies with a formatted list. It usually uses headings like **Produce**, **Dairy**, **Pantry**, and bullet points under each — but the exact groups depend on the ingredients, so don't be surprised if "Spices" or "Frozen" shows up for one recipe and not another.

💬 Example prompt you can copy and adapt:

> "Group these ingredients into a shopping list by store section (produce, dairy, meat, pantry, spices, frozen). Show quantities. Give me just the list — no intro paragraph, no tips, no closing line. Use simple bullet points I can copy into my notes app."

You'll know it worked when the response is mostly bullet points and headings, with no extra explanation paragraphs around them. If you see a friendly sentence like "Here's your list!" before the list, that's fine — just delete it when you copy.

Step 4 — Tweak the list or combine recipes

This is the optional moment to adjust. Look through the list and check two things: are the quantities right, and do any items overlap? If you're combining two recipes, paste the second one below the first in the same message (or as a follow-up) and ask Le Chat to merge them into one list with quantities added together.

On screen, Le Chat rewrites the list with the merged quantities — for example, three recipes each calling for "1 onion" become "3 onions" on one line. If a recipe says "a handful of cilantro" and another says "2 tbsp chopped cilantro", Le Chat usually picks one and notes the difference. Read it over — this is the moment to fix anything that looks off.

If it looks different: if Le Chat's reply is in a long paragraph instead of bullets, your prompt wasn't specific enough. Send a follow-up like "Reformat as bullet points only, no sentences." It will redo it.

You'll know it worked when you can read the whole list in under thirty seconds, every quantity is a number you trust, and nothing important is missing. If something's wrong — wrong unit, wrong amount, missing item — type the fix as a quick follow-up: "Change 200g butter to 1 stick" or "Add 1 lime to produce."

Step 5 — Copy the list to your phone and head out

Highlight Le Chat's reply (or just tap **Copy** if your browser offers a copy button on the code-style blocks), then open your notes app — Apple Notes, Google Keep, Samsung Notes, or even a plain text message to yourself. Paste it in.

You'll see the headings and bullets come across cleanly in most modern notes apps. Some apps flatten the bullets into plain lines, but the structure (Produce / Dairy / etc.) usually survives as section titles. Pin the note to the top of your list so it's the first thing you see in the store.

If it looks different: in Safari on iPhone, you may need to use **Share → Select All → Copy** instead of dragging to highlight, because long AI replies can be tricky to grab. In the Le Chat mobile app, look for a small **copy icon** at the top-right of each AI message — tap it once and the whole reply goes to your clipboard.

You'll know it worked when the list is on your phone, readable at a glance, with store sections as headers and quantities next to each item. Walk into the store, tick items as you drop them in the cart, and toss the note when you get home.

Common mistakes

- **Asking without a format.** "Make me a shopping list" usually gives a paragraph of ingredients. Always say *grouped by section, bullet points only, no intro or outro* — otherwise you'll spend more time editing than you saved.
- **Forgetting the quantities.** Le Chat can summarize measurements ("a pinch", "to taste") or drop them entirely. If you care about exact amounts, add to your prompt: *"Keep the quantities — don't drop '1 tbsp' or '200 g'."*
- **Trusting the list blindly.** AI assistants occasionally misread a measurement (1 tbsp can become 1 tsp). Spend ten seconds scanning the list before you leave — it's faster than walking back to the store for a missing ingredient.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** the next time a friend sends you a link to "the best lasagna ever," you can have a printed-and-ready shopping list in two minutes flat. It also works for meal prep — paste four dinner recipes at once and Le Chat merges them into one master list for the week.
- **For your work or business:** if you run a small café, catering side-business, or a cooking class, this same trick turns any recipe PDF into a clean prep list for your team. The "no intro, no closing, bullet points only" format becomes a reusable prompt you keep in a note.
- **If you're just getting started:** don't worry about prompt engineering. One sentence — *"Group by store section, keep quantities, bullet points only"* — is enough to get a usable list nine times out of ten. Iterate from there.

Try it now

Pick a recipe you've been meaning to cook. Open `chat.mistral.ai`, paste the ingredients, and send this exact prompt:

> "Group these ingredients into a shopping list by store section. Keep quantities. Bullets only, no intro or closing."

Copy whatever Le Chat gives you into your notes app. That's the whole flow — and from now on, every recipe you save is two minutes away from the store.

How to Write a Personalized Bedtime Story for Your Child Tonight

5 steps · Read online

> **In short:** Open any AI assistant, type your child's name, their favorite animal, and tonight's mood, and you'll get a fresh 5-minute bedtime story in under a minute. Read it yourself or have the AI read it aloud — most assistants do this on a free plan.

This guide is for any parent, grandparent, or caregiver who wants a brand-new bedtime story tonight without writing one from scratch. No storytelling experience needed — just a phone, laptop, or tablet and about ten minutes.

Before you start

- **Any AI assistant** you already use — ChatGPT, Gemini, Claude, Copilot, Le Chat, and DeepSeek all work. If you don't have one yet, pick any of them and sign up on their website (most offer a free tier — check the official pricing page for current plan details).
- A device you can read on, ideally one that can also speak aloud (any phone or laptop with speakers).
- About 10 minutes total — 2 minutes to type the prompt, 2 minutes for the story to arrive, 5 minutes to read it.
- One honest note up front: the AI will draft the story, but it can't replace you reading it. Kids settle faster when a familiar voice does the reading — the AI just gives you the words.

Step 1 — Open your AI assistant and start a new chat

Open the app or website of the AI you usually use. If you've never used one, go to the homepage of any major assistant and create a free account — look for a button like **Sign up** or **Get started** in the top-right corner. Once you're in, start a fresh chat by looking for a **New chat** button or a + icon, usually at the top-left of the sidebar. You'll see an empty text box with a blinking cursor waiting for your question.

💬 Example: you don't need to type anything yet — just confirm the empty box is there.

If the assistant opens straight into an old conversation, scroll up or look for **New chat** in the sidebar. On a phone, the + or pencil icon usually sits at the top of the conversation list.

You'll know it worked when you see a blank chat screen with a text box ready for typing.

Step 2 — Type the story prompt with your child's details

Click into the text box and write a request that includes three things: your child's name, their favorite animal, and the mood you want tonight (calm, brave, silly, sleepy). You can also add a setting — a forest, the moon, under the sea — if your child has one. Keep it short and natural; the AI will fill in the rest.

Example: "Write a 5-minute bedtime story for my 5-year-old named Maya. Her favorite animal is a fox. Tonight she needs to feel brave because she's starting daycare tomorrow. Set it in a moonlit forest. Use simple words. End with Maya falling asleep smiling."

After you press Enter (or the **Send** arrow), the assistant starts typing its reply within a few seconds. You'll see words appear one chunk at a time — that's normal, not an error.

If the language comes out too advanced for your child's age, add a line like "use words a 4-year-old knows" and try again. If it spells the name wrong, just double-check the spelling in your original prompt and re-send it.

You'll know it worked when a story of roughly 300–500 words appears on screen, with your child's name and the animal woven through it.

Step 3 — Read it together and ask for tweaks

Read the story aloud to your child, or read it silently first if you want to check it. If a line feels off — too scary, too long, mentions something your child doesn't know — just type a follow-up request in the same chat. The assistant remembers the story, so you don't need to start over.

Example: "Make the fox a little funnier, and cut the part about the dark cave — Maya doesn't like caves."

Within seconds, a new version appears below your message. You can do this as many times as you like. If you want it shorter, type "make it 3 minutes instead of 5." If you want a rhyme, type "rewrite it as a rhyming poem."

If the assistant starts drifting away from the story (suggesting books to buy or adding random facts), politely say "please rewrite only the story, no extra tips." That usually fixes it.

You'll know it worked when your child smiles, asks a question about the fox, or asks to hear it again — all three are good signs.

Step 4 — Have the AI read it aloud (optional)

If you want a hands-free version, look for a **speaker icon**, a **Read aloud** button, or a **Play** triangle near the assistant's reply. On some apps this sits at the bottom of the message; on others

it's tucked inside a ⋯ menu or a small icon next to the text. Tap it, and the assistant reads the story in a synthetic voice while you hold the teddy bear.

Example: tap the speaker icon, then say to your child, "Want to hear what the fox says?"

If you can't find a speaker icon, copy the story (long-press then **Copy**, or use **Ctrl+C** / **Cmd+C**) and paste it into a separate text-to-speech app on your phone. Most phones have one built in — look in your settings for something called **Read Aloud**, **Spoken Content**, or **Text-to-Speech**.

You'll know it worked when you hear a voice reading the story and your child looks up from their toys.

Step 5 — Save the story so you can use it again

If your child loved it, save the chat. Most assistants keep your conversations automatically, but it's worth giving the chat a name you'll recognize later. Look for a way to **rename** the chat — usually a pencil icon next to the chat title in the sidebar — and call it something like "Maya's brave fox story." Next week, you can come back and type "tell me another story about Maya and the fox, this time she's learning to share" to get a sequel.

Example: rename the chat "Maya's brave fox night 1."

If you want a printable copy, copy the final story text into a notes app, an email to yourself, or a document. Some assistants also have a **Share** button (an arrow pointing up or a link icon) that lets you send the story to yourself or to a co-parent.

You'll know it worked when you can find the chat again tomorrow by name, and your child recognizes "their" fox.

Common mistakes

- **Asking for too much at once.** "Write a 30-minute epic with three villains and a plot twist" overwhelms the AI and your child. Stick to one mood, one animal, and one small moment — five minutes is plenty for bedtime.
- **Skipping the read-aloud check.** The AI sometimes slips in a sentence that's too complex or a little spooky. Always skim the story once before you start reading it to your child.
- **Forgetting to rename the chat.** Without a clear name, you'll scroll through dozens of conversations trying to find "the fox one" next week. Take five seconds at the end to rename it.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** Bedtime stops being a negotiation about which book to read for the hundredth time. You get a fresh story every night, and your child gets to be the hero of it.
- **For a tired caregiver:** When you don't have the brainpower to make up a story at 9pm, the AI carries the writing. You still do the cuddling, the silly voices, and the "one more chapter" — that part is yours.
- **If you're just getting started:** Try it once with the example prompt in Step 2, swapping in your own child's name and favorite animal. That's the whole learning curve.

Try it now

Open any AI assistant on your phone, type this prompt (filling in the blanks): "Write a 5-minute bedtime story for my [age]-year-old named [name]. Their favorite animal is a [animal]. Tonight they need to feel [mood]. Set it in [place]. Use simple words and end with [name] falling asleep smiling." Read it to your child tonight — no prep, no printing, no pressure.

How to build a calming bedtime routine for young kids in minutes

5 steps · Read online

> **In short:** In about 20 minutes you can use any AI chat assistant to draft an evening routine with timed steps, refine it over several messages, and print a one-page reminder card. The assistant can't know your child's habits, so you must check every suggestion against your own family's needs.

This guide shows you how to build a bedtime routine for a young child, aged roughly 3 to 7, with a plan you can tweak and a card for the fridge. You'll use a skill most chat assistants support well: a multi-step conversation where each reply builds on the last one. It's for parents, grandparents, and caregivers who want a calmer evening without starting from scratch.

Before you start

- **An AI chat assistant you already use** (any one works, free or paid). You should already know how to start a chat and send a message.
- **A notes app or word processor** on your phone or computer, to save your template and card.
- **A printer, or a phone that can print**, for the card. A nearby print shop also works.
- **About 20 to 30 minutes** total. Have your child's age and usual bedtime handy.

Step 1 — Write down your family's details first

Before you type anything to the assistant, open your notes app and jot down five things: your child's age, the time you'd like them asleep, the time you currently start winding down, the two or three activities they already enjoy (bath, a picture book, a song), and one activity that always causes trouble. A short list like this is the most useful thing you can give the assistant.

Why this matters: a generic routine is easy to write, but a routine that fits your house is what you'll actually use. The assistant only knows what you tell it in the chat. If the screen doesn't look like a chat box, look for a text field labeled something like "Message" or "Ask anything," though yours may differ.

💬 Example: "My son is [child's age] years old. We'd like him asleep by [bedtime]. He loves [favorite activity] and fights us about [tricky part] every night."

You'll know it worked when you have a short, specific list of facts ready to paste into the chat.

Step 2 — Ask for a timed first draft

Open a new chat and paste your details, then ask for a routine with clock-style timings counting backward from bedtime. Ask for gentle transitions, meaning a small signal that tells your child the next part is starting, such as a song or a countdown. Ask for pacing that fits the child's age. Most replies will arrive as a numbered list in one or two chunks. If the answer is a long essay instead, reply and say "Please format this as a numbered list with times."

Expect a first draft that's usable but generic. That's normal. You're not looking for a final answer yet.

Example: "Create a 30-minute bedtime routine for a [child's age]-year-old, ending at [bedtime]. Put a time next to each step, count backward from bedtime, and add one gentle transition cue between steps."

You'll know it worked when you see a numbered list where each line has a time and a single activity.

Step 3 — Refine the plan across several messages

This is the intermediate skill: keep the same chat and ask for changes one at a time. Read the draft and pick the single biggest problem. Perhaps the bath is too long, or the "wind-down" step lacks a clear start. Tell the assistant exactly what to change, and ask it to keep everything else the same. Repeat two or three times. Each round, check the new version against your Step 1 notes. If the reply drifts, say "Go back to the previous version and change only the bath step."

A caution: the assistant doesn't know whether a timing suits your child. Only you can judge that from experience. If a step seems too long or too short for your household, change it.

Example: "Keep this routine the same, but shorten the bath to 8 minutes and move the story to after pajamas. Then add a calm song as the transition into the story."

You'll know it worked when each change is clearly reflected in the list and the other steps stay unchanged.

Step 4 — Save a reusable template

Once you like the plan, ask the assistant to turn it into a template with blanks. This lets you reuse the structure on busy nights, or adapt it for a second child, a sleepover, or a change of season. Copy the reply into your notes app, title it something like "Bedtime template," and keep it where you can find it quickly.

Many assistants keep long chats, but a saved template is more reliable than digging back through old messages. If the reply comes back without blanks, ask again and specify the format. The template is yours to edit, so feel free to rewrite any line in your own words.

💬 Example: "Turn this final routine into a template. Replace each specific time with [time] and each activity with [activity], and keep the transition cues as they are."

You'll know it worked when your notes app holds a copyable version with clearly marked blanks.

Step 5 — Create a printable fridge card

Now ask for a one-page reminder card. Request large text, short lines, and simple icon ideas such as "a bath duck" or "a moon." Keep the card to six or seven lines so a child can read it with a grown-up. Paste the reply into a word processor, increase the font size if needed, and print it. Some people laminate the card or tape it up with painter's tape so it comes off without damage.

If the printout looks crowded, ask the assistant to shorten each line. If you don't have a printer, copy the card onto a whiteboard by hand.

💬 Example: "Make a one-page bedtime card with six lines, one step per line, large simple words, and a short icon idea next to each step."

You'll know it worked when the card fits on one page and a child can point to the next step without help.

Common mistakes

- **Trusting the first draft as final.** Generic timings may not fit your child. Fix: run at least two refinement rounds, then test the routine for a week and adjust.
- **Forgetting the honest limit.** The assistant can't see your child, can't diagnose sleep problems, and can't promise better sleep. Fix: if bedtime struggles continue, talk with your child's doctor or pediatrician, and treat the AI's plan as a starting idea.
- **Letting the chat get messy.** Long chats with many edits can blur the details. Fix: once the plan is settled, copy the final version into your notes and start a fresh chat for new ideas.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** You can build a calmer evening in one sitting, then reuse the template on nights when you're tired.
- **For your business or work:** If you run a daycare, after-school program, or childcare team, the same workflow can draft a shared routine for staff to review and adapt to each group.
- **If you want to go further:** Ask the assistant to compare two versions of your routine (in one chat, for your own use) and explain the trade-offs. Then test the version you choose for a week, and record in your notes what worked.

Try it now

Open your notes app and write your child's age, bedtime, and favorite activity. Then open an AI chat and send: "Create a 30-minute bedtime routine for a [child's age]-year-old, ending at [bedtime], with a time next to each step." Read the list once and pick one change to make.

How to design a custom birthday card with Midjourney in 10 minutes

5 steps · Read online

> **In short:** You'll learn to build a birthday card image in Midjourney by writing one base prompt, refining it through a few rounds, and leaving room for a name and a personal line. Midjourney generally needs a paid plan, and it often garbles written words, so add the final text in a design app.

You already know how to type a prompt and get a picture back. This guide shows you a more useful workflow: building a prompt in layers, comparing results, and tweaking one piece at a time. By the end, you'll have a card image that fits a specific person, ready for a little text overlay.

Before you start

- A Midjourney account and access to the place you usually generate images (the web interface or Discord, depending on how you use it). We assume you already know how to send a prompt.
- A paid Midjourney plan is usually required. Check the official site for current plan options, since they change.
- A free design app or your phone's photo editor, for the final text. Any simple tool with a text box works.
- The recipient's name, one short personal line (for example, "Happy birthday, Dana, here's to the garden year!"), and about 10 to 15 minutes.

Step 1 — Write a base prompt for the card's look

Start by describing the picture, not the words. Name the mood, the main subject and the style in one sentence. Midjourney reads your prompt as a set of visual ideas, so the more concrete the picture, the better. Keep it to one or two sentences for now. Don't ask for a name or sentence yet, because image generators usually struggle with written words.

💬 Example: "A cheerful birthday card scene with a watercolor bouquet of sunflowers and soft paper texture, warm yellow and sage green tones, [birthday style] mood."

If the image comes back too busy or too dark, that's normal for a first try. You'll refine it in the next steps.

You'll know it worked when the image shows the main subject and mood you described, even if the details are off.

Step 2 — Leave room for your text

Cards need empty space where the message will go. Tell Midjourney exactly where that space should be, so your name and line have a clean place to land later. Add a simple phrase to the end of your base prompt. Midjourney doesn't always obey placement words perfectly, so treat this as a strong hint, not a guarantee.

💬 Example: "...with open, uncluttered space across the top third for a message."

Also check the shape. Midjourney lets you request a proportion, such as a portrait card, by adding a parameter like `--ar 5:7` to the end of the prompt. If you're unsure about the exact syntax for your version, leave the shape out and crop later in your design app.

If the top is still full of flowers, try a stronger phrase like "plain background at the top" and generate again.

You'll know it worked when the top area of the picture looks calmer and has room for a short line of text.

Step 3 — Add a personal detail, not a name

Instead of putting the name in the image, add a personal detail that makes the card feel made for someone. Think of a hobby, a favorite color, or a place. This is the "custom" part: the picture reflects the person, and you'll add the name yourself afterward. Be specific, but keep the prompt short enough that the main subject stays clear.

💬 Example: "...with a tiny garden bench and a teal bicycle in the background, since [recipient's hobby] is gardening."

Generate once and compare with your Step 2 result. Ask yourself: does this feel like it belongs to this one person? If one detail dominates, remove it and try a softer version.

If the results look random, the prompt may have too many ideas. Cut the least important item and try again.

You'll know it worked when the picture includes your personal detail in a way that still feels like one cohesive scene.

Step 4 — Refine with variations

Midjourney usually shows a grid of images. Pick the one you like best and look for a button labeled something like Vary, Variations, or Upscale. The exact wording and layout can differ between the web interface and Discord, so look for any option that creates new versions of one

image. Use Vary when you like the overall direction and want small changes. Use Upscale when you want a larger, sharper version of the one you chose.

💬 Example: "Keep the sunflower bouquet and the open space at the top, but make the light warmer and the paper texture more visible."

Refining is a conversation with the image: each round changes one or two things. If the result drifts too far, go back to the last version you liked and make a smaller change.

Remember that the strongest, most detailed images may take longer to produce and may use more of your plan's allowance.

You'll know it worked when the new version keeps what you liked and improves one specific thing you asked for.

Step 5 — Add the name and message outside Midjourney

Save your favorite image to your device. Open a simple design or photo app, add a text box over the open area at the top, and type the recipient's name and your personal line. Check the spelling carefully, because Midjourney isn't reliable for exact text. Choose a readable font and a color that contrasts with the background. Many designers keep text in a single line at the top. If you want a printed card, check your printer's paper size and set the image to fit.

💬 Example: type "Happy birthday, [recipient name]! Here's to a year full of sunshine." in the open space.

If the app's text tools look different, look for an option called Text, Add text, or a letter "T" icon.

You'll know it worked when your name and message sit clearly over the image and you can read every word at phone size.

Common mistakes

- **Asking Midjourney to write the name.** Generated text often comes out misspelled or scrambled. The fix: leave the name out of the prompt and add it in a design app, as in Step 5.
- **Changing everything at once.** A new prompt with five new ideas makes it hard to know what helped. The fix: change one or two things per round, and keep the version you liked.
- **Assuming it's free.** Many people expect to use Midjourney for free, but it generally requires a paid plan. The fix: check the official site before you start, so you aren't surprised mid-project.

Midjourney can create the picture, but it can't send the card, know the recipient's real preferences, or guarantee perfect spelling. You're still the one who checks the final result.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** Make a personal card for a grandparent, friend, or coworker in one evening, with a picture tied to their hobby.
- **For your business or work:** Create a themed birthday card for a team member or a client's celebration, then match the style to your brand colors.
- **If you want to go further:** Try building a reusable prompt template with blanks for the hobby, colors, and mood. Then you can make a set of cards for a whole family in minutes.

Try it now

Open Midjourney, type the base prompt from Step 1 with a hobby of someone you know, and generate one image. Then ask yourself which single detail you'd change first.

Track your household budget with AI: simple steps for beginners

4 steps · Read online

Getting a clear picture of your household spending doesn't need complex spreadsheets or expensive software. By the end of this guide, you will know how to use a free **AI assistant** (a computer program designed to understand and respond to human language) to quickly organize your everyday expenses and find practical ways to save money, all with simple text commands. This guide is for anyone looking to simplify their personal budgeting.

Before you start

- **An AI assistant account**: You'll need access to a free AI chat tool, such as ChatGPT, Claude, or Google Gemini. These tools are available through a web browser or a dedicated app on your device.
- **A device with internet access**: A computer, tablet, or smartphone will work perfectly.
- **Your recent spending details**: Have a list of 5-10 recent transactions ready. You can find these in your bank's mobile app, on paper receipts, or simply by jotting down what you remember spending over the last few days.
- **Time commitment**: This whole process should take you about 10-15 minutes.

Step 1 — Gather your spending data

Your first step is to collect your recent spending information. Don't worry about formatting anything perfectly – the beauty of AI is that it can understand messy, everyday lists. Just get your transactions into a rough list, either by typing them out or copying them from a digital source.

What you see on screen: You might be looking at your bank's app, a collection of paper receipts, or just a blank document where you're typing. **What happens next:** You'll have a single, easy-to-read list of your spending, ready to share with the AI. **If it looks different:** If your bank app doesn't allow easy copying, simply write down each transaction, including the item and the amount, into a simple text document or notepad. 💬 Example: `Coffee $5.20, Petrol $75.00, Groceries $140.00, Electricity bill $195.00, Netflix $19.00, Takeaway dinner $45.00, Public transport $12.00.` **You'll know it worked when:** You have a clear, even if rough, list of your recent transactions in one place, ready for the next step.

Step 2 — Ask the AI to categorise your expenses

Now it's time to let the AI do the heavy lifting. You'll give the AI a **prompt** (which is simply the instruction you give to an AI, written in plain language, like asking a question). This prompt will

tell the AI how to sort your spending.

What you see on screen: Open your chosen AI assistant (like ChatGPT, Claude, or Gemini). You'll typically see a chat window with a text box at the bottom, labeled something like "Message" or "Ask AI". **What happens next:** After you press Enter or click the "Send" button, the AI will process your request. You'll usually see it start typing a response, often quite quickly, as it reads your list, groups the items logically, and calculates subtotals. **If it looks different:** If you don't see a clear "Send" button, just pressing the Enter key on your keyboard usually works. Ensure you've chosen a common AI assistant, as their interfaces are very similar for basic chat. 💬 Example: `"Please categorise the following list of household expenses into clear groups (like Food, Utilities, and Transport) and show me the total spent in each group: [Paste your list here]"` **You'll know it worked when:** The AI assistant displays your expenses categorised into groups with a total amount spent in each group, presented clearly in the chat window.

Step 3 — Get personalized saving tips

With your spending now neatly organized, the AI becomes a handy financial sounding board. Because it remembers the previous conversation – this is called its **context window** (think of it as the AI's short-term memory for your current chat) – you can ask it for tailored advice.

What you see on screen: The AI's previous categorised list will still be visible above your new prompt. The AI will start generating new text based on its understanding of your past expenses. **What happens next:** The AI will provide specific, practical suggestions on how you might be able to reduce your spending, directly related to the categories it just analyzed for you. **If it looks different:** If the AI seems to "forget" the previous categories, you can simply remind it by saying "Based on *the categories you just created*, can you suggest..." 💬 Example: `"Looking at these categories, can you suggest three realistic and gentle ways I could reduce my spending next week without making major lifestyle sacrifices?"` **You'll know it worked when:** The AI provides several actionable, personalized ideas for saving money, rather than generic tips.

Step 4 — Create a reusable weekly template

To keep your budgeting momentum going, ask the AI to design a simple, personalized template that you can use to track your spending manually next week. This helps you stay on top of your finances without needing to use the AI every single day.

What you see on screen: The AI's response will appear as a text output, likely a bulleted list or a simple table, presenting a structure for your budget. **What happens next:** You'll receive a ready-to-use template that you can easily copy and paste into any document, like a Word file or

a note-taking app, to fill in your actual spending. **If it looks different:** If the template isn't quite right (e.g., too many columns or not enough detail), simply ask the AI to "Please simplify it into a bulleted list" or "Can you add a column for notes?". 💬 Example: `"Create a simple weekly budget template for me based on these exact categories. Keep it clean so I can copy and paste it into a blank document to write in my actual spending next week."` **You'll know it worked when:** The AI presents a clear, organized budget template based on your specific spending categories, which you can easily copy and adapt for your ongoing use.

Common mistakes

- **Sharing sensitive personal information:** AI assistants are powerful, but they're not a secure place for private data.
    - *The fix:* Always review and delete account numbers, tax file numbers, home addresses, or full names from any financial data before pasting it into an AI tool.
- **Expecting perfect math:** While AI is great at categorising and understanding language, it's primarily a text-based tool, not a calculator.
    - *The fix:* For very long lists of numbers, the AI can occasionally make minor adding mistakes. Always do a quick manual check of the final total.
- **Being too vague in your prompts:** The AI can only work with the instructions you give it. If your prompt is unclear, the response might not be what you hoped for.
    - *The fix:* Be specific! Ask for "three realistic ways" instead of "some tips," or "categorise into Food, Transport, and Utilities" if you have specific categories in mind.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** You can instantly understand where your money is going without spending hours squinting at complex spreadsheets or getting bogged down in financial jargon. It's a quick and accessible way to gain insight into your spending habits.
- **For your business or work:** You can use these exact same sorting techniques to quickly categorise business receipts, project expenses, or client hours, making tax time or project reporting much simpler.
- **If you're just getting started:** Keep it incredibly simple. Start by analyzing just one weekend's worth of transactions to see how easy the process is, then gradually increase the amount of data you feed it.

Try it now

Open your preferred AI assistant right now, copy the text below, and hit send:

Here is my spending from yesterday: Cafe breakfast $24, Train fare $4.50, Supermarket top-up $38. Can you put these into categories and tell me my total spend?

How to Plan a Kids' Birthday Party Without Losing Your Mind

7 steps · Read online

> **In short:** A simple 7-step plan — date, theme, budget, invites, food and a day-of run sheet — turns a kids' birthday party into a calm afternoon instead of a last-minute scramble. Set the budget early and most of the stress disappears.

You can throw a party your kid remembers without throwing yourself into chaos. This guide gives you a calm, step-by-step plan you can start today — even if the birthday is weeks away. It won't stop every sugar crash or shy-kid meltdown, and it shouldn't try to. The job of a good plan is to make the day easier for *you*, so you can be present for the moments that matter.

Before you start

- A calendar — phone or paper, either works.
- A rough idea of how many kids your child actually wants there (not "everyone in class").
- About 90 minutes total, spread over a week — most of this work happens in 10-minute chunks.
- No special app needed. A notes app, a napkin, or a piece of paper is enough.

Step 1 — Lock in the date, time and guest count

Open your calendar and pick a date plus a 2-hour window, like **Saturday 2:00–4:00pm**. Then ask your child which 5–10 friends they really want there — the honest list, not the polite "everyone in class" answer. Write the number down. These three things — date, time window, and headcount — are the foundation everything else sits on. If your calendar app looks different, a notebook works just as well; the tool doesn't matter, the decision does. 💬 Example: "Saturday, June 14, 2:00–4:00pm. Guests: 8 kids + 2 siblings." You'll know it worked when you can say the date, time and number of kids out loud without checking.

Step 2 — Pick a theme and set a budget

Ask your child one question: *"What do you want this party to feel like?"* Pirate ship, dance party, dinosaur dig — anything works. Write the theme in one short phrase. Then set a budget: a single number for the whole party, split into three buckets — food, decorations/activities, and a small "surprises" cushion. Most stress at kids' parties comes from spending that wasn't planned, not from the kids being picky. 💬 Example: "Theme: dinosaur dig. Budget total $200. Food $80, decor + activities $90, surprises $30." You'll know it worked when you have one clear theme phrase and one number for the total spend.

Step 3 — Build a simple countdown checklist

Open a notes app, a piece of paper, or a spreadsheet — whatever you already use. Create four buckets: **4 weeks out, 2 weeks out, 1 week out, day before**. Now drop the obvious tasks into each: book the venue (if not home), send invites, buy decorations, plan food, buy or bake the cake, prep goody bags. Don't try to make it pretty. A messy list you'll actually use beats a tidy one you won't. If a spreadsheet feels like overkill, four sticky notes on the fridge work fine. Example: "4 weeks: send invites. 2 weeks: buy decor + cake ingredients. 1 week: confirm RSVPs. Day before: set up." You'll know it worked when you can glance at the list and see exactly what to do today.

Step 4 — Send the invites and track the RSVPs

Send invites at least 2–3 weeks ahead — paper ones in mailboxes, a text to the parent group, or a free template from a basic invite app. Each invite should include the date, time, address, theme (so parents know what to expect), and an RSVP date about a week before the party. As replies come in, write each name next to yes, no, or "didn't reply yet." This list is your real headcount — the one you actually use to buy food and a cake. Example: "Hi! Maya's turning 6, dinosaur-dig party, Saturday June 14, 2–4pm at our place. Please RSVP by June 7." You'll know it worked when you have a clear yes-list 5 days before the party, not the morning of.

Step 5 — Plan food, cake and one anchor activity

Keep the food simple: one main, one snack, one drink, and the cake. Kids don't need variety; they need predictability. The **anchor activity** is the one thing kids will remember — a treasure hunt, a piñata, a dance freeze game — pick one, plan the supplies, and stop there. Two extra "just in case" activities (a coloring sheet, a movie queued up) cover you if the anchor ends early. If you can't decide between two activities, flip a coin — indecision takes more energy than a small mistake. Example: "Food: mini sandwiches + grapes + juice + cake. Anchor: backyard dinosaur dig with toy fossils." You'll know it worked when you can list the food in one breath and name the main activity without looking.

Step 6 — Write a day-of run sheet (the calm-maker)

The night before, write a single page with five time blocks: **setup** (1 hour before), **guest arrival**, **food/cake**, **activity**, and **goodbye**. Under each block, write the 2–3 things that MUST happen — not a wish list, only the must-haves. Example: "2:00 guests arrive. 2:15 snack. 2:45 dinosaur dig. 3:30 cake. 3:50 goody bags. 4:00 pickup." Tape it to the fridge. When something goes sideways (it will), the run sheet is your reset button — you read the next block and keep moving. Example: "1:00 setup. 2:00 arrive. 2:15 snack. 2:45 dig. 3:30 cake. 3:50 bags. 4:00 done." You'll know it worked when you can read it in 30 seconds and know what comes next.

Step 7 — Day-of: do less, breathe more

On the day, give yourself one rule: **do less than planned**. Skip one decoration, shorten the activity by 10 minutes, and stop trying to photograph everything. Kids don't measure the party by how perfect it looked; they measure it by how relaxed you were. If something flops, no kid has ever gone home saying "the piñata was too short." After the last guest leaves, write down one thing that worked and one you'd change — that's gold for next year. You'll know it worked when the kids are smiling, the cake is eaten, and you actually enjoyed it.

Common mistakes

- **Skipping the budget.** Picking a theme and adding up the receipts later usually ends in a $50 surprise at the register. Fix: pick the total number in Step 2 and split it into three buckets *before* you shop.
- **Inviting "the whole class."** 25+ kids triples food cost, triples activity planning, and triples your stress. Fix: let your child pick 6–10 real friends, then add 2–3 siblings if needed.
- **Planning too many activities.** Three scheduled games means none of them actually get finished, and you spend the party refereeing transitions. Fix: one anchor activity + one backup, and let the rest be free play.
- **No run sheet.** Without one, the day turns into a blur of "what now?" moments and a hangry child at 3pm. Fix: spend 10 minutes the night before writing the five time blocks from Step 6.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** The shape of this plan — date, scope, budget, list, day-of script — works for playdates, holidays, and family trips too. Same bones, different costume.
- **For your work or small business:** Project planning uses the same skeleton: scope, budget, timeline, run sheet. The party is a low-stakes way to practice the muscle you'll use on bigger projects.
- **If you're just getting started:** Do Steps 1, 2, and 3 on a napkin tonight. Don't open a spreadsheet, don't download a template, don't overthink it. The messy first draft is the one that actually saves you on the day.

Try it now

Open your phone's notes app, write your child's next birthday date at the top, and list the 5–10 names of friends they'd actually want there. That's your foundation — everything else slots in on top of it, one step at a time.

Create a Smart-Home Security Alert with Alexa Routines

7 steps · Read online

> **In short:** This guide shows you how to set up an Alexa routine that announces a voice alert or sends a push notification when a door sensor opens. Basic Alexa routines are free; Alexa+, which adds advanced AI features on top, is free for Prime members in the US and available as a paid subscription without Prime.

This guide helps you turn your Amazon Alexa-enabled devices into a simple security monitor. By the end, you'll be able to set up an alert that tells you instantly when a door or window with a smart sensor is opened, perfect for keeping an eye on things at home.

Before you start

- An **Amazon account**.
- The **Alexa app** installed on your smartphone or tablet.
- At least one **Alexa-enabled device** (like an Echo speaker or Show display) connected to your account. This is where the alert will sound.
- A **compatible smart-home door or window sensor** already set up and linked to your Alexa app. This device detects when something opens.
- Basic Alexa routines with smart home sensors are included with standard Alexa — no extra subscription required. (Alexa+ is Amazon's upgrade that adds generative AI features; in the US it's included with Prime.)
- Roughly **10-15 minutes** of your time.

Step 1 — Open the Alexa App

First, find and tap the **Alexa app icon** on your smartphone or tablet's home screen. The icon usually looks like a blue speech bubble with a white ring inside, or the Alexa logo. Once it opens, you'll see your main Alexa home screen, which shows various cards with suggestions, recent activities, or smart home device statuses. After tapping, the app will load, bringing you to this central screen. If it looks different, you might need to update your app or log in with your Amazon account. You'll know it worked when: The Alexa app's main "Home" screen is visible, showing your connected devices and activities.

Step 2 — Start a New Routine

Now, let's head to the 'Routines' section to create your alert. Look for the **"More"** button, usually located in the bottom right corner of the Alexa app screen. Tap on it, and a menu will slide up from the bottom with options like 'Skills & Games', 'Reminders', and 'Routines'. Tap **"Routines"**. On the next screen, you'll see any existing routines you have. To start fresh, tap the

"+" icon (plus symbol), usually in the top right corner. You'll know it worked when: A new screen appears titled "New Routine" or "Create a Routine", ready for you to add details.

Step 3 — Name Your Routine

It's a good idea to give your routine a clear name so you know what it does at a glance. Tap the field that says **"Enter routine name"** or "Routine Name". A keyboard will appear, allowing you to type a descriptive title. For this alert, choose something like "Door Open Alert" or "Front Door Security". Tapping the name field will open the keyboard, then type. Example: `Front Door Open Alert` You'll know it worked when: The name you typed is displayed at the top of the routine creation screen.

Step 4 — Set the Trigger (Door Sensor)

This is where you tell Alexa *when* to perform the action. We call this a **trigger** – it's like the starting gun for your routine. Tap **"When this happens"** or "Add event". From the list of options, choose **"Smart Home"**. You'll then see a list of your connected smart home devices. Find and tap your **door or window sensor** from this list. A new screen will appear asking for the "State" – select **"Open"**. This means the routine will start when the sensor detects the door opening. You'll know it worked when: Your door sensor is listed under "When this happens" with the state "Open".

Step 5 — Choose the Action (Announce Alert)

Next, we define what Alexa should *do* when the trigger occurs – this is called the **action**. Tap **"Add action"** or the "+" button next to "Add action". A list of available actions will appear. Scroll down and select **"Alexa says"**. On the next screen, choose **"Customized"**. Here, you can type the exact message you want Alexa to announce, like "The front door has been opened." If you prefer a notification on your phone, choose "Send notification" instead of "Alexa says." Example: `Attention, the front door has just opened.` You'll know it worked when: Your custom message or "Send notification" is listed under "Add action".

Step 6 — Select Device for Alert & Save

Now, tell Alexa *where* to announce the alert. If you selected "Alexa says" in the previous step, tap **"From"** at the bottom of the screen. You can choose a specific Echo device (e.g., "Living Room Echo") or "The device you speak to" (if you want it to announce on the closest Alexa speaker). If you chose "Send notification," you won't see this option as it sends to your phone. Once you've chosen, tap **"Save"** or the tick mark, usually in the top right corner. Alexa will process your new routine. You'll know it worked when: You return to the main "Routines" screen, and your new "Front Door Open Alert" is visible in the list.

Step 7 — Test Your Routine

The final step is to make sure your new routine works perfectly. Find the door or window where your smart sensor is installed. **Open the door** slightly, as you would normally. You should hear your chosen Alexa device announce your custom message, or receive a push notification on your phone if you selected that option. If it doesn't work right away, give it a few seconds, as sometimes there's a small delay. You'll know it worked when: Your Alexa device announces your message, or your phone receives a notification, immediately after you open the door.

Common mistakes

- **Sensor not properly connected or battery low:** If Alexa doesn't recognize the door opening, double-check that your smart sensor is correctly paired with Alexa and has fresh batteries. The Alexa app's "Devices" section can usually show the sensor's status.
- **Alexa device is muted or volume is too low:** If you don't hear the announcement, ensure the volume on your chosen Alexa speaker is up and it's not muted. Try saying "Alexa, what's the volume?" to check.
- **Routine is not enabled or saved:** After creating the routine, sometimes users forget to tap "Save". Make sure the routine is listed in your "Routines" section and its toggle switch is set to "Enabled."

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** This simple routine offers a basic layer of security and awareness for your home. You'll get an immediate heads-up if a child opens a door they shouldn't, if a pet pushes open a gate, or simply when someone arrives home, even if you're in another room. It adds a smart ear to your home environment.
- **For your business or work:** While this guide focuses on personal use, a similar setup could be used in a home office to monitor a storage cupboard or an infrequently used back entrance. It helps maintain awareness of physical access points without needing a full security system.
- **If you're just getting started:** Try creating another routine that switches on a smart light when the same door opens, but only at night. This combines a security alert with a practical convenience.

Try it now

Open your Alexa app, go to "Routines," and enable or disable your "Front Door Open Alert" with a single tap to see how easily you can manage your new smart home security feature.

How to plan a multi-stop road trip with realistic driving times

6 steps · Read online

> **In short:** A realistic road-trip plan pairs each destination with a drive time, a midday break, a fuel stop, and an overnight — not just a list of places you want to visit. In about 30 minutes you can turn a wish list into a day-by-day itinerary an AI assistant can help you tighten.

A good road-trip plan answers three questions before you ever pack a bag: how far you'll actually drive each day, where you'll sleep, and where you'll stop in between. This guide walks you, step by step, through building that plan — with the help of any AI assistant you already use (ChatGPT, Gemini, Claude, Copilot, or similar). You don't need any special software, and you don't need to be a planner type.

Before you start

- **An AI assistant** you can type into — a free account on ChatGPT, Gemini, Claude, Copilot, or whichever you prefer. No paid plan is needed for this task.
- **A rough list of places** you want to visit, in the order you'd like to see them (even a messy list works).
- **A rough trip length** — how many days you have, including travel days at each end.
- **About 30 minutes** of focused time. You'll do a little typing, then a little editing — the AI does the math and the draft.

Step 1 — Gather your wish list and your constraints

Open your AI assistant and start a fresh chat. In one message, tell it four things: where you're starting from, the places you want to visit (in order), how many days you have, and any hard constraints (one traveler who can't do more than 6 hours of driving a day, no overnight drives, a pet coming along, a budget ceiling, and so on). **What you see:** a chat box with a blinking cursor; if you've used the tool before, an empty conversation thread. **What happens next:** the assistant will probably echo back your list to confirm it understood, then ask a clarifying question or two — that's normal. **If it looks different:** if you don't see a chat box, look for a button labeled **New chat**, **New conversation**, or a + icon at the top or side of the screen. **Example:** *"I'm starting from Denver. I'd like to visit Rocky Mountain National Park, Cheyenne, and the Black Hills in South Dakota. I have 6 days total, including travel. I can drive about 5 hours a day max, and I'd like one overnight stop roughly halfway. I have a small dog."* **You'll know it worked when** the assistant restates your starting point, your three stops, your day count, and your driving cap in plain language.

Step 2 — Ask for a day-by-day draft

In the same chat, ask the assistant to build a draft day-by-day plan that respects the cap you gave it. Specifically say you want realistic drive times between each stop, not "as the crow flies" distances (a straight line on a map can look short but take twice as long by road), and you want one named overnight town between the longer legs. **What you see:** the assistant typing out a multi-paragraph response with a numbered or bulleted breakdown. **What happens next:** it produces a draft — probably Day 1, Day 2, and so on, with a drive time for each leg and a suggested town to sleep in. **If it looks different:** some assistants format plans as tables; others use bold headings. Either way works. If the assistant gives only a list of places with no times, your prompt was too vague — send a follow-up like *"Now turn that into a day-by-day plan with drive times for each leg."* **Example:** *"Please build me a day-by-day plan for those 6 days. Use realistic driving times (not straight-line distance), keep each day under 5 hours behind the wheel, and pick one overnight town roughly halfway between Denver and the Black Hills. Show me where I'd stop for lunch and fuel on each driving day."* **You'll know it worked when** the response has 5–6 labeled days, each with a drive-time number (like "about 4h 20m"), an overnight town, and a meal or fuel note.

Step 3 — Sanity-check the longest driving day

Now zoom in on the day the assistant flagged as the longest. Ask it to break that single leg into smaller pieces: roughly when to leave, where to stop for lunch (a town about halfway, not a rest area if you can help it), where to refuel, and a rough arrival time at the overnight town. Driving fatigue (the dangerous tired feeling you get after hours at the wheel) is the single biggest risk on a road trip, so this day matters most. **What you see:** a focused reply about one specific day, usually formatted as a short timeline. **What happens next:** the assistant produces a morning–midday–evening breakdown with rough clock times. **If it looks different:** if it gives you only kilometers and not clock times, ask "What time would I arrive if I leave at 8 a.m.?" **Example:** *"For Day 3 (the longest one), break it down: what time should I leave, where should I stop for lunch around midday, where should I fuel up, and what time would I arrive at the overnight town?"* **You'll know it worked when** you can read the response and picture your actual morning, afternoon, and evening — start time, lunch stop, fuel stop, arrival time.

Step 4 — Add buffer for the unexpected

Ask the assistant to add a 30–60 minute buffer to each driving day. Real roads have construction (roadwork that slows you down), weather, a wrong turn, a coffee stop that turns into a 25-minute chat, and a dog that needs an extra walk. A plan without buffer turns a 5-hour drive into a 7-hour day and ruins the next morning. Tell the assistant to bake that slack into the plan, not pile it onto the last day. **What you see:** an updated day-by-day plan with slightly more relaxed timing. **What happens next:** the assistant revises the itinerary — usually by

trimming a side stop, not by adding a day. **If it looks different:** if the assistant says it can't add buffer without adding a day, that's a useful signal: your original trip may be too ambitious, and you should either cut a stop or add a day. **Example:** *"Now go back through each driving day and add a 45-minute buffer for construction, weather, or a longer-than-planned lunch. Don't just tack it on at the end — spread it through the day."* **You'll know it worked when** every driving day in the plan has at least a half-hour of slack built in, and the longest day is still under your stated driving cap.

Step 5 — Pin the overnights and confirm them

Overnights are the load-bearing pieces of the whole plan — if one falls through (a fully booked hotel, a closed campground), the trip falls apart. Ask the assistant to name **two** options for each overnight town: a mid-range hotel/motel and a budget campground or guesthouse, and to flag any night where options look thin (small towns in the middle of long drives often have only one or two places to stay). **What you see:** a short list of overnight towns, each with 1–2 named accommodation types. **What happens next:** you now have a list to actually book — the AI can't book for you, but it can tell you what to search for. **If it looks different:** the assistant may hedge with phrases like "there are usually a few options in town" — that's fine; treat it as a signal to book early, especially in summer. **Example:** *"For each overnight town, give me two options: one mid-range hotel/motel, and one budget campground or guesthouse. Flag any night where options look limited."* **You'll know it worked when** each overnight has at least two named options, and you've spotted the one or two nights where you should book first.

Step 6 — Save the plan in a format you'll actually use

Ask the assistant to put the final plan into one clean block you can copy into a notes app, an email to your travel companions, or a printed sheet on the passenger seat. Specify the format you want — a numbered day-by-day list, a simple table, or a single paragraph per day. **What you see:** a final, neatly formatted plan you can copy with one click (look for a **Copy** button at the bottom-right of the response, or select the text and copy it). **What happens next:** you paste it into wherever you keep trip notes — Apple Notes, Google Docs, a printed page, a group chat. **If it looks different:** some assistants add a "Share" or "Export" option; if not, plain copy-and-paste works on every device. **Example:** *"Now give me the whole plan as a clean numbered list — one day per section, with drive time, overnight town, and one sentence on what to see or do there. I want to copy this straight into my notes."* **You'll know it worked when** you have the entire trip in one block you can paste somewhere and read at a glance, with no further editing needed.

Common mistakes

- **Trusting straight-line distance.** A map dot that seems "right next door" can be a 3-hour mountain drive. Always ask for driving time, never just kilometers.
- **Skipping the buffer.** A plan that uses every minute of your driving cap will crack the first time you hit construction or weather. Build slack in from the start.
- **Leaving overnights to chance.** Small towns have one motel and zero campgrounds. Book the first and second nights as soon as you have the plan — the rest can wait a week.
- **Asking the AI to "just plan it" with no constraints.** The more you tell it (max hours, pet, budget, season), the closer the first draft is to usable. A vague prompt gets a vague plan.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** the same shape — a goal, a constraint, a buffer, a backup — works for almost any multi-step plan (a move, a wedding, a busy weekend). Practicing it on a road trip makes the next one easier.
- **For your business or work:** if you ever drive to client sites, conferences, or field visits, the same template (drive time + meal + fuel + overnight) turns a string of appointments into a route a colleague could follow.
- **If you're just getting started:** the easiest first move is to ask any AI assistant for a 3-day plan between two cities you've actually driven between. Seeing it laid out day-by-day is what makes the difference click.

Try it now

Open your AI assistant and type this in one message: *"I'm driving from [your city] to [a city about 5 hours away] with one overnight stop. Plan me a 3-day round trip with realistic drive times, a lunch stop on the way out, and a buffer for traffic. Tell me what time to leave each morning."* Watch how much of the plan shows up in the first reply.

How to Plan a Weekend Getaway Itinerary with Any AI Assistant

6 steps · Read online

> **In short:** Open any AI assistant (ChatGPT, Gemini, Claude, Copilot, Le Chat or DeepSeek all work), paste in a short brief about your city, dates and interests, and ask for a day-by-day plan plus a short list of restaurants. You can have a usable weekend itinerary in about ten minutes, though you'll still need to confirm opening hours and book tables yourself.

A weekend getaway is one of the easiest first projects for an AI assistant, because the answer mostly comes from your own head: where you're going, when, and what you enjoy. The AI's job is to organize all of that into a tidy day-by-day plan so you don't spend your Friday night scrolling review sites. You don't need any special tool — the free version of any major assistant is enough. What you do need is a clear, specific first message. That's the whole trick.

Before you start

- **An account on at least one AI assistant.** ChatGPT, Gemini, Claude, Microsoft Copilot, Le Chat (Mistral) or DeepSeek all work for this task. The free plan is fine; you don't need to pay.
- **A device** — phone, tablet or computer with the app installed or the website open. The same prompts work everywhere.
- **A few facts to paste in:** your destination city, your arrival and departure dates, who's traveling (solo, couple, family with kids), and two or three interests (coffee shops, museums, hiking, live music, etc.). Optional: a neighborhood you'd like to stay in and a rough daily budget per person.
- **Roughly 10 minutes.** Step 1 takes 1 minute; the back-and-forth in Steps 2–5 takes 5–8; saving the plan takes 1.

Step 1 — Open a fresh chat in your AI assistant

Open the app or website of the assistant you've chosen and start a brand-new conversation. Look for a button labeled **"New chat," "New conversation,"** or a simple + or **pencil icon** at the top or bottom of the screen. On a phone it's usually at the top-right of the chat list; on a computer it's often a top-left button next to the assistant's name. If you can't see it, look for a small **chat-bubble icon with a plus**. A blank text box appears, ready for your first message. Starting fresh matters because the AI uses everything earlier in the chat as context, and an old conversation about your taxes will steer it the wrong way. If your screen looks like a list of past chats instead, tap the most recent one only after you've started a new one above it. You'll know

it worked when you see an empty text box with a blinking cursor and no text above it from a previous conversation.

Step 2 — Paste in your trip basics

In the empty text box, type or paste a short paragraph that gives the AI the four things it can't guess: **destination, dates, who is coming, and your interests.** Keep it under 80 words. The cleaner the brief, the better the plan. After you press **Enter** (or the **paper-plane / send arrow** icon), the assistant will usually reply with a short acknowledgment and start asking follow-up questions, OR jump straight into a draft plan — both are normal. If you don't see a send button on mobile, tap the text box once to bring up the keyboard, and the send icon should appear in the bottom-right corner of the keyboard. Some assistants also accept voice input through a **microphone icon** — feel free to speak the same paragraph out loud if typing feels slow. You'll know it worked when the assistant starts replying to *your* trip instead of giving a generic greeting.

Example: *"Plan a weekend trip to Lisbon, Portugal. Dates: Friday March 13 to Sunday March 15, 2026. Two adults, no kids. We like walking neighborhoods, local food, one or two museums, and live music at night. We'd like to stay in the Alfama or Baixa area. Budget: about €80 per person per day, not counting the hotel."*

Step 3 — Ask for a day-by-day plan, broken into morning, afternoon and evening

Send a second message that asks for the plan in a specific shape: **one day at a time, with morning, afternoon and evening blocks.** This structure is what turns a generic list into something you can actually use. After you send it, the assistant usually writes a numbered day-by-day plan with suggested times and short notes for each block. Some assistants will offer a table; others will use plain bullet points — both are fine. If the first reply is a wall of text with no time blocks, your request didn't get through clearly; just send the same instruction again, perhaps in shorter form. On Claude and ChatGPT, you can also tap **"Regenerate"** to get a second version of the same answer. You'll know it worked when the reply shows three labeled sections for each day (Morning, Afternoon, Evening) with concrete places or activities, not vague advice like "explore the city."

Example: *"Great, now write it as a day-by-day plan. For each day, give me three blocks: morning, afternoon and evening. Include a one-line reason for each pick and approximate travel time between spots. Keep the walking under 6 km per day."*

Step 4 — Ask for restaurant and café suggestions that match the plan

Send a follow-up that asks specifically for **food: breakfast, lunch, dinner and one or two coffee stops**, tied to the neighborhoods you'll already be in that day. This is where the AI shines, because it can place a casual lunch near your 2 pm museum instead of making you commute across town. The assistant will typically respond with a list of named places, what cuisine each one serves, and a price range. A small caveat: restaurants open and close, so treat the names as strong hints, not gospel. Some assistants (ChatGPT, Gemini, Copilot) can pull live web data and link to the current website or menu; others (older Claude versions, some Le Chat configurations) work only from their training data. If your assistant doesn't link anything, copy two or three names into a search engine before you go. You'll know it worked when you have at least 8–10 named places spread across your two days, with a clear sense of which meal they're for.

Example: *"Now suggest places to eat across the weekend, tied to the neighborhoods in the plan. I want: 2 breakfast spots, 2 lunch spots, 2 dinner spots and 1 coffee stop per day. Mark which cuisine each place is known for and a rough price (€, €€, €€€). Skip tourist-trap places and prefer family-run spots."*

Step 5 — Refine with one or two targeted follow-ups

Now that you have a draft, send **one or two short follow-ups** to fix the parts that don't fit you. Good follow-ups are specific: "swap Saturday afternoon for something outdoors," "we don't drink, suggest alcohol-free evening options," "we have a 4-year-old, add one kid-friendly stop per day." Each follow-up produces a revised plan, usually within seconds. Don't send five messages at once — one tweak at a time gives you a cleaner result and makes it easier to undo a change. If the assistant forgets an earlier request, paste the relevant line from your first message back into the chat to remind it. Some assistants have a small **"Edit"** or **pencil icon** next to your old messages; tapping it lets you rewrite your own message and re-roll the assistant's answer from that point. You'll know it worked when the latest reply reflects your tweak and the rest of the plan still makes sense.

Example: *"Swap the Saturday afternoon museum for an outdoor activity — we want sunshine if possible. Keep everything else the same."*

Step 6 — Save the plan somewhere you can read it without internet

Once the plan feels right, copy it into **Notes, Google Docs, Apple Notes, Notion, or a simple text file** so it's there even when you have no signal. Long press the assistant's reply on a phone (or **right-click** on a computer) and choose **Copy**, then paste into a note titled with your destination and dates. On ChatGPT you can also tap **Share** → **Read view** and save the link; on Gemini there's an **Export to Docs** button at the bottom of the reply. Keep restaurants in a separate short list inside the same note, with addresses or a screenshot of the map. You'll know it

worked when you can open the note on your phone in airplane mode and see your whole weekend at a glance.

💬 Example: Create a note called "Lisbon March 13–15" with two sections — "Plan" (the day-by-day) and "Eat" (the restaurant list with addresses).

Common mistakes

- **Vague first message.** "Plan me a weekend trip" gives a generic reply. Always include destination, dates, who's going and interests in the first message.
- **Trusting opening hours and prices blindly.** AI assistants can name a real restaurant that has since closed or changed its menu. A 30-second check on Google Maps the day before saves disappointment.
- **Forgetting to ask for the plan in time blocks.** Without "morning / afternoon / evening" the AI often gives a flat list of attractions with no logic for how to chain them. Ask for the structure up front.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** You can turn a vague idea ("we should go somewhere next month") into a usable plan in one sitting — no travel agent, no forum scrolling. The same prompt style works for day trips, birthday weekends, and visiting friends in another city.
- **For your business or work:** The same technique scales to client visits, conference travel and team offsites: paste in the city, event schedule, and number of attendees, and ask for a structured plan with meal blocks. You'll still book the tables, but you'll stop overpaying for hotels in the wrong neighborhood.
- **If you're just getting started:** Treat the AI as a fast first draft, not a finished booking system. The plan is a starting point; the verification step (Step 6, plus a quick check of hours) is what turns it into a real trip.

Try it now

Open your AI assistant, start a new chat, and paste in this exact prompt — replace the city with your own destination:

"Plan a weekend trip to [YOUR CITY] on [DATES]. Two adults. We like [2–3 interests, e.g. local food, walking neighborhoods, live music]. Suggest a day-by-day itinerary with morning, afternoon and evening blocks, plus 6 named places to eat across the two days."

You'll have a draft itinerary in under a minute.

How to plan a family road trip with kid-friendly stops and breaks

6 steps · Read online

> **In short:** Ask your AI assistant (ChatGPT, Claude, Gemini, Copilot, Le Chat, or another) to break the trip into short driving chunks, suggest kid-friendly stops, and draft a snack list the family can vote on. You keep the final say — the assistant does the research and the formatting.

Family road trips live or die by the stops. A six-hour straight shot sounds romantic on a map and feels like a hostage situation by mile three. The trick — two-to-three-hour chunks between breaks, one kid-friendly stop each, snacks everyone picked ahead of time — is well known. The hard part is doing the planning without it eating your whole week. That's where a chat assistant earns its keep: it does the boring research, and you keep the family happy.

Before you start

- An AI assistant you already use — ChatGPT, Claude, Gemini, Microsoft Copilot, Le Chat, or any other. Free plans work; paid plans usually give longer answers and fewer rate limits.
- A rough idea of the trip: starting city, destination, total days, kids' ages, and any must-see stops.
- About 30 to 45 minutes at the kitchen table with the family.
- A notes app on your phone so you can copy the final plan somewhere useful.

Step 1 — Open one fresh chat and give it a clear job

Start a new conversation in your assistant and, if the app lets you, name the chat something you'll recognize later — *"Summer road trip 2026"* or *"Grandma's house drive"*. The whole planning session lives in this one chat so the assistant remembers the trip details from message to message. If your app doesn't offer chat titles, just start the first message with a clear subject line.

Example: name the chat *"Smith family road trip July 2026"*.

You'll know it worked when you see a new chat with your title at the top and an empty message box at the bottom. If you don't see a way to rename the chat, look for a pencil or edit icon near the chat list — most apps keep it there.

Step 2 — Send one structured prompt with all the trip basics

In the message box, type a single paragraph that lays out the whole trip at once: where you're starting, where you're going, how many days you have, the kids' ages, any must-see places, and

your daily driving cap. Six to ten sentences is plenty. This is the prompt you'll keep reusing as the family changes its mind, so keep the structure the same.

Example: *"Plan a 5-day family road trip from Denver to Yellowstone in July. Two kids, ages 6 and 9. We want to drive no more than 3 hours per day. Must-see: a dinosaur museum and one national park. Avoid: toll roads. Suggest kid-friendly stops every 2-3 hours and a snack plan for the car."*

You'll know it worked when the assistant replies with a structured plan — usually a list of daily chunks with stops and times. If the answer is vague or too short, send the same prompt again with one extra sentence: *"please put the daily plan in a table with columns for day, drive, stops, and notes."*

Step 3 — Ask it to break the route into 2-3 hour driving chunks

Reply in the same chat — don't start a new one, or the assistant forgets everything — and ask for a day-by-day driving schedule. This is the heart of the trick: shorter chunks mean shorter meltdowns. Ask for each day's start and end city, total miles, and one or two suggested stops in between.

Example: *"Now give me a day-by-day driving schedule. For each day, show departure city, arrival city, total miles, and 2 kid-friendly stops between them — a park, playground, or quirky roadside attraction. Keep each day under 3 hours of driving."*

You'll know it worked when you see a table or list with every day's drive broken into clear segments, plus the type of stop suggested for each one. If a suggested stop is more than 30 minutes off your route, ask for a closer alternative — *"swap that stop for one within 15 minutes of the highway"* — and the assistant will rework the day without losing the rest.

Step 4 — Build a snack and break plan the family agrees on

Send another message in the same chat asking for a snack list, but tell the assistant to give you options to vote on, not a finished list. A snack the kids picked feels like a treat; a snack you picked feels like punishment. Ask for three small buckets: things to buy at the store, things to pack from home, and one small "treat" surprise per day.

Example: *"Now a snack plan for 5 days in the car, 2 kids. Give me: (a) 5 store-bought snacks easy to eat in the car, (b) 5 things to pack from home, (c) one small 'special' surprise per day. Keep it to foods that don't melt or make a mess. Format as a single list, not a table."*

You'll know it worked when you get a single readable list you can copy into your notes app or shopping app. Bring that list to the kitchen table, let the kids cross off what they don't like, and

you have an agreed-on plan in about five minutes — instead of the usual forty-minute argument.

Step 5 — Iterate on the family's feedback

This is the step that turns a one-shot answer into a real plan. Once the kids have vetoed a few snacks and you've changed your mind about a stop, send a follow-up message in the same chat summarizing what's new. The assistant will rebuild just the changed pieces without you having to re-explain the whole trip. This is also where you ask for things the AI can't do alone — like swapping a museum because it's closed Tuesdays, or finding a playground with shade at your lunch stop.

💬 Example: *"Update the plan: kids vetoed beef jerky and fish crackers — swap those for two similar store-bought options. The dinosaur museum is closed Tuesdays; move that day to Wednesday. Recalculate the driving schedule, leave the rest unchanged."*

You'll know it worked when the assistant gives a clean revised plan that keeps the trip structure and only swaps the pieces you listed. If it tries to rewrite the whole trip from scratch, add *"only update the items I listed, leave everything else as is"* — that keeps it focused.

Step 6 — Save and share the final plan

When the plan feels right, copy the assistant's last reply into your notes app, a shared family document, or a printed sheet for the glove box. Most assistants also have a way to share or export a chat — look for an icon like a share arrow, three dots, or a *"copy"* button near the chat. Some assistants let you pin a chat to the top so you can come back to it during the trip and ask quick follow-ups without losing context.

💬 Example: copy the final reply and paste it into *"Trip plan — final"* in your notes app, then share it with your travel partner.

You'll know it worked when you have a single document on your phone you can open at a gas station, follow up in the same chat if plans change, and the kids recognize the snack list from the kitchen table vote.

Common mistakes

- **Starting a new chat for every question.** Each new chat makes the assistant start from scratch. Keep the whole planning session in one chat so it remembers the trip, the kids' ages, and your preferences.
- **Asking for "the best" snack or "the best" stop.** That usually gets a generic list. Ask for *"two or three options the kids can vote on"* — you get something the family actually

agrees on, and you avoid the trap of ranking tools or brands.

- **Trusting driving times blindly.** AI assistants don't have live traffic. Their *"3-hour drive"* can easily be 4 hours in summer. Add a 30-minute buffer to each day's drive, especially around big cities and holiday weekends.
- **Forgetting to check the weather.** The AI can draft a plan, but it can't read tomorrow's forecast for you. Before you leave, open your weather app and adjust — then send a quick follow-up like *"swap Tuesday's park stop for an indoor option, rain expected"* and the chat will reshape just that day.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** the same one-chat pattern works for any family planning — birthday parties, weekend camping, holiday dinners. One structured prompt at the top, then iterate as the family changes its mind.
- **For your business or work:** if you coordinate team offsites or multi-day conferences, the same chunked-day, vote-on-it technique scales up — add a *"budget per day"* and *"meeting rooms needed"* to the original prompt and you have an event-planning template.
- **If you want to go further:** turn your best trip-planning prompt into a reusable template. Save it in a notes app under *"trip prompt v1"*, replace the specifics for the next trip, and you'll get a first-draft plan in under a minute — without re-explaining the basics each time.

Try it now

Open your AI assistant right now and send this single message:

💬 *"Plan a 3-day family road trip from [your city] to [your destination] in [month]. We have [number] kids, ages [ages]. Drive no more than 3 hours per day. Suggest one kid-friendly stop per day — park, playground, or quirky roadside attraction. Then give me 5 store-bought car snacks and 5 things to pack from home. Format as plain lists."*

You'll have a first-draft plan in under a minute — and a clear sense of what to ask for next.

Set up a shared Alexa+ household whiteboard for the whole family

6 steps · Read online

> **In short:** With Alexa+, you create one named list (think of it as a shared whiteboard) that every adult in the household can add to by speaking to any Echo in the house, and read back the same way. Setup takes about five minutes; using it is one sentence per note.

You can already talk to Alexa to add items to a shopping list — this guide turns that same idea into a wall everyone in the family actually reads. Think of it as a fridge notepad that updates itself whenever anyone speaks. A partner can drop a note on the kitchen Echo while you're at the grocery store, and you'll hear it when you walk in the door.

> **Before you start**
>
> - You already use Alexa on at least one Echo device in your home (you've added items to a list or asked a question out loud). You also have the Alexa app installed on your phone and you're signed in with your Amazon account.
> - You need **two or more adult profiles linked to the same Amazon Household** in the Alexa app — that's how everyone in the family gets permission to write to the same board. If you live alone, you can still use the guide, but the "shared" benefit only kicks in once a second adult is added to the Household.
> - **Time needed:** about 5 minutes for setup, then a few seconds per note from then on.
> - **Cost:** this works on the standard Alexa experience; Alexa+ features are rolling out gradually and may require an Alexa+ subscription on some accounts. If a step below gives you an "upgrade" prompt, that is what it is — you can still use a basic named list without Alexa+.

Step 1 — Open the Alexa app and find Household settings

On your phone, open the **Alexa app** (the orange speech-bubble icon — if you can't find it, search your home screen for "Alexa"). Tap the **Devices** tab along the bottom — it usually looks like a small house or plug icon. At the top-right of the Devices screen, tap the **Settings** gear icon (look for it if your layout differs, sometimes it's behind a ⋯ menu). Scroll down until you see a section called **Your Household** or **Amazon Household**.

What happens next: A list of adults and children linked to your Amazon account appears. If more than one adult is already listed, you're set up. If you're the only adult, you'll need to invite

someone (a partner, a grown child) before shared notes will reach them.

💬 Example: say to yourself *"I want everyone in the house to be able to read this board."* That's the goal — the next steps get you there.

You'll know it worked when you see at least two adult names (yours plus one other) listed under Your Household, or you successfully sent an invite that the other person accepted.

Step 2 — Create a dedicated list for the whiteboard

Back on the main screen of the Alexa app, tap the **Communicate** or **Lists** icon (it depends on your app version — look for a checklist or speech-bubble-with-lines icon at the bottom, often labeled **Lists**, **Notes**, or **More**). Inside the Lists area, look for a button or link that says **Create List** (sometimes hidden behind a + plus-sign icon). Name the list something everyone will recognize — for example: *Family Board*, *House Notes*, or *Fridge Board*.

What happens next: A new named list appears in your Lists tab. This list is the "whiteboard." Anything spoken into any Echo in your home and added to this list will show up here, and any adult in the Household can read it.

💬 Example: name it `Family Board` — short, obvious, and easy to remember when you say it out loud.

You'll know it worked when the new list shows up in the Lists tab and Alexa confirms the name when you ask her (try: *"Alexa, what's on Family Board?"* — she should say the list is empty).

Step 3 — Add your first note by voice

Stand within earshot of any Echo in your home and say the wake word — usually **"Alexa,"** but yours might be **"Echo," "Amazon,"** or **"Computer,"** depending on what you picked during setup. Then speak a single sentence that includes the list name and what you want to add. Speak naturally, at a normal pace — you don't need to pause between words.

What happens next: Alexa chimes or flashes a blue ring (on older Echos) or a blue light bar (on newer ones), then repeats your note back and confirms it was added to the list. Open the Alexa app's Lists tab to see the note appear as text within a few seconds.

💬 Example: *"Alexa, add 'Pick up dry cleaning on the way home' to Family Board."*

You'll know it worked when Alexa repeats the note back to you AND it shows up in the Family Board list inside the app. If only one of those two things happens, see Common mistakes below.

Step 4 — Have another household member post their own note

This is the moment that turns a personal list into a shared board. Ask the other adult in your Amazon Household to walk up to a different Echo (a different room is the whole point) and speak a note the same way you did. They use their own voice, and they don't need to open the app at all — they just talk to the Echo.

What happens next: That note lands on the same Family Board list inside your Alexa app, alongside yours. Both of you can read every note, no matter which Echo it was spoken to.

💬 Example: your partner says, *"Alexa, add 'Sam has soccer practice at 4' to Family Board."* You see it on your phone within a few seconds.

You'll know it worked when a note spoken in one room appears in the Family Board list in the Alexa app on another adult's phone. If it doesn't, double-check that the other person is listed as an adult in the Amazon Household (Step 1).

Step 5 — Read the board back out loud from any Echo

The board isn't just for writing — it's also for reading hands-free. From any Echo in the house, ask Alexa to read the list back to you. Useful moments: while cooking, while getting the kids ready, while walking in the door. You can also ask how many items are on it without hearing them all.

What happens next: Alexa reads each note out loud in the order they were added. For a long board, she'll usually say something like *"You have seven items"* first, then ask if you want to hear them all.

💬 Example: *"Alexa, what's on Family Board?"* — full readout. *"Alexa, how many items are on Family Board?"* — just the count.

You'll know it worked when Alexa reads your notes back without you opening the app.

Step 6 — Pin the routine and tell the family how to use it

A whiteboard only helps if people remember to use it. Take two minutes to tell the family how it works: "Say *Alexa, add [your note] to Family Board* from any Echo in the house. Ask *Alexa, what's on Family Board?* to hear the notes." If you have a wall Echo or Echo Show, you can also enable the Alexa app's list screen on the Show so notes scroll visibly in the kitchen.

What happens next: Over the next few days, the board fills up with the small things people would otherwise forget to mention — reminders, asks, wins. Old notes stay on the list until you delete them.

Example: a shared line the family can memorize: *"Alexa, add [thing] to Family Board."*

You'll know it worked when notes start appearing without anyone asking *"did you see my message?"* — the board becomes the answer.

Common mistakes

- **"Alexa added it to Shopping List, not Family Board."** You forgot to say the list name. Every voice note has to end with *"to Family Board"* (or whatever you named it). Fix: delete the wrong entry in the app and re-speak the note with the list name at the end.
- **"My partner's notes don't show up in my app."** They probably aren't listed as an adult in your Amazon Household. Fix: go back to Step 1 and either add them as an adult or have them accept the Household invite on their own account.
- **"Alexa says she can't find the list."** The list name has to match exactly what you said — *"Family Board"* and *"Family Boards"* are different to Alexa. Fix: pick a short, one-or-two-word name in Step 2 and stick with it.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** Less "did you tell me about…?" and fewer missed dentist appointments. The board works because speaking a note takes one second and reading it back takes even less — nobody has to remember to open an app.
- **For your business or work:** This same trick works for a home office: create a list called *"Work Notes"* and use it as a quick voice-captured idea log. Speak thoughts while doing dishes, review them at your desk later.
- **If you want to go further:** Try a second list for time-sensitive things — *"Errands Today"* — and delete items off it each evening as a simple habit. Two short lists are easier to scan than one long one, and the daily reset keeps the board from turning into a junk drawer.

Try it now

Pick one note that's on your mind right now — a reminder, an errand, something you keep forgetting to mention. Stand near any Echo and say: *"Alexa, add [your note] to Family Board."* That's it. You now have a household whiteboard, and the family can start posting to it tonight.

How to plan a full week of family dinners and one smart shopping list

6 steps · Read online

> **In short:** An AI assistant can draft a 7-day family dinner plan that respects picky eaters, dietary needs, and leftovers, and turn it into one store-grouped shopping list in about 15 minutes. You stay the editor of every final choice.

Tuesday used to be the day you stood in front of the fridge at 5pm, hoping something would suggest itself. This guide is for anyone who has ever opened a takeout app at the last minute and thought, *I meant to plan this week*. With an AI assistant — ChatGPT, Gemini, Claude, Copilot, or whichever one you already use — you can turn that scattered stress into a single 15-minute planning session. The assistant does the drafting. You stay in charge.

Before you start

- An AI assistant you can type into on the web, on a phone, or in an app. A free plan is enough; paid plans are usually faster and longer, but not required.
- A rough idea of who you are feeding, any allergies or diets, and the week you mean (next Monday to Sunday, or whenever you shop).
- About 15–20 minutes the first time you do this. After that, 5 minutes is enough to refresh the list.

Step 1 — Open a new chat and set the scene

Open your AI assistant and start a fresh conversation. Type one short paragraph that describes your family: how many people, ages if it helps, and the ground rules — one vegetarian in the house, a child who refuses anything green, a partner cutting back on red meat, that kind of thing. Tell the assistant the week you mean. After you send, you'll see a reply in a few seconds — usually a short acknowledgement plus a follow-up question or a first draft. If your assistant offers a "Projects" or "Memory" menu, you can ignore it for now; the regular chat box is enough. If the interface looks different, the idea is the same: a blank box, you type, the assistant replies.

💬 Example: "I'm planning dinners for next week for a family of four: two adults, a 7-year-old who won't eat mushrooms or spicy food, and a 12-year-old who is vegetarian at home. I want to cook 5 nights and use leftovers for 2. About $120 for the week."

You'll know it worked when the assistant either asks a clarifying question or starts listing meals — usually both.

Step 2 — Ask for the 7-day plan in the format you want

Now ask for the actual plan and tell the assistant exactly how to lay it out. "Give me a table with columns for day, dinner, and which ingredients can be reused." Or: "one sentence per night, plus a one-line note on leftovers." The more concrete the format you ask for, the less you'll have to rewrite. After you send, the assistant produces a draft that usually covers 5–7 dinners with brief notes. If the response cuts off mid-list, type "continue" and it picks up — this happens often with long answers. If the reply doesn't show a table, ask for one; most assistants will redraw the answer in the new format.

💬 Example: "Make a 7-night plan using my rules. Format it as a table: Day | Dinner | Leftover note. Keep weekday dinners to 30 minutes or less; weekends can be longer."

You'll know it worked when you can read down the list and immediately picture at least three nights.

Step 3 — Push back on the nights that don't fit

No first draft survives contact with a real family. Read the plan and flag the nights that won't work — the fish night, the 90-minute cook, the night you have practice at 6. Tell the assistant specifically which nights to swap and any rules to keep (don't introduce a new cuisine, keep Tuesday under 30 minutes, double Wednesday's recipe for Thursday's lunch). After you send, the assistant revises — usually in one or two messages — and offers alternatives. This is the step where picky-eater wars are won or lost; the assistant is much better at swapping within your rules than at guessing what your family will actually eat.

💬 Example: "Swap Friday — we have practice until 7. Replace it with something using the same chicken from Wednesday. Keep Tuesday under 30 minutes; the soup won't work."

You'll know it worked when every night on the list feels like something you could realistically cook this week.

Step 4 — Ask for one consolidated shopping list

Once the plan feels right, ask the assistant to build a single shopping list — not seven mini-lists. Be specific: ingredients merged across the week (one onion for three recipes, not three onions), grouped by where they live in the store (produce, dairy, pantry, frozen, meat or fish), and amounts in real units (cups, grams, tablespoons) rather than "some onions." After you send, the assistant produces a grouped list. If it gives you a flat list, just reply: "group this by store section." If you shop at more than one store, ask for a split version. The assistant can't know which brands or prices you'll find — that part is your eyes at the store.

💬 Example: "Now turn the plan into one shopping list. Group by store section (produce, dairy, meat, pantry, frozen). Merge duplicates across recipes. Give amounts in cups, grams, and

tablespoons."

You'll know it worked when you can walk through the store and check items off section by section, without backtracking.

Step 5 — Ask for a simple backup plan

Real weeks go sideways. Ask the assistant for a "pivot list" — three backup dinners that use only ingredients already on your shopping list, plus a few pantry staples (pasta, rice, eggs, canned tomatoes). Frame it as: "If Tuesday's recipe falls apart, what's the fastest thing I can make from what's already on the list?" After you send, you get a short, ranked list. This isn't about cooking more — it's about giving yourself a 6pm exit ramp when the original plan doesn't happen. If your assistant has a Memory or Projects feature, you can store the backup list for next time.

💬 Example: "Give me 3 backup dinners I can make using only ingredients from this shopping list, plus pasta, rice, eggs, and canned tomatoes. Each one under 25 minutes."

You'll know it worked when you have a short list of "if everything goes wrong" meals you actually like.

Step 6 — Save the plan and take it to the store

Copy the final plan and shopping list into your phone's notes app, a shared family note, or a paper list — whichever you'll actually look at while shopping. Most AI assistants have a copy or share button near the reply; look for a small icon that looks like two overlapping squares, a paperclip, or a share arrow, but apps change often so any "copy" or "share" control nearby will do. Paste it into Notes, Google Keep, Apple Notes, or a shared grocery app, then tick items off section by section at the store. If something is out of stock, open a new chat and ask: "I'm at the store and there's no Greek yogurt — what can I sub in dinner three without breaking the plan?" That's a genuinely useful use of the tool mid-shop.

💬 Example: paste the plan and list into a note titled "Week of [date] dinners" so the family can find it from any phone.

You'll know it worked when Sunday night you already know what Monday's dinner is, and the list in your hand is the only one you need.

Common mistakes

- **Asking for too vague a brief.** "Plan my dinners" gets you a generic list. Always include family size, dietary needs, budget, and how many nights you're actually cooking. The more specific the brief, the less you'll have to rewrite.

- **Accepting the first draft.** The first plan is a starting point, not a finished menu. Spend two minutes swapping the nights that won't work — this is where the plan becomes yours rather than the assistant's.
- **Getting seven separate shopping lists.** If the assistant gives you one list per recipe, ask it to merge them into a single list grouped by store section. That single step is the biggest time-saver in the whole process.
- **Forgetting leftovers.** If you don't tell the assistant to plan for them, it'll plan seven fresh meals and you'll have too much food. Always say how many nights you want to cook versus how many you want to eat.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** A 15-minute Sunday planning session replaces the daily "what's for dinner" decision, and the store trip gets faster because the list is grouped. Most families save 30–60 minutes a week once the rhythm is set.
- **For your work or side projects:** The same pattern — brief, draft, push back, ask for one consolidated output — works for travel plans, weekly schedules, and project task lists. Once you have the muscle, the assistant becomes useful for any repeated planning job, not just meals.
- **If you're just getting started:** Pick the AI assistant you already have an account with, run Step 1 once, and see what comes back. You don't need to switch tools to get value — you just need to give it a clear brief.

Try it now

Open your AI assistant, start a new chat, and send the Step 1 example prompt as your very first message. Don't edit it first — see what the assistant comes back with, then adjust from there. You'll have a rough first plan in under two minutes.

Build a Simple Household Budget Calculator with GitHub Copilot

6 steps · Read online

> **In short:** GitHub Copilot is an AI helper that lives inside a code editor and suggests code as you type. In about 15 minutes you can build a tiny calculator that adds your monthly expenses and prints a total, even if you've never written a line of code before. Copilot writes the suggestions, but you still type the run command and check the math yourself.

You don't need a programming background for this one. Think of Copilot like a friend sitting next to you: you describe what you want in plain English, and it drafts the code. You review it, change a few numbers, and run it. By the end you'll have a small file on your computer that adds up any list of expenses you give it.

Before you start

- A **GitHub account** (free at github.com — you'll need it to sign into Copilot).
- **Visual Studio Code**, a free code editor from Microsoft (download and install it like any other program). It works on Windows, Mac and Linux.
- The **GitHub Copilot** extension installed inside VS Code and signed in. A free tier exists; paid tiers give higher usage limits. Check the current plans on GitHub's official pricing page.
- **Python** installed on your computer (free from python.org) — needed only if you want to run the calculator yourself. If you'd rather not install anything, you can paste the code into a free online Python runner instead.
- About **15–20 minutes** total.

Step 1 — Open VS Code and confirm Copilot is ready

Open Visual Studio Code. When it starts, you'll see a large empty white area in the middle (where you'll write your code), a narrow sidebar on the left, and a thin menu bar across the top with File, Edit, View and other items. In the left sidebar, open the Extensions view — usually an icon made of four small squares, or you can reach it from the View menu at the top by choosing Extensions. Type **GitHub Copilot** into the search box, click the result published by GitHub, then click Install. A sign-in window may pop up asking for your GitHub account details. If you've installed Copilot before, the sign-in may already be done, and you'll see a small status message near the bottom of the window. If you can't find the Extensions icon, try the View menu — every recent version of VS Code puts it there. 💬 Example: in the search box, type GitHub Copilot and pick the first result whose publisher name is "GitHub." You'll know it

worked when the install finishes and the bottom of the window shows Copilot as ready (the exact wording varies by version).

Step 2 — Create a new Python file for your budget

Go to the File menu at the top and choose New File (or press Ctrl+N on Windows, or Cmd+N on Mac). A blank white page opens in the middle of the editor. Save it right away with File → Save As, then type the name **budget.py** and pick a folder you can find again — your Desktop or Documents folder works well. The .py at the end tells the editor this is a Python file, which helps Copilot give better suggestions. The tab at the top of the editor should now show your file's name. If VS Code asks you to pick a language, choose Python. If you don't have Python installed on your computer, that's okay for this step — the file will still save as plain text, and you can install Python later or use an online runner. 💬 Example: when the Save As window opens, type budget.py as the filename and click Save. You'll know it worked when the tab at the top of the editor shows "budget.py" with a small colored Python logo next to it.

Step 3 — Describe your budget in plain English

Move your cursor into the empty file and start typing a comment. A comment in Python starts with the # symbol — the computer ignores it, but Copilot reads it to understand what you want. Type your comment slowly. After a few words, Copilot may start suggesting the rest of the line in **ghosted gray text**. Don't worry about writing perfect English; just describe your goal clearly. If no gray suggestion appears right away, that's normal — Copilot often waits until you press Enter or pause for a second after typing. 💬 Example: "# A simple budget calculator that adds my monthly expenses and prints the total." You'll know it worked when a line of ghosted gray text appears right after your comment.

Step 4 — Accept the suggestion and review the code

When the gray suggestion looks reasonable, press the **Tab** key to accept it. The ghosted text turns into real, editable code. If the suggestion looks wrong, press **Esc** to dismiss it, then edit your comment to be clearer and wait for a new suggestion. After accepting the first line, Copilot usually suggests the next line below it — press Tab again to accept each one. You'll likely end up with something like a list of numbers, a line that adds them together, and a line that prints the result. You don't have to understand every word of the code — the point is that you now have a working draft. 💬 Example: Copilot might suggest three lines that look like expenses = [1200, 350, 80, 45] to set up a list, total = sum(expenses) to add them up, and print(f"Your total monthly expenses are: ${total}") to show the result. You'll know it worked when your file has several lines of code below your original comment.

Step 5 — Run the calculator to see your total

Now you'll make the calculator actually do its job. Look at the top menu bar for **Terminal**, click it, and choose **New Terminal** (the wording can vary slightly between Mac, Windows and Linux). A text panel slides up from the bottom of the window. In that bottom panel, type **python budget.py** and press Enter. If Python is installed, you'll see one line appear with your total — something like "Your total monthly expenses are: $1675." If you see an error like "python: command not found," Python isn't installed yet — either install it from python.org, or paste your code into a free online Python runner to see the result there. Example: in the terminal, type python budget.py and press Enter. You'll know it worked when a single line with a dollar amount appears in the bottom panel.

Step 6 — Change the numbers to match your own expenses

The numbers Copilot suggested are just placeholders. Click back into the top part of VS Code (the file itself) and find the list of numbers — it usually looks like **expenses = [1200, 350, 80, 45]**. Replace each number with a real expense from your life: rent, groceries, phone bill, gym, streaming subscriptions, anything that repeats each month. Keep the commas between the numbers and keep everything inside the square brackets [ ]. Press **Ctrl+S** on Windows or **Cmd+S** on Mac to save, then go back to the terminal panel and run **python budget.py** again. Your new total appears. If you see a red "SyntaxError" message, you probably forgot a comma or a bracket — check the brackets and commas carefully. Example: try replacing the list with expenses = [1500, 400, 60, 30, 25] for rent, food, phone, gym and a streaming subscription. You'll know it worked when the new total in the terminal matches the sum of the numbers you typed (1500 + 400 + 60 + 30 + 25 = 2015).

Common mistakes

- **Forgetting to save before running.** The terminal reads the file from disk, not what you see on screen. If you change the numbers but don't save, you'll keep getting the old total. Press Ctrl+S (or Cmd+S on Mac) every time you edit, then run again.
- **Missing a comma or a bracket in the list.** Python lists need commas between numbers and matching square brackets. Without them, you'll see a red "SyntaxError" in the terminal. Check that every number except the last has a comma after it, and that you have both an opening [and a closing].
- **Asking Copilot something it can't actually do here.** Copilot is great at writing small code snippets like this, but it can't pull your real bank statements, read your email receipts, or do your taxes. Use this calculator for rough monthly planning, and a real budgeting app if you want automatic tracking.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** see at a glance how much you spend each month and which bills take up the most space — small numbers add up faster than most people expect.
- **For your business or work:** the same idea works for recurring costs like software subscriptions, contractor fees or client invoices. Just change the labels in the list to match what you actually pay.
- **If you're just getting started:** try adding five real expenses today and run the calculator. Next week, add two more. The point isn't the code — it's the habit of writing your numbers down where you can see them.

Try it now

Open VS Code, create a new file called budget.py, and type this exact comment: **# A simple budget calculator that adds monthly expenses and prints a total.** Then pause for a second. Watch what Copilot suggests in gray — press Tab to accept it, and you have a working starter in under a minute.

Set up Alexa+ voice profiles so each family member gets their own briefing

6 steps · Read online

> **In short:** In the Alexa app, you can create a separate profile for each person, train the Echo to recognize their voice, and link their own music, reminders and calendar. Voice recognition is not perfect, so check the results. You need an Alexa+ setup and an Echo device, and some Alexa+ features may depend on your plan.

This guide shows you how to set up a voice profile for each person in your household, so the same Echo speaker can greet each person by name and answer with their own reminders, calendar and music. It is written for someone who already uses Alexa for simple tasks like setting timers or playing a song.

Before you start

- **Assumed:** you already have an Amazon account, an Echo device connected to Wi-Fi, and the **Alexa app** on a phone or tablet. You know how to talk to Alexa and ask a question.
- **Plan:** Alexa+ is Amazon's newer, more conversational version of Alexa. Access and pricing can differ by country and plan, and some features may require Prime or a paid subscription. Check Amazon's official Alexa pages for current details.
- **Each person's phone or accounts:** to link personal calendars or music, each person needs their own account for that service.
- **Time:** about 30 to 40 minutes, plus a few minutes for each person to train their voice.

Step 1 — Create a profile for each person

Open the **Alexa app** and tap the **menu icon** (often three lines or a row of dots in a corner). Look for a section called **Settings**, then a part about **Your Profile**, **Profiles** or **Voice**. The exact label may vary by app version, so look for anything that mentions people or voices. Tap **Add** or **+** and enter each person's name. Use the name you want Alexa to say out loud, such as "Maya" or "Dad."

Once you save a name, the app usually moves on to a screen asking how to set up that person's voice. You may also see a choice for an adult or a child profile. Choose the option that matches each person.

💬 Example: add a profile named "Jordan" and then one named "Sam."

If it looks different: if you can't find a profiles section, try the **Devices** tab, select your Echo, and look for a setting about people or voice recognition.

You'll know it worked when each person's name appears in the list of profiles inside the app.

Step 2 — Train the Echo to recognize each voice

Select the profile you just created and look for a button like **Set up voice recognition** or **Teach Alexa your voice**. Tap it. The app will ask you to say a few short phrases out loud, one at a time. Hold the phone at a normal distance and use a quiet room with no TV or music.

Speak naturally, as you would to a friend. Don't whisper or exaggerate. After each phrase, the app usually shows a checkmark or a progress bar. Repeat this for every family member, one person at a time, so the voices don't get mixed up.

💬 Example phrase to say when prompted: "Alexa, what's on my schedule today?"

If it looks different: some setups let you finish voice training directly on the Echo instead of in the app. If the app asks you to say a phrase that isn't shown, follow the on-screen instructions, since prompts change over time.

You'll know it worked when the app confirms the voice is set up for that person, and Alexa responds with that person's name after you say the wake word.

Step 3 — Link each person's music service

Still in the same profile, look for a section about **Music**, **Default music** or **Connected services**. Tap it, then choose the music service that person uses, such as Amazon Music or another service Alexa supports. Sign in with that person's own account. Your music choices stay with that account, so this is the step that makes "play my music" work differently for each person.

Be aware that some music services are only available with a subscription, and not every service supports every feature.

💬 Example: ask Alexa, "Play my workout playlist." If it works, the playlist comes from the signed-in account.

If it looks different: if you don't see a music section inside the profile, check the app's main **Music** settings and see if there's a way to assign a default service to each person.

You'll know it worked when the right person's music starts playing after they speak to Alexa and ask for a playlist.

Step 4 — Add personal reminders and calendars

This is where each person's briefing becomes personal. Look for a section called **Calendar**, **Accounts** or **Connected calendars** inside that person's profile. Choose the calendar service they use and sign in. If you don't see the option, look under the main settings for **Calendar** and link it there.

Then set up reminders the same way you did for music. Ask Alexa to create a reminder while you're speaking as that person. That reminder should belong to that profile only.

💬 Example: say, "Alexa, remind me to call the dentist tomorrow at nine a.m." Then ask, "Alexa, what are my reminders?"

If it looks different: calendar linking can change, and some options may appear only on certain plans or regions. If a calendar doesn't appear, try linking it from the Alexa app's **Calendar** menu instead.

You'll know it worked when Alexa reads back only that person's events and reminders when they ask.

Step 5 — Try a morning briefing for each person

Now test the full experience. Speak to Alexa as one family member and ask for a short summary of the day. Something like: "Alexa, what's my day look like?" Listen to the answer. It should include that person's calendar events and reminders, not someone else's.

Then switch to another family member and repeat the same question. Compare the two answers. Each should be different, and each should use the right name.

💬 Example: "Alexa, good morning. What do I have today, and what music should I hear while I get ready?"

If it looks different: if Alexa gives the wrong person's information, the voice may not be recognized. Go back to Step 2 and train that voice again in a quieter room, then test again.

You'll know it worked when each person hears their own schedule and their own music choices without mixing up the two.

Step 6 — Review the privacy settings

Voice profiles store information about how each person sounds, so it's worth checking what's saved. In the Alexa app, look for **Privacy** or **Voice history** under settings. Review what's stored, and look for an option to delete a voice profile or old recordings. Options vary, so look for words like "delete" or "remove."

Also think about who can hear the answers. Alexa may read calendar events out loud, so use voice profiles mainly for adults and keep sensitive details out of shared rooms.

💬 Example of a good habit: after a few weeks, ask Alexa, "What's on my calendar this week?" If you hear something you don't want said in the kitchen, remove that calendar link or switch that information off.

If it looks different: if you can't find a privacy page, look under the main settings menu for a section about your device or your data, then use the search option if your app has one.

You'll know it worked when you have reviewed the voice settings, and you know how to delete a profile if you ever need to.

Common mistakes

- **Training voices together:** If two people speak at the same time during setup, Alexa may mix up their voices. **Fix:** train one person at a time and wait for the confirmation before starting the next.
- **Assuming it's always right:** Colds, background noise and similar voices can confuse recognition, and Alexa can't always tell who is speaking. **Fix:** test each profile regularly and retrain a voice if answers look wrong.
- **Expecting Alexa to handle everything:** Alexa can read your calendar and reminders, but it can't replace a shared family calendar or take actions in apps you haven't linked. **Fix:** link the services each person actually uses and keep a shared calendar for family plans everyone must see.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** Each person in your home can ask the same Echo for their own morning schedule, reminders and playlists, without everyone hearing each other's events.
- **For your business or work:** If you work from home, you can keep your work calendar and reminders separate from family routines by setting up your own profile.
- **If you want to go further:** Once you're comfortable with profiles, try building a simple routine that combines a morning briefing with lights or a thermostat, if your devices support it.

Try it now

Open the Alexa app and check whether a profiles or voice section is already there. If it is, add one profile for yourself, then say, "Alexa, what's on my calendar today?" in the next two minutes to see whether it reads your own schedule.

How to Plan a Kids Birthday Party on a Tight Budget in One Afternoon

6 steps · Read online

> **In short:** In one afternoon, an AI chat assistant can help you draft a budget split, a guest count, a party-day timeline and a shopping list for your child's age. It works from the numbers you give it, so check every price yourself before you spend.

Planning a kids' party can feel like a dozen tasks at once. In this guide you will use one chat to work through the whole plan, step by step, with each answer building on the last. By the end you will have a budget, a guest list, a timeline and a shopping list, all matched to your child's age.

Before you start

- **An AI chat assistant account.** Any general chat assistant, such as ChatGPT, Gemini or Claude, works for these steps. The free version is usually enough. Features can vary by plan and change over time.
- **Your own numbers.** Have your child's age, your total budget, the party date, the place (home, park or a rented room), and a rough headcount ready.
- **A notes app or paper.** You will save one reusable template there.
- **Time:** about 60 to 90 minutes, mostly typing and checking.

You already know how to open a new chat and send a message, so we start with the planning.

Step 1 — Save a reusable party-planning template

Open a new chat and type a short instruction that tells the assistant who to be and what to ask you. Think of it like a recipe card: the same card works whether you are baking a small cake or a big one. Once you have the template, copy it into your notes app so you can paste it into a fresh chat next time.

The message box is usually at the bottom of the screen. Paste your template there and press send, or tap the arrow or send icon beside it. You should see your text appear as your message, followed by a reply that starts typing out a few questions. If the reply looks different, that is fine. Some assistants answer right away instead of asking questions. Just type the details in the next step.

💬 Example: "You are a practical party planner who knows how to stretch a tight budget. I am planning a birthday party for my [child's age]-year-old. My total budget is [total budget] dollars, the party is at [home or park], and I expect about [number] guests. Ask me up to three questions, then build the plan in the order I list next."

You'll know it worked when the assistant replies with questions or a plan that clearly uses your child's age and budget.

Step 2 — Ask for a budget breakdown

In the same chat, ask for a split of your total budget into categories. Because the assistant can see your earlier message, it already knows your budget and the age you gave. You do not need to repeat those details, which is the big advantage of building in one chat.

Look for the message box again and type your request. A good breakdown lists each category with a dollar amount and a percentage, and it adds a small reserve for surprises, like a broken decoration or a sudden extra guest. If the reply is only a paragraph with no numbers, reply with "Please show each category as a dollar amount and a percentage."

💬 Example: "Using the details above, split my budget into categories such as food, cake, decorations, activities, goody bags and a reserve for surprises. Show each category as a dollar amount and a percentage, and make the reserve clearly labeled."

You'll know it worked when the reply lists categories whose dollar amounts add up to your total budget.

Step 3 — Set a guest count that fits the budget

Now ask the assistant to work out how many children you can realistically invite. Take the per-child cost from the breakdown, then ask for a guest list in three tiers. This turns a vague wish list into a decision you can make.

Type your request in the same chat. You should get a short list with the tiers labeled, often something like "must invite," "could invite" and "skip this year." Some families count siblings as guests, so decide that now and say it in your message. If the list has more guests than the budget can cover, ask the assistant to recalculate with a smaller number.

💬 Example: "Given the breakdown you just gave me, how many guests can I invite if each child costs about [dollars per child] dollars in food and goody bags? Sort the list into must invite, could invite and skip this year."

You'll know it worked when the reply gives a specific guest number and explains how it reached it.

Step 4 — Build a one-afternoon party timeline

A timeline keeps the party from running late. Ask the assistant to lay out the party day hour by hour, and then list the tasks to finish in the two days before. The planning itself happens this

afternoon, but the timeline is for the party.

Type your request and look for a reply with time blocks, such as setup, arrival, activity, food, cake and cleanup. Check that the blocks match when your guests really arrive. If the timing looks rushed, reply with "Add a 15-minute buffer between each block," and the assistant should adjust the schedule.

💬 Example: "Make a timeline for the party day, starting at [start time] and ending at [end time]. Include setup, arrival, one activity, food, cake and cleanup. Then list the tasks I should finish the two days before the party."

You'll know it worked when the timeline has clear start times for each block and a separate list of tasks for the days before.

Step 5 — Turn the plan into a shopping list

Here the assistant cannot see store shelves or today's prices, so you bring the real numbers. Open a store's website or check a recent receipt, copy the item names and prices, and paste them into the chat. Tell the assistant that these are the prices to use. The assistant can do the grouping and the arithmetic, but it works only with what you give it.

Paste your list into the message box and send it. A good reply groups items by store section and shows a total. It should also say how far you are over or under budget. If the reply invents prices you did not provide, reply with "Use only the prices I pasted, and mark any item I did not price."

💬 Example: "Here are my prices, one item per line: [paste your list here]. Group them into a shopping list by store section, add up the total, and tell me how far over or under my budget I am."

You'll know it worked when the total matches your own calculation of the pasted prices, and any items without a price are flagged.

Step 6 — Check the answer before you trust it

Assistants can make arithmetic slips and hidden assumptions, so this last step is the most important. Ask the assistant to show its work. You are not testing the assistant; you are making sure the plan matches your real life.

Type your check request, then read the reply line by line. Compare the totals with a calculator, and confirm the guest count matches what you plan to invite. If the reply is vague, ask it to list each assumption it made.

💬 Example: "Check your totals line by line and list any assumptions you made, such as guest count or prices. Tell me which ones I should verify myself before I buy anything."

You'll know it worked when the reply lists its assumptions and your own calculator agrees with its totals.

Common mistakes

- **Trusting prices the assistant did not get from you.** Assistants can guess at costs. Fix it by pasting real prices from a store site or receipt, and asking it to flag anything unpriced.
- **Sending one giant request.** A long, tangled message gets a messy answer. Fix it by following the steps in order, one request per message, so each answer builds on the last.
- **Forgetting the parents' side.** Food restrictions and pickup times are easy to miss. Fix it by adding a line to your invitation asking about any food needs, and by asking the assistant to add "confirm food needs" to your timeline.

Also keep in mind that the assistant cannot book a venue, check if a store has your items in stock, send invitations or buy anything for you. It drafts the plan; you make the calls.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** The same template works for any family event. Keep the saved card in your notes app and swap in new details.
- **For your business or work:** The same steps work for planning a team lunch or office event with a set budget and headcount.
- **If you want to go further:** Ask the assistant to turn your timeline into a printable checklist, then paste it into your notes app as a reusable template for next year's party.

Try it now

Open a new chat, paste the Step 1 template with your child's age and budget filled in, and send it. Within two minutes you will have the assistant's first set of questions, and the rest of the plan can build from there.

Plan a Week of Family Dinners and a Matching Grocery List with Qwen

6 steps · Read online

> **In short:** Tell Qwen (Alibaba's AI assistant) your family's likes, dietary needs and weekly food budget, and it will draft a seven-day dinner plan plus one consolidated shopping list you can take to the store.

By the end of this guide, you'll have a real weeknight dinner plan for your family and one printed list that covers every meal — without spending Sunday afternoon flipping through cookbooks. This works whether you cook for two or six, eat meat or follow a plant-based diet, and whether your week starts on Monday or Sunday.

Before you start

- A Qwen account (sign up at chat.qwen.ai with an email — the basic chat is free; paid tiers may exist for heavier use).
- A few minutes to think about your family's tastes, any allergies or restrictions, and a rough food budget for the week.
- Total time: about 10–15 minutes for the whole planning session.

Step 1 — Open Qwen and start a new chat

Open your browser and go to **chat.qwen.ai**. If you already have an account, click **Log in** in the top-right and enter your email and password. If this is your first visit, click **Sign up**, type your email, set a password, and confirm the verification email Qwen sends you. After you land on the chat page, look for a **New chat** button or a pencil/edit icon in the left sidebar and click it. A blank conversation box appears, usually with a placeholder like "Send a message to Qwen...". You don't need to type anything yet — just confirm the chat is empty and ready. 💬 Example: leave the box empty for now and just press the new-chat button once. If it looks different: on a phone or tablet the menu may hide behind a ☰ or ⋯ icon in the top corner; tap it once and the new-chat option appears in the side panel. You'll know it worked when you see an empty text box with no previous messages above it and Qwen's greeting message at the top of the screen.

Step 2 — Describe your family's tastes, needs and budget

Click inside the chat box and type a single short paragraph that covers four things: how many people you're cooking for, any foods you love, any you want to avoid (allergies, picky eaters, dietary needs), and a rough weekly food budget. Press **Enter** to send. Qwen usually takes a few seconds to reply, and you'll see a typing indicator (three small dots) while it works. Keep this first message short and factual — Qwen uses it as the setup for everything that follows. 💬 Example:

"I'm cooking dinner for a family of four (two adults, two kids ages 6 and 9). We love pasta, chicken, and Mexican flavors. Nobody eats pork, and one person is lactose intolerant. Our weekly food budget for dinners is about $120." If it looks different: if Qwen opens a longer "system prompt" field first, paste your description there instead — same effect. You'll know it worked when Qwen replies with a short acknowledgment, like "Got it — four people, no pork, lactose-free, about $120/week," or asks one clarifying question.

Step 3 — Ask for a seven-day dinner plan

Type a follow-up message that asks for a full week of dinners based on the information you just gave. Be specific about the format you want: one dinner per day, a short list of ingredients for each, and roughly how long it takes to cook. Press **Enter** to send. Qwen will produce a structured plan with each day labeled (Monday through Sunday, or whatever week layout you prefer) and a one- to two-sentence description per meal. 💬 Example: "Based on that, please build me a 7-day dinner plan starting Monday. One dinner per day. For each meal list the dish, main ingredients, and rough cook time. Aim for variety — no repeats. Keep weeknight meals to 30 minutes or less." If it looks different: if Qwen gives you only three or four days, reply with "continue with the remaining days" and it will pick up where it stopped. You'll know it worked when you see seven clearly labeled meals (Monday, Tuesday, Wednesday, and so on) with ingredients and times for each.

Step 4 — Refine any meals you don't like

Skim the plan quickly. If a meal doesn't fit your family — maybe the kids hate fish, or you don't own a slow cooker — type a short reply telling Qwen what to swap. Press **Enter** to send. Qwen keeps the rest of the week intact and only changes what you flagged, so you don't lose the work you've already done. This is also the moment to add anything you forgot earlier, like "we don't eat shellfish" or "we already have rice and beans in the pantry." 💬 Example: "Swap Wednesday — we don't have a slow cooker. Replace it with a 30-minute stovetop pasta. Also, no shellfish anywhere in the week please." If it looks different: if Qwen rewrites the entire week, tell it "only change the days I mentioned, leave the rest as-is." You'll know it worked when the updated days show new meals and your untouched days still say the same dish as before.

Step 5 — Ask for one consolidated shopping list

Once the dinner plan is final, send one more message asking Qwen to merge every ingredient from the week into a single shopping list, grouped by aisle (produce, meat, dairy, pantry, frozen, other). Mention that you want quantities, and ask it to flag anything you might already have at home. Press **Enter** to send. Qwen will produce a clean, copyable list — usually with bullet points or a small table — that you can read at a glance in the supermarket. 💬 Example: "Now turn the full week into one shopping list, grouped by store section. Include quantities for 4 people. At

the end, add a 'check your pantry' note for things people often already have (olive oil, salt, pepper, basic spices)." If it looks different: if Qwen gives you one long flat list, reply with "please regroup this by aisle — produce, meat, dairy, pantry, frozen, other — and keep quantities." You'll know it worked when you see a list with clear section headers and quantities you can hand to anyone (or take yourself) at the store.

Step 6 — Copy or save the list for your trip

Hover near the top-right of Qwen's shopping-list reply and look for a **Copy** icon (two overlapping pages) or a **Download** button. Click **Copy** to put the whole list on your clipboard, then paste it into your notes app, email, or a printed sheet. If you don't see those buttons, just highlight the list with your mouse, press **Ctrl+C** (or **Cmd+C** on a Mac), and paste it anywhere. The list is plain text — it works in Apple Notes, Google Docs, a paper printout, or a shared family chat. 💬 Example: paste it into a note titled "Dinners — week of [date]" so next week you can start a fresh chat and not lose this one. If it looks different: on mobile, long-press the list, choose **Select all**, then **Copy** — the steps are slightly different but the result is the same. You'll know it worked when the list shows up exactly as written, in another app, with no missing ingredients or scrambled formatting.

Common mistakes

- **Skipping the budget.** If you don't mention a dollar range, Qwen will suggest ingredients that push you over what you can spend. Add the number — even a rough one — in Step 2, and check totals at Step 5.
- **Asking for the shopping list too early.** Get the dinner plan finalized first (Step 4), then ask for the list. If you ask before refining, you'll redo the whole list after every swap.
- **Letting one weird meal derail the whole plan.** If a single night looks off, ask Qwen to swap just that day — don't restart from scratch. You're five minutes from a fix, not a full re-plan.
- **Forgetting that Qwen can't read your actual fridge.** The shopping list is a draft, not a sensor. You'll still want to glance at your pantry before you head out.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** Sunday meal planning drops from an hour of flipping through recipes to a 10-minute Qwen session, and you stop throwing out unused groceries at week's end.
- **For your family or shared home:** anyone in the household can take the same list to the store — it's one shared artifact instead of a half-remembered note stuck to the fridge.
- **If you're just getting started:** the easiest first move is to try Step 2 only — just describe your family and ask "what's a good easy dinner for us tonight?" You'll get value before you commit to a full week.

Try it now

Open chat.qwen.ai, start a new chat, and paste this: *"Family of three, two adults and a toddler. We like chicken, pasta, and rice dishes. No nuts. Budget $80/week for dinners. Suggest one easy dinner for tonight, ready in 30 minutes."* You'll have a real meal idea in under a minute.

How to Use Gemini to Make Your LinkedIn Photo Look Professional at Home

6 steps · Read online

> **In short:** You can ask Gemini to give a snapshot a cleaner, more professional look, as long as you start with a clear, face-forward photo. Image editing may not be available in every country or app version, and the result should still look like you. Check every edit before you post it.

You will learn how to take a good starting photo at home, ask Gemini for a simple professional edit, and check that the result still looks like you. This is for anyone who wants a tidier profile picture without booking a photo session. The steps below are written for a complete beginner.

Before you start

- **A Google account** and the **Gemini app or the Gemini website** on your phone or computer. Sign in with your Google account when prompted.
- **One clear photo of yourself**, taken in good light. Most people find that a recent photo works best, because LinkedIn viewers are used to seeing your current face.
- **About 20 to 30 minutes.** Image edits can take a minute each, and you may want to try two or three versions.

Image editing is not guaranteed on every plan or in every region. If you can't find an option to upload a picture, it may not be available to you yet.

Step 1 — Take or choose a clear, face-forward photo

Pick a photo where your whole face is visible, you are looking toward the camera, and the lighting is soft. Stand facing a window during the day so the light falls on your face evenly. Avoid harsh overhead lights and strong backlight, which turns you into a dark silhouette.

Keep the background simple, such as a plain wall. Make sure no one else is in the frame. Shoulders and head should fill most of the picture, and the image should be sharp, not blurry.

If you have to take a new photo, use the back camera of your phone and ask someone to hold it at eye level. If your phone is the only option, set the picture to the highest quality it offers.

You'll know it worked when you can see your eyes, your full face and your shoulders clearly on your screen, with no heavy shadows across your face.

Step 2 — Open Gemini and find the upload option

Open the Gemini app or website and sign in. Look for a **plus sign, a paperclip, or an image icon** near the text box at the bottom of the screen. Tapping it usually lets you add a photo from your device. The exact icon may vary depending on your phone, browser, or app version, so look around the text box before you give up.

If you don't see any upload option, try the website in a desktop browser, or update the app from your app store. If it still isn't there, your account or region may not have image editing yet. In that case, you can still use the honest tips in Step 6 with a different editing tool.

Once you tap the icon, your device's photo gallery or file browser should open. Choose the photo you picked in Step 1.

You'll know it worked when your selected photo appears as a small preview above or beside the text box.

Step 3 — Ask Gemini for a simple professional edit

With your photo attached, type a clear instruction in the text box, then send it. Keep the request modest: you want a cleaner look, not a new face. Describe what you want in plain words.

💬 Example: "Make this headshot look more professional with softer, even lighting and a plain light gray background. Keep my face, hairstyle, and expression exactly as they are."

Tapping send usually starts the process, and Gemini shows a loading indicator or message while it works. The reply may come back as a new image, or as text describing a change. If Gemini only describes the edit and doesn't return a picture, ask it directly to create the edited image.

If the result looks different from what you asked for, rephrase with more detail, such as "Keep the same crop and only soften the shadows." Expect to try two or three versions. Gemini may not get it right on the first attempt.

You'll know it worked when Gemini returns an image that looks like a cleaner version of your original photo.

Step 4 — Compare the edit with your original

Look at the new image and your original side by side, ideally on the same screen. Check your face first: do your eyes, nose, mouth and smile look like yours? Next, check your skin tone, hair and clothing. Gemini should not change your age, build, or features, and it should not add accessories or details you don't wear.

Make sure the background looks natural and that no part of your hair, ears, or shoulders has been blurred or distorted. Zoom in on the edges of your face and on your hands if they're visible.

If the edit changed your face, reject it and try again with a stronger request, such as "Do not change my facial features, only adjust lighting and background." If the result looks too smooth or unnatural, ask for less retouching.

You'll know it worked when someone who knows you would recognize you immediately in the new picture.

Step 5 — Ask for one small adjustment

If the edit is close but not quite right, ask for one change at a time. Changing several things in one message makes it harder to see which change caused a problem. Keep your follow-up short and specific.

💬 Example: "Keep everything the same, but make the background a little warmer and lighten the shadows under my chin."

Send the message and wait for the new image. Compare it with the previous version, as you did in Step 4. If one change improved the photo and another made it worse, you can ask for only the good change again.

Note that AI tools can make mistakes, such as slightly warping a line or adding an odd shadow. Do not keep asking for edits forever. Usually one or two small adjustments are enough. If you're still unhappy after three rounds, return to your original photo, or try retaking the picture in better light.

You'll know it worked when the image looks clean and you feel comfortable with how it represents you.

Step 6 — Save the picture and check it before you upload

When you're happy with the result, save the image. Press and hold the image on a phone, or right-click it on a computer, and choose the option that saves or downloads it. You can also use the download or share icon if one appears near the picture. Choose a clear file name, such as "linkedin-headshot-final."

Before you upload it to LinkedIn, view the file at a small size, as a profile picture will appear on a phone. Make sure your face is still easy to see at that size. Then open LinkedIn, go to your profile, and use the edit option for your photo to upload the file. LinkedIn may have its own guidance on profile photos, so check it there.

Finally, ask yourself whether the photo looks like you on a good day. If it doesn't, your original photo is a perfectly good choice too.

You'll know it worked when your new profile photo appears on your LinkedIn profile and still looks like you in the small preview.

Common mistakes

- **Asking for a new face or body.** Requests like "make me look ten years younger" can change your appearance in ways you didn't intend. Fix it by asking only for lighting, background, or cropping changes, and say you want your features kept the same.
- **Starting with a dark, blurry or cropped photo.** AI edits can't fully repair poor source images. Fix it by retaking the photo in soft daylight, with the camera at eye level.
- **Posting the first result without checking it.** A small change, like a distorted ear or an odd shadow, is easy to miss on a large screen. Fix it by comparing the edit with your original at the same size, as in Step 4.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** A good profile picture can be a simple, low-cost way to refresh your photo for social media, a community group, or a club directory.
- **For your business or work:** If you're updating a professional profile, a clean, natural-looking headshot helps people recognize you when you meet them in person or on a video call.
- **If you're just getting started:** Begin with a photo you already took in good daylight, then make one small request. Small steps are easier to check.

Try it now

Open Gemini, attach your best face-forward photo, and send this message: "Keep my face, hairstyle, and expression exactly as they are, and make the lighting softer and even." Compare the result with your original, and you'll have a first version in about two minutes.

Plan a Weekend Getaway Itinerary with Grok in 10 Minutes

6 steps · Read online

> **In short:** Give Grok your city, dates, travel companions and a few interests, and it drafts a day-by-day itinerary in under a minute. You stay in charge of bookings — Grok suggests, you decide.

By the end of this guide you'll have a clean, printable weekend plan you can open on your phone the morning you leave, even if you've never opened Grok before. It's built for short trips, where one good plan beats ten open browser tabs.

Before you start

- A free xAI account (or an X account, since Grok lives inside X too) — sign-up takes about two minutes.
- A phone or laptop with the Grok website or the X app installed.
- About 10 minutes total: 2 minutes to open the chat, 5 minutes to chat, 3 minutes to tidy the plan.
- A rough idea of where you want to go and when — even "somewhere coastal in October" is plenty.

Step 1 — Open Grok in a fresh chat

Open **grok.com** in your browser, or tap the Grok icon inside the X app (usually near the center of the bottom menu bar). If you're already logged in, you land straight in a chat window with an empty text box at the bottom, ready for your first question. If you see your previous chats instead, tap **"New chat"** or the **pencil icon** so Grok starts with a clean slate. A blank thread means it won't get confused by old questions.

If you can't spot Grok inside the X app, check the menu bar at the bottom and the side menu — its placement shifts with app updates. On a desktop, you can also reach Grok through **x.com/i/grok** if the main site isn't loading for you.

Example: type nothing yet — just open the chat and confirm the text box is ready.

You'll know it worked when you see an empty chat box with a blinking cursor and a send arrow at the right.

Step 2 — Tell Grok the basics of your trip

Tap inside the text box and type a short paragraph that covers four things in plain language: **where you're starting from**, **where you're going**, **the dates**, and **who's traveling with**

you. Think of it like leaving a note for a friend who's never met you — clear and friendly beats clever. After you press the send arrow (or the Return key), Grok usually replies in a few seconds with a short acknowledgment or a clarifying question. That reply tells you it understood the basics.

If you're on a phone and the keyboard hides the send button, look for a paper-airplane icon ➤ or an up-arrow ↑ at the right edge of the input bar — they do the same thing.

💬 Example: "I'm in Boston, planning a weekend trip to Portland, Maine, October 18-20. It's me and my partner, no kids. We like cozy coffee shops, short coastal walks and one really good dinner out."

You'll know it worked when Grok replies with a sentence that mentions your destination and dates, confirming it understood.

Step 3 — Add your interests, pace and limits

Send a second message that layers in what you actually enjoy: hobbies, food preferences, mobility limits, a budget vibe, or one "must-do" item. The more specific you are, the less generic the plan becomes. Grok reads both messages together, so you don't have to repeat yourself — just keep adding context. After you send, the model usually responds with a follow-up question or jumps straight into suggestions. Either is fine.

If you'd rather skip the back-and-forth, fold everything into one long first message — Grok handles long prompts well. If it asks too many questions, just say "skip the questions, give me a draft plan" and it will move on.

💬 Example: "Add: we don't mind driving up to 30 minutes for a view. We love bookstores and seafood but hate tourist-trap lobster rolls. Budget is casual — fancy once, cheap the rest. Must-do: a lighthouse."

You'll know it worked when Grok's next reply reflects your new details — you'll see your "lighthouse" or "bookstore" word come back in the text.

Step 4 — Ask for a full day-by-day draft

Now ask Grok to put it all together as a structured itinerary — day by day, morning to evening. The phrase "day-by-day" is the magic trigger: it pushes the model away from vague lists and into a usable schedule. You'll typically see a reply come back with bold day headings (Friday, Saturday, Sunday) and time blocks underneath, plus a few suggested restaurants or stops. Reading time is about 15 seconds — that's your draft.

If the reply is one big wall of text, reply with "format that as a numbered list with times" and try again. If it ignores one of your must-dos, point that out — see Common mistakes below.

Example: "Great. Now draft a full weekend itinerary, day by day, with morning, afternoon and evening suggestions. Include the lighthouse. Keep each day walkable, no back-to-back driving."

You'll know it worked when you see something like "**Saturday morning**" and "**Saturday afternoon**" as clear headings, with 2–4 concrete suggestions under each.

Step 5 — Tweak the plan until it fits

This is the fun part. Read the draft and tell Grok what to change — too much driving, swap dinner for lunch, add a Sunday breakfast, drop the museum. Treat the chat like a texting friend: short, specific edits work best. Each time you send an edit, Grok usually rewrites the affected sections rather than starting over, so the plan gets tighter with every turn. Two or three rounds is usually enough.

If Grok suggests something you've already done or doesn't interest you, just say "swap that for X" and move on. If you want a printable summary, ask: "give me a one-page bullet list I can screenshot."

Example: "Drop the brewery tour — neither of us drinks. Swap the Saturday afternoon museum for a 2-hour bookstore browse. Move the lighthouse to Sunday morning so we can catch the sunrise."

You'll know it worked when the updated plan reflects every edit and nothing from the old version contradicts the new one.

Step 6 — Save the plan off your screen

Once the plan feels right, get it off the chat and onto something you'll actually open on the trip. The easiest move is to ask Grok for a clean, copy-paste-friendly version, then paste it into your Notes app, a Google Doc or a message to yourself. You can also screenshot the chat, but text is easier to search and edit later. Grok cannot book hotels, flights or restaurants for you — that's still your job, and worth knowing upfront so you don't expect it to.

If you want it extra tidy, ask: "rewrite this as a plain text checklist, no markdown, no emoji." That version pastes into almost anything without breaking.

Example: "Perfect. Now give me the final plan as a clean plain-text list — day by day, time, place, one sentence on why. No markdown, no emoji, ready to paste into Notes."

You'll know it worked when you have a clean text list you can read in 30 seconds the morning of the trip, without scrolling back through chat history.

Common mistakes

- **Sending a one-liner like "plan my weekend."** Grok will guess everything and most of it will be wrong. Fix: spend 60 seconds on Steps 2 and 3 — destination, dates, who, what you like. Specificity saves you twenty minutes later.
- **Trusting suggestions as bookable facts.** Restaurants close, hours change, prices shift. Fix: cross-check any place you'd actually visit in five minutes on Google Maps before you go.
- **Asking for too many cities in one trip.** "Boston, NYC and Philly in 48 hours" produces a rushing plan nobody enjoys. Fix: keep one home base and treat day trips as optional add-ons.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** A weekend plan that used to take an evening of browser tabs and group-chat messages now takes one short conversation — and the result is shaped by what *you* actually like.
- **For your work or business:** The same "give me a day-by-day draft, then tweak" pattern works for client visits, conference schedules, offsite agendas and even family reunions — anything with a time, a place and a few people.
- **If you're just getting started:** Try this first with a trip you already half-planned. You won't be starting from zero, so it's easier to spot where Grok helps and where your own knowledge does the heavy lifting.

Try it now

Open Grok and type one sentence: "I'm in [your city], planning a weekend trip to [somewhere 1-3 hours away], dates [when]. It's me and [who]. I like [one interest] and I want to avoid [one thing]." See what comes back. Ninety seconds, no booking required.

Plan a 3-day weekend trip with DeepSeek, based on your interests and budget

6 steps · Read online

> **In short:** DeepSeek is a free AI assistant you can use in any browser. Give it a destination, your interests, and a rough budget, and it will draft a day-by-day weekend itinerary with activity ideas, food suggestions, and a cost breakdown — usually in under a minute. It can't book hotels or flights for you, but it's a strong starting point for planning.

You've got three days off, a vague idea of where you want to go, and zero interest in scrolling through forty travel blogs. DeepSeek (a free AI chatbot you can use through a web browser) can turn a few sentences about what you like and how much you want to spend into a draft itinerary you can actually use. This guide walks you through asking for that plan, refining it, and saving it somewhere handy.

Before you start

- **A free DeepSeek account** — sign up with an email address at the official DeepSeek website. The free tier is enough for trip planning.
- **A web browser** on a phone or computer — DeepSeek works in Chrome, Safari, Firefox and Edge.
- **Rough answers to four questions**: where you want to go, when, what you enjoy (food? nature? museums? nightlife?), and a ballpark budget per person. Don't worry about being precise.
- **About 10–15 minutes** for your first try. The whole conversation, including tweaks, usually takes less time than a single packing list.

Step 1 — Open DeepSeek and start a new chat

Go to the official DeepSeek website and sign in with the account you made. Once you're in, you'll see a clean chat screen with a text box at the bottom — this is where you type your request to the AI. There's usually a button like **"New Chat"** at the top-left or in the sidebar; tap it so the AI doesn't get confused by any previous conversation. If you don't see that button, refreshing the page works just as well — a blank chat box means you're starting fresh.

💬 Example: nothing to copy yet — this step is just opening the app.

You'll know it worked when the chat box is empty and ready for your first message.

Step 2 — Send your first planning prompt

Tap inside the text box and type a clear request that covers destination, dates, interests, and budget. Press the **paper-airplane icon** (or hit Enter) to send it. The AI will pause for a few seconds while it thinks — this is normal — then a full itinerary will appear as a written reply. Don't worry if it isn't perfect on the first try; the whole point of the next steps is to improve it. If your screen shows a **Send** button instead of an airplane, that's the same thing.

💬 Example: "Plan a 3-day weekend trip to Lisbon, Portugal, for two adults in mid-October. We love walking neighborhoods, trying local food, and one nice museum. Budget is about €120 per person per day, not including flights. Give us a day-by-day plan with morning, afternoon, and evening ideas, plus rough costs."

You'll know it worked when the AI replies with a structured day-by-day plan, usually within 30–60 seconds.

Step 3 — Read the itinerary and flag what you want to change

Read through the reply from top to bottom. Don't judge it too quickly — the first draft is a starting point, not the final answer. Look for the parts that genuinely excite you (jot those down) and the parts that feel off (an activity you'd never do, a restaurant type you don't eat, a cost that looks unrealistic). Use this quick mental checklist: Does each day have a sensible flow? Are travel times between spots reasonable? Is the food suggestion something you'd actually enjoy? This step is preparation for Step 4 — you're gathering feedback, not making changes yet.

💬 Example: none — this step is about reading, not typing.

You'll know it worked when you have a short mental list of "keep", "change", and "add" notes for the next message.

Step 4 — Ask for specific changes in a follow-up message

Type a new message in the same chat, asking DeepSeek to revise based on your notes. The magic of an AI chat is that it remembers the whole conversation, so you can refer back to the earlier plan without re-explaining everything. Be specific about what you want — vague feedback like "make it better" usually produces a worse plan, while a clear ask like "swap the museum for an outdoor hike on Day 2" gets you exactly that. The reply will replace or update the earlier itinerary in the same chat window.

💬 Example: "That looks great overall. Three changes: please drop the fado show on Day 1 (we're too tired after the flight) and replace it with a relaxed waterfront walk. On Day 2, swap the museum for a half-day Sintra trip by train. Also push the dinner budget up a bit — we'd rather one great meal than three average ones."

You'll know it worked when the new reply reflects your changes and the rest of the plan still makes sense.

Step 5 — Ask for a cost breakdown and packing reminders

Once the plan feels right, send one more message asking for a clear cost summary and a short packing list. This pulls everything into a format you can actually take on the trip. DeepSeek will usually reply with a table-style list of expected daily costs (accommodation, food, transport, activities) and a quick list of items to bring based on the weather and activities in your plan. If something in the breakdown looks too low or too high, ask it to adjust — that's why you keep chatting instead of starting over.

💬 Example: "Perfect. Now give me a cost breakdown per person per day (hotel, food, local transport, activities) and a short packing list for October weather and a lot of walking."

You'll know it worked when you see a tidy cost table and a packing list you can copy into your notes app.

Step 6 — Copy the plan somewhere you can use it offline

Highlight the final itinerary with your mouse or finger, copy it, and paste it into your phone's notes app, email, or a shared document with your travel partner. AI chats can disappear if you clear your browser, and you don't want to be stuck at the airport with no internet trying to remember what Day 2 said. If you travel with someone, paste it into a shared note so you can both edit it in real time on the trip. Treat the AI's plan as a strong draft — still confirm opening hours and book restaurants yourself.

💬 Example: paste it into a note titled "Lisbon — Oct 17–19" and share it with your travel partner.

You'll know it worked when you can open the plan from your phone's home screen without signing into DeepSeek.

Common mistakes

- **Too vague in the first message.** "Plan me a trip" gives generic answers. Always include destination, dates, who's going, and a budget number — even an approximate one.
- **Trying to make it perfect in one shot.** The first reply is rarely the best one. Plan on sending at least two follow-up messages to refine.
- **Trusting prices without checking.** AI cost estimates are reasonable guesses, not quotes. For anything expensive (tours, fancy restaurants), confirm the real price on the official website before you go.

- **Asking it to book things.** DeepSeek can plan, but it can't reserve hotels, buy tickets, or check your passport. You'll still do those steps yourself.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** You can draft a similar plan for a day trip, a long weekend, or even a "things to do this Saturday" list — the same prompt pattern works at any scale.
- **For your business or work:** The same skill (asking an AI to draft a structured plan from a few constraints) helps with meeting agendas, project outlines, and event planning.
- **If you're just getting started:** Treat the AI like a knowledgeable friend who talks fast — give it clear inputs, then edit the output. You'll get better results every time.

Try it now

Open DeepSeek in your browser and send this exact message: *"Plan a 3-day weekend trip to a city I haven't visited yet. Pick one for me, suggest why, and give me a day-by-day plan with food ideas and a rough cost breakdown for two people on a mid-range budget."* See what it picks — then in your second message, ask it to swap one activity for something more outdoorsy. That's the whole loop, and it takes about three minutes.

Organize Travel Planning Research with Perplexity's AI-powered Q&A

6 steps · Read online

Planning a holiday or a weekend getaway can feel like a mountain of research, right? This guide will show you how to use Perplexity, an **AI-powered Q&A tool** (think of it like a super-smart research assistant who reads widely and then summarizes the key facts for you), to quickly gather all your travel information and even create a basic itinerary. By the end, you'll be able to ask specific questions about your trip and get organized answers, saving you time and stress.

Before you start

- A device with an internet connection (computer, tablet, or smartphone).
- A web browser (like Chrome, Safari, or Edge) or the Perplexity mobile app installed.
- A free Perplexity account (signing up is quick with Google or Apple).
- Roughly 5-7 minutes to follow along.

Step 1 — Open Perplexity and start a new search

Your first step is to open Perplexity and get ready to ask your first question. When you open the Perplexity website or app, you'll usually see a clear **search bar** right in the center of the screen, often with a prompt like "Ask anything...". This is where you'll type your questions, just like you would on a regular search engine. Once the page is loaded, you're ready to start your travel research.

If it looks different: The exact layout might vary slightly between the website and the mobile app, or if they've updated the design. Always look for a prominent text box where you can type your question. Example: (No typing for this step, just observation) You'll know it worked when you see the main Perplexity screen with a large, inviting text box ready for your input.

Step 2 — Ask for flight information

Now it's time to find out about your travel options. You can type a question directly into the search bar about flights, like where to fly from and to, and your desired dates or month. Perplexity will then use its **conversational answer engine** (meaning it searches the web and summarizes the answers for you, often with links to its sources, like footnotes in a report) to find relevant flight information. This is much faster than sifting through multiple airline websites yourself.

If it looks different: If you don't immediately see flight options, try rephrasing your question to be more specific, like including airport codes or date ranges. Example: "Find me flights from

Portland (MEL) to Nashville (BNE) for the last week of September." You'll know it worked when Perplexity provides a summary of flight options, likely including airlines, approximate prices, and links to travel sites.

Step 3 — Ask for accommodation options

With flights in mind, let's explore where you'll stay. In the same chat window, you can now ask Perplexity for accommodation suggestions based on your destination and preferences. Think about the type of place you want – a hotel, an Airbnb, or perhaps a budget hostel. Perplexity will continue the "conversation," remembering your previous questions and providing relevant choices, often categorised by price or type.

If it looks different: If the answers aren't quite right, try adding keywords like "budget hotels," "family-friendly Airbnb," or "boutique hotels near city center." Example: "What are some good mid-range hotels in Nashville city center for a family of four?" You'll know it worked when you see a summary of accommodation options, complete with descriptions, estimated costs, and often links to booking sites.

Step 4 — Research activities or attractions

Once you know how you're getting there and where you're staying, the fun part begins – planning what to do! Ask Perplexity about popular attractions, hidden gems, or specific activities you're interested in. You can ask for things suitable for different interests, like "things to do with kids," "best art galleries," or "outdoor adventures." Perplexity will summarize key details about each suggestion, helping you build your daily plan.

If it looks different: If the suggestions aren't tailored enough, be more specific about your interests (e.g., "free activities," "museums for history buffs," "best hiking trails"). Example: "Suggest family-friendly activities in Nashville, especially outdoor options near the river." You'll know it worked when Perplexity lists a variety of activities, often with a brief description and opening hours or location details.

Step 5 — Refine and summarize your plan

After gathering all that information, you can ask Perplexity to help you organize it. This is where you can start turning your research into a basic itinerary. You can ask it to combine the information it has provided, or even to draft a simple plan based on your preferences. Perplexity will use the **context window** (its memory of your current conversation) to piece together a coherent response. Remember, it can draft the plan, but it can't book things for you directly.

If it looks different: If Perplexity struggles to create a full itinerary, break it down into smaller requests, such as "Summarize things to do on day 1" or "Combine flight and hotel info."

Example: "Create a simple 3-day itinerary for a family trip to Nashville using the information we discussed, including suggested activities." You'll know it worked when Perplexity presents a structured summary or a drafted itinerary based on your previous questions and instructions.

Step 6 — Export or save your research

Now that Perplexity has helped you gather and organize your travel plan, you'll want to save it. You can easily copy and paste the summary or itinerary into a document, an email, or a note-taking app. Perplexity typically provides options to **share or copy** the chat content, making it simple to transfer your organized research. Look for an icon that looks like a share symbol (an arrow pointing up from a box) or a simple "Copy" button.

If it looks different: If you don't see a clear share or copy button, you can always manually highlight the text with your mouse or finger and then use your device's standard "copy" function. 💬 Example: (No typing for this step, just observation) You'll know it worked when your Perplexity research is saved or shared to another location, ready for you to use in your travel planning.

Common mistakes

- **Being too vague in your questions:** Asking "Plan my holiday" is too broad for Perplexity to give a useful answer.
    - **The fix:** Be specific! Include dates, locations, number of people, interests, and budget ranges (e.g., "Plan a 5-day budget family trip to Phoenix for late November, focusing on outdoor activities").
- **Not using follow-up questions:** Treating Perplexity like a one-off search rather than a conversation.
    - **The fix:** Continue the conversation! Build on previous answers by saying things like "Now, tell me about hotels in that area" or "What about restaurants near those attractions?"
- **Expecting direct bookings or real-time availability:** Perplexity provides information and summaries, not live booking services.
    - **The fix:** Use the links Perplexity provides to external websites (like airline or hotel booking sites) to check live prices and make actual reservations. Perplexity is a research assistant, not a travel agent.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** You can quickly research and organize information for any personal project, from choosing a new appliance to planning a home renovation, without getting lost in countless browser tabs.

- **For your business or work:** You can rapidly summarize complex reports, research competitor activities, or gather background information for presentations, making your workday more efficient.
- **If you're just getting started:** Try planning a dream weekend getaway to a local destination you've always wanted to visit. Ask about public transport, coffee shops, and one main activity.

Try it now

Open Perplexity and ask for "the best places to get a flat white coffee in your nearest city, open on a Saturday morning." See how it finds and summarizes the information for you!

How to Use Amazon's Conversational Alexa+ at Home

6 steps · Read online

Imagine asking your smart speaker to help you organize a busy weekend, suggest dinner recipes, and schedule your day without having to repeat her name every few seconds. This guide will show you how to use the upgraded Alexa+ to have fluid, natural conversations that make managing your home much easier. While Alexa+ can help plan and coordinate tasks, remember it can't physically perform actions like cooking or directly send emails outside of its integrated systems.

Before you start

- **An Alexa-enabled device:** This guide applies to any compatible Amazon Echo speaker, smart display (like an Echo Show), or the official Alexa app installed on your mobile phone or tablet.
- **An active Amazon account:** Your device needs to be set up and linked to your Amazon account.
- **Alexa+ turned on:** In the US, Alexa+ is available to all customers and is free for Prime members. If you have Prime, say "Alexa, upgrade to Alexa+" to your device, or sign in with your Amazon account at alexa.com. Without Prime, alexa.com and the Alexa app offer a free text-based chat with limited access.
- **A stable internet connection:** Your Alexa device needs a reliable Wi-Fi connection to access its cloud-based AI capabilities.
- **Rough total time:** Allow about 5-10 minutes to follow this guide and try out a short conversation.

Step 1 — Turn on Follow-Up Mode

Alexa+ is built for natural, back-and-forth conversation and uses **generative AI** (an advanced type of artificial intelligence that can create new, human-like responses and content, acting like a highly capable digital assistant). To keep talking without saying her name every time, you use a setting called Follow-Up Mode. Amazon says you can switch it on by saying "Turn on Follow-Up Mode", or in your device settings or the Alexa app.

You'll know it worked when Alexa confirms the change and, after her next answer, a visual indicator shows that you can speak without the wake word.

💬 Example: Say clearly, "Alexa, turn on Follow-Up Mode."

Step 2 — Ask for help with a household task

With Alexa+ ready, you can speak to her more naturally, just like you would to a person. You don't need to use stiff commands. Describe your situation or request in detail. Alexa+ is designed to understand **context** (this means she remembers previous parts of your conversation, much like you'd remember what a friend told you moments ago), so feel free to provide background information.

You'll know it worked when Alexa processes your request and starts offering suggestions or asking clarifying questions, showing she's grasped the core of your query.

💬 Example: "I have some leftover roast pumpkin and spinach in the fridge. What is a quick, colorful lunch I can make with these in ten minutes?"

Step 3 — Refine ideas without repeating yourself

Once Alexa+ offers her initial suggestions, you don't need to say her wake word ("Alexa") again to continue the discussion, as long as Follow-Up Mode is on. According to Amazon, you can follow up for up to about 8 seconds after Alexa's response, and a visual indicator shows when you can speak without the wake word. You can immediately ask to modify a suggestion, request more details, or explore different options.

If the indicator goes away, Alexa has stopped listening for follow-ups. Just say "Alexa" again and continue. Follow-Up Mode does not work in every situation: Amazon notes it is not available during media playback or calls, and it does not apply to skills or smart home commands.

You'll know it worked when Alexa responds directly to your follow-up, building on her previous answer without you needing to say her name.

💬 Example: "That salad sounds great, but I do not have any feta cheese. What can I use instead?"

Step 4 — Turn your conversation into action

After you've refined your plan and settled on a course of action, you can ask Alexa+ to help you make it happen. For example, you can ask her to add items to your shopping list or to set a reminder or a timer. This saves you from manually performing these common follow-up tasks.

If Alexa says she can't complete an action, try rephrasing your request. For instance, instead of "send this," try "add this to my shopping list."

You'll know it worked when Alexa verbally confirms that she has performed the requested action, for example, "I've added the new ingredients to your shopping list," or "Your cooking timer for fifteen minutes has been set."

💬 Example: "Perfect. Add the alternative ingredients to my shopping list and set a cooking timer for fifteen minutes."

Step 5 — End the conversation

When you're finished, you can simply stop speaking. The follow-up window only lasts for a few seconds after Alexa's answer, so she returns to her standard "wake word needed" state on her own. If you prefer, you can also say something like "Thank you, Alexa. That's all for now."

If Alexa seems to keep listening after a long pause, you can always turn Follow-Up Mode off by saying "Turn off Follow-Up Mode" or in your device settings or the Alexa app.

You'll know it worked when the follow-up indicator is gone and Alexa only responds again when you say her name.

💬 Example: "Thank you, Alexa. That's all for now."

Step 6 — Review your actions

It's always a good idea to quickly check that Alexa carried out the tasks you requested, especially for things like shopping lists or reminders. You can ask Alexa directly, or open the Alexa app on your phone to verify. This step helps build confidence in using her conversational abilities for important daily management.

You'll know it worked when Alexa reads back your items, or you see the new items or reminders correctly listed in the Alexa app.

💬 Example: "Alexa, what's on my shopping list?" or "Alexa, what reminders do I have for today?"

Common mistakes

- **Repeating the wake word unnecessarily:** It's natural to want to say "Alexa" before every sentence, but while the follow-up indicator is showing, you don't need to. The fix: If the indicator is visible, just keep talking.
- **Waiting too long to speak:** The follow-up window only stays open for about 8 seconds after Alexa finishes speaking. If you need a moment to think, she might stop listening. The fix: If you need to pause, try to keep your response relatively quick, or simply say "Alexa" again to continue.
- **Over-complicating your requests:** While Alexa+ is much smarter now, giving ten different, complex instructions in one long breath can still lead to misunderstandings. The fix: Break down complex requests into one or two thoughts at a time, allowing Alexa to process each piece of information before moving on.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** You can easily organize chaotic family schedules, brainstorm dinner options, or plan your weekend activities entirely hands-free while washing up or cooking, making household management feel less like a chore.
- **For your business or work:** If you work from home, you can use Alexa+ as a quick brainstorming partner to outline your daily schedule, draft a simple checklist for your projects, or get quick facts without breaking your workflow.
- **If you're just getting started:** Keep things light and simple. Start by asking for a straightforward recommendation, like a three-step evening wind-down routine, to get used to the natural flow of the conversation.

Try it now

Walk up to your Alexa device (or open the Alexa app) and say: **"Alexa, turn on Follow-Up Mode."**

Then ask: **"Can you help me plan a quick morning routine for a productive day?"** See what she suggests, and then try asking one follow-up question, like "What about an evening wind-down routine?" without saying her name again.

Use Alexa+ to guide you through cooking recipes and manage multiple kitchen timers

6 steps · Read online

Imagine cooking without constantly checking a cookbook or fumbling with a phone covered in flour. This guide will show you how to use your Alexa+ smart speaker to be your hands-free kitchen helper, reading out recipe steps and managing multiple timers, so you can focus on the food.

Before you start

- An Alexa+ **smart speaker** (a voice-controlled device like an Amazon Echo)
- The **Alexa app** installed on your smartphone or tablet
- An active internet connection
- Roughly 10-15 minutes of your time

Step 1 — Set up your Alexa+ device and app

To begin, ensure your Alexa+ smart speaker is powered on and connected to your home's Wi-Fi network. Then, open the Alexa app on your smartphone or tablet. You should see a home screen displaying various Alexa+ features and connected devices. If you're setting up a new device, the app will usually guide you through the process automatically. If it looks different, look for a "Devices" icon (often a house or speaker symbol) at the bottom of the screen, then tap the plus (+) icon to add a new device. Example: N/A You'll know it worked when your Alexa+ device appears in the "Devices" section of your app and the light ring on your Alexa+ stops pulsing and shows a solid color (usually blue or white), indicating it's ready.

Step 2 — Find a recipe to follow

With your Alexa+ ready, you can now ask it to find a recipe. Simply stand within hearing distance of your Alexa+ and clearly state your request. Your Alexa+ (a **voice assistant**, which is an AI that listens to your spoken commands and responds verbally) will light up, typically with a blue ring, to show it's listening. It will then search for recipes based on your request and often ask you to confirm which one you'd like, or start listing ingredients. Example: "Alexa+, find me a recipe for pumpkin soup." You'll know it worked when Alexa+ responds with "I found a few recipes for pumpkin soup, which one sounds good?" or starts listing the ingredients for a recipe.

Step 3 — Begin cooking with guided instructions

Once Alexa+ has found a recipe you like, you can ask it to start guiding you through the cooking process. After you confirm the recipe, Alexa+ will usually ask if you want to start. Once you agree, it will read out the first step. You can then use simple voice commands to move through the recipe, hands-free. If it looks different, Alexa+ might ask you to say "start" or "begin" to kick things off. Example: "Alexa+, start the recipe." or "Alexa+, next step." or "Alexa+, repeat that." You'll know it worked when Alexa+ begins to read the first instruction, such as "First, gather your ingredients..." and pauses, waiting for your next command. Alexa+ can draft the recipe, but it cannot physically prepare the meal for you.

Step 4 — Set multiple timers for different dishes

Cooking often means juggling several things at once, and Alexa+ can manage multiple timers for you. To set a timer, just tell Alexa+ the duration and, optionally, give it a name. Your Alexa+ will confirm each timer has started. This is incredibly useful when you have different components of a meal that need varying cooking times, like rice, vegetables, and meat. Example: "Alexa+, set a timer for 10 minutes for the rice." and then "Alexa+, set another timer for 25 minutes for the chicken." You'll know it worked when Alexa+ verbally confirms each timer, saying something like, "Okay, a 10-minute timer called 'rice' starting now," and then for the next, "25-minute timer called 'chicken,' starting."

Step 5 — Check and manage your active timers

With several timers running, you might need to check their status or make adjustments. Simply ask your Alexa+ about your timers, and it will respond with the remaining time for specific timers or list all active timers. This is particularly handy if you lose track or need to pause something for a moment. If it looks different, some Alexa+ models with screens might display the timers, but voice feedback is always available. Example: "Alexa+, how much time is left on the chicken timer?" or "Alexa+, pause the rice timer." You'll know it worked when Alexa+ clearly states the remaining time for a specific timer, or responds, "The rice timer is paused," giving you the information or control you requested.

Step 6 — Handle timer alerts

When a timer finishes, your Alexa+ smart speaker will chime loudly to get your attention, ensuring you don't overcook anything. When you hear the alert, you can tell Alexa+ to stop the alarm or even snooze it if you need a few more minutes. Simply speak clearly to stop the noise. If the alarm continues, try a different phrasing like "Alexa, cancel timer." Example: "Alexa+, stop." or "Alexa+, snooze for 5 minutes." You'll know it worked when the chime stops immediately, and Alexa+ confirms, "Okay, stopping the timer," or "Okay, snoozing the timer for 5 minutes," allowing you to attend to your dish.

Common mistakes

- **Not speaking clearly or loudly enough:** Alexa+ relies on clear voice commands. If it doesn't understand you, it might say, "Sorry, I didn't get that." **Fix:** Articulate your words, speak directly to the device, and make sure there isn't too much background noise.
- **Forgetting specific timer names:** When you set multiple timers, it's easy to forget which name you assigned to which dish. If you say "Alexa, how much time is left on the timer?" it might ask for clarification. **Fix:** Try to use memorable, distinct names for each timer, like "rice timer" or "oven timer." If you forget, you can always ask "Alexa, what timers are running?"
- **Expecting Alexa+ to know every recipe:** While Alexa+ has access to many recipes, it won't know every single one, especially very specific or obscure family recipes. **Fix:** If Alexa+ can't find your exact recipe, try rephrasing with common ingredients, or ask for a more general dish, then adapt it with your own knowledge.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** Cooking becomes less stressful and more enjoyable. You can keep your hands free for chopping and stirring, reduce the risk of burning food with perfectly managed timers, and easily adapt recipes as you go. It's like having a personal sous chef.
- **For your business or work:** While primarily personal, the timer function can be useful for managing timed breaks, setting focus intervals, or keeping track of client call durations in a home office environment. The recipe guidance could also inspire meal prep for busy work weeks.
- **If you're just getting started:** Try setting just one timer for a simple task, like brewing tea. Once you're comfortable with that, ask Alexa+ to find a very simple three-step recipe, like scrambled eggs, and follow along. This builds confidence with voice commands before tackling more complex dishes.

Try it now

Walk into your kitchen, and simply say, "Alexa+, set a timer for 3 minutes for my tea." This quick action will help you experience the convenience of hands-free timing right away.

How to Use Gemini to Plan a Week of Simple Dinners From Food You Already Have

6 steps · Read online

> **In short:** You'll learn to list what's in your fridge and pantry, then ask Gemini, Google's AI assistant, for a week of simple dinners built from those items. Gemini can't see your kitchen unless you tell it what's there or share a photo, so your list is the key ingredient.

Stuck at 6 p.m. wondering what to cook, and tempted to order takeout? This guide is for anyone who wants to use up what they already own. By the end, you'll have a five- or seven-night dinner plan and a short shopping list of only the things you're actually missing.

Before you start

- **A Google account** and access to Gemini, either through the Gemini app or the Gemini website. Basic chatting is free, though some features may depend on your plan.
- **About 20 to 30 minutes** the first time. Later weeks take much less.
- **A notepad, phone notes app, or paper** for your kitchen list.

Step 1 — Open Gemini and start a new chat

Open the Gemini app on your phone or go to the Gemini website on a computer. You should see a large text box near the bottom of the screen with a line like "Ask Gemini" or similar wording. Look for a button such as "New chat" or a plus sign if you're in a conversation already. Starting fresh keeps your meal plan from getting mixed up with older questions.

💬 Example: Tap the text box and type "Hi, I'd like help planning dinners this week using food I already have."

You'll know it worked when Gemini replies in a friendly way and the text box stays open for your next message.

Step 2 — Take inventory of your fridge and pantry

Before you type anything to Gemini, walk through your kitchen and write down what you have. Check the fridge, the freezer, and the pantry shelves. Include partial items, like half an onion or the last cup of rice, and note anything that's close to its date, since those should be used first. Don't worry about spelling or neat categories. A rough list is enough.

If you want, group your items under simple headings like "Fridge," "Freezer," and "Pantry." Gemini doesn't need a perfect list. The more specific you are, such as "about 4 eggs" or "one can

of diced tomatoes," the more useful the dinner ideas will be.

You'll know it worked when you have a list of at least 10 to 15 items on your notepad.

Step 3 — Tell Gemini what you have and what you need

Now paste or type your list into the chat. Add the details Gemini needs to plan well: how many people you're feeding, how many nights you want to cook, and how much time you have on a typical weeknight. Mention anything you don't eat or want to avoid. Keep it to plain sentences. You don't need any special format.

Example: "I have eggs, half a bag of rice, a can of black beans, two onions, a bag of frozen peas, and some cheese. Please plan dinners for [number] people for [number] nights, each taking about [minutes] minutes to cook."

You'll know it worked when Gemini repeats some of your items back to you or starts suggesting ideas. If it asks a follow-up question, answer briefly.

Step 4 — Ask for a week of dinners that use your items first

Now ask for the actual plan. Tell Gemini to prioritize anything that will spoil soonest, and to keep the recipes simple. Ask for one main dish per night, plus a short list of ingredients for each. Gemini will usually return a day-by-day plan, but the exact layout can vary, so if it gives you a paragraph instead of a list, just ask it to reformat.

Example: "Using mainly the items I listed, make a dinner plan for [number] nights. Use anything that might spoil first, and list the main ingredients for each dinner."

If a suggestion calls for something you don't have, don't panic. Simply reply with "Swap the chicken for something I already have." Gemini can adjust. Keep in mind that its suggestions are a starting point. It can't check whether your food is still safe to eat, so look at dates and smell or look at items yourself before cooking.

You'll know it worked when you see a plan with a dinner for each night and most of the main ingredients come from your list.

Step 5 — Get a shopping list of only the missing items

Once you like the plan, ask Gemini to compare the recipes with your original list and create a short shopping list. This is where the savings add up, because you'll buy only what's truly missing. Look for a tidy list in the reply. If the answer includes items you already listed, point them out so Gemini can correct itself.

💬 Example: "Compare the ingredients for this plan with my pantry list and give me a shopping list of only the items I still need to buy."

You'll know it worked when the shopping list is noticeably shorter than a full grocery list and doesn't repeat things you already have.

Step 6 — Refine the plan and save it

Read the plan and ask for changes. Maybe a night needs to be faster, or someone in your home doesn't like fish. Just type your change in plain words, and Gemini will update the plan. When you're happy, copy the final version into your notes app or take a screenshot so you can find it while you're at the store or in the kitchen. Some versions of the app also let you use a copy button under a reply. Look for an icon that looks like two overlapping squares, if it's there.

💬 Example: "Make Wednesday's dinner faster, under [minutes] minutes, and replace the fish with something vegetarian."

You'll know it worked when you have one final plan, saved outside the chat, that you can follow without opening Gemini again.

Common mistakes

- **Expecting Gemini to see your kitchen.** It only knows what you type or upload. Fix it by listing your items every time, or by attaching a photo if your version of the app offers an attachment button, such as a plus sign or paperclip.
- **Writing a vague list.** "Some vegetables" gives weak results. Fix it by naming items and rough amounts, like "one bag of spinach" or "three potatoes."
- **Trusting the plan blindly.** Gemini can make mistakes about quantities and cooking times. Fix it by checking the portions against what you have, and by using your own judgment on freshness and food safety.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** Use the plan to make grocery trips shorter and cut down on the leftovers that end up in the trash.
- **For your business or work:** If you cook for a team event or a small office lunch, the same method helps you plan with what's on hand and build one shopping list instead of many.
- **If you're just getting started:** Begin with a single night. Ask for one dinner using three items you already own, and see how it feels before planning a whole week.

Try it now

Open Gemini, then write down five things in your fridge or pantry. Type them into a new chat and ask: "Suggest one simple dinner for [number] people using only these items." That's it. Two minutes, and you'll have your first idea.

Quickly compare two holiday cities using Qwen Chat

6 steps · Read online

By the end of this guide you'll be able to type two city names into Qwen Chat and receive a tidy, easy-to-read comparison of weather, costs and attractions. It's perfect for anyone who wants a fast first look without digging through dozens of travel blogs.

Before you start

- A free Qwen Chat account (sign-up takes about two minutes on the website).
- A device with a web browser – phone, tablet or computer will do.
- No special plan is required; the free tier can generate the comparison.
- Roughly ten minutes total time.

Step 1 — Open the Qwen Chat website and start a new conversation

Open your preferred web browser and navigate to **qwen.ai**. You'll see a clean, white landing page with a large text box at the bottom labeled *Type a message...* (this is the **prompt box**, where you type instructions for the AI). Click inside that box; the cursor will blink, showing the field is ready for typing. If you're on a phone and don't see the box, look for a button that says **New chat** or a plus sign (+) in the corner. You'll know it worked when the cursor appears in the prompt box ready for you to type.

Example: (no typing needed yet – just open the site).

Step 2 — Log in or continue as a guest

If you already have an account, click the **Log in** button near the top-right of the page and enter your email and password. After you press **Enter**, the page will refresh and the prompt box will stay at the bottom, now showing your name or avatar on the side (that indicates you're signed in). If you prefer not to create an account, look for an option to continue without signing in; clicking it will skip the sign-in step. On some devices the link may be under a three-dot menu (···) instead. You'll know it worked when you either see your profile name or the prompt box remains active without a sign-in form.

Example: (type your email — e.g., *alice@example.com* — and password, then hit **Enter**).

Step 3 — Type a clear prompt asking for a city comparison

In the prompt box, type a single sentence that names the two cities and the aspects you want compared. This sentence is called a **prompt** – think of it as the exact question you ask the AI.

For example: "Compare Key West and Santa Cruz Bay for a 5-day holiday in July, focusing on weather, daily cost and top attractions." After you press **Enter** or click the send icon (usually a paper-plane shape), the AI will start typing a response in the chat window. If the send icon looks different, it might be a labeled **Send** button instead. You'll know it worked when the AI's reply appears, beginning with a short introductory sentence.

💬 Example: Compare Key West and Santa Cruz Bay for a 5-day holiday in July, focusing on weather, daily cost and top attractions.

Step 4 — Review the summary and ask for bullet-point highlights

Read the AI's first reply; it will usually give a brief paragraph summarizing the main differences. If the paragraph feels too long to scan, type a follow-up prompt like "Give me the key points as a bullet list." When you send that, the AI adds a new message with each point on its own line, making it easier to read. If the interface offers any format buttons above the reply, you can try clicking those to get a different layout. If you don't see any, just type the follow-up prompt. You'll know it worked when you see a list where each line starts with a dash or a bullet.

💬 Example: Give me the key points as a bullet list.

Step 5 — Request a simple two-column table for easy comparison

Now ask the AI to turn the bullet points into a table, which is a grid of rows and columns that lets you compare side-by-side. Type something like "Please put the weather, cost and top attraction for each city into a two-column table." After you hit **Enter**, the AI will generate a text-based table that looks like:

City	Weather	Daily cost	Top attraction
Key West	Warm, tropical	Moderate	Florida Keys
Santa Cruz Bay	Mild, coastal	Moderate	Cape Hatteras Lighthouse

If the AI replies with plain text instead of a grid, you can type "Format that as a table, please." You'll know it worked when you see neatly aligned columns separated by vertical bars (|) and hyphens (-) as shown above.

💬 Example: Please put the weather, cost and top attraction for each city into a two-column table.

Step 6 — Save or share the comparison for later reference

To keep the chat for future use, look for a menu option in the top-right corner of the conversation pane — it might be labeled with words like **Save**, **Copy**, or shown as three dots (⋯). Click it; a small message like "Link copied to clipboard" may appear, or a confirmation dialog may show that your chat was saved. On mobile, you may need to tap the three-dot menu first before the save option appears. If you cannot find any of those, you can always select the whole table with your cursor, right-click and choose **Copy**, then paste it into a notes app. You'll know it worked when you either see a confirmation message or successfully paste the table elsewhere.

💬 Example: Tap the three-dot menu → Copy link.

Common mistakes

- **Mistake:** Using vague city names such as "Gold Coast."
  Fix: Specify the exact suburb or region (e.g., "Surfers Paradise vs. Santa Cruz Bay") so the AI knows which places to compare.
- **Mistake:** Expecting real-time prices or live weather forecasts.
  Fix: Remember Qwen Chat provides general estimates based on typical data; always double-check current prices or forecasts on official sites.
- **Mistake:** Skipping the follow-up request for bullet points or a table, leaving you with a long paragraph.
  Fix: After the first reply, explicitly ask "Give me the key points as a bullet list" or "Format that as a table" to get a scannable layout.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** When you're torn between two holiday spots, a quick chat with Qwen Chat gives you the core differences so you can decide without endless scrolling.
- **For your business or work:** Planning a team retreat or client visit? Use the same steps to compare venues on cost and amenities, helping you budget faster.
- **If you're just getting started:** Try the guide with two cities you already know a bit about; the easy copy-and-paste prompts will build your confidence in shaping AI replies.

Try it now

Open **qwen.ai** in your browser, type "Compare Portland and Nashville for a 4-day winter holiday, focusing on weather, cost and things to do," and hit **Enter**. In under a minute you'll have a concise comparison to help you pick your next getaway.

How to plan a trip with AI: itinerary, budget and tips

6 steps · Read online

By the end of this guide you'll have a complete travel plan – daily activities, a budget in US dollars and insider tips – ready to copy into any document. It's written for anyone who has never spoken to an AI before.

Before you start

- A computer, tablet or smartphone with internet access.
- A free AI chat tool (e.g., ChatGPT, Google Gemini, Microsoft Copilot) and an account you can sign into.
- A short list of the places you definitely want to see and rough travel dates (e.g., "7 days, arriving 1 July").
- About 10–15 minutes total to follow the steps and copy the results into a document.

Step 1 — Open a fresh conversation

Open your chosen AI chat tool in a web browser or app, then look for a button that says **New chat**, **Start a new conversation** or a plus-sign icon. Click it; a blank chat window should appear, usually showing a text box at the bottom and a welcome message at the top. If you don't see a plus-sign, look for a menu (three horizontal lines) and choose "New chat" from there. 💬 Example:

```
I'm planning a 7-day trip from Chicago to Japan. I want to spend 4 days in Tokyo and
3 days in Kyoto, love food markets, quiet temples and scenic train rides. Can you give
me a day-by-day itinerary, a budget in US dollars and five local tips?
```

You'll know it worked when the AI writes back with an introductory paragraph confirming the request and asks if you'd like more details.

Step 2 — Ask for a high-level itinerary

In the same chat window, type a short follow-up prompt asking the AI to outline the trip in broad strokes. Look for the text entry box at the bottom of the screen; it may be labeled "Type a message…" or simply show a blinking cursor. After you press **Enter** or click the send arrow, the AI will generate a list of days with main activities. If the screen shows a loading spinner instead of a response, wait a few seconds – the model may be thinking. 💬 Example:

```
Give me a simple outline: Day 1–2 in Tokyo, Day 3 travel to Kyoto, Day 4–7 exploring Kyoto. List one main activity per day.
```

You'll know it worked when you see a numbered list (e.g., "Day 1 – Arrive in Tokyo, explore …") appear under your prompt.

Step 3 — Request a detailed day-by-day plan

Now ask for more specifics. Click inside the same text box, type a new prompt, and press **Enter**. The AI should expand each day with times, opening hours and a food suggestion. If the AI's reply is only a short paragraph, add "Include approximate travel times, opening hours and one restaurant recommendation per day." as part of the prompt. 💬 Example:

```
Expand the outline. Include start-time, travel time between activities, opening hours, and one food recommendation each day. Use a 24-hour clock and metric distances.
```

You'll know it worked when each day is presented in a table-like format with columns for time, activity and food tip.

Step 4 — Ask for a budget breakdown

Create a separate prompt that asks the AI to estimate costs. Position the cursor in the text box, type the request and hit **Enter**. The AI will list categories such as flights, accommodation, food, local transport and activities, usually with US dollar figures. If the response shows only a single total, add "Please split the total into the categories mentioned." as a follow-up. 💬 Example:

```
Provide a budget estimate for a mid-range traveller in US dollars. Break it down into flights, accommodation, food, local transport and activities. Assume I'll stay in small hotels and eat at a mix of casual and nicer places.
```

You'll know it worked when every category has a dollar amount next to it and the sum matches the overall total.

Step 5 — Request local insider tips

In the same chat, ask for practical advice that isn't in a typical guidebook. Type a short prompt, press **Enter**, and wait for the AI to list tips such as best times to visit, payment methods and seasonal events. If you receive fewer than five tips, ask "Give me two more suggestions.". 💬 Example:

```
Give me five practical tips a local would share, like the best time of day to visit popular spots, how to pay for transport, and any festivals happening during my travel dates.
```

You'll know it worked when the AI returns a bullet list of five distinct pieces of advice, each labeled as a tip.

Step 6 — Review, copy and tidy the plan

Select the entire AI output (click→drag or press Ctrl+A / Cmd+A) and copy it (Ctrl+C / Cmd+C). Open a blank document in your favorite editor (Word, Google Docs, Notepad). Paste the content (Ctrl+V / Cmd+V). If the formatting looks messy, use the editor's "Paste without formatting" option or manually add line breaks. The final document should show a clear schedule, a budget table and a tip list. 💬 Example:

```
(press Ctrl +A, then Ctrl +C, open a new document, press Ctrl + V)
```

You'll know it worked when the document displays a tidy, readable table with columns for Day, Time, Activity, Food and a separate budget section you can scroll through.

Common mistakes

- **Skipping the "new chat" step:** Starting a conversation in an old thread can mix topics. Fix it by always creating a fresh chat before entering prompts.
- **Being too vague in prompts:** Asking "Plan my trip" without details leads to generic results. Fix it by including dates, cities, interests and budget preferences as shown in the examples.
- **Trusting the numbers blindly:** AI estimates are based on typical prices and may miss sales or seasonal spikes. Fix it by double-checking flight and hotel prices on real booking sites.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** Planning a weekend getaway to the Miami Beach becomes as easy as typing a few sentences; you'll leave with a day-by-day agenda, a cost estimate and local hacks before you book anything.
- **For your business or work:** If you travel for conferences, you can generate client-ready itineraries in minutes, freeing up time for preparation instead of research.
- **If you're just getting started:** Try the process with a short domestic trip first – the low stakes let you see how the AI responds and where you might need to tweak prompts.

Try it now

Open your AI chat tool, click **New chat**, copy the starter prompt below and press **Enter**. In two minutes you'll have a basic outline to build on.

```
I'm planning a 3-day trip from Portland to the Oregon Coast. I want to see Cannon Beach, a quiet beach and a local winery. Build me a day-by-day itinerary, estimate a budget in US dollars and give me three local tips.
```

How to Plan a Camping Trip with Any AI Assistant

5 steps · Read online

> **In short:** Any AI assistant — like ChatGPT, Gemini, Claude or Copilot — can help you plan a personalized camping trip. Give it your location, dates and group size, and it will draft a gear checklist, suggest nearby campsites and create a meal plan in under five minutes. The tool won't book anything for you, but it will give you a solid starting point you can refine in conversation.

Whether you're heading to the Blue Ridge Mountains, the Grampians or the Kimberley, planning a camping trip involves dozens of small decisions — what tent pegs do you need for sandy ground? What meals keep well without a fridge? An AI assistant can work through all of that with you, step by step, like a knowledgeable friend who has done the research. Here's how to use one effectively.

Before you start

- **An AI assistant** — any of ChatGPT, Gemini, Claude, Copilot or similar. The prompts in this guide work across all of them.
- **A rough plan** — know your destination state, the season and how many people are coming. Even "somewhere in Colorado in October, two people" is enough to start.
- **About 10–15 minutes** to work through the prompts and read the results. No paid plan needed — the free tier handles this easily.

Step 1 — Ask for a personalized gear checklist

Open your AI assistant and start a new conversation. Think of a prompt as a set of instructions — the more detail you give, the more useful the answer. Mention your destination, the season and who is coming along.

💬 Example: *"We're planning a two-night camping trip in the Blue Ridge Mountains in October for two people. One of us is a vegetarian. We're bringing a four-season tent. Can you give us a packing list broken into categories like shelter, clothing, cooking and safety?"*

The assistant will respond with a list, usually organized under headings. Read through it and notice any gaps — it might mention a first aid kit but forget to mention blister pads, for instance. Don't worry about perfection yet; you're building a draft.

What to do if the answer looks different: Some assistants format lists differently. If yours returns a wall of text instead of bullet points, try a follow-up: *"Could you break that into bullet points?"* Most assistants will reformat on request.

You'll know it worked when you have a list of at least 15–20 items you can physically check off before you pack.

Step 2 — Ask for nearby campsite and route ideas

Now that you have your gear sorted in your head, it's time to think about where to go. Be specific about the state or region — the assistant can't guess where you live. Also mention whether you want a powered site, a basic bush camp or something in between.

Example: *"We're flying into Kansas City and have a car. We're looking for camping spots within a three-hour drive that are dog-friendly, have basic facilities and are good for first-time campers. What do you recommend and what's the rough driving time to each?"*

The assistant will name several options. Note down the ones that sound right, then check a trusted source like the national parks website for current conditions, fire bans and booking requirements. An AI assistant knows a lot, but it doesn't always have the latest road closures or campsite bookings — think of it as a research assistant, not a live travel agent.

What to do if the answer looks different: If the assistant suggests spots that are too far or don't match your criteria, reply with more detail: *"That's helpful, but we can't drive more than four hours. What about closer to Portland instead?"*

You'll know it worked when you have two or three named campsites with enough detail (driving time, facilities, booking link or walk-in info) to start comparing them.

Step 3 — Ask for a meal plan that suits your trip

Food on a camping trip needs to survive a car boot, work without a proper fridge and require minimal cooking gear. Ask the assistant to think practically about this — mention any dietary needs and how many meals you need to cover.

Example: *"For a two-night camping trip for two adults (one vegetarian), give us a simple meal plan for breakfast, lunch and dinner for both days. We have a small gas cooker, a cooler box and basic utensils. Keep it to ingredients that don't need refrigeration."*

The assistant will suggest meals and a shopping list. This is one of the most useful things an AI can do — it thinks across the whole trip at once rather than meal by meal, so it can flag things like "you only need one small jar of pasta sauce for both nights." Review the list and swap anything that sounds impractical — if a recipe calls for a mortar and pestle you don't own, ask for an alternative.

What to do if the answer looks different: Some assistants give very elaborate recipes. If yours does, ask: *"Can you simplify those recipes to three steps or fewer and just list the ingredients?"*

You'll know it worked when you have a clear shopping list organized by meal, with ingredients that mostly overlap so you pack fewer individual items.

Step 4 — Refine your plan with a follow-up prompt

The first answers are a starting point. Most assistants have a context window — a memory for everything you've said so far in this conversation — so you can build on what you've already asked. This step is about tightening the plan to fit your situation.

💬 Example: *"That's great. One person in our group gets travel sickness, so we need to stop every two hours on the drive. Could you suggest a realistic driving schedule from Kansas City with breaks included? Also, we're on a tight budget — can you suggest cheap meal swaps for the vegetarian options?"*

The assistant will adjust its previous answers based on your new information. This iterative approach is the real strength of using an AI — instead of searching multiple websites and comparing advice manually, you have one conversation that builds on itself.

What to do if the answer looks different: If the assistant ignores part of your follow-up, try separating the questions more clearly: *"First, the driving schedule. Second, the budget meal swaps."*

You'll know it worked when you have a revised plan that addresses your specific constraints (budget, travel sickness, dietary needs) without you needing to search anywhere else.

Step 5 — Save or copy your plan

At this point your conversation contains a full draft — gear list, campsites, meal plan and driving schedule. The assistant won't save this for you automatically, so you need to do it manually. Copy the text into a notes app, email it to yourself or screenshot the key parts.

💬 Example: *"Can you summarize everything we've discussed into one message — the packing list, campsite options, meal plan and driving schedule? Make it easy to read so I can copy it into my notes."*

This single summarized message becomes your trip reference document. You can refer back to it on your phone while packing or on the road.

What to do if the answer looks different: If the summary is too long or cuts off, ask for a shorter version: *"Can you give me a one-page summary?"*

You'll know it worked when you have a single document you can open on your phone, no internet required, that covers everything you need for the trip.

Common mistakes

- **Asking too vaguely.** "Plan my camping trip" gives the assistant very little to work with. Mention your state, the number of people and the season — that small detail makes a huge difference in the quality of the answer.
- **Not checking the local rules.** An AI assistant might suggest a campsite that is closed, requires a permit you didn't know about, or is booked out months in advance. Always cross-check with the official national parks or campsite booking website for your state.
- **Asking it to book things.** An AI assistant can draft emails, write booking enquiry forms and suggest websites, but it cannot make a reservation on your behalf. If you need to book a campsite, you'll need to do that part yourself.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** Next time you have a planning task — a road trip, a dinner party menu, a home renovation — you can use the same approach. Give context, ask in stages and refine your answer before committing.
- **For your business or work:** The same prompt technique works for project checklists, client brief templates and meeting agendas. Once you know how to ask an AI clearly, you can apply it to almost any structured planning task.
- **If you're just getting started:** Your easiest first move is to open any AI assistant right now and ask for a packing list for your next weekend away. Change one detail — your destination or your group size — and watch how much the answer shifts.

Try it now

Open an AI assistant and paste this prompt, filling in your own details:

💬 Example: *"We're doing a [number]-night camping trip in [state or region] in [month] for [number] people. [Any dietary needs or special notes]. Can you give us a packing list, campsite ideas, a meal plan and a driving schedule?"*

Your plan will be ready in under two minutes. Refine it with one follow-up question, then save the final version to your notes. That's all it takes to go from blank page to trip outline.

Create AI-generated grocery shopping lists from pantry photos using Meta AI

5 steps · Read online

Imagine snapping a quick photo of your pantry or fridge and having a smart assistant suggest what you might need to buy at the shops. This guide will show you how to do exactly that using Meta AI, making your grocery runs simpler and more efficient. It's perfect for anyone looking to streamline their household tasks and cut down on forgotten items.

Before you start

- **A Meta account:** You'll need an active Facebook or Instagram account.
- **Access to Meta AI:** This is often found within your Messenger or Instagram app, or the app for your Ray-Ban Meta smart glasses.
- **A device with a camera:** A smartphone or your smart glasses will work perfectly.
- **Time needed:** Allow about 5-7 minutes to complete this process for the first time. The feature is generally available on free plans.

Step 1 — Open a Meta app and find Meta AI

Your first step is to open a Meta app where Meta AI is available and locate the chat assistant. Meta AI is like having a very clever digital assistant that can process information and understand images, built right into the apps you might already use.

ACTION: Open either your **Messenger** or **Instagram** app on your phone, or the app for your **Ray-Ban Meta smart glasses**. Then, look for the Meta AI icon or start a new chat with it.

WHAT YOU SEE: In Messenger, you might see a "Meta AI" chat already pinned at the top of your conversations, or a blue circular icon often representing Meta AI. In Instagram, you might tap the messages icon (a paper plane) and then look for the Meta AI chat. If you're using Ray-Ban Meta smart glasses, open their dedicated app.

WHAT HAPPENS: Tapping on the Meta AI chat or icon will open a new conversation window with the AI assistant.

IF IT LOOKS DIFFERENT: If you don't immediately see a Meta AI chat, try tapping the "New Chat" or "Compose" icon (often a square with a pencil inside or a plus sign) and then searching for "Meta AI" in the contact list.

You'll know it worked when you see a clear chat window with "Meta AI" or a similar greeting at the top, ready for you to type a message.

Step 2 — Start a new conversation

Once you've found Meta AI, it's a good idea to start a fresh conversation for your grocery list to keep things clear and focused.

ACTION: If you're in an ongoing chat, look for an option to **start a new chat** or simply type your request into the existing input box if it's already a fresh topic.

WHAT YOU SEE: A blank chat screen will appear, often with some suggested questions or prompts that Meta AI can answer. These suggestions are just there to give you ideas, so don't worry about them for now.

WHAT HAPPENS: You'll have a clean slate, ready to provide your input without any previous chat clutter. This ensures the AI is focused solely on your current task.

IF IT LOOKS DIFFERENT: Some apps might not have a dedicated "new chat" button within an AI conversation. In this case, simply type your request into the message box. The AI is smart enough to understand you're starting a new topic.

You'll know it worked when you see a clear, empty message input box at the bottom of the screen, indicating you're ready to send your first message or photo.

Step 3 — Take a photo of your pantry

Now for the fun part! You'll use your device's camera to show Meta AI what's in your pantry or fridge. A clear picture helps the AI "see" your items better.

ACTION: Tap the **camera icon** (usually a small camera graphic) located near the message input box. This will open your device's camera. Take a well-lit, clear photo of a section of your pantry, fridge, or cupboard.

WHAT YOU SEE: Your phone's camera view will appear on your screen. Frame your shot to clearly show the items you want Meta AI to assess. After you take the photo, a preview will usually pop up, asking if you want to use it.

WHAT HAPPENS: Once you confirm you want to use the photo, it will be attached to your message in the Meta AI chat, but not yet sent. It's like clipping a picture to a letter before you put it in the post.

IF IT LOOKS DIFFERENT: If you don't see a camera icon, look for a **paperclip icon** or an **image gallery icon** (often a mountain landscape). Tapping this will let you select a photo from your device's gallery, so you can take the picture first with your regular camera app and then attach it. Ensure your photo isn't too blurry and has decent lighting so the AI can identify items.

You'll know it worked when the photo you just took appears in the message input area, above where you would type text, ready to be sent.

Step 4 — Ask Meta AI for a shopping list

With your photo attached, it's time to tell Meta AI what you need. Be specific with your request to get the best results.

ACTION: In the message input box, type your request. Then, tap the **send button** (often a paper plane icon) to send both the photo and your message to Meta AI.

WHAT YOU SEE: Your typed message and the attached photo will be sent into the chat. Meta AI will typically show a "typing" indicator as it processes your request and analyzes the image. This AI process involves a large language model working alongside image recognition technology to understand both your words and the contents of your picture.

WHAT HAPPENS: Meta AI will examine the items in your photo and use your request to generate a suggested grocery list. It's a good idea to be specific about what you're looking for — for example, ask what items you might be low on or need to restock.

IF IT LOOKS DIFFERENT: Make sure the photo is definitely attached before you hit send. If the AI doesn't give a useful list, try rephrasing your question to be even clearer, for example, "Look at this picture of my fridge, what groceries do I need for healthy meals?"

💬 **Example:** "Based on this photo of my pantry, what groceries do I need to buy? Please list items I might be low on or running out of."

You'll know it worked when Meta AI responds with a bulleted or numbered list of suggested grocery items in the chat.

Step 5 — Refine your list with follow-up questions

Meta AI is an interactive tool, meaning you can chat back and forth to fine-tune the results. Your first list might be a good start, but you can make it even better.

ACTION: Type follow-up questions or instructions into the message input box and send them to Meta AI.

WHAT YOU SEE: Meta AI's previous response will still be visible, and your new message will appear below it. The AI will again show a "typing" indicator.

WHAT HAPPENS: Meta AI will use your new instructions to adjust the previously generated list. It can add items, remove them, or change the quantity suggestions based on your feedback. For instance, if it suggests milk but you just bought some, you can tell it to remove that item.

IF IT LOOKS DIFFERENT: If Meta AI misunderstands, try simplifying your request. Instead of "Can you exclude all dairy and gluten-free items, and also add some fresh fruit?", try "Remove dairy. Remove gluten-free items. Add fresh fruit." one by one.

💬 **Example:** "Please make this list suitable for a single person for just three days." or "Could you remove the pasta and add more fresh vegetables instead?"

You'll know it worked when Meta AI provides a revised grocery list that more accurately reflects your needs and preferences, incorporating your recent feedback.

Common mistakes

- **Blurry or dark photos:** If Meta AI can't clearly see the items, its suggestions will be generic or inaccurate.
    - **Fix:** Retake photos in good, bright light, focusing on specific sections. Ensure items aren't obscured.
- **Too much clutter:** An overloaded pantry shelf with items stacked on top of each other can confuse the AI.
    - **Fix:** Focus on one shelf or section at a time, or tidy up a bit before snapping your picture.
- **Vague requests:** Just sending a photo without a clear question won't give you specific results.
    - **Fix:** Always pair your photo with a clear, concise question like "What am I missing for a week's worth of meals?"

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** This means fewer forgotten items at the shop, less food waste because you're buying what you actually need, and more time saved not having to manually check every shelf. It's a small step that adds up to a big convenience!
- **For your business or work:** While primarily personal, a similar approach could apply to managing supplies in a small home office or a tiny cafe. Imagine quickly checking inventory for stationery or basic ingredients simply by snapping a photo and asking an AI for a restock list.
- **If you're just getting started:** Don't try to photograph your entire pantry at once. Start with a single shelf, like your spice rack or breakfast cereals, and practice asking Meta AI to identify what you have.

Try it now

Grab your phone, open your Messenger or Instagram app, and find Meta AI. Take a photo of your fruit bowl or a single cupboard shelf and ask Meta AI, "What fresh produce do I have, and

what am I missing for a healthy snack?" See what it suggests!

How to run your first open-source LLM from DeepSeek on a home PC

5 steps · Read online

Have you ever wanted to chat with a powerful AI without sending your private conversations off to a tech company's distant servers? This step-by-step guide will show you how to download and run DeepSeek's open-source AI entirely on your own laptop, keeping your data completely secure and offline.

Before you start

- **A modern computer:** A Windows PC or Mac laptop, ideally made in the last few years, with at least 8GB of memory (often called RAM).
- **A stable internet connection:** You'll need to download several gigabytes of files, so a reliable connection will make the process smoother.
- **Hard drive space:** Around 5GB of free storage space on your computer to hold the AI model and the helper application.
- **Time commitment:** Roughly 15-20 minutes, with most of that time spent waiting for downloads.
- **No paid plans needed:** Both the helper application (Ollama) and the DeepSeek AI model are completely free to download and use.

Step 1 — Download and install Ollama

To run an AI model on your computer, you first need a special helper application that translates between your computer's hardware and the AI's digital brain. We'll use a free, trusted tool called **Ollama**. Think of Ollama like a video player, while the DeepSeek AI is the movie file you want to play.

Visit the official Ollama website in your web browser. You'll see a prominent "Download" button or options for different operating systems like "Download for Mac" or "Download for Windows." Click the appropriate button for your computer. Once the download is complete, find the downloaded file (usually in your "Downloads" folder) and double-click it to start the installation. Follow the on-screen prompts, accepting the default options, much like installing any other software. If the website layout looks different, simply look for a section titled "Download" or "Get Ollama" and select your computer's operating system.

You'll know it worked when: The Ollama application is installed on your computer, and you might see an Ollama icon in your system tray (bottom-right on Windows) or menu bar (top-right on Mac).

Step 2 — Open your computer's command center

To tell Ollama to fetch and start the DeepSeek model, we need to use a simple text command. This is done through a special window where you type instructions directly to your computer, often called the "command center" or "terminal."

- **On Windows:** Click your Start menu (the Windows icon, usually bottom-left), type "cmd" into the search bar, and then click to open the "Command Prompt" app.
- **On a Mac:** Press the `Command` key and the `Spacebar` on your keyboard at the same time (this opens Spotlight Search), type "Terminal," and then press `Enter`.

A new window will open on your screen. This window usually has a black or dark background with white text and a blinking cursor. It might look a bit old-fashioned or "retro," but it's very powerful for specific tasks. If you see "PowerShell" open on Windows instead of Command Prompt, that's perfectly fine too, as it works similarly.

You'll know it worked when: You see a dark window on your screen with a line of text ending in a blinking cursor, typically showing something like `C:\Users\YourName>` on Windows or `YourName@YourComputerName ~ %` on Mac.

Step 3 — Download and run DeepSeek

Now we will fetch a lightweight version of DeepSeek's model. This is an **LLM (Large Language Model)**, which is the digital engine or "brain" that powers a chatbot like ChatGPT. We'll use a smaller version of DeepSeek-R1 that is specifically designed to run smoothly on everyday home computers.

In your Command Prompt or Terminal window, type the following command *exactly* as shown. Pay close attention to spacing and punctuation, then press `Enter`. Your typed command will appear on the screen.

💬 Example: `ollama run deepseek-r1:1.5b`

After you press Enter, your computer will automatically start downloading the DeepSeek model files. You'll see text indicating the download progress, often showing a percentage or a download speed. Depending on your internet connection, this could take a few minutes. If it seems to get stuck or you see an error, double-check your spelling of the command and ensure your internet is connected.

You'll know it worked when: The download completes, and the command line prompt changes to a chat interface, often showing a line like `>>>` or `Send a message (/? for help)`, indicating the AI is ready for your input.

Step 4 — Start your private conversation

You are now connected to an offline AI running entirely on your local machine! This means your conversations stay on your computer and are not sent to any external company's servers.

At the `>>>` prompt, type your question or a command (this is called a "prompt") and press `Enter`. For example, you could ask it for ideas, summaries, or explanations. After you send your message, the AI will begin to "think" and then generate its response word by word, just like you might see in online chatbots.

💬 Example: `What are three fun activities to do on a rainy weekend afternoon?`

If the AI's response seems to miss the point, try rephrasing your question with more detail. This AI is running entirely on your computer, so its speed will depend on your hardware.

You'll know it worked when: The AI finishes typing its full response, and a new prompt (like `>>>`) appears below, ready for your next input.

Step 5 — Finish your chat session

When you're finished chatting with DeepSeek and want to close the conversation, you can simply tell the AI you're done. This will return you to your computer's regular command line, where you started.

At the `>>>` prompt, type the special command `/bye` and then press `Enter`. The chat session will then end, and the AI will stop responding.

💬 Example: `/bye`

After typing `/bye` and pressing Enter, the chat interface (the `>>>` prompt) will disappear. You will then see your standard command line prompt again (e.g., `C:\Users\YourName>` or `YourName@YourComputerName ~ %`), indicating that you have exited the DeepSeek chat and are back to your computer's general command center. If `/bye` doesn't seem to work, you can usually force quit by holding down the `Control` key (or `Ctrl` on Windows, `Command` on Mac) and pressing the `C` key a couple of times.

You'll know it worked when: The `>>>` chat prompt disappears, and you see your regular computer command line prompt again, ready for you to close the window or type other computer commands.

Common mistakes

- **Typing errors in commands:** A single typo can stop the command from working.

    - **The fix:** Always double-check your spelling, spacing, and use of hyphens in commands like `ollama run deepseek-r1:1.5b` before pressing Enter. The command line is very precise!
- **Very slow AI responses:** If the AI takes a very long time to generate a reply, your computer may be running low on active memory (RAM).
    - **The fix:** Try closing web browsers, games, or video editing software to free up your computer's RAM. Also, stick to smaller models like the `1.5b` or `8b` versions for better performance on typical laptops. The "b" stands for "billions of parameters," which are like the neural connections in the AI's brain; fewer parameters mean the AI needs less processing power.
- **Downloading a model that's too large:** Trying to download the huge "70b" versions of models will likely not work well on a home PC and can take up significant disk space.
    - **The fix:** For your home computer, avoid models with "70b" in their name. Stick to smaller, more efficient versions like `deepseek-r1:1.5b` or, if your computer is powerful, perhaps a `deepseek-r1:8b` version.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** You can safely brainstorm personal gift ideas, draft private diary entries, or summarize sensitive documents knowing that your data remains strictly on your own physical computer drive and isn't shared with anyone. It's like having a private, digital thought partner.
- **For your business or work:** You can experiment with copywriting, organize messy data, or draft confidential reports without worrying about breaching client privacy policies or company data protection rules, as no information leaves your device.
- **If you're just getting started:** The easiest first move is to ask DeepSeek simple questions you might otherwise type into a search engine, but with the added benefit of getting a conversational answer and knowing your query is private.

Try it now

Once you've installed Ollama and run DeepSeek-R1, try asking it a simple, creative question. For instance, ask: "Give me three healthy snack ideas for busy weekdays."

How to Send a Quick Voice Message to a Family Member's Echo

5 steps · Read online

> **In short:** With Alexa+, you can speak a short voice note to one Echo and have it play out loud on another Echo in your home, hands-free. Amazon says Alexa+ understands more conversational wording than the older Alexa, so you can name a room or a person in plain English. Note: Alexa+ is still rolling out — if your Echo doesn't have it yet, the older "Drop In" command still works with similar steps.

You're downstairs chopping vegetables. Your partner is upstairs with headphones on, and the kids have a movie blaring. Yelling doesn't work, and walking up costs you time and a clean knife hand. A short voice note dropped on the bedroom Echo solves it in about ten seconds. This guide walks you through that — naming the right Echo, speaking your message, and checking it actually arrived.

One honest limit up front: this is a one-shot voice note, not a phone call. The other person can't talk back through the Echo, and if their device is on Do Not Disturb, the message will arrive silently in the Alexa app instead of playing out loud.

Before you start

- **Two Echo devices**, both signed in and on the same Amazon household (or a family member's account that has accepted you as a contact). One is the speaker, one is the receiver.
- **The Alexa app** (free on iOS or Android), already installed and signed in on your phone.
- **Clear names for each Echo** in the app — something like "Kitchen Echo" and "Bedroom Echo" — so Alexa can tell them apart.
- **Communications turned on** in the app. It usually is by default, but if it was ever disabled, you'll need to switch it back.
- **About 5 minutes** the first time, around 30 seconds once you've done it a few times.
- **A quick honesty note:** if you only have one Echo, this guide doesn't apply yet — you need a second device to receive the message. Also, Alexa+ features are still reaching devices in waves; if a step doesn't match your screen, the older "Drop In" command may be what your Echo understands instead.

Step 1 — Name each Echo so Alexa can tell them apart

Open the **Alexa app** on your phone. At the bottom of the screen, look for a tab that has a small speaker or chip icon — this is usually labeled **Devices**. When you tap it, you'll see a list of every Echo on your account. If two of them have the same generic name, tap the one you want to rename, then look for an **Edit** option (often labeled "Edit Name" or shown as a small pencil

icon) and give it a room-based name. Example name pair: "Kitchen Echo" and "Bedroom Echo." **If it looks different:** the Devices tab sometimes lives under a **Menu** button (three lines, often in the top-left corner). If you can't find a rename option, your device may not be on the Alexa+ rollout yet — the older "Drop In" command works the same way and uses the same names. You'll know it worked when both Echos appear in the app with clearly different, location-based names.

Step 2 — Make sure the recipient is in your Alexa contacts

Still in the Alexa app, look at the bottom bar for a tab that has a chat-bubble or speech-bubble icon — this is often labeled **Communicate**, though some accounts see **Talk** or **Message** instead. Tap it, then look near the top for **Contacts**. You should see the family member you want to message if you've ever called or messaged them through Alexa before. If they're not there, look for an **Add Contact** button and follow the prompts to add them by name or by their Amazon account email. Example: add "Mom" with her Amazon account email so her Echo shows up under that name. **If it looks different:** if you only see your own devices and no contacts, communications may be turned off. Look in the app under **Settings → Alexa Account → Alexa Communications** (or something similar) and switch it on. You'll know it worked when you can see the family member's name in your contacts list, with at least one of their Echo devices listed underneath.

Step 3 — Send a voice note by speaking to your Echo

Walk over to the Echo you want to send **from** and say the wake word — usually "Alexa" — followed by your request in plain language. Amazon says Alexa+ is designed to understand more conversational phrasing than the older Alexa, so you don't need to memorize a rigid command. Just describe what you want the way you'd describe it to a person. Example phrases: "Alexa, drop a voice message on the Kitchen Echo." / "Alexa, send a voice message to Mom's Echo saying dinner is ready." / "Alexa, tell the Bedroom Echo we'll leave in five minutes." **If it looks different:** if you only have one Echo in your home, Alexa may say she can't find the device you named — go back to Step 1 and make sure the names match what you actually said. If the older "Drop In" wording is what your Echo understands, that still works; the rest of the steps below behave the same way. You'll know it worked when Alexa confirms out loud — something like "Sending your message to the Kitchen Echo" — and you hear a short chime.

Step 4 — Speak your note, then stop talking to send it

After the chime, just talk naturally — a short sentence is plenty. Think of it like leaving a voice memo on someone's answering machine: keep it short, speak clearly, and stop. There's no "send" button. Stopping talking is what sends it. If you pause for a moment after your message, Alexa wraps up the recording and ships it. Example: "Hey, dinner's on the table — come down

when you can." **If it looks different:** if the recording seems to keep going longer than you'd like, just stay quiet for a beat and it will close on its own. If your message gets cut off mid-sentence because you paused too long, just say the command again and try once more — speaking in one smooth go usually works best. You'll know it worked when Alexa says something like "Message sent" and the Echo's light ring returns to its normal idle color (usually blue, then off).

Step 5 — Check on the receiving Echo

On the Echo that's supposed to play your message, the voice note will play out loud automatically when it arrives. The light ring usually pulses while it's playing, so anyone nearby knows a message just dropped. If you're curious whether it landed, open the **Alexa app**, go back to the **Communicate** tab, and look for a **Recent** or **Conversations** list — your voice drop should appear with the recipient Echo's name and the time it was sent. 💬 Example: send "Test from the kitchen" the first time you set this up, then walk to the other Echo and confirm you heard it play. **If it looks different:** if the recipient Echo is muted or has **Do Not Disturb** turned on, the message still arrives in the Alexa app but won't play out loud on the device. Open the app, tap that Echo, and look for a **Do Not Disturb** toggle to switch it off if needed. You'll know it worked when the receiving Echo plays your words out loud in Alexa's voice, or when the entry shows up in your Recent list with the right device name and time.

Common mistakes

- **Both Echos have the same name.** If everything is just "Echo," Alexa can't tell them apart and will either ask a clarifying question or send to the wrong one. Rename each device with its room (Step 1).
- **The recipient isn't in your contacts.** You can only send a voice message to someone who has accepted your contact request in the Alexa app. Add them through the Communicate tab first, then have them accept on their end.
- **Do Not Disturb is on the receiving Echo.** The message still arrives but stays silent. Turn off Do Not Disturb in the Alexa app, or say "Alexa, turn off Do Not Disturb" on that specific Echo.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** a quick voice drop replaces the "yell upstairs" routine, the "send a text" friction, and the "find my phone" scramble. It's also handy for relatives who prefer talking to typing — kids, older parents, anyone who'd rather hear your voice than read a message.
- **For your business or work:** if you run a small home business, you can drop a voice note from your office Echo to a workshop or garage Echo without leaving what you're doing — useful when your hands are full or you're mid-task.

- **If you're just getting started:** the easiest first move is renaming your two most-used Echos with their room names. Once that's done, every future voice drop is a single sentence away.

Try it now

Pick two Echos in your home, give them clear room names in the Alexa app, and send one short test message between them. Time yourself — most people land their first successful drop in under a minute once the names are set.

How to plan a stress-free family road trip with Copilot

5 steps · Read online

> **In short:** With Microsoft Copilot, you can build a family road trip plan in four short conversations — route stops, packing list, snacks and budget — and copy everything into your phone. The free version is enough for this task, and Copilot can't book hotels or buy tickets, so you'll do that part yourself.

Imagine you're three weeks out from a long weekend, the kids have been asking "where are we going?" for a month, and your only plan so far is a vague idea and a full inbox. Copilot — Microsoft's free AI assistant that lives in your browser and in a mobile app — can take that fuzzy outline and turn it into a real itinerary while you sit with a coffee. The trick is to ask one focused question at a time, treat the replies like a draft, and adjust as you go. The whole plan takes about twenty minutes if you already know your start city, your end city, and roughly how many days you have.

Before you start

- A free Microsoft account (or just open Copilot without signing in for basic use).
- The Copilot website (copilot.microsoft.com) or the Copilot mobile app on iOS or Android.
- A rough idea of your start city, end city and total driving days — exact stops not required yet.
- About 20–30 minutes in one sitting, ideally on a phone or laptop you can read comfortably.

Step 1 — Open Copilot and start with the big picture

Go to copilot.microsoft.com in your browser, or open the Copilot app on your phone. You'll see a chat box near the bottom of the screen, usually with placeholder text like "Ask me anything…" and a small send arrow. Type your first question about the trip — be specific about who's going, how many days you have, and any must-see stop you already have in mind. After you press send, a short reply usually appears within a few seconds with a suggested route and one or two clarifying questions. If your screen looks different, look for a search-bar-shaped text field near the bottom, or tap a button labeled "New chat" to start fresh.

💬 Example: "We're a family of four with two kids (ages 7 and 10) planning a 5-day road trip from Chicago to Denver in mid-July. We want to see Mount Rushmore on the way. Can you suggest a route with 2–3 fun stops each day that won't exhaust the kids?"

You'll know it worked when Copilot replies with a day-by-day route and asks a clarifying question or two — that's the conversation starting.

Step 2 — Ask for a packing checklist

In the same chat, type a follow-up asking for a packing checklist. You'll see your earlier message and Copilot's reply above, and an empty text box below — that's where this prompt goes. Copilot usually returns a list grouped by category (clothes, toiletries, car kit, entertainment) and may ask about your climate or vehicle type. If the reply feels too generic, mention the kids' ages again, or ask for it as a bulleted list under a tight word count so it's easy to screenshot. If you don't see a clear list format, type "please format as a simple bulleted list I can screenshot" and it will rewrite.

Example: "Great route, thanks! Now can you make us a packing checklist for the car and for the kids? July weather, minivan, two adults and two kids. Format it as a simple bulleted list I can screenshot — keep it under 20 items total."

You'll know it worked when Copilot produces a structured list with categories you didn't have to think of yourself — like "car emergency kit" or "snacks and water bottle refills."

Step 3 — Ask for kid-friendly snack and activity ideas

Still in the same conversation, type a request for snacks and in-car games for the kids. After you send it, Copilot typically replies with a mix of snack suggestions (some store-bought, some DIY) and simple games like license-plate bingo or road-trip trivia. If the suggestions feel too adult or too babyish, mention the ages again and ask for things that don't need screens. On the mobile app, this is a good moment to try voice mode — look for a small microphone icon near the text box — and dictate while your hands are busy. If voice mode doesn't appear, just type; the answers are the same.

Example: "Can you suggest 8 road-trip snacks that won't melt in a hot car and 5 screen-free games for a 7- and 10-year-old on a 5-hour driving day?"

You'll know it worked when the reply includes both snacks AND games, with at least one idea you hadn't considered before.

Step 4 — Build a simple budget together

Ask Copilot to draft a rough budget for the trip. After you send the prompt, it usually replies with cost categories — fuel, food, lodging, attractions, and a small buffer — plus a sample total. If a category is missing (pet care, souvenirs, an extra hotel night), ask it to add one. Be honest if the total feels too high or too low; tell Copilot your rough number and it adjusts. Treat any specific dollar figures as starting estimates — real fuel prices, hotel rates and attraction tickets change constantly. If the budget reply is missing a category you care about, type "please add a category for souvenirs and pet boarding" rather than starting over.

💬 Example: "Can you make a simple budget for a 5-day family road trip for 4 people? We need fuel, 2 hotel nights, food, attraction tickets for Mount Rushmore and one other stop, plus a buffer. Try to keep the total around $1,500."

You'll know it worked when Copilot returns a budget broken into clear categories with a sample total, and you can change one or two numbers to match your reality.

Step 5 — Copy the plan into your phone's notes

Once the four pieces exist, ask Copilot to combine them into one short summary you can save. In the same chat, type something like "Can you put all of this into one short summary I can copy into my notes app?" and Copilot usually produces a compact version with headings. Look for a small "Copy" icon at the bottom-right of its reply, or tap and hold the message to select and copy it. Paste the result into your phone's notes app, email it to yourself, or share it with your travel partner. If something looks off, ask Copilot to fix just that piece ("can you swap Day 2's stop to Wall Drug?") instead of starting a new chat from scratch.

💬 Example: "Perfect. Now can you write one short summary — under 300 words — that combines the route, top 5 packing items, 3 favorite snacks, and the budget total? I'll paste this into my phone's notes app."

You'll know it worked when you can paste a clean, organized summary into your notes app and share it with at least one other person.

Common mistakes

- **Asking for everything in one giant prompt.** Copilot does better with focused questions. A single mega-prompt crammed with route, snacks and budget usually returns a vague answer that misses parts.
- **Forgetting to mention the kids' ages.** Without that detail, suggestions default to generic adult travel and miss the part that actually makes a family trip work.
- **Treating Copilot's budget as the final word.** Numbers like fuel cost or hotel price are rough estimates that depend on your car, the season and current rates. Use them as a starting point and adjust yourself.
- **Starting a new chat for every question.** Stay in the same conversation so Copilot remembers your route, family size and dates — it saves you retyping the basics every time.
- **Assuming Copilot can book things for you.** It can draft the plan, but it can't reserve hotels, buy tickets or pull up live gas prices. You'll do those clicks yourself.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** A road trip plan you build in twenty minutes replaces about two hours of scrolling through travel blogs and Pinterest boards — and you can adjust it on the fly as weather, moods or budgets change.
- **For your business or work:** The same "ask one focused question at a time" approach works for project planning, event coordination or any multi-step task. Treat Copilot like a patient assistant who needs clear instructions, not a magic eight ball.
- **If you're just getting started:** Don't worry about getting the perfect prompt on the first try. If a reply misses the mark, just tell Copilot what you actually wanted — "shorter", "more kid-friendly", "add a hotel stop" — and it adjusts. The conversation is the work.

Try it now

Open copilot.microsoft.com and send this one message: "We're a family of four planning a 3-day road trip from [your city] to [a nearby city] this summer. Can you suggest a route with one fun stop each day?" See what comes back — that's your starting point, and the rest of the plan builds on it.

Plan Your Next Holiday: Create a Custom Travel Itinerary with Meta AI

5 steps · Read online

By the end of this guide you'll have a draft day-by-day holiday plan built around your dates, budget and the kinds of places you actually enjoy — no travel agent needed. This is for anyone with a trip in mind who dreads the blank-page problem of "where do I even start?". One honest note up front: Meta AI can brainstorm the plan and suggest places, but it can't book flights, hotels or restaurants for you, and details like opening hours or ticket prices may drift out of date — always double-check before you go.

Before you start

- **A free Meta account** — the same one you use for Facebook, Instagram or WhatsApp. If you don't have one, you can sign up at meta.ai with just an email. Meta AI itself is free on the standard plan.
- **A phone or a computer** with internet access. Meta AI works in any modern browser at meta.ai, and inside the Meta apps on both iPhone and Android.
- **Roughly 10–15 minutes** of uninterrupted time, plus a few quick notes on your own preferences — when you're going, who you're traveling with, what you enjoy. A notes app nearby helps.

Step 1 — Open Meta AI and start a new chat

Pick the route that matches where you are right now. The simplest is on a computer: open any modern browser and go to **meta.ai** — that's the official Meta AI website. After you sign in with your Meta account (Facebook, Instagram or WhatsApp all work), a clean chat window opens with a text box at the bottom that says something like "Ask Meta AI…" — that's where the planning starts. On a phone, you have three clear options. **In WhatsApp**, open the app and look at the very top of the Chats tab for a circular blue icon (a chat bubble with a sparkle) labeled "Meta AI" — tap it once. **In Facebook**, tap the magnifying glass search icon at the top of the app, type "Meta AI" into the search bar, then tap the official Meta AI result from the list. **In Instagram**, tap the messenger icon (the paper-airplane shape) at the top right of the home screen, then look along the top of your message list for a "Meta AI" banner. Each route lands you on the same chat screen once you're signed in. If the icon isn't where described, the easiest fallback is the website: meta.ai works on every device, every account, and never needs an app update. If the website won't load, try a different browser, or check that you're signed into your Meta account. **You'll know it worked when** you see an empty chat with the text "Ask Meta AI" or a similar prompt at the bottom, and your profile picture at the top.

Step 2 — Send your first travel prompt

Tap inside the text box at the bottom of the chat and write one clear first message covering the basics: where you want to go, when, how long, and who's coming. The more useful detail you give upfront, the more tailored the draft — think of it like briefing a friend who's planning alongside you. After you tap the paper-plane send icon (or press Enter on a computer), Meta AI usually replies within seconds with a written day-by-day outline. If a small spinner shows instead, wait — longer answers can take 10–20 seconds. The free plan lets you send many messages a day; if you ever see a "too many messages" notice, wait an hour or switch to a different Meta app and continue. **You'll know it worked when** a chunk of text appears below your question with headings like "Day 1", "Day 2" and so on.

💬 Example: *"Plan a 5-day trip to Kyoto for two adults in early November. We like quiet temples, walking and local food. Mid-range budget, flying in and out of Osaka."*

Step 3 — Refine the plan with a follow-up question

Treat the first reply as a starting draft, not the final answer. Read it, then ask one specific follow-up that pushes the plan closer to what you actually want — swap a busy day for a slower one, add a rest afternoon, or shift the budget. Type the question into the same text box and send; Meta AI keeps the whole conversation in mind, so each new answer builds on the last rather than starting over. If the reply misses the mark, rephrase with more detail — instead of "make it cheaper", try "cut Day 3 down to under $80 per person". On a phone, if you don't see a text box, scroll down — it sometimes hides under the keyboard. **You'll know it worked when** the new reply clearly references your previous question and feels closer to your style.

💬 Example: *"Day 2 is too packed — swap the afternoon bus tour for a slow walk through Higashiyama and a casual dinner near Gion. Keep it under ¥6,000 per person."*

Step 4 — Ask about food, transport and neighbourhood tips

Once the day-by-day shape feels right, layer on the practical details that make a trip feel lived-in: where to eat, how to get around, and which neighbourhoods to wander in the evening. Type one focused question at a time so answers stay organized — Meta AI usually replies with short lists grouped by area, plus notes on trains, buses and walking times. One honest caveat: opening hours and prices can be a year or two out of date, especially for small local spots, so treat any specific time or dollar figure as a starting point and verify with the venue's own website before you travel. If the reply feels generic, name your hotel or district — that sharpens suggestions quickly. **You'll know it worked when** the reply includes two or three concrete recommendations you can drop straight into your notes.

💬 Example: *"We're staying near Kyoto Station. Suggest three dinner spots within a 10-minute walk — one ramen, one nicer izakaya, one vegetarian-friendly. Also: what's the easiest way to get to Arashiyama from our hotel?"*

Step 5 — Save the plan so you don't lose it

Meta AI doesn't keep a tidy "trips" folder for you, so saving the plan is your job — and best done while the chat is still open. On a phone, scroll back through the conversation and take screenshots (Power + Volume Up on most Androids, Side Button + Volume Up on iPhones), then file them into a dedicated album called something like "Kyoto trip". On a computer, highlight the answers, copy them, and paste into a Google Doc or notes app, then tidy into one page. You can also tap the share icon inside the chat (look for an arrow pointing up, or three dots in the corner of each reply) and send the whole conversation to yourself in Messenger or email. Do this before you close the tab — clearing browser history can wipe the chat. **You'll know it worked when** you can open your phone tomorrow, swipe to the album, and read the full plan offline.

Common mistakes

- **Giving a one-line prompt and expecting magic.** Meta AI works best when you share dates, companions and rough budget in the first message — without those, you'll get a generic answer and spend ages correcting it later. **Fix:** open with a single paragraph of context, then refine.
- **Trusting opening hours and prices as gospel.** AI suggestions can drift out of date, especially for small local spots. **Fix:** cross-check the first three places on your list with Google Maps or the venue's own site before you travel.
- **Asking five things at once.** Packing "best food, transport, day trips and hotels" into one message produces a vague, jumbled reply. **Fix:** ask one focused question per message — the conversation stays organized and each answer is more useful.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** a saved Meta AI itinerary becomes a ready-made packing and booking checklist — you can scan it the night before each day of the trip instead of fumbling with guidebooks or twelve open browser tabs.
- **For your business or work:** the same prompt-and-refine pattern works for client visits, conference trips or team off-sites — describe the goal, the people and the constraints, and let Meta AI draft an agenda you can then tweak.
- **If you're just getting started:** don't worry about getting the perfect prompt on the first try. Send a rough message, read the reply, and ask one follow-up. The plan improves with every round, and that's the whole point.

Try it now

Open Meta AI on your phone right now and send this: *"Plan a 2-day weekend trip in my own city for one adult. I like coffee, long walks and live music. Budget under $80 a day."* See what comes back — that's a 2-minute taste of how the tool thinks, and you can build on it from there.

How to plan meals and a grocery budget with AI

5 steps · Read online

By the end of this guide you'll be able to feed your family with meals that use what's already in your kitchen, while only adding the few items you truly need – all driven by a simple AI chat. This is perfect for anyone who wants to save time, reduce waste and keep the grocery bill low.

Before you start

- A free account with an AI chat tool (e.g. ChatGPT, Claude or Gemini).
- A device with internet access – a smartphone, tablet or computer will do.
- A camera or a notes app so you can capture a quick inventory of your fridge, freezer and pantry.
- About 10 minutes total: 5 minutes to record what you have, 5 minutes for the AI to generate the plan.
- No special technical knowledge required; the guide explains every term as you go.

Step 1 — Capture what you already have

Action: Open your phone's camera (or a notes app) and either snap a photo of each shelf or type a short list of the items you can see.
What you see: The camera view shows your pantry, fridge or freezer; a notes app shows a blank page ready for typing.
What happens next: After the photo you can tap the screen to focus, or after typing you'll have a list you can copy to the clipboard.
If it looks different: On a tablet you may need to open a separate "Notes" or "Keep" app – look for an icon that looks like a sheet of paper.
💬 **Example:**

```
Pantry: ½ bag basmati rice, 1 tin diced tomatoes, 1 jar pesto, 2 tins chickpeas
Fridge: 3 eggs, 1 lemon, 1 small onion
Freezer: 4 chicken thighs
```

Success check: You'll know it worked when you have a piece of text (or a photo) that you can easily copy or reference while you're on a computer later.

Step 2 — Start a fresh chat with an AI tool

Action: Open a web browser, go to the website of your chosen AI (for example https://chatgpt.com) and sign in if required.

What you see: The home screen shows a large white text box at the bottom and usually a "New chat" button at the top-left.
What happens next: Clicking "New chat" (or a plus icon) clears any previous conversation and presents a blank prompt field.
If it looks different: Some platforms label the button "Start new conversation" or use a three-line menu; any option that creates a fresh thread will do.
Example: Click the "New chat" button, then you'll see an empty box ready for typing.

Success check: You'll know it worked when the screen shows an empty conversation area with a blinking cursor ready for your first message.

Step 3 — Ask the AI for a dinner plan

Action: Copy the inventory list from Step 1 and paste it into the chat, then add a request like "Plan 5 simple dinners for two people that use as many of these items as possible. Keep each recipe to five ingredients or fewer."
What you see: The text box now contains your inventory followed by the request, and a send button (often an arrow icon) or you can press Enter.
What happens next: The AI begins typing a response; after a few seconds you'll receive five recipe paragraphs, each in plain language.
If it looks different: Some tools require you to hit the "Enter" key on your keyboard instead of a send button – just make sure the cursor is in the box and press Enter.
Example:

```
Here's what I have at home right now:
Pantry: ½ bag basmati rice, 1 tin diced tomatoes, 1 jar pesto, 2 tins chickpeas.
Fridge: 3 eggs, 1 lemon, 1 small onion.
Freezer: 4 chicken thighs.
Please plan 5 simple dinners for two people that use as many of these items as
possible. Give me the recipes in one short paragraph each. Keep each recipe under 5
ingredients total.
```

Success check: You'll know it worked when the AI returns five distinct meal ideas, each described in a single short paragraph and using mostly the ingredients you listed.

Step 4 — Request a combined shopping list and an approximate budget

Action: After the recipes appear, send a follow-up message saying "Now give me a single combined shopping list with quantities for the missing items only, and tell me the total cost in

US dollars using typical supermarket prices."
What you see: The same chat window with a new empty line at the bottom ready for your follow-up text.
What happens next: The AI generates a bullet-point list of any ingredients it couldn't find in your inventory, adds estimated quantities, and calculates a total price.
If it looks different: Some platforms collapse the reply panel until you scroll; simply scroll down a little if you don't see the response immediately.
💬 **Example:**

```
Now give me a single combined shopping list with quantities for the missing items only.
Also tell me the approximate total cost in US dollars using typical supermarket prices.
```

Success check: You'll know it worked when the AI replies with a list like "- 1 small zucchini ($2.50) – 1 block feta ($4.00) – 1 bunch parsley ($1.20)" and a line that reads "Total ≈ $7.70".

Step 5 — Turn the meals into calendar events you can copy

Action: Ask the AI to format each dinner as a calendar entry you can paste straight into your phone or computer calendar.
What you see: The chat input field again, where you type something like "Write each dinner as a text line I can copy into my calendar. Title each event 'Dinner – [recipe name]' and include the ingredients I already have plus any missing items."
What happens next: The AI returns a plain-text list, each line beginning with the word "Dinner –" followed by the recipe name and a short ingredient summary.
If it looks different: Occasionally the AI may output a markdown table; you can still select the rows and paste them – the formatting will be stripped automatically.
💬 **Example:**

```
Write each dinner as a text line I can copy into my calendar. Title each event "Dinner
- [recipe name]". Include the ingredients I already have plus any missing items.
```

Success check: You'll know it worked when you can highlight the whole block of text, copy it, and paste it into your calendar app without extra symbols or errors.

> **What the AI can't do:** The assistant can suggest recipes, list missing items and estimate costs, but it cannot place an online order for you or guarantee that every store will price items exactly as shown.

Common mistakes

- **Mistake:** Listing every single spice and condiment.
  Fix: Group spices together (e.g., "spices – mixed herbs, cumin, paprika") so the AI focuses on the main ingredients you actually need to use.
- **Mistake:** Forgetting to ask for a *combined* shopping list, resulting in duplicate items.
  Fix: Use the exact phrasing "single combined shopping list" as shown in Step 4; this tells the AI to merge all missing items.
- **Mistake:** Assuming the AI knows local prices without specifying the currency.
  Fix: Always mention "US dollars" in your request – the AI will then use typical local supermarket pricing instead of US dollars or another market.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** Spend a few minutes each weekend feeding the AI your kitchen inventory and you'll walk out of the supermarket with only the two or three items you truly need, and a clear idea of how much you'll spend.
- **For your business or work:** Use the same process to plan office lunches or staff catering, cutting down on food waste and keeping the weekly food budget transparent.
- **If you're just getting started:** Try the simplest version – paste tonight's fridge contents into the chat and ask for one recipe. It's a low-effort way to see the benefit instantly.

Try it now

Open your AI chat, paste the inventory below, and send the first prompt:

```
Here's what I have at home right now:
Pantry: ½ bag basmati rice, 1 tin diced tomatoes, 1 jar pesto, 2 tins chickpeas.
Fridge: 3 eggs, 1 lemon, 1 small onion.
Freezer: 4 chicken thighs.
Plan 3 simple dinners for two people using as many of these items as possible. Give me the recipes in one short paragraph each.
```

Give it a minute – the AI will reply with three meal ideas you can try tonight!

Turn whatever's left in your fridge into a real recipe with Le Chat

5 steps · Read online

> **In short:** Le Chat is Mistral's AI assistant — type in what's left in your fridge and it will suggest a real recipe you can cook tonight. There's a free option to start, no install required, and most people get a usable answer in under a minute. It can't taste your food, but it can spark a meal you'd actually want to eat. Note: Mistral now calls this assistant **Vibe** (formerly Le Chat) — you may see either name in the app and on mistral.ai.

You've stared into the fridge at 6 p.m., seen three random vegetables, half a bag of pasta, and some questionable cheese. No plan. No energy for a grocery run. This guide shows you how to hand that mess to Le Chat and walk away with a real recipe in about five minutes — even if you've never opened an AI assistant before.

Before you start

- **A free Le Chat account.** You can sign up with an email address or a Google/Apple account at Mistral's site. The basic plan is enough for recipe questions; paid plans exist for heavier use, but you don't need one tonight.
- **A phone, tablet, or computer with internet.** Le Chat works in any web browser, and there's also a mobile app if you'd rather cook from your phone.
- **Roughly 5 minutes.** Most of that is the chat itself thinking.
- **No cooking skills required** — but it helps if you know roughly what equipment you have (a stove, an oven, a microwave, nothing fancier).

Step 1 — Open Le Chat and start a fresh chat

Open your browser and go to Le Chat (Mistral's chat assistant). If you're on a phone, you can also use the Le Chat app. Once you arrive, you'll see a clean screen with a text box near the bottom — that's where you type your message. Look for a button or link that says something like **"New chat"** or **"Start a new conversation"** if you see leftover messages from earlier; a fresh chat keeps your recipe ideas separate from anything else you've asked about.

If you're not logged in yet, you'll be asked to sign up or log in first. An email address is enough — no credit card needed for the basic option. **If it looks different on your device:** the layout is similar on mobile and desktop, but on smaller screens the text box usually sits at the bottom of the screen, and menus may be tucked behind a **☰ icon** in the corner.

Example: you don't need to type anything yet — just confirm a fresh, empty chat is ready.

You'll know it worked when you see an empty chat screen with a clear text box and no old messages above it.

Step 2 — Tell Le Chat what's actually in your fridge

Tap inside the text box and type a list of ingredients you have on hand. Don't worry about being neat — Le Chat understands plain lists, short sentences, even messy notes like "a bit of sour cream, maybe 2 days left." Mention the main items, how much of each you roughly have, and anything you definitely do **not** want to use (stale bread, sad lettuce). Then send the message by tapping the **send** arrow or pressing **Enter** on a keyboard.

A short pause — usually a few seconds — and a reply appears underneath your message. The assistant reads what you wrote and starts to think about combinations. **If it looks different on your device:** the send button might be a paper-airplane icon, a circle with an arrow, or just the **Enter** key on a physical keyboard.

Example: copy and adapt this — *"Here's what's in my fridge: 2 eggs, half an onion, a handful of spinach, leftover cooked rice (about 1 cup), some grated cheddar, soy sauce, and one tortilla. I don't want anything too spicy. What can I make for dinner for 1 person?"*

You'll know it worked when you see a written reply that names at least one specific dish based on your ingredients.

Step 3 — Ask for the details you actually need to cook it

The first reply usually gives a quick idea, but you still need a real recipe — amounts, steps, time. Ask a follow-up question in the same chat. Mention how many people you're cooking for, how much time you have, and any tools you want to use (one pan, an oven, no oven, etc.). The more useful detail you give here, the more useful the recipe will be.

Because you're still in the same conversation, Le Chat already knows your ingredients — you don't have to repeat them. Just tell it what shape you want the answer in. **If it looks different on your device:** if the chat stops mid-answer, look for a small **"continue"** or **"regenerate"** button at the end of the message.

Example: *"Great idea — please give me a full step-by-step recipe for the rice omelette. I'm cooking for 1, I have about 25 minutes, only a frying pan and a spatula, and I'd like it written as numbered steps."*

You'll know it worked when the reply includes a recipe title, ingredient amounts, numbered cooking steps, and a rough total time.

Step 4 — Tweak the recipe if something doesn't fit

Read the recipe. If an ingredient is missing, a step feels too hard, or a measurement looks off, just ask. This is the moment where AI cooking help really pays off — you can ask for a swap, a simpler method, a vegetarian version, or a faster version, all without starting over. The assistant keeps the whole conversation in mind, so it will adjust what it already wrote.

Think of it like texting a friend who actually answers back: short, clear messages work best. Tell it the **one thing** you want to change, and let it respond. **If it looks different on your device:** if a reply is too long to fit on screen, scroll up and down within the message; some apps also have a **copy** button near the answer.

💬 Example: *"I don't have soy sauce — can you swap in Worcestershire sauce instead? And can you make it ready in 15 minutes instead of 25?"*

You'll know it worked when the new version of the recipe reflects your changes (different sauce, shorter timing) and still makes sense as a meal.

Step 5 — Save the recipe so you can actually cook it

When you're happy with the answer, keep it somewhere you can read while you cook. You can copy the recipe to your notes app, take a screenshot, or just leave the chat open on a counter-friendly device. If you start a new chat later, your old conversation won't be the focus — so saving it yourself is the safest move.

If you want, you can also ask for a shopping list for the next time you cook it, or ask how to store leftovers. **If it looks different on your device:** on phones, a long press on the answer often brings up a copy option; on computers, right-click works the same way.

💬 Example: *"Can you give me a short grocery list for next time I make this, and tell me how to store leftovers in the fridge?"*

You'll know it worked when the recipe is sitting somewhere you can reach while standing at the stove — on your phone, a printout, or a notes app.

Common mistakes

- **Listing ingredients without saying how much.** "Some chicken" gives a vague answer. Even rough amounts — *"about 150 g of chicken"* — make the recipe much more useful.
- **Forgetting to mention dietary needs or allergies.** If you can't eat nuts, dairy, or gluten, say so in your first message. It's easier than asking for a swap later.
- **Starting a brand-new chat for every follow-up.** Stay in the same conversation so the assistant remembers your ingredients. A new chat makes it forget everything and you'll have to repeat yourself.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** this turns "I have nothing to eat" into a real dinner in the time it takes to boil water. It also helps you use up food before it goes bad, which saves money and reduces waste.
- **If you're just getting started:** the easiest first move is to open Le Chat right now and paste the example prompt from Step 2, swapping in whatever is actually in your fridge tonight. You don't need to plan ahead — the messier your real-life fridge, the better the test.

Try it now

Open Le Chat, list three to five ingredients you have at home right now, and ask for a dinner recipe for one person. Cook the result tonight — no grocery run required.

Use Qwen Chat to create a simple meal plan for the week using ingredients you already have

5 steps · Read online

Do you ever stare into the fridge, full of food, but have no idea what to cook? This guide will show you how to use Qwen Chat, an artificial intelligence (AI) assistant, to create a practical meal plan for the week using just the ingredients you already have on hand. It's perfect for anyone wanting to save time, reduce food waste, and get creative with their cooking without needing to buy extra groceries.

Before you start

- An Alibaba account, which you can set up for free on the Qwen Chat website.
- Access to the Qwen Chat website or app on a computer, tablet, or smartphone.
- Roughly 5-10 minutes to follow the steps and generate your first meal plan.

Step 1 — Open Qwen Chat

To begin, you'll need to open Qwen Chat in your web browser or launch the app on your device. Think of Qwen Chat like a smart, digital assistant ready to help you brainstorm ideas. When the page loads, you'll usually see a clean interface with a large text input box at the bottom, where you can type your messages, and a main area above it where the conversation will appear. If you've used it before, you might see old chats listed on the side.

If it looks different: If you don't immediately see a chat box, look for a button or link labeled "Start Chat," "New Chat," or a speech bubble icon, which will lead you to the main conversation area.

You'll know it worked when you see a blank chat area, ready for your first message, and a text input box at the bottom of the screen.

Step 2 — Start a new conversation

Before giving Qwen Chat your meal plan request, it's a good idea to start a fresh conversation. This ensures the AI assistant focuses entirely on your new task without getting sidetracked by anything you might have discussed previously. Look for a "New Chat" button or a similar icon, often a square with a plus sign (+) or a speech bubble. Tapping or clicking this will clear any previous conversation history and give you a clean slate.

If it looks different: Some versions of Qwen Chat might automatically present a new chat when you open the tool. If so, simply proceed to the next step. If you're unsure, look for an option to "Clear Chat" or "Reset Conversation" to start fresh.

You'll know it worked when the chat window is empty and the message box is ready for your first request.

Step 3 — Tell Qwen what you have

Now it's time to tell your AI assistant what ingredients you're working with. This instruction is called a "prompt"—it's like giving specific directions to a very clever personal assistant. Type out a clear message listing all the ingredients you have available and what kind of meal plan you need (e.g., how many days, which meals). The more detail you provide, the better Qwen can understand and help you. When you're ready, press the 'Enter' key on your keyboard or tap the 'Send' button, often represented by a paper plane icon.

If it looks different: If Qwen Chat doesn't immediately start responding after you hit 'Enter', double-check your internet connection or look for a distinct 'Send' button next to your text box that you may need to tap.

Example: `I have chicken breast, spinach, pasta, canned tomatoes, cheese, and eggs. Please suggest a simple meal plan for dinner for 5 days using these ingredients.`

You'll know it worked when Qwen Chat begins typing a response, and you see its suggestions appearing in the chat window.

Step 4 — Refine your request

Qwen Chat will usually give you a good first draft, but it might not be perfect right away. This is where you can refine your "prompt" by adding more details or specific preferences. Perhaps you forgot to mention you have some rice, or you need to avoid spicy food. Simply type another message into the chat box, building on the previous conversation. Qwen Chat remembers what you've already discussed, so you don't need to repeat the entire list of ingredients. This back-and-forth is how you guide the AI to meet your exact needs.

If it looks different: If Qwen Chat seems to misunderstand or "forget" previous details, you can gently remind it by saying something like "Remember my ingredients from before..." before adding your new request.

Example: `That's a great start! Could you also make sure to include one vegetarian option and avoid anything too spicy? I also have some rice.`

You'll know it worked when Qwen Chat responds by updating its meal plan, incorporating your new preferences and making the necessary changes to its suggestions.

Step 5 — Review and make final adjustments

With Qwen Chat's updated suggestions, take a moment to read through the entire 5-day meal plan. Check if the meals sound appealing and if they fit your cooking style and time availability. If there are any specific days or dishes you'd like to change, or if you have a last-minute ingredient you want to include, just ask! You can be as specific as you like, for example, asking Qwen to swap out a particular meal or suggest a different side dish. This final step helps you customize the plan exactly how you like it.

If it looks different: If Qwen Chat struggles with a very specific, complex request, try breaking it down into smaller, simpler questions. For example, instead of asking to completely restructure three days, focus on one day at a time.

💬 **Example:** `Day 3 sounds perfect, but could you swap the pasta dish on Day 2 for something with rice instead?`

You'll know it worked when Qwen Chat provides a revised meal plan that you're happy with, reflecting all your preferences and adjustments.

Common mistakes

- **Not giving enough detail initially:** Qwen Chat is smart, but it can't read your mind. If you just say "meal plan," it won't know your ingredients or how many days you need. Always start with a clear list of what you have and your basic requirements.
- **Forgetting Qwen Chat remembers the conversation:** You don't need to re-list all your ingredients every time you refine your request. Just refer to previous information or add new details, and the AI will build upon what's already been discussed.
- **Expecting perfection on the first try:** AI often works best with a bit of guidance. Don't be afraid to ask Qwen Chat to make changes, add details, or swap out meals. Think of it as a collaborative process.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** Using Qwen Chat to plan meals can free up your mental energy, reduce last-minute stress about "what's for dinner," and help you use up ingredients before they spoil, cutting down on food waste.
- **For your business or work:** While this guide focuses on meal planning, the same principle of giving clear "prompts" and refining AI responses applies to many work tasks, like brainstorming ideas, drafting emails, or outlining project plans.
- **If you're just getting started:** The easiest first move is to pick just three ingredients you have and ask Qwen Chat for one dinner idea. See how it works, then build up to a full weekly plan!

Try it now

Open Qwen Chat and type a simple request: "I have eggs, bread, and cheese. Please suggest three easy dinner ideas." See what it comes up with in the next two minutes!

Plan a weekend trip with Le Chat: a 4-step itinerary for any city

4 steps · Read online

> **In short:** Le Chat (Mistral's AI assistant) can sketch a balanced two-day plan for any city in minutes — sights, food, and how to get around. The free plan is enough for trip planning, though you should still double-check opening times and ticket prices yourself. Note: Mistral now calls this assistant **Vibe** (formerly Le Chat) — you may see either name in the app and on mistral.ai.

Standing in a city you've never visited, with two days to fill, can feel overwhelming. Le Chat is the AI assistant made by Mistral (a French AI company), and it works well as a starting point for trip planning — you describe the city, the vibe you want, and any constraints, and it drafts a plan you can shape. Here is how to get a useful itinerary out of it in four clear steps.

Before you start

- A free Le Chat account — sign up at chat.mistral.ai or in the iOS/Android app
- A device with a browser, or the Le Chat app installed on your phone
- A city in mind, plus a rough sense of when you're going and who you're with (a partner, kids, a friend with mobility needs, and so on)
- About 10–15 minutes total

Step 1 — Open Le Chat and start a fresh chat

Go to **chat.mistral.ai** in a browser, or open the Le Chat app on your phone. If you are not already signed in, look for a **Sign in** button — usually in the top-right corner of the page; the app usually opens straight to your last conversation. Once you're in, find a button labeled something like **New chat** (often a square with a pencil or a small "+" icon) and tap it so you begin with a clean thread. An empty message box appears at the bottom of the screen. From now on, everything you type in this thread will be read together as one planning session — so day two will automatically remember day one.

💬 Example: type `Hi — I'm planning a weekend trip and could use a hand shaping the itinerary.`

If it looks different: some browsers land you on a pricing page first — ignore that and look for a **Log in** or **Start chatting** link. On mobile, if a previous chat is already open, swipe right from the left edge or tap the menu icon (often three lines, or your profile picture) to find **New chat**.

You'll know it worked when you see an empty chat box with your prompt at the bottom and no earlier conversation above it.

Step 2 — Ask for a balanced day-one plan

Now type a single clear prompt that gives Le Chat everything it needs in one go: destination, dates, who's coming, and the kind of day you want. Press **Enter** (or the send arrow) to send. Within a few seconds, a reply streams in — usually broken into a **Morning**, **Afternoon**, and **Evening** block, with one sight, one meal suggestion, and a transit note for each part of the day. If the answer feels too generic ("here are the top 10 things to do"), don't accept it: hit the **regenerate** button (usually a circular arrow next to the reply) or simply ask in the same chat for a more local, slower-paced version.

💬 Example: `I'm spending Saturday in Lisbon, Portugal, with my partner. We like walking, local food, and one big museum — no beaches. Build me a day-one itinerary with morning, afternoon, and evening, plus how we'd get between stops.`

If it looks different: the reply may come as one long paragraph instead of broken-up blocks. That's fine — just ask in the next message to **format it as a schedule with time slots**, and it will reorganize the same content.

You'll know it worked when you can read the reply top-to-bottom and roughly picture your Saturday without needing to Google anything.

Step 3 — Add day two with a different vibe, then layer in transit

In the same chat (don't start a new one — Le Chat keeps the city's context), send a second prompt asking for Sunday with a deliberately different flavor. Adding one contrasting word works wonders: "quieter", "more local", "outdoors", or "kid-friendly". In the same prompt, also ask for transit: how to realistically move between the stops, plus a **rainy-day backup** for any outdoor piece. Le Chat replies in the same thread, building on what it just suggested — and that built-in memory is the real reason a chat-style assistant is useful here.

💬 Example: `Now do Sunday — quieter, more neighborhood feel, no big attractions, no repeat of any Saturday stop. After that, tell me how we'd realistically get between stops on foot, by metro, and by tram, and what's the indoor backup if it rains?`

If it looks different: if day two overlaps too much with day one, push back — type `day two must not repeat any place from day one`. If transit advice stays vague ("use public transport"), ask for **specific lines or route names**, and it will usually name them.

You'll know it worked when you have two clearly different days and a rough sense of which tram, metro, or walk connects each cluster of stops.

Step 4 — Polish the plan and save it to your phone

For the final step, ask Le Chat to package the whole conversation into something portable. A prompt like *"Summarize this whole weekend into a one-page checklist I can paste into my phone's notes app"* usually produces a clean list with time slots, addresses, and a one-line "don't forget" at the bottom. Then look for a **Copy** button — often at the bottom-right of the reply, or just long-press the text — and paste the result into Notes, Google Keep, or any app you check on the go. As a backup, take a screenshot; phone screenshots never fail when the train's underground and you have no signal.

💬 Example: `Rewrite our full weekend as a numbered checklist, one block per time slot, with the address of each place. Keep it under 30 lines so it fits on one phone screen.`

If it looks different: if the reply comes back too long, just send `shorter, please` and Le Chat will compress it. If there's no Copy button, select the text with your finger or mouse and choose **Copy** from the menu that pops up.

You'll know it worked when the plan is sitting in your notes app, ready to open the moment you land.

Common mistakes

- **Asking too vaguely.** "Plan my trip" gets a generic answer every time. Always include the city, the dates, who's coming, and one vibe word — "local", "outdoorsy", "foodie" — in the very first prompt.
- **Starting a new chat for every question.** Each new chat loses the city's context. Keep everything about the same weekend in one thread so day two automatically remembers day one.
- **Trusting the plan blindly.** Le Chat can invent a closing time, a tram line that doesn't exist, or an address that's slightly off. Before you travel, cross-check opening hours, ticket prices, and any transit route on the city's official tourism site or a current map.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** the same four-step rhythm — set the scene, ask for a first draft, push for a contrast, then save — works for any "blank page" task. A birthday plan, a weekend with visiting friends, or a Saturday with the kids all start the same way.
- **For your business or work:** the pattern generalizes well. A kickoff meeting agenda, a client visit, or a small workshop can all be drafted the same way: give the assistant the context, ask for a structured first version, request the second pass with a different angle, and export the result.
- **If you're just getting started:** the most useful habit is to give the assistant more context than feels necessary. Two sentences of "who, where, when, vibe" will save you ten follow-

up questions later, and the plan you get back will feel like it was written by someone who actually knows you.

Try it now

Open chat.mistral.ai (or your Le Chat app), start a new chat, and paste this single message: *"I'm planning a weekend in [your city] with [whoever]. I like [vibe]. Build me a balanced Saturday with sights, one meal, and how to get between stops."* See what comes back in 30 seconds — then tell it what to change.

Photos, video & music

How to generate AI images in Picsart: a beginner's step-by-step guide

7 steps · Read online

> **In short:** Picsart has a built-in AI image generator that turns your text prompts into pictures, then lets you keep editing in the same conversation. The AI tools usually sit behind a paid plan, and the engine works best with still images — not video.

If you've ever opened Picsart to fix a photo, design a poster, or make a quick thumbnail, the app already has an AI image generator tucked inside. Type a sentence, and Picsart turns it into a picture. Don't like something in the result? Stay in the same chat and ask for a change — the AI keeps the rest of the image intact. Here's how to try it, step by step, even if you've never touched an AI image tool before.

Before you start

- A Picsart account — sign-up is free, but AI image generation usually requires a paid plan. Check Picsart's current pricing page before you start.
- The Picsart app on your phone or tablet, or the web version in your browser at picsart.com.
- A rough idea of what you want to make: a poster, a product mock-up, a photo edit, or a wallpaper.
- About 10 minutes for your first image.

Step 1 — Open Picsart and find the AI image generator

Open the Picsart app and sign in. Once you're on the home screen, look for a tile, button, or section whose name suggests AI image generation — common labels include **AI Image Generator**, **AI Playground**, or **Text to Image**. If you don't see any of those on the main grid, tap the + (plus) button at the bottom-center of the screen, or look for a **Create** tab along the bottom row of icons — the AI tools usually live in one of those two places. On the web version at picsart.com, look in the top menu for something like **AI Tools** or **Create**.

💬 Example: this step has nothing to type — just finding the right entry point.

You'll know it worked when a screen appears with a text field where you can describe the image you want (usually called the prompt box) and at least one option to either start from text or upload a photo.

Step 2 — Pick your starting point: text, photo, or template

Inside the AI image tool, you'll usually see a few big choices near the top of the screen: **Text to Image** (start from a written description), **Image to Image** (start from a photo you upload), or a ready-made template you can fill in. Tap whichever fits what you want — for your first try, choose **Text to Image** if it's available. If the screen also shows a model selector — a small dropdown, a chip near the prompt box, or a tile in a side panel — pick whichever option is marked as the latest or recommended. Picsart rotates AI models over time, and the list changes often, so we won't name a specific one here.

Example: this step is a tap, not a typing step — the key choice is **Text to Image** for a first run.

You'll know it worked when the screen shows an empty prompt box and a clearly labeled button like **Generate**, **Create**, or an arrow icon.

Step 3 — Choose a canvas size (if the app asks)

Before you write your prompt, some versions of the tool show a size or shape picker. If you see it — usually a small icon shaped like a square, a rectangle, or a phone outline, or a dropdown near the prompt box — pick the shape that matches where you'll use the picture. A square shape works for Instagram-style posts, a tall rectangle works for phone wallpapers and Stories, and a wide rectangle works for banners and YouTube thumbnails. If the app also shows a quality choice (sometimes labeled with letters or numbers like 1K, 2K, or 4K, where higher means sharper but slower), pick the lowest one for a quick test so you don't burn through your credits.

Example: for a square post, choose the square option; for a phone wallpaper, choose the tall rectangle; if you see a quality choice, pick the lowest setting for a quick test.

You'll know it worked when a small preview, a number, or a labeled chip on the screen shows the shape and size you picked.

Step 4 — Write your prompt and generate the image

In the prompt box, describe the picture you want in plain, specific language. Name the subject, the mood, the colors, the lighting, and any text you want visible on the image — Picsart says its AI image generator handles on-image text reasonably well, which is useful for posters and diagrams. The more concrete you are, the closer the result will be to what you imagined. Then tap the **Generate** button (sometimes labeled **Create** or shown as an arrow icon). After a few seconds, one or more images appear on screen — pick the one you like best, or tap **Regenerate** if none feel right.

Example: "A friendly poster for a Saturday morning yoga class, soft pastel colors, with the words 'Saturday Morning Yoga' clearly readable in the center, hand-drawn style."

You'll know it worked when a finished image appears on screen and matches the canvas shape you picked in Step 3.

Step 5 — Refine the image in the same chat

Here's where the in-chat editing saves time: you don't have to start over when something's off. Stay in the same conversation and send a follow-up message describing one specific change. The AI keeps the rest of the picture intact and adjusts only what you asked for. You can chain several refinements one after another — change colors, swap a background, add a logo, rewrite the on-image text — without losing the previous version. Be specific: name the exact color, the exact word, the exact object. If you can't find the chat box, look for a field at the bottom of the screen that says something like **Message**, **Ask anything**, or **Describe a change**.

💬 Example: after the yoga poster above, send: "Make the background soft pink, change the words to 'Bring a friend!', and add a small sun in the top-right corner."

You'll know it worked when the new image shows your specific change and the rest of the picture still looks like the previous version.

Step 6 — Edit an existing photo (optional)

If you'd rather start from a picture you already have, look for an **Upload** or **Image** button near the prompt box — usually shown as a small picture icon or a + sign. Tap it and pick a photo from your device. Once the photo appears, describe the edit you want in the prompt box. For finer control, look for a brush or markup tool near the image — common labels are **Mask**, **Edit**, or a small paint-bucket or brush icon. With that tool, drag your finger across the part of the photo you want changed; the painted area is the only part the AI will redraw. Then write a short note in the prompt box describing what should appear there. Be specific about what to remove, replace, or add.

💬 Example: upload a group photo, then type: "Remove the person in the red shirt on the right." Or paint over the background with the brush tool and write: "Replace this background with a sunset beach."

You'll know it worked when the edited photo appears with your specific change applied and the rest of the image still looks natural.

Step 7 — Save and export your image

When you're happy with the result, look for a **Save**, **Download**, or **Export** button — usually at the top-right corner of the image or inside a ⋯ (three dots) menu. The app may ask you to pick a file format: choose **JPG** for everyday sharing, or **PNG** if you need a transparent background

(for layering the image on top of other designs). The image then saves to your device's photo gallery or your computer's Downloads folder. If you want to keep editing the file inside Picsart later, look for a **Save to project** or **Save as draft** option instead.

💬 Example: not a typing step — the key choice is **JPG** for everyday sharing, **PNG** only if you need a transparent background.

You'll know it worked when the image file appears in your phone's gallery (or your computer's Downloads folder) and opens like any normal picture.

Common mistakes

- **Picking the wrong starting mode.** If you upload a photo but meant to start from text (or the other way around), the result will look off. In Step 2, double-check you've chosen the right mode — **Text to Image** or **Image to Image** — before tapping Generate.
- **Asking for vague edits.** "Make it better" or "fix it" gives the AI nothing to act on. Always name the specific change: a color, an object, a word, a mood. The more concrete the instruction, the closer the result.
- **Forgetting the cost.** Each generation usually spends credits or counts against your plan's allowance. A higher-quality image costs more than a lower-quality one, and each follow-up edit in the chat counts as another generation. Check your remaining credits before kicking off a long chain of edits — otherwise the tool may stop mid-conversation.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** You can make a custom birthday card, a flyer for a school bake sale, or a fun wallpaper for your phone — in minutes, without any design training.
- **For your business or work:** You can mock up a quick social-media post, an event poster, or a product visual to share with a colleague before commissioning a designer for the final version.
- **If you're just getting started:** Begin with one simple text-to-image prompt (Step 4) at the lowest quality setting. Get a feel for what the tool does well before moving on to photo edits or higher-quality output.

Try it now

Open Picsart, find the AI image generator, and create one square image of your favorite season — one sentence prompt, no edits, just see what comes back. Takes about two minutes.

Auto-write captions for your photos using Hugging Face's free image captioning tool

7 steps · Read online

> **In short:** Hugging Face hosts free AI demos in its "Spaces" section, including image captioning tools that describe a photo in one short sentence. You upload an image, wait a few seconds, and copy the text — no coding needed.

By the end of this guide, you'll know how to turn a pile of unlabeled vacation or family photos into one-line descriptions, ready to drop into a social media post, paste as alt text, or use to search your own library.

Before you start

- A free Hugging Face account (you can sign up with an email, or sign in with a Google or GitHub account if you have one already).
- A modern browser on a laptop or desktop — Chrome, Edge, Firefox, or Safari all work. Phones work too, but a bigger screen makes uploading easier.
- 5–15 photos saved on your device, ideally as JPEG or PNG and under ~5 MB each so they upload quickly.
- Roughly 10 minutes for your first batch.

Step 1 — Create a free Hugging Face account

Open your browser and go to **huggingface.co**. Look for a **Sign up** button or link, usually near the top-right of the page. Type your email, pick a password, and confirm your inbox when the verification email arrives.

A free account lets you try any of the public demos. The page should land on your profile or the home feed once you're done.

💬 Example: the verification email is usually titled something like "Confirm your Hugging Face account".

If it looks different: if you already have an account, click **Log in** instead of Sign up — and if your browser saved an old login, you may skip straight to the homepage.

You'll know it worked when you see your profile picture or initials in the top-right corner of the page.

Step 2 — Find an image captioning Space

From the top menu, click **Spaces** — think of a Space as a small web app built by someone in the Hugging Face community. In the search bar on the Spaces page, type **image captioning** and press Enter. You'll see a list of community-built demos; look for ones with clear names related to image captioning (if it's available, you might find options with names like **BLIP Image Captioning** or **ViT-GPT2 Image Captioning**).

Don't worry about picking the "best" one. Most of these demos do the same basic job: read your photo and write one sentence about it.

💬 Example: searching for "BLIP image captioning" may return a Space built by Salesforce, which has been one of the popular captioning demos on the site.

If it looks different: if the search bar isn't obvious, try the **Filters** button, choose the **Computer Vision** category, and scroll until you spot a captioning demo.

You'll know it worked when you land on a page whose title mentions "Image Captioning" and shows an upload area or a button that says something like "Upload" or "Drop an image here".

Step 3 — Open the demo and wait for it to load

Click on the chosen Space to open it. The first time you visit, the demo may take 10–30 seconds to wake up — this is normal, since free demos often go to sleep when no one is using them. A progress bar, a spinner, or words like "Running" or "Starting" usually appear while it loads.

Once it's ready, you'll see an upload area and, on most Spaces, a short blurb explaining what the model does.

💬 Example: a typical blurb is "A short image captioning model based on BLIP, fine-tuned on COCO" — COCO is just the name of a popular photo dataset the model learned from.

If it looks different: if you only see a gray box for more than a minute, refresh the page once. If it still won't load, try a different captioning Space from the search results in Step 2.

You'll know it worked when the upload area becomes active — usually it says "Drop image here" or shows a small image icon.

Step 4 — Upload your first photo

Drag a single photo from your desktop into the upload area, or click the area to open a file picker and choose your picture. The photo appears as a small preview on the page. Don't upload dozens at once — most free demos are built to caption one image at a time.

Wait a few seconds. The caption will appear in a text box or label below the image.

💬 Example: a beach sunset photo might return something like "a sunset over the ocean with orange clouds", and a family group shot might return "a group of people smiling and standing together".

If it looks different: if nothing happens after about 30 seconds, look for a **Submit** or **Run** button near the upload area — some Spaces require you to confirm the upload before they process it.

You'll know it worked when a short English sentence describing your photo appears in or near the upload area.

Step 5 — Try a few more photos to see the range

Pick 3–5 different photos — a landscape, a portrait, a pet, a city street, a close-up of food — and run them through the demo one at a time. This helps you see what the tool handles well and where it gets confused. You'll likely notice it's strong at obvious scenes (beaches, dogs, kitchens) and weaker at very specific or unusual images.

💬 Example: a clear photo of a coffee cup on a wooden table might come back as "a cup of coffee on a table" — accurate, but plain.

If it looks different: don't be surprised if the caption is generic ("a person standing outside") for busy scenes. That's the model playing it safe rather than guessing at details it can't see clearly.

You'll know it worked when you have a small list of captions that roughly match each photo's main subject.

Step 6 — Copy and store your captions

Highlight the caption text in the demo's output box and copy it with **Ctrl+C** on Windows or **Cmd+C** on Mac. Paste it into a notes app, a Google Doc, or a spreadsheet right next to the photo's filename. Repeat for each photo. There's no built-in batch export — the work is mostly copying and pasting one at a time.

💬 Example: a simple spreadsheet column might read `beach_sunset.jpg → "a sunset over the ocean with orange clouds"`.

If it looks different: if the caption text isn't selectable, right-click the output area and choose **Copy** from the menu instead.

You'll know it worked when you have a tidy list of one-line descriptions you can reuse later.

Step 7 — Use your captions in real life

Now do something useful with them. For social media posts, paste a caption under your photo and tweak the wording if you want more personality. For alt text (the short description screen readers use for images on websites), paste it directly into the image's alt-text field. For organizing your own photo library, drop the captions into a folder named "_captions.txt" so you can search them later.

💬 Example: a LinkedIn post becomes "Wrapped up a long week with a walk on the beach 🌅 — a sunset over the ocean with orange clouds. Felt good to breathe."

If it looks different: alt-text fields look slightly different on every site — on a WordPress blog it's under "Image attributes", on X or Twitter it's the small alt field you fill in while uploading.

You'll know it worked when you stop staring at unlabeled photos thinking "what was this one again?"

Common mistakes

- **Uploading giant RAW files straight from a camera.** Free demos often struggle with files over ~10 MB, and some reject RAW formats entirely. Convert to JPEG first, or resize using your phone's built-in photo editor.
- **Expecting one upload to caption a whole album at once.** Most demos only handle one image at a time. Captioning 200 vacation photos means 200 separate uploads — plan for it to take a while, or pick a few favorites first.
- **Trusting the caption blindly.** Image captioning AI can mislabel things — it might call a labrador a "golden retriever" or skip a person in the background. Always glance at the caption before publishing or pasting it as alt text.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** captioning a personal photo for the first time feels like giving your camera a tiny voice. You can finally find that one sunset photo from three summers ago by searching the captions.
- **For your business or work:** if you run a blog, a small shop, or any website with lots of photos, alt text is something search engines and accessibility tools really do look at. Auto-captioning gives you a starting point in seconds — you then edit for accuracy and tone.
- **If you're just getting started:** skip the jargon and just play. Upload one photo of your pet, laugh at whatever the AI writes, and you've already learned the basics.

Try it now

Pick one favorite photo from your camera roll, open huggingface.co in your browser, search for "image captioning" in Spaces, upload the photo, and copy the caption. Two minutes, one photo,

one sentence — that's the whole loop.

How to remove a photo background cleanly with Meta AI on your phone

7 steps · Read online

> **In short:** Open Meta AI in WhatsApp, Messenger or Instagram, upload a photo, and ask it to "remove the background." Meta AI will usually generate a transparent version you can save as a PNG. You'll get a clean cutout in about a minute, though fine details like frizzy hair or sheer fabric can still need a touch-up.

You already chat with Meta AI in WhatsApp, Messenger or Instagram. This guide adds one more thing you can do there: turn any photo into a clean cutout (the photo with the background taken away) and drop it onto a new background, all from your phone, no Photoshop, no extra app. The whole workflow takes about five minutes once you've done it once.

Before you start

- **The app:** Meta AI built into **WhatsApp, Messenger, or Instagram** on your phone (iPhone or Android). If you can already chat with Meta AI in any of these, you're set.
- **A photo on your phone:** JPEG or PNG, ideally with a clear subject (a person, a product, a pet) and decent lighting. Busy, low-contrast backgrounds are the hardest to cut.
- **Roughly 5–10 minutes** for the first try, less after that.
- **Free.** No paid plan is required for the workflow below. Meta may rate-limit (cap how many times you can ask in a short window) on busy days, so have a backup photo ready.
- **What Meta AI can and can't do here:** it can usually remove a simple background in one go, but it is not pixel-perfect. Fine hair, glasses, and see-through materials can leave a faint halo (a soft glow around the edges of the cutout). It's great for social posts and product shots, less great for printing at poster size.

Step 1 — Open a Meta AI chat

Tap the **circular blue/purple Meta AI icon** — in WhatsApp it's usually at the top of your Chats tab or behind a **blue "AI" button** in the bottom-right; in Messenger it's the top of the search bar; in Instagram it's in the search/DMs area. If you don't see it, type **Meta AI** into the app's search bar. The chat screen opens, showing a short welcome message and the message box at the bottom. You'll know it worked when the box at the bottom says something like "Message Meta AI" or shows a send arrow.

Step 2 — Upload the photo you want to cut out

Tap the **paperclip or "+" icon** next to the message box to attach a file. From the menu that appears, pick **"Gallery"** (Android) or **"Photo & Video Library"** (iPhone) and choose the

photo. The image appears inside the chat as a small preview above the message box. If your app doesn't show a paperclip, look for a **camera icon** instead — the option is the same. Don't send the message yet; the prompt you add in the next step shapes what Meta AI does with the image.

💬 Example: choose a clear, well-lit photo of a friend standing in front of a plain wall, or a product on a tabletop.

You'll know it worked when the photo preview is sitting above the message box, ready to go with your next sentence.

Step 3 — Write the prompt that asks for the cutout

Tap the message box and type a short, direct instruction. Be specific: say "remove the background" rather than just "edit this." If you already know where you want to use the image, mention that too — it helps the model (the AI "brain" that reads your words and produces the answer) pick a sensible default background color.

💬 Example: `Remove the background from this photo and give me the subject on a transparent background.` Or, if you'd like a new background in the same step: `Remove the original background and place the person on a soft white studio background.`

Tap **send** (the paper-plane or arrow icon). Meta AI will usually reply within 10–30 seconds with a new version of your image. You'll know it worked when a new picture appears in the chat that looks like your subject on a flat color or transparent-looking background.

Step 4 — Check the edges before you save

Pinch to zoom in on the edges around the subject — especially around hair, fingers, glasses, and anything thin. Look for a faint color halo (a thin glowing outline) where the old background is bleeding through, or a slightly hard "stamped" edge. If the cut is clean, move to Step 5. If you see issues, stay in the same chat and ask for a fix in plain words.

💬 Example: `Zoom in around the hair — I can still see a faint gray halo. Please clean up the edges.` Or: `The fingers on the right hand look chopped. Please redo with finer edge detail.`

You'll know it worked when the second image shows noticeably cleaner edges than the first, with no obvious halo or missing fingers.

Step 5 — Save the new image to your phone

Long-press the new image Meta AI produced. A small menu appears with options like **"Save," "Save to Photos,"** or **"Download."** Tap the save option. The image lands in your phone's

Photos or Gallery app, usually in a folder called **Recents** or **Downloads**. If long-press doesn't show "Save," look for a **three-dot ⋯ menu** on the image instead, or tap the image to open it full-screen and then tap the **download/save icon** in the corner.

You'll know it worked when the new image appears in your Photos app as its own file, separate from the original you uploaded.

Step 6 — Drop the cutout onto a new background

Open any simple editor on your phone — the built-in **Photos** app on iPhone, or **Google Photos** on Android both work. Open the saved cutout, then tap **Edit**, and look for an option like **"Add Photo"** or **"Overlay / Sticker"** that lets you put a second image behind the first. Pick your new background — a sunset you took, a logo, a solid color. Resize and reposition, then save.

💬 Example: a beach sunset from your camera roll, so your friend looks like they're standing on vacation.

You'll know it worked when the final saved image shows your original subject, with clean edges, sitting naturally on the new background you chose.

Step 7 — Keep your reusable prompt in one easy-to-find place

Don't retype the prompt every time. Save the working version from Step 3 in your phone's **Notes app** or in the **Notes** feature of WhatsApp/Messenger itself, then copy-paste it next time. For even faster reuse, ask Meta AI in the same chat: `Save this as a reusable prompt I can paste next time.` Meta AI will usually reply with a tidy, copy-ready version you can keep.

💬 Example: `Remove the background from this photo and give me the subject on a transparent background. Keep the subject exactly the same — only the background should change.`

You'll know it worked when, next time, you can paste the saved prompt, attach a photo, and get a clean cutout in under a minute.

Common mistakes

- **Asking vaguely.** "Edit my photo" is too open. Always name the change: "remove the background," "place the subject on white," "tighten the edges." A specific instruction gets a specific answer.
- **Uploading a tiny, blurry, or low-contrast photo.** If the subject and the background are similar colors (a black dog on a dark couch), Meta AI will struggle. Pick a photo with a clear difference between subject and background.
- **Saving the wrong image.** The chat shows both your original upload and the new generated image. Long-press the *new* one, not the one you sent. If you saved the original

by mistake, just repeat Step 3 and save the reply.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** Clean cutouts are perfect for WhatsApp or Instagram stickers of your pet, a quick profile picture with a softer background, or a fun "I went to Paris" photo where you actually went to the kitchen. Five minutes of fiddling beats a desktop app you don't have time to learn.
- **For your business or work:** If you sell a few products on a side hustle, you can knock out consistent product photos for a catalog or marketplace listing without paying a designer. The edges won't be magazine-perfect, but they're good enough for a small storefront and free.
- **If you want to go further:** Try a two-step prompt in one chat — first remove the background, then ask `Now place the subject on a marble countertop with soft daylight from the left.` The model remembers the previous image in the same conversation, so each new instruction builds on the last one instead of starting over.

Try it now

Open Meta AI in WhatsApp, Messenger or Instagram right now. Pick a photo of a person or object that is already on your camera roll, paste this prompt, and send:

💬 `Remove the background from this photo and give me the subject on a transparent background.`

Save the result to your phone. That's a complete, reusable workflow you can do again in under a minute next time.

How to Write a Gemini Image Prompt That Gets Close to What You Pictured

7 steps · Read online

> **In short:** Gemini can create images from a written description. Describing five things, the subject, setting, style, lighting and framing, usually gets you much closer to your picture on the first try. Image creation may depend on your account, location or plan.

You have a picture in your head, but Gemini can only work with the words you type. By the end of this guide, you'll know how to describe any image in five clear parts, so the result looks much more like what you had in mind. This is for anyone who has ever typed "a cat in a hat" and been surprised by the result.

Before you start

- A Google account, and access to the Gemini chat in a web browser or the Gemini app on your phone.
- Image creation may not be available in every region or on every plan. If you can't find an image option, it may not be switched on for your account yet.
- About 15 to 20 minutes. Most of that time is trying, looking and adjusting.

Step 1 — Open Gemini and start a fresh chat

Open Gemini in your browser or app. Start a new chat, usually by tapping a pencil or "new chat" icon, so your image request isn't mixed up with older messages. You'll see an empty text box at the bottom of the screen, often with placeholder words like "Ask Gemini" or "Enter a prompt here." Those words may be different on your device. If you see a button or option for creating images, you can use it, but you can also simply type a request that starts with "Create an image of..." and see what happens. After you send it, Gemini usually replies with one or more pictures, sometimes taking a few seconds.

💬 Example: "Create an image of a friendly cup of coffee on a wooden table."

You'll know it worked when Gemini replies with a picture, or with a message explaining why it can't make one yet.

Step 2 — Name the subject

The subject is the main thing in the picture: a who, or a what. Be specific. "A dog" leaves Gemini guessing about breed, size and what it's doing. "A small brown dog with floppy ears, sitting and looking up" gives it real direction. Good subjects usually include one clear action or pose. Keep it to one or two main subjects at first, because crowded scenes are harder to get right. Write your

subject as a full phrase near the start of your prompt, so Gemini sees it first. If the subject is a real, named person, skip it: Gemini may not create images of real people, and it's safer to describe a made-up character instead.

- Example: "Create an image of a [animal or person] doing [one action] with [one object]."

You'll know it worked when your subject is clearly the first thing you notice in the result.

Step 3 — Describe the setting

The setting answers where and when. Think of it like a stage: the subject is the actor, and the setting is the backdrop. Name a place and, if it matters, a time of day or season. "In a kitchen" is vague; "in a small sunny kitchen with white tiles" paints a clearer scene. Add one or two background details, such as "with plants on the windowsill," so the scene feels finished. Don't overload it with dozens of objects, since Gemini may add or drop small things anyway.

- Example: "...in a [place] during [time of day]."

You'll know it worked when the background matches the place you named, even if the details differ a little.

Step 4 — Choose a style

The style tells Gemini how the picture should look: a photograph, a watercolor painting, a cartoon, an oil painting or a 3D-style render. This single word can change the whole mood, so it's one of the most useful ingredients. If you want realism, say "photo-like." If you want something playful, say "cartoon style with bold outlines." You can also name a mood, like "calm" or "cheerful." Avoid naming a living artist to copy their exact look; describing the style in your own words is simpler and works just as well.

- Example: "...in a soft watercolor style with pale, gentle colors."

You'll know it worked when the result looks like the kind of picture you described, whether that's a painting, a photo or a drawing.

Step 5 — Add the lighting

Lighting is the difference between a flat picture and one with atmosphere. Name where the light comes from and how it feels: "warm morning sunlight from the left," "soft overcast light," "candlelight," or "a neon glow at night." Lighting also helps set the mood, so it's worth a few words. If you don't mention lighting at all, Gemini will choose something for you, which is fine for quick tests but less predictable when you want a specific look. One clear light source is easier to get right than several.

Example: "...lit by [light source] coming from [direction]."

You'll know it worked when the shadows and brightness in the picture roughly match the light you described.

Step 6 — Choose the framing

Framing is how the camera sees the scene. Is it a close-up of a face, a wide shot of a landscape, or a view from above? Words like "close-up," "medium shot," "wide shot," "eye level" and "bird's-eye view" are easy to type and make a big difference. If you're not sure, "a medium shot at eye level" is a safe starting point for most subjects. Framing also decides how much of the subject is visible, so say whether you want the whole thing or just part of it.

Example: "Framed as a [shot type] from [angle]."

You'll know it worked when the subject's size and position on the screen match the framing you asked for.

Step 7 — Combine the five parts, send, and refine

Now put everything into one flowing prompt, in this order: subject, setting, style, lighting, framing. Send it, then look at the result carefully. Change one ingredient at a time, such as "make the lighting warmer," so you can see what actually changed. Gemini can usually make a new version when you ask it to adjust, and you can keep going until the picture is close to your idea. It won't read your mind, so small details like exact colors or the number of objects may still differ, and that's normal.

Example: "Create an image of a small brown dog with floppy ears, sitting on a porch in a quiet village at sunset, in a soft watercolor style, lit by warm evening light from the left, framed as a medium shot at eye level."

You'll know it worked when the picture matches most of your five parts, and any remaining differences are things you can fix with one small change.

Common mistakes

- **Writing a single vague word.** "A beautiful landscape" leaves almost everything open. The fix is to add at least a place, a style and a light source, even in short phrases.
- **Piling on too many ideas at once.** Ten objects, three styles and two light sources confuse the result. The fix is to pick one main subject and one clear style, then add details gradually.
- **Expecting a perfect copy on the first try.** Gemini works from words, not from your memory of the picture. The fix is to treat the first result as a draft and adjust one part at a

time.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** Make a birthday card design, a picture for a family slideshow, or a cozy illustration for a bedtime story your child can help describe.
- **For your business or work:** Sketch a rough visual for a flyer, presentation or social post before you hire someone to make the final version, and check that any image you use is appropriate for your purpose.
- **If you're just getting started:** Begin with subject and style only. Once that works, add setting, lighting and framing one at a time.

Try it now

Think of one simple picture you've been imagining, such as a bowl of soup by a rainy window. Write one sentence that names the subject, setting, style, lighting and framing, then send it to Gemini. Compare the result with your picture, and change just one word to see how it shifts.

Generate unique profile pictures for social media with Midjourney

7 steps · Read online

> **In short:** Midjourney is an AI image generator. In this guide you use it inside Discord: you type /imagine with a short description, get four options, pick one, and save it as your new profile picture. You need a Midjourney subscription.

A profile picture is often the first thing people see about you online. With Midjourney you can describe the look you want, such as a cartoon portrait or a watercolor avatar, and get several versions in about a minute. This guide uses Midjourney's Discord bot. You can also create on the Midjourney website; Midjourney's own docs explain both.

Before you start

- **A Midjourney subscription.** Midjourney's Discord Quick Start says you need a subscription before you can create images. Check the plans on midjourney.com.
- **A Discord account** and the Discord app or website.
- **About 15–20 minutes** for your first few tries.

Step 1: Join the Midjourney server on Discord

Open Discord and find the server list on the left side. Press the + button at the bottom of the list, click **Join a Server**, then paste the official invite link `http://discord.gg/midjourney` and press **Join**.

Then open a channel where the bot works. Midjourney's docs say to use any channel labeled **general-#** or **newbie-1** through **newbie-10**. The bot does not generate images in other channels on its server.

You'll know it worked when the Midjourney server appears in your server list and you can open one of those channels.

Step 2: Start your first image with /imagine

A **prompt** is the text description you give the AI. Type / in the message box, and a list of commands appears. Keep typing until you see **/imagine**, click it, type your description into the prompt field, and press **Enter**. The first time, the Midjourney Bot asks you to accept its Terms of Service before it creates anything.

💬 Example: `/imagine prompt: a cheerful fox wearing round glasses, cartoon style, bright colors`

You'll know it worked when the bot starts working on your request. Midjourney says it creates four image options within a minute. If you don't see any Midjourney commands, check Midjourney's command troubleshooting tips.

Step 3: Write a prompt for a profile picture

Be specific about the subject, mood, style, colors, and background. Words like "portrait," "headshot," or "close-up" help keep the focus on one face. Midjourney's docs say images use a square 1:1 aspect ratio by default, which suits most profile picture slots. If you have changed your default settings, add `--ar 1:1` at the end of the prompt to keep the image square.

💬 Example: `/imagine prompt: [describe the person or character], smiling gently, digital art portrait, soft pastel colors, simple background --ar 1:1`

You'll know it worked when your prompt includes who or what is in the picture, a style, and a simple background.

Step 4: Review your grid of four images

You'll get a grid of four images with two rows of buttons under it:

- **U1, U2, U3, U4** separate one image from the grid, so it's easier to download and edit. In current Midjourney versions, these buttons no longer make the image bigger.
- **V1, V2, V3, V4** create a new grid of variations based on one image.
- The 🔄 button reruns your prompt for a fresh grid.

The numbers follow the grid: 1 is top left, 2 is top right, 3 is bottom left, and 4 is bottom right.

You'll know it worked when you can see the grid and both rows of buttons.

Step 5: Pick your favorite and adjust it

Click the **U** button for the image you like best. Once it is separated, more options appear, including **Vary (Strong)** and **Vary (Subtle)** for new versions, **Zoom Out** to extend the background, the arrow buttons to extend the image in one direction, and **Web** to open the image on midjourney.com. If you want it larger, Midjourney's docs describe **Upscale (Subtle)**, which keeps the look close to the original, and **Upscale (Creative)**, which adds new details. Upscaling uses more of your subscription's GPU time.

You'll know it worked when a single image of your choice appears with the extra buttons below it.

Step 6: Save your new profile picture

Midjourney's docs say: on a computer, click the image to open it at full size, then right-click and choose **Save image**. On a phone, long-tap the image and then tap the download icon. Your images are also available on midjourney.com when you log in with your Discord account.

You'll know it worked when the image file opens in your photos or files app.

Step 7: Refine or try again

If the result isn't quite right, try **Vary (Subtle)** for small changes, or write a new /imagine prompt with clearer details. Midjourney also has **Vary Region** in Discord for regenerating one part of an image. Small, step-by-step changes to your wording usually work better than starting over every time.

You'll know it worked when a new version gets closer to the picture you have in mind.

Common mistakes

- **A vague prompt.** "Person" gives a very generic result. *The fix:* Describe the face, expression, clothing, style, and background.
- **Using the wrong channel.** On the Midjourney server, the bot only works in its general and newbie channels. *The fix:* Use a **general-#** or **newbie-1** to **newbie-10** channel.
- **Expecting U buttons to enlarge the image.** In current versions they only separate the image. *The fix:* Use **Upscale (Subtle)** or **Upscale (Creative)** when you really need a bigger file.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** You can make a profile picture or avatar that matches your personality, without needing a photo shoot.
- **For your business or work:** You can create a consistent illustrated look for a small team or project page. Check your workplace's rules on AI images first.
- **If you're just getting started:** Start with a cartoon or illustrated style. It is easier to get a pleasing result than with a realistic portrait.

Try it now

Open Discord, go to a **newbie** channel on the Midjourney server, and type: `/imagine prompt: a friendly astronaut with a big smile, cartoon style, bright colors`. Pick your favorite with a U button and save it.

Create a multi-room music playlist with Alexa+

7 steps · Read online

> **In short:** With Alexa+ you can set up a voice routine so a single phrase — like "Alexa, play my dinner playlist" — starts the same music in every room at once. It uses the Alexa app's Routines feature.

Imagine saying "Alexa, play my dinner playlist" and the same music starts in the kitchen, lounge and bedroom at once. You'll learn how to set up one playlist that plays across multiple rooms with a single voice command.

Before you start

- An **Amazon account** (free).
- The **Alexa app** installed on your phone or tablet (Android or iOS).
- At least one **Amazon Echo device** (like an Echo Dot, Echo Show or Echo Studio) in each room.
- A **music streaming service** already linked to Alexa (Amazon Music, Spotify, Apple Music, etc.).
- Roughly **15 minutes** of your time.

Step 1 — Open the Alexa app and go to Devices

Open the Alexa app on your phone or tablet. At the bottom of the screen you'll see a row of icons — look for the one that looks like a **house outline** (this is the Devices section). Tap it. You should see a list of all your Echo devices, often grouped by room.

You'll know it worked when the screen shows your rooms and devices.

Example: Look for the house-shaped icon at the bottom of the Alexa app and tap it.

Step 2 — Pick a room to start

Choose the room where you want the music to begin. Tap the room name (for example, "Kitchen"). Inside that room view, look for a menu option — this is typically a **three-dot menu (⋯)** in the top-right corner, though on some app versions it may appear as a **gear icon** or a **menu with three lines** instead.

You'll know it worked when a menu slides up or opens from the bottom of the screen.

Example: Open the Kitchen room and look for the ⋯ menu in the top-right corner.

Step 3 — Find the routine option in the menu

From the menu that just appeared, look for an option to add this room to a routine — the exact wording may be **"Add to Routine"** or something similar depending on your app version. Tap it.

If you're not sure which option it is, look for any menu item that mentions "routine" or "routine" in English — this is the feature that links your voice phrase to your music action.

You'll know it worked when a routine setup screen opens.

Example: Tap **Add to Routine** (or the equivalent option in your app version).

Step 4 — Choose a voice trigger

In the routine setup screen, look for the option to set a **voice trigger** — on many versions this is labeled **"Voice"** and shown with a microphone icon. Tap it. A text box appears where you can type the phrase you want to say to Alexa to start the playlist.

If the voice option isn't visible, look through the list of available trigger types for something related to speaking or voice commands.

You'll know it worked when a text box opens for the phrase you want to say.

Example: Tap the voice trigger option and then tap inside the text box.

Step 5 — Type your wake-up phrase

Type the short phrase you'll say after "Alexa" — leave out the word "Alexa" itself. For example:
"play dinner playlist"

Confirm the phrase and move to the next step. Alexa may show a summary of the phrase you've entered.

You'll know it worked when the summary confirms your exact phrase.

Example: Type "play dinner playlist" and confirm it. Later you'll say "Alexa, play dinner playlist".

Step 6 — Add the music action

In the routine setup, look for an action type related to music — this may be labeled **"Music"** (often with a musical note icon) or something similar depending on your app version. Tap it. A

new screen opens where you can pick the playlist and the devices that should play it.

If you don't see a music option right away, look through the list of available actions for anything about playing audio or music.

You'll know it worked when you see options to choose a playlist and to choose which devices or rooms should play it.

Example: Tap the music action and then tap the option to choose a playlist.

Step 7 — Pick your playlist and devices

Select the playlist you want to play everywhere. Then choose all the rooms where you want the music to play (for example, Kitchen, Lounge, Bedroom) — look for a device or room picker. Save the routine.

You'll know it worked when the routine summary shows your chosen playlist and all the rooms you selected.

Example: Select "Dinner Vibes" playlist and tick Kitchen, Lounge and Bedroom.

Common mistakes

- **Wrong room selected** — If the music only plays in one room, double-check Step 2 and make sure you picked the correct room before saving the routine.
- **Phrase already used** — If Alexa says the phrase is taken, add a word like "my" or change the wording slightly (for example, "Alexa, start dinner playlist").
- **Device not selected** — If a room is missing, go back to Step 7 and make sure every room is ticked before saving.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** Set up a "Good morning" routine that plays your favorite news podcast in the bedroom and kitchen at the same time.
- **For your business or work:** Create a "Focus time" routine that plays lo-fi beats in every meeting room whenever you say "Alexa, start focus time".
- **If you're just getting started:** Start with one room and one playlist; once it works, add more rooms in the same routine.

Try it now

Open the Alexa app, go to Devices, pick a room, tap the menu icon → look for a routine option → choose voice trigger → type your phrase → add a music action → pick your playlist and devices → Save. Say the phrase out loud to test it.

Sharpen Your Photos with AI Using Upscayl

6 steps · Read online

Do you have a cherished photo that's just a little bit blurry, or an old snap you wish looked sharper and ready for a larger print? This guide will show you how to use the free AI image super-resolution application, Upscayl, to quickly enhance your images. By the end, you'll be able to give your photos a professional, crisp finish, making them poster-worthy in minutes.

Before you start

- **Install the free Upscayl application:** You'll need to download and install Upscayl on your computer. It's an open-source tool, which means it's developed by a community and freely available for use.
- **A computer with a dedicated graphics card (GPU) is recommended:** While Upscayl can run on most systems, a graphics card (like an NVIDIA, AMD, or Intel Arc GPU) will significantly speed up the processing of your images, making the enhancement much faster.
- **A photo to enhance:** Choose a digital image that's slightly blurry or low-resolution that you'd like to improve.
- **Time:** Allow around 5-7 minutes to follow the steps and enhance your first image. Upscayl is free to use with no hidden costs.

Step 1 — Launch Upscayl

First, open the Upscayl application on your computer. Look for its distinctive icon on your desktop, in your Start menu (Windows), Applications folder (macOS), or program launcher (Linux), and double-click it. When it launches, you'll typically see its main window, often featuring a clean interface with a central area to load images and various options organized on the side. This is your starting point for transforming your photos. **If it looks different:** If it's your very first time launching Upscayl, you might see a quick setup or welcome screen, possibly asking to confirm default file paths or to download initial AI models. Follow any clear on-screen prompts to complete this setup before proceeding. **You'll know it worked when:** The Upscayl application window fully appears on your screen, indicating it's ready for you to select an image and begin the enhancement process.

Step 2 — Load Your Image

Now it's time to bring in the photo you want to improve. In the Upscayl window, you'll usually find a prominent button labeled "Open Image" or a clear "Drag and Drop" area in the center of the screen. Click the "Open Image" button, and your computer's file browser window (like File

Explorer on Windows or Finder on macOS) will pop up. Navigate to where your blurry photo is stored on your computer, select it with a click, and then click "Open." Your chosen image will then appear in the main Upscayl window, usually displayed as a clear preview. **If it looks different:** If the image doesn't load immediately, an error appears, or the preview area remains empty, ensure your photo is in a common format like JPG, PNG, or WEBP. You might also try restarting the application and attempting to load the image again. **You'll know it worked when:** Your selected photo is clearly visible within the Upscayl application's main preview area, confirming it has been loaded successfully and is ready for enhancement. 💬 Example: Select a file named `old_family_photo.jpg` from your `Pictures` folder.

Step 3 — Choose an AI Model

With your photo loaded, you need to tell Upscayl which "recipe" or AI model to use for the enhancement. Think of an AI model as a specialized algorithm (a set of computational instructions) that the AI follows to intelligently reconstruct and add detail to your image. Each model is trained differently and can produce slightly varied results depending on the original image. On the left side of the Upscayl window, you'll see a "Models" section with a list of AI options like "Real-ESRGAN," "Remacri," or "Ultramix_Balanced." Click on a model to select it; for general photos, "Real-ESRGAN" or "Ultramix_Balanced" are excellent starting points known for good all-round performance. **If it looks different:** If you don't see many models listed, or options are greyed out, you might need to download additional models within Upscayl's settings. Look for a "Download Models" button or an option to manage models in the application's configuration or preferences menu. **You'll know it worked when:** The name of the model you clicked is clearly highlighted or appears as the active selection, indicating that Upscayl will use this specific AI algorithm for processing.

Step 4 — Select Upscale Factor

Next, you'll decide how much larger you want your image to become. The "upscale factor" determines how many times the image's width and height will be multiplied, significantly increasing its total number of pixels and its overall resolution. For example, a 2x factor makes the image twice as wide and twice as tall (quadrupling the total pixels), while a 4x factor makes it four times wider and four times taller (sixteen times the total pixels). Below the models section, you'll typically find options for "Upscale Factor," often presented as buttons like 2x, 3x, 4x, or sometimes a custom size. Select "4x" for a significant improvement in detail and resolution for most images, providing a good balance of quality and processing time. **If it looks different:** Some AI models are specifically designed for particular upscale factors, so if an option like "4x" is greyed out, try selecting "2x" or "3x" instead. Alternatively, you might need to switch to a different AI model (as described in Step 3) that supports a higher factor. **You'll know it**

worked when: The "4x" option (or your chosen upscale factor) is clearly selected or highlighted in the Upscayl interface, confirming your desired output size.

Step 5 — Start the Enhancement

Once your photo is loaded and you've selected your preferred AI model and upscale factor, it's time to let the AI do its work. Look for a prominent button, usually positioned at the bottom right of the Upscayl window, labeled "Upscayl" or "Enhance." Click this button to begin the super-resolution process. Depending on your computer's processing power (especially if you have a dedicated graphics card like an NVIDIA RTX GPU) and the original image size, this can take anywhere from a few seconds to a minute or two. You might see a progress bar, a spinning icon, or a message indicating that the AI is actively processing your image. **If it looks different:** If the "Upscayl" or "Enhance" button appears greyed out or inactive, double-check that you've successfully loaded an image and made definite selections for both the AI model and the upscale factor. All required options must be chosen to activate the enhancement button. **You'll know it worked when:** The progress indicator disappears, and Upscayl either displays the enhanced image in a side-by-side view or automatically prompts you to save it.

Step 6 — Review and Save Your Enhanced Image

After the AI has finished processing, you'll see your newly enhanced image. Take a moment to compare it with the original; Upscayl often provides a side-by-side comparison or an easy toggle to switch between the two. Notice the improved sharpness, clarity, and detail in areas that were once blurry or pixelated. If you're pleased with the result, Upscayl will usually prompt you with a "Save As" dialogue box, which is your computer's standard file explorer. Choose a location on your computer to save your crisp new poster-ready photo, and give it a descriptive name so you can easily find it later. **If it looks different:** If a "Save As" prompt doesn't automatically appear, look for a "Save" or "Export" button within the Upscayl application itself. Some versions might also automatically save the enhanced image to a default folder (like "Pictures" or "Downloads") if no prompt is explicitly given. **You'll know it worked when:** You have a new, sharper, and higher-resolution version of your photo saved as a separate file on your computer, ready for use. While Upscayl can significantly enhance your photos, it cannot perfectly invent details from an extremely blurry or tiny original image that were never present in the first place, but it can significantly improve clarity.

Common mistakes

- **Not downloading AI models:** Upscayl relies on various specialized AI models to perform its magic, and not all are included in the initial application installation.
    - **The fix:** If you see few or no options in the "Models" section (Step 3), go into Upscayl's settings or preferences and look for a "Download Models" or "Manage

Models" option to acquire more AI algorithms.

- **Choosing the wrong AI model:** Different models are optimized for different image types (e.g., general photos, illustrations, specific art styles). Using a model designed for, say, anime on a family portrait might give unnatural or distorted results.
    - **The fix:** Experiment! If an image looks strange after processing, try re-loading the original and selecting a different model. "Real-ESRGAN" or "Ultramix_Balanced" are generally good choices for everyday photos and realistic images.
- **Expecting miracles from extremely low-quality sources:** While AI super-resolution is powerful, it cannot invent information that simply isn't there in the original image. An image that is completely out of focus, heavily pixelated, or tiny from the outset will still have significant limitations even after enhancement.
    - **The fix:** Aim for input photos that are only moderately blurry or low-resolution. The better the starting material (even if just slightly), the more impressive and natural the AI's final result will be.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** You can rescue cherished old photos that are a bit blurry, prepare family pictures for larger prints or digital display, or make your social media images stand out with professional-level sharpness and detail.
- **For your business or work:** Enhance product photos for e-commerce listings, sharpen images for presentations or marketing materials, or improve scans of documents and graphics to make them clearer and more legible for your audience and colleagues.
- **If you're just getting started:** Pick one of your favorite slightly blurry photos – perhaps a holiday snap or an old family picture – and follow this guide. Start by selecting the "Real-ESRGAN" model and a 4x upscale factor. Seeing the transformation firsthand is the best way to understand the power of AI image enhancement.

Try it now

Grab a photo that needs a little boost, launch the free Upscayl application, and follow these steps to give it a fresh, crisp look in the next few minutes.

How to create images with AI: a beginner's first try

6 steps · Read online

Imagine typing a simple sentence and watching a brand-new, unique image appear on your screen in seconds. It's like having a digital artist ready to bring any idea to life, no drawing skills required. Whether you want to design a custom greeting card, create a visual for a work presentation, or just visualise a creative thought, **AI image generators** make it possible. By the end of this guide, you will know how to choose a free tool, write a description that the AI understands, and be aware of how you can use your new creations.

Before you start

- **A computer or smartphone** with an internet connection and a web browser.
- **A free account** with an AI image generation platform. Many trusted companies offer free ways to create images — for this guide, we suggest exploring **Microsoft Copilot** (at copilot.microsoft.com) or **Canva** (at canva.com), as both have options to create images without needing a paid subscription. You'll need to sign up for a free account if you don't already have one.
- **Roughly 10-15 minutes** of time to follow along with the steps and create your first images.

Step 1 — Choose and open a free tool

Your first action is to pick a free online tool and open it in your web browser. You don't need to spend money to try this out, as many trusted companies offer free **AI image generators** — these are smart computer programs that act like a digital artist, translating your written words into pictures. We'll use Microsoft Copilot as our primary example.

Open your web browser and go to `copilot.microsoft.com`. If you're not logged in, you'll see a screen asking you to sign in with a Microsoft account or create one. Once you're signed in, you'll see the Copilot interface. **If it looks different:** If you're using Canva, open `canva.com` and log in. Then look for AI-related features, often found in the design creation flow or through a search function. **You'll know it worked when** you see the main interface of your chosen tool, ready for you to input commands or search for tools.

Step 2 — Find the image generator

Now that you're in the tool, you need to tell it you want to create an image. In Microsoft Copilot, look for the image generation feature — this may be a dedicated button, a mode toggle, or you can simply describe what you want in the chat. Type a simple instruction into the input area. When you do this, you're giving a **prompt** to the AI – this is just a fancy word for the

instruction you write to tell the AI what you want to see. **If it looks different:** In Canva, explore the AI image creation options, which may be labeled differently or located in various places within the design interface. **You'll know it worked when** the tool responds by acknowledging your image request, or when a dedicated image generation interface appears with a specific text box for your image description.

💬 Example:

> "Create an image of"

Step 3 — Write your first detailed "prompt"

To get a great result, your **prompt** (the instruction) needs to be more than just one or two words. Think of it like giving a detailed recipe to a chef – the more specific you are, the better the dish will be! A good prompt usually has three main ingredients:

1. **The Subject:** Who or what is the main focus of the picture (e.g., "a fluffy ginger cat").
2. **The Details:** What they are doing, the colors, and the background (e.g., "wearing a blue knitted jumper, sitting on a wooden park bench, bright sunny day").
3. **The Style:** Do you want a realistic photo, a watercolour painting, a 3D cartoon, or something else (e.g., "soft watercolour painting style").

Now, type your complete, detailed description into the text box and send it. The AI will then start processing your request. **If it looks different:** If the AI seems confused, try rephrasing your request slightly, such as "Generate a picture that shows..." instead of "Create an image of...". **You'll know it worked when** you see a message like "Generating your image..." or a loading indicator, confirming the AI is working on your request.

💬 Example:

> "A fluffy ginger cat wearing a blue knitted jumper, sitting on a wooden park bench, bright sunny day, soft watercolour painting style."

Step 4 — Generate and review your images

After you send your detailed prompt, the AI will get to work. It usually creates a few different image options based on your description. This process can take anywhere from a few seconds to about half a minute, depending on the tool and how busy it is.

Once the AI has finished, you'll see a collection of images appear on your screen, usually displayed side-by-side or in a grid. Take a moment to look at them. Don't worry if they're not absolutely perfect yet – this is just the first draft! This step shows you the AI's interpretation of your words. **If it looks different:** Some tools might generate only one image at a time, or

show a progress bar as they work. If the images look completely wrong, double-check your prompt for any typos or unclear instructions. **You'll know it worked when** you see your newly generated images displayed clearly on your screen, all inspired by the description you provided.

Step 5 — Refine or download your favorite

You don't have to settle for the first set of images. Most AI tools allow you to refine your results, just like talking to a helpful assistant. You can ask for changes to the images you see or generate completely new ones with a tweaked prompt.

If you want to make changes, simply type a follow-up instruction. If you're happy with an image, look for a "Download" or "Save" button, which is often an arrow pointing downwards or a disk icon, usually found near the individual image or at the bottom of the collection. Clicking this will save the image to your device. **If it looks different:** The download button might be hidden behind a "..." (three dots) menu or a right-click option. If you're refining, some tools let you select a specific image to refine, while others apply changes to the whole set. **You'll know it worked when** you either see a new set of images based on your refinements, or you've successfully saved an image file to your computer or phone.

Example:

> "Change the jumper color to yellow, and add a small friendly magpie sitting on the bench next to the cat."

Step 6 — Review your image for watermarks and usage

Before you share your AI masterpiece, it's helpful to understand two quick concepts: **watermarks** and **usage rights**. Take a close look at the images you've generated.

A **watermark** is a faint, semi-transparent logo or symbol placed in the corner of an image to show which tool created it. Many free tools include these automatically to keep the images easily recognizable as AI-made. Next, think about **usage rights**, which are the rules for how you can use the images. As a general rule, images you make on free accounts are perfect for personal fun, sharing with friends, or school projects. However, if you plan to use them to make money (like on a commercial website or product packaging), you must check the tool's terms of service (their official list of rules) as some free tiers do not allow commercial use. **If it looks different:** Some tools might offer a paid plan to remove watermarks, or their terms of service might be difficult to find. Look for a "Terms" or "Legal" link, usually at the bottom of the website. **You'll know it worked when** you can identify if your image has a watermark, and you have a general understanding of whether your chosen free tool allows personal or commercial use of your creation.

Common mistakes

- **Being too vague:** Typing "a dog" gives the AI too much room to guess. You might end up with a cartoon pug when you wanted a realistic golden retriever.
    - **The fix:** Be specific! Add details about the breed, color, action, and setting (e.g., "A golden retriever puppy frolicking in a field of sunflowers, hyperrealistic photo style").
- **Expecting perfect text spelling:** AI image generators are brilliant with shapes and colors, but they often struggle to spell words inside images. If you ask for a sign that says "Welcome", the AI might print scrambled letters or strange symbols.
    - **The fix:** It's usually best to avoid asking the AI to generate text within your images. Create the image first, then add text later using a separate image editing tool.
- **Forgetting that AI does not know real people:** For safety and privacy reasons, free tools will not let you generate realistic images of real public figures, celebrities, or your friends.
    - **The fix:** Stick to fictional characters, general subjects, or broad descriptions (e.g., "a young woman reading a book" rather than "Sarah reading a book").

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** You can instantly create custom birthday invitations, organize your home with beautifully styled labels, or make a unique phone wallpaper that no one else has – all with just a few words.
- **For your business or work:** You can quickly mockup visual ideas for presentations, create colorful backdrops for social media posts, or brainstorm logo concepts without spending hours searching through generic stock photo libraries.
- **If you're just getting started:** Remember that experimenting is half the fun. There are no wrong answers, and the more you practice describing your ideas, the better and more accurate your results will be.

Try it now

Let's get you started right now. Open Microsoft Copilot or Canva in a new tab, find the image generator function, and type this simple prompt:

*"A friendly koala wearing a green scarf, holding a warm mug of tea, soft digital illustration style"

How to Make Your First AI Video by Starting with a Simple Storyboard

6 steps · Read online

> **In short:** Before you generate anything, write four to six numbered shots, each with what appears on screen, how many seconds it lasts, and what is said. Then generate one shot at a time. The most important thing to know: AI video tools usually make short clips, so plan your video as a series of short pieces.

Making your first AI video is much less frustrating when you know what you want before you type a single word. In this guide you will write a simple storyboard, turn each shot into a request for an AI video generator, and stitch the clips into one short video. It is written for complete beginners, so no experience with video or AI is needed.

Before you start

- **An AI video generator account.** Many generators, such as Sora, Veo, Runway or Pika, ask you to sign up with an email address. Some have a limited free option, and longer or higher-quality videos may need a paid plan. Check the official pricing page before you commit.
- **A simple place to write.** A notebook, a notes app or a document works fine.
- **A basic video editor.** Your phone or computer probably has one built in. Any simple editor that lets you drag clips into order will do.
- **Time:** about 60 to 90 minutes for your first video, including waiting for clips to render.

Step 1 — Choose one small idea

Pick a subject that fits in 15 to 30 seconds. Good first ideas are a cup of coffee steaming on a windowsill, a dog running across a park, or a paper boat floating down a puddle. Keep it to one place, one main subject and one feeling. A simple idea gives the AI fewer things to get wrong.

Write your idea in one sentence at the top of your page. Then ask yourself: what should the viewer feel at the end? If you can answer that in a few words, you are ready.

Honest note: AI video tools cannot read your mind. They work best when the idea is clear and specific, so spend a minute making it both.

💬 Example: write something like "A calm morning in a small kitchen, with steam rising from a mug of tea."

You'll know it worked when you can describe your video in one sentence that a friend could picture without any extra explanation.

Step 2 — Write four to six numbered shots

A shot is one continuous view from the camera, like one scene before a cut. On your page, draw a numbered list. For each shot, write three things: what appears on screen, how many seconds it lasts, and any words that are spoken. Keep each shot to about 3 to 6 seconds, since many AI clips are short.

If you are not sure how to break your idea into shots, a chat assistant can help you draft the list. You still make the final choices. Tell it how long you want the video to be, then read its suggestion and change anything that does not match your vision.

If your first list runs to ten shots, cut it down. Shorter videos are easier to get right on your first try.

Example: "Help me plan a 20-second video about [your topic]. Give me 5 numbered shots, and for each one list what is on screen, how many seconds it lasts, and any words spoken."

You'll know it worked when every shot has a visible subject, a length in seconds, and a clear purpose in the sequence.

Step 3 — Turn one shot into a clear description

Now take shot number 1 and rewrite it as a short, specific description for the generator. Include the subject, the setting, the lighting, and the camera movement. For example, "slow zoom in" or "camera stays still." Avoid long, crowded sentences. One clear idea per sentence works better than a paragraph of loose adjectives.

Keep your style words the same for every shot, such as "soft morning light" or "warm, cozy colors." Repeating the same look is one of the easiest ways to make separate clips feel like one video.

Do not ask for spoken dialogue in the clip yet. Many generators handle speech and lip movement unreliably, so plan to add voices later in your editor.

Example: "A ceramic mug of tea on a wooden table in [describe your setting], soft morning light, camera slowly zooms in, 5 seconds."

You'll know it worked when your description names the subject, the setting, the light and the camera movement without any confusing wording.

Step 4 — Generate shot 1 and compare it with your plan

Open your video generator and find the text box where you type a description. It is often labeled something like "Prompt" or "Describe your video," but yours may use different words. Paste in

your shot 1 description and choose the length closest to your storyboard. Then start the generation. Wait for it to finish, which can take a few minutes.

When the clip appears, watch it at least twice. Ask yourself: does it show what my storyboard describes? Is the subject visible? Does the motion look roughly right? If something is off, adjust one detail in your description and generate again. Changing one thing at a time makes it easier to see what helped.

If the result looks nothing like your plan, simplify the description and remove extra details. Most early misses come from too many instructions at once.

Example: "A ceramic mug of tea on a wooden table, soft morning light, camera slowly zooms in, 5 seconds." Try "Make the light warmer" as a follow-up adjustment if needed.

You'll know it worked when the first clip matches your written shot 1 closely enough that you could place it in your storyboard without feeling it is from a different story.

Step 5 — Generate the remaining shots in order

Repeat the process for shots 2 through 6, one at a time. Paste the same style words into each description so the lighting and colors stay consistent. Save each clip to a folder on your device, and name the files with their shot numbers, such as "shot-1" and "shot-2." This small habit saves a lot of confusion later.

Expect that not every clip will be perfect. A common reality is that the subject changes slightly from one shot to the next, especially if a person or animal appears in several scenes. If a shot is far off, regenerate just that one rather than starting over. Keep the clips that match your plan and set aside the rest.

Also check the length. If a clip is shorter than you planned, you can trim the others or repeat a short moment in your editor.

Example: "Same soft morning light and warm, cozy colors as before. A hand lifts the mug from the table, camera holds still, 4 seconds."

You'll know it worked when you have a saved file for each shot and each one roughly matches its line in your storyboard.

Step 6 — Put the clips in order and export your video

Open your video editor and create a new project. Import all your saved clips. Drag them onto the timeline in storyboard order, from shot 1 to the final shot. Trim each clip so it matches the

seconds you planned. Most editors have a simple tool for this, often shown as scissors or a small cut icon. If you cannot find it, look for a button that lets you split or shorten a clip.

For a voice, you have two easy options. You can record yourself reading your spoken lines with a voice memo app and add the audio to the timeline, or use a text-to-speech feature if your editor has one. Keep the voice track separate from the clips so you can adjust it on its own.

When everything looks right, export or save the video to your device. Play the exported file from start to finish once before you share it.

💬 Example: "Shot 1 is 5 seconds, shot 2 is 4 seconds, shot 3 is 6 seconds. Place them in that order on the timeline." Use this as a reminder check rather than something you type into the generator.

You'll know it worked when the exported file plays from start to finish in your planned order, with the length close to your storyboard total.

Common mistakes

- **Starting with a long, detailed script.** Beginners often write a full story and hope the AI will split it up. The fix is to write the storyboard first, with short shots, and generate one shot at a time.
- **Changing the style in every shot.** If you describe a new look each time, the clips will not match. The fix is to reuse the same style words in every description.
- **Expecting perfect speech and lip sync from the generator.** Many tools handle spoken words unreliably. The fix is to leave dialogue out of the clips and add your voice in the editor.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** a short video of a family recipe, a birthday greeting or a hobby project can be planned and made in one evening.
- **For your business or work:** a simple product or process explainer can be sketched as a storyboard, then shared with a team for feedback before any clip is generated.
- **If you're just getting started:** write your storyboard on paper first. Even one good plan will make your first video noticeably better than a random prompt.

Try it now

Take five minutes and write a three-shot storyboard for a 10-second video about something in your room. For each shot, write what is on screen and how many seconds it lasts. You have now done the most important part of making an AI video.

Safely Rename a Batch of Photos with a GitHub Copilot Script

6 steps · Read online

> **In short:** With GitHub Copilot inside VS Code, you can describe a renaming task in plain English and get a working Python script back — no coding required. The trick is to test on copies first so your originals stay safe.

By the end of this short guide, you'll have asked Copilot to write a small Python script, tested it on copies of your photos, and renamed an entire folder without typing a line of code yourself. If you have a folder of vacation shots named `IMG_4829.jpg`, `IMG_4830.jpg`, and so on, this is for you.

Before you start

- **A computer** running Windows, macOS, or Linux.
- **VS Code installed** — the free code editor from Microsoft (download from `code.visualstudio.com`).
- **The GitHub Copilot extension** installed in VS Code, with a Copilot account signed in. Copilot offers a free tier and paid plans; check the official GitHub page for current availability and which features each tier includes.
- **Python installed** on your computer (download from `python.org`). Python is the language your script will be written in — think of it as plain English instructions for your computer.
- **A folder of photos** you'd like to rename, plus enough free disk space to make a copy. The whole task takes about **15 minutes**.

Step 1 — Make a working copy of your photos

Right-click your photo folder in your file manager, choose **Copy**, then **Paste** somewhere easy to find, like your Desktop. Rename the copy to something like `photos-test`. This is the folder you'll experiment on.

On macOS, you can also select the folder and press Option-drag to duplicate it. On Windows, hold Ctrl while dragging. You'll see a second folder appear next to your originals, with all the same files inside.

If it looks different: If your photos live in cloud storage like Google Drive or iCloud, the same Copy/Paste idea works — just make sure the copy finishes syncing before you start renaming anything. Some file managers hide the "Paste" option inside an Edit menu; look there if right-click doesn't show it.

You'll know it worked when you see two folders: your untouched originals and a clearly named test copy.

Step 2 — Open the test folder in VS Code

Open VS Code, then go to **File → Open Folder…** and pick your new `photos-test` folder. VS Code's left sidebar (called the **Explorer**) now lists every photo in the folder.

A workspace in VS Code is simply the folder you opened — think of it as putting that folder "on your desk" so the editor can see everything inside it. Nothing is moved or copied; VS Code is just looking.

If it looks different: On the VS Code welcome screen, there's a big **Open Folder** button you can click instead. If the Explorer sidebar is hidden, use **View → Explorer** to bring it back.

You'll know it worked when the names of your test photos appear in the left sidebar.

Step 3 — Open the Copilot chat panel

In VS Code, open the **Copilot Chat** panel. The keyboard shortcut is **Ctrl+Alt+I** on Windows and Linux, or **Cmd+Shift+I** on macOS. A chat window appears — usually on the side of the window.

Copilot is an AI coding assistant: you describe what you want in plain language, and it suggests code. You don't have to understand the code right now — that's the whole point of having an AI helper.

If it looks different: If the shortcut doesn't open anything, look for a small chat-bubble icon in the VS Code sidebar, or use the menu **View → Copilot Chat**. Some older versions put Copilot under **File → Preferences** instead.

You'll know it worked when a chat box is visible with a blinking text cursor, ready for your message.

Step 4 — Describe your renaming task in plain English

Click into the chat box and type what you want. Be specific about the folder, the file types, and the new naming pattern. Copilot reads your message and proposes a Python script in the chat.

The more clearly you describe the rule, the better the script will be. If your rule is "rename to `vacation-001.jpg`, `vacation-002.jpg`, …", say that exactly. If you want the date taken included, ask for that too.

💬 Example: `Write a Python script that renames every .jpg and .png file in the current folder to "vacation-2024-001.jpg", "vacation-2024-002.jpg", and so on. Skip files that already match this pattern.`

If it looks different: Copilot might ask a follow-up question like "What folder should I use?" — just answer in the same chat. If it offers several code blocks, pick the one that looks closest to what you asked for and ignore the rest.

You'll know it worked when a code block appears in the chat with a Python script inside it.

Step 5 — Save the script and run it on the test folder

When Copilot shows a script, look for a small **"Insert into new file"** button above the code (or a similar option like **"Apply"** or **"Copy"**). Click it, and VS Code creates a new file. Save this file inside your test folder as `rename.py`.

Now open VS Code's built-in terminal from the top menu: **Terminal → New Terminal**. A text panel slides up from the bottom. Type `python rename.py` and press Enter.

The terminal is a text-based way to talk to your computer directly — instead of clicking icons, you type commands and read text replies.

If it looks different: If `python` isn't recognized, try `python3 rename.py` instead — that's more common on macOS and Linux. On Windows, you may need to install Python from `python.org` and tick **"Add Python to PATH"** during setup for the command to work.

You'll know it worked when the terminal shows your photos being renamed one by one, and the file list in the Explorer updates.

Step 6 — Verify, then run the same script on your real folder

Open the test folder in your regular file viewer (Finder, Explorer, or Files) and check the new names. Open a few photos to make sure none are broken — the picture files themselves shouldn't change, only their names.

If the names look right, you have two safe options: copy your `rename.py` script into your real photo folder and run it there, or ask Copilot to adjust the script so it points to a different folder. Either way, your originals stay untouched.

If it looks different: If a photo won't open, the file may have been partially affected — restore it from your test copy or your originals. If the names look wrong, go back to Step 4 and ask Copilot to fix the rule, then re-test on the test folder before touching real files.

You'll know it worked when your real photo folder shows the clean new names, and every photo still opens normally.

Common mistakes

- **Skipping the test folder.** It's tempting to point the script straight at your real photos, but one wrong rule can scramble hundreds of filenames at once. Always run the script on copies first, then on the real folder only after you're sure the names are right.
- **Running the script twice without changing the names.** The second run will keep building on your filename pattern (`vacation-2024-001.jpg` could become `vacation-2024-001-001.jpg`). Either move the renamed files out, or include the "skip if already named" rule in your prompt.
- **Trusting Copilot's first answer without reading.** Copilot is helpful but not perfect. If the script does something you didn't ask for — like deleting files or changing the file extension — rewrite your prompt to be more specific and try again on the test folder.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** A folder of 200 vacation photos can go from chaos to `paris-day1-001.jpg`, `paris-day1-002.jpg`, and so on in under a minute. No more guessing which `IMG_4829.jpg` was the Eiffel Tower shot.
- **For your work or business:** Product photos, invoice scans, and event pictures often arrive with cryptic camera names. A two-minute script saves the headache of clicking through 80 files one by one, and the same approach scales to thousands of files.
- **If you're just getting started:** Don't worry about learning Python itself — you're learning how to ask an AI for a script. The skill that matters here is describing your rule clearly, not writing the code by hand.

Try it now

Open your test folder in VS Code, open the Copilot chat, and paste this exact message.

```
Write a Python script that lists every .jpg file in the current folder and renames them to "sample-001.jpg", "sample-002.jpg", in the order they appear. Print the new names before doing it.
```

Run it on a tiny folder of 3 to 5 test files. Seeing those photos rename themselves is the moment this stops feeling like magic and starts feeling like a tool you control.

How to Summarize a Long YouTube Video in 60 Seconds with Any AI

6 steps · Read online

> **In short:** Paste a YouTube link into any AI assistant and ask for a summary — in about a minute you get the main points, key quotes, and a one-sentence takeaway without watching. The catch: not every assistant reads YouTube links directly, so we cover that fallback too.

Found a one-hour interview you don't have time to watch? A 40-minute lecture you need for work tomorrow? You don't have to skip it. Any modern AI assistant can read the page a YouTube link points to and pull out the important parts. Here's the whole workflow, start to finish.

Before you start

- **A YouTube link** — the URL of the video you want summarized. It works on desktop, mobile, or in the YouTube app.
- **An AI assistant** you already have access to — ChatGPT, Gemini, Claude, Copilot, Le Chat, or any other mainstream option. Free or paid plans both work, though some assistants may need a paid plan to read external links reliably.
- **Roughly 2–3 minutes** for the whole thing, including reading the summary.

Step 1 — Copy the YouTube video link

Open the YouTube video you want summarized and look at the address bar at the top of your browser (or the link shown under the video title in the YouTube app). A YouTube link starts with **youtube.com** or **youtu.be** and ends with a jumble of letters and numbers — that's the video's unique ID. Tap and hold (on phone) or click and drag (on computer) to highlight the whole address, then copy it. On the YouTube mobile app, tap **Share** under the video and choose **Copy link** instead — it's faster. If you're on a TV or game console and don't see a copy option, open the video in a phone or computer browser to grab the link from there. 💬 Example: Your copied link will look something like youtube.com/watch?v=AbCdEfGh123 — the letters and numbers at the end are the video's ID. You'll know it worked when the address is highlighted or your phone briefly says "Copied."

Step 2 — Open your AI assistant

Open the website or app for the AI you normally use. Most readers already have at least one of these: ChatGPT, Gemini, Claude, Copilot, or Le Chat. Open a new chat — look for a button like **New chat**, **New conversation**, or a + or pencil icon in the corner of the screen. Starting fresh

matters because a long previous chat can confuse the assistant about what you want right now. You'll know it worked when you see an empty message box, usually at the bottom of the screen, with a prompt that says something like "Message..." or "Ask anything" — your exact wording may be different.

Step 3 — Paste the link and ask for a summary

Click in the empty message box and paste the YouTube link you copied. Then type your request. A short, clear instruction works best — tell the assistant what you want and how long the answer should be. Press **Enter** (or tap the send arrow). The assistant will fetch the video's public page, read its title and description, and (on most assistants) the transcript too. A short summary appears in under a minute. Example: "Here's a YouTube link: [paste your link]. Summarize this video in 5 bullet points and keep it under 150 words." You'll know it worked when the assistant replies with bullet points or a short paragraph that names the video's main topic and the people or ideas involved.

Step 4 — Pull out a few key quotes

The summary gives you the gist, but sometimes you want the actual words someone said — a striking line, a statistic, or a memorable phrase. Ask for those next. Quotes are useful when you want to share the video with a friend or quote it in your own work. Type a follow-up question that specifically asks for verbatim lines. The assistant will return them with quotation marks and usually say who said them. Example: "Now pull out 3 key quotes from that video, with the speaker's name for each one. Keep each quote to one sentence." You'll know it worked when the reply contains lines wrapped in quotation marks and the speaker is named beside each one.

Step 5 — Get a one-sentence takeaway

A bullet-point summary is great for studying, but a single sentence is easier to remember and share. Ask for the takeaway last. The assistant will compress everything it just read into one line you can use as a reference or send to a colleague. If you have a specific audience in mind — your team, your teacher, your family — say so, because the assistant will word the takeaway differently for each. Example: "In one sentence, what's the single most important takeaway from that video, written so I can send it to my manager?" You'll know it worked when the reply is a single complete sentence (not a paragraph) that captures the main idea.

Step 6 — Save or share your summary

Now that you have the points, quotes, and takeaway, decide where they should live. Most assistants have a **Copy** button at the top or bottom of each reply — tap it to grab the text and paste it into your notes app, email, or document. Some assistants also have a **Share** button that

creates a link you can send to someone. If you don't see either button, you can manually select the text and copy it the same way you copied the YouTube link in Step 1. You'll know it worked when the summary text is sitting in another app — your notes, an email draft, or a message — and you can read it again without opening the AI chat.

Common mistakes

- **Pasting the link without any instructions.** The assistant may reply with "What would you like me to do with this?" — always tell it you want a summary, in what length, and for whom.
- **Assuming every assistant reads YouTube links directly.** A few assistants only read the video's title and description, not its full transcript. If your summary feels thin or vague, ask the assistant to look up the video's transcript, or copy the transcript yourself from YouTube (look for an option like **Show transcript** under the video description) and paste that text instead of the link.
- **Trusting the summary on a topic you know nothing about.** Summaries are usually accurate, but AI can still mix up names, dates, or numbers. For important decisions — anything medical, legal, financial, or that affects other people — verify the quote or fact by checking the original video yourself.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** Next time someone sends you a 30-minute tutorial or a long podcast episode on YouTube, decide in 60 seconds whether it's actually worth your time. Skip the noise, keep the useful stuff.
- **For your business or work:** Before a meeting, paste the link to a recorded presentation or webinar and ask for the five main points plus the speaker's recommendations. You walk in prepared without sitting through the whole recording.
- **If you're just getting started:** Pick one YouTube video you've been putting off, follow the six steps above, and see how much you actually retain from the summary versus the full video. Most people are surprised how often the bullet points are enough.

Try it now

Open your AI assistant right now, paste the link to any YouTube video you've been meaning to watch, and type: "Summarize this video in 5 bullet points and pull out 2 short quotes." You'll have a usable summary in about a minute — that's the whole skill.

How to Ask ChatGPT for Step-by-Step Photo Editing Help in Your Phone's Editor

6 steps · Read online

> **In short:** You can ask ChatGPT how to brighten, crop, or remove red-eye in your phone's photo editor, and it will reply with numbered steps for the app you name. It cannot edit your photo for you, and it can only see a picture if your app lets you attach one.

By the end of this guide, you'll be able to describe a photo problem to ChatGPT and follow its numbered steps inside your own photo app. This is for anyone who takes pictures on a phone and wishes they knew how to fix them, with no editing experience needed.

Before you start

- **A ChatGPT account.** You can sign up for free on the official ChatGPT website or app. Image uploads may depend on your plan or app version, so check the app's help screens if the attach option is missing.
- **Your phone's built-in photo editor** (or any photo app you already use). You'll need it open alongside the chat.
- **About 15 minutes.** Two switches between apps are normal, so keep your phone charged.

Step 1 — Tell ChatGPT which photo app you use

Open ChatGPT and start a new chat. Look for a **"New chat"** option, often a pencil or plus icon. Tell the assistant which editor you're using, because menus differ between phones and apps. The reply will be more accurate when it knows whether you use the built-in editor on an iPhone, a Samsung, a Pixel, or another app entirely. If you're not sure of the app's name, say so, and describe the icons you see on the editing screen instead.

💬 Example: "I'm editing a photo on my [phone brand] using the [app name] app. Please give me numbered steps I can follow on my own screen."

You'll know it worked when ChatGPT replies with a short list of steps or asks a helpful follow-up question about your app.

Step 2 — Describe what looks wrong

Be specific about the problem. "It looks bad" is hard to fix, but "too dark," "tilted," or "a bright red glow in both eyes" gives the assistant something to work with. Common photo problems include brightness, cropping (cutting away the edges you don't want), and red-eye (the bright

red reflection flash photos often cause in eyes). Mention one main problem first. Fixing one thing at a time keeps each step easy to follow.

Example: "The photo is too dark on the left side, and I want to crop out the trash can in the corner."

You'll know it worked when ChatGPT's answer addresses your exact problem, not a general photo tip. If it gives you a broad lesson instead, reply with one more detail, such as "the faces are in the center."

Step 3 — Attach your photo, if you can

Some versions of ChatGPT let you share a picture. Look for a **paperclip, plus sign, or image icon** near the message box. Tap it, choose your screenshot or photo, and then send a message describing what you want. Attaching a screenshot of your editor's menu is a great way to get more precise steps, because the assistant can compare its advice to what you actually see. If you don't see any attach option, skip this step and describe the screen in words instead.

Example: "Here is a screenshot of my editing screen. Which button should I tap to brighten the photo?"

You'll know it worked when your image appears in the chat as a thumbnail above your message, and ChatGPT refers to what's in it. If it doesn't mention the image, try resending it or describe the screen in words.

Step 4 — Ask for one fix at a time

Now ask for the steps. Good requests name a single task and ask for numbers, so you can tick off each one. A helpful habit is to add "tell me where to find each tool" so you aren't left guessing. Common tasks include adjusting brightness, cropping to a new frame, or using a red-eye tool, which many phone editors place under an edit or adjust area. Read the list once through before you tap anything, so you know the whole path.

Example: "Give me numbered steps to crop this photo to a square, and tell me where the crop tool usually is."

You'll know it worked when you get a numbered list with clear, single actions, like "Tap Edit" followed by "Choose Crop." If the steps are too vague, ask for more detail on one step.

Step 5 — Follow the steps on your own screen

Switch to your photo editor and go through the steps one by one. If a step says to tap something you can't find, don't panic. Apps change often, so look for an icon that matches the description,

such as a sun for brightness or a square with corners for cropping. Check the result after each step. When the photo looks right, save or export it so your original stays untouched. Many apps let you undo changes if you make a mistake.

💬 Example: "I can't find the red-eye tool in my app. I see a row of icons with a magic wand and a sun. What should I try?"

You'll know it worked when the photo visibly changes after each step, and you can compare it with the original before saving.

Step 6 — Ask for help when the menu doesn't match

Sometimes the steps won't match your screen. That's normal, and you can say so. Describe what's on your screen, and ChatGPT can suggest a different route. Keep the message short, and say exactly which step got stuck. If the advice still doesn't work, the most reliable fallback is your app's own help section or a search for the app name plus the task.

💬 Example: "Step 3 says to tap Adjust, but my screen only shows Filters, Markup, and Edit. What's the closest option?"

You'll know it worked when you get a new route or a clear explanation, and you can continue with the task.

Common mistakes

- **Asking for everything at once.** A request like "fix everything" often produces a long, tangled answer. Fix it: ask for one change per message, such as brightness first, then cropping.
- **Trusting the menu names without checking.** Labels differ between phones and app versions, so a name in the reply may not match yours. Fix it: look for an icon that matches the function, and tell ChatGPT what you actually see.
- **Expecting ChatGPT to edit the photo.** It can explain the steps, but it can't change the picture on your phone. Fix it: keep your photo app open and do each step yourself.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** Fix a family snapshot that's too dark, straighten a tilted shot, or crop out a stray hand before you share it with relatives.
- **For your business or work:** Get clear steps for resizing a product photo or cropping a headshot for a staff directory, without learning a complex desktop program first.
- **If you're just getting started:** Pick one photo you already like and ask ChatGPT for steps to crop it. One small win teaches you more than reading about the process.

Try it now

Open a photo that needs a small fix, open ChatGPT, and send this message: "I'm using [app name] on my phone. Give me numbered steps to brighten this photo." Then follow the first step on your own screen.

Create Royalty-Free AI Music Loops for Podcasts and Videos

5 steps · Read online

Imagine having custom background music for your podcast, YouTube video, or even a presentation, without needing a huge budget or any musical training. By the end of this guide, you'll know how to use Artificial Intelligence (AI) to generate unique, royalty-free music loops that perfectly match the mood of your content. This guide is for anyone who wants to add a professional touch to their projects without the hassle. It's important to know that while AI can create fantastic music, it cannot read your mind or fully understand complex musical theory, so clear instructions are key!

Before you start

- **A device with internet access:** You'll need a computer, laptop, or tablet with a stable internet connection. Most AI music tools, like the one we'll use, operate through a web browser.
- **A Suno.ai account:** This guide uses **Suno.ai** as a practical example. Visit the Suno.ai website and sign up using a Google, Discord, or email account. This process is typically quick.
- **About 10-15 minutes of time:** This is a rough estimate for following the steps and generating your first few music loops.
- **A creative idea:** Have a general sense of the mood, style, or genre of music you're looking for. Do you need something calm, energetic, mysterious, or upbeat?

Step 1 — Sign up or log in to Suno.ai

First, you need to access an **AI music generator**, which is a special online tool that uses **Artificial Intelligence (AI)** — computer programs that can learn and solve problems — to compose original music based on your descriptions. For this guide, we'll use **Suno.ai**, a popular and user-friendly option. Open your web browser (like Chrome, Firefox, or Safari) and navigate to the Suno.ai website (usually by typing "suno.ai" into your browser's address bar). You'll typically see prominent buttons to "Sign up" or "Log in." Choose the option that suits you, often by linking an existing Google or Discord account, or by creating a new account with your email.

If it looks different: If you're on a mobile device, the layout might be slightly condensed, but you'll still find clear sign-up or log-in options. If you're using a different AI music generator, the exact buttons might vary, but look for similar "Get Started" or "Join" prompts. **You'll know it worked when** you are successfully redirected to a main dashboard or a prominent creation screen, indicating you are logged in and ready to begin generating music.

Step 2 — Find the creation area and understand the prompt

Once you're signed in to Suno.ai, you'll typically land on a page that features a large text box, often labeled "Describe your music here" or "What do you want to hear?". This is your **prompt box** – a designated area where you'll type your instructions for the AI. A **prompt** is simply the text description you give to the AI, telling it exactly what kind of music you want it to create. Think of it like giving a detailed brief to a composer. Look around this area for other settings like a checkbox for "Instrumental" or a "Generate" button.

If it looks different: Some AI music generators might require you to click a "Create" or "Generate" button first to reveal the prompt box. Regardless of the tool, your goal is to locate the main text input field where you can describe your desired music, usually a long, empty box. **You'll know it worked when** you see a clear text input field on your screen, indicating that this is where you'll type your musical vision for the AI.

Step 3 — Craft your music idea (your 'prompt')

Now it's time to tell the AI what to compose! In the prompt box, type a clear and descriptive explanation of the music you're looking for. Consider these elements: the **genre** (like folk, electronic, rock), **mood** (happy, reflective, energetic), **tempo** (how fast or slow the music should be), and **instrumentation** (which instruments you want to hear, such as piano, guitar, or drums). The more specific you are, the better the AI can match your vision. Remember, we're aiming for a **music loop**, which is a short piece of music designed to play seamlessly over and over, so clarity is crucial.

💬 **Example:** `A calm, ambient electronic loop for a meditation podcast, featuring soft synth pads, a subtle bassline, and a gentle, pulsing rhythm. Focus on a peaceful and reflective mood.` **If it looks different:** Some AI music tools might offer specific dropdown menus for genre, mood, or instrumentation instead of requiring you to type them into the main prompt. If these dedicated options exist, it's generally best to use them as they can guide the AI more precisely. **You'll know it worked when** you have typed your detailed musical description into the prompt box, ready for the AI to process.

Step 4 — Generate your music and listen

After you've carefully written your prompt, look for the "Generate," "Create," or "Make Music" button, usually located below or next to the prompt box. Click this button to send your instructions to the AI. The tool will then process your request, using its understanding of musical patterns and your description to produce sound clips. This process typically takes a few seconds to a minute, depending on the tool and the complexity of your request. The tool may generate one or more variations of your music.

If it looks different: While the AI is generating, you might see a progress bar, a spinning icon, or a message indicating that the music is "processing." If you are using a free plan, you might only get one generation per prompt or have a daily limit on the total number of generations you can make. **You'll know it worked when** one or more generated music tracks appear on your screen, each typically accompanied by a play button. Press the play button on each track to listen and determine if it matches your original vision.

Step 5 — Refine and download your chosen loop

It's common not to get the perfect result on the very first try, so don't hesitate to experiment! If the music isn't quite right, go back to your prompt (from Step 3) and make small, precise adjustments. For instance, you could add details like "add a subtle orchestral swell" or change a mood word from "calm" to "serene." Once you find a music loop you love, look for a download button, often represented by an arrow pointing downwards, a cloud icon, or the word "Download." Click this to save your music file to your device. Most tools allow you to save the file as an **MP3** (a common, compressed audio format that balances quality and file size) or **WAV** (a higher-quality, uncompressed audio format ideal for professional use).

If it looks different: The download icon might be found within a three-dot menu (...) next to the track, or there might be a specific "Export" option. On a free tier, some tools may restrict downloads or offer lower-quality files. Always review the tool's terms regarding "royalty-free" usage to ensure you're allowed to use the music for your specific purpose, especially if it's for commercial content like monetised videos; some may require attribution (crediting the AI). **You'll know it worked when** the music file appears in your device's downloads folder or a designated location, ready for you to use in your podcast, video, or other creative projects.

Common mistakes

- **Being too vague in your prompt:** Just saying "happy music" doesn't give the AI enough detail to understand your specific needs.
    - **The fix:** Be much more specific. Add details about instruments ("upbeat acoustic guitar, light drums, simple piano melody"), tempo ("fast tempo"), and exact mood ("joyful and bright, like a morning sunrise").
- **Forgetting about "loop" functionality:** If the tool has a specific "loop" setting, or if you don't explicitly ask for it, you might get a song with a distinct ending that won't repeat seamlessly.
    - **The fix:** Always include "loop" or "seamless loop" in your prompt, e.g., "a seamless electronic loop." If the tool has a dedicated "loop" checkbox or setting, ensure it's ticked before generating.
- **Not checking usage rights:** Assuming all AI-generated music is free for any use can lead to unexpected copyright issues, especially if you plan to monetise your content.

    - **The fix:** Always confirm the AI music generator's terms and conditions, particularly for "royalty-free" usage and commercial licensing. "Royalty-free" usually means you don't owe ongoing payments, but some tools might still require you to credit the AI (attribution).

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** You can easily create unique background music for your personal videos, social media stories, or even just for studying or relaxing. This allows you to personalize your digital content in a snap, making your home movies feel more professional or crafting the perfect atmosphere for your focus sessions.
- **For your business or work:** You can quickly produce bespoke, original music for marketing videos, online courses, corporate presentations, or business podcasts. This saves significant time and helps you avoid the complex licensing fees and legalities often associated with traditional stock music libraries.
- **If you're just getting started:** Begin with very simple prompts, like "upbeat acoustic guitar loop" or "calm piano instrumental." Listen to what the AI produces and then gradually add more detail or experiment with different genres.

Try it now

Open Suno.ai on your device, log in, and type a simple prompt like "energetic electronic loop for a workout video" into the prompt box. Click 'Generate' and listen to the results!

Remove Distractions from Photos with Google Photos Magic Eraser

5 steps · Read online

Have you ever taken a fantastic photo, only to have it ruined by a random person in the background, an overflowing bin, or an unsightly power cord? Google Photos' Magic Eraser feature uses a bit of clever Artificial Intelligence (AI) to help you instantly remove those distractions, leaving your pictures looking clean and professional. This guide will walk you through each simple step to make your photos shine.

Before you start

- You'll need the **Google Photos app** installed on your smartphone or tablet.
- You'll need a **Google Account** signed in to the app.
- Pick a photo from your library that has a clear object or person you'd like to remove.
- This feature is generally **free and available** on most modern devices via the Google Photos app, though very heavy or advanced use might have limitations on some free accounts.
- This whole process should take about **5 minutes**.

Step 1 — Open Google Photos and choose a photo

To begin, find and tap the **Google Photos app icon** on your device. It usually looks like a colorful pinwheel. Once the app is open, you'll see your photo library, often displayed as a grid of small picture previews, also known as thumbnails. Tap on the specific photo you want to edit.

What you see: Your device's home screen or app drawer, then your photo library in Google Photos, followed by your chosen photo appearing in full-screen view.

What happens next: The selected photo will open up, filling your screen, ready for you to view or edit.

If it looks different: If your photos aren't showing in a grid, look for a 'Library' or 'Photos' tab at the bottom of the screen. Tap it to see all your pictures.

You'll know it worked when your chosen photo fills the screen, showing all its details.

Step 2 — Find the Magic Eraser tool

With your photo open, you need to access the editing tools. Look for an **'Edit' button** at the bottom of the screen – it often looks like a pencil icon or a set of sliders. Tap this button to enter the editing mode. Once there, you'll see a row of different editing options like 'Crop', 'Adjust', or

'Filters'. Swipe through these options from right to left until you find and tap the **'Tools' section**. Inside 'Tools', you'll then see the 'Magic Eraser'.

What you see: Your photo with various editing icons or tabs appearing along the bottom. After tapping 'Edit', you'll see a new set of options, and then a menu specifically for 'Tools' will slide into view, revealing 'Magic Eraser'.

What happens next: The app transitions from viewing your photo to its comprehensive editing interface. Tapping 'Tools' brings up a selection of smart editing features, including the Magic Eraser.

If it looks different: The 'Edit' button might be a pencil or a 'Settings' icon. If you don't immediately see 'Tools' in the main editing bar, try looking under an 'Adjust' tab or swiping further along the bottom options.

You'll know it worked when you see 'Magic Eraser' clearly listed among the other editing tools, ready for you to select.

Step 3 — Let the AI suggest removals or draw your own

Now that you've selected 'Magic Eraser', the fun begins! The Artificial Intelligence (AI), which is like a clever computer program designed to think and learn, will immediately start analyzing your photo. It's looking for common distractions like people, power lines, or objects that stand out from the background. The AI will then present "suggestions" by highlighting these areas with a subtle, shimmering outline.

What you see: Your photo with the Magic Eraser interface active. You might notice flashing outlines around objects that the AI thinks you might want to remove. Below the image, you'll also see options to 'Erase' (using a brush) or 'Undo'.

What happens next: The AI has completed its scan. If it found anything, the suggested distractions will be highlighted on your screen. If no suggestions appear, that's perfectly fine – you can simply proceed to manually draw over any unwanted areas yourself.

If it looks different: If the highlights don't appear, or the AI doesn't suggest anything, don't worry. This just means you'll guide it yourself. The brush tool will still be active, ready for you to use.

You'll know it worked when the screen shows your photo with potential distractions outlined, or the brush tool is visible, indicating Magic Eraser is ready for input.

Step 4 — Erase unwanted elements

With Magic Eraser active, you have two ways to remove things. If the AI highlighted an object, simply **tap on the highlighted area**. The AI will then try to intelligently remove it and fill the gap with what it thinks the background should look like. For anything the AI didn't highlight, or for more precise control, use your finger to **draw a line or doodle directly over the unwanted object** on the screen. Try to cover the entire object you wish to remove.

What you see: As you tap or draw, the selected part of your photo will disappear almost instantly. The app will attempt to blend the surrounding pixels (the tiny dots that make up your image) to create a natural-looking background where the object once was.

What happens next: The unwanted element vanishes from your photo. You'll see the cleaned-up version right away, giving you a clearer, distraction-free image.

If it looks different: If the result isn't perfect, or if it leaves a blurry patch, don't panic. This tool works best on clear, distinct objects. Simply tap the 'Undo' arrow (often pointing left) at the bottom or top of the screen to reverse the last change and try again.

You'll know it worked when the unwanted object is gone, and the area where it used to be is filled in, making your photo look much tidier.

Step 5 — Refine and save your work

After erasing, take a moment to look closely at your photo. Sometimes, a first pass might leave a slight blur or an incomplete edge. If you need to make further adjustments, you can zoom in by pinching out on the screen with two fingers, and then use the brush tool again for finer detail. You can also use the 'Undo' arrow if you change your mind about a particular erasure. Once you're happy with your edits, look for a **'Done' button** or a tick icon, usually at the bottom-right, and tap it. Then, to save your masterpiece, tap **'Save copy'** (or sometimes just 'Save') at the bottom of the screen.

What you see: Your edited photo still on screen, possibly with 'Done' and 'Save copy' buttons. After tapping 'Save copy', you might see a brief 'Saving' message.

What happens next: Tapping 'Done' exits the Magic Eraser tool, taking you back to the main editing screen. Tapping 'Save copy' processes your changes and creates a brand-new version of your photo in your Google Photos library, leaving your original photo untouched.

If it looks different: The 'Done' button might be a simple checkmark. 'Save copy' might simply be labeled 'Save', or it could appear as a menu option after you tap 'Done'.

You'll know it worked when you see a confirmation message like 'Saved' or 'Copy saved', and you can then find the new, cleaned-up version of your photo alongside the original in your Google Photos library.

Common mistakes

- **Over-erasing**: Accidentally drawing over too much of your photo, or parts you actually wanted to keep, can make the result look unnatural.
    - **The fix:** Always use the 'Undo' arrow immediately if you make a mistake. It will revert your last action, allowing you to try again with more precision.
- **Unnatural background fill**: Sometimes, the AI can't perfectly guess what should be behind an object, leaving a blurry or repetitive pattern.
    - **The fix:** This often happens with complex backgrounds. Try erasing in smaller, more precise sections. If it still doesn't look right, remember that Magic Eraser works best on less complicated backgrounds.
- **Forgetting to save the copy**: After spending time perfecting your photo, it's easy to tap back out of the app without saving, losing all your hard work.
    - **The fix:** Always remember to tap 'Done' and then 'Save copy' (or 'Save') once you're satisfied. Google Photos will usually prompt you if you try to exit without saving, but it's good practice to make it a habit.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** Instantly clean up your holiday snaps by removing stray tourists, make family photos picture-perfect by getting rid of background clutter, or simply tidy up a shot of your pet for social media.
- **For your business or work:** Enhance product photos for online listings by removing dust or distracting elements, clear up real estate images by erasing power lines or bins, or prepare professional-looking profile pictures for your business's social media.
- **If you're just getting started:** Look for a photo with a single, clear, distinct object against a relatively uniform background – like a small sign on a wall, or a distant person against the sky. This will give you the best chance of a perfect 'erase' on your first try!

Try it now

Find a photo in your Google Photos library that has a simple, easy-to-remove object, like a small rubbish bin in the distance or a loose cable on the floor. Follow the steps above to magically erase it and see the difference!

How to use Kling AI video templates in Picsart Flow

5 steps · Read online

> **In short:** Picsart Flow includes Kling-powered video templates that turn a still photo, a character reference image, or a short script-plus-footage combo into a short AI-generated clip. You can try them without editing experience, though longer videos and higher resolution usually need a paid plan.

Want to make a short video but don't have filming skills, a camera, or editing software? Kling is a video-generation model that creates short clips from a still photo, a character image, or a written script combined with your existing footage. Picsart Flow hosts it as ready-made templates, so you mostly just upload, type a sentence, and wait. This guide walks through all three template styles one at a time. None of this requires a video background — only a clear idea of what kind of clip you'd like to end up with.

Before you start

- A free Picsart account (you can sign up with email, Apple, or Google — check the latest sign-up options on the Picsart login page).
- The Picsart app on your phone, or the Picsart web editor on a laptop. Picsart Flow tools may live in different spots in each, so this guide uses language like "look for" rather than exact menu names.
- A few source images saved to your device. For best results, use clear, well-lit photos where the subject is centered.
- Around 15–30 minutes for your first full run-through (most of that is waiting for the AI to render).
- A realistic expectation: AI video is impressive but imperfect. People may look slightly off, hands can blur, and motion can wobble — that's normal for current tools.

Step 1 — Open Picsart Flow and find the Kling templates

Tap the Picsart app to open it, then look along the bottom or side menu for a section called something like **Flow**, **AI Tools**, or **Video**. The exact label depends on your version and platform, so if you don't see "Flow", search inside the app for "Kling" or "AI video" — that usually leads you to the same area. Once you land on the Kling page, scroll until you see a row of template tiles. You'll typically find three styles: one that animates a single photo, one built around a character reference image, and one that combines your footage with a script.

Example: search terms to try inside the app — `Kling`, `AI video`, `photo to video`.

You'll know it worked when you see a screen with several preview tiles, each labeled with the input it needs (photo, image, or footage).

Step 2 — Use the photo-to-video template

Pick the **photo-to-video** template and tap it. The app will ask you to upload one image from your camera roll. Choose a clear photo where the main subject (a person, a pet, a product) is easy to see. After upload, a small text box appears asking what should happen in the video — that's called a **prompt** (the instruction you give the AI). Type one short sentence describing the motion you want, then tap the generate button. The app will show a progress indicator while Kling works. This step usually takes 30 seconds to a few minutes, depending on clip length and server load.

💬 Example: `The woman slowly turns her head to the right and smiles, with soft sunlight on her face.`

You'll know it worked when a short video preview appears in place of the still photo. If it looks wrong, tap regenerate or tweak the prompt — small wording changes make a big difference.

Step 3 — Try the character reference sheet template

Now pick the **character reference** template, sometimes labeled "character sheet" or "consistent character." This one is designed for keeping the same face or outfit across multiple clips — useful for short stories, social media series, or product mascots. The app will ask you to upload one or more images of the same character from different angles. Add a short prompt describing the scene, then generate. Kling tries to keep facial features and clothing consistent, which is harder than it sounds for AI, so your first result may need two or three tries.

💬 Example: `A young woman with short black hair, wearing a yellow raincoat, walks through a misty forest at dawn.`

You'll know it worked when the generated clip shows a person who actually resembles your reference images, in roughly the same clothes and setting. If the face drifts, regenerate or add more reference images — more input usually helps consistency.

Step 4 — Combine footage with a script

The third template, often called **video-to-video** or **script + footage**, lets you feed Kling a short video clip you already have plus a written description of what should change. Think of it as a soft redraw: the AI keeps the general shape and motion of your clip, but re-styles it. Upload a short clip (a few seconds is enough), then type a script describing the new mood, setting, or style. This is the template most people use for stylized social posts — turning a daytime clip into a moody

evening scene, for example. Generation takes longer here because the model has more to process.

💬 Example: `Change the setting to a neon-lit Tokyo street at night, keep the same walking motion.`

You'll know it worked when your uploaded clip now looks visually different (new lighting, color, or setting) while the original motion still feels familiar.

Step 5 — Preview, trim, and export

Once any template finishes, tap the result to open a preview screen. Most flows let you trim the start and end by dragging handles on a small timeline bar. If the clip is too long, shorten it; if the opening is awkward, trim the first second. When it looks right, look for an **Export**, **Save**, or **Download** button — usually at the top or bottom of the preview. On the free plan, you may get a watermark or a lower resolution; higher resolutions and watermark-free exports are typically behind a paid plan. The exact limits change often, so check Picsart's current pricing page if this matters for your project.

💬 Example: trim suggestion — `keep only seconds 2 through 6` (drag the handles until those seconds are highlighted).

You'll know it worked when a finished video file appears in your phone's photo library or downloads folder.

Common mistakes

- **Uploading a blurry or busy photo.** Kling struggles with tiny faces and cluttered backgrounds. Use the clearest, simplest image you have.
- **Writing prompts that are too long.** Two sentences is plenty. Long paragraphs confuse the model and often produce muddled motion.
- **Expecting perfect hands or text.** AI video still fumbles fingers, writing, and small details. If those matter, plan to crop them out of frame or pick a different shot.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** you can turn a favorite vacation photo into a short clip to share with family, without learning video software.
- **For your business or work:** small businesses can produce quick product clips, social teasers, or stylized B-roll (extra footage used to support a story) without hiring a video editor — useful for one-person shops and busy marketing teams.

- **If you're just getting started:** begin with the photo-to-video template on a single clear selfie or pet photo. It's the fastest way to see what Kling can do in under five minutes.

Try it now

Open Picsart, search for the photo-to-video template, and upload one clear photo of someone smiling. Type: `The person gently blinks and turns to look out a window, soft natural light.` Tap generate, wait a minute, and watch your first Kling clip come to life.

How to Turn Your Saved Articles and Notes into a Personal Podcast with Gemini Notebook

5 steps · Read online

> **In short:** Google's Gemini Notebook (formerly NotebookLM) can read up to about 50 of your own sources — links, PDFs, Google Docs, pasted text — and turn them into a roughly 10-to-20-minute audio conversation between two AI voices. It is free with a Google account, and the audio stays grounded in your sources rather than the open internet.

You've got a folder full of articles, a few PDFs you keep meaning to read, and a commute that could use better company. Gemini Notebook is a free Google tool built for exactly this kind of "I'll get to it later" pile. Point it at your reading list, ask for an audio overview, and two synthetic hosts will chat through the highlights while you walk, drive, or wash dishes.

Before you start

- **A Google account** — any personal Gmail address works.
- **A web browser** on a phone, tablet, or computer — Gemini Notebook runs in the browser, no install needed.
- **3 to 5 sources** to feed it: web links, PDFs on your computer, Google Docs from your Drive, YouTube links, or text you can copy and paste.
- **About 15 to 20 minutes total** for setup plus the first audio generation (the audio itself usually takes a few minutes to cook).
- One honest note: the audio is a *summary* of your sources, not a verbatim read-aloud. If you need every word spoken, this is not the right tool.

Step 1 — Open Gemini Notebook and create a fresh notebook

In your browser, go to the Gemini Notebook homepage and sign in with your Google account when prompted. Once you're in, look for a button that says something like **New Notebook** (it may say *Create* or show a plus-sign +). Click it. You'll see a clean workspace with a left sidebar, a center area that invites you to add a source, and a small notes section. If your screen looks different — Google updates its products often — look for a clearly empty page with wording like **Add your first source** in the middle.

💬 Example: type a short name like "Weekend reading" or "Q3 research" into the notebook title field so you can find it later.

You'll know it worked when a new notebook opens with an empty source list and the Studio panel on the right is ready.

Step 2 — Drop in your first article or PDF

Look for a button or panel labeled **Add source** (it might say *Upload* or *Insert*). Click it and you'll see a small window offering several options: paste a website link, upload a file from your computer, pick a Google Drive document, paste raw text, or add a YouTube link. Pick whichever matches what you saved. For a typical "I've been meaning to read this" article, copy the URL from your browser and paste it in. A short loading indicator appears while Gemini Notebook reads the page, then the source shows up in the left-hand Sources list with a small icon and the page title.

💬 Example: paste the URL of one long article you've been putting off.

You'll know it worked when the source appears in the list with its title — usually within a few seconds for a normal web page, longer for big PDFs.

Step 3 — Build out your reading list

Repeat the same **Add source** action for each article, PDF, or document you want covered. Aim for **3 to 10 sources** in one notebook — enough variety for a meaty conversation, not so many that the summary loses focus. Each source gets its own row in the Sources list. You can mix types freely: two web articles, one PDF report, one Google Doc of meeting notes, and one YouTube link all work together.

💬 Example: add 4 items — a long-form article, a PDF report you downloaded last week, a Google Doc with your own notes, and one more link.

You'll know it worked when every source shows up in the Sources panel and none of them show a red error icon. If one fails to load, remove it and try again — usually a sign-in or link problem.

Step 4 — Generate the Audio Overview

Now look at the **Studio** panel on the right side of the screen. Inside it, look for an option labeled something like **Audio Overview**. Click the button that says **Generate** (the exact wording can change as Google updates the product). A small status message appears — usually "Generating audio overview…" — and Gemini Notebook begins writing a script between two AI hosts, then voicing it. This usually takes **2 to 5 minutes**, depending on how much material you fed it. You can leave the tab open and do something else; it'll be ready when you come back.

💬 Example: type an optional instruction in the custom prompt box if you see one, such as "Focus on the parts about pricing strategy."

You'll know it worked when a small audio player appears in the Studio panel with a play button and a total length (typically between 8 and 25 minutes).

Step 5 — Listen, save, or try again

Press the **play button** ▶ on the audio player. Two voices start chatting through your sources — one asks questions, the other explains, they bounce ideas back and forth like a real conversation. You can pause, drag the slider, and adjust playback speed. Look for a small download or share button near the player if you want to save the file for offline listening; if you don't see one, the audio stays inside Gemini Notebook for that session. If the summary misses the point or sounds off, click **Regenerate** (or a similar refresh icon) — each generation is a fresh script, and quality varies.

💬 Example: while listening, jot down a question in the Notes section on the right so you can ask Gemini Notebook's chat about it after.

You'll know it worked when the two hosts are clearly discussing the *content* of your sources — naming the same people, companies, or ideas from your PDFs and links — instead of generic filler.

Common mistakes

- **Pasting 30 sources at once.** The summary gets thinner and more generic the more you add. Stick to a tight theme: 3 to 10 sources that actually belong together.
- **Trying to feed paywalled or login-only pages.** Gemini Notebook can only read what's publicly accessible on the open web. For paywalled articles, download the PDF or paste the text manually.
- **Expecting the audio to quote your sources verbatim.** It summarizes and discusses them — it does not read them aloud. If you need a literal read-aloud, this tool won't deliver.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** Got a stack of "read later" articles about a topic you care about — gardening, parenting, fitness — feed them in and listen on a walk. It's a friendlier way to catch up than scrolling.
- **For your business or work:** Drop in your project briefs, meeting notes, and a few industry reports. The audio overview becomes a quick briefing you can listen to on the way to a meeting.
- **If you're just getting started:** Pick one notebook, one topic, and three sources you've already saved. That's all you need to hear whether the format clicks for you.

Try it now

Open Gemini Notebook in your browser, create a new notebook, and paste in the link to one article you've been meaning to read. Hit the Audio Overview generate button. By the time you make a cup of coffee, you'll have your first mini-podcast.

How to label AI-made videos when you post them on YouTube, TikTok and Facebook

4 steps · Read online

> **In short:** If your video looks real but was made or significantly changed with AI, mark it before you post. On **YouTube**, select **Yes** under **AI use** in the upload details. On **TikTok**, tap **Next**, then **More options**, and turn on **AI-generated content**. On **Facebook**, Meta requires its AI label for photorealistic video or realistic audio that was digitally created or altered.

More and more videos are made or edited with AI: a cloned voice-over, a generated scene, a face swapped into a clip. Viewers deserve to know when something that looks real isn't. YouTube, TikTok and Meta each have their own rules and their own label. This guide describes each one separately, based on that company's own help pages and announcements, so you can follow the rules wherever you post.

Before you start

- **The finished video,** and a clear idea of which parts were made or changed with AI.
- **Your account** on the platform where you'll post.
- **About 5 minutes per platform.**

Step 1 — Decide whether your video needs a label

Each company sets its own rules. In general, **realistic** AI content needs a label, and small edits usually don't. Here is what each one says.

YouTube says to disclose content that:

- makes a real person appear to say or do something they didn't,
- alters footage of a real event or place, or
- shows a realistic-looking scene that didn't actually happen.

YouTube also asks you to disclose AI music when it's the main focus of the video. It says you don't need to disclose clearly unrealistic or animated content, beauty filters, color or lighting fixes, captions, or using AI only to help write your script, title, or thumbnail.

TikTok asks you to label content that was completely generated or significantly edited by AI.

Meta (Facebook) requires its label for photorealistic video or realistic-sounding audio that was digitally created or altered.

💬 Example: A clip where your cloned voice reads the narration over real footage → label it. A clip where you only used AI to brainstorm the title → no label needed on YouTube.

You'll know it worked when you can say in one sentence what in your video is AI-made.

Step 2 — YouTube: turn on "AI use" while uploading

In **YouTube Studio**, start your upload as usual. In the details, find the **Attributes** section. Under **AI use**, select **Yes** if your video needs disclosure.

YouTube says the label then appears in the expanded description, and for some topics in the video player itself. According to YouTube, disclosing on its own won't limit your video's audience or its eligibility to earn money. Creators who repeatedly don't disclose may have a label added by YouTube or face penalties.

You'll know it worked when your video's expanded description shows the label after it's published.

Step 3 — TikTok: switch on "AI-generated content"

In the **TikTok app**, record or upload your video, then tap **Next**. Tap **More options** and turn on **AI-generated content**. Then post as usual.

On a **computer**, click **Upload**, choose your video, click **See more**, turn on **AI-generated content**, and click **Post**.

TikTok says it may also add a label automatically, for example when you use its own AI effects or when the file carries **Content Credentials** (C2PA) showing it was made with AI. Once a label is on, it can't be removed after posting. Labeled videos still have to follow TikTok's Community Guidelines.

You'll know it worked when your posted video shows TikTok's AI-generated label.

Step 4 — Facebook: use Meta's AI label before you post

Meta says people must use its AI disclosure and label tool when they post a **photorealistic video** or **realistic-sounding audio** that was digitally created or altered, and that it may apply penalties if they don't. Meta shows these posts with an **AI info** label, and it may add the label itself when it detects industry-standard signals that content was made with AI.

Meta doesn't publish step-by-step screens that we could verify, so here's the safe approach: before you post, look for the AI label option in your post or reel settings and turn it on.

If it looks different: If you can't find the option, check Meta's Help Center for the current steps before posting.

You'll know it worked when your published post shows the **AI info** label.

Common mistakes

- **Thinking "it's only a little AI" means no label:** A realistic cloned voice or a swapped face counts, even if the rest is real footage.
  - **The fix:** Use Step 1. If the AI part could make viewers believe something happened that didn't, label it.
- **Labeling on one platform and forgetting the others:** Each platform has its own switch.
  - **The fix:** When you post the same video in several places, turn the label on in each one.
- **Hiding the AI part in the caption only:** A caption alone may not count as the platform's label.
  - **The fix:** Use the official switch. You can also mention it in the caption.
- **Using someone else's face or voice without permission:** A label doesn't make that okay.
  - **The fix:** Only use people's likeness or voice with their clear consent.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** If you share fun AI clips with friends and family, a label keeps anyone from mistaking them for real events.
- **For your business or work:** Labeling protects your reputation and helps you follow each platform's rules for realistic AI content.
- **If you're just getting started:** Make it a habit. Before you post, ask yourself: "Could someone think this really happened?" If yes, switch the label on.

Try it now

Pick one video you plan to post this week. Write down in one sentence what in it was made with AI, check it against Step 1, and if it needs a label, turn on the switch from Step 2, 3, or 4 when you upload it.

How to Edit Your Phone Photos with Simple Text Instructions in Meta AI

6 steps · Read online

> **In short:** Send Meta AI a photo, type what you want changed ("remove the person on the left", "make the sky look like sunset"), and it returns a new version. Simple edits usually work on the first try; complex changes may need a couple of attempts.

Ever take a great photo and then notice a stranger walking through the background? Or snap a sunset shot where the sky came out dull and gray? You don't have to learn a photo editor to fix these — Meta AI can do small edits just by typing what you want. This guide walks through how, on your phone, in a few minutes.

Before you start

- A phone with **Meta AI** available — built into WhatsApp, Instagram, Facebook, or Messenger. If you don't see it in any of those, the same chat works at **meta.ai** in your phone's browser.
- A Meta account (the same one you use for Facebook or Instagram works).
- One photo saved on your phone that you'd like to edit — landscape, portrait, or a quick snapshot, any of them.
- A working internet connection.
- About **5 minutes** for your first edit, and a little patience if the first attempt isn't quite right.

> **One honest note:** Meta AI is great at small, focused edits — sky color, brightness, removing a clear object. It is not a replacement for a full photo editor like Photoshop. If your request is very complex, the result may surprise you, and that's normal.

Step 1 — Open a chat with Meta AI

Open WhatsApp, Instagram, Facebook, or Messenger, then find the contact or chat labeled **Meta AI**. It's usually marked with a little blue or purple ring around its profile picture. In WhatsApp, tap the green new-chat button and look for "Meta AI" near the top of your contacts. In Instagram, start a new direct message and search for "Meta AI". A one-on-one chat opens, with a text box at the bottom and a paperclip or + button on the left for attaching things. If you can't find Meta AI in any app, open your phone's browser and go to **meta.ai** — sign in with your Facebook or Instagram account if asked, and you'll land in the same chat. 💬 Example: Open WhatsApp → tap the new-chat icon → tap "Meta AI" in the contacts list. You'll know it worked when a chat thread opens with "Meta AI" at the top and a text box you can type into.

Step 2 — Send the photo you want to edit

Tap the paperclip, +, or camera icon next to the text box, then pick **Photo** or **Gallery** from the menu. Your phone's photo library opens. Select the photo you want — just one to start, so the AI has a clear focus. The photo appears as a small preview in the chat; tap **Send** (the arrow button) to deliver it. The image uploads in a few seconds, and Meta AI now "sees" it. If you're using **meta.ai** in the browser instead, look for an upload icon — usually an arrow pointing up or a small picture frame — on the left side of the message box. Tap it, pick the photo, and send the same way. 💬 Example: One landscape photo where the sky looks flat and gray — perfect for your first edit. You'll know it worked when your selected photo shows up in the chat as a sent message.

Step 3 — Type what you want changed

In the text box right below the photo, write a short, plain sentence describing the edit. Tap send. You'll see three small dots animating while Meta AI thinks — that means it's working. Within a few seconds, sometimes up to a minute, it replies with a new image, usually with a one-sentence acknowledgment like "Here's the edited version." The new photo lands in the chat as another message bubble. If the reply is **only text** with no image, your instruction was probably unclear — try again with the wording in the example below. 💬 Example: "Make the sky look like a bright sunset with orange and pink clouds" — or simpler, "Remove the person on the right" or "Brighten the photo so it doesn't look so dark." You'll know it worked when a new image appears in the chat that looks like your photo, but with the change you asked for.

Step 4 — Look closely at the edit

Tap the new image to open it full-screen. Pinch out with two fingers to zoom in on the area you asked to change. Now look at it honestly: did the edit land where you wanted? Sometimes Meta AI nails it. Other times the change is subtle, or it shifted something you didn't ask to change — a face looks slightly different, or a building in the background got smudged. That happens, and it doesn't mean you did anything wrong. If the image is small and won't zoom in the chat, take a screenshot of your phone (side button + volume up on most phones) — that captures the full-size version for closer inspection. 💬 Example: Ask yourself — is the person really gone, or is there a faint shadow where they stood? Is the sky the color you wanted, or does it look painted on? You'll know it worked when you can decide, honestly, whether this version is good enough to keep or whether you'd like to try again.

Step 5 — Ask for a redo if it's not quite right

If the edit missed the mark, reply in the same chat with a clearer or more focused instruction. Keep the conversation going — Meta AI keeps the photo and your request in context, so you can

iterate. Useful phrases: "Try again", "Make it stronger", "Keep everything else exactly the same and only change the sky", or pointing out what went wrong, like "The person is still there — try once more". If the AI keeps misunderstanding after several tries, start a brand new chat, send just the photo again, and write your best, clearest instruction first. Long threads with many edits sometimes confuse the model. 💬 Example: First try didn't remove the person cleanly? Send: "Try again — remove the person on the right side, but keep everything else exactly the same." You'll know it worked when a new version finally looks like what you wanted — or when you've accepted that this particular edit isn't possible and you'd rather try a different photo.

Step 6 — Save the photo you like

When you're happy with an edited version, save it to your phone. Tap and hold the image in the chat — a small menu appears with options like **Save**, **Save to Photos**, or **Share**. Tap "Save" and the photo lands in your camera roll or gallery, just like one you took yourself. In some apps you'll see a small downward-arrow icon on the image — tap that instead. In **meta.ai** in the browser, long-press the image (or right-click on a computer) and choose "Save image as". Only save once you're sure — once it's in your camera roll, you can't easily get back to the older versions still sitting in the chat. 💬 Example: Save your favorite version, then close the chat. Your original photo is untouched on your phone, and the edited version is now saved next to it. You'll know it worked when you open your phone's Photos or Gallery app and see the edited photo sitting there.

Common mistakes

- **Asking for too many changes at once.** "Remove the person, fix the sky, brighten everything, and add a reflection in the water" is too much for one message. The AI may handle one or two of those, badly, while ignoring the rest. **Fix:** ask for one change at a time, and send the photo back through Step 3 each time.
- **Writing vague instructions.** "Make it better", "fix this", or "improve it" leaves the AI guessing — usually wrong. **Fix:** describe exactly what to change in plain words. "Make the sky bluer" works; "nicer sky" doesn't.
- **Not zooming in to check the result.** On a phone screen, a small image can look fine until you look closely — then you notice a smudged face or a ghostly outline where someone was removed. **Fix:** always open the image full-screen and zoom in on the edited area before saving.
- **Saving the first version without comparing.** The first attempt is rarely the best one. **Fix:** wait until you've tried once or twice and you've got the version you actually want, then save that one.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** vacation photos where someone walked into your shot, birthday candles that came out dim, a beach picture where the sky was gray — all fixable in under a minute with one short instruction.
- **For your business or work:** quick product photos, social media posts, or marketplace listings where the background needs cleanup. Type what you want removed, send it through, save the result. It won't replace a designer, but it gets you 80% of the way in seconds.
- **If you're just getting started:** pick a photo that's been bothering you — maybe a great group shot with a stranger in the corner — and try removing them first. It's the easiest edit to see if Meta AI is working for you.

Try it now

Open Meta AI right now in WhatsApp, Instagram, or **meta.ai** in your browser. Send one photo you've taken recently — anything from this week. Then type one short instruction, such as "Make the colors look brighter" or "Remove the trash can in the corner". The whole thing takes under two minutes, and you'll see exactly how the tool responds to your wording — which makes the next edit easier too.

How to Sort and Clean Up a Messy Phone Photo Library with Gemini

6 steps · Read online

> **In short:** Gemini can look through photos you upload, flag near-duplicates, group similar shots, and pull readable text out of old screenshots — all without touching your library. You stay in control: Gemini suggests, you decide what to delete.

By the end of this guide, you'll know how to use Gemini as a careful second pair of eyes for your photo mess — the kind where you have seven nearly-identical sunset shots and a folder full of screenshots you can never search. This is for anyone whose phone gallery has gotten out of hand and wants a low-risk way to start sorting through it.

Before you start

- A free Google account (any Gmail address works). The free Gemini tier is enough for small batches; a paid Google AI plan lets you upload more photos at once and keeps longer conversations in memory — check Google's official site for current plan options.
- The Gemini app on your phone, **or** a browser pointed at the Gemini website.
- About 20–30 minutes for your first batch.
- A folder of photos you actually want to clean up. Pick one small group to start with — don't try the whole library on day one.

Step 1 — Open Gemini and start a fresh chat

Tap the Gemini app icon, or visit the Gemini website in your browser. If you're not signed in, sign in with your Google account. Look for a **"New chat"** button — usually a plus sign or a small pencil icon at the top of the chat list — and tap it. A blank conversation opens. Starting fresh keeps the AI focused on the photos you're about to share, not on a leftover question from yesterday's weather check.

If you don't see "New chat," try the **three-line menu** (sometimes called a hamburger icon) in the top corner — the option to start over is usually inside it. On some devices the same button looks like a small **square with a pencil** inside instead.

💬 Example: tap **New chat**, then wait for the empty text box to appear.

You'll know it worked when you see a clean text box with no messages above it and a paperclip or upload icon somewhere nearby.

Step 2 — Gather a small batch of photos to upload

Don't try your whole library on day one. Pick **10 to 20 photos** that feel like they might overlap — the seven sunset shots from your last trip, the burst-mode photos from your kid's birthday, the screenshots you saved last month. In your phone's gallery, tap **Select** (or hold one photo until checkboxes appear), choose the photos, then tap **Share**, and pick **Gemini** from the list of apps. On a computer, drag the photos straight into the chat box.

If the share menu doesn't show Gemini, copy the photos to your clipboard and paste them into the chat. On older Android phones the upload icon looks like a **paperclip** 📎; on iPhones it's often a small **plus sign** + at the bottom of the text box.

💬 Example: open your gallery, select the 8 beach photos from last weekend, tap **Share** → **Gemini**.

You'll know it worked when the photos appear as small thumbnails in your message and Gemini replies with something like "Got it — I can see 8 photos."

Step 3 — Ask Gemini to flag duplicates and similar shots

Now comes the useful part. In the same chat, type a short, clear question about the photos you just shared. The clearer your instruction, the better the answer. You can ask Gemini to find photos that look almost the same, group them by scene, or just describe what makes each one different. It can read the image content directly — the colors, the framing, who's in the shot — and reason about which ones are worth keeping.

If Gemini's response is too generic, follow up with a more specific question. After a vague "they all look similar," try "Which one is sharpest?" or "Which one best shows both people smiling?" If the free tier says it's reached a limit, work in even smaller batches, or look into a paid plan for larger uploads.

💬 Example: "Here are 8 photos from the same sunset. Can you group any that look like near-duplicates, and tell me which one of each group is the sharpest or best composed?"

You'll know it worked when Gemini gives you a numbered list or short table, like "Group A: photos 1, 3, and 5 are nearly identical — keep #3."

Step 4 — Pull searchable text out of an old screenshot

Screenshots are useless until you can search them. Take a single screenshot — a recipe, an address, a confirmation number, a Wi-Fi password you saved months ago — and share it with Gemini the same way you did in Step 2. Then ask Gemini to read the text out of it and rewrite it in a clean, searchable form. This works for receipts, WhatsApp messages, store hours, anything that ended up trapped inside an image.

The text won't be added back to your photo library automatically — you'll copy it out yourself in Step 6. And Gemini can misread small or blurry text, so for anything important like medical info or legal documents, always double-check the original screenshot.

💬 Example: "Please transcribe the text in this screenshot. Format it as: store name, date, total amount, and any reference number."

You'll know it worked when Gemini replies with readable text you can copy and paste, and that text matches what you actually see in the screenshot.

Step 5 — Ask for a simple cleanup plan

Once Gemini has analyzed a batch, ask it to summarize what it found into a short, action-friendly list. You're looking for a "do this, then this, then this" answer — not a long essay. The point is to turn Gemini's observations into a checklist you can actually use in your phone's gallery. This is also where Gemini's "context window" (the amount of text and images it can keep track of in one conversation) matters: if your batch is too big, it may start forgetting earlier photos.

If the plan is too long, ask for the top three actions only. If it's missing something obvious, ask a follow-up like "Did you see any photos that look like receipts or notes I should transcribe?"

💬 Example: "Based on what you saw, give me a short checklist of which photos I can safely delete and which I should keep. Keep it under 5 bullet points."

You'll know it worked when you have a short, scannable list that feels doable in under five minutes.

Step 6 — Take the plan into your Photos app

Now switch to your phone's gallery or Google Photos. Open the same batch of photos. Use Gemini's checklist as your guide: delete the ones it flagged as duplicates, keep the sharpest of each group, and save the transcribed text somewhere searchable — a notes app, a contact entry, or a dedicated "Screenshots I've read" album. This is the step where the cleanup actually happens, and it's the step only you can do.

For an extra safety net, turn on your gallery's recently-deleted folder so any mistake can be undone within 30 days. On Google Photos it's usually at **Library → Trash**; on iPhone it's at **Albums → Recently Deleted**.

💬 Example: open the 8 beach photos, delete 5 based on Gemini's notes, star the best one, and paste the transcribed receipt text into your notes app.

You'll know it worked when your batch is smaller, the photos you kept are the ones you actually want, and the old screenshots have become searchable text.

Common mistakes

- **Uploading your whole library at once.** Gemini gets less accurate with very large batches, the conversation becomes hard to follow, and you may hit free-tier limits fast. Work in groups of 10–20.
- **Letting Gemini "decide" what to delete.** Gemini can suggest, but it can't actually delete anything from your phone — and it shouldn't. Always make the final call yourself, in your own gallery, with your finger on the button.
- **Trusting transcribed text blindly.** Especially for numbers, dates, and addresses — Gemini reads most of it right, but a single wrong digit on a confirmation code can cost you a refund. Always glance back at the original screenshot.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** That folder of 200 mystery screenshots from the last three years can finally become a few searchable notes — addresses you can find, receipts you can expense, articles you can actually read.
- **For your business or work:** If you snap whiteboards, business cards, or reference material on the go, this same flow turns them into text you can paste into documents, spreadsheets, or your CRM.
- **If you're just getting started:** Pick **one** folder — say, screenshots from last month — and run the full six steps on just that folder. Twenty minutes later, you'll have a feel for the process before touching anything bigger.

Try it now

Open Gemini right now, share it the last five photos you took, and ask: "Which of these is the best one, and why?" You'll get a tiny but real taste of how Gemini sees your library — and you'll have deleted nothing by accident.

How to Generate Images with Google Gemini: A Beginner's Guide

6 steps · Read online

Imagine being able to paint a picture just by describing it out loud. Whether you need a quick illustration for a work presentation or a fun graphic for a party invitation, Google Gemini lets you turn your words into custom images in a matter of seconds. This guide will walk you through the simple steps to create your own unique visuals.

Before you start

- **A Google Account:** You will need to be signed into a standard Google account. If you use Gmail or YouTube, you already have one.
- **Access to Gemini:** Open your web browser and go to `gemini.google.com`, or open the Gemini app on your mobile device.
- **Device:** This guide works on any computer, tablet, or smartphone with internet access.
- **Cost:** Image generation in Gemini is currently available for free, though usage limits may apply or change over time with AI tools.
- **Time:** This guide will take approximately 5-7 minutes to follow.

Step 1 — Open Gemini and start a new chat

First, make sure you're ready to talk to Gemini. When you open `gemini.google.com` in your web browser, you'll see the main Gemini interface, which typically features a large text box at the bottom of the screen and a "New chat" button somewhere near the top. This is your blank canvas for a fresh conversation.

When you click or tap the "New chat" button, the text box at the bottom will clear, indicating Gemini is ready for your first instruction. This prepares the AI for a new request, ensuring it doesn't get confused with previous topics.

If you don't see a "New chat" button, look for a plus sign (+) icon or a menu option like "Start new conversation" in the top-left corner.

You'll know it worked when the text input area at the bottom of the screen is empty and ready for you to type.

Step 2 — Tell Gemini to generate an image

To create an image, you need to write a **prompt** (the written instruction you give to an AI, acting like a friendly request to a helpful assistant). Gemini needs to know right away that you

want a picture, not just text. Always start your prompt with a clear command for image creation. Type your command into the text box at the bottom of the screen.

After typing your command, press the "Enter" key on your keyboard or click the send icon (often a paper airplane or arrow button) next to the text box. Gemini will then process your request, and you'll typically see a "Generating..." message as it works.

If you accidentally just type a description without the command, Gemini might try to answer you with text. Just clarify in your next message, "Please make an image of that."

Example:

> "Create an image of..."

You'll know it worked when Gemini starts to show a message like "Generating image(s)..." or "I'm working on that for you."

Step 3 — Describe your subject with details

An AI **image generator** (a tool that turns written text into digital pictures) needs details to work its magic. Think of it like describing a scene to a friend who has their eyes closed. After your initial command from Step 2, continue to type in the main text box, adding specific information about what you want to see.

When you add more detail to your prompt and press Enter or the send button, Gemini will process this enriched request. It will use these clues to build a more accurate and vibrant picture, displaying the results directly in the chat window.

If the images don't quite match your vision, it often means your description was a little too vague. Try adding more adjectives or focusing on specific objects, colors, or actions.

Example:

> "Create an image of a fluffy golden retriever puppy wearing a bright red collar, sitting on a sun-drenched green lawn next to a yellow tennis ball."

You'll know it worked when Gemini presents you with usually two to four image options that directly reflect the details you provided in your prompt.

Step 4 — Choose your visual style

Gemini can create images in many different artistic styles. If you don't specify a style, it will usually default to a realistic photo. To change the mood or appearance, add style keywords to

your prompt in the same text box where you've been typing. This instructs Gemini on the artistic direction for the image.

When you include a style in your prompt and submit it, Gemini will generate new images that incorporate that specific artistic look. You'll see the images appear within the chat interface, often in a grid or gallery format. This allows you to easily compare different styles or refinements.

If the style doesn't look quite right, try using a slightly different keyword (e.g., "cartoon" instead of "3D cartoon") or being more specific (e.g., "impressionist oil painting").

Example:

> "Generate a watercolour painting of a quiet beach at sunset, with soft purple and orange colors in the sky."

You'll know it worked when the new images Gemini presents clearly show the artistic style you requested, such as brushstrokes for a "watercolour painting" or distinct lines for "line art."

Step 5 — Refine your generated images

Once Gemini generates your images, you might want to make some tweaks. You don't need to start from scratch. You can simply talk to Gemini like a person, typing a new instruction in the text box that refers to the images it just made. This tells Gemini to adjust the previous output rather than starting a completely new image set.

After you send your refinement request, Gemini will consider your feedback and generate updated versions of the images, incorporating the changes you asked for. These new images will appear in the chat, usually below your request.

If Gemini seems confused by your request, try being more specific about which image you want to change ("the last one," "the first image") or what exact element needs altering ("the background," "the animal").

Example:

> "Can you make the sky in that last picture a bit more blue, and add a single sailboat in the background?"

You'll know it worked when Gemini displays new images that show the specific adjustments you asked for, like a bluer sky or a newly added sailboat.

Step 6 — Save or share your image

Once you have an image you like, you'll want to save it or share it. Look for the image within the chat window. Usually, if you click or tap on an image, it will open in a larger view, where you'll find options to download or share.

When you select the download option (often an arrow pointing down, or a "Download" button), the image will be saved to your device's downloads folder or photo gallery. If you choose to share, a menu might appear allowing you to copy the image or share it directly to other applications.

If you don't see a clear download button, try right-clicking (on a computer) or long-pressing (on a mobile device) the image itself; this usually brings up a context menu with "Save image as..." or "Download image" options.

You'll know it worked when the image file appears in your device's downloads or photo library, ready for you to use or share.

Common mistakes

- **Being too brief:** Writing "a cat" will give you a random result. Instead, give Gemini specific details.
    - **The fix:** Writing "a sleepy tabby cat curled up on a knitted blue blanket in front of a warm fireplace" gives Gemini the clues it needs to make something beautiful and specific to your idea.
- **Asking for readable text:** AI image tools sometimes struggle to spell words correctly or make them look natural inside pictures.
    - **The fix:** It is usually best to generate the image without any text, and then add your words later using a simple design app or photo editor.
- **Using negative words:** AI models respond better to what *should* be in the picture, not what *shouldn't*.
    - **The fix:** Instead of saying "a kitchen with no clutter," try saying "a clean, tidy, minimalist kitchen with polished benchtops." Always frame your request in a positive, descriptive way.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** You can design personalized birthday cards, create unique social media posts, or even generate custom phone wallpapers to match your mood.
- **For your business or work:** You can quickly create eye-catching graphics for slide decks, blog posts, or social media updates without needing a massive budget for stock photos or a professional designer.

- **If you're just getting started:** Don't worry about making your prompts perfect. Just play around, try different styles, and see what the AI creates. The best way to learn is by experimenting!

Try it now

Let’s make your very first image. Copy and paste the prompt below into Google Gemini right now to see what happens:

> **"Create a simple, cheerful cartoon illustration of a happy koala holding a warm cup of tea."**

Create Your First AI Image with Midjourney: A Beginner Walkthrough

6 steps · Read online

> **In short:** Midjourney turns a written description into a picture in roughly a minute. You'll need a Midjourney subscription, about ten minutes, and a clear idea of what you want to see. The finished image is yours to download and use.

In the next ten minutes, you'll go from a blank screen to a finished picture saved on your device. No art background needed — if you can describe what you want, you can do this. We'll skip the jargon and focus on the buttons you'll actually press.

Before you start

- **A Midjourney account** — sign up on the official Midjourney website using your email, a Google account, or a Discord login. Generating images requires a paid subscription; current plans and pricing are listed on Midjourney's official pricing page, so check there before you commit.
- **A web browser or the Midjourney web app** — you can work on a computer, tablet, or phone. Discord also works as an alternative entry point if you already have an account there.
- **About 10–15 minutes** of your time, plus another minute or so while the AI draws.
- **One clear idea** of a picture you'd like to see. "A cat" works as a starter; "a calico cat asleep on a stack of books, soft morning light" gives a much better result.

Step 1 — Create your Midjourney account

Open your web browser and go to the official Midjourney homepage. Look for a sign-in or sign-up button — it's usually in the top-right corner, often labeled something like **"Sign In"** or **"Get Started."** Click it, then sign in with your email, a Google account, or a Discord login.

After signing in, the page will guide you through choosing a subscription plan. Pick whichever option feels right for a first try — you can change or cancel later. Once payment is confirmed, the page reloads and drops you into your personal Midjourney workspace.

If you'd rather start in Discord, the same tool runs inside a chat window there. Either path leads to the same image-quality results, so don't worry about choosing wrong.

💬 Example: when asked for your email, use the one you check most often — that's where receipts and account notices will go.

You'll know it worked when you see the Midjourney workspace, with a place to type your picture description and your account name visible somewhere on screen.

Step 2 — Find the create screen

Once you're in your workspace, look for the area where you can start a new image. On the Midjourney web app, this is usually a large text box near the middle of the screen, sometimes paired with a sidebar that lists past images or quick-start options. On mobile, the input area may fill the whole screen.

Click anywhere inside that text box. Your cursor should start blinking there. Don't type yet — just confirm you've found it. This box is where you'll describe your picture, so it's worth a moment to make sure you're in the right place.

If your version looks more like a Discord chat, type **/imagine** in any message field and Discord will offer to autocomplete it. Either way, you're heading to the same destination: a box waiting for your words.

If you don't see a text box at all, look for a button that says something like **"Create"** or **"Imagine,"** or shows a + symbol — clicking it usually opens the input area.

You'll know it worked when your cursor is blinking inside an empty text box and no error message is showing.

Step 3 — Write your first prompt

Now describe one picture in plain words. Imagine texting a friend who paints for you — tell them the subject, the mood, the setting, and the style. A **prompt** is just the name for this description; nothing fancy.

Be specific. *"A flower"* gives you a generic flower. *"A single red poppy in a glass jar, morning sunlight, photo-realistic"* gives you something that actually looks the way you pictured it. Short sentences are fine. So is a comma-separated list.

When your description feels right, look for a button nearby — usually a paper-plane icon, an arrow, or the word **"Generate"** — and click it once. Don't click twice; each click spends a credit and starts a fresh image, so patience saves you money.

💬 Example: `a cozy reading nook by a window, warm lamp light, watercolor illustration, soft colors`

You'll know it worked when the button greys out, a small progress message appears, and within about a minute the first signs of your picture start forming on screen.

Step 4 — Review your generated image

When generation finishes, you'll typically see your image appear on screen. Depending on your settings and the version being used, this might be a single image or a grid of variations. Either way, take a moment to look at what Midjourney created from your description.

If you're looking at a grid and none of the images feels right, look for a button like **"Re-roll"** or a circular ↻ arrow somewhere near the grid. That tells Midjourney to try again with the same prompt and produce new attempts.

You'll know it worked when you can clearly see your generated image(s) and at least one of them makes you think *"ooh, that's nice."*

Step 5 — Upscale your favorite

If you're working with a grid, near it you'll typically find a row of small buttons labeled something like **U1, U2, U3, U4** — one under each image. The **U** stands for **upscale**, which simply means turning the small preview into a full-size, sharp picture. There are usually also **V1–V4** buttons, which create **variations** on that specific image.

Click the **U** button under the picture you like most. Within a few seconds, a single full-resolution version of that image appears. This is the one you'll keep.

If the upscaled image has a small detail you'd like changed — say the cat's eyes are the wrong color — you can run a new variation on it, or simply upscale a different image from the grid instead.

You'll know it worked when a single, larger, sharper image appears alongside or in place of the small grid preview.

Step 6 — Download the image to your device

Click the upscaled image to open it full-size. Look for a download control — this might be a small downward arrow ⬇, a button that says something like **"Save"** or **"Download,"** or an option inside a right-click or menu. One tap or click should save a PNG or JPG file straight to your device.

On a phone, the image often opens in a new tab. From there, look in your browser's menu (often three dots or a share icon) for an option to save the picture to your Photos or Gallery app. On a computer, the file usually lands in your Downloads folder.

The file is now yours. You can post it, print it, set it as your wallpaper, or send it to a friend. Midjourney's standard paid plans deliver images without a watermark, so the picture is ready to

share as soon as it's saved.

You'll know it worked when the file appears in your **Downloads** folder (computer) or **Photos / Gallery** app (phone), and you can open it again from there.

Common mistakes

- **Writing a one-word prompt.** "Cat" gives you a random cat. Always include at least one detail about mood, style, or setting — Step 3 has an example you can copy and tweak.
- **Clicking Generate twice in a hurry.** Once is enough. Every extra click spends a credit and starts a fresh image. If the first result isn't ready yet, just wait — a progress indicator should be visible.
- **Asking the AI to draw readable text.** Midjourney struggles with words inside images — a sign that says "OPEN" often comes out misspelled or jumbled. Use a real text tool or a graphic editor for readable words, and let Midjourney handle the rest of the picture.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** your first image is great for a phone wallpaper, a birthday card, or a custom avatar — small personal touches that feel one-of-a-kind without paying a designer's fee.
- **For your business or work:** a single Midjourney picture can become a blog header, a slide background, or a quick mockup for a client conversation. It's not a replacement for a designer on real projects, but it's a fast way to test an idea visually.
- **If you're just getting started:** the easiest first move is to re-run the same prompt with one word changed each time — *"watercolor"* becomes *"oil painting"* becomes *"pencil sketch"* — and watch how the style shifts while the subject stays the same.

Try it now

Take one minute and write down a single sentence describing a picture you actually want to see. Then open Midjourney, paste it into the prompt box, and hit Generate. By the time you finish reading this paragraph, your first image will probably be ready to look at.

How to Create AI Logos with Recraft V4.1 Vector

6 steps · Read online

> **In short:** Recraft describes a two-stage AI logo workflow — generate lots of concepts on a raster model first to explore ideas, then switch to Recraft V4.1 Vector for the final mark. The vector output is an SVG file that stays crisp from a 16-pixel browser tab icon to a printed sign.

Designing a logo used to mean either learning vector design software yourself or paying a designer. Today, AI tools like Recraft can sketch dozens of ideas in seconds. The catch is the file format: a regular image — a "raster" picture made of tiny colored squares called pixels — can look fuzzy when you blow it up or shrink it down. A vector file, built from mathematical lines instead of pixels, stays sharp at any size.

This guide walks through Recraft's two-stage approach: explore concepts as raster images first, then generate the final logo in Recraft V4.1 Vector. The final file is an SVG (Scalable Vector Graphics) you can use on a tiny favicon, a website header, or a printed sign without any blurriness.

Before you start

- A free Recraft account (sign up at recraft.ai with an email address or a Google account — check the site for the current plan options, since free and paid tiers exist)
- A recent web browser (Chrome, Firefox, Safari, or Edge)
- A rough idea of your brand: name, vibe, and one or two colors you like
- About 20–30 minutes for your first attempt

Step 1 — Sign in and start a new project

Open recraft.ai in your browser and sign in with the account you just made. Look for a button that says something like "New design" or "Create" — on most creative tools it sits near the top-left of the canvas. After you click it, a blank workspace opens. You'll see a text box where you type what you want and some style controls to the side. If your screen looks crowded instead of clean, look for a "Blank canvas" option in a menu — it's the simplest starting point.

💬 Example: type a one-line description like "warm coffee shop, hand-lettered feel, soft cream and forest green" into the prompt box.

You'll know it worked when the canvas is empty and your cursor is blinking in the prompt field, ready for instructions.

Step 2 — Generate a batch of concepts on a raster model

In the style controls (often a sidebar or a row of icons above the prompt box), pick the option that produces raster-style images — sometimes labeled "Raster," "Photo," or shown with a small photo icon rather than a vector-shape icon. Recraft describes starting with raster because it's fast and easy to compare many ideas side by side. Then describe your logo in plain words and click the button that generates results — it usually looks like a small arrow, a sparkle ✨, or the word "Generate." Expect to wait about 10–20 seconds.

💬 Example prompt: "minimalist logo for a yoga studio, lotus flower, calm pastel palette, no text in the image."

You'll know it worked when several image options appear on the canvas within half a minute. If nothing appears, look for a small "Retry" or "Generate again" link — sometimes the first attempt stalls.

Step 3 — Pick a direction and copy what works

Scroll through the generated options and click the one that feels closest to what you want. Most AI image tools let you "favorite" or "select" an image — look for a heart icon, a star, or a "Use this image" button when you hover over it. You're not done yet: this is just your starting point. Read the prompt you typed in Step 2 and tweak the words that mattered most — shape, mood, colors — so your next round focuses on what you liked. This is the part of Recraft's workflow where you "lock in" the direction.

💬 Example: if you loved the lotus shape but the colors felt too cold, change "calm pastel palette" to "warm peach and sand palette" before you continue.

You'll know it worked when you can point to the one image you want to keep, and you have a tighter prompt that names its strongest traits.

Step 4 — Switch to Recraft V4.1 Vector for the final mark

Now go back to the style controls and switch from the raster setting to the vector setting. Recraft describes V4.1 Vector as the model that returns a clean SVG instead of a pixel image. SVG is just a file format where shapes are stored as mathematical instructions — like a recipe for drawing a circle — rather than a fixed grid of colored dots. Look for a label like "Vector," "V4.1 Vector," or an icon that looks like geometric shapes rather than a photograph. Make sure your refined prompt is still in the text box, then generate again.

💬 Example: paste your tightened prompt from Step 3 — for instance, "minimalist lotus logo, warm peach and sand palette, simple shapes only, no text."

You'll know it worked when your result looks like a clean illustration with crisp edges — you can zoom in really close without it turning blurry — and the file is described somewhere in the

interface as an SVG.

Step 5 — Export the SVG and verify it at small sizes

Find the export or download control — usually an icon that looks like a downward arrow ⬇, a share icon, or a button labeled "Export" or "Download." If asked to choose a format, pick SVG (not PNG or JPG — those are raster formats that go soft when scaled). Save the file somewhere easy to find, like your Desktop. Then comes the honest test: open the SVG on your phone or in any image viewer and shrink it to about 16 pixels tall — that's the size of a browser tab favicon. If your logo still reads clearly at that size, it works. If the details turn to mush, you may need to simplify the design.

💬 Example: open the file in a browser tab, then zoom out until it looks tiny. If the lotus shape is still recognizable, you're good.

You'll know it worked when the same SVG file looks sharp both as a 16-pixel favicon and at the size of a website header — no blurriness at either end.

Step 6 — Save variations and name your files well

Before you call it done, generate one or two more versions with small tweaks — different colors, a simpler version, or one with your business name typed in. Most tools let you download each result separately. Give every file a clear name that describes what's inside — your future self will thank you when you have six SVGs on your desktop and can't tell them apart. A simple naming pattern works: `brandname-logo-style-color.svg`, something like `lotus-logo-minimal-peach.svg`.

💬 Example: `lotusyoga-logo-minimal-peach.svg`, `lotusyoga-logo-simple-mono.svg`, `lotusyoga-logo-with-text.svg`.

You'll know it worked when you can open any file two weeks from now and instantly know which version it is, without having to open them all.

Common mistakes

- **Skipping the raster stage and going straight for vector.** The vector model is great for the final mark, but it's slower to compare ideas. Generate lots of cheap raster options first, then commit to vector once you know what you want — that two-step rhythm is the whole point of Recraft's described workflow.
- **Exporting as PNG or JPG instead of SVG.** Raster files look fine on screen but turn blurry the moment you scale them up or shrink them down. Always pick SVG for the logo you plan to use everywhere.

- **Adding too much detail.** Tiny text, thin lines, and busy patterns can vanish when the logo is shrunk to favicon size. If your design falls apart at 16 pixels, simplify it — a strong logo usually has one or two clear shapes, not ten.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** you can finally make a logo for your side project, bakery, garage band, or dog-walking business without paying a designer or learning Illustrator. Twenty minutes of experimenting is enough for a first version you can actually use.
- **For your business or work:** a single SVG file travels anywhere — your website header, email signature, business card, social media profile, even the tiny favicon in the browser tab — and looks identical at every size. That means one design, no redesigns.
- **If you're just getting started:** don't aim for perfect on your first try. Generate a batch, pick the one that makes you smile, then refine it. AI logo tools reward quick iteration, not overthinking.

Try it now

Open recraft.ai, type "friendly minimalist logo for a [your project name], [two colors you like]" into the prompt box, and generate a raster batch. Spend five minutes just looking at the results and noticing which shapes and colors pull you in — that's your style direction, and you'll use it as the seed for your vector version.

How to Create Custom Images with Copilot for Invites and Social Posts

6 steps · Read online

> **In short:** Copilot can turn a plain sentence into a custom image you can use on invitations, Instagram, or a personal vision board. Sign in with a Microsoft account, open the Designer tool, describe what you want in plain words, and download what comes out.

You don't need Photoshop, Canva, or any design background to get a one-of-a-kind picture for your next event, post, or vision board. Copilot's built-in image generator — Microsoft Designer — takes a sentence from you and turns it into a finished image in roughly 30 seconds. This walkthrough shows the whole flow, including what to write so the picture actually comes out the way you imagined.

Before you start

- A **free Microsoft account** (the same one you use for Outlook, OneDrive, or Xbox). If you don't have one, signing up takes about two minutes.
- A **browser** (Chrome, Edge, Safari, or Firefox) or the **Copilot mobile app**. Either works.
- Roughly **10–15 minutes** for your first picture — faster once you've done it a few times.
- The image generator is free to use, but the free plan has a **daily limit** on how many images you can create. If you want a lot more images or faster generation, look into the paid **Microsoft Copilot Pro** plan on Microsoft's official pricing page for the current rate.

Step 1 — Open Copilot and switch to image mode

Go to **copilot.microsoft.com** in your browser, or open the Copilot app on your phone. Sign in with your Microsoft account if you aren't already. Look for a chat box near the bottom of the screen that says something like **"Ask me anything..."** — and right next to it, find a small **image or picture icon** 🖼️, or a toggle labeled **"Designer"** or **"Create an image."** Tap or click that option. The chat box changes to invite an image description instead of a question, and a small note about Microsoft's content policy may pop up the first time. 💬 Example: don't type anything yet — just make sure you can see the image-creation prompt box. You'll know it worked when the chat box now asks you to **describe an image** instead of asking a question.

Step 2 — Describe the picture you actually want

Click inside the new prompt box and write a sentence or two describing your image. Be specific: include the **subject**, the **style** (watercolor, photo-realistic, cartoon, flat design), the **mood** (cheerful, calm, dreamy), and the **colors** if they matter. The more detail you give, the closer the

result matches what you imagined. If your screen looks different, look for a separate **"Designer" link** in the top menu, or a button labeled something like **"Image creator"** — Microsoft moves these around as they update the site. Example: "A watercolor birthday invitation background with soft pink peonies, gold confetti, and the words 'Emma turns 30' written in elegant script at the top." You'll know it worked when you hit Enter and Copilot starts **generating four different versions** of your image — this usually takes 15–30 seconds.

Step 3 — Review the four versions and pick your favorite

When the images finish loading, you'll see a grid of **four square images**, all based on your description. Don't rush — open each one in full size by clicking it, and check the small details that matter for your project: is the text readable, are the colors right, does the mood fit the occasion? If none of them are quite right, you don't need to start over — go back to the prompt box and describe what you'd change. Copilot can run another round based on your new description. Example: "Same image but make the peonies larger, and put the text 'Emma turns 30 — Saturday June 14' in the center." You'll know it worked when at least one of the new four images is **close enough to use**, or when you've nailed down exactly which change to ask for next.

Step 4 — Polish the prompt if the text in the image looks wrong

Here's an honest limitation: image generators — Copilot included — are **still hit-or-miss at writing words inside pictures**. Names, dates, and quotes can come out misspelled, scrambled, or warped. If your invite or vision board needs accurate text (like a name or a date), the safest workflow is to **leave the text out of the prompt entirely**, then add it yourself later in a free tool like Canva, PowerPoint, or even your phone's photo editor. This is one extra step, but it guarantees your text actually says what it should. Example: for the invite, ask for "A watercolor birthday invitation background with soft pink peonies and gold confetti, no text." Then you add "Emma turns 30 — Saturday June 14" yourself. You'll know it worked when you have a beautiful background image **without any text problems to fix**.

Step 5 — Download the image you want to use

Hover your cursor over the image you like best. A small toolbar appears underneath — look for a **download icon** (a downward arrow into a tray) or a button labeled **"Download"**. Click it once. Your browser saves the image to your normal Downloads folder, usually as a PNG or JPG file. On the phone app, the download button might say **"Save"** or look like a square with an arrow — if you can't find it, take a screenshot instead, which works on every phone. Example: click the **Download** button below your favorite peony image and wait for the file to appear in your Downloads folder. You'll know it worked when you can open the file on your computer or phone and see the finished picture, ready to drop into your design.

Step 6 — Drop the picture into your project

Open whichever tool you normally use — Canva, PowerPoint, Google Slides, Instagram, your phone's photo editor — and **import or insert** the image you just downloaded. Resize it to fit your canvas: square (1:1) for Instagram, portrait (9:16) for stories, landscape (16:9) for invitations printed on letter-size paper. If you want a different shape than the square Copilot gave you, you can either crop with the same tools or describe a different aspect ratio in Step 2 next time (some Copilot versions accept hints like "wide landscape format" or "tall poster format"). Example: in Canva, click **"Uploads"**, drag in your downloaded peony image, drop it onto a square Instagram template, and add the text "Emma turns 30 — details in bio" on top. You'll know it worked when your finished design **looks unique to you** and is ready to send, post, or print.

Common mistakes

- **Asking for text inside the image.** Image generators often misspell names and dates. Strip the text out of the prompt and add it yourself in Canva or your editor — it'll be sharper and faster.
- **Vague prompts.** "A nice background" gives you something generic. **"Watercolor peonies, pink and gold, birthday mood, square"** gives you something usable.
- **Stopping after the first round.** The first four images are a starting point, not the finish line. If they're close, ask for one specific change. The second round is usually the keeper.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** the next birthday invite, save-the-date, or holiday card can be made in the time it takes to brew coffee — no software to install, no design skills needed.
- **For your business or work:** social posts, internal event flyers, or vision-board slides for team workshops can be created on the fly. If you batch three or four prompts in one sitting, you have a week's worth of visuals before lunch.
- **If you're just getting started:** open Copilot today and try the birthday invite example from Step 2. Once you've made one, every future prompt is easier.

Try it now

Open **copilot.microsoft.com**, switch to image mode, and type: *"A dreamy watercolor vision board image with a calm beach at sunrise, a notebook, a cup of coffee, and soft pastel colors, no text."* Save the result you like best. That's your first custom picture — made in under five minutes.

Use Gemini on Your Phone to Pull Editable Text from Any Photo or Screenshot

5 steps · Read online

> **In short:** Open the free Gemini app, snap or attach a photo of a sign, page, or screenshot, and ask Gemini to lift the words out as copyable text. You'll need a Google account, the app on Android or iOS, and about three minutes.

You're standing in a parking lot staring at a faded sign with the rates, or you saved a screenshot of a recipe and now you want the ingredients in a real list. Gemini (Google's AI assistant app) can read the image for you and hand back the text — searchable, editable, ready to paste anywhere. This guide shows the exact taps on both Android and iPhone.

Before you start

- A Google account (the same one you might use for Gmail or YouTube). Sign-up is free if you do not have one.
- The **Gemini** app installed on your phone. Free on Android (via the Play Store) and iPhone (via the App Store). On many Android phones Gemini replaces the Google Assistant — if so, you already have it.
- A photo ready: either saved in your gallery (a screenshot, a receipt) or something you can point your camera at (a sign, a page in a book).
- Roughly **3 minutes** for the first run; faster once you know the flow.
- Honest note: on the free plan, Gemini handles a generous number of image chats per day. If you hit a limit, it will tell you, and the same feature is included in the paid plan if you ever upgrade.

Step 1 — Open Gemini and start a fresh chat

Tap the **Gemini app icon** on your home screen — a four-pointed star with pink, purple, and blue edges. The first screen is a chat page with a text box at the bottom and a few suggested prompts above it. If a previous conversation is still open, look for a small **"+"** or **pencil icon** near the text box and tap it to start fresh. If you can't see those, just force-quit the app and reopen it — a new chat loads automatically.

💬 Example: nothing to type yet — this step is just opening the app.

You'll know it worked when you see a blank chat with a blinking cursor in the text box at the bottom of the screen.

Step 2 — Add your photo (camera or gallery)

Tap the **camera icon** 📷 (or a small **picture/landscape icon** 🖼 — different phones place it slightly differently). A small menu appears offering **"Camera"** and **"Photos"** or **"Gallery"**. Pick **Camera** if you're pointing at a live sign or page; pick **Photos** if the image is already in your phone (a screenshot, a downloaded PDF page, a screenshot of a recipe). Allow camera and photo permissions the first time the app asks — the prompt only shows once. Take the photo or tap the one you want, then confirm by tapping **"Add"** or **"Use photo"**.

If your version of the app doesn't show this menu, look for a **"+"** button next to the text box and pick **Image** from the popup.

💬 Example: no text needed yet, just pick the image.

You'll know it worked when a small thumbnail of your photo appears just above the text box, and the text box is still empty waiting for your instruction.

Step 3 — Tell Gemini what to do with the image

Tap the text box and type a short instruction — or skip typing entirely by tapping the **microphone icon** 🎤 and speaking. The photo stays attached; your instruction goes below it. Gemini reads the image (the technical word is **multimodal** — meaning it can understand both pictures and words in the same chat) and replies with the text it found.

Be specific. A vague "what does this say?" works, but a clearer request gives a better answer. If the photo has a lot of clutter around the text, ask Gemini to skip the extras.

💬 Example: "Pull out all the text from this photo, line by line, exactly as written." — or — "Read the recipe in this image and list just the ingredients."

You'll know it worked when Gemini replies with the words from your photo written out as normal text (not a description like "this is an image of..."). If it gives a description instead, your prompt was too vague — rephrase with the exact wording you want.

Step 4 — Copy the text out so you can use it

Look at Gemini's reply. Long-press on the text (press and hold with your finger for about a second) until a highlight bar appears with options like **Copy**, **Select all**, and **Share**. Tap **Copy**, and the text is now on your phone's clipboard — invisible, but ready to paste. Open Notes, Messages, your email app, or Google Docs, tap into a text field, and tap **Paste**. The words from the photo appear in your new app, perfectly editable.

If long-press doesn't show a menu, look for a tiny **"Copy"** button or a ⋯ **(three-dot)** icon at the bottom-right corner of Gemini's reply message — both Android and iOS sometimes tuck the option there.

💬 Example: paste it into Notes and you'll have a searchable copy of that faded parking sign — no more squinting at the photo.

You'll know it worked when you can paste the text into another app and the words are correct, spelled the way they were in the original image.

Step 5 — Try a quick follow-up (translate, shorten, save)

This is where it gets useful. Stay in the same chat — Gemini remembers the photo, so you don't have to attach it again. Type a new instruction and Gemini builds on the text it already pulled. Common follow-ups: translate to another language, shorten into bullet points, rewrite in simpler words, or turn it into a checklist. When the answer is what you want, tap the **share icon** on Gemini's reply to send it to another app, or long-press and copy it the same way you did in Step 4.

If the free plan ever tells you you've hit a limit for the day, the same flow keeps working on a paid plan — check Google's official pricing page for the current plan names and details.

💬 Example: "Now translate that to Spanish." — or — "Shorten this list to the five most important points." — or — "Turn these ingredients into a grocery checklist with quantities."

You'll know it worked when Gemini's next reply is the translated, shortened, or reformatted version of the same text — proof that it's using the original photo as context, not starting over.

Common mistakes

- **Asking too vaguely.** "What does this say?" sometimes gets you a description of the image instead of the text. Always include the word *text*, *words*, or *list* and tell Gemini what to do with them.
- **Forgetting to allow camera or photo permissions.** If tapping the camera icon does nothing, open your phone's Settings, find Gemini, and switch both **Camera** and **Photos** permissions on, then try again.
- **Trying it on handwriting that's too messy.** Printed text works very well. Cursive handwriting is hit-or-miss — if Gemini misses letters, snap a flatter, more even-lit photo and try once more, or just type the few unclear words yourself.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** Snap a photo of a recipe card, a Wi-Fi password sticker, a museum placard, or a friend's handwritten note and turn it into text you can search, save, or share. No more typing things out by hand from a photo.

- **For your business or work:** Photograph a whiteboard after a meeting, a printed receipt, a page from a contract, or a business card at a conference and pull the text straight into an email, spreadsheet, or note. It saves a surprising amount of retyping.
- **If you're just getting started:** The easiest first move is one screenshot you already have — a recipe, an address, a quote. Attach it, ask for the text, and copy it somewhere useful. After that one try, every future photo is the same three taps.

Try it now

Open Gemini, attach any photo already in your phone's gallery — a screenshot, a receipt, a sign you snapped yesterday — and type: "Pull out all the text from this photo exactly as written." Copy the reply into your Notes app. That's the whole trick, and it's the same trick you'll use tomorrow.

Move Midjourney images into a Canva design without losing quality

5 steps · Read online

> **In short:** You can place a Midjourney image into a Canva design and keep it sharp by saving the largest version you can download, sizing your Canva page first, and typing all text in Canva instead of asking Midjourney to draw it. Nothing can make a small image sharper after the fact.

Midjourney is excellent at making pictures, but it is less reliable at writing clear words inside them, and a picture that looks crisp on your screen can turn soft once it's stretched across a slide or a post. Canva is where you add layout and text. This guide shows you how to bring the two together so your final design looks clean. It's written for people who already make images in Midjourney and have used Canva a little.

Before you start

- A Midjourney account with at least one finished image you want to use. Midjourney generally requires a paid plan, so check the official pricing page if you're not sure what you have.
- A free or paid Canva account, opened in a web browser or the Canva app.
- A computer is easiest for this workflow, since you'll be watching file sizes and zoom levels.
- Plan about 20 minutes for your first run.

Step 1 — Download the largest version of your image

Open the image you want in Midjourney. Look for a download icon (often a small arrow pointing down) or a **Download** option in a menu. If you don't see it, check the **three-dot menu** on the image, since layouts change. If you see an **Upscale** button on the image, consider using it first, because a larger version gives you more room to crop and resize without blur. Save the file to a folder you'll remember, and keep its original name.

Upscaling may depend on your plan or on which version of the tool you're using, so if the button isn't there, use the image as it is.

You'll know it worked when the file lands in your Downloads folder (or wherever your browser saves files) and it opens as a picture on your computer.

Step 2 — Create a Canva design at the exact size you need

Sign in to Canva and start a new design. Look for a **Custom size** or **Create a design** option, and enter the width and height in pixels. For a square social post, a common size is 1080 by 1080

pixels. For a widescreen slide, 1920 by 1080 is a standard choice. Setting the size first means you won't have to stretch the picture later, and stretching is the main cause of mushy images.

If you can't find a custom size option, search the template library for your platform and open a blank template from there. It will still give you a fixed page size.

Example: "Create a square social post, 1080 by 1080 pixels, with a bold headline for [your business name]." (Use this as a reminder for your own page setup; you don't type it into Canva.)

You'll know it worked when your blank page appears with the dimensions shown near the top of the screen.

Step 3 — Upload the image and place it without stretching

Find the **Uploads** area in the left-hand side panel. It may be labeled **Uploads**, **Upload files**, or represented by an upward arrow. Choose your Midjourney file, or drag it onto the page. Once it appears on the page, click it and drag one of the **corner handles** inward or outward. Hold the **Shift** key while you drag, which keeps the width and height in proportion so the image doesn't look squashed.

Fill the page with the image, or cover part of it and leave space for text. If the image looks blurry at this point, it's usually because the source file was small, so go back and try a larger download.

Example prompt for Midjourney (type this before you download): "A quiet lighthouse on a rocky cliff at sunrise, [your chosen style], soft light, with open empty sky on the left for a headline, no text in the image."

You'll know it worked when the image fills the space you planned, edges look straight, and nothing is distorted.

Step 4 — Add all text as Canva text, not inside the picture

Click **Text** in the left panel and choose a heading style or a plain text box. Type your words directly onto the page, then move the box over the open space in your image. Keep the font size large enough that it reads well on a phone. Midjourney often writes letters that look almost right but have small errors, and enlarging those letters makes the errors more obvious. Canva text stays crisp at any size because it's drawn fresh, not stretched.

If your text lands on a busy part of the picture, try the **color** setting for the text or add a simple shape behind it so the words stand out.

Example: "Spring sale: [your offer] this weekend only" (type this into a Canva text box, not into Midjourney).

You'll know it worked when your words are sharp when you zoom in and the text is easy to read against the background.

Step 5 — Download with the right file type and check it at full size

Click the **Share** button in the top-right corner, then choose **Download**. A file-type menu usually appears. For social posts and screens, choose **PNG**, which keeps edges clean. For printing, look for **PDF Print**. Some file types or quality options may be limited on the free plan, so check the menu. Once downloaded, open the file and zoom to 100 percent. Look at the edges of the image and the letters. If anything looks soft, go back to Step 1 and check which size of image you downloaded.

You'll know it worked when the finished file looks sharp at 100 percent zoom and your text has clean edges.

Common mistakes

- **Stretching the picture to fill the page.** This blurs edges and warps shapes. Fix it by setting the page size first (Step 2) and resizing with the corner handles while holding Shift.
- **Asking Midjourney to draw your headline.** Text inside generated images is often misspelled or fuzzy. Fix it by typing all words in Canva (Step 4) and telling Midjourney to leave empty space instead.
- **Downloading a tiny preview.** A small file can't be made sharp later. Fix it by using the largest version you can download and checking the file opens clearly before you start designing.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** Make a birthday card, a family photo album cover, or a recipe card with a generated picture and your own handwritten-style text, all sharp enough to print at home.
- **For your business or work:** Create social posts and presentation slides where the picture is generated in Midjourney and the headlines, prices, and logos are placed in Canva, so your words are always accurate and readable.
- **If you want to go further:** Build a reusable Canva template with your favorite page size and text styles, then drop in a new Midjourney image each time you need a new post. Canva's own help pages describe how to save templates; look for a **Save as template** or similar option in the menu.

Try it now

Pick one Midjourney image you already like, download it, and place it into a new Canva page sized 1080 by 1080 pixels. Type one short headline in a Canva text box, export it as a PNG, and open it at 100 percent zoom. You'll see the difference between a crisp image and a blurry one in about two minutes.

How to Turn a Messy Photo of Handwritten Notes Into Clean, Editable Text

5 steps · Read online

> **In short:** Upload a photo of handwritten notes to an AI assistant that accepts images, ask for a word-for-word transcription, then refine it in follow-up messages. Check the result against the photo, because handwriting can be misread.

By the end of this guide, you'll be able to take a photo of a scribbled to-do list or meeting notes and get back text you can copy, edit and share. This is for anyone who has ever struggled to read their own handwriting a day later.

Before you start

- An account with an AI assistant that accepts **image uploads**, such as ChatGPT, Gemini or Claude. The free level may allow photos, but limits change, so check the app's help page if you hit one.
- A phone or computer with a camera or saved photos.
- Good light and a flat page. Roughly 15 minutes in total.
- We assume you already know how to start a new chat and send a message.

Step 1 — Photograph the page so it can be read

Place the paper on a table near a window or lamp, and hold your phone directly above it so the camera points straight down. Tap the camera button in your phone's camera app and take one sharp photo. Avoid shadows across the writing and keep your fingers off the lens. When you open the photo, you should be able to read every line without squinting. If the image looks tilted or blurry, retake it, because the AI works from what it can see. If you're photographing one page of a larger notebook, shoot each page separately rather than the whole spread.

💬 Example: No typing yet. Just make sure your photo shows the whole page with all the handwriting visible.

You'll know it worked when the photo is clear enough that you could read it yourself on a small screen.

Step 2 — Upload the photo into a new chat

Open a new chat with your AI assistant. Look for a paperclip, a plus sign (+) or an image icon next to the message box. Tap it, choose "photo" or "upload" if asked, and select the picture you just took. A small thumbnail of the photo should appear above or beside your message box. Then type your request in the box, and send it. Usually the assistant reads the image first and then

replies, sometimes after a few seconds. If you don't see an attachment icon, look for a menu with three dots or a "Add" option near the box, since the layout differs between phones and computers.

💬 Example: "Here is a photo of my handwritten notes. Transcribe every line exactly as written, keep the line breaks, and put a question mark in parentheses next to any word you cannot read."

You'll know it worked when the thumbnail is attached before you send, and the reply contains lines of text that match your notes.

Step 3 — Check the transcription against the photo

Compare the reply with your photo line by line. Handwriting is the main weak spot: a "7" can look like a "1", and a word written in a hurry may be guessed. Any word marked with a question mark is a spot to fix yourself. Copy the reply into your own notes app for now, and correct mistakes by hand. If many lines are wrong, don't argue with the chat. Instead, send a new message saying which line is off and what the correct word is, for example "Line 3 says 'call Dan' but it reads 'call Dave'." The assistant will usually fix that line and keep the rest.

💬 Example: "Line 4 should read 'pick up dry cleaning on Thursday', not 'pick up dry cleaning on Tuesday'. Please fix that and keep everything else the same."

You'll know it worked when the text matches your photo except for the lines you deliberately corrected.

Step 4 — Build on the transcription with a follow-up request

This is where the assistant becomes more useful than a simple copy tool. Because the chat remembers the earlier reply, you can ask it to reshape the text without uploading the photo again. Ask for a checklist, a summary, or a list sorted by category. Keep your request specific, because vague ones produce vague results. Review the new output the same way you reviewed the transcription, since the assistant may move an item to the wrong group or invent a due time that was never written down.

💬 Example: "Using the corrected text above, turn it into a checklist grouped by [home tasks] and [work tasks]. Put anything with a day or time written next to it at the top of its group."

You'll know it worked when each item from your notes appears once, under a sensible heading, with no new items added.

Step 5 — Save your instructions as a reusable template

If you do this every week, retyping instructions wastes time. Write your best prompt once in a notes app, then copy and paste it into a new chat with each new photo. Keep the parts that stay the same, and leave clear blanks for the parts that change, such as the type of notes. Your template is just your own text in a document, so it works with any assistant that accepts photos. Test it on one page first, and adjust it if the results don't match what you want.

💬 Example: "Transcribe this photo of handwritten [meeting or to-do] notes exactly as written. Mark unclear words with a question mark in parentheses. Then list action items, with a name next to each one if a name appears."

You'll know it worked when pasting the template into a new chat with a new photo produces a useful result without any extra explaining.

Common mistakes

- **Trusting the first transcription.** Handwriting is easy to misread, especially names, numbers and dates. Fix the fix: compare each line with the photo before you rely on it.
- **Uploading a blurry or angled photo.** The assistant can only work from what it sees. Fix it: retake the photo in good light, held directly above the page.
- **Asking for too much in one message.** A long request with five jobs often gets a messy answer. Fix it: send one clear request at a time, and use follow-up messages to refine.

The assistant also can't check your handwriting against the real world. It can't know what you meant to write, and it can't confirm a deadline or a phone number is correct. Treat its output as a draft.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** Turn a grocery list or a recipe you scribbled on the back of an envelope into a neat list on your phone.
- **For your business or work:** Photograph a whiteboard or paper meeting notes, then ask for action items grouped by owner.
- **If you want to go further:** Build a short template for each kind of note you take, such as a meeting, a school lesson or a recipe, and keep them in one notes document.

Try it now

Pick the most recent page of handwriting you have, take one photo in good light, and upload it to a new chat with this request: "Transcribe every line exactly as written and mark unclear words with a question mark in parentheses." Compare the result with your page, and you're done.

Learning & getting started

Build a simple weekly study plan with Meta AI in 10 minutes

7 steps · Read online

Imagine opening your calendar on Sunday night and seeing every exam, quiz and assignment laid out in color-coded blocks. You'll know exactly what to study each day and when to take breaks. Meta AI can build that plan for you in under ten minutes, even if you're starting from scratch.

Before you start

- A phone, tablet or computer with the **Meta AI app** (iOS/Android) or **Meta website** open in a browser.
- A free **Meta account** (sign-up takes 2 minutes).
- Your exam dates, quiz dates and assignment deadlines written down or in your calendar.
- Roughly **10 minutes** of quiet time.

Step 1 — Open Meta AI and start a fresh chat

Open the **Meta AI app** on your phone or go to meta.ai in any browser. On the home screen you'll see a search bar and a list of recent chats. Tap the **plus icon** (a circle with a pencil inside) or the "New chat" button to begin a fresh conversation. A blank chat screen appears with a blinking cursor ready for your first message.

You'll know it worked when you see a clean chat window and the prompt "Ask Meta AI anything…" at the bottom.

💬 Example: *Just open the app or website.*

Step 2 — Tell Meta AI your courses and dates

In the chat box, type a clear message that lists each course, its exam date, any quizzes, and assignment deadlines. Use simple bullet points so the AI can read them easily.

For example: "Here are my courses and dates:

- Math exam 15 June
- History essay due 20 June
- Chemistry quiz 12 June
- English speech 25 June"

After you press send, Meta AI will reply with a short summary confirming it understood everything.

You'll know it worked when you see a reply that repeats your courses and dates back to you.

💬 Example: *Math exam 15 June, History essay due 20 June, Chemistry quiz 12 June, English speech 25 June*

Step 3 — Ask for a weekly study plan

On the same chat line, type: "Create a 7-day study plan that spreads the work evenly and includes short breaks."

Meta AI will reply with a color-coded weekly calendar. Each day shows which topics to study and when to take 10-minute breaks. If the reply feels too long, ask for a shorter version by typing "Make it more compact."

You'll know it worked when you see a calendar with dates, study blocks, and break reminders.

💬 Example: *Create a 7-day study plan that spreads the work evenly and includes short breaks.*

Step 4 — Adjust the plan to fit your life

Look at the plan Meta AI gave you. If an evening block feels too late, reply: "Move the Math block to 4 pm each day instead."

If you already have a part-time job on Wednesdays, say: "Remove Wednesday evening and shift those hours to Thursday morning."

Meta AI will update the calendar instantly. If the button you expect isn't there, look for a small "Edit" or "Regenerate" link near the plan.

You'll know it worked when the calendar updates and the new times appear.

💬 Example: *Move the Math block to 4 pm each day instead.*

Step 5 — Ask for topic breakdowns

Pick one course from the plan and ask Meta AI to break it into smaller topics. For example: "For Math, list the exact chapters and topics I should study each day."

Meta AI will reply with a detailed checklist. If the list feels overwhelming, ask for “only the top three topics per day.” If you prefer flashcards, say “turn the list into flashcard questions.”

You’ll know it worked when you see a clear checklist or flashcard list for that day.

Example: *For Math, list the exact chapters and topics I should study each day.*

Step 6 — Save or export the plan

At the bottom of the chat, look for a small **share icon** (an arrow pointing up or three connected dots). Tap it and choose “Copy” to save the plan to your phone’s notes or “Save as image” to add it to your calendar app. If you don’t see the icon, look for a menu with “Export” or “Share.”

You’ll know it worked when you can paste the plan into another app or save it as an image.

Example: *Tap the share icon and choose “Copy.”*

Step 7 — Set phone reminders

Open your phone’s calendar or reminder app and paste the copied plan into tomorrow’s events. Set each study block as a calendar event with a 10-minute alert. If you prefer voice reminders, ask Meta AI to “turn the plan into voice reminders” and follow the link it provides.

You’ll know it worked when tomorrow’s events appear in your calendar with study blocks and alerts.

Example: *Paste the plan into tomorrow’s calendar events.*

Common mistakes

- **Too vague a prompt:** Writing “Plan my study” gives a messy reply. Fix: list your courses and dates clearly.
- **Ignoring breaks:** Meta AI may pack blocks too tightly. Fix: reply “add a 10-minute break every 50 minutes.”
- **Not editing:** The first plan might clash with your job or sport. Fix: ask Meta AI to shift or remove blocks until it fits.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** Use this plan to stay on track without last-minute cramming. You’ll finish each day knowing exactly what you accomplished.

- **For your business or work:** The same technique works for project deadlines and client deliverables—just swap “exam” for “milestone.”
- **If you're just getting started:** Start with one small course and build the habit of reviewing the plan each morning.

Try it now

Open Meta AI, paste your courses and dates, and ask for a weekly study plan. You’ll have a color-coded calendar in under two minutes.

How to Translate and Understand Other Languages with AI

6 steps · Read online

By the end of this guide, you'll be able to turn any piece of foreign text—whether a quick chat, a restaurant menu, or a PDF report—into clear English (or your preferred language) with an AI tool. You'll also learn how to keep the meaning intact, ensuring your translations are accurate and natural-sounding. This guide is for anyone who's never used artificial intelligence for translation before.

Before you start

- **An internet-connected device:** This could be a mobile phone, tablet, or computer.
- **A free account on an AI chat platform:** You'll need access to a text-generating AI like ChatGPT, Claude, or Gemini. The steps in this guide work similarly across these tools.
- **A piece of text to translate:** Have the foreign text ready to copy-paste, or displayed on your screen so you can type it out.
- **Time commitment:** This guide takes about 5-10 minutes to follow along for the first time.

Step 1 — Open your AI chat tool

First, open the website or app for your chosen AI chat platform. This is the place where you usually "talk" to the AI, typing messages and receiving replies. Once it's loaded, you'll typically see your past conversations on one side and a main chat area. To start fresh, look for a button that says **"New chat"** or a simple **plus-icon (+)**. Tapping or clicking this will clear your screen.

What you see: A blank main chat area, often with a message box at the bottom ready for your input. **What happens next:** The AI prepares a clean, new conversation thread, meaning it won't be influenced by any previous topics you've discussed. **If it looks different:** On a mobile app, the "New chat" button might be in a corner or accessible through a menu icon (three horizontal lines). On a computer, it's often in a sidebar on the left. **Example:** Click the "New chat" button. **You'll know it worked when** you see a blank message box and no previous conversation messages are visible.

Step 2 — Ask the AI to translate, adding context

In the blank message box, type a clear instruction (this is called a **prompt** – it's the specific request you give the AI) telling the AI what you need. After your instruction, paste the foreign text you want to translate. Adding details like "keep the tone friendly" or "preserve the formal style" is crucial because it tells the AI not just *what* to translate, but *how* to translate it, helping it retain the original meaning and feel.

What you see: The cursor blinking in the message box, waiting for your input. **What happens next:** As soon as you hit Enter or click the "Send" button, the AI will begin processing your prompt and generating its translation. **If it looks different:** The "Send" button might be an arrow icon, a paper airplane symbol, or simply the Enter key on your keyboard.
Example:

```
Please translate the following Italian text into English and keep a relaxed,
conversational tone:

Ciao! Come stai? Spero che la giornata vada bene. Ci vediamo stasera?
```

You'll know it worked when the AI starts typing its translated response below your message, usually appearing word by word.

Step 3 — Review the AI's initial translation

Once the AI finishes typing, carefully read the translation it provides. While AI is very good, it can sometimes miss **nuance** – subtle differences in meaning, tone, or style that depend on the specific situation or culture. Scan for any words or phrases that seem a little off, don't quite make sense, or don't match the tone you expected. Don't worry if it's not perfect yet; the next step will fix it.

What you see: The AI's full translated text displayed on your screen. **What happens next:** You mentally compare the AI's output with your understanding of the original text, looking for any potential improvements. **If it looks different:** The AI might offer multiple versions, or ask a clarifying question. If it does, read its question and answer it in the message box.
Example: If the AI translated "Ciao! Come stai?" as "Hello! How are you?" **You'll know it worked when** you have identified any parts of the translation that might need further adjustment, based on your original instruction or intent.

Step 4 — Refine the translation with specific feedback

If something in the initial translation didn't quite hit the mark, don't just accept it. Reply to the AI in the same conversation, giving it clear, specific feedback. You can highlight a particular word, ask for a different tone, or even provide additional context that the AI didn't have before. This helps the AI learn and give you a more accurate and contextually appropriate translation.

What you see: The previous AI translation and a new blank message box below it. **What happens next:** The AI will use your feedback to revise its previous answer, often providing a much better translation that addresses your specific concerns. **If it looks different:** The AI

might offer an explanation for its initial choice before providing a revised version. **Example:** Following on from the previous step, you might type:

```
Could you make the greeting even more casual, like "Hey there! How's it going?" for
"Ciao! Come stai?" And ensure the entire message keeps that very relaxed feel.
```

You'll know it worked when the AI provides a new version that makes more sense, sounds more natural, or perfectly matches the tone you intended.

Step 5 — Translate longer documents using “chunking”

For larger documents like multi-page PDFs or long articles, consider breaking the text into smaller sections rather than pasting everything at once. This method is called **"chunking"**. Modern AI tools can handle much larger texts than before (many support tens of thousands of words in a single message), but chunking still helps maintain accuracy, especially for complex or technical texts, and makes it easier to review each section.

What you see: Your larger document open on one side of your screen, ready for you to select and copy text. **What happens next:** You copy a manageable section of text, then repeat steps 2-4 for each "chunk," ensuring each part is translated and refined before moving to the next. **If it looks different:** The exact method for copying large text varies by program; you might need to drag your mouse, use keyboard shortcuts (Ctrl+A then Ctrl+C on Windows, Cmd+A then Cmd+C on Mac), or use a "Select All" option. **Example:**

```
Translate the following section of a legal document into plain English, maintaining a
formal and precise tone, without using any legal jargon where a simpler term will
suffice:

[Paste the first few paragraphs of your legal document here]
```

You'll know it worked when the AI successfully translates that section without error or truncation, providing a complete response to that specific chunk.

Step 6 — Save your translated text in a useful format

Once you're satisfied with a translated section (or the entire document, if you were chunking), select the AI's answer and copy it. Then, open a document program on your device (like Microsoft Word, Google Docs, Apple Pages, or even a simple Notepad application) and paste the text there. Remember to save your new document with a clear, descriptive name so you can easily find it later.

What you see: The AI's translated text highlighted on your screen, ready to be copied. **What happens next:** The text is stored in your device's clipboard, ready to be pasted into another application. **If it looks different:** Most AI tools have a "Copy" icon next to their response, or you can highlight the text and right-click to choose "Copy" (or use keyboard shortcuts: Ctrl+C on Windows/Linux, Cmd+C on Mac). **Example:** Highlight the AI's translation, press **Ctrl + C** (or **Cmd + C** on Mac), open a new Google Doc, and press **Ctrl + V** (or **Cmd + V** on Mac) to paste. **You'll know it worked when** you see the translated text appear in your chosen document program, ready for you to save.

Common mistakes

- **Forgetting to add context:** Simply asking "Translate this" without specifying the tone or purpose can lead to a translation that feels inappropriate or robotic.
    - **Fix:** Always include a phrase like "keep a friendly tone," "translate for a business email," or "explain in simple terms for a beginner."
- **Pasting too much text at once:** While modern AI tools have large capacity, trying to translate an entire book in one go can sometimes result in the AI missing details or giving incomplete answers.
    - **Fix:** For very long texts, consider breaking them into smaller sections and translate them one by one, keeping them in the same chat conversation to maintain context.
- **Accepting the first translation blindly:** Even advanced AI can misinterpret something, especially if the original text is highly specialized or uses slang.
    - **Fix:** Always read through the AI's translation and, if anything feels off, ask the AI to rephrase or clarify it with more specific instructions.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** You can instantly understand a foreign menu, decode a message from a friend overseas, or get the gist of a news article in another language. No more guessing what "Risotto ai funghi" means!
- **For your business or work:** You can quickly translate client emails, understand product specifications, or review documents from international partners, saving you time and potentially avoiding the need for a professional translator for initial drafts.
- **If you're just getting started:** The easiest first step is to open your AI chat, paste a short sentence in another language (like "Hola, ¿cómo estás?"), and ask for a simple translation into English. You'll see the AI do the heavy lifting in seconds.

Try it now

Take a piece of foreign text you have handy—maybe a label on a food item, a line from a song, or a snippet from an article online. Open your preferred AI chat tool, type the prompt "Please

translate the following into English and keep it casual:" and then paste your text. Hit send, and watch the AI instantly provide its translation!

Use ChatGPT to Practice a Foreign Language Without Feeling Awkward

6 steps · Read online

> **In short:** ChatGPT can become a patient conversation partner for almost any language — it speaks at your level, corrects you kindly, and never gets bored. You'll need a free ChatGPT account and the app or website; you'll learn the most by speaking out loud.

Practicing a new language in front of another human can feel awkward — especially when you're worried about sounding silly. A chatbot removes that pressure. There's no raised eyebrow when you mix up "ser" and "estar," and you can ask the same question five different ways without feeling like you're wasting anyone's time. This guide walks you through setting up a calm, private practice session you can repeat whenever you have a few spare minutes.

Before you start

- **A free ChatGPT account** is enough to begin. Voice practice and longer conversations may need a paid plan — if a feature asks you to upgrade, that's the moment to know.
- **The ChatGPT app on your phone** is the easiest way to talk out loud. The website on a laptop also works, especially if you'd rather type.
- **The language you want to practice.** If you only have a vague idea ("maybe Spanish"), that's fine too — pick something specific in Step 1.
- **Headphones with a microphone**, if you're in a shared space and don't want others to hear you practicing.
- **Roughly 15 minutes** for the first setup. After that, every practice session takes as little as five minutes.

Step 1 — Open a new chat and name it for the language

Open the **ChatGPT app** on your phone, or visit chatgpt.com on a browser, and tap the **"New chat"** button. On the phone app this is usually a pencil-and-paper icon at the top-right; on the website it's a button at the top-left. A blank conversation opens with a message box at the bottom that says "Ask anything" or "Message ChatGPT". Now rename the chat so you can find it again later. Tap the **chat title at the very top of the screen** — it usually shows today's date by default — and a small text field appears. Type your chosen name and tap **Done**, **Save**, or the checkmark to confirm. If tapping the title doesn't do anything, look for a **pencil icon** ✏️ next to it, or open the **three-dot menu** ⋯ at the top and choose "Rename". Naming the chat keeps all your practice in one tidy place. 💬 Example: name the chat *"Spanish practice — beginner"*.

You'll know it worked when the top of the screen shows your chosen name instead of today's date, and the chat is ready for your first message.

Step 2 — Tell ChatGPT exactly how you want to practice

Tap the message box at the bottom of the screen and type a short "briefing" message explaining what you want. Mention your level, the language, the kind of situation you want to rehearse, and how you'd like corrections — the more specific you are, the more useful the reply will be. ChatGPT answers well when you give it a small "job description," almost like briefing a friendly tutor. Tap the **up-arrow send button** (or press Enter on a computer) when you're ready. If the first reply comes back in English instead of your target language, simply remind it — *"Please reply only in Spanish from now on."* 💬 Example: *"Please reply only in simple Spanish sentences. I'm a complete beginner. After each of my messages, correct any mistakes in a kind bullet list, then ask me a follow-up question to keep the conversation going. Keep your replies short."* You'll know it worked when ChatGPT's first reply is in your chosen language, uses short sentences, and ends with a question (like *"¿Cómo te llamas?"*).

Step 3 — Send your first reply and let it correct you

Tap the message box at the bottom of the chat and type your answer to ChatGPT's question in your own words — even a rough guess is fine. Type slowly if it helps. After you tap send, ChatGPT will usually (a) gently correct any spelling or grammar slip, (b) give you a smooth model version of the sentence, and (c) ask you a new question on the same topic to keep things moving. This is the heart of practice: writing forces you to recall vocabulary, and seeing ChatGPT's correction turns the mistake into a real lesson. If it doesn't correct you, add to your original instructions from Step 2: *"Please always correct me, even on small mistakes."* 💬 Example: if ChatGPT asked *"¿De dónde eres?"*, type *"Yo soy de México"* — or even the imperfect *"Yo es de México"* — so ChatGPT has something to correct, which is the whole point. You'll know it worked when you see your own message followed by a short, kind correction and another question waiting for you at the bottom of the screen.

Step 4 — Turn on voice mode to practice speaking out loud

Speaking is the part most learners skip because it feels awkward — and it's the part that builds real fluency. In the ChatGPT app, look for a **microphone icon** 🎤 or a **headphones icon** near the message box, usually at the bottom-right. Tap it, and a "Listening…" indicator appears while the keyboard slides out of the way. If you don't see a microphone, open the side menu (look for a button like ☰ or your profile picture) and look for a setting called **"Voice mode"** or **"Voice chat"**. Speak one short sentence, pause for a moment, and let ChatGPT respond out loud. Voice mode is included on the free plan with daily usage limits; the more natural-sounding **Advanced Voice** (longer replies, smoother turn-taking) usually needs a **paid Plus plan**. If

voice isn't available right now, read ChatGPT's written replies out loud instead — that still counts. 💬 Example: say out loud *"Buenos días, ¿cómo estás?"* and wait for ChatGPT to answer in voice. You'll know it worked when ChatGPT replies out loud in Spanish (or your chosen language) and you can keep talking without typing.

Step 5 — Drill the words you keep getting wrong

After a few exchanges, you'll start noticing patterns — the same word you keep misspelling, the same tense that always confuses you. Type a message in the chat box asking ChatGPT to focus on those exact trouble spots. This is where a chatbot beats a textbook: it can run the same drill over and over without getting tired, and it can build the drill around *your* mistakes, not a generic list. You can also ask it to slow down, give you more examples, or quiz you with little flashcards inside the same chat. 💬 Example: *"I keep mixing up 'ser' and 'estar.' Can you give me 5 more practice sentences and tell me which one to use, with a short explanation?"* You'll know it worked when ChatGPT returns a short drill, you answer it, and the explanations match your actual confusion rather than a textbook chapter.

Step 6 — Save your progress and find the chat again tomorrow

Before you close the chat, type one last message asking ChatGPT for a short summary of what you learned and what to review next time — this turns the conversation into a personal study note you can re-read. To find the chat again later, open ChatGPT and look at the **list of past conversations**. On a laptop browser, that list usually lives in a **left-hand column (sometimes called the "sidebar")**. On the phone app, tap the **menu icon ☰** at the top-left, or tap your **profile picture**, to open the same list — you'll see the chat title you chose in Step 1. Tap it and the conversation reopens exactly where you left off. Most apps also offer a **share or bookmark icon** (often a downward arrow or a little flag) if you'd like to save the summary into your phone's notes app. Consistency beats long sessions: five minutes a day for two weeks will take you further than one long hour once a month. 💬 Example: *"Please summarize today's lesson in 5 bullet points I can review before our next session, and list 3 things we should practice again."* You'll know it worked when you have a short, readable recap at the bottom of the chat and you can find the same conversation again in seconds.

Common mistakes

- **Skipping the setup instructions.** If you just type *"Let's practice Spanish"* with no detail, ChatGPT will speak like a textbook. Take two minutes in Step 2 to set the rules — that small effort changes everything.
- **Stopping at the first mistake.** It's tempting to give up when ChatGPT corrects you. The whole point is the retry. Read the correction, copy the right version out loud, and send it back in your own words.

- **Treating it like a quiz instead of a chat.** If you only ask "translate this word" drills, you practice vocabulary but not conversation. Mix in real little exchanges — ordering coffee, introducing yourself, asking for directions. That's where fluency actually grows.
- **Expecting ChatGPT to grade your accent.** ChatGPT can correct your grammar and word choice, but even the paid **Advanced Voice** mode (a Plus plan and above) won't reliably judge how you pronounce things. For real pronunciation feedback, record yourself with a voice-memo app and listen back, or practice with a human tutor.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** You can warm up before a real trip or a phone call with a relative who speaks another language — five minutes of "ordering coffee" role-play in ChatGPT is surprisingly effective at calming nerves.
- **For your business or work:** If you ever speak with international colleagues or clients, this is a private rehearsal space. Practice a short self-introduction, a polite disagreement, or small talk before the real meeting — no risk of freezing up on the spot.
- **If you're just getting started:** Pick *one* language you're curious about, set up the chat with very simple beginner rules, and commit to one short session a day for a week. That's all it takes to feel less awkward.

Try it now

Open ChatGPT right now, name a new chat *"Spanish practice — beginner"*, and send this exact message: *"Please reply only in simple Spanish. I am a complete beginner. Correct my mistakes gently after each message, then ask me one easy question. Start now."* Reply to its first question — even a guess counts — and you're practicing.

How to Build a 30-Day Plan to Learn Almost Any New Skill from Scratch

6 steps · Read online

> **In short:** Tell an AI assistant the skill you want, how much time you really have, and your starting point — then ask for a day-by-day 30-day plan. Review it, cut anything too ambitious, and you'll have a roadmap you can actually follow.

Learning a new skill can feel like staring at a mountain. The trick isn't motivation — it's a realistic day-by-day plan that fits your real life. In the next few minutes, you'll use an AI assistant (ChatGPT, Gemini, Claude, Copilot, Le Chat, or any other) as your personal planning partner, and walk away with a 30-day roadmap tailored to your free time. The AI can draft the plan, but it can't open the app for you on day 14 when you're tired — that's still your job.

Before you start

- An account on any AI assistant you like — ChatGPT, Gemini, Claude, Copilot, and Le Chat all work for this. A free plan is enough.
- A rough idea of the skill you want to learn, written as one specific sentence ("beginner conversational Spanish" beats "Spanish").
- An honest estimate of your real free time per day. Most people overestimate by 2–3× — write down the realistic number, not the hopeful one.
- About 15 minutes total.

Step 1 — Pick one skill and write it down in one sentence

Open a notes app, or grab a piece of paper. Write the skill you want to learn as one short, specific sentence. The more specific you are, the better your plan will be. "Get fit" is too vague; "be able to jog 3 km without stopping" is concrete enough to plan around.

You'll see the sentence sitting there in front of you. Read it back and ask: *Can I picture what success looks like in 30 days?* If not, tighten it. If your skill is broad (like "learn to code"), pick the smallest useful version of it (like "build a simple personal website in HTML and CSS").

If you change your mind halfway through, that's fine — but starting with one clear sentence keeps the AI focused instead of guessing what you want.

💬 Example: "I want to learn beginner conversational Spanish so I can order food and have small talk on a trip to Mexico."

You'll know it worked when you can read your sentence out loud and immediately picture what 'done' looks like at day 30.

Step 2 — Write down your real time and your starting point

Before you open the AI, get honest about three numbers: how many minutes per day you can actually commit, how many days per week you'll likely skip (most weeks have at least one off day), and where you're starting from (complete beginner, or some experience).

You'll see a clear, simple list when you're done — something like "20 minutes a day, 5 days a week, total beginner." This step matters because AI assistants are optimists — they'll happily suggest a 2-hour daily plan that you'll quietly abandon by day 4.

If you're not sure how much time you have, look at your actual week and find the smallest realistic slot — early morning, lunch break, or after dinner. Twenty focused minutes beats two hours you'll never find.

💬 Example: "20 minutes a day on weekdays, weekends flexible, complete beginner, no paid courses."

You'll know it worked when you could defend every number to a skeptical friend without flinching.

Step 3 — Open your AI assistant and send the planning prompt

Open the AI assistant you chose and look for the chat or message box — usually a large text area at the bottom or center of the screen. Paste a single message that includes your skill, your time, your level, and the structure you want.

After you press send, you'll see the AI start typing a response. Most assistants produce a table or day-by-day list within a few seconds. If you get a wall of generic advice instead, your prompt was too vague — add more specifics and try again.

If your tool has a "Projects" or "Gems" feature, you can save this prompt for later — but a regular chat is enough for now. Different assistants label the send button differently ("Send," "Ask," or a paper-plane icon), so look for the button at the bottom-right of the message box.

💬 Example: "I want to learn beginner conversational Spanish for a Mexico trip in 30 days. I have 20 minutes a day on weekdays, weekends are flexible, and I'm a complete beginner. Please build me a day-by-day plan that: 1) fits in 20 minutes on weekdays and up to 60 minutes on weekends, 2) focuses on speaking and listening first, 3) uses free resources only, and 4) includes a small checkpoint at the end of each week. Format as a numbered list, one entry per day."

You'll know it worked when the response shows day 1, day 2, day 3… all the way to day 30, with a specific task for each.

Step 4 — Check the plan for realism and cut anything too ambitious

Read through the plan with a critical eye. Highlight anything that asks for more time than you said you had, anything that jumps ahead before you've built the basics, and any day that requires a paid resource you don't actually have. Your job here is to make the plan smaller, not bigger — AI tends to pack each day full.

You'll see your edited plan sitting next to the original. Most people find they need to cut 20–30% of what the AI suggested. That's not a failure of the tool; it's the whole point of this step.

If a section feels off (too advanced, wrong focus), tell the AI directly and ask it to redo just that part. For example: "Week 3 feels too hard — rewrite it for someone who only started last week."

💬 Example: "Days 18–22 ask for 90 minutes each. I only have 60 minutes on weekends. Please rewrite that week with shorter sessions and remove the paid app recommendation."

You'll know it worked when you can glance at any single day and think, "Yes, I can actually do that in the time I have."

Step 5 — Save the plan somewhere you'll see it every day

Copy the finished plan into a place you'll actually look at — a note on your phone, a printed page on the fridge, a calendar reminder, or a simple spreadsheet. The best plan in the world does nothing if you forget it exists by Tuesday.

You'll see the plan sitting where your future self can find it. If you use a calendar app, block the time slots now while you're thinking about it. If you prefer paper, print it — there's something about a physical page that makes people follow through.

If your AI assistant has a "Projects" or "Memory" feature, you can also save the conversation so you can ask follow-up questions later ("I'm stuck on Day 12 — help me rework it"). Otherwise, bookmark the chat in your browser.

💬 Example: "I'll paste the plan into my calendar as 20-minute events on weekdays, and a 60-minute block on Saturday morning."

You'll know it worked when, two days from now, you don't have to search for the plan — it's already in front of you.

Step 6 — Check in with the AI at the end of each week

After every 5–7 days, come back to the same chat (or start a new one with the same prompt) and tell the AI what actually happened. Be honest: what you skipped, what worked, what felt boring or too hard. Ask it to adjust the next week based on real life, not the original plan.

You'll see the assistant suggest a revised week — usually tightening what worked and dropping what didn't. This is the step that turns a static plan into a living one, and it's the difference between people who finish and people who quietly quit at day 9.

If you've fallen behind, don't restart from day 1 — ask the AI to compress the plan instead. Frame it as a shift forward, not a failure.

💬 Example: "I'm on day 8. I skipped day 5 and day 6 because of work. Days 1–4 went well, but the 30-minute listening exercise felt too long. Can you adjust the rest of the plan so I still finish in 30 days total, and shorten the listening parts to 15 minutes?"

You'll know it worked when each new week feels easier than the last — because it actually fits your life.

Common mistakes

- **Picking a skill that's too broad.** "Learn photography" gives you a useless plan. Tighten it to something specific, like "learn to take sharp, well-lit photos in natural light with my phone."
- **Lying about your free time.** If you tell the AI you have 90 minutes a day but you really have 20, you'll quit by day 5. Use the honest number from Step 2.
- **Treating the first plan as final.** The first response is a draft, not a contract. Always cut and adjust before you commit.
- **Forgetting to check in.** A plan you never revise becomes a plan you abandon. Set a weekly reminder to update it with the AI.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** You can use this exact method for cooking, drawing, a new language, an instrument, basic coding, or any hobby you've been putting off. The real skill here is the prompt, not the topic.
- **For your business or work:** The same prompt structure works for picking up a new tool at work — Excel pivot tables, a CRM, basic SQL, a design tool. You'll stand out by having a real plan instead of "I'll figure it out eventually."
- **If you're just getting started:** Pick one small skill you've actually wanted for at least a month — not a New Year's resolution from last week — and try this prompt tonight. Small, specific, and already wanted is the winning combination.

Try it now

Pick one skill, open your favorite AI assistant, and paste this: "I want to learn [SKILL] over 30 days. I have [X minutes] per day, [Y days] per week. I'm a [beginner / some experience]. Build me a day-by-day plan using free resources, with weekly checkpoints. Keep each daily task realistic for my time." Save the response, then cut one thing that feels too ambitious. You'll have a real plan in under ten minutes.

How to turn your messy study notes into practice quiz questions

6 steps · Read online

> **In short:** You can paste your messy notes into any AI assistant — ChatGPT, Gemini, Claude, Copilot, or similar — with a clear prompt, and get back flashcards, multiple-choice questions, and short-answer prompts in seconds. No special app or paid plan is required for the basic version.

Reading your own notes is one of the slowest ways to study. Quizzing yourself works much better — but writing questions by hand takes ages. The good news is that any modern AI assistant can turn your messy class or textbook notes into a ready-made practice set in well under a minute. This guide walks you through it step by step, even if you've never typed a single prompt before.

Before you start

- **An AI assistant account.** Any major one will do: ChatGPT, Gemini, Claude, Microsoft Copilot, Le Chat, or similar. The free tier is fine for this task.
- **A device with internet** — phone, tablet, or computer.
- **Your messy notes** in a form the AI can read. Typed notes from a notes app or a Google Doc work best. Photos of typed pages usually work too; photos of cramped handwriting often don't — type those out first.
- **About 10 minutes** for your first run. After that, it's a two-minute habit.

One honest note up front: AI assistants sometimes invent confident-sounding but wrong answers, especially with dates, numbers, and names. Treat the questions as a fast first draft you check, not a finished test. (We cover that in Step 4.)

Step 1 — Open a fresh chat in your AI assistant

Open the website or app of the AI assistant you picked (for example, chatgpt.com, gemini.google.com, or claude.ai). Look for a button that says **"New chat"** or **"New conversation"** — usually near the top-left of the screen or in a sidebar. Click or tap it. A blank chat box appears with a blinking cursor and a send button on the right.

If you don't see "New chat", look for a **pencil icon** 🖍️, a **plus icon** ➕, or a **"+"** next to "Chats" — every assistant uses one of these for the same job. If a sign-in page pops up first, just enter your account details and continue.

💬 Example: no typing in this step — you're just opening a clean chat.

You'll know it worked when the screen shows an empty message box and any previous conversation is gone.

Step 2 — Paste your notes into the chat box

Click inside the empty message box at the bottom of the screen. Copy your notes from wherever they live — a notes app, a Google Doc, a Word file, or even an email to yourself — and paste them in. On a phone, tap and hold, then choose **Paste** from the small menu that appears. On a computer, the shortcut is **Ctrl+V** (Windows) or **Cmd+V** (Mac). The text will show up in the chat box, usually as one long block.

If your notes are very long (many thousands of words), paste them in chunks instead — one section at a time. Most assistants work best when each message stays reasonable in size. If your notes are on paper, type the key points into the chat box manually before moving on; don't try to paste a photo of your handwriting.

💬 Example (a short chunk you might paste): "Cell biology chapter 7. Mitochondria = powerhouse of the cell, makes ATP. Double membrane: outer is smooth, inner folded into cristae. ATP made via the Krebs cycle in the matrix and the electron transport chain on the cristae. Chloroplasts are found only in plant cells and do photosynthesis. Both mitochondria and chloroplasts have their own DNA — endosymbiosis theory."

You'll know it worked when your notes appear as readable text inside the chat box and the send button becomes active.

Step 3 — Ask for the quiz format you want

Below the pasted notes, still inside the same message, type a short request for the kind of quiz you want. The clearer you are, the better the output — don't just write "make a quiz", say what kind of questions and how many. Press the **send button** — usually an arrow icon ➤ on the right of the chat box, sometimes the Enter key on a keyboard — to submit.

If the assistant's first reply ignores your quiz request and does something else instead — like summarizing the notes — send a quick follow-up message restating what you want. Most assistants respond well to a clear, second nudge.

💬 Example (a prompt you can copy and adapt): "Turn the notes above into: (1) 5 multiple-choice questions with 4 options each, (2) 5 short-answer questions, (3) 5 flashcard-style Q&A pairs. Put the correct answer on a separate line for each one."

You'll know it worked when the assistant replies with a clearly numbered or labeled list of questions, each with options, an answer line, or a Q&A pair.

Step 4 — Quickly check the questions against your notes

Read the questions the assistant just produced. Keep your original notes open in another tab, a second window, or on paper beside you. Spot-check about five questions at random: does the answer actually match what your notes say? Pay extra attention to numbers, dates, names, and "who said what" — those are the spots where AI assistants most often slip up.

If a question is wrong, underline or circle it. If several are wrong, copy the bad ones back into the chat and ask the assistant to fix them. This is normal — think of the assistant as a fast first draft, and you as the editor.

💬 Example (a quick fix prompt): "Question 3 says the answer is 1972, but my notes say 1927. Please correct it and double-check the rest for similar mistakes."

You'll know it worked when every question on your list has an answer that matches your source notes — or when you've flagged the ones that don't.

Step 5 — Save the questions somewhere you can find them

Highlight the assistant's reply with your cursor (or press and hold on a phone), then **copy** it. Open any notes app you already use — Apple Notes, Google Keep, Notion, a Word doc, even a plain text file on your desktop — and **paste** it in. Give the entry a clear title with the date and the topic, like *"Bio Chapter 7 practice — 12 March"*.

If your assistant offers a **share**, **download**, or **export** button — some show a paperclip icon, a download arrow, or three dots ⋯ — you can also use that to send the questions to your email or save them as a file. If you don't see that option, copy-paste works on every device.

💬 Example (a paste title): "History Unit 4 practice questions — 12 March 2026"

You'll know it worked when you can close the AI tab and reopen your notes later to find the full question set, neatly stored under a recognizable title.

Step 6 — Use the questions to actually test yourself

Put your notes away. Open the saved quiz. For each multiple-choice question, cover the answer line with your hand and pick an answer out loud or in your head. For short-answer and flashcard questions, try to answer in one or two sentences **before** you peek. Mark the ones you got wrong — those are the spots to re-read tonight.

This last step is the whole point: the AI made the quiz so you don't have to, but the learning only happens when you wrestle with the questions yourself. Two passes through the same set usually beat one long review.

💬 Example (a self-test routine): "10 questions, cover the answers, answer first, then check — repeat for any I missed."

You'll know it worked when you have a small list of weak spots to revisit and you feel more confident about the rest.

Common mistakes

- **Pasting a photo of your own handwriting and expecting it to work.** Most assistants can read typed text in images but stumble on cramped handwriting. Fix: type or dictate the key points first, then paste the typed version.
- **Writing a vague prompt like "make a quiz from this".** You'll usually get a few questions, but not the format you wanted. Fix: say exactly what you need — multiple-choice, short-answer, or flashcards — and how many of each.
- **Trusting every answer without checking.** AI assistants sometimes invent plausible-sounding facts that aren't in your notes at all. Fix: keep your notes open and spot-check five questions per set, especially any with dates, numbers, or proper names.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** if you're a student, this turns an hour of note review into a 10-minute habit you can run the night before any quiz — and the questions are reusable the next day.
- **For your work:** if you're learning a new skill, certification, or tool for your job, the same trick works on training videos, manuals, and slide decks. Paste the highlights, get a quiz, test yourself.
- **If you're just getting started:** the easiest first move is to take the single page of notes you already have open right now, paste in one paragraph, and ask for three multiple-choice questions. That's it — the rest of the habit builds from there.

Try it now

Open a fresh chat in your AI assistant, paste the last page of notes you studied, and ask for **three multiple-choice questions with the answer on a separate line**. Ninety seconds from now you'll have a tiny quiz you can test yourself on right away.

How to use Qwen Chat to create personalized study flashcards for any subject

6 steps · Read online

By the end of this guide, you'll be able to paste in your study notes, ask Qwen (Alibaba's AI assistant) to turn them into question-and-answer flashcards, and then copy them into whatever quiz tool you already use — so revising takes a fraction of the usual time. This is for anyone studying for an exam, picking up a new skill, or just trying to remember things better.

Before you start

- **An account at chat.qwen.ai.** You can sign in with a Google account, a GitHub account, or an email address — pick whichever you already use. A free plan is available and is enough for this task.
- **A device with a browser** (laptop, tablet or phone). Qwen Chat is web-based, so no install is required.
- **Some study material to work from.** A few paragraphs of notes, a chapter summary, or even a short topic description is plenty. The more specific your notes, the better the cards.
- **Roughly 10–15 minutes.** Most of that time is reading and picking the cards you want to keep.

Step 1 — Open Qwen Chat and start a fresh conversation

Open your browser, go to **chat.qwen.ai**, and sign in if you aren't already. Once you're on the main chat screen, look for a button like **"New Chat"** (often a small + icon or a pencil symbol near the top or left side of the page). Click it. A blank conversation box opens, ready for your message. Starting a new chat each time keeps earlier topics from confusing the AI, which is important because a long, mixed conversation tends to make answers less focused. **If it looks different:** if you can't find a "New Chat" button, just type your request into whatever text box is visible — Qwen will treat it as the start of a new thread on its end. **You'll know it worked when** the screen shows an empty message field with no previous conversation visible.

Step 2 — Tell Qwen what subject you're studying and paste in your notes

Type a short intro that says (a) the topic, (b) roughly what level you're at, and (c) the notes you want turned into cards. Then press **Enter** or tap the send arrow. Qwen will read your message and start processing it. This first message is where you set the "frame" — the more clearly you describe the subject, the more on-target the flashcards will be. **If it looks different:** if your

notes are very long, consider pasting just one section at a time so Qwen doesn't have to skim anything important. **You'll know it worked when** Qwen replies by acknowledging the topic and confirming what it's about to do.

Example: *"Hi Qwen — I'm studying for a Year 9 biology exam on cell structure. Here's my notes: [paste your notes here, or describe: 'The main topics are animal cells vs plant cells, the function of the nucleus, mitochondria, ribosomes, cell membrane, and how osmosis works.' Please make 12 flashcards covering these."*

Step 3 — Ask Qwen to format each flashcard clearly

In the same conversation, send a second message asking Qwen to lay out every flashcard in a consistent format — usually **"Question: … / Answer: …"** on separate lines, with a number in front of each one. Press send and wait a few seconds. Qwen will re-format its previous answers into a clean list you can easily copy. A consistent layout saves you time later because you can paste the whole block into a spreadsheet or a flashcard app without re-typing anything. **If it looks different:** if Qwen gives you a paragraph instead of a list, just reply with *"Please list them numbered, with Question and Answer on separate lines."* — it will happily redo them. **You'll know it worked when** the response is a numbered list where each item has a clear "Question" line and an "Answer" line.

Example: *"Great, please rewrite those as a numbered list, with each one formatted exactly like this: 'Card 1 — Question: [question] | Answer: [answer]'. Use a vertical bar to separate Q and A so I can copy them straight into a spreadsheet."*

Step 4 — Ask for more cards, harder cards, or a quick quiz check

Now send another short message asking Qwen to either (a) generate **more cards** on the same topic, (b) make the existing cards **harder** (for example, "give me application-level questions, not just definitions"), or (c) **quiz you** by hiding the answers and asking the questions one at a time. This is where Qwen really shines as a study partner — you can keep refining the same set until it matches your exam style. **If it looks different:** the "quiz me" option is just a chat request; there's no special button. **You'll know it worked when** Qwen either produces a longer list, asks you a question, or offers a "harder" version of the same cards.

Example: *"Please add 6 more cards, but make them harder — focus on application and 'why' questions rather than simple definitions. Then quiz me on the first 5 cards one at a time."*

Step 5 — Copy the flashcard list out of Qwen

Scroll back up to the formatted list and **select the text** with your mouse, then copy it (**Ctrl+C** on Windows/Linux, **Cmd+C** on Mac, or long-press on mobile). Open the place you want to study from — Google Sheets, Notion, a notes app, or a flashcard app like Anki or Quizlet — and paste it in. Qwen doesn't store your cards in a built-in flashcard deck, so this copy step is the bridge between the AI's output and your study routine. **If it looks different:** on mobile, you may need to tap-and-hold inside Qwen's response to bring up a "Copy" or "Select all" option. **You'll know it worked when** the flashcards appear as editable text in your chosen app, ready to import or tweak.

Step 6 — Test yourself, then come back and refine weak cards

Spend a few minutes quizzing yourself with the cards you just saved. Notice which ones you got wrong, felt fuzzy on, or found too easy. Then **return to your Qwen chat** and ask it to focus on exactly those weak spots — for example, *"Give me 5 more cards that drill the difference between osmosis and diffusion, because I keep mixing them up."* This feedback loop is what makes AI-generated flashcards genuinely useful: the set evolves with your understanding, instead of staying static like a textbook chapter. **If it looks different:** if Qwen has lost the thread of your earlier messages, just paste in your original topic description again as a refresher. **You'll know it worked when** you can identify at least 3 cards that you now answer confidently, and a short list of topics you still want to drill.

💬 Example: *"I got these wrong: [list 2-3 topics]. Please make 4 more cards on those specific points, and include a tiny hint on the back of each one."*

Common mistakes

- **Pasting a 50-page textbook and expecting perfect cards.** Qwen works best when you give it focused chunks of notes or a clear topic summary. **Fix:** paste one section at a time, or describe the key concepts in your own words first.
- **Skipping the "format" step.** If you don't ask for a numbered "Question / Answer" layout, you'll get a paragraph that's painful to copy into anything. **Fix:** always send the second message asking for the exact format you want.
- **Treating AI cards as automatically correct.** Qwen can occasionally get a fact subtly wrong, especially for niche subjects. **Fix:** spot-check the first 5 cards against your actual textbook or syllabus before you commit to the whole set.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** any time you need to remember a list — countries and capitals, foreign vocabulary, recipe ratios — you can spin up a quick flashcard set in minutes instead of handwriting them.

- **For your study or exams:** you get a personalized revision deck that adapts to *your* notes, not a generic one from the internet, and you can ask for harder questions as the exam gets closer.
- **If you're just getting started:** don't overthink it — pick one small topic, run through the six steps above once, and you'll have the hang of it by the second subject.

Try it now

Open **chat.qwen.ai**, start a new chat, and paste in this exact message to make your first set of cards right now:

> *"Please create 8 flashcards covering the basics of [your subject — e.g. 'the solar system', 'French food vocabulary', 'intro to spreadsheets']. Format each one as: 'Card N — Question: ... | Answer: ...'. Keep answers under 20 words."*

Two minutes from now you'll have a deck you can copy into your favorite notes app and start quizzing yourself tonight.

Getting started with Z.ai: a beginner's guide to the free chatbot

6 steps · Read online

> **In short:** Z.ai is a chatbot you use in a web browser at chat.z.ai, and it runs on the company's GLM models. You can start with a simple question in minutes. The most important thing to know: it can sound confident while being wrong, so check anything important.

This guide is for anyone who has heard about AI chatbots and wants a calm, first look at one. By the end, you'll have opened Z.ai, asked a real question, improved the answer, and learned what not to type into it. No technical background is needed.

Before you start

- **A device with a web browser.** A phone, tablet, or computer works. You don't need to install anything.
- **An email address you can check**, in case the site asks you to sign up or sign in. Whether an account is required can change, so follow what the site asks.
- **About 20 minutes** for the whole guide.

Step 1 — Open chat.z.ai and look around

Open your browser, type **chat.z.ai** into the address bar, and press Enter. You should see an empty chat with a message box at the bottom of the screen. This box is where you type. Chat assistants like this one work like a very fast, very patient text conversation: you type a message, and the reply appears below it.

Take a moment to look at the rest of the page. You may see a sidebar with past conversations, a button to start a new chat, and a menu for settings. Don't worry about any of it yet. If you're asked to sign in or create an account, follow the on-screen steps and use an email address you check often. If the page looks different from this description, look for the message box first, because that's the one thing you need.

Example: You don't need to type anything yet. Just find the message box.

You'll know it worked when you can see a place to type your message and the page has loaded without errors.

Step 2 — Check which model you're using

Z.ai is built on what it calls its GLM models. "Model" is simply the name for the AI engine behind the chat. Think of it like a car engine: the same dashboard can sometimes sit on different

engines, and each one handles tasks a little differently. Some sites let you choose a model from a menu near the top of the chat or near the message box.

If you see a model menu, tap or click it and look at what's available. Model names and options can change over time, so don't rely on a name from this guide or someone else's article. If you don't see a menu, that's fine; the default model will still answer your questions. Pick the option that's labeled as the general or everyday choice if you're unsure.

💬 Example: Not applicable here. You're just checking what's on screen.

You'll know it worked when you've either picked a model from the menu or confirmed that no menu is shown and you're ready to type.

Step 3 — Ask your first question

Click inside the message box, type a question in ordinary language, and press Enter, or tap the send arrow next to the box. Write as if you're talking to a helpful friend. A few seconds later, the reply should start appearing below your message, a few words at a time.

Start with something simple that you already know the answer to, so you can judge the reply yourself. Good first questions are about everyday topics. Remember: the assistant cannot see your screen, your files, or the live internet unless the site specifically offers those features. It answers from patterns it learned during training, so it can be wrong.

💬 Example: "Explain the difference between a sprain and a strain in simple words, and give me two examples of each, using [your hobby] as the example."

If the reply is very short or seems to ignore your question, press the button to start a new chat and try again with more detail.

You'll know it worked when a written answer appears below your message and it relates to the question you asked.

Step 4 — Improve the answer with a follow-up

The first answer is rarely the best one. The easiest way to improve it is to reply in the same chat, the way you'd continue talking with a person. The assistant remembers what you said earlier in that conversation, so you can ask it to adjust, shorten, or explain differently. Click in the message box below its reply and type your follow-up.

Be specific about what you want. Saying "make it simpler" or "give me three bullet points" helps much more than "try again." If the reply still misses the point, rephrase your original question with more detail about who the answer is for.

💬 Example: "That's helpful, but I'm a complete beginner. Please rewrite it in five short sentences and avoid medical or technical words."

You'll know it worked when the new reply matches the change you asked for, such as being shorter, simpler, or in a different format.

Step 5 — Try a practical task

Now try something useful for your daily life. Chatbots are good at drafting, organizing, and explaining. For example, you can ask for help writing a polite message, planning a simple schedule, or making a shopping list from a recipe. The assistant can draft the text, but it can't send emails, book appointments, or make purchases for you. You still copy the result and use it yourself.

If you want the assistant to work with a longer piece of text, such as a paragraph from a letter you received, paste it into the message box. Only paste text you're comfortable sharing, and remove names, account numbers, and addresses first.

💬 Example: "Help me write a short, friendly reminder to a neighbor about returning my ladder. Keep it under 60 words and end with a thank-you."

You'll know it worked when the assistant gives you a draft you can read, copy, and edit before using it anywhere else.

Step 6 — Decide what to keep private

This step matters more than any other. Treat a chatbot like a public postcard: anything you type could be stored, reviewed under the company's rules, or seen by someone who gets access to your account. Z.ai has its own privacy policy, and different AI companies handle stored conversations differently, so read the policy on the official site before sharing anything personal. Look for the section on how long chats are kept and how to delete them.

As a simple rule, don't type passwords, bank or card numbers, Social Security numbers, medical records, or other people's private details. For a sensitive document, use a short summary or a made-up version instead. Also check whether your account has a way to clear your chat history, and use it if you're on a shared computer.

💬 Example: Instead of pasting a real bill, try: "Here is a made-up bill for a [service type] with a $[amount] charge. Explain in simple terms what each line might mean."

You'll know it worked when you've read the privacy section, know where to delete past chats, and have a personal rule for what stays out of the message box.

Common mistakes

- **Trusting every answer.** Chatbots can state wrong facts with confidence. Fix it by checking important details, such as dates, rules, or health and money information, with an official source or a qualified professional.
- **Sharing too much too soon.** Beginners often paste whole documents or personal details. Fix it by removing names, numbers, and addresses before you paste anything.
- **Giving up after one reply.** A vague first answer doesn't mean the tool is useless. Fix it by asking a follow-up with a clear instruction, like "shorter" or "for a beginner."

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** You can use Z.ai to explain a confusing letter, plan a weekend meal, or draft a message to a friend. Ask it to explain things in plain words, then double-check anything that matters.
- **For your business or work:** You can ask it to outline a meeting agenda, rewrite a paragraph for clarity, or brainstorm names for a project. Keep client, employee, and company information out of the chat unless your employer has approved the tool for that use.
- **If you're just getting started:** Start with low-stakes questions and drafts. Build the habit of checking the answer and protecting your personal details. That habit matters more than any single feature.

Try it now

Open **chat.z.ai** in your browser, find the message box, and type this: "Give me three simple tips for starting a new hobby, written for a complete beginner." Read the reply, then send one follow-up asking it to make the tips shorter. Two minutes is all it takes.

Using Claude to Understand Complex Topics for Study or Work

6 steps · Read online

Feeling overwhelmed by a new subject or a tricky report? Claude can be your personal tutor, helping you unravel complex information into easy-to-grasp insights. This guide will show you how to use Claude to simplify anything from scientific papers to business jargon, making learning less daunting and boosting your confidence.

Before you start

- An Anthropic account. The free tier of Claude is usually enough for these basic explanation tasks.
- Access to the Claude website (claude.ai) on a computer or mobile device.
- Roughly 10-15 minutes to follow along with the steps.

Step 1 — Open Claude and Start a New Chat

Your first step is to open Claude and begin a fresh conversation. This gives you a clean slate to explore your topic. On your device, open your web browser and type `claude.ai` into the address bar, then press Enter. Once the page loads, look for a "New Chat" button or a similar option, often found on the left side of the screen or as a prominent button in the main window. Clicking this will clear any previous conversation you might have had, getting you ready to ask about your complex topic. If it looks different: Claude's interface might vary slightly over time. If you don't see "New Chat", look for an icon like a plus sign (`+`) or a speech bubble to start a new conversation. You'll know it worked when you see a blank message box, ready for your input, usually with "Ask Claude anything" or similar text.

Step 2 — Introduce the Topic

Now it's time to tell Claude what you want to understand. You'll give it a "prompt", which is just the instruction you give to an AI. Think of it like telling a smart assistant exactly what you want it to do. In the message box at the bottom of the screen, type a clear request asking Claude to explain your complex topic. Be specific about the subject. Once you've typed your request, press the Enter key on your keyboard or click the 'Send' button (often a paper airplane icon) next to the message box. Claude will then begin to process your request and generate an initial explanation. 💬 Example: `Explain the concept of 'quantum entanglement' in physics.` You'll know it worked when Claude starts typing out its response directly in the chat window, appearing as a new message above your prompt.

Step 3 — Ask for Simpler Terms

Claude's initial explanation might still use some technical language. To make it truly accessible, you'll ask for "simpler terms" or an "analogy" – explaining something unfamiliar by comparing it to something familiar, like explaining how a computer processes information by comparing it to a kitchen preparing a meal. In the message box, type a follow-up request, building on the previous answer. For instance, you can ask it to rephrase the explanation. Claude will then take its previous response and try to simplify it, often using less technical jargon or more common words. Example: `Can you explain that in simpler terms, like you're talking to a high school student?` If it looks different: If Claude seems to misunderstand, clarify that you want the *previous* explanation rephrased. You'll know it worked when Claude provides a new, less complicated explanation, often using everyday language or a relatable comparison.

Step 4 — Request Examples or Scenarios

Abstract explanations are much easier to grasp when you have concrete examples. This step helps you anchor the concept in real-world scenarios. Type another request in the message box, specifically asking for examples related to your topic. You might want examples from everyday life, or specific scenarios related to your study or work. Claude will then generate a list of examples or describe practical scenarios that illustrate the concept you're learning, helping to solidify your understanding. Example: `Please give me two everyday examples where this concept might apply.` You'll know it worked when Claude provides several distinct examples, often using bullet points or numbered lists, that demonstrate the complex topic in action.

Step 5 — Deepen Understanding with Follow-up Questions

Even with simpler terms and examples, you might still have specific parts of the topic that are unclear. This is where you can dive deeper into specific points. Claude has a "context window," which means it remembers what you've discussed so far in the conversation. Identify any specific terms or ideas from Claude's previous answers that you still find confusing. Type a direct question about that specific point in the message box. Claude will use the existing conversation to provide more detailed clarification on that particular aspect, without you needing to re-explain the whole topic. Example: `You mentioned 'decoherence' in the first explanation. Can you elaborate on what that means specifically?` You'll know it worked when Claude focuses its response precisely on the term or idea you asked about, offering a more in-depth explanation than before.

Step 6 — Summarize and Verify

Finally, it’s a good idea to consolidate your learning by asking for a summary and considering how to cross-reference important information. Remember that Claude, like all AIs, can sometimes experience "hallucinations" – where it confidently makes something up that isn't true or doesn't exist. Type a request for a concise summary of the entire discussion. While Claude

generates this, consider if the topic is critical (e.g., medical advice, financial figures, legal information). For critical topics, always verify the information with reliable sources like textbooks, academic journals, or expert opinions. Claude will provide a brief overview of the key points covered, allowing you to quickly review what you've learned. 💬 Example: `Can you summarise our conversation about quantum entanglement in three short paragraphs?` You'll know it worked when Claude presents a clear, condensed version of the main ideas from your chat.

Common mistakes

- **Being too vague in your initial prompt:** If you just say "Explain physics," Claude won't know where to start. **Fix:** Always be specific, like "Explain the concept of 'black holes' in astrophysics."
- **Overloading Claude with too many questions at once:** Asking for an explanation, examples, and a summary all in one prompt can sometimes lead to less focused answers. **Fix:** Break down your requests into smaller, sequential steps, as shown in this guide.
- **Trusting critical information without verification:** While Claude is a powerful learning tool, it should not be treated as the sole source of truth, especially for sensitive or crucial data. **Fix:** Always cross-reference facts, figures, and important definitions with reputable, human-verified sources to ensure accuracy.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** You can use Claude to understand complex news articles, decode technical terms in product manuals, or get a simpler breakdown of health information from your doctor. It turns confusing information into something you can actually use.
- **For your business or work:** Use Claude to quickly grasp industry reports, understand new software features, or simplify complex legal or financial documents. This can save you time and help you contribute more confidently in meetings.
- **If you're just getting started:** Pick one confusing email you received or an article you skimmed recently. Copy and paste a paragraph you didn't understand into Claude and ask, "Can you explain this paragraph to me in simple terms?"

Try it now

Find a recent news article about a scientific breakthrough, a new piece of technology, or a complex economic policy. Choose one paragraph that you find particularly hard to understand, then paste it into Claude and ask, "Explain this to me like I'm new to this topic." See how quickly it can clarify things for you!

AI Made Simple: A Gentle First Guide for Beginners

5 steps · Read online

If you've ever felt a bit daunted by new technology, this guide is for you. You'll learn how to confidently use artificial intelligence (AI) to help you with daily tasks, spark creative ideas, and even assist with writing – all while understanding how to keep your personal information safe.

Before you start

- **An internet-connected device:** A computer or tablet offers the easiest experience for typing and seeing the responses clearly. Smartphones work too, but the screen might feel a bit small.
- **A free AI account:** You will need to sign up for a free AI tool like ChatGPT (from OpenAI) or Gemini (from Google) using your email address. This guide focuses on free versions.
- **Stable internet connection:** Ensure you have a reliable internet connection to access the AI.
- **Time:** Allow about 5-10 minutes to follow this guide and complete your first interaction.

Step 1 — Open your AI chat and sign in

Your first step is to open your chosen AI program. Think of these as helpful digital assistants that you can text back and forth with, just like sending a message to a friend. These programs are often called **chatbots** (which is just a fancy name for a computer program designed to have conversations with people).

Open your web browser (like Safari, Chrome, or Edge) and go to the website for ChatGPT or Gemini. Look for a "Log in" or "Sign up" button. If you've never used it before, choose "Sign up" and follow the simple on-screen prompts to create a free account using your email address.

What you see: You'll typically see a clean login page asking for your email and password, or options to sign in with your Google or Apple account. **What happens next:** After successfully logging in or signing up, you'll be taken to the AI's main chat interface, which usually has a large, empty text box at the bottom of the screen. **If it looks different:** If you see a "Download App" option, that's fine too! The steps in the app will be very similar. If you're struggling to find the sign-in, look for words like "Get Started" or "Join for Free". **You'll know it worked when:** You see a clear, simple screen with a large empty box at the bottom, ready for you to type your message.

💬 Example: Type **chatgpt.com** or **gemini.google.com** into your browser's address bar. Then, click "Sign up" and follow the prompts to create your free account.

Step 2 — Find the chat box and say hello

Once you're logged in, you'll be on the main chat screen. This is where you'll interact with the AI. It's usually a very straightforward screen with most of the space dedicated to the conversation area, and a typing box at the bottom. The message you type into the AI is called a **prompt** (the instruction or question you give the AI so it knows how to help you).

To begin, simply click on the large empty text box at the bottom of your screen. This will make your keyboard appear if you're on a tablet or phone, or make a cursor blink if you're on a computer, showing it's ready for you to type. Then, type a simple greeting.

What you see: A large, often white or light-colored, empty box at the bottom of the screen, usually labeled "Message" or "Type your prompt here". **What happens next:** As you type, your message will appear in the box. When you press Enter (or tap a Send button, often an arrow icon), your message will move into the main conversation area, and the AI will begin to process your request. **If it looks different:** The typing box might be at the top of the screen or on the side. Look for the largest area where you can type, usually with a small arrow or "send" button nearby. **You'll know it worked when:** Your greeting (e.g., "Hello!") appears in the main chat area, and the AI responds with its own greeting or acknowledgement.

Example: Type **Hello, how are you today?** into the chat box and press Enter.

Step 3 — Write your first clear question (your 'prompt')

The biggest hurdle for beginners is knowing what to type to the AI. You don't need to use special computer code or keywords. Simply type in full, natural sentences, just as if you were talking to a friendly person who wants to help. The clearer your question (your **prompt**), the better the AI can understand and assist you.

Think about what you want to achieve, then phrase it as a polite request or question. It's like asking a librarian for help: the more detail you give, the better they can guide you. After typing your request, press Enter or click the Send button (often a paper airplane or arrow icon).

What you see: Your previous conversation with the AI, and the empty chat box at the bottom of the screen. **What happens next:** The AI will "think" for a few moments (you might see a typing animation or a loading spinner), then it will generate and display its response directly in the chat window, just above your last message. **If it looks different:** Some AI tools might offer voice input options (a microphone icon). You can try those too, but typing is usually more precise for beginners. If the AI seems confused, try rephrasing your question more simply. **You'll know it worked when:** The AI generates a complete answer to your question, appearing as new text in the conversation history.

💬 Example: Instead of typing short, blunt terms like "scone recipe easy", type: **Could you please share a simple recipe for traditional scones that uses basic ingredients I likely have in my pantry?**

Step 4 — Ask the AI to refine its answer

The AI is incredibly flexible and patient. If the first answer it gives you is too long, too complicated, or not quite right, you can ask it to change the result. You don't need to start a new conversation; just type a follow-up request in the same chat. You can ask it to make things simpler, shorter, or even more fun.

This process of giving feedback and asking for adjustments is called **iterating** (which just means trying again, but with improvements, based on what you learned from the last attempt). Don't be afraid to ask for exactly what you need. Type your request into the same chat box you used before, and press Enter or the Send button.

What you see: The AI's previous answer displayed in the chat, and the empty chat box waiting for your next instruction. **What happens next:** The AI will take your feedback and generate a revised version of its previous answer, incorporating your new instructions. It will display this new answer in the chat below your request. **If it looks different:** Sometimes the AI might apologize if it didn't understand. If this happens, try rephrasing your request for changes even more simply and directly. **You'll know it worked when:** The AI provides a new, updated version of its original answer that better matches what you asked for (e.g., a shorter recipe or a different tone).

💬 Example: If the recipe it gave you looks too detailed, you can type: **That recipe looks good, but could you please simplify it into just five clear, numbered steps?**

Step 5 — Understand what AI can't do (and stay safe)

While AI is a wonderful helper, you must treat it like a polite stranger at a library information desk. They are happy to help you find information, but you would never hand them your bank card or tell them your medical history. The AI lives *only* within its chat window in most cases; it cannot handle sensitive personal data the way a doctor or bank can. (Some newer AI tools can browse the web or interact with applications, but they still operate mainly within their chat interface for everyday use.)

Never type your home address, phone number, passwords, bank details, or private medical worries into an AI. Its primary purpose is to generate text, not to handle sensitive personal data. Protecting your privacy is essential, and the AI cannot truly keep your information private in the way a doctor or bank can.

What you see: Your ongoing conversation with the AI. No changes on screen will indicate a privacy risk, so this step relies on your awareness. **What happens next:** If you stick to safe topics, nothing negative will happen. The AI will continue to provide helpful, general information. If you accidentally share personal data, the AI might even warn you, but it's best not to rely on that. **If it looks different:** Some AI tools have optional privacy settings in your account menu (e.g., "Data & Privacy"). You can explore these, but the core rule of not sharing personal details always applies. **You'll know it worked when:** You feel confident using the AI without worrying about accidentally giving away private information, knowing its limitations regarding sensitive data.

💬 Example:

- **Safe prompt: What are some gentle exercises to help improve balance at home?**
- **Unsafe prompt: My name is Margaret, I live at 12 Main Street, and my doctor just prescribed me this specific medication for my heart...**

Common mistakes

- **Expecting perfect accuracy:** Sometimes AI makes things up with absolute confidence. Tech experts call this a **hallucination** (when an AI confidently invents a false fact or detail). Always double-check important details—like travel times, opening hours, or historical dates—on an official website or trusted source.
- **Using it for medical, financial, or legal decisions:** AI is brilliant for brainstorming dinner ideas or drafting emails, but it is not a doctor, accountant, or lawyer. Always consult real, qualified professionals for medical, legal, or financial advice.
- **Being too vague in your prompt:** If your first attempt at a question doesn't give a good answer, it's often because the AI didn't have enough detail to work with. **Fix:** Instead of "write about dogs", try "Write a short, heartwarming story about a Golden Retriever who helps an elderly neighbor in a small American town."

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** You can easily draft tricky emails to businesses, write warm RSVP notes for family gatherings, or get creative ideas for using up leftovers in your kitchen. It's like having a thoughtful assistant available 24/7.
- **For your business or work:** You can quickly organize newsletter articles, write clear meeting agendas, or brainstorm fundraising ideas for your local club. It can help you save time on routine writing tasks.
- **If you're just getting started:** The simplest way to build confidence is to play. Do not worry about saying the "wrong" thing; the AI is infinitely patient and will never judge you. Start with simple questions you know the answer to, just to see how it works.

Try it now

Open your chosen AI tool right now, type this exact sentence into the chat box, and press Enter:

Can you please write a warm RSVP email to my friend Sarah, letting her know I would love to attend her afternoon tea party next Tuesday?

How to pick the right free AI app when you're just getting started

5 steps · Read online

> **In short:** All five major free AI apps — ChatGPT, Gemini, Claude, Copilot, and Le Chat — can handle the three tasks beginners try most: writing help, answering questions, and coding assistance. They work differently under the hood, but for everyday use the real difference comes down to integrations, conversation style, and how each one fits into your existing tools.

The idea that one AI assistant is simply "the best" is a myth. Each tool is built by a different company, trained in its own way, and optimized for its own strengths. For a beginner, this actually works in your favor — it means there is a good fit for almost every need. This guide walks you through comparing the free tiers of the five most widely available assistants so you can choose with confidence, not guesswork.

Before you start

- An internet connection and any device (phone, tablet, or computer).
- At least one free account — you do not need to pay for anything to follow this guide.
- About 15 minutes to test a few tools side by side.

Step 1 — Decide what you actually want to do

Before looking at any app, name your goal in one sentence. The three tasks beginners try most are:

- **Writing and drafting** — emails, social posts, summaries, brainstorming ideas.
- **Answering questions and explaining things** — looking something up, learning a new topic.
- **Getting help with code** — understanding a programming concept or writing a simple script.

Most free AI apps handle all three reasonably well. The differences show up in *how well* they handle each one, and whether they fit into tools you already use.

💬 Example: "I want to draft a short email to my manager explaining why a project deadline needs to move." You'll know it worked when you can state your goal clearly — that sentence is your comparison checklist.

Step 2 — Compare writing and creative tools

For drafting, editing, and generating ideas, each app takes a different approach.

ChatGPT (OpenAI) and **Gemini** (Google) both produce quick, well-formatted drafts across many formats. They are good all-around choices for everyday writing tasks.

Claude (Anthropic) tends to give longer, more detailed responses and often catches nuance in longer pieces. If you write a lot of reports, emails, or documents, it may feel like a thoughtful editor rather than a speed-draft tool.

Copilot (Microsoft) connects directly to Microsoft Word and Outlook. If you already pay for Microsoft 365, you can generate and edit text inside those apps without switching windows.

Le Chat (Mistral AI) handles multilingual writing naturally — a useful advantage if you work across languages or need content in a language other than English.

All five will produce usable drafts. The question is whether one of these fits more naturally into your existing workflow.

💬 Example prompt to try in two tools: "Write a 150-word product description for a small handmade candle business." You'll know it worked when you can compare the results side by side and spot the style differences — one may be more energetic, another more formal.

Step 3 — Compare question-answering and knowledge tools

When you need an answer rather than a draft, the tools differ most on two points: how current the information is, and how deeply they explain.

Gemini draws on Google's search infrastructure for real-time information. If your question involves recent events, current prices, or anything time-sensitive, it may have an edge here on the free tier.

ChatGPT and **Claude** have knowledge cutoff dates — they do not browse the live web the same way. They explain concepts in depth and handle follow-up questions particularly well, making them strong for learning and research conversations.

Copilot uses the same underlying model as ChatGPT but displays search results alongside its answer, which some users find helpful for verifying factual claims.

Le Chat handles questions in multiple languages fluidly and can switch between them mid-conversation.

If your primary need is quick, up-to-date answers, try Gemini for that task. For learning and exploring a topic over several questions, ChatGPT or Claude may feel more natural.

💬 Example prompt: "Explain what a budget spreadsheet is to someone who has never made one." You'll know it worked when the explanation uses everyday language and builds on ideas step by step — not when it throws jargon at you.

Step 4 — Compare coding and learning tools

If you are curious about how code works or want help writing a simple script, here is how the tools line up.

ChatGPT and **Copilot** both generate code snippets with plain-language explanations. Copilot's advantage shows up if you write code inside Microsoft development tools — the integration is built in.

Claude tends to explain code in more detail and can walk through longer programs step by step, which some beginners find helpful.

Le Chat supports a wide range of programming languages and can switch between them in the same conversation.

Gemini integrates with Google tools and works well for web-related code and simpler scripts.

None of the free tiers are full development environments — they will not run your code for you. But for understanding, learning, and writing small scripts, all five are worth trying.

💬 Example prompt: "Write a simple Python script that asks for your name and prints a greeting." You'll know it worked when you can copy the result, paste it into a free online Python editor, and run it without errors.

Step 5 — Make your decision in three questions

After testing all five tools with the same prompt, answer three quick questions to narrow your choice:

1. Which response felt most natural to read?
2. Did any tool integrate with an app you already use (Microsoft 365, Google Workspace)?
3. Did any tool answer in the language or style you preferred?

Write the answers down. If you are a writer or content creator, you will likely lean toward ChatGPT or Gemini for their versatility. If you already use Microsoft tools every day, Copilot removes friction by living where you already work. If you value thoughtful, detailed responses, Claude may feel like the best fit. If you work across languages or want a tool that switches easily between them, Le Chat is worth a closer look.

💬 Example: After comparing results from Steps 2 through 4, note which tool you would open first if you had a real task due tomorrow. You'll know it worked when you feel a clear pull toward one tool for one specific reason — that is a sign the fit is right, not just familiarity.

Common mistakes

- **Assuming one tool beats all others.** Every comparison you read online reflects one person's use case. Your needs may be different. The tools are genuinely close in quality for most everyday tasks.
- **Missing tools you already have access to.** If you already pay for Microsoft 365, Copilot may already be on your computer. If you have a Google account, Gemini is a free web app. Check your existing subscriptions before signing up for something new.
- **Sticking with the first tool you try.** First impressions vary. A tool that felt awkward at first may click once you adjust how you phrase your prompts. If a tool almost worked, try rephrasing before switching.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** A good AI assistant can cut the time you spend staring at a blank page, wrestling with an unfamiliar topic, or figuring out where to start on a task. The right tool makes that feel easy rather than frustrating.
- **For your business or work:** If you handle any written communication, internal documents, or basic research as part of your job, even a free AI assistant can take the first draft off your plate. The best fit is the one that connects to the tools you already use.
- **If you are just getting started:** Pick one tool and commit to using it for three real tasks this week. At the end of the week, ask yourself whether it felt natural. If yes, keep going. If not, try the next one on this list.

Try it now

Open two of the five tools in separate tabs or windows right now. Paste the same prompt into both:

> "Give me three ideas for a weekend project I could finish in two hours with no special skills or tools."

Compare the results side by side. Notice the differences in tone, length, and creativity. That feeling of "this one speaks my language" is your signal. Trust it — and open that one first next time you have a task to tackle.

How to study and learn faster with AI – a beginner's step-by-step guide

5 steps · Read online

By the end of this guide, you'll be able to ask an AI to break down a tough topic, create a handy summary, and build a short quiz – so you can master new material quicker than before. This guide is written for anyone who wants to study smarter, not harder, by using a free digital learning assistant.

Before you start

- **An active internet connection** and a web browser (like Chrome, Firefox, Safari, or Edge).
- **A free OpenAI ChatGPT account.** You'll use this popular AI tool as our example. If you don't have one, you'll create one in Step 1.
- **A device** such as a computer, laptop, tablet, or smartphone. The steps are written for a web browser experience, but the concepts apply to mobile apps too.
- **A way to take notes** (either pen and paper or a digital note-taking app) to write down your quiz answers.
- **Rough total time:** Allow about 15-20 minutes to go through all the steps and try them out with your own topic.

Step 1 — Set up your AI chat

First, open your web browser and go to the AI chat website. For this guide, we'll use ChatGPT, a **large language model (LLM)** – which is essentially a powerful computer program trained on a huge amount of text, allowing it to understand and generate human-like language. You'll need to sign in, or create a free account if you don't have one yet.

You'll know it worked when you see a blank text box ready for your message, usually at the bottom of the screen.

Example: Visit `https://chatgpt.com`. On the first page, click the "Sign up" button. Follow the prompts to enter your email, create a password, and verify your email address. You may also need to provide your name and date of birth. After completing the short setup, you'll land on the main chat interface. If it looks different, look for "Log In" or "Sign Up" usually in the top-right corner or center of the screen.

Step 2 — Ask for a plain-language explanation

Now that you're in the chat, think of a subject you want to understand better – maybe "photosynthesis" from biology or "supply-chain logistics" for a business course. Type a clear instruction, called a **prompt**, into the text box that tells the AI exactly what you need. Make sure to specify the level of detail, like asking it to explain it "simply" or "like I'm a beginner."

You'll know it worked when the AI starts typing out an explanation in response to your message, appearing just above your prompt.

💬 Example: Type into the message box:

```
Explain photosynthesis in simple terms, like I'm a high-school student with no science background.
```

Then, press the 'Enter' key on your keyboard or click the 'Send message' button (often a paper plane icon) next to the text box.

Step 3 — Request a bullet-point summary

After getting a basic description, it's helpful to condense the main ideas. This makes it easier to remember the core concepts. In the same chat, ask the AI to summarize the key points into a short, easy-to-read list. This helps you grasp the structure of the topic at a glance, like creating a quick cheat sheet for yourself.

You'll know it worked when the AI presents a concise, numbered or bulleted list directly below your request, making the key information easy to skim.

💬 Example: Type into the message box:

```
Summarize the main steps of photosynthesis in 5 bullet points.
```

If it looks different, and the summary isn't quite right, try being more specific, for example: "Can you re-summarize that for me, focusing only on the cause and effect, in three short sentences?"

Step 4 — Create a quick practice quiz

Testing yourself is one of the fastest ways to figure out what you've actually learned and what you still need to review. Ask the AI to generate a few questions based on the summary it just provided. This step turns passive reading into active recall, which is a proven technique for strengthening your memory and understanding. You can choose the type of quiz, like multiple-choice or short answer.

You'll know it worked when the AI displays a short list of questions, each with several options to choose from, or a clear question with space for your answer.

💬 Example: Type into the message box:

```
Make three multiple-choice questions about the bullet-point summary of photosynthesis.
Include one correct answer and three distractors for each question.
```

If it looks different, and the questions aren't in the format you wanted, rephrase your prompt to specify, for instance: "Instead, can you make three open-ended questions?"

Step 5 — Check your answers and get clarification

Now that you have your quiz, write down your answers on a piece of paper or in your notes app. Once you're done, type your answers back into the chat. Then, ask the AI to tell you which ones were correct and, importantly, why any wrong answers were incorrect. This feedback loop helps to correct misunderstandings and deepens your knowledge, converting a guess into solid understanding.

You'll know it worked when the AI clearly identifies which of your answers were correct and provides explanations for any you got wrong, or expands on the right ones.

💬 Example: Type into the message box:

```
Here are my answers to the photosynthesis quiz: 1-B, 2-A, 3-C. Which are correct, and
can you explain any mistakes?
```

If it looks different, and the AI seems confused, make sure your answers are clearly formatted (e.g., "Question 1: A, Question 2: B") so it can easily understand what you're checking.

Common mistakes

- **Being too vague with your prompt:** Asking "Explain photosynthesis" without specifying the audience can give you a textbook-dense reply that's hard to digest.
    - **The fix:** Always add context like "in simple language," "for a beginner," or "like I'm in primary school."
- **Skipping the quiz or checking answers:** It's tempting to just read the summary and move on. Without actively testing yourself, you won't truly know which gaps remain in your understanding.
    - **The fix:** Treat the quiz and answer check as a critical part of the learning process. It forces your brain to retrieve information, which solidifies memory.

- **Relying solely on one AI answer:** AI tools can occasionally **hallucinate** (confidently make up facts or information that isn't true). While usually accurate, it's not infallible.
    - **The fix:** If something feels off or incredibly important, copy the same question into a new chat, or search a reliable source (like a textbook or reputable website) to verify the information.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** Want to understand your mortgage statement, a complex news article, or a new cooking recipe? Use the exact same steps – ask for a plain explanation, a short list of key points, then a quick quiz to lock in your understanding. It's like having a personal expert on standby.
- **For your business or work:** Turn a complex report or industry jargon into a one-page briefing for your team, and follow it with a short quiz to ensure everyone is on the same page about new procedures or project goals.
- **If you're just getting started:** The easiest first move is to pick a current study topic, ask the AI for a simple explanation, and then see how the summary looks. You'll instantly feel the benefit of having a personal tutor on demand.

Try it now

Open your AI chat tool, pick the subject you're studying this week, and type the first prompt from Step 2. In the next two minutes, you'll have a clear, beginner-friendly explanation right in front of you – the essential first step towards faster, more effective learning.

Build a personal study-buddy flashcard page in 15 minutes with Hugging Face Spaces

5 steps · Read online

> **In short:** You'll create a free **Static Space** on Hugging Face and paste in one ready-made `index.html` file. It shows your flashcards one by one: you think of the answer, reveal it, and mark **I knew it** or **Not yet**. Cards you don't know yet come back until you've got them all.

Flashcards work best when you test yourself instead of just rereading notes. This guide gives you a small quiz page you can open on any device with a browser. To be clear about what it is: it's a simple page that runs your own cards. It doesn't use an AI model, and it doesn't make up questions for you, so every answer it shows is one you wrote.

Before you start

- **A Hugging Face account.** Sign up at huggingface.co if you don't have one.
- **Know what's free.** Hugging Face's docs say Static Spaces are free for everyone and never need a paid plan. (Gradio and Docker Spaces, which run on compute, need a paid plan to create, so this guide uses a Static Space.)
- **A few questions you want to learn,** each with a short answer.
- **About 15 minutes.** You won't write code yourself: you'll copy one file and change only the question and answer text.

Step 1: Create a new Space

Go to huggingface.co/spaces and click **Create new Space** (or open huggingface.co/new-space directly). Fill in the form:

- **Name:** something short, such as `my-study-buddy`. It becomes part of your Space's address.
- **License:** optional. You can leave it empty.
- **SDK:** choose the **static HTML** option.
- **Visibility: Public** lets anyone with the link open your page. **Private** keeps the page and its files visible only to you (other people get a "404" error). Hugging Face notes that **Protected** is part of paid plans.

Then create the Space.

You'll know it worked when you're taken to your new Space's page, with tabs such as **Files**.

Step 2: Add the quiz file

Hugging Face's docs say a Static Space serves the HTML in a file called **index.html**. To add it in your browser, open the **Files** tab and click **Add file**, then choose to create a new file. Name it `index.html`.

If an `index.html` file is already listed in your Space, open that file and replace everything in it instead.

You'll know it worked when you see an editor where you can name the file and type its content.

Step 3: Paste the ready-made code

Copy this whole block and paste it into the file:

```
<!DOCTYPE html>
<html lang="en">
<head>
<meta charset="utf-8">
<meta name="viewport" content="width=device-width, initial-scale=1">
<title>My Study Buddy</title>
<style>
  body { font-family: system-ui, sans-serif; max-width: 560px; margin: 40px auto;
padding: 0 16px; }
  #card { border: 2px solid #ccc; border-radius: 12px; padding: 24px; min-height:
120px; }
  #answer { margin-top: 16px; }
  button { font-size: 16px; padding: 10px 16px; margin: 12px 8px 0 0; cursor: pointer;
}
</style>
</head>
<body>
<h2>🎏 My Study Buddy</h2>
<p id="progress"></p>
<div id="card">
  <strong id="question"></strong>
  <div id="answer" hidden></div>
</div>
<button id="show">Show answer</button>
<button id="knew" hidden>I knew it</button>
<button id="again" hidden>Not yet</button>
```

```
<script>
// Your flashcards: ["question", "answer"]. Change, add, or delete lines.
const CARDS = [
  ["What do plants make during photosynthesis?", "Sugar and oxygen, using sunlight,
water, and carbon dioxide."],
  ["What is the Spanish word for \"apple\"?", "la manzana"],
  ["What is 7 × 8?", "56"],
];

const queue = CARDS.slice();
for (let i = queue.length - 1; i > 0; i--) {
  const j = Math.floor(Math.random() * (i + 1));
  [queue[i], queue[j]] = [queue[j], queue[i]];
}
let known = 0;
const el = (id) => document.getElementById(id);

function showCard() {
  if (queue.length === 0) {
    el("question").textContent = "Done! You knew all " + CARDS.length + " cards. Reload
the page to start again.";
    el("answer").hidden = true;
    el("show").hidden = el("knew").hidden = el("again").hidden = true;
    el("progress").textContent = "";
    return;
  }
  el("question").textContent = queue[0][0];
  el("answer").textContent = queue[0][1];
  el("answer").hidden = true;
  el("show").hidden = false;
  el("knew").hidden = el("again").hidden = true;
  el("progress").textContent = "Known: " + known + " / " + CARDS.length;
}

el("show").onclick = () => {
  el("answer").hidden = false;
  el("show").hidden = true;
  el("knew").hidden = el("again").hidden = false;
};
```

```
el("knew").onclick = () => { queue.shift(); known++; showCard(); };
el("again").onclick = () => { queue.push(queue.shift()); showCard(); };

showCard();
</script>
</body>
</html>
```

At the bottom of the editor, save the file to the `main` branch (you can add a short message, such as "Add quiz page"). Hugging Face's docs say your Space rebuilds and restarts automatically each time you save a change.

You'll know it worked when `index.html` appears in your Space's file list.

Step 4: Try your flashcards

Open your Space's page (the **App** view). You'll see one question. Think of the answer, then click **Show answer**.

- Click **I knew it** to remove the card from this round.
- Click **Not yet** to send it to the back of the line. It will come back.

When every card is marked **I knew it**, the page says you're done. Reload the page to start a new round.

You'll know it worked when the counter at the top goes up each time you click **I knew it**.

Step 5: Put in your own questions

Open `index.html` again from the **Files** tab and edit the lines between `const CARDS = [` and `];`. Each card is one line in this shape:

```
  ["Your question?", "Your answer"],
```

Keep the quotation marks, the comma between question and answer, and the comma at the end of the line. If your text needs a quotation mark inside it, put a backslash in front of it (`\"`), as in the "apple" example. Save the file again, and your Space updates.

💬 Example:

> ["What is the capital of Canada?", "Ottawa"],

You'll know it worked when your own questions show up after you reload the page.

Common mistakes

- **The page is blank after an edit.** A missing quotation mark or comma in a card line usually causes this. Compare your line with the shape in Step 5, or paste the original code again.
- **Others can't open your link.** If your Space is private, only you can see it. You can change visibility later from your Space's **Settings** tab.
- **Expecting progress to be saved.** The page doesn't remember results between visits. Reloading starts a new round.
- **Expecting it to write questions for you.** It only shows the cards you typed. If you want help drafting questions, write them first with an AI assistant, check them yourself, then paste them in.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** Practice vocabulary, dates, or formulas on your phone in short sessions.
- **For your business or work:** Put product facts or safety steps on cards so new team members can quiz themselves. Keep the Space private if the content is internal.
- **If you're just getting started:** This is a low-risk first project on Hugging Face: one file, free hosting, and nothing to install.

Try it now

Create the Space, paste the code, and replace the three sample cards with five questions from whatever you're studying this week. Then go through one round and see how many you knew on the first try.

Using Perplexity AI for Quick Study Summaries and Exam Prep

5 steps · Read online

Imagine having a tireless study assistant that doesn't just summarize a topic, but actually shows you exactly where it found the answers. This guide will show you how to use Perplexity AI to create trustworthy study summaries and practice quizzes for any subject, helping you get ready for assessments with confidence. Perplexity is an **AI-powered answer engine** (a smart online tool that uses artificial intelligence to find information) that searches the web and answers with numbered citations, so you can check every important fact against the original source.

Before you start

- **A device with an internet connection:** You'll need a computer, tablet, or smartphone to access Perplexity AI.
- **A free Perplexity account:** You can sign up on perplexity.ai with your email address, Google, or Apple. The free plan is enough for this guide.
- **Rough total time:** About 10–15 minutes to complete your first summary and quiz.

Step 1 — Open Perplexity AI and start a new session

Go to **perplexity.ai** in your browser or open the Perplexity app, and start with an empty search box. Perplexity calls each conversation a **session**. Start a new session for each subject you study, so the summary and the quiz stay together and don't mix with other topics. You'll know it worked when you see an empty search box with no earlier answers above it.

Step 2 — Choose where Perplexity should look

Before typing your study question, you can tell Perplexity where to search. This is like telling a librarian which section of the library you're interested in.

In the search box, find the **globe icon** and click or tap it. **Web** is the everyday choice. Depending on your plan, you may also be able to narrow the search to a content type such as **Academic** (scholarly papers). Perplexity's help center notes that you can't switch Focus within a session, so choose before your first question. If you don't see a narrower option, stay with **Web** — it works well for most school subjects. You'll know it worked when your choice stays selected as you start typing. 💬 Example: Choose **Academic** if you see it and you're preparing an essay on a history or science topic.

Step 3 — Craft a clear question (prompt)

To get the best study summaries, you need to write a clear **prompt** (the instruction you give to an AI). Think of it like giving precise instructions to a diligent research assistant.

Type your detailed question into the search box. For study purposes, tell Perplexity what topic you want to learn and exactly how you want the information organized (e.g., "as a comparison table," "in bullet points"). Then select **Search** and send it. If the answer misses the point, rephrase your prompt with more detail. You'll know it worked when Perplexity writes a summary or explanation that follows the format you asked for. Example: "I am a biology student preparing for an exam. Summarize the key differences between mitosis and meiosis. Present this as a simple comparison table followed by bullet points explaining the main phases of each."

Step 4 — Review and verify sources (citations)

One of the main challenges with AI is **hallucination** (when an AI confidently makes up incorrect information). Perplexity helps you catch this by providing **citations** (links to the original pages where it found the information).

Perplexity's help center says each answer includes numbered citations linking to the original sources. Select one of the numbers next to a fact to open the source, then quickly scan it to check that the AI summarized it accurately. Some sources carry a small shield label — **Government**, **Academic**, or **Trusted** — which rates the website, not each individual claim, so still read the passage itself. You'll know it worked when you can see the original article or document behind that specific piece of information.

Step 5 — Generate a self-test quiz

The best way to prepare for an exam is through **active recall** (testing your memory rather than just rereading your notes). You can ask Perplexity to turn the summary it just made into a quick multiple-choice quiz.

Once your summary is complete, type a follow-up question in the box below the answer, asking Perplexity to create a quiz. Perplexity says follow-up questions stay in the same session, so it can build the quiz from the summary it just wrote. If it shows the answers right away, simply ask it to put them at the end. You'll know it worked when you see a list of numbered questions with answer options, ready for you to test your knowledge. Example: "Based on the summary of cell division you just created, write a 5-question multiple-choice quiz. Put the answers at the very bottom of your response so I don't see them while I test myself."

Common mistakes

- **Blindly trusting the summary:** Even the best AI can misinterpret or make up information.
    - **Fix:** Always open at least one or two of the numbered citations to cross-reference the information with the original source. It's like checking the references in a textbook.
- **Being too vague in your prompt:** If you just ask for "American history," you'll get a very generic, long wall of text.
    - **Fix:** Be specific about the era, topic, or event you are studying. Include keywords like "summarize," "explain," or "compare" to guide the AI.
- **Not keeping your best summaries:** If you're signed in, Perplexity keeps your sessions, but it's wise to keep important study notes in a place you control.
    - **Fix:** After a useful summary or quiz is generated, copy and paste the text into a document or a note-taking app to save it for later review.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** You can quickly look into a hobby, a household project, or a news story and check the facts behind the answer in the cited sources.
- **For your business or work:** You can research industry trends or new regulations and see exactly where each piece of information came from.
- **If you're just getting started:** Use Perplexity as a fast starting point for a difficult topic, then open the citations to go deeper without getting lost in endless search results.

Try it now

Open Perplexity AI and ask it: "What are the main stages of photosynthesis, presented as a bulleted list with simple explanations for each stage?" Make sure to open at least one citation to verify a fact.

The main AI assistants explained simply (and what each is best at)

4 steps · Read online

If you've ever felt overwhelmed by the growing number of AI assistants on the market, this guide is for you. We'll help you spot the right one for your everyday tasks by exploring their unique strengths. You'll learn how to identify which AI is best suited for different situations, from writing help to quick research.

Before you start

- **Internet connection:** You'll need a stable internet connection and a web browser (like Chrome, Firefox, or Safari) to access most of these tools. Many also offer free mobile apps for your smartphone or tablet.
- **Free account:** Most of the assistants we mention offer a "free tier" or trial, which lets you try them out without spending any money. You'll usually need to create a free account with an email address.
- **Device:** You can follow along using a computer, laptop, tablet, or smartphone. The screens might look slightly different, but the core steps remain the same.
- **Time commitment:** This guide will take roughly 5-7 minutes to read and understand. You can spend an extra 5-10 minutes trying out one or two of the assistants for yourself after reading.

Step 1 — Meet the friendly all-rounders (ChatGPT and Gemini)

These assistants are like versatile pocket-knives, great for a wide range of tasks. Both run on a **large language model (LLM)** – think of this as the AI's "brain" that lets it understand your questions and generate human-like text responses. Your action here is to mentally consider how these tools work.

When you open ChatGPT (from OpenAI) or Gemini (from Google), you'll typically see a clean chat window, often with a large text box at the bottom where you type your questions or "prompts." After you type your request and press Enter, the AI will start generating text in response. If the screen looks different, don't worry – most AI chat tools will have a clear input area marked "Ask me anything," "Type your message," or similar.

💬 Example: "Give me a step-by-step plan to organize my garage this weekend, including how to categorise items."

You'll know it worked when the AI starts typing out its response to your prompt, offering suggestions for your garage organization. While these tools can draft plans, they can't physically

tidy your garage for you!

Step 2 — Use the work-and-writing specialists (Claude and Copilot)

If your main need is professional writing or office-based tasks, these assistants are designed to shine. Your action in this step is to imagine using one of these for a work-related task.

For Claude (from Anthropic), you'll find a similar chat interface to the all-rounders, usually with a clear text input box. When you enter a prompt asking for help with writing or summarizing, Claude will generate a response, often known for its thoughtful and natural tone. If you're using Copilot (from Microsoft), you won't typically open a separate app; instead, you'll see a small "Copilot" icon or button appear directly within Microsoft Office apps like Word, Excel, or Outlook. Tapping this often opens a side panel where you can chat with the AI about the document you're working on.

💬 Example: "Read this draft email to my landlord and help me make the tone more polite but firm."

You'll know it worked when Claude gives you a refined version of your email or Copilot, within your Office app, offers suggestions directly relevant to your document. Note that Copilot's deeper integration might require a specific Microsoft 365 subscription. These tools can polish your words, but they can't actually send the email or write the entire report from scratch without your input.

Step 3 — Try the search and social discoverers (Perplexity and Grok)

When you need facts, summaries from the web, or insights into the latest trends, these assistants act like research helpers. Your action for this step is to understand how these tools gather and present information differently from a standard search engine.

If you open Perplexity, you'll typically see a straightforward search bar, much like a regular internet search engine. After you type your question, instead of just a list of links, Perplexity will present a clear, summarized answer based on its web search, complete with footnotes or links to the sources it used. For Grok (from xAI), which is linked to the X platform (formerly Twitter), you might access it via the X app or a dedicated Grok interface. It will provide real-time summaries of news, public opinion, or trending topics as they happen on the platform.

💬 Example: "What are the latest updates on the local public transport extensions, and where can I read the official announcements?"

You'll know it worked when Perplexity provides a concise answer with clickable source links, or Grok presents a summary of current discussions and news related to your query. While these tools are great for summarizing information, they don't perform actual investigative journalism or verify the ultimate truth of every piece of content they find.

Step 4 — Explore international options (Qwen, Mistral and DeepSeek)

Beyond the most well-known names, there are powerful AI assistants developed by companies around the world, each with unique strengths. Your action here is to consider these tools for tasks that might benefit from specialized capabilities like language translation or complex reasoning.

When you access Qwen (from Alibaba), Mistral's assistant (now called Vibe, formerly Le Chat) or DeepSeek, you'll generally encounter a familiar chat interface. For Qwen, after you input text, it excels at translating and understanding cultural nuances, particularly across Asian languages. DeepSeek often stands out for its strong abilities in logical problem-solving, mathematics, and coding assistance. The screen usually features a clear chat history and a text input area at the bottom.

💬 Example: "Translate this business greeting into polite conversational Japanese and explain any cultural etiquette I should keep in mind."

You'll know it worked when the AI provides a translation that feels culturally appropriate, or delivers a well-reasoned answer to a complex, logical problem. These assistants can provide sophisticated language and reasoning help, but they cannot replace a human expert for critical cross-cultural communication or advanced coding projects.

Common mistakes

- **Assuming perfect accuracy:** AI can sometimes "hallucinate" – meaning it confidently generates incorrect or made-up facts. Always double-check critical information like dates, legal details, medical advice, or statistics, as the AI cannot guarantee truth.
- **Stopping after the first answer:** If the AI's first response isn't quite right, don't give up! Treat the assistant like a conversation partner. Guide it by saying, "That's a bit too formal – can you make it sound friendlier?" or "Can you expand on point number three?"
- **Using overly vague prompts:** Giving the AI too little detail can lead to generic or unhelpful answers. Instead of "Write a story," try "Write a short, uplifting story about a shy koala who learns to sing, set in a misty rainforest, for children aged 5-7."

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** Use Gemini to find a recipe from the ingredients you already have in your fridge, or consider Claude to craft a heartfelt birthday card with just the right tone.
- **For your business or work:** Let Copilot summarize long meeting notes directly inside your document, or have ChatGPT draft social media posts to free up your creative time for other tasks.
- **If you're just getting started:** Pick one assistant that seems most appealing, spend a few minutes exploring its interface and trying a simple prompt, then gradually add more tools to your digital toolkit as you become comfortable.

Try it now

Open a free account with **ChatGPT** or **Gemini** in your web browser right now. Look for the large text box at the bottom of the screen, then copy and paste this prompt to see how the assistant responds: *"Write a friendly three-sentence reminder for my neighbor about the upcoming rubbish collection day."* You'll know it worked when the AI generates a response directly in the chat window.

How to use Meta AI inside WhatsApp – step-by-step for beginners

6 steps · Read online

By the end of this guide, you'll be able to ask Meta AI for answers, recipe ideas, or quick drafts right from your WhatsApp conversation, even if you've never used AI before. This is perfect for anyone who wants to quickly tap into AI without switching between apps.

Before you start

- You need a WhatsApp account set up on your phone (either an iPhone running iOS or an Android device).
- Your WhatsApp app should be updated to its latest version, as this often brings new features like the Meta AI button.
- Meta AI is generally a free feature within WhatsApp, so you won't need a paid plan for this guide.
- You should be comfortable tapping a few icons and typing messages, no coding or special skills are needed.
- This guide will take roughly 5-10 minutes to follow all the steps and try out your first AI chat.

Step 1 — Find the Meta AI chat

To begin, open WhatsApp on your phone and go to the **Chats** tab. Look for the **Meta AI** icon there — WhatsApp's own help page describes it as a multicolored oval ring (some people see a pink-and-purple one, others a blue-and-purple one). Tap it to open your chat with Meta AI. If you don't see it, tap the **Search** field at the top of your Chats instead. **What you see:** The ring-shaped Meta AI icon on the Chats tab, or the Search field at the top. **What happens next:** Tapping the icon opens your chat with Meta AI. In the Search field, you can tap one of the suggested prompts, or type your own question and tap **Ask**. **If it looks different:** Meta AI isn't available in every country or in every language yet, and the icon's colors can vary. If you can't find it at all, update WhatsApp first and check again. 💬 Example: Tap the Search field at the top of your Chats, type "Suggest a quick dinner idea", and tap **Ask**. **You'll know it worked when:** A chat with Meta AI opens and your question appears in it.

Step 2 — Start your first conversation

Once you've found "Meta AI" (either through the Meta AI icon or search), tap on its name to open the chat window. This is just like starting a conversation with a friend. You'll likely see a welcome message explaining what Meta AI can do. To activate the AI, you need to send it your

first message. **What you see:** The Meta AI chat screen with a welcome message from the AI, and a message typing box at the bottom. **What happens next:** After sending your message, Meta AI will process it using a **Large Language Model (LLM)** – think of an LLM as a very smart, digital brain that understands and generates human-like text. It will then type a response back to you. **If it looks different:** Instead of a "Start chat" button, you might just be able to type directly into the message box. This is normal. 💬 Example: Type "Hi Meta AI, what can you do?" and press the send button (usually a paper plane icon). **You'll know it worked when:** Meta AI sends a friendly greeting or an explanation of its capabilities in reply to your message.

Step 3 — Ask a question or give a task

Now that you've started the conversation, it's time to ask Meta AI for something specific. This instruction you give is called a **prompt**. The clearer and more detailed your prompt, the better and more useful Meta AI's response will be. Think of it as telling a helpful assistant exactly what you need. **What you see:** Your prompt appears in the chat, and a "typing..." indicator usually shows that Meta AI is working on its response. **What happens next:** Meta AI will generate an answer, idea, or draft based on your prompt and display it in the chat. This process usually takes a few seconds. **If it looks different:** Sometimes the AI replies almost instantly, without a "typing..." indicator. This is fine – it just means it's processed your request very quickly. 💬 Example: Type "What's a simple, healthy breakfast idea I can make in under 5 minutes?" and send it. **You'll know it worked when:** Meta AI's detailed response appears in the chat window, directly addressing your question.

Step 4 — Use the AI's reply

Once Meta AI has generated its response, you have several options for how to use the information. You can copy the text, forward it to another chat, or simply read it and continue the conversation. For now, let's try copying the response so you can paste it anywhere you like. **What you see:** Meta AI's reply is displayed in the chat. Next to or below the message, you might see small icons like an arrow to forward, or you can often tap and hold the message for more options. **What happens next:** The selected text will be copied to your phone's clipboard, ready for you to paste into a note, an email, or another WhatsApp chat. **If it looks different:** If you don't see a specific "copy" button, try tapping and holding Meta AI's message. A small menu should pop up with options, including "Copy". 💬 Example: Tap and hold Meta AI's breakfast recipe, then choose "Copy" from the menu that appears. **You'll know it worked when:** You can switch to another app (like your notes app) and successfully paste the recipe text there. Remember, Meta AI can draft the message, but it can't send it to other people for you.

Step 5 — Keep the conversation flowing

Meta AI remembers what you've discussed earlier in the same chat. This is called its **context window** – think of it like the AI's short-term memory for your current conversation. You can ask follow-up questions or refine your previous request without having to repeat all the details. **What you see:** Your new follow-up question in the chat, appearing below Meta AI's last reply. **What happens next:** Meta AI will consider your new question in light of everything you've talked about so far in this chat. It will then provide a response that builds on the previous information. **If it looks different:** If the AI seems to "forget" an earlier detail, it might be due to the context window reaching its limit, or your follow-up prompt might be too vague. Just try rephrasing your question with a little more detail. 💬 Example: After getting the breakfast idea, type "Can you suggest some healthy lunch ideas too, keeping the 5-minute prep time in mind?" and send. **You'll know it worked when:** Meta AI provides new lunch ideas that are specifically quick and healthy, without you having to re-explain those requirements.

Step 6 — Start a fresh chat for a new topic

If you want to talk about something completely unrelated to your current conversation, start a new chat with Meta AI. A separate thread keeps the two topics apart, so the AI focuses on your new question. **What you see:** Your open chat with Meta AI. **What happens next:** Tap the **new chat** button (a plus sign). WhatsApp starts a separate thread and names it after your first message. **If it looks different:** If you don't see the plus sign, go back to the Chats tab and open Meta AI again from its icon or the Search field — the feature can look a little different depending on your region and app version. 💬 Example: Open your chat with Meta AI, tap the plus sign, and type "Help me plan a picnic for four people." **You'll know it worked when:** A new, empty Meta AI chat opens, named after your first message.

Common mistakes

- **Not finding the Meta AI chat:** Sometimes the Meta AI icon isn't immediately visible, or you might overlook the search bar.
    - **The fix:** Always try the **Search** bar at the top of your WhatsApp Chats screen and type "Meta AI". It will appear in your contacts. Also, ensure your WhatsApp app is fully updated, as new features roll out in versions.
- **Using vague prompts:** Asking things like "Help me with work" is too broad, and Meta AI won't know where to start.
    - **The fix:** Be specific! Provide context, keywords, or examples. For instance, "Draft a short email to my team about our meeting on Friday" is much better.
- **Expecting unlimited memory:** While Meta AI remembers your current chat, it doesn't remember previous chats or things from days ago.
    - **The fix:** If you're switching to a completely new topic or continuing a discussion from a long time ago, start a new chat (see Step 6) and provide all the necessary

context in your first prompt.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** Need a quick travel tip, a joke for a group chat, or a summarized news headline? Just type it into WhatsApp and Meta AI does the heavy lifting, giving you instant information or creative sparks without leaving your messaging app.
- **For your business or work:** Draft a short client email, get a bullet-point outline for a meeting agenda, or brainstorm taglines for a project without needing to open a separate writing tool. It's a quick assistant right in your pocket.
- **If you're just getting started:** The easiest first move is simply sending a friendly "Hello Meta AI" and seeing its response. This requires no extra apps or sign-ups beyond your existing WhatsApp account.

Try it now

In the next two minutes, open WhatsApp, find "Meta AI" using its icon on the Chats tab or the search bar, send the message "What’s a fun weekend activity for two people near the beach?" and glance at the answer. You’ve just taken your first step into AI-powered chatting!

A Beginner's Guide to Using ChatGPT Voice for Hands-Free Tasks

6 steps · Read online

By the end of this guide, you'll be able to start a spoken conversation with ChatGPT and get it to help you cook, drive, or tidy up – all without lifting a finger. This is perfect for anyone who wants a little extra help while multitasking and keeping their hands free.

Before you start

- **ChatGPT app installed:** You'll need the official ChatGPT app on your smartphone or tablet (available for iPhone and Android devices).
- **OpenAI account:** Make sure you're signed in with your OpenAI account. This feature is available on both free and paid plans, though paid users might get access to newer voice models sooner.
- **Quiet spot:** For the best experience, choose a place with minimal background noise so your device can hear your voice clearly.
- **Rough time commitment:** This entire process should take about 5-10 minutes to set up and try your first conversation.

Step 1 — Start the voice conversation

Open the ChatGPT app on your device. Once the main chat screen loads, you'll see a text input box at the bottom. To activate the voice mode, **tap the voice icon** located in the bottom-right corner, next to where you'd normally type your message. This is typically represented by a waveform or sound wave symbol. Tapping it switches the app into *real-time voice* – meaning you can speak to the AI and hear its reply instantly, much like a phone call.

If it looks different: The icon might sometimes move slightly due to app updates, but it's typically in the bottom-right area. Look for a waveform symbol or a microphone icon that suggests voice interaction.

You'll know it worked when a new screen appears with a dynamic animation (often a colorful wave or line) that responds to sound, indicating it's ready to listen.

Step 2 — Choose a voice you like

When you use the voice mode for the very first time, the app will usually present a list of sample voices for ChatGPT to use. **Tap on each option** to hear a short demo of the different tones and accents available, then **select your favorite** by tapping the "Choose" button (or a similar selection option). This voice will be used for all future spoken interactions.

If it looks different: If you don't see the voice selection screen, it means a default voice is already set. You can change this later by going to the ChatGPT app's main "Settings" menu (usually found by tapping your profile picture in the top-left or bottom-left corner of the main chat screen) and looking for a "Speech" or "Voice" option under the ChatGPT settings.

You'll know it worked when the screen transitions from the voice selection menu to the main listening indicator, confirming your chosen voice has been saved.

Step 3 — Give your first spoken instruction

The screen will now display a simple listening indicator – typically a wave animation or a microphone icon – letting you know ChatGPT is ready for your input. **Speak your first *prompt* naturally**, as if you were talking to a friend. A *prompt* is simply the instruction, question, or statement you give to the AI. There's no need to press any button while you talk; the app automatically detects when you've finished speaking based on pauses.

💬 Example: "Hi! I'm planning a weekend trip to the Blue Ridge Mountains. Can you suggest some scenic bushwalks that are good for beginners?"

If it looks different: If the listening indicator doesn't seem to react to your voice, check your phone's microphone permissions for the ChatGPT app in your device's main settings. You might also need to speak a little louder or clearer if you're in a noisy environment.

You'll know it worked when the dynamic animation responds to your voice as you speak, and then after a brief pause, you'll see your words appear as text on the screen, ready for ChatGPT to process.

Step 4 — Hear the reply and respond

After you finish speaking and your words appear on screen, the ChatGPT app will pause briefly to process your request. Then, in your chosen voice, it will **speak the answer back to you**. Listen carefully to the response. Once the AI has finished its reply, the listening indicator will reappear automatically. Simply **speak your follow-up question or comment** immediately – you don't need to tap the screen or press any buttons to continue the conversation.

💬 Example: "Those sound great! What's the best way to get to the Wentworth Falls track if I'm coming from Chicago?"

If it looks different: If the AI cuts off or mishears you, just say "Could you please repeat that?" or "I wasn't finished, sorry!" and continue. Sometimes, a strong accent or background noise can make it difficult for the AI to understand everything perfectly.

You'll know it worked when the AI responds directly to your follow-up, seamlessly continuing the dialogue as if you were talking to a person.

Step 5 — Control your spoken conversation

While you're chatting with ChatGPT, you have a few ways to manage the conversation. If you need it to **pause** while it's speaking, you can simply say "Stop" or "Hold on." To manually **end the entire voice conversation** and return to the text chat screen, look for a prominent 'X' icon or a 'Stop' button that usually appears on the screen during the voice session. Tapping this will close the voice interface.

Example: (While ChatGPT is explaining) "ChatGPT, hold on a moment please."

If it looks different: The exact look and placement of the 'X' or 'Stop' button might vary slightly depending on your device or app version, but it's typically easy to spot. If you can't find it, you can always close the app entirely and reopen it to reset the session.

You'll know it worked when the AI pauses its reply immediately, or when the voice interface closes and you return to the standard text chat screen.

Step 6 — Go fully hands-free

Now that you know how to start and control a voice conversation, you can truly go hands-free! **Place your phone on a kitchen bench**, slip it into a pocket, or set it on the car console. The voice mode is designed to keep listening for your commands and responses, even if the screen dims. You can now use ChatGPT as a constant companion for various tasks without needing to interact with the screen.

Example: "Okay ChatGPT, tell me a short mystery story, but pause every two minutes so I can guess the suspect."

If it looks different: If the AI stops responding when the screen dims, check your phone's power-saving settings; some modes can restrict background app activity. Ensure you have a stable internet connection, as dropped signals can interrupt the conversation.

You'll know it worked when you can continue to ask questions, receive answers, and have a natural back-and-forth with ChatGPT, all while your hands are busy with other activities.

Common mistakes

- **Pausing too long mid-sentence:** The AI may think you're finished and start responding, which can interrupt your thoughts.

    - **Fix:** If this happens, simply say "Hold on, I wasn't done yet" and continue speaking. The AI is usually forgiving and will pick up where you left off.
- **Background noise:** Loud noises like a running tap, frying pans, or traffic can confuse your phone's microphone, making it hard for ChatGPT to understand you.
    - **Fix:** Using earbuds with a built-in microphone helps a lot, as they focus on your voice and filter out ambient sounds.
- **Using keyword strings:** You don't need to speak like a search query (e.g., "Recipe pumpkin chicken fast"). This isn't how conversational AI works.
    - **Fix:** Talk naturally, using full sentences and common language. ChatGPT's language model is designed to understand everyday speech patterns, making your interactions much smoother.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** Turn mundane chores like washing dishes, tidying up, or gardening into moments for learning. Ask for recipe ideas, quick facts, shopping list additions, or even play an interactive game – all without needing to touch your phone.
- **For your business or work:** Dictate initial drafts of emails, practice a presentation out loud, or simply think through a complex problem while you're commuting or taking a walk. It can act as a sounding board, helping you organize your thoughts.
- **If you're just getting started:** Try using the voice feature while you're cooking. It keeps the screen clean of sticky fingers and makes the kitchen a more interactive and helpful space. ChatGPT can read out ingredients, convert measurements, or even suggest substitutions on the fly.

Try it now

Grab your phone, open the ChatGPT app, and tap the voice icon in the bottom-right corner. Once the listening screen appears, say:

> "Hi! I have leftover roast chicken, half a pumpkin and some spinach. What quick dinner can I make?"

You'll hear the AI's suggestion right away – that's your first step into having a hands-free conversation with AI!

Getting started with DeepSeek for everyday help

6 steps · Read online

Imagine having a brilliant, patient assistant who doesn't just give you quick answers, but actually sits down and thinks through your trickiest problems step-by-step. By the end of this guide, you will know how to use DeepSeek, a powerful AI tool, to organize your daily life and solve complex tasks, giving you more clarity and saving you time.

Before you start

- **An internet connection:** You'll need to be connected to the internet.
- **A computer or mobile device:** You can access DeepSeek through a web browser on your computer or by downloading their official app on your smartphone or tablet.
- **An email address or phone number:** You will need one of these to create your free DeepSeek account.
- **Rough total time:** This guide should take about 6-8 minutes to follow through completely.

Step 1 — Set up your free account

Your first action is to visit the official DeepSeek website in your web browser or download the DeepSeek app from your device's app store. Once on the site or in the app, you'll see a landing page. Look for a button like **Sign Up** or **Log In**, usually located in the top-right corner or center of the screen. Tap or click this to begin. After choosing to create an account (e.g., with email, Google, or mobile number), you'll be guided through providing your details and verifying them. If it looks different: The buttons might say "Register" or "Create Account". Just pick the option that lets you set up a new account. You'll know it worked when you see a clean, simple chat screen appear, usually with a text box at the bottom ready for your messages.

Step 2 — Turn on "Deep Think"

DeepSeek has a special superpower called **Deep Think**, which is its *reasoning model*. Think of a *reasoning model* like a thoughtful chef who talks through a complex recipe out loud, planning each step before they start chopping, rather than just handing you a plate of food instantly. This mode helps DeepSeek slow down, plan its thoughts, and makes it incredibly accurate for puzzles, math, or tricky organization tasks. On your chat screen, look for a toggle switch or button near the text input box that says **Deep Think**. Click or tap it to turn it on. If it looks different: The toggle might be labeled "Reasoning Mode", "Plan & Execute", or might be hidden under a small settings icon next to the chat box. Look for any option that implies a more thoughtful, step-by-

step approach. You'll know it worked when the toggle switch changes color, moves to an "on" position, or shows a clear indicator that Deep Think is active.

Step 3 — Write your first prompt

Now it's time to write your first *prompt*. A *prompt* is simply the instructions or questions you type to the AI, like giving clear directions to a helpful assistant. Because DeepSeek excels at reasoning, you can ask it complex questions that involve budgets, scheduling, or making difficult decisions. Type your instructions into the text box at the bottom of the screen, ensuring you provide as much detail as possible to help the AI understand your needs. If it looks different: The text box might have placeholder text like "Ask me anything..." or "Type your message here." Example: Copy and paste this prompt into the chat box to try it out:

> "I have a busy Saturday ahead. I need to take the dog to the vet at 9:00am (takes 1 hour), buy groceries (takes 45 minutes), and drop off a birthday present at my sister's house, which is a 20-minute drive from the vet. I also need to be home by 1:00pm for a delivery. Can you organize the perfect, stress-free schedule for me, including realistic travel times?" You'll know it worked when your text appears clearly in the input box, ready to be sent.

Step 4 — Send your prompt and observe the 'thinking'

With your detailed prompt ready in the text box, your next action is to send it to DeepSeek. Look for a "send" button, usually an arrow, paper plane icon, or a button labeled "Send" or "Enter", typically located next to your text box. Click or tap this button. What happens next is a small moment of anticipation. DeepSeek will start to process your request, and you'll often see an indicator showing it's "thinking" or "generating" a response. This process might take a few seconds, especially with Deep Think enabled, as it meticulously plans its answer. If it looks different: The send button might be a simple text label that says "Go" or "Submit." Just click the clear action that makes your message go to the AI. You'll know it worked when your prompt disappears from the input box and appears in the chat history above, and you see an animation or text like "DeepSeek is thinking..." appear.

Step 5 — Review DeepSeek's thought process

Once DeepSeek has finished processing your request, it will display its "thought process" before giving you the final answer. This is a unique and valuable feature. You'll see a small section appear, often collapsible, labeled something like "Thought Process" or "Steps Taken". Your action is to click on this section to expand it. What happens next is fascinating: you'll see a detailed breakdown of how the AI approached your problem, organizing the timeline, double-checking travel distances, and ensuring everything fits your criteria. If it looks different: Look for a small

arrow, a "Show details" button, or "Expand" next to the thought process summary. This might also be represented by a small icon that you click. You'll know it worked when the thought process section opens up, revealing several bullet points or numbered steps explaining the AI's internal logic.

Step 6 — Read the final answer

After reviewing DeepSeek's planning steps, scroll down past the expanded thought process. Your next action is simply to read the final, polished answer or solution that DeepSeek has generated based on its detailed reasoning. What you see is the practical outcome of its "thinking" mode – in our example, a perfectly organized, stress-free schedule for your Saturday. The answer will usually be clearly presented, often using bold text, bullet points, or numbered lists to make it easy to follow. If it looks different: The formatting of the final answer might vary slightly, but the core information will be there. It might be a solid block of text if your prompt was very simple. You'll know it worked when you see the complete, well-structured schedule, or the answer to your question, displayed clearly below DeepSeek's thought process.

Common mistakes

- **Impatience with "Deep Think":** Because Deep Think mode is working hard behind the scenes to calculate the best route or solution, it might take 10 to 15 seconds to start writing. Don't worry—it hasn't frozen! The wait is worth the highly accurate result.
- **Keeping your prompts too simple:** DeepSeek thrives on detail, especially in "Deep Think" mode. If you just ask it to "make a schedule," it has to guess too much. Tell it your preferences, your time limits, and your goals to get the best outcome.
- **Forgetting to enable "Deep Think":** If you're asking a complex question and getting a very quick, but potentially less detailed, answer, double-check that you've remembered to toggle "Deep Think" on. It makes a big difference for intricate tasks.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** You can use DeepSeek to budget your weekly groceries, plan a holiday itinerary with driving times and stops, or get complex topics (like how home loans work) explained in simple, easy-to-understand terms.
- **For your business or work:** You can use it to draft professional emails for tricky situations, solve complex spreadsheet formulas, or brainstorm creative marketing ideas for your local business, knowing it will think through the nuances.
- **If you're just getting started:** Keep the "Deep Think" toggle on for any task that involves planning, problem-solving, or making decisions. Treat it like a friendly colleague who loves helping you double-check your plans and figure things out.

Try it now

Let's test DeepSeek's brainpower right now. Open your new DeepSeek chat, make sure **Deep Think** is toggled on, and send this prompt:

> "Explain the difference between a solar eclipse and a lunar eclipse as if I am a ten-year-old. Use a fun analogy using kitchen items like oranges and torches."

Getting started with MiniMax Code: a beginner's guide

6 steps · Read online

> **In short:** MiniMax Code is an AI helper you reach through its website at agent.minimax.io. You'll need an account, and some features may depend on the plan you choose. Check its current details on the official site. Always review what it gives you before you act on it.

Have you heard that AI tools can help with much more than writing code, but you're not sure where to begin? This guide is for you. By the end, you'll have signed in, sent your first everyday request, and learned a simple habit for checking the answers. You don't need any technical background.

Before you start

- **An internet connection and a web browser** on a computer, tablet, or phone. A larger screen is easier for beginners.
- **A MiniMax account.** You'll create one on the official site during Step 1.
- **About 20 to 30 minutes** for the whole guide. Plan limits and features may change, so look at the official site for current details.

Step 1 — Open the official site and find the sign-in button

Type **agent.minimax.io** into your browser's address bar and press Enter. Before you go further, make sure the address in the bar matches exactly, because fake sites often look similar. The home page should load, and you'll usually see a button in the top corner or the center of the page that says something like **Sign in**, **Log in**, or **Get started**. Click it. You'll be asked to create an account or sign in with an email address or another option the page shows.

Choose the option that fits you, enter the details it asks for, and follow the confirmation steps. Use a password you don't use anywhere else.

If it looks different: the page layout changes often. If you can't see a sign-in button, look for a menu icon (three short lines) in a corner.

You'll know it worked when the site shows a welcome screen or a chat area instead of the sign-in form.

Step 2 — Find the place where you type your request

Once you're signed in, look for a large text box near the bottom or center of the screen. It may have placeholder text such as "Ask anything" or "Send a message," though yours may read

differently. This is where you type. The tool is designed for back-and-forth conversation, so think of it as a patient assistant you can keep talking to.

Click inside the box, and a blinking cursor should appear. Type a single short test sentence, such as "Hello, can you hear me?" and press the send button, which often looks like a paper plane or an arrow. Wait a few seconds for the reply to appear.

If it looks different: if you don't see a text box, look for a button labeled "New chat" or a plus sign, then try again. If nothing responds, refresh the page.

You'll know it worked when your message appears on screen and a reply starts to appear below it.

Step 3 — Send your first everyday request

Now try something that has nothing to do with programming. Everyday planning is a good starting point. Type a request with a few specific details, because the more context you give, the more useful the answer usually is.

💬 Example: "Help me plan five easy weekday dinners for [number] people. Keep each meal under 30 minutes and list the ingredients for each one."

Replace the bracketed part with your own details. Send the message and read the reply slowly. A good answer usually has a clear structure, such as a list or a set of steps.

If it looks different: if the reply is too general, that's normal for a first try. Don't worry. Step 4 shows how to improve it.

You'll know it worked when you get a reply that is organized and relates to the details you gave.

Step 4 — Ask follow-up questions to improve the answer

The first reply is rarely the final one. Treat it as a draft. Type a follow-up message that points to exactly what you want to change. You can ask it to shorten the answer, add something, or change the tone. The tool remembers the earlier part of the same chat, so you don't need to repeat everything.

💬 Example: "Thanks. Make the list vegetarian, and cut it down to three dinners that need no more than five ingredients each."

Send the message and compare the new reply with the first one. If you're not happy with the result, you can simply keep refining. This back-and-forth is the most useful skill you'll practice.

If it looks different: if the tool seems to lose track of the conversation, start a new chat and paste in the key details again. Long chats can get confusing, so shorter ones are often easier to follow.

You'll know it worked when the second reply reflects your changes and keeps the parts you liked.

Step 5 — Try a summary task, and leave out private details

A very practical use is condensing long text. Find a short article, a newsletter, or a message you're allowed to share, and copy a paragraph or two of it. Paste it into the text box, then type your instruction after it. Keep the text you paste free of passwords, bank numbers, medical details, and anything else private, since you should assume anything you share in a chat is sensitive.

Example: "Summarize the text below in five short bullet points for a busy reader. Text: [paste your paragraph here]"

Read the summary next to the original to check that the main points are really there. Summaries can leave things out or change emphasis, so spot-check them.

If it looks different: if pasting doesn't work on your device, type a shorter excerpt by hand instead.

You'll know it worked when the reply lists the main points from the text you shared in a shorter form.

Step 6 — Check the answer before you trust it

This is the most important step. AI tools can produce confident answers that are incorrect, and that's a known limitation of this whole category of technology. Before you act on any answer that involves facts, dates, prices, or health, financial, or legal matters, check it against an official source. You can also ask the tool to show its assumptions so you know what to verify.

Example: "List the three main assumptions behind your last answer, so I can check each one myself."

Read the list and verify the points that matter most. For health, money, or legal decisions, talk to a qualified professional. The tool can explain a topic, but it isn't a substitute for expert advice.

If it looks different: if the tool doesn't give a clear list, ask it directly what it's unsure about in its answer.

You'll know it worked when you can point to the specific claims you still need to verify.

Common mistakes

- **Typing the same vague request and expecting a perfect answer.** Fix it by adding details like who the answer is for, how long it should be, and what format you want.
- **Sharing private information in the chat.** Fix it by removing names, account numbers, passwords, and personal health details before you paste anything.
- **Trusting every answer without checking.** Fix it by verifying important facts on an official source, as described in Step 6.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** you can use it to plan meals, draft a polite message to a neighbor, or break a long to-do list into smaller steps.
- **For your business or work:** you can use it to outline a presentation, rewrite a meeting summary, or brainstorm ideas, then review the results yourself.
- **If you're just getting started:** begin with low-stakes tasks like planning or summarizing, and build from there.

It can draft, organize, and explain, but it can't confirm that what it says is true, and it can't see your files, email, or accounts unless you share the content in the chat.

Try it now

Open agent.minimax.io, sign in, and type this into the text box: "Give me three simple ideas for a 10-minute daily habit that helps me [your goal, such as sleep better or save time]." Read the reply, then ask one follow-up question to improve it. You've just completed your first real conversation.

Organize your work with Claude Projects – a step-by-step beginner's guide

6 steps · Read online

By the end of this guide you'll have a brand-new Claude Project that holds all your relevant chats and documents, and you'll know how to ask Claude to draw on everything at once. It's ideal for anyone who wants a clean, goal-focused AI workspace without needing any technical background.

Before you start

- **Claude account:** Sign up for a free Anthropic Claude account (you'll need an email and a password).
- **Device:** A desktop or laptop with a modern web browser (Chrome, Edge, Firefox or Safari).
- **Plan:** Projects are available on Claude — check the current plan details for file size limits.
- **Time:** Expect about 5–7 minutes to complete all steps.

Step 1 — Sign in and open the Claude dashboard

Open your browser, go to **claude.anthropic.com**, and click the **Log in** button. You'll see a screen with fields for your email and password; enter them and press **Enter**. After logging in, the main chat view appears – a white space with a text box at the bottom. Look for the navigation area in the sidebar; you should see a section labeled "Projects". If you don't see it immediately, look for a menu option called "Dashboard" or similar. 💬 Example: `email@example.com` + `YourPassword` → press **Enter**.
You'll know it worked when you see a list of past conversations and a side panel showing your Projects.

Step 2 — Create a new Project

In the Projects area, find a button to create a new project – it may say "+ New Project" or show a similar create option. Click it; a small dialog pops up asking for a name and an optional description. A **Project** is just a digital folder that groups together chats and files for a single aim – think of it as a binder you keep on your desk. Type a clear name (e.g., `Q3 Marketing Campaign`) and a short description (e.g., `Copy, ad ideas and feedback for the next quarter`). 💬 Example:

```
Name: Q3 Marketing Campaign
Description: All copy, ad ideas and feedback for the upcoming quarter
```

You'll know it worked when the new project appears in your project list, and the main area switches to an empty workspace titled with your project name.

Step 3 — Add existing chats to the Project

With your project open, look for a way to add existing conversations – there may be an "Add conversation" button or similar option. Click it; a panel slides in showing recent chats with check-boxes beside each title. A **chat** (or conversation) is simply a previous dialogue you've had with Claude. Tick the boxes next to the chats you want linked (e.g., "Ad copy brainstorming" and "Email subject line ideas"). After selecting, press the **Add** button at the bottom of the panel. Some versions may let you drag a chat tile into the project area instead of using check-boxes – if you don't see check-boxes, try dragging. 💬 Example: Tick "Ad copy brainstorming" and "Email subject line ideas", then click **Add**.
You'll know it worked when those chat titles appear as cards inside the project workspace, indicating they're now part of the same folder.

Step 4 — Upload supporting files

Next, locate an upload option in the project pane – it may be labeled "Attach file", "Upload file", or show as an icon. Click it; a file-chooser window opens. Navigate to a document on your computer (PDF, text file, spreadsheet or image) and select it, or simply drag the file onto the designated area. Claude will process the file, extracting its text so it can be referenced later. If you only see a large rectangle that says "Drag files here or click to upload", that's the same upload area. 💬 Example: Drag `CampaignBrief.pdf` from your desktop onto the upload box.
You'll know it worked when the file shows up as a line item inside the project, often with a tiny icon indicating its type (PDF, sheet, etc.) and a loading bar that disappears once processing finishes.

Step 5 — Write a prompt that uses everything

Now you can ask Claude to work across the whole project. In the text box at the bottom of the project screen, type a clear instruction that refers to the combined material. A **prompt** is simply the question or task you give the AI. For example, ask it to summarize the ideas from the attached chats and the PDF, then suggest three headline options. Press **Enter**. Claude will read the linked chats and the uploaded file, then start typing a response that pulls information from all sources. If the answer seems vague, try re-phrasing with more specifics – Claude usually produces better results when the prompt is detailed. 💬 Example:

```
Summarize the key ideas from all attached chats and the brief, and suggest three
headline options.
```

You'll know it worked when Claude's reply includes references to the chat content and the PDF, such as "Based on the ad copy brainstorming chat..." or "From the CampaignBrief.pdf...".

Step 6 — Share the Project (optional)

If you want teammates to see or edit the workspace, look for a **Share** button – it may be shown as an icon or found inside a "More actions" menu. Click it; a dialog appears offering a copy-able link or an email-invite field. Choose **Copy link**, then paste the URL into an email or chat message. Some versions may place the sharing options inside a dropdown menu; if you don't see the option directly, look for a menu with additional actions. 💬 Example: Click **Share**, then press **Copy link**.
You'll know it worked when a small banner appears saying "Link copied to clipboard" or when an invitation confirmation message shows up.

Wrap-up — What you've achieved and where to go next

You now have a fully functional Claude Project that brings together past chats, files, and a single prompt that pulls from everything. This workspace can be reused: simply add new chats or files as the task evolves, and ask Claude to update its output. In future sessions you can duplicate the project (look for a "Duplicate" or "Copy" option) to keep a record of each campaign or research topic. Remember that Claude can read the content you upload, but it cannot send emails or publish documents for you – you'll need to copy the generated text into your own tools.

Common mistakes

- **Skipping the description:** Without a clear name or description you may forget the project's purpose.
  Fix: Add a brief description when creating the project; you can edit it later by clicking the project title.
- **Linking unrelated chats:** Adding conversations that aren't relevant can confuse Claude's responses.
  Fix: Only select chats that directly support the current goal; remove any that feel off-topic.
- **Forgetting to upload files:** If a file isn't attached, Claude can't reference its content.
  Fix: After each upload, double-check that the file appears in the project list; re-upload if the name is missing.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** Planning a home renovation? Create a Project for the remodel, add design sketches, budget spreadsheets, and chat notes about contractors – then ask Claude to summarize costs and suggest next steps.

- **For your business or work:** Use a Project to collate marketing copy drafts, product spec PDFs, and internal feedback chats, allowing Claude to generate a unified campaign brief in minutes.
- **If you're just getting started:** The easiest first move is to set up a simple "Weekend Planning" project, add a few personal chats and a PDF itinerary, and watch Claude combine everything into a single plan.

Try it now

In the next two minutes, open Claude, create a new Project called **"My First Project"**, add one recent chat and upload a small text file, then type the prompt:

💬 Example: `Give me a quick summary of the chat and the uploaded file.`

If Claude returns a combined summary, you've successfully completed the core workflow – congratulations!

Getting started with Kimi: a beginner's guide

6 steps · Read online

> **In short:** Kimi is an AI assistant from Moonshot AI that you can use in a web browser at kimi.com. You type a question, it writes an answer. Free access and limits can change, so check kimi.com for current plan details before you rely on it.

Kimi is an AI assistant, which means a program you chat with by typing, the way you would message a helpful friend who knows a lot about many topics. By the end of this guide you will have opened Kimi in your browser, asked your first question, and learned how to ask follow-up questions to get a more useful answer. This guide is written for complete beginners, so you do not need any tech background.

Before you start

- **A web browser** on a computer, tablet or phone, such as Chrome, Safari, Edge or Firefox.
- **An internet connection.** Kimi runs online, so it will not work offline.
- **An email address** is helpful in case you decide to create an account. You may be able to start without one, depending on what the site offers.
- **Time:** about 10 minutes for the whole guide.

Step 1 — Open Kimi in your browser

Click the address bar at the top of your browser, type **kimi.com**, and press Enter. The home page should load with a simple chat screen. Look for a large text box near the middle or bottom of the page, often with placeholder words like "Ask anything" or a similar invitation. You may also see a row of suggestions or a menu.

If the page looks different, that is normal, because websites change their layouts often. If you land on a page that is not Kimi, check the spelling of the address and try again. You can also search for "Kimi Moonshot AI" and open the official result.

You'll know it worked when you can see a text box where you can type a message.

Step 2 — Sign in, or look for a way to start

Some AI assistants let you chat right away, while others ask you to sign in first. Look for a button labeled **Sign in**, **Log in** or **Sign up**, usually in a corner of the screen. If you create an account, you will typically enter an email address and follow the instructions sent to it. Keep your password somewhere safe.

If you do not see a sign-in button and the chat box is already there, you can probably start without an account. Either way, Kimi may show usage limits on free access, so if a message says you have reached a limit, that is the tool telling you something useful, not an error on your part. Plan details can change, so check kimi.com for the current options.

You'll know it worked when you either see your chat screen ready to use or a confirmation that your account is set up.

Step 3 — Type your first question

Click inside the text box. Type a plain question in ordinary words, the same way you would ask a knowledgeable person. There is no special command to learn. Short, specific questions usually get the best first results.

Next to or below the text box, look for a send button, which is often a small arrow or paper-plane icon. You can also press Enter on your keyboard. Your question appears in the chat, and the answer starts to appear below it, often word by word.

Example: "Explain what a context window is in simple words, using a kitchen example."

If nothing happens after you send, wait a few seconds, since answers can take a moment. If the page shows an error, refresh it and try again. You can also shorten your message.

You'll know it worked when your question appears in the chat and an answer begins to appear underneath it.

Step 4 — Read the answer and check it

Read the full reply before deciding whether it helps. A good answer usually addresses your question directly and explains its terms. If the reply is too long or too technical, you can say so in the next message.

AI assistants can sound confident even when they are wrong, so check anything important, such as dates, numbers, names, or health and money matters, against a trusted source. Kimi can help you draft, explain and brainstorm, but it can't guarantee every fact. Treat it like a smart first draft, not a final authority.

Example: "Summarize that answer in three short bullet points I could read in under a minute."

If the answer misses the point, do not give up. Rephrase your question with more detail in the next step.

You'll know it worked when you can see a reply you can read and act on, even if you want to adjust it.

Step 5 — Ask a follow-up question to improve the answer

Type a new message in the same text box, in the same chat. Because the assistant can see the earlier messages in this conversation, you can say things like "make it shorter," "explain it for a teenager," or "give me another example." Each follow-up builds on what came before.

Start a fresh chat if the conversation becomes confusing or you change topics completely. Look for a button or icon labeled **New chat** or a plus sign, usually near the top or on the side. If you do not see it, look for a menu with three lines or three dots in a corner.

💬 Example: "Thanks. Now give me the same explanation again, but for a 10-year-old and in under 80 words."

If the follow-up response goes off track, you can say "Please try again and focus only on [your main topic]." Being specific is the fastest fix.

You'll know it worked when the new answer reflects your change, such as a shorter length or a different level of detail.

Step 6 — Try a useful everyday prompt

Now try a question from your real life. Kimi works well for tasks like drafting an email, planning a meal, comparing ideas, or explaining a confusing document you paste in. The more context you give, the better the result. Remember to remove private details, such as full addresses, account numbers, or passwords, before you share text with any AI tool.

💬 Example: "Help me write a short, polite email to my landlord asking when the [repair type] will be fixed, and keep it under 100 words."

Read the draft, change any details that are not quite right, and make the final decisions yourself. Kimi can write the words, but it can't send the email for you, and it does not know your situation unless you tell it.

You'll know it worked when you have a draft you can read, edit and use in your own words.

Common mistakes

- **Asking vague questions and expecting perfect answers.** Fix this by adding detail, such as who the answer is for and how long it should be.

- **Trusting every fact without checking.** Fix this by verifying important numbers, dates and advice with a reliable source.
- **Sharing private information.** Fix this by replacing names, addresses and account numbers with general descriptions before you paste anything.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** Kimi can help you plan a trip, explain a recipe substitution, or turn a messy list of errands into a simple schedule.
- **For your business or work:** Kimi can help you draft a meeting agenda, summarize a long document you have the right to share, or brainstorm a list of options for a presentation.
- **If you're just getting started:** Begin with low-stakes questions, such as asking for a simple recipe or a plain-English explanation of a topic you already know, so you can see how the assistant responds.

Try it now

Open kimi.com in your browser, type this into the text box, and press send: "Give me three simple ways to use an AI assistant at home this week, each in one sentence."

ChatGPT for Teens: Using the New College Planner and Flashcards to Study

6 steps · Read online

> **In short:** OpenAI has announced a College Planner, flashcards and quizzes for ChatGPT for Teens. This guide shows you how to find them and use them to study one topic from start to finish. Availability may vary, so not every account may see these features yet.

OpenAI has announced a College Planner, flashcards and quizzes for ChatGPT for Teens, plus a teen advisory group to help shape the product. In this guide you'll learn to find these features, use the planner to organize college tasks, and then build a study loop: flashcards, a quiz, and a review of what you missed. It's written for students and for parents who want to help.

Before you start

- A ChatGPT account, with the ChatGPT for Teens experience available to you. If a parent or school set up your account, some features may be limited or managed by them.
- A phone or computer with the ChatGPT app or website. The steps below work the same either way, though button positions differ.
- Your class notes on one topic, typed or copied into a document.
- We don't know for certain whether these features require a paid plan. Check the official pricing page in your account before you start.
- Plan on about 30 to 40 minutes. You already know how to start a chat and send a message, so we'll skip that.

Step 1 — Find the College Planner

Open ChatGPT for Teens and look in the side menu or the menu icon for an option named **College Planner**. Tap it. A new conversation should open with a planning prompt or a short set of questions. If you don't see the name, look for words like "college" or "applications" in the menu, or try the app's search if it has one. If nothing appears, the feature may not have reached your account yet. Check back later, or look at OpenAI's official help pages for current availability. Once it opens, type one clear message to start.

💬 Example: "Help me make a college application timeline. I'm a [grade level] student who wants to apply to [number] schools."

You'll know it worked when the planner replies with questions or a draft timeline, and you can keep typing back and forth in the same conversation.

Step 2 — Give the planner your real details

Good planning depends on specifics. In the same conversation, send one message listing what you know: your target start term, your deadlines if you have them, and the kinds of schools you're considering. The planner usually uses those details to shape its answer, so the more concrete you are, the more useful the plan. If you don't know a detail, say so. Don't guess. A line like "I don't know my counselor's deadline yet" helps the planner mark that item as something to confirm rather than something to trust.

💬 Example: "My deadline list so far is unknown, so mark those as to-confirm. I want to focus on [your state or region] schools and apply early in [month]."

You'll know it worked when the reply separates confirmed items from items you still need to check.

Step 3 — Build on the plan one step at a time

A plan is most useful when you refine it. Ask for one piece at a time, such as "just the essays for the next two weeks." Each new message can refer to earlier answers because they stay in the same conversation. If the planner's answer is too long or too general, say so and ask for a shorter version with specific dates or tasks. Also copy your final plan into a notes app or document. Chat history is not a substitute for your own record.

💬 Example: "Narrow that to the next two weeks only, and make each task take under 30 minutes."

You'll know it worked when the reply is shorter, focused on specific tasks, and still builds on the earlier plan.

Step 4 — Turn your class notes into flashcards

Now switch to studying. Flashcards are a simple tool: a question on the front, a short answer on the back. Paste your notes into a message and ask for flashcards. Look for a flashcard option in the menu if the app offers one; otherwise, asking in plain words works too. Check the cards against your notes. The AI can misread notes or invent details, so a card with an answer you can't find in your notes should be removed or fixed.

💬 Example: "Make 10 flashcards on [subject topic] from these notes. Front: a question. Back: a short answer under 15 words. Notes: [paste your notes here]."

You'll know it worked when you see 10 question-and-answer pairs, and each answer matches something in your notes.

Step 5 — Quiz yourself and review the misses

A quiz is more active than rereading. Ask the AI to quiz you one question at a time, wait for your answer, and then say whether you were right and why. Answer honestly, even if you're unsure. When you get one wrong, ask the AI to explain it differently and to make a new flashcard for that item. Repeating this loop, flashcards, then quiz, then fixing misses, is usually more useful than one long session.

💬 Example: "Quiz me on [subject topic], one question at a time. Wait for my answer, then tell me if I'm right and explain briefly."

You'll know it worked when each question waits for your answer, and the feedback explains your mistakes instead of just saying "wrong."

Step 6 — Verify before you rely on it

This step matters most for college planning. The AI can describe typical application steps, but it cannot see your school's calendar, a specific college's current deadlines, or any changes made after its training. Open each college's official admissions website and confirm dates and requirements yourself. Ask your school counselor about anything that affects your transcript or test plans. Use the AI for organizing and explaining, and use official sources for facts.

💬 Example: "Which items on this timeline need me to confirm dates on each college's official admissions website?"

You'll know it worked when the reply lists the items to verify, and you've checked at least one date against the official site.

Common mistakes

- **Trusting the plan without checking dates.** Deadlines change and vary by school. Fix it by confirming every date on the official college website or with your counselor.
- **Pasting too little or too much into a single message.** A tiny note gives thin flashcards; a huge dump can blur the results. Fix it by pasting one topic or one chapter at a time.
- **Skipping the review step.** Making flashcards feels productive, but the real learning comes from answering and correcting. Fix it by doing the quiz and fixing every miss before you stop.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** A student can use the planner to break a busy week into small tasks and use flashcards to review a chemistry unit in short sessions.

- **For your business or work:** Parents and tutors can use the same loop to build practice questions from a lesson plan, then check each one against the original material.
- **If you want to go further:** Try building a full study schedule across several subjects, with a flashcard set and quiz for each, and ask the AI to rank your weakest topics for the next session.

Try it now

Open the College Planner if you can see it, or your current chat if you can't. Paste five lines from your latest class notes and ask for three flashcards. Answer them yourself, then check each answer against your notes.

Turn one sentence into a ready-to-use study timetable with Qwen Chat

6 steps · Read online

Imagine typing one sentence and instantly receiving a full week of study blocks, color-coded subjects, and built-in breaks—ready to paste straight into your calendar. That's what Qwen Chat can do for your exams. You don't need spreadsheets or fancy apps; just a free AI assistant and five minutes.

Before you start

- A free Qwen Chat account (web or mobile app)
- Your exam date and the subjects you need to study written down
- A phone, tablet or computer with internet
- Total time: about 6–8 minutes

Step 1 — Open Qwen Chat and start a fresh chat

Open your web browser or the Qwen Chat app. Look for a button like **"New Chat"** or a plus sign (+) in the top-right corner. Tap or click it. A clean chat window opens with a blinking cursor ready for your first message. You'll know it worked when you see a fresh chat box with the cursor waiting for you to type.

💬 Example: `Start a new chat`

Step 2 — Tell Qwen Chat your exam details

In the chat box, type a clear sentence that includes:

- your exam date
- the subjects you need to study
- how many days you have left
- any special topics or chapters you must cover

The AI will read your message and prepare to create your schedule. You'll know it worked when you see the AI's first reply starting with something like "Here's a personalized study plan…"

💬 Example: `Create a 7-day study plan for my math and science exams on 15 June. I have 10 days left and must cover algebra, geometry, and the periodic table.`

Step 3 — Ask for a timetable that fits your life

If the first reply feels too rigid, ask the AI to adjust it. Say you want:

- study blocks of 45–60 minutes
- short breaks between subjects
- time for meals and sleep
- weekends mostly free

The AI will reorganise the plan and show you a new version. You'll know it worked when the new reply lists study blocks with clear start and end times and includes breaks.

💬 Example: `Make the blocks 50 minutes each with 10-minute breaks. Keep weekends mostly free and add 8 hours of sleep each night.`

Step 4 — Ask for color-coding and labels

Tell the AI you want each subject to have a different color and a short label. Ask it to add:

- subject names in bold
- estimated difficulty level (easy, medium, hard)
- page numbers or topics for each block

The AI will add colors and labels so your plan looks neat and easy to scan. You'll know it worked when the reply shows colored labels like 🔴 **Math – Algebra (p.45-52)** and 🟢 **Science – Periodic Table (p.78-83)**.

💬 Example: `Add colour-coded labels for each subject and include the page numbers or topics for every block.`

Step 5 — Copy the plan into your calendar or to-do list

Highlight the whole timetable in the chat and copy it (Ctrl+C or tap-hold and copy). Paste it into your phone's calendar, Google Calendar, or a notes app. If your calendar asks for event titles, keep the subject names and times exactly as they appear. You'll know it worked when you see every study block in your calendar with the right color and label.

💬 Example: `Copy the plan below into your calendar: Monday 10 June, 4:00–5:00pm – 🔴 Math – Algebra (p.45-52)`

Step 6 — Ask for a quick summary and tips

Ask Qwen Chat for a short summary that lists:

- total study hours per subject
- the hardest topics to focus on
- a quick tip for each subject

The AI will send a concise recap you can screenshot or save as a note. You'll know it worked when you see a bullet-point list like "Math: 3 hours total – focus on algebra; tip: practice past papers."

💬 Example: `Give me a quick summary of hours per subject and one tip for each.`

Common mistakes

- **Mistake:** Typing a vague prompt like "make me a study plan." **Fix:** Be specific: include exam date, subjects, days left, and key topics.
- **Mistake:** Accepting the first plan without checking the timing. **Fix:** Ask the AI to adjust block length and break times to fit your routine.
- **Mistake:** Forgetting to copy the plan before closing the chat. **Fix:** Highlight and copy the whole timetable before you leave the chat.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** Use Qwen Chat to build a stress-free revision timetable for any test—school, university, or even a driving theory exam. No spreadsheets, no guesswork.
- **For your business or work:** Turn project deadlines into day-by-day task lists with built-in breaks, so you stay sharp and avoid burnout.
- **If you're just getting started:** Start with one small exam. Once you see how easy it is, you'll use the same trick for every future test.

Try it now

Open Qwen Chat, start a new chat, and paste this prompt: `Create a 5-day study plan for my history exam on 20 June. I have 8 days left and must cover World War II and the Cold War. Make each block 50 minutes with 10-minute breaks and keep weekends free.`

How to build a simple study schedule in the weeks before a big exam

5 steps · Read online

> **In short:** The schedule that works is one that fits your real life: count back from the exam, rank topics by weight and weakness, place hard work in your strongest hours, and bake in breaks and a weekly self-check.

That big exam is three weeks out and the textbook feels taller than your motivation. A schedule won't learn the material for you, but it will give you a clear next step every morning. Here's how to build one in five concrete steps, no fancy app required.

Before you start

- **The exam date and a list of what it covers** — a syllabus (the official list of topics the test will cover), a course outline, or your own chapter list. Anything works.
- **A calendar you can scribble on** — paper, a notes app, a spreadsheet, or a printed weekly view. Whatever you'll actually look at.
- **Roughly 45 minutes** for the first pass, then about 10 minutes a week to adjust it.
- **Optional:** an AI assistant (ChatGPT, Gemini, Claude, Copilot, Le Chat, or any other) that you can paste a topic into and ask "break this into five subtopics in order of difficulty". Helpful, not required.

Step 1 — Count back from the exam and map your weeks

Open your calendar and put a big mark on the test day. Then count backwards in weeks and give each block a short label: "W1 — foundation", "W2 — depth", "W3 — review & mock". If you have one week, one block is fine; if you have six, mark the first as warm-up and the last as buffer.

What you'll see on screen (or on paper): a blank week-by-week grid with the exam on the right edge and today on the left. Each week now carries a short phrase naming what kind of work belongs there.

What happens next: the mountain stops being one giant pile. You're not staring at "everything I don't know" anymore — you're staring at "what I should do this week". That shift matters more than the exact labels.

If it looks different on your device: a paper planner works exactly the same way. If you'd rather skip the labels, just write the week numbers above each column.

💬 Example: For a 21-day window, write `W1 — foundation | W2 — depth | W3 — review & mock`. For 10 days, write `W1 — learn + drill | W2 — review + mock`.

You'll know it worked when you can point at any week and say, in one short phrase, what it's for.

Step 2 — List every topic, then rank by weight and weakness

Grab your syllabus and turn each chapter, lecture, or module into a single line on a list. Then walk down the list twice. First pass — weight: how much of the exam is this topic worth? Second pass — weakness: how shaky do you feel about it right now? Mark each item H, M, or L for both. Anything that scores H on either list goes into your "must-cover" pile.

What you'll see on screen: a plain list of maybe 15–30 lines, each with two short codes beside it. Some items glow — H on weight, H on weakness, or both.

What happens next: your priorities stop being a guess. You study what matters and where you actually need help, instead of the chapter that's loudest in your textbook.

If it looks different on your device: if you don't have a syllabus, use the table of contents of your main textbook as a stand-in. Don't have time to rank every item? Pick the five topics that feel heaviest and rank only those.

💬 Example: `Ch 4 — Cell biology | weight: H | weakness: H`, `Ch 7 — Statistics | weight: M | weakness: L`, `Ch 11 — Lab safety | weight: L | weakness: M`.

You'll know it worked when you can name your top three must-cover topics without looking at the list.

Step 3 — Block daily sessions around your real peak energy

Look at your real day — classes, work, commute, sleep, meals, kids, the dog. Find the 60–90 minute window when your brain is sharpest. For many people that's morning, but yours might be late evening. Carve that window out, on as many days as you can, and assign it your highest-priority topic from Step 2. Lower-priority or easier review work fills the smaller, lower-energy pockets.

What you'll see on screen: your week, with one or two solid blocks per day labeled with a topic from your list, and the rest of the day left alone. You're not scheduling every minute — you're protecting the minutes that matter.

What happens next: study time stops fighting the rest of your life. You stop promising "8pm study" when you know 8pm-you is half-asleep, and start promising "7am study" because you've

seen the pattern before.

If it looks different on your device: if your week is wildly uneven (one day free, four days slammed), put your longest block on the free day and let the slammed days carry shorter 20–30 minute reviews. That's still a schedule.

💬 Example: a week might look like `Mon 7–8am: Ch 4 cell biology | Mon 8:30–9pm: 30 min flashcards Ch 7 | Tue 7–8am: Ch 4 problems | Wed 6:30–7:30pm: Ch 5`.

You'll know it worked when you can glance at any weekday and see exactly which topic you're doing and when.

Step 4 — Bake in breaks, reviews and a weekly self-check

A schedule without breaks collapses by Wednesday. Inside each daily block, add a 5–10 minute break at the halfway mark — walk, water, stare out the window. Add one short review slot near the end of each week where you re-read notes from earlier weeks for 30 minutes. And add a 15-minute Sunday-or-Monday self-check: what got done, what didn't, what needs to move.

What you'll see on screen: your week now has a little padding. Each big block carries a small break in it, and the week ends with a small review window instead of another cram.

What happens next: you stop "forgetting" week-one material by week three, because you actually see it again. And when life knocks out a block, your self-check catches it on Monday before it becomes a crisis.

If it looks different on your device: if you study on an app rather than paper, look for a "split session" or "add break" toggle — most study apps have one. If your week has no good review slot, fold a 10-minute review into the last few minutes of two of your regular blocks.

💬 Example: in your daily block, write `7:00–7:45 work | 7:45–7:55 break | 7:55–8:30 work`. For the weekly self-check, write a single line: `Sun 6pm — what got done / what didn't / what moves`.

You'll know it worked when you can list, without looking, what you reviewed last week.

Step 5 — Test the plan with one real practice question

Before you commit, run the schedule once. Pick the highest-priority topic from Step 2 and do a single timed practice question on it — past paper, end-of-chapter problem, flashcard. Don't grade yourself harshly; just notice whether the time you scheduled was actually enough. If the question felt impossible in that window, the schedule needs more space for that topic. If it felt comfortable, the schedule is roughly right.

What you'll see on screen (or on paper): one practice question, a timer, your honest answer, and a one-sentence note to yourself about whether the time was enough.

What happens next: you have real feedback instead of a guess. The schedule becomes a working draft instead of a wish list, and you can adjust it during Sunday's self-check instead of on exam eve.

If it looks different on your device: no practice questions handy? Try explaining the topic out loud for two minutes, as if teaching a friend. If you can't, the schedule needs more time on that topic. Same signal, different test.

💬 Example: set a 10-minute timer, answer one past-paper question on your H-weighted, H-weakness topic, then write one sentence: `Felt too short — add 20 min next week` or `Felt OK — keep as is`.

You'll know it worked when you can point to one concrete signal that says whether your plan is realistic or not.

Common mistakes

- **Scheduling every minute of every day.** The plan dies by day 3 because real life interrupts. Protect your peak-energy window; leave the rest of the day alone.
- **Studying your favorite topics first.** Comfort is not a priority. Follow the H/H ranking from Step 2; save easy wins for low-energy pockets.
- **Skipping the weekly self-check.** If you never look back, you'll keep repeating the same missed blocks. A 10-minute Sunday review catches drift before it becomes a disaster.

What this means for you

- **If you're a student:** A schedule like this fits on a single page, which means you'll actually look at it. It also makes saying "no" to extra plans easier — your peak block is non-negotiable.
- **If you're an adult returning to study:** Your "real life" has more moving parts than a college student's. Use the energy-honest version from Step 3: protect one good block, fill the edges, and don't pretend you have four free hours if you don't.
- **If you're helping a teen or younger student:** Sit with them through Steps 1–2 and let them run Steps 3–5 themselves. The schedule works best when it's theirs.

Try it now

Open your calendar app or a piece of paper. Mark the exam date, count backwards, and write down the five topics that scare you most. That's the whole first pass — about five minutes.

Everything else builds from there.

Getting Started with Alibaba's Qwen Chatbot

5 steps · Read online

If you've heard about AI but haven't taken the plunge, Qwen is an incredible place to start. This friendly guide will show you how to easily access Alibaba's free Qwen AI assistant and use its impressive language skills to make your daily tasks much simpler, whether you need to translate a phrase or tidy up some notes.

Before you start

- **An internet connection:** You'll need a stable connection on your chosen device.
- **A device:** You can use a computer, tablet, or smartphone to access the web portal.
- **An email address or phone number:** You will need one of these to create your free Qwen account.
- **A quick test idea:** Think of a simple task you want help with, such as translating a phrase or writing a short note, so you have something to try immediately.
- **Time commitment:** This guide should take you approximately 5-10 minutes to follow from start to finish.

Step 1 — Access the Qwen chat portal and create an account

To begin, we need to visit the platform where Qwen lives. Qwen is created by Alibaba, and they provide a free web chat interface where anyone can talk to the assistant.

Open your preferred web browser (like Chrome, Safari, or Edge) and type "Qwen chat" into the search bar, then press Enter. You'll see a list of results; look for the official Qwen website, often labeled "Qwen — Alibaba Cloud" or "Qwen by Alibaba". Once on the site, look for a prominent button or link that says "Sign Up" or "Register" to create your new account. Follow the simple prompts, which typically involve entering your email address or phone number, verifying it with a code, and setting up a secure password. If you already have an account, just click "Log In".

If it looks different: Websites change often. If you don't immediately see a "Sign Up" button, look for "Try Now", "Get Started", or a general "Login" link, which usually offers a registration option.

You'll know it worked when you are successfully logged in and see a clean, friendly chat box ready for your instructions, usually with a greeting message from Qwen.

Step 2 — Send your first welcoming prompt

Now it is time to say hello to Qwen. To talk to any AI assistant, you use a **prompt**. A prompt is simply the written instruction or question you type to tell the AI what you want it to do, like

giving a clear task to a helpful assistant.

Look for the chat input field, usually a long, empty text box at the bottom of the screen, and click inside it. Type a simple greeting or question there. After you've finished typing, press the 'Enter' key on your keyboard or look for a 'Send' button (often an arrow icon) next to the input field and click it. Qwen will then process your request and generate a response directly in the chat window.

Example:

> "Hello Qwen! I am learning how to use your chatbot. Can you please introduce yourself in two short sentences and tell me what your name means?"

If it looks different: If pressing 'Enter' doesn't send your message, look for a distinct 'Send' button, usually a paper plane or arrow icon, next to your message box.

You'll know it worked when Qwen's response appears above your message, demonstrating its ability to understand and reply to your text.

Step 3 — Test its exceptional multilingual skills

Qwen is built on a highly advanced **LLM (large language model)**, which is like the digital 'brain' that allows the computer to understand, process, and write human-like text. One of Qwen's greatest strengths is its ability to handle different languages with incredible natural flow. It doesn't just translate word-for-word; it understands cultural context, like a friendly local tour guide might.

Let's test this by asking Qwen to translate a message while keeping the tone warm and natural. Type your request into the chat box and send it. Qwen will then generate the translations you asked for, typically presenting them clearly labeled by language.

Example:

> "Could you please translate 'I would love to invite you to our community barbecue this weekend' into casual French and polite Japanese?"

If it looks different: If the translation doesn't seem quite right or is too formal, try adding more context to your prompt, like "for a message to a close friend" or "for a formal email".

You'll know it worked when Qwen provides the phrases in French and Japanese, clearly labeled, demonstrating its understanding of casual versus polite tones.

Step 4 — Organize messy information

Beyond translation, Qwen is fantastic at sorting out cluttered thoughts and making sense of disorganised lists. You can feed it a jumbled list of ideas, ingredients, or tasks, and ask it to tidy things up for you, presenting the information in a clear, structured way.

Type your messy list directly into the chat box, followed by an instruction to organize it. For instance, you might ask it to categorise items or put them in alphabetical order. Once you send your prompt, Qwen will process the information and display the organized version in the chat.

Example:

> "Please organize this messy list of groceries into neat categories: apples, chicken breast, broccoli, carrots, rice, milk, cheddar cheese, and pasta."

If it looks different: If Qwen's organization isn't quite what you had in mind, try to be more specific in your prompt, e.g., "Organize this list into a table with two columns: 'Fruit & Veg' and 'Pantry Staples'."

You'll know it worked when Qwen neatly presents your groceries in categories like 'Dairy' or 'Vegetables', making the list much easier to read and understand.

Step 5 — Summarize text efficiently

Qwen isn't just for creating new text; it's also brilliant at condensing existing information. If you have a long email, an article, or a set of notes, Qwen can quickly extract the main points and provide a concise summary. This saves you time by getting straight to the core message.

To try this, copy a short paragraph of text from anywhere (like an email or a website) and paste it into the chat input field. Then, add a clear instruction to summarize. Send your prompt, and Qwen will generate a shorter version of the text, focusing on the most important details.

Example:

> "Summarize this paragraph for me, keeping it to two sentences: 'The annual community fete will be held next Saturday, October 26th, from 10 am to 4 pm at the Central Park Oval. There will be food stalls, live music, face painting for kids, and a pet show. Entry is free, but donations for local charities are welcome. Please bring your own picnic blanket and water bottle.'"

If it looks different: If the summary is too long or too short, you can specify a word count or sentence limit in your next prompt, like "Summarize this in 50 words" or "Give me the three key takeaways."

You'll know it worked when Qwen provides a much shorter version of the text, highlighting the key details you asked for, without losing the main meaning.

Common mistakes

- **Assuming it only speaks Chinese:** Because Qwen was developed by a team in China, many beginners think it is only useful for Chinese text. In reality, it is a truly global assistant that handles English, Spanish, Arabic, German, and dozens of other languages beautifully. The fix is simply to ask Qwen in the language you prefer, and it will respond accordingly.
- **Sharing confidential details:** Just like when you use any other online service, never paste sensitive personal information, bank details, or private business files into the chat. Qwen is a powerful tool, but it's not a secure vault for private data. Always treat your prompts as if they could be seen by others.
- **Expecting real-time news updates:** Qwen is brilliant at writing, translating, and brainstorm-related tasks, but it is not a live search engine connected to current events. Use it for creative and analytical help rather than looking up today's local weather, current sports results, or the latest stock prices.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** You can easily communicate with neighbors from different backgrounds by translating messages, translate foreign-language recipes into English, or draft polite letters to your local council in clear, concise language.
- **For your business or work:** You can draft welcoming messages for international clients, translate product descriptions for new markets, or quickly summarize long, complex documents or email threads, saving you valuable time.
- **If you're just getting started:** Simply treat Qwen like a polite, knowledgeable friend. You don't need to use complicated technical jargon – just ask your questions naturally and clearly, and Qwen will do its best to help.

Try it now

Let's take action! Open your Qwen chat window right now, type this prompt, and see how quickly it helps you plan your evening:

> "Give me three quick, budget-friendly ideas for dinner tonight using chicken and whatever vegetables I have left in the fridge."

Getting started with GitHub Copilot: a beginner's guide

5 steps · Read online

By the end of this guide, you'll have GitHub Copilot installed and ready to type real code for you inside Visual Studio Code. You'll try it on a tiny "hello world" file, so you can see the magic without risk. This is perfect for anyone in a business or work setting who needs to write a bit of code but isn't a full-time developer.

Before you start

- **A free GitHub account:** This is an online account that helps you manage code projects. Signing up is quick, usually under a minute.
- **A GitHub Copilot plan:** Copilot offers a Free plan with limited usage, and paid plans with higher limits. You'll need a plan that is active on your GitHub account to use it.
- **Visual Studio Code (VS Code) installed:** This is a free code editor where Copilot lives. Download it from the official website and install it on your computer (Windows, Mac, or Linux).
- **Time needed:** Allow about 10-15 minutes to follow all the steps.

Step 1 — Install the Copilot extension

First, open **Visual Studio Code** on your computer. You'll see a clean window, usually with a welcome screen. On the far left side, look for the **Activity bar** — this is a vertical row of icons. Find and click the **Extensions icon**, which looks like four connected squares. This will open the Extensions view. In the search bar at the top, type "Copilot" and press Enter. You should see an extension named **GitHub Copilot** by "GitHub" itself. Click the "Install" button next to it. Example: In the Extensions search bar, type `Copilot`. You'll know it worked when: The "Install" button changes to "Manage", and a new, distinct GitHub Copilot icon (a stylised half-circle) appears in your Activity bar. If you don't see the Extensions icon, you can usually press `Ctrl+Shift+X` (Windows/Linux) or `Cmd+Shift+X` (Mac) to open it.

Step 2 — Sign in with your GitHub account

Now that the extension is installed, you need to link it to your GitHub account. Click the newly appeared **GitHub Copilot icon** in your Activity bar on the left. This will typically open a sidebar panel related to Copilot. Within this panel, you should see a prompt to "Sign in to GitHub" or "Authorise GitHub Copilot". Click on this. What happens next is that a new browser window or tab will automatically open, directing you to the GitHub website to complete the sign-in process. Use the same GitHub account details you prepared earlier. Example: After clicking "Sign in", enter your GitHub username and password in the browser window. You'll

know it worked when: Your browser displays a confirmation message like "GitHub Copilot is ready" or "Authorisation successful". Close the browser tab and return to Visual Studio Code, where the Copilot panel will likely update to show you are signed in. If the browser window doesn't appear, check if your browser's pop-up blocker is active and temporarily disable it for this site.

Step 3 — Turn on the AI helper in a new file

With Copilot signed in, let's create a space for it to work. In VS Code, go to **File > Open Folder...** (or `File > Open...` on Mac) and choose an empty folder on your computer. If you don't have one, just create a new empty folder anywhere, then open it. Once a folder is open, look in the **Explorer panel** (the top icon in the Activity bar, resembling two overlapping sheets of paper). Right-click inside the Explorer panel's empty space, or click the "New File" icon (a blank page with a plus sign) at the top of the Explorer panel. Name the new file `hello.py` and press Enter. The `.py` part tells VS Code it's a Python file. 💬 Example: For the filename, type `hello.py`. You'll know it worked when: An empty `hello.py` file opens in the main editing area of VS Code. VS Code might also suggest installing a "Python extension" – if so, click "Install" to help it understand Python code better. If you have trouble opening a folder, try "File > New Text File" to just get started, though working in a folder is usually best.

Step 4 — Ask Copilot to write your first line

Now for the exciting part! With `hello.py` open and empty, type the following exact line, which is a **comment** (a note in code that the computer ignores but a human can read) explaining what you want the AI to do. After typing the line, press your `Enter` key.

```
# write a function that prints hello world
```

What happens next is that Copilot, acting as your AI assistant, will process your comment. After a brief pause (usually a second or two), you'll see a greyed-out suggestion, often called "ghost text," appear right after your cursor. This is Copilot's suggestion for the code. To accept this code, press your `Tab` key. 💬 Example: Type `# write a function that prints hello world` and press Enter. You'll know it worked when: The gray ghost text suggestion (which should be Python code for printing "Hello, world!") is inserted into your file. If the ghost text doesn't appear, check the bottom-right status bar of VS Code for a small Copilot icon; if it has a spinning circle, it's still thinking. If it's greyed out, it might be inactive – try typing again or restarting VS Code.

Step 5 — Run your first AI-generated code

After accepting the code in `hello.py`, you'll have a function defined. Now, let's make it actually run! Go to the end of the `hello.py` file, on a new line, and type the name of the function Copilot

created (it's usually `print_hello_world()`) to call it. Now, to run the code, go to the top menu in VS Code and click **Run > Run Without Debugging**, or simply press the `F5` key (this is a common shortcut). If VS Code asks you to select an environment, choose "Python File" or "Python Debugger". 💬 Example: Type `print_hello_world()` (using the exact function name Copilot generated) on a new line after the function definition, then press `F5`. You'll know it worked when: A **Terminal panel** opens at the bottom of VS Code, and you see the text "Hello, world!" (or similar, depending on Copilot's exact output) displayed there. This confirms your AI-generated code successfully ran. If it looks different, ensure you have the Python extension installed (from Step 3's suggestion) and that you selected "Python File" when prompted to run. Copilot cannot *send* your output anywhere else; it only suggests code within the editor.

Common mistakes

- **No active Copilot plan:** Copilot won't work unless a plan (the Free plan included) is active on your GitHub account, for example if you've used up its monthly limits.
    - **Fix:** Check which plan your GitHub account has by visiting the GitHub Copilot settings page in your browser.
- **Copilot suggestions aren't appearing:** Sometimes Copilot needs a moment to 'wake up', or there might be an issue with your internet connection or VS Code configuration.
    - **Fix:** Wait a few seconds after typing your prompt. Check the Copilot icon in the VS Code status bar (bottom right); if it's spinning or shows an error, try restarting VS Code or checking your internet connection.
- **Blindly accepting suggestions:** Copilot provides suggestions, but they might not always be exactly what you need, or they could contain minor errors.
    - **Fix:** Always read the ghost text carefully before pressing `Tab`. If it's not quite right, you can ignore it by continuing to type, or delete it and rephrase your comment to guide Copilot towards a better answer.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** If you need a quick script to, say, automate renaming a batch of photos or converting a list of dates, Copilot can help you generate the basic Python or JavaScript code much faster, allowing you to focus on the small tweaks.
- **For your business or work:** Copilot can significantly speed up routine coding tasks, whether it's writing boilerplate code for web development, generating SQL queries, or automating Excel macros. This frees up your time to tackle more complex, strategic problems, boosting productivity across your team.
- **If you're just getting started:** Start by using Copilot for very small, defined tasks, like generating a simple function or a single line of code. Don't be afraid to experiment with

different prompts, and always review the generated code to understand what it's doing. This is a fantastic way to learn by seeing practical code examples.

Try it now

Open VS Code, create a new file named `calculate.py`. Inside it, type `# create a function that adds two numbers and returns the sum`, then press Enter. Accept Copilot's suggestion, then add a line like `result = add_numbers(5, 3)` and `print(result)`. Save the file, press `F5` to run it, and see the result in the terminal. You just wrote – and ran – your first AI-assisted functional code in under two minutes!

Getting started with Cohere: a beginner's guide

5 steps · Read online

By the end of this guide, you'll understand what Cohere's AI tools are and how to use them to quickly draft text for your work, even if you've never used artificial intelligence before. You'll be ready to try a simple task, like writing an email, in just a few minutes.

Before you start

- A Cohere account (you can sign up for a free tier; availability and limits may vary).
- A computer or laptop with an internet connection.
- A web browser (such as Chrome, Firefox, Edge, or Safari).
- Roughly 7 minutes to follow the guide and try the example.

Step 1 — Sign up and access the chat area

Your first step is to get logged in and find Cohere's main interaction area. Cohere provides an online space where you can type instructions to an AI (Artificial Intelligence) and it will respond, much like a chat conversation.

1. Go to Cohere's website in your web browser.
2. Look for a button like "Sign Up" or "Get Started" to create your free account, or "Log In" if you already have one. You'll be asked to provide an email and create a password, then confirm your email address.
3. After logging in, you'll land on your Cohere dashboard. Look for a main section or button that says something like "Chat," "Playground," or "Start writing," which will lead you to the text input area.
    - **If it looks different:** If you don't immediately see a "Chat" button, browse the menu items on the left or top of the screen for sections labeled "Playground" or "Explore." These are common names for where you can interact directly with the AI.
    - **You'll know it worked when** you see a large, empty text box on the screen, usually at the bottom or center, ready for you to type your instructions.

Step 2 — Send your first instruction (a "prompt")

Now you're ready to "talk" to the AI. The instruction you give the AI is called a **prompt** – think of it like telling a helpful assistant exactly what you need. The AI understands everyday language, so you can ask it anything you'd normally ask a colleague.

1. In the large text box you found in Step 1, type your instruction.

2. Press the "Enter" key on your keyboard, or click a "Send" button or arrow icon next to the text box.
    - **What you see:** Your typed prompt will appear in the chat history, and then you'll see a small indicator (like dots or a spinning icon) showing the AI is thinking.
    - **What happens next:** The AI will process your instruction and start typing its response directly into the chat window.
    - **If it looks different:** If the AI doesn't reply, check if you pressed "Enter" or the "Send" button. Sometimes there's a small delay, so wait a few seconds. If it still doesn't reply, try a simpler prompt. 💬 Example:

```
Write a short welcome email for new customers. Keep it friendly and under 100 words.
```

- **You'll know it worked when** the AI's response text starts appearing in the chat area above your prompt.

Step 3 — Refine the AI's answer with follow-up instructions

The AI provides a great starting point, but you can always guide it further to match your specific needs, like your business's tone of voice. This is possible because the AI retains the context of the current session, letting you build on its last reply.

1. Read the AI's response. If it's not quite right, you can ask for changes in the same chat box.
2. Type a new instruction that refers to the AI's previous answer. For instance, you could ask it to shorten the text or change its style.
3. Press "Enter" or click the "Send" button.
    - **What you see:** Your follow-up instruction will appear below the AI's previous response, and then the AI will begin generating a revised version.
    - **What happens next:** The AI will take your feedback and produce an updated email draft, incorporating your new instructions while still considering the original request.
    - **If it looks different:** If the AI seems to ignore the previous messages and gives a completely new answer, you might need to be more explicit. For example, say "Based on your last email, please make it..." 💬 Example:

```
Make it shorter, about 60 words, and use a warmer, more personal tone.
```

- **You'll know it worked when** the AI generates a new, modified version of the email that reflects your latest instructions.

Step 4 — Copy your work for use in other applications

Once you're happy with the AI's draft, you'll want to transfer it to where you'll actually use it, such as your email client (like Outlook or Gmail) or a document. Remember, Cohere's AI generates text, but it doesn't send emails or manage documents directly.

1. Carefully select (highlight) all the text of the AI's final reply using your mouse or trackpad.
2. Once the text is highlighted, right-click on it (or use a two-finger tap on a Mac trackpad) and choose "Copy" from the menu that appears. Alternatively, you can press `Ctrl+C` (on Windows) or `Command+C` (on Mac) on your keyboard.
    - **What you see:** The text you selected will usually turn a different color, indicating it's highlighted.
    - **What happens next:** The selected text is now saved to your computer's "clipboard," which is a temporary storage area for copied information.
    - **If it looks different:** Some interfaces also provide a dedicated "Copy" button next to the AI's response – look for an icon that looks like two overlapping squares. If so, simply click that.
    - **You'll know it worked when** you can paste the text into another program, such as an empty email draft or a word processor document.

Step 5 — Try another practical business task

Cohere's AI can assist with a wide variety of everyday business tasks, not just email drafting. You can use the same chat window to try a completely different type of task to see its versatility.

1. In the same chat window, type a new, unrelated prompt that focuses on a different business need.
2. Press "Enter" or click the "Send" button.
    - **What you see:** Your new prompt appears, and the AI will begin thinking and typing its response for this fresh request.
    - **What happens next:** The AI generates an entirely new piece of content, showing its ability to switch gears and handle different types of information and requests.
    - **If it looks different:** If you prefer to start a completely fresh conversation and erase the previous chat history, look for a "New Chat" button or icon (often a plus symbol `+` or a speech bubble icon) somewhere on the screen, usually in the top-left or top-right of the chat interface. 💬 Example:

```
Summarize these three points of customer feedback: "The product was easy to use.
Shipping took longer than expected. Customer service was helpful but slow to respond."
```

- **You'll know it worked when** the AI provides a concise summary or a completely different type of output (e.g., a list of ideas) based on your new instruction.

Common mistakes

- **Being too vague in your instructions:** AI is smart, but it's not a mind-reader. If you just ask "Write something," it won't know what you want.
    - **Fix:** Be specific! Add details about the topic, length, tone, and audience. For example, "Write a 50-word product description for hiking boots, highlighting their waterproof features and comfort, in an adventurous tone."
- **Forgetting to copy your output:** Your chat history might not always be saved long-term, or if you close the tab, the generated text will be gone.
    - **Fix:** Always copy the AI's useful responses to a document or email draft as soon as you're happy with them.
- **Expecting perfection on the first attempt:** The AI's first draft is just that — a draft. It might not be exactly what you need straight away.
    - **Fix:** Treat the AI as a collaborator. Use follow-up prompts to refine, adjust, or completely rewrite its answers until they meet your expectations.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** You can use Cohere to quickly draft emails, social media posts, or even generate creative ideas without staring at a blank page. It's like having a brainstorming partner available 24/7.
- **For your business or work:** You can significantly speed up content creation for reports, product descriptions, marketing copy, or customer service responses. This frees up your time to focus on higher-value tasks that require your unique

Try it now

1. Sign up for a Cohere account (or log in if you already have one).
2. Open the chat/playground area.
3. Try the example prompt above and iterate on the response.
4. Copy the final text into your email client or document.
5. Experiment with another business-related prompt.

Getting started with Microsoft Copilot in everyday apps

5 steps · Read online

By the end of this guide, you'll know where Microsoft Copilot lives on your Windows PC, how to bring it up, and you'll have completed a useful first task. Imagine turning a rough email into a tidy summary, or getting a quick overview of a long web page – that's what Copilot helps you do. This tutorial is for anyone who wants a quicker, smarter way to work, whether you're handling personal errands or day-to-day office duties.

Before you start

- You have a Windows PC with a working internet connection (the Copilot app comes preinstalled on new Windows 11 PCs).
- You are signed in with a Microsoft account (the same one you use for Windows, Outlook, or Office).
- Your built-in apps – Microsoft Edge, Outlook, Word, PowerPoint – are up to date (they usually update automatically in the background).
- Some features, especially within Office apps like Word, Outlook, or PowerPoint, require a Microsoft 365 plan that includes Copilot. Microsoft has also changed its plan names over time, so check your account page to see what yours includes. This guide focuses on features that are easy to reach.
- Rough total time: This guide should take you about 5-10 minutes to follow along with.

Step 1 — Spot the Copilot icon

The Copilot icon acts like a little helper button in Microsoft Edge. To begin, open Microsoft Edge, your internet browser. Look at the upper-right corner of the browser window.

What you see on screen: You'll typically see several small icons. Look for the Copilot icon. Its look can change between Edge versions, so if you are unsure, point at an icon for a moment and read its label. **What happens next:** Nothing happens yet when you just spot it; you're just identifying your starting point. **If it looks different:** If you don't see it there, update Edge and check again. The exact place and design of the icon can differ between versions. Example: (No typing needed for this step, just observation.) **You'll know it worked when:** You can clearly see the Copilot icon in your Microsoft Edge browser window.

Step 2 — Open Copilot in Microsoft Edge

Once you've spotted the Copilot icon in Microsoft Edge, it's time to activate it. Click on that button. This action is like tapping a friend on the shoulder to get their attention.

What you see on screen: After clicking, Copilot opens next to the page you are viewing. This is where you'll chat with Copilot. **What happens next:** The Copilot panel appears with a box for typing your request. This means it's ready for your instructions. **If it looks different:** The exact layout can differ between Edge versions. If the icon isn't there, make sure your Edge browser is up to date and that you are signed in with your Microsoft account. Example: `Summarize this article about recent climate change research.` **You'll know it worked when:** The Copilot panel is open in your Edge browser, and you see a text input area ready for your question or command. Copilot can use the context of the page you have open, and depending on your settings it may also use other open tabs. You can review or change this in Edge's settings under Copilot and AI, so it only sees what you are comfortable sharing.

Step 3 — Use Copilot in Outlook to tidy an email

Microsoft Copilot can help you quickly understand lengthy emails, saving you time. First, open your Microsoft Outlook application and select an email that has a good amount of text or information.

What you see on screen: With a longer email conversation open, Outlook can offer a summary from Copilot at the top of the conversation, where you may see a "Summary by Copilot" or "Summarize" option. The exact appearance varies between Outlook versions and plans. **What happens next:** Selecting that option shows a short summary of the conversation. If you have a Copilot chat or panel in Outlook, you can also type your own instruction there. **If it looks different:** If you can't find any Copilot option, your Outlook version or Microsoft 365 plan may not include it yet. Copilot features in Office apps depend on your plan and on updates. Check your plan details in your Microsoft account. Example: `Summarize this email in three bullet points, focusing on key action items.` **You'll know it worked when:** Copilot displays a concise summary of the email, often presented as bullet points, based on your instruction. Copilot can draft the summary, but you stay in charge of sending any message, and it can miss highly nuanced human emotion or sarcasm.

Step 4 — Generate a slide outline in PowerPoint

Getting started with a presentation can be daunting, but Copilot can help you create a structure. Open Microsoft PowerPoint and start a new, blank presentation. This gives Copilot a clean slate to work with.

What you see on screen: Look for Copilot among the options at the top of the PowerPoint window. The top area with all your editing options is called the "ribbon". The exact label and position of the Copilot option can differ between versions. **What happens next:** Selecting it opens a Copilot panel or a box where you can type your request for the presentation outline. **If it looks different:** If you can't find Copilot in PowerPoint, your PowerPoint version or Microsoft

365 plan may not include it yet. Copilot in Office apps depends on your plan and on app updates. 💬 Example: `Create an outline for a 5-slide presentation on how to reduce household energy consumption.` **You'll know it worked when:** Copilot generates a list of slide titles and perhaps some key talking points. Copilot provides a structure, but it can't replace your own judgment, so review the content for accuracy before you use it.

Step 5 — Open the Copilot app in Windows

Copilot is also available as its own app on Windows, which is handy when you want a quick answer without opening a browser.

What you see on screen: Look for the Copilot app in the taskbar or in the Start menu. Some keyboards have a Copilot key, and on many Windows 11 PCs you can also press the Windows key + C to open it. Which of these work depends on your PC and Windows updates. **What happens next:** The Copilot app opens with a box for typing your question. You may be asked to sign in with your Microsoft account. **If it looks different:** If you can't find it, search for "Copilot" from the Start menu. If it isn't installed, you can usually get it from the Microsoft Store. 💬 Example: `What is the current time in London, UK?` **You'll know it worked when:** The Copilot app opens, and after you type your question and press Enter, Copilot shows an answer. For important facts, double-check the answer with an official source.

Common mistakes

- **Looking in the wrong place:** Copilot shows up in different places in different apps and versions. If you can't find it, check that the app is up to date and that your account or plan includes Copilot.
- **Leaving the query too vague:** Simply typing "Help me" often leads to broad or unhelpful answers. Instead, provide clear, specific instructions. For example, rather than "Summarize this," try "Summarize this email in three bullet points, highlighting the deadlines."
- **Forgetting to sign in:** Copilot relies on your Microsoft account to access certain features and integrate with your documents securely. If you see a sign-in prompt, follow the steps to log in before proceeding. Without being signed in, many Copilot features will be unavailable or limited.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** You can quickly turn a lengthy email about a community event into a short checklist, or get the gist of a long news article in seconds, freeing up time for other activities.

- **For your business or work:** Generate meeting-ready PowerPoint outlines in minutes, or summarize dense project documents, allowing you to focus on strategic thinking rather than administrative tasks.
- **If you're just getting started:** The easiest first move is to open Microsoft Edge, navigate to any interesting article, then open Copilot in the side panel and ask it to summarize the page.

Try it now

Open Microsoft Edge, browse to any news website you like, then click the Copilot icon in the upper-right corner. In the text box that appears, type `Summarize the main article on this homepage in two short sentences.` In the next two minutes, you'll see how Copilot quickly pulls the main ideas together – giving you a practical taste of how it can help you across all your everyday apps.

Getting started with Duck.ai: a beginner's guide to private AI chat

5 steps · Read online

> **In short:** Duck.ai is DuckDuckGo's AI chat, and you can start a conversation without making an account. DuckDuckGo says it does not use your chats to train its AI models. Still, treat it as a helpful tool, not a vault: never type passwords, bank details or private medical records into any chat.

You will learn how to open Duck.ai, start your first chat without signing up, write a message the AI can actually help with, and understand what DuckDuckGo's privacy promises mean in everyday terms. This guide is for anyone who is curious about AI chatbots but would rather not hand over an account or a pile of personal details to try one out.

Before you start

- **A web browser or the DuckDuckGo app.** Any modern browser on a phone, tablet or computer will work. You can go straight to the Duck.ai website.
- **An internet connection.** Duck.ai runs online, so it won't work offline.
- **No account needed.** This is the whole point of this guide. If a sign-in screen appears, you can usually keep going without one.
- **About 10 minutes.** Plan on reading and trying each step once.

Step 1 — Open Duck.ai

Open your web browser and type **duck.ai** into the address bar at the top. Press Enter. You should land on a simple page with a message box near the bottom, where you type your questions. The page is designed to be clean, so you may see little else besides a short introduction and a few suggested topics.

If you already use the DuckDuckGo app or its browser, look for an option to open the AI chat there. The exact spot can change, so search the app's menu for "Duck.ai" or look for a chat or AI-style icon. Both routes lead to the same chat.

If it looks different: the website may show a notice about how Duck.ai works, or ask you to accept terms. Read it briefly, then look for a button that lets you continue. Those notices are normal and you only need to deal with them once.

You'll know it worked when you see an empty chat with a message box at the bottom and nothing asking you to sign in.

Step 2 — Start a chat without an account

Stay on the Duck.ai page and look at the message box. You do not need to create a username, enter an email address or choose a password to begin. The chat is ready as soon as the page loads. Think of it like walking into a public library reading room: you can sit down and start reading without a membership card, although some rooms have rules you should know about.

If you see a prompt asking you to sign in or subscribe, look for a button or link that says you can continue without doing so, or simply close the prompt and return to the message box. Some features, such as higher usage limits, may need a paid plan, so check the official Duck.ai site for current details before you rely on any particular feature.

If it looks different: sometimes Duck.ai shows a list of suggested topics above the message box. You can ignore those and type your own question.

You'll know it worked when you can click into the message box and see a blinking cursor, ready for your first message.

Step 3 — Type your first question

Click into the message box, type your question, and press Enter (or tap the send arrow next to the box, if you see one). Your message appears in the chat as a bubble. After a moment, the answer starts appearing below it, usually one word or line at a time. This is the AI generating its reply, which can take a few seconds.

Keep your first question simple and specific. Vague questions get vague answers. Try swapping in your own details wherever you see square brackets, and remember to leave out anything private.

💬 Example: "Give me three simple dinner ideas I can cook in under 30 minutes for [number] people, using [two ingredients you have]."

If it looks different: if nothing happens after you press Enter, check that you're connected to the internet, then try again. If the answer doesn't appear at all, refresh the page and retype your question.

You'll know it worked when your message shows up in the chat and a reply starts appearing beneath it.

Step 4 — Ask a follow-up to refine the answer

Read the reply carefully. If it's almost right but too long, too basic or aimed at the wrong person, type a follow-up in the same message box. The chat remembers what you said earlier in this conversation, so you don't need to repeat everything. It's like talking to a helper across a table: you can say "make it shorter" and they know what "it" means.

Follow-ups work best when they name one change at a time. A clear request gives a clear result.

💬 Example: "Thanks. Make these ideas shorter, and add one tip for a beginner who has never cooked [dish type]."

If it looks different: if the chat feels confused or the answers drift off topic, start a new chat for a fresh subject. Look for a "new chat" button or a plus-style icon near the top or side of the page. Starting over is a normal habit and doesn't break anything.

You'll know it worked when the new reply reflects your change, such as being shorter or including the beginner tip.

Step 5 — Understand what the privacy promises mean for you

This step matters most. DuckDuckGo built Duck.ai around privacy, and it says publicly that it does not use your chats to train its AI models. Think of training as the AI studying what people write so it can improve. DuckDuckGo's position is that your conversations aren't used for that study. It also says it removes identifying details, such as your IP address, before sending your chats to the AI companies whose models it offers. Check DuckDuckGo's own privacy pages for the exact current wording, because policies can be updated.

Privacy promises are not the same as secrecy. A few things still apply. Your chat is still processed by a service, so don't type anything you would be upset to see leaked. Look for a settings or menu icon on the page to see whether you can clear your chat history. If you see that option, it's a good way to tidy up after a conversation you'd rather not keep.

💬 Example: "Help me write a short thank-you note to my neighbor for watering my plants while I was away."

If it looks different: privacy settings may be tucked under a menu, behind a gear icon, or in a separate section about your data. If you can't find them, search DuckDuckGo's help or privacy pages for "Duck.ai" instead of guessing.

You'll know it worked when you have located the chat history or privacy options and understand that the safest habit is simply not typing sensitive details in the first place.

Common mistakes

- **Typing sensitive information.** Passwords, Social Security numbers, bank logins and private medical details should never go into any AI chat, even one with strong privacy promises. The fix: describe the situation in general terms instead, such as "a bill I need to dispute" rather than your account number.

- **Trusting the answer without checking it.** AI can sound confident and still be wrong. The fix: verify important facts, especially health, money or legal questions, with a trusted source or a professional.
- **Expecting it to remember you forever.** Duck.ai is built for quick, private chats, so it doesn't work like a personal assistant who knows your life. It also can't open your files or see your screen unless a feature clearly says it can. The fix: paste in the details you need for each conversation.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** Use Duck.ai to plan a weekend trip, draft a birthday message, or explain a confusing paragraph from a recipe or manual. Keep the details general and you'll get useful help without over-sharing.
- **For your business or work:** Use it to brainstorm email subject lines, summarize a public article you've already read, or practice a difficult conversation. Don't paste confidential client, employee or company information, and check your employer's policy before using any AI tool for work.
- **If you're just getting started:** Begin with one low-stakes question, like a recipe or a gift idea. Once you see how the chat responds, you'll understand the rhythm and feel more comfortable with the tool.

Try it now

Open **duck.ai** in your browser, type "Suggest three easy weekend activities for [your city] in [season]," and press Enter. When the reply appears, type one follow-up asking it to make the list shorter. You'll have used Duck.ai without an account in under two minutes.

Getting started with Claude for clear, careful help

5 steps · Read online

Claude is an AI assistant from Anthropic that can help you work through long pieces of writing, draft text carefully, and explain complex ideas. This guide will walk you through how to get set up and send your very first **prompt** (that's the instruction or question you give to an AI) in about 5-7 minutes. By the end, you'll be able to ask Claude to summarize documents or draft detailed messages for you.

Before you start

- A computer, tablet, or smartphone with an active internet connection.
- A valid email address or a Google account for signing in. When you first sign up, Claude may also ask you to verify a phone number with a text message.
- Access to Claude's free plan for everyday use, which is what we'll be using.
- Roughly 5-7 minutes to follow all the steps.

Step 1 — Create your free account

First, open your web browser and go to claude.ai, the official Claude website from Anthropic. You'll either sign up by choosing "Continue with Google" or by entering your email address and choosing "Continue with email". This creates your personal space where you can chat with Claude.

If you're asked to verify your phone number, follow the on-screen steps. The exact layout of the sign-in screen can differ between the website and the apps, so look for the option that matches Google or email sign-in.

💬 Example: Enter your email address and choose the option to continue with email. You'll then be asked to check your inbox for a login link. You'll know it worked when a screen tells you to check your email (or, if you used Google, you land in your new account).

Step 2 — Confirm your account and meet your workspace

If you signed up with email, Claude sends you a message with a link to log in; the subject line reads "Secure link to log in to Claude.ai". Claude doesn't use a password for your account. Open the email and click the link. If you open it on the same device where you started, you're logged in automatically. If you open it on a different device, the link gives you a verification code to enter on the device where you started.

If the email doesn't arrive, check your spam or junk folder and try again after a few minutes.

💬 Example: Open the email from Claude and click the login link, or enter the verification code on the original device if you were asked for one. You'll know it worked when the Claude chat screen loads, with a message box where you can type.

Step 3 — Understand your chat interface and Claude's "memory"

Once you're logged in, you'll see a simple, uncluttered screen. Think of this as your blank digital notepad, ready for a new conversation. The message box is your main entry point for typing messages to Claude, and replies appear in the conversation.

Near the message box you'll find options for adding files and other tools. The exact layout can differ between the website and the apps, so if something looks different, look around the message box for the option you need. Claude works with a **context window**, which is the amount of text it can keep in view in one conversation. Imagine a large desk where you can spread out several documents at once, though a very long conversation or document can still reach its limits. The free plan also has usage limits that reset every five hours, according to Anthropic.

💬 Example: Click inside the message box. Your cursor will start blinking, indicating it's ready for you to type. You'll know it worked when your cursor is active in the message box, showing it's ready for input.

Step 4 — Try a "careful reading" and summary task

Claude can help when you want to understand long, dense, or complicated pieces of writing. Let's put this to the test. You can paste a lengthy email, a news article, a recipe, or even some terms and conditions directly into the message box. After pasting, add a clear instruction about what you want Claude to do with that text. Claude can't *truly* understand the text like a human, but it's good at processing it based on your instructions.

After you paste your text, it will appear in the message box. Below your pasted text, type your instruction, then send your message with the send button next to the message box (or the Enter key). The send button looks different in different versions, so use whichever control is clearly meant for sending.

💬 Example: Copy a long piece of text (e.g., from a news article), paste it into the message box, then type this directly below the pasted text: *"Please summarize the text above into three simple, easy-to-read bullet points. Highlight any action steps I need to take."* Then send your message. You'll know it worked when Claude starts writing out a neat summary in the conversation.

Step 5 — Ask for a detailed, natural and polite reply

Claude is designed to write in a clear, natural style, which makes it useful for drafting emails, notes, or messages where the tone is very important. Let's ask Claude to craft a polite but firm message.

Type your request directly into the message box. Claude will process your request and write a response in the conversation. Make sure your instruction clearly specifies the tone and purpose of the message you need.

💬 Example: Type this into the message box: *"I need to ask my neighbor to keep their dog from barking early in the morning. Can you draft a friendly, polite, but clear note I can drop in their mailbox? I want to keep a good relationship with them, so please make sure it's not accusatory."* Then send your message. You'll know it worked when Claude writes a balanced draft of the message, with an appropriate opening and closing, which you can then customize.

Common mistakes

- **Trusting Claude for up-to-date facts without checking:** Without web search, Claude answers from what it learned during training, which can be out of date. Web search is available on the free plan: in the standard chat you can switch it on from the + menu near the message box, and in newer views Claude searches the web when it helps. Searches count toward your usage limits.
    - **The fix:** For news, sports scores, or anything that changes, make sure web search is on (or paste in the information yourself), and check important facts against the original source.
- **Putting too many unrelated tasks in one message:** If you ask Claude to write a recipe, plan a budget, and draft a work email all in the same long prompt, the answer might get muddled and not focus on any one task well.
    - **The fix:** Give Claude one clear job at a time to get the most careful and focused results. You can always start a new message (or even a new conversation) for a different task.
- **Being too vague with your instructions:** Claude is powerful, but it's not a mind-reader. If you just say "Summarize this," it might not know *what* to summarize or *for whom*.
    - **The fix:** Be specific. Instead of "Summarize this," try "Summarize this academic paper for someone with no biology background, focusing on the main findings in five bullet points." The more detail you give, the better the result.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** You can paste in dense terms and conditions, appliance manuals, lengthy school newsletters, or even complex recipes and ask Claude to explain them to you

in plain English, pulling out the key points or action steps you need to take.

- **For your business or work:** You can paste in drafts of long reports, important emails, or project proposals and ask Claude to check your spelling, refine your tone, or organize your thoughts into a clear table or executive summary. It's like having a patient editorial assistant.
- **If you're just getting started:** Use Claude as a patient, friendly tutor. If you don't understand a concept, just ask: "Can you explain this to me like I am a beginner?" or "Break this down into simple steps."

Try it now

Let's take two minutes to see how Claude handles a creative task. Log into your account (or ensure you're still logged in), type the following prompt into the chat box, and hit send:

"Give me three creative, budget-friendly ideas for a weekend family dinner that an average home cook could make. Include a quick shopping list for each idea, focusing on common ingredients."

How to translate and condense foreign-language articles with Copilot

5 steps · Read online

> **In short:** Paste a foreign-language article into Copilot, ask for a plain English summary, then follow up on the parts you care about. Pasted text works most reliably; PDFs and live links vary by plan and account type.

You've probably hit a long article in Spanish, German, Japanese, or Mandarin that you really need to understand — a news piece, a research paper, a product manual, maybe a competitor's announcement from another country. With Microsoft's Copilot assistant, you can paste the text in and walk away with a clear English summary plus translations of the parts that actually matter to you. This guide walks through the whole workflow in five short steps.

Before you start

- A free Microsoft account — any email works, and signing up takes about a minute at account.microsoft.com.
- A way to reach Copilot. The easiest is the website at **copilot.microsoft.com** in any modern browser. If you'd rather use your phone, install the free Copilot app: on iPhone, open the App Store and search **"Microsoft Copilot"**, tap **Get** and wait for the download; on Android, open Google Play and do the same, then tap **Install**. Once installed, open the app and sign in.
- The foreign-language text ready to paste — copied from a webpage you've already opened, or pulled from a document you've saved on your device.
- About 10 minutes for a typical article, longer for a dense PDF.

Step 1 — Open Copilot in a fresh chat

Open **copilot.microsoft.com** in your browser, or launch the Copilot app on your phone. The screen loads to a clean chat window with a message box near the bottom. Starting a fresh conversation matters here — an old chat with earlier topics in it can confuse Copilot and dilute the answer you want. If you don't see a clean empty input area, look for a **"New chat"** button or a **"+"** icon near the top of the screen. On a Windows 11 computer, Copilot may also live in your taskbar as a small colorful icon you can click instead.

Example: nothing to type yet — just have the empty chat window open and ready.

You'll know it worked when the message box is empty and waiting for input, with no earlier conversation visible above it.

Step 2 — Paste the article in small chunks

Click in the message box and paste the article text. To paste on most computers, press **Ctrl+V** (Windows) or **Cmd+V** (Mac). On a phone, long-press the message box and tap **Paste**. The text appears in the box before you send anything — this is your chance to check that the whole thing came through cleanly. Here is the concrete rule for chunking: anything longer than **about 2,000 words (roughly 8 to 10 printed pages, or a Word count above 2,000)** should be split into pieces. Paste section 1, get the summary, then paste section 2 in a fresh message. If your screen shows a red warning or the box refuses the paste, trim the text first and keep only the parts you actually need translated.

💬 Example: just paste the article text directly into the box, no instructions yet — you'll add the ask in the next step.

You'll know it worked when the full chunk of text shows up in the message box, ready to send.

Step 3 — Ask for a plain English summary

With the text pasted in, type your instruction and send the message. Tell Copilot three things: what language the text is in, how long you want the summary, and that you want plain English (not formal or technical phrasing). Copilot reads your pasted text plus your instruction together and starts drafting a reply. Within a few seconds, a condensed English summary appears in the chat. If the first response feels too dense or uses unfamiliar terms, just ask for a simpler version in a follow-up — Copilot remembers the conversation and will rewrite it on the spot.

💬 Example: "This is in German. Please give me a 5-bullet summary in plain English, no jargon, written for a general reader."

You'll know it worked when you see a short, clear English summary that captures the main points of the original article.

Step 4 — Drill into the parts that matter most

Now you can ask follow-up questions about the specific sections you actually care about. Either paste just that paragraph from the original you want translated in full, or describe the section by topic. Copilot will translate just that piece, in context, instead of trying to translate the whole article again. This is where the tool really earns its keep: instead of wading through the entire piece, you get the parts you actually need in proper English, with surrounding context preserved. If the translation sounds awkward or stiff, ask for a more natural phrasing — "Can you rephrase that in everyday English?" works well.

💬 Example: "Translate the paragraph about the new tax rules in full, in everyday English. Keep any proper names, dates, and numbers exactly as they are."

You'll know it worked when you get a clean English version of just the section you asked about, with the meaning preserved.

Step 5 — Copy your summary out for safekeeping

Once you're happy with the summary and the section translations, copy the parts you want to keep. Click and drag to select the English text in Copilot's reply, then copy it the usual way (**Ctrl+C / Cmd+C**, or long-press on a phone), and paste it into your notes app, email, or document. The conversation in Copilot stays available the next time you open it, but having a local copy means you can read it offline, search it later, or share it with someone else. One honest limit: Copilot won't reliably read a PDF or article just from a pasted web link, and file uploads aren't available in every version or plan — for important documents, copying the text out and pasting it in (as in Step 2) is the most dependable approach.

💬 Example: nothing to type — just select the text you want and copy it somewhere you'll find it again.

You'll know it worked when the English summary is saved outside Copilot, in a place you control.

Common mistakes

- **Pasting a URL instead of the text.** Copilot often can't fetch the article, especially if it's behind a paywall or a login. Always copy and paste the actual text from the page — that one step makes the whole difference.
- **Forgetting to say "in plain English."** Without that hint, Copilot may translate literally and keep stiff, formal phrasing that's hard to read. One extra word in your prompt fixes this.
- **Trusting numbers and proper names without checking.** Translations can mistranslate names of people, companies, places, dates, and specific figures. Always glance back at the original for any fact you'll repeat or rely on.
- **Sending a wall of more than about 2,000 words at once.** Paste in chunks, or paste just the section you actually need. Very long single pastes can get cut off without warning.
- **Asking for a translation without saying why.** "Translate this" gives a literal word-for-word version; "summarize this for a presentation" gives you something you can actually use. Tell Copilot the purpose and the output improves a lot.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** When you spot an interesting article from abroad — a recipe, a travel guide, a local news story — you can get the gist in under a minute without learning the language.
- **For your business or work:** You can scan foreign-language reports, competitor coverage, or industry news from other countries in a fraction of the time, and pull out the specific quotes, numbers, or rules you need to act on.
- **If you're just getting started:** Begin with a short article you can also read in the original — that way you can see how well Copilot's summary matches the real meaning, and you'll quickly learn what phrasing gets you the best results.

Try it now

Find one short article online in a language you don't speak — a French recipe, a German product review, a Japanese travel guide, anything that catches your eye. Copy the first paragraph, paste it into Copilot, and send this exact prompt: *"Summarize this in three plain-English bullet points written for a general reader."* You'll see the whole workflow in action in under two minutes.

How to Study Three Sources for One Exam in Gemini Notebook

5 steps · Read online

> **In short:** Put your three readings into one fresh Gemini Notebook (formerly NotebookLM) notebook, then ask the chat for a study guide tied to your exam topic — answers come only from those sources, so the summary stays focused on what you actually need to learn.

You already know how to open Gemini Notebook and drop a source into a notebook. The next level is treating one notebook as a dedicated study tool for a single exam topic: three sources in, one focused chat conversation out, and a study guide you can actually use the night before the test. Here's how to set that up so the AI gives you answers that match your exam, not a generic overview. One honest note up front: Gemini Notebook only answers from the sources you upload — it will not pull in outside facts to fill a gap — so choose your three readings carefully.

Before you start

- A Google account signed in to Gemini Notebook (you already have this).
- Three sources on the same exam topic: PDFs, Google Docs, website links, YouTube URLs, or text you can paste. Roughly 10–30 pages each works best; very long sources slow the tool.
- About 15–20 minutes the first time, faster after you've done it once.

Step 1 — Make a fresh notebook named for the exam topic

Open Gemini Notebook and create a brand-new notebook instead of dropping your sources into an old one. Give the notebook the exact exam topic as its title — for example, "Midterm — Climate Policy" or "Module 3 — Cellular Respiration." A focused title does two things: it keeps the AI from mixing in sources from another class, and it reminds you later what this notebook is for. After you save the title, you'll see an empty notebook with a place to add sources. If you don't see a "New notebook" button, look for a plus-sign icon or a "Create" option in the sidebar. Example: name the notebook "Final Exam — Macroeconomic Policy." You'll know it worked when the notebook appears in your sidebar with that exact title and the source panel is empty.

Step 2 — Add your three sources in a deliberate order

Use the "Add source" button — look for it in the main panel where sources normally go — and upload your three readings one at a time. Order matters less than completeness: Gemini Notebook pulls from every source you give it, so include the textbook chapter, the professor's slides, and any assigned article, even if they overlap. If a source is a website, paste the link; if it's a YouTube lecture, paste the video URL. After each upload, wait for the small confirmation

before moving to the next one. If the panel offers multiple formats (Drive, link, upload), pick whichever matches your file type. Example: add (1) the Chapter 12 PDF, (2) the lecture slides Google Doc, (3) the journal article link. You'll know it worked when all three appear as separate cards in the source panel, each with a short title and a small page count or duration.

Step 3 — Pin the exam question in the chat

Open the chat panel — look for a "Chat" tab or a message-box at the bottom of the notebook — and write a single, specific instruction: tell the AI exactly what the exam will ask and what you want back. Mention the topic, the kind of questions (multiple choice, short answer, essay), and the format you want (a study guide, a quiz, a comparison table). The clearer your instruction, the more useful the answer. The AI can only answer from the three sources you added, so the prompt tells it where to focus. Example: "Create a study guide for my midterm on climate policy. List the 8 most-tested concepts from these sources, define each in 2 sentences, and flag any points where the three sources disagree." You'll know it worked when the AI replies with a structured study guide that quotes or paraphrases points from your three readings, not outside knowledge.

Step 4 — Generate an audio overview for on-the-go review

Look for an "Audio Overview" option — it usually sits near the top of the notebook view, often labeled something like "Generate" or accompanied by a sound-wave icon. Tap it once and confirm; Gemini Notebook turns your three sources into a short spoken summary, with two AI hosts talking through the material. Generation typically takes a few minutes; you'll see a status note while it runs. When it's done, a play button appears and you can listen on the walk to class or during a chore. If you don't see an audio option on your plan, check Google's Gemini Notebook help page for current availability. Example: tap "Generate" beside "Audio Overview," then wait for the "Ready" badge. You'll know it worked when a play button shows up next to the audio overview and you can hear the two hosts summarize your three sources.

Step 5 — Drill into weak spots with follow-up questions

After you read the study guide, scan it for anything fuzzy or unfamiliar. In the same chat, type a follow-up that targets one gap at a time — the AI still has your three sources and your earlier instruction loaded, so it can go deeper without you repeating context. Ask it to define a term, compare two concepts, or quiz you with one practice question. If an answer feels off, look for small citation markers in the response and click them to see which source it pulled from; that way you can check the original reading rather than trust the summary blindly. Example: "Quiz me with 5 short-answer questions on the carbon cycle, then show me which source each answer came from." You'll know it worked when the AI gives a fresh answer that cites your three readings, and clicking a citation reveals the exact line in the source.

Common mistakes

- **Skipping the instruction in Step 3.** A vague "summarize this" gives a generic overview. Tell Gemini Notebook what your exam asks and what format you want — the prompt is half the work.
- **Uploading sources that don't match the topic.** If one of your three readings is on a different chapter, the study guide will drift off-topic. Glance at each source's title before adding it.
- **Trusting the summary without checking.** Gemini Notebook can occasionally misstate a detail from your own sources. When a point matters for your grade, open the source and confirm — the citation markers make this a two-click check.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** Use the same pattern for any focused decision — three reviews of a product you're buying, three reports on a neighborhood you're considering — and ask the chat for a side-by-side comparison.
- **For your business or work:** Treat one notebook as a project file: drop in the brief, the data, and the meeting notes, then ask for a one-page summary you can hand to a stakeholder.
- **If you want to go further:** Once you've used this three-source pattern, try uploading sources in two languages or two formats (a PDF plus a YouTube lecture) and ask Gemini Notebook to reconcile where they disagree.

Try it now

Open Gemini Notebook, create a notebook titled after your next exam, add one source, then type: "Quiz me with 3 questions on this topic." Two minutes from now you'll know whether this workflow fits the way you study.

Getting Started with ChatGPT: Your First 15 Minutes

5 steps · Read online

By the end of this short guide you'll have a free ChatGPT account, know exactly how to type your first question, and understand how to start a new chat whenever you need a fresh slate. Perfect for anyone who's never used an AI chatbot before.

Before you start

- A device with internet access (desktop, laptop, tablet or smartphone).
- A web browser such as Chrome, Firefox, Safari or Edge **or** the official ChatGPT app downloaded from your device's app store.
- An email address you can open to verify a new account (the sign-up screen may also offer other options, such as continuing with Google or Apple).
- No credit card is needed for the free tier. According to OpenAI, free users get everyday text chats, while tools such as file uploads, image creation and data analysis have their own usage limits; ChatGPT tells you when you reach one, and a paid plan raises the limits.
- Set aside about ten minutes to follow the steps one-by-one.

Step 1 — Create a free ChatGPT account

Open your browser and navigate to `chatgpt.com`. At the top of the page you'll find buttons to sign up (at the time of writing, labeled something like "Sign up for free") or log in if you already have an account. Choose to sign up. You can continue with an account such as Google or Apple, with a phone number, or by entering your email address. Follow the on-screen prompts to verify your details; you'll then land in ChatGPT with a blank chat ready. If the screen looks different, look for any option that says sign up, create account or similar. 💬 Example: `myemail@example.com` – type your own email address where the form asks for it. You'll know it worked when you reach the chat screen, with a message box ready for your first question.

Step 2 — Locate the chat input box (the "prompt" area)

On the main chat screen, look for the message box, the empty field where you type (it usually has a short hint text inside). What you type there is called a *prompt*—the written instruction you give the AI, much like telling a friend exactly what you need. When you click inside, a blinking cursor appears, ready for you to type. If you don't see the box, look for the field where you can enter text, or reload the page. 💬 Example: `What are three quick ways to organize a weekend garden project?` – copy and paste the sentence into the box. You'll know it worked when the cursor blinks inside the box and the keyboard (on mobile) or typing cursor (on desktop) is active.

Step 3 — Send your first useful prompt

Now type a clear request into the prompt box—think of it as a short question you would ask a knowledgeable friend. Press the **Enter** key on a keyboard or use the send button next to the box (it looks different on different devices). ChatGPT will start generating a response and a block of text appears in the chat. If pressing Enter does nothing, try the send button instead. 💬 Example: `Suggest five healthy dinner ideas that use chicken and broccoli.` – copy this line exactly and press Enter. You'll know it worked when a list of dinner ideas shows up in the chat window, each on its own line.

Step 4 — Refine the answer with follow-up questions

Read the answer you just received. If you need more detail—perhaps a vegetarian version or a side-dish suggestion—simply type another sentence in the same box and press Enter again. The AI remembers the earlier exchange within the same conversation (this is known as the *context window*, similar to a notebook where previous notes are visible). If the new reply seems unrelated, try re-phrasing your request with more specifics, such as "Please give a vegetarian twist to the third idea". If you suddenly see a blank screen instead of the same chat, you may have accidentally opened a new conversation; look for your list of past chats in the left sidebar and click on the original chat to return to it. 💬 Example: `Can you make those ideas vegetarian instead?` – paste this and hit Enter. You'll know it worked when the AI returns revised dinner suggestions that no longer include chicken.

Step 5 — Start a fresh conversation when you change topic

When you want to ask about a completely different subject—like "How do I fix a leaky faucet?"—choose **New chat**. You can find it near the top of the left sidebar (if you can't see the sidebar, look for a menu button that opens it). Selecting it opens a brand-new, empty conversation. The wording can differ slightly depending on your language and app version. 💬 Example: `Explain how a basic battery charger works.` – type this into the fresh chat box and press Enter. You'll know it worked when the previous dinner ideas disappear and a new answer about batteries appears.

Common mistakes

- **Being too vague:** Typing "cars" or "help" leaves the AI guessing. Fix it by adding specifics, e.g., "What are the fuel-efficiency ratings of hybrid cars released in 2023?"
- **Forgetting to start a new chat:** Continuing a new topic in the same thread can mix up answers. Fix it by always starting a new chat before switching subjects.
- **Assuming the AI can send messages for you:** ChatGPT can draft text but cannot send it from your email or messaging app. Fix it by copying the generated draft and pasting it into your own email client.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** You can quickly draft a polite text to a neighbor, brainstorm birthday party themes, or get a simple recipe without opening a cookbook.
- **For your business or work:** Use ChatGPT to generate marketing copy, outline a short report, or summarize meeting notes—saving you time that would otherwise be spent writing from scratch.
- **If you're just getting started:** The easiest first move is to ask for a short list of pros and cons on a small decision, such as "Should I buy a reusable coffee cup?" This shows you how the AI thinks without overwhelming you.

Try it now

Open ChatGPT, type `Help me write a friendly reminder text for my friend about our coffee catch-up tomorrow.` and press Enter. In less than two minutes you'll have a ready-to-send message you can copy into any chat app.

Translate a Foreign-Language Message in Messenger with Meta AI

5 steps · Read online

> **In short:** Open the Messenger chat, mention @Meta AI, and ask it to translate the message. It replies in plain English right under your request — no copy-pasting. It works best for short, casual messages; long technical texts may need a second pass.

You know the feeling: someone sends a message in Spanish, Japanese, or German, and you stare at it for ten seconds trying to sound out a word. With Meta AI (Meta's built-in assistant, available inside Messenger in many regions) sitting right inside your chats, you can get a translation in seconds without leaving the conversation. Here's how to do it on your phone, step by step.

Before you start

- **The Messenger app** on iPhone or Android — the latest version is best, because older versions may not show Meta AI yet.
- **A Meta account** (the same one you use for Facebook or Instagram).
- **A chat with at least one foreign-language message** in it — ideally with someone who can confirm the translation.
- **Roughly 2 minutes.** That's the whole thing.

Step 1 — Open the chat with the foreign-language message

Tap the Messenger icon on your phone and find the conversation with the message you can't read. Open it. You'll see the chat fill the screen, scroll to the newest messages, and show the foreign-language text in its bubble near the bottom. The message is right there — you don't have to dig for it. If you have lots of chats, use the search bar at the top of Messenger and type the person's name to jump straight in.

💬 Example: a Spanish message that says *"Oye, podemos vernos mañana a las 5?"* (you don't know what it means yet).

You'll know it worked when the chat screen takes over your phone and you can see the unread message sitting in its bubble.

Step 2 — Bring Meta AI into the chat

Tap the message text box at the bottom — the one you normally type replies into — and type **@Meta AI**. A small list of suggestions should pop up; look for one labeled **Meta AI** and tap it to invite the assistant into the chat. If @Meta AI doesn't appear as a suggestion, your app may be

on an older version, or Meta AI may not be available in your region yet — in that case, update Messenger from your app store and try again. On some versions you'll also see a colorful ring or circle labeled **Meta AI** near the top of the chat; tapping that works the same way.

💬 Example: type `@Meta AI` and tap the Meta AI suggestion from the pop-up list.

You'll know it worked when a small "Meta AI" chip appears next to your message, or when Meta AI posts a welcome reply in the chat.

Step 3 — Ask Meta AI to translate the message

With @Meta AI now part of the conversation, type your translation request in plain English. Mention the language if you know it, and quote the original message so the AI knows exactly what to translate. Press send. Meta AI replies in the same chat thread — you don't have to switch screens or open a new tab. Keep your request short and direct; the clearer your instruction, the better the translation usually is.

💬 Example: `@Meta AI translate this to English: "Oye, podemos vernos mañana a las 5?"`

You'll know it worked when Meta AI posts a reply in English within a few seconds, right under your message.

Step 4 — Read the translation and check it makes sense

Read Meta AI's reply carefully. Short, everyday sentences usually translate cleanly. Watch out for slang, idioms, or proper names — AI translations sometimes miss those, or pick the wrong meaning for a word with several. If the translation looks odd or incomplete, your next move is Step 5. If it reads naturally, you're done — go ahead and reply to your friend in English, or use Step 5 to ask for a draft reply in their language.

💬 Example: Meta AI's reply reads *"Hey, can we meet tomorrow at 5?"* — that one is smooth and obvious in meaning.

You'll know it worked when you understand what the original message meant and can decide how to respond.

Step 5 — Ask a follow-up if the translation is unclear

If the first translation is confusing, too formal, or missing a word, send a follow-up message to Meta AI in the same chat. Ask for a simpler version, a different tone, or just for the meaning of one specific word. Meta AI keeps the context of the conversation, so it can adjust without starting over. If you'd like, you can also ask Meta AI to help you write a reply in the foreign language — copy what it drafts, edit if needed, and send it to your friend.

💬 Example: `@Meta AI can you make that sound more casual?` or `@Meta AI what does "mañana" mean on its own?`

You'll know it worked when the new reply reads more clearly, or when you have a draft reply in the original language to send back.

Common mistakes

- **Forgetting to type @Meta AI.** If you just type "translate this" without the @ mention, your message goes to your friend, not the AI. Always start your request with `@Meta AI`.
- **Asking Meta AI to translate a very long paragraph.** Short messages translate cleanly; long blocks can lose nuance or drop words. For long or important texts, use a dedicated translation tool or ask a native speaker.
- **Trusting the translation for anything high-stakes.** Meta AI is great for casual chats, but for legal, medical, or business messages, double-check with a native speaker or a professional translator before acting on it.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** the next time a relative abroad sends a quick message, you'll know what it says in seconds — and you can reply right away instead of leaving them on read.
- **For your business or work:** if a colleague or client messages you in another language, you can keep the conversation moving in Messenger instead of juggling translation apps and copy-paste.
- **If you're just getting started:** try it once this week with any short message in a language you don't speak. Two minutes, and you'll have it down for life.

Try it now

Open Messenger, pick the most recent chat with a message you can't quite read, and type `@Meta AI translate this to English` followed by the message. See what comes back — that's the whole skill.

Getting Started with Grok: Your Guide to Everyday AI Answers

5 steps · Read online

Need a quick explanation of today's news, a few ideas for dinner, or a complicated topic in simple words? This guide shows you how to open Grok, the AI assistant made by xAI, sign in, and ask your first questions. By the end, you'll know how to follow up on an answer and how to check the sources when Grok searches the web for you.

Before you start

- **An X account or an email address:** xAI says you can sign in to Grok with your X account or with email, and your history syncs across your devices.
- **No paid plan needed to begin:** Grok is free to try on the web and in the apps. A paid plan, SuperGrok, adds higher limits.
- **A device with internet access:** a computer with a web browser, or a phone with the Grok app (iOS or Android).
- **Rough total time:** about 5–10 minutes the first time.

Step 1 — Open Grok

- **On a computer:** open your web browser and go to **grok.com**.
- **On a phone:** install the official **Grok** app by xAI from the App Store or Google Play, then open it.
- **If you use X:** Grok is also available inside X, but this guide uses grok.com and the Grok app. 💬 Example: type grok.com into your browser's address bar and press Enter.
- **You'll know it worked when:** you see Grok's start screen with a text box for your question.

Step 2 — Sign in

Choose to sign in, then use your X account or your email address and follow the on-screen steps. Signing in keeps your conversations, so you can continue them later on another device. 💬 Example: on your phone, sign in with the same account you used on your computer, so your earlier chats appear in both places.

- **You'll know it worked when:** you're back on the start screen, signed in, and ready to type.

Step 3 — Send your first question (prompt)

A **prompt** is simply the instruction or question you give to an AI. Think of it as sending a message to a very knowledgeable friend.

- **Action:** click or tap the text box, type your question in a full sentence, and send it (on a computer, pressing **Enter** works too).
- **What happens next:** Grok writes its answer below your question. 💬 Example: type: "I have some leftover roast chicken, half a pumpkin, and some spinach. Can you suggest a simple dinner recipe I can make in under 30 minutes?"
- **You'll know it worked when:** Grok's written answer appears directly below your question.

Step 4 — Refine your question or ask a follow-up

Sometimes Grok's first answer isn't exactly what you needed. Instead of starting over, type a follow-up in the same conversation. xAI says you can continue any conversation with its context intact, so Grok keeps your earlier question and its own answer in mind.

- **Action:** type a clarifying request and send it, just like in Step 3.
- **If Grok seems to lose track:** add a little more detail from the original topic to your follow-up. 💬 Example: after receiving a recipe, type: "Could you make that a vegetarian recipe instead?"
- **You'll know it worked when:** Grok's new answer changes the recipe instead of starting from scratch.

Step 5 — Ask about current events and check the sources

Grok can search the web and X live, so it can answer questions about what's happening right now. xAI says these answers come with citations to the sources it used.

- **Action:** start a new conversation for a new topic, then ask about a recent event in a full sentence.
- **What to check:** open at least one cited source before you rely on the answer. Posts on X can be early, incomplete, or simply wrong, especially during breaking news. 💬 Example: type: "What are the latest updates on the space mission launch from this morning? Summarize the main points in three bullet points and list your sources."
- **You'll know it worked when:** Grok gives a short summary with sources you can open and compare.

Common mistakes

- **Not double-checking facts (hallucinations):** AI can sometimes produce a **hallucination** (an answer that sounds plausible but is actually made up or incorrect).

    - **Fix:** verify important details — dates, figures, health or money questions — in the cited sources or another reliable source.
- **Treating fresh posts as confirmed news:** live search makes Grok fast on breaking stories, but the first posts about an event are often wrong.
    - **Fix:** look for an official or well-established source among the citations before you share or act on the answer.
- **Giving up after the first answer:** if Grok's first response misses the point, many beginners assume the AI isn't helpful.
    - **Fix:** ask a follow-up, add more detail, or request a rewrite — for example, "Can you explain that in simpler terms?" or "Give me more details about point number two."

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** Grok can be your quick go-to for dinner ideas from leftovers, decoding a confusing news headline, or drafting a polite message to a local business.
- **For your business or work:** use Grok to catch up on what people are saying about your industry, brainstorm social-media captions, or get a first explanation of a new trend — then check the sources.
- **If you're just getting started:** keep it simple — use Grok for the small, everyday questions that pop up. The more you use it, the better you'll get at asking the right questions.

Try it now

Open Grok on your device, sign in, and type the following question into the text box:

> "Explain why the sky appears blue in one clear sentence."

Send the prompt and read the answer. You've just taken your first step toward using AI for everyday curiosity.

Getting started with Google Gemini for everyday life

4 steps · Read online

> **In short:** Go to gemini.google.com, sign in with your Google Account, type your request in the text box at the bottom, and click **Submit**. Keep chatting in the same conversation to refine the answer, and double-check anything important, because Google says Gemini can make mistakes.

Gemini is Google's AI assistant. You can ask it to plan a meal, draft an email, or explain a topic in plain words, and it writes an answer for you. This guide follows Google's own Gemini help pages and walks you through your first conversation.

Before you start

- **A Google Account.** Google's help page says you need a personal Google Account (or a work or school account your organization has set up for Gemini). Work accounts also require you to be 18 or older.
- **A device with internet.** A computer, tablet, or phone.
- **No paid plan for these steps.** You can try everything below with a personal Google Account.
- **About 6 minutes.**

Step 1 — Open Gemini and sign in

Open your web browser and go to **gemini.google.com**. If you aren't signed in yet, sign in with your Google Account.

On a phone, Google also offers the Gemini mobile app for Android and for iPhone and iPad. Google's help pages have separate setup instructions for each.

If it looks different: If Google asks you to review terms or settings the first time, read them and continue. Screens can change between versions, but the text box for your request is the part you need.

You'll know it worked when you see a text box at the bottom of the page where you can type.

Step 2 — Write your request like a sentence

In the AI world, the request you type is called a **prompt**. Gemini is built on an **LLM (large language model)**: software trained on large amounts of text so it can understand your request and write a reply in its own words.

That's why full sentences with details work better than a few keywords. Say who it's for, what you need, and any limits, such as time or budget.

💬 Example (keywords only): "Best parks in Chicago with barbecues" 💬 Example (a full prompt): "I am planning a family picnic in Chicago. Recommend three parks with free barbecues, shade, and nearby parking."

You'll know it worked when you have a prompt ready that says what you want, for whom, and with which limits.

Step 3 — Send your first prompt

Click the text box at the bottom of the page and type your prompt. Google's help page says you can also add a file or an image if you want. Then click **Submit** to send it.

Gemini writes its answer above the text box.

You'll know it worked when Gemini's answer appears on the screen.

💬 Example: "I have leftover pumpkin, baby spinach, and pasta in my cupboard. Can you suggest a simple dinner recipe I can make in 20 minutes using these ingredients?"

Step 4 — Follow up in the same chat

If the first answer isn't quite right, don't start over. Type a follow-up in the same text box, and Gemini takes the earlier messages in this conversation into account.

When you want a fresh topic, Google's help page says to click **New chat** at the top left (if you don't see it, open the **Menu** first).

You'll know it worked when Gemini changes or expands its previous answer based on your follow-up.

💬 Example follow-up prompts:

- "Can you make that recipe dairy-free?"
- "Can you write out a quick shopping list for any extra ingredients I might need?"

Common mistakes

- **Typing only a few keywords:** "pasta recipe" gets you a very general answer.
  - **The fix:** Add details, such as "easy vegetarian pasta for one person, ready in 15 minutes." The more context you give, the more useful the answer.

- **Starting a new chat for every change:** A new chat doesn't continue your earlier conversation.
    - **The fix:** Ask your follow-up in the same chat, such as "Can you make that shorter?" or "Now turn that into an email."
- **Trusting important facts without checking:** Google's help page says Gemini can make mistakes and that you shouldn't rely on its responses as professional advice. AI can **hallucinate (confidently state something that sounds real but is wrong)**.
    - **The fix:** Double-check important details, such as health information, opening hours, travel times, or rules, with a reliable source.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** Plan a weekly menu, draft a polite reply to an invitation, brainstorm gift ideas, or get help wording a difficult message.
- **For your business or work:** Get a first draft of an email, brainstorm headlines, or ask for a plain-language explanation of a topic. Check the result before you use it.
- **If you're just getting started:** Don't worry about writing the "perfect" prompt. Type naturally, then ask Gemini to try again or be more specific.

Try it now

Go to **gemini.google.com**, sign in, and type this prompt:

"Suggest three relaxing weekend day-trip ideas starting from my local area, including one spot for lunch." (Replace "my local area" with your town or neighborhood.)

Work & email

How to Get Quick Summaries from Long Documents with Claude

7 steps · Read online

Ever feel swamped by lengthy reports, articles, or complex documents? This guide will show you how to use Claude, an **AI (Artificial Intelligence)**, which is like a very smart computer program designed to think and learn, to quickly get the main points from almost any text. By the end, you'll be able to upload a document and ask Claude to summarize it for you, giving you the essential information you need in a flash.

Before you start

- You'll need a free Claude account (or a paid plan if you prefer). This will give you access to Claude's website.
- Access to the Claude website through your computer's web browser.
- A digital document you want to summarize, such as a PDF or a plain text file. Note that Claude has limits on the file size and length it can process, but free plans are usually sufficient for most common documents.
- This whole process should take you about 5-7 minutes.

Step 1 — Access Claude's Website

Your first step is to open your web browser and navigate to the Claude website. Think of Claude as a powerful **Large Language Model (LLM)**, which is like the highly intelligent engine behind an AI, specifically designed to understand and generate human language. You'll usually see a clean, welcoming chat interface where you can begin interacting with the AI.

You'll know it worked when you see a main chat area, often with a text box at the bottom ready for you to type in.

Step 2 — Start a New Conversation

To ensure you're starting fresh, it's a good idea to begin a new conversation with Claude. Look for a "New Chat" button, which is commonly found on the left-hand side of the screen or near the top. Clicking this will give you a clean slate, meaning Claude won't carry over any previous topics or instructions from old chats, so your summary request will be clear.

If it looks different on your screen, don't worry! Apps change often. You might see a small plus (+) icon, or a menu option like "Start new conversation." Simply click whatever seems to open a fresh chat.

You'll know it worked when the main chat window is clear, with no previous messages, and the message box at the bottom is empty, waiting for your input.

Step 3 — Upload Your Document

Now it's time to get your document into Claude. Look for a paperclip icon, usually found near the message box where you type. This icon is universally used for attachments. Clicking it will open your computer's file explorer, allowing you to browse and select the PDF or text file you wish to summarize. Claude can handle various formats, but PDFs and plain text are generally the most reliable for summarisation. Remember, very large files might not upload on a free plan, as Claude, like all AIs, has a **context window** – this is like the AI's short-term memory, limiting how much text it can 'remember' at once.

If you don't see a paperclip, look for an "Attach file" text link or a similar icon that suggests adding a file.

You'll know it worked when the name of your uploaded document appears in the message box, usually next to your cursor, indicating it's ready to be sent.

Step 4 — Craft Your Summary Request

With your document attached, it's time to tell Claude what you want. This instruction is called a **prompt**, which is simply the command you give to the AI. In the message box, type out a clear request for a summary. Being specific helps Claude understand exactly what you're looking for, rather than just giving a generic overview. For instance, you could ask for specific details or a summary tailored to a particular audience.

If your message box is hard to find, it’s usually a long, horizontal bar at the very bottom of the chat window.

You'll know it worked when your complete summary request appears in the message box, ready to be sent to Claude. 💬 Example: "Please summarize this document for me, highlighting the main points and key takeaways relevant to small businesses."

Step 5 — Send Your Request

Once your document is attached and your summary request is typed, the next step is to send it to Claude. Look for a "Send" button or a paper plane icon, usually located at the right end of the message box. Clicking this will submit both your document and your prompt to the AI. Claude will then begin processing the information, reading through your document and generating a summary based on your instructions. This process usually happens quite quickly.

If the button looks different, it might be an arrow or just the word "Send". Just click the button that looks like it will submit your message.

You'll know it worked when your message disappears from the box, and Claude's response starts appearing in the main chat window, beginning with your requested summary.

Step 6 — Review and Refine the Summary

After Claude generates the summary, take a moment to read through it. AI responses are usually very helpful, but sometimes they might not hit every single point you need, or you might want more detail on a specific section. This is where you can interact further. If you need more information or a different perspective, just type another prompt in the message box, referring back to the document or the summary Claude just gave you. For example, you could ask Claude to elaborate on a particular section or rephrase the summary for a different audience.

If the answer isn't quite what you expected, don't worry, that's normal with AIs. Just try rephrasing your question or adding more specific details in your next prompt.

You'll know it worked when you've either received a summary that fully meets your needs or have asked follow-up questions that yield the specific additional information you were looking for. 💬 Example: "Can you list the top three challenges mentioned in the document and suggest potential solutions?"

Step 7 — Save or Copy Your Summary

Once you're happy with Claude's summary, you'll likely want to save or copy it for your own use. You can typically highlight the text of Claude's response using your mouse, then right-click and select "Copy." You can then paste this summary into a document, email, or wherever you need it. Some AI tools also offer specific "Copy" buttons next to their responses or even export options, though these vary.

If you don't see a direct "copy" button, highlighting the text and using your computer's standard copy (Ctrl+C on Windows, Command+C on Mac) and paste (Ctrl+V or Command+V) functions will always work.

You'll know it worked when you've successfully pasted the summary into another application or saved it to a file, making it ready for your tasks.

Common mistakes

- **Uploading unsupported files or files that are too large:** Claude works best with common document types like PDFs, Word documents, and text files. If you try to upload

an image or a video, or a document that's many hundreds of pages long, it might not work.
    - **The fix:** Convert your file to a supported format like PDF or plain text. If it's very long, you might need to split it into smaller sections or use a paid plan with a larger context window.
- **Vague summary requests:** Just saying "Summarize this" might give you a general overview, but it might not be what you actually need. Claude is good, but it can't read your mind!
    - **The fix:** Be specific! Ask for "three key takeaways," "a summary for someone who knows nothing about this topic," or "the pros and cons of this proposal." The more detail you give in your **prompt**, the better the result.
- **Not verifying critical information:** While Claude is powerful, it's an AI and can sometimes **hallucinate**, which is when an AI confidently presents false or inaccurate information as if it were true. It generates text based on patterns, not absolute truth.
    - **The fix:** Always cross-check any critical facts, figures, or sensitive information from the summary with the original document or another reliable source, especially if you plan to use the summary for important decisions. Claude can draft an excellent summary, but it can't verify the truthfulness of *every single detail* for you, especially in complex or niche topics.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** Imagine quickly understanding the long terms and conditions for a new app, getting the gist of a lengthy news article, or grasping the main points of a new recipe or instruction manual without reading every single word. Claude can save you precious time.
- **For your business or work:** This skill is invaluable for professionals. You can rapidly review lengthy reports, condense meeting minutes, extract key findings from research papers, or quickly understand client briefs, allowing you to focus on decision-making rather than sifting through pages of text.
- **If you're just getting started:** Pick a news article you're interested in online. Copy the main text, paste it into a new Claude conversation, and ask, "Summarize this for me in three sentences." It's a quick, easy way to get a feel for how it works!

Try it now

Find a short PDF document (perhaps a product manual or a short article) or copy-paste the text from a recent online news story into Claude, and then ask it to "Give me the top three main points from this text." See how quickly you can get to the core information!

Turn Messy Notes into a Polite Meeting Agenda in Five Minutes

7 steps · Read online

> **In short:** Paste your messy email thread or bullet list into any AI assistant with a clear instruction about timing, owners, and tone, then iterate. You'll get a polite, structured agenda in under five minutes — though you'll still need to send the invites yourself.

A 30-minute meeting with seven bullet points, three owners, and zero structure usually ends with 20 minutes wasted on "wait, who's covering that?" — and another 10 on a follow-up email nobody reads. This guide shows how to feed that mess into any AI assistant and walk out with a timed, owner-clear agenda you can actually send. It's written for people who already use AI for everyday tasks and want one more workflow that saves real time at work.

Before you start

- An account on any AI assistant you already use — ChatGPT, Claude, Gemini, Copilot, Le Chat, or DeepSeek all handle this pattern. No new signup needed.
- The messy source material within reach: an email thread to copy from, a notes app with bullet points, or a transcribed voice memo.
- About five minutes once you've done it once; a little longer the first time as you build your reusable template.

Step 1 — Gather the messy material in one place

Open your AI assistant in a browser or app and start a fresh chat. Paste your raw material — the email thread, the bullet list, the voice-note transcript — straight into the message box, and add two short sentences of context before you hit send: what the meeting is for, how long it is, and who's coming. You're not asking for the agenda yet; you're staging the inputs.

💬 Example: "Below is the email thread about our Q3 launch. Goal: 30-minute sync to unblock the design freeze. Attendees: Maria, John, Sarah."

You'll see your pasted text sitting in the input area, with the send button below it. After you send, the assistant confirms receipt and begins working. If your assistant has a "Projects" or "custom instructions" feature, you can save the context sentence there for next time — but a plain chat works fine without it.

You'll know it worked when the assistant's first reply acknowledges the inputs you provided and starts producing structured output rather than asking what you meant.

Step 2 — Ask for a first draft with explicit structure

Send a follow-up instruction in the same chat telling the assistant how to shape the draft: numbered topics, a duration in minutes next to each, a named owner per topic, a polite opener, and a small buffer between items. The clearer your structure request, the less you'll need to fix later.

Example: "Now produce the draft. Use a polite opener, list each topic with a duration in minutes and a single owner, leave a 2-minute buffer between topics, and end with a one-line confirmation request."

You'll see a numbered agenda appear, with minutes and names attached to each line. If your assistant formats the response as a table by default — some do — reply with "please rewrite as a numbered list with bold topic names" and the next version arrives in the shape you wanted.

You'll know it worked when your chaotic items are reordered into clear blocks with names and minutes, and you can read the whole meeting in one glance.

Step 3 — Calibrate the politeness

Reply in the same chat asking for tone adjustments. The first draft is almost never the right tone — it usually sounds either too stiff ("Please find below the agenda…") or too casual for a workplace you share with senior people. Tell the assistant which direction to move.

Example: "The opener feels stiff. Loosen it. Our team uses first names and avoids phrases like 'circling back'. Keep the same structure and timings."

You'll see a revised version where the wording changes but the structure stays. If the assistant doesn't pick up your tone signal, paste one sentence of how you'd actually open the meeting and ask it to match that register — that's the fastest shortcut to a natural voice.

You'll know it worked when the opener reads like something you'd say out loud without wincing.

Step 4 — Lock down the owners and timing

Send another short instruction asking the assistant to verify two things: each topic has exactly one named owner, and the minutes add up to the meeting length. This is where most agendas quietly fall apart — two topics assigned to the same person back-to-back, or a 45-minute agenda for a 30-minute slot.

Example: "Confirm each topic has exactly one owner. Add up the minutes and show the total at the end. If anything overflows, suggest what to cut."

You'll see a revised agenda where totals match and names sit beside each item. If the assistant doesn't add a "Total: X minutes" footer, ask for one — it's the simplest way to verify the math yourself before you copy anything out.

You'll know it worked when the total at the bottom equals your available time, and no item is missing a name.

Step 5 — Add a closing line with next steps

Ask the assistant to add a short "Next steps" block at the bottom: who sends the calendar invite, who brings what (slides, doc, numbers), and when the follow-up happens. This is the part most agendas skip, and it's the part that decides whether the meeting actually moves anything.

💬 Example: "Add a 'Next steps' block at the end: Maria sends the calendar invite by tomorrow morning; John brings the latest design mockup; follow-up sync the following Monday."

You'll see a new block appear below the agenda. If your team uses a specific tool — Notion, Google Docs, Slack — name it in your prompt and the assistant will adjust the closing line to fit that workflow.

You'll know it worked when each person at the meeting knows exactly what to do before it starts and after it ends.

Step 6 — Copy the result into your real-world tool

Select the final agenda in the chat and paste it into the place your team will actually see it — an email draft, a shared doc, a calendar description, or your meeting software. This step is small but it matters: the moment the agenda lives outside the chat, you can edit it, share it, and update it without re-asking the AI.

If your assistant offers a "copy" or "export" button, use it; otherwise highlight the text and use your system copy shortcut. The text lands in the new tool with light formatting shifts depending on the destination — that's normal.

You'll know it worked when the agenda sits in the same place your team already works, and you didn't need to retype a single bullet.

Step 7 — Save your prompt as a reusable template

Highlight the full chat — your original messy input, the structure request, the tone instructions, the owners-and-timing check, the closing block — and save it as a reusable template. A plain text file in your notes app works. If your assistant supports saved prompts or custom instructions, use that instead so the template loads automatically.

💬 Example: a doc titled "Agenda from messy notes" with three labeled blocks: [PASTE INPUT], [STRUCTURE REQUEST], [TONE NOTES].

Next time you have a chaotic thread, you paste the template, swap in the new content, and skip the prompt-writing step. The first time costs you ten minutes; every meeting after that costs you one.

You'll know it worked when the next agenda takes you under a minute to draft.

Common mistakes

- **Treating the first draft as final.** The first reply is a sketch. Always run one tone-and-owners pass — usually two — before you copy anything out.
- **Owners stay vague ("the team", "marketing").** Vague owners mean nobody follows up. One named person per topic, every time, no exceptions.
- **Forgetting the AI can't send the invite.** Once you copy the agenda out, the chat ends and the tool stops helping. You still need to send the calendar invite, share the doc, and chase the owners yourself.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** The same pattern tidies up a 10-minute prep before a school meeting, a volunteer group call, or a family planning session — paste the chaos, ask for structure, lock in who does what.
- **For your business or work:** Every recurring meeting — weekly stand-up, monthly review, project sync — gets a polished, owner-clear agenda in minutes instead of 30 minutes of wrestling with bullet points.
- **If you want to go further:** Try the same input-to-structure pattern on other meeting artefacts: a recap email after the meeting, a project kickoff brief from a Slack thread, or a status report from scattered updates. The skill is the same — stage the messy input, request the shape you want, iterate on tone and owners.

Try it now

Open any AI assistant, paste your messiest recent email thread, and send this single line: "Turn this into a 30-minute agenda with one named owner per topic and a polite opener." Watch what comes back — that's your starting point for the iteration loop above.

How to Clean Up a Flooded Email Inbox Using AI in One Afternoon

7 steps · Read online

> **In short:** You can use any AI assistant (ChatGPT, Claude, Gemini, or Copilot) to group your unread email into folders and write a one-paragraph summary of what needs attention today. Most people finish in under three hours.

By the end of this guide, you'll have a tidy inbox with folders that make sense, plus a single short paragraph at the top telling you what actually matters right now. The AI does the thinking; you do the clicking.

Before you start

- An account with any AI assistant you can already use — ChatGPT, Claude, Gemini, Copilot, or Le Chat all work. The free version is enough.
- Your email account (Gmail, Outlook, Yahoo, Apple Mail, anything) open in a web browser.
- About 2–3 hours of quiet time — most of it is waiting, not typing.
- A notes app or blank document where you can paste text (Notepad, Google Docs, Notes — anything that saves text).

Step 1 — Pick which AI you'll use, and open it in a new tab

Open the AI assistant of your choice in a browser tab and sign in. You'll see a chat box at the bottom of the screen with a blank text field waiting for your first message. The conversation is private to you — nothing you paste is sent back to your email provider.

If you've never used one before, ChatGPT, Claude, or Gemini are all safe picks. The free version is plenty for this task; paid plans just let you paste longer messages. If you can't find your bookmark, search "[tool name] login" in Google — the first result is almost always the real site.

Example: open chatgpt.com, claude.ai, gemini.google.com, or copilot.microsoft.com.

You'll know it worked when you see a typing box with a "Send" arrow or paper-plane icon, and the AI greets you when you say hello.

Step 2 — Make a copy of your unread emails the AI can read

In your email account, search for `is:unread` (Gmail), `unread:true` (Outlook web), or use the "Unread" filter in the left sidebar. The screen fills with every message you've ignored — that's your starting pile.

Pick the most recent 50–100 unread emails. Copy the subject lines and senders into a plain text document with `Ctrl+C` (Windows) or `Cmd+C` (Mac). If your email client offers "Export to .csv" for the unread folder, that's even faster — but only export unread mail, never your whole account.

💬 Example: in Gmail, tick the checkbox at the top of the inbox. If a "Select all conversations" link appears, click it. Open the ⋯ menu and choose "Export."

You'll know it worked when you have a file with rows like "Sender — Subject — Date — first 2 lines."

Step 3 — Ask the AI to group the emails into 5–7 folders

Switch back to your AI tab and paste the list in. Then ask it to suggest a folder structure — copy the prompt below as-is.

The AI will respond with a small list of folder names (5–7 is the sweet spot — too many and you stop using them) and which emails belong where. It will not move anything itself; it only suggests. That part is still on you.

💬 Example prompt: *"Here is a list of my unread emails. Group them into 5–7 folder names that make sense, and tell me which emails go in which folder. Use plain folder names a normal person would understand. Don't add explanations yet — just the list."*

You'll know it worked when you see something like: "Personal & Family — 12 emails. Bills & Receipts — 8 emails. Work — 27 emails. Newsletters — 41 emails. Calendar & RSVPs — 6 emails."

Step 4 — Create those folders in your email client

In your email account, create the folders the AI suggested. Most email apps have a "+" or "Create new label/folder" button in the left sidebar — if you don't see it, right-click an existing folder name and look for "New label," "New folder," or "Create."

Name them exactly as the AI wrote them, with the same spelling and capitalization. Lowercase, plural, no emoji — keeping it boring makes it stick. If the AI suggested something like "WorkStuff" and you'd prefer "Work," rename it now. The point is a structure you'll actually use.

💬 Example: in Gmail, look in the left sidebar, scroll to "Labels," click the "+" next to it, and type "Bills & Receipts." In Outlook web, right-click "Folders" in the sidebar and choose "New folder."

You'll know it worked when every new folder name shows up in the sidebar, ready to receive mail.

Step 5 — Move messages into folders, starting with the small groups

Go back to your inbox and tackle the smallest group first — usually "Calendar & RSVPs" or "Personal." Open each email, click "Move to," and pick the matching folder. Do not read anything. The goal is an empty inbox, not total comprehension.

For the biggest group (often "Newsletters"), speed this up: search `category:promotions` (Gmail), `category:updates`, or use the bulk-select checkbox at the top of the list, then choose "Move to" → "Newsletters." This is the only step that feels slow — the rest is fast.

💬 Example: type `label:unread from:newsletter` in the search box, select all results, move them to your "Newsletters" folder in one click.

You'll know it worked when your main inbox counter shows a much smaller number than before, and the moved messages no longer appear in the inbox list.

Step 6 — Ask the AI to write your "what matters now" summary

Now paste the remaining urgent emails (the ones still in your inbox, or the Work and Personal folders) back into the AI and ask it to write a short paragraph telling you what actually needs attention today.

The AI is good at this — it sorts through noise, spots deadlines and asks, and skips pleasantries. Your job is to give it enough context: who is waiting on you, what is due this week, what can wait a month.

💬 Example prompt: *"Here are the remaining unread emails. Write me one short paragraph (under 100 words) telling me what I actually need to act on today, what's due this week, and what I can ignore. Start with the most urgent."*

You'll know it worked when the AI returns a single paragraph beginning with the deadline or action that's most urgent, like: "Reply to the school about Thursday pickup by tomorrow morning — they need a yes or no. Confirm the dentist appointment on Friday. Ignore the three shipping notifications…"

Step 7 — Pin that summary somewhere you'll see it

Take the paragraph the AI wrote and put it where your eyes land first in the morning. The easiest spot: the very top of your inbox (most email apps let you "Pin" or "Star" a message), or a sticky note on your desktop, or the first line of today's to-do list.

This is the whole point of the exercise. A clean inbox feels good for ten minutes — a clear "what matters now" keeps you focused all week. The folders are just a parking lot; the paragraph is the compass.

💬 Example: copy the paragraph into a new email titled "Today" addressed to yourself, and pin it at the top of your inbox.

You'll know it worked when tomorrow morning, before you open any other email, you can read that one paragraph and know what to do first.

Common mistakes

- **Exporting your whole email account instead of just unread.** The AI does not need ten years of receipts to group your unread mail — and pasting your entire inbox into a chatbot is risky. Stick to unread, and only the last few hundred.
- **Letting the AI invent clever folder names like "CriticalPath_Q3_Items."** If a folder name is not something you'd write on a sticky note, change it. Boring folder names get used; clever ones get ignored.
- **Reading every email as you move it.** That's not cleanup, that's procrastination wearing a costume. Move first, read later — the summary tells you what actually matters.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** you'll stop dreading the inbox icon. The folder structure is a parking lot for things you don't need to act on; the summary is your morning compass.
- **For your work or business:** if you get a lot of client email, do this once a month. The folder names might shift slightly (a new project, a new client), but the pattern stays the same.
- **If you're just getting started:** pick one AI you already trust, do Steps 1–4 today, and save 5–7 for tomorrow. Two shorter sessions beat one exhausting one.

Try it now

Open your email account, search for unread messages, and copy the first 30 subject lines into your AI chat. Ask it for 5 folder names. That's it — ten minutes of work, and you'll already see the shape of the cleanup.

Check your resume for ATS-friendly keywords using Hugging Face's Inference API

7 steps · Read online

You'll learn how to scan your resume for keywords that applicant tracking systems (ATS) love, using free AI tools. This helps your resume get past the first filter and into a human's hands.

Before you start

- A **free Hugging Face account** (sign up here)
- A **resume in PDF or Word format** (saved on your device)
- A **computer or laptop** (phone works, but a larger screen is easier)
- **No coding skills needed** — this guide is for everyone
- **Total time:** about 10 minutes

💡 *What is ATS?* Think of it as a robot that scans your resume before a human does. It looks for keywords from the job ad. If your resume doesn't have enough of those words, it might get rejected before you even know.

Step 1 — Create a free Hugging Face account

Go to huggingface.co and click **Sign Up** in the top-right corner. Fill in your email, choose a username and password, then click **Create account**. Check your email and confirm your account.

You'll see your Hugging Face profile page. This is your dashboard — your home base for using AI models.

💬 Example:

```
Email: yourname@example.com
Username: resumehelper
Password: MyPassword123!
```

You'll know it worked when you see your profile picture and username in the top-right corner.

Step 2 — Open the Inference API page

On the Hugging Face homepage, look for **Products** in the top menu. Hover over it and click **Inference API**. This is a free tool that lets you run AI models without installing anything.

You'll see a page with a text box and a list of AI models. This is where you'll paste your job ad and resume.

💡 *What is an API?* Think of it like a waiter in a restaurant. You tell the waiter what you want (your job ad and resume), and the waiter brings it to the kitchen (the AI model) and brings back the answer — without you needing to cook.

You'll know it worked when you see a text box that says **Enter your prompt here** and a button that says **Submit**.

Step 3 — Choose an ATS-friendly keyword finder model

In the text box, type or paste this model name exactly:

```
microsoft/Phi-3-mini-4k-instruct
```

Then press **Enter** or click **Submit**.

This model is a smart AI assistant that can read your job ad and resume and tell you which keywords are missing.

💡 *What is a model?* Think of it like a super-smart student who has read thousands of job ads and resumes. It knows what words to look for.

You'll know it worked when you see a chat window open with a welcome message from the AI.

Step 4 — Write your job ad and resume into the chat

In the chat box, type or paste this exact prompt (copy the whole block):

```
I need help finding ATS-friendly keywords for a job application.
Here is the job ad:
[PASTE JOB AD HERE]

Here is my resume:
[PASTE RESUME TEXT HERE]

List the top 10 keywords from the job ad that are missing from my resume.
```

Replace `[PASTE JOB AD HERE]` with the full text of the job ad you're applying for. Replace `[PASTE RESUME TEXT HERE]` with the text of your resume. To copy text from a PDF, open the PDF, select the text, and press **Ctrl+C** (Windows) or **Cmd+C** (Mac). Paste it into the chat with **Ctrl+V** or **Cmd+V**.

💬 Example:

```
I need help finding ATS-friendly keywords for a job application.
Here is the job ad:
We are looking for a digital marketing specialist with experience in SEO, Google
Analytics, and content creation.

Here is my resume:
I have 3 years of experience in digital marketing, including social media management
and email campaigns.
```

You'll know it worked when the AI replies with a list of keywords, like:

> The top 10 keywords missing from your resume are: SEO, Google Analytics, content creation, PPC, keyword research, on-page optimization, conversion rate optimization, Google Ads, Ahrefs, backlink building.

Step 5 — Ask the AI to rewrite a sentence with the missing keywords

Copy one of the missing keywords from the AI's reply. Then, in the same chat, type:

```
Rewrite this sentence from my resume to include the keyword [KEYWORD]:
"I have 3 years of experience in digital marketing, including social media management
and email campaigns."
```

Replace `[KEYWORD]` with the keyword you copied, like **SEO** or **Google Analytics**.

💬 Example:

```
Rewrite this sentence from my resume to include the keyword SEO:
"I have 3 years of experience in digital marketing, including social media management
and email campaigns."
```

You'll know it worked when the AI replies with a rewritten sentence that includes the keyword naturally, like:

> I have 3 years of experience in digital marketing, including SEO strategy, social media management, and email campaigns.

Step 6 — Save your updated resume

Copy the rewritten sentence from the AI's reply. Open your resume file (Word or Google Docs), find the sentence you want to update, and paste the new version over it. Save the file with a new name like `Resume_ATS_Updated.pdf`.

💡 *Why save a new file?* This way, you always have your original resume to go back to if you need to.

You'll know it worked when you have a new file saved with your updated resume text.

Step 7 — Run the process again to double-check

Repeat Step 4 with your updated resume. Paste the same job ad and your new resume text into the chat. Ask the AI:

```
List the top 10 keywords from the job ad that are still missing from my resume.
```

You'll know it worked when the AI replies with a shorter list of missing keywords, or says:

> All the top keywords from the job ad are now included in your resume.

Common mistakes

- **Mistake:** Pasting the job ad or resume as an image or screenshot. **Fix:** Copy the text from the PDF or Word file and paste it as plain text. Images can't be read by the AI.
- **Mistake:** Using a phone to copy and paste large blocks of text. **Fix:** On a phone, it's easy to lose your place. Use a computer or laptop if you can. If you must use a phone, paste smaller chunks of text at a time.
- **Mistake:** Expecting the AI to rewrite your whole resume perfectly in one go. **Fix:** The AI is great at spotting missing keywords, but it can't rewrite your whole resume in one sentence. Update one sentence at a time, then check again.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** You'll spend less time guessing which keywords to add to your resume. The AI does the hard work for you, so you can focus on the rest of your job application.
- **For your business or work:** If you're hiring, you can use this same method to check if your job ads include the right keywords. It helps attract candidates whose resumes will pass the ATS filter.
- **If you're just getting started:** This is the easiest first move to make your resume ATS-friendly. No coding, no expensive tools — just free AI and a few minutes of your time.

Try it now

Open your resume file and copy the first sentence. Go to huggingface.co, open the Inference API, and paste this prompt:

```
I need help finding ATS-friendly keywords for a job application.
Here is the job ad:
[PASTE A JOB AD YOU'RE APPLYING FOR]

Here is my resume:
[PASTE THE FIRST SENTENCE OF YOUR RESUME]

List the top 5 keywords from the job ad that are missing from my resume.
```

Press **Submit** and see what the AI suggests. You'll have your first ATS keyword list in under 2 minutes.

Drafting Professional Presentations from Scratch Using Microsoft Copilot in PowerPoint

7 steps · Read online

Imagine turning a messy idea or a blank slide deck into a polished, ready-to-use presentation in under 10 minutes. With Microsoft Copilot in PowerPoint, you can draft outlines, generate slide titles, and fill in speaker notes—all from a simple prompt. This guide walks you through every step, from opening PowerPoint to exporting your finished slides.

Before you start

- A **Microsoft 365 account** (free or paid)
- The **PowerPoint desktop app** (Windows or Mac) or **PowerPoint on the web**
- A **device with internet access**
- Roughly **10–15 minutes** of your time
- Optional: a **Microsoft 365 Copilot license** (paid) for full features

> ⚠️ Note: Some Copilot features may require a paid Microsoft 365 Copilot license. If you don't have it, you'll still be able to use basic Copilot features like generating outlines and slide titles.

Step 1 — Open PowerPoint and start a new presentation

Open the **PowerPoint app** on your computer or go to PowerPoint on the web. Click **New blank presentation** to start with a blank slide deck.

You'll see a single slide titled "Click to add title." The ribbon at the top shows tabs like **Home**, **Insert**, and **Design**.

If you don't see the **Home** tab, look for a menu at the top with words like **File**, **Home**, or **View**.

You'll know it worked when you see a blank slide with a title and subtitle placeholder.

Step 2 — Open Copilot in the PowerPoint ribbon

On the **Home** tab in the ribbon, look for a button labeled **Copilot** (it looks like a sparkle or a chat bubble with stars). Click it to open the Copilot pane on the right side of your screen.

You'll see a chat box, usually at the bottom of the Copilot pane. This is where you'll type your instructions.

If you don’t see the Copilot button, make sure you’re using the latest version of PowerPoint. Look for **File > Account > Update Options > Update Now**.

You'll know it worked when the Copilot pane opens on the right with a blinking cursor ready for your prompt.

💬 Example: Type or paste:

```
Help me create a presentation about the benefits of remote work for a team of 20 software developers.
```

Step 3 — Give Copilot a clear prompt to generate an outline

In the Copilot chat box, type a clear, specific prompt. Include:

- Your **topic**
- Your **audience**
- Any **key points** you want covered

After you press Enter, Copilot will process your request and show a message like “Generating outline…” in the pane.

You’ll see a new section titled **Outline** appear in the Copilot pane, with 4–6 suggested slide titles and bullet points.

If the outline isn’t quite right, you can type:

```
Add a slide about work-life balance and another about team collaboration tools.
```

You'll know it worked when you see a structured outline with slide titles and bullet points in the Copilot pane.

💬 Example:

```
Create an outline for a 10-minute presentation on 'How Remote Work Boosts Developer Productivity'. Include slides on flexibility, tools, and team culture.
```

Step 4 — Insert the outline into your slides

Click the **Add to presentation** button under the outline in the Copilot pane. Copilot will automatically create new slides based on the outline.

You'll see your slide deck grow from one blank slide to 5–7 slides with titles and bullet points.

If the slides look too plain, don't worry—you can edit them later. If the Copilot pane disappears, click the **Copilot** button again to reopen it.

You'll know it worked when you see multiple slides with titles and bullet points in your deck.

Step 5 — Ask Copilot to generate speaker notes for each slide

Select the first slide. In the Copilot pane, type:

```
Add speaker notes to this slide explaining the benefits of remote work for developers.
```

Copilot will write 2–3 sentences of speaker notes under the slide. Repeat this for each slide by selecting it and asking Copilot to add notes.

You'll see a small note icon appear on each slide. Click the icon to read the notes.

If speaker notes don't appear, make sure you've selected the slide first. If Copilot doesn't respond, refresh the pane or check your internet connection.

You'll know it worked when you see speaker notes appear under each slide.

💬 Example: For a slide titled "Flexibility," Copilot might add:

```
Speaker notes: Remote work lets developers choose their most productive hours. Studies show 60% of developers report higher focus at home. Mention our recent productivity report from Q2.
```

Step 6 — Refine content with follow-up prompts

With the outline and notes in place, ask Copilot to improve or expand any slide. For example:

```
Rewrite the slide titled 'Team Collaboration Tools' to include specific examples like Microsoft Teams and GitHub.
```

Copilot will update the slide content in real time. You can also ask it to:

- Shorten the text
- Add a quote
- Include a data point

You'll see the slide content change immediately after you press Enter.

If Copilot doesn't update the slide, try clicking **Refresh** in the Copilot pane or re-selecting the slide.

You'll know it worked when the slide content updates to match your new prompt.

💬 Example:

```
Add a quote from Satya Nadella about remote work culture to the last slide.
```

Step 7 — Export or present your presentation

When you're happy with the slides, save your presentation (**File > Save As**). To present, click **Slide Show > From Current Slide** or press **F5**.

You'll see your slides full-screen, ready to present.

If you want to share it, go to **File > Share > Send a Copy** to export as PDF or PowerPoint file.

You'll know it worked when you can present or share a complete, professional-looking deck.

Common mistakes

- **Mistake:** Writing a vague prompt like "Make a presentation." **Fix:** Be specific: include topic, audience, and key points. Example: "Create a 5-slide presentation on AI tools for small business owners."
- **Mistake:** Expecting Copilot to write perfect content in one try. **Fix:** Use follow-up prompts to refine slides. Ask Copilot to shorten, add data, or include a quote.
- **Mistake:** Not checking speaker notes or slide content for accuracy. **Fix:** Always review Copilot's output. Edit or remove anything that doesn't fit your message.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** Need to present a project update at work? Use Copilot to draft slides in minutes instead of hours. Great for team meetings, client pitches, or internal reviews.

- **For your business or work:** Create consistent, professional presentations without hiring a designer. Use it for quarterly reviews, training decks, or onboarding materials.
- **If you're just getting started:** Start with a simple prompt and let Copilot do the heavy lifting. You'll save time and look polished—even if you're not a designer.

Try it now

Open PowerPoint, start a new presentation, and open Copilot. Type:

```
Help me create a 5-slide presentation about the benefits of remote work for a team of 20 software developers.
```

Press Enter. Review the outline, add it to your slides, and start presenting in under 10 minutes.

Digitize Handwritten Notes into Editable Text with AI

6 steps · Read online

Do you have notebooks full of brilliant ideas, meeting notes, or shopping lists that you can never quite find when you need them? This guide will show you how to quickly turn those physical scribbles into digital text using AI, so they're always searchable and editable, right on your phone or computer. It's for anyone who wants to bring order to their paper notes without retyping a single word. While AI is great at "reading" your handwriting, it can't understand *meaning* or summarize for you yet – it just converts the words.

Before you start

- **A smartphone or tablet with a working camera.** Ensure your device has enough battery life and storage for a few photos.
- **Access to an app that offers AI-powered OCR.** This means **Optical Character Recognition**, a technology that "reads" text from images. Think of it like a very clever digital assistant looking at your picture and identifying each letter and word, then turning it into text you can actually edit. The "AI-powered" part means it uses advanced artificial intelligence to understand different handwritings and layouts, making it much more accurate than older systems. Many free note-taking or scanning apps now include this feature, such as Google Keep (available on Android and iOS) or Microsoft OneNote (available on Android and iOS).
- **A free Google or Microsoft account.** You'll likely need one of these to use the apps suggested, though you probably already have one set up on your device. Ensure you're logged in before you start.
- **Roughly 5-10 minutes** to follow these steps for your first digitized note.

Step 1 — Prepare your notes for capture

Before you take a photo, you need to set up your handwritten notes in a way that helps the AI "read" them clearly. You'll see your physical notes lying on a surface. Your goal is to give the AI the best possible image to work with, as good, even lighting and legible handwriting make a big difference for the AI to understand your scribbles correctly. Think of it like a librarian trying to read tiny, smudged print – the clearer, the better!

Once prepared, your notes will be ready for you to take a photo. If your usual handwriting is quite messy, try to write a little slower and clearer for important notes you plan to digitize, as this significantly improves the AI's accuracy.

Example: Place your handwritten notes on a plain, uncluttered surface, like a clear desk. Position them under natural light from a window, if possible, or use a well-lit lamp to avoid

casting shadows over your writing. Make sure the paper is flat and smooth, with no creases. You'll know it worked when your notes are lying flat, look easy to read in the available light, and are clear of any distracting objects, ready for a photo.

Step 2 — Open your scanning app

Now it's time to open your chosen app. You'll see your device's home screen with various app icons. You need to locate and tap on the icon for your OCR app. For this guide, we'll use Google Keep as the primary example, which is free and widely available. Microsoft OneNote is another option that includes document scanning. Once opened, the app will load, often showing your existing notes or presenting a default view.

If you don't already have one of these apps, you'll need to download it from your device's app store (Google Play Store for Android or Apple App Store for iOS) and install it first. Look for the app icon, which usually looks like a colorful note for Google Keep or a blue notebook icon for Microsoft OneNote.

Example: Tap the "Google Keep" app icon on your home screen or app drawer (it looks like a yellow and white notepad). Alternatively, tap the "Microsoft OneNote" app icon (a blue notebook icon). You'll know it worked when the app opens and you see its main interface, such as a list of notes or a camera view, indicating it's ready for you to take action.

Step 3 — Take a clear photo

With your chosen app open, you'll typically see options to create a new note or use the camera. You need to find and tap the camera or scan icon to activate your device's camera within the app. The screen will then switch to a camera interface, often with specific modes like "Document" or "Scan" in apps like OneNote to help you capture text accurately.

Position your device directly above your notes, aiming for a straight-on shot without shadows, ensuring all your writing fits within the frame. Then, tap the shutter button. The app will capture the image, and some might even automatically detect the edges of your document and crop the image for you, making it look neater.

Example: In Google Keep, tap the plus (+) icon at the bottom of the screen, then choose the camera icon (it might be labeled 'Take photo' or 'Image'). In Microsoft OneNote, select 'Camera' from the options at the bottom, then hold your phone steady over your notes and tap the shutter button. You'll know it worked when you see a sharp, unblurred image of your notes presented within the app, often with the document edges automatically detected and cropped, ready for the next step.

Step 4 — Initiate text recognition with AI

With your clear photo captured in the app, it's time for the AI-powered OCR to do its magic. You'll typically see your captured image on the screen, possibly with a menu or a button related to text. You need to find and tap an option that tells the app to "read" the text from the image. This button might say something like "Scan text," "Recognize text," "Grab image text," or simply show a 'T' icon.

Once you activate this function, the AI will process the image you've taken, which usually takes just a few seconds. A new screen or panel will then appear, displaying your handwritten words now typed out as digital text. If you don't see an obvious "Grab image text" button, try tapping on the image itself, or look for a three-dot menu (⋯) or a gear icon (⚙️) that might contain the option you need.

💬 **Example:** In Google Keep, after your photo is captured, tap on the image to view it full screen. Then, look for a three-dot menu (⋯) in the top-right corner of the screen and tap the option labeled 'Grab image text'. In Microsoft OneNote, after taking a photo, tap the 'Text' icon that appears on the captured image to extract the text. You'll know it worked when a new text box or a separate screen appears, displaying your handwritten words now typed out as digital text, ready for you to review.

Step 5 — Review and make corrections

The AI is incredibly smart, but it's not perfect! Especially with unique handwriting, faint lines, or unusual symbols, it might make a few mistakes. You'll see the extracted text, usually in an editable field, displayed on your screen. Take a moment to read through this digitized text carefully and correct any errors.

As you make corrections, the text on your screen will update instantly, just like in any word processor. If the text isn't directly editable, look for an "Edit" button or a cursor you can tap to activate the editing mode. Remember, the AI is a great starting point, but it usually cannot perfectly capture every nuance of human handwriting, so your review is crucial for accuracy and ensures your digital notes are truly useful.

💬 **Example:** Carefully read through the digitized text. If you spot a word like "flow" incorrectly appearing as "flew," tap on "flew" and type "flow" to correct it. Also, remove any extra spaces, line breaks, or unwanted characters the AI might have picked up from smudges or background textures on the paper. You'll know it worked when you've corrected all the obvious mistakes, and the digital text accurately reflects your original handwritten notes, making them much clearer than your original scrawl.

Step 6 — Save or export your editable text

After reviewing and correcting your digitized notes, you can now save them or share them. You'll see options on your screen to save the note within the app, copy the text to your device's clipboard, or share it to other applications. This final step means your old scribbles are now **editable text** (you can change it whenever you like) and **searchable text** (your device can find it instantly when you search).

Once you take action, your app will usually confirm that the note has been saved, or the text will be transferred to your chosen destination. If you don't see an explicit "Save" button, look for an arrow pointing left (←) or a "Done" button, which will usually save your changes within the app you're using. Free versions of apps might have limits on how many notes you can save or what export options are available, but basic saving and copying are almost always free.

💬 **Example:** Tap the 'Save' or 'Done' button within your chosen app to store the note. Alternatively, look for a 'Share' icon (often a three-dot connection or an upward-pointing arrow) to copy the text to your phone's clipboard or send it directly to an email, a document app like Google Docs or Microsoft Word, or cloud storage like Google Drive or OneDrive. You'll know it worked when your app confirms the note is saved (e.g., you see it in your main notes list), or when you successfully paste the text into another application, ready for editing, searching, or sharing.

Common mistakes

- **Poor lighting or blurry photos:** Shadows or dim light make it incredibly hard for the AI to "read" your notes accurately, and blurry images are almost impossible for it to decipher. Always aim for bright, even light, and hold your phone steady when taking the picture. If the first attempt is blurry, simply delete it and retake the photo.
- **Not reviewing the extracted text:** It's easy to assume the AI got it all right, but even the best AI can make mistakes, especially with unique handwriting or complex layouts. A quick check and correction can save you from future confusion or embarrassment when you try to use the notes later. Always perform a quick read-through.
- **Using an app without a strong OCR feature:** Not all camera or note-taking apps have robust AI-powered OCR. If your results are consistently bad (lots of errors, missing text), try downloading a dedicated scanning app like Google Keep or Microsoft OneNote, which are known for good text recognition capabilities.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** Imagine quickly finding that recipe idea you scribbled down weeks ago, or having a digital copy of your kids' school notes that you can share instantly with a co-parent. No more rummaging through stacks of paper! This tool helps you keep

important information organized and accessible, whether it's a shopping list, a quick thought, or important reminders.

- **For your business or work:** Effortlessly convert meeting notes, brainstorming sessions, or client feedback from paper to a digital format. This makes them searchable, easy to share with colleagues, and simple to integrate into digital documents, saving you valuable time on transcription.
- **If you're just getting started:** Pick one short, clearly written note – like a shopping list or a phone number – and try to digitize it. It's a low-pressure way to see how well the AI works with your handwriting.

Try it now

Grab a piece of paper and quickly jot down three items on your grocery list. Now, open Google Keep (or Microsoft OneNote), take a clear photo of your list, and use the app's text recognition feature. In less than two minutes, you'll have your shopping list in an editable format, ready to paste into a messaging app or email!

Summarize Any Long Document or Article with AI

6 steps · Read online

Tired of scrolling through a 20-page policy, a lengthy news article, or a long email thread? This guide will show you how to use a free AI tool to quickly get a short, reliable summary. In just a few minutes, you'll be able to cut through the noise and focus only on what truly matters.

Before you start

- **A device with internet access:** A computer, tablet, or smartphone is perfect.
- **A free AI chat tool:** We'll use general instructions that work for popular options like ChatGPT (find it at `chatgpt.com`) or Gemini (at `gemini.google.com`). You'll need to create a free account and log in.
- **A document or article to shorten:** This could be a webpage, a PDF where you can select text, an email thread, or any plain text.
- **Rough total time:** About 6 minutes to follow all the steps.

Step 1 — Copy your document text

First, open the document or article that you want the AI to summarize. Once it's open, you need to select all the relevant text. On a computer, you can often do this by clicking your mouse at the start of the text and dragging to the end, or by using a keyboard shortcut like `Ctrl+A` (Windows) or `Cmd+A` (Mac) to select everything. With the text highlighted, press `Ctrl+C` (Windows) or `Cmd+C` (Mac) to copy it to your **clipboard**. The clipboard is a temporary storage area on your device, like a hidden notepad, where copied items wait to be pasted.

You'll know it worked when the text is highlighted (often in blue or gray), and you've used the copy command. Although nothing visibly changes on your screen after copying, the text is now safely on your clipboard, ready for the next step. If you can't select text, try opening the document in a different program (e.g., a web browser for PDFs) or look for a "Select All" option within the application's menu.

💬 Example: Open a long email thread. Press `Ctrl+A` (Windows) or `Cmd+A` (Mac) to select the entire email body, then press `Ctrl+C` (Windows) or `Cmd+C` (Mac).

Step 2 — Open your AI chat tool

Next, open your preferred free AI chat tool in your web browser or dedicated app. For instance, you might type `chatgpt.com` into your browser's address bar for ChatGPT, or `gemini.google.com` for Gemini. If you're using a phone or tablet, simply launch the app. If you're prompted, make sure you're logged into your free account.

You'll typically see the AI tool's main chat interface, which usually features a large, empty text box at the bottom of the screen. This is where you'll type your messages to the AI. The tool is now waiting for your instructions. If your screen looks different, or you see old conversations, look for a "New Chat" button, a plus sign icon (`+`), or a similar option to start a fresh, blank conversation.

💬 Example: Open your web browser and navigate to `gemini.google.com`. Log in to your account if prompted, then ensure you have a blank conversation ready.

You'll know it worked when you see an empty chat box, ready for you to type your first message, usually labeled "Message [AI name]..." or "Type your prompt here...".

Step 3 — Craft your summary request (Prompt)

Now, in the AI's chat box, you'll type your instruction for the summary. This instruction is called a **prompt** – it's like giving a clear job description to the AI. Be specific about the desired length, format (e.g., bullet points), and tone for your summary. A good prompt helps the AI understand exactly what you need.

You'll see the words you type appearing in the chat box. At this stage, the AI is just receiving your input, and you haven't sent anything yet. If the chat box shows pre-written suggestions, simply ignore them and type your own request. Being clear upfront saves time later.

💬 Example: Type this into the chat box (do not press Enter or Send yet):

> "Please summarize the following document in three concise bullet points. Keep the language neutral and factual, avoiding any personal opinions or interpretations."

You'll know it worked when your complete summary request is typed into the box, clearly visible, but you haven't sent it to the AI yet.

Step 4 — Paste your text and send

After typing your summary request, move your cursor to the end of your prompt, then immediately paste the long document text that you copied in Step 1. You can do this by pressing `Ctrl+V` (Windows) or `Cmd+V` (Mac). The pasted text will appear right after your instruction in the same chat box. Once both your prompt and the entire document text are in the box, press Enter or click the "Send" button (often a paper plane icon) to send everything to the AI.

You'll see your prompt and the long document text appear in the chat history. After a moment, the AI will start generating its response. This processing is called **inference**, which is when the AI "thinks" about your request and creates an output. If your document is extremely long (e.g., hundreds of pages), the AI might tell you it's too much text for its **context window**. The

context window is like the AI's short-term memory – the amount of information it can "remember" and process at once. If this happens, you might need to break your document into smaller chunks and summarize them separately, or consider a paid plan, as some free versions may have usage restrictions.

Example:

> "Please summarize the following document in three concise bullet points. Keep the language neutral and factual, avoiding any personal opinions or interpretations.
>
> [Now, paste your copied document text here, directly after the prompt.]"

You'll know it worked when you see your message disappear into the chat history, and the AI begins to type out its summary, usually appearing as new text below your input.

Step 5 — Check and refine the summary

Once the AI has generated its summary, carefully read through the bullet points it provided. Compare them against the original document to ensure they are accurate, don't miss any crucial details, and match the tone you requested. Sometimes, AI can "hallucinate" – meaning it confidently makes up information that isn't present in the original text, or misinterprets something. If anything feels off, needs clarification, or isn't quite what you wanted, simply type a follow-up question or instruction in the chat box.

You'll see the AI's initial summary in the chat. When you ask a follow-up question, your new prompt will appear, and then the AI will try to adjust its response based on your feedback. If the AI completely misunderstands or gives a poor response, you might need to try rephrasing your initial prompt more clearly or start a new chat conversation altogether.

Example:

> "The third bullet point mentions 'Section 5'. Please confirm the exact wording of Section 5 from the original text and update that bullet point to be more precise. Also, can you ensure the overall tone is strictly professional?"

You'll know it worked when the AI responds with an updated summary that addresses your feedback, making it more accurate and aligned with your specific needs.

Step 6 — Finalise and use your summary

Once you are completely happy with the AI's summary, it's time to make it your own. You can copy the final bullet points from the chat interface to your clipboard. Most AI tools allow you to highlight the text with your mouse (click and drag) and then use the copy command (`Ctrl+C` or

`Cmd+C`). Some tools may also have a specific "Copy" button or icon next to the AI's response to make this easier.

You'll see the polished, accurate summary on your screen. After copying, the text is on your clipboard, ready to be pasted into another application, like an email, a report, or your personal notes. If there isn't an obvious "copy" button, simply highlight the AI's text and use your device's standard copy function.

💬 Example: Paste the finalised bullet points into a new email, a team chat application like Microsoft Teams, or a note-taking app on your phone to share or save.

You'll know it worked when the summary text is successfully copied (you can test this by pasting it into a simple text editor like Notepad or Notes) and you can then paste it into your desired application.

Common mistakes

- **Too vague a request:** Asking for "a summary" without specifying length or format can result in a lengthy, unstructured response. **The fix:** Always be specific. Say "in three bullet points," "one short paragraph," or "a summary suitable for an executive" in your prompt.
- **AI "hallucinations" or opinions:** AI tools can sometimes confidently present incorrect information or add their own interpretations that aren't in the original text. **The fix:** Always include phrases like "keep the language neutral and factual; do not add your own opinions" in your initial prompt, and critically review the summary against the original document. Don't be afraid to ask for corrections.
- **Text too long for the AI:** Trying to summarize extremely long documents (e.g., an entire book or a very dense legal document) might hit the AI's **context window** limits. **The fix:** Modern AI tools have much larger context windows than before, but extremely long documents may still require breaking them into smaller sections, or using a paid plan if available.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** The next time you receive a long work email, a detailed news article, a community newsletter, or even a lengthy recipe blog post, you can quickly get the main points without reading every single word. This saves you valuable time and helps you stay informed efficiently.
- **For your business or work:** Condense lengthy reports, meeting minutes, customer feedback surveys, or policy documents into concise, actionable bullet points. This can help you prepare for presentations faster, communicate key information efficiently to colleagues, or quickly grasp the core of complex documents. Remember, while AI is

incredibly helpful, it cannot provide legal or medical advice, and human review is crucial for critical documents.

- **If you're just getting started:** Pick one long email thread you've received today, or a lengthy article you saved to read later. It's an easy first step that will quickly show you the power of AI summaries and build your confidence in using these tools.

Try it now

Open any long email thread you've received in the last week, copy the messages, and remove names, addresses, or account numbers you'd rather not share. Paste the text into your AI chat tool with this prompt:

"Summarize this email thread in five bullet points, then list any decisions that were made and any questions still waiting for an answer."

Before you rely on the summary, compare it with the first and last messages in the thread. If something important is missing, ask a follow-up such as "What did the thread say about the deadline?"

How to turn a long PDF contract into a plain-English summary in 5 minutes

6 steps · Read online

> **In short:** Open any AI assistant that accepts PDF uploads, attach the file, and ask a few focused questions about deadlines, fees, and cancellation. You'll get a plain-English summary in minutes — but always read the original key clauses yourself, because AI summaries can miss important details.

Contracts hide the important parts deep in the small print: the auto-renewal clause, the 30-day cancellation window, the fee that "may apply" later. An AI assistant can pull all of that into a short, readable summary, but only if you ask the right questions. This guide shows the technique that works in any major AI assistant that accepts PDF uploads — ChatGPT, Claude, Gemini, Copilot, Le Chat, and others.

Before you start

- An AI assistant that can read PDF files you upload. Most major assistants do this on their free tier, but very long contracts (over roughly 100 pages) may need a paid plan. Check the upload limit on the assistant's pricing page if your document is unusually long.
- The contract itself, saved as a PDF on your computer or phone.
- About 10 minutes. The summary itself is fast; the careful read-through at the end takes a moment.
- A quiet moment to actually read what the assistant tells you.

Step 1 — Start a fresh chat and upload the PDF

Open your AI assistant and begin a brand-new conversation. A clean slate gives you the cleanest answer — older chats can confuse what the assistant reads in the new document. Once the chat is open, look for a **paperclip**, **attachment**, or **plus icon** near the message box. Tap that, then choose the PDF from your files. Some assistants also let you drag and drop the file straight onto the chat window.

If you don't see a paperclip, look for a **+ icon** or a button labeled something like **Add files** or **Upload**. On phone apps the icon often hides inside a small menu at the side of the text box.

💬 Example: "I'm uploading a contract. Please don't analyze it yet — I'll ask my questions one at a time."

You'll know it worked when the file name appears above the message box (or as a small chip beside it) and the assistant confirms it can see the document. If nothing happens after 30

seconds, the file may be too large — check the assistant's file-size limit before assuming the tool is broken.

Step 2 — Ask for a plain-English overview first

Before you drill into the details, ask the assistant to give you a one-paragraph summary of what the document is, who it's between, and what it covers. This grounds the rest of the conversation: once the assistant has the big picture in mind, its later answers tend to be more accurate. Type your question in the message box where the uploaded file is already attached, and press Enter or the send arrow.

If the answer is longer than a paragraph or feels like a sales pitch, ask it to "shorten to one paragraph and skip the legal jargon." If the assistant gives you only a vague intro, ask a follow-up: "What kind of contract is this — a service agreement, a lease, a sales contract, or something else?"

💬 Example: "In plain English, what is this document, who are the parties, and what is the main thing being agreed to?"

You'll know it worked when the assistant gives you back a short paragraph (3 to 6 sentences) that names the type of contract, the people or companies involved, and the core purpose. If any of those three is missing, ask one more focused question before moving on.

Step 3 — Ask the three questions that actually matter

Now the real work. In the same chat, type three focused questions, one after another: **deadlines** (when does this start, when can I leave, when does it auto-renew), **fees** (what does it cost, what changes after the first period, what extra charges might apply), and **cancellation** (how do I end this, what's the notice period, what happens if I miss it). Ask all three in one message so the assistant can answer them together. Press Enter and wait — usually under a minute.

If the assistant answers only one of the three, send the missing questions in a fresh message. If the answer feels too short, ask "Please list every date, dollar amount, and cancellation step you can find in the document."

💬 Example: "From this contract, list: 1) every deadline or time limit I need to know, 2) every fee, charge, or price that might apply, and 3) exactly how I cancel, including any notice period. Use bullet points."

You'll know it worked when the assistant gives you a structured, easy-to-scan answer with three clear sections. If any answer is "I can't find that in the document," ask it to point to the page or section it looked at — sometimes the answer is there and the assistant missed it.

Step 4 — Push for the things people forget to ask

Once you have the big three, push one more layer. Contracts hide risk in the small print: what happens if you miss a payment, who pays legal fees in a dispute, whether the company can change terms mid-contract, and which country's laws apply. Ask these as a follow-up message in the same chat. The assistant now has the document **and** your earlier answers in its context window (the conversation history it can refer to), so it can build on what it already told you.

If the assistant's answer feels generic, paste in the actual clause: "I'm looking at section 8.2. What does this mean in plain English, and what's the worst-case scenario for me?"

💬 Example: "What happens if I miss a payment, who covers legal fees in a dispute, can the company change the terms mid-contract, and which state's laws apply? Point me to the section for each."

You'll know it worked when the assistant points to specific sections or page numbers and explains each risk in a sentence a non-lawyer can follow. If it just says "this is a standard clause" without explaining the actual risk, ask "what's the worst that could happen to me, in concrete terms?"

Step 5 — Ask for a one-page checklist you can save

Now ask the assistant to compress everything into a short, printable checklist you can keep next to the contract. A checklist is easier to skim than a long summary, and it's the format most people actually re-read later. Ask in the same chat — the assistant still has the document and your earlier conversation. The result should fit on one screen: action items, key dates, and money amounts, plain and short.

If the checklist comes back too long, ask it to "cut this to the 10 most important items I'd forget in six months."

💬 Example: "Summarize everything we just found into a one-page checklist I can save: dates I must remember, amounts I'll be charged, and the steps to cancel. Keep it under 15 lines."

You'll know it worked when you can copy the answer into a notes app and read it in under a minute. If the checklist still feels like a wall of text, ask the assistant to put each item on its own line with the date or amount in bold.

Step 6 — Spot-check three sections in the original PDF

AI summaries are good, but they're not perfect. The assistant can misread a clause, skip a footnote, or paraphrase something in a way that changes the meaning. Before you rely on the summary, open the original PDF and read three things yourself: the **cancellation clause**

(usually labeled "Termination"), the **fees section** (often "Fees," "Charges," or "Payment Terms"), and any **date or deadline** the assistant flagged. If those three match what the assistant told you, the rest of the summary is very likely accurate.

If you can't find the section the assistant mentioned, use the PDF's search function (Ctrl+F on a computer, or the magnifying glass icon in most phone PDF apps) and type a keyword from the clause. If something doesn't match, send a follow-up question: "Section X says something different — can you re-read and reconcile?"

💬 Example: "Cancellation clause says 30 days, fees say a charge after year one, and auto-renewal is 60 days before expiration — can you re-read sections 7, 9, and 12 and tell me if your summary matches?"

You'll know it worked when the three sections you read match the summary, and you feel comfortable either signing the contract or deciding not to. If anything is off, send the assistant the exact text and ask it to explain the difference — that's how you catch the small print that changes everything.

Common mistakes

- **Asking one giant question.** A single "summarize this contract" prompt usually gives a vague, hard-to-scan answer. Splitting it into overview, the three big questions, the hidden risks, and a checklist gets you a result you can actually use.
- **Trusting the summary without checking.** AI assistants can misread clauses, especially around fees and dates. Always read the cancellation, fees, and deadline sections yourself before you sign. The summary is a map, not a replacement for the territory.
- **Letting a long chat get messy.** After 20 or 30 messages, the assistant can lose track of what it told you earlier. If the conversation gets long, copy the checklist into a new chat, re-upload the PDF, and start fresh. Cleaner chats give cleaner answers.
- **Skipping the free-tier limits.** Some assistants let you upload small files on the free plan but cap the size on paid plans. If your upload fails, check the assistant's file-size limit before assuming the tool is broken.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** Leasing a new apartment, renewing a phone plan, signing up for a gym membership — the same five-step question set works for any contract. Once you've done it twice, the second one takes about three minutes.
- **For your business or work:** Vendor agreements, client contracts, partnership letters, freelancer terms — all of these can be summarized the same way. The checklist step is

especially useful when you need to brief a partner or a manager who hasn't read the document.

- **If you want to go further:** Try a second AI assistant on the same PDF and compare the two summaries. Two independent reads catch more than one — and they don't always agree on which clauses matter most. Just don't paste a confidential contract into a tool your company hasn't approved for outside use.

Try it now

Pick the last contract you signed — apartment lease, phone plan, gym membership, anything with more than five pages. Upload it to your AI assistant and ask the three big questions from Step 3. Save the answer somewhere you can find it in six months, when the renewal notice arrives. You'll never read a long contract the same way again.

Unlock Document Insights with Gemini Notebook

6 steps · Read online

Imagine having a smart assistant that can read all your scattered notes, long reports, or important documents and then answer your questions using *only* the information you've provided. That's the power of Google Gemini Notebook (formerly NotebookLM). By the end of this guide, you'll be able to upload your own documents, ask intelligent questions, and quickly pull out key information or summaries without sifting through pages yourself. It’s perfect for students, researchers, or anyone dealing with lots of text.

Before you start

- **A Google Account:** You'll need a standard Google account (like the one you use for Gmail or Google Drive) to access Gemini Notebook.
- **A Web Browser:** Access Gemini Notebook through a web browser on your computer. While it works on tablets, a computer provides the best experience for this guide.
- **An Internet Connection:** A stable connection is needed to upload documents and interact with the AI.
- **A few documents:** Have 1-3 documents (e.g., a PDF report, a text file of notes, or a Google Doc) ready to upload. These will be your "sources".
- **Cost:** Gemini Notebook is currently available for free.
- **Time:** This guide will take about 10-15 minutes to follow.

Step 1 — Access Gemini Notebook

First, you'll need to open Gemini Notebook in your web browser. This is where you'll create a dedicated space for your documents and questions. You'll see a welcome screen or an overview of your existing Notebooks, which are like individual project folders. If you're logged into your Google account, it should open directly. If it asks you to sign in, use your Google account details.

If it looks different: If you see a welcome tour or introductory pop-ups, simply click through them to get to the main interface. Look for a "Create new Notebook" or a large "+" button to start. **You'll know it worked when:** You see the Gemini Notebook interface, likely with a main content area and a sidebar, and perhaps a prompt to create your first Notebook.

Step 2 — Create a New Notebook

A "Notebook" in Gemini Notebook is like a digital binder where you keep all the related documents for a specific topic or project. It helps keep your information organized and ensures the AI only uses the sources relevant to that project. To create one, look for a prominent button or option to start a new project.

What you see: On the main screen, you'll typically find a large "New Notebook" button or a similar option in a sidebar. Clicking it usually prompts you to give your new Notebook a name. **What happens next:** A small pop-up window will appear, asking you to name your new workspace. Give it a descriptive title that reflects the documents you'll be adding, so you can easily find it later. **If it looks different:** If you don't see a "New Notebook" button, look for an icon like a "+", a folder, or text that says "Create". The exact placement might vary, but it's usually at the top or in a left-hand navigation pane. 💬 Example: `My Research Notes on Renewable Energy` **You'll know it worked when:** A new, empty Notebook with your chosen name appears on your screen, ready for you to add "sources".

Step 3 — Add Your Source Documents

"Sources" are the documents you want Gemini Notebook to read and analyze. These can be PDFs, Google Docs, text files, or even web pages saved as PDFs. The AI will then use *only* these sources to answer your questions, acting like a super-smart indexer for your own content. You can usually add multiple files to a single Notebook.

What you see: Inside your new Notebook, you'll see an area labeled "Sources" or "Add sources", often with an "Upload" button or an option to connect to Google Drive. Click the "Upload" button. **What happens next:** A file explorer window (or Google Drive selector) will open, allowing you to choose documents from your computer. Select one or more relevant files. Gemini Notebook will then process these files, which might take a few moments depending on their size and number. **If it looks different:** Look for an icon representing a document, a paperclip, or a cloud upload symbol if "Upload" isn't immediately visible. If you're using a Google Doc, there might be a direct integration option for Google Drive. **You'll know it worked when:** Your uploaded documents appear listed under the "Sources" section in your Notebook. You might see a "Processing" status initially, which will change to "Ready" when the AI has finished reading them.

Step 4 — Ask a Question Based on Your Sources

Now that Gemini Notebook has your documents, you can start asking it questions. Remember, the key here is that the AI (which is powered by a large language model, or LLM – a sophisticated computer program that understands and generates human-like text) will *only* refer to the information within the sources you provided. This prevents "hallucinations" – when an AI confidently makes up facts – and ensures its answers are grounded in your specific content.

What you see: In the main area of your Notebook, there's usually a chat box or a "Ask your sources" field, similar to what you'd find in a regular chat AI. Type your question here. **What happens next:** The AI will process your question, consult *only* the uploaded sources, and then generate an answer directly below your prompt. It will often include small citations (like "Source

1, Page 3") pointing back to where it found the information in your documents. **If it looks different:** The chat box might be labeled differently, perhaps "Query sources" or "Enter prompt". Just ensure you're typing your question into the area designated for interacting with your documents. 💬 Example: `What are the key challenges mentioned in the "Renewable Energy Report.pdf"?` **You'll know it worked when:** You receive a detailed answer from Gemini Notebook, specifically referencing your uploaded documents, with citations next to the relevant parts of its response.

Step 5 — Explore and Refine with Follow-up Questions

The conversation doesn't have to end with the first answer. Gemini Notebook is designed for back-and-forth interaction. If an answer is too broad, too short, or if you want to dive deeper into a specific point, you can ask follow-up questions. This helps you refine your understanding and extract exactly what you need.

What you see: After receiving an answer, the chat box typically remains open, or a "New prompt" button appears. You can type another question directly into this field, building on the previous interaction. **What happens next:** Gemini Notebook will take your new question and the context of your previous conversation into account, again pulling information solely from your sources. The new response will appear below the previous one, continuing the thread. **If it looks different:** If the chat box clears, simply re-type your follow-up question. The AI remembers the context of the current conversation within the Notebook. 💬 Example: `Can you summarise the solutions proposed for reducing these challenges?` **You'll know it worked when:** You get a new answer that directly addresses your follow-up question, further refining the information based on your sources, and continuing the conversational flow.

Step 6 — Generate an Overview or Summary

One of Gemini Notebook's most powerful features for a beginner is its ability to quickly generate an "Overview" or summary of your entire Notebook or specific documents. This is incredibly useful for getting the gist of large amounts of text without reading every word, or for quickly preparing for a meeting or study session.

What you see: Look for a button or option in your Notebook, often labeled "Overview", "Summarize Notebook", or "Generate Summary". It might be in the sidebar or at the top of the main conversation area. Click it. **What happens next:** Gemini Notebook will quickly process all the documents within that specific Notebook and generate a concise summary or a list of key topics and insights. This often appears as a new section or card in your Notebook interface. **If it looks different:** The feature might be represented by an icon, such as a bulleted list or a document with an arrow, or be found under a "Tools" or "More actions" menu. **You'll know it**

worked when: A new, structured summary or overview appears in your Notebook, highlighting the main points and themes from all your uploaded sources.

Common mistakes

- **Expecting general knowledge answers:** Gemini Notebook *only* answers from your uploaded sources. If you ask a question not covered in your documents, it won't be able to help, and might even tell you it can't find the information. **Fix:** Always ensure your question can be answered by the content you've provided.
- **Uploading unsupported file types:** While Gemini Notebook supports common formats like PDFs and Google Docs, it can't read every type of file (e.g., image files, spreadsheets, or proprietary formats). **Fix:** Convert your documents to a supported format like PDF or plain text before uploading.
- **Asking overly broad or vague questions:** A very general question might lead to a generic or incomplete answer, even with relevant sources. **Fix:** Be specific with your prompts. If you want details on a particular section, mention it. If you want a specific type of information, ask for it directly (e.g., "List the pros and cons of X").

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** If you're planning a trip, you could upload travel guides and articles into a Notebook and ask it to highlight the best restaurants or activities in your destination, saving hours of reading.
- **For your business or work:** You can drop in client reports, internal policies, or research papers and quickly get summaries, compare different sections, or pull out specific data points for presentations, making your research much faster and more accurate.
- **If you're just getting started:** Try uploading a favorite recipe or a hobby-related article. Then, ask Gemini Notebook simple questions like "What are the main ingredients?" or "What's the first step?" to get a feel for how it extracts information.

Try it now

Open Gemini Notebook, create a new Notebook, and upload two or three of your own PDF documents, like a household bill, a product manual, or an article you've saved. Then, ask it: "What are the key points in these documents?"

Translate Everyday Documents with DeepSeek Chat

6 steps · Read online

Ever received a message, recipe, or small document in a language you don't understand? This guide will show you how to use DeepSeek Chat to quickly translate short texts with natural, readable results, all for free and without needing special apps. By the end, you'll be able to paste a few paragraphs and get a clear translation in seconds, perfect for managing international communications, helping a friend, or even understanding that tricky instruction manual.

Before you start

- **A free DeepSeek account:** You'll need to sign up for a DeepSeek account at `chat.deepseek.com`. It's quick and free to create.
- **A device with internet access:** Any computer, tablet, or smartphone with a web browser (like Chrome, Firefox, or Safari) will work.
- **A short document to translate:** This guide works best with text-based documents up to a few paragraphs or a page long. Things like emails, short letters, or recipes are ideal. DeepSeek Chat excels at text, but it won't perfectly recreate complex layouts with tables or graphics.
- **Rough total time:** Expect to spend about 5-10 minutes following this guide from start to finish.

Step 1 — Open DeepSeek Chat in your browser

Your first step is to open DeepSeek Chat. Head over to `chat.deepseek.com` in your web browser. You'll likely see a sign-in screen if you're not already logged in. Type in your email address and password to access your account.

What you see on screen: Initially, you'll see a login page. After successfully entering your details, the screen will change to the main DeepSeek Chat interface. This usually features a sidebar on the left listing any previous conversations and a large, empty area in the center. **What happens next:** Once logged in, you'll be taken to your personal DeepSeek Chat dashboard. **If it looks different:** If you're taken straight to a chat conversation without a login, it means you're already logged in – great! If you see a button to "Sign Up" instead of "Sign In", you'll need to create your free account first. **You'll know it worked when:** You see the DeepSeek Chat interface, with a clear input box at the bottom of the screen ready for your message.

Step 2 — Start a fresh conversation

To ensure a clean slate for your translation, it's best to start a new chat. This prevents any previous conversation topics from confusing the AI. Look for a prominent button or option to begin a new conversation.

What you see on screen: Typically, in the left sidebar, there will be a list of any past chats you've had. Above or below this list, or sometimes in the top bar, you'll find a button to start a new chat. It's often labeled "New Chat", "Start new conversation", or simply has a plus (+) icon. **What happens next:** Clicking this button will clear the main chat area, presenting you with a fresh, empty conversation window. **If it looks different:** If you can't find a "New Chat" button, look for a small square icon with a plus sign, or a chat bubble icon, usually in the top-left corner of the DeepSeek Chat window. **You'll know it worked when:** The main chat area becomes a blank canvas, with a message box waiting for you at the bottom, indicating you're ready for your first input.

Step 3 — Paste your document and instruct the AI

Now it's time to bring your text into DeepSeek Chat and tell it what you need. Copy the text from your document (Ctrl+C on Windows/Linux, Cmd+C on Mac) and paste it into the message box at the bottom of the DeepSeek Chat window (Ctrl+V or Cmd+V). Then, type a clear instruction, often called a "prompt" (which is simply the text command you give to the AI), to guide the translation.

What you see on screen: Your copied text will appear in the message box. Below or next to it, you'll type your prompt. **What happens next:** Once you send your message (usually by pressing Enter or clicking a send button, often an arrow icon), DeepSeek Chat will process your request and begin generating a translation. **If it looks different:** If the text appears very small or has strange formatting after pasting, don't worry too much; DeepSeek focuses on the words themselves. If the message box seems to have a character limit, your text might be too long – try breaking it into two parts. 💬 **Example:** (After pasting your text, type this into the message box):

> Please translate this into English in a natural, easy-to-read style. Keep the layout simple and do not add extra explanations. **You'll know it worked when:** You see DeepSeek's response start to appear below your message, usually typing out word by word.

Step 4 — Review the initial translation

After DeepSeek Chat presents its translation, it’s important to read through it carefully. AI models are good, but not perfect, and sometimes context or nuance can be missed. Check for accuracy, ensure the tone matches the original, and look for any sentences that sound a little awkward or 'machine-translated'.

What you see on screen: DeepSeek's complete translation will be displayed in the chat window, directly below your original message and prompt. **What happens next:** As you read, you'll form an opinion on whether it meets your needs, or if it requires any adjustments. **If it looks different:** If the translation seems incomplete, or the AI asks clarifying questions, it means it needs more context. You can reply with more details about the original document's purpose. **You'll know it worked when:** You feel confident that the translation accurately reflects your original text and desired tone, or you've identified specific areas you want to improve.

Step 5 — Refine the translation with follow-up prompts

If the initial translation isn't quite perfect, you can ask DeepSeek to make changes. This is where the "chat" part of DeepSeek Chat really shines – you can have a conversation with the AI to refine its output. Be specific about what you want to change, focusing on tone, clarity, or particular phrases.

What you see on screen: Your chat history will now include your original text, the first translation, and the message box is ready for your next instruction. **What happens next:** DeepSeek will process your refinement request and generate a revised version of the translation. You can repeat this step as many times as needed until you're satisfied. **If it looks different:** If the AI seems to misunderstand your refinement, try rephrasing your instructions in simpler terms or giving a specific example of what you want to change. 💬 **Example:**

> Make the translation more conversational and keep the same tone as the original. Use a polite, formal tone suitable for a business letter. Please rephrase the third paragraph to sound more like a native speaker wrote it, but keep the meaning exact. **You'll know it worked when:** DeepSeek provides a refined translation that better matches your specific needs, making the text sound exactly how you want it.

Step 6 — Copy and save your final translation

Once you're completely happy with the translation, the final step is to copy it and save it wherever you need it. Simply highlight the translated text in the chat window using your mouse or finger, then copy it (Ctrl+C or Cmd+C).

What you see on screen: The translated text will be highlighted, showing it's ready to be copied. **What happens next:** The text is stored in your device's clipboard. You can then open any other document, email, or note app and paste it in (Ctrl+V or Cmd+V). **If it looks different:** On some mobile devices, highlighting might be a bit tricky; try long-pressing the text until selection options appear, then drag the handles to select all. **You'll know it worked**

when: The translated text is safely pasted into your chosen document or application, and you've saved the file (e.g., "Recipe_English_Pasta.docx").

Common mistakes

- **Pasting too much text at once:** While DeepSeek has a generous context window (its "memory" of the conversation), very long documents (many pages) can sometimes lead to incomplete or less accurate translations.
    - **The fix:** Break longer documents into smaller, manageable chunks (a few paragraphs or a page at a time) and translate section by section. You can combine them later.
- **Not specifying the target language or tone:** If you don't clearly state the desired output language or style, DeepSeek might default to English or a generic, literal translation.
    - **The fix:** Always include the target language in your prompt (e.g., "translate this into German"). If the original text has a specific tone (e.g., casual, formal, humorous), tell DeepSeek to match it.
- **Expecting complex formatting to be preserved:** DeepSeek is excellent with words and basic line breaks, but it won't replicate intricate layouts like tables, columns, specific fonts, or embedded images.
    - **The fix:** Be prepared to re-format the text after you've copied the translation. Focus on getting the language right first, then adjust the visual presentation in your preferred document editor.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** Imagine you've received a handwritten note from a neighbor in another language, or found a delicious recipe online in Italian. Paste it into DeepSeek and get an English translation in seconds, making everyday tasks smoother and more connected.
- **For your business or work:** Quickly translate short business emails, product descriptions, or client notes to communicate effectively with international colleagues or customers. It's a fast way to get the gist of a document without needing a professional translator for every small piece of text.
- **If you're just getting started:** Pick a simple one-paragraph note or a few sentences you'd like translated. This is the easiest way to understand how DeepSeek handles your requests and observe its accuracy and natural language generation firsthand.

Try it now

Open DeepSeek Chat at `chat.deepseek.com`, start a new chat, paste this short sentence, and ask for a translation into a language you're curious about or learning:

> “Hello, how are you today?”

You'll see the translation appear almost instantly, giving you a taste of DeepSeek Chat's power.

How to Prepare for a Job Interview Using a Pasted Job Post

6 steps · Read online

> **In short:** Paste a job listing and a short note about your background into your AI assistant, and you'll come away with ten likely interview questions, two talking points for each, and five thoughtful questions to ask the interviewer — typically in under ten minutes of back-and-forth.

A good interview answer sounds rehearsed without sounding rehearsed. The trick is having specific stories and numbers ready before you sit down — and that's exactly what an AI assistant is good at when you give it the right inputs. In fifteen minutes, you can walk into a room with three lists ready: questions they'll probably ask, talking points for each, and questions you'll ask them. It can draft the prep, but it can't read the room or know which story from your past will actually land — that's still on you.

Before you start

- **An AI assistant you already use** — ChatGPT, Claude, Gemini, Copilot, or any other chat-style assistant. The steps are the same.
- **The full job description** copied to your clipboard. Don't paraphrase yet; the more detail the assistant sees, the sharper the output.
- **A short paragraph about you** — your current role, years of experience, and one or two wins you'd actually mention in an interview.
- **About 15 minutes** — enough time to do the back-and-forth and skim the result.

Step 1 — Open a fresh chat and name it after the role

Click **New chat** (or **New conversation** — look for a pencil-and-paper icon or a + sign) in your assistant. Before you type anything, give the chat a name you'll recognize later, like "Acme Senior Designer interview" or just the company plus the role.

Why a new chat? Older messages from unrelated work can leak in and confuse the assistant. A fresh, named thread keeps everything you build here tied to this one interview — easy to find the night before, easy to revisit if a second round is scheduled.

💬 Example: name it "Acme – Marketing Lead interview prep."

You'll know it worked when a new empty chat opens with the name you chose (or with an editable title field at the top of the screen).

Step 2 — Paste the job description and your background in one message

In your new chat, send a single message that contains two clearly labeled blocks: the job description, and a paragraph about you. Use clear labels like **"JOB POSTING:"** and **"ABOUT ME:"** so the assistant knows where one ends and the other begins. Very long descriptions (over a few thousand words) may need to be split into two messages if your app refuses the paste.

What happens next: the assistant usually replies with a short acknowledgement ("Got it — ready when you are") or jumps straight into a summary. Either is fine.

If it looks different: if pasting a long posting fails, try uploading the posting as a file — most assistants accept PDFs and text files in the same chat where you usually send text.

💬 Example:

```
JOB POSTING:
[Paste the full job description here — responsibilities, requirements, and any "nice to haves"]

ABOUT ME:
[Paste 4–6 sentences: current role, years of experience, two recent achievements with numbers if you have them]
```

You'll know it worked when the assistant confirms it has the context — usually with a brief recap, a clarifying question, or simply by being ready to answer your next prompt.

Step 3 — Ask for ten likely interview questions

Send a single, specific prompt asking for ten questions the hiring manager is likely to ask, based on what you just pasted. Ask for a mix of categories — behavioral, technical, and situational — so the list isn't one-note.

Why ten? Fewer than that and you may miss the ones that come up. More than ten and you'll feel overloaded. Ten is the sweet spot: enough to practice, small enough to actually read.

💬 Example: "Based on the job posting and my background above, give me ten interview questions a hiring manager is most likely to ask me. Mix behavioral, technical, and situational questions. For each, add one sentence on what they're really trying to find out."

If it looks different: if the list comes back generic, follow up with "make these specific to [the company or team from the posting]" and ask for a fresh list. A vague list is usually a sign the original prompt needed more context, not a sign the assistant is broken.

You'll know it worked when you have a numbered list of ten specific, role-tied questions — not stock ones like "tell me about yourself."

Step 4 — Get two concrete talking points for each question

Without starting a new chat, follow up with a second prompt asking for two concrete talking points under each of the ten questions. Ask for stories, examples, or numbers drawn from your own background — and tell the assistant to flag any question where your pasted background looks thin and you'll need to dig deeper yourself.

What happens next: the assistant writes a structured answer, often with a short headline per question and a couple of ideas underneath. This is the moment the prep actually becomes useful.

If it looks different: if the response is too long to scan, add "keep each talking point to two sentences max" in your next prompt, or ask it to rewrite the same list more concisely.

💬 Example: "Now for each of those ten questions, give me two concrete talking points I could use, drawing from my background. Keep each point to one or two sentences. Flag any question where my pasted background seems thin."

You'll know it worked when each of the ten questions now has two short, specific points you could picture yourself saying out loud.

Step 5 — Ask for five smart questions to ask back

In the same chat, ask for five questions you, the candidate, should ask the interviewer. Ask for ones that show you did your homework — about the team, the goals, or how the role is measured. The point is to leave the conversation with real signals, not rehearsed fluff.

💬 Example: "Give me five strong questions I, the candidate, can ask back at the end of the interview. Make them specific to this role and company. Skip anything generic like 'what's the culture like'."

If it looks different: if any of the questions come back feeling templated, follow up with "replace any you can't tailor to this exact role" — most assistants will rewrite them on the spot.

You'll know it worked when you have five questions you wouldn't have thought of on your own, and each one is something you'd genuinely want answered.

Step 6 — Pin or save the chat and skim the highlights

Take thirty seconds to skim the chat and star, pin, or copy the talking points that felt most true to you. Different apps handle this differently — look for a **star icon** next to an answer, a **pin**

option in a menu, or just copy the best points into a notes app where you'll actually see them again.

Why bother? Two reasons. First, you'll want to reread the chat the morning of the interview. Second, picking the strongest two or three talking points now means you practice those — not all twenty.

If it looks different: if your assistant has no pin or star option, the chat's title alone usually makes it easy to find later. Or paste the talking points into your phone's notes app under the company name.

💬 Example: pick the talking points that felt truest to your real work — maybe one about leadership, one about a measurable result, one about a hard problem you solved — and re-read them once before you walk into the interview.

You'll know it worked when you can open the chat or your notes in under ten seconds and find the three talking points you actually plan to use.

Common mistakes

- **Pasting only the company blurb.** If the description is six paragraphs long and you paste just the first one, the assistant's questions will be vague. Paste the whole thing — responsibilities, requirements, and any "nice to haves" — so the assistant has the full picture.
- **Asking for "interview questions" without context.** A generic request gets generic answers. Always include both the job description and your background in the same chat; that's what makes the list specific to *this* role and *your* level.
- **Stopping after the first list.** The ten questions are the start, not the end. The follow-up that asks for talking points is where the real prep happens. Skip it and you'll have a list of questions with nothing ready to say.
- **Treating the output as a script.** The assistant may suggest a story you don't actually have. Treat the talking points as a draft, not a script — swap in your own real examples whenever you can.
- **Reusing the same chat for unrelated work.** Once you start mixing topics, the assistant's answers drift. Keep this chat dedicated to one interview until you're done with it.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** the same recipe works for any "I have a document and I want to be ready" moment — a school presentation, a doctor's appointment where you want a list of questions, or a tough conversation with a landlord. Paste the source, share your context, ask for what you need.

- **For your business or work:** if you ever sit on the other side of the table, paste the job description and a candidate's resume into the same flow and you'll get a quick read on likely strengths, gaps, and good first-round questions — useful when screening applications.
- **If you want to go further:** the next level is saving this whole structure as a **Custom Instruction** or a saved template in your assistant, so the next time you prep, you only paste the job posting and your background — the rest of the structure is already loaded. Many assistants also let you create a dedicated "Project" or named workspace for one company, so multiple chats (prep, follow-up, salary research) live together.

Try it now

Open a new chat in the assistant you already use, name it after a real interview you have coming up (or one you're imagining), and paste one real job description plus four sentences about your background. Then send the prompt from Step 3. Ten minutes from now, you'll have a list you didn't have ten minutes ago.

Write a Resume From Scratch (Even With No Work Experience)

6 steps · Read online

> **In short:** A resume is a one-page story of what you've done, what you're good at, and what you want next — and you can build one from school, volunteering, caregiving, side jobs or hobbies. You don't need formal work experience; you need to describe your real life in the language employers recognize.

Writing a resume from zero feels harder than it is. Most "first resumes" stay blank because people think they have nothing to put on them. In reality, you've already handled deadlines, solved problems, dealt with people, and learned new things — you just haven't framed that work as work yet. This guide walks you through turning everyday experience into a clean, honest resume a hiring manager can read in under a minute.

Before you start

- **A computer or phone** with a notes app, Google Docs, Microsoft Word, or a free resume builder (look for one by searching "free resume template").
- **About 60–90 minutes** for your first draft. After that, updates take 10 minutes.
- **A list of what you've actually done** — school, classes, projects, babysitting, family jobs, club roles, volunteering, online courses, certifications. Don't filter yet; just dump everything.
- **A job (or two) you'd like to apply to.** Even a saved job posting helps you match words later.

Step 1 — Pick a clean, one-page layout

Open Google Docs and click **Template Gallery** in the top-right, or search for "resume" in Microsoft Word's template search. Pick something simple: name at the top, contact line below it, then clear section headings (think "section headers" — the bold labels that divide your resume into parts like Experience and Education). Avoid heavy designs, photos, or color blocks; hiring managers scan, they don't admire.

If templates feel overwhelming, just open a blank document and type your name big at the top. You'll add structure next. If you don't have Word or Docs, free builders like the ones from job search sites work too — search "free resume builder" and pick one with no signup wall.

Example: section headers to copy — `Summary`, `Experience`, `Education`, `Skills`, `Projects`.

You'll know it worked when you have a blank one-page document with your name at the top and five empty sections waiting for content.

Step 2 — Write a 2-sentence summary at the top

Under your name and contact info, add a **summary** — two short sentences that say who you are and what you're aiming for. Think of it as the cover of a book: it tells the reader what to expect inside. Use plain words, not job titles you haven't earned.

If you've never had a job, your summary can lean on what you're studying, what kind of work you want, and one strength. Keep it specific — "hardworking" doesn't say much, but "organized, comfortable with spreadsheets, and quick to learn new tools" paints a picture. If you don't know exactly what you want yet, write a **target** instead: "Looking for an entry-level role in retail, admin, or customer service."

💬 Example: "High school senior finishing in May 2026. Strong with customers, cash handling, and staying calm under pressure. Looking for part-time retail or front-desk work."

You'll know it worked when someone reading just those two sentences could guess what kind of job you'd be good at.

Step 3 — Turn life experience into an "Experience" section

Create an **Experience** section heading and list anything where you showed up, did something, and someone (even a family member or teacher) noticed. Jobs count, but so do babysitting siblings, helping at a family store, school projects, volunteering at a food bank, mowing lawns, Discord servers you moderate, or a class group you led. For each entry, use this format: **Title — Where — Dates** (even if dates are approximate), then 2–4 short **bullet points** underneath describing what you did.

Each bullet should follow a simple recipe: *did what, using what skill, with what result*. You don't need fancy words; you need honest ones. If you watched three younger cousins every afternoon while your parent worked, that's "supervised and cared for three children daily, planned meals, handled minor conflicts, and maintained a consistent routine." That's a real bullet.

💬 Example (babysitting): `Cared for three children (ages 4–9) after school each day. Prepared snacks, helped with homework, and organized weekly craft activities.`

💬 Example (school project): `Led a 4-person team on a science fair project. Researched topics, delegated tasks, and presented findings to a panel of 5 judges.`

You'll know it worked when your experience list has 3–6 entries and every bullet describes something you actually did.

Step 4 — Build an "Education" section and a "Skills" list

Add an **Education** section right below Experience. Include your school (or "Self-taught" / "Online coursework"), graduation year (or expected year), and one line of relevant classes or achievements — anything that hints at what you know. No degree yet? No problem: list what you ARE studying, plus any courses, workshops, or certificates, even free ones from sites like Coursera, Khan Academy, or YouTube tutorials.

Then add a **Skills** section. This is just a comma-separated list of tools and abilities: typing speed ("60+ WPM" if true — WPM means words per minute), languages, software (Google Sheets, Canva, TikTok editing, whatever you actually use), and people-skills ("customer service," "calm under pressure"). Skip anything you can't honestly do.

💬 Example education entry: `Lincoln High School — Expected graduation May 2027. Coursework: Business Math, Intro to Computer Science, Spanish II.`

💬 Example skills line: `Skills: Google Docs, Sheets, Canva, social media scheduling (Meta Business Suite), conversational Spanish, POS cash handling.`

You'll know it worked when a stranger could scan these two sections and quickly see what you know and where you learned it.

Step 5 — Add optional sections that strengthen your story

Two more sections often help first-time resumes: **Projects** and **Volunteering**. A project can be anything you built or organized — a class group, a club, a YouTube channel, a small Etsy shop, a Discord community, a coding exercise. Volunteering covers anything you did for free that helped people — church groups, school events, neighborhood cleanups, food drives, coaching a kid's team.

You can also add **Languages**, **Certifications** (CPR, food handler's permit, even a free online certificate you actually finished), or **Awards** (perfect attendance, honor roll, employee-of-the-month at a family business — yes, that counts). If you have nothing extra, skip these — a tight two-page-equivalent on one page beats a sparse two pages.

💬 Example project entry: `Project: Neighborhood plant-swap app — designed a simple scheduling tool in Google Sheets, promoted via local Facebook group, coordinated 3 successful swaps with 40+ attendees.`

You'll know it worked when your resume fills the page naturally and every line answers "what did this person actually do?"

Step 6 — Proofread, shorten, and save as a PDF

Read your resume out loud once. Fix anything that sounds awkward, too long, or that you can't defend in an interview. Most first drafts are too long; aim for one page. Cut filler like "hardworking team player" unless you back it up with an example. Replace vague verbs ("helped," "worked on") with specific ones ("organized," "built," "answered," "tracked," "taught").

Save the final file as a **PDF** (in Google Docs: **File → Download → PDF**; in Word: **File → Save As → PDF**). PDFs keep your formatting intact no matter who opens them. Name the file clearly: `FirstName-LastName-Resume.pdf`.

💬 Example: cut this — "Responsible for various tasks including helping customers." Replace with — "Greeted 80+ customers daily, restocked shelves, and handled returns at a family-run grocery store."

You'll know it worked when you can email the file, the formatting holds, and you feel ready to explain any line on it out loud.

Common mistakes

- **Mistake:** Leaving the page half-empty because you think you "don't have experience." **Fix:** List school projects, caregiving, volunteering, hobbies done seriously, or small paid gigs — anything with responsibility counts. If the page is still sparse, add a one-line "Interests" section (photography, gaming communities, language learning) and tie one to a skill.
- **Mistake:** Using only generic words like "hardworking" and "team player." **Fix:** Replace each with a concrete example — "trained two new volunteers on check-in procedures" beats "good trainer" every time.
- **Mistake:** Lying or stretching the truth. **Fix:** Stick to what really happened, then frame it precisely. A hiring manager will ask follow-ups; honest, well-described experience always beats padded claims.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** A resume is just a written summary of your life so far — once you've made one, updates for the next 10 years take minutes, not hours.
- **For your business or work:** If you hire people, a resume built this way tells you whether someone can actually describe what they did — a skill that predicts on-the-job clarity.
- **If you're just getting started:** Your first resume won't be perfect, and that's fine. Send it to one job you actually want, see what feedback comes back, and revise. Resume-writing is a skill, and it improves with each round.

Try it now

Open a blank document right now and type your name at the top. Underneath, write one sentence describing what you're good at, and one sentence describing the kind of work you'd like. That's your summary. You just started a real resume — the rest is filling it in, one honest line at a time.

How to Use Gemini Deep Research for Thorough Reports

6 steps · Read online

Imagine having a tireless personal research assistant who can scour dozens of websites, cross-reference facts, and write a polished report in minutes. This guide will show you how to use Gemini's powerful capabilities to gather deep insights for work, study, or personal projects, just like a professional researcher.

Before you start

- A Google account: You'll need a standard Google account to access Gemini.
- Access to Gemini: Ensure you can open Gemini in your web browser (gemini.google.com) or use the Gemini app on your mobile device. Some advanced features might perform better or offer more depth with a Gemini Advanced subscription, but the core research principles apply to all versions.
- A device: A computer, laptop, tablet, or smartphone with internet access.
- A clear topic or question: Have a specific subject in mind that you want Gemini to research.
- Rough total time: This process usually takes 5-10 minutes, depending on the complexity of your research topic and how many follow-up questions you ask.

Step 1 — Start a new chat and enable web search

First, let's open Gemini and make sure it has permission to search the internet. An AI (Artificial Intelligence) tool like Gemini is powered by an LLM (Large Language Model) – think of it as the super-smart brain that helps the AI understand and generate human-like text. To perform deep research, this brain needs access to the wider internet.

When you open Gemini, you'll see a clear text box at the bottom of the screen where you type your messages. Open the "Add Files" menu in the text box and choose "Deep Research." There is no separate search switch to turn on: Google's help page says that, by default, Gemini includes Google Search as a source for your research. If you ever want to change the sources, use the "Sources" option.

If it looks different: Menu names can vary by device and app version, so if you don't see "Add Files," look for "Deep Research" in the tools or options menu next to the text box. Just ensure you're starting a fresh conversation, usually by clicking a "New Chat" button (often a '+' icon) in the side menu.

You'll know it worked when: "Deep Research" appears as the selected option in the text box before you type your first question.

Step 2 — Craft a detailed research prompt

A prompt is simply the instruction you give to an AI. To get a high-quality, in-depth report, you need to be very clear with your prompt. Don't just ask a one-sentence question. Instead, tell Gemini who the report is for, what specific areas to cover, and how you want the final document organized. Think of it like giving instructions to a new research assistant.

Type your detailed instructions into the text box. The more detail you provide, the better Gemini can understand your needs and focus its search.

Example:

> "Act as an expert researcher for a homeowner. Please conduct a deep, multi-step search of the web to investigate current trends in home solar battery storage for residential properties in the US. Focus on average cost ranges, typical lifespan, available government rebates or incentives, and environmentally friendly recycling options. Organize the report with clear headings, bullet points, and provide specific examples where possible. Include links to your sources."

You'll know it worked when: Gemini acknowledges your request (often by saying "Okay, I can help with that...") and begins to indicate it's searching the web or preparing to ask clarifying questions.

Step 3 — Answer Gemini's clarifying questions

One of the cleverest parts of Gemini's deep research process is that it doesn't just guess what you want. It will often reply with two or three clarifying questions to narrow down the scope of its search. This is Gemini using its "brain" (the LLM) to ensure it understands your request perfectly, saving you time later.

Read Gemini's questions carefully. These might be about geographical focus, specific types of technology, or the target audience for the report. Type your concise answers in the text box below.

If it looks different: Gemini might sometimes jump straight into generating the report if your initial prompt was extremely clear. If it doesn't ask questions, that's fine; simply move to the next step.

Example: If Gemini asks, "Are you interested in global statistics or a specific country for the solar battery research?" you might reply:

> "Focus primarily on American residential properties, especially those in suburban and regional areas, not just cities."

You'll know it worked when: Gemini confirms it has understood your answers, perhaps by saying "Got it," and then transitions to the next stage of gathering information.

Step 4 — Observe Gemini gathering information

Once you've clarified the details, Gemini will begin its thorough search. You'll often see a visual progress bar or a series of messages indicating what the AI is doing in real-time. These messages might pop up within the chat window, showing stages like "Searching for battery lifespans" or "Analyzing recycling policies." This is Gemini actively using Google Search, its default source, to find and process information from various websites, much like a human researcher would.

This step takes longer than a standard AI reply—often up to a minute or two—because the assistant is reading actual web pages rather than relying purely on its pre-existing training memory.

If it looks different: Sometimes, the progress indicators might be subtle, or Gemini might just show a spinning wheel. As long as the chat isn't frozen and you see some activity, it's working.

You'll know it worked when: You see clear messages indicating Gemini is searching the web ("Using Google Search...", "Searching for..."), followed by text beginning to appear that resembles your requested report structure.

Step 5 — Review and verify the generated report

When the report is ready, Gemini will present a structured document, usually complete with clear headings, bullet points, and, crucially, citations or links to the websites it used. This is your chance to put on your detective hat.

Before you copy the text for use, perform a quick spot-check. Click on a few of the provided links to make sure they are active and support the claims made in the report. This protects you against "hallucination," which is the term for when an AI confidently invents facts or links that do not actually exist. While rare with Gemini's search capabilities, it's always wise to verify important details.

If it looks different: Ensure you scroll to the end of the report. The citations are often small numbers or footnotes. If you don't see any, you can politely ask Gemini: "Can you provide the source links for this report?"

You'll know it worked when: You've clicked on a few links and confirmed that the information in the report aligns with the content on the source websites.

Step 6 — Refine or ask follow-up questions

The first report Gemini provides is a great starting point, but you might want to dive deeper or change the focus slightly. This is where the interactive nature of AI truly shines. You can continue the conversation, asking for more details on a specific section, requesting a different format, or even asking Gemini to summarize complex points.

Type your follow-up questions or requests into the text box. This allows you to iteratively improve the research until it perfectly meets your needs.

💬 Example:

> "Can you expand on the environmental impact of lithium-ion battery production? Also, please summarize the key points of this report in three bullet points, suitable for a quick presentation slide."

You'll know it worked when: Gemini provides new information, rephrases existing content, or summarizes the report based on your latest instructions, showing its ability to build on previous responses.

Common mistakes

- **Being too broad:** Asking for a report on "the history of technology" is too vast for a single deep dive. *The fix:* Narrow your focus to a specific decade, tool, or industry, or break it into smaller prompts.
- **Skipping the fact-check:** Never copy and paste a report straight into an important document or project without clicking the source links to verify the numbers and claims. *The fix:* Always dedicate a few minutes to spot-checking sources and ensuring accuracy.
- **Ignoring clarifying questions:** If Gemini asks for clarification, don't skip it or give a vague answer. Your response is crucial for guiding the AI to find the exact data you need, rather than general information. *The fix:* Take a moment to provide a clear, concise answer to each of Gemini's questions.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** You can quickly get a clear, sourced overview of a complicated topic, like how a new local recycling rule works or what to know before adopting a dog, with each key point linked to a source you can check.
- **For your business or work:** You can get a sourced first draft of a market overview or a background briefing in minutes, then spend your time checking and sharpening it instead of searching from scratch.
- **If you're just getting started:** Pick a topic you already know a little about. That makes it easier to spot where the report is strong and where a source needs a closer look.

Try it now

Open Gemini, choose **Deep Research** as shown in Step 1, and type:

"Create a short report on how to start a small vegetable garden on a balcony, with a source for each tip."

Answer any clarifying questions Gemini asks. When the report is ready, open two of the source links and check that they really say what the report claims.

How to Organize a Messy Email Inbox Into Simple Folders in One Sitting

6 steps · Read online

> **In short:** Sort by sender, archive or delete anything that doesn't need a reply, then create just three broad folders (To act on, To read later, To keep) so the system still works a month from now. The whole thing takes about 30 minutes.

A messy inbox isn't a personal failure - it's what happens when there's no system. Here's a 30-minute plan that creates one simple system, designed to keep working long after you've finished. It works in any major email app because the idea is the same everywhere: stop the noise at the door, then give the messages that matter a home.

Before you start

- A computer or phone with your email app or website open. The steps apply generally to Gmail, Outlook, Apple Mail, Yahoo, and similar services - exact button names vary, but the ideas don't.
- About 30-45 minutes of quiet time, with no other tabs open competing for attention.
- Your password nearby in case you get logged out, and a notepad (or a note on your phone) so you can jot down anything that needs a real follow-up.

Step 1 — Pick your window and open the inbox the right way

Choose a 30-45 minute block when you won't be interrupted - a Sunday morning, a lunch break, after the kids are asleep. Open your email app or website and sign in. The key move: switch your inbox view from "Unread" or "Priority" to something that shows everything - often labeled "All Mail" or "All Messages." This matters because you need to see the full mess before you can fix it. Think of it like clearing the table before you start sorting the dishes.

If your app doesn't have a clear "All Mail" option, look for a folder on the left sidebar labeled something like "All," "Everything," or "Archive." The goal is to see every message in one long list, not just the unread ones. On phone apps, the default view usually already shows everything in your inbox, which works fine.

💬 Example: tell yourself out loud, "I'm spending the next 35 minutes on this. No answering anything that needs more than 60 seconds."

You'll know it worked when your full inbox is visible in one list - usually hundreds or thousands of messages, not just the unread ones.

Step 2 — Sort by sender so the pattern jumps out

Find the option to sort or group your email by sender. In many webmail apps this lives under a sort menu (look for a downward arrow, a "Sort by" option, or three vertical dots near the top of the message list). On a phone app, look in the top-right corner for a filter or sort icon. When you group by sender, the same address suddenly appears 20, 30, or 50 times - that's your noise made visible.

If you can't find a "sort by sender" option, search for one big sender's name instead - the one whose name you recognize the most in the list. The point is the same: figure out who's filling your inbox before you start moving anything.

💬 Example: search "Amazon" and count how many emails you find. If the number is in the double digits, that's a sender you'll handle in Step 3.

You'll know it worked when you can see, at a glance, which senders dominate your inbox - usually a handful of marketing lists, a few retailers, and some auto-notifications.

Step 3 — Clear the noise: archive or delete

Start with your biggest offenders - the senders who appear most often. For each one, you have three honest choices: read and reply (rare), archive the whole batch (the default for anything that doesn't need a response), or delete it. Look for an "unsubscribe" link near the bottom of marketing emails and click it - that legally stops future mail from the same sender. "Archive" just means moving a message out of your inbox while keeping it findable, like putting a paper into a filing cabinet instead of leaving it on your desk.

If you're not sure which messages to keep, ask one question: "Will I need this in six months?" A receipt for a big purchase, yes. A flash sale from a store you visited once, no. Anything you can't answer becomes "archive" - still searchable, just not in your way.

💬 Example: for the Amazon thread - open one message, click "unsubscribe" near the bottom, wait for the confirmation page, then select all Amazon emails (look for a checkbox at the top of the list) and click "Archive" or "Delete."

You'll know it worked when unsubscribe confirmations start arriving in your inbox saying "you've been removed" - that's a sign you've cut the supply line.

Step 4 — Create your three broad folders

Now make just three folders. Pick simple, broad names that won't go stale next month: "To act on" (anything requiring a real reply or decision), "To read later" (interesting but not urgent - articles, newsletters you'll actually open), and "To keep" (receipts, confirmations, contracts, anything you might need to find again). A "folder" here is just a named container for related emails - like a labeled drawer in that same filing cabinet.

Most email apps have a "+" or "Create new folder/label" button - look for it in the left sidebar, often just above the existing folder list. Right-clicking the sidebar often brings up the same option. Keep the names short - one or two words each.

If your app uses "labels" instead of folders (some do), the idea is the same: three broad categories that you tag messages with. You can apply more than one label to the same message later if you need to.

💬 Example: name them "To act on," "To read later," "To keep" - exactly those three, no more. Resist the urge to add a fourth on the same day.

You'll know it worked when all three folders appear in your left sidebar and you can click into an empty one.

Step 5 — Sweep the remaining emails into the right folder

Go back to your inbox. Now that the noise is gone, what remains are messages that probably need your attention or your future self's attention. Work through them quickly, one at a time: open, decide, file. Most belong in one of your three folders. A few might need a quick reply - if it takes less than 60 seconds, reply now; if it takes longer, file it under "To act on" and keep moving.

If a message doesn't fit any of the three folders, archive it instead of creating a new one. The point of three folders is that they stay broad - resist the urge to add a fourth until you've lived with these for at least a month.

💬 Example: a newsletter you want to read on the weekend → drag to "To read later." A package tracking update → drag to "To keep." A friend's question that needs a real answer → drag to "To act on."

You'll know it worked when your actual inbox (the view that doesn't include your new folders) is mostly empty - ideally under 20 messages.

Step 6 — Add one simple rule so it keeps working

Find your email app's "filter" or "rule" feature - usually under Settings, then a tab labeled "Filters," "Rules," or "Inbox rules." A filter is just an automatic instruction: "when an email arrives from this address, move it to that folder." Create one rule for your biggest remaining sender (often a newsletter you actually like, or a frequent work contact).

This is the step that keeps the system working months from now. Without a rule, you'll have to re-sort every week. With even one rule, the inbox stays close to empty on its own.

If your email app doesn't support automatic rules, do the next best thing: make a tiny daily habit of glancing at your inbox once a day and dragging anything obvious into the right folder - two minutes is usually enough.

💬 Example: in Gmail settings, choose "Create new filter" → From: newsletter@example.com → "Apply the label: To read later." Every future issue lands in the right folder automatically, no work from you.

You'll know it worked when the next email from that sender shows up already filed - and you didn't have to do anything.

Common mistakes

- **Creating too many folders.** The temptation is to make one for "Bills," one for "Work," one for "Family" - and suddenly you have fifteen folders, half empty, and you can't find anything. Three broad folders beats ten narrow ones. Add a fourth only after a real, repeated need shows up.
- **Filing things you'll never look at again.** "To read later" can quietly become a graveyard of saved articles. If a newsletter has been sitting unread for two weeks, archive it unopened. The point of saving is to read, not to feel productive.
- **Skipping the unsubscribe step.** Just archiving the noise doesn't stop it from arriving tomorrow. The unsubscribe link is the actual fix - archive is just the bandage. Spend the extra 10 seconds per sender; it pays back forever.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** A clean inbox means you stop dreading the little red badge on your phone. You see the few messages that actually matter when you open the app, instead of scanning past 400 to find them.
- **For your business or work:** When you search for an old receipt or a past conversation, you find it in seconds because everything has a home. Tax season, warranty claims, and "what did they say last March?" all get easier.
- **If you're just getting started:** Tomorrow morning, spend 10 minutes only on Step 3 - clearing one big sender. Don't try to do all six steps at once yet. Get a feel for the rhythm before committing the full 30 minutes.

Try it now

Open your email app right now and find the single sender with the most emails in your inbox. Click "unsubscribe" at the bottom of one of their messages. That's it - one minute, one sender, one less source of noise tomorrow.

Practice job interview questions with Qwen before the real interview

6 steps · Read online

> **In short:** Qwen can play the role of an interviewer, ask you common questions, and give you honest feedback on how your answers come across — clarity, completeness, and confidence. You'll need about 20–30 minutes for one full practice run, and a free account is enough to start. It cannot read your body language or tone, so for video interviews, do at least one round on camera separately.

By the end of this guide, you'll have run a real mock interview with Qwen, gotten concrete feedback on your answers, and saved your best versions for the night before the real thing. This is for anyone with an interview coming up — first job, career change, or just wanting to sound more polished.

Before you start

- A Qwen account (free sign-up with email or a supported login).
- A device with a browser — a computer is easier for long answers, a phone works too.
- A job title or two in mind that you actually want to practice for.
- About 20–30 minutes for a full session, or 5 minutes for a quick drill.

Step 1 — Open Qwen and start a fresh chat

Go to Qwen's chat page in your browser, or open the Qwen mobile app if you have it installed. Look for a **"New Chat"** button or a small **"+"** or pencil icon — usually at the top of the sidebar on a computer, or right above the message box on a phone. Click or tap it. A fresh, empty conversation opens with a blank message box at the bottom. Starting fresh matters because leftover context from an earlier chat could push Qwen's questions in the wrong direction. If you don't see a New Chat button, try refreshing the page — sometimes the sidebar hides it on smaller screens.

💬 Example: just type "Hi" first to confirm the chat is responsive, then move to Step 2 to set up the real practice.

You'll know it worked when you see an empty message box with no previous messages above it.

Step 2 — Tell Qwen what role you're practicing for

In the message box, type a short paragraph that gives Qwen the context it needs to ask realistic questions. The more specific you are about the job, the better the questions will be. Mention the job title, the industry, the seniority level, and one or two skills you want to highlight. Press Enter

or tap send. Qwen usually replies with a short confirmation like, "Got it — let's practice for a marketing coordinator role." If the reply feels off or skips your details, scroll up, click the **regenerate** button (usually a circular arrow), or retype your setup more simply.

💬 Example: "I have an interview next week for a marketing coordinator role at a mid-size SaaS company. I have 2 years of experience in social media and email campaigns. Please act as the hiring manager and interview me one question at a time. After each answer, give me feedback on clarity, completeness, and confidence, then move to the next question."

You'll know it worked when Qwen replies acknowledging the role and confirms it will go one question at a time.

Step 3 — Answer the first question like it's real

Read Qwen's question carefully, then answer as if you were sitting in the actual interview. Type your answer in the same box — don't overthink it, don't use perfect essay language, just answer the way you naturally would. The point is to practice, not to write something polished. If you blank out, write "I'm not sure" the way you might say it out loud, then keep going. The more honestly you answer, the more useful Qwen's feedback will be. If the question feels too easy, ask for a harder version before answering — this is normal interview prep, not a sign you're doing it wrong.

💬 Example: if Qwen asks "Tell me about a time you handled a difficult customer," you might type something like: "At my old retail job, a customer wanted to return a laptop past the 30-day window. I listened to her frustration, explained the policy, then asked my manager if we could do a store credit as a one-time exception. She agreed, and the customer left happy. I learned that sometimes bending the rules a little keeps a customer for life."

You'll know it worked when you've typed a full, honest answer — anything between 3 and 12 sentences is a typical interview length.

Step 4 — Ask for specific feedback on your answer

After you finish typing, don't wait for Qwen to move on. Type a follow-up asking it to evaluate what you just said, and be specific about what kind of feedback you want — clarity, completeness, confidence, filler words, structure. Qwen usually gives you a paragraph or two of concrete suggestions, like "your answer is clear but you ramble in the second sentence" or "you named the result but didn't explain your specific role." If you want a number, ask for a score out of 10. If the feedback feels too soft ("great answer, well done!"), push back: ask Qwen to be tougher, since you'd rather hear it now than in a real interview room.

Example: "Before the next question, can you give me feedback on my last answer? Specifically: (1) Was it clear and easy to follow? (2) Did I actually answer what was asked? (3) Did I sound confident or unsure? (4) What is the one thing I should improve? Please be honest — I'd rather hear it from you than from a real interviewer."

You'll know it worked when Qwen responds with specific, actionable feedback — not just a generic compliment, but actual comments about what was strong and what to improve.

Step 5 — Push yourself with follow-up and pressure questions

Real interviewers rarely stop at one question on a topic — they ask follow-ups like "and what would you do differently?" or "how did your manager react?" So once you've answered and gotten feedback, ask Qwen to dig deeper. Type a message asking for a follow-up, or simply say "ask me a harder version of that one." If you really want to stress-test yourself, ask Qwen to challenge you: "Now push back on my answer as if you don't believe me." This is where most of the real interview prep happens — the first answer is usually fine, but it's the second and third round that separates nervous candidates from confident ones.

Example: "That feedback helps. Now please ask me a follow-up question about the same story — something a real interviewer would press me on. I'll answer, you give me feedback, and then we move on."

You'll know it worked when Qwen asks a sharper, more specific question that builds on what you said — not a brand-new topic.

Step 6 — Save your best answers for the day before

Once you've practiced for 20–30 minutes and feel you've landed some strong answers, ask Qwen to summarize your session. Then copy your best answers into a notes app, a Google Doc, or even a simple text file on your phone. The night before the interview, re-read your saved answers out loud — this refreshes the words in your mouth so they sound natural, not memorized. If Qwen gave you specific suggestions ("trim the first sentence, end with a number"), apply those edits now and save the cleaner version. Treat the saved file as your personal answer bank — you can reuse and refine it for future interviews.

Example: "Can you give me a summary of the three strongest answers from this session, plus one thing I should remember to improve next time?"

You'll know it worked when you have a short document with your polished answers that you can re-read on the morning of the real interview.

Common mistakes

- **Asking Qwen to "just give me good answers."** That turns it into a cheat sheet, not practice. You learn by answering yourself and getting feedback, not by copying what Qwen writes.
- **Pasting ten questions into one prompt and answering them all at once.** That's a quiz, not an interview. Real interviews are conversational. Ask Qwen to go one question at a time so you can answer, get feedback, then continue.
- **Stopping after one round of feedback.** The first answer is rarely the best. Ask Qwen to ask the same question again with a follow-up, or to push back, or to make the question harder. Two or three rounds of pressure is where confidence actually builds.
- **Forgetting that Qwen can't read body language or tone.** Qwen evaluates what you *type*, not how you *sound*. If you're prepping for a video interview, do at least one practice round on camera or out loud, separately, to catch the things text can't show.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** Even outside job hunting, this same trick works for any high-stakes conversation — a parent-teacher meeting, a price negotiation, a tough email you're about to send. Practice the words before you have to say them.
- **For your business or work:** If you hire people or run interviews yourself, you can flip the script — ask Qwen to generate the five most common weak answers to a question you always ask, so you know what to listen for when you're the one in the chair.
- **If you're just getting started:** This is one of the most useful first things to try with any AI assistant. No technical setup, no cost to begin, and you'll immediately see why "AI as a practice partner" beats "AI as a cheat sheet."

Try it now

Open Qwen right now and run a single 60-second drill: ask it, "Give me one common interview question for a [your job title] role." Read the question, close the laptop, and answer it out loud in your room. That's it — your first mock interview is done.

How to write a polite but firm complaint email that actually gets a reply

6 steps · Read online

> **In short:** You can ask any AI assistant — ChatGPT, Gemini, Claude, Copilot, Le Chat, or another — to draft a complaint email that stays calm, lists the facts, and ends with one clear ask. The trick is giving it the right facts and tone instructions; it can write the draft in seconds, but you still need to read it aloud, cut it to one ask, and send it yourself.

You've had a bad experience with a company. Maybe a product arrived broken, a bill is wrong, or support stopped replying. You want to complain, but you don't want to sound rude — and you really want a reply this time. An AI assistant can help you write a message that's hard to ignore: short, factual, polite, and impossible to misread. Here's how to do it in about 15 minutes.

Before you start

- **An AI assistant you can type into.** Any major one works (ChatGPT, Gemini, Claude, Copilot, Le Chat, DeepSeek). A free account is enough for this task.
- **A real complaint in mind.** Pick one you actually need to send — vague practice complaints don't teach you much.
- **About 15 minutes.** Most of that time is reading the draft out loud and editing, not waiting for the AI.

One honest note before we start: the assistant can draft the email, but it can't send it for you, and it can't guarantee a reply. What it *can* do is remove the hardest part — finding the right words when you're frustrated.

Step 1 — Write down the five facts a rep will need

Before you open any AI tool, get the facts out of your head and onto paper (or a notes app). The biggest reason complaint emails get ignored is that they're vague. A sentence like "Your service is terrible" gives a customer-service rep nothing to act on.

Open a blank note and answer five questions in one or two short sentences each: (1) What did you buy or sign up for, and when? (2) What went wrong? (3) What have you already tried to fix it? (4) What do you want them to do now? (5) What's your deadline for a response?

💬 Example: "Bought a blue wool coat from Example Outfitters on March 4 (order #1234). It arrived March 10 with a torn lining. Emailed support on March 11, no reply. I'd like a replacement shipped by March 25, or a full refund."

You'll know it worked when you can read the note out loud in under 30 seconds and someone else would understand what happened without asking follow-up questions.

Step 2 — Open your AI assistant and start a fresh chat

Open the AI assistant you normally use, on whatever device is handy — phone, tablet, or computer. When the chat window opens, start a new conversation rather than continuing an old one. A fresh chat gives the assistant a clean slate, so it won't accidentally mix in tone or facts from a previous topic.

Look for a button like a **"New chat"**, **"+"**, or **pencil icon** near the top or side of the screen. On some apps it lives inside a menu (often three dots or three lines). If you can't find it, just refresh the page or close and reopen the app — most assistants start you on a blank conversation by default.

💬 Example: type "I want to draft a complaint email" as your first line, just to confirm the chat is responding.

You'll know it worked when you see a blank message box at the bottom of the screen and the assistant is ready for your prompt.

Step 3 — Paste a prompt that names the facts, the tone, and the ask

Now copy the five facts from Step 1 and paste them into the chat, followed by a short set of instructions. The clearer your instructions, the closer the first draft will be to something you'd actually send.

Type something like the prompt below — adjust the wording to your situation, but keep the same four pieces: facts, tone, length, and ask.

💬 Example: "Please draft a polite but firm complaint email. Facts: [paste your five facts here]. Tone: calm, professional, no sarcasm, no insults. Length: under 150 words. End with one specific ask and a reasonable deadline of 5 business days. Do not invent any order numbers, dates, or names I didn't give you."

You'll know it worked when the assistant produces a complete email — greeting, facts, what you want, deadline — in one block of text that reads like a real human wrote it. If the first draft comes out too long, too stiff, or too emotional, that's normal; you'll fix that in the next step.

Step 4 — Read the draft out loud and tame the tone

Don't send the first draft yet. Read it out loud, slowly. Your ear catches things your eyes miss — awkward phrases, sentences that sound angrier than you feel, or phrases that sound so polite they sound sarcastic.

If a sentence makes you wince, copy that one sentence back into the chat and ask the assistant to rewrite it in a calmer voice. Don't throw the whole draft away; most of it is probably fine. Common rewrites you'll want: "I'm extremely disappointed" becomes "I'd like this resolved"; "This is unacceptable" becomes "I'd like to understand what happened"; "You need to fix this immediately" becomes "I'd appreciate a response by [date]."

If the draft came out too apologetic — sounding like you're asking permission to complain — say so directly. Example: "Make this sound more confident. I'm being reasonable, but I expect a real answer."

You'll know it worked when you can read the email aloud without rolling your eyes, and a friend would describe the tone as "firm but polite" — not angry, not groveling.

Step 5 — Cut the email down to one clear ask

A complaint email that asks for three different things often gets three different "we'll look into it" replies and nothing actually happens. Read the draft and circle the single most important thing you want.

If the email mentions a refund, a replacement, an apology, and a discount, pick the one that matters most and cut the others. You can always bring up the others in a later email if the first ask is refused. Then paste the draft back into the chat and ask for the trim.

Example: "Shorten this to one ask: I want a replacement coat shipped by March 25. Remove the part about the discount."

You'll know it worked when the last paragraph of the email contains exactly one sentence that begins with "I'd like" or "Please" and ends with a specific date. Everything else in the email is supporting context, not a wish list.

Step 6 — Send it, save the thread, and set a follow-up reminder

Copy the final draft into your real email app, fill in the real order number, your name, and any attachments (photos of the damage, receipts, screenshots of the original chat). Read it one last time to make sure no detail was lost in the copy-paste — small errors like a wrong date can undo an otherwise strong email.

Before you hit send, take a screenshot of the email and save the AI chat somewhere you can find it. If you have to follow up later, you'll have a record of exactly what you asked for. Then set a

calendar reminder for two business days after your stated deadline.

💬 Example follow-up: "Following up on my email below — I haven't received a response. I'd still like a replacement coat shipped by March 25. Please let me know either way."

You'll know it worked when the email is sitting in your sent folder, you have a date on your calendar for the follow-up, and you feel — for the first time in this whole mess — that you've said exactly what you needed to say.

Common mistakes

- **Letting the AI invent facts.** If you say "I ordered something last month," the assistant may invent an order number or date that sounds real but isn't. Always paste your *own* facts, and add the line "Do not invent any details I didn't give you."
- **Sending the first draft without reading it.** AI drafts are usually 80% right and 20% wrong in tone. The 20% is what makes an email sound robotic or slightly off. Always read it out loud.
- **Asking for too many things at once.** "I want a refund, a replacement, an apology, and a discount" usually gets you nothing. Pick one ask, and bring up the others later if needed.
- **Copying a tone that doesn't sound like you.** If the draft sounds too stiff or too formal, paste in a sentence you've actually written before — a text to a friend, an older email — and ask the assistant to match that voice.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** The next time a delivery is wrong, a bill is off, or a service lets you down, you'll have a way to complain that takes 15 minutes instead of an evening of staring at a blank screen.
- **For your business or work:** The same method works for vendor disputes, late invoices, or client complaints. A calm, one-ask email is also the right tone when you're escalating an issue to a manager — you sound professional, not emotional.
- **If you're just getting started:** The very first email to draft this way is the hardest. After that, you'll have a prompt template you can reuse with new facts pasted in.

Try it now

Open your AI assistant, paste this prompt, and fill in the five facts from Step 1: *"Draft a polite but firm complaint email. Facts: [your facts]. Tone: calm and professional. Length: under 150 words. End with one specific ask and a 5-business-day deadline. Do not invent any details."* Read the result out loud, trim it to one ask, and you'll have a sendable email in under 10 minutes.

Draft a Polite but Firm Refund Email with Le Chat

6 steps · Read online

> **In short:** Le Chat, Mistral's AI assistant, can turn a messy complaint into a calm, clear refund request in a few minutes. You describe what went wrong and what you want back; the assistant shapes it into a respectful email. You'll still review, personalize and send the message yourself from your own email account. Note: Mistral now calls this assistant **Vibe** (formerly Le Chat) — you may see either name in the app and on mistral.ai.

If a product arrived broken, a service didn't deliver what was promised, or a charge looks wrong, the hardest part is often just writing the email. You want to be firm enough to be taken seriously, but polite enough that the person reading it on the other end actually wants to help. That's exactly the kind of writing Le Chat is good at shaping. This guide walks you through it, start to finish, in roughly ten minutes.

Before you start

- A free or paid Le Chat account. Mistral says Le Chat has a free tier with a daily message limit and paid plans for heavier use; check the current tiers on Mistral's site before you start.
- Access to Le Chat in your browser (go to chat.mistral.ai) or through the official app.
- The key facts about your case: order or invoice number, what you bought, when, what went wrong, and what you'd like the company to do (refund, replacement, repair, credit).
- Roughly 10 minutes.

Step 1 — Open Le Chat and start a fresh conversation

Go to **chat.mistral.ai** in your browser, or open the Le Chat app on your phone. If you're not already signed in, log in with the Mistral account you created. Once you're on the main chat screen, look for a **"New chat"** button, a **pencil icon**, or a **plus (+) sign** — these are common ways to start a clean conversation. Click or tap it so you have an empty chat box ready.

💬 Example: you don't need to type anything yet. Just click the button that starts a new chat.

You'll know it worked when the screen shows an empty message box with no previous conversation in the list, and any old chats are out of the way. Starting fresh matters because Le Chat only uses what you put in *this* conversation, so an empty box means nothing will confuse the reply.

Step 2 — Tell Le Chat what happened, in plain words

In the empty message box, write a short, honest description of what went wrong. Don't try to make it sound polite yet — that's Le Chat's job. Just give the facts in a few sentences: what you bought, when, what was supposed to happen, what actually happened, and how you found out. Think of it like writing a quick note to a friend, not a letter to a lawyer.

Example: "I bought a noise-canceling headphone set from AudioBrand on October 12, order #44291, for $189. It was supposed to arrive by October 19. It arrived on October 24 in a damaged box, and the right ear cup doesn't work. AudioBrand support replied once and then stopped responding."

You'll know it worked when Le Chat confirms it understands the situation, usually by restating the key facts back to you in one or two sentences. If the assistant seems to have misunderstood something, just reply with a short correction ("no, it was the headphones, not the charger") before moving on.

Step 3 — Tell Le Chat the tone you want

Right after describing the problem, in the same message or in a follow-up, tell Le Chat how you want the email to sound. The trick is to name the tone in everyday words: "polite but firm" works well, but so do phrases like "respectful and clear," "calm but serious," or "friendly but I want a real answer, not a brush-off." Also tell Le Chat who you are to the company — a regular customer, a long-time subscriber, whoever fits — so the tone matches.

Example: "Now please turn this into a refund request email. Keep the tone polite but firm — I'm a regular customer who's been patient, but I want a real resolution, not a generic reply. Don't threaten legal action. Keep it under 200 words."

You'll know it worked when Le Chat produces a short, readable email draft with a greeting, a clear statement of the problem, and a specific ask at the end. If the draft feels too soft or too aggressive, you can simply say "a bit firmer, please" or "softer please" and Le Chat will adjust in the next message.

Step 4 — Add the missing details Le Chat should include

Most refund requests get ignored or delayed because the reader on the company's side doesn't have enough information to act. Look at Le Chat's draft and check whether it includes: your name, the order or invoice number, the date of purchase, what the product or service was, what went wrong, what you want (full refund, partial credit, replacement), and a reasonable deadline for a reply. If anything is missing, ask Le Chat to add it.

Example: "Please add my order number (#44291), the date I bought it (October 12), and a line asking for a full refund or a replacement within 7 business days. Also add a short closing

sentence thanking them for looking into it."

You'll know it worked when a fresh version of the email appears with those details woven naturally into the text, not pasted in as a random list. If Le Chat puts the details in a weird spot — like the middle of a sentence — tell it where you'd rather see them ("put the order number right after my name").

Step 5 — Ask Le Chat to give you two versions

Before you settle on a draft, ask Le Chat for one more option that's slightly different. This is a small step that pays off: it gives you something to choose from, and it also lets you see how Le Chat handles the same facts in a different style. You can ask for a "shorter and more direct" version, or a "warmer and more conversational" one.

💬 Example: "Can you give me one more version that's shorter and more direct — about 100 words? Keep the same tone and the same ask."

You'll know it worked when two clearly different drafts are sitting in your chat, and you can spot the small differences in tone and length. Pick the one that feels closest to how you'd actually write, and use the other as a source of small phrases you can borrow (an opening line, a polite but firm closing sentence, a good way to ask for a deadline).

Step 6 — Personalize the email and send it yourself

Copy your chosen version out of Le Chat into your own email app. Read it once out loud — does it sound like something *you* would say? If anything feels off, change the words. Add a real sign-off with your actual name. Attach any proof you have (a photo of the damaged item, the receipt, the original confirmation email). Then send it from your own email account, addressed to the company's support or billing address — not to Le Chat, since Le Chat can write the email but it can't send it for you.

💬 Example: your finished email might start, "Hi AudioBrand Support team, I'm writing about order #44291, a noise-canceling headphone set I purchased on October 12..."

You'll know it worked when the email in your outbox is calm, specific, and signed with your real name, and the company has everything it needs to act on it. If you don't hear back within the deadline you set, Le Chat can also help you draft a polite follow-up using the same conversation as a reference.

Common mistakes

- **Sending the AI's draft without reading it.** Le Chat usually writes well, but it doesn't know your real voice. Skim it once, fix anything that doesn't sound like you, and add your

name before sending.

- **Leaving out the order number or date.** Customer support can't help with a complaint they can't trace. If your facts aren't in the email, the reply will almost always be "could you provide more details?" — which slows everything down.
- **Asking for a refund without saying what kind.** "I want my money back" is vague. Be specific: full refund, replacement, store credit, or repair. The clearer the ask, the faster the answer.
- **Being rude "to sound firm."** Strong wording is fine; insults or sarcasm aren't. A polite, factual email gets better results than an angry one, even when you're frustrated.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** the next time a package arrives broken, a subscription overcharges you, or a service quietly stops working, you'll have a ready way to write a calm, effective email in a few minutes instead of staring at a blank screen.
- **For your business or work:** the same prompt style works for vendor disputes, invoice corrections, and client complaints. You describe the situation, name the tone, ask for a clear action, and let the assistant shape the wording.
- **If you're just getting started:** the easiest first move is to paste one short paragraph about a real (or made-up) situation into Le Chat and ask for a polite version. Seeing the result once is the fastest way to learn what the assistant is good at.

Try it now

Open chat.mistral.ai, start a new chat, and paste a real complaint you actually have (or a short made-up one) followed by: "Turn this into a polite but firm refund request email, under 200 words, that asks for a full refund within 7 business days." Read what comes back — that's the whole skill, in one message.

How to Summarize and Organize a Long Meeting Transcript You Recorded

6 steps · Read online

> **In short:** You can turn a messy meeting transcript into a summary, a list of decisions, action items with owners, and open questions, using a few focused passes with an AI chat assistant. The catch: the answers are only as reliable as the transcript, so you check them against it.

Have you ever finished a long meeting and realized nobody wrote down who was doing what? A recording can help, but a raw transcript is often a wall of text. In this guide, you'll learn to sort that wall into four clean sections using an AI chat assistant. You'll finish with a reusable instruction you can paste into any new chat, and an organized note you can share with the people who were there.

Before you start

- An AI chat assistant account you already use, and the ability to start a new chat and send a message.
- A transcript as plain text or a document. Many recording apps create one automatically; typed notes work too.
- Permission to share the content. Many workplaces have rules about sending meeting material to outside tools, so check first if the meeting was confidential.
- A notes app or word processor for saving your reusable instruction.
- Time: about 30 to 40 minutes for your first meeting, and less once you have the routine.
- Plan note: uploading files and very long inputs may depend on your plan, and limits vary by tool. Check your tool's settings or help pages.

Step 1 — Prepare the transcript

Open your transcript and skim it. Delete obvious noise, such as repeated "um"s and any side conversation that isn't part of the meeting. Keep speaker labels like "Maria:" or "Sam:", because they let the assistant match names to tasks later. If your transcript has timestamps (time markers like "00:14:32"), keep them. They help you find a moment in the recording when you spot-check. If there are no timestamps, don't worry; you'll search by sentence instead.

If the transcript is over an hour long, split it into sections of about 20 to 30 minutes and label them "Part 1," "Part 2," and so on. Shorter sections usually produce more reliable answers. To share the text, look for a paperclip or plus icon near the message box, which often opens a file picker. If you can't find one, paste the text straight into the box.

Example: "This is Part 1 of 3 from the [project name] weekly sync, recorded on [date]."

You'll know it worked when the file name appears above your message, or the assistant confirms it received the text.

Step 2 — Save a reusable instruction

Open your notes app, create a new note, and write one master instruction. You'll paste it into every meeting. Typing careful instructions from scratch each time is slow, and small differences in wording can give you inconsistent results. Your template should give the assistant a role, name the sections you want, and state the rules: use only what was said, write "not stated" when a name or date is missing, and never guess.

Nothing special is needed on screen here. You're simply saving text. Any notes app or document works, and you don't need any special features.

Example: "You are helping me organize a meeting transcript. Use only what is stated in the transcript and never guess. Produce four sections: Summary, Decisions, Action items (task, owner, due date), and Open questions. If an owner or date is not stated, write 'not stated.' The participants are [meeting participants]."

You'll know it worked when you have one saved block of text you can copy into any new chat in under a minute.

Step 3 — First pass: summary and decisions

Start a new chat. Look for a button labeled "New chat," or a pencil or plus icon, usually at the top of the screen or in the sidebar. Attach your transcript with the paperclip or plus icon, or paste it into the box. Then paste your master instruction and add a request for only the summary and decisions. A narrow first request keeps the answer focused. Ask the assistant to quote the exact sentence behind each decision, which gives you an easy way to verify it.

If the answer stops partway through, reply with "Continue from where you stopped." If you split the transcript into parts, repeat this step for each part, then ask for one merged summary at the end.

Example: "Using the transcript above, write a summary of no more than 150 words. Then list each decision that was made, with the exact sentence it came from in quotation marks."

You'll know it worked when each decision has a quoted sentence, and you can find that sentence in the transcript using search (Ctrl+F on Windows or Command+F on a Mac).

Step 4 — Second pass: action items with owners

Stay in the same chat and ask for action items. The assistant can still see your transcript and its earlier answer, so this follow-up builds on your work. Be aware that in very long chats, early details can get lost. If the answers become vague, start a new chat and paste in the summary and decisions instead.

If the assistant names an owner the transcript never mentions, don't accept it. Ask it to check each name against the text and replace unsupported names with "not stated."

💬 Example: "Using the decisions you just listed and the transcript, list the action items. For each one give the task, the owner, and the due date. If the transcript doesn't name an owner or a date, write 'not stated.' Then quote the line where each owner's name appears."

You'll know it worked when every owner has a quoted line you can find, and any unfamiliar name has been replaced with "not stated."

Step 5 — Third pass: open questions and a self-check

Ask for open questions: topics that were raised but never settled, plus anything the assistant couldn't confirm. This step matters most, because meetings often end with loose threads that nobody wrote down.

Then pick two or three action items and spot-check them yourself. If your transcript has timestamps, jump to that time in the recording and listen. If it doesn't, search the transcript for the quoted sentence. You can also compare the item with your own memory of the meeting. Only a person who was there can confirm whether a decision was truly final.

💬 Example: "List the open questions: topics that were raised but not settled. Then re-check your decisions and action items against the transcript, and tell me which ones you cannot confirm from the text."

You'll know it worked when the assistant names specific items it couldn't confirm, and at least two of your spot-checks match the recording or your memory.

Step 6 — Organize and save

Copy the four sections into one document and name it clearly, such as the meeting name and date. Then give the chat a clearer name so you can find it later. Look in the chat list on the side of the screen. Hover over the chat or right-click it, and look for a three-dot icon (⋯) or a pencil icon. A menu with a word like "Rename" or "Edit" should appear. Labels vary by app, so if you don't see one of those words, try clicking the chat title itself. If nothing appears, that's fine: the saved document is what you'll actually reuse.

Share the document only after your spot-checks are done. One saved record is easier to find than a long chat history.

💬 Example: "Sync notes: [project name], [month] [year]"

You'll know it worked when you can open the document and find the summary, decisions, owners, and open questions within one minute.

Common mistakes

- **Trusting the output without checking it.** The assistant can organize what it reads, but it can't hear the recording, read the room, or know whether a decision was final. Fix it by checking the quoted lines and spot-checking two or three items every time.
- **Pasting one huge transcript into one long chat.** Long chats can lose early details, and answers become generic. Fix it by splitting long recordings into labeled parts, and starting a fresh chat with your summary if answers drift.
- **Sharing confidential content without permission.** Your meeting may be private, or your workplace may have rules about outside tools. Fix it by checking those rules first, and removing sensitive names or details before you paste.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** Turn a long family planning call, a school parent meeting, or a recorded class lecture into a one-page list of what matters, with the people responsible for each task.
- **For your business or work:** Run the same master instruction after every team meeting, then share the organized note with attendees once you've checked the action items against the transcript.
- **If you're just getting started:** Begin with one short recording, even a five-minute call, so you can practice the passes before tackling a long meeting.

Try it now

Pick the most recent conversation you recorded, even a short one. Paste its transcript into a new chat and send this: "List only the decisions made, and quote the exact sentence behind each one." Then check one quote against the recording.

How to Draft a Polite Follow-up Email After a Job Interview

6 steps · Read online

> **In short:** Send a short, specific thank-you email within 24 hours of the interview — three or four sentences, one fresh detail from the chat, and a clear next step. Keep it warm, not needy; this guide shows you exactly what to write and what to avoid.

A good follow-up email is one of the few small things still fully in your control after an interview. It takes about ten minutes to write, and it quietly reminds the hiring manager who you are. Below is a simple, friendly process you can follow the same day, even if you've just walked out of the meeting room still buzzing.

Before you start

- **Time needed:** roughly 10–15 minutes, ideally within 24 hours of the interview.
- **What you need:** the interviewer's name, their email address, and the job title you applied for. A notes app (your phone is fine) where you scribbled two or three things that came up in the conversation.
- **Tool:** any email app or webmail — Gmail, Outlook, Apple Mail, whatever you already use. No special software required.
- **Optional:** an AI assistant (such as ChatGPT, Gemini or Claude) can help you polish your draft, but it cannot send the email for you, and it doesn't know what was actually said in the interview — that's your job to feed in.

Step 1 — Jot down three things you actually talked about

Open your notes app the moment you can after the interview — even two minutes in the parking lot is better than waiting. Write down three specific things that came up: a question they asked, a story you told, a detail about the role or the team. These are the bricks you'll build the email from. **What you see:** your phone's notes app, the date at the top, and probably a few messy half-sentences. **What happens next:** you'll have raw material to pull from, so the email can sound like *you* and not like a template you copied off the internet. **If it looks different:** if you didn't take notes, try to recall one question you were asked and one thing you said that landed well. Even one believable detail is enough. **You'll know it worked when** you have at least two concrete points you can reference in the email — something the interviewer would recognize as "ours, not just any interview." 💬 Example: *Asked about handling an angry customer → I told the café story. Mentioned the new Nashville office opens in March.*

Step 2 — Open a new email and set the subject line

Open your email app and click **Compose** (or **New Message**). For the subject line, keep it short and easy to scan — the interviewer gets a lot of mail. A clear subject line is like a polite wave from across a crowded room: it says "this is the person you met today, not a stranger." **What you see:** a blank email with a To, Subject and message area. **What happens next:** the moment you type their name correctly, the email already feels more personal than half the inbox they'll skim today. **If it looks different:** on some apps the button says **New email**, **Write**, or shows a pencil icon — any of these will do. **You'll know it worked when** the subject clearly says thank-you, names the role, and is short enough to read fully on a phone screen. 💬 Example: `Subject: Thank you – Marketing Coordinator interview`

Step 3 — Open with a warm, specific thank-you

In the first one or two sentences, thank the interviewer by name and mention something specific from your conversation. This is the part that turns a generic "thanks for the interview" into a real, human note. **What you see:** the cursor blinking at the top of the message body. **What happens next:** the reader instantly knows this email is about them and the meeting they actually had — not a copy-paste sent to ten companies. **If it looks different:** if you interviewed with a panel, address the lead person by name and use "and the team" for the rest. **You'll know it worked when** the first paragraph would only make sense to someone who was in that room. 💬 Example: *Hi Sarah, thank you so much for taking the time to chat with me this morning about the Marketing Coordinator role. I really enjoyed hearing how the team is planning the March launch.*

Step 4 — Briefly reinforce why you're a fit

Now add two or three sentences that gently remind them of your strengths, tied to something you actually discussed. This is where your notes from Step 1 come in. Think of it like adding one fresh photo to a friend's birthday card — small, but it shows you remembered. **What you see:** the email is taking shape — it's getting longer than a text but shorter than a letter. **What happens next:** the interviewer gets a quick, evidence-based recap of why you belong in the role, without you having to repeat your whole CV. **If it looks different:** if the conversation was mostly about the company or the role itself, you can skip this part and go straight to Step 5 — a thoughtful question can carry the same weight. **You'll know it worked when** the reader can see, in plain words, that you understood the role and can do it. 💬 Example: *Our chat about managing the café's social media during the weekend rush reminded me how much I enjoy fast-paced, customer-facing work — that's exactly the energy I'd love to bring to your team.*

Step 5 — Close with a clear, low-pressure next step

End with one short sentence that says you're looking forward to hearing from them, and sign off politely. Avoid phrases like "I really need this job" or "Please let me know ASAP" — they add

pressure, and pressure is the opposite of what you want. **What you see:** the email might be around 80–120 words in total. That's the right length. **What happens next:** the email lands in their inbox as a calm, professional note — easy to reply to, easy to forward, easy to remember. **If it looks different:** if you don't know the next steps (some processes are slow), just say "I'm happy to provide anything else you need" — it's honest and useful. **You'll know it worked when** the email closes without begging, without bragging, and without leaving the interviewer unsure about what you want. 💬 Example: *I'm excited about the role and would love to hear how the next steps look. Thanks again, Sarah — have a lovely rest of your week.*

Step 6 — Do a quick proofread and hit send

Read the whole email out loud once, slowly. Check the interviewer's name is spelled right, the role title matches the job ad, and there are no obvious typos. Then send. **What you see:** the final email, maybe 100 words on screen. **What happens next:** the email is on its way. Most of the work is done. **If it looks different:** if you spot a mistake after sending, don't panic — a small typo is not worth a follow-up apology. Save that energy for the next step in the process. **You'll know it worked when** you can read it back and think, "yes, that sounds like me on a good day." 💬 Example (final email): *Hi Sarah, thank you so much for taking the time to chat with me this morning about the Marketing Coordinator role. I especially enjoyed hearing how the team is planning the March launch. Our conversation about handling busy weekend rushes reminded me how much I love fast-paced, customer-facing work, and I'd be thrilled to bring that energy to Wynnum Co. I'm excited about the role and would love to hear how the next steps look. Warm regards, Jordan.*

Common mistakes

- **Sending one identical email to everyone.** If you can't tell which interviewer it was for, they can tell you didn't write it. Always swap at least one specific detail.
- **Writing five paragraphs.** A follow-up is a thank-you card, not a second cover letter. If it scrolls on a phone, it's too long.
- **Sounding desperate or pushy.** Lines like "I really need this opportunity" or "Any update would be appreciated" add pressure. Keep the tone calm and confident.
- **Forgetting to proofread the name.** Getting the interviewer's name wrong undoes the whole "personal" effect. Double-check before you send.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** The same habit — a short, specific, timely message — works after a coffee chat, a school meeting, a meeting with a tradie, or a volunteering shift. It makes you the person people remember kindly.

- **For your work or job search:** A clean follow-up email slightly tilts the odds in your favor because most candidates don't bother, and many who do bother send something generic. Yours doesn't have to be brilliant — it just has to be real.
- **If you're just getting started:** Don't try to write the perfect email. Write a rough one, read it out loud, and send it within 24 hours. Done beats perfect every time.

Try it now

Within the next five minutes, open your notes app and write down three things you remember from your last interview (or your last important meeting). That's the hard part done — the email writes itself from there.

How to practice for a job interview with an AI mock interviewer tonight

6 steps · Read online

> **In short:** You can run a realistic mock interview with any major AI assistant tonight by giving it the job description, asking it to play interviewer, and stress-testing one tough answer at a time. It won't replace a real human, but it will sharpen what you actually say.

Job interviews don't reward memorization — they reward clarity under pressure. Tonight you can build that clarity with a practice partner that already lives in your phone or browser: an AI assistant. The trick isn't to ask random questions. It's to run a short, repeatable session that stress-tests your real answers before a human ever hears them. Below is a method you can use tonight, and again the night before any interview.

Before you start

- An account with any major AI assistant — **ChatGPT, Claude, Gemini, Microsoft Copilot, and Le Chat** all work for this. Use whichever you already have; don't sign up for a new one tonight.
- The job description for the role. Copy-paste the whole posting, even if it's long — the AI uses every line.
- A quiet 30–45 minutes, ideally with headphones and a microphone so you can hear yourself.
- Optional: a notes app open on your phone so you can save weak spots at the end.

Step 1 — Open a fresh chat with your AI assistant

Open the AI assistant of your choice in a browser or app and start a brand-new conversation. What you'll see is a blank chat box — no prior context, no leftover questions from yesterday. This matters because the assistant draws on the whole chat thread when it replies, so a clean slate means a clean practice session. In ChatGPT, look for a top-left button that says **New chat**; in Claude, Gemini, and Copilot, look for **New chat** or a + icon near the conversation list. On mobile, you may need to swipe to your conversation history first before the button appears. 💬 Example: just open the chat — no typing yet. You'll know it worked when you see an empty message box with a placeholder like "Message…" or "Ask anything."

Step 2 — Tell the AI exactly what role you're practicing for

Paste the job description into the chat, then add two or three lines about your background. What you'll see is a long message appear, followed by the assistant's reply — usually a short

acknowledgment like "Got it, here's how I'll approach this." The assistant now has the context it needs to ask realistic questions instead of generic ones. If your tool has a **Custom instructions** or **Memory** setting, you can paste the role there so it persists across chats; otherwise just paste it into the first message of this session. On Claude and ChatGPT those settings live under your profile picture; on Gemini they're under **Settings**. Example: "I'm preparing for a Senior Customer Success interview at a B2B SaaS company. Here is the job description: [paste]. My background: 4 years in support, promoted once, led a small team. Please ask me one question at a time, like a real interviewer would." You'll know it worked when the assistant references your actual role or company in its next reply — not a generic "tell me about yourself."

Step 3 — Start with the one question you find hardest

Ask the assistant to ask you the single question you're most worried about — usually a behavioral or scenario question, not the opener. What you'll see is the assistant posing it the way a real interviewer would: *"Tell me about a time you dealt with a difficult customer."* Read the question, then **answer out loud** — even if you're typing, speak the answer aloud so you catch filler words, awkward pauses, and rambling. This is the most underused part of practice, and the part that actually changes how you sound in the room. If your assistant has a voice mode (ChatGPT and Gemini both do on desktop and mobile), switch to it now; otherwise read your typed answer out loud to yourself once you're done. Example: "Ask me one question at a time. Start with: 'Tell me about a time you had to win back an unhappy customer.'" You'll know it worked when you've actually spoken a full answer of roughly 60–90 seconds — not just thought one.

Step 4 — Ask for specific, structured feedback

Once you've answered, prompt the assistant to score your reply and point to one improvement. What you'll see is a short rubric — usually a 1-to-5 rating on clarity, specificity, or impact, plus one thing to tighten. This is where generic praise is useless, so ask for criticism directly; the assistant now becomes a coach instead of a yes-machine. If it forgets and just says "great answer!", tell it again to be tougher — most assistants default to polite, especially in voice mode. On the free plan of all the assistants listed above, text feedback is unlimited; voice mode may have a small daily cap. Example: "Rate my answer from 1 to 5 on clarity, specificity, and impact. Give me one strength and one specific thing to improve. Be honest — I'd rather hear it from you than from an interviewer." You'll know it worked when you can name one concrete sentence or word you'd change before tomorrow.

Step 5 — Run a five-question dress rehearsal

Once your warm-up answer feels solid, ask the assistant to run a full short interview. What you'll see is it moving through five questions in sequence — one at a time, waiting for your reply

before continuing. Treat this like the real thing: no peeking at notes, no redoing an answer, and try to keep each answer between 60 and 90 seconds. If your assistant has voice mode, use it for this round; speaking back-to-back is closer to the actual interview than typing. Set a phone timer for 10 minutes so you don't run over. If the screen shows a **Stop** or **Regenerate** button, ignore both and just answer naturally. 💬 Example: "Now run a 5-question mock interview, one question at a time. Wait for my answer before moving on. Mix behavioral and role-specific questions." You'll know it worked when you've answered five questions back-to-back out loud and feel a bit tired — that's the real interview muscle kicking in.

Step 6 — Capture your three weakest spots before you close the chat

End the session by asking the assistant to summarize the patterns it noticed — vague answers, missing numbers, weak openings. What you'll see is a short list of two to four patterns, plus the specific questions that exposed them. Screenshot it or copy it into your notes app before you close the chat, because tomorrow you'll want to practice those exact spots. This single summary is what turns a random practice session into a repeatable method: each night you run the same drill, you knock down one more weak pattern. Be aware — the assistant may flatter you here too, so push for the harshest pattern if its list feels too soft. 💬 Example: "Based on this whole session, list the three patterns that hurt my answers most, and the one question I should drill tomorrow." You'll know it worked when you have a 3-item checklist saved somewhere outside the chat.

Common mistakes

- **Reading your answer instead of saying it.** Typing an answer and reading it back to yourself feels safe but doesn't catch the rambling, filler words, or long pauses a real interviewer hears. Speak every answer out loud, even if it feels awkward.
- **Letting the assistant be too polite.** Most AI assistants default to "great answer!" — which is useless for practice. If your feedback feels like a hug, tell the assistant directly to score you from 1 to 5 and give one specific improvement.
- **Practicing only "tell me about yourself."** That opener is rarely the question that decides the interview. Spend at least half your session on the two or three harder behavioral and scenario questions for the actual role — that's where the real anxiety hides.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** If you're between jobs or thinking about a change, this same loop works for promotion conversations, salary reviews, or even asking a landlord to fix something — anywhere a clear, structured answer matters more than a clever one.

- **For your business or work:** Use this method to rehearse client pitches, performance reviews, or tough conversations with a colleague. The "AI asks, you answer out loud, get one specific critique" pattern generalizes to almost any high-stakes talk.
- **If you're just getting started:** Don't try to do all six steps tonight. Do Step 1, paste the job description, and answer one tough question out loud. That's already more practice than most candidates do.

Try it now

Open your AI assistant right now, paste the job description into a fresh chat, and type: *"Ask me one question at a time. Start with the hardest behavioral question for a [role] interview."* Then answer it out loud. That's the whole loop in two minutes — and the easiest way to find out where you actually stand tonight.

Pull Names, Emails, and Phone Numbers Out of Messy Text with Cohere

6 steps · Read online

> **In short:** Cohere's Playground can read a messy block of contact info and pull out every name, email, and phone number as a clean list. Sign up free, paste your text into the chat box, and ask for structured output. The model can still miss details, so always review the result before you trust it.

If you've ever stared at a forwarded "who's coming Friday" email trying to copy ten contact details one by one, this workflow is for you. Cohere is an AI company whose Command model is good at reading tangled text and pulling structured data — meaning data organized into clear categories — out of it. By the end of this guide, you'll have a five-minute routine that turns a paragraph of mixed-up contact info into a tidy list you can paste straight into a spreadsheet.

Before you start

- A free Cohere account. Sign-up needs an email address and is available on the Cohere website. The free trial comes with enough credits to run this workflow many times.
- A block of messy text containing at least five contacts. Good sources: a forwarded meeting email, a pasted conference attendee list, or a stack of email signatures from a recent thread.
- A web browser on a laptop or desktop. The Playground is much easier to use on a larger screen than on a phone.
- About 10 minutes of unhurried time. No coding or technical background is needed.

Step 1 — Create your Cohere account

Open the Cohere website in your browser and look for a **Sign Up** or **Get Started** button, usually in the top-right corner of the homepage. Click it and register with your email address, or pick Google or GitHub sign-in if those options are visible. After you confirm your email, Cohere drops you on a dashboard. This is your control center: it shows your credit balance (how many free uses you have left), any API keys (codes developers use to call Cohere from their own software — you can ignore these for this task), and links to the tools. If you already have an account, just sign in. If a "Tell us about yourself" survey appears, look for a small **Skip** link at the bottom to bypass it.

If your home screen shows API Keys or Billing first instead of a welcome page, you're still in the right place — use the left sidebar to find the rest of the tools.

You'll know it worked when you land on a page that shows your name in the top-right corner and a sidebar with at least one tool link.

Step 2 — Open the Playground

From your dashboard, look for a link or tile labeled **Playground** — sometimes called **Try Cohere** or **Chat**. Click it. A new page opens with a large text box on the left (where you'll type instructions) and an empty response area on the right. At the top of the page there's usually a dropdown menu to pick which Cohere model you want to use. Think of the Playground as a sandbox — a safe testing space where you can experiment without affecting any real system.

If you don't see a Playground link in the sidebar, look for a top navigation bar with options like **Dashboard**, **Playground**, **API Keys**, and **Docs** instead. If you land on a page full of code, you've opened the API reference — click the **Playground** tab to leave it.

You'll know it worked when you see a big empty text box and a button labeled something like **Generate** or **Send**.

Step 3 — Pick the Command model

At the top of the Playground, find the model dropdown — a small clickable box that lists available AI models (an AI model is the "brain" that reads your text and writes a response). Choose **Command** or **Command-R** if those options are visible, since those are best at following instructions for structured tasks. If newer model names appear, any of the "Command" family should work fine. Leave the other settings (temperature, max tokens) at their defaults for now — **temperature** controls how creative or predictable the output is, and **max tokens** controls how long the response can be. Defaults are safe.

If the dropdown only shows older model names like "generate" or "summarize", Cohere may have redesigned this part of the Playground — pick whichever current model is highlighted or marked as recommended.

You'll know it worked when the model name at the top of the page shows a "Command" option, and the right-hand response area is empty and ready.

Step 4 — Paste your messy text and ask for a clean list

Click inside the big text box on the left and paste your block of messy contact info. Then, on a new line below the text, write a short instruction telling the model what you want. The instruction is called a **prompt** — a prompt is simply the question or task you give an AI. Be specific: name the three things you want pulled out (names, emails, phone numbers) and the format you want them in.

💬 Example: Below the pasted text, add: `Extract every person's full name, email address, and phone number from the text above. Return the result as a plain list with one contact per line, in this format: Name — Email — Phone.`

If your Playground uses separate "System" and "User" boxes, put the instruction in the System box (which sets the AI's behavior for the whole conversation) and the messy text in the User box (which carries your actual request).

You'll know it worked when you press Send and the right-hand panel fills with text that lists each contact on its own line.

Step 5 — Read the answer and double-check it

Look at the response on the right. It should show one contact per line in the format you asked for. Read every line carefully — AI models can make small mistakes, especially with phone numbers that use unusual formatting or emails that look similar to each other. If anything is missing or wrong, that's normal; you can either fix it by hand or try the prompt again. To try again, click the small **retry** or **regenerate** button (often shaped like a circular arrow ↻) next to the response.

If the answer comes back as a paragraph instead of a list, your prompt wasn't specific enough — go back to Step 4, add the words "one contact per line" and "format: Name — Email — Phone", and try again.

You'll know it worked when the response shows every contact from your original text, neatly aligned, and any missing or wrong entries are easy to spot and correct.

Step 6 — Copy the clean list into your spreadsheet

Highlight the model's response with your mouse, copy it with **Ctrl+C** (Windows) or **Cmd+C** (Mac), then open your spreadsheet and paste it into the first cell with **Ctrl+V** or **Cmd+V**. If your pasted text uses dashes (—) as separators and your spreadsheet expects tabs or commas, you can split it into columns using your spreadsheet's "Text to Columns" feature — usually found under the **Data** menu.

If your spreadsheet pastes everything into a single column instead of three, run Text to Columns with the dash as the separator. If you don't have a spreadsheet, you can paste the list into a plain text file and still have a useful, organized record.

You'll know it worked when your spreadsheet shows one row per contact, with names, emails, and phone numbers sitting in their own neat columns.

Common mistakes

- **Asking for too many things at once.** If your prompt asks for names, emails, phones, job titles, companies, and addresses in the same go, the model may drop some details. Split big tasks into smaller prompts to keep results accurate.
- **Trusting the output blindly.** AI models can misread a "1" as an "l" or skip a contact entirely. Always skim the clean list against your original text before you send anything.
- **Pasting private info you wouldn't want stored.** Free AI tools may log your inputs to improve their service. For sensitive contacts, replace names with initials or use a paid enterprise plan that promises not to train on your data.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** When a club, volunteer group, or family thread scatters contact info across dozens of messages, you can turn the whole mess into one tidy list in under five minutes — no typing, no copy-paste errors.
- **For your business or work:** Receptionists, sales teams, and event coordinators can clean up leads, conference RSVPs, or business-card scans in bulk, freeing hours each week for higher-value work.
- **If you're just getting started:** Try it once with a small forwarded email first. Seeing ten contacts appear as a clean list in seconds is the fastest way to trust the workflow — and to start imagining the other messy texts in your life you could clean up the same way.

Try it now

Open the Cohere Playground, paste any short email containing three or more contacts, and run the prompt from Step 4. Watch the clean list appear — then paste it into a spreadsheet to see the time you just saved.

Use Alexa+ as a Hands-Free Meeting Note-Taker and Task Builder at Work

6 steps · Read online

> **In short:** Alexa+ can listen to your meeting on an Echo device, capture what was said, and turn the action items you call out into a personal to-do list. The notes usually live inside the Alexa app, not in a shared doc, so they're a private capture layer rather than a full meeting tool.

You're already comfortable talking to Alexa+ for music, timers, or quick questions. This guide teaches one more capable workflow: running Alexa+ alongside a meeting to capture notes by voice, then pulling a clean task list out of what was said. Your hands stay on the keyboard, and you don't have to switch windows to write things down.

Before you start

- An **Amazon account** with **Alexa+** access set up and an Echo device (or the Alexa mobile app) already signed in. You should already know how to say "Alexa, ..." and get a response.
- **Permission to capture**: let people know the meeting is being recorded by voice, or stick to using Alexa+ on your own desk for personal note-taking.
- Roughly **15 minutes** for your first full run; shorter after that.
- A quiet spot for the Echo within earshot of where you usually sit in meetings.
- A free account is enough for basic note-taking, but Alexa+ features and availability vary by region and device — some capabilities may require a paid Amazon plan, so check Amazon's official page if anything you need is locked.

Step 1 — Open a new note in the Alexa app

Say **"Alexa, create a note"** or **"Alexa, start a new note called Quarterly planning."** On the Alexa app on your phone, you can also open the **Notes** section from the menu and tap a button like **Create Note**. A small confirmation sound or a notification appears, and Alexa tells you the note title back so you can verify it was created.

If your device shows a different menu, look for a **Notepad**, **Lists and Notes**, or **Capture** section instead — the label varies by app version. If you don't see any notes option at all, your region or plan may not support it; double-check Amazon's help page.

Example: say *"Alexa, create a note called Q2 planning sync."*

You'll know it worked when Alexa replies with the note name and you see a new entry in the Alexa app's Notes section.

Step 2 — Add to the note as the meeting happens

During the meeting, dictate into the open note. Say **"Alexa, add to my note"** followed by your sentence, or just say **"Alexa, write this down: …"** if you want to be explicit. Each spoken line gets added as its own bullet in the same note, so you can keep capturing without interrupting the conversation.

If Alexa+ doesn't seem to hear you across the room, move the Echo closer, or lower background music and open windows. The microphone on most Echo devices is good for a normal office, but heavy room echo or fan noise can confuse it.

💬 Example: *"Alexa, write this down: Maria will finalize the budget by Friday. John is drafting the comms. Sarah is booking the follow-up."*

You'll know it worked when Alexa repeats a short summary of what it captured and the new bullets appear in the note on your phone.

Step 3 — Ask Alexa+ to pull out the action items

After the meeting, say **"Alexa, what are the action items from my note?"** or **"Alexa, summarize the tasks from my Q2 planning sync note."** Alexa+ will read back the sentences that look like tasks — anything starting with a name and a verb, deadlines, or commitments. The reply is spoken, and you can also see it in the app.

If the summary misses something, try asking more directly: **"Alexa, list everything in that note that has a person's name."** Different wording often pulls out different pieces. If Alexa+ asks a clarifying question instead of answering, give it the note name again to keep things on track.

💬 Example: *"Alexa, pull the action items from my Q2 planning sync note and read them back to me."*

You'll know it worked when Alexa reads a short list of name-plus-task pairs and that list matches what you remember from the meeting.

Step 4 — Send those tasks to your personal to-do list

Say **"Alexa, add those to my to-do list,"** or specify the list name: **"Alexa, add the action items to my Work to-do list."** Each action item becomes its own to-do entry, which you can

then check off from the Alexa app or by voice later. This is the moment the captured meeting actually turns into tracked work.

If you only want some of the items, ask **"Alexa, add the first two action items to my to-do list"** instead of dumping all of them. If your to-do lists don't show up, ask **"Alexa, show my lists"** to see what's available, then rename or create a new one.

Example: *"Alexa, add all of those action items to my Work to-do list."*

You'll know it worked when Alexa confirms each task was added, and you can see the new entries in the to-do list inside the Alexa app.

Step 5 — Ask Alexa+ to draft a follow-up email from the note

Say **"Alexa, write an email to my team recapping the meeting"** or **"Alexa, draft a short summary email from my Q2 planning sync note."** Alexa+ will compose a short message that names the key decisions and tasks, which you can review before sending. This step is optional, but it saves the manual rewrite most people do right after a meeting.

If you want a different tone, say so: **"Alexa, make it more formal"** or **"Alexa, make it three sentences."** You can also add a recipient by saying **"Alexa, send it to John"** if John is saved as a contact and your setup supports email.

Example: *"Alexa, draft a follow-up email from my Q2 planning sync note. Keep it under five sentences."*

You'll know it worked when Alexa reads back a complete draft email with the key points and tasks you dictated.

Step 6 — Review and clean up at the end of the day

Before you close your laptop, open the Alexa app and skim the note. Delete anything that was said off the record, correct any names Alexa misheard, and check the to-do list for the day. This is the small habit that makes the whole workflow trustworthy — without it, you end up with a pile of half-clean notes.

If you want to keep the note, say **"Alexa, save my note"** or simply leave it open. If you'd rather discard it, say **"Alexa, delete the note called Q2 planning sync."** Both work; pick one and stay consistent.

Example: *"Alexa, show my note called Q2 planning sync so I can review it."*

You'll know it worked when the note opens in the Alexa app with all the bullet points you spoke during the meeting, ready for a quick proofread.

Common mistakes

- **Forgetting to tell people the meeting is being captured.** Voice capture is still recording. A short "I'm using Alexa+ to take notes for myself" at the top of the meeting avoids uncomfortable surprises later.
- **Letting one Echo hear two people at once.** Alexa+ tries to capture everything in range. If your coworker is on a call next to you, expect their words in your note. Use a closer Echo or a headset-mic setup if you need cleaner separation.
- **Trusting the summary without checking.** Alexa+ usually picks up the right action items, but it can miss a deadline or mishear a name. A 60-second skim of the note at the end of the day catches almost every mistake.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** for personal calls or family planning — say, a phone call with a relative about a doctor's appointment — Alexa+ can capture the to-dos without you scrambling for a pen. The same note-and-list workflow works outside work.
- **For your business or work:** in a one-on-one or a small recurring meeting, Alexa+ becomes a private capture layer: you stay engaged in the conversation, and the action items are already waiting in your to-do list when the meeting ends. It is not a replacement for shared meeting tools — it complements them.
- **If you want to go further:** once the to-do list is captured, ask Alexa+ to schedule the deadlines you mentioned, or to set reminders that fire an hour before each due date. That turns a passive list into a workflow that nudges you, not just a record you have to remember to check.

Try it now

Pick your next meeting — even a 15-minute one — and run through Steps 1 to 4 only. Create the note at the start, dictate a couple of lines, then ask Alexa+ to pull out the action items and add them to a to-do list. You'll see in under ten minutes whether the workflow fits how you actually work.

How to build or improve your CV with AI

6 steps · Read online

You'll walk away able to turn a messy list of jobs into a clear, professional CV and tweak it for each role in under 20 minutes. No design skills required.

Before you start

- **A free AI chat tool account:** Like ChatGPT, Gemini, or Claude. You'll need to have an account set up and be logged in. We'll use **ChatGPT** for our examples, but the steps are similar for other tools.
- **Access to the AI tool:** Via a web browser on a computer or tablet is recommended, though a smartphone app can also work.
- **Your work history:** A simple list of your job titles, dates, and key tasks (you'll create this in Step 1).
- **One job description:** The description of a job you'd like to apply for, which you'll use to tailor your CV.
- **Rough total time:** Allow about 15-20 minutes for your first draft.

Step 1 — Gather your raw material

Open a digital note-taking app, a blank document in a word processor, or even a simple text editor on your device. This is where you'll jot down your work history without worrying about formatting.

You'll see a blank page or a new document ready for you to type. Once you start typing, your text will appear on the screen. If you're more comfortable writing by hand, that's fine too – just make sure it's clear enough to type into the AI later.

💬 Example:

```
2022–2024  Café Manager, Brew House
- Led a team of 8 during peak hours
- Created weekly rosters and handled payroll
- Reduced waste by 15 % through better ordering
2020-2022 Barista, The Daily Grind
- Prepared coffee and served customers
- Managed cash register and end-of-day reports
- Maintained cleanliness and stock levels
```

You'll know it worked when you have a rough, unformatted list of your work history, including dates, job titles, companies, and 2-3 bullet points of what you did for each role.

Step 2 — Open your AI tool and start a new chat

Navigate to your chosen AI chat tool (like ChatGPT) in your web browser or open its app. Look for the option to start a "New Chat" or "New Conversation," which is typically a button in the top-left or bottom-left corner of the screen.

You'll see the main interface of the AI tool, often with a list of past conversations on one side and a large input box at the bottom. Clicking "New Chat" will clear any previous conversation. If you don't see a clear "New Chat" button, look for a "+" icon or a conversation bubble icon.

You'll know it worked when you see a clear, empty chat space ready for your message, usually with a prompt that says "Message ChatGPT..." or similar in the text box.

Step 3 — Paste your history and ask for a first draft

Now, copy the raw work history list you prepared in Step 1. Go back to your AI chat tool, click into the message input box, and paste your list. Then, add a clear instruction (known as a "prompt") for the AI to follow, asking it to create a professional CV.

You'll see your work history list appear in the chat input box. After you type your instruction and press Enter or click the "Send" button (often a paper plane icon), the AI will begin typing its response below your prompt. If nothing happens, make sure you've clicked the send button after typing.

💬 Example:

```
List:
2022–2024  Café Manager, Brew House
- Led a team of 8 during peak hours
- Created weekly rosters and handled payroll
- Reduced waste by 15 % through better ordering

Turn the list into a clean, professional CV in American English.
Use a simple reverse-chronological layout.
Keep it to one page.
Use bullet points, not paragraphs.
Do not add any made-up details.
```

You'll know it worked when the AI starts typing out a formatted CV based on your input, usually presenting it in distinct sections like 'Experience' and 'Education'.

Step 4 — Polish the language

After the AI provides its first draft, you'll want to make the bullet points more impactful. Instruct the AI to refine your descriptions by using strong action verbs and including quantifiable results where appropriate, which makes your achievements stand out more.

You'll see the AI's previous CV draft above, and the current chat input box below it. The AI will then generate a revised version of the CV directly within the same chat window. If the AI seems confused, simply say "Referring to the CV you just wrote, please..." to guide it.

💬 Example:

```
Rewrite every bullet point to start with a strong action verb and include a
quantifiable result where possible.
```

You'll know it worked when the AI presents a new version of your CV, with bullet points starting with words like 'Managed,' 'Developed,' or 'Achieved,' and where numbers (like 'reduced waste by 15%') are clearly highlighted.

Step 5 — Tailor for the job you want

This is where AI truly saves time. Copy the entire job description for the specific role you're applying for. Then, paste it into the AI chat and instruct the AI to adjust your CV to match the keywords and skills mentioned in that job description.

You'll see the text of the job description in your device's clipboard. After you paste it into the chat and send your prompt, the AI will use this new information to adapt your CV. If the job description is an image, you'll need to manually type out the key requirements.

💬 Example:

```
Please rewrite my CV bullet points to specifically match the keywords and skills
mentioned in this job description:

[Paste the full job description here, e.g., "Seeking a café manager with proven
leadership skills, experience in staff rostering, and a track record of reducing
operational costs and food waste."]
```

You'll know it worked when the AI presents an updated CV where the skills and experiences mentioned closely mirror the language used in the job description, making your application feel more relevant.

Step 6 — Format and export

Finally, ask the AI to give you the finished CV in a plain text format. This makes it easy to copy and paste into any word processor like Microsoft Word or Google Docs, where you can then apply your preferred visual formatting (fonts, spacing, etc.) before saving or printing.

You'll see the complete, tailored CV as the AI's latest response. The AI will then reformat its output, stripping away any complex styling to present the text in a simple, unformatted block. If the text still has too much formatting, just ask it again more directly, for instance, "Just give me the raw text, no special characters or extra lines."

💬 Example:

```
Give me the final CV in plain text so I can easily copy it into Word or Google Docs for final formatting.
```

You'll know it worked when the AI displays your CV in a simple, unformatted block of text, easy to select and copy directly into your chosen document editor.

Common mistakes

- **Not providing enough detail:** If your initial work history is too sparse, the AI can't create strong bullet points.
    - **Fix:** Go back to Step 1 and add more concrete examples, responsibilities, and any numbers you can remember (e.g., "managed a team of 5," "processed 20 invoices daily").
- **Relying on the AI for facts:** AI tools can sometimes "hallucinate," meaning they confidently make up information that isn't true.
    - **Fix:** Always double-check every date, job title, company name, and achievement the AI includes. The AI can draft and phrase, but it cannot verify your personal history.
- **Skipping the "plain text" export:** If you just copy the formatted text directly from the chat, you might bring over hidden formatting codes that make it hard to edit in Word or Google Docs.
    - **Fix:** Always follow Step 6 and request plain text, then apply your desired formatting (like bolding and bullet styles) *after* you've pasted it into your word processor.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** Update your CV once with the AI, then reuse it for every application by quickly tailoring it to each job description, saving you hours.
- **For your business or work:** Keep a master CV or professional bio in plain text and ask the AI to quickly adapt it for client proposals, tender applications, or conference speaker profiles.
- **If you're just getting started:** Start with your most recent job and build one page at a time. The AI can help you find the right words even if you're not sure what to write.

Try it now

Open your chosen AI chat, paste the example prompt from Step 3, and hit send. You'll have a first draft of your CV in under two minutes, ready for refinement!

Turn a Messy Spreadsheet Export into Clean Data with Copilot

6 steps · Read online

> **In short:** You can paste a messy CSV — different date formats, mixed capitalization, extra columns — into GitHub Copilot's chat and ask it to clean the data. It will return a tidy version with consistent formatting, ready to save back as a CSV. You'll need a free GitHub account and a browser; the whole thing takes about ten minutes.

If you've ever opened a spreadsheet export and immediately wished someone would just fix it for you, this guide is for that moment. We're going to use GitHub Copilot, an AI assistant that lives inside GitHub, to clean up a typical messy export in plain English. No coding background needed — think of it as sending your spreadsheet to a very patient friend who loves organizing things.

Before you start

- A free **GitHub account** (sign up at github.com if you don't have one).
- A web browser — Chrome, Edge, Safari, or Firefox all work.
- Your messy file in **CSV format** (CSV means "comma-separated values" — basically a spreadsheet saved as plain text; if you have an Excel file, see the note below).
- About **10 minutes**.
- A free Copilot tier gives you a limited number of chat messages per month; if you hit the limit, paid plans are available — check the current price on Microsoft's pricing page.

> **Note on Excel files:** If your file is `.xlsx` (Excel's default format), open it in Excel or Google Sheets first and use *File → Save As → CSV* before starting. Copilot's chat works with text, not native spreadsheets.

Step 1 — Open GitHub Copilot Chat in your browser

Go to **github.com** and sign in. Look at the top-right corner of the page for a **round profile icon** — click it. A small dropdown menu appears; look for an option that says **"Copilot"** or **"Try Copilot"** and click it. This opens the Copilot chat panel, usually on the right side of the screen. If you don't see Copilot in the menu, look for a **chat bubble icon** in the top navigation bar instead. After clicking, you'll see a chat window with a text box at the bottom that says something like *"Ask Copilot…"* or *"Message Copilot…"*. 💬 Example: type a test message like "Hi" to confirm it works. You'll know it worked when Copilot replies with a friendly greeting in the chat panel.

Step 2 — Open your messy CSV and copy the contents

On your computer, find the CSV file you want to clean. **Right-click** the file (on Windows) or **control-click** it (on Mac) and choose **"Open With" → Notepad** (Windows) or **TextEdit** (Mac). A plain text window opens showing rows of comma-separated data — it looks a bit ugly, but that's normal. Press **Ctrl+A** (Windows) or **Cmd+A** (Mac) to select everything, then **Ctrl+C** or **Cmd+C** to copy. The entire contents of your file are now on your clipboard (the clipboard is your computer's temporary copy-paste storage). Example: a typical messy row might look like `john smith,01/05/2024,yes,USA` — that's what we're going to clean. You'll know it worked when you can see highlighted text in the text editor and your cursor briefly changes to indicate a copy action.

Step 3 — Paste your data into Copilot and describe the mess

Click back into the Copilot chat box. **Paste** your copied data with **Ctrl+V** (Windows) or **Cmd+V** (Mac). The CSV text appears inside the chat message box — it may look cramped, but Copilot can read it. Now, **on a new line below the pasted data**, type a short, clear instruction describing what you want fixed. Be specific about the problems you see — mixed date formats, inconsistent capitalization, extra columns, whatever applies to your file. If the data is small (under about 50 rows), it often works to paste and ask in one message. For larger files, you'll get better results by asking Copilot to write code that cleans the data instead (see Step 5). Example: after pasting, type — *"Clean this CSV. Make all dates YYYY-MM-DD, capitalize names properly, remove the 'country' column, and standardize 'yes/no' to TRUE/FALSE."* You'll know it worked when Copilot responds with a cleaned version of your data, formatted as a neat table or code block.

Step 4 — Review the cleaned output and ask for fixes

Copilot usually returns the cleaned data inside a **code block** — that's a gray box with the data inside, framed by lines like `csv at the top and` at the bottom. **Read through it carefully.** AI assistants sometimes make small mistakes, especially with unusual date formats or unusual names. If something looks off — say all your dates came out wrong, or a name got changed — just reply in the chat with the specific problem. Copilot will try again. Think of this like editing a document with a helpful coworker: you check their work, and you ask for changes when needed. Example: type — *"The dates are now wrong. January 5 became 2024-05-01 instead of 2024-01-05. The original format was DD/MM/YYYY."* You'll know it worked when the new response shows your correction applied to every row.

Step 5 — For larger files, ask Copilot to write you a cleaning script

If your CSV has more than about 50 rows or several problems at once, copying and pasting gets awkward. Instead, paste just the **first 5–10 rows** as a sample and ask Copilot to write a small

program that cleans the whole file for you. Copilot will return code in **Python** (a popular programming language — but you don't need to know Python to use it) along with instructions. You'll copy the code, run it on your computer, and it will produce a new clean file. This sounds technical, but it's actually the easier path for bigger files — and you can always paste small bits back into chat to ask follow-up questions. 💬 Example: type — *"Here's a sample of my CSV. Write a Python script that cleans the full file the same way and saves the result as clean_data.csv."* You'll know it worked when Copilot gives you a complete code block you can save as a `.py` file and run.

Step 6 — Save the cleaned data back to a file

For small files where you got a cleaned table in chat, click the **copy icon** in the top-right corner of the code block (it usually looks like two overlapping squares). Open a new file in Notepad or TextEdit, paste the cleaned data in, and save it with a new name like `clean_data.csv` — keeping the `.csv` extension is important so other programs recognize it as a spreadsheet. For the script approach from Step 5, run the Python file once and it will create the cleaned file automatically; the script's output line will tell you where it saved. You can now open `clean_data.csv` in Excel, Google Sheets, or any spreadsheet program. 💬 Example: name the new file `customers_clean_2024.csv` so it's easy to find later. You'll know it worked when the new file opens cleanly in a spreadsheet program with consistent formatting across every row.

Common mistakes

- **Forgetting to check the output.** AI assistants can quietly change a name or misread a date format. Always skim the cleaned data before saving — it takes 30 seconds and saves real headaches.
- **Leaving dates ambiguous.** "01/05/2024" could mean January 5 or May 1 depending on the country. If your original data is ambiguous, tell Copilot explicitly: *"the original dates are DD/MM/YYYY"* — otherwise it will guess.
- **Trying to paste a huge file directly into chat.** Most chat windows have a character limit, and very large pastes often get truncated (cut off partway through). For files over a few hundred rows, use the script approach in Step 5 instead.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** That export from your bank, your running app, or your kid's school can become readable in minutes instead of hours of manual fixing.
- **For your business or work:** Monthly reports from different tools often arrive in slightly different formats. Cleaning them once with Copilot, then saving the script, means next month's report is one click away from being tidy.

- **If you're just getting started:** Pick the smallest, most annoying spreadsheet on your computer and try Steps 1–4 on it. You'll learn the most from a real example.

Try it now

Open any small CSV on your computer (or export one from a spreadsheet app), and paste its first few rows into Copilot Chat with the instruction: *"Clean this data and show it back to me as a table."* That's it — your first cleaned spreadsheet in under two minutes.

Transcribe spoken meetings or interviews into text with AI for notes

6 steps · Read online

Ever wished you had perfect written notes of a conversation or lecture, without the hassle of typing it all out yourself? This guide will show you how to use everyday AI tools to transform your spoken audio recordings into text, making it much easier to review, organize, and share important information. You'll be able to quickly capture key points from discussions, interviews, or even your own voice memos.

Before you start

- **An AI Assistant Account:** You'll need access to an AI assistant that can process audio. Popular options include ChatGPT, Gemini, Claude, Copilot, Le Chat, or DeepSeek. Most offer free tiers, but some advanced features or longer audio files might require a paid subscription.
- **An Audio File:** Have a meeting recording, interview, or voice memo ready on your device. Common formats like MP3, WAV, or M4A usually work best.
- **Internet Connection:** A stable internet connection is essential for the AI tool to process your audio.
- **Time:** This process typically takes 5-10 minutes, plus the duration of your audio file for processing.

Step 1 — Choose and open an AI transcription tool

First, you'll need to select an AI assistant that supports audio uploads and open its website or app. For example, if you're using ChatGPT, navigate to `chatgpt.com` in your web browser. You'll typically see a main chat interface, perhaps with a text input field at the bottom and past conversations listed on the side. This is where you'll start your new interaction. If you're on a mobile device, open the specific AI app instead. Example: Go to `chatgpt.com` in your web browser. You'll know it worked when you see the AI assistant's main chat window, ready for your input.

Step 2 — Start a new conversation

Once you're in the AI assistant's interface, you need to begin a fresh conversation. This helps keep your tasks organized and prevents the AI from getting confused with previous topics. Look for a button or icon that says "New Chat," "New Conversation," or similar, usually found in a prominent spot like the top-left or bottom-left corner of the screen. Clicking it will clear the current chat area, giving you a blank slate. Example: Click the "New Chat" button in the

top-left corner. If it looks different, search for an icon that resembles a speech bubble with a plus sign, or simply look for an option to start a fresh interaction. You'll know it worked when the main chat area becomes empty, showing a clear text input box, ready for your new request.

Step 3 — Upload your audio file

Now it's time to provide the AI with the audio you want to transcribe. In the text input area, look for an attachment icon – often a paperclip symbol. Click on this icon, which will open a file browser window on your computer or device. Navigate to where your audio file is saved, select it, and then confirm by clicking "Open" or "Select." The AI assistant will then begin uploading the file, and you might see a progress bar or the filename appear in the chat area. Example: Click the paperclip icon, then select your "Meeting_Notes_Audio.mp3" file from your Downloads folder. If you don't see a paperclip, look for an upload button, an arrow pointing upwards, or a similar icon designed for adding files. On some mobile apps, you might need to tap the microphone icon and then select a file from your device's storage. You'll know it worked when you see the audio file's name or a representation of the file (like a waveform or small icon) appear in the chat input area, indicating it's ready to be sent.

Step 4 — Give a clear instruction (the "prompt")

Once your audio file is uploaded, you need to tell the AI what to do with it. This instruction is called a "prompt," and it's how you guide the AI's actions. In the text input box, type a clear request, making sure to include what you want the AI to do (transcribe) and any specific instructions (like identifying speakers, though this isn't always perfect). Then, press Enter or click the "Send" button (often a paper airplane icon). Example: "Please transcribe this audio. If possible, identify different speakers." If the AI starts generating a response that isn't what you expected, try to be more direct and simple in your prompt. You'll know it worked when the AI starts processing your request, often showing a "typing" indicator or a message that it's "thinking."

Step 5 — Review the transcribed text

After a short wait, the AI assistant will present the transcribed text directly in the chat window. This text will be the spoken words from your audio file, converted into written form. Take a moment to read through it. Pay attention to how well the AI captured the spoken words, especially if there were background noises, accents, or technical terms. You can scroll through the entire transcription. Example: The AI displays a long block of text beginning with "Speaker 1: Welcome everyone..." You'll know it worked when a block of text, resembling the content of your audio recording, appears in the chat window.

Step 6 — Refine and edit your notes

The initial transcription might not be 100% perfect, especially with complex audio. Now you have the opportunity to make corrections or ask the AI to summarize the text. You can copy the transcription into a document and edit it manually, or you can ask the AI follow-up questions right in the chat. For instance, you could ask it to "Summarize the main points of this meeting" or "List all action items mentioned." This lets you quickly turn raw transcription into useful notes. 💬 Example: "Can you now provide a summary of the key decisions made in the recording?" If the AI struggles with a summary, try guiding it by saying, "Focus on decisions related to the budget and deadlines." You'll know it worked when the AI either gives you a refined response or you've successfully copied and edited the text to your satisfaction.

Common mistakes

- **Poor audio quality:** If your recording has a lot of background noise, muffled voices, or people speaking over each other, the AI will struggle to transcribe it accurately.
    - **Fix:** Ensure your original recording is as clear as possible. Use a good microphone and record in a quiet environment. You might need to manually correct more of the text.
- **Using an unsupported file format:** While most AI tools accept common audio formats, an unusual one might fail to upload.
    - **Fix:** Before uploading, check if your audio file is in a widely supported format like MP3 or WAV. If not, use a free online converter to change it.
- **Vague instructions (prompts):** Simply uploading the file without a clear prompt might lead to the AI just confirming the upload or not knowing what to do.
    - **Fix:** Always include a clear instruction like "Transcribe this audio" or "Convert this recording to text" to guide the AI.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** Imagine quickly getting written notes from a university lecture, a detailed family discussion, or even your own voice journal, allowing you to easily recall specific details without re-listening to hours of audio.
- **For your business or work:** You can effortlessly convert recorded client interviews, team meetings, or presentations into searchable text documents. This saves hours of manual note-taking, improves accuracy, and makes it simple to share key takeaways with colleagues.
- **If you're just getting started:** Try transcribing a short, clear voice memo you've recorded on your phone. It's a great way to see how accurate the AI can be with everyday speech.

Try it now

Grab your phone and record a quick voice memo of about 30 seconds, perhaps describing your day or giving yourself a reminder. Then, follow the steps above to upload it to an AI assistant and ask it to transcribe what you said. See how well it captures your words!

Write a polite refund request email in 2 minutes with ChatGPT

6 steps · Read online

Ever bought something that didn't quite work out, and now you need to ask for your money back? Crafting a clear, firm, yet polite email can feel like a chore. This guide will show you how to use ChatGPT, an artificial intelligence (AI) assistant, to quickly draft a professional refund request email that you can send right away. By the end, you'll be able to tell ChatGPT about your problem and get a ready-to-send email in just a couple of minutes.

Before you start

- You'll need an active OpenAI account for ChatGPT. A free account is perfectly fine for this task.
- Access to ChatGPT either through its website (chatgpt.com) on a computer or tablet, or via the official ChatGPT app on your mobile phone.
- Roughly 5-10 minutes of your time.

Step 1 — Open ChatGPT and start a new chat

Begin by launching the ChatGPT application on your device or navigating to the ChatGPT website in your web browser. When it loads, you'll typically see your past conversations listed on the side, and a large text box at the bottom of the screen where you can type your messages. To ensure you're starting fresh, look for a "New Chat" button or icon, usually positioned in the top-left or bottom-left corner of the screen. Tapping or clicking this will clear your previous conversation and give you a blank canvas.

If it looks different: On mobile apps, the "New Chat" option often appears after you tap a menu icon (three horizontal lines) in the top corner. Look for a plus (+) sign or a speech bubble icon that indicates starting a fresh conversation.

You'll know it worked when: The main conversation area is empty, ready for your first message, and the text input box is clear.

Step 2 — Tell ChatGPT about your purchase problem

Now it’s time to explain your situation to ChatGPT. In the large text input box at the bottom of the screen, type out all the important details about your purchase and why you need a refund. Think of it like explaining to a helpful friend who knows nothing about your problem. The more information you provide, the better the email ChatGPT can draft for you. Remember to include the item, where you bought it, when, the price, the specific issue, and any order numbers.

💬 Example: I purchased a faulty toaster from "Toast Heaven" online on 28 May 2024 for $55.00, order number TH98765. It only toasts on one side. I would like a polite email requesting a full refund.

You'll know it worked when: Your typed message appears clearly in the input box, ready for you to send it to ChatGPT.

Step 3 — Send your request and review the draft email

Once you've typed all the details, send your message to ChatGPT. Look for a paper airplane icon or a "Send" button next to your text input box and click it. ChatGPT will then process your request, which might take a few seconds, and then generate a draft email based on the information you provided. Read through this draft carefully to make sure it includes all the key points and sounds just right for your situation.

If it looks different: ChatGPT might type out the response in segments rather than all at once. Be patient and wait for the entire email to be displayed.

You'll know it worked when: You see a complete email formatted for a refund request appearing in the chat window, ready for your review.

Step 4 — Refine the email's tone or content (optional)

If the first draft isn't quite perfect, you can ask ChatGPT to make changes. Maybe you want the email to sound a bit firmer, or perhaps you forgot to add a crucial detail like asking for a return label. Simply type a new instruction into the message box, referring to the email it just generated. ChatGPT is very good at understanding follow-up requests within the same conversation, making it easy to fine-tune your message.

💬 Example: Can you make it a bit more direct and also ask for instructions on how to return the faulty item?

You'll know it worked when: ChatGPT generates a new version of the email that incorporates your requested changes, which you can then review again.

Step 5 — Copy the finished refund request email

Once you're happy with the email, it's time to copy it so you can send it from your preferred email application. You can usually do this by clicking and dragging your mouse over the entire text to highlight it, then right-clicking (or long-pressing on a mobile device) and selecting "Copy". Many AI assistants also offer a small "Copy" button, often located near the generated text, which makes this step even quicker.

If it looks different: On some mobile apps, there might be a specific copy icon (like two overlapping squares) next to the AI's response. Tap this to copy the text to your device's clipboard.

You'll know it worked when: The entire email text is highlighted, and you receive a small pop-up notification (or hear a sound) confirming that the text has been copied.

Step 6 — Paste the email into your mail app and send

Open your regular email application, such as Gmail, Outlook, or Apple Mail, and start composing a new message. In the main body of the email, click (or tap and hold on mobile) and select "Paste". The refund request email you drafted with ChatGPT will now appear. Remember to fill in the subject line, the recipient's email address (usually found on the company's website under "Contact Us"), and double-check your name and contact details at the end.

If it looks different: The formatting might shift slightly when you paste, but the main text should be there. Adjust any line breaks or bolding as needed.

You'll know it worked when: The complete email appears in your new message, ready for you to add the recipient and subject, and then click "Send".

Common mistakes

- **Not providing enough detail:** A common mistake is giving ChatGPT a vague prompt like "Write a refund email." The AI needs specific information (what, when, where, why, order number) to write an effective and accurate email. Always try to provide all relevant details upfront to get the best first draft.
- **Expecting ChatGPT to send the email:** ChatGPT is an AI assistant that *generates* text; it cannot access your email account or send messages on your behalf. You must manually copy the generated email and paste it into your own email application to send it.
- **Forgetting to proofread:** While ChatGPT is very good, it can sometimes make small errors or choose phrasing that isn't quite right for your personal situation. Always read through the drafted email carefully before sending to catch any mistakes, ensure all details are correct, and confirm the tone matches what you intend.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** You can quickly handle minor consumer issues or disagreements without the stress of writing formal complaints from scratch. Whether it's a faulty product or an incorrect bill, a clear and polite email can help resolve it faster.
- **For your business or work:** This skill extends beyond personal refunds. You can use ChatGPT to draft professional communications, internal memos, or even customer service

responses, saving valuable time and ensuring a consistent, polite tone across your written exchanges.

- **If you're just getting started:** Using ChatGPT for a practical task like drafting an email is an excellent, low-stakes way to explore what AI can do. It helps you get comfortable with giving instructions (prompts) and seeing immediate, useful results.

Try it now

Think of a recent small purchase you've made, even if you don't need a refund. Spend two minutes with ChatGPT and see if you can draft a polite email explaining an imagined minor issue and requesting a resolution. It’s a great way to practice!

Use AI to Rewrite Your Resume and Catch a Recruiter's Attention

6 steps · Read online

> **In short:** Paste your resume into any AI assistant (ChatGPT, Claude, Gemini, Copilot, Le Chat, DeepSeek — or another), ask it to tighten bullet points and flag weak spots, then read every change before you keep it. AI can sharpen your wording in minutes, but it does not know what you actually did at work, so you stay the editor.

By the end of this guide, you'll have a cleaner version of your resume and a short list of things to fix next — without lying about a single job you held.

Before you start

- A current resume, either as a Word/PDF file or copied text (the more complete the draft, the better the rewrite).
- A free AI assistant in your browser or on your phone — ChatGPT, Claude, Gemini, Microsoft Copilot, Le Chat, DeepSeek, or any other you already use. A paid plan is not needed for this task.
- About 20–30 minutes total. Most of that time is reading the AI's suggestions, not typing.

Step 1 — Get your resume into plain text

Open your resume in whatever program you normally use (Word, Google Docs, Pages, or even a PDF reader). Select the whole document with **Ctrl+A** (Windows) or **Cmd+A** (Mac), then copy it with **Ctrl+C** or **Cmd+C**. Then paste it into a plain text file, an email draft, or a notes app so you have clean text with no strange formatting. If your resume is a scanned image, you'll need to retype it or run it through an OCR tool first, because most AI assistants cannot read words inside a picture unless you attach the picture directly.

Example: paste into a new note titled "Resume — May 2026 — plain".

You'll know it worked when your whole resume sits in one block of readable text, with no broken columns or missing letters.

Step 2 — Open a fresh chat in any AI assistant

Open your AI assistant in a browser or app, and start a **new chat**. A fresh chat keeps the AI focused only on your resume, without pulling in older conversations. Look for a button labeled something like **"New chat"**, **"New conversation"**, or a **+** or **pencil icon** near the top or side of the screen. If you can't find that button inside the app, closing and reopening the app usually does the same thing.

💬 Example: type "Hi" first, just to confirm the chat is working.

You'll know it worked when you see an empty message box with no previous replies above it.

Step 3 — Paste your resume and ask for a tighter version

Paste your plain-text resume into the message box, then write a short instruction that says three things: tighten the wording, start each bullet with a strong action verb, and do not invent anything. Hit **Enter** or tap the **send** arrow. The AI will reply with a rewritten version of your resume. If the answer comes back in pieces or stops halfway, simply reply **"continue"** and it will pick up where it left off.

💬 Example: "Here is my resume. Rewrite it so each bullet starts with a strong action verb, keep it to one page worth of content, and only use facts I already gave you — do not add jobs, degrees, or skills I did not mention."

You'll know it worked when you can read a new version where each bullet starts with a word like *led*, *built*, *cut*, *shipped*, or *designed*, and nothing about your past has changed.

Step 4 — Ask for a list of gaps and weak spots

In the same chat, send a follow-up message asking the AI to point out what is missing or weak. Be specific: ask for gaps a recruiter would notice, places where a number would help, and skills that are common in your field but not mentioned. The AI will produce a short list. Treat this list as a to-do, not a script — only act on items you actually recognize as true.

💬 Example: "Read the resume I pasted earlier. List 5–8 things a recruiter would notice as missing, vague, or weak. For each, say what I should add or fix. Do not assume things about me that I did not tell you."

You'll know it worked when you get a numbered list with concrete suggestions such as "no metrics on your sales role" or "missing the name of the tool you used".

Step 5 — Edit the rewrite yourself, line by line

Open your real resume file (the original, not the AI's output) and apply the changes by hand, sentence by sentence. The AI's version is a draft, not a final product — it can drop a date, misread a job title, or rephrase something in a way that isn't quite true. As you copy each line over, ask yourself one simple question: *could I defend this sentence in a job interview?* If the answer is no, rewrite it in your own words before saving.

💬 Example: if the AI changed "Helped customers with questions" to "Resolved complex customer escalations", only keep it if you actually handled difficult escalations — otherwise

soften it back to what really happened.

You'll know it worked when every line of your resume is something you could say out loud about yourself without hesitating.

Step 6 — Save, proofread, and back up the file

Save the edited resume as a new file — for example, "Resume — AI edit — May 2026" — so the original is still safe. Read the new version aloud once, slowly, to catch awkward phrasing and small typos. Run a spell-check in Word or Google Docs. Then email the file to yourself so you have a backup you can open on any device. Now your resume is sharper, the gaps list tells you what to work on next, and you have not invented a single job you did not do.

💬 Example: read each bullet out loud; if you stumble on a sentence, rewrite it before you save.

You'll know it worked when you can open the file on your phone, see a clean one- or two-page document, and feel ready to send it to a real job posting today.

Common mistakes

- **Pasting the AI output straight into your resume without reading it.** Fix: always edit line by line. The AI may drop a job, exaggerate your role, or invent a metric — you have to catch that before it reaches a recruiter.
- **Letting the AI add skills or tools you never used.** Fix: if you see a tool, certification, or skill in the rewrite that you did not mention in your original text, delete it. Hiring managers will ask about it in the interview.
- **Asking for a one-page rewrite when your experience needs two.** Fix: tell the AI the target length in lines or words, or accept a slightly longer version that covers your real history — an honest two pages beats a cramped, fictional one.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** any time you need to rewrite a piece of writing — a cover letter, a school application, a LinkedIn summary — the same paste-and-edit pattern works. You stay in charge of what is true.
- **For your business or work:** if you review resumes for hiring, you can use AI in the same way to spot weak verbs and missing metrics in your own job postings, so the roles you advertise attract stronger applicants.
- **If you're just getting started:** the easiest first move is to try this on a short piece of writing you already have — your LinkedIn "About" section, for example. It is shorter than a full resume, so you learn the rhythm in ten minutes.

Try it now

Open any AI assistant, paste the first three bullets of your current resume, and ask it to rewrite just those three lines with stronger action verbs. Read the result, keep the changes you like, throw out the rest. That single small step is the whole guide in miniature.

Generate a quick FAQ page for a small business website using Perplexity

6 steps · Read online

Imagine having a polished FAQ page for your small business website in under 10 minutes—without writing a single sentence yourself. Perplexity can gather your customers' most common questions, organize them, and even draft clear answers you can copy straight into your site.

Before you start

- A free Perplexity account (sign up at perplexity.ai)
- Your business website or a blank document where you can paste the FAQ
- A list of 3–5 real customer questions (or you can use the examples below)
- About 10 minutes total time

Step 1 — Open Perplexity and start a new chat

Open your web browser and go to perplexity.ai. If you're already signed in, you'll see the main search bar in the center of the page. Click inside the search bar to start a new chat. A blinking cursor will appear, ready for your first instruction. If you see a "Welcome back" message instead, click "New chat" or the plus icon (+) in the top-left corner to clear the previous conversation. You'll know it worked when you see a fresh chat window with a blinking cursor and the words "Ask anything…" at the top.

Example: (Just press Enter—no typing needed yet.)

Step 2 — Give Perplexity your first instruction

In the chat box, type or paste the exact instruction below and press Enter. This tells Perplexity what you want it to do.

Example: Create a clear, well-organized FAQ page for a small eco-cleaning business called GreenShine Cleaners. Use these customer questions: "What cleaning products do you use?", "Are your products safe for pets?", "How do I book a cleaning session?", "Do you offer eco-certified cleaning?", and "What areas do you serve?". Keep answers short, friendly, and ready to paste onto a website.

After you press Enter, Perplexity will start gathering information and drafting answers. You'll see a spinning icon or the words "Thinking…" appear while it works. If the chat box looks different on your screen (for example, you see a microphone icon instead), look for a text box

with a Send arrow or a paper-plane icon. You'll know it worked when the chat shows a draft answer beginning with "# GreenShine Cleaners – FAQ".

Step 3 — Review the draft and ask for improvements

Read the draft Perplexity produced. If any answer feels too long, too short, or off-brand, type a follow-up message asking for a tweak. Use plain language so Perplexity understands your request.

💬 Example: Make the answer to "What cleaning products do you use?" shorter and more casual. Also, add a line about how customers can request a full ingredient list.

After you send the follow-up, Perplexity will revise that section and show the updated text. If Perplexity ignores your request, try rephrasing it in simpler words or add "please" at the end. You'll know it worked when you see the revised sentence appear in the chat, matching the tone you asked for.

Step 4 — Ask Perplexity to organize the answers into a ready-to-paste format

Once you're happy with the content, ask Perplexity to format the FAQ as a clean, numbered list with clear headings. This makes copying and pasting much easier.

💬 Example: Please organize the FAQ into a clean numbered list with bold question headings and short answers underneath each one. Make it ready to paste directly onto a website.

Perplexity will replace the draft with a neatly formatted list. You'll see numbered items like "1. What cleaning products do you use?" followed by the answer. If the formatting looks messy, tell Perplexity "Please format this as plain Markdown with bold headings" and it will try again. You'll know it worked when the chat shows a clean list with bold questions and short answers, ready to copy.

Step 5 — Copy the FAQ text and paste it into your website

Highlight the entire FAQ list in the chat. Right-click and choose Copy, or use Ctrl+C (Windows) or Cmd+C (Mac). Then open your website editor or content management system (like WordPress, Wix, or Squarespace) and paste the text where you want the FAQ to appear. Most editors let you paste directly from the clipboard.

💬 Example: (No typing needed—just highlight and copy.)

After pasting, preview the page to make sure the formatting looks correct. Headings should be bold, questions should stand out, and answers should be easy to read. If the pasted text loses its formatting, look for a “Paste as plain text” or “Remove formatting” option in your editor and try again. You’ll know it worked when the FAQ appears neatly on your site, with bold questions and clear spacing between each item.

Step 6 — Add your business details and finalise

At the top of the FAQ, add your business name and a short introduction sentence. At the bottom, include a call-to-action like “Have more questions? Contact us at hello@example.com or call (212) 555-0123.” This gives customers a clear next step.

💬 Example: GreenShine Cleaners – Frequently Asked Questions Welcome to GreenShine Cleaners! Below are answers to our most common questions. If you don’t see yours, feel free to reach out.

Have more questions? Contact us at hello@example.com or call (212) 555-0123.

After you add these lines, save the page and publish it if your site allows. If your editor doesn’t let you edit the page directly, look for a “Save draft” or “Publish” button in the top-right corner. You’ll know it worked when the FAQ page is live on your site and looks professional.

Common mistakes

- **Mistake:** Using vague questions that Perplexity can’t answer well. **Fix:** Give Perplexity real customer questions you’ve heard before, or use the example questions in Step 2.
- **Mistake:** Accepting long, technical answers that don’t match your brand voice. **Fix:** Ask Perplexity to shorten or simplify the answer in your follow-up message.
- **Mistake:** Forgetting to format the final list for easy copying. **Fix:** Always ask Perplexity to organize the answers into a clean numbered list before you copy.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** If you run a café, gym, or online shop, you can use this same method to quickly create an FAQ page that answers the same questions over and over—freeing up your time for customers who need real help.
- **For your business or work:** Instead of spending hours writing and editing FAQs, you can generate a polished draft in minutes and focus on running your business.

- **If you're just getting started:** Start with three real customer questions you hear often. Paste them into Perplexity and follow the steps above—you'll have a ready-to-use FAQ in under 10 minutes.

Try it now

Open Perplexity, paste the example instruction from Step 2 (or your own three questions), and press Enter. In two minutes you'll see a draft FAQ appear—ready to copy and paste onto your site.

Practice answers for your next job interview with Meta AI

6 steps · Read online

> **In short:** Meta AI can act as a practice interviewer on your phone or laptop. You answer common questions, get feedback on clarity and length, and rewrite until it sounds right — all for free. It can't read your face or tone, but it helps you rehearse anytime.

Rehearsing out loud is one of the most reliable ways to feel calmer in a real interview, and Meta AI gives you a free place to do it whenever you want. This guide walks you through running one full practice question — from the first prompt to a refined second draft — so you can repeat the pattern on your own for any role.

Before you start

- A free Meta account (the same one you use for Facebook or Instagram) or just a browser — no paid plan needed.
- The Meta AI app on iPhone or Android, **or** go to **meta.ai** on any browser.
- About 20–30 minutes for your first full practice session.
- One job role in mind (for example, "marketing coordinator" or "customer support lead") so the questions feel real.

Step 1 — Open Meta AI and start a fresh chat

Open the **Meta AI app** on your phone, or visit **meta.ai** in your browser. Tap the **blue circle icon** (or look for a button that says **"Ask Meta AI"**) to start a new conversation. A blank chat box appears with a small **microphone icon** 🎤 next to it. If you already have old chats, look for a **"New chat"** option at the top of the screen — older messages can confuse the practice session, so a clean slate is the easiest start. 💬 Example: leave the box blank for now and tap the send arrow so Meta AI knows you're ready. You'll know it worked when the screen shows a fresh, empty conversation with no previous questions at the top.

Step 2 — Set up the interview scenario

In the chat box, briefly tell Meta AI what role you're practicing for and how many questions you'd like to try. It responds by listing a few common interview questions for that role and asks which one you want to start with. If you don't see interview-style questions, your prompt was too vague — try being more specific about the job title and seniority, and the questions will follow. 💬 Example: "I'm interviewing for a project coordinator role next week. Can you act as a friendly interviewer and ask me five common questions, one at a time? After I answer each one, give me feedback on clarity and length, then move to the next question." You'll know it worked

when Meta AI replies with its first question (something like "Tell me about yourself") and waits for your answer.

Step 3 — Answer the first question out loud or in writing

Tap the **microphone icon** 🎤 to answer by voice, or just type into the box — either works. Speak or write at the pace you'd use in a real interview. Don't try to be perfect on the first try. The whole point is to get a real first draft on the page so Meta AI has something concrete to react to. If you freeze, just say "let me think for a moment" out loud; the silence is fine and is part of realistic rehearsal. 💬 Example (typed answer to "Tell me about yourself"): "I'm a customer support specialist with four years of experience helping SaaS users. Before that I worked in retail, where I learned how to keep calm when someone's frustrated. I'm looking for a role where I can grow into team leadership." You'll know it worked when your words appear on the screen and Meta AI waits for your next message — that's your cue to ask for feedback.

Step 4 — Ask for feedback on clarity, length and tone

After Meta AI replies to your answer, ask it specifically to grade your response. This is the step most people skip, and it's where the real learning happens. A general "how was that?" usually gets a vague reply; a structured prompt gets usable notes. Be honest about what you want — pacing, filler words, whether you rambled — and the feedback will be sharper. 💬 Example: "Please rate my last answer on three things: (1) clarity, (2) length — was it too long or too short?, and (3) tone — did it sound confident? Then give me two concrete suggestions to improve it." You'll know it worked when Meta AI responds with a clear breakdown (often numbered points) and at least one specific suggestion you can act on right away.

Step 5 — Rewrite your answer and ask for a comparison

Now write a tighter second version, directly applying the feedback. Paste or dictate it, then ask Meta AI to compare the two. This back-and-forth is what makes the answer start to sound like **you on a good day** instead of a memorized script. If the second draft still feels off, ask Meta AI which sentence it would cut first — that's often the most useful single piece of advice it can give. 💬 Example: "Here's my revised answer. Compare it to my first one — which parts are clearer, and which sentence should I cut?" You'll know it worked when Meta AI points to specific lines (like "this opening is stronger now, but the middle drags") and you can feel the difference when you read your two drafts out loud.

Step 6 — Run through more questions to build stamina

Once you've nailed the first question, ask Meta AI for the next one. Two or three questions in a row is a realistic mini-interview and will save you from getting rusty on the easy opener. If you

run out of standard questions, ask for "behavioral" or "tough" ones — like "What's your biggest weakness?" Save any answer that finally clicks into a notes app; you'll want it on hand on the real day, not buried in a chat scroll. 💬 Example: "Thanks, that was helpful. Please ask me the next interview question." You'll know it worked when you can move from one question to the next without stopping to think about the format — only the content.

Common mistakes

- **Asking Meta AI for "the right answer."** It can't predict what your interviewer wants. Use it to refine *your* answer, not to write a generic one you'll forget by lunch.
- **Giving one-sentence replies.** They're too short for useful feedback. Aim for at least 3–4 sentences so there's something meaningful to work with.
- **Stopping after the first draft.** The polished second version is where confidence actually comes from. Always do at least one rewrite before moving on.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** rehearse a tricky phone-screen question on your lunch break without booking a coach or bugging a friend.
- **For your business or work:** use the same loop to practice salary negotiation, a promotion pitch, or a difficult client conversation.
- **If you're just getting started:** don't try to rehearse the whole interview tonight — just one question, end to end, is enough to feel the difference.

Try it now

Open Meta AI right now and send this single message: *"Ask me one common interview question for a [your target role] role. After I answer, give me feedback on clarity and length."* See what you get back in under a minute.

Ask any AI assistant to explain the confusing parts of a lease or contract

5 steps · Read online

> **In short:** Paste a confusing clause into any AI assistant (ChatGPT, Gemini, Claude, Copilot or others) and ask for a plain-English explanation of what you're agreeing to. It's not a lawyer, but it can turn legal-sounding language into something you actually understand.

Lease agreements, phone contracts and service terms are full of sentences that read like they were written to confuse you on purpose. In the next few minutes, you'll learn how to ask any AI assistant — ChatGPT, Gemini, Claude, Copilot or others — to translate one tricky paragraph into plain English, so you know what you're really agreeing to before you sign anything. It's a small habit that can save you money, arguments and regret later.

Before you start

- A contract or lease document — paper, PDF, photo on your phone, or a webpage
- A free account with at least one AI assistant (ChatGPT, Gemini, Claude, Microsoft Copilot, DeepSeek or any other you like)
- About 10–15 minutes, in a quiet place where you can read carefully

Step 1 — Pick one paragraph that confuses you

Open the contract and scroll until you hit a sentence that makes you pause — something with words like "indemnify," "perpetuity," "liquidated damages" or "subject to." Highlight that whole paragraph, or the sentence plus the one before and after it, so the AI has enough context. If the document is on paper, retype that one paragraph into your phone's notes app. If it's a PDF or a web page, you can usually press and hold with your finger, or right-click with your mouse, to copy the text.

💬 Example: imagine the lease says, "Lessee shall be liable for all damages arising from Lessee's use of the premises, including but not limited to structural damage caused by Lessee, Lessee's guests, or Lessee's invitees." Copy that whole sentence — that's the paragraph you'll work with.

You'll know it worked when you have a clean block of text ready to paste, with no private details like your full name, address, account number or signature line included.

Step 2 — Open any AI assistant in a new chat

Open the AI assistant you've signed up for — usually a website like chatgpt.com, gemini.google.com, claude.ai, copilot.microsoft.com, or the matching phone app. If you're not

signed in, log in or sign up with your email; the basic chat is free on all of them. Tap "New chat" or look for a button near the top-left that starts a fresh conversation. The chat box is usually a wide text field near the bottom of the screen, with a blinking cursor.

If you don't see "New chat," look for a pencil icon, a plus sign, or a "Compose" button instead — every app puts it somewhere slightly different. On a phone, you may need to tap your profile picture first, then choose "New chat" from the menu that slides up.

You'll know it worked when you see an empty message box and the assistant either greets you or shows a blank screen with a blinking cursor, ready for your first message.

Step 3 — Paste the clause and ask for a plain-English explanation

Tap inside the message box and paste your paragraph — long-press on a phone, or Ctrl+V on Windows / Cmd+V on a Mac. Then type a short instruction right after it (or on a new line below). The instruction tells the assistant how to answer. Press Enter or tap the send arrow, then wait a few seconds. The assistant will reply with a plain-language version of what that clause actually means.

If the reply is too short or still sounds like a lawyer, don't worry — you'll sharpen it in the next step. If one assistant refuses to help or gives a strange answer, just try a different one. This kind of task is well within what all major assistants handle.

💬 Example: paste the lease paragraph above, then add this line: "Explain this in plain English, like you're talking to a friend who has never rented before. Tell me what I'd actually have to do or pay."

You'll know it worked when you get back 2–5 sentences that sound like a normal person talking — not a courtroom.

Step 4 — Ask what you're really agreeing to — and what to worry about

Stay in the same chat and type one or two sharper follow-up questions. AI assistants remember the conversation, so you don't have to paste the clause again. Push the assistant to point out the obligations, deadlines, money, and anything that could surprise you later. The more specific your question, the more useful the answer.

If the reply feels too general, push for a concrete example ("for example, what would count as 'structural damage'?") or ask for a one-sentence summary. If the assistant hedges a lot — "it

depends," "you should consult a lawyer" — that's actually a good sign. It means the clause is genuinely tricky, and you've found the part worth a closer look.

💬 Example: "What am I actually agreeing to do here? What's the worst part I should be worried about? Give me one concrete example of when this clause would kick in for me."

You'll know it worked when you can list 2–3 specific things the contract is asking you to do, each starting with "you'll have to" or "the other side can" — not vague generalities like "this clause covers responsibilities."

Step 5 — Ask "what questions should I ask before I sign?"

One last prompt: ask the assistant to put itself in your shoes and come up with questions YOU should bring to the other party — the landlord, the seller, the service provider, or your own lawyer. This is where assistants earn their keep, because they've read thousands of contracts and know what people forget to ask. If the list is long, ask it to group by topic or pick the most important ones.

If the questions feel too generic, add a sentence about your situation. A first apartment, a freelance gig, and a used-car purchase all have very different gotchas, and a quick context line makes the answer much sharper.

💬 Example: "Pretend I'm about to sign this lease tomorrow. What 5 questions should I ask the landlord — or my own lawyer — before I do? List them in plain English."

You'll know it worked when you have a short list of questions you would not have thought of on your own, and at least one of them makes you go back and re-read the contract a second time.

Common mistakes

- **Trusting the AI as if it were a lawyer.** It's not. AI assistants can miss jurisdiction-specific rules, recent law changes, or unusual clauses in your specific document. The fix: treat the output as a heads-up that helps you ask better questions, not a legal verdict. For anything involving real money, long commitments, or your rights, talk to a qualified professional.
- **Pasting personal details you don't need to share.** Contracts include your name, address, account numbers and signature. The fix: black those out before pasting — the AI only needs the clause itself, not who you are or where you live.
- **Asking "explain this whole contract" in one go.** The assistant will give a shallow answer because there's too much text for one reply. The fix: pick one paragraph at a time, the way we did in Steps 1–5. Five focused questions almost always beat one giant one.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** the next time you sign an apartment lease, phone contract, gym membership, car rental or insurance renewal, you can pull out one confusing sentence, paste it in, and read a plain-English version in under a minute — before you commit any money or sign anything.
- **For your business or work:** the same trick works on client agreements, NDAs, freelance contracts, vendor terms, and the small-print updates software companies push out. A five-minute AI pass often catches the one clause that costs you the most later.
- **If you're just getting started:** open any contract you already have at home — a phone bill, a streaming service's terms, a credit-card statement — and pick the shortest sentence you don't understand. That's your first practice run, and it takes less than two minutes.

Try it now

Open the nearest contract on your phone or computer, copy the first sentence you don't understand, paste it into any AI assistant, and type: "Explain this in plain English, like I'm 12." Read the reply. That's the whole skill — and you've just done it.

Turn Your Class Notes Into Practice Questions With Any AI Assistant

5 steps · Read online

> **In short:** Paste your class notes into any AI assistant — ChatGPT, Gemini, Claude, Copilot, Le Chat, or others — and ask it to quiz you with questions drawn from your own material. It works on a phone or laptop, the free plans are enough to start, and the whole habit takes about 15 minutes.

By the end of this guide you'll have a routine you can use the night before any test: turn your notes into practice questions, answer them one at a time, and find the gaps before the real exam catches them. This works for high school, college, online courses, coding bootcamps, language classes, and professional certifications — anywhere notes exist.

Before you start

- **Your notes** in a copyable form: a document, a Google Doc, photos of handwritten pages, or a PDF.
- **An AI assistant account** — ChatGPT, Gemini, Claude, Copilot, Le Chat, or any other major one. The free tier is enough.
- **A phone or laptop** with internet access.
- **About 15 minutes total** — most of that is you thinking through the answers.

Step 1 — Gather your notes in one place

Open the folder, notebook, or app where your class material lives, and pull one chunk of it into a single, easy-to-copy window. If your notes are split across a notebook, a slide deck, and a textbook, you'll want them together so the AI sees the full picture. The chunk can be one chapter, one lecture, or one topic — just keep it focused enough that you can scroll through it in under a minute.

If your notes are handwritten, snap a few clear photos or type out the key points in a text file. **If it looks different** on your end — say you only have a printed page — photograph it once or type the headings plus a few lines of detail; the AI doesn't need every word, just enough to know what the material covers. **You'll know it worked when** your material is visible on screen and copyable (or uploadable) without hunting around.

💬 Example: One lecture's worth of typed notes, three photos of a whiteboard, or the last few hundred words of a Google Doc.

Step 2 — Open an AI assistant and start a fresh chat

Open any AI assistant in a browser or app, and start a brand-new conversation. You'll usually see a blank chat box near the bottom of the screen, sometimes with placeholder text like "Message" or "Ask anything" — yours may say something slightly different. Type a short message so the AI has somewhere to respond, and check that the conversation history above is empty.

A clean chat matters: if the AI is already mid-conversation about something else, it may blend topics and your study questions get muddier. **If it looks different** — say you're on a phone — look for a "+" or pencil icon at the top of the screen to start a new chat, or open the sidebar menu. The major assistants all follow this pattern: ChatGPT, Gemini, Claude, Microsoft Copilot, Mistral's Le Chat, DeepSeek, Perplexity, and others. **You'll know it worked when** you see an empty text box with a send button (often a paper-airplane icon).

💬 Example: Visit chatgpt.com, gemini.google.com, claude.ai, copilot.microsoft.com, or chat.mistral.ai — any of these will do.

Step 3 — Paste your notes and ask for practice questions

Paste your notes into the chat box, then add a clear request for questions. The AI reads your material and replies with a numbered list of practice questions, usually within a few seconds. Watch the reply stream in below — you'll see questions that clearly come from your notes, not generic ones about the topic.

Be specific in your ask: how many questions, what types (multiple choice, short answer, essay), and what difficulty. **If it looks different** on your assistant — some tools let you upload files directly through a paperclip icon — use that instead of pasting, and the AI will read the file the same way. **You'll know it worked when** the AI replies with a numbered list of questions that reference details only someone who read your notes would recognize.

💬 Example: "Here are my notes on cellular respiration. Please create 10 practice questions that mix multiple-choice, short-answer, and one short essay. Start easy and get harder."

Step 4 — Ask the AI to quiz you one question at a time

Reply in the same chat and ask the AI to walk you through the questions one at a time, then check your answer before showing the next one. This is the step that turns reading into learning — instead of seeing all the answers at once (which feels productive but isn't), you actively recall each one. The AI will give you question #1 and wait.

If your assistant dumped everything in Step 3 and you can already see the answers, you can still recover. **If it looks different** — some assistants may want to keep listing — simply type: "Stop after the first question, wait for my answer, then continue." **You'll know it worked when** you

receive one question with no answer visible, and the AI is clearly waiting for your reply before going further.

💬 Example: "Great list. Now quiz me one at a time. After I answer, tell me if I'm right and briefly explain why. Wait for me before showing the next question."

Step 5 — Save the questions and review what you missed

When you're done with the quiz, ask the AI to summarize which topics you got wrong or hesitated on, then copy that summary into your notes. Now you have a personalized weak-spots list instead of a one-off conversation. Reviewing that list the next day is what actually moves information into long-term memory — the quiz alone won't.

If your assistant doesn't summarize well, scroll back through the chat and copy any question you struggled with by hand. **If it looks different** — say you closed the tab by accident — most assistants keep your chat history under a "History" or "Chats" sidebar so you can reopen it. **You'll know it worked when** you have a short, honest list of two to five weak topics to revisit before the real test.

💬 Example: "Based on my answers, list the 3 topics I struggled with most and suggest one specific thing I should re-read in my notes for each."

Common mistakes

- **Pasting too little context.** Three bullet points isn't enough — the AI will invent questions instead of basing them on your material. **Fix:** paste at least a full page or lecture's worth of notes.
- **Reading all the answers at once.** If the AI shows every question with its answer, you skip the recall step and the session barely helps. **Fix:** in Step 4, ask the AI to quiz you one question at a time.
- **Quizzing without reviewing the misses.** Doing the quiz and walking away leaves your weak spots exactly where they were. **Fix:** at the end, save the AI's summary of what you got wrong and re-read that section the next day.
- **Quizzing only the easy stuff.** It's tempting to ask about topics you already understand, because the answers feel good. **Fix:** specifically request harder questions, or pick the chapter you dread most.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** Any time you have something to learn — a new language, a driving theory test, a hobby certification — this habit replaces rereading with active recall, which is one of the most effective study techniques researchers have measured.

- **For your work or business:** Use it to prep for a job interview, a sales call, a certification exam, or a presentation: paste your prep notes, get quizzed, find the gaps the night before.
- **If you're just getting started:** Don't try to convert a whole semester tonight. Pick one chapter, one lecture, or one topic — get 5 or 10 questions out of it, answer them, and review what you missed. That's the smallest version of this habit that still works.

Try it now

Open an AI assistant right now, paste the last page of notes you took this week, and ask for 5 practice questions. Answer them one at a time without peeking at your notes, then look at what you got wrong. That's the whole habit — and it's the one to repeat before every test.

How to Tailor Your Resume to a Specific Job Posting in 15 Minutes

5 steps · Read online

> **In short:** Paste the job ad and your resume into any AI assistant, ask it to pull out the keywords recruiters look for, then ask for rewritten bullet points that match — you'll have a tailored resume in about 15 minutes without rewriting it from scratch.

Recruiters spend about seven seconds scanning a resume before deciding whether to keep reading. The good news is that the words they look for are almost always spelled out in the job ad. With any AI assistant — ChatGPT, Gemini, Claude, Copilot, Le Chat, or whatever you already use — you can pull those words out, see where your resume matches and where it doesn't, and rewrite just the lines that need it.

Before you start

- A current copy of your resume (Word, Google Doc, or plain text) and the full job posting, both copyable as text.
- A free account with any AI assistant you can type into — ChatGPT, Gemini, Claude, Copilot, and others all work for this.
- About 15 minutes.

Step 1 — Open your AI assistant and paste the job ad

Open the AI assistant of your choice in a browser or app, and start a new chat — a fresh chat keeps your resume work separate from anything else you've asked the assistant about. Then copy the full text of the job posting — the title, the responsibilities, the requirements, and any "nice to have" section — and paste it into the message box. Hit send.

💬 Example prompt: "Here is a job posting. Please read it carefully. I will paste my resume next, and I want you to compare the two."

You'll know it worked when the AI replies with something like "Got it — I've read the posting" or asks for your resume. If the assistant has a project or named-chat mode (Claude has Projects, ChatGPT has projects, Gemini has Gems), you can create a new one called "Resume Tailor" so all your work stays in one place. If not, a fresh chat works just as well.

Step 2 — Ask the AI to list the key requirements

Now type a follow-up message asking the assistant to pull out the key skills, tools, and experience the job is really asking for. Tell it you want a clean list you can compare against your resume later, not a rewrite yet.

Example prompt: "From the job posting above, list the top 8–12 skills, tools, or types of experience the employer cares most about. Put them in a numbered list. If a requirement appears more than once or is mentioned in both the responsibilities and the requirements section, mark it as a high-priority keyword."

You'll know it worked when the AI gives you a numbered list of clear, plain-language skills — like "Project management," "Excel," "Two years of customer-facing experience," or "Familiarity with HIPAA." Those are the words you want to show up in your resume. If the job ad is short (under 200 words), the list may be thin — ask the assistant to also infer the obvious related skills for that job type. If it's long and full of jargon, ask it to translate any acronym it doesn't define.

Step 3 — Paste your current resume and ask for a match check

Copy all the text from your current resume (or just the most recent section if you only want to tailor one part) and paste it into the same chat. Ask the AI to compare your resume against the keyword list it just made, and tell it you want a clear picture of what matches and what's missing — not a rewrite yet.

Example prompt: "Here is my current resume. Compare it to the keyword list you just made. Tell me three things: (1) which keywords already appear, (2) which keywords are missing even though I probably have that experience, and (3) any keyword that appears in my resume but is not actually true for me. Use bullet points."

You'll know it worked when the assistant returns three clean groups of bullets — matches, gaps, and "be careful" items. The "gaps" list is your to-do list for the next step. If your resume is more than two pages, paste only the most recent or most relevant section and tell the AI which job you're targeting — older roles rarely need tailoring. If your resume had columns or tables that didn't paste cleanly, don't worry; the AI reads plain text just fine.

Step 4 — Ask for rewritten bullet points to fill the gaps

Now ask the AI to write new bullet points, or rewrite your existing ones, so each missing keyword shows up in a real accomplishment. Be specific: give it one missing skill at a time, paste the actual work you did, and ask for two or three bullet options you can edit. This is the step most worth doing slowly.

Example prompt: "I noticed 'cross-team collaboration' is missing. Here is what I actually did: I worked with the sales team every Monday to update them on engineering timelines, and I sat in on product reviews once a week. Rewrite 2–3 resume bullet points that honestly show this. Keep each bullet to one line, start with a strong verb, and include a number if possible."

You'll know it worked when the assistant gives you short, punchy bullets (under 25 words each) that you could honestly copy into your resume. If a bullet feels exaggerated or makes you uncomfortable, throw it out — your resume should only say things you can defend in an interview. AI drafts fast, but it can also invent details you never actually did, so always treat its suggestions as a first draft you edit, never a final answer you paste blindly. The AI cannot know what you really did — only you do.

Step 5 — Update your resume, save a tailored copy, and do a final read-through

Open your resume file, and only change the lines that match the AI's gap list. Don't rewrite anything that already works — recruiters can spot a totally rewritten resume, and small, focused edits look more natural. Save the new version with a clear name so you remember which job it fits, then read the whole resume once, out loud if you can, to make sure it still sounds like you.

💬 Example file name: "Resume_SeniorAccountManager_AcmeCorp_March2026.docx"

You'll know it worked when every keyword from the AI's priority list either shows up in your resume (in your own truthful words) or you've decided on purpose not to include it. A tailored resume is not a lie — it's the same story, told in the words the job ad is listening for.

Common mistakes

- **Asking the AI to "rewrite my resume" all at once.** The result is usually generic and may invent experience you don't have. Always give it your real accomplishments and ask for one bullet at a time.
- **Adding keywords you don't actually have.** Stuffing your resume with words the AI pulled out, just because they appeared in the ad, is a fast way to fail an interview. If a keyword doesn't match real experience, leave it out or be ready to discuss it honestly.
- **Rewriting the entire resume for every job.** You only need to change the bullets that matter for each role — your "Education" section or old jobs almost never need editing, and trying to retune everything will burn you out.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** If you've been applying to lots of jobs with no replies, this 15-minute habit can quickly show you why — usually the resume is talking around the keywords, not using them.
- **For your business or work:** Internal applications, freelance pitches, and proposal submissions follow the same logic — match the words the decision-maker uses, and you get past the first filter.

- **If you're just getting started:** Open one AI assistant, pick one job you actually want, and run through these five steps today. Don't try to perfect it. The first tailored version is rarely the last — and that's normal.

Try it now

Pick one real job posting you'd actually apply for. Copy the whole ad into your AI assistant right now, paste your current resume after it, and send the prompt from Step 3. You'll have a gap list in under a minute — and that's the start of a tailored resume.

How to translate a letter or document into plain English with any AI

5 steps · Read online

> **In short:** Paste the foreign text (or its scan) into any AI assistant, ask for a faithful plain-English version that preserves tone and key dates, then verify the critical numbers. Free tools handle short letters; longer or sensitive documents may need a paid plan or a human translator for legal weight.

Imagine a thick envelope lands on your kitchen table — a notice from a foreign agency, an email from a relative abroad, a scanned rental contract from a trip. Your stomach drops a little because the words aren't yours. The good news: in 2026, you can turn almost any foreign-language letter or document into clean English in minutes, and you don't need to be technical to do it. This guide walks you through the process with any major AI assistant — ChatGPT, Gemini, Claude, Copilot, Le Chat, or DeepSeek — using the same five moves.

Before you start

- **Any AI assistant** you already have an account with (ChatGPT, Gemini, Claude, Copilot, Le Chat, DeepSeek — all work the same way for this task). Free plans are fine for short letters.
- **The original text** — typed out, copied from an email, or a clear photo/scan. Blurry scans slow everything down.
- **Roughly 10 minutes** for the first try; about 3 minutes once you've done it twice.
- *Honest heads-up:* an AI translation is great for understanding what it means. It is **not** a certified translation — for official or court purposes you'll still need a sworn human translator.

Step 1 — Get the text into a clean, copyable form

Open the letter, email, or scanned document and get its words into a form you can copy. For digital text, highlight it all and copy. For a paper letter or PDF scan, open your phone's camera app (or a scanner app like the one that came preinstalled) and take a straight, well-lit photo — flat on the table, no shadows, no fingers in the shot. On most phones, the built-in scanner detects the page automatically; if not, look for a button labeled something like **Scan**, **Capture**, or **Document** in your camera or Notes app. 💬 Example: photograph a single A4 page top-down on a dark table, with a desk lamp to the side — not behind you, which causes glare. You'll know it worked when the page edges form a clean rectangle on screen and you can tap **Save** or **Copy text**.

Step 2 — Open your AI assistant and paste the text

Open the assistant of your choice in a browser or app, start a new chat, and paste the text into the message box. If you have a scan instead, tap the **paperclip** or **attachment icon** next to the message box and choose your photo or PDF. A small thumbnail appears next to your message. If your app shows a different icon for attachments, look for one shaped like a **plus sign (+)** or a **picture icon** — most assistants tuck uploads behind one of those. Hit **Send** or the **up-arrow** button. Example: paste 200 words of a German utility letter, or attach one JPG of a Spanish rental contract. You'll know it worked when the assistant confirms it received the text — usually a short reply like "Got it" or it just starts answering.

Step 3 — Ask for a faithful, plain-English version with key details preserved

In the same chat, type a short instruction that tells the assistant three things: (1) translate the full content, (2) keep the original tone (formal stays formal, friendly stays friendly), and (3) preserve any dates, names, amounts, deadlines, and reference numbers exactly as written. Send it. Most assistants will return a clear English version within seconds. Example: *"Please translate this letter into plain English. Keep the tone the same as the original (formal/polite). Keep all dates, names, addresses, account numbers, and amounts exactly as they appear — do not round or reformat them."* You'll know it worked when you see a clean English paragraph (or several) that reads naturally and the numbers match the source exactly.

Step 4 — Ask for a short summary of what action, if any, is needed

This is the step most people skip — and it's the one that saves you from missing a deadline. Add a second message asking the assistant to summarize, in three or four bullet points: what the sender wants, what you must do (if anything), by when, and what happens if you don't. Some assistants call this a "TL;DR" or "key takeaways" — the wording you use doesn't matter, the idea does. Example: *"Now give me 3–4 short bullets: (1) what the sender wants, (2) what I need to do, (3) by when, (4) what happens if I do nothing."* You'll know it worked when the reply ends in numbered or bulleted lines and you can answer the question "what should I do next?" without rereading the full translation.

Step 5 — Verify the critical details before you act

Read the summary first, then the full translation. Cross-check every date, name, address, account number, and amount against the original — these are the items AI most often mistypes or "smooths over." If something is off, ask the assistant to redo it: *"Please re-check item 3 — the amount should be 1,240 EUR, not 1,420."* For anything legal, medical, or financial that you'll act

on, treat the AI output as a draft you double-check, not as the final word. 💬 Example: spot-check the deadline date and the account/IBAN number first; those are the two mistakes that cause the most real-world pain. You'll know it worked when every important number matches the original and you feel confident telling a friend "this letter says I have until June 14 to respond."

Common mistakes

- **Pasting a blurry photo of text instead of a clean scan.** The assistant will guess, and guesses on numbers are dangerous. Retake the photo flat on a table with even lighting.
- **Asking only for "a translation" without asking to preserve tone and details.** You'll get a clean-sounding version that quietly dropped the deadline or the account number. Always include the three-part instruction from Step 3.
- **Trusting the translation on legal, medical, or financial documents without a human check.** AI is excellent at understanding meaning; it is not a certified translator. For anything that goes to a court, a tax office, or a hospital, use a sworn human translator for the final version.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** the next time a foreign bank, utility, school, or relative sends you something, you'll read it in English in under five minutes — and you'll know what (if anything) you need to do about it.
- **For your business or work:** use the same five moves to triage incoming foreign-language invoices, contracts, and supplier emails. The summary step alone can save an hour of "what does this actually want from me?" thinking per message.
- **If you're just getting started:** try it once this week on any small piece of foreign text you have lying around — an old email, a product manual, a menu. The first one takes ten minutes; the second one takes three.

Try it now

Pick one short piece of foreign-language text in your email or on your desk right now — even a single paragraph is enough. Open your usual AI assistant, paste it in, and send the Step 3 prompt word-for-word. Read the summary it gives you, then decide what (if anything) you'd actually do about it. That's the whole skill, and you now have it.

Turn your Zoom call into meeting minutes in 5 minutes with Grok

5 steps · Read online

You just finished a Zoom call and need minutes fast. Instead of typing for half an hour, you can get help from Grok to create a concise summary. Here's how.

Before you start

- A **Zoom cloud recording with an audio transcript** — or your own notes from the call. Zoom's help center says audio transcription needs a Pro, Business, Education, or Enterprise account with cloud recording and audio transcription turned on, so switch it on before the meeting.
- A **Grok account** — xAI says you can sign in with your X account or email, and Grok is free to try.
- A **computer or phone** with a web browser.
- Roughly **5 minutes** of your time.
- A **text editor** or email app to paste the minutes.
- **Permission to share the content:** check that your company's rules allow pasting meeting notes into an AI tool, and leave out anything confidential.

> Grok can't send the minutes for you — you'll copy and share them yourself.

Step 1 — Get your Zoom transcript or notes

Sign in to the Zoom web portal, select **Recordings & Transcripts** in the navigation menu, open the **Cloud recordings** tab, and click the name of your meeting. Zoom saves the audio transcript as a separate **VTT** file in the list of that meeting's recording files — download it. A VTT file opens in any text editor. If there is no transcript — for example because transcription was off during the call — play the recording and write down the key points yourself, then use those notes in the next step. You'll know it worked when you have a text file or written notes with the key points from the call.

💬 Example: Open "Team Sync" in **Recordings & Transcripts** and download its transcript file.

Step 2 — Open Grok and start a new conversation

Go to grok.com in your browser or open the Grok app, and sign in with your X account or email. Start a fresh conversation, so the minutes don't mix with an earlier chat. You'll know it worked when you see an empty text box ready for your prompt.

Example: Type nothing yet — just leave the conversation empty for the next step.

Step 3 — Ask Grok to write minutes from your notes or transcript

If you have a Zoom transcript file: open it, copy the text, and paste it into Grok's text box. If you took your own notes: paste those instead. Then type your prompt:

Example: "Please write concise meeting minutes from these notes. Include key decisions, action items with owners, and next steps. Keep it under 200 words."

After you send the prompt, Grok writes the minutes below it. If nothing happens, refresh the page and send it again. You'll know it worked when Grok displays a formatted set of minutes.

Step 4 — Review and polish the minutes

When Grok finishes, read the minutes it generated and compare them with your transcript or notes — especially names, numbers, and deadlines. If anything is missing or unclear, reply in the same conversation. After you send the follow-up, Grok revises the text and shows the new version. If Grok doesn't change the text, try rephrasing your request ("Include the project name and deadline in the minutes."). You'll know it worked when the updated minutes appear in the conversation.

Example: "Add the name of the project we discussed and the deadline for the next milestone."

Step 5 — Copy and share the minutes

Highlight the minutes text in the conversation, press **Cmd+C** (Mac) or **Ctrl+C** (Windows), and paste them into your email, Slack, or document. Add a subject line like "Minutes from 5 June sync" and send. If the text doesn't copy, try selecting it again or right-clicking and choosing Copy. You'll know it worked when the minutes appear in your email or chat app exactly as you pasted them.

Example: Subject: Minutes from 5 June sync Body: Please find the minutes below.

Common mistakes

- **Mistake:** Pasting too little information for Grok to work with. **Fix:** Include your full notes or transcript — the more context Grok has, the better the minutes.

- **Mistake:** Asking Grok to write minutes without specifying the format. **Fix:** Always include "key decisions, action items with owners, and next steps" in your prompt so the output is useful.
- **Mistake:** Sharing the minutes without checking them. **Fix:** Compare names, numbers, and deadlines with the transcript, then ask Grok to add anything missing — it's faster than rewriting yourself.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** After any quick catch-up, turn your notes into minutes in minutes instead of typing for half an hour.
- **For your business or work:** Share clear, concise notes with your team right after the call, so everyone knows what to do next.
- **If you're just getting started:** Start with one call this week and see how much time you save.

Try it now

Open **Recordings & Transcripts** in the Zoom web portal, get your transcript or notes, and paste them into Grok. Ask it to write concise minutes — you'll have the first draft in under two minutes.

Land Your Dream Job: Use AI for Resumes and Interviews

4 steps · Read online

By the end of this guide, you'll know exactly how to use free AI tools to turn your work history into a compelling resume, write a cover letter that gets noticed, and even practice answering tough interview questions. Whether you're just starting out or you've been in the workforce for years, these steps will help you feel ready and confident when your dream job appears.

Before you start

- A free **AI chat tool** (an artificial intelligence program you can type questions or instructions into, like a very smart conversation partner) such as ChatGPT, Gemini, or Claude. Any one of these free versions will work.
- Your current resume or a detailed list of your past jobs, skills, and achievements.
- A computer, tablet, or smartphone with internet access.
- A quiet spot and about 45-60 minutes to focus on your job application materials.

Step 1 — Polish your work history into a standout resume

AI can help you rewrite your resume, making it clear, concise, and full of strong **action verbs** (words that show you were actively doing something, like "led" or "created"). This helps hiring managers quickly see your impact.

1. **Open your chosen AI chat tool.** You'll see a blank chat window, similar to a messaging app, often with a text box at the bottom ready for your input.
2. **Paste your resume prompt.** Copy the example below, then paste it into the text box at the bottom of the chat window. Make sure to replace `[Job Title]` and `[Paste your current resume or job list here]` with your specific details. 💬 **Example:**

```
I'm updating my resume for a Project Manager role. Here's my current experience:

[Paste your current resume or job list here]

Rewrite it to highlight my most relevant skills and achievements. Use strong action verbs like "led," "created," and "improved." Keep it to one page and use bullet points. Make it sound professional but easy to read.
```

3. **Send your prompt to the AI.** Press the 'Enter' key on your keyboard or click the 'Send' button (often an arrow icon or a paper plane) next to your text box. The AI will then start typing its response.

- **If it looks different:** Some AI tools might have a large 'New Chat' button you need to click first. Others might have a prompt suggestion box pop up. Just find the main text entry area.
- **You'll know it worked when** you see the AI tool begin to generate a rewritten version of your resume directly in the chat window, usually appearing line by line.

Step 2 — Tailor your resume for a specific job

Hiring managers want to see why you're a perfect fit for *their* job. AI can quickly adapt your resume to match a specific job description, highlighting the **keywords** (important words or phrases) they're looking for.

1. **Find and copy a job posting.** Locate a job advertisement online that you're interested in. Carefully select and copy only the text of the job description (avoiding images or website navigation).
2. **Paste the job description and your resume into the chat.** In the *same ongoing chat conversation* with the AI, copy the example below. Replace `[Paste your resume from Step 1]` with the polished resume you got in Step 1, and `[Paste the job description here]` with the text you just copied. 💬 **Example:**

```
Here’s my resume:

[Paste your resume from Step 1]

Here’s a job description:

[Paste the job description here]

Rewrite my resume to highlight the skills and experiences that specifically match this job. Use keywords from the job description. Keep it to one page.
```

3. **Send your request to the AI.** Press 'Enter' or click the 'Send' button. The AI will process both pieces of information, comparing your experience to the job requirements.
   - **If it looks different:** If your AI tool creates a brand new chat for each prompt, simply copy the resume output from Step 1 and the new job description into the *same* prompt in the *new* chat.
   - **You'll know it worked when** the AI presents a new version of your resume in the chat, featuring wording and emphasis that directly addresses the requirements mentioned in the job description you provided.

Step 3 — Draft a compelling cover letter

A cover letter tells a story about why you're excited about a particular job and how your unique experience fits. AI can help you create a first draft in minutes, saving you time and ensuring it's well-structured.

1. **Open your AI chat tool, either in the same conversation or a new one.** You'll see the chat interface, ready for your next prompt. Using the same chat can sometimes help the AI remember previous context, but starting fresh is also fine.
2. **Input your cover letter prompt.** Copy the example prompt below into the chat's text box. Be sure to replace `[Job Title]`, `[Company Name]`, and `[Paste your tailored resume from Step 2]` with your accurate information. 💬 **Example:**

   ```
   Write a one-page cover letter for a Marketing Coordinator role at "Bright Ideas Agency". Here's my resume:

   [Paste your tailored resume from Step 2]

   Mention one specific achievement from my resume that matches the job description for a Marketing Coordinator. Keep it professional but warm, and use a friendly tone.
   ```

3. **Send the prompt and review the draft.** Press 'Enter' or click the 'Send' button. The AI will quickly generate a cover letter. Read through it carefully.
   - **If it looks different:** If the AI produces a letter that's too long, simply type a follow-up prompt like "Make it shorter, keeping it to one page." If the tone is off, you can ask "Can you make it sound more enthusiastic?"
   - **You'll know it worked when** a complete cover letter, addressed to the specified company and job title, appears in the chat, incorporating elements from your tailored resume.

Step 4 — Practice interview answers with AI

AI can act as a **mock interviewer** (a pretend interviewer who helps you practice), asking common questions and giving **feedback** (constructive advice for improvement) on your answers. This helps build confidence for the real thing.

1. **Start a new conversation with your AI chat tool.** It's usually best to start a fresh chat for this step, as interview practice is a distinct task from resume/cover letter writing. Look for a "New Chat" or "Start new conversation" button, often found in a sidebar or at the top of the interface.

2. **Paste the interview practice prompt.** Copy the example below and paste it into the new chat's text box. Remember to fill in `[Job Title]` with the role you're applying for. 💬 **Example:**

```
I’m preparing for an interview for a Customer Service Representative role. Ask me 5 common interview questions for this position, one at a time. After I answer each one, give me specific feedback on how I can improve, being encouraging.
```

3. **Engage with the AI and practice your answers.** Press 'Enter' or click 'Send'. The AI will ask its first question. Speak your answer out loud as if in a real interview, then type your spoken answer into the chat. The AI will then provide feedback and ask the next question.
    - **If it looks different:** If the AI asks all five questions at once, simply reply with "Please ask them one by one, and give feedback after each." If the feedback isn't specific enough, try prompting "Can you give me an example of how I could rephrase that?"
    - **You'll know it worked when** the AI first asks a relevant interview question, and after you respond, it provides encouraging and specific advice on your answer before moving on to the next question.

Common mistakes

- **Over-relying on AI for the final product:** AI is a powerful assistant, not a replacement for your personal touch. Always review, edit, and tailor the output to make it sound authentically *you* and ensure all facts are correct. The AI can draft, but you are the editor.
- **Skipping the tailoring step:** Sending a generic resume and cover letter is a common pitfall. The specific tailoring (Step 2 and 3) to each job description is crucial for demonstrating why you're a perfect match and can significantly increase your chances of getting an interview.
- **Memorising interview answers word-for-word:** While AI feedback helps you craft strong answers, don't just memorise them. Focus on understanding the *structure* and *key points* of a good answer. This allows you to speak naturally and confidently in the actual interview, rather than sounding rehearsed.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** You’ll feel ready to apply for jobs with confidence, knowing your resume and cover letter are polished and tailored. This reduces last-minute stress before hitting "submit" and helps you present your best self.

- **For your business or work:** If you're a hiring manager, you can use similar AI tools to quickly summarize long resumes, identify key skills, or even draft interview questions for candidates, streamlining your recruitment process.
- **If you're just getting started:** Begin with Step 1 today. Even if you're not actively applying for jobs right now, building a strong, up-to-date resume is a fantastic way to reflect on your skills, track your accomplishments, and prepare for future opportunities.

Try it now

Open your AI chat tool and paste the prompt from **Step 1**. In less than 15 minutes, you'll have a fresh, polished resume ready to tailor for your next dream job. You've got this!

Automate meeting note-taking with Microsoft 365 Copilot in Teams

4 steps · Read online

> **In short:** In a Microsoft Teams meeting, Copilot can answer questions about what has been said, and after the meeting you can reopen it from the meeting chat's Recap tab. For Copilot to help after the meeting ends, live transcription must be turned on during the meeting. You need a work license that includes it.

Taking notes while you also try to listen is hard. With Microsoft 365 Copilot in Teams, you can ask for a quick summary, open questions, or a list of ideas while the meeting is still going, and come back to the same Copilot conversation later. This guide follows Microsoft's own support pages.

Before you start

- **The right license.** Microsoft's support page says intelligent recap is available as part of the Microsoft 365 Copilot license, and also in Teams Premium, an add-on license. Ask your IT admin if you're not sure what you have.
- **A meeting inside your organization.** Microsoft says Copilot won't work in meetings hosted outside the participant's organization.
- **Permission to transcribe.** Let people know before you start; Teams also shows everyone a notification.
- **About 10 minutes** to try it in a short test meeting.

Step 1: Turn on live transcription

In the meeting, select **More actions** in the meeting controls, then select **Transcribe**. Confirm the language everyone is speaking and select **Confirm**. Microsoft's support page says all participants see a notification that the meeting is being transcribed.

Why this matters: Copilot can be turned on without transcription, but Microsoft says you need live transcription during the meeting to ask Copilot about the meeting or see your Copilot conversation after it ends. Depending on the meeting options, selecting Copilot may also ask you to start transcription.

You'll know it worked when the transcription notification appears and the spoken text starts showing with speaker names and time stamps.

Step 2: Ask Copilot during the meeting

Select **Copilot** in the meeting controls. This opens a private chat with Copilot that other attendees don't see. Type a question about the meeting so far.

💬 Example: "List the ideas discussed so far, including people's feedback."

Other prompts from Microsoft's support page include "Where do we disagree on this topic?" and "What questions can I ask to move the meeting forward?" If you join more than 5 minutes late and Copilot is active, Teams sends a notification, and you can select **Open Copilot** for a catch-up summary.

You'll know it worked when Copilot answers in the side panel based on what has been said.

Step 3: Find the recap after the meeting

Go to **Chat** and open the chat of the past meeting. Select **Recap**. If transcription was on, you can open Copilot there and see the same conversation history you had during the meeting. You can also select **Open Copilot** in the upper-right corner of the meeting chat. The full transcript is under **Recap** › **Transcript**, where you can download it.

💬 Example: "Summarize the decisions and the next steps, and say who agreed to do what."

You'll know it worked when your earlier Copilot conversation appears and Copilot answers new questions about the finished meeting.

Step 4: Turn the notes into a document

For longer answers, Microsoft says you can select **Open in Word**, and for tables, **Open in Excel**. From there you can tidy up the notes and share them the usual way, for example by attaching the file to an email. Read the notes first and correct anything Copilot got wrong before you send them to others.

💬 Example: "Create a table with the action items, the owner, and the due date mentioned in the meeting."

You'll know it worked when the notes open in Word or Excel and you can edit them.

Common mistakes

- **Forgetting transcription.** Without it, Copilot isn't available about the meeting after it ends. *The fix:* Start transcription at the beginning of the meeting (Step 1).
- **Trying it in a meeting hosted by another organization.** Microsoft says Copilot won't work there. *The fix:* Use it in meetings inside your own organization.

- **Sending notes without reading them.** Copilot can misunderstand who said what. *The fix:* Check the summary against the transcript before you share it.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** If you lead a volunteer group or a club that meets in Teams through work or school, a shared, checked summary helps everyone remember what was decided.
- **For your business or work:** You can focus on the conversation and get the decisions and next steps in writing afterward, in Word or Excel if you need a document.
- **If you're just getting started:** Try one short internal meeting: turn on transcription, ask Copilot one question during the meeting, and open the Recap tab afterward.

Try it now

Start a short test meeting with a colleague in your organization. Select **More actions** › **Transcribe**, talk for two minutes about a pretend project, and ask Copilot: "What are the next steps so far?" After the meeting, open the meeting chat, select **Recap**, and ask Copilot one more question.

How to Get Honest Feedback on Your Resume Using Any AI Assistant

6 steps · Read online

> **In short:** You can paste your resume into any AI assistant and ask it to review it like a recruiter would. Ask the right questions, and you'll get honest feedback on vague wording, work gaps, formatting issues and more — before you send it to a real employer.

You have probably spent hours staring at your own resume, wondering if it actually reads well to someone else. The trouble is, asking a friend feels awkward, and a professional critique service costs money. Here is something free and instant: use any AI assistant as a practice recruiter. It has read thousands of job listings, understands what hiring managers look for, and will tell you plainly where your resume falls short. This guide shows you how to set that up so you get genuinely useful feedback, not just polite encouragement.

Before you start

- **An AI assistant** — any of ChatGPT, Gemini, Claude, Copilot or similar will work. No special account needed; the free tier is fine for this.
- **Your resume** — have it open or copied so you can paste it into the chat. Works best as plain text, but a PDF you can copy from is fine too.
- **A job listing** — grab one or two real listings for roles you're aiming at. You'll paste the key requirements alongside your resume so the AI can compare the two.
- **About 15–20 minutes** — the first run will take a little longer as you read the feedback; subsequent reviews are much faster.

Step 1 — Choose your AI assistant and open a fresh chat

Pick whichever assistant you already use regularly — ChatGPT, Gemini, Claude or Copilot all handle this task well. The thing you are looking for is a clean, empty conversation, because you want the assistant to focus only on your resume and not be distracted by earlier questions.

Open the app or visit the website and start a new chat. Look for a button like **New Chat**, **+ New Thread** or simply a text box waiting at the bottom of the screen. If the app opened to a previous conversation, tap the button to start fresh.

On a phone the button is usually near the top of the screen or on a tab bar. On a computer it is often in the top-left corner. If you are not sure, look for a small icon that looks like a speech bubble or a pen and paper — that almost always means "new conversation".

Example: *"New Chat"* button in ChatGPT's sidebar (left side), or tapping the text input field at the bottom of the Gemini app.

You'll know it worked when you see a blank chat box with a cursor blinking in the input area and no previous messages visible.

Step 2 — Paste your resume into the chat

Find your resume on your computer or phone. Copy it — select all the text (Ctrl+A or Cmd+A, then Ctrl+C or Cmd+C). Then click or tap inside the chat's input box and paste it (Ctrl+V or Cmd+V, or long-press and choose Paste).

You will see your resume text appear in the chat as a long message. Give it a moment to finish loading. The whole resume might take a few seconds to paste if it is long — just wait until the text looks complete.

Some people prefer to paste just the most recent version of their resume. Others paste a few versions and ask for feedback on each one. Either works. Just make sure what you paste is a fair reflection of what you actually plan to send to employers.

Example: Select and copy the text from your resume file, then paste it with a short note like: *"Here is my resume. Please review it for a [job title] application."*

You'll know it worked when your full resume appears in the chat as a single message, readable and complete. If part of it was cut off (for example if it was a very long document), just paste the rest in a follow-up message and mention it is a continuation.

Step 3 — Paste in a real job listing

Open a job ad for a role you genuinely want. Copy the text — at minimum the job title, the key responsibilities and the required skills section. You do not need the whole posting; the first half to two-thirds is usually enough.

Paste it into the chat as a second message, right after your resume.

Why this matters: a resume that looks fine on its own can still miss the mark for a specific role. By giving the AI the job listing alongside your resume, it can check whether your experience actually lines up with what the employer is asking for. That is what a recruiter does in the first 30 seconds of scanning a resume.

Example: *"Here is the job listing I'm applying for: [paste the job title, responsibilities and required skills from the ad]."*

You'll know it worked when you can see both your resume and the job listing clearly in the chat — the assistant should now have enough context to compare the two.

Step 4 — Ask for honest feedback in a recruiter's voice

Now type your request. This is the most important step — the way you ask determines how honest and useful the feedback is. Use a prompt like the one below, which tells the assistant to be direct and to structure its response.

💬 Example: *"Please review my resume against this job listing. Be honest and direct, like a recruiter doing a first-round screen. Tell me: 1) whether my resume matches what the employer is looking for, 2) any vague or weak wording I should fix, 3) whether I have any unexplained gaps or red flags a hiring manager might notice, and 4) whether the formatting would make it easy or hard to scan quickly."*

The four questions in that prompt are intentional. A vague request like *"give me feedback on my resume"* tends to get a polite summary. A structured request gets structured, actionable advice. You can copy the example above word for word or adapt it to your situation.

If the AI gives you a very short answer (just "looks good!"), ask a follow-up question: *"Can you be more specific? Tell me one thing you would flag if you were a recruiter."* That usually prompts it to go deeper.

You'll know it worked when the assistant responds with a clear, numbered list of specific observations — things like *"Your summary says 'experienced professional' which is too vague — replace it with one concrete achievement"* rather than just *"Good resume."*

Step 5 — Ask for a rewritten example of one weak section

The AI has flagged problems. Now ask it to show you what a better version looks like. Pick the section it mentioned was weakest — this is usually the personal summary at the top, or a job description where the wording was vague.

This step turns feedback into something you can actually use. You will see the difference between the original and the improved version side by side, which teaches you what strong resume language sounds like.

💬 Example: *"Could you show me what a stronger version of my personal summary would look like? Please rewrite it using specific numbers or achievements where possible."*

The AI will return a rewritten paragraph. Read it alongside your original and notice the differences — more specifics, stronger action verbs, clearer results. Compare the two versions and decide which elements you want to keep from the AI's version.

You'll know it worked when you have a concrete before-and-after example you can use as a guide for editing your own resume.

Step 6 — Repeat for each role you apply to

If you are applying for more than one type of role — say an office administration position and a retail supervisor role — repeat this process with each separate job listing. The feedback for each will be different, because each role values different skills.

The good news is this gets faster the second time. By step six you will be comfortable pasting your resume, pasting the job listing, and asking for feedback. The whole process takes five to ten minutes once you have done it once.

One honest note: the AI can give you strong advice on wording, clarity and structure. It is less reliable at knowing the exact norms of your specific industry or country. If you are applying in a regulated field (nursing, accounting, law, construction) it is worth double-checking the AI's suggestions against a real person in that field or a trusted industry guide.

💬 Example: *"Here is my resume again and a different job listing for a [different role]. Please give me the same honest feedback."*

You'll know it worked when you have a tailored set of feedback for each distinct role type, showing how your resume should be customized rather than sent as-is to every job.

Common mistakes

- **Asking without a job listing.** Asking *"is my resume good?"* gets a generic answer. Always paste a real job listing alongside it — the comparison is what makes the feedback specific and useful.
- **Pasting your whole resume as a screenshot or PDF image.** The AI can read images in most tools now, but plain text copy-paste is more reliable and less likely to cut off parts of your resume. If you must use a screenshot, mention to the AI: *"I'm pasting this as an image — please let me know if you cannot read any part of it."*
- **Taking the first answer at face value.** If the AI says *"looks great!"* without specifics, push back. Ask for one concrete change it would make if it were the hiring manager. One honest, specific flag is worth more than three pieces of vague praise.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** before your next job application, you can do a quick, free dry run. It takes ten minutes and could be the difference between your resume landing in the "maybe" pile or the "call this person" pile.
- **For your business or work:** if you are a manager hiring others, you can use the same technique to test whether your own job listing is clear and competitive — paste your ad alongside a competitor's to see how they describe the same role differently.
- **If you are just getting started:** the best first move is to paste your current resume and one job listing for a role you genuinely want, then use the example prompt in Step 4 word for word. You will get useful feedback immediately, no experience needed.

Try it now

Open any AI assistant, start a new chat, and paste your resume. Then paste a job listing for a role you are interested in. Type the prompt from Step 4, copy it word for word if you like. Read the response. Pick one specific thing to fix in your resume today.

That is all it takes — about ten minutes, no cost, and you will know more about how your resume reads to a hiring manager than you did this morning.

How to Use Copilot in Word to Turn a Long Report Into a One-Page Summary

6 steps · Read online

> **In short:** With **Copilot** (Microsoft's AI helper built into Word) you can ask Word to read your long report and produce a short, executive-ready summary in about a minute. You'll need a Microsoft 365 plan that includes Copilot, your report already open in Word, and a clear idea of who will read the summary.

You wrote a 12-page report. Your boss has two minutes. The good news: you don't have to rewrite the whole thing by hand. Copilot lives right inside Word, and one of its most useful tricks is summarizing a long document into something tight. The trick is asking it the right way, and giving the output a quick human polish before you send it.

This guide walks you through the whole thing, step by step, even if you've never opened Copilot before.

Before you start

- **A Microsoft 365 plan that includes Copilot.** Copilot is a paid add-on, so check that your plan (or your company's plan) actually has it turned on. If you only see "Try Copilot" or no Copilot button at all, the feature isn't on your account yet.
- **The desktop or web version of Microsoft Word** (Windows, Mac, or Word for the web). The exact steps below describe the desktop ribbon, but the web version works almost the same way.
- **Your long report open in Word**, saved as a `.docx` file. It can be a report you wrote, or one a teammate shared with you (as long as you have permission to edit it).
- **Roughly 10–15 minutes**, including time to polish what Copilot gives you.
- A rough sense of **who will read the summary** (your boss? a client? the whole team?) — that one detail makes a big difference in how you phrase your request.

One honest note: Copilot is great at cutting length and pulling out key points, but it can sometimes drop a number, miss a nuance, or smooth over a caveat you cared about. Plan to read the summary once before sending it anywhere.

Step 1 — Open your long report and find the Copilot button

Start by opening the document you want to summarize in Microsoft Word. Now look at the top of the window — that long strip of buttons is called the **ribbon** (think of it as Word's main menu bar). On the **Home** tab, look toward the top-right area for a button labeled **Copilot**. It usually has a small sparkle or ribbon-like icon next to it.

When you click it, a **Copilot chat panel slides open** on the right side of the screen. Your document stays where it is on the left. If you don't see a Copilot button on the Home tab, click the **Home** tab first to make sure you're in the right place, or look for it under a ⋯ **(More) menu** or a tab called something like **Copilot** or **Help**.

💬 Example: open `Q3-Project-Update.docx` from your Documents folder and click the **Copilot** button on the Home tab.

You'll know it worked when the chat panel appears on the right and you can see your document still on the left, with a text box at the bottom of the panel where you can type.

Step 2 — Ask Copilot to summarize the report

In the text box at the bottom of the Copilot panel, type a short request asking for a summary. The clearer you are about **how long** you want it and **who it's for**, the better the result. Copilot works best when you treat it like a quick conversation, not a search engine.

After you press Enter, Copilot reads through your report (this can take 10–30 seconds for a long document) and writes a draft summary directly in the chat panel. It does **not** delete or change your original report — your long version is still safe on the left.

💬 Example: *"Summarize this report into a one-page executive summary. Keep the original tone, the key numbers, and any important dates. Write it for a senior manager who has two minutes to read it."*

You'll know it worked when a block of summary text appears in the Copilot panel, usually with bullet points or short paragraphs, and a small note saying it was generated from your document.

Step 3 — Tell Copilot how long and what to keep

Your first draft is rarely the final version, and that's normal. Read the draft in the Copilot panel and notice what's missing or off. Then reply in the same chat box with a follow-up request that tightens it up. Common follow-ups: make it shorter, keep only the numbers, write it as one paragraph, or drop the jargon.

Copilot remembers the conversation in the same panel, so each new message refines the previous draft instead of starting over. This is where you save yourself a real round of editing.

💬 Example: *"Shorter. Cut it to about 350 words, keep all the percentages and dollar figures, and remove any section about background context. Use short bullet points under three headings: Wins, Risks, Next Steps."*

You'll know it worked when a new, shorter version replaces the previous one in the panel and you can see the changes are focused on what you asked for (length, format, or specific content).

Step 4 — Insert the summary into a new document

Once the draft in the panel looks right, you have two choices: insert it straight into the current document, or send it to a new file. For a clean one-pager you'll probably want a **new document** so the original report stays untouched.

Look just below the draft in the Copilot panel for a button that says something like **Insert**, **Add to document**, or **Copy**. If you see an option that says **"Create a new document"** or **"Open in new doc"**, use that — it gives you a blank page with your summary already laid out. If you only see **Insert**, clicking it will paste the summary at your cursor's location in the current document instead, which you can then copy into a new file later.

💬 Example: click **"Create a new document"** (or, if you don't see that exact option, click **Insert**, then press `Ctrl+C` and paste into a fresh blank document).

You'll know it worked when a new Word file opens containing the summary, formatted with the headings and bullet points you asked for, and your original long report is still untouched in its own tab.

Step 5 — Polish the summary by hand (the part Copilot can't do)

This step is short but important. Read the new one-pager from top to bottom, slowly, as if you were your boss. Cross-check every number, name, and date against the original report on the left. Copilot is good, but it's not perfect — a single wrong percentage is the kind of thing that erodes trust fast.

Tighten anything that sounds generic, fix any sentence that doesn't sound like you, and add a one-line intro or closing if the summary feels abrupt. Usually this takes 2–3 minutes and is what turns a "decent AI draft" into a "boss-ready" one.

💬 Example: if Copilot wrote *"Revenue grew significantly,"* you change it to *"Revenue grew 18% to $4.2M, ahead of the 12% target."*

You'll know it worked when the one-pager reads like something you wrote on a calm Tuesday morning, every number checks out, and the whole thing fits comfortably on a single page.

Step 6 — Save and share the one-pager

When you're happy with it, save the new file with a clear name so you (and your boss) can find it later. Then share it however your team normally shares documents — email, a chat link, or a shared drive. If you started from someone else's report, you now have **your own separate one-pager**, so you can share just the summary without giving away the full document.

💬 Example: click **File** → **Save As**, name the file `Q3-Project-Update-OnePager.docx`, and email it to your boss with the subject line *"Q3 update — 2-minute read."*

You'll know it worked when the file is saved, the original long report is still untouched, and the one-pager is ready to send or present.

Common mistakes

- **Asking for a "summary" with no other details.** If you just type "summarize this," you'll get a generic, sometimes rambling result. Always add the **length** you want (one page, 300 words), the **audience** (my boss, a client, a non-technical reader), and any **must-keep items** (numbers, dates, names).
- **Trusting the first draft without checking.** Copilot can drop, round, or slightly misstate numbers. Always spend two minutes comparing the one-pager against the original report before you send it.
- **Inserting the summary over the original report.** If you use **Insert** instead of **Create a new document**, the summary lands inside your long file. That's fixable (press `Ctrl+Z` to undo), but it's a common beginner slip. When in doubt, copy the summary, open a blank document, and paste it there.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** any time you have a long document (a school paper, a long article, a personal project plan) you can ask Copilot to do the same thing — pull out the key points so you can read the short version first, then dive into the long version only if you need to.
- **For your business or work:** this is one of the fastest ways to produce the executive summary that almost every long report needs. A 12-page status update becomes a one-pager in roughly five minutes of effort, and the rest of the time is polish, not writing.
- **If you're just getting started:** the easiest first move is to pick a report you already have open, run Step 1 and Step 2 exactly as written, and see what comes back. Even a rough first draft tells you a lot about how Copilot handles your kind of writing.

Try it now

Open any document you have on your screen right now — even a two-page one — click the **Copilot** button in Word, and type: *"Summarize this in five bullet points for a manager who has*

one minute to read it." That single 30-second experiment will teach you more about how Copilot works than any article.

Ask Plain-English Questions About a Long PDF Using Hugging Face's Free Document Q&A

6 steps · Read online

> **In short:** Hugging Face has a free chat tool that reads any PDF you upload and answers plain-English questions about it. You'll need a free account to upload files. It works best on text-based PDFs — scanned image files give poor results.

By the end of this guide, you'll be able to drop a long PDF into Hugging Face's chat and get a direct answer in seconds — even if the document is 50, 80, or 100 pages long. This is for anyone who's ever skimmed a lease, a warranty, a workplace policy, or a research report hunting for one specific fact.

Before you start

- A computer, phone, or tablet with a modern browser (Chrome, Firefox, Safari, or Edge — updated within the last year)
- A PDF file already saved on your device — a contract, manual, report, or any text-heavy document
- About 5–10 minutes the first time (later attempts take about 1 minute)
- A free Hugging Face account (you can create one with just an email during the process — no payment needed)
- Honest note: scanned PDFs that are basically images of pages don't work well. If your PDF was created by scanning paper, the tool will struggle. PDFs that were exported from Word, Google Docs, or a website work best.

Step 1 — Open the Hugging Face chat tool in your browser

Open a new browser tab and type `hf.co/chat` into the address bar. This takes you to Hugging Chat — Hugging Face's free chat assistant. The two names refer to the same product: **Hugging Chat** is the friendly name for the chat experience, and **Hugging Face** is the company behind it. When the page finishes loading, you'll see a clean chat window with a message box at the bottom, similar to many messaging apps you've used before.

If `hf.co/chat` doesn't load for any reason, try the longer address `huggingface.co/chat` instead — both lead to the same place. If your browser shows a security warning, double-check the spelling; a typo could land you on the wrong site.

You'll know it worked when you see a chat interface with a text box near the bottom that says something like "Ask anything" or "Type a message."

Step 2 — Sign in or create a free account

Look near the top-right of the page for a **Sign in** or **Log in** button. Click it. On the page that appears, you can either enter the email and password of an existing Hugging Face account, or click **Sign up** to create a new one. Sign-up only needs an email and a password — no payment, no card, no phone number.

After you finish signing in, the page refreshes and the top-right corner now shows your profile name or avatar instead of a "Sign in" button. If the page doesn't refresh automatically, just click back to the chat tab and reload it.

You'll know it worked when you land back on the chat page and your username appears at the top of the screen.

💬 Example: if you don't have an account yet, click **Sign up**, enter your email, choose a password, and confirm the verification email Hugging Face sends you.

Step 3 — Upload your PDF

Look near the message box for an **attachment icon** 📎, a **paperclip**, a + plus-sign, or a button that says something like "Attach," "Upload," or "Add files." The location of this control may vary slightly as the product updates. Click it, and a file picker window opens on your device.

Navigate to the PDF on your computer — usually in your **Downloads** folder or **Documents** folder — select it, and click **Open** or **Upload**. The chat area will show the file name, often with a small spinning indicator while it processes. This can take anywhere from a few seconds to a minute, depending on the PDF's length and Hugging Face's current load.

If you can't find an upload button at first glance, look inside a **plus (+) menu** or a **paperclip** tucked into the text box, or check the toolbar above the chat area — the exact location varies as the interface evolves.

You'll know it worked when the file name appears in the chat with a checkmark or "ready" label, and the text box becomes active again.

💬 Example: pick a file like `apartment-lease-2024.pdf` from your Documents folder.

Step 4 — Ask your question in plain English

Click into the text box at the bottom of the chat and type your question the way you'd ask a friend. Don't worry about special keywords or commands — plain, everyday English works best. Press **Enter** or click the **send** arrow ➤ to submit your question.

The AI reads your PDF and replies with an answer, usually within 10–30 seconds. The reply appears in a chat bubble above your message, with the answer written out in full sentences. If the first answer is vague or off-target, ask a follow-up like "Can you quote the exact sentence?" or "Which page is that on?" — the tool can usually give you the source line. If it gives a confident answer that doesn't quite match what's in your PDF, that's a sign to double-check the original document rather than trusting the reply fully.

You'll know it worked when you see a written answer in the chat that directly addresses your question — and ideally mentions something specific from your PDF, like a date, a clause number, or a person's name.

💬 Example: type one of these after your PDF uploads: *What's the cancellation policy? How many days of vacation do part-time employees get? What's the warranty period for the battery?*

Step 5 — Ask follow-up questions to dig deeper

The chat remembers your PDF for the rest of the conversation, so you can ask as many questions as you want without re-uploading. Try asking the same question in a different way, or push for more detail with prompts like "summarize section 3 in three bullet points" or "are there any exceptions to this rule?" Each new answer appears as a fresh chat bubble, building on what came before.

If the AI says it doesn't know something, take that answer seriously — it means the information really isn't in the document, and the tool is being honest rather than guessing.

You'll know it worked when you can hold a back-and-forth conversation about the document, with each new answer building on the previous one.

💬 Example: after asking about the cancellation policy, follow up with *What happens if I cancel in the first 30 days?*

Step 6 — Save or copy the answers you need

When you find an answer you want to keep, highlight the AI's reply with your mouse, right-click, and choose **Copy**. Then paste it into a note, an email, or wherever you need it. On a phone, long-press the reply text and tap **Copy**.

If you want to start fresh with a different PDF, look for a **New chat** button — often at the top-left, sometimes shown as a pencil 🖍️ icon or a "+" sign. Clicking it clears the current document from memory so the next file doesn't get mixed up with the previous one.

You'll know it worked when the chat window empties and the message box is ready for a new upload.

Common mistakes

- **Uploading a scanned PDF and expecting great results.** If your PDF was made by photographing paper pages, the tool can't read the text well. The fix: if you have the original Word or Google Docs file, export it as a PDF from there instead. Otherwise, use a dedicated OCR tool (think of OCR, or "optical character recognition," as software that turns the image of text back into real text the computer can read) — Adobe Acrobat's built-in OCR or a free online option both work.
- **Asking questions before the upload finishes.** If you type your question while the file is still spinning, the AI won't have the document yet and will either refuse or answer from general knowledge. The fix: wait for the file name to show a "ready" or checkmark before typing.
- **Trusting answers that sound confident but feel wrong.** Like all AI, this one can sometimes make up details that sound plausible but aren't actually in the document — a problem called hallucination (meaning the AI confidently states something that isn't true). The fix: always ask the AI to quote the exact line or name the page number. If it can't, treat the answer as unverified.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** That 60-page appliance manual you tossed in a drawer and never opened again? Upload it once and ask "How do I clean the filter?" whenever you need to. The same trick works for warranties, lease agreements, school handbooks, and insurance policies — anywhere you've got a long PDF and a specific question.
- **For your business or work:** Got a long compliance document, a vendor contract, or a research report? Use this tool to pull out the three or four clauses that actually matter to you, instead of spending an hour highlighting. It's also handy for comparing two documents — open one in a chat, ask your questions, then start a new chat for the second one and compare the answers side by side.
- **If you're just getting started:** The very first PDF to try is something low-stakes but long — maybe a public report, a user manual, or a sample contract you find online. Practice asking "What's the main topic?" first, then move to "What does it say about X?" Once you've done that once, every document after that gets easier.

Try it now

Open `hf.co/chat` in your browser right now and pick any PDF sitting on your computer — an old manual, a contract, a report from work. Upload it and ask: *"What's the most important*

thing I should know from this document?" That single question, asked in about 30 seconds, will show you exactly how much time this tool can save you the next time a long PDF lands in your inbox.

Get Plain-English Explanations of Any Contract With Claude

6 steps · Read online

> **In short:** You can paste a contract — rental agreement, terms of service, employment offer — into Claude and ask for a plain-language summary. It's free to try, takes about 10 minutes the first time, and Claude can't replace a lawyer, but it can save you an hour of squinting at dense legal text.

Got a 30-page PDF that nobody on Earth would actually read end-to-end? You can hand the text to Claude and ask, in your own words, "what does this actually say?" This guide walks through the whole flow: getting the contract text onto your screen, dropping it into Claude, and asking the right questions. No legal background needed.

Before you start

- **A Claude account**, free or paid — sign up at `claude.ai`. The free plan covers most personal use. Paid plans have a larger context window, which helps with very long contracts.
- **The contract itself**, ideally a digital copy (PDF, email attachment, or webpage). Photos of paper pages are much harder for Claude to work with because the text has to be read off the image.
- **A way to extract the text** if it's a PDF. Most computers let you select and copy text from a PDF directly. If yours doesn't, a free online "PDF to text" tool works.
- **Rough total time**: 10–15 minutes the first time, around 5 minutes once you've done it once.

> ⚠️ **What Claude can't do.** Claude is an AI assistant, not a lawyer. It can summarize and explain, but it cannot give you legal advice, predict how a court would rule, or know which laws apply in your specific situation. For anything with real consequences — signing a lease, accepting a job offer, disputing a charge — run the summary past a human professional.

Step 1 — Get the text out of the document

Open the contract as a PDF or webpage and **copy the text** the way you would from any other file: click at the start, hold **Shift** and click at the end, then press **Ctrl+C** (Windows/Linux) or **Cmd+C** (macOS). On a phone, long-press in the text and choose **Select All**, then **Copy**. The text is now stored on your clipboard, ready to paste anywhere. You'll know it worked when your clipboard holds a wall of text you can paste into a notes app or chat box to test. **If it looks different:** some PDFs lock their text behind scanned images. If **Select All** only grabs a few words, try opening the PDF in Adobe Acrobat Reader, Google Drive, or your browser — they

sometimes unlock the text layer. If that fails, use a free "PDF to text" tool online, or simply type the section headings you can see into Claude and ask it to explain what those usually mean. Don't paste a screenshot: Claude works with text, not images.

Step 2 — Open Claude and start a fresh chat

Go to `claude.ai` in your browser, sign in, and click **New chat** in the sidebar (top-left). A blank conversation box appears at the bottom of the screen — that's where your message will go. You'll know it worked when you see an empty message box with a **Send** arrow and a small + or paperclip-shaped attach icon nearby. **If it looks different:** some accounts land directly in a recent conversation. Just look for a **+ New chat** or **Start new conversation** button at the top of the left sidebar. On the mobile app, look for a + or pencil icon in a corner to start fresh.

Step 3 — Paste the contract and ask your first question

Click inside the message box and press **Ctrl+V** (Windows/Linux) or **Cmd+V** (macOS) to paste the long block of contract text *into the same message* as your question. Then add a clear request on a new line and hit **Send**. 💬 Example: "Here's the rental agreement I was sent. In plain language, what am I actually agreeing to? Highlight anything unusual or that renters often overlook." You'll know it worked when Claude replies with a structured summary — usually with headings like *Key terms*, *Your obligations*, *What to watch out for* — instead of just echoing the text back at you. **If it looks different:** if Claude's reply is short or feels generic, it may have ignored your question. Just send a second message asking for a clearer summary. If the contract is *very* long, you might see a "this is too long in one go" notice — move to **Step 4** for that workaround. Paid plans allow you to attach the PDF directly using a paperclip-style button next to the message box, which can skip the copy-paste step for shorter documents.

Step 4 — Break the document into chunks if you got the "too long" notice

Claude can read a lot at once, but huge contracts can overflow the limit. **Open a notes app** and split the contract text into rough sections by hand: "Section 1 — Parties," "Section 2 — Term and Rent," "Section 3 — Deposits," and so on. Then send each chunk in its own message, with one short question per chunk. 💬 Example: "[Paste section 1 here] In one paragraph, summarize what this section says and flag anything I should negotiate." You'll know it worked when each section gets its own focused answer with a small "what to watch out for" line. At the end, ask: "Based on everything I've pasted, give me a 5-bullet summary of the whole contract and the three most important things to push back on." **If it looks different:** if you don't want to split the file manually, paid plans offer a much bigger context window — think of this as Claude's short-term memory: how much text it can keep in mind during one chat — and often fit a long

contract without splitting. You can also try attaching the PDF directly with the paperclip button mentioned in Step 3, which is another way to handle longer documents.

Step 5 — Ask targeted follow-up questions

Now that Claude has the document in its **context** (the chat's working memory: everything you've sent and received so far in this conversation), you can ask it pointed questions without re-pasting anything. This is where the real time-saving happens — most contracts only have four or five questions that actually matter to you. Example: "Can I get my security deposit back if I move out 30 days early?" or "If they change the price mid-contract, am I locked in?" or "What's the worst part of this agreement for me as the renter?" You'll know it worked when Claude pulls a specific clause out of the text — usually with the section or clause number — and translates it into everyday language. **If it looks different:** if Claude's answer feels vague, ask it to "quote the actual sentence from the contract" first, then re-explain it. That trick forces it to ground its answer in the real text instead of guessing.

Step 6 — Save the summary somewhere you'll find it

Once you have a summary you trust, click the small **copy** icon at the corner of Claude's reply, or highlight the text and copy it the usual way. Paste it into an email to yourself, a note in your phone, or a shared doc with anyone who also needs to know. Example: "Save these notes and remind me to ask the landlord about the early-termination fee before I sign." You'll know it worked when you have a plain-English record of the contract's main points, separate from the original legal document, that you can re-read in under five minutes. **If it looks different:** Claude's chat history stays in your sidebar by default and you can reopen it from any device you're signed into. If you want a downloadable file, ask Claude: "Turn this summary into a Markdown checklist I can save" — it'll output one in chat that you can copy into a notes file.

Common mistakes

- **Pasting a photo or screenshot of the contract.** Claude reads text, not images, unless you attach the file directly with the paperclip button in Step 3. Type or copy the actual text first whenever you can.
- **Asking one giant question like "explain this contract."** You'll get a wishy-washy answer. Ask for specific things: the cancellation terms, the fees, who's responsible for repairs, the auto-renewal clause.
- **Trusting the summary without checking.** Claude sometimes misreads a number or a date. If something matters to you, ask Claude to quote the original sentence so you can compare. For anything serious — money, a job, a home — confirm with a real lawyer or a free legal-aid clinic.

- **Sharing private contracts in public chats or forums.** Treat contract text like you would any sensitive document: only paste it into a private Claude chat tied to your own account.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** Before you click "I agree" on a new app's terms of service, the cleaning service's policy, or your kid's summer-camp registration, drop the text into Claude and ask "what's the catch?" You'll catch auto-renewal clauses and data-sharing sections that most people miss.
- **For your business or work:** When a client or vendor emails a 20-page service agreement, you can have a plain-English brief ready in minutes instead of bookmarking it for "later." Bring the brief — and your annotated questions — to whoever signs things for your business.
- **If you're just getting started:** Don't wait for a "big" contract to try this. A short terms-of-service page works fine to learn how to ask the right questions.

Try it now

Pick one document in your email right now — even a four-paragraph cancellation policy from a gym or a streaming service you forgot to cancel. Paste it into a new Claude chat and ask: *"In plain language, what does this actually let them do? What's the catch?"* You'll have your answer in under a minute, and you'll know exactly how to repeat this the next time something bigger shows up.

How to Turn Your Notes into a Polished Report with AI in Minutes

6 steps · Read online

Are your thoughts scattered across sticky notes, meeting minutes, or bullet points? Do you wish you could magically transform them into a well-structured, professional report without hours of effort? This guide will show you how to use an AI helper to do just that, giving you a strong first draft in a fraction of the time. You'll learn how to get from raw information to a coherent report, ready for your final touches. While the AI can draft the report, it can't add your personal insights or send it for you.

Before you start

- **An AI account:** You'll need access to an AI tool like ChatGPT, Gemini, or Claude. Most offer free versions that are perfect for this task, though some may have daily limits on how much you can use them.
- **Your notes:** Gather all the information you want to include in your report. It's perfectly fine if they're a bit rough – the AI will help organize them!
- **An internet-connected device:** You can follow this guide on a computer, tablet, or smartphone.
- **Rough total time:** Expect to spend about 5-10 minutes actively following these steps, plus any time you need to gather your initial notes.

Step 1 — Organize your raw notes

First, open a simple text editor or notes app on your device, like Notepad, Apple Notes, or Google Docs. You'll see a blank page, ready for your ideas. Now, transfer all your relevant points, facts, and ideas into this single document. Don't worry about perfect sentences or paragraphs just yet; the goal is to get everything into one place in a clear, bullet-point style. If you already have your notes digitally, you can skip copying them and just open the existing document.

💬 Example:

```
Project X Meeting - Oct 6
Attendees: Sarah, Ben, Chloe
Discussed:
- Phase 1 progress (on track, small delay on marketing assets)
- Budget review (under budget by 5%, good!)
- Client feedback (positive on initial design, want more color options)
Decisions:
```

```
- Green light for Phase 2 launch planning
- Allocate extra resources to marketing assets
- Research additional color palettes for client
Action Items:
- Sarah: Send updated timeline to client by Friday
- Ben: Prepare Phase 2 budget draft for next week
- Chloe: Compile color options for review
```

You'll know it worked when you have all your key points, discussions, and actions written down in a single document, even if they're messy.

Step 2 — Choose your AI helper

You have several excellent choices for an AI assistant that can help with writing. These are often called **Large Language Models (LLMs)**, which you can think of as incredibly knowledgeable digital assistants that can understand and generate human-like text, much like a super-smart assistant who can read and write very quickly. Open your chosen AI tool (e.g., ChatGPT, Gemini, or Claude) in your web browser or app. You'll see a main chat screen with a place to type your message. If you're not sure where to start, look for an option to start a new chat.

You'll know it worked when you see a blank message box, ready for you to type your instructions into your chosen AI.

Step 3 — Craft your AI instruction (the 'prompt')

This is where you tell the AI exactly what you want. The instruction you give the AI is called a **prompt**. Think of a prompt as your clear, detailed instructions to a very intelligent assistant. The more specific you are, the better the result. You can draft this in a separate document or directly in the AI's chat box. Focus on clearly outlining your goal, the intended audience for the report, the desired tone (e.g., professional, informal), and any key sections you want to include. Then, prepare to paste your organized notes directly after your instructions.

💬 Example:

```
Please turn the following raw meeting notes into a concise, professional report for my team. The report should include an executive summary, key discussion points, decisions made, and a clear list of action items with owners and deadlines.

[PASTE YOUR NOTES FROM STEP 1 HERE]
```

You'll know it worked when you have a complete instruction in mind, covering your goal, audience, tone, and desired sections, with a placeholder for your notes.

Step 4 — Copy, paste, and send

With your full instruction (including your notes) ready, it's time to send it to your AI helper. First, highlight all the text you prepared in Step 3, including your actual notes, and copy it to your clipboard (usually Ctrl+C on a computer, or a long press and the copy option on a phone). Then, click in the message box of your AI chat window and paste your entire instruction (Ctrl+V, or a long press and the paste option). You'll see all your text appear in the message box. Finally, press Enter on your keyboard or use the send button next to the message box (it looks different from tool to tool).

You'll know it worked when the AI starts typing its response, usually after a brief pause of a few seconds.

Step 5 — Review and refine

The AI will quickly generate a first draft of your report right there in the chat window. It's crucial to remember that this is just a starting point and still needs your human review. Read through the generated report carefully, checking for accuracy (does it correctly reflect everything in your notes?), clarity (is it easy to read and understand?), and completeness (were any points from your notes missed?). Be aware that AI can sometimes "hallucinate," meaning it might confidently make up facts or details not present in your original notes, especially if your input was vague. If the report isn't quite right, simply type a follow-up instruction to the AI in the same chat window.

💬 Example: "Can you make the executive summary shorter and focus only on the decisions?" or "Please add a section about budget implications using the figures I provided." You'll know it worked when you either have a list of specific changes you want the AI to make, or you're satisfied enough with the current draft to move on.

Step 6 — Make it your own

Once the AI has given you a solid draft, it's time to bring your human touch to the final product. Select all the text from the AI's generated report in the chat window (many tools also offer a way to copy a response in one step). Then, open your preferred word processor, like Microsoft Word, Google Docs, or Apple Pages, and paste the text into a new document. You'll see the AI's draft appear. This is your chance to add any personal insights, specific context the AI couldn't know, apply your company's branding, refine the formatting (headings, bullet points), and ensure the tone and style perfectly match your needs.

You'll know it worked when the AI's report is sitting in your chosen word processor, ready for your final personal touches and formatting to become a truly finished document.

Common mistakes

- **Vague prompts lead to vague results:** If you don't tell the AI exactly what you want, it might give you a generic or unhelpful response.
    - **The fix:** Be specific about your audience, desired tone, and required sections in your initial prompt. Think of it like giving instructions to a new assistant – the more detail, the better.
- **Expecting perfection on the first try:** AI is a powerful tool, but it's not foolproof. Its output is a draft and can sometimes "hallucinate" (make up) information.
    - **The fix:** Always review the AI's output carefully for accuracy, clarity, and tone. Don't be afraid to ask for revisions directly within the chat ("Please make X change" or "Can you rephrase Y?").
- **Overloading the AI with disorganized information:** While **LLMs (large language models)** have a good "memory" for a conversation, called the **context window**, pasting extremely long, chaotic notes all at once can sometimes confuse it.
    - **The fix:** Take a moment to roughly organize your notes into key headings or bullet points (as in Step 1) before giving them to the AI. This structure helps the AI understand your input better.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** Imagine quickly turning jotted ideas for a holiday plan, a family event, or even a detailed shopping list into a well-organized summary to share with loved ones. It saves you time and ensures everyone is on the same page.
- **For your business or work:** This technique can dramatically cut down the time you spend on administrative tasks like writing meeting minutes, project updates, research summaries, or preparing reports for stakeholders, allowing you to focus on more strategic, high-value work.
- **If you're just getting started:** Begin with a simple set of notes, like your grocery list or a few points from a quick phone call. Ask the AI to turn them into a clear summary. You'll quickly see how powerful and helpful this process can be!

Try it now

Grab a few bullet points from your last meeting, or a list of ideas for an upcoming project you're thinking about. Go to your favorite AI tool (ChatGPT, Gemini, or Claude), paste your notes, and use this simple prompt: "Turn these notes into a concise summary for me." See what it creates in seconds, and how quickly you can get a structured overview from your raw thoughts!

How to Triage and Clean Up an Overwhelming Inbox with Copilot

6 steps · Read online

> **In short:** Copilot can turn a 500-message inbox into five emails that actually need your attention today, but you need a Microsoft 365 plan with Copilot included, and Copilot drafts your replies rather than sending them on your behalf.

If your inbox feels like a mountain and you're scared to open Outlook, this guide is for you. In about 20 minutes, you'll turn a clogged inbox into a short list of real priorities — and you won't need to read every single message to do it. This works best for people who handle a mix of work email and personal mail in Microsoft 365.

Before you start

- A **Microsoft 365 account** with a **Copilot license**. Copilot is included with some Microsoft 365 business and enterprise plans. For personal use, Microsoft retired the separate Copilot Pro add-on and folded it into **Microsoft 365 Premium** — check the current price on Microsoft's own pricing page before you subscribe, because these plans change. Free personal Outlook accounts don't include Copilot features.
- The **new Outlook** — on the web at outlook.com (or your work sign-in page), the **new Outlook for Windows** (the toggle near the top-right says "Try the new Outlook"), Outlook for Mac, or the Outlook mobile app. The classic Outlook for Windows doesn't have the full Copilot experience.
- **About 20–30 minutes** for the first clean-up. After that, around **five minutes a day** keeps it tidy.

Step 1 — Open Outlook and find the Copilot button

Open Outlook on whichever device you prefer. If you're on the web, sign in at outlook.com or your work's Microsoft 365 sign-in page. If you're on a computer, open the **new Outlook for Windows** or **Outlook for Mac**. The new Outlook has a cleaner ribbon at the top and a more obvious Copilot button.

Look for a button labeled **Copilot** with a small four-pane colorful icon, usually near the top-right of the screen. Clicking it opens a chat-style panel on the right-hand side. On mobile, the Copilot entry point is sometimes tucked inside an **Apps** or **Tools** menu — tap your profile icon to find it.

If you can't see the Copilot button at all, two things are usually true: you're on the classic Outlook for Windows (toggle to "Try the new Outlook" at the top-right), or your account doesn't have a Copilot license yet (check with your IT team or your Microsoft 365 subscription page).

You'll know it worked when you can click the Copilot button and a panel slides open on the right side of the screen, ready for you to type.

Step 2 — Ask Copilot to summarize your unread emails

Now you're in the Copilot panel. At the bottom is a text box where you type a request. Press **Enter** or click the send arrow.

Copilot scans your unread mail and returns a short summary grouped by sender or topic — for example, "3 from your manager, 2 from a client, 14 newsletters". You'll see this as a few bulleted points inside the Copilot panel, not as new emails in your inbox. The summary updates each time you ask, so you can re-run it after cleaning up.

If the text box is labeled differently on your version — "Message Copilot" or behind a chat icon — that's fine, the behavior is the same. On mobile, the panel usually takes the full screen. If nothing appears after 15 seconds, refresh and try once more — Copilot occasionally needs a moment to load on first use.

- Example: *"Summarize my unread emails from today and group them by sender."*

You'll know it worked when a short, structured list appears in the Copilot panel, with names, topics and rough counts.

Step 3 — Spot the emails that actually need a reply

This is the heart of the triage. Stay in the Copilot panel and ask a follow-up question that filters the summary down to what really matters. Copilot ranks using signals like who sent it, urgency words in the subject line, and time-sensitive phrases such as "by Friday" or "ASAP".

You should now see a much shorter list — usually three to five emails Copilot considers the most important. Each one comes with a short reason next to it, like "from your manager, mentions a deadline" or "client waiting on a quote". This is the list you'll actually act on today.

If the list is too long, be more specific. If it's too short, ask for more. Vague requests give vague results — the more you tell Copilot about what "important" means to you, the better the ranking.

- Example: *"From my unread emails, which 5 are most urgent today, and why?"*

You'll know it worked when you can glance at the Copilot panel and immediately name the three to five emails that deserve your real attention.

Step 4 — Draft replies in your own tone

Open the first email that needs a reply. Look inside the message for a Copilot button — usually labeled **Draft a reply** or shown as a small Copilot icon near the reply arrow. Click it. A reply window opens with Copilot's suggested text already filled in.

Read the draft carefully. Copilot usually matches the tone of the original email and pulls in useful context from the thread, but it can still sound stiff or miss a personal detail. Edit the draft to add anything specific, soften the tone, or remove anything you'd rather not say.

If the "Draft a reply" button isn't there, look for it inside the ··· menu near the reply arrow, or right-click the email. On older Outlook versions this feature may not exist — work from the Copilot summary and write the reply yourself.

Example: click **Draft a reply**, then add to Copilot's suggestion: *"Make it warmer and add: I'll send the report by 5pm today."*

You'll know it worked when the reply box contains a complete draft that mostly says what you want, with your edits on top. **Important:** Copilot never sends anything without you pressing Send.

Step 5 — Sweep the noise: archive, delete, unsubscribe

Now for the easy wins. Ask Copilot to list the newsletters, automated notifications and marketing emails sitting in your inbox. It pulls them out into a single view, so you can see the noise without scrolling through real mail.

Go through the list. For each item, either **archive** it (moves it out of the inbox but keeps it searchable), **delete** it, or, if it's a recurring sender you don't want, look for the **unsubscribe** link Copilot usually highlights. Most legitimate newsletters include a one-click unsubscribe at the bottom of the email.

If unsubscribe links aren't showing, your reading pane may be hiding them — open one email in its own window and look at the very bottom. Copilot sometimes surfaces the unsubscribe link directly inside its panel so you don't have to open each one.

Example: *"List all the newsletters and automated emails in my inbox from the last 7 days."*

You'll know it worked when your inbox looks visibly smaller and the only messages left are the ones you genuinely need to act on.

Step 6 — Set up an ongoing triage habit

Make this a five-minute daily habit. Tomorrow morning, before opening any individual email, open Copilot and ask for a fresh summary. Spend two minutes reading the priority list, then

reply, archive or delete each item before moving on. The big weekly panic becomes a small daily check-in.

If your work generates a flood of mail, ask Copilot to build a simple Outlook rule — for example, moving every email from your manager into a folder called **Priority** and flagging it. Copilot can create these without any coding.

If the rule option isn't available on your version, set up Outlook rules manually: **Settings** → **Mail** → **Rules**. Copilot will suggest what to add, and you confirm and save each one.

💬 Example: *"Create a rule that moves every email from my manager into a folder called 'Manager' and marks it as important."*

You'll know it worked when tomorrow's inbox takes you five minutes, not an hour.

Common mistakes

- **Letting Copilot send replies on its own.** Copilot drafts — it never sends unless you press Send yourself. Always read the draft before clicking.
- **Trusting the priority list blindly.** Copilot ranks using sender, keywords and timing, but it can miss context. An email from your child's school may look low-priority to an algorithm and still be the most important one today.
- **Asking vague questions.** "Help with my email" gets a vague answer. Specific prompts like "which 5 emails need a reply today" give focused, useful results.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** A weekly 30-minute inbox reset becomes a daily five-minute habit. Less stress on Sunday night, fewer missed messages from people who matter.
- **For your business or work:** You stop reacting to email and start choosing what to respond to. The five important emails get your full attention instead of getting buried under 500 others.
- **If you're just getting started:** Try Step 2 on its own first — just open Copilot and ask for a summary. Once you see it work, the rest of the steps feel natural.

Try it now

Open Outlook, find the Copilot button, and type: *"Summarize my unread emails from today and tell me which ones need a reply."* Five minutes, one prompt, and you'll see your inbox shrink in front of you.

Polish Your Resume Bullet Points with Le Chat in 10 Minutes

6 steps · Read online

> **In short:** Paste a plain description of what you did at work into Le Chat, ask it to rewrite that as a resume bullet, and you'll get back a sharper, more impressive line in about ten minutes — even if writing isn't your strongest skill. Note: Mistral now calls this assistant **Vibe** (formerly Le Chat) — you may see either name in the app and on mistral.ai.

Most people describe their work the way they talk in real life: short, plain, missing the impressive parts. Recruiters scan your resume in seconds, though, and plain sentences get skipped. Le Chat — Mistral's AI assistant — can take your rough notes and turn them into the kind of bullet point a hiring manager actually pauses on. You stay in charge of the truth; Le Chat just helps with the wording.

Before you start

- A free Le Chat account (sign up with an email at Mistral's chat page).
- A short, rough description of one thing you did at a job — even a single messy sentence is fine.
- A web browser on a phone, tablet, or computer.
- About ten minutes, and one promise to yourself: only put **real** numbers on your resume. Le Chat can suggest placeholders, but the final figures must come from your actual experience.

Step 1 — Open Le Chat and start a fresh chat

Go to Le Chat in your browser and sign in if you aren't already. Once the page loads, look for a button labeled something like **New chat** or **Start new conversation** — usually at the top of the chat list on the left side of the screen, or shown as a plus icon. Tap or click it. A blank conversation opens, with an empty message box near the bottom often labeled something like **Message Le Chat** or **Ask anything**, though yours may use different words.

If you can't find the new chat button, look for a **pencil icon**, a +, or a small **chat bubble with a plus sign** — those are the most common shapes. On a phone, the option is often tucked inside a **menu icon** (three lines or three dots) at the top-left.

You'll know it worked when you see a clean, empty chat screen with a blinking cursor in the message box and no previous messages in the list.

Step 2 — Paste your rough description into the chat box

Click inside the message box at the bottom of the screen and type, or paste, one short sentence describing what you actually did at work. Don't worry about making it sound impressive yet — plain language is exactly what you want. You can write it the way you'd explain your job to a friend over coffee.

The text appears in the box as you type. If you paste from a notes app, you may see a short preview of how many characters you've added. Once you're happy with the description, you're ready for the next step — but don't hit send just yet.

Example: *"I helped customers with their bills and account questions at the front desk of a phone store for about two years."*

You'll know it worked when your sentence sits in the message box, ready to send, and the cursor is still blinking at the end.

Step 3 — Ask Le Chat to rewrite it as a resume bullet

Now add a short instruction below your description telling Le Chat exactly what you want, then hit **Enter** or the **send** icon — usually a small paper airplane or upward arrow on the right edge of the text box. Le Chat reads your description plus your instruction and replies with one or more polished bullet points.

If your app has separate buttons for **send** versus **new line**, look for the send icon — it's almost always on the right side of the message box. On a phone, send often lives at the far right of the keyboard area rather than as a separate button.

Example: full message to send — *"I helped customers with their bills and account questions at the front desk of a phone store for about two years. Please rewrite this as 3 strong resume bullet points a recruiter would notice. Start each one with a strong action verb."*

You'll know it worked when Le Chat's reply appears below your message with three (or more) bullet lines, each starting with a verb like *Resolved*, *Assisted*, *Handled*, or *Supported*.

Step 4 — Ask for a version with measurable impact

Strong resume bullets almost always include a number — how many, how much, how often. Send a short follow-up message asking Le Chat to add measurable impact, but with one clear honesty rule: tell it to use placeholders like **[X%]** or **[# of customers]** for anything you haven't actually measured. That way you don't accidentally paste in fake results that sound true.

Le Chat will write a new version of the bullets with placeholder numbers in square brackets. If the reply doesn't include placeholders, send a quick follow-up: *"Please show numbers in brackets like [X%] so I can fill in real numbers from my own records."*

💬 Example: *"Now give me a stronger version with measurable impact. Put any numbers you don't know in brackets like [X%] or [# of customers] — I will fill in the real numbers myself."*

You'll know it worked when the new reply contains bullet points that include either real numbers or clear placeholders in brackets, never bare made-up figures you could mistake for real ones.

Step 5 — Pick your favorite and ask for one more variation

Read Le Chat's reply and pick the bullet that sounds closest to your real experience. Copy that one. Then send a short follow-up asking Le Chat to tighten the wording — make it shorter, swap a weak verb for a stronger one, or combine two ideas into one line.

If two bullets both sound good, ask Le Chat to merge them. If none of them sound like you, ask for a version with a different tone (for example, "more formal" or "more friendly"). Le Chat will respond with a fresh draft you can compare against the earlier one.

💬 Example: *"I like bullet #2 the best. Please make it slightly shorter and swap 'helped' for a stronger verb. Keep it to one line under 25 words."*

You'll know it worked when you can clearly see one bullet point that sounds like *you* on a strong day, fits on one line, and would make a recruiter pause for half a second longer than the rest of your CV.

Step 6 — Save the final line and repeat with your next bullet

Copy your finished bullet into your resume document. Add a tiny note to yourself, like an asterisk * next to it, so you remember this one came from a Le Chat draft and still wants a quick personal read-through. Then start the cycle again with the next plain sentence from your work history.

If you're not happy with the final line, send one more message asking Le Chat to **combine** your favorite two drafts into one bullet. The trick is to keep iterating in small steps rather than asking for a "perfect" version in one go — small requests give cleaner results.

💬 Example (next round): *"Now do the same for this bullet: 'answered phones and took messages for a real estate office'. Rewrite as one strong resume line with placeholders for any numbers."*

You'll know it worked when you have one polished bullet sitting in your resume, you've starred it for review, and you've already sent a fresh prompt to Le Chat for the next one — momentum is what makes this faster than staring at a blank page.

Common mistakes

- **Letting Le Chat invent real numbers.** It may try to fill in plausible figures (like "20% increase") that sound true but aren't. Always use the bracket-placeholder trick from Step 4, then add only numbers you can prove.
- **Writing bullets that sound nothing like you.** If the final line uses five-dollar words or industry jargon you never use at work, ask Le Chat to **rewrite in your own everyday voice** — recruiters can spot fake-sounding CVs in seconds.
- **Doing all your bullets in one giant prompt.** Long prompts give vague replies. One plain sentence plus one clear instruction per bullet is faster, cleaner, and far easier to fix when something is off.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** If you're applying for a new job, switching fields, or returning to work after a break, this turns the hardest part of resume writing — describing yourself — into a ten-minute habit instead of an evening of dread.
- **For your business or work:** If you help others with hiring, mentoring, or coaching, you can teach this exact loop to job-seeking friends, students, or clients, and skip the part where they freeze in front of an empty Word document.
- **If you're just getting started:** Don't try to rewrite your whole resume today. Start with the single bullet you've been avoiding the most — the one job you never know how to describe — and run it through Steps 2 to 5. That's more than enough.

Try it now

Open Le Chat, paste the roughest sentence you can write about one thing you did at your last job, and add this line below it: *"Rewrite this as one strong resume bullet a recruiter would notice, with action verb, task, and result."* Send it. You'll have your first improved bullet before your coffee gets cold.

Draft a Calm, Professional Reply to a Frustrating Work Email with DeepSeek

6 steps · Read online

> **In short:** Open DeepSeek, paste the email that upset you, and ask for a calm, professional reply that keeps the door open. Refine it in 1–2 follow-ups, add your own voice, then send from your own email client — DeepSeek can draft the words, but it can't send the message for you.

We've all stared at a tricky email and typed three different replies, deleted them all, and walked away. DeepSeek — an AI assistant you reach through your browser — works well as a thinking partner for this exact moment. It reads the email, suggests a tone that matches your goal, and gives you a draft you can edit instead of starting from scratch while your heart is still racing.

Before you start

- **A free DeepSeek account.** Sign up on DeepSeek's official website using an email address or a phone number; the basic chat is free.
- **The email itself.** Have it open in another tab so you can copy the full text, not just your memory of it.
- **A clear goal.** Before you start, decide in one sentence what you want this reply to achieve — keep the relationship, set a boundary, propose a fix, or all three.
- **Roughly 5–10 minutes total.** Reading the email, drafting, refining, and personalizing usually takes less time than drafting from scratch in an emotional state.

Step 1 — Open DeepSeek in a fresh browser tab

Go to DeepSeek's official website in a new tab. Look for the chat box — it's usually a long text field near the bottom or middle of the screen, often with placeholder text such as "Message DeepSeek" or "Ask anything." Sign in if you have an account, or create one with the sign-up button if you don't.

If the layout looks different from what I describe, scroll until you spot a wide text input field with a send or arrow button — that is your chat box. Some pages show a sidebar with previous chats on the left; if you see one, click **New chat** so this conversation starts clean.

💬 Example: type "hi" first and press Enter, just to confirm the chat is working.

You'll know it worked when your test message appears in the conversation and DeepSeek replies, even briefly.

Step 2 — Paste the original email as context

Click into the chat box and paste the full email that upset you — every word, not a summary. The exact wording helps DeepSeek understand the tone, the pressure points, and what the other person actually wants. After pasting, press Enter twice to leave space, then add a short instruction line on what you want.

If the email is very long, paste it anyway; trimming can drop the part that matters most. If your inbox adds "From:", "To:", and "Subject:" lines above the email, leave them in — they help DeepSeek understand the relationship.

💬 Example: paste the email, then on a new line write: "Draft a calm, professional reply that addresses the points without sounding defensive. Keep it under 150 words, and end with a clear next step."

You'll know it worked when DeepSeek's reply refers to specific things from the email — names, dates, or complaints — instead of giving you a generic template you could have written yourself.

Step 3 — Tell DeepSeek who you are and what outcome you want

Before sending that first instruction, add 2–3 short sentences about your role, your relationship to the sender, and the result you want. This is the difference between a generic template and a reply that actually fits your situation. Without this context, DeepSeek will write a polite-but-empty reply that any stranger could send.

Be honest about the stakes — say if the relationship matters, if there's a deadline, or if you need to push back on something.

💬 Example: "I'm the project manager. The sender is a senior client who is upset about a missed deadline on the Q3 rollout. I want to keep the relationship, acknowledge the delay honestly, and propose a recovery plan. Tone should be respectful and steady, not overly apologetic."

You'll know it worked when the new reply includes details that match your situation — your role, the deadline, the recovery plan — rather than generic phrases like "I understand your frustration."

Step 4 — Refine the draft with one or two follow-ups

Read the first draft carefully. If a sentence still feels too cold, too soft, too long, or just wrong for your situation, type a short follow-up telling DeepSeek exactly what to change. Most good replies take two or three rounds, not one.

You can ask for shorter, firmer, warmer, more specific, or for a particular paragraph to be rewritten. The more concrete your feedback, the closer the next draft will land.

💬 Example: "Make the opening warmer — start with 'Thanks for flagging this' instead of 'I understand your concern.' Tighten the second paragraph; it repeats the first. End with a specific date for the recovery timeline."

You'll know it worked when the next version reflects your feedback — not a brand-new email, but the same email with the parts you flagged actually changed.

Step 5 — Strip the AI tells and add your own voice

AI replies have tells — phrases like "I appreciate your patience," "I understand your frustration," or "I hope this helps" that sound polite but feel hollow to a real reader. Scan the draft for any of these and ask for replacements. Then add one small personal touch only you can add, like a specific date, a name, or a shared reference.

Read the draft out loud once. If a sentence makes you wince, change it. If a sentence sounds like you, keep it.

💬 Example: ask "Replace 'I appreciate your patience' with something that sounds like a real person." Then add a line yourself — "I'll send the updated timeline by end of day Friday" — so the reply contains a real commitment, not a vague promise.

You'll know it worked when you can read the whole thing out loud and it sounds like something you would actually say to a colleague, not something a machine stitched together.

Step 6 — Copy, personalize, and send from your own email client

Look for a copy icon near DeepSeek's reply — usually at the top-right or bottom of the message block. Click it, then open your email client, start a reply to the original thread, and paste. Read the draft one more time **inside your own inbox** before sending; things look different in context.

This step matters because DeepSeek can draft, but it can't send the email for you, and it doesn't know your company's signature, your usual sign-off, or any small facts only you have.

💬 Example: paste the draft, then change the recipient's first name, your signature line, and any project-specific facts (a meeting room, a ticket number, a teammate's name) before hitting send.

You'll know it worked when you send a reply that feels calm, addresses the issue directly, and preserves the working relationship — without you having to write it from scratch while your blood pressure was still up.

Common mistakes

- **Sending the AI draft without reading it.** AI drafts almost always need at least one edit. Always read out loud before sending; if a sentence sounds off to you, it will sound off to them too.
- **Letting the AI invent commitments.** DeepSeek may suggest timelines, actions, or promises you can't actually keep. Strip any commitment that isn't true, or change it to something you can deliver.
- **Being too formal or too cold.** The default AI tone is often stiff. If the original email was casual, your reply should be too — add a line about shared context (a project name, a recent meeting) so it doesn't read as a legal response.
- **Forgetting the human line.** A perfectly polished AI reply can still feel robotic. Adding one sentence that only you could write — a specific date, an inside reference, a real next step — is what turns a draft into something that lands.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** The same approach works for tricky messages from landlords, family, or anyone you've been putting off replying to — paste, give context, refine, then send from your own account.
- **For your business or work:** This is a thinking partner, not a replacement for judgment. Use it to lower the activation cost of replying, especially on days when you're tired or the email hit a nerve.
- **If you're just getting started:** Don't try to write the perfect prompt on the first try. Type what you want in plain language, see what comes back, then tell DeepSeek what to change. Two or three short rounds will get you further than one long, careful prompt.

Try it now

Open DeepSeek in a new tab, paste the most recent work email that's been sitting in your inbox unanswered, and write: *"Draft a short, calm reply that acknowledges the issue and proposes a next step."* Read what comes back. You'll either have a usable starting point in 30 seconds — or, at the very least, a clear sense of where your own reply should go.

How to Write a Tailored Cover Letter for One Job Posting Using ChatGPT

6 steps · Read online

> **In short:** Paste one job posting and a short note about your background into ChatGPT with a clear instruction, and you'll get a focused cover letter draft in minutes. The draft is a starting point — you'll still rewrite parts in your own voice before sending.

Staring at a blank page when you need a cover letter is the worst part of applying for a job. The good news: you don't have to start from zero. ChatGPT works like a very fast first-drafter — give it the job post and a few lines about you, and it hands back a structured letter you can shape. This guide walks through that process, one step at a time, so a complete beginner can follow it on a phone or a computer.

Before you start

- A free ChatGPT account (sign up at chatgpt.com if you don't have one) — a paid plan is not required for this task.
- The job posting copied into a note or kept open in a second tab.
- A few short sentences about yourself — your current role, key experience, and why this job interests you.
- About 10–15 minutes total.

Step 1 — Open ChatGPT in a fresh conversation

Go to **chatgpt.com** in a browser, or open the ChatGPT app on your phone. If you already have an account, sign in; if not, create one (an email address is enough). Once you're in, look for the **text box at the bottom of the screen** — it's the place you type your message. It's usually labeled something like *Message ChatGPT* or *Ask anything*, but the wording changes sometimes.

If ChatGPT opens an old conversation from a previous session, start a fresh one. Look near the top of the page for a button like a **pencil icon**, a **"+"**, or a **"New chat"** label, and tap it.

💬 Example: Just type **"Hi"** and send it, so you can see how the assistant replies.

You'll know it worked when the assistant greets you back and the text box is empty, ready for your real request.

Step 2 — Gather two pieces of text in front of you

Before you ask ChatGPT for anything, make sure you can see **the job posting** and **a short summary of your background** — both ready to paste. Open the job listing in one browser tab

and either type a few lines about yourself in the Notes app, or open your résumé next to the posting.

What you really need from the job post is: the **job title**, the **main requirements**, and any **keywords that stand out** (for example, "cross-functional teams" or "client-facing"). What you need about yourself is: your **current role**, your **years of experience**, and **one or two achievements** you want to mention.

Example (your background summary): *"I'm a project manager with 6 years in healthcare IT. Led a team of 4. I also volunteer teaching kids to code on weekends. I'm applying because I want to move into renewable energy."*

You'll know it worked when both pieces of text are visible without scrolling, ready to copy.

Step 3 — Paste both into ChatGPT with a clear instruction

This is the most important step. Click into the **text box at the bottom** of the chat, paste the job posting first, then paste your background summary, then write one clear sentence telling ChatGPT what you want. The clearer you are, the better the draft will be — think of it like giving instructions to a colleague who has never read your résumé.

What you'll see after you press send: your long message appears in the chat, and within a minute or two, a full cover letter draft appears below it. If the message is too long for one box, send the job post first and the rest in a second message.

Example (copy and adapt this prompt): *"Here's the job I'm applying for: [paste the job post]. Here's a short note about me: [paste your background summary]. Please write a 3-paragraph cover letter that highlights my project management experience and why I want to move into renewable energy. Keep the tone warm but professional."*

You'll know it worked when a structured letter appears in the chat, with an opening paragraph, a middle paragraph about your experience, and a closing paragraph.

Step 4 — Read the draft and ask for changes that fit you

Don't accept the first draft as final. **Read it slowly**, line by line, and notice what feels off — maybe a phrase sounds too stiff, or the letter mentions a skill you don't actually have. Tell ChatGPT exactly what to change, and a new version will appear.

What you'll see: your follow-up message goes into the text box, and a revised draft replaces the old one below it. Each round of feedback tightens the letter. If the draft is completely off-track, you can ask ChatGPT to start over with **"Let's try again — focus more on [specific thing]."**

Example: *"The second paragraph sounds too formal — can you make it sound more like a real person talking? Also, please add one sentence about my volunteer work teaching kids to code."*

You'll know it worked when the draft feels closer to your own voice and only mentions things you've actually done.

Step 5 — Move the draft into your own document

Once the draft is close to right, **copy it out of ChatGPT** and paste it into a Word document, Google Doc, or plain text file. Working in your own editor makes the next step — the rewriting — much easier than editing inside the chat.

If copying is awkward on mobile, look for a **share or copy icon** at the corner of the chat reply, or just select the text with your finger and copy. You can also email the draft to yourself from the chat.

Example: Paste it into a Google Doc and rename the file **"[Job title] — cover letter — [your name]"** so it's easy to find later.

You'll know it worked when the letter is open in your own editor, separate from the chat, and you can edit it freely without losing the original.

Step 6 — Rewrite parts in your own voice

This is the step that turns a ChatGPT draft into *your* cover letter. **Read every sentence out loud.** If you wouldn't actually say it that way to a real person, change the words. Replace any phrase that feels like a machine wrote it — usually the openings ("I am writing to express…") and the closings ("Thank you for your consideration…") — with something you'd really say.

You don't have to rewrite the whole letter. Often, just changing the first sentence and the last one is enough to make it sound like you. **One honest rule:** never claim experience the assistant invented. If a sentence mentions a skill you don't actually have, delete it — recruiters notice.

Example: Change *"I am writing to express my interest in the position of Project Manager at your company"* to *"When I saw your opening for a Project Manager, it felt like a natural next step for me — here's why."*

You'll know it worked when you could imagine saying each sentence out loud in an interview without flinching, and every claim in the letter is something you've actually done.

Common mistakes

- **Pasting the job post without telling ChatGPT what to focus on.** The result is a generic letter. **Fix:** always end your prompt with a short sentence about which strengths to highlight and what tone you want.
- **Letting the assistant invent experience.** If your background summary is vague, ChatGPT may confidently make up skills you don't have. **Fix:** mention only things you've actually done, and delete any line in the draft that doesn't match your real experience.
- **Sending the first draft as-is.** Recruiters can spot a robotic cover letter in seconds. **Fix:** always rewrite at least the first and last paragraph, so the letter sounds like a real person wrote it.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** the same prompt style works for **volunteer applications, scholarship essays, or short personal statements** — any time you need a tailored first draft from a long description and your own background.
- **For your work:** when you're job hunting, this approach lets you apply to **more roles in less time**, because each tailored draft only takes a few minutes instead of an hour.
- **If you're just getting started:** pick **one job** you've already saved, paste the post into ChatGPT with three sentences about yourself, and ask for a one-paragraph version. A short letter is the easiest way to learn how the tool responds before you commit to a longer one.

Try it now

Pick one job posting you've been meaning to apply for. Open ChatGPT, paste the post plus a three-sentence summary of your background, and ask for a **one-paragraph cover letter draft**. Read it once, change the first sentence to something you'd actually say, and you're done — your first tailored draft, in under ten minutes.

Use Qwen to Write a Clear Project Update Email for Your Manager

6 steps · Read online

> **In short:** Open Qwen in your browser, paste three quick notes — what's done, what's stuck, and what's next — then ask it to write a 30-second project update. You'll get a clean email draft in about a minute.

By the end of this short walkthrough, you'll have a tight project update email drafted in a fraction of the time it would normally take you. This guide is for anyone who has ever stared at a blank email trying to summarize a week of work into a few polite sentences — and Qwen (Alibaba's AI assistant) is a perfectly capable helper for the job.

Before you start

- A free Qwen account. Sign up with an email address, Google, or Apple on the Qwen chat page. The free tier is enough for this task.
- A web browser on a phone or computer — Qwen runs in any modern browser.
- About five minutes of quiet time.
- Three short notes about your project: what's done, what's blocked, and what's next. Even half-sentences work — Qwen will tidy them up.

Step 1 — Open Qwen in your browser

Type the address of the Qwen chat page into your browser's address bar and press Enter. The page loads with a mostly empty screen and a long text box near the bottom. The box is often labeled something like "Message" or "Send a message" — your version may say something slightly different, but the box itself is the part that matters. If you can see a **Sign in** or **Log in** button at the top right, you'll need an account before you can send anything; Step 2 covers that.

Example: N/A for this step — just opening the page.

You'll know it worked when you can see a text input box at the bottom and (after signing in) a conversation area above it.

Step 2 — Sign in so your chats are saved

Click the **Sign in** button near the top of the page. A small window or panel appears with options to continue with email, Google, or Apple — pick whichever is fastest for you. Follow the prompts to either create a free account or log in to one you already have. When it's done, your name, an avatar, or a small profile icon appears in the corner of the page.

If you don't see "Sign in" but you're not in a chat yet, look for a button labeled **Log in**, **Get started**, or your profile picture. Some browser versions drop you straight into a chat as a guest — that's fine for a one-off draft, but signing in lets you come back to the conversation later if you need to.

💬 Example: N/A for this step — just signing in.

You'll know it worked when the page reloads and shows your account info, and the chat box is ready to receive a message.

Step 3 — Paste your three rough notes

Click inside the text box at the bottom of the page. Now type, or paste, your three short notes — done, stuck, next. They don't need to be sentences; bullet points, fragments, even one-word reminders are fine. The goal here is to get your real thoughts out of your head and onto the screen. Qwen is a large language model (an AI trained to read and write text — think of it as the engine behind most modern AI assistants), and it reads whatever you give it as raw source material.

If your notes are scattered across a notebook, a Slack thread, or a meeting transcript, copy them in as a single block. Don't try to polish them — that's Qwen's job, not yours.

💬 Example: Done: shipped the new onboarding flow on Tuesday. Stuck: waiting on legal review for the privacy notice. Next: design review on Friday, Maria owns the agenda.

You'll know it worked when all three of your notes are visible in the text box and the send button (usually a small arrow or paper-plane icon) becomes active.

Step 4 — Ask Qwen to write the email

Now you tell Qwen what you want — this kind of instruction is called a **prompt**, which is just a fancy word for "the thing you ask the AI." Press Enter or click the send button. Qwen starts typing its reply within a second or two, and a complete email draft appears in the conversation area within about ten seconds. Read it once, top to bottom.

If the first draft sounds too formal, too casual, or doesn't quite match how your team communicates, don't worry — Step 5 fixes that. For now, just check that the three facts you gave it (done, stuck, next) all made it into the email and that nothing important got dropped.

💬 Example: Turn these notes into a short project update email to my manager. Keep it under 120 words, friendly-professional tone, one short paragraph for each section (Done, Stuck, Next). No subject line needed.

You'll know it worked when you can see a complete email draft in the conversation with your three notes turned into proper sentences.

Step 5 — Tweak the draft until it sounds like you

Type a follow-up message asking Qwen to adjust the draft. It will replace the previous version with a new one in the same conversation. You can ask for it to be shorter, warmer, more direct, more formal, or to mention a specific date or person. Be specific about what you want changed — vague requests get vague results. The first version is rarely the last one; expect to do two or three rounds of small adjustments.

If something important is missing — a deadline, a person's name, a number — just type "add that the design review is Friday at 2pm" and Qwen will fold it in. Remember: Qwen can only work with what you tell it. It doesn't know your real project, your real colleagues, or your real deadlines, so it cannot fill in facts you didn't share.

💬 Example: Shorter — aim for 80 words max. Drop the "Hope this helps" opener. Add that the design review is Friday at 2pm.

You'll know it worked when the new draft matches how you'd actually write the email and includes every fact your manager needs.

Step 6 — Copy the draft and paste it into your email

Find the **copy** button near the email draft — it's usually a small icon shaped like two overlapping squares, sitting at the top or bottom of Qwen's reply. Click it. If you can't find a copy button, click and drag to highlight the whole draft, then press Ctrl+C (Windows) or Cmd+C (Mac). Open your email client — Gmail, Outlook, anything — start a new message to your manager, paste the text with Ctrl+V or Cmd+V, add a subject line, and send.

Qwen can draft the email, but it can't send it for you — the final send is always yours, and so is the responsibility for what's in it.

💬 Example: N/A — this is a copy/paste action.

You'll know it worked when the email draft is sitting in your email client, ready for you to add a subject line and hit send.

Common mistakes

- **Giving Qwen too little to work with.** If you only paste one vague sentence like "stuff is going OK, some blockers," the email will be vague too. The more concrete your three notes, the better the draft. Numbers, dates, and names are gold here.

- **Sending the first draft without reading.** Qwen sometimes smooths over real problems or invents polite-sounding filler. Always read the final version as if a colleague wrote it — fix anything that's wrong, missing, or too corporate.
- **Writing for a manager who already knows everything.** If your manager is up to speed, ask for a one-line status. If they need context, ask for a fuller version. State who the reader is in the prompt, and Qwen will adjust.
- **Forgetting who owns the next step.** A "Next" section without an owner creates confusion. Always include the name of the person responsible for the next action — otherwise your manager has to email you back to ask.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** The same three-notes trick works for any short status-style message — a volunteer group update, a family trip recap, a quick summary of a doctor's appointment to send to a relative. Anywhere you'd normally write "here's what's happening," Qwen can tidy it up.
- **For your business or work:** This is the easiest way to write weekly status updates, project briefs, and stakeholder check-ins without sitting in front of a blank screen. Once you get the hang of the three-notes format, you can draft an update in under five minutes — and the output is consistent in tone every week.
- **If you're just getting started:** Don't overthink the first prompt. Open Qwen, paste whatever you have, and ask for a short email. You can refine from there. The hardest part is starting — Qwen does the rest.

Try it now

Open the Qwen chat page, paste your last three project notes (done, stuck, next) into the text box, and ask Qwen to turn them into an email of 100 words or fewer. Read the result, tweak one small thing, then copy it into your next status update. You'll have a real, sendable draft in about three minutes.

Practice a Job Interview With Le Chat: 5 Sample Questions and Instant Feedback

6 steps · Read online

> **In short:** In about 15 minutes, you can run a full mock interview in Mistral's Le Chat (chat.mistral.ai) using 5 common questions, receive a sample strong answer for each, then improve your favorite answer with one follow-up prompt. A free account is enough; paid plans may answer faster during busy hours. Note: Mistral now calls this assistant **Vibe** (formerly Le Chat) — you may see either name in the app and on mistral.ai.

Whether you're prepping for your first real interview or just nervous about a callback, rehearsing out loud is the fastest way to find the rough edges in your answers. Le Chat is a friendly chat assistant built by Mistral, a French AI company, and it works just like sending messages to a friend. You ask a question, it answers — and you can ask it to play the interviewer, give you feedback, or even write a stronger version of what you said.

Before you start

- **An account.** You can sign up at chat.mistral.ai with an email address or a Google account. The free tier is fine for this exercise.
- **A device with a browser.** Phone, tablet, or computer — any of them work. The screen will look slightly different on each.
- **Roughly 15 minutes.** Five questions, a couple of minutes thinking and writing each, plus one follow-up polish at the end.
- **A real job posting (optional but helpful).** If you have one open in another tab, Le Chat can tailor answers to the specific role. Without it, the answers will be more general — still useful, just less targeted.

One honest note before we start: Le Chat can draft and critique answers, but it cannot predict what your real interviewer will say. Treat the output as practice material, not as a script to memorize.

Step 1 — Open Le Chat and start a fresh conversation

Open your browser and go to **chat.mistral.ai**. If you're not signed in, the button to look for reads **Log in** or **Sign up** in the top-right corner. After signing in, you land on a clean page with an empty chat box at the bottom labeled something like **Message Le Chat…**. Above the box you'll see a list of past chats on the left, or a **New chat** button if you've used it before.

Tap **New chat** (or just click into the empty box). The screen should turn into a blank conversation ready for your first message. If you see a welcome screen with example prompts, look for an **X**, **Skip**, or **Start chatting** button to dismiss it.

Example: type nothing yet — just confirm you're on a fresh, blank chat.

You'll know it worked when the chat shows no old messages and the text box is empty.

Step 2 — Set up Le Chat as your mock interviewer

Click into the message box and tell Le Chat what role you want it to play. This is called a **prompt** — just the instruction you give to the AI. A clear setup makes the rest of the session go smoothly. After you press **Enter** (or the **send** arrow), Le Chat usually replies within a few seconds with a short confirmation.

Example:

> You are a friendly interviewer at a mid-sized company. Ask me one common interview question at a time, wait for my answer, then give me short feedback on what was strong and what I could tighten up. After 5 questions, wrap up with three overall tips. Start with question 1.

You'll know it worked when Le Chat replies with something like *"Great, let's get started. Question 1: ..."*

If it dives straight into question 1 without acknowledging the setup, that's fine too — the role-play has begun either way.

Step 3 — Answer question 1 out loud or in writing

Read the first question slowly. Give yourself a real moment to think, then write a draft answer — a few sentences is plenty. Don't try to make it perfect on the first try; the whole point is to have something Le Chat can react to. Press **Enter** to send.

Example: if the question is *"Tell me about yourself,"* a starter answer could be:

> I'm a retail supervisor with four years of experience leading a team of eight. Before that I studied business in college. I enjoy solving problems for customers on the spot, and I'm now looking for a role where I can use those skills in an office setting.

You'll know it worked when Le Chat's reply names specific things you did well and suggests one or two small improvements.

Step 4 — Go through all five questions the same way

Keep replying with your draft answers, one after another. Le Chat will move you to question 2, then 3, and so on, each time giving short feedback before the next question. You don't need to fix anything yet — just keep the rhythm of answer → feedback → next question. If a question catches you off guard (for example, *"What's your greatest weakness?"*), it's perfectly fine to type *"I'll be honest, I don't have a good answer ready, here's my best attempt..."* and then try.

💬 Example: when you reach the wrap-up, Le Chat's message will look something like:

> That's all five questions. Here are three overall tips: 1) lead with a concrete example more often, 2) keep answers around 60 seconds when spoken, 3) prepare one story you can adapt to many questions.

You'll know it worked when the wrap-up message arrives and you can see all five of your answers plus the feedback above them in the conversation thread.

Step 5 — Pick one answer and ask Le Chat to strengthen it

Scroll back up to the question whose feedback most surprised you — usually the one with the most room to improve. Copy your own answer (or just click into the chat box again) and ask for a stronger version. Be specific about what you want: a short spoken version, a version that leads with a story, or a version that sounds less formal. Le Chat will rewrite it for you.

💬 Example:

> Can you rewrite my answer to question 2 ("What's your greatest weakness?") as a 60-second spoken answer that names a real weakness, shows what I'm doing about it, and ends on what I'm good at?

You'll know it worked when Le Chat returns a polished version you can picture yourself saying out loud.

Step 6 — Save the polished answer and the tips

In the top-right corner of the chat, look for a button like **Share** or a copy icon — Le Chat can give you a link to the whole conversation. If that isn't there, simply select all the text in the conversation (`Ctrl+A` on a computer, long-press on mobile), copy it, and paste it into a note on your phone or a document. Saving the polished answer plus the three final tips means you have real rehearsal material the next time you practice.

💬 Example:

> Here are the five questions, my drafts, Le Chat's feedback, and the polished answer to question 2 — keep all of this together so you can re-read it before the real interview.

You'll know it worked when you can open that note tomorrow and see your polished answer without having to scroll through the chat again.

Common mistakes

- **Sending a vague setup prompt.** If you just type *"Help me practice,"* Le Chat may not know to play the interviewer role. Always tell it the role, the number of questions, and what to do at the end.
- **Trying to make answer #1 perfect.** Your first draft is the practice material, not the final answer. The polishing happens in Step 5, so don't stall early.
- **Asking Le Chat to predict the real interview.** It can help you rehearse, but it doesn't know who you'll be meeting. Avoid prompts like *"What will they ask me?"* and stick to general common questions.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** Mock interviews in Le Chat are a low-stress way to rehearse any kind of answer — a school presentation, a salary talk, even a tough message to a friend. Once you learn the "act as X, then give feedback" pattern, you can reuse it for almost anything.
- **For your business or work:** If you hire or mentor others, you can flip the same prompt and ask Le Chat to play the *candidate*. It's a quick way to see which questions reveal the most about a person.
- **If you're just getting started:** Run the session once without any prep at all. The point isn't a perfect answer today — it's noticing that the process is shorter and less scary than you imagined.

Try it now

Open chat.mistral.ai in a new tab and send this single message:

> Pretend you are an interviewer. Ask me one common interview question and wait for my answer.

Type your honest first attempt — even two sentences is enough — and read the feedback. The whole thing takes under two minutes, and you'll already have one rehearsed answer before the day is out.

Summarize Long Articles and Reports Using DeepSeek Chat

6 steps · Read online

Do you ever come across a really long article, news report, or document online and wish you could just get the main points without reading every single word? DeepSeek Chat can help you do exactly that! This guide will show you how to use DeepSeek Chat, a type of AI known as a **large language model (LLM)** — which is like a very smart digital assistant trained on heaps of text — to quickly summarize text and save you time.

Before you start

- An internet connection and a device (computer, tablet, or smartphone).
- A free DeepSeek Chat account (you can sign up with Google, GitHub, or email).
- Access to the DeepSeek Chat website (chat.deepseek.com).
- Rough total time: 5-10 minutes for your first summary, plus a few minutes if you need to create an account.

Step 1 — Log in to DeepSeek Chat

Your first step is to open your web browser and go to the DeepSeek Chat website. When you arrive at `chat.deepseek.com`, you'll be greeted by a login screen, as DeepSeek Chat requires you to sign in to use the service. You'll see options to "Continue with Google," "Continue with GitHub," or "Continue with Email." Choose your preferred method and follow the prompts to either log in to an existing account or quickly create a new one. If you've used DeepSeek Chat before, you might find yourself automatically logged in and taken straight to the chat interface. You'll know it worked when you're successfully past the login screen and see the main chat area with an input box at the bottom.

Step 2 — Start a New Chat

Before you paste your content, it's a good idea to start a fresh conversation. This keeps your summary distinct and ensures DeepSeek Chat focuses only on your current request, rather than any previous topics. On the DeepSeek Chat page, look for a button or icon that allows you to start a new chat. This is usually located in the top-left corner and might look like a plus sign (+), a speech bubble with a plus, or simply say "New Chat." Tapping or clicking this will clear any previous conversation, giving you a blank canvas. If you don't see a clear "New Chat" button, simply ensure your existing chat history is empty, or you can just start typing your request if it's the first time you're using the service. You'll know it worked when the main chat area is empty, displaying only the input box at the bottom of the screen.

Step 3 — Prepare Your Text

Now it's time to get the article or report you want DeepSeek Chat to summarize. Copy the full text from its source, whether it's a web page, a document, or an email. Highlight the entire section of text you need summarized. If it's a web page, you can often select all the text by pressing `Ctrl + A` (on Windows) or `Cmd + A` (on Mac) and then copying it with `Ctrl + C` (Windows) or `Cmd + C` (Mac). For documents, use the same copy shortcuts after highlighting. DeepSeek Chat works best with plain text, so don't worry about formatting. If your text is very long, like a full book or a huge technical report, be aware that AI models have a **context window** (the amount of text they can 'remember' or process at one time). If your text exceeds this, DeepSeek Chat might only read the beginning. For most articles or short reports, this won't be an issue. You'll know it worked when the text is copied to your device's clipboard, ready to be pasted.

Step 4 — Paste and Craft Your Prompt

With your text copied, head back to DeepSeek Chat. Now you'll paste the text and tell DeepSeek Chat exactly what you want it to do with it using a **prompt** — which is just an instruction you give to the AI. In the large input box at the bottom of the DeepSeek Chat screen, first type your instruction, then paste your copied text. Be specific about how you want the summary. For example, you can ask for bullet points, a short paragraph, or a particular length. Once you've entered both your prompt and the text, look for a "Send" button (often a paper airplane icon or a button labeled "Send" or "Enter") and click it. If the input box seems too small for your text, don't worry; it will usually expand as you type or paste. 💬 Example: `Please summarise the following article for me in 3-5 key bullet points. Highlight the main arguments and conclusions. [PASTE YOUR ARTICLE HERE]` You'll know it worked when DeepSeek Chat starts generating a response in the chat area above the input box, and you can see its digital assistant typing.

Step 5 — Review the Summary

Once DeepSeek Chat has finished processing your request, it will display the summary directly in the chat window. Take a moment to read through it and see if it captures the essence of the original text. You'll see DeepSeek Chat's response appear as a distinct message in the chat history, usually just below your prompt. Check if the summary is clear, concise, and accurately reflects the key information from your original article. Sometimes, an AI might miss a nuance or focus on a less important detail, but generally, it will provide a good overview. If the summary doesn't quite hit the mark, that's perfectly normal, and you can easily ask DeepSeek Chat to adjust it in the next step. You'll know it worked when DeepSeek Chat has generated and displayed a summary for you in the chat interface.

Step 6 — Refine for Clarity (Optional)

If the first summary isn't exactly what you need, you can ask DeepSeek Chat to refine it. Think of it like asking a colleague for another pass at a draft. This step allows you to get closer to your ideal summary. In the same chat window, type a follow-up instruction. You can ask for a shorter or longer summary, a different format (e.g., "now make it a single paragraph"), or to focus on a specific aspect of the text. For instance, if it missed a key point, you could say, "Can you also include information about X?" or "Please make it even shorter." If DeepSeek Chat struggles to understand your refinement, try rephrasing your request more simply. Sometimes breaking down a complex request into smaller steps helps the AI. 💬 Example: `Could you make that summary even shorter, perhaps just two sentences?` You'll know it worked when DeepSeek Chat provides a revised summary based on your new instructions.

Common mistakes

- **Pasting too much text:** DeepSeek Chat has limits on how much text it can process at once (its "context window"). If you paste a very long document, it might only summarize the beginning.
    - **Fix:** For extremely long documents, try summarizing it in sections, or ask DeepSeek Chat to focus on specific chapters or parts if you can copy them individually.
- **Vague instructions:** If you just say "summarize this," DeepSeek Chat might give you a general summary that isn't quite what you need (e.g., too long, or too short).
    - **Fix:** Be specific in your prompt. Ask for bullet points, a specific word count, or to highlight particular themes. The more detail you give, the better the result.
- **Not verifying the summary:** While AI is powerful, it can occasionally misunderstand context or "hallucinate" (confidently make up information).
    - **Fix:** Always quickly skim the original text or a trusted source to ensure the summary is accurate, especially if you plan to use the information for something important. DeepSeek Chat cannot guarantee 100% factual accuracy, so always double-check critical details.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** You can quickly get the gist of long news articles, blog posts, or emails without spending ages reading. It's great for catching up on topics or deciding if a full read is worth your time.
- **For your business or work:** Use DeepSeek Chat to condense lengthy reports, meeting minutes, research papers, or customer feedback into digestible summaries. This saves time and helps you quickly extract key insights for better decision-making.
- **If you're just getting started:** Start by summarizing a short online news article. Keep your prompt simple, like "Summarize this article in three bullet points," and experiment with different types of text to see how DeepSeek Chat performs.

Try it now

Find a short news article online, ideally under 1000 words. Open DeepSeek Chat (chat.deepseek.com), log in if needed, paste the article into the chat, and type `Please give me a summary of this article in four bullet points.` Hit send and see what DeepSeek Chat creates for you!

How to turn a meeting into clear notes and action items with AI

6 steps · Read online

Imagine never having to stress about taking minutes during a busy work call again. By the end of this guide, you will know how to use an AI assistant to turn a chaotic wall of text or scribbled notes into clean, structured action items for your team. This method helps you stay focused during conversations, knowing a digital assistant can help organize the details later.

Before you start

- **An account** with a free AI assistant (such as ChatGPT, Google Gemini, or Claude). You'll usually need an email address to sign up.
- **Access to the AI tool** via a web browser on a computer, tablet, or smartphone. Most free AI tools are available as websites.
- **Some rough text** from a recent meeting. This could be a transcript (a word-for-word written record of everything spoken, automatically generated by video call software like Zoom or Teams) or just your own messy typed notes.
- **Privacy awareness**: Ensure you do not upload highly sensitive corporate secrets or personal customer details into free, public AI tools without your company's explicit permission. If in doubt, redact (remove) sensitive information first.
- **Rough total time:** Allow 5-10 minutes for your first try.

Step 1 — Gather and clean your meeting text

Your first step is to get your raw meeting information ready. Open the document, email, or video conferencing application (like Zoom or Teams) where your meeting notes or transcript are stored. Select all the text from the meeting and copy it. While you're looking at the text, take a quick moment to delete any highly private or sensitive information—like bank account numbers or specific client passwords—before you copy it.

You'll know it worked when you have the meeting text copied, and you've given it a quick check for anything sensitive.

Step 2 — Open your AI assistant

Next, open your preferred web browser (like Chrome, Safari, or Firefox) and type in the website address for your chosen AI tool (e.g., chatgpt.com for ChatGPT, gemini.google.com for Gemini, or claude.ai for Claude). Log in if prompted. Think of these tools as friendly, highly capable office assistants who are ready to read and write at your command.

You'll know it worked when you see the AI assistant's main chat screen, with a place to type your message. If a welcome screen appears, follow its prompts until you reach the main chat screen.

Step 3 — Write your prompt (instruction)

To get the best result from your AI assistant, you need to write a clear **prompt**. A prompt is simply the specific instruction or question you type into an AI tool to tell it what to do. In the message box, you'll type or paste your instructions. For a great meeting summary, tell the AI exactly who it is representing, what to look for, and how to format the output.

You'll know it worked when you see the text of your instructions clearly visible in the input box, ready for you to add your meeting notes.

💬 **Example:**

> "Act as a professional administrative assistant for a marketing team. Below is a raw meeting transcript. Please organize this text into three distinct sections:
>
> 1. **Summary:** A three-sentence overview of the main topics discussed.
> 2. **Key Decisions:** A bulleted list of any final decisions made during the call.
> 3. **Action Items:** A list of tasks, clearly showing who is responsible for each task and the deadline (if mentioned). Keep the tone professional, clear, and direct, suitable for an internal team email."

Step 4 — Paste your meeting text

Now, immediately below the prompt you just typed or pasted into the chat box, you will paste your messy notes or full meeting transcript. Just click in the message box and use your device's paste command (Ctrl+V on Windows, Command+V on Mac, or tap and hold on mobile). If the text is very long, don't worry. Most modern AI systems have a large **context window** (which is simply the AI's short-term memory—the maximum amount of text it can read and remember in a single go).

You'll know it worked when your meeting text appears directly below your prompt in the message box. If the text looks too long for the box, don't worry; the AI can still read it all.

Step 5 — Send your request to the AI

Once your prompt and the meeting text are both in the chat box, it's time to send them to the AI for processing. Use the send button next to the message box (or press Enter). Click or tap it. The AI will then start processing your request, reading through all the information you provided and working to organize it as instructed.

You'll know it worked when the AI assistant begins writing its response, often line by line. The send button looks different from tool to tool, so use whichever one is clearly meant for sending.

Step 6 — Review and refine the results

After a few moments, the AI will present its organized output: a summary, key decisions, and action items. Read through this first draft carefully. It's important to remember that while AI is powerful, it can sometimes **hallucinate** (a term for when the AI confidently makes up facts, names, or dates that were never actually mentioned). Always read through the output once to verify accuracy before sharing it. If the first draft isn't perfect, you can easily ask for changes. You do not need to start over; just type a new request in the chat box, talking to the AI like a human colleague. The AI can draft the notes, but it cannot verify facts or send the final email for you.

You'll know it worked when you have a structured set of meeting notes that accurately reflect your discussion, and you're happy with the clarity and format.

💬 **Example follow-up prompts:**

- *"Can you make the action items list shorter and focus only on Dave's tasks, ignoring Sarah's for now?"*
- *"Reword the summary so it sounds a bit more casual, ready to put into our team Slack channel, and make it two sentences instead of three."*
- *"Please add a 'Next Steps' section at the end, saying we'll review these items next week."*

Common mistakes

- **Trusting the AI blindly:** AI tools can sometimes *hallucinate* (confidently make up facts, names, or dates that were never mentioned).
    - **The fix:** Always read through the AI's output carefully and cross-reference it with your memory or original notes to verify accuracy before sharing.
- **Uploading sensitive client details:** Unless your business has a secure, private enterprise agreement with the AI provider, avoid pasting private customer names, company financials, or other confidential information into free, public AI tools.
    - **The fix:** Before copying, replace real sensitive names with placeholders like "Client A" or "Project X," and remove any specific numbers like bank details.
- **Vague instructions:** If you simply ask the AI to "summarize this," you might get a long, rambling paragraph that doesn't meet your needs.
    - **The fix:** Always ask for specific structures (like bullet points), roles (e.g., "Act as a professional assistant"), and tones (e.g., "Keep the tone professional and direct") to save yourself editing time.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** You can use this exact method to organize messy family group chats about upcoming holidays, sorting who is bringing what into a neat checklist, or turning a jumbled thought into a clear plan.
- **For your business or work:** You can stay 100% focused on the human conversation during a meeting, knowing you do not have to scribble everything down frantically. This frees you up to engage more deeply.
- **If you're just getting started:** This is the ultimate low-risk way to experience how AI can save you hours of administrative work every single week by turning unstructured text into organized information.

Try it now

Open an AI tool right now, copy the simple text below, and paste it into the chat after asking the AI to "Please turn this messy note into a neat bulleted list of action items:" to see how easily it works.

Copy this text:

> "Dave needs to call the plumber by Wednesday morning. Sarah is going to check the budget tomorrow. We decided to reschedule the team lunch to next Friday."

Practice Job Interview Questions with DeepSeek

6 steps · Read online

> **In short:** DeepSeek is a free AI assistant you can use in any browser. Open it, ask it to play the role of an interviewer, and it will ask you common questions, score your answers, and suggest stronger wording. It cannot read your face or hear your voice, so pair it with a real video call for full practice.

Job interviews make almost everyone nervous. The good news: a few hours of practice in front of an honest audience can turn that nervous energy into confidence. DeepSeek (a free AI chat assistant) makes a surprisingly patient practice partner — it can take the role of a hiring manager, throw realistic questions at you, give you feedback, and even rewrite your answers in a sharper way. This guide walks you through exactly how to set that up, step by step, even if you have never opened an AI chat tool before.

Before you start

- **A free DeepSeek account.** Sign up at deepseek.com with an email address or a Google account. The free tier is enough for this guide.
- **A device with a browser.** A laptop is easiest because the screen is bigger, but a phone or tablet works too.
- **About 30–45 minutes.** The first run-through takes longer; once you know the pattern, a 10-minute warm-up is plenty.
- **The job description (optional but helpful).** If you have a real posting in mind, keep it open in another tab so you can paste key details into the chat.

Step 1 — Open DeepSeek and start a new chat

Go to **deepseek.com** in your browser and sign in. After login you'll land on the main chat screen — a wide, mostly empty page with a text box at the bottom. Look for a small **"New Chat"** button or a **pencil/plus icon** near the top of the conversation list. Click it. The text box clears and you're ready to type. If you don't see a "New Chat" button, refresh the page; DeepSeek usually opens a fresh conversation by default. **You'll know it worked when** the text box is empty, no previous messages are visible, and a blinking cursor sits in the input area.

Step 2 — Set the role and the job

Type a short setup message that tells DeepSeek who it should pretend to be and what job you are practicing for. The more concrete you are, the more useful the questions will be. Think of it like handing a real interview coach a one-page brief. Paste this into the box, then edit the bracketed parts to match your situation. 💬 Example: *"Act as a friendly hiring manager interviewing me*

for a [Customer Support Specialist] role at a mid-size company. Ask me one question at a time, wait for my answer, then give brief feedback and the next question. Keep questions realistic for this job." Hit **Enter** (or tap the **paper-plane / send arrow**). A few seconds later, DeepSeek will reply confirming the role and asking the first interview question. **You'll know it worked when** the first question appears within 10–15 seconds and clearly relates to the job you named.

Step 3 — Answer the question like it's real

Read the question, take a breath, and type your answer as you would actually say it out loud. Don't try to be perfect — the whole point of practice is to hear how you sound before you say it for real. If the question is "Tell me about a time you dealt with a difficult customer," answer with a real story, not a textbook definition. Aim for two to four sentences. The **Shift + Enter** key combination usually adds a new line, while **Enter** alone sends the message. **You'll know it worked when** DeepSeek's reply shows specific feedback (what was strong, what was missing) and then asks the next question. If the reply is just "Great, next question," prompt it: *"Can you tell me what was strong in my answer and what I should add?"*

Step 4 — Ask for a stronger version of your answer

Once you have answered two or three questions this way, you have raw material to work with. Pick the answer that felt weakest, or the one for the most important question, and ask DeepSeek to rewrite it. Be specific about the tone you want. 💬 Example: *"Here's my answer to your last question: '[paste your answer]'. Please rewrite it to sound more confident, around 90 words, with a clear result at the end."* Read the rewrite out loud — that's the part most people skip, and it's where the practice actually sticks. **You'll know it worked when** the rewritten version is shorter, punchier, and you can say it naturally in under a minute.

Step 5 — Ask for the questions you fear most

Every job has a few questions that make candidates freeze: *"What's your biggest weakness?"*, *"Why are you leaving your current job?"*, *"Where do you see yourself in five years?"*. Ask DeepSeek for the full list, plus a model answer for each. This gives you a safety net so nothing in the real interview catches you off guard. 💬 Example: *"Give me the 8 most common interview questions for a [Customer Support Specialist] role, and a short model answer for each in plain language."* The model answers won't be your words — and that's the point. Use them as a starting template, then rewrite them in Step 6 so they sound like you. **You'll know it worked when** you have a written list of questions and sample answers you can scroll through on your phone right before the real interview.

Step 6 — Run a final mock interview, one question at a time

Now switch into test mode. Tell DeepSeek to behave like a real interviewer with no feedback between questions, just like in the actual room. Type your answers as if you had two minutes to think, then send. At the end, ask for an overall score and three things to improve. This single run-through usually surfaces the gaps your earlier practice hid. 💬 Example: *"Let's do a 5-question mock interview now. No feedback between questions, just like a real interview. After the last answer, give me an overall score out of 10 and three specific things to improve."* **You'll know it worked when** you finish the five questions without checking your notes, and the final score gives you a clear list of what to work on next.

Common mistakes

- **Skipping the role setup.** If you just type "ask me interview questions," you'll get generic lists instead of a back-and-forth conversation. Always set the role in Step 2.
- **Treating the AI's feedback as the final word.** DeepSeek's suggestions are a starting point, not gospel. If a rewrite doesn't sound like you, say so and ask for another version — it's free to keep asking.
- **Practicing only by reading.** Reading sample answers in your head is not the same as typing them out loud. Always speak the final version at least once, because the real interview uses your voice, not your eyes.
- **Forgetting what the tool can't do.** DeepSeek can't see your face, hear your tone, or notice that you're fidgeting. For a real dress rehearsal, pair this guide with a video recording of yourself, or ask a friend to mock-interview you on a video call.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** You walk into your next interview with a short list of practiced stories and a few strong sentences already in your mouth. The nerves don't disappear, but the "blank mind" feeling does.
- **For your business or work:** If you manage or hire people, this same trick works in reverse. Use DeepSeek to generate realistic interview questions for the roles you need to fill, so every candidate gets a fairer, more consistent first round.
- **If you're just getting started:** One 20-minute session before bed for three nights in a row is more useful than one five-hour cram session. Consistency beats intensity.

Try it now

Open deepseek.com, paste this exact message, and answer the first question it gives you: *"Act as a friendly hiring manager. Ask me one common interview question at a time. After I answer, give me two lines of feedback and the next question. Start now."* Set a 10-minute timer and see how far you get.

How to Clean Up a Messy Old Word Document with Copilot in Ten Minutes

6 steps · Read online

> **In short:** You can use Copilot in Word to summarize a messy file, rewrite the worst paragraphs, and turn scattered notes into a clean table. You'll still do a quick manual review at the end, but the heavy lifting takes about ten minutes — and you'll need a Microsoft 365 plan that includes Copilot.

Every office has at least one of them: a Word document that started clean five years ago and grew messy with every edit. Different fonts here, random sizes there, and paragraphs that wander in three directions at once. Copilot is Microsoft's AI assistant that sits inside Word (along with Excel, Outlook, and the rest of Microsoft 365) — think of it as a smart helper in a side panel, ready to rewrite or summarize whatever you point it at. This guide is for anyone who needs to ship a polished file before a meeting.

Before you start

- A Microsoft 365 subscription that includes **Copilot** (Copilot is a paid add-on — check your plan on Microsoft's official pricing page).
- The messy document saved on your computer or in OneDrive, and opened in Word desktop or Word for the web.
- About 10 minutes of focused time. The longer the document, the longer each step takes.

Step 1 — Open the document and confirm Copilot is available

Open your messy file in Microsoft Word on desktop (Windows or Mac) or in Word for the web in your browser. Look at the ribbon at the top of the window — if Copilot is turned on for your account, you'll see a Copilot button (often shown with a small sparkle icon ✨) on the Home tab, or a Copilot panel pinned to the right side of the document. If you don't see a Copilot button on the Home tab, scan other tabs or click the ⋯ menu in the top-right corner — Microsoft moves the location around between updates. If nothing shows up, your plan doesn't include Copilot yet, so check the Microsoft 365 pricing page before going further. 💬 Example: open `Old-Project-Summary.docx` from your Documents folder. You'll know it worked when a Copilot panel is visible somewhere in the Word window.

Step 2 — Ask Copilot for a quick read of the whole document

Click the Copilot button to open its chat panel. In the message box at the bottom, ask Copilot to summarize the document and point out the messiest sections. Your message appears as a bubble, then Copilot replies with a short summary and a list of the biggest problems it sees —

usually inconsistent terminology, mixed tenses, or sections that repeat each other. If the panel is empty or greyed out, your license doesn't cover Copilot — that's the first thing to check before going further. Example: "Summarize this document in 5 bullet points and tell me which sections are most inconsistent." You'll know it worked when Copilot returns a summary you can read in under a minute.

Step 3 — Pick the worst paragraph and ask Copilot to rewrite it

In the document, click and drag to highlight one paragraph that looks the messiest — long and run-on, or written in a totally different voice from the rest. Then open the Copilot panel and ask it to rewrite that paragraph in a tone matching the rest of the document. Copilot returns a fresh draft in the chat, and you can click **Insert** or **Replace** to drop it in (the exact button name varies by version). If you don't see an Insert button, copy the rewrite manually and paste it over the original. If the rewrite misses the tone, refine your prompt — try adding "in 2-3 short sentences" or "more formal" until it lands. Example: "Rewrite this paragraph in the same plain, professional tone as the rest of the document. Keep it under 80 words." You'll know it worked when the new paragraph reads cleaner and matches the document's voice.

Step 4 — Convert scattered lists into a clean table

Many old documents hide bullet points inside long paragraphs. Highlight a chunk of text that contains scattered names, dates, or tasks. In the Copilot panel, ask it to convert that chunk into a clean table with clear column headers. Copilot returns a table preview in the chat, and you click **Insert** to drop it into the document at the cursor (or copy and paste it at the right spot if Insert isn't there). If the table has too many columns, ask Copilot to redo it with fewer. If your document is actually a scanned PDF that you opened in Word, Copilot may not be able to read it — run OCR first, or transcribe the key parts by hand. Example: "Convert the names, dates and tasks in the highlighted text into a 3-column table called Name | Date | Task." You'll know it worked when a tidy table appears in your document where the wall of text used to be.

Step 5 — Draft a clean opening summary to paste at the top

Scroll back to the top of the document. In the Copilot panel, ask it to draft a 3-4 sentence executive summary of the whole document. Copy the result and paste it at the very top, before the original first paragraph. Then go to the original first paragraph and either delete it (if it was an old intro) or move it below the new summary. If the new summary feels off, add more detail to your prompt — for example, "Write a 4-sentence summary for a manager who has 30 seconds to read it. Plain language, no jargon." Copilot drafts; you decide. Example: "Write a 4-sentence executive summary of this document for a busy manager. Plain language, no jargon." You'll know it worked when the new top of the document reads like a clean overview.

Step 6 — Do a 2-minute manual review before saving

Now step away from Copilot. Quickly scroll through the document and look for: leftover references to people who no longer work there, dates that are years out of date, and any numbers that don't add up. Fix those by hand — Copilot cannot check facts for you, and you don't want a wrong number sneaking into a shared file. Then save the cleaned version under a new name using **File → Save As**, so you keep the original messy file as a backup. If you don't see Save As in the menu, look for **File → Download As** or use the keyboard shortcut **F12** on Windows. 💬 Example: rename the file to `Project-Summary-Clean-2026.docx`. You'll know it worked when the new file opens cleanly and the original is still on your computer.

Common mistakes

- **Expecting Copilot to fix fonts and styles for you.** Copilot works on text, not on Word's visual styles. For mixed fonts and sizes, use Word's **Clear Formatting** button (Home tab → Styles pane → Clear All) — that's a one-second job once the words are right.
- **Pasting Copilot's rewrite without reading it.** Copilot sometimes invents a number or smooths over a key fact to make a paragraph flow. Always skim the new text against the old one before you replace it.
- **Saving over the original file.** Use **Save As** with a new name, not just Save. That way, if a rewrite goes wrong, your messy original is still there to fall back on.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** A clean Word file is easier to forward to family, a volunteer group, or your accountant — fewer "what does this mean?" replies in your inbox.
- **For your business or work:** You can ship a polished brief or report to a client in a single sitting, even when the source material was a mess. That means fewer late nights reformatting someone else's old draft.
- **If you're just getting started:** Pick your shortest messy file (under five pages) for your first try. A small win builds the habit; a 40-page monster can wait until next week.

Try it now

Open the shortest messy Word file on your computer and ask Copilot to summarize it. That single question tells you whether Copilot is available on your plan — and gives you a quick win — before you commit ten minutes to the full cleanup.

Draft a simple cover letter for a job application with DeepSeek

6 steps · Read online

Landing a new job often starts with a great cover letter, but writing one from scratch can take ages. This guide will show you how to use DeepSeek, an AI assistant, to quickly draft a clear and concise cover letter, saving you time and effort. By the end, you'll be able to create a personalized draft ready for your final review.

Before you start

- A DeepSeek account. Check their website for signup options and current account types available.
- An internet-connected device (computer, tablet, or smartphone).
- The full job advertisement text for the role you're applying for.
- A rough idea of your key skills and experiences you want to highlight.
- Rough total time: 10-15 minutes.

Step 1 — Open the DeepSeek Chat

To begin, open your web browser and go to the DeepSeek website (deepseek.com). If you're not already logged in, you'll see a prompt to do so. Once logged in, you'll land directly on the main chat interface, which usually features a large text box at the bottom of the screen ready for your input and a history of past conversations above. This is where you'll interact with the AI assistant, which is like a smart computer program that can understand and generate human-like text. If it looks different: Look for a "Chat" or "Start a new conversation" button if you're on a different page, or if the layout has changed slightly. You'll know it worked when you see a clear text input box where you can start typing your request.

Step 2 — Start with a Clear Request (Prompt)

Now that you're in the chat, type a clear instruction, known as a 'prompt', to tell DeepSeek what you need. Think of a prompt as your direct command to the AI assistant, guiding its response. Be specific and concise. After typing, click the send button (look for an arrow, airplane icon, or "Send" label) next to the text box. The AI will then start processing your request, which is its way of thinking about your input. If it looks different: The send button might be in a different location or have a different icon. Just make sure your text is ready before you hit enter or click the send button. 💬 Example: `I need help drafting a cover letter for a Marketing Coordinator position.` You'll know it worked when your message appears in the chat history, and DeepSeek starts typing a response below it.

Step 3 — Provide Key Job Details

For the best results, DeepSeek needs to understand the job you're applying for. Copy the entire job advertisement from where you found it (e.g., a job board or company website) and paste it into the chat. Then, add a brief sentence or two identifying the company and the exact role title. This detailed information helps the AI assistant tailor the letter specifically to the job's requirements, keywords, and company culture, making it more relevant. If it looks different: If the job ad is very long, you might need to send it in two parts, but DeepSeek usually handles long inputs well. 💬 Example: `Here is the full job advertisement: [paste job ad here]. I am applying for the 'Community Engagement Officer' role at 'Green Earth Initiatives'.` You'll know it worked when DeepSeek confirms it has received the job details or asks for more information to proceed.

Step 4 — Add Your Personal Touch

Next, tell DeepSeek about *you*. Share your relevant skills, experiences, and why you believe you're a strong candidate for this particular role. Focus on how your abilities align with the responsibilities mentioned in the job advertisement. The more specific examples you provide, the better DeepSeek can weave them into the letter, making it more authentic and compelling. This context helps the AI assistant highlight your strengths effectively. If it looks different: Don't worry if DeepSeek doesn't respond immediately; it's simply gathering all your input before generating a draft. 💬 Example: `I want to highlight my strong project management skills and 3 years of experience in leading volunteer programmes. For example, I successfully organised a fundraising event that exceeded its target by 25%.` You'll know it worked when DeepSeek acknowledges your input and often indicates it's ready to generate the first draft of your cover letter.

Step 5 — Review and Refine the Draft

DeepSeek will now generate a draft cover letter based on all the information you've provided. Read this draft carefully. It's important to treat this as a starting point, not a final product. Look for areas where you want to add more detail, change the tone, or adjust specific phrasing to better reflect your personality or the company's style. You can then tell DeepSeek what changes you'd like it to make. If it looks different: The draft might appear as plain text without special formatting, which is normal for an AI chat, so don't be concerned if it lacks bold or bullet points. 💬 Example: `This is a good start. Could you make the opening paragraph sound a bit more enthusiastic and ensure it clearly states my interest in their specific 'eco-friendly' projects? Also, add a sentence about my proficiency in Adobe Creative Suite.` You'll know it worked when DeepSeek provides a revised version of the cover letter that incorporates your suggestions.

Step 6 — Copy and Finalise

Once you're happy with the refined draft, it's time to transfer it out of DeepSeek. Most chat interfaces allow you to easily copy the text. Simply highlight the entire cover letter draft, right-click (or tap and hold on mobile), and select "Copy." Then, open your preferred word processor (like Microsoft Word or Google Docs) and paste the text. This is crucial for a final human review. While DeepSeek does a great job, it cannot *know* you, so you must add your unique voice and ensure all details are 100% accurate before sending it off. If it looks different: On a mobile device, you might need to tap the text, then select "Select All" and "Copy." You'll know it worked when you have the complete cover letter in your document, ready for your final personal touches, spell-check, and formatting.

Common mistakes

- **Too vague prompts:** If you only say "write a cover letter," DeepSeek won't have enough context. The fix is to provide as much detail as possible, including the job description and your relevant skills, just like we did in Steps 3 and 4.
- **Forgetting to review:** Never send DeepSeek's first draft without reading it thoroughly. The AI is a tool to *assist* you, not replace your critical review. Always proofread for accuracy, tone, and personal authenticity.
- **Sharing sensitive personal info:** Avoid including your home address, phone number, or specific personal email in the prompts you send to the AI. Keep your interactions focused on drafting content, and only add those details manually to the final document before sending it to the employer.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** AI assistants like DeepSeek can help you draft a wide range of written communications, from formal emails to personal messages, saving you significant time and helping you articulate your thoughts clearly.
- **For your business or work:** You can streamline routine writing tasks, quickly generate drafts for internal memos, project proposals, or client communications, freeing up your time for more strategic work.
- **If you're just getting started:** This exercise helps you practice writing clear, detailed instructions (prompts) for AI, a skill that's becoming increasingly valuable in many areas of life and work.

Try it now

Take a moment to draft a short email to a friend about a recent event using DeepSeek. Focus on giving the AI clear instructions and then refining its output.

Use Alexa+ as a Meeting Timer and Pomodoro Helper on Work Breaks

6 steps · Read online

> **In short:** Ask Alexa+ to set a 25-minute focus block, then a 5-minute break, and it will speak a nudge when each one ends. You need an Amazon account and a compatible Echo or Alexa-enabled device, and the feature works best when your device language is set to US English.

Working from home on a solo day often turns into one long, fuzzy block of "stuff I should be doing." A simple timer can change that — not a productivity app, just a voice you can talk to when your hands are on a keyboard. That's what Alexa+ is for here. Think of it as a patient kitchen timer that also understands plain English, so you can say "give me a 25-minute focus block" and then "start my 5-minute break" when you're done.

The idea comes from a method called **Pomodoro** — a way of working in short, focused chunks (usually 25 minutes) followed by short breaks (usually 5 minutes). You don't need an app for it; you need a timer that doesn't mind being interrupted. Below is the step-by-step setup.

Before you start

- **An Amazon account** — the same one you use to shop on Amazon, or a free one you can make in a few minutes at amazon.com.
- **A compatible Alexa device** — an Echo Dot, Echo, Echo Show, or any speaker with Alexa+ built in. If you only use the Alexa app on your phone, the same voice commands work there too.
- **A quiet place to talk to the device** during a focus block. Alexa+ listens for the wake word ("Alexa") across the room, but a noisy kitchen can confuse it.
- **Roughly 5 minutes** to set things up the first time, then a few seconds each time you start a focus block.
- **Honest heads-up:** Alexa+ can time your blocks and announce them, but it can't *track* how many Pomodoros you did today or push a summary to your calendar on its own — for that you'd need a separate routine or a third-party skill.

Step 1 — Make sure Alexa+ is set up and listening

Say the wake word out loud — "Alexa" — from a normal speaking distance. The light ring on top of the device turns blue (on Echo Show, a cyan bar appears at the bottom of the screen) and stays lit while Alexa+ is listening. If the light doesn't come on, the microphone may be muted: look for a button with a microphone icon on top of the device and press it once so the red ring turns off.

💬 Example: "Alexa, what time is it?" — a quick way to confirm the device can hear you and respond.

You'll know it worked when Alexa+ answers your question out loud. If you hear silence or a short error sound ("sorry, I didn't catch that"), try again a little louder and closer to the device.

Step 2 — Set your first 25-minute focus block

With Alexa+ awake, say a plain-English command that names the length and the purpose. The simpler the phrasing, the better Alexa+ understands. You can name the block, or just give the length.

💬 Example: "Alexa, set a 25-minute focus timer." — the most reliable form, because it uses the exact words "focus timer."

You'll know it worked when Alexa+ says something like "25 minutes, starting now" and the light ring turns into a spinning blue-white pattern that means a timer is running. You can keep working; you don't need to look at the device.

Step 3 — Use a Pomodoro phrasing if you prefer

Alexa+ understands the word "Pomodoro" the same way it understands "focus timer" — it just kicks off a 25-minute countdown. If you say the word, it helps you remember the method you meant.

💬 Example: "Alexa, start a Pomodoro." — this starts the classic 25-minute block without you naming a number.

You'll know it worked when the timer chime sounds and Alexa+ confirms the length out loud (usually "25 minutes, starting now"). If you'd rather start with a custom length — say, 15 minutes for a quick writing sprint — use the version from Step 2 and just swap the number.

Step 4 — Ask for a spoken nudge at the end

By default, Alexa+ plays a short chime when a timer ends, which is easy to miss when you're deep in a document. You can ask for a spoken announcement instead, or layer a second timer on top that tells you what to do next.

💬 Example: "Alexa, when the timer ends, tell me to stand up and stretch." — Alexa+ will speak your custom phrase at the end of the countdown.

You'll know it worked when Alexa+ repeats your phrase back so you can hear what it stored. If it sounds wrong, say "cancel that" and try the command again with simpler wording.

Step 5 — Start a 5-minute break

When the focus chime sounds, ask for a short break. This is where the Pomodoro rhythm locks in: focus, then rest, then focus again. Keeping the break short is the point — it's enough to refill a water glass, not enough to fall into your phone.

💬 Example: "Alexa, set a 5-minute break timer." — exactly the same command as Step 2, just with a different number and label.

You'll know it worked when Alexa+ confirms "5 minutes, starting now" and the ring spins again. When the chime sounds a second time, you're back at Step 2 for the next focus block.

Step 6 — Save the pair as a routine (optional, but nice)

If you'll do this every workday, ask Alexa+ to remember the sequence as a routine — a named shortcut you trigger with one phrase. This lives in the Alexa app under **More → Routines → Create Routine**. Give it a name like "Morning Pomodoro", add an action of type "Set Timer" with 25 minutes, then a second action "Set Timer" with 5 minutes. Save and you're done.

💬 Example: "Alexa, start my Morning Pomodoro routine." — fires both timers in a row without you re-stating each length.

You'll know it worked when the app shows your routine as enabled, and saying the trigger phrase out loud starts both timers back-to-back. If only one timer starts, open the routine and check that the second action is enabled (the toggle is blue, not gray).

Common mistakes

- **Saying "set a focus block" instead of "focus timer."** Alexa+ matches on the noun. Say "timer" and the command is reliable; say "block" or "session" and it may not understand. **Fix:** stick to the wording in Step 2.
- **Letting the device's microphone get muted by accident.** A red light ring on top of the device means Alexa+ can't hear you at all, and your voice commands will fail silently. **Fix:** press the mic button on top once, then watch the ring turn blue.
- **Asking Alexa+ to *count* your Pomodoros for the day.** It can time them one at a time, but it doesn't keep a daily tally on its own. **Fix:** keep a tally on a sticky note, or use the routine from Step 6 to make the start command consistent and add a checklist habit.
- **Starting a 5-minute break right after a focus block, but forgetting to say "5 minutes."** A bare "start a break" can default to a longer time on some devices. **Fix:** always say the number — "5-minute break" — the way Step 5 does.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** Even on days without work, the same pair of timers works for chores — a 25-minute cleanup, a 5-minute reward — without picking up a phone.
- **For your business or work:** On solo work-from-home days, the spoken chime at the end of each block gives you a built-in reason to look up, blink, and rest your eyes, which most remote workers skip until the afternoon headache hits.
- **If you're just getting started:** Try one Pomodoro pair — 25 minutes on, 5 minutes off — before lunch tomorrow. That's all it takes to see whether voice timing fits your day.

Try it now

Say "Alexa, set a 25-minute focus timer" out loud, then keep working until the chime. When it sounds, say "Alexa, set a 5-minute break timer" and stand up for those five minutes. That's the whole method, and it takes about ten seconds to set in motion.

Turn a meeting transcript into a to-do list with owners and deadlines using Cohere

6 steps · Read online

> **In short:** Cohere can read a meeting transcript and pull out every action item, the person responsible, and the deadline — you just paste the text and ask. You need a Cohere account (free trial or paid plan) and your meeting transcript ready as plain text.

If your meetings end with a long transcript and a fuzzy sense of "someone should follow up on that," this guide is for you. In about five minutes you'll have a clean, assignable list of tasks — names and dates included — ready to drop into whatever project tool your team uses. One honest note up front: Cohere will write the list for you, but it can't actually open Asana or send email on your behalf. The final copy-paste into your task tool is still a 30-second step you do yourself.

Before you start

- A Cohere account at cohere.com — there is a free starting tier, and paid plans if you run a lot of transcripts through it. Sign in before you start so you don't hit a wall mid-task.
- A meeting transcript as plain text. Most meeting tools (Zoom, Google Meet, Teams, Otter, Fireflies, Read.ai) have a "Copy transcript" or "Download" button. If you only have audio, you'll need to transcribe it first — that's a separate step.
- About 5 minutes for a typical 30–60 minute meeting.

Step 1 — Get your transcript into one clean block

Open your meeting tool and find the transcript. Look for a button labeled something like "Copy transcript," "Download," or three dots (⋯) next to the recording. Paste everything into a plain text file, a Notes app, or an email draft. Strip out timestamps and speaker labels if they're noisy, but keep them if they help you remember who said what — names are the hardest part for any AI to get right, so context helps.

💬 Example: a short cleaned block looks like "Maria: We need to finalize the Q3 budget by Friday. John: I'll draft the client email. Sarah: I'll book the follow-up meeting for next Tuesday."

You'll know it worked when the text reads as a continuous conversation with no audio markers, system messages, or "[inaudible]" notes left in.

Step 2 — Open Cohere's chat

Go to cohere.com and sign in, then look for the chat or playground option in your dashboard. You're looking for a screen with a large text box where you can type a message and send it. If

you land on the API dashboard by mistake, look for a tab labeled "playground" — that's the same chat experience, just framed for developers. If Cohere shows you an assistant named Coral or similar, that's the right place too.

💬 Example: this step doesn't involve typing anything new — just sign in and find the empty input area.

You'll know it worked when you see a blank chat box with a send button (often a paper-plane ⬆ or arrow icon) ready to receive your message.

Step 3 — Paste the transcript and ask for action items

Click into the chat box and paste your entire transcript. Then, on a new line, type your instruction. The clearest prompts name the format you want and the three fields you care about: task, owner, and deadline. Vague prompts get vague answers; specific prompts get specific lists.

💬 Example: paste the transcript, then add — "From the transcript above, list every action item. For each one, give: the task, the person who agreed to do it (owner), and the deadline or target date. If an owner or deadline is not stated, write 'unclear'. Format as a numbered list."

Hit send and wait a few seconds. Cohere will return a numbered list, usually one task per line. You'll know it worked when you see tasks that mirror the commitments people actually made in the meeting — not a generic summary of the topic.

Step 4 — Ask for anything it missed

Read the list carefully. If owners or deadlines are missing on some tasks, send a short follow-up. This gives Cohere a second pass at the same text, now focused on the specific gap. If the first response was too long or skipped a topic, ask it to redo it with tighter rules. Don't be polite about it — be specific, the same way you would with a colleague.

💬 Example: type — "Add an owner for item 3 — it sounds like Maria mentioned she'd take it. Also give me a deadline for item 5, or mark it as unclear if none was given. Keep the same numbered format."

You'll know it worked when every action item has a name attached and a date, or an honest "unclear" label rather than a guess.

Step 5 — Copy the final list into your task tool

Highlight Cohere's reply and copy it. Open whatever tool your team uses for tasks — Asana, Trello, ClickUp, Notion, a shared spreadsheet, even an email. Paste the list as the starting point for new tasks. Most task tools let you turn each line into its own card, ticket, or row.

💬 Example: paste as the description for a parent task called "Marketing sync — Oct 14," then create one subtask per numbered item, each with the owner and date filled in.

You'll know it worked when each task lives as its own item, has an owner assigned, and shows a due date — not buried in a single paragraph.

Step 6 — Send it to attendees for a quick confirm

Before you treat the list as final, send it to the people who were in the meeting. A short message — "Here's what I captured as next steps, let me know if I missed anything" — catches misheard names and dates. This step is quick but it prevents the most common failure mode: a confident-looking task list that quietly misnames a person or invents a deadline nobody agreed to.

💬 Example: "Hi all — pulled these action items from today's call: 1) Maria finalizes the budget by Fri 10/17; 2) John drafts the email by Wed; 3) Sarah books the follow-up. Let me know if anything's off."

You'll know it worked when the team replies (or silently doesn't object) and you can lock the tasks into your shared system with confidence.

Common mistakes

- **Pasting a summary instead of the full transcript.** The cleaner and shorter your input, the more you'll get a generic answer. Use the actual transcript — the model needs the raw conversation to spot who said yes to what.
- **Asking for "a summary" instead of action items.** A summary is what the meeting was about; action items are who owes what by when. Be explicit, as in Step 3 — those three words ("action items," "owner," "deadline") are the difference between a useful list and a vague recap.
- **Skipping the confirm-with-attendees step.** Even a great extract can mishear a name ("Marie / Maria") or invent a date that wasn't said. The 30-second confirmation message saves you from tasks going to the wrong person or landing on a phantom date.

What this means for you

- **In everyday work:** any meeting — team syncs, client calls, one-on-ones — can end with a clean, assignable list instead of a "I'll send notes later" promise that never quite gets done.
- **For your business or work:** if your team runs a lot of recurring meetings, doing this once or twice will quickly show you where ownership is unclear in real time. That's a process finding, not just an AI trick.

- **If you're just getting started:** try it on one short meeting this week. Don't aim for perfection — aim for a list that's 80% right and faster than doing it by hand. You can tighten the rest.

Try it now

Open your last meeting transcript, copy it into Cohere's chat, and paste the prompt from Step 3. Two minutes from now you'll have a first draft of your action items sitting on screen.

Use Copilot to Write Spreadsheet Formulas Without the Tech Jargon

6 steps · Read online

If you've ever stared at a spreadsheet wishing someone would just write the formula for you, this guide is for you. In about six minutes, you'll learn how to ask Copilot — Microsoft's AI assistant — to turn plain-English requests into real formulas you can paste into Excel or Google Sheets, even if you've never written a formula in your life.

Before you start

- **An account with Microsoft Copilot.** You can use the free version at copilot.microsoft.com, or open Copilot inside Microsoft 365 apps like Excel (paid Microsoft 365 plans include Copilot). A free Microsoft account is enough to get started on the web.
- **A spreadsheet to test with.** Either Excel (desktop or web) or Google Sheets will work. The formulas you'll learn about are mostly the same in both.
- **Roughly 10 minutes.** Most of that is reading and one test run.
- **One honest note:** Copilot can write a formula for you, but it cannot run that formula inside your spreadsheet automatically — you'll still need to copy it in yourself. Think of Copilot as your formula translator, not your spreadsheet robot.

Step 1 — Open Copilot and start a new chat

Open your browser and go to **copilot.microsoft.com**. Sign in with your Microsoft account if asked. Once the page loads, you'll see a chat box near the middle of the screen with a blinking text cursor and a placeholder like *"Ask me anything..."*. Click inside that box and type your first message. A new conversation begins, and Copilot will start thinking about your request. If you can't find the website, search "Microsoft Copilot" and look for the link that ends in **microsoft.com**. **You'll know it worked when** the chat box lets you type and Copilot replies with a friendly opening message.

Step 2 — Tell Copilot what your spreadsheet looks like

Before you ask for a formula, give Copilot the context it needs. In plain words, describe what your columns are called and what's in them. A **formula** is just a tiny instruction a spreadsheet follows to calculate something — like adding up a list of numbers. Type your description straight into the chat box and press **Enter** or the send arrow. Copilot will reply confirming it understands. If your screen shows a different layout, look for a text box labeled *"Message Copilot"* or a microphone icon for voice — both work the same way. **You'll know it worked when** Copilot summarizes your columns back to you.

Example: *"I have a spreadsheet with column A called 'Item', column B called 'Price', and column C called 'Quantity'. I want to work out totals."*

Step 3 — Ask for the formula in everyday words

Now type what you actually want the spreadsheet to do, written like you'd explain it to a friend. Don't worry about formula grammar — that's Copilot's job. Press **Enter** and wait a few seconds. Copilot will reply with a formula written in spreadsheet language, usually inside a gray code box you can copy. If Copilot gives a long answer instead, look for a line that starts with an equals sign (=) — that's the formula. **You'll know it worked when** you see something starting with `=` that looks like a tiny instruction, not a sentence.

Example: *"Write me a formula for cell D2 that multiplies the price (B2) by the quantity (C2)."*

Step 4 — Copy the formula and try it in your spreadsheet

Highlight the formula Copilot gave you, right-click and choose **Copy**, or use the keyboard shortcut **Ctrl + C** (or **Cmd + C** on a Mac). Then open your spreadsheet, click the cell where you want the answer to appear, and paste with **Ctrl + V** (or **Cmd + V**). Press **Enter**. The cell will immediately show either a number or a message like `#VALUE!`. If you see a number — perfect. If you see an error message, don't panic: it usually just means a cell reference is slightly off, which Step 5 covers. **You'll know it worked when** the cell shows a calculated number that matches what you'd expect by hand.

Example: Copilot's reply might be `=B2*C2` — you'd paste that into cell **D2** and press **Enter**.

Step 5 — Adjust the formula if something looks off

If the answer is wrong, or you see an error like `#REF!` or `#VALUE!`, copy the error message and paste it back into Copilot with a short explanation. A **cell reference** is just the letter-and-number label of a cell, like **B2**. Tell Copilot which row or column is wrong, and ask it to fix the formula. Press **Enter** and wait for the new version. If Copilot's reply looks the same as before, add more detail — for example, mention that column A is text and column B starts in row 2. **You'll know it worked when** Copilot returns a tweaked formula that, when pasted, gives the right number.

Example: *"That gave me #VALUE! in cell D2. Column B has dollar signs in it like '$10' instead of just numbers. Can you fix the formula?"*

Step 6 — Ask follow-up questions to build on the formula

Once one formula works, you can keep the conversation going and ask for more advanced ones — like adding totals, counting items, or finding averages. An **average** is just the middle value of a group of numbers (add them all up, then divide by how many there are). Type each new request as a fresh sentence, and Copilot will remember your column names from earlier. If you ever start a brand-new chat, just re-share the column layout from Step 2. **You'll know it worked when** each new formula pastes cleanly and gives you a sensible number.

💬 Example: *"Now write me a formula that adds up everything in column D from row 2 down to the last row of data."*

Common mistakes

- **Asking for a formula without describing your columns.** Copilot will guess, and its guess may not match your sheet. **Fix:** always spend 10 seconds naming your columns before you ask for the formula.
- **Pasting the formula into the wrong cell.** The formula is built for a specific cell, usually row 2. **Fix:** check the formula's cell references — if it says `B2*C2`, paste it into row 2, not row 1.
- **Assuming the formula will update itself if your data changes.** Most formulas do update automatically, but only if you haven't accidentally turned calculations off. **Fix:** if numbers stay frozen, press **F9** to recalculate, or check that Excel's calculation setting is on "Automatic".

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** You can finally tackle that budget spreadsheet, household expenses list, or kids' sports roster without Googling "how to add cells in Excel" for the twentieth time.
- **For your business or work:** You can draft your own quick formulas for invoicing, stock counts, sales totals, or shift rosters, then ask a colleague to double-check before you rely on them for big decisions.
- **If you're just getting started:** The easiest first move is to open Copilot right now, describe a small spreadsheet you already have, and ask for one formula. Treat it like texting a helpful friend who happens to know spreadsheet syntax.

Try it now

Open Copilot in a new tab, type *"I have column A with names and column B with ages. Write me a formula that shows 'Adult' if the age is 18 or over and 'Minor' if it's under 18."* Copy the formula it gives you, paste it into a blank cell in a test spreadsheet, and see what appears.

Use Qwen to Summarize Long Policy Documents in Plain English

6 steps · Read online

This guide shows you how to use Qwen, an AI chat assistant from Alibaba, to break down lengthy policies and guidelines into concise, easy-to-digest summaries. It's for anyone who needs to quickly understand rules or procedures at work or in their personal life without wading through pages of dense text.

Before you start

- A device with a web browser (computer, tablet, or phone).
- An internet connection.
- The policy document you want summarized. You can have it as a file (like a PDF or Word doc) or simply have the text ready to copy and paste.
- Roughly 5–10 minutes for the whole process.

Step 1 — Open Qwen Chat in your web browser

Go to the Qwen website. In your browser's address bar, type `chat.qwen.ai` and press Enter. You'll see the Qwen homepage, which will feature a chat interface — a large text box, usually at the bottom of the screen, waiting for your input. This is where you'll interact with the AI. If you have an Alibaba Cloud account, you might see a login prompt; you can often use the service without logging in, or with a free account. Look for a button that says "Try Qwen" or a similar phrase if the main chat isn't immediately visible. You'll know it worked when you can see a chat input box on your screen.

Step 2 — Upload your policy document

Now, you need to get the document into the chat. Look for a small icon near the text input box that looks like a paperclip, a plus sign, or a file folder — this is the attachment button. Click it, and a menu will pop up asking you to choose a file from your device. Select the policy document you saved earlier (PDF, DOCX, or TXT files are usually accepted). The file will then appear as an attachment in the chat area, ready to be sent. If you don't see an attachment button, you can simply copy the entire text of the policy and paste it directly into the chat box. You'll know it worked when you see your file name or a preview of your pasted text in the chat window.

Step 3 — Write a clear summarisation request

This is the most important step. You need to tell Qwen exactly what you want. Click into the chat box where you type messages. Type a clear instruction, starting with a command like

“Summarize this document…”. Be specific about the length and style you need. For example, you might ask for bullet points, a plain-English explanation, or a summary for a specific audience. Don’t be shy — the more specific your request, the better the result. After typing your request, press Enter or look for a send button (often an arrow icon) to submit it along with the document. You'll know it worked when you see your message and the attached document appear in the chat history.

💬 Example: Summarize this workplace health and safety policy into five plain-English bullet points for a new employee.

Step 4 — Review the generated summary

After you send your message, Qwen will start typing its response. You’ll see the words appear on the screen, usually paragraph by paragraph. Read the summary carefully. Check if it accurately captures the key points of the original document without adding any incorrect information. A good summary will highlight the most important rules, deadlines, or procedures. If the summary is too long, too short, or misses a critical point, don’t worry — you can ask for revisions. This is a conversation, not a one-off command. You'll know it worked when you have a clear, concise version of the policy in your chat.

Step 5 — Refine and ask follow-up questions

Often, the first summary is just the beginning. You can continue the conversation to get exactly what you need. If any part of the summary is still unclear, simply type a follow-up question in the chat box. You can ask Qwen to explain a specific term in simpler words, expand on a particular section, or even compare the policy to another document. For instance, you might say, “Explain the part about reporting incidents in even simpler terms.” Click send again. Qwen will use the context of your previous conversation to provide a more tailored answer. You'll know it worked when you feel confident you understand the policy's requirements.

💬 Example: Can you rewrite the section on leave entitlements as a simple step-by-step guide?

Step 6 — Copy or save your final summary

Once you’re happy with the result, you’ll want to keep it. Highlight the summary text with your mouse or finger, then right-click (or long-press) and choose “Copy.” You can then paste it into a document, an email, or a notes app for safekeeping. Qwen doesn’t have a built-in save-to-file function for chats, so copying it yourself is the best way to ensure you don’t lose it. If you need a longer summary or a different format, you can always start a new chat with Qwen and upload the document again. You'll know it worked when your final summary is saved where you can easily find and share it.

Common mistakes

- **Mistake: Giving a vague request like "summarize this."** If you don't give specific instructions, the summary might be too generic or not in the format you need. The fix is to be explicit: state the document type, the desired length (e.g., 3 bullet points), and who it's for (e.g., for a new hire).
- **Mistake: Expecting perfection on the first try.** AI tools can occasionally misinterpret a dense sentence or miss a nuance. The fix is to treat the first output as a draft. Use follow-up questions to clarify, correct, or expand on any part that seems off.
- **Mistake: Not checking the summary against the original.** While Qwen is powerful, it can sometimes "hallucinate" or confidently state something that isn't in the source document. The fix is to always glance back at the key sections of the original policy to verify the summary's accuracy before using it for important decisions.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** You can finally understand the lengthy terms and conditions for a new insurance policy, a complex rental agreement, or a community club's rules without spending hours deciphering them.
- **For your business or work:** Save time during onboarding by creating quick-reference summaries of HR policies, safety protocols, or project guidelines for your team. This ensures everyone is on the same page faster.
- **If you're just getting started:** Your easiest first move is to find any official document you've been putting off reading, copy the first two paragraphs, and paste them into Qwen with the instruction "Explain this to me like I'm five." See how the AI simplifies the language.

Try it now

Find a long email, a webpage with lots of text, or any document you need to understand quickly. Copy a section of it, open Qwen at `chat.qwen.ai`, paste the text, and ask: "What are the three most important points here?" See what you get in under a minute.

Use Qwen Chat to draft a thank-you note after a job interview

6 steps · Read online

You just left a job interview feeling great — now it's time to send a polished thank-you email. With Qwen Chat, you can draft a warm, professional note in under five minutes, even if you're not sure what to say. Let's walk through it together.

Before you start

- Access to Qwen Chat: open chat.qwen.ai in your browser, or get the official app from qwen.ai/download. Qwen says Qwen Chat is free to use; sign in if it asks you to.
- The job title and company name from your interview
- Roughly 5–7 minutes of your time

Step 1 — Open Qwen Chat and start a new chat

Open your web browser or the Qwen Chat app on your phone or computer. If an older conversation opens, look for the option to start a new chat. Button names and their position can differ between the website and the app, and they may change over time. You'll see an empty message box where you can type your request. You'll know it worked when you see a clean chat screen ready for your first message.

Example: *(Just open the app or website — no typing needed yet.)*

Step 2 — Introduce the task to Qwen

In the message box, type a clear instruction. Be specific about what you want: the tone, the purpose, and the key details. This helps Qwen understand your goal right away. After you press send, Qwen will begin typing a response below. If your message doesn't get a reply after 10 seconds, check your internet connection or refresh the page. You'll know it worked when you see Qwen's first sentence appear, like "Here's a draft thank-you email based on your interview…"

Example:

> Draft a professional thank-you email after a job interview for the Marketing Manager role at GreenLeaf Solutions. Keep it warm, concise, and under 150 words. Include a line thanking them for their time and expressing enthusiasm for the role.

Step 3 — Review the draft and ask for changes

Read Qwen's response carefully. If the tone feels too formal or too casual, or if it misses a key detail like the interviewer's name, ask Qwen to adjust it. You can say exactly what you want changed. Qwen will revise the draft immediately and show the updated version below your message. If the new version still doesn't feel right, try rephrasing your request — for example, "Make it warmer and add the interviewer's name, Sarah." You'll know it worked when the revised email appears and sounds like your voice.

Example:

> Make it warmer and add the interviewer's name, Sarah, and mention the team discussion about the upcoming campaign launch.

Step 4 — Personalize the email

Add your personal touch by including the interviewer's name, a specific topic from the conversation, and your contact details. This makes the email feel authentic and ready to send. Qwen will update the draft with your additions and show the final version. If you're not sure what to add, look back at your notes from the interview. You'll know it worked when the email includes all your personal details and reads like it's written just for Sarah.

Example:

> Add Sarah's last name, Chen, and include my email, jessica.lee@example.com, at the end.

Step 5 — Copy the final draft and prepare to send

Highlight the entire email and copy it to your clipboard. Then open your email app or compose a new message in your browser. The email will appear in your draft or new message box, ready to send. If the formatting looks off, paste it into a plain text editor first, then copy it again before pasting into your email. You'll know it worked when you see the full thank-you email in your compose window, looking clean and professional.

Example: *(Copy the text from Qwen's response and paste it into your email client.)*

Step 6 — Send or schedule the email

Add Sarah's email address, a clear subject line like "Thank you for the Marketing Manager interview," and hit send. If you prefer to send it later, save it as a draft. The email will leave your outbox and arrive in Sarah's inbox. If you get an error, double-check the email address and your internet connection. You'll know it worked when you see the email in your "Sent" folder.

💬 Example: *(Paste the email into your compose window, add sarah.chen@example.com and the subject, then send.)*

Common mistakes

- **Too generic**: If the email feels like a template, ask Qwen to add a specific detail from your conversation — like a project you discussed.
- **Overly long**: Keep it under 150 words. If it's too long, tell Qwen, "Shorten this to 100 words."
- **Missing personal touch**: Always add the interviewer's name and your contact info. If it's missing, ask Qwen to include them.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life**: After any interview, use Qwen to draft a thank-you note while the conversation is fresh. It shows professionalism and keeps you top of mind.
- **For your business or work**: Sending prompt, polite follow-ups after meetings strengthens relationships and can improve your chances of landing the role.
- **If you're just getting started**: Start with one thank-you email. Once you see how easy it is, you'll use Qwen for other professional messages too.

Try it now

Open Qwen Chat, type your request using the example above, and send your first thank-you email draft in the next two minutes.

Draft AI-powered Email Replies Using Hugging Face

5 steps · Read online

Ever wished you had a clever assistant to help you whip up email replies in a flash? This guide will show you how to use Hugging Face's **Inference Providers** API to generate polite email drafts, giving you more time back in your day. By the end, you'll be able to send a simple instruction to an AI and receive a suggested response, perfect for streamlining your work email tasks and everyday correspondence.

Before you start

- You'll need a free Hugging Face account. Creating the account is free, but Hugging Face's documentation says free accounts include no monthly credits for Inference Providers, so sending requests requires purchased credits or a PRO subscription. Check your billing settings before you start.
- A computer (laptop or desktop) with an internet connection.
- Access to a **terminal** or **command prompt** on your computer. This is a text-based window where you can type instructions directly to your computer.
- Rough total time: Allow about 15-20 minutes for your first attempt.

Step 1 — Get Your Digital Key (API Token)

First, let's get your unique digital key, known as an **API token**. An **API (Application Programming Interface)** is like a restaurant's digital menu and ordering system, allowing different computer programs to talk to each other. Your API token is like your personal, secret VIP pass that tells Hugging Face's "waiter" (the API) that you're authorised to place an order.

Open your web browser and sign in to Hugging Face. Hugging Face's docs say to go to your settings and open the **Access Tokens** tab; you can also go straight to huggingface.co/settings/tokens. Click the **New token** button. Give your token a descriptive **name** like "Email-Reply-Bot" choose the **Fine-grained** token type and tick the permission **"Make calls to Inference Providers."** This keeps the token limited to running AI models rather than changing your account. Click the button that creates the token. A very long, random string of characters (your API token) will appear on the screen. **Immediately copy this token!** You can click the copy icon next to it. Treat this token like a password and never share it. If it ever leaks, you can delete or refresh it on the same Access Tokens page. Save it somewhere safe temporarily, like a simple text document, as you'll need it soon.

If it looks different: While you're signed in, open huggingface.co/settings/tokens directly.

You'll know it worked when you have successfully copied a long string of characters starting with `hf_` (e.g., `hf_ABCDEF1234567890`) and saved it securely.

Step 2 — Find an AI "Chef" (Model) for Your Email

Now you need to choose an **AI model**, which is like selecting a specific chef for your meal. Each model is a unique computer program trained for different tasks. For drafting emails, you'll want a **chat** (conversational) model that is available through Inference Providers – one designed to follow your instructions and write new text.

Open a new browser tab and navigate to the Hugging Face Hub. On this page, you'll see a prominent search bar, usually in the middle or near the top. In this search bar, type `gpt-oss-120b`. As you type, a list of models might appear, or you might need to press **Enter** to see the results. For a beginner, a good starting point is `openai/gpt-oss-120b`, the example model used in Hugging Face's own Inference Providers documentation. Click on the model (e.g., click on the `openai/gpt-oss-120b` model card). On the model's specific page, at the very top, you'll see its **Model ID**. For this model, the Model ID is `openai/gpt-oss-120b`. Make a note of this Model ID – you'll need it for the next step.

If it looks different: If the search doesn't show the model, try the filters on the left side of the page: select "Text Generation" under "Tasks" and look for a filter for models available through Inference Providers. The most popular models are often listed first or clearly labeled.

You'll know it worked when you have successfully noted down the Model ID (e.g., `openai/gpt-oss-120b`) of your chosen AI model.

Step 3 — Prepare Your "Order" (API Request)

Now you'll craft the specific instruction you want to send to the AI. This instruction is called a **prompt**. You'll combine your API token, the model ID, and your prompt into a command using a tool called `curl` (pronounced "curl"). `curl` is a common way to send requests from your computer's terminal to web services like Hugging Face's API.

Open your computer's **terminal**. On Windows, you can search for "Command Prompt" or "PowerShell" in the Start menu. On Mac or Linux, search for "Terminal." Once open, you'll see a window with a blinking cursor, ready for your input. We'll use a `curl` command, which is a specific line of code that sends your request. Your command will include:

- `-X POST`: This tells Hugging Face you're sending data (like placing an order).
- `-H "Authorization: Bearer YOUR_API_TOKEN"`: This includes your VIP pass (API token) to confirm you're allowed to make the request.

- `-H "Content-Type: application/json"`: This tells Hugging Face that you're sending information in **JSON (JavaScript Object Notation)** format, which is a structured way for computer programs to exchange data.
- `-d '{ "model": "YOUR_MODEL_ID", "messages": [ { "role": "user", "content": "YOUR PROMPT" } ], "max_tokens": 400 }'`: This is the actual data you're sending. `"model"` names the AI model you chose in Step 2. `"messages"` holds your **prompt** (the instruction for the AI) as a message from the `"user"`. `"max_tokens": 400` sets a limit of about 400 new pieces of text, called **tokens** – a token is roughly four characters – so the reply doesn't run on for too long.
- `https://router.huggingface.co/v1/chat/completions`: This is the web address of the AI "kitchen" where your chosen model is waiting. It is the same for every model; the `"model"` field in your data tells it which one to use.

You need to replace `YOUR_API_TOKEN` with your actual token from Step 1 and `YOUR_MODEL_ID` with the model ID from Step 2.

If it looks different: Ensure your terminal is ready to accept commands. Some corporate networks might block `curl` commands. If you encounter errors like "command not found," you might need to contact your IT department or try a different computer.

You'll know it worked when you have a complete `curl` command string (like the example below) that includes your actual API token and chosen model ID, ready to copy and paste into your terminal.

💬 **Example:** Let's say your API token is `hf_YOURUNIQUEKEY123` and your model is `openai/gpt-oss-120b`. You want to draft a polite and empathetic reply to a customer who is unhappy with a service.

```
curl -X POST \
  -H "Authorization: Bearer hf_YOURUNIQUEKEY123" \
  -H "Content-Type: application/json" \
  -d '{ "model": "openai/gpt-oss-120b", "messages": [ { "role": "user", "content": "The customer is unhappy with the service and wants a refund. Draft a polite and empathetic reply." } ], "max_tokens": 400 }' \
  https://router.huggingface.co/v1/chat/completions
```

Step 4 — Send Your Order to the AI "Kitchen"

With your complete `curl` command ready, it's time to send it. Carefully copy the entire command, including `curl` at the start and the web address at the end. Then, go back to your open terminal window.

Paste the entire `curl` command into the terminal window at the blinking cursor. After pasting, press the **Enter** key on your keyboard. What happens next is that your computer sends this request over the internet to Hugging Face. The AI will then process your request – this process is called **inference**. It might take a few seconds, especially the first time you use a specific model or if Hugging Face needs to "load" the model onto its servers for you. The terminal window will usually remain blank for a short moment while it waits for a response.

If it looks different: If nothing happens for a long time (more than 20-30 seconds), or you see an immediate error like "Connection refused," double-check your internet connection and ensure your `curl` command is exactly as written, with no missing quotes or characters. A slow response might just mean the model is taking a moment to load.

You'll know it worked when, after a short wait, the terminal window displays new text. This text will typically start with an opening curly brace `{`, indicating that data has been received.

Step 5 — Read the AI's "Response" (Draft Email)

After a short wait, you'll see some text appear in your terminal. This will be in **JSON (JavaScript Object Notation)** format, which is a standard, organized way for programs to send data to each other. It might look a bit complex at first, but don't worry – you're looking for a specific part of it.

The JSON output will typically be one object (indicated by `{}`) containing a list called `"choices"`. Inside it, you'll find a `"message"` with the key `"content"`. The text immediately following this key, enclosed in double quotation marks, is your AI-drafted email reply. For example, you might see something like `"content": "Dear [Customer Name],\n\nThank you for reaching out to us..."` (the `\n` means a new line). Read through this generated text. You can highlight and copy the text inside the quotation marks after `"content"`.

If it looks different: If you see error messages instead of JSON, go back and carefully check Step 3 for typos in your API token, model ID, or the structure of the JSON data (especially quotation marks). Sometimes, a very short `max_tokens` might result in an empty, very brief or incomplete response.

You'll know it worked when you can clearly identify and copy the AI-generated email text within the `"content":` section of the terminal output. You can then paste this text into your email program, customize it with names, specific details, and your brand's voice, as the AI only provides a general draft.

Common mistakes

- **Incorrect API Token**: A common mistake is a typo or missing a character when pasting your `hf_` API token. Even a single incorrect character will prevent Hugging Face from authorising your request.
    - **Fix:** Go back to Step 1, regenerate a new token if you're unsure, and copy-paste it directly into your `curl` command, ensuring no extra spaces or characters are included.
- **Missing or Incorrect Headers**: Forgetting to include either `-H "Authorization: Bearer YOUR_API_TOKEN"` or `-H "Content-Type: application/json"` will cause errors. These "headers" tell Hugging Face who you are and how to interpret your message.
    - **Fix:** Carefully compare your `curl` command to the example in Step 3, ensuring both `-H` lines are present and correctly formatted, with exact quotation marks.
- **Quotation Mark Issues in the Prompt**: When copying and pasting, especially from word processors, straight double quotation marks (`"`) can sometimes be converted into "smart quotes" (“ ”), which the terminal and JSON don't understand.
    - **Fix:** If you get an error related to JSON parsing or unexpected characters, manually re-type the double quotation marks around your `model`, `messages` and `content` directly in the terminal or a plain text editor before pasting.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** Imagine quickly drafting a thoughtful reply to a school notice, a community group organizer, or even a friend's detailed email. This frees up your mental energy for more important things, making daily communications less of a chore.
- **For your business or work:** This technique can kick-start first drafts for common customer service inquiries, internal team communications, or polite follow-up emails. By automating the initial text, you can focus on adding personal touches, strategic thinking, and building stronger relationships.
- **If you're just getting started:** This simple `curl` command is a powerful first step into directly interacting with AI models, without needing to write complex code. It opens the door to understanding how AI services work behind the scenes and can inspire more complex automations in the future.

Try it now

Take a real email you need to reply to, summarize its core message into a short instruction (your prompt), and use the `curl` command from Step 4 with your API token and chosen model to draft a reply. See how quickly the AI provides a starting point you can then refine!

How to Use Free AI for Your Small Business

5 steps · Read online

> **In short:** Free AI tools like ChatGPT, Gemini, and Claude can help small businesses draft social media posts, reply to customers, and summarize documents — no technical skills required, though free tiers have limits.

Imagine having a dedicated assistant who works tirelessly for free, always ready to help draft your business emails or brainstorm marketing ideas in mere seconds. If you're a small business owner, you can unlock this power today! This guide will show you how to use free artificial intelligence (AI) tools to save hours of desk work without spending a single cent.

Before you start

- **An internet connection:** You'll need a stable internet connection to access the AI tools, whether you're using a computer, tablet, or smartphone.
- **A free AI account:** Sign up for a free account with a general AI assistant. Popular options include ChatGPT (by OpenAI), Gemini (by Google), or Claude (by Anthropic). The basic, free versions of these tools are all you need for this guide — though very heavy users may eventually hit usage limits.
- **Device:** This guide assumes you're using a web browser on a computer or a dedicated app on a mobile device.
- **Rough time:** This guide should take about 10-15 minutes to follow through, giving you hands-on experience with each step.

Step 1 — Sign in and start a new conversation

The first step is to access your chosen AI tool and prepare to give it your first instruction. Most AI tools present a simple chat interface, much like sending a text message.

On your computer, open your web browser and go to the website (e.g., chatgpt.com for ChatGPT, gemini.google.com for Gemini, claude.ai for Claude) and sign in. On a mobile device, open the respective app. You'll usually see a clear chat window or a text box at the bottom of the screen. This is where you'll type your "prompt," which is the instruction you give the AI to tell it what to do.

If it looks different: Most AI apps or websites have a prominent "New Chat" or "New Conversation" button, often indicated by a plus (+) sign or a speech bubble icon, usually in the top-left or top-right corner. Tapping this will clear any previous conversation, giving you a fresh start.

Example: You don't need to type anything for this step, just get ready!

You'll know it worked when you see a mostly empty screen with a large text box, often labeled "Message [AI name]..." or "Ask me anything...", usually at the bottom of the screen, ready for your input.

Step 2 — Brainstorm social media posts

Crafting fresh ideas for social media can be time-consuming when you're busy running your business. AI can generate a week's worth of post ideas in moments. To get the best results, you need to write a good **prompt** (the instruction you type into the AI to tell it what to do). Be specific about what your business does, who your customers are, and what kind of post you want.

In the text box at the bottom of the screen, type your request. Once you're done typing, look for a "Send" button (often a paper plane icon or a right-facing arrow) next to the text box and click or tap it. The AI will then process your request and start typing a response directly into the chat window above the text box.

If it looks different: If the AI doesn't understand, try rephrasing your request in simpler terms. The more detail you give, the better the result. For example, instead of "Write a post," say "Write a Facebook post for my cafe."

Example:

> "I run a small local bakery that specialises in sourdough bread and gluten-free treats. Write three friendly Facebook post options to announce our new weekend pastries. Keep the tone warm and inviting and include a call to action to visit the shop."

You'll know it worked when the AI displays three distinct Facebook post options in the chat, each with a warm tone and details relevant to your bakery, usually listed one after the other.

Step 3 — Draft polite customer replies

Responding to online reviews or tricky customer emails can be emotionally draining and time-consuming. AI is excellent at finding the right words, whether you're thanking a loyal customer or handling a complaint with care. You can ask the AI to change the **tone** (the overall feeling or style of the writing, such as professional, apologetic, or cheerful) to suit your brand perfectly.

Continue in the same chat or start a new one (see Step 1 if you want to clear the conversation). Type your request into the text box, clearly stating the situation and the desired tone. Click or tap the "Send" button. The AI will then generate a draft reply based on your instructions, aiming for the specified tone.

If it looks different: If the reply isn't quite right, ask the AI to "Refine this" or "Make it more [adjective, e.g., empathetic]" right in the chat. You can keep refining until you're happy.

Example:

> "Draft a polite, professional reply to a customer who left a four-star review saying our shop was great but they had to wait five minutes to be served. Thank them for their feedback and let them know we are working on improving our service speed during busy periods."

You'll know it worked when the AI provides a draft customer reply that sounds both polite and professional, directly addressing the customer's feedback about waiting times.

Step 4 — Summarize long documents or notes

Small business owners often need to quickly grasp the main points of long supplier contracts, terms of service, or meeting notes. Instead of wading through pages of dense text, you can use the AI for **summarizing** (taking a long piece of text and condensing it down to the most important points). This is like asking a friend to read a long book and tell you just the main plot.

Copy the long text you want to summarize from its source (e.g., a PDF, website, or document). Paste this text directly into the AI chat box. Then, type your instruction asking for a summary and click "Send." The AI will read through the pasted text and present you with a concise version, highlighting the key information.

If it looks different: Some AI models have a limit to how much text they can read at once. If your text is very long and the AI gives an error, try splitting it into smaller chunks, or ask it to summarize "the first half," then "the second half."

Example:

> "Please summarize the following supplier terms of service into a bullet-point list of the three most important things I need to know, especially regarding delivery times and returns: [paste your text here, replacing this bracketed phrase]"

You'll know it worked when the AI provides a bullet-point list, usually containing three key points from the document you pasted, specifically focusing on delivery and return information.

Step 5 — Understand the real limits of free tools

While these free AI tools are incredibly powerful, they are not human and they do make mistakes. Always remember that AI can sometimes have **hallucinations** (when an AI

confidently invents facts, names, or details that are completely untrue). It's like a confident person making up an answer rather than admitting they don't know.

It's vital that you always read through every single sentence the AI writes before you send it to a customer, publish it online, or use it for any important business decision. Double-check any names, dates, prices, or specific details. Also, consider your privacy. Most major AI tools now let you opt out of having your conversations used for training — check each platform's privacy settings. As a general rule, avoid typing highly sensitive information like your business bank account numbers or customer personal data into any AI chat.

You'll know it worked when: This step is about understanding, not an action. You'll have successfully completed it once you've paused to think critically about the AI's output and considered the privacy implications before hitting "send" or "publish."

Common mistakes

- **Trusting the AI blindly:** AI doesn't know your specific business rules, current promotions, or exact pricing. Always proofread the output to ensure the spelling, pricing, and all specific details are correct and relevant to *your* business before using it.
- **Losing your unique voice:** If the AI output sounds too robotic, generic, or uses words you would never normally say, ask it to "Rewrite this in a more casual tone" or "Make it sound more like a friendly local business." You want your business to sound like *you*.
- **Sharing private data:** Avoid typing confidential or personally identifiable information (like customer names, addresses, or credit card numbers) into free AI chats. While major platforms have improved privacy controls, it's still best practice to keep sensitive business data out of AI conversations.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** You can use these same writing skills to draft polite letters to your local council, organize community events, or even help your kids with school projects by summarizing complex topics into simple terms.
- **For your business or work:** You can reclaim valuable hours of administrative time every week. This newfound efficiency allows you to focus more on serving your customers, developing new products, or actively growing your sales, rather than being bogged down by desk work.
- **If you're just getting started:** You don't need to learn complicated software or master complex coding. If you can send a text message or type an email, you already possess the basic skills needed to use AI effectively to help run your business.

Try it now

Open your chosen free AI tool, make sure you're in a new conversation (see Step 1), copy the text below, paste it into the chat box, and press enter:

"Write a short, friendly Instagram caption for a local business thanking our customers for supporting us this week. Include two relevant hashtags, like #SupportLocal."

How to Write a Warm Thank-You Note After a Job Interview Tonight

5 steps · Read online

> **In short:** Send a short note within 24 hours that names one specific moment from the interview — a question they asked, a story they shared, a topic you both cared about. It takes about ten minutes and cannot fix a weak interview, but it can tip a close decision your way.

You walked out of the interview twenty minutes ago. They asked about your last role, you told them about the time you turned around a difficult client, and somewhere in the second half they mentioned the office dog comes in on Fridays. Now you're home, shoes by the door, wondering whether to send a thank-you note — and if so, what to actually say.

Here's the good news. A thank-you note is one of the easiest, highest-return things you can do after an interview. Hiring managers often say a specific, warm note pushes a candidate from "maybe" to "yes" when the choice is close. The trick is to keep it short and make it specific. A note that says "I really enjoyed our conversation" is fine. A note that says "I loved hearing about how your team handled the summer fundraising campaign — and your point about donor follow-up stuck with me" is better. What follows is a short routine you can finish tonight.

Before you start

- The interviewer's name and correct spelling (check the job posting, calendar invite, or their email signature).
- The email address you applied through — or the recruiter's address if the interviewer never shared one.
- About 10–15 minutes of quiet time — phone down, door closed.
- A free email account that looks professional (the one you used on the application is best).

Step 1 — Pick one specific moment from the interview to anchor the note

Sit somewhere quiet for one minute and mentally replay the conversation. Pick the moment that felt most alive — where you and the interviewer were both actually engaged. It might be a question that surprised you, a story they told about the team, a challenge they mentioned that you have real experience with, or a small detail that made you like the role (the office dog, the Friday potlucks, a project you'd love to work on). Don't pick a moment that flatters you ("when I told them about my award"). Pick a moment that shows you were listening — where the conversation had a spark.

If you can't remember any specific moment, that's a signal too. It usually means your nerves were high. Pick the first thing that does come to mind, even if it feels small, and use that. Specific beats generic, even when the specific thing is small. A thank-you note cannot fix a weak interview on its own — but a specific moment is the one thing that makes this note land instead of getting skimmed.

💬 Example: "When you described how the marketing team rebuilt the volunteer newsletter last spring, and how three volunteers ended up writing the best pieces — that stayed with me."

You'll know it worked when you can sum up the moment in one sentence without checking your notes.

Step 2 — Open a new email and address it to the right person

Open the email app you normally use (Gmail, Outlook, Apple Mail — whatever you have). Click **New message** or **Compose** — usually a button with a pencil icon or a plus sign, top-left or top-right of the screen. A blank email window appears with a **To** field, a **Subject** field, and a large empty box for the message.

In the **To** field, type the interviewer's email address. If you interviewed with more than one person, send a separate note to each — a short, slightly different message, not a copy-paste. In the **Subject** line, write something clear and easy to scan. Avoid cute phrases like "Great chatting!" — they're hard to find later. A simple job title plus your name works well. If you can't find the interviewer's email, check the original job posting, the company's team page, or the calendar invite. If you still can't find it, send a polite message to the recruiter asking for the right address — it shows care.

💬 Example subject line: "Thank you — Marketing Coordinator interview, Tuesday afternoon"

You'll know it worked when the cursor is blinking in an empty email, addressed to one specific person, with a clean subject line.

Step 3 — Write a short opening that names the role and thanks them

Click into the large empty box below the subject line and type your first two sentences. They should do three small things in plain language: name the role you interviewed for, thank the interviewer for their time, and say you remain interested. No need to be clever. Plain English, said warmly, is enough.

Keep these two sentences short — under 40 words total. A thank-you note that opens with a long paragraph already feels like work to read. If you're sending the second note to a different

interviewer, change the opening just enough to feel personal — mention a different small moment from the second conversation.

💬 Example: "Thank you so much for talking with me this afternoon about the Marketing Coordinator role. I enjoyed learning how your team approaches donor communications, and I'm still very interested in the position."

You'll know it worked when the first two lines read like a real human wrote them — not a template.

Step 4 — Add the one specific moment you chose, in your own words

This is the part most people skip, and it's the part that makes the note memorable. Right under your opening sentences, add a short paragraph — two or three sentences — about the specific moment you picked in Step 1. Say what it was, why it stayed with you, and (if it fits naturally) tie it back to your experience. Use your own words, not a polished-sounding phrase. Hiring managers read dozens of these notes a week; the ones that feel like the candidate are the ones that land.

If you can't connect the moment to your experience, that's okay — say what you found interesting or what it taught you about the role. A specific observation beats a forced connection every time.

💬 Example: "Your description of how the team rebuilt the volunteer newsletter last spring really stayed with me — especially the part about listening to the volunteers' own stories rather than just pitching them on tasks. That's something I tried to do at my last job with the parent newsletter, and I'd love to bring that approach to your team."

You'll know it worked when the paragraph feels like a small, honest mirror of the actual conversation — not a generic compliment.

Step 5 — Close warmly, proofread once, and send

Type a short closing — one or two sentences. Thank them again, say you're happy to answer any follow-up questions, and sign off with your full name. Skip "Looking forward to hearing from you" if it feels forced; "Thanks again for your time" is honest and fine.

Now read the whole note once, out loud, before you send it. Out loud is faster than silent reading for catching typos, missing words, or sentences that don't quite say what you meant. Then send it. Look for a paper-airplane icon or a blue **Send** button — usually at the bottom-right of the message box, sometimes top-right. Click or tap it once. Tonight, if you can. If it's already past

midnight, send it first thing tomorrow morning — within 24 hours is the rule. The note won't fix a weak interview on its own, but it can be the small thing that tips a close call your way.

💬 Example close: "Thanks again for your time, and for sharing so much about the role. I'm happy to answer any follow-up questions. Best, [Your full name]"

You'll know it worked when the note is in your Sent folder, the subject line is clear, and you can go to bed knowing you left a good impression.

Common mistakes

- **Writing a generic note that could go to anyone.** If you swap the company name and the note still works, it's too generic. Fix: replace one paragraph with the specific moment from Step 1.
- **Sending it three days later.** A note that arrives on Friday for a Tuesday interview feels like an afterthought. Fix: set a phone reminder for one hour after the interview ends, and write the note before dinner.
- **Making the note too long.** Two short paragraphs is plenty. A note that runs four paragraphs gets skimmed. Fix: cut anything that doesn't say something specific about *this* interview.
- **Forgetting to check the spelling of the interviewer's name.** A misspelled name quietly undoes the warmth of the whole note. Fix: copy the name from the calendar invite or job posting before you start typing.
- **Sending from a nickname email address.** An address like `skaterboy2003@example.com` makes the note feel like it came from a different person than the one who interviewed. Fix: send from the email you used on your application.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** A short, specific thank-you is a habit that works in more places than job interviews — a doctor's appointment that went well, a teacher who helped your kid, a neighbor who lent you a tool. Same rule: name the moment.
- **For your work or business:** If you're the one hiring, watch for the notes that mention a real moment from the conversation. They tend to come from candidates who were actually paying attention — useful signal beyond politeness.
- **If you're just getting started:** Don't overthink the first draft. Get a rough version into your Sent folder tonight; you can always polish a thank-you note *less*, never *more*. Done beats perfect.

Try it now

Open your email app, write a two-paragraph note to the person who interviewed you most recently, click Send before midnight, then close your laptop. Tomorrow morning, start the rest of your day.

How to write a standout cover letter with AI

5 steps · Read online

By the end of this guide, you'll be able to produce a customized cover letter for almost any role in just a few minutes, using an AI tool to help you organize your thoughts while keeping the tone genuine and human. This is for anyone who's new to AI tools and wants a practical way to boost their job applications without spending hours on each one.

Before you start

- You'll need an internet-connected computer or tablet.
- Have a specific job advertisement (or a detailed job description) you want to apply for ready to reference.
- You'll need access to an AI chat service (like ChatGPT, Gemini, or Claude). Most popular services offer a free tier or a trial period to get started.
- This whole process should take you around 10-15 minutes the first time, and even quicker once you get the hang of it.

Step 1 — Capture the job's key points

Open the job advertisement you're interested in and carefully read through it. Your first action is to identify and note down the three or four most important requirements or responsibilities mentioned. Look for words that describe what the employer *really* cares about.

You'll see the job ad, likely as a web page or a PDF document. As you read, you'll start to form a mental list of key expectations. Write these down in a simple list in a notepad app, a blank document, or even just on a piece of paper. If it looks different, for instance, if you only have a printed ad, simply use a pen and paper.

You'll know it worked when you have 2-4 concise bullet points from the job ad that represent the core skills or tasks needed for the role.

💬 Example:

```
1. Strong communication skills
2. Experience with project management tools (e.g., Asana, Trello)
3. Ability to work with cross-functional teams
```

Step 2 — Gather your own selling points

Now, think about your own professional experience and achievements. Your action here is to create a short list of your personal skills and experiences that *directly match* the key requirements you noted in Step 1. Focus on specific examples, not just general statements.

You'll be looking at your notes from Step 1 and probably recalling past roles or even scanning your existing resume (or CV, short for Curriculum Vitae, which is another name for a resume). What happens next is you'll start to connect your past actions with the job's needs. If it looks different or you're finding it hard to remember specifics, open your existing resume or LinkedIn profile for inspiration.

You'll know it worked when you have 2-4 bullet points, each describing a personal achievement or skill that directly relates to one of the job requirements from the previous step.

💬 Example:

```
- Regularly ran weekly updates for a 10-person team, which improved overall stakeholder satisfaction by 20%.
- Successfully managed a complex product launch from start to finish using Trello, delivering the project on time and within budget.
- Presented quarterly performance reports to senior leadership, consistently praised for clarity and effective communication of results.
```

Step 3 — Write a comprehensive prompt for the AI

Open your preferred AI chat service (such as ChatGPT, Gemini, or Claude) in your web browser or dedicated app. Your action is to type out a clear, detailed instruction, called a "prompt", into the chat box, explaining exactly what you need. A prompt is simply the command or question you give to an AI.

You'll see a blank text input field, usually at the bottom of the screen, where you type your message. After you type, you'll typically press 'Enter' or click a 'Send' button (often shaped like a paper airplane). If it's your first time, you might see a welcome message or need to click a "New Chat" button to start a fresh conversation. If your AI tool has different models (like 'free' versus 'paid'), any of them will likely work for this, but more advanced models sometimes follow instructions better.

You'll know it worked when your complete instruction, including all the details from the job ad and your experience, is typed into the chat box, ready to send.

💬 Example:

```
"Write a cover letter for a Project Coordinator role at XYZ Company.
The job requires strong communication, experience with Asana or Trello, and teamwork
across departments.
Use the following specific details from my experience:
- Ran weekly updates for a 10-person team, improving stakeholder satisfaction by 20%.
- Managed a product launch using Trello, delivering on time.
- Presented quarterly reports to senior leadership, praised for clarity.
Keep the tone professional but friendly, and make sure the letter is under 300 words.
Address it to the hiring manager."
```

Step 4 — Review and personalize the draft

After you send your prompt, the AI will generate a draft cover letter. Your action is to carefully read through this draft, checking every sentence for accuracy, tone, and whether it truly reflects your personal voice.

You'll see the AI's response appearing directly above your prompt in the chat window, usually building word by word. What happens next is you'll have a complete, although generic, letter that needs your human touch to make it truly effective. If the AI generates a letter that's too short, or much too long, you can simply type a follow-up instruction like "Please make it longer" or "Can you shorten this to 250 words?".

You'll know it worked when you've adjusted the letter to feel authentically 'you', replacing any bland phrases with your own genuine voice and specific details. Critically, confirm all facts are true to your experience – an AI can "hallucinate" (confidently make things up that aren't true), so always verify before you use the text.

💬 Edited Snippet:

```
...I was excited to see that XYZ Company values cross-functional collaboration, because
at my current role, I regularly bring together marketing, design, and engineering teams
to meet product deadlines, consistently exceeding expectations.
```

Step 5 — Polish the final version and save

Once you're completely happy with the personalized content, your action is to copy the entire cover letter from the AI chat window and paste it into a word processor (like Microsoft Word or Google Docs) or directly into the employer's online application portal. The AI tool can draft the letter, but it can't send it for you!

You'll see the AI's response on your screen. To copy, you can usually click and drag your mouse to highlight the text, then right-click and select "Copy," or use keyboard shortcuts (Ctrl+C on Windows, Cmd+C on Mac). What happens next is the text will be stored temporarily, ready to be pasted. If it looks different, and you can't highlight the text, look for a "Copy" button near the AI's response, or try selecting all text (Ctrl+A or Cmd+A) and then copying.

You'll know it worked when your cover letter is neatly formatted in your document or application, free of typos, includes your contact details, and is ready to send.

💬 Final Check List:

- Is the letter addressed to a specific person (e.g., "Dear Alex Smith") if the job ad provided a name? If not, a general "Dear Hiring Manager" is fine.
- Does the letter fit neatly onto a single page?
- Are your name and contact details clearly visible at the top?
- Have you run a quick spell-check and grammar check? Most word processors have this built in.
- Does the tone remain professional yet personable throughout?

Common mistakes

- **Copy-pasting the AI's output without editing:** The AI generates text based on patterns, which can often sound generic or include details that aren't true for your specific situation. Always replace generic phrases with your own words and verify every fact.
- **Over-loading the prompt with too much information at once:** If you give the AI too many disconnected ideas or a wall of text, it might blend unrelated points or lose focus. Keep your initial prompt structured and concise, then refine with follow-up questions if needed.
- **Forgetting to mention the company name or specifics:** A cover letter should show you've done your homework. While the AI can include the company name, always double-check that it appears naturally in the letter, demonstrating genuine interest.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** You can use this exact approach to draft other important short texts – like thank-you notes after an interview, referral emails for a friend, or any personal letter that needs a clear structure and a professional yet friendly tone.
- **For your business or work:** If you're managing a team or client relationships, this method helps you quickly draft initial client proposals, project briefs, or internal communications, ensuring the language is clear, tailored, and consistent.

- **If you're just getting started:** The easiest first move is to try the prompt from Step 3 with a real job ad you've saved. You'll instantly see how AI can transform your bullet points into a coherent, structured draft, ready for your personal touch.

Try it now

Open your favorite AI chat tool, paste the example prompt from Step 3 (remember to replace the example company and your details with your own), and hit **Enter**. In the next two minutes, you'll have a draft cover letter ready to fine-tune. Good luck!

Turn a Quick Brainstorm into a Clear Meeting Agenda with DeepSeek

5 steps · Read online

> **In short:** Paste your messy meeting notes into DeepSeek and it will draft a structured agenda with time boxes, named owners, and a clear order — usually in under a minute. DeepSeek writes the agenda; it does not send invites, book a room, or add the entry to your calendar for you.

We've all sat in the meeting where ten people arrive with twelve different ideas and leave with no clear next step. This guide walks you through turning that rough brainstorm into a clean, time-boxed agenda that anyone could actually run from. It assumes you've never opened DeepSeek before, and it leans on plain language the whole way. (If "AI chat assistant" is a new phrase: think of DeepSeek as a very fast coworker who reads your notes and writes back structured suggestions — it doesn't store your data after you close the tab on the free plan.)

Before you start

- **A free DeepSeek account** — sign up at chat.deepseek.com with an email or a Google account. The free plan is enough for this task; no credit card needed.
- **Phone or laptop with a browser** — the web version works on any modern browser. A DeepSeek app is also available on iOS and Android if you'd rather work from your phone.
- **About 10 minutes total** — roughly 2 minutes to collect your ideas, a minute to paste and wait, and a few minutes to refine the answer.
- **Your raw brainstorm** — anything goes: bullets, a voice-memo transcript, Slack messages, or even a photo of scribbled notes.

Step 1 — Collect your meeting ideas in one place

Open any note-taking app you already use and dump every topic, question, and decision you want covered into a single document. If you don't have a favorite, the simplest options are Apple Notes (on iPhone or Mac), Google Keep (on Android or in any browser), or the Notes/Notepad app that comes with Windows. A blank email draft, a Google Doc, or even a piece of paper all work too — anything you can copy from later. Don't worry about order or wording; just get everything out of your head. If your ideas live in different places — a Slack thread, a quick voice memo, an email reply — copy them all into that one document so DeepSeek can read them together. 💬 Example: a brainstorm bullet list — "product launch — pricing — who's doing the demo — what is the social plan — we still owe the legal review a reply — vendor contract is stuck — hire for the support role — Q4 OKRs" You'll know it worked when you can highlight all of those bullets with one swipe and copy them as a single block of text.

Step 2 — Open a fresh DeepSeek chat

In your browser's address bar, type **chat.deepseek.com** and press Enter. The first screen you'll see is the DeepSeek homepage with a "Start Now" or "Log In" button — click it, then sign in with the email or Google account you used to register. Once you're in, you'll land on a chat page with an empty message box near the bottom and your past conversations listed in a sidebar on the left. Click the **"New Chat"** button (usually at the top of that sidebar, sometimes drawn as a pencil or plus icon) so the assistant starts fresh — older threads can confuse it with leftover rules from earlier questions. If you can't find "New Chat," look in the top-left corner; on mobile, it's often a small pencil icon instead. Example: navigate to chat.deepseek.com, sign in, then click the "New Chat" option in the left sidebar. You'll know it worked when the screen shows a blank chat with an empty text field at the bottom, ready for typing.

Step 3 — Pick the right model and paste your prompt

Before you type, look for the **model selector** — a small chip or dropdown near the top of the chat box that shows the current model's name. DeepSeek offers two main choices: **DeepSeek-V3** (the everyday chat model, fast for most tasks) and **DeepSeek-R1** (a "reasoning" model that prints a short "thinking" block before answering — picture a student scribbling their work on the page before giving the final answer). For agenda drafting either works fine; if you want to see the reasoning, pick R1, otherwise leave the default. Click inside the input box, paste your brainstorm, then add a short instruction underneath: meeting length, who's attending, and what kind of agenda you want. Hit the send button (a paper-airplane or arrow icon at the right edge of the box). Example: "Here are our notes for the meeting. It's a 45-minute weekly product sync on Tuesday with Maria, John, Sarah, and me. Please turn these into a structured agenda with time boxes, topics, and a named owner per item. Notes: product launch, pricing decision, demo owner, social plan, legal review reply, vendor contract, support hire, Q4 OKRs." You'll know it worked when DeepSeek prints a numbered agenda with names, durations, and clear topics — usually within 30 seconds, sometimes with a visible "thinking…" block first if you picked R1.

Step 4 — Read the result and ask for adjustments

Now scan the agenda on your screen. Does it cover every point you cared about? Are the time boxes realistic? Is the right person named for each item? If something feels off, send a short follow-up message — DeepSeek will rewrite or nudge the agenda in place. Treat it like chatting with a colleague: short, specific notes get better results than vague ones. If the agenda missed a topic entirely, paste that bullet again and ask for it to be added. If the assistant assigned a task to "TBD," tell it who the right person is and it will fill in the name. This back-and-forth is normal — the first reply is a draft, not a finished document. Example: "Move the budget review to minute 15, give Priya ownership of the next-step list, and cut the demo recap to two minutes."

You'll know it worked when the second reply matches your team's reality and you can picture running the meeting straight from the page.

Step 5 — Copy the final agenda into your shared tool

Once the agenda looks right, copy DeepSeek's text. Most replies show a small **copy icon** (two overlapping squares) in the corner of the response; if you don't see one, highlight the text with your finger or mouse and copy it the usual way. Paste it into the place your team actually reads — a calendar invite description, a Slack message, a Google Doc, or an email. Spend one minute adding your own touches: a one-line welcome, a link to the relevant doc, the meeting link itself. DeepSeek doesn't send the invite for you, doesn't book a room, and on the free plan it won't remember this conversation next week — so saving it where your team lives matters.
Example: paste the agenda into your meeting invite's description field, then write "Welcome — please read before joining" above it and the meeting link below. You'll know it worked when the agenda is sitting in your calendar or shared doc, formatted clean, with everything your team needs to walk in prepared.

Common mistakes

- **Pasting only one or two bullets.** The agenda will feel thin because the assistant had nothing to work with. *Fix:* include every topic, even the wishlist ones — DeepSeek can decide what to drop once it sees the full picture.
- **Forgetting to mention who's attending.** Without names, the assistant can't assign owners. *Fix:* drop the list of attendees into the prompt so ownership lands on real people, not "TBD."
- **Skipping the meeting length.** If you don't say "30 minutes" or "60 minutes," DeepSeek will guess and the time boxes may not fit your slot. *Fix:* always include the total duration, plus a rough sense of which topics are must-cover versus nice-to-have.
- **Sending the first draft unchanged.** The output is a starting point, not a finished document. *Fix:* spend two minutes on Step 4 — small edits make the agenda feel owned, not auto-generated.
- **Assuming DeepSeek will send the invite for you.** It drafts the plan only — the calendar entry, the room, the email are still your job. *Fix:* copy the agenda into the tool your team uses and add the meeting details yourself.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** the same trick works for any get-together — a family holiday plan, a coach's practice schedule, a birthday surprise — because the recipe (dump ideas, ask for structure, refine) is the same everywhere.

- **For your business or work:** instead of starting every meeting from silence or retyping the same template, you get a fresh, customized agenda in under a minute, and the time boxes push your team to leave with real decisions instead of more questions.
- **If you're just getting started:** the simplest move is to run this on your very next meeting — open DeepSeek, paste three bullets and the attendees' names, and see what comes back. The first draft almost always teaches you something about what you actually needed to decide.

Try it now

Open chat.deepseek.com in a new tab, paste three meeting topics and the names of three attendees, and ask it for a 30-minute agenda with named owners. You'll have a draft in under a minute, and you'll know exactly whether this trick belongs in your weekly workflow.

How to use AI to write quick, polite emails and replies

5 steps · Read online

> **In short:** AI can turn your rough bullet points into a polished email in just a couple of minutes — the key is reviewing the draft to keep your voice and verify facts before you send.

By the end of this guide, you'll be able to generate a polished email or reply using AI, saving time while still sounding like yourself. This is perfect for anyone who writes emails at work, school, or for personal matters and wants to speed up their correspondence.

Before you start

- **An internet-connected device** (such as a computer, tablet, or smartphone).
- **A free AI chat service** accessible via a web browser. Examples include the web version of ChatGPT, Gemini, or Claude. These services use an **LLM (large language model — like the engine behind ChatGPT)**, which is like a very smart computer program that can understand and generate human-like text.
- **A basic idea of what you want to say**, just the key points or feelings you need to include.
- **Rough total time:** Allow about 5-7 minutes for your first guided attempt, then just a couple of minutes for subsequent emails.

Step 1 — Open a new AI chat

Launch your preferred web browser (like Chrome, Safari, or Edge) and navigate to the website of your chosen free AI chat service. Once there, look for a prominent button or link that initiates a fresh conversation. This might be labeled "New chat," "Start chatting," or "New conversation." Clicking it will prepare the AI for your first request.

You'll know it worked when you see a clear, empty text box, usually near the bottom of the screen, often with a subtle prompt like "Message..." or "Type your message here," ready for your input. If it looks different, some services might automatically open a new chat when you first visit, or you might need to find a small 'plus' icon (+) or a speech bubble icon in a corner to start afresh.

Step 2 — Tell the AI what you need

In the empty text box, type a clear, brief instruction that tells the AI the purpose of your email, who you're writing to, and any important details you want included. This instruction is called a **prompt (the instruction you give to an AI)**, which is simply the set of directions you give to

the AI, much like telling a helpful assistant what you need them to do. Make sure to include all key pieces of information the email needs.

💬 Example: `Draft a polite reply to my colleague Sam about the project deadline. Mention that I'll need an extra two days and thank him for his patience.`

You'll know it worked when you click the "Send" button (often a paper plane icon or similar) next to your typed message, and the AI immediately starts typing its response directly into the chat window, usually appearing character by character. If it looks different, sometimes the AI might wait for you to hit the Enter key, or if there's a microphone icon, you might be able to speak your prompt instead of typing.

Step 3 — Review the draft and adjust the tone

Once the AI has generated its first draft, read through it carefully. Pay close attention to the **tone** of the email, which is how polite, formal, or casual it sounds, similar to how you adjust your voice when speaking to different people. Make sure this tone matches how you usually communicate. If it's not quite right, simply type another prompt asking the AI to **re-tone** the text to better suit your style or the recipient.

💬 Example: If the draft starts with "Dear Mr. Sam," you might ask, `Can you change the greeting to 'Hi Sam,' and make the overall email a bit more casual?`

You'll know it worked when the AI generates a new, updated version of the email that better matches your desired tone and formality. If it looks different, some AI tools might offer multiple draft options upfront, or provide "thumbs up/down" buttons to give feedback, but you can always type a new request to refine the text further.

Step 4 — Verify facts and add personal touches

Now that the email's tone is right, it's crucial to manually check every single piece of factual information the AI has included. AI can sometimes **hallucinate (when an AI confidently makes something up)**, which means it confidently invents details like dates, numbers, or names that sound real but are completely made up, much like a dream that feels true until you wake up. Replace any incorrect details with the right ones. Then, "sprinkle in" a personal touch – this could be your favorite sign-off, a quick, relevant joke, or a unique phrase that makes the email truly sound like *you*.

💬 Example: If the AI's draft says "the deadline is Friday 12 May," carefully confirm this specific date and day are correct before you proceed.

You'll know it worked when you've confidently verified all key details (dates, names, figures) against your own knowledge or reliable sources, and feel the email genuinely reflects your

personal communication style. If it looks different, don't worry about the AI's interface here, as this step is about your careful human review of the generated text, not further AI interaction.

Step 5 — Copy and paste into your email program

With your final, fact-checked, and personalized email ready in the AI chat window, it's time to move it to its destination. Use your mouse or trackpad to highlight and select the entire message. Then, copy the text using your device's standard method (often by right-clicking and choosing "Copy," or by pressing `Ctrl + C` on Windows/Linux or `Command + C` on a Mac). Switch over to your email program (like Gmail, Outlook, or Apple Mail), click to compose a new email or reply, and paste the AI-generated message into the main body of the email.

💬 Example: In Gmail, click the "Compose" button, then click into the large blank area of the new message window and press `Ctrl + V` (Windows/Linux) or `Command + V` (Mac) to paste the text.

You'll know it worked when the perfectly drafted email is sitting in your email program, ready for you to add the recipient's address, a subject line, any necessary attachments, and finally, to click the "Send" button. If it looks different, some AI tools have a dedicated "Copy" button you can click near the generated text, which performs the same action.

Common mistakes

- **Skipping the fact check:** AI is excellent at language, but it can sometimes invent details or **hallucinate (when an AI confidently makes something up)**.
    - **Fix:** Always, always verify any dates, numbers, names, or specific references the AI includes. Cross-reference them with your own information before sending.
- **Leaving the AI's generic sign-off:** AI often uses neutral closings like "Best regards" or "Sincerely," which might not match your usual style.
    - **Fix:** Replace these with your own natural sign-off, whether it's "Cheers," "Thanks," or something more formal that you consistently use.
- **Over-editing the AI's output manually:** If the initial draft isn't quite right, you might be tempted to fix it yourself by typing a lot.
    - **Fix:** It's usually faster and more effective to give the AI a clearer, more specific prompt in the chat. Tell it exactly what you want changed (e.g., "Make it sound more urgent," or "Can you add a clear call to action?").

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** Imagine drafting a quick thank-you note to a friend, a polite request to your local council, or an RSVP for an event without spending ages hunting for the right words. AI can help you sound articulate and organized even when you're short on time.

- **For your business or work:** You can produce consistent, well-structured replies to client inquiries, internal team updates, or routine requests, freeing up precious minutes each day for deeper, more complex tasks. This can streamline your professional communication and ensure a polished image.
- **If you're just getting started:** The easiest first move is to copy and paste the simple example prompt from Step 2 into your chosen AI tool. Seeing how the AI instantly turns your bullet points into a full, polite email is a fast and fun way to grasp the power of this technology.

Try it now

Open your favorite free AI chat tool, click to start a "New chat," and paste the example prompt from Step 2. Within a few minutes, you'll have a ready-to-send email draft – a fast first taste of how AI can dramatically speed up your everyday correspondence and help you communicate clearly.

How to Turn Messy Voice Memos Into Clean, Searchable Notes

5 steps · Read online

> **In short:** Record a voice memo, get the text version on your phone, paste that text into any AI assistant (ChatGPT, Gemini, Claude, Copilot, Le Chat, or others) with a clear cleanup request, and save the result in a notes app. Works for meeting ideas, lecture points, and shower thoughts — no fancy setup, no paid plan required.

By the end of this guide, you'll have a simple system: ramble into your phone for a couple of minutes, then turn that recording into clean, searchable notes using any AI assistant you already have. It works for meeting ideas, lecture points, and those random shower thoughts you actually want to remember later.

Before you start

- **Your phone** with a built-in voice recorder — iPhone has *Voice Memos*, Android has *Recorder*, most other phones have something similar. No extra app needed.
- **An AI assistant account** — any of these work and have free options: ChatGPT, Gemini, Claude, Copilot, Le Chat, or DeepSeek. Use the one you already have.
- **A notes app with a search bar** — Apple Notes, Google Keep, Notion, Obsidian, Evernote, or the default notes app on your phone. You will use search later to find what you recorded.
- **About 10 minutes the first time**. After you have done it once, the whole thing takes about two minutes per memo.

> One honest note before you start: AI assistants are great at cleaning up what you said, but they cannot read minds. If you forgot to mention an idea in the recording, no AI can invent it back for you. Speak first, then clean.

Step 1 — Record a voice memo (or open an old one)

Open your phone's built-in voice recorder and tap the big round **record button** (usually red). Speak naturally for 30 seconds to 5 minutes — no need to be tidy, this is the messy version on purpose. When you are done, tap the button again (or **Stop** on Android) to save it. The new recording appears in your list with a timestamp and a short title like "New Recording 1".

If your phone does not have a voice recorder, look in the **Tools** or **Utilities** folder, or open the Clock app and switch to a stopwatch, which often has a record option. Third-party options like *Easy Voice Recorder* work too.

💬 Example: just talk out loud for two minutes about what you want to remember — meeting points, lecture notes, a story idea, anything.

You'll know it worked when you see the new file in your recordings list with a play button next to it.

Step 2 — Turn the audio into text

Open the recording you just made and look for a button that says **Transcript**, **Transcribe**, or **Get Text** — usually just below the play bar. Tap it once, then wait. After a few seconds to a couple of minutes (depending on length), a block of text appears that roughly matches what you said. Read it once to catch any obvious mistakes. If your phone does not have a transcript button, you can also paste the audio file directly into an AI assistant that accepts voice (most do now, including ChatGPT, Gemini, and Claude) — the assistant will transcribe and clean in one go.

If neither works on your device, a free web tool like *otter.ai* or the free tier of *Microsoft 365 Copilot* will transcribe an audio file in about a minute.

💬 Example: tap the transcript button, then put your phone down while it works. Do not keep talking — the recorder might still be listening.

You'll know it worked when you see a block of text that contains words you remember saying, even if the punctuation and spelling look a little off.

Step 3 — Open a fresh chat in an AI assistant

On your phone or computer, open the AI assistant you picked in *Before you start* — ChatGPT, Gemini, Claude, Copilot, Le Chat, or whichever you like. Start a **new chat** (do not continue an old one, the AI does better with a clean slate). You will see an empty text box and a send button, usually a little arrow or paper plane icon. That box is where the magic happens.

If the app opens on an old conversation, look for a + or **New chat** button, usually at the top of the screen or in the sidebar.

💬 Example: open the app, hit **New chat**, and leave the box empty for a moment.

You'll know it worked when you see a fresh, empty conversation with no previous messages in it.

Step 4 — Paste the transcript and ask for clean notes

Tap inside the empty chat box, then **paste your transcript** from Step 2. After the pasted text, add a short request that tells the AI what you want. Press send. Within a few seconds, the AI replies with organized, bulleted notes — usually with headers, lists, and the filler words like "um" and "uh" removed. If the response is too short, reply **"Be more thorough"**; if it is too long, reply **"Make it shorter, please"**.

If the AI gave you raw text without structure, send a follow-up: **"Please put this into bullet points under clear headers."** That is the most common fix.

💬 Example: paste the transcript, then add — *"Please turn this into clean, organized notes. Use bullet points, group related ideas under clear headers, fix the grammar, and remove filler words. Keep my own wording where it matters."*

You'll know it worked when the AI's reply is structured with headers and bullets (or numbered points), not just a flowing wall of text.

Step 5 — Save the result in a notes app you can search

Highlight the AI's reply and **copy** it (long-press on mobile, or Ctrl/Cmd + C on a computer). Open your notes app, create a new note, and **paste** the cleaned-up notes in. Give the note a clear title that includes the topic and the date — that title is what you will type into the search bar later. That is the whole point of this step: from now on, a single search finds what you rambled about days or weeks ago.

If the AI was opened on the same phone, you can usually just **share** the response directly to your notes app — look for the share icon (a square with an arrow pointing up) under the AI's reply.

💬 Example: name the note *"2026-01-15 Team meeting — Q2 ideas"* or *"2026-01-15 Shower thought: podcast about old maps"*. The more specific, the easier to find.

You'll know it worked when the note appears in your app with a title you can read at a glance, and you can search for a word from your memo and find it.

Common mistakes

- **Recording in a noisy place.** Background noise, music, or other voices wreck the transcript. Find a quiet room, or hold the phone closer to your mouth. The fix is simple: re-record in a calmer spot.
- **Asking the AI to "summarize" when you actually want full notes.** Summarize means short; organize means full but tidy. Be specific in your prompt — say *"organize into clean notes"* if you want everything kept.

- **Forgetting to give the note a useful title.** A note called *"New note 7"* is impossible to find later. Always add a date and a one-line topic in the title.
- **Pasting sensitive stuff without thinking.** Whatever you paste into an AI assistant is sent to that company's servers. For private medical, financial, or work-confidential content, do not paste the raw text — clean it up yourself, or use a local tool.
- **Skipping Step 2 and pasting a 20-minute audio file.** Many free AI plans have upload limits, and a long file eats your quota fast. A 2-3 minute memo is the sweet spot.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** Next time a thought hits you in the shower, on a walk, or while cooking, you have a 2-minute way to capture it. By the end of the month, your notes app holds a searchable archive of every idea worth keeping.
- **For your business or work:** After meetings, record a quick recap on your phone while it is still fresh, then turn it into clean notes you can share with the team. You no longer have to choose between "pay full attention" and "write everything down" — you do both.
- **If you're just getting started:** Try the workflow once this week with something low-stakes, like a quick grocery list or a movie you want to watch. The habit sticks faster when the first one is easy.

Try it now

Open your voice recorder, talk for 60 seconds about what you did yesterday, then run it through Steps 2 to 5. You will have a searchable note about your own day — and the whole system, ready to use for anything that matters more.

Use Claude to Rewrite an Angry Email So It Says What You Actually Mean

5 steps · Read online

> **In short:** Paste your angry draft into Claude, add one line about who you're writing to, and it returns a calmer version that keeps your real point. Free with a Claude.ai account; works on phone and desktop in any browser.

You've just typed something you'd never actually send — full of sarcasm, CAPS, and three exclamation marks. Before you regret hitting send, Claude can reshape that draft in seconds: same meaning, fewer grenades. This guide walks you through the five-minute version, and one honest thing to know up front — Claude drafts the email for you, but it cannot send it from your account. You still copy, paste, and press send yourself.

Before you start

- **A free Claude account.** Sign up at claude.ai with your email or Google account if you don't have one. The free tier covers everything in this guide.
- **Your angry draft somewhere you can copy it.** A Notes app, a Gmail draft, even a screenshot works — you'll paste it into Claude in Step 2.
- **Roughly 5 minutes.** Most of that is reading Claude's rewrite and tweaking one or two lines.
- **An honest read of what you actually want.** "I want them to fix the bug by Friday" is much more useful to Claude than "I'm furious." We'll cover this in Step 3.

Step 1 — Open a fresh chat in Claude

Go to **claude.ai** in any browser, or open the Claude mobile app, and sign in. Look for a button labeled **"New chat"** or **"Start chat"** — usually at the top of the sidebar on desktop, or as a **+** icon at the top of the conversation list on mobile. Click it. A blank conversation appears with a small text field at the bottom and a paperclip icon for attachments. Starting fresh matters: if you reuse an old chat, Claude may carry over context from a previous task, and your email rewrite will land in the wrong tone. If you can't find the new-chat button, look for a **pencil icon**, a **"+"**, or your account avatar in the corner — apps rearrange these often. 💬 Example: type "Hi" and press Enter once, just to confirm the chat is working. You'll know it worked when you see an empty conversation with no previous messages and a blinking cursor in the message box.

Step 2 — Paste your angry draft as the first message

Click into the message box at the bottom of the screen and paste your full draft — yes, even the CAPS and the sarcastic bits. Claude isn't judging you; it's reading the rough emotion so it knows

what to soften. After you paste, the text fills the box; if it's longer than the visible area, the box will grow or scroll. Press **Enter** (or tap the **send** arrow ➤ on mobile) to submit. Claude reads it and replies within a few seconds, with its first attempt at a rewrite. If your draft is in a screenshot, look for a **paperclip or camera icon** next to the message box — tap it, pick the image, and add a short note saying "rewrite this email". On desktop, the same paperclip lets you upload files. You'll know it worked when Claude responds with a rewritten version of your email, not a question or an apology.

Step 3 — Tell Claude who you're writing to and what you actually want

Claude's first rewrite is usually a safe, polite version. The next message is where you steer it. In the same chat, type two short pieces of information: **who the reader is** (your boss, a vendor, a coworker, your landlord) and **the one outcome you want** (a refund, an apology, a deadline moved, a meeting booked). Press Enter. Watch what Claude does: it reads your follow-up, adjusts the tone, and gives you a second version. Often the second version is the one you'll actually send. If the tone didn't shift between version one and version two, your follow-up was too vague — try again with more detail about the reader. 💬 Example: "This is going to my project manager. I want them to move the deadline from Friday to next Wednesday because the design files aren't ready. Keep it short — under 120 words." You'll know it worked when the new version names the right person, includes your specific ask, and reads like something you'd actually type yourself.

Step 4 — Ask for tone tweaks without starting over

This is where the back-and-forth pays off. If the rewrite is still too cold, too formal, or accidentally passive-aggressive, tell Claude in plain words what feels off. Type something like "softer, please" or "more direct, less apology" or "remove the line about 'understanding their busy schedule' — it sounds sarcastic." Claude rewrites again, keeping the structure and adjusting only the part you flagged. On screen, you'll see a new version appear below your last message, with the older ones still visible above. If the rewrite gets worse, look for a **"Retry"** or **"Regenerate"** button near Claude's response — usually a small circular arrow — to get a fresh attempt without losing your instructions. If you can't find a retry button, just type "try again" in the chat; it has the same effect. 💬 Example: "Drop the apology paragraph. I don't need to apologize — I need the refund processed by Monday." You'll know it worked when the new version reads like something a calm, confident version of you would write, and you'd be comfortable seeing it in your sent folder.

Step 5 — Copy the final version and send it yourself

When you have a version you like, click and drag to select the rewritten email, then copy it with **Ctrl+C** (Windows) or **Cmd+C** (Mac), or long-press on mobile and choose **Copy**. Open your email app — Gmail, Outlook, Apple Mail, whatever you use — paste it into a new message, fill in the recipient and subject line, and send as you normally would. Claude drafts; you deliver. If you're not ready to send yet, save the draft and sleep on it; sending angry emails the next morning is rarely a regret. On screen, you'll see Claude's full reply in the chat, but you only need the email body — ignore any intro lines Claude adds like "Here's a rewritten version:" and copy only the actual email text. You'll know it worked when the email is sitting in your outbox (or drafts folder) in your own account, addressed to the right person, and your hands feel calmer than they did ten minutes ago.

Common mistakes

- **Letting Claude send the email for you.** It can't. Claude is a chat tool — it drafts the message, but you copy, paste, and hit send from your own email app. Anything claiming to "send automatically" is a different tool, not Claude.
- **Skipping the "what do I actually want" line.** A rewrite without context is a generic polite version. Always tell Claude the reader and the outcome, or you'll get a draft that's pleasant but doesn't move anything forward.
- **Forgetting to remove the worst lines.** Claude sometimes leaves one sarcastic phrase behind because it appeared in your original. Read the final version once more before you copy — if a line makes you wince, ask Claude to cut it.
- **Sending the first rewrite without checking.** The first response is a starting point, not a finished email. The second or third version, after you've given feedback, is almost always the one worth sending.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** The next time a customer service reply makes your eye twitch, or a note from a neighbor pushes a button, you can draft a response in two minutes instead of stewing for an hour — and the message you actually send will be the calm one.
- **For your business or work:** Most professional conflict gets worse because of tone, not content. A 30-second Claude pass before sending a frustrated email to a client, vendor, or coworker turns a relationship risk into a routine message.
- **If you're just getting started:** Don't wait for a big blow-up. Practice once this week on a low-stakes email that bugged you — a slow refund, a missed meeting — so the workflow is familiar the next time something bigger lands.

Try it now

Find one email you wrote this week that felt a little sharper than you wanted. Paste it into Claude, add one line about who it's going to and what you want, and ask for a calmer rewrite. Then send the new version (or save it as a draft). Two minutes, one less regret.

Translate a French or Spanish Email into English in Seconds with Hugging Face

5 steps · Read online

> **In short:** Hugging Face hosts free AI translation tools you can use straight from your browser. Paste in a French or Spanish email and you get a readable English version in seconds — no paid translator, no language skills, and no software to install.

A message lands in your inbox from a French supplier, a Spanish client, or a relative overseas. You don't speak the language, and the clock is ticking. Years ago, that meant copying text into a paid service or waiting for a bilingual friend. Today, an AI model on **Hugging Face** — a popular website where companies and researchers share AI tools for anyone to try — can do the heavy lifting for free. This guide walks you through the whole thing, from sign-up to a translated email in your hand.

Before you start

- **A free Hugging Face account.** Sign-up takes about a minute at the official site. You'll need an email address.
- **A web browser** on a phone, tablet, or computer. No app to download.
- **The text you want translated.** Have it copied to your clipboard, or open the email next to your browser so you can paste it.
- **Roughly 5 minutes total**, including account creation the first time.

One honest note before we begin: this works beautifully for everyday emails, short letters, and chat-style messages. Very long documents (think: full contracts or 20-page reports) can hit the tool's input limit, and you'll want a different approach for those.

Step 1 — Create your free Hugging Face account

Open your browser and go to the Hugging Face homepage. Look for a **sign-up** or **"Sign up"** button, usually near the top-right corner. Enter your email address, choose a password, and confirm your email through the link they send you. After confirmation, you'll land on your personal dashboard.

If it looks different: some visitors are automatically logged in through their Google or GitHub account — if you see a button labeled **"Continue with Google"** (or GitHub), that's a faster path and creates the same kind of account.

Example: use your regular email and a password you don't reuse anywhere else.

You'll know it worked when you see your username or profile icon in the top-right corner of the page.

Step 2 — Search for a French-to-English translation tool

From your dashboard, look for a **search bar** at the top of the page and type something like **"French to English translation"** or **"Spanish to English translation"**. Press Enter. You'll see a list of results — some are AI models (the brains behind the tool), and some are **Spaces** (ready-to-use mini-apps with a friendly interface).

Click on a result that says **Space** underneath its name and shows a little **gradio** or **streamlit** label — those are the ones with a built-in text box you can type into. Community-built translation Spaces are very common and free.

If it looks different: if no Space shows up, try the simpler search **"translation"** and skim the first few results. You're looking for any Space with two text boxes labeled something like **"Input"** and **"Output"**.

Example: search for "French to English translation" if your email is in French.

You'll know it worked when the Space opens and you can see at least one text box on the page asking you to type or paste something.

Step 3 — Paste the foreign-language email into the input box

Click inside the **left-side** or **top** text box — usually labeled something like **"Source text"**, **"Input"**, or simply **"Enter text"**. Open your email in another tab or window, highlight the French or Spanish message, copy it (Ctrl+C on Windows, Cmd+C on Mac, or tap-and-hold "Copy" on a phone), then click back into the text box and paste it (Ctrl+V, Cmd+V, or tap-and-hold "Paste").

If it looks different: some Spaces put both text boxes side by side rather than stacked. The one that already has text in it (your language) is the input; the empty one is where the English will appear.

Example: a French line like *"Bonjour, je vous écris concernant la livraison prévue vendredi."* — paste the whole email, paragraphs and all.

You'll know it worked when the foreign-language text appears inside the input box and you can see your cursor blinking at the end of it.

Step 4 — Pick your language pair and click Translate

Look for a small **dropdown menu** or **radio buttons** somewhere on the page labeled **"Source language"** and **"Target language"** — or similar wording. Set the source to **French** (or **Spanish**) and the target to **English**. Then click the button that says **"Translate"**, **"Submit"**, or shows a little arrow icon.

The model will start working. Depending on the length of your email, this takes anywhere from two seconds to about ten seconds. You'll see the output text appear in the second box, often labeled **"Output"**, **"Translation"**, or **"Result"**.

If it looks different: some Spaces skip the language-picker step and figure it out automatically. Others have a "Detect language" option — if you see it, leave the source on auto-detect and just set the target to English.

💬 Example: leave source set to "French" or "auto-detect", and target set to "English".

You'll know it worked when a block of English text appears in the output box — readable, mostly natural-sounding, and recognizably the same email.

Step 5 — Read the translation and copy it out

Read through the English version carefully. AI translation is good, but it's not perfect — names, dates, and very idiomatic phrases can sometimes come out a little stiff or slightly off. If something looks unclear, try rephrasing the tricky sentence and pasting just that sentence back in for a second pass.

When you're happy with the result, highlight the English text, copy it, and paste it wherever you need it — back into your email reply, into a note, or into a chat message to a colleague.

If it looks different: some Spaces include a small **copy-to-clipboard** icon right next to the output. If you see one, click it instead of highlighting manually — it's faster.

💬 Example: you'd get something like *"Hello, I'm writing to you regarding the delivery scheduled for Friday."* — clear, polite, ready to act on.

You'll know it worked when you have a readable English version of the email saved somewhere, and you understand what the sender is asking for.

Common mistakes

- **Pasting a huge document all at once.** Many Spaces cap input at a few hundred words. If nothing happens, try splitting the email into two or three shorter chunks and translating one at a time.

- **Skipping the language-pair setting.** If you forget to set the target to English, the output may come back in the original language. Always double-check the dropdowns before clicking Translate.
- **Treating the first result as gospel.** AI translations are usually right, but names, dates, and unusual phrases can be wrong. If a number or a person's name looks strange, paste just that word or phrase back in and ask the tool to clarify — or confirm with the original sender before acting on it.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** when a relative abroad sends a holiday update in French, or a Spanish-speaking neighbor writes about a package pickup, you can read it in seconds instead of asking someone to translate for you.
- **For your business or work:** if you deal with international suppliers, clients, or remote teammates who write in another language, this gives you a quick first read so you can decide which messages need a careful human translation and which are routine enough to act on immediately.
- **If you're just getting started:** the easiest first move is to translate one short email you've been ignoring — you'll see in two minutes how useful this becomes part of your regular routine.

Try it now

Find one unread email in another language sitting in your inbox right now. Sign up for Hugging Face, search for a French-to-English or Spanish-to-English translation Space, paste the message, and read the result. Total time: under five minutes.

How to Prepare for Your Next Job Interview Using Free AI Tools

5 steps · Read online

> **In short:** Free AI chatbots like ChatGPT, Claude, and Gemini can act as personal mock interviewers — analyzing job descriptions, generating practice questions, and helping you polish your answers using the STAR method. The entire process takes 30-60 minutes.

Preparing for a job interview can feel overwhelming, but you do not have to do it alone. This guide will show you how to use free AI tools as a personal, non-judgemental mock interviewer to help you practice your answers and calm your nerves.

Before you start

- **An AI chatbot account:** You'll need a free account with an AI chatbot, such as ChatGPT, Claude, or Gemini. Think of an AI chatbot as a highly responsive digital conversationalist powered by an LLM (large language model — like the engine behind ChatGPT that processes and generates text). Access can be through their website or a mobile app.
- **Your job application materials:** Have the text of the job description you are applying for, along with a draft of your current resume, ready to copy and paste.
- **Your device:** A computer (desktop or laptop) or a mobile device (tablet or smartphone) with internet access.
- **Time commitment:** This entire process should take roughly 30-60 minutes, depending on how much you wish to practice.

Step 1 — Extract the key interview questions

Instead of guessing what an employer might ask, you can ask the AI to analyze the job description to find the most likely questions. This helps you focus your preparation.

To do this, you will type a *prompt* (the instruction you give to an AI). You'll see a chat input field, often labeled "Message" or "Type your message here." After you send your prompt, the AI will process it and begin to type a response above your input field. If your screen looks a bit different, simply look for the main text input area at the bottom of the screen.

💬 Example:

> "I am interviewing for a job. Here is the job description: [Paste Job Description]. Based on this, what are the top 5 questions the interviewer is most likely to ask me? Please explain why each question is important."

You'll know it worked when the AI lists 5 specific questions, each followed by a short explanation of why that question is relevant to the job description you provided.

Step 2 — Research the company's culture

To stand out, you need to show that you understand the employer's values and mission. You can use the AI to identify core themes, which will help you tailor your language to match their workplace culture.

In the same chat window, where you see the AI's previous answers and your input box, you'll type your next prompt. Once sent, the AI will process the text you provide and extract the underlying values. If you're on a mobile device, the chat history might scroll up as the AI types its new response.

Example:

> "I want to make sure my answers align with this company's values. Here is some text from their 'About Us' page: [Paste About Us Text]. Can you identify the top 3 cultural values they care about, and suggest how I can show I have these traits?"

You'll know it worked when the AI lists 3-4 distinct values (like "innovation" or "teamwork") and provides a brief suggestion on how you can weave these into your interview answers.

Step 3 — Set up a mock interview roleplay

This is where the magic happens. You can ask the AI to act exactly like a friendly, professional hiring manager. It will ask you one question at a time, wait for your response, and then give you constructive feedback.

Continue the conversation in your existing chat window. After you send this prompt, the AI will acknowledge your request and then type out the first interview question. If the AI asks for more information before starting, simply refer back to the job description you provided in Step 1. The AI cannot "hear" your voice, so you will need to type your answers.

Example:

> "I want you to act as an interviewer for the role described earlier. Ask me one practice question at a time. After I reply, give me friendly feedback on how to make my answer stronger, then ask the next question. Let's start with the first question."

You'll know it worked when the AI responds by saying something like 'Alright, let's begin! Here's your first question:' followed by an interview question.

Step 4 — Polish your stories using the STAR method

Employers love structured answers. The AI can help you organize your past experiences using the STAR method (Situation, Task, Action, Result — a classic, easy-to-follow formula for telling clear stories about your work history).

You'll type your rough story into the chat, just as you would with any other message. The AI will then read your summary and restructure it into the STAR format, making your achievement clear and impactful. Even if you're still in the roleplay from the previous step, the AI is usually smart enough to pause the interview and help you with this specific request.

Example:

> "Here is an experience I want to share in my interview: [Type a rough, messy summary of a past work achievement]. Can you help me rewrite this using the STAR method so it sounds professional and clear?"

You'll know it worked when the AI presents your experience broken down into distinct 'Situation,' 'Task,' 'Action,' and 'Result' sections, making it much easier to remember and articulate.

Step 5 — Calm your pre-interview nerves

Anxiety often comes from a fear of the unknown. You can ask the AI for advice on handling difficult, unexpected questions, or even ask it to share a quick, calming breathing exercise to help you focus.

Type your query directly into the chat box, just as you have for the previous steps. The AI will then generate a response offering practical advice or a simple exercise. If the AI suggests an exercise, you might need to mentally follow along, as it cannot guide you audibly. Remember, while the AI can offer suggestions, it cannot replace professional advice or truly understand your emotional state.

Example:

> "I am feeling quite nervous about my interview tomorrow. Can you give me three simple strategies to stay calm if I get asked a question I do not know the answer to?"

You'll know it worked when the AI provides a numbered or bulleted list of practical strategies, such as taking a moment to think or rephrasing the question, to help you manage interview stress.

Common mistakes

- **Trusting made-up facts (hallucinations):** Sometimes AI can *hallucinate* (when an AI confidently presents incorrect details as truth). Always double-check any facts about the company or role on their official website.
- **Sounding like a robot:** Use the AI's suggestions as a guide, but do not memorise its responses word-for-word. Employers want to hire *you*, complete with your unique personality and natural speaking style. Practice saying the answers aloud in your own words.
- **Sharing private information:** Never paste highly sensitive details into public AI tools, such as your tax file number, bank details, or private client details from your previous workplace. Always keep your information general and anonymous.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** You will build stronger communication skills, helping you feel more confident when speaking to new people, presenting ideas, or even preparing for important conversations.
- **For your business or work:** You can easily prepare for internal promotions, salary reviews, or client pitches in a fraction of the usual time, ensuring you present your best self.
- **If you're just getting started:** Treat the AI like a patient, encouraging mentor. You can make mistakes and refine your answers in a completely private, safe space before speaking to a real person.

Try it now

Open your chosen AI tool, copy the text below, and press send:

> "I have an upcoming interview for a customer service role. Can you give me one common interview question for this type of job, and a simple tip on how to answer it well?"

Ask Alexa+ to Read Your Calendar Aloud and Get a Heads-Up Before Meetings

5 steps · Read online

> **In short:** Link a Google or Microsoft calendar to Alexa in the Alexa app, then ask any Echo "what's on my calendar today?" to hear your meetings read out loud. Add a "remind me 10 minutes before my next meeting" command and Alexa+ will warn you ahead of each one.

Say one short sentence to your Echo in the morning and you'll hear today's meetings read out — with times, titles, and any details you've saved in the event itself. No phone, no typing, no scrolling. This guide walks a complete beginner through linking a calendar, picking the right voice command, and setting automatic reminders before each meeting.

Before you start

- An Echo device (Echo Dot, Echo Show, or similar) or the Alexa app on a phone.
- A free Amazon account, signed in on both the device and the app.
- A Google or Microsoft calendar that already has at least one event on it.
- An Alexa+ subscription. Pricing, bundled offers and availability change often and differ by country — check Amazon's site in your region for the latest. In the US, Alexa+ is included with Prime, and separate plan options may also be available. The calendar features described here require an Alexa+ subscription.
- About 5–10 minutes for the first-time setup, then roughly 10 seconds per morning.

Step 1 — Link your calendar to Alexa

Open the Alexa app on your phone and tap the **More** tab in the bottom-right corner, then choose **Settings**. Scroll until you see **Calendar** — if it isn't visible right away, try looking under "Account settings" or "Connected services" first. Tap your calendar provider (Google or Microsoft) and sign in with the same account that holds your events. A screen will ask if you want to give Alexa access; tap **Allow**. If your account has several calendars, pick the one you want Alexa+ to read from.

💬 Example: When asked "Which calendar should Alexa use?" choose "Work" if that's where your meetings live — not the "Holidays" or "Family" one.

If "Calendar" doesn't appear in the menu, tap the magnifying-glass search at the top of Settings and type "calendar" — it usually shows up immediately.

You'll know it worked when the app shows a checkmark or "Linked" label next to your account, and a recent event appears in the Calendar section.

Step 2 — Make sure your Echo is awake and listening

Place your Echo somewhere you'll be in the morning — kitchen counter, bedside table, or desk. The light ring around the top should be **off** or glowing soft **blue**; that means Alexa is ready but not yet talking. If the ring is **red**, the microphone is muted — press the small microphone button on top once to unmute. If you don't own an Echo, open the Alexa app and tap the blue Alexa button at the bottom of the screen; it listens through your phone's mic.

Example: Say *"Alexa, hello"* as a quick test. You should hear a short chime and a friendly spoken reply.

On devices with a screen (Echo Show), a thin blue light bar along the bottom edge does the same job the top ring does on a regular Echo.

You'll know it worked when Alexa answers your test question out loud — that confirms the microphone, speakers, and account are all wired up correctly.

Step 3 — Ask Alexa+ to read today's meetings

Say clearly: *"Alexa, what's on my calendar today?"* A short chime plays, then Alexa+ starts reading each event in order — the time, the event title, and any details you've saved inside the entry (a location, a video-call link, an agenda note). Exactly which details are spoken back depends on what you put into the event itself. If today is empty, Alexa+ will say something like "You have no events scheduled for today."

Example: *"Alexa, what are my meetings today?"* and *"Alexa, read my schedule"* work just as well. *"Alexa, what's next on my schedule?"* gives you only the very next event.

If Alexa+ answers with "I can't access your calendar" or "Please link a calendar first," go back to Step 1 — the link didn't take. Try unlinking and re-linking the account once.

You'll know it worked when you hear your real meetings read out loud, in the right order, with the correct times.

Step 4 — Ask Alexa+ to remind you before each meeting

Now add the warning ahead of time. Say *"Alexa, remind me 10 minutes before my next meeting."* Alexa+ creates a reminder tied to your next calendar event. You can pick any lead time — 5 minutes, 15 minutes, even an hour. When the moment arrives, the Echo chimes and

announces the meeting name. For back-to-back meetings, Alexa+ keeps tracking the next one automatically.

💬 Example: *"Alexa, remind me 10 minutes before my next meeting"* — Alexa+ confirms with "Okay, I'll remind you 10 minutes before [meeting name]."

If you only want a reminder for one specific meeting, say *"Alexa, remind me 15 minutes before my call with Maria"* and it will only fire for that one event.

You'll know it worked when Alexa+ repeats the meeting name and the lead time back to you as confirmation.

Step 5 — Build your 10-second morning command

Pick one phrase and use it every day. The shorter and clearer the command, the more reliably Alexa+ understands it. A good all-in-one prompt: *"Alexa, good morning — what's on my calendar and remind me 10 minutes before each meeting."* That single sentence triggers both the schedule read-out and the day's reminders.

💬 Example: *"Alexa, good morning, what's on my calendar today and remind me 15 minutes before each meeting."* — a complete, copy-and-paste morning command.

If you'd rather split it, ask *"Alexa, what's my day look like?"* first, then set the reminder separately. Both approaches work the same.

You'll know it worked when Alexa+ reads your day and confirms the reminder in one go — you can keep getting ready while it talks.

Common mistakes

- **Skipping the calendar link.** The most common reason "Alexa, what's on my calendar?" fails is that no calendar is linked yet. Open the Alexa app → More → Settings → Calendar and connect a Google or Microsoft account before you start asking.
- **Linked the wrong calendar.** If you have multiple Google calendars (work, personal, family, holidays), Alexa+ only reads the one you picked. Open the app, check the selected default, and switch it if needed.
- **Asking while the mic is muted.** A red light ring means Alexa cannot hear you. Press the microphone button on top once and wait for the ring to turn blue before you speak.
- **Expecting Alexa+ to change the calendar for you.** It can read events and set reminders, but it cannot move, edit, or cancel meetings on your behalf. Update the event in your calendar app; Alexa+ picks up the change within a couple of minutes.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** Say one sentence while brushing your teeth and hear the full day out loud — no screen, no scrolling, no notifications buried under twenty other apps. Handy for parents juggling school runs, drivers on the way to work, visually impaired users, or anyone who simply prefers listening.
- **For your work or business:** Use it to never walk into a meeting unprepared. A 10-minute warning gives you time to find the link, open the right tab, and skim the agenda. Teams running back-to-back calls lose several minutes a day to "wait, what's next?" — this removes that.
- **If you're just getting started:** Don't try to set reminders for every meeting at once. Link the calendar, ask once, and only add a reminder if you actually need it. Small steps beat over-engineering.

Try it now

Open the Alexa app, link your Google or Microsoft calendar, then walk up to any Echo in your home and say: *"Alexa, what's on my calendar today?"* — that's the whole first move. If it works, add one reminder tomorrow: *"Alexa, remind me 10 minutes before my next meeting."*

How to Use Gemini to Keep One Project's Notes and Chats Together in One Place

5 steps · Read online

> **In short:** In Gemini, a Notebook is a workspace for one project. You add files, pasted notes and links, then chat about them there. It may not appear on every account yet, so check the Before you start section first.

This guide shows you how to set up one project space in Gemini, add your material to it, and come back later without digging through old chats. It's for anyone juggling a school assignment, a home renovation, a job search or a work project. You don't need any tech background, just a Google account and a few files or notes you already have.

Before you start

- **A Google account** and a web browser on a computer, or the Gemini app on a phone or tablet.
- **Check availability.** Google has described Gemini Notebooks as rolling out to students, educators and workplace accounts. If you don't see a Notebook option, your account may not have it yet. You can still follow the same idea by starting a separate chat for each project and pasting your key notes at the top.
- **Some extras may need a paid plan.** Google has mentioned a paid add-on for certain expert sources. The basic steps below don't depend on it.
- **Time needed:** about 20 minutes for your first project.

Step 1 — Open Gemini and look for Notebooks

Go to gemini.google.com in your browser, or open the Gemini app and sign in. On a computer, look for a side panel on the left. Somewhere in it, look for an entry labeled **Notebooks** or a similar folder-style icon. On a phone, the menu is often behind a three-line icon at the top-left of the screen. Tap it to see your list of recent chats and any Notebook options.

Once you're in, you should see a list or an empty area where your projects will live. This is the "desk" for all your project material.

Example: You don't type anything in this step.

If it looks different: Menus change often. If you can't find Notebooks anywhere, try the search bar at the top of the Gemini screen and type "notebook." If nothing appears, your account probably doesn't have it yet, and you can use the separate-chat method from the Before you start section.

You'll know it worked when you can see a Notebooks area or a place to create a new project workspace.

Step 2 — Create one Notebook for one project

Look for a button like **New notebook**, a plus sign (+) or **Create**. Tap it and give your project a clear name. Keep it short and specific, because you'll see this name every time you return. Something like "Kitchen remodel 2026" is more useful than "Stuff."

Gemini will open an empty Notebook. Think of it as a labeled folder on your desk. Everything you add here stays connected to this one project, and nothing from your other projects gets mixed in.

Example: Name the notebook "[project name] for [month and year]", such as "Kitchen remodel for June."

If it looks different: If you're asked to pick a type or a template, choose the simplest or blank option. You can always add files later.

You'll know it worked when the new Notebook opens with your chosen name at the top and an area ready for sources.

Step 3 — Add your files, notes and links as sources

Look for an **Add sources**, **Upload** or plus-sign button inside the Notebook. Tap it and choose what you want to add. Common choices include uploading a file from your device, pasting text, or adding a web link. Start with two or three items so you can see how it works.

For a file, pick a PDF, a document or an image from your device. For notes, paste text you wrote earlier, such as a shopping list, meeting notes or a rough plan. Once an item is added, it usually appears in a list of sources next to or below your chat area.

Example: Paste this into a text source: "Budget: [total amount] for materials. Contractor: [contractor name], available starting [date]. Must finish before [deadline]."

If it looks different: Some options may be labeled differently, or certain file types may not be supported. If an upload fails, try saving the file as a PDF or copying the text into a paste box.

You'll know it worked when each item you added shows up in the source list with its name visible.

Step 4 — Ask questions about your sources

Click or tap in the chat box at the bottom of the Notebook. It's often labeled something like "Ask a question" or "Message," though yours may read differently. Type a question about your project, the way you'd ask a helpful coworker who had read all your files.

Gemini usually answers using the sources you added, which is the main benefit of a Notebook. If an answer seems to miss something, you can rephrase it with more detail or ask the assistant to point to which source it used.

Example: "Using my sources, what is left in the [project name] budget, and which tasks should I finish first?"

If it looks different: If the answer seems to ignore your files, check that the sources still appear in the list. A source that failed to upload won't be used. You can also ask, "Which of my sources did you use for that answer?"

You'll know it worked when the answer references details from your own files or notes, not generic advice.

Step 5 — Come back later and keep building

Close the Notebook and reopen it a few days later. Find it under your Notebooks list by its name. Your sources and past chats should still be there. Add new material as it comes up, such as a receipt, an email you pasted or a new photo of a plan. Then ask a fresh question or request a summary.

This is where the time saving shows up. Instead of searching through a dozen old chats, you open one project and everything is in the same place.

Example: "Summarize everything I've added so far to the [project name] notebook in five short bullet points."

If it looks different: If you don't see your old chats, check whether you're in the same notebook, since each one keeps its own history. Some older chats may still be in your general Gemini history instead.

You'll know it worked when the summary includes items you added in earlier sessions, not just the latest one.

Common mistakes

- **Putting every project in one giant Notebook.** Mixing topics makes answers muddy. The fix is one Notebook per project, and a clear name for each.

- **Assuming Gemini knows about files you never added.** It works from what's inside the Notebook. The fix is to upload or paste the material you want it to use, then check the source list.
- **Trusting every answer without checking.** Gemini can make mistakes or sound confident when it's wrong. The fix is to verify important facts, such as dates, money amounts and deadlines, against your original files. For medical, legal or financial decisions, talk with a qualified professional.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** Plan a trip, track a home project or organize a family event in one Notebook, then ask for a checklist whenever you need one.
- **For your business or work:** Keep meeting notes, client files and project updates together, so you can ask for a status summary without rereading everything. Check with your workplace about which accounts and data are allowed.
- **If you're just getting started:** Start with one small, low-stakes project, like a weekend errand list, so you can learn the steps without pressure.

Try it now

Open Gemini, create one Notebook named after a project you care about, and paste in one page of notes. Then ask: "What are the three most important things in my notes right now?" If the Notebooks option isn't there yet, do the same thing in a single new chat.

Polish your emails for better clarity and tone using ChatGPT

5 steps · Read online

Ever wish you could quickly refine an email to make it sharper, more polite, or just easier to read? This guide will show you how to use ChatGPT, a clever AI assistant, to do just that. By the end, you'll be able to take a rough email draft and quickly turn it into a polished message ready for anyone, whether it's for work, school, or personal connections.

Before you start

- You'll need a free **ChatGPT account**. You can sign up easily on their website (chatgpt.com) or download the ChatGPT app on your phone or tablet.
- Access to a **web browser** on a computer, or the **ChatGPT app** on a mobile device.
- An **email draft** you want to improve.
- This guide should take you about **5-10 minutes** to follow.

Step 1 — Open ChatGPT and start a new chat

First, open your web browser and go to the ChatGPT website (chatgpt.com) or launch the ChatGPT app on your device. Once it's loaded, you'll usually see your previous conversations on the left side (if you've used it before) and a large, empty text box at the bottom, ready for your input. If you've just signed in, you'll likely be on a blank canvas. If you're on a computer, look for a "New chat" button, often at the top-left of the screen, to ensure you're starting fresh. If you don't see a "New chat" option, simply ensure the main conversation area is empty and the text box at the bottom is ready for you to type in. You'll know it worked when the main part of the screen is clear, and a text box is visible at the bottom, usually with a placeholder like "Message ChatGPT..." or "Type your message here...".

Step 2 — Paste your email draft into the chat box

Now, take the email you've drafted and want to improve. Copy all the text from that email. Then, switch back to ChatGPT and paste your email draft directly into the large text box you saw in Step 1. Don't worry about adding any instructions yet; just get the email text in there. You'll see all your copied email text appear inside the chat box. If the text is very long, it might fill several lines. If it looks different, make sure you've selected all the text from your email before copying, and then use your device's paste function (like right-click and "Paste" on a computer, or tap and hold then "Paste" on a phone). You'll know it worked when your entire email draft is displayed within the ChatGPT input box, ready for you to add your instructions.

Step 3 — Give your first instruction (the "prompt")

This is where you tell ChatGPT what you want it to do. The instruction you give to the AI is called a **prompt** – think of it like telling a helpful assistant exactly what task you need completed. Below your pasted email in the text box, type your instruction for refining the email. Be clear about your goal. Once you've typed your instruction, press the "Enter" key on your keyboard or click the "Send" button (often a paper airplane icon) next to the text box. ChatGPT will then "think" for a moment, which means it's processing your request using its **large language model (LLM)** – this is the clever AI engine that powers ChatGPT. If it looks different, you might have an older version of the app, but the "send" button will always be clearly visible, often in the bottom-right corner of the chat box. You'll know it worked when ChatGPT starts typing out a new, improved version of your email directly in the chat window, based on your instructions. 💬 Example: "Please refine this email for clarity and a professional tone. Make it concise."

Step 4 — Ask for specific changes to refine it further

ChatGPT usually does a great job with initial refinements, but sometimes you need to fine-tune things a bit more. This is where the magic of conversation comes in – you can ask for more specific changes. In the same chat, type another instruction after ChatGPT's first response. Maybe you want it shorter, or a different tone, or to emphasise a particular point. Then, send your new instruction just like before. You'll see your new request appear below ChatGPT's last message, and then it will generate another response, often building on the previous one. If it looks different, remember you're just continuing the conversation in the same chat window. Always type your new instruction in the message box at the bottom. You'll know it worked when ChatGPT provides another version of your email, or specific suggestions, that address your latest request, showing it understood your follow-up. 💬 Example: "Can you make it sound a bit warmer and shorten it to less than 100 words? Also, ensure it clearly asks for a meeting next week."

Step 5 — Review, edit, and copy your polished email

Now it's time to review the AI's suggestions. Read through the different versions or specific edits ChatGPT has provided. Choose the version you like best, or combine parts from different responses. Remember, ChatGPT is a tool; the final decision is always yours. Once you're happy, highlight the text of the improved email that ChatGPT generated, and copy it. Most AI chat interfaces will have a small "copy" icon (often two overlapping squares) that appears next to the generated text, which will copy the entire response for you. You'll see the text highlighted, or a small confirmation message like "Copied to clipboard." If you don't see a copy icon, simply click and drag your mouse across the text on a computer, or tap and hold then drag the selection handles on a mobile device, to select all the text. Then use your device's copy function. You'll

know it worked when the polished email text is copied to your device's clipboard, ready to be pasted into your email application.

Common mistakes

- **Being too vague in your prompts:** Saying "make it better" isn't as helpful as "make it more formal and remove any jargon." Be specific about the tone, length, or points you want to emphasise.
- **Not providing enough context:** If your email is about a specific project, person, or deadline, mention it. ChatGPT works best with information, even if it's just a quick sentence like, "This email is for my manager about the Q3 report."
- **Expecting perfection on the first try:** AI often needs a few tries or follow-up questions to get exactly what you're looking for. Think of it as a conversation; it gets better with feedback. It drafts the email, but it can't send it for you or understand complex human emotions without explicit instructions.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** You can quickly craft clear messages for neighbors, school groups, or family, ensuring your intentions are always understood and your tone is just right. No more agonising over wording!
- **For your business or work:** Improve professionalism and efficiency. Draft sensitive messages, project updates, or client communications with confidence, knowing they are polished and impactful, saving you precious time.
- **If you're just getting started:** Start with a simple email you've already written. Ask ChatGPT to "make this email more polite" or "shorten this email significantly." It's a great way to see its power in action without much effort.

Try it now

Grab a short email you sent recently, perhaps a quick update or a question. Paste it into ChatGPT, and then give it one instruction: "Please make this email sound more friendly and less formal." See how quickly it transforms your message!

How to use Claude to draft a polite work email in 5 minutes

5 steps · Read online

Do you sometimes stare at a blank screen, wondering how to word that tricky work email politely and professionally? This guide will show you how to use Claude, an AI assistant, to draft clear and courteous emails in just a few minutes, so you can spend less time writing and more time doing. By the end, you'll be able to get a solid first draft for almost any work message.

Before you start

- You'll need a device with internet access (computer, tablet, or smartphone).
- A free Claude account.
- About 5-7 minutes to follow the steps.

Step 1 — Open Claude and log in

First, you need to access Claude, your AI assistant. Open your web browser (like Chrome, Firefox, or Safari) and go to Claude's website. If you're using a mobile device, you might use the dedicated Claude app if you've downloaded it. Once the page loads, you'll see a prompt to log in or sign up. If you already have an account, enter your email address and password. If not, follow the simple on-screen instructions to create a new, free account. If it looks different: The login screen might vary slightly, but always look for "Log in" or "Sign up" buttons. If you're using the app, it will usually open directly to your chat history after logging in once. You'll know it worked when you see your chat history (if you have one) or a blank chat screen ready for a new conversation.

Step 2 — Start a new conversation

Now that you're in Claude, let's begin drafting your email. Look for a button that allows you to start a new chat or conversation. This is your blank canvas where you'll tell Claude what you need. Clicking this button clears any previous conversation history, giving you a fresh start for your new email task. It's like opening a new, empty document in a word processor. If it looks different: You might see a "+ New Chat" button, a speech bubble icon, or sometimes a simple "New conversation" text link, usually located in the top-left or top-right corner of the screen. You'll know it worked when the main part of your screen becomes empty, and a blinking cursor appears in the text box at the bottom, indicating you're ready to type.

Step 3 — Describe your email in a prompt

This is where you tell Claude exactly what kind of email you need. The instruction you give to an AI is called a **prompt** – think of it like telling a helpful assistant precisely what you want them

to write. Be as clear and specific as possible about the purpose of the email, who it's going to, and any key points you want to include. Don't worry about perfect grammar or tone yet; Claude will handle that. If it looks different: The text box where you type your prompt is usually at the bottom of the screen. 💬 Example: "Draft a polite email to my team, Sarah and David, requesting a brief meeting next Tuesday to discuss the upcoming project milestones. We need to confirm who is responsible for each task by the end of the week." You'll know it worked when Claude quickly starts typing out an email draft above your prompt, usually within a few seconds.

Step 4 — Review and refine Claude's draft

Once Claude generates its first draft, take a moment to read it over. Check if it includes all your key points and if the tone is suitable for your workplace. If something isn't quite right, you can simply tell Claude what changes you'd like. This is where you act as the editor, guiding the AI to perfect the email. You can ask for a different tone, more detail on a specific point, or to shorten it. If it looks different: Claude's reply will appear above your input box. Your follow-up instructions go into the same input box. 💬 Example: "That's great, but can you make it a bit more formal and add a sentence about needing everyone's input during the meeting?" You'll know it worked when Claude generates a revised version of the email that incorporates your feedback. Keep refining until you're happy with the draft.

Step 5 — Copy the finished email

Once Claude has produced an email draft you're happy with, the final step is to copy it so you can paste it into your actual email client (like Outlook or Gmail). You'll typically see options to select all the text or a specific "Copy" button or icon near Claude's response. Select the entire email, then click the copy command. Now it's ready to be pasted into your email application, where you can add the recipient's email address, a subject line, and send it off. If it looks different: Look for a small icon that looks like two overlapping squares (the universal "copy" symbol) or simply highlight the text with your mouse and right-click to select "Copy." You'll know it worked when you get a small notification saying "Copied to clipboard" or when you can successfully paste the email into a different application.

Common mistakes

- **Too vague prompts:** If you ask Claude to "write an email," it won't know the topic, recipient, or purpose.
    - **The fix:** Always include key details: who it's for, what it's about, and what action you want the recipient to take (e.g., "Draft an email to my manager, Jane, requesting a day off on Friday, 15th July, for a personal appointment.").
- **Not specifying tone:** Claude defaults to a neutral, helpful tone, but work emails often need specific nuances. If you don't mention it, the draft might not match your workplace

culture.
    - **The fix:** Add a tone request like "make it very formal," "keep it concise and direct," or "make it friendly but professional" to your prompt or during refinement.
- **Forgetting to review:** It's easy to just copy the first thing Claude writes, but AI can sometimes make small errors or miss nuances.
    - **The fix:** Always read through the draft carefully. Check for correct names, dates, and ensure the message truly reflects what you want to convey before sending. Claude drafts, but you remain the editor and sender.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** You can quickly draft emails for school assignments, community group notices, or even a polite complaint to a service provider, without stressing over the perfect words.
- **For your business or work:** Save valuable time on daily communication. Get a professional draft for internal memos, client updates, project requests, or follow-up emails, allowing you to focus on strategic tasks rather than sentence structure.
- **If you're just getting started:** Try asking Claude to draft a simple thank you email after a meeting or a quick note to a colleague asking for help on a task. It's a low-stakes way to get comfortable with the process.

Try it now

Open Claude and try drafting a short email to a fictional colleague, asking them to send you a report by the end of the day. Remember to be specific about the report's name and the deadline!

How to Draft a Polite Email Asking for a Deadline Extension with AI

5 steps · Read online

> **In short:** Turn one sentence about your situation into a polite extension request you can edit and send. You need any AI chat assistant and a realistic new date. The draft is a starting point, so check every fact yourself before sending.

Missing a deadline is stressful, but asking for more time politely is a normal part of work and school. In this guide you'll learn to give an AI chat assistant a short, clear brief, shape the draft in a few rounds, and save a reusable instruction so the next request takes minutes. The assistant can write the words, but it can't send the email for you, and it doesn't know your workplace or the real state of your project.

Before you start

- An account with any AI chat assistant you already use, and a chat window open.
- The original deadline, the new date you can realistically meet, and a general reason (for example, "waiting on information from another team").
- A notes app on your phone or computer, which you'll use in Step 4.
- Time needed: about 15 minutes. A free plan usually handles this task well.

Step 1 — Write your one-sentence brief

Start a new chat and type a single sentence that includes the task, the original deadline, the general reason, and the new date you need. Look for the message box at the bottom of the screen; it's often labeled something like "Message" or "Ask anything," though yours may differ. Press send. The assistant usually begins writing a reply within a few seconds. If you don't see a message box, look for a pencil or "new chat" icon to start a fresh conversation. Keep the sentence concrete. "I need more time" gives the assistant very little to work with, while specific dates and a reason let it write something sensible.

Example: "I need to ask my manager, [manager name], to move the [project name] deadline from [original date] to [new date] because I'm waiting on data from another team."

You'll know it worked when the assistant replies with a draft email or asks you a clarifying question.

Step 2 — Ask for the draft with a clear structure

Once the first reply appears, send a second message that tells the assistant the tone, the length, and what to include. Three details are enough: how formal to be, roughly how long the email

should be, and one specific new date you can offer. Without them, drafts often come out generic or too long. Type your message in the same box and press send. You'll usually see a new, complete draft with a subject line. If the assistant only gives advice and no email, reply with "Please write the full email now." If the draft seems too stiff or too casual, that's normal at this stage; you'll fix it in Step 3.

💬 Example: "Write the email in a warm, professional tone, under 120 words, with a clear subject line and one specific new date I can offer."

You'll know it worked when you see a subject line, a greeting, a short body, and a closing with a proposed date.

Step 3 — Refine the draft one change at a time

Read the draft and pick one thing to change. Good single changes include shortening the apology, adding a line about work you've already completed, or making the request sound less like a demand. Ask for one change per message, and tell the assistant to keep everything else the same. Because the assistant can see the earlier draft in the same chat, each round builds on the last one. If it rewrites the whole email and loses the parts you liked, paste the version you want to keep and ask for only the single change. Doing this in two or three rounds usually produces a better result than one long request.

💬 Example: "Keep the same email, but cut the apology to one short sentence and add that I've already finished [part of the work]."

You'll know it worked when the new draft keeps the wording you liked and changes only what you asked about.

Step 4 — Save a reusable instruction

When you have a version you're happy with, copy your best brief and your refinement request into a note titled something like "Deadline email prompt." Next time you need an extension, paste the note into a new chat and fill in the details. Some assistants also let you save standing instructions in a settings or personalization area, often under a name like "custom instructions." Look for something like that, but if you don't see it, don't worry; the note works everywhere. Keep the saved instruction short so you can reuse it without rereading it.

💬 Example: "Each time I give you a situation, write a polite deadline-extension email with a subject line, under 120 words, ending with one specific new date and no excuses."

You'll know it worked when you can paste the note into a new chat and get a usable draft after only typing one new sentence.

Step 5 — Check every detail before you send

Read the draft out loud, slowly, and compare it with your own notes. Check the names, the dates, the reason, and any promise the email makes. Ask the assistant to list every fact it included so you can confirm each one. Delete anything you can't back up, and replace any invented reason with your real one. The assistant doesn't know whether your deadline can truly move or what your workplace expects, so that judgment stays with you. If the request involves money, legal terms, or a formal contract, consider checking with the person responsible for that area before you commit to a new date.

💬 Example: "List every date, name, and promise in this email so I can check each one against my notes."

You'll know it worked when every fact in the email matches your notes and you're comfortable standing behind each sentence.

Common mistakes

- **Sending the first draft unread.** Fix it by reading the email out loud and checking every date and name before pressing send.
- **Writing a vague brief.** "I need more time" produces a vague email. Fix it by including the original date, the new date, and a general reason.
- **Letting the assistant invent details.** AI tools sometimes add reasons or promises you never mentioned. Fix it by deleting anything untrue and adding your real explanation.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** Ask a school, a landlord, or a gym for more time on a form or payment deadline, using the same steps.
- **For your business or work:** Ask a manager or client to move a project milestone, and attach a short status update to the request.
- **If you want to go further:** Build a small library of saved templates for common requests, such as rescheduling a meeting or asking for a revised quote, and ask the assistant to suggest a fallback date if the first one is refused.

Try it now

Open your AI chat assistant and type one sentence with your task, your original deadline, a general reason, and your new date. Then read the first draft and decide which single change to request.

How to analyze files and spreadsheets with ChatGPT

5 steps · Read online

By the end of this guide you'll be able to drag-and-drop a PDF report or an Excel budget into ChatGPT, ask it for a short summary, request exact numbers, and have it draw a basic chart for you. This is for anyone who wants to make sense of documents faster, whether at home or at work.

Before you start

- A free or paid ChatGPT account (sign up at chatgpt.com if you don't have one).
- A web browser on a laptop, desktop or tablet – the file-upload button is easiest to see on a full-size screen.
- The document you want to explore: a PDF (Portable Document Format) or a spreadsheet file such as XLSX, CSV or a Google Sheet export.
- An internet connection and about 5 minutes of uninterrupted time.
- Charts and data analysis also work on the free plan, but free accounts have tighter daily limits on uploads and analyses than paid plans (Plus, Business, Enterprise).

Step 1 — Open a new chat

Click the **+ New Chat** button – usually a plus-sign at the top-left of the ChatGPT homepage. You'll see a blank conversation window with a faint line that says "Start typing…" at the bottom. The platform prepares a fresh context so the AI will focus only on the file you later provide. If you don't see a plus-sign, look for a button that says "New chat" or a similar icon in the upper corner.

Example: simply click the button – no text to type yet.

You'll know it worked when the chat pane clears and a blinking cursor appears ready for you to type.

Step 2 — Upload your file

Locate the **paper-clip** icon or a button labeled "Upload a file" underneath the text box. Clicking it opens your computer's file picker; navigate to the PDF or spreadsheet you saved and select it. After you confirm, a small thumbnail (for PDFs) or a file name (for spreadsheets) appears inside the chat area. This is the AI's equivalent of handing a paper report to a colleague. If you don't see a paper-clip, look for a button that says "Attach" or a menu item called "Upload".

Example: select *budget-2025.xlsx* and wait for the thumbnail to show.

You'll know it worked when the file name or preview shows up right under the message box.

Step 3 — Ask for a plain-language summary

Type a concise request such as:

```
Please give me a short summary of the main points in this file.
```

When you press **Enter**, ChatGPT scans the uploaded document and begins typing a paragraph that highlights headings, key figures and any conclusions it finds – much like a teammate giving you the gist of a meeting. The response may take a few seconds, especially for larger PDFs. If the reply looks generic, try adding "in plain language" to your prompt.

💬 Example: copy-paste the exact sentence above.

You'll know it worked when the AI returns a short paragraph that mentions the document's major sections or numbers.

Step 4 — Query specific data

Now ask a focussed question, for example:

```
What was the total revenue listed for Q3?
```

or, for a spreadsheet:

```
Which product category had the highest sales in the East region?
```

After you send the prompt, the model looks through the file, finds the relevant row or cell, and replies with the exact value and a brief context. If the answer seems unrelated, make sure you referenced the correct file – you can re-upload it or specify "in the spreadsheet". If the AI says it cannot find the data, try phrasing the request differently, such as "show me the cell that contains Q3 revenue".

💬 Example: copy-paste either of the two questions above.

You'll know it worked when the response includes a number (e.g., "$2.8 million") and mentions the row or column where it was found.

Step 5 — Request a simple chart

Finally, ask the AI to visualise the data. A typical prompt looks like:

```
Create a bar chart of quarterly sales from the spreadsheet.
```

The assistant will generate an image of a bar chart and embed it directly in the chat. You can right-click the image and choose "Save image as..." to download it for a report or presentation. Charts work on the free plan too, though free accounts have tighter daily limits than paid plans.

If no chart appears, check that the file contains numeric sales data and try a more explicit request such as "draw a line chart of the sales column".

💬 Example: paste the exact sentence above and hit **Enter**.

You'll know it worked when a picture of a chart shows up beneath your message, complete with labeled axes.

Common mistakes

- **Uploading an unsupported file type:** ChatGPT accepts many formats — PDFs, Word and PowerPoint files, spreadsheets (XLSX, CSV), text files and images — but not every file type. Double-check the file extension before you click "Open". *Fix:* If the upload fails, save a copy in a common format (such as PDF or CSV) and try again.
- **Being too vague in the prompt:** Phrases like "Explain this" often lead to generic replies. *Fix:* Include the specific thing you want – "summarize the key findings" or "list the Q3 revenue".
- **Expecting the AI to edit the original file:** ChatGPT can read and comment on a document, but it cannot change the file itself. *Fix:* After you get the information, open the original file in Excel or a PDF editor to make any edits.
- **Hitting the free-plan limit:** Free accounts can create charts and analyze files too, but with tighter daily limits than paid plans. *Fix:* If you reach the limit, wait and try again later, or consider a paid plan (Plus, Business, or Enterprise) if you use this often.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** Quickly turn a lengthy utility bill or school grade sheet into an easy-to-read summary before you discuss it with family or teachers.
- **For your business or work:** Extract key performance indicators from monthly reports without opening Excel, then share a ready-made chart with your manager.
- **If you're just getting started:** The easiest first move is to practice with a short PDF, like a news article, and ask for a one-sentence summary.

Try it now

Open a recent PDF receipt or a small Excel file, start a new ChatGPT chat, upload the file, and type:

```
Summarize the main points in this file.
```

You'll see the AI turn a raw document into clear, actionable information in under two minutes. Happy analyzing!

Turn any messy meeting notes into a clear summary with Claude

5 steps · Read online

Do you ever leave a meeting with a jumble of handwritten scribbles or disjointed digital notes, then spend ages trying to make sense of them? This guide will show you how to use Claude, an AI assistant, to instantly turn those messy notes into a crystal-clear summary, complete with key decisions and action items. You'll finish this tutorial ready to share professional, concise summaries in minutes, not hours.

Before you start

- An Anthropic account (the company behind Claude). The free tier works perfectly for this task.
- Access to the Claude website (claude.ai) on your computer, tablet, or phone.
- Your messy meeting notes, ready to copy and paste.
- This whole process should take about 5-10 minutes.

Step 1 — Open the Claude website

The first step is to get Claude up and running. Open your preferred web browser (like Chrome, Safari, or Edge) and type "claude.ai" into the address bar at the top, then press Enter. This takes you to Claude's home page. If you've used Claude before and are already logged in, you might land directly on the chat screen. If not, you'll see options to "Log in" or "Sign up." Choose "Log in" if you have an account, or "Sign up" if you need to create one – it's a straightforward process, usually just needing an email address.

You'll know it worked when you see the main chat interface, which usually has a large input area at the bottom and a sidebar on the left.

Step 2 — Start a fresh conversation

To ensure Claude focuses only on your current task, it's best to start with a clean slate. Look for a button or link in the sidebar, usually on the left side of the screen, that says something like "New Chat" or has a plus sign (`+`) icon. Clicking this clears the previous conversation history, giving you an empty chat window. Think of this like opening a brand-new document on your computer; it helps keep things organized.

If you don't see a "New Chat" button, look for a "Start a new conversation" or similar text near the top of the sidebar. You'll know it worked when the main chat area becomes empty, showing a blank canvas ready for your input.

Step 3 — Paste your meeting notes

Now it's time to bring your notes into Claude. Open your document, email, or app where your messy meeting notes are stored. Select all the text from your notes (you can usually do this by pressing `Ctrl+A` on Windows or `Cmd+A` on Mac, or by dragging your mouse over the text), then copy them (`Ctrl+C` or `Cmd+C`). Go back to the Claude website, find the large text input box at the bottom of the screen, click inside it, and paste your notes (`Ctrl+V` or `Cmd+V`).

You'll know it worked when your entire block of meeting notes appears within the input box, ready for Claude to read.

Step 4 — Give Claude specific instructions

Pasting your notes is only half the job; now you need to tell Claude what you want it to do. This instruction is called a "prompt," and it's like telling a chef exactly what kind of meal you want. After pasting your notes, type your instructions directly below them in the same input box. Be specific about what you need. Do you want bullet points? Key decisions? Action items with responsible people and deadlines? The more detail you give, the better the summary will be.

💬 Example: "Please summarize these meeting notes into clear bullet points. Highlight key decisions and list all action items, including who is responsible and by when. Make it concise."

You'll know it worked when, after you press Enter (or click the 'Send' button, often a paper plane icon), Claude starts typing its response, creating your summary.

Step 5 — Review and refine your summary

Claude will now present you with a summary based on your instructions. Read through it carefully. AI models, while powerful, aren't perfect and can sometimes misunderstand context or miss nuances, especially with very messy notes. If the summary isn't quite what you wanted, don't worry! You can ask Claude to make adjustments. Type another instruction in the same chat box, asking it to clarify, expand on a point, or change the format.

💬 Example: "Could you make the action items bolder and add a separate section for 'Next Steps'?" or "Please ensure all participant names are correctly spelled from my original notes."

You'll know it worked when Claude provides a revised summary that better matches your needs, or confirms it has made the requested changes.

Common mistakes

- **Too vague a prompt:** If you just say "Summarize this," Claude will give you a general overview. *Fix:* Be specific! Ask for "key decisions," "action items," "who is responsible," "in

bullet points."

- **Pasting unmanageable notes:** While Claude handles a lot of text (this is called its "context window," like how much it can remember at once), extremely long or poorly formatted notes can still be tricky. *Fix:* For super long notes, break them into two or three chunks and summarize each part, then ask Claude to combine those summaries.
- **Not reviewing the output:** Sometimes, Claude might "hallucinate" (confidently make up information) or misunderstand a detail from your notes. *Fix:* Always read the summary against your original notes to ensure accuracy, especially for names, dates, and critical decisions.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** Easily summarize family discussions, notes from a club meeting, or even a lengthy article you've read, making information easier to digest and share.
- **For your business or work:** Drastically cut down the time spent on post-meeting administration. You can quickly generate professional summaries for team members, clients, or stakeholders, ensuring everyone is aligned on decisions and next steps.
- **If you're just getting started:** Try summarizing a short email you received or a recipe you're thinking of trying. Focus on just one or two key pieces of information you want to extract.

Try it now

Grab a recent email, a short list of bullet points from a personal to-do list, or even a few sentences you've jotted down. Head over to Claude and ask it to "Summarize this into three key points." See how quickly it can make sense of your text!

Write marketing emails fast with Cohere's text generation

5 steps · Read online

Tired of staring at a blank screen while you try to craft a sales email? By the end of this guide you'll be able to feed Cohere a few simple instructions and walk away with a ready-to-send subject line and body that sound just like your brand. This is for anyone who wants a quick, reliable writing boost without needing any code.

Before you start

- A free Cohere account (sign-up at cohere.com).
- A web browser on a laptop, desktop, or tablet with an internet connection.
- A clear idea of the product or service you want to promote (one sentence is enough).
- About 5 minutes total – the guide is designed to be completed in a short coffee break.

Step 1 — Sign in and open the Cohere Playground

Open your web browser and go to **cohere.com**. Click the **Log in** button in the top-right corner (it looks like a small person icon). After you log in you'll see a dashboard with tiles such as "Playground", "Projects", and "Documentation". Click the tile labeled **Playground** – it may also appear as a button that says "Try the Playground". The Playground opens a clean text area where you can type prompts and watch the AI reply. If you don't see a Playground tile, look for a menu icon (three horizontal lines) and choose "Playground" from the list.

Example: none needed for this step – just click.

You'll know it worked when a blank white box with a cursor appears, ready for you to type.

Step 2 — Write a prompt that tells Cohere who you are and what tone you need

In the text box, type a **prompt** (the instruction you give to an AI, like a brief you hand to a copywriter). Explain the product, the offer, and the voice you want. For instance, write:

> "Write a short marketing email for a local organic fruit and vegetable delivery service called **Fresh Harvest**. Announce a new weekly box subscription, offer a 10 % discount for the first month, and keep the tone warm, friendly, and helpful."
>
> When you press **Enter** or click the **Generate** button below the box, Cohere's large language model (LLM – a computer program that predicts text like the engine behind ChatGPT) will start producing a response. If the button looks different, it may be a blue "Submit" or a paper-plane icon; click whatever appears to send your prompt.
>
> Example: copy the sentence above exactly into the box.

> You'll know it worked when the screen fills with a subject line and several paragraphs of email copy.

Step 3 — Review the first draft and note what needs tweaking

The AI's reply will usually include a subject line on the first line, followed by a blank line, then the email body. Read it carefully; check that the product name, discount amount, and tone match what you asked for. If the subject line is too long, or the body feels too formal, you'll need to ask for a revision. Remember, Cohere can draft text but **cannot send the email for you** – you still have to copy the result into your email client. If the layout looks different (for example, the reply appears in a side panel rather than under the prompt), scroll down until you see the generated text.

💬 Example: none needed – just read.

You'll know it worked when you can see both a subject line and at least three paragraphs of body text.

Step 4 — Refine the tone with a follow-up prompt

Below the first answer, there's another text box for a new prompt. Type a short instruction that asks the AI to adjust the style, for example:

> "Make the email sound a bit more relaxed and casual. Use American spelling such as 'favor' and 'organize', and shorten the subject line to under six words."
> Press **Generate** again. The AI will produce a revised version that follows your additional guidance. If the button for generating a second answer is hidden, look for a small "+" icon next to the original prompt or a "Regenerate" link – clicking either will send the new instruction.
>
> 💬 Example: copy the sentence above exactly.
>
> You'll know it worked when the new output shows a shorter, punchier subject line and the body uses the requested spelling variations.

Step 5 — Copy the finished email into your favorite email client

Select the entire subject line and body text (click and drag, then press **Ctrl + C** on Windows or **Cmd + C** on macOS). Open your email program (Gmail, Outlook, etc.) and start a new message. Paste the copied text into the subject field (**Ctrl + V** / **Cmd + V**) and the body area. Make any final personal touches – for example, add the recipient's name or a signature block. If you don't see a paste option, right-click in the field and choose "Paste".

💬 Example: none – just use the copy-and-paste shortcuts.

You'll know it worked when the email draft in your client shows the exact subject line and body you generated, ready to hit "Send".

Common mistakes

- **Using a vague prompt:** Writing “write a sales email” leaves the AI guessing and often produces generic copy. Fix it by always including the product name, the specific offer, and the desired tone.
- **Forgetting to edit the AI output:** The generated text may contain placeholders like “[Your Name]”. Always replace those with real details before sending.
- **Assuming the AI can send the email:** Cohere only creates the wording; you must manually copy the result into your email platform and press send.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** You can quickly draft polite RSVP messages, community newsletters, or club updates without breaking a sweat.
- **For your business or work:** Generate whole weeks of promotional emails, newsletters, and even social-media captions in a single session, freeing up hours for strategy instead of writing.
- **If you're just getting started:** Treat the prompt as a conversation – you can keep refining until the copy feels just right, no need for a perfect first try.

Try it now

Open the Cohere Playground, paste the “Fresh Harvest” prompt from Step 2, hit Generate, and watch the AI give you a ready-to-use email draft. You’ll have a complete marketing email in under two minutes – give it a go!

Get Started with xAI's Grok to Draft Professional Emails in Seconds

4 steps · Read online

Imagine transforming your rough notes into a polished, professional email in mere seconds. This guide will show you how to use xAI's Grok to quickly draft clear correspondence, upload files for extra context, and even organize follow-up reminders. By the end, you'll be able to manage your professional communications with less effort and more confidence. However, it's important to remember that while Grok drafts the email, it cannot send it for you or automatically integrate with your calendar, so a final check and manual action will always be needed.

Before you start

- **An active Grok account:** Grok is available on grok.com, in the iOS and Android apps, and inside X. You can sign in with an X or email account. It is free to try, with usage limits, and a paid plan adds higher limits.
- **A device with internet access:** You'll need a computer, tablet, or smartphone to access Grok's interface.
- **A rough idea for your email:** Have a few key bullet points ready about your message's purpose, the recipient, and the desired tone (e.g., formal, friendly, urgent).
- **Time commitment:** This guide takes about 5-10 minutes to follow.

Step 1 — Select your preferred writing mode

When you first open Grok, you'll see its chat interface, similar to a messaging app. Look for an option that lets you choose its "personality" or **mode** – this is like telling it what kind of assistant you need. It's often labeled as "Standard" or "Fun," sometimes represented by a small toggle switch or a menu. Tap or click on this option.

WHAT YOU SEE: You'll typically see "Standard" and "Fun" listed as choices. Standard mode is like a focused professional, while Fun mode is more playful and might use jokes or casual language. WHAT HAPPENS NEXT: Selecting "Standard" will activate this more serious, professional persona for Grok. The interface might briefly refresh, or the selected mode will simply highlight. IF IT LOOKS DIFFERENT: If you don't see a clear "Standard" or "Fun" toggle, look for a "Settings" or "Preferences" icon (often a gear or three dots) within Grok and navigate through those options to find the mode selection. 💬 Example: (No specific text to type for this step, as it's a selection.) You'll know it worked when: The "Standard" option is clearly highlighted or selected, confirming Grok is ready for professional tasks.

Step 2 — Write a clear prompt

A **prompt** is simply the instruction or question you type into the AI. For the best email drafts, tell Grok exactly who you are, who you're writing to, and the main goal of the email. Think of it like giving a brief to a human assistant – the more detail, the better the outcome. Type your instructions into the text input box at the bottom of the screen.

WHAT YOU SEE: You'll see an empty text box at the bottom of the Grok conversation area, usually labeled "Message Grok..." or similar. WHAT HAPPENS NEXT: As you type, your text appears in the box. Once you've finished your instructions and press Enter or click a "Send" button (often an arrow or paper plane icon), Grok will start processing your request and generating the email. IF IT LOOKS DIFFERENT: The input box might be at the top or side on some devices; simply locate the area where you can type your message. Example: "Act as a helpful project manager. Draft a polite email to a client, Sarah, explaining that our monthly progress report will be delayed by two days due to final data verification. Assure her we are prioritizing quality and ask if we can meet briefly on Thursday at 2:00pm to discuss the findings." You'll know it worked when: Grok begins typing out a fully structured email response, usually with a subject line, greeting, and sign-off, directly in the chat window.

Step 3 — Upload a document for context

Sometimes, your email needs to reference information from a document, like a project brief or a spreadsheet. Instead of typing out all that detail, Grok allows you to upload a file directly. Look for an attachment icon, often represented by a paperclip, a plus symbol (+), or a small document icon, usually located near the text input box. Click or tap this icon to open your device's file selector.

WHAT YOU SEE: After clicking the attachment icon, your device's file browser window will pop up, allowing you to navigate and select a file from your computer or phone. WHAT HAPPENS NEXT: Once you've selected a file (like a PDF, text document, or image file), it will upload to Grok. You'll typically see the file's name appear in the chat interface, often above your text input box, indicating it has been attached. IF IT LOOKS DIFFERENT: If you don't see a paperclip, look for a plus sign (+) or a small icon of a document. Grok usually supports common file types like PDF, TXT, DOCX, and common image formats. Example: (After uploading a relevant file) "Based on this attached project timeline, draft a quick update email to my team summarizing our key achievements this week and highlighting the next three deadlines." You'll know it worked when: The name of your uploaded document (e.g., "ProjectTimeline.pdf") appears clearly in the chat, confirming Grok has received the file for context.

Step 4 — Ask Grok to draft a follow-up reminder

Effective email management goes beyond just sending messages. You can use Grok to help you stay organized by generating quick reminders or action points based on your conversation. After

drafting an email, simply continue the conversation by asking Grok to create a concise reminder for you. This is especially useful for prompts that you can later copy into your personal calendar or task manager.

WHAT YOU SEE: You'll still be in the same Grok conversation, with your previously drafted email visible. The text input box will be ready for your next instruction. WHAT HAPPENS NEXT: Grok will process your request and generate a short, actionable sentence or bullet point that serves as a reminder. This will appear as a new message in the chat. IF IT LOOKS DIFFERENT: The chat history might be longer, but the functionality of the input box remains the same for follow-up prompts. 💬 Example: "Now, write a short, one-sentence reminder that I can copy into my calendar or task manager to prompt me to check in with Sarah if she hasn't replied by Friday morning." You'll know it worked when: Grok provides a clear, concise, action-oriented note (e.g., "Follow up with Sarah regarding project report by Friday morning.") in the chat window.

Common mistakes

- **Using "Fun" mode for serious communications:** Accidentally leaving Grok in "Fun" mode for important business emails can lead to inappropriate jokes or a casual tone that doesn't fit the situation. Always double-check and select "Standard" mode before drafting professional messages.
- **Sharing highly sensitive private data:** While Grok can process documents, it's crucial never to upload files containing confidential personal information, tax file numbers, private client data, or proprietary secrets. Once uploaded, there's a risk this data could be processed or stored by the AI, potentially compromising privacy.
- **Not proofreading and customizing:** Grok is a powerful tool, but it's an assistant, not a human. It won't know specific nuances of your business relationships or personal details like exact dates or internal jargon. Always read through the drafted email carefully to ensure all names, dates, facts, and the overall tone are correct and appropriate before sending.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** You can use Grok to write polite but firm letters to utility companies, craft clear school permission notes, or prepare community group announcements in a fraction of the usual time, helping you communicate effectively without stress.
- **For your business or work:** You can clear a cluttered inbox rapidly, ensuring every client and colleague receives a thoughtful, professional response. This frees up your time for deeper, more strategic tasks that require human insight.
- **If you're just getting started:** Keep your prompts simple and clear. You don't need complex technical language; just talk to Grok as if you were giving instructions to a

helpful and polite colleague.

Try it now

Open Grok, select "Standard" mode if it's not already active, and copy-paste this simple prompt to see it in action:

"Draft a warm thank-you email to a colleague named David who helped me finish a major presentation on Friday afternoon. Keep it short and professional."

Understand anything

Fact-Check Online Claims with Perplexity's Sources

6 steps · Read online

In our busy online world, information flies around faster than ever. Sometimes, a post on social media might sound convincing but isn't quite right. This guide will show you how to use Perplexity, an AI assistant, to quickly check the facts and understand where information truly comes from. By the end, you'll be able to confidently verify claims, helping you decide what's reliable to share. While Perplexity is excellent at finding and compiling information, remember it doesn't perform human critical analysis or judgment; it's always up to you to evaluate the original sources.

Before you start

- A device with internet access (computer, tablet, or smartphone).
- Access to Perplexity, either through its website (perplexity.ai) or its mobile app. A free account is sufficient for this guide.
- Roughly 5-7 minutes of your time.

Step 1 — Open Perplexity

First, let's get Perplexity ready. Open your web browser and type `perplexity.ai` into the address bar at the top of the screen, then press your keyboard's Enter key. If you're on a mobile device, find and launch the Perplexity app. Once loaded, you'll typically see a clean, simple screen featuring a prominent search bar right in the middle, often displaying placeholder text like "Ask anything..." or "Search the web". This is your main input area, waiting for your questions.

If it looks different: The specific layout might vary slightly depending on whether you're using the website or the app, or due to recent updates. However, you should always find a clear, large text box or search bar positioned centrally, as it's the most obvious place to type your query.

You'll know it worked when you see the Perplexity interface with a clear text input area, ready for you to type your question.

Step 2 — Ask about your claim

Now, let's ask Perplexity to investigate a social media claim. Carefully type the specific statement or question you want to check directly into that main search bar. Try to phrase your query clearly and directly, just as you would ask a person for information. For example, if you saw a post about a new animal, you might ask "Is the 'blue-spotted tree frog' a real animal?". Once you've finished typing your question, press the Enter key on your keyboard or tap the "Ask"

button (which might appear as an arrow or a magnifying glass icon) usually located next to your input.

If it looks different: If there isn't a clearly visible "Ask" button, simply pressing Enter after typing your question usually works on most devices. Make sure your question is specific enough so Perplexity understands exactly what you're trying to verify.

💬 Example: `Is it true that taking a cold shower every morning can cure the common cold?`

You'll know it worked when Perplexity starts to process your request, usually with a short loading animation while it looks for sources.

Step 3 — Review the summary and its citations

After a brief moment, Perplexity, acting as an **AI assistant** (a computer program designed to help with tasks and provide information), will present you with a **summary answer**. This is the AI's best attempt to directly address your question, drawing information from various online sources. Read through this summary carefully. You'll typically find a concise answer, along with key facts or explanations. Notice that within the summary, there will be small **numbered references**, like [1], [2], or [3], next to specific pieces of information. These numbers are crucial because they point directly to the original sources Perplexity used.

If it looks different: The summary might be formatted as a series of bullet points, a few longer paragraphs, or a mix of both. Regardless of the exact appearance, the core information and the numbered references should be clearly visible, usually appearing immediately below your initial question.

You'll know it worked when you see a generated answer to your query, complete with small, numbered citations embedded within the text.

Step 4 — Examine the source list

This is where Perplexity truly shines for transparency and fact-checking. Scroll down slightly below the main summary answer. You'll find a dedicated section, typically labeled "Sources" or "References." Here, you'll see a list of the actual websites or articles that Perplexity consulted to formulate its answer, corresponding to the numbers you saw in the summary. For each source, there will usually be a title, a brief description of the content, and the website's address. This **transparency** (showing you exactly where the information came from) is vital because it lets you see *where* the information originated, not just *what* the AI says.

If it looks different: The sources might be displayed as small, clickable cards, or as a simple list. On a mobile device, you might need to tap an "Expand Sources" or a similar button to reveal the full list. Just look for a distinct section that clearly lists external website links.

You'll know it worked when you see a list of external website links, each labeled with a number that corresponds to the citations in the AI's summary.

Step 5 — Dive into an original source

To truly verify a claim and understand its context, it's essential to go directly to the original source. Click on one of the numbered source links from the "Sources" section that seems most relevant to the claim you're checking or appears to be from a **reputable** (trustworthy and respected) organization. This action will open that original webpage in a new browser tab or sometimes within Perplexity itself (depending on your device settings). Now, you can read the information in its original context. Check if the information presented by Perplexity accurately reflects what the source says, look for publication dates, the author, and whether the website itself appears trustworthy (e.g., is it a known news organization, a research institution, or a personal blog?). Comparing the AI's summary with the actual source helps you confirm its accuracy.

If it looks different: If clicking a link doesn't open a new tab, check your browser's pop-up blocker settings, as they can sometimes interfere. You might also have the option to right-click (on a computer) or long-press (on a phone) the link to copy its address, then paste it directly into a new browser tab yourself.

You'll know it worked when you are actively viewing the actual website or article that Perplexity used, allowing you to read the original information.

Step 6 — Refine your query or ask follow-ups

Sometimes, your first question might not give you the complete picture, or the sources provided might be unclear. If you need more information or a different angle, you can ask a follow-up question. Below Perplexity's initial answer, you'll usually see an "Ask a follow-up" prompt or a new blank input box. Type your refined question there, focusing on clarifying details or asking for more specific types of sources. For example, if the initial sources were mostly opinion pieces, you might ask "Are there any scientific studies on this topic?". This iterative process helps you narrow down your search and get more precise, verifiable information.

If it looks different: Instead of an explicit "Ask a follow-up" button, you might simply see another blank input box directly below the answer, allowing you to continue the conversation. If you want to start a brand-new search entirely, look for a "New Thread" or "New Search" button, usually found near the top of the screen or within a side menu.

💬 Example: `Can you find government health organisation statements about cold showers and colds?`

You'll know it worked when Perplexity processes your follow-up query, generating a new answer and set of sources based on your refinement.

Common mistakes

- **Not checking the sources thoroughly**: It's tempting to just read Perplexity's summary and assume it's entirely correct. The AI compiles information, but it can sometimes misinterpret or give too much weight to less reliable sources. Always click through to the original sources to verify the context and content yourself.
- **Being too vague with your question**: Asking broad questions like "Tell me about this news" might not yield precise fact-checks. Instead, provide the specific claim or statement you want to investigate. Being specific helps Perplexity pull more relevant information.
- **Ignoring source reliability**: While Perplexity provides sources, it doesn't always rate their trustworthiness. A quick check of a source's website (e.g., is it a well-known news organization, a research institution, or just a personal blog?) and its publication date is crucial for deciding if the information is truly reliable.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** You can quickly become a more informed social media user. Before sharing a sensational post or falling for misinformation, you can take a minute to verify it, protecting yourself and your friends from spreading inaccurate content.
- **For your business or work:** If you work in communications, marketing, or any field where accurate information is key, Perplexity can be a fast way to cross-check industry news, claims from competitors, or statistics before you use them in a report or presentation.
- **If you're just getting started:** The easiest first move is to pick one social media post you're curious about today and run its exact claim through Perplexity. Focus on just reading the summary and then clicking through one source link to see the original content.

Try it now

Find a recent claim or statistic on your social media feed that caught your eye, perhaps something surprising or highly shared. Type that exact claim into Perplexity's search bar and hit Enter. Once you have the summary, scroll down and click on the first source link provided to see where the information originally came from.

How to Ask Gemini to Explain Your Bank Statement in Plain English

6 steps · Read online

> **In short:** You can upload a bank statement into Google's Gemini and ask plain-English questions to surface real spending, recurring charges and hidden fees. Gemini can't read your bank account — think of it as a translator for the numbers on your statement.

A monthly bank statement is full of small numbers, merchant codes and fee names that rarely mean anything at first glance. With Google's Gemini, you can hand it that document and ask, in normal sentences, "what am I actually paying for?" — and get a readable answer back. This guide walks you through it, one step at a time.

Before you start

- A free Google account (the same one you use for Gmail or YouTube).
- Access to Gemini in a browser (gemini.google.com) or the Gemini mobile app — both work for this. The free version is enough for reading a single statement.
- A copy of your monthly bank statement, saved as a PDF or a screenshot — most banks let you download it from their website or app.
- About 10 minutes the first time; once you've done it once, the same questions work on next month's statement.

Step 1 — Open Gemini and start a fresh chat

Go to **gemini.google.com** in your browser, or open the **Gemini app** on your phone. If you are not signed in, the page will ask you to sign in with your Google account — the same email and password you use for Gmail. Once you are in, look for a button or link along the left side or top of the screen that says something like **"New chat"** or **"Start a new chat"** and click or tap it. A blank conversation opens. If you don't see that exact label, look for a **pencil icon**, a **"+" sign**, or a text box that says **"Ask Gemini"** — any of those will start a fresh conversation.
Example: open the Gemini app, tap "New chat," and you should see an empty text box with the prompt "Ask Gemini" at the bottom. You'll know it worked when you see an empty text field with no previous messages above it.

Step 2 — Upload your bank statement

Look for a small **paperclip icon**, a **"+" button**, or an **"Upload"** option near the text box — every version of Gemini has a way to attach a file. Click it, then choose the **PDF** of your statement from your computer or phone. If your statement is a stack of screenshots instead, you

can either upload them one at a time or, on the desktop site, drag and drop them all into the chat window together. The file name appears in your message once it uploads. If you can't find an upload option at all, your version may only accept **pasted text** — open your PDF, select all the text (Ctrl+A or Cmd+A), copy it (Ctrl+C or Cmd+C), and paste it (Ctrl+V or Cmd+V) directly into the chat box instead. Example: "I'm pasting my bank statement below — it's about 3 pages of transactions." You'll know it worked when a small thumbnail or file name shows up next to your message, and Gemini replies with something like "Got it, I'm reading the statement now."

Step 3 — Ask for a plain-language summary

Now type a first question in the same chat. Don't ask for anything fancy yet — just ask Gemini to read the statement and tell you, in normal words, what happened in the month. Think of it as asking a friend who is good with numbers to glance at the page and explain it. Be specific about the period, and tell Gemini how you'd like the answer — short bullets, full sentences, whatever you prefer. If Gemini answers with generic budgeting advice instead of reading your actual statement, it probably didn't see the file — re-upload it or paste the text directly into the chat. Example: "Please read the statement I just uploaded and give me a plain-English summary of what happened in November. List the top 3 things I spent money on and any fees I was charged. Keep it under 200 words." You'll know it worked when Gemini replies with a readable summary that mentions real names and amounts from your statement — not a generic answer about budgeting.

Step 4 — Ask about recurring charges and small fees

Now go one level deeper. Small monthly fees — a $4.99 streaming service, a $12 "account maintenance" charge, a $2 ATM surcharge — are easy to miss when you scroll quickly. Ask Gemini to look specifically for anything that appears more than once, or anything that looks like a fee rather than a purchase. This is the step where most people discover charges they've been paying for months without noticing. If Gemini says it can't see any recurring charges, the file may have been only partially read — ask it to look at every page, or paste the full transaction list into the chat. Example: "Now look only at the charges that happened more than once this month, and anything that looks like a fee or service charge. For each one, tell me the name, the amount, and how many times it appeared." You'll know it worked when you get a short list of repeated merchants and fee names you can scan in 30 seconds — and probably one or two that surprise you.

Step 5 — Ask about your real spending patterns

The next question is about categories. Gemini can group your transactions by type — food, transport, subscriptions, cash withdrawals — and show you where most of the money went. This

is helpful even if your statement already has a "category" column, because Gemini's version often groups things more sensibly for everyday reading, and you can ask follow-up questions about any category that looks too big or too small. If Gemini lumps almost everything into "other," your statement may have lots of unfamiliar merchant names — ask it to list the biggest "other" items so you can see what got hidden. Example: "Group all my spending from this statement into simple categories like food, transport, subscriptions, bills and other. Show me the total for each category and the percentage of my total spending. Then tell me which category grew the most compared to a normal month." You'll know it worked when you see a small table or list with named categories, dollar totals and clear percentages — something you could read once and remember.

Step 6 — Save your insights or turn them into questions for your bank

The last step is making sure you don't lose what you just learned. If something in the summary or the fee list looked wrong, copy Gemini's exact wording of that charge — the merchant name, the date, the amount — and use it next time you contact your bank. You can also ask Gemini to rewrite the whole summary into an email or a checklist you can save. To come back to this conversation later, look in the left sidebar for your recent chats — your version of Gemini should keep a running list you can reopen. If you can't find it, bookmark the page in your browser before you close the tab. Example: "Turn the summary from Step 3 and the fee list from Step 4 into a short email I can send to my bank asking about the $12 monthly fee. Keep the tone polite and include the date and amount for each charge." You'll know it worked when you have either a saved conversation, a copyable email draft, or a clear list of questions to bring to your bank's customer service.

Common mistakes

- **Uploading a statement from a bank that masks real names.** Some banks replace merchant names with codes (like "POS DEBIT 8842"). Gemini can't decode those on its own — you'll get a vague answer. If this happens, ask your bank for an itemized version.
- **Asking one giant question instead of several small ones.** A request like "tell me everything about my statement" usually produces a fuzzy answer. Three or four short, focused questions (like in Steps 3, 4 and 5) get sharper results.
- **Forgetting to remove sensitive info if you share the chat.** A bank statement has your account number, sometimes your address and always your full name. If you ever screenshot a Gemini chat to share it, blur those parts first.
- **Treating Gemini's answer as a final verdict.** It can misread a number, miss a charge or guess wrong about a fee. Always check the original statement before calling your bank — Gemini helps you ask better questions, it doesn't replace them.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** the next time a charge looks unfamiliar on your statement, you can paste it into Gemini and ask, in one sentence, "what is this $9.50 charge from XYZ?" before you spend 20 minutes on hold with customer service.
- **For your business or work:** if you run a small business and review statements monthly, this same set of questions can become a 5-minute weekly check instead of a 90-minute pile of receipts.
- **If you're just getting started:** try it on a statement you already understand well — your last month, perhaps. That way you can quickly see whether Gemini's summary is accurate, before you trust it on a more confusing one.

Try it now

Open Gemini, upload this month's bank statement, and paste this single prompt: "Read this statement and list every charge I don't recognize, with the date and amount. Keep it to 10 items or fewer." Ninety seconds, one question — and you'll likely learn at least one thing you didn't know you were paying for.

How to Fact-Check a Suspicious Text or Link Before Forwarding It

6 steps · Read online

> **In short:** Paste a suspicious message into any AI assistant to list its warning signs, then verify the claim yourself through a trusted channel. The AI cannot confirm that a link is safe or that a message is true, so treat its answer as a second pair of eyes.

A message that says "forward this to everyone now!" can make anyone hit send. This guide shows you how to use an AI assistant as a careful first reader: you'll build a reusable checklist, get a clear list of red flags, and finish with a plan for what to check before you share. It's written for anyone who already uses a chat assistant and wants a more reliable routine.

Before you start

- An account on any AI assistant you already use. You know how to start a chat and send a message, so we skip that part.
- The suspicious text or link, copied into a notes app on your phone or computer.
- A free plan is usually enough for this. Very long pastes can be cut short on some plans, and limits can change, so check the reply is complete.
- About 10 minutes.

Step 1 — Save a reusable checklist

Open your notes app and create a note called something like "Scam check template." Paste in the instructions below, so you never have to rewrite them. Most people find this helpful because the same checklist gets used every time, which keeps your review consistent.

Once saved, the template is simply copied into a new chat each time. You don't need any special settings or paid features for this; it's just a saved piece of text you control.

If your assistant has a feature for saved instructions or custom profiles, you can paste the template there instead. Look for a settings area with words like "instructions" or "custom." If you can't find one, the notes app works just as well.

💬 Example: "You are helping me check a message before I forward it. Look for these warning signs: urgency or pressure, requests for money, gift cards or passwords, a sender I can't verify, links that don't match the company they claim to be, and wording that feels off. Then list what you cannot tell from the text alone."

You'll know it worked when your note holds the full template and you can copy it in one tap.

Step 2 — Start a fresh chat with the message

Open your AI assistant and start a new chat, so earlier conversations don't mix into this check. Copy the template from your note and paste it into the message box. Then add the suspicious message below it. Most assistants accept both in one message, and you should see your text appear in the chat box before you send.

Tell the assistant who sent it, if you know. That detail matters. If the message says it came from a friend, a bank, or a delivery company, mention that, but don't assume it's true.

If the box won't take a long paste, try pasting in two parts, with the template first and the message second in a new message. If the reply only covers part of the text, ask it to continue.

Example: "Here is the message I received from [who sent it]: [paste the message here]"

You'll know it worked when the assistant replies with a structured list or a set of observations about the message, rather than just repeating your text back to you.

Step 3 — Ask for the evidence behind each flag

A red flag is only useful if you know why it's there. Read the assistant's list, then send a follow-up asking it to show its reasons. This builds on the first answer, which is a simple but powerful way to get a more useful response.

Look for each flag to point to exact words from the message. If the assistant claims something is suspicious but can't point to a specific sentence, be skeptical of that flag and ask again.

If the follow-up answer is vague, rephrase your request with more specifics, such as "only list flags you can tie to a quoted sentence." Keep the chat open so the assistant remembers the message you pasted.

Example: "For each warning sign you found, quote the exact words from the message and explain in one sentence why it could be a concern."

You'll know it worked when every flag comes with a quoted phrase and a short reason, so you can check the reasoning yourself in the original text.

Step 4 — Inspect a link without tapping it

If the message contains a web address, don't tap it yet. Copy the address as text, or long-press it to copy, and paste it into the chat. The AI can break the address into parts so you can read it more clearly.

Here's what to look for. In an address like `https://usps-tracking.example.com/pay-now`, the name that matters most is the part right before the main ending, which here is `example.com`. The words in front of it can be anything, so a famous company's name at the start proves very little. The AI can help you spot that pattern, but it cannot visit the site to tell you whether it's live or dangerous.

Be cautious of shortened links and links that ask you to log in or pay right away. Those are reasons to slow down, not to panic.

Example: "Break down this web address into its parts and tell me which part is the actual site name: [paste the address here]"

You'll know it worked when the assistant explains which part of the address belongs to the site and points out any mismatch with the company it claims to be.

Step 5 — Confirm through a channel you trust

This is the most important step, and no AI can do it for you. Ask the assistant which claims in the message you would need to confirm directly. Then check each one through a source you already trust: type the company's address yourself, use the official app, or call the phone number printed on a bill or a card you own. Don't use a number or link that came inside the message.

If the message claims a friend is in trouble or needs money, call that person on a number you already have saved. Scammers often rely on urgency to stop people from checking.

If you can't reach anyone to confirm, the safe choice is to hold off on sharing it. Waiting costs almost nothing.

Example: "Based on this message, what are the three most important claims I should confirm directly with the company before I share it?"

You'll know it worked when you have a short list of specific things to verify and a plan for how you'll check each one outside the message.

Step 6 — Draft a calm heads-up for family

Once you know what you're going to do, ask the assistant to help you write a short message to the people you'd otherwise have forwarded to. A calm, specific note is more useful than an all-caps warning, and it helps your family learn the checking habit too.

Keep the draft short and kind. Mention what you found and what you're doing about it, without blaming the person who sent it to you. Read the draft before sending, because you know your family better than the assistant does.

💬 Example: "Write a short, calm message I can send to [family member name] saying I'm not sure this text is real, that we should check it with [trusted contact] first, and that they shouldn't share it yet."

You'll know it worked when you have a short, friendly draft that you can edit and send in your own voice.

Common mistakes

- **Trusting the AI as the final judge.** The assistant reads the text you give it and can be wrong. The fix is to always confirm the key claims through a source you trust, as in Step 5.
- **Clicking the link to "see what it says."** Even a quick tap can load a page you didn't mean to visit. The fix is to paste the address into the chat as text, as in Step 4, and check it through the official site you type yourself.
- **Forwarding first and checking later.** Once a message is sent, you can't pull it back. The fix is to make Steps 2 to 5 a habit: pause, paste, check, then decide.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** When a worrying text arrives about a package, a bill, or a relative in trouble, paste it into your checklist and follow the steps before anyone in your family acts on it.
- **For your business or work:** Keep the template in a shared note so coworkers can use the same checklist before forwarding a suspicious invoice or request to the team.
- **If you want to go further:** Try building a short library of templates for different situations, such as payment requests, delivery notices, or account alerts. Keep each one short, and test it on a message you already know is legitimate so you learn what a normal message looks like.

Try it now

Open your notes app and save the template from Step 1. Then take one message you received recently, paste it into a new chat with the template, and read the first list of flags. You'll know this worked when you have a saved template and a short, quoted list of observations for a real message.

How to compare two rental listings side by side with weighted pros and cons

6 steps · Read online

> **In short:** Open any AI assistant, paste both listings, list your priorities with weights, and ask for a scored comparison table. The assistant won't visit the apartment for you, but it will turn a wall of listing text into a clear trade-off table in minutes.

When you're choosing between two rentals, the listings blur together. This five-minute workflow works in any AI assistant — ChatGPT, Gemini, Claude, Copilot, Le Chat, DeepSeek, or whichever you already have — and scores both places against the priorities you set yourself.

Before you start

- An account with any AI assistant you already use (free or paid — both work for this).
- The full text of both rental listings, copied from the listing page or app. Screenshots alone won't work — only pasted text.
- A short list of what actually matters to you (commute, noise, utilities included, lease length, pets, parking — three to six items is enough).
- About 15 minutes.

Step 1 — Open a new chat and paste both listings

Start a fresh conversation — don't drop this into an old chat, or the assistant will weigh your rentals against whatever you were talking about before. In the message box at the bottom of the screen, paste the first listing, leave a blank line, then paste the second one. End the message with a one-line note telling the assistant what it's looking at. Example: "Listing A — 2-bed in Eastside, $X/month, 12-month lease. — — Listing B — 1-bed + den in Northgate, $Y/month, month-to-month. Compare these two rentals." If the listing is mostly images or a PDF, you'll need to type out the key facts by hand — assistants can't reliably read screenshots unless your plan includes file upload or vision, and even then the result varies. You'll know it worked when you can scroll up and see both listings sitting in the chat, and the assistant acknowledges them in its first reply.

Step 2 — Tell the assistant your priorities and how much each matters

Send a second message that lists the things you care about and gives each one a weight — how much it should count in the final score. Weights are how you stop the assistant from treating "has a dishwasher" as equally important as "20-minute commute." The format that works best is a numbered list with a 1–5 or 1–10 weight next to each priority. Example: "Here are my

priorities, weighted 1–5: 1) Commute under 30 min by transit (5). 2) Quiet street, no main road (4). 3) Utilities included in rent (3). 4) Allows my cat (5). 5) In-unit laundry (2). Score both listings against these." If your assistant has a "memory" or "custom instructions" setting (different apps call it different things), you can save the weights there once and reuse them for future comparisons. You'll know it worked when the assistant restates your priorities back to you without being asked — that means it actually loaded them into the conversation.

Step 3 — Ask for a clean side-by-side table first, before any scores

Now ask for a comparison table with one row per feature and one column per listing. Don't ask for scores yet — you want a neutral snapshot of what each listing actually says, so you can spot places where the assistant fills in gaps with guesses. The clearer this table is, the more honest the scoring will be in the next step. Example: "Make a table with these rows: rent, lease length, square feet, utilities included, parking, laundry, pet policy, commute time to downtown, nearest noise source. One column for Listing A, one for Listing B, one for 'verified or missing.' If a fact isn't in the listing, write 'not stated.'" If the table renders as plain text instead of a real grid (some mobile apps do this), ask the assistant to "rebuild it with pipes and dashes" and it will produce a text-only version that still reads clearly. You'll know it worked when every row is filled with text from the listing — or says "not stated" — instead of the assistant inventing something to fill the gap.

Step 4 — Add weighted scores and a recommendation

Send a third message asking the assistant to score each listing on your weighted priorities and add a one-line recommendation at the bottom. This is the step that turns the table into a decision. The math is simple: multiply each priority's weight by the listing's score on that priority, then add them up. The listing with the higher total wins — *on your priorities*, not on someone else's. Example: "Now score both listings 1–10 on each priority from Step 2, multiply by the weight, and show the totals. Add a two-sentence recommendation naming which one wins on my priorities and why." If the assistant hedges with "it really depends on you," that's a sign it didn't read your weights carefully — nudge it with "use the weights literally, don't substitute your own." You'll know it worked when you see a final number for each listing and the recommendation names a clear winner with a stated reason.

Step 5 — Push back on vague answers and list what to verify

Before you act on the recommendation, ask the assistant to flag anything it had to guess at, plus every "not stated" cell from the table. This step is the safety net — assistants can sound confident about facts that aren't actually in the listing, and a lease you signed based on a wrong assumption is an expensive lesson. The honest answer often involves several things you need to

ask the landlord directly. 💬 Example: "List every fact in the table you marked 'not stated' and anything you had to infer. For each one, write a one-line question I can email the landlord." If the assistant invents a detail (like "utilities are included" when the listing didn't say so), that's a hallucination — when an AI confidently states something that isn't actually there. Call it out with: "You made that up; the listing didn't say it. Replace with 'unverified, ask landlord.'" You'll know it worked when you have a short, concrete list of questions to send before you sign anything.

Step 6 — Save the prompt structure as a reusable template

Copy the three prompts you sent (Steps 1, 2, and 4) into a notes app and label it "Rental comparison template." Next time you're weighing two places, open a new chat, paste the template, swap in the new listings and weights, and you'll get the same scored comparison in minutes — no setup, no re-thinking the structure. 💬 Example: "PROMPT 1: [paste listings + intro line]. PROMPT 2: [paste weighted priorities]. PROMPT 3: [paste score-and-recommend request]." If your assistant supports a way to save reusable prompts (different apps call this Projects, Gems, custom instructions, or similar — check the menus if you're not sure), you can store the template there so it loads automatically next time. You'll know it worked when the template is sitting in your notes ready to go the next time a listing site or a landlord's email hands you two options.

Common mistakes

- **Letting the assistant pick your priorities.** It will default to generic things like "location" and "price." Insist on *your* weights, even if they feel quirky — a quiet street might matter more to you than square footage, and that's the whole point of doing this yourself.
- **Pasting only the headline summary.** The first paragraph of a listing is marketing. The fine print about utilities, parking, and pet fees is usually further down — paste the whole thing, or you'll be comparing ad copy instead of facts.
- **Trusting the score without checking the table.** A 9/10 on "utilities included" means nothing if the listing never actually said that. Always read the table before you read the score, and send the "not stated" list to the landlord before you commit.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** When you're weighing two rentals (or two cars, or two phone plans), this same three-prompt pattern turns a messy comparison into a clear trade-off table in minutes — without you having to argue with yourself about which factor matters more.
- **For your work or business:** The same structure works for choosing between vendors, job offers, software plans, or any two options where you want *your* priorities to drive the

score — not the assistant's defaults.

- **If you want to go further:** Try extending the prompt to three listings instead of two, or add a "dealbreaker" rule that automatically disqualifies any option missing a non-negotiable (like "no cat-friendly place counts, period").

Try it now

Pick one priority that matters to you (commute, pets, quiet, anything), find two short rental listings — even made-up ones work for practice — and run Steps 1 to 4 in a fresh chat. You'll see the decision become obvious in under five minutes.

Catch Up Fast: Summarize Long Chats in WhatsApp and Messenger with Meta AI

6 steps · Read online

By the end of this guide you'll know how to ask Meta AI (a built-in helper inside WhatsApp and Messenger) to read through a long chat and give you a short, useful summary in plain language. This is for anyone who has ever scrolled back through hundreds of messages thinking *"what did I miss?"* — whether it's a family group chat or a busy work thread.

Before you start

- A phone with **WhatsApp** or **Messenger** installed, updated to the latest version (Meta AI is rolled out in stages, so update to be sure).
- A personal Meta account already logged in on that app.
- Meta AI available in your country or region — if you cannot see it after updating, it may not have reached your area yet.
- Around **5 to 10 minutes** of your time, plus the chat you want summarized open in another window or conversation.

One honest note up front: Meta AI **cannot read old messages you have not shared with it**. You will need to either paste the messages into a chat with Meta AI or @-mention it in a recent thread. It is free to use, but anything you send is processed by Meta — so avoid pasting very sensitive personal details.

Step 1 — Open WhatsApp or Messenger and look for Meta AI

Open the app you usually use (WhatsApp or Messenger) and look at the top of your chat list or your contacts. You should see Meta AI listed as an option, sitting alongside your usual contacts. Tap it once. A new chat window opens, just like starting a conversation with a friend. You'll know it worked when you see a message from Meta AI indicating it's ready to help. **If it looks different:** some users see a different icon or a "New chat" option with an AI symbol, or a search bar at the top — any of these can lead to Meta AI. If you see nothing related to AI, your app may need an update, or Meta AI may not yet be available in your region.

Step 2 — Open the chat you want summarized, side by side

Leave the Meta AI chat open, then open the long chat you want to catch up on. On most phones you can switch between apps with the square "recent apps" button, or use your phone's split-screen feature if available. You will see the full message history of your long chat on one screen and the Meta AI chat on the other. This makes copying easy. **If it looks different:** on tablets or

split-screen devices you can arrange both windows side by side so both sit next to each other at the same time.

Step 3 — Copy the messages you want summarized

In the long chat, press and hold the first message you want Meta AI to read, then choose **Copy**. For a range of messages, keep tapping each one until you have selected the section you missed (often the last 20 to 50 messages is plenty). Then tap **Copy** again. The text now sits on your phone's clipboard, ready to paste — like copying a paragraph from a website. **If it looks different:** some Android phones show a small menu with "Copy", "Forward" and "Share"; on iPhone you'll see "Copy" appear above the selected message. If selecting one-by-one is too slow, try **Forward** instead, then paste into the Meta AI chat in one go.

💬 Example: *"I copied messages from a 40-person family group covering about a day's worth of chat — roughly 30 messages with photos, links and a few voice notes."*

You'll know it worked when your phone briefly shows a small "Copied" label or a tick next to the selected messages.

Step 4 — Paste the messages into Meta AI and ask for a summary

Switch back to the Meta AI chat. Tap inside the message box, hold for a moment, and choose **Paste**. The copied messages appear as one long block. On a new line underneath, type a clear, kind request that tells Meta AI exactly what you want — think of this as giving instructions to a helpful assistant, not just dumping text on it. Then tap the send arrow. After a few seconds, Meta AI replies with a summary. **If it looks different:** if the paste does not appear, try tapping once inside the text box first, then holding your finger down again. If Meta AI replies in a language you did not expect, add "Please reply in English" at the end of your message.

💬 Example: *"Here are the messages from my family group from yesterday. Please summarize them in 5 short bullet points, focus on any decisions or plans people made, and ignore the photos. Reply in plain English."*

You'll know it worked when Meta AI replies with a summary rather than echoing the messages back at you.

Step 5 — Refine the summary if it is too long or off-target

Read Meta AI's reply. If the summary is too vague, too long, or misses what you actually care about, reply with a short follow-up message asking for a change. The assistant remembers the conversation, so you can be casual about it. Each new request usually takes a few seconds. **If it**

looks different: if Meta AI seems stuck or repeats the same answer, try starting a brand-new chat and pasting the messages again with a clearer instruction — sometimes a fresh start produces better results.

💬 Example: *"Great, but please make it 3 bullet points instead of 5, and add a one-line 'action items' section at the end showing what I might need to reply to."*

You'll know it worked when the new summary matches what you actually wanted to know — short, focused and useful.

Step 6 — Save or share the summary

Once you are happy with the summary, you can save it for later or send it to someone else. Tap and hold the assistant's message, then choose **Copy** to put it on your clipboard, or look for the forward option to send it to another chat or contact. Many phones also let you tap **Share** and save it straight to Notes, email or a document. **If it looks different:** if you don't see forward options, look for a menu icon or arrow next to the message. From there you can usually forward, share or save the message.

💬 Example: *"I forward the summary to a private chat with myself called 'Catch-up notes' so I can search it later without scrolling through the original group."*

You'll know it worked when the summary now lives somewhere easy to find — your notes app, a saved message, or a chat you control.

Common mistakes

- **Pasting months of messages at once.** Meta AI has a limit to how much text it can read in one go, and very long pastes often get cut off or produce a generic answer. **Fix:** paste the last 20 to 50 messages only, or split a longer chat into two requests.
- **Sharing sensitive personal information.** Anything you paste into Meta AI is processed by Meta's servers, so names, addresses, phone numbers or financial details should be removed first. **Fix:** change real names to "Alex", "Sam" and "the host" before pasting, especially for group chats with people you do not know well.
- **Expecting Meta AI to know your whole chat history without pasting.** Unlike asking a friend, the assistant only sees what you have shared with it in that conversation. **Fix:** always paste the messages you want summarized, or @-mention Meta AI inside a recent thread so it can see the surrounding context.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** catch up on noisy family or friend group chats before replying, instead of scrolling through 200 messages on the train.
- **For your business or work:** turn long WhatsApp or Messenger threads with clients, teammates or event groups into a short briefing you can skim in 30 seconds and forward to a colleague.
- **If you're just getting started:** pick one group chat you fall behind on, copy the last 20 messages, paste them into Meta AI and ask for 3 bullets — that single step is the whole skill in miniature.

Try it now

Open your busiest group chat right now, copy the last 20 messages, paste them into a Meta AI chat, and ask: *"Summarize these in 3 bullet points and list anything I need to reply to."* It takes under two minutes and you'll have the skill for life.

Summarize Long Articles into Key Bullet Points with Grok on X

6 steps · Read online

In today's fast-paced world, it's easy to feel overwhelmed by the sheer volume of information available online. This guide will show you how to use Grok, an AI assistant integrated into the X platform, to quickly condense long news articles or reports into concise bullet points. By the end, you'll be able to get the essential information from any article in moments, letting you stay informed without needing to read every word. While Grok can summarize the content of an article, it cannot verify the accuracy of the original article's claims or perform actions like sending emails for you.

Before you start

- An active X Premium+ subscription, as Grok is only available to subscribers of X's highest tier.
- The X app on your mobile device or access to the X website on a computer.
- Roughly 5-10 minutes of your time.

Step 1 — Access Grok on X

First, open the X app on your phone or visit the X website on your computer. Once the X feed has loaded, look for a special icon that represents Grok. On mobile, this is usually a diamond-shaped icon found in the bottom navigation bar. On a computer, you might find a "Grok" option listed in the left-hand sidebar menu, often near your profile or notifications. Tap or click on this icon to enter the Grok interface. If it looks different: The X interface can change, so if you don't see a diamond icon or a clear "Grok" label, look for an icon that stands out, or check the 'More' menu (often three lines or dots) for an entry labeled "Grok". You'll know it worked when you see Grok's chat interface, which usually includes a welcome message or a list of previous conversations.

Step 2 — Copy the Article Link

Now, you need to find the online article you want to summarize. Open your web browser (like Chrome, Safari, or Edge) and navigate to the news article, blog post, or report you're interested in. Once you're on the page, look for the web address (URL) at the top of the browser window. Tap or click on this address to highlight it, then use your device's copy function (e.g., right-click and 'Copy' on a computer, or long-press and 'Copy' on a phone) to save the link to your clipboard. If it looks different: Some apps have a 'Share' button (often an arrow pointing upwards or a three-dot menu) that includes a 'Copy Link' option. If you can't easily highlight the

URL, look for that share option. You'll know it worked when the link is saved and ready to be pasted elsewhere.

Step 3 — Start a New Chat with Grok

With your article link copied, return to the Grok interface within the X app or website. To begin a fresh summarisation task, you'll need to start a new conversation. Look for a button that typically indicates starting something new, like a '+' symbol, a pencil icon, or a "New Chat" button, usually located at the top-right or bottom-right corner of the Grok chat screen. Tapping this will clear any previous messages and give you a clean slate. If it looks different: If you don't see an obvious 'new chat' icon, you can often just type your request directly into the existing message box. Grok is usually smart enough to treat a new request as a new topic. You'll know it worked when the chat area is empty and a message input box is clearly visible at the bottom of the screen, ready for you to type.

Step 4 — Paste Your Link and Request a Summary

Now it's time to tell Grok what you want. Click or tap inside the message input box at the bottom of the Grok chat screen. Paste the article link you copied in Step 2 into the box. After the link, type a clear instruction asking Grok to summarize the content. Be specific about the format you prefer, like asking for bullet points, to help Grok deliver exactly what you need. If it looks different: If pasting doesn't work, try typing the full URL manually if it's short, or check your device's clipboard settings to ensure the link was copied correctly. Grok might indicate if it's having trouble accessing the link. 💬 Example: `Please summarise this news article into 5 clear bullet points, focusing on the main findings: [paste your article link here]` You'll know it worked when the summary starts appearing in the chat below your message.

Step 5 — Review Grok's Summary

Once Grok has finished processing your request, its summary will appear in the chat window, presented in the bullet-point format you asked for. Read through these points carefully. This is your chance to quickly understand the core message, key arguments, and important facts from the article without having to read every sentence of the original text. Take a moment to ensure the summary captures what you expected and is easy to understand. If it looks different: Sometimes, Grok might ask a clarifying question if the article is too long, behind a paywall (which Grok cannot bypass), or contains ambiguous content. If this happens, try rephrasing your request or finding a more accessible article. You'll know it worked when you have a concise list of key information that helps you quickly grasp the article's main content.

Step 6 — Refine the Summary (Optional)

Grok's initial summary might be great, but you can always ask for more details or a different perspective if needed. If a particular bullet point sparked your interest, or if you feel something important was missed, simply type a follow-up question into the message box. You can ask Grok to expand on a specific detail, explain a complex term, or even rephrase the summary for a different audience (e.g., "Summarize this for a high school student"). This allows you to dig deeper without returning to the original lengthy article. If it looks different: If Grok says it can't find the information, it might be that the detail wasn't explicitly in the article, or it's too specific for a general summary. Try rephrasing your follow-up in simpler terms. 💬 Example: `Can you elaborate on the economic implications mentioned in bullet point 2?` You'll know it worked when Grok provides a more detailed or adjusted response, showing it's continuing to process the article's information based on your new prompt.

Common mistakes

- **No Grok access:** Grok is a premium feature, so if you can't find it or get an error, ensure your X subscription is the highest tier (X Premium+). The fix is to upgrade your X subscription.
- **Pasting a broken or inaccessible link:** If Grok says it can't access the article, check that the link is correct and that the article isn't behind a paywall or login that Grok can't bypass. The fix is to find a publicly accessible link or try a different article.
- **Vague summary request:** If Grok gives a less-than-useful summary, your request might have been too general. The fix is to be more specific in your prompt, like "Summarize into 5 bullet points" or "Focus on the environmental impact."

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** Quickly catch up on news headlines or understand long reports from community groups without spending hours reading. It's perfect for when you're short on time but want to stay informed.
- **For your business or work:** Efficiently digest industry news, competitor analysis, or lengthy internal reports, allowing you to extract critical insights faster and make more informed decisions.
- **If you're just getting started:** Practice by picking a news article you'd normally skim, then use Grok to get a bullet-point summary. Compare it to what you would have highlighted yourself.

Try it now

Open the X app, navigate to Grok, and paste a link to any recent news article. Ask Grok to summarize it for you in three bullet points. See how quickly you can get the main gist!

Summarize a long chat thread into 3 bullet points with Copilot

6 steps · Read online

Ever feel lost trying to find the key takeaways from a really long email chain or group chat? This guide is for anyone who wants to quickly cut through the noise and get straight to the important decisions and actions. By the end, you'll be able to use Microsoft Copilot to summarize any long text into three clear bullet points, making it easy to catch up or share concise updates.

Before you start

- A free Microsoft account (you can sign up for one easily if you don't have it).
- A web browser like Microsoft Edge, Google Chrome, or Mozilla Firefox.
- A long piece of text you want to summarize, such as an email conversation or a chat history.
- Roughly 5-7 minutes to follow the steps.

Step 1 — Open Copilot in your browser

Your first move is to open Copilot in your preferred web browser. Simply type `copilot.microsoft.com` into your browser's address bar at the top of the window, then press `Enter` on your keyboard. The Copilot homepage should load, presenting you with a clear chat input box usually located at the bottom of the screen, waiting for your commands. If the page looks a little different, don't worry – websites update often. Just look for a prominent chat area or a button that says "Start chat" or "Ask me anything." You'll know it worked when you see a clear input box at the bottom of the screen, probably saying "Ask me anything" or similar.

Step 2 — Sign in to your Microsoft account

To get the most out of Copilot, it's best to sign in. Look for a "Sign in" button, typically positioned in the top-right corner of the Copilot page, and click it. A new screen will appear, prompting you to enter your Microsoft account details, like your email address or phone number, and then your password. If you're already signed in, you'll see your profile picture or initials in that corner and can simply skip this step. If it offers choices like "work or school account," usually you'll select "personal account" for this task. You'll know it worked when your profile picture or initials appear in the top-right corner, indicating you are successfully logged in.

Step 3 — Craft your summary request

Now it's time to tell Copilot exactly what you want it to do. In the chat input box at the bottom of the screen, type out your specific instruction. Be clear that you want a summary, how many bullet points you need, and what you want it to focus on – in this case, decisions and action

items. This "instruction" is often called a **prompt** (which is just the message you send to an AI). Your typed message will appear in the input box, ready for you to add the content you want summarized. 💬 Example: `Summarize the following chat thread into exactly three short bullet points, focusing on key decisions and action items:` You'll know it worked when your complete instruction is clearly visible in the chat box, ready for the content you're about to paste.

Step 4 — Paste your long text

Next, you need to provide Copilot with the text to summarize. Go to the original source of your long chat thread or email chain (like your email client or messaging app), select all the text you want, and copy it. Then, click directly into the Copilot chat input box, making sure your cursor is positioned right after the instruction you typed in Step 3. Now, paste the copied text. The entire block of text will appear in the input box after your instruction. Copilot has a "context window" (the amount of text it can "remember" and process in one conversation), but for most chat threads, it will fit easily. You'll know it worked when all your copied text is visible in the input box, ready to be sent.

Step 5 — Send your request

With your instruction and the long text in place, it's time to send it to Copilot. Press the `Enter` key on your keyboard, or click the "Send" button that looks like a paper plane icon, usually located next to the input box. Once sent, your entire message will move from the input box into the main chat history. Copilot will then show a "thinking" indicator, meaning it's processing your request. After a short moment, it will generate its response, providing your summary. If the "Send" icon looks a little different, just know it's always near the input box. You'll know it worked when Copilot starts typing its response, and you see the summary appear as three bullet points in the chat window.

Step 6 — Review and refine your summary

Read through the three bullet points Copilot has generated. Does it capture the essence of the conversation? Does it highlight the key decisions and actions as you intended? If it's not quite perfect, you can ask Copilot to refine it. Simply type a follow-up request in the input box, explaining what changes you'd like. Copilot will then generate a revised summary based on your new feedback. This helps you get precisely what you need from the conversation. 💬 Example: `Please make the bullet points even shorter, just focusing on who needs to do what.` You'll know it worked when you have a concise, useful three-point summary of your original long text that meets your needs.

Common mistakes

- **Pasting text without a clear instruction:** If you just paste a long thread into Copilot without telling it what to do, it might simply repeat parts of the text or give a generic response. Always start with a specific instruction, like "Summarize this into three bullet points."
- **Assuming the AI knows context:** Copilot only "knows" what you provide in the current conversation. If your chat thread refers to external documents or past discussions, Copilot won't have that information unless you paste it in. Make sure all necessary information is included for the best summary.
- **Too much text for one go:** While Copilot has a large capacity, extremely long documents (tens of thousands of words) might exceed its "context window" (the amount of text it can process at once). If Copilot seems to miss the end of your content, try breaking the original text into two or three smaller chunks and summarizing them separately.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** Imagine catching up on a flurry of family messages about a holiday plan or quickly understanding the core points of a long community group discussion. Copilot helps you get the gist without having to read every single message, saving you precious time.
- **For your business or work:** Instantly extract the crucial decisions, assigned tasks, and next steps from lengthy meeting transcripts, project update emails, or internal team chats. This ensures you're always informed and can provide concise updates to colleagues without sifting through pages of text.
- **If you're just getting started:** A great way to practice is to take a long news article or a detailed product review you're interested in, copy the text, and ask Copilot to summarize it into three bullet points. This helps you see how it condenses information.

Try it now

Find a recent long email or a lengthy article online that you've been meaning to read. Copy the main body of text. Then, open Copilot, paste your copied text, and simply add the instruction: "Summarize this into three clear bullet points." See how quickly you can get the core information!

Ask Copilot to compare two product specs and list the differences

6 steps · Read online

You've got two product pages open and need to decide which one fits your needs. Instead of reading both from top to bottom, give Copilot the key specs and let it list the differences for you. In minutes, you'll have a clear side-by-side summary—no PhD in spreadsheets required.

Before you start

- A **GitHub account** (free is fine)
- A **computer or phone** with a web browser
- Two product pages open in separate tabs (for example, two software pricing pages or two laptop spec sheets)
- Rough time needed: **5 minutes**

Step 1 — Open Copilot in your browser

Go to github.com/github-copilot and sign in with your GitHub account. Alternatively, you can find Copilot through the GitHub homepage by clicking the Copilot option in the navigation menu. You'll see a chat box ready for your question.

If you already use Copilot in another way (like in your IDE or on Windows), you can also access the web-based chat from the main GitHub interface.

Example: Type or paste: "Hello"

You'll know it worked when Copilot answers your greeting with a short reply in the chat.

Step 2 — Share the first product's specs

Since Copilot can't automatically read external web pages, you'll need to copy the key specs from the product page yourself. Go to your first product page, select and copy the main specifications (like processor, RAM, storage, screen size, weight, and price), then paste them into the chat box.

Example: Paste: "Here are the specs for the first laptop: Processor: Intel Core i7-13700H, RAM: 16GB LPDDR5, Storage: 1TB SSD, Screen: 14" 2.8K OLED 120Hz, Weight: 1.4kg, Price: $2,199"

You'll know it worked when Copilot acknowledges the specs and confirms it's ready to compare.

Step 3 — Ask Copilot to format the specs

Now, tell Copilot how you want the specs organized. Type: "Format these specs as a clean bullet-point list."

Copilot will return a neat list of the specs you shared, making them easy to compare with the second product.

Example: Type: "Format these specs as a clean bullet-point list."

You'll know it worked when you see a clear list like: • Processor: Intel Core i7-13700H • RAM: 16GB LPDDR5 • Storage: 1TB SSD • Screen: 14" 2.8K OLED 120Hz • Weight: 1.4kg • Price: $2,199

Step 4 — Repeat for the second product

Go back to your browser and copy the key specs from the second product page. Return to Copilot and paste those specs into the chat.

Example: Paste: "Now for the second laptop: Processor: AMD Ryzen 9 7940HS, RAM: 32GB LPDDR5, Storage: 512GB SSD, Screen: 16" 2.5K IPS 165Hz, Weight: 1.8kg, Price: $1,799"

You'll know it worked when Copilot acknowledges the second set of specs.

Step 5 — Ask Copilot to compare the two lists

Now ask Copilot to compare the two sets of specs. Type: "Compare these two products and list the differences in a clear table or bullet list."

Copilot will take the two lists and highlight what's different—like RAM upgrades, storage options, screen refresh rates, or price changes.

Example: Type: "Compare these two products and list the differences in a clear table or bullet list."

You'll know it worked when you see a concise comparison like: • RAM: 16GB vs 32GB (second product has more) • Storage: 1TB vs 512GB (first product has more) • Price: $2,199 vs $1,799 (second product is cheaper) • Screen: 14" vs 16" (second product has a larger screen)

Step 6 — Ask for a recommendation (optional)

If you're still unsure, ask Copilot to give a simple recommendation based on your needs. Type: "Which of these two products is better for video editing on a budget?"

Copilot will weigh the specs against your stated use case and suggest the better option.

Example: Type: "Which of these two products is better for video editing on a budget?"

You'll know it worked when Copilot gives a concise recommendation with reasons.

Common mistakes

- **Pasting the wrong specs**: Double-check what you're copying from the product page. If you include the wrong specs, just paste the correct information and ask Copilot to start over.
- **Not including enough detail**: If you only paste partial specs, Copilot can't give you a full comparison. Include the key specs: processor, RAM, storage, screen, weight, and price.
- **Assuming Copilot remembers**: Copilot doesn't keep memory between chats. If you open a new chat, you'll need to paste both sets of specs again. Bookmark your chat or keep it open to avoid redoing steps.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life**: Next time you're choosing between two gadgets, appliances, or software tools, use Copilot to do the heavy lifting. Copy the specs, paste them in, and get a clear comparison in seconds—no more squinting at tiny font on a phone screen.
- **For your business or work**: When your team debates which tool to adopt, run this comparison in a shared chat. Everyone sees the same facts, and you avoid long email threads full of conflicting opinions.
- **If you're just getting started**: Start with two simple product pages you already have open. Try the steps above, and you'll see how easy it is to turn messy specs into a clean comparison.

Try it now

Open two product pages in your browser right now. Copy the first set of specs, go to github.com/github-copilot, paste them in, and ask Copilot to format them. Do the same for the second page, then ask it to compare them. You'll have your answer in under five minutes—no spreadsheets, no PhD required.

Summarize Long Research PDFs with Cohere’s Clever AI

5 steps · Read online

Imagine turning a dense, fifty-page research paper or a lengthy report into a crisp, one-page summary in under ten seconds. Whether you're a student tackling academic journals or a professional keeping up with industry reports, this guide will show you how to use Cohere to extract key insights without the headache, using a simple online tool.

Before you start

- **A Cohere account:** You'll need a free developer account to access the tools. Sign up on Cohere’s website.
- **A research PDF:** Have a PDF document ready on your computer that contains selectable text (not scanned images).
- **A web browser and computer:** You'll use the Cohere website on a desktop or laptop, as the interface might look different on a mobile device.
- **Time needed:** This guide should take about 10-15 minutes to follow.

Step 1 — Log in and find your API Key

Before we can ask the AI to read our document, we need a digital passkey to access its brain. This passkey is called an **API Key (Application Programming Interface Key)**, which is a unique password that securely connects your computer or web browser directly to the AI engine.

Once you log into your new Cohere dashboard, you'll usually see a menu on the left side of the screen. Look for a tab or section labeled "API Keys" or "Developers." Click on this to reveal your keys. Your active "Trial" API key will be displayed there; make sure to copy it. Keep this key private, just like you would with a bank password, to protect your account. You'll know it worked when you see a long string of letters and numbers (your unique key) next to "Trial API Key" or similar wording on the screen.

💬 Example: Your key will look like a long string of random letters and numbers, such as `a1B2c3D4e5...`

Step 2 — Open the Cohere Playground

Writing code can be intimidating if you're just starting out, but Cohere provides a **Playground** (an online sandbox or testing space) where you can experiment with AI settings using simple buttons instead of writing code.

From your Cohere dashboard, look for a prominent "Playground" button, which is often found at the top or in the sidebar. Clicking this will take you to a page where you can choose different

AI "templates." Select the "Summarize" option from the list of templates. After selecting, a new interface will load, typically showing a large text box on the left for your input and various setting sliders on the right. If you don't immediately see "Summarize," look for a section like "Templates" or "Use Cases." You'll know it worked when you see a main text area on the left and settings options on the right, with "Summarize" active or prominently displayed.

Step 3 — Extract and paste your PDF text

Currently, most AI tools work best when you feed them raw text directly. We need to copy the text out of our PDF and give it to the tool. Remember, the Cohere Summarize tool processes text you provide; it can't directly *open* your PDF file itself.

Open your research PDF on your computer using any PDF reader. Carefully highlight the main sections of the paper you want summarized – the introduction, key findings, and conclusion are usually the most important for a comprehensive overview – and copy them (using Ctrl+C on Windows or Command+C on Mac). Switch back to your Cohere Playground window. You'll see a large input box on the left, usually labeled "Input" or "Text to Summarize." Paste the text you copied from your PDF directly into this box. Don't worry if the formatting looks a bit messy after pasting; the AI is smart enough to read past odd spacing and line breaks. You'll know it worked when your text appears in the input box, ready for the AI to process.

💬 Example: Paste the text you copied from your PDF into the large input box on the left side of the Playground.

Step 4 — Customize your summary settings

On the right side of the screen, you'll see a panel of options. These sliders and dropdowns let you tell the AI exactly how you want your information presented, giving you control over the summary's output.

You'll typically find settings for "Length," "Format," and "Extractiveness."

1. **Length:** Choose between "Short," "Medium," or "Long." For a quick overview of a dense paper, "Short" is usually best.
2. **Format:** Select "Bullets" (perfect for quick scanning of key points) or "Paragraph" (better for a narrative, flowing summary).
3. **Extractiveness:** This slider controls how much the summary sticks to the exact wording of your original text versus rephrasing it in simpler, more general terms. Set it to "Low" if you want a plain-English translation that simplifies academic jargon, or "High" if you need the exact academic terms and phrases preserved.

If these options aren't immediately visible, look for a "Settings" or "Options" panel on the right side of the screen that you might need to expand. You'll know it worked when your chosen settings (e.g., "Short," "Bullets," "Low") are displayed next to their respective labels.

Step 5 — Generate your summary

Now it's time to let the AI do the heavy lifting and transform your long text into a concise summary.

Once you've adjusted your settings, scroll to the bottom of the right-hand panel or the Playground interface. Look for a button labeled "Generate" or "Run." Click this button to begin the AI summarisation process. Within a few seconds, a polished, easy-to-read summary will appear in a separate output window or section on the right side of the screen. If the "Generate" button is greyed out, double-check that you have pasted some text into the input area. You'll know it worked when a new section on the right-hand side of the screen populates with your AI-generated summary, which you can then copy and save for your study notes or work files.

💬 Example output:

> **Key Findings:**
>
> - The study tested 500 participants over twelve months.
> - Using AI tools reduced administrative tasks by 40%.
> - Participants reported higher satisfaction when using clear, visual interfaces.

Common mistakes

- **Pasting scanned images instead of text:** If your PDF is a scanned photocopy of an old book, you won't be able to highlight and copy the text.
    - **The fix:** Ensure you use "selectable" PDFs, where you can actually highlight individual words. If you only have a scanned image, you'll need to run the file through an Optical Character Recognition (OCR) tool first to convert the images into real text before copying.
- **Hitting the text limit with very long documents:** While Cohere can handle substantial text, free accounts often have limits on the total number of words (or "tokens") you can process in one go. If you paste an entire book, it might fail or only summarize a portion.
    - **The fix:** For extremely long documents, try breaking them into key sections (e.g., summarize chapter by chapter) or focus on only the most critical parts like the introduction, methods, results, and conclusion.
- **Leaving your API key visible:** Your API key is like a personal password; sharing it publicly could allow others to use your Cohere account, potentially incurring costs or

misusing the service.

    - **The fix:** Never share screenshots that show your API key, and never paste it into public forums or messages. If you accidentally share it, simply click "Regenerate Key" in your Cohere dashboard to disable the old one and get a new, secure key.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** You can use this method to quickly understand long product manuals, complicated rental agreements, or lengthy council planning reports before making big decisions, saving you hours of reading.
- **For your business or work:** You can easily digest competitor research, market studies, or complex industry regulations without spending hours reading every page, helping you stay informed and make quicker decisions.
- **If you're just getting started:** Try starting with a short news article (about 500-1000 words). Copying and pasting a single page of text into the Playground is the gentlest way to see how the AI structures its thoughts before tackling bigger documents.

Try it now

Open a browser tab, sign up for a free Cohere account, and copy just three paragraphs from any online news article. Paste it into the Cohere Summarize Playground, hit **Generate**, and watch how quickly it extracts the main point for you!

Use Claude to Pull Out the Key Points of a Long Research Paper

5 steps · Read online

> **In short:** Upload a research paper PDF to Claude and ask for a plain-English summary in five short sections. You'll need a Claude account and the PDF file; the whole thing takes about ten minutes.

Research papers are dense by design — they're meant to be read carefully and argued with, not skimmed on a Tuesday afternoon. Claude, the chat assistant from Anthropic, is unusually good at reading long documents and pulling out the bones of what's actually being said. This guide walks you through turning any academic PDF into a clean, structured summary you can actually use, whether you're a student trying to understand a paper for class, a journalist scanning sources, or a professional keeping up with research in your field.

Before you start

- A free Claude account at **claude.ai** (a paid plan unlocks more file uploads and longer documents — check Anthropic's site for current plan details).
- The research paper saved as a PDF on your computer or phone. Most journal articles have a free author copy on the author's university page or on repositories like PubMed Central.
- About 10 minutes.

Step 1 — Open Claude and start a fresh chat

Open **claude.ai** in your browser, or launch the Claude mobile app, and sign in. If you don't have an account yet, the sign-up button is right at the top of the page — you'll need an email address and a password. Once you're in, look for a button labeled **"New chat"** (or a **+ icon**) and click it. A blank conversation screen opens with an empty message box at the bottom. 💬 Example: N/A — no typing in this step. You'll know it worked when you see a clean, empty chat with no previous messages and a text box ready at the bottom of the screen.

Step 2 — Attach the PDF

Click the **paperclip icon** 📎 next to the message box. A file picker opens; browse to your PDF, select it, and confirm. On mobile, the same paperclip opens your phone's file or photos app — pick **"Files"** or **"Documents,"** not photos. If you can't spot a paperclip, look for a **+ plus icon** or a button that says **"Add file"** or **"Upload"** — Claude offers the same feature under slightly different labels depending on the device and platform. After you select the file, its filename appears as a small chip just above the text box. 💬 Example: N/A — no typing in this step. You'll

know it worked when the PDF's filename is visible as a label or chip above the message box, before you've typed anything.

Step 3 — Ask for a structured five-section summary

Click into the message box and type a clear, specific prompt asking for the summary in five labeled parts. Then send it — press Enter on a computer, or tap the upward arrow on mobile. You'll see a small "thinking" indicator for a few seconds while Claude reads the PDF, and then its reply appears. The reply should be longer than a chat message — usually several short paragraphs with headings or numbered points. Example: "Please summarize this paper in plain English using five short sections: (1) the main question the research tries to answer, (2) the method they used, including who or what they studied, (3) the key findings, (4) what the authors conclude, and (5) the limits of the study the authors mention. Keep each section to 2–4 sentences." You'll know it worked when Claude's reply breaks into labeled sections that match what you asked for — usually with bold headings, numbered items, or clear paragraph breaks.

Step 4 — Ask follow-up questions on the parts that confuse you

Stay in the same chat and type a question about something in the summary that didn't quite land — a method, a term, a number, anything. Press Enter. Claude replies with a focused answer because it still has the full PDF in memory and the previous summary right in front of it. This is where Claude really earns its keep: you don't have to re-upload or re-explain. If the first answer is still fuzzy, ask a sharper follow-up, like "Can you give me a concrete example?" or "What does that mean in everyday language?" Example: "In section 2 you mentioned 'a randomized controlled trial with 240 participants' — can you explain in plain words what that actually means they did, step by step?" You'll know it worked when Claude's reply addresses that one specific question and references details from the paper rather than answering in general terms.

Step 5 — Copy or export the summary for later

Hover over Claude's reply and look for a small **copy icon** (usually two overlapping squares) in the corner of the message — click it and the entire reply lands on your clipboard, ready to paste into a note, an email, or a Google Doc. If you don't see a copy icon, click and drag to highlight the text manually, then press Ctrl+C (or Cmd+C on a Mac). For the full conversation history, look for a **download or share** option in the chat's menu — Claude can export the whole thread as a text or PDF file. One honest note: Claude can summarize well, but it can miss nuances, misread a graph caption, or smooth over a contradiction the authors are actually arguing about, so use the summary as a map, not the territory. Example: N/A — no typing in this step. You'll know it worked when you can switch to another app and paste the summary cleanly, or when a downloaded file appears in your downloads folder.

Common mistakes

- **Asking for "a summary" without specifying the format.** Claude will give you something, but it will often be one wall of paragraph text. Always tell it the structure you want — sections, length, audience — because it's dramatically better at filling a template than guessing what you meant.
- **Forgetting to check that the PDF actually uploaded.** If you typed your prompt and sent it without seeing a file chip above the box, Claude is answering from its general knowledge, not from the paper. Scroll up, look for the filename, and re-attach if it's missing.
- **Trusting the summary as a substitute for the paper.** For anything important, spot-check the original section Claude points you to. The summary is a map; the paper is the territory, and the map can drop landmarks.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** When a news article cites a study and you want to know what it actually said — without paying $40 for the journal — drop the free PDF into Claude and get a five-section summary in two minutes, enough to decide whether it's worth your evening.
- **For your business or work:** If you review research, write literature reviews, or build products grounded in evidence, this turns an afternoon of skimming into a quick first pass. You still need to read the key papers yourself, but Claude handles the long tail of "is this worth my time?" decisions.
- **If you're just getting started:** Open Claude right now and pick the shortest paper you can find — a two-page report or even a one-paragraph abstract works for practice. Ask for the same five-section summary and see how Claude structures the answer.

Try it now

Find any open-access research paper (try Google Scholar with the PDF filter, or browse PubMed Central), upload it to Claude, and paste the example prompt from Step 3. You'll have a structured summary in under two minutes — and you'll know whether the paper deserves a closer read.

Use Qwen to Translate a Short Message for a Friend

5 steps · Read online

> **In short:** You can paste any short message into Qwen (Alibaba's AI assistant), name the language and tone you want, and get a ready-to-send reply in seconds. It's free to start, no setup beyond a quick sign-up, and works in your browser.

Got a message in another language — a sweet note from a relative overseas, a WhatsApp from a friend abroad, or a school update you can't quite read? Qwen can translate it for you, and even rewrite it in the tone you want: friendly, formal, or casual. Here's how to do it in five minutes, even if you've never used an AI tool before.

Before you start

- A free Qwen account (sign up with email, Google, or Apple — takes about a minute).
- A phone, tablet, or computer with a browser. Qwen works on all three.
- The message you want translated — copy it from your messaging app, email, or screenshot.
- About five minutes total. No payment needed for the basics, though some heavy users may eventually want a paid plan for faster replies and higher usage limits. Check the official Qwen site for current plan details.

Step 1 — Open Qwen and sign in

Open your browser and go to the Qwen website. On the homepage, look for a button labeled something like **Sign in** or **Log in**, usually at the top-right corner. Tap it, then choose how you want to sign in — email, Google account, or Apple ID all work. If you've never used Qwen before, you'll be asked to create a free account; the form just asks for an email and a password, then sends a quick verification code to your inbox.

If your screen looks different, don't worry. Some users land on a regional version of the site; the sign-in button may say **Get started** or **Try free** instead. Look for any button near the top of the page that invites you in. 💬 Example: sign in with your usual Gmail address. You'll know it worked when you see a chat window with a text box at the bottom and a short greeting from the assistant.

Step 2 — Paste the message you want translated

Click inside the text box at the bottom of the screen — it often shows placeholder text like **Message Qwen** or **Ask anything**, though your version may phrase it slightly differently. Tap or click inside the box, then paste your message. You can paste with the keyboard shortcut **Ctrl+V**

on a computer or **long-press → Paste** on a phone. Don't worry if the original message is messy or has emojis; Qwen reads through all of it.

If you only have a photo of the message (a screenshot, say), look for a small **paperclip icon** or **image icon** next to the text box. Tap it, choose the photo from your library, and Qwen will read the words in the image. Example: paste this short Spanish line — *"Hola María, ¿puedes venir a cenar el sábado? Te echo de menos."* You'll know it worked when your pasted text appears inside the chat box, ready for the next step.

Step 3 — Tell Qwen the language and tone you want

Now write a short instruction below your pasted message — in the same text box, just press **Enter** to add a new line, or send the message first and then ask for the translation. The instruction is called a **prompt** (think of it like a request slip you hand to a helpful assistant). Keep it simple: name the target language and the feeling you want.

If the message comes from a relative and you want it to sound warm, ask for a **friendly** tone. If it's for a teacher or business contact, ask for **formal**. If it's for a close friend, **casual** is fine. You can also add things like "keep it short" or "include the original text too" if that helps. Example: *"Please translate this to English in a friendly tone, as if I'm writing back to my aunt."* You'll know it worked when Qwen replies with a clear translation and a short note like "Here you go!" or "Sure, here's the translation:"

Step 4 — Check the translation and ask for tweaks if needed

Read Qwen's reply out loud in your head. Does it sound natural? If something feels off — maybe a phrase is too stiff, or the assistant kept a word that should sound softer — just ask for a change in the same chat. There's no need to start over. Type one more short sentence explaining what to adjust, and Qwen will rewrite the line for you.

If your screen looks different, the reply may appear as a longer message with the translation first and a short explanation second — that's normal. Some Qwen versions also show a small **copy icon** (two overlapping squares) in the corner of the reply; clicking it copies the translation so you can paste it straight into your messaging app. Example: *"Lovely, but can you make the second sentence a little warmer? She always signs off with love."* You'll know it worked when Qwen gives a fresh version that sounds closer to what you want, or clearly explains why it kept a certain phrase.

Step 5 — Send the translated message

Once the reply sounds right, copy it. On a computer, highlight the text and press **Ctrl+C** (or **Cmd+C** on a Mac). On a phone, long-press the translation and choose **Copy** from the menu

that pops up. Then switch to your messaging app, tap into the text field, and paste with **Ctrl+V** or long-press → **Paste**. Hit send, and you're done.

One honest note: Qwen can translate the words beautifully, but it can't read tone from a voice message or know inside jokes between you and your friend. If a line still feels awkward, trust your gut — rephrase it yourself, or add a smiley to soften it. 💬 Example: the final English reply — *"Hi María, can you come over for dinner on Saturday? I miss you."* You'll know it worked when your friend or family member replies in their language, smiling.

Common mistakes

- **Forgetting to specify the tone.** A literal translation can sound cold or robotic. Always add a word like *friendly*, *formal*, or *casual* — it changes the result more than you'd think.
- **Asking for a whole conversation at once.** Qwen handles short, single messages best. If you have a long thread, break it into one message at a time so the translation stays accurate.
- **Trusting names, numbers, or dates without checking.** Qwen can occasionally guess wrong on a name or misread a phone number from a photo. Always glance over those before hitting send.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** You can reply to a relative's message in their own language even if you only speak a few words. It's a small way to stay close across distance.
- **For your business or work:** If you chat with international clients or colleagues, Qwen can quickly turn a short business note into formal English, Spanish, French, or dozens of other languages — handy for a one-line email when you don't have time to draft from scratch.
- **If you're just getting started:** The easiest first move is exactly what you just did — pick one message you've been meaning to reply to, paste it in, and try a translation. Once you see how natural it feels, you'll find more uses on your own.

Try it now

Open Qwen, paste the last short message you received that you couldn't fully read, and ask: *"Translate this to English in a friendly tone."* You'll have your first translation in under a minute — and probably your second idea for how to use it before you've finished reading this.

How to use Gemini Deep Research to plan a big purchase decision

6 steps · Read online

> **In short:** Gemini Deep Research browses dozens of websites for you and returns a structured report with source links, so comparing big purchases like cars, appliances, or laptops stops being a full weekend of manual Googling.

Buying a new laptop, a refrigerator, or a used car usually means opening forty browser tabs and reading half of them. Gemini's **Deep Research** feature does that scrolling for you: it reads many sites, summarizes what it found, and hands you a tidy report with links back to where each claim came from. This guide walks you through using it, step by step, so the report actually answers *your* question.

Before you start

- **A Google account** signed in on the Gemini website or the Gemini app.
- **Access to Deep Research.** It may be limited to paid Google AI plans on some accounts, so check the plan page for the latest availability before relying on it.
- **A rough idea of what you're shopping for** (a category, a budget range, and 2–3 must-haves work best — more on this in Step 2).
- **About 15–25 minutes.** Deep Research usually takes a few minutes to run, and you'll want time to read the report it returns.
- An honest expectation: the report gives you a strong starting point, but it does **not** buy the thing for you, and prices or availability can be outdated by the time you read them.

Step 1 — Open Gemini and pick the Deep Research mode

Go to the Gemini website or open the Gemini app, then look in the chat box for a model or tool picker — usually a small dropdown above the text field. From that picker, choose the option labeled **"Deep Research."** On some accounts the option appears as a separate **Tools** button or a dedicated tab at the top of the chat. If you don't see it, it might not be enabled on your plan yet, or it could live behind a different name like **"Research"** or **"Pro."**

💬 Example: when the picker appears, click the dropdown that currently shows "Fast" or "Pro" and switch it to **Deep Research**.

You'll know it worked when the text field gains a small brief outline or "Plan" panel, and the placeholder text inside the box mentions research or sources.

Step 2 — Describe your purchase in concrete detail

This is the most important step: the more specific your prompt, the more useful the report. Type a short paragraph that names the **item, your budget range, your must-haves, your deal-breakers, and how you'll use it.** Think of it like a one-page brief you'd give a friend who's shopping on your behalf — vague briefs produce vague reports. Avoid jargon the AI won't understand; instead, describe the thing in plain words.

💬 Example: "I need a quiet, energy-efficient dishwasher for a small kitchen, budget roughly $700–$1,000 USD, must fit a 24-inch opening and run under 45 dB. I cook most nights for two, sometimes four. Compare the top 5 models available in my country, with pros, cons, and where each one tends to be cheapest."

You'll know it worked when you see a clear "Research plan" or outline appear below your message — Gemini usually shows what it intends to search for before it starts.

Step 3 — Approve the plan and let it run

Below the research plan, look for a button like **"Start Research"** or **"Begin."** Click it, then step away. Deep Research browses many websites in the background and writes as it goes, so the response can take **several minutes** (sometimes five, sometimes fifteen) — far longer than a normal chat reply. A progress bar or running indicator usually appears. **Do not close the tab** while it's running, or you'll lose the work.

💬 Example: hit the "Start Research" button, then make a coffee; the first draft of the report appears inline as it finishes each section.

You'll know it worked when a long, structured report lands in the chat, with section headings, bullet points, and small numbered or linked citations you can click.

Step 4 — Read the report and click at least three sources

Don't trust any AI research report blindly. Scroll to the end of the report first and look for a **Sources** section, or for inline footnote-style numbers next to specific claims. Click at least three of those links and read the original page for a minute each, especially anything related to price, warranty, or safety. The sources tell you whether the report is repeating marketing copy or actually weighing real reviews.

💬 Example: open the report, jump to the "Sources" list at the bottom, and click the first three links — if any of them are dead, irrelevant, or from a brand's own press release, treat the matching claim with caution.

You'll know it worked when you can point to a specific source link and say, out loud, "this is where that fact came from."

Step 5 — Ask two or three follow-up questions to narrow the field

Once the first report lands, treat it like a starting point, not the final answer. Ask Gemini to compare your top two candidates head-to-head, to look for known reliability complaints, or to translate the report into a simple "if you care most about X, choose Y; if you care about Z, choose W" decision guide. One question per message works best. If an answer feels too generic, push back: ask for specific model numbers, specific dates, or specific failure modes.

💬 Example: "Now compare models A and B from your report on noise, energy use, and reliability over five years — which one wins for a household of two who cooks daily?"

You'll know it worked when Gemini's reply is sharper and more specific than the original report, and ideally points back to the same source list.

Step 6 — Turn the report into a personal decision checklist

Before you close the chat, ask Gemini to summarize the entire research session into a short **decision checklist** you can actually use: 3–5 finalist products, the deciding criteria for each, and the questions you still need to answer before you spend money. Copy that checklist into a note on your phone or print it. The point of the report is to leave your head clear, not crammed with new jargon.

💬 Example: "Summarize this whole conversation into a checklist: top 3 dishwashers I should see in a store, what to test in person, and what to double-check on the manufacturer's site before I buy."

You'll know it worked when you have a one-page summary in your hand that you could read in two minutes in a showroom.

Common mistakes

- **Mistake:** Treating the report as a buy recommendation. **Fix:** It's a starting brief — the final choice is still yours, and any purchase should be confirmed against the official product page and the live price.
- **Mistake:** Skipping the sources. **Fix:** Always click at least three source links. If you can't find them, or they look unreliable, ask Gemini to redo the research with more trusted sites.
- **Mistake:** Closing the tab while research is running. **Fix:** Deep Research takes several minutes; leave the tab open until the full report appears, or you'll lose the work.
- **Mistake:** Asking a vague prompt like "best laptop under $1,000." **Fix:** Add your must-haves (size, weight, battery life, ports) and your main use (work, gaming, school) — the more detail, the better the report.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** A big purchase — a car, a fridge, a laptop — stops being a weekend of forty open tabs. You get a sourced brief instead, then spend your time on the decisions that actually need a human.
- **For your business or work:** The same workflow works for buying equipment, software subscriptions, or vendor comparisons at work: ask Deep Research to compare three vendors against your checklist, then read the sources yourself before signing anything.
- **If you're just getting started:** Pick one purchase you've been putting off, write a two-sentence brief in Step 2, and run the report end to end. The first run is the slowest; the second one feels easy.

Try it now

Open Gemini, switch to **Deep Research**, and paste this single sentence as your first prompt: *"I'm buying a [item] with a budget of [low]–[high], and my must-haves are [X, Y, Z]. Compare the top 5 options and end with a short decision checklist."* Fill in the brackets, hit Start Research, and read the sources before you trust any of it.

How to Ask ChatGPT to Explain Any AI News Headline in Plain English

6 steps · Read online

> **In short:** Paste any confusing AI headline into ChatGPT with a short instruction, and it usually returns a plain-English summary plus why the news matters to you. The trick is telling it exactly what you want — a short summary, no jargon, and a "why should I care" sentence.

Every week, AI companies release a flood of announcements packed with words like "multimodal," "fine-tuned," and "context window." Most headlines read like they were written for engineers, not for the rest of us. The good news: ChatGPT is unusually good at translating that jargon back into normal language — if you ask it the right way. Here's the simple routine.

Before you start

- A free or paid ChatGPT account (the free tier is enough for this task).
- Access to ChatGPT in a browser or in the app on your phone.
- One AI news headline that confused you — copied and ready to paste.
- About 5 minutes for the whole routine.

Step 1 — Pick one headline that's giving you trouble

Scroll your news feed, email, or a trusted news site until you find a single AI headline that made you stop and think, "wait, what does that actually mean?" Copy that exact headline to your clipboard, exactly as it was written. You are about to hand it to ChatGPT as raw material — the AI works best when it sees the original wording, not your summary of it. If nothing on your feed fits, any announcement from the past week works fine; you don't need breaking news. 💬 Example headline to try: *"Anthropic's Claude gets a 1M-token context window with extended thinking mode"* You'll know it worked when one specific headline sits in your clipboard, ready to paste.

Step 2 — Open ChatGPT and start a fresh chat

Open ChatGPT in your browser or in the app. Look for a button or option labeled something like **"New chat"** — it's usually near the top of the sidebar on desktop, or behind a small **compose** or + icon on mobile. Tap or click it. A blank chat window appears. Starting fresh matters here: an old conversation can confuse the AI, because it might try to answer in the style of whatever you were discussing before. A clean chat is a clean slate. 💬 Example: just open the app — no typing needed yet. You'll know it worked when you see an empty text box with a blinking cursor and no previous messages above it.

Step 3 — Paste the headline and ask for a plain-English summary

Click into the empty text box and paste your headline. Then, on a new line, type a short instruction telling ChatGPT exactly what you want. The simplest prompt that almost always works is: *"Explain this headline in plain English, like I'm not a tech expert. Keep it under 100 words."* Press **Enter** (or tap the send arrow). ChatGPT will start typing a reply within a few seconds. The reason this prompt works is that you told it three things at once: who the audience is (a non-expert), how long the answer should be (under 100 words), and what kind of answer you want (a plain summary, not a definition list). 💬 Example full prompt to paste:

> Anthropic's Claude gets a 1M-token context window with extended thinking mode
> Explain this headline in plain English, like I'm not a tech expert. Keep it under 100 words.

You'll know it worked when the reply uses everyday words — verbs like "remembers," "thinks longer," "reads at once" — instead of repeating the original jargon.

Step 4 — Add a second prompt: "Why does this matter to me?"

Most AI news only becomes useful when you know whether it actually changes your life. In the same chat (don't start a new one — ChatGPT remembers the conversation), click into the text box again and ask a follow-up. A reliable follow-up is: *"Now explain why this might matter to a regular person who isn't a developer or AI researcher. Give me 2-3 concrete examples."* Press **Enter**. ChatGPT will usually answer in a few short paragraphs with specific scenarios — like whether it changes how you write emails, search for information, or use your phone. If the answer still feels vague, ask one more time: *"Give me a real-world example I might notice this week."* 💬 Example follow-up to paste:

> Now explain why this might matter to a regular person who isn't a developer or AI researcher. Give me 2-3 concrete examples.

You'll know it worked when you can finish the sentence "This matters to me because…" without thinking.

Step 5 — Ask about any word you still don't understand

You will almost certainly hit one word in the reply that still sounds like gibberish — something like "token," "fine-tuning," or "multimodal." Don't skip past it. In the same chat, type: *"In one sentence, what does [word] mean? Use an analogy a 10-year-old would get."* ChatGPT will swap the technical term for a familiar picture, like comparing a token to a puzzle piece or a context window to a notebook page. This is the moment where a confusing headline finally

becomes something you actually understand — and you can repeat this step as many times as you need. 💬 Example follow-up to paste:

> In one sentence, what does "context window" mean? Use an analogy a 10-year-old would get.

You'll know it worked when you can explain the term to a friend in one breath, without looking anything up.

Step 6 — Save the chat so you can find it again

Once the explanation makes sense, keep it. In the ChatGPT sidebar, look for your chat's title — ChatGPT usually names it automatically after the first message. If the auto-title is something like *"New chat"*, click the title and rename it to something you'll recognize later, like *"Context window — what it actually means."* Now your explanation lives in your sidebar like a small personal glossary, ready the next time the same word pops up in a headline. Over time, this becomes your private AI dictionary, built one confusing headline at a time. 💬 Example new title: *"Claude context window — plain English"* You'll know it worked when you can scroll your sidebar a week from now, click the renamed chat, and instantly re-read the explanation.

Common mistakes

- **Pasting just a phrase instead of the full headline.** A snippet like "new reasoning model" gives ChatGPT nothing to explain. Always paste the whole headline as it was published.
- **Forgetting to specify the audience.** If you don't say "plain English" or "I'm not a tech expert," ChatGPT may answer for an engineer, which can be more confusing than the headline itself.
- **Starting a new chat for every follow-up question.** Each new chat makes ChatGPT forget what you already discussed. Keep all your questions in the same conversation so it can build on the explanation.
- **Trusting the explanation as the final word.** ChatGPT can misread a headline or fill in gaps that weren't there. If the answer sounds important, check the original source before acting on it — see Step 4 for the "real-world example" trick.
- **Skipping over a word you don't understand.** One unexplained term can quietly undo the whole summary. Use Step 5 until nothing in the reply feels like a foreign language.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** the next time a friend sends you an AI headline and asks "is this a big deal?", you'll have a 30-second way to find out instead of doom-scrolling for an hour.

- **For your business or work:** if you manage a team, marketing channel, or client communication, you can use this same routine to translate any technical announcement into a short brief your colleagues will actually read — and you can save the explanations as a shared reference.
- **If you're just getting started:** pick one headline from this week, paste it into ChatGPT, and ask for a plain-English summary. That's the whole skill — the rest of the routine grows from there.

Try it now

Open ChatGPT right now, paste one AI headline you saved recently, and send this exact prompt: *"Explain this headline in plain English, like I'm not a tech expert. Keep it under 100 words."* Read the reply once. If one word still feels unclear, ask ChatGPT to define it using a 10-year-old analogy. That's the routine — done in under two minutes.

Research and Draft Short Social Media Captions with Perplexity

6 steps · Read online

By the end of this guide, you can turn a fuzzy idea into a ready-to-post social media caption backed by real sources — whether you manage a personal account or post on behalf of a small business. This is for beginners who want to save time without sounding robotic.

Before you start

- **A free Perplexity account** — sign up at the Perplexity homepage with an email or social login. A free plan is enough for this guide; Perplexity Pro (paid) gives more daily searches and access to advanced AI models.
- **A device with a browser** — Perplexity works on desktop, mobile web, and the iOS/Android apps. Screens look similar across all three.
- **A topic in mind** — even something rough, like "sustainable coffee" or "weekend hiking near Nashville".
- **Rough total time: 15–20 minutes.**

> **One honest note:** Perplexity can research facts, summarize articles, and draft captions, but it can't post to social media for you — you'll still copy the caption into Instagram, LinkedIn, X, or your scheduler.

Step 1 — Open Perplexity and start a new thread

Open Perplexity in your browser or app, then sign in if prompted. Look for a **"New Thread"** button or a clean search box at the top of the screen — it usually has placeholder text like *"Ask anything..."* or *"What do you want to know?"*. Click or tap inside the box. The cursor blinks, ready for typing.

If your screen looks different, look for a **pencil icon**, a **"+" button**, or a **"Home"** tab that returns you to a blank search box. Each Perplexity conversation is called a "thread", so starting fresh keeps your research tidy.

You'll know it worked when the page reloads with an empty box and no previous answers above it.

Step 2 — Ask Perplexity to research trending angles for your topic

Type a clear, specific question into the search box. Beating your hands at the keyboard here won't help — give Perplexity a **topic**, an **audience**, and a **goal** in plain English. After you press Enter (or tap the arrow icon), Perplexity starts writing a short answer with **numbered**

footnotes — those tiny superscript numbers are links to the sources it used. Below the answer, you'll often see a list of **related questions** you can click for a deeper dig.

If the answer feels too generic, try the **"Focus"** dropdown (look for buttons labeled **Web**, **Social**, **Academic**, or **All**) — switching to **Social** tells Perplexity to lean on posts and trending discussions rather than formal articles.

Example: *"I'm writing a 3-sentence Instagram caption for a small American coffee roastery. What are 5 trending topics in sustainable coffee right now in the US, with sources from 2025 or 2026?"*

You'll know it worked when Perplexity returns an answer with at least 3 numbered footnote links you can tap to read the underlying articles.

Step 3 — Pick one angle and ask for supporting facts

Scroll through the answer and choose **one** angle that excites you — don't try to cover all five. Click the related question that matches your pick, or type a new follow-up question into the same box. A new answer appears below the first, still with its own numbered sources. The conversation history stays visible, so you can scroll up and compare.

If a footnote link looks interesting, click it — Perplexity opens the source in a new tab. Don't worry about reading every word; skim for a quote, a stat, or a phrase you might want to mention.

Example: *"Tell me more about the rise of compostable coffee pods in the US. Give me 3 specific statistics or quotes from American sources I could mention in a post."*

You'll know it worked when you have one sentence or stat from a source you'd be happy to credit in your caption.

Step 4 — Switch into "drafting mode" with a clear instruction

Now you've done the research — time to write. Stay in the same Perplexity thread and type a new prompt. This time, you're telling Perplexity to **write**, not research. Be specific about the **platform**, **length**, **tone**, and what facts to include. Perplexity drafts a caption right inside the chat.

If the tone feels off, try adding words like "warm", "playful", "matter-of-fact", or "professional" to your instruction. Perplexity works best when you tell it exactly how the caption should sound.

Example: *"Write a 3-sentence Instagram caption for our compostable coffee pods. Tone: warm and friendly, not salesy. Mention that 1 in 3 people now look for compostable packaging,*

according to a 2025 survey. End with a question to invite comments."

You'll know it worked when Perplexity produces a short caption (3 sentences or so) that includes your chosen fact and ends with a question or call-to-action.

Step 5 — Refine the draft in the same conversation

Read the caption out loud — does it sound like you? If a sentence feels clunky, type a quick refinement request right below the draft. Perplexity updates the answer in place, and the old version scrolls up so you can compare. This back-and-forth is normal and usually takes 2–3 quick rounds.

If Perplexity suggests adding emojis and you'd rather skip them, just say so. The same goes for hashtags — you can ask it to suggest 3–5 relevant ones or to leave them out entirely.

💬 Example: *"Make sentence 2 shorter and a bit punchier. Keep the question at the end. Suggest 5 relevant hashtags."*

You'll know it worked when the caption sounds natural when you read it aloud, includes your key fact, and fits the platform's vibe.

Step 6 — Save your sources and copy the caption

Before you leave Perplexity, capture the **footnote links** from Steps 2 and 3 — you may want to credit a source in your post, or come back to read more later. Look for the small numbered superscripts next to sentences; click them to copy the URL from your browser's address bar.

Then copy the caption itself. Look for a small **copy icon** (two overlapping squares) near the draft, or simply highlight the text with your mouse or finger and copy it. Paste it straight into Instagram, LinkedIn, X, or your scheduling tool.

If Perplexity's Pro plan would help you here, note that the **free plan has a daily cap on Pro searches**, but regular searches are unlimited for most users — you can complete this whole guide on the free tier.

You'll know it worked when you have the final caption ready to paste, plus 2–3 source links saved in case you want to reference them later.

Common mistakes

- **Mistake:** Asking one giant question like *"Write me a caption about coffee."* **Fix:** Always include the **topic**, the **audience**, the **platform**, and the **length** — specificity saves you a round-trip.

- **Mistake:** Trusting Perplexity's footnotes without checking one or two. **Fix:** Click at least one source to confirm the stat or quote actually says what Perplexity implied. AI can misread a source.
- **Mistake:** Forgetting to add a human touch. **Fix:** After copying the caption, change one small thing — a word, an emoji, your own opener — so it sounds like *you*, not a template.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** Posting about a hobby, a trip, or a family milestone becomes a 10-minute task instead of a 30-minute staring-at-the-screen session.
- **For your business or work:** You can keep a steady posting rhythm without paying an agency, and every caption can be backed by a real source — handy if you ever get asked "where did you get that number?"
- **If you're just getting started:** Treat the first caption as practice, not a masterpiece. The second one will already feel easier.

Try it now

Open Perplexity, type this exact prompt, and watch what comes back:

> *"I'm writing a 2-sentence LinkedIn post for a small accounting firm in Portland. Find 1 recent statistic about AI tools being used by American small businesses in 2025 or 2026, with a source. Then draft the post in a confident but friendly tone, ending with a question."*

You should have a researched, source-backed draft within 2 minutes.

Compare Products with Perplexity Before You Buy

6 steps · Read online

Want to make sure you're getting the best value or the right features before spending your hard-earned cash? This guide will show you how to use Perplexity, an AI-powered search engine, to quickly compare products, understand their differences, and even check user opinions, all in one place. By the end, you'll be able to compare anything from new phones to kitchen appliances, helping you shop smarter and more confidently.

> **In short:** Perplexity lets you compare products by asking direct questions, then shows you AI-generated summaries with source links — useful for research, though the free version has usage limits.

Before you start

- An internet-connected device (computer, tablet, or phone).
- Access to the Perplexity website (perplexity.ai) or the Perplexity app.
- Perplexity offers both free and paid tiers — the free tier has daily search limits, while paid plans (Pro, Enterprise) offer higher usage. This guide works with either, but you may hit limits on the free version.
- The whole process should take about 5-7 minutes.

Step 1 — Open Perplexity

Start by opening Perplexity in your web browser or launching the app on your device. When you first arrive, you'll see a clean interface designed for asking questions. The main feature is usually a large text box in the center, often labeled "Ask anything..." or "Search here." This is your gateway to getting information. If you're on a mobile device, the layout might be slightly more compact, but the central search bar will still be prominent. You'll know it worked when you see the main Perplexity screen with a clear input box, ready for your query.

Step 2 — Enter your comparison query

Now it's time to tell Perplexity what you want to compare. Click or tap inside the main search box and type a clear question asking for a comparison. Think about what specific products you're interested in and what aspects you want to know about. After typing, you might see a "Search" or "Ask" button appear, or you can simply press the 'Enter' key on your keyboard or the 'Go' button on your mobile device's keyboard. If it looks different, some versions might have a microphone icon if you prefer to speak your query. You'll know it worked when the AI starts processing your request, often showing a spinning icon or a "Generating answer" message.

Example: `Compare the Google Pixel 8 vs Samsung Galaxy S24 on camera quality and battery life.`

Step 3 — Review the AI's summary

Once Perplexity has finished processing your request, it will present a summary of the comparison. This usually appears as a concise, easy-to-read answer, often using bullet points, short paragraphs, or even a simple table to highlight key differences and similarities between the products. Below the summary, you'll typically see numbered source links – these are the websites and articles Perplexity used to gather its information. If it looks different, the exact layout can vary slightly, but always look for a clear answer section at the top of the page. You'll know it worked when you see a well-organized summary directly comparing the products you asked about.

Step 4 — Explore the sources

To ensure the information is reliable and to dig deeper into specific details, it's a good idea to check Perplexity's sources. Each piece of information in the summary often has a small, numbered link next to it. Click on these numbers, or find the "Sources" section usually located below the main answer. What happens next is that clicking a source link will open the original webpage in a new tab in your browser. If it looks different, sometimes the sources are just listed with their titles, and you click the title rather than a number. You'll know it worked when a new browser tab opens to an external website, letting you see where the AI got its information from, like a review site or a manufacturer's product page.

Step 5 — Ask follow-up questions

Perplexity isn't a one-shot tool; you can continue the conversation to get more detailed insights. Below the initial answer, you may find a section with suggested "Related Questions" or a new input box where you can type your own follow-up. This allows you to ask for clarification, or to explore other aspects of the products you're comparing. For example, if the initial summary didn't cover specific features you care about, now's your chance to ask. If it looks different, you might need to scroll down to find a new prompt area or simply type directly into the main chat box again. You'll know it worked when Perplexity provides a fresh answer, refining its previous information based on your new question. 💬 Example: `Which one is generally considered better for low-light photography according to user reviews?`

Step 6 — Refine your query for specific details

Sometimes, you need to go beyond a general comparison and focus on very specific features or scenarios. You can start a completely new query (by clicking "New Thread" or clearing the

search bar if available) or continue in your current conversation. For this step, try asking Perplexity a highly specific question about a particular product feature or how it performs in certain conditions. This is where Perplexity shines for deep dives, pulling targeted information from various sources. If it looks different, some versions might automatically clear the search bar for a new query, while others require you to click a "Start a new query" button. You'll know it worked when Perplexity gives you a highly focused answer, directly addressing your specific detail. 💬 Example: `What are the pros and cons of an OLED TV screen for watching sports, compared to a QLED screen?`

Common mistakes

- **Being too vague with your query:** If you just type "compare phones," Perplexity won't know what you're looking for.
    - **The fix:** Be specific! Name the products and the aspects you care about (e.g., "Compare iPhone 15 vs Samsung Galaxy S24 for camera and battery").
- **Not checking the sources:** Perplexity is excellent, but like any AI, it draws from various sources, and some might be outdated or biased.
    - **The fix:** Always glance at the numbered sources. If you see a review site you trust, or the manufacturer's official page, that's a good sign. If something seems off, check another source.
- **Expecting live pricing or stock information:** Perplexity excels at product specifications, features, and reviews, but it's not a live shopping tool.
    - **The fix:** Use Perplexity for product research, then check specific retailer websites for the latest prices, deals, and stock availability.
- **Hitting free tier limits:** If you're on the free version, you may reach daily search limits quickly.
    - **The fix:** If you need unlimited comparisons, consider upgrading to a paid plan. Otherwise, space out your queries or focus on the most important comparisons.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** Imagine you're buying a new fridge or a pair of running shoes. Instead of trawling through countless review sites, you can ask Perplexity to summarize the key differences, pros, and cons of your top choices. This saves you time and helps you feel more confident about your purchase.
- **For your business or work:** If you're deciding between two different project management software tools, or researching the best laptop for your team, Perplexity can provide a quick breakdown of features, pricing tiers (if publicly available), and user feedback, helping you make an informed decision for your budget and needs.

- **If you're just getting started:** Try comparing two items you know well, like different brands of coffee machines or popular car models, focusing on just one or two aspects you care about most.

Try it now

Open Perplexity and ask it to compare two household items you might consider buying, like "Compare features of the Dyson V15 Detect vs Samsung Bespoke Jet for pet hair removal." See how quickly you get a concise answer!

How to Compare Phone Plans and Pick the Right One Without the Jargon

6 steps · Read online

> **In short:** Pick a plan by looking at your real monthly data use, the all-in cost (not just the advertised price), and the coverage in your area — most people overpay because they pick by brand instead of fit.

Picking a phone plan can feel like decoding a foreign language. Carrier websites throw around words like "unlimited," "deprioritization," "throttling," and "MVNO" without explaining any of them. This guide walks you through a simple way to compare plans on your own terms: what you actually use, what you actually pay, and what you actually need.

Before you start

- Your last 2-3 phone bills (paper, email, or in your carrier's app)
- About 30-45 minutes of quiet time
- A notebook, spreadsheet, or a notes app
- A friend or family member on a different plan (optional, for coverage feedback)
- Roughly 7 days to think it over — no need to decide in one sitting

Step 1 — Look at your real monthly usage

Open your last 2-3 phone bills — paper, email, or the carrier's app. Find the "data used" line. Data means the internet your phone uses over the cell network, not your home Wi-Fi. If your bill just says "unlimited," check your phone's settings: most phones show usage under **Settings > Network & internet > Data usage**, and you'll see a number like "8.2 GB used this month." If you can't find it, menus change between phone brands — look for "Cellular" or "Mobile data" instead. No number at all? A rough rule: light users (email, maps, some video) use 5-10 GB; heavy users (lots of streaming, video calls) use 20+ GB. Example: "I used 12 GB last month — mostly maps, Spotify, and one Zoom call a day." You'll know it worked when you have one number written down that you trust.

Step 2 — Decide which features actually matter to you

Make a short list of must-haves and nice-to-haves. Must-haves are things you'd cancel the plan over if missing. Common features to consider: **hotspot** (using your phone as a Wi-Fi source for a laptop — some plans limit this to 5-10 GB even on "unlimited" tiers), international calling or roaming, talk and text (most plans include unlimited, but double-check), family or multi-line discounts, and 5G access. Don't trust the word "unlimited" without reading the fine print — many "unlimited" plans slow your speeds after 20-50 GB, a practice called **throttling**, or push

you behind other users in crowded areas, called **deprioritization**. Example list: "Must-haves: at least 15 GB, hotspot, 5G. Nice-to-haves: international roaming." You'll know it worked when you have a clear top-3 list of features you actually care about.

Step 3 — Learn the four main plan types

There are roughly four kinds of phone plans, and knowing which one you're looking at saves real money. **Postpaid** = you pay at the end of the month, usually through a big carrier, often with a phone installment plan attached. **Prepaid** = you pay upfront for 30 days, no contract. **MVNO (Mobile Virtual Network Operator)** = smaller brands (think Mint, Consumer Cellular, Cricket) that rent coverage from the big carriers (Verizon, AT&T, T-Mobile) and resell it cheaper. **Family plan** = multiple lines on one account, usually with a per-line discount. The catch: MVNOs are usually much cheaper but may run slightly slower in busy areas because the host carrier prioritizes its own customers first. Example: "I'll compare a Verizon postpaid plan, an AT&T-based MVNO, and a T-Mobile prepaid plan." You'll know it worked when you can tell which type a plan is just by reading its website.

Step 4 — Calculate the real total monthly cost

The advertised price is almost never what you actually pay. Add up: the plan's base price, taxes (often 10-20% extra, varies by region), any **device installment** (paying off a phone in monthly chunks — say $25 for a phone on a 24-month plan), and any "regulatory" or "administrative" fees. Then check for auto-pay or paperless billing discounts — many carriers knock off a small amount if you let them charge your card automatically. Also watch for **introductory pricing** that jumps up after 12 or 24 months. The real question isn't "what does it cost now" but "what will it cost in year two?" A $30 plan that becomes $70 after a year is the more expensive plan. Example: "$40 plan + $6 taxes + $25 phone = $71/month total. After promo ends: $95/month." You'll know it worked when you can see — in one number — what this plan will cost you a year from now.

Step 5 — Check coverage where you actually live and travel

A cheap plan is worthless if it doesn't work in your apartment, your office, or your parents' house. Coverage maps on carrier websites are optimistic — they're the best case. For a real check, ask friends and neighbors on different carriers how their service is at your home address. If you commute, ask about the route. If you travel, look for the carrier's international options or roaming add-ons. Some MVNOs have slightly weaker indoor signal in rural areas, even though they use the same towers as the host carrier. If you live in a city, almost any plan will work fine. If you live in a small town or rural area, this is the most important step in the whole guide. Example: "I asked my neighbor: 'How's your T-Mobile signal in our building?' He said: 'Two

bars, calls drop.'" You'll know it worked when you can name two people whose coverage matches your daily life.

Step 6 — Compare 2-3 plans side by side

Pick your top three plans from the previous steps. Make a simple table — paper, notes app, or spreadsheet — with these columns: plan name, monthly cost in year two (including everything), data allowance, your must-have features (yes/no), and a "gut feeling" line. The gut-feeling column matters: a plan that ticks every box but has awful customer service is a plan you'll hate in six months. Read recent reviews, but focus on patterns, not single angry comments. Once your table is filled in, the right plan usually jumps out: it hits your must-haves, stays affordable in year two, and has good coverage where you live. If two plans tie, pick the one with the friendlier cancellation policy — flexibility is worth real money. 💬 Example row: "Plan A: $55/mo, 25 GB, hotspot yes, support fair. Plan B: $45/mo, 15 GB, no hotspot, support good. Pick A — hotspot is a must-have." You'll know it worked when you can point to one plan and say, "That's the one — and here's why."

Common mistakes

- **Picking by brand loyalty instead of fit.** The cheapest "unlimited" plan is rarely the cheapest plan for you specifically.
- **Forgetting the year-two price.** Promotional rates that double after 12-24 months are the most common cause of bill shock.
- **Trusting "unlimited" without reading the fine print.** Most "unlimited" plans slow down your speeds or deprioritize your traffic after a set amount of data.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** a $20-40 monthly difference over two years is $500-1,000 — real money for a vacation, an emergency, or a small home repair.
- **For your work or business:** if your job depends on reliable calls or hotspot for a laptop, the cheapest plan is rarely the right one — downtime costs more than the savings.
- **If you're just getting started:** pick one plan from a major carrier or well-known MVNO with no contract, then reassess in 3 months once you know your real usage. No decision has to be permanent.

Try it now

Pull up your last phone bill right now. Find the data usage number. Write it down somewhere you can find again. That's the single most important number in choosing a plan — and you just got it in under a minute.

How to ask Alexa+ to translate a short phrase on your Echo

5 steps · Read online

> **In short:** Your Echo can translate short spoken phrases into many languages, hands-free, as long as you say the wake word first. Some languages and accents work better than others, and Alexa+ cannot reliably translate long conversations or read written text from a photo.

If you've ever frozen at a bakery counter abroad or waved at a relative who doesn't share your language, the Echo on your kitchen counter can quietly fix that moment. You don't need an app, a phone or a dictionary — just your voice, the wake word, and a short, clear sentence. This guide walks you through a translation workflow that goes beyond the basic one-off request: setting the target language once, asking for the slow spelling when a word matters, and recovering when Alexa+ gets it wrong.

Before you start

- An Echo device (any generation that supports Alexa+ — the newer the device, the smoother the experience, but older Echos still work for most translations).
- An Amazon account already linked to your Echo, and a working internet connection (translations run in the cloud, not on the device).
- The wake word turned on — by default it's "Alexa," but if you've changed it, use whatever you chose.
- A rough idea of the target language and how its name sounds in English (for example, "Spanish," "Japanese," "Brazilian Portuguese"). Alexa+ understands English language names; it does not usually need the exact locale code.
- About 5 minutes for the first run, then it gets faster the more you practice.

Step 1 — Say the wake word and a simple "translate" request

Stand within a few feet of the Echo so the microphone can pick you up cleanly — the seven-mic array on most Echos hears across a room, but a quiet kitchen beats a loud living room. Say the wake word, then a short sentence that names the source and target language. The light ring on top turns blue, then a spinning cyan or white ring while Alexa+ thinks, then it speaks the translation out loud.

Example: "Alexa, how do I say 'Where is the bathroom?' in French?"

If your Echo doesn't light up at all, the wake word may be off or the mic button on top is pressed in (red ring). Look for a small microphone or mic-off icon on top and tap it once to unmute. If you renamed the wake word to "Echo" or "Amazon," swap that in for "Alexa" in every example

below. You'll know it worked when the ring spins, you hear a short chime, and Alexa+ speaks the translated phrase clearly.

Step 2 — Set a target language so you don't repeat yourself

If you know you'll be asking for several phrases in the same language, you can pin it for the conversation. Say a short setup line first, then each phrase after that only needs the wake word. The light ring pulses briefly to acknowledge the mode, and every following translation goes into that language until you change it or stop talking for a minute or two.

💬 Example: "Alexa, speak Spanish for the next five minutes." Then: "Alexa, how do I say 'the check, please'?"

If "speak X for the next Y minutes" doesn't work on your device, try the simpler form: "Alexa, translate everything I say into Italian." It does the same thing in plain words. Some older Echos may not support timed modes — if nothing changes, fall back to including the target language in every request, like Step 1. You'll know it worked when your second request comes back in the same language without you naming it again.

Step 3 — Ask for the slow version when pronunciation matters

A spoken translation is only useful if a real person can understand you. When a phrase contains a tricky word — a city name, a food, a medication — follow up and ask Alexa+ to say it more slowly, or to spell it out letter by letter. The Echo will repeat the phrase at a slower pace, or say each letter with pauses, which you can copy down or repeat after.

💬 Example: "Alexa, can you say that more slowly?" — or — "Alexa, spell that in French."

If the slow version is still too fast, ask "even slower" or "one more time, slowly" — most Echoes will keep slowing down. If the spelling uses letters your language doesn't share (like the Spanish ñ or French accents), ask "how is that spelled with accents?" and Alexa+ usually spells it out phonetically. You'll know it worked when the second version is noticeably slower than the first, or when you hear each letter named individually.

Step 4 Translate what someone else just said to you

This is the move most people miss: you can have Alexa+ listen to a foreign-language phrase and bring it back in English (or another language you know). Hold the conversation close to the Echo and ask for a translation after the speaker finishes. The light ring stays blue while it's "listening" past the wake word, so you don't need to say the wake word again until Alexa+ replies.

💬 Example: "Alexa, translate that into English." — after someone has spoken in another language near the device.

If Alexa+ says it didn't catch anything, the room was probably too noisy, or the speaker paused too long and the Echo thought its turn was over. Try again, and this time say "Alexa, listen to this and translate it" before the other person speaks, so the listening window stays open. You'll know it worked when Alexa+ repeats the foreign phrase back to confirm what it heard, then gives you the English version.

Step 5 — Save the translation in your Alexa app for later

Sometimes the phrase matters — a hotel address, an allergy, a relative's name. Open the Alexa app on your phone, tap the **Activity** tab (look for a clock or list icon along the bottom), find the translation in the recent list, and tap the three dots or a share icon to send it to yourself by message, email, or notes. This way you don't have to remember it from memory or write it down on a napkin.

💬 Example: after a translation you want to keep, open the app and search the activity feed for the first word of the phrase.

If the Activity tab is empty or you can't find the entry, the translation may not have been logged — not every Echo logs every interaction. As a backup, just ask: "Alexa, what did you just say?" and it will repeat the translation, which you can then type into your phone. You'll know it worked when the phrase appears in the app's activity list with a timestamp, or when you can copy it from a message you sent yourself.

Common mistakes

- **Speaking too fast or mumbling.** The Echo's translation is only as good as what it heard. Slow down, pause between the wake word and the phrase, and face the device. The fix: treat it like talking to someone across a quiet table, not someone across a noisy street.
- **Asking for a language Alexa+ doesn't support well.** Most major languages — Spanish, French, German, Italian, Portuguese, Japanese, Mandarin, Hindi, Arabic, plus regional variants like Brazilian Portuguese and Mexican Spanish — translate cleanly. Smaller languages or dialects may come back patchy or romanized (written in Latin letters instead of the original script). The fix: check Amazon's current list of supported languages before you rely on it for a trip.
- **Trying to translate a full conversation.** Alexa+ handles short phrases; if you speak for 30 seconds straight, it often misses the second half. The fix: break the conversation into one- or two-sentence chunks, and let Alexa+ respond between them.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** the next time a neighbor, a delivery driver or a family member speaks a different language at the door, you can get a polite phrase in seconds without pulling out your phone or asking them to write it down.
- **For your travel or work:** before a trip, sit with the Echo for two minutes and learn ten core phrases — greetings, please and thank you, yes and no, "how much," "where is," and "I don't understand." The repetition is a built-in flashcard drill.
- **If you want to go further:** connect the Alexa app to a note-taking tool like a shared phone note or a simple spreadsheet, and build a personal phrasebook from your activity feed over a week — the phrases you'll actually use, in the order you'll need them.

Try it now

Pick the one phrase you'd most like to have in another language this week — "how much is this?", "thank you very much," or your name — and say it to your Echo right now. Ask for the slow version, then save it in the Alexa app. You'll have your first saved, rehearsed translation in under two minutes.

How to Compare Two Job Offers Side by Side Using AI Safely

5 steps · Read online

> **In short:** You can use any AI assistant — ChatGPT, Gemini, Claude, Copilot, Le Chat or DeepSeek — to build a side-by-side comparison of two job offers, as long as you scrub personal info first. The AI builds the table; you keep control of your privacy.

Two job offers can look almost identical on paper until you line them up next to each other. This guide shows you how to ask any AI assistant to build a comparison table from the offer details you already have, and how to keep sensitive information out of the chat. It is for anyone weighing two offers and feeling a little lost in the numbers.

Before you start

- A free account with at least one AI assistant (ChatGPT, Gemini, Claude, Copilot, Le Chat, DeepSeek — any one works).
- Both job offers in some written form: letters, emails, or your own notes from a phone call.
- About 15 minutes of quiet time, plus a blank note on your phone or computer where you will rewrite the offer facts by hand.

Step 1 — Rewrite the offer facts by hand, in your own notes

Open a fresh blank note on your phone or computer — the Notes app, Google Docs, Notion, or even paper — and copy the facts of each offer into it by hand. Type out only what would go on a comparison table: job title, base pay, bonus structure, location, working hours, vacation days, health benefits, start date. Leave out your name, home address, employee ID, references, signatures, and any greeting lines.

What you see: a plain page filling with short, neutral lines. What happens next: you now have an anonymized (stripped of any detail that could identify you) summary of each offer — clean enough to share, but stripped of identifying details.

If it looks different: any plain text editor works, even your phone's notes app. The point is a fresh page, not your offer email.

💬 Example: Offer A — "Title: Senior Marketer; Base: $X; Bonus: up to 10%; Location: 3 days office, 2 remote; Vacation: 18 days; Health: full coverage; Start: 2 weeks." Use the same shape for Offer B.

You'll know it worked when a stranger could read your note and not learn your name, your address, or anything beyond the jobs themselves.

Step 2 — Read your note once and remove anything sensitive

Before opening any AI assistant, read your note with fresh eyes and ask: is there anything here that could identify me, or that I would not want sitting on a third-party server (a company computer that stores your chat so the AI can process it)? Remove anything that answers yes.

What you see: a short checklist of risky items. What happens next: you strip your note down to the safest possible version before a single character is sent to the AI.

If it looks different: even assistants with strong privacy settings benefit from this habit. Building the muscle now means you will not accidentally share something sensitive the next time you paste text into a chat.

💬 Example: never paste your full name plus employer combo, home address, phone number, government ID numbers (Social Security, passport), bank details, names of current coworkers or your manager, references' contact info, NDA-protected clauses from your current employer, or your past salary history.

You'll know it worked when the only information left in your note is the kind you would feel comfortable writing on a public whiteboard.

Step 3 — Open the AI assistant and paste a clear prompt

Open the assistant of your choice in a fresh chat — never inside an existing conversation, because older messages could leak in. Paste your cleaned-up note, then ask the AI to build a side-by-side comparison table.

What you see: a chat box, usually empty or with a short greeting. What happens next: the assistant returns a formatted table with one column per offer and one row per category — pay, benefits, time off, and so on.

If it looks different: every assistant has its own layout. Look for a text box labeled something like "Message", "Ask anything" or "Send a message" — yours may use slightly different words, but the idea is the same: a blank area where you type or paste.

💬 Example: "Here are the facts of two job offers I'm comparing. Please build a clear side-by-side table with one column per offer and rows for: base salary, bonus, vacation, health benefits, location, working hours, and start date. At the bottom, add a short Pros and Cons summary for each." Then paste your note.

You'll know it worked when a structured table appears on screen with both offers in their own columns and the categories you asked for in the rows.

Step 4 — Add the things the AI cannot measure for you

The AI's table is great for numbers, but it cannot feel your gut, meet your future manager, or drive the commute at 5 p.m. Open your note again and add three rows the AI cannot fill: how the role feels, how the team treated you, and how daily life would actually work.

What you see: your note grows by a few lines. What happens next: you now have the AI's clean data side-by-side with your lived sense of each offer — the part no chatbot can replace.

If it looks different: if you only have written offers and never visited either workplace, write what you do know. Reading company reviews, looking at the office on a map, or checking the commute at peak hour all count as "your sense" of the offer.

Example: add three rows — "Team vibe — Offer A felt warm in the interview; Offer B felt formal"; "Commute — Offer A 25 min by train; Offer B 55 min by car at peak"; "Growth — Offer A clearer path to senior; Offer B broader role but less clear ladder".

You'll know it worked when your final comparison has both the hard numbers from the AI and the human notes only you can write.

Step 5 — Decide your next move and keep your privacy

Read the full table and ask which offer you keep coming back to. Then close the chat: most assistants let you delete a conversation from the side panel.

What you see: a delete or "remove" option in the chat menu. What happens next: the conversation is gone from your account; your offer details live only in your notes app, where you control them.

If it looks different: some assistants keep a short-term copy after deletion, and paid plans may save chat history by default. Look under Privacy or Data controls for a toggle like "Save conversations" or "Improve the model" — turning it off stops future chats being used to train the AI.

Example: in your assistant's settings, search for a toggle named something like "Save conversations" or "Improve the model for everyone" — switch it off if you want your offer details to stay private.

You'll know it worked when you have a clear favorite between the two offers, your note is the only place the details live, and the chat is either deleted or set to stay private.

Common mistakes

- **Pasting the whole email without cleaning it first.** Greetings, signatures, and "cc" lists can include names, phone numbers, or links back to your identity. Strip the note down before the AI ever sees it — see Step 2.
- **Trusting the AI to make the decision for you.** A table is a great mirror, but it cannot choose for you. If the AI's "Pros and Cons" feels off, ignore it and re-read your human notes from Step 4.
- **Forgetting the things no spreadsheet can measure.** Vacation days and salary are easy to compare; team vibe, manager style, commute, and growth path are not. If those rows are missing from your final table, the comparison is incomplete.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** the same habit — stripping personal info before pasting it into any chatbot — protects you whether you are comparing jobs, asking about medical symptoms, or sharing a tricky email you want help rewriting.
- **For your work or business:** if you ever help someone else compare offers (a partner, a friend, a mentee), walk them through the scrub-the-note-first step. It is the single most useful privacy habit to teach.
- **If you are just getting started with AI:** pick one task you already do by hand — comparing offers, drafting an email, summarizing a long article — and try it once with a free assistant. The skill is repetition, not genius.

Try it now

Open your notes app, find one offer letter or email, and rewrite its facts into a fresh note with names and address removed. That single act is the whole habit — and it takes under two minutes.

Use Grok to Explain a Confusing News Article in Plain English

5 steps · Read online

> **In short:** Paste a confusing news article into Grok with a short, specific request, and it returns a plain-English summary of who is involved, what happened, and why it matters. Paywalled articles usually have to be copied and pasted manually, since Grok often can't read them from a URL alone.

We've all clicked a headline that sounded important, then bounced off after two paragraphs of jargon. This guide walks you through turning one of those articles into something you can actually understand — using Grok, the AI assistant from xAI. By the end, you'll have a five-minute routine you can repeat whenever a story makes your eyes glaze over.

Before you start

- **An X account** (the same one you'd use to post on X / Twitter). It's free to create one if you don't have it.
- **A web browser** or the **X app** on your phone — Grok lives inside both.
- **One news article** you want explained. Have it open in another tab or app before you begin.
- **About 5 minutes.** That's the whole routine.
- A free X account works for basic chats. Heavier or longer use may need a paid plan; check Grok's official page for the latest details.

Step 1 — Open Grok and start a fresh chat

Open a browser and go to **grok.com**, or open the X app and find the **Grok** option. If you're not signed in, Grok will ask for your X account. Once inside, look for a text box near the bottom of the screen, usually labeled something like "Ask Grok" or "Message Grok." Tap inside it to start a new conversation. If older chats are showing, look for a **pencil icon** or a **+ button** to begin fresh; this keeps your new article separate from earlier context. If you're on the X mobile app, the Grok icon usually sits in the middle of the bottom navigation bar — tap it and the chat window slides up. 💬 Example: type a quick "hi" first, just to confirm everything is working, before pasting anything. You'll know it worked when you see an empty chat box with a blinking cursor, ready for your question.

Step 2 — Copy the article text

On the page with the article you want explained, select the text. On a computer, click at the start and drag your mouse to the end; on a phone, long-press the first word and drag the highlight bar to the last word. Then choose **"Copy"** — usually from a right-click menu on desktop, or a small

pop-up menu on mobile. The words now live on your device's clipboard, ready to paste anywhere. If copying doesn't work on some sites, try your browser's **Reader Mode** or print the page to a PDF, then copy from there. If the article is paywalled, you can usually only copy the visible preview — but that's still better than pasting only the link, because Grok often can't read paywalled pages from a URL alone. Example: copy the headline, byline, and the first three to five paragraphs — usually enough for a clear summary. You'll know it worked when you paste the text into any other app (like Notes) and the article words appear there.

Step 3 — Paste the article and ask for a plain-English summary

Click into Grok's text box and paste your copied text — **Ctrl+V** or **Cmd+V** on a computer, **long-press then "Paste"** on a phone. Right below the pasted text, add a clear instruction asking for a plain-English explanation. Hit **Enter** or tap the **send arrow** (usually a small upward icon next to the box). Grok starts typing a reply within a few seconds — you'll see words appear one by one or in chunks, finishing with a complete summary. If the reply is too short or misses the point, send a follow-up message in the same chat with a more specific prompt. The interface varies slightly between web and mobile, but the basic paste-and-send flow is the same everywhere. Example: paste the article, then on a new line type: *"Explain this like I'm smart but not an expert. Who is involved, what actually happened, and why does it matter?"* You'll know it worked when Grok replies with a short, organized summary written in everyday words.

Step 4 — Ask follow-up questions about the parts you still don't understand

Read Grok's reply. If anything is still fuzzy — a person you don't recognize, a phrase you don't know, or a number that doesn't quite make sense — just type another question in the same chat. Grok remembers the conversation, so you don't need to paste the article again. Watch for the new reply appearing just below your question, usually within seconds. If Grok doesn't have enough information to answer, it will usually say so honestly or ask you to clarify. If the chat window looks frozen, scroll down — sometimes the reply sits below where you're looking. This is where the conversation really starts to feel useful. Example: *"Who is [Name] you mentioned? Why are they important in this story?"* You'll know it worked when Grok answers your specific question in plain English, building on the earlier summary.

Step 5 — Ask for the "why does this matter" angle

This is the step most people skip — and it's the most useful. Ask Grok to connect the dots to your everyday life: why should a regular person care, what might happen next, or what to watch for. Type a short request and send it. Grok will reply with a brief take. Treat it as a starting point, not the final word — news is complex, and Grok's reading is just one view among many. If you want a different angle, simply ask — for example, how a small business owner might read the same

story, or how it could affect renters in a city. The free plan covers basic chats; very long sessions may eventually hit a limit, and exact limits change, so check Grok's official page for current details. 💬 Example: *"In two or three sentences, why should an ordinary person care about this story, and what's the most likely next development?"* You'll know it worked when you can explain the article to a friend in your own words — that's the real test.

Common mistakes

- **Pasting only a paywalled URL.** Grok can sometimes read public web pages from a link, but paywalled articles often block that — only a short preview loads, or nothing does. The fix: copy the visible text and paste it directly into the chat, even if it is only the first few paragraphs.
- **Asking "explain this" with no context.** A bare "what does this mean?" usually gets a vague reply. The fix: tell Grok who you are and what you want — for example, *"I'm a regular reader, not an expert — please give me the short version and the context."*
- **Trusting the summary without checking key facts.** Grok can sometimes mix up details (this is called a **hallucination** — when an AI confidently states something that isn't actually true). The fix: for anything that affects a real decision, double-check the names, numbers, and dates against the original article or another reliable source.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** the next time a confusing headline crosses your feed — about a new law, a court ruling, a market shift — you have a five-minute routine to actually understand it instead of scrolling past.
- **For your work:** when a colleague shares a dense industry article or a long report, you can pull out the key points quickly and decide whether the full read is worth your time.
- **If you're just getting started:** try this once with one short article before you need it. Build the habit on something low-stakes, so the routine feels natural the next time something genuinely confusing shows up.

Try it now

Pick one headline from today's news that made you feel a little lost. Copy the first three to five paragraphs, paste them into Grok, and type: *"Explain this like I'm smart but not an expert. Who is involved, what actually happened, and why should I care?"* Two minutes, start to finish.

Explain a tricky school topic with Grok in five minutes

5 steps · Read online

> **In short:** Open Grok, name the topic and your child's age, and ask it to retell the subject as a short story. You'll have a simple, kid-friendly explanation in about a minute, ready to read together at the kitchen table.

Homework time can go from calm to chaos in about ten minutes flat — usually the moment a tricky word appears in the textbook and nobody in the room can explain it. Grok is an AI assistant made by xAI, and one of the things it does well is take a confusing subject and rewrite it as a story a kid can actually follow. You don't need to be a teacher. You just need to know the topic, the age, and a good opening message. One honest note up front: Grok can rewrite the topic as a story, but it can't replace reading the textbook or doing the actual homework — your child still needs to know what the teacher is asking for.

Before you start

- A Grok account — you can sign up at the official Grok site or inside the X app. The basic chat is usually available on the free plan; some newer or more powerful models may need a paid tier, so check the current plan list if you want the strongest answer.
- A phone, tablet or computer with Grok open in a browser or app.
- The exact homework topic from your child's book, worksheet or class note — even a rough idea works.
- About **5–7 minutes** total.

Step 1 — Open Grok and start a new chat

Open the Grok app on your phone, or visit grok.com in a browser on your computer. Look for the **chat box near the bottom of the screen** — usually a rounded text field labeled something like "Ask anything" or "Message Grok." If you've used Grok before, your old chats appear in a sidebar on the web or behind a menu icon on mobile. Tap the **"New chat"** button or the **pencil / "+" icon** to start fresh, so the assistant doesn't get confused by an earlier conversation. 💬 Example: tap the "+" or pencil icon at the top of the chat list to open a blank chat. If your screen looks different, the new-chat option is often hidden behind a **☰ menu** at the top-left, or inside an account/profile icon at the top-right — open it and look for a "New chat" entry. You'll know it worked when you see a blank chat screen with a single text field and no old messages above it.

Step 2 — Name the topic, the age and the goal

Type one clear sentence into the chat box that includes three things: the subject (for example, "the water cycle" or "the French Revolution"), your child's age or grade, and what you want —

usually "as a short story" or "in simple words." Then press the **paper-plane icon ➤** or hit **Return / Enter** to send. Grok starts typing a reply within a few seconds; you'll see words appear one by one, the way a person would text. 💬 Example: *"My son is 10. Please explain the water cycle as a short story he can read on his own — about 150 words, no big words."* If your screen shows a **microphone icon** instead of a text box, tap the small **keyboard icon** to switch to typing first. Some mobile builds put the new-chat option behind the **☰ menu** — open it and choose "New chat" if you skipped Step 1. You'll know it worked when Grok starts writing a response — usually a title line, then a paragraph or two of story text.

Step 3 — Ask for one small example or scene

Stories land better when there's a concrete moment the child can picture in their head. After the first reply, send a short follow-up asking Grok to add **one tiny example, analogy or scene** — something a kid can see (a leaf, a king, a battery, a fish). This makes the idea stick. Type it the same way: into the text box, then tap the send arrow. Grok rewrites or extends the explanation in plain English. 💬 Example: *"Can you add one short scene with a leaf falling off a tree, so the 'evaporation' part makes sense?"* If the reply feels too long or too grown-up, just say so — *"A bit shorter, please, and use simpler words."* The assistant adjusts in the next message. If the text field won't send, check that you didn't accidentally tap a microphone, and that the message bubble actually appears above the chat box. You'll know it worked when the new reply contains a concrete image your child can repeat back to you — "a leaf falls into a puddle and floats up as steam."

Step 4 — Read it together and ask one question

Sit with your child and read the story out loud — slowly is fine. Pause at the end and ask **one** question to check the idea landed. You can type it into Grok first to see if the assistant agrees with the answer, or ask your child directly and then check together. This is where homework stops being a fight: your child is retelling, not being quizzed. 💬 Example: ask your child *"So what does the sun do to the water in the puddle?"* — then type *"Did I explain the water cycle correctly to a 10-year-old?"* into Grok for a sanity check. If Grok's answer comes back with new vocabulary your child doesn't know, ask it to **swap the hard word for a friendlier one** — *"Replace the word 'precipitation' with something a 10-year-old would actually say."* If your child loses interest halfway, ask Grok to **shrink the story** to about 80 words and try again. You'll know it worked when your child can summarize the topic in their own words without staring at the textbook.

Step 5 — Save the story for next time

If the topic is going to come up again — most school subjects do — keep the chat. Look for a **"Share" or "Copy" icon** near Grok's reply, often a small arrow pointing up or two overlapping

squares. Tap it to copy the text into a notes app, an email or a message to yourself. That way, tomorrow's homework — or next week's review — starts with a story your child already half-remembers. 💬 Example: tap the share icon, then paste the story into Apple Notes, Google Keep or a simple text message to yourself. If you don't see a share button, **long-press the reply text on mobile** (or **right-click on a computer**) and choose **"Copy"** — the text goes to your clipboard, ready to paste anywhere. Inside the X app, the chat lives within X itself, so saving usually means copying the story out before you close the tab. You'll know it worked when the story is safely in your notes app, ready to open at the kitchen table tomorrow.

Common mistakes

- **Asking for "an explanation" without naming the age.** Grok will write for an adult, and the child will tune out. Always include the age in the very first message.
- **Treating the first reply as the final one.** A great explanation usually takes two or three short follow-ups. If it feels off, ask Grok to try again in simpler words — don't give up after one round.
- **Quizzing instead of retelling.** Asking "did you understand?" puts a child on the spot. Asking "tell it back to me in your own words" is much kinder and shows whether the story actually landed.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** the next time a homework page makes everyone in the room sigh, you can turn it into a five-minute story instead of a thirty-minute argument.
- **For your business or work:** the same trick — *"explain X like I'm 10"* — is one of the fastest ways to break down a dense report, a contract clause or a long email you don't fully understand.
- **If you're just getting started:** start with one subject your child already half-likes — a favorite animal, a sport, a video game world — and ask Grok to explain it in story form. It's the easiest first win.

Try it now

Pick one topic from tonight's homework, open Grok, and paste this: *"My child is 10. Please explain [TOPIC] as a 150-word story with no big words. End with one tiny example."* Read the result together and see how it lands.

How to Fact-Check a Viral Claim or Breaking News Story with Perplexity

5 steps · Read online

> **In short:** Perplexity is an AI answer engine that searches the live web and shows the sources behind every sentence, so you can trace a viral claim back to the place it actually came from in a few minutes. The free plan covers most routine fact-checks; unlimited deep research and file uploads live behind the paid Pro plan.

A shocking headline lands in your group chat at 9 p.m. Before you forward it, paste it into Perplexity and you'll see — in plain English, with citations attached — what the underlying sources actually say, who first said it, and when. This guide walks you through five concrete steps written for someone who has never opened Perplexity before. The whole routine takes about ten minutes the first time, and less once you've done it a few times.

Before you start

- A free Perplexity account (sign up with email, Google, or Apple — about a minute).
- A web browser, or the Perplexity mobile app on iOS or Android.
- The claim or headline you want to check, copied exactly as you saw it.
- Roughly 10 minutes the first time.

Step 1 — Open Perplexity and paste the exact claim

Go to the Perplexity homepage in your browser, or open the app. You'll see a chat-style page with a large text box in the middle and a small "Search" button or send arrow beside it. Click inside that box and paste the claim you want to check, exactly as you saw it — including any numbers, names, or quotes. Press Enter. Perplexity begins searching the live web and writes back a short paragraph answer with small numbered links (like `[1]`, `[2]`, `[3]`) at the end of each sentence. If you can't find the search box on mobile, look for a magnifying glass or a "+" icon at the bottom of the screen.

Example: `A widely shared post claims a major bank will close 200 branches next month.`

You'll know it worked when you see a written paragraph answer with numbered citations at the end of each sentence and a list of source links below it.

Step 2 — Read the inline citations and click into at least two sources

Look at the small numbered marks `[1]`, `[2]`, `[3]` after each sentence, then scroll down to the "Sources" panel that lists each linked page with its publication name. Click at least two of those links to open the original articles in a new tab. Read the relevant paragraph in each one yourself — this is the step most people skip, and it's the one that protects you from being fooled by a confident-sounding AI summary. If the citation numbers are hard to spot, Perplexity sometimes shows small preview cards beside the text instead — click those.

Example: (no typing required — just click the numbered links under the answer)

You'll know it worked when you've actually opened two of the linked pages and read the exact paragraph each one uses to back up the claim.

Step 3 — Switch the Focus to get the right kind of sources

Look for a small "Focus" selector above or next to the search box — usually a row of buttons or a dropdown labeled with options like **All**, **Web**, **Academic**, **Social**, **News**, or **YouTube**. Pick the focus that matches what you're checking: choose **News** for breaking stories, **Academic** for health or science claims, **Social** for tweets and posts. Perplexity then narrows its next search to that type of source, which makes the results far more useful. If you don't see a Focus row, look for a "Sources" filter, a small gear icon near the input box, or a "···" menu in the corner — apps move these controls around.

Example: tap **News** if you're checking a breaking story, or **Academic** if the claim is about a medical or scientific finding.

You'll know it worked when the sources listed under your next answer are mostly news outlets, academic journals, or whichever focus you chose.

Step 4 — Ask Perplexity to trace where the claim first appeared

In the same chat thread, type a follow-up question that asks for the origin: who first said this, when, and on what platform. Perplexity runs another search and answers with citations pointing to what looks like the earliest mention it can find — sometimes a tweet, sometimes a press release, sometimes a news article. If it tells you it can't find a clear origin, that itself is a useful signal: the claim may not have a traceable source. Keep in mind that Perplexity searches the live web, but a story that's only minutes old may not yet be indexed — if you see "no results found," wait a few minutes and try again.

Example: `Who first made this claim? When and where did it originally appear?`

You'll know it worked when you can name a date, a person or outlet, and a link that matches the earliest appearance of the claim.

Step 5 — Cross-check with a fresh, differently-worded search

Open a brand-new thread — look for a "+ New Thread" or "Search" button at the top of the page, or simply open Perplexity in a new browser tab. Ask the same claim using different words. A second independent answer appears with its own sources. Compare the two answers side by side: do they point to the same underlying outlets, or do they disagree? Two searches agreeing on the same sources is a strong signal; two searches disagreeing means the claim deserves more digging before you trust it.

💬 Example: instead of pasting the original post, ask `What did the bank actually announce about branch closures this month?` in your own words.

You'll know it worked when two independent searches point to the same underlying sources, or — when they don't — you have a clear list of what to investigate further before sharing.

Common mistakes

- **Trusting the AI summary without opening the citations.** Perplexity's summary can still be wrong, vague, or outdated. Fix: always click at least two of the numbered links and read the source yourself.
- **Mixing up the publication date with the date of the event.** A 2024 article about a 2019 event is not "news from yesterday." Fix: check when each linked article was actually published before you treat it as evidence.
- **Sharing the answer before checking that the sources actually support it.** Sometimes the citation points to a page that doesn't quite say what the summary claims. Fix: if a source doesn't back the claim, the AI answer is unreliable — don't forward it.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** Before forwarding a shocking headline in a group chat, run it through these five steps. You'll either confirm it quickly and share with confidence, or you'll catch a bad claim before it spreads.
- **For your work or studies:** Journalists, researchers, students, and anyone whose reputation depends on getting facts right can use this same routine as a quick first pass on a lead — it won't replace primary-source verification, but it filters out the obviously false in minutes.
- **If you're just getting started:** Don't try to build a perfect workflow on day one. Pick one viral claim you've seen today and run it through Steps 1 to 3. That's enough to feel how the citations work.

Try it now

Open Perplexity, paste the most recent surprising headline you've seen today, and read the first three numbered sources that come back. That single two-minute move is enough to see how the tool works — and you'll either feel better about the headline, or you'll have caught something worth a closer look.

Fact-check a viral claim with Perplexity before you share it

5 steps · Read online

> **In short:** Perplexity (an AI search tool) searches the web and shows you the actual articles behind any claim, so you can decide for yourself whether a viral headline is true. You do not need to create an account to start — you can try it right now on the website.

You see a headline in your group chat. It sounds shocking. Your gut says it could not possibly be true — or maybe it could. Before you forward it with a "Can you believe this?" comment, there is a quick way to check: type the claim into Perplexity. It will pull up real articles and show you what reliable sources actually say. This guide walks you through that in about 60 seconds.

Before you start

- **Device:** any phone, tablet, or computer with a browser — no app download needed
- **Account:** not required on the free plan; you can search immediately
- **Time:** about 1–3 minutes per claim
- **What you need:** the headline or claim you want to check

Step 1 — Open Perplexity in your browser

Type **perplexity.ai** into your address bar and press Enter. The homepage loads with a clean search bar right in the center of the screen — a large white box that says "Ask anything" with a microphone icon on the right side. You may also see a few suggested questions below the bar. If you see a sign-up prompt in the top-right corner, you can dismiss it or ignore it; the free version works without logging in. Some features (like saving your search history) require an account, but looking up a claim does not.

Example: navigate to **perplexity.ai**

You'll know it worked when you see the Perplexity logo at the top and a central search box ready to accept your text.

Step 2 — Type in the headline or claim you want to check

Click the search bar and type the exact headline or claim you saw. You do not need to clean it up or rephrase it — paste it as-is, even if it is messy or full of CAPS. Perplexity will search across the web to find articles that discuss the topic. For the best results, include just enough context for the search to understand the topic: the main noun, event, or person the claim is about.

Example: "Harvard study proves 5G causes memory loss"

You'll know it worked when your text appears inside the search bar and you can see a blinking cursor or the microphone icon waiting for your next action.

Step 3 — Read the answer and check the cited sources

Press Enter or tap the search button. Perplexity generates a short answer at the top — a plain-language summary of what it found. Directly below that answer, you will see a list of source cards: small boxes showing the name of each article or website, the publisher, and a small icon representing the type of source. Each card is clickable. The most useful part of this screen is reading what those real articles say — not just Perplexity's summary. If you scroll down, Perplexity may also show you a "Related questions" section that breaks the topic into smaller angles. If you do not see any sources listed, try rephrasing the claim or adding a key name or date.

💬 Example: Click the first source card to open the original article and read the opening paragraph — does it match what the headline claimed?

You'll know it worked when you see a blue or underlined list of clickable sources appearing below the answer.

Step 4 — Open one or two sources to verify the claim yourself

Tap a source card that looks most relevant — a reputable news site, university, or government page is generally more reliable than an unknown blog. The link opens the original article in a new tab. Scan the opening paragraph and look for whether the article actually says what the viral claim says. Check three things: (1) Does the article mention the same fact the claim mentioned? (2) Does it use words like "study," "research," or "report" — or does it just quote someone online? (3) Is the article recent, or is it from years ago being shared out of context? If the source is behind a paywall, you will see a partial preview — scroll to see what you can, then move to a second source.

💬 Example: The article says "A small 2021 study at one university looked at this topic" — that is very different from a large, peer-reviewed government report. Look for that difference.

You'll know it worked when you can read at least the headline and opening paragraph of the original source and compare it directly to the claim you typed in Step 2.

Step 5 — Ask a follow-up question if the answer is unclear

Perplexity lets you keep asking in the same conversation. If you opened a source and it raised more questions — "Is this from a real university?" "Is this the only study?" — type a follow-up directly below the answer. Perplexity treats this as a continuing thread, so it remembers what

you already asked. You can push deeper without retyping the whole claim. This is especially useful when a claim is vague or when you want to check multiple angles.

💬 Example: "Is this study peer-reviewed?" or "What do other sources say about this claim?"

You'll know it worked when your follow-up question appears as a new bubble in the conversation and Perplexity generates a fresh answer with new sources below it.

Common mistakes

- **Only reading Perplexity's summary, not the sources.** The AI summary is helpful but it is still an AI paraphrase. Always click at least one source card to read what the original article actually says — that is where the real fact-checking happens.
- **Taking a single source as proof.** One article does not make a fact. If you find only one site making a claim and every other source is silent, treat that claim as unconfirmed rather than verified.
- **Searching with an emotionally charged version of the claim.** If you type "XYZ company caught stealing user data!" the search may return opinion articles and outrage posts. Try a neutral version instead: "XYZ company data collection 2024." This surfaces factual reporting rather than reaction posts.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** Before forwarding a shocking headline to family or friends, you can spend 60 seconds checking whether a real source backs it up. This saves you from spreading something that turns out to be years-old, taken out of context, or simply made up.
- **For your business or work:** If you see a claim about your industry — a competitor, a regulation change, a market report — you can quickly verify whether it came from a credible source or was fabricated by a clickbait article. This protects you from making decisions based on bad information.
- **If you are just getting started:** Your very first move is to take one claim you saw recently (even something small, like a product recall or a celebrity quote) and type it into Perplexity right now. Click one source. Read three sentences. That is all it takes to build the habit.

Try it now

Go to **perplexity.ai**, paste one claim from your group chat or social feed, and click through to at least one source. Read the headline and opening paragraph. Ask yourself: does the original article actually say what the viral post said it said?

How to Translate Menus, Signs and Labels with Your Phone and Gemini

5 steps · Read online

> **In short:** Point your phone camera at any foreign text — a menu, a street sign, a product label — and Gemini will read it and translate it into English in seconds. It usually handles common languages well, though decorative fonts, handwriting, or blurry shots can trip it up.

In a few minutes you'll know how to translate almost any printed text in the world using just your phone and Gemini — Google's AI assistant. This guide is for complete beginners, and assumes you've never opened the app before. All you need is a phone, the app, and a steady hand.

Before you start

- The **Gemini app** installed (free from the Google Play Store on Android, or the App Store on iPhone).
- A **Google account** signed in on your phone — the same one you'd use for Gmail or YouTube.
- **Camera permission** turned on for the app (your phone will ask the first time).
- A **working internet** connection — Wi-Fi or mobile data. Some translation features need the cloud to work.
- Roughly **2–3 minutes** to translate one thing end-to-end.

A quick honest note: Gemini's camera translation is good for everyday situations, but it won't always be perfect. For anything safety-critical (food allergens, medication labels, legal notices), treat the answer as a starting point and double-check with a human.

Step 1 — Open Gemini and switch to camera mode

Tap the **Gemini app icon** on your phone — look for a four-pointed spark or star in blue and white. The main chat screen opens with a text box near the bottom. Find the **camera icon** — it usually sits right next to the text box, or tucked inside an attachment menu (a **+** or **paperclip**). Tap it once. A small panel slides up with options like **Take photo** or **Open camera live**. If you only see one option, that's the one to use.

💬 Example: tap the camera icon, then choose **Take photo** if you want a still image, or **Open camera live** if you want to stream what's in front of you.

You'll know it worked when your phone's viewfinder fills the screen, showing what the back camera sees.

Step 2 — Frame the text and capture it

Hold your phone about **20–30 cm** from the menu, sign, or label — close enough that the text fills about two-thirds of the screen. Try to keep the phone flat and steady, and avoid harsh shadows across the words. If you chose live camera, just point and hold; if you chose photo, tap the round **shutter button** at the bottom of the screen once. Stay still for a moment after the click so the image isn't blurry.

Example: aim so that one menu section, one sign, or one product label fills most of the frame, then tap the round shutter button.

You'll know it worked when Gemini shows the photo (or live video feed) on screen, with a text box ready for your question.

Step 3 — Ask Gemini to translate

Right below the photo, you'll find a text box — type a short, direct instruction. Mention the source language if you know it, and always say the language you want the answer in (English is the default, but you can ask for others). Press the **send icon** (an arrow or paper plane). Within a few seconds, Gemini replies with the translated text, usually noting what language it spotted.

Example: type **"Translate this menu into English. For each dish, give me the name, a short description, and flag anything containing nuts, dairy, or shellfish."**

You'll know it worked when Gemini's reply contains a clear English version of the text, with any extra details you asked about.

Step 4 — Ask follow-up questions

If anything is still unclear — a single word, an abbreviation, a cultural reference — just type a follow-up question in the same chat. Gemini remembers the photo and its first answer, so you can dig deeper without re-snapping the picture. Ask things like "what does 'al dente' mean here?", "is this dish usually spicy?", or "which one is the cheapest soup?" You can also ask it to **rewrite the translation over the photo** if you want a visual overlay.

Example: type **"What does the small text under each item say? And which of these soups would you order if you don't like spice?"**

You'll know it worked when Gemini responds with a specific clarification, using the same photo as context — no need to upload anything again.

Step 5 — Save or share the result

Once the translation looks right, you can keep it, copy it, or send it to someone else. Look for small **icons near Gemini's reply** — usually a **copy** icon (two overlapping squares) and a **share** icon (an arrow pointing up out of a box). Tap **copy** to paste the translation into Notes, Messages, or a translation app. Tap **share** to send it to a friend who's still puzzling over the menu across the table.

💬 Example: tap **copy**, open Notes, then paste — your translated menu is now scrollable on your own screen.

You'll know it worked when the translated text appears in your Notes app (or wherever you pasted it), ready to read at your own pace.

Common mistakes

- **Tilting the phone so the text is skewed.** Hold the phone flat and face the text straight on. If the photo is already taken at an angle, ask Gemini to "read the text even though it's skewed" — it usually copes.
- **Photographing a dense full page and getting a muddled answer.** A single packed menu is hard for any AI to parse cleanly. Photograph one section at a time, or ask Gemini to "list only the items under 'Pasta'".
- **Trusting the translation without checking the important bits.** Gemini is accurate most of the time, but it can misread a price or miss an allergen. For anything critical (medical, dietary, financial), confirm with a human or an official source.
- **Forgetting to mention the source language.** If the menu mixes two scripts (say, Japanese and English), tell Gemini which part to translate. Otherwise it may try to translate the bits you don't need.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** ordering food abroad, reading street signs while traveling, decoding foreign product labels at the supermarket, or checking the back of a souvenir you just bought.
- **For your business or work:** reading labels on imported goods, understanding signage or documents from overseas clients, or sanity-checking translations before sending them to a customer.
- **If you're just getting started:** don't wait for your next holiday. Try it on the next unfamiliar label or sign you see — the back of a bottle, a product in a specialty shop, anything with foreign text. The first try is the only hard one.

Try it now

Grab one thing with foreign text near you — a food packet in the cupboard, a souvenir, or even a foreign-language webpage on another screen. Snap it with Gemini, ask for a translation, and read the answer. Two minutes, done.

How to Use Perplexity Spaces to Organize Your Digital Research

4 steps · Read online

Imagine having a personal research assistant who reads dozens of web pages for you, files them away in neat folders, and answers your questions based *only* on those sources. By the end of this guide, you will know how to use Perplexity Spaces to group your searches, upload files, and keep your projects beautifully organized. While it excels at information synthesis, remember Perplexity cannot make real-world decisions or take actions like sending emails on your behalf.

Before you start

- **Get a Perplexity account:** You'll need either a free or paid (Pro) account. The core features of Spaces are available on the free plan, but Pro offers higher limits for file uploads and more advanced AI models.
- **Access Perplexity:** You can use Perplexity directly through your web browser (on a computer or tablet) or via its dedicated mobile app for phones.
- **Choose a topic:** Have a specific research project in mind. This could be anything from planning a family holiday, studying a complex topic for personal growth, or researching competitors for work.
- **Time commitment:** Expect to spend about 5-10 minutes following this guide, and then more time exploring your new Space.

Step 1 — Create your first Space

To keep your research from getting cluttered, you need to create a dedicated folder. In Perplexity, these folders are called **Spaces** (formerly known as Collections). Think of a Space as a digital ring-binder: instead of having fifty open browser tabs, you put all your notes and web searches inside this single, organized binder.

ACTION: Open Perplexity on your device and click to create a new Space. **WHAT YOU SEE:** Once logged in, you'll see a left-hand navigation panel. Look for "Library" or "Spaces", often with a plus icon (+) next to it, or a clear "New Space" button. **WHAT HAPPENS NEXT:** A new panel or pop-up window will appear, prompting you to name your Space and add a description. **IF IT LOOKS DIFFERENT:** If you don't see "Library" or "Spaces", look for a menu icon (three horizontal lines) which might reveal a sidebar with these options. Older versions might still use the term "Collections" instead of "Spaces". 💬 **Example:** Give your Space the name "Backyard Veggie Garden Plan" and a description like "Planning out my first home vegetable patch, focusing on organic methods." **SUCCESS CHECK:** You'll know it worked when the new Space appears in your list on the left-hand panel, ready for you to click into it.

Step 2 — Set the ground rules with instructions

One of the best features of a Space is the ability to give it "AI Instructions". This is a **prompt** (the plain-language instructions you write to tell the AI how to behave). By setting these instructions, you don't have to repeat yourself every time you ask a question inside this Space, ensuring consistent answers.

ACTION: Type your specific guidelines into the designated "AI Instructions" field within your new Space. **WHAT YOU SEE:** Inside your newly created Space, look for a section clearly labeled "AI Instructions" or "How should the AI respond?". This will typically be a text box where you can type. **WHAT HAPPENS NEXT:** As you type, the instructions are usually saved automatically, or you might see a "Save" button to confirm them. These instructions will then guide all future AI interactions within this particular Space. **IF IT LOOKS DIFFERENT:** The instructions might be found within a "Settings" or "Preferences" sub-menu for your Space, or you might need to toggle a switch to enable custom instructions first. **Example:** Type: "You are an expert horticulturalist helping a beginner. When I ask questions, please keep your answers simple, focus on organic methods, and always suggest plants that grow well in warm, coastal climates." **SUCCESS CHECK:** You'll know it worked when your instructions remain visible in the text box or a confirmation message appears, indicating they are now active for this Space.

Step 3 — Add your own sources

Sometimes the best information isn't on the public internet—it's sitting on your hard drive. You can upload files directly into your Space, which the AI will then use. A **source** is any document, web link, or file that you feed to the AI. Once uploaded, the AI will read these files and use them to answer your questions, effectively making them part of its knowledge base for this Space.

ACTION: Click the 'Add Files' or paperclip icon and select the documents you want to upload. **WHAT YOU SEE:** Within your active Space, look for an attachment icon (it usually looks like a paperclip), a button labeled "Add Files", or a section for "Sources" or "Uploads". **WHAT HAPPENS NEXT:** A file upload window from your computer or phone will open, allowing you to browse and select documents like PDFs, text files (.txt), or Word documents (.docx). **IF IT LOOKS DIFFERENT:** You might see a drag-and-drop area where you can simply pull files from your desktop. The number of files or their size may vary depending on your Perplexity plan, with Pro offering greater capacity. **Example:** Select a PDF file from your computer titled "Local Nursery Price List 2024.pdf" which contains prices for soil, plants, and fertilisers. **SUCCESS CHECK:** You'll know it worked when the uploaded file's name appears listed under "Sources" or "Files" within your Space, confirming it's ready for the AI to read.

Step 4 — Search and ask questions

Now that your Space is set up with custom instructions and potentially your own files, you can start searching. Every question you ask inside this Space will remember your instructions and look through any files you uploaded, providing highly relevant and focused answers.

ACTION: Type your question into the search bar at the top or bottom of your Space page and press Enter. **WHAT YOU SEE:** You'll see a prominent search bar (often labeled "Ask anything" or similar) within the main area of your active Space. Your custom instructions and uploaded files will be visible, indicating the AI's current context. **WHAT HAPPENS NEXT:** Perplexity will process your query, referring to both its general web knowledge, your specific AI Instructions, and the content of your uploaded files. It will then generate a detailed answer, typically citing its sources. **IF IT LOOKS DIFFERENT:** The search bar might be located at the very bottom of the screen on some mobile devices, or simply be a large text input field. If the answer misses the point, try rephrasing with more detail or reminding the AI of its instructions. 💬 **Example:** Type: "What are the best vegetables to plant this month for a warm, coastal climate, and what organic soil mix do you recommend from the price list I uploaded?" **SUCCESS CHECK:** You'll know it worked when Perplexity displays a detailed answer directly below your question, citing sources from both the web and your uploaded files (clearly indicating if information came from your documents).

Common mistakes

- **Searching in the wrong place:** It's easy to accidentally type your query into the main Perplexity home page search bar instead of inside your specific Space. If you do this, the AI won't use your uploaded files or custom instructions.
    - **The fix:** Always ensure you have clicked into your desired Space first, so its name is clearly visible at the top of the screen before typing your question.
- **Writing overly complex instructions:** If you give the AI twenty different, potentially conflicting rules to follow, it might get confused or prioritize some rules over others, leading to inconsistent answers.
    - **The fix:** Keep your AI instructions simple, focused, and direct. Start with two or three clear guidelines, test them, and refine them only if necessary.
- **Expecting the AI to 'know' everything:** While powerful, Perplexity relies on the information it has access to (the internet, your uploaded files). It can't magically infer specific details not provided.
    - **The fix:** Be explicit in your questions, especially when referring to uploaded files. Ask questions that the AI can answer using the context you've given it. If you need specific data, ensure that data is in an uploaded document.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** You can organize your busy personal life. Use Spaces to plan a travel itinerary, collect healthy recipes that fit your dietary needs, or compare local school options for your kids. No more scattered notes or endless browser tabs.
- **For your business or work:** You can streamline your daily tasks. Create a Space for a specific client, upload their brand guidelines and previous reports, and then use it to draft emails, research competitors, or write new reports that perfectly match their style and existing context.
- **If you're just getting started:** Don't worry about uploading files yet. Just create a single Space for a simple hobby (like learning about American native birds), set one basic instruction (e.g., "Act as a friendly bird expert"), and see how much cleaner and more focused your search history becomes.

Try it now

Let's get you set up in the next two minutes:

1. Open Perplexity and click on **Library** on the left-hand navigation panel.
2. Create a Space called **Weekend Getaways**.
3. Inside that Space, type this first question into the search bar: "What are three quiet, nature-focused weekend destinations within a two-hour drive of my current location?"

Automate the boring bits

Set Up Different Alexa+ Routines for Weekday and Weekend Mornings

7 steps · Read online

> **In short:** To get different behavior on weekdays vs weekends, you create two separate Alexa+ routines — one scheduled for Mon–Fri, one for Sat–Sun. Day-of-week is set on the whole routine, not on individual actions, so two routines is the honest way.

Saturday morning, your Echo starts the weekday news flash — and that's the moment most people realize one routine can't quietly branch into "weekday actions" and "weekend actions" inside itself. The supported way is to build two routines and schedule each on the days you want. This guide walks you through both, from opening the Routines screen to testing each one out loud.

Before you start

- An Amazon account signed in on at least one Echo device, with the Echo powered on and connected to Wi-Fi.
- The **Alexa app** on a phone or tablet (free on iOS and Android), signed in to the same Amazon account as the Echo.
- Two short, easy-to-say names picked out — one for weekdays, one for weekends.
- About **15 minutes** the first time, closer to **5 minutes** once you've done it once.

Step 1 — Open the Routines section

In the Alexa app, look at the bottom-right corner of the screen for a tab that looks like three horizontal lines or dots (sometimes labeled **More**). Tap it, then look for an option that says something like **Routines**. If you can't find it there, look in a **Settings** or **Automations** area, or use the search bar at the top of the app to type "Routines". When you land on the Routines screen, you'll see a list of any routines you've already created, with a button at the top — often a + symbol or a label like **Create Routine** — to start a new one.

If your version of the app puts Routines somewhere else, try the **Settings** tab and look for an **Automations** or **Routines** subsection — Amazon moves this between updates.

💬 Example: routine name — `Weekday Morning`

You'll know it worked when the screen shows a fresh form with fields for a name, a "When this happens" trigger, and an "Add action" button.

Step 2 — Name the routine and pick the days it runs

Tap the routine name field and type a short phrase you'll remember saying, like `Weekday Morning`. Then look for a "When" or "Schedule" section. If you see an option like "At a specific time," tap it and set the time you want — say, **6:30 AM**. Then look for a day picker, usually a row of seven checkboxes or buttons labeled Mon, Tue, Wed, Thu, Fri, Sat, Sun. Check **Mon through Fri** and leave Sat and Sun unchecked. This day picker is the only place Alexa+ stores weekday vs weekend logic — there is no separate per-action day filter.

If the app shows a **Voice** option instead of typing the trigger phrase, tap the microphone icon and say the phrase out loud; the app will transcribe what it heard so you can confirm the spelling.

💬 Example: name `Weekday Morning`, voice trigger *Alexa, start my weekday morning*, time **6:30 AM**, days **Mon–Fri only**

You'll know it worked when the routine form shows your time, and the days row has Mon through Fri selected, with Sat and Sun greyed out or unchecked.

Step 3 — Add the weekday actions

Tap the **Add action** button. The app shows categories like Music, Smart Home, Calendar, Weather, and News — pick the one you want for each step. Add the things you only want on weekdays: a news flash, traffic for your commute, the office lights turning on, the coffee maker clicking to life. For each action, follow the prompts to pick the device, playlist, or skill from a list — don't type device names by hand if you can avoid it, because the spelling has to match exactly. When you're done adding weekday actions, save the routine, usually with a **Save** button at the top-right of the screen.

If a particular action asks for its own time or day filter, just leave it at the default — Alexa+ only filters days on the whole routine, not on individual actions inside it.

💬 Example: actions — **News → Flash Briefing**, **Smart Home → Turn on "Kitchen Lights"**, **Smart Home → Turn on "Coffee Maker" plug**

You'll know it worked when the routine screen shows your weekday actions in a list, and the days row at the top still confirms Mon–Fri only.

Step 4 — Test the weekday routine out loud

With the routine saved, stand near your Echo and say the trigger phrase out loud — for example, "Alexa, start my weekday morning." Listen for the news flash, watch for the lights to come on, and listen for the coffee maker's click. If something doesn't fire, the most common cause is the routine being switched off, or the device name in the action not exactly matching the real device name — go back into the routine and check.

Alexa+ doesn't always offer a dedicated in-app "Test routine" button, so speaking the trigger phrase is usually the fastest way to confirm it works. There is also no way to simulate "today is a Saturday" inside the app — the routine only fires when its schedule says so.

💬 Example: say `Alexa, start my weekday morning` and listen for the news flash within a few seconds.

You'll know it worked when each weekday action runs in the order you set, and your Echo doesn't complain about a missing device or skill.

Step 5 — Create a separate weekend routine

Go back to the Routines list (the same screen as Step 1) and tap **Create Routine** again. Give it a different name — something like `Weekend Morning` or `Saturday Slow Start` — so you can tell them apart at a glance. Set the time you want (a later hour is fine if you sleep in on weekends). This time, in the days row, check **only Sat and Sun** and leave Mon through Fri unchecked.

You can give the weekend routine a totally different voice phrase, or use the same phrase on both routines — Alexa+ just runs whichever routine is scheduled for today, so there's no clash as long as the day pickers don't overlap.

💬 Example: name `Weekend Morning`, time **8:00 AM**, days **Sat–Sun only**

You'll know it worked when the new routine appears in your list next to the weekday one, and its days row shows only Sat and Sun selected.

Step 6 — Add the weekend-only actions

In the new weekend routine, tap **Add action** and pick the things you only want on Saturday and Sunday: a sleepy playlist, a slow light fade, no news flash, maybe the coffee maker staying off. Save the routine the same way you did in Step 3. Then double-check that this routine's days row is Sat–Sun only, not every day — otherwise it will also fire on weekdays and fight the other routine for control of your devices.

If both routines happen to share a device (say, the same smart plug), the weekend routine can include its own "off" or "skip" action for that device — Alexa+ will run whichever routine is scheduled for today.

💬 Example: actions — **Music → Play "Slow Morning" playlist**, **Smart Home → Turn off "Bedroom Lights" fade-out**, **Weather → Read forecast** (skip the news flash entirely)

You'll know it worked when the weekend routine shows only the steps you want, and a glance at the days row confirms Sat–Sun only — no overlap with the weekday routine.

Step 7 — Save and let the calendar do the work

Both routines are now saved. From here on, Alexa+ runs the weekday one Mon–Fri at your chosen time and the weekend one Sat–Sun at its chosen time — you don't have to do anything. The day-of-week picker is the only "branching" Alexa+ offers for routines; there is no per-action day filter, no "if I'm home, do this; if I'm away, do that" logic in the standard routine builder, and no way to make one routine do different things on different days. Two routines scheduled on different days is the supported path.

If a routine suddenly stops firing one morning, the first things to check are: is the routine still enabled (the toggle on the list screen), is the Echo online, and did the trigger phrase get accidentally edited from another device.

💬 Example: on Monday morning, expect the weekday routine; on Saturday, expect the weekend one. If the wrong one fires, open that routine and check the days row.

You'll know it worked when a full week goes by and each morning plays the right music, news, and lights — without you having to remember which day it is.

Common mistakes

- **Expecting one routine to branch by day inside itself.** Alexa+ applies day-of-week to the whole routine, not to individual actions, so you can't tag a news flash as "Mon–Fri only" inside a routine that also plays weekend music. Fix: build two routines and schedule each on the days you want.
- **Both routines scheduled to fire on the same day.** If both have Mon–Fri checked, Alexa+ runs both at 6:30 and the actions fight each other for control of your devices. Fix: in the days row, leave the weekend routine on Sat–Sun only and the weekday one on Mon–Fri only — no overlap, no clash.
- **A device renamed on the Smart Home screen but not in the routine.** Alexa+ matches device names exactly, so a renamed plug silently stops working. Fix: open the routine, edit the action, and pick the device from the dropdown list again — don't type it by hand.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** one phrase, two very different mornings — news, lights, and coffee on weekdays, a slow playlist and no rush on weekends. You don't have to remember which day it is, because Alexa+ already does.
- **For your business or work:** the same pattern works for any day-of-week split — opening routines for a home-based shop, focus music on weekdays, lights off on Sundays. Two routines with separate schedules is the same trick in a different costume.

- **If you want to go further:** Alexa+ routines can layer a few more things on top of a single routine — a second time trigger, a smart-home device trigger like "when the front door unlocks," and on some plans a location or weather condition. Per-action branching still doesn't exist, but two routines plus a location condition can cover most everyday cases.

Try it now

Open the Alexa app, find the Routines section, and build just one routine: a name, a single time, and one action — for example, your favorite morning playlist at 7 a.m. every day. Save it, say the trigger phrase out loud, and confirm the music plays. You've now got the smallest working routine — splitting it into weekday and weekend versions is one extra routine away.

How to Build a Simple Weekly Schedule in Google Sheets with Gemini

7 steps · Read online

> **In short:** You can ask Gemini, the AI built into Google Sheets, to design a weekly schedule from a plain description of your week — with time blocks, color categories, and a formula that totals hours automatically. You only need a Google account.

Most weeks you can list your time blocks in your head — work, gym, family dinner, the Saturday coffee — yet you never actually write them down. That's the gap this guide fills. In about ten minutes, you'll describe your week in plain English and end up with a color-coded schedule in Google Sheets that adds up your hours for you. The result is something you'll actually open on Sunday evening, not a spreadsheet that dies in your downloads folder.

Before you start

- A Google account (free — the same one you use for Gmail).
- A computer or phone that can open Google Sheets: go to sheets.google.com in any browser, or install the free Google Sheets mobile app.
- Roughly 10 to 15 minutes, and a rough mental picture of what your week actually looks like.
- Some Gemini features inside Sheets are only available on paid Google plans — if you don't see the Gemini option, check Google's official pricing page for the latest plan details. A free workaround: draft the schedule at gemini.google.com first, then paste it into Sheets.

Step 1 — Open Google Sheets and start fresh

Open sheets.google.com in your browser, or launch the Google Sheets app, and sign in with your Google account. Click the "+" button or "Blank spreadsheet" to create a new, empty sheet. Name it by clicking "Untitled spreadsheet" at the top-left and typing something you'll recognize later — "My weekly schedule" works fine.

Example: name it "Spring weekly schedule" or "My week plan".

If it looks different: on a phone, the "+" usually sits in the bottom-right corner; if you only see templates, tap "Blank" inside that section. Menu wording changes often — just look for any option that creates a fresh, empty sheet.

You'll know it worked when you see a grid of empty cells with column letters (A, B, C…) across the top and row numbers (1, 2, 3…) down the side.

Step 2 — Open the Gemini side panel

Look at the top-right corner of the Sheets window for a small sparkle ✨ icon or a button labeled something like "Help me" or "Ask Gemini." Click it. A side panel slides in from the right edge — this is your chat window, and you'll stay inside your spreadsheet the whole time.

💬 Example: type "Hi" as a quick first message to confirm Gemini is responding.

If it looks different: Gemini's exact location in Sheets has moved over the years. If you don't see a sparkle, open the "Tools" menu (sometimes labeled "Extensions" on older versions) and look for anything mentioning Gemini or "Ask." On Workspace accounts, your admin may need to turn Gemini on — if the option is entirely missing, ask your IT admin or check Google's help pages.

You'll know it worked when you can type a question into the side panel and an answer appears in the same panel within a few seconds.

Step 3 — Describe your week and ask for a template

In the Gemini side panel, write a short paragraph describing a typical week. Be specific — even if it feels messy. Then ask for a weekly schedule layout with time blocks, categories you can color-code, and a formula that totals hours per category. Gemini will reply either with a written layout you can copy, or with a button to insert a table directly into your sheet.

💬 Example: "Here's my week. I work Monday to Friday, 9 a.m. to 5 p.m. I teach a yoga class Tuesday and Thursday evenings from 6 to 7:30 p.m. I hit the gym three mornings a week, around 6:30 to 7:30 a.m. on Monday, Wednesday, and Friday. Saturday morning is family breakfast from 9 to 11 a.m. Please build a weekly schedule in this sheet with rows for each day, columns for morning, midday, afternoon, and evening, and a SUM formula that totals the hours automatically."

If it looks different: some versions of Gemini in Sheets can only chat (no insert button). If that happens, copy the layout into the cells yourself — see Step 4.

You'll know it worked when you see either a table inserted into the sheet or a clear text description of where each activity should go.

Step 4 — Build the time-block grid yourself (the easy way)

If Gemini gave you a written description, copy it into your sheet by hand. In row 1, type the days of the week across the columns (Monday in A1, Tuesday in B1, and so on — or use one column per time slot if you prefer). In column A, starting from row 2, type your time blocks: "6:30–7:30 a.m.", "9:00 a.m.–5:00 p.m.", "6:00–7:30 p.m.", and so on. Then drop each activity into the cell where day and time meet.

Example: in cell B2 (Tuesday morning) type "Gym"; in cell C5 (Wednesday afternoon) type "Deep work block"; in cell A8 (Monday evening) type "Family dinner."

If it looks different: some people prefer one row per day and one column per time slot — both are normal layouts. Choose the one that's easier to read on your device.

You'll know it worked when you can read down a column to see one full day's plan, or across a row to see one time slot across the week, without guessing.

Step 5 — Add color categories so your eyes can scan it fast

Highlight the column or row headers by clicking the letter at the top of the column (or the row number on the left), then pick a fill color from the toolbar. Look for a paint-can icon or a "Fill color" button. Then color each activity by type: one color for work, one for fitness, one for family, one for rest. Pick colors that mean something to you.

Example: blue for work, green for fitness, yellow for family time, gray for rest or sleep.

If it looks different: the fill-color icon sometimes looks like a tipped-over paint bucket. On a phone, the same tool lives inside the formatting menu, often marked with an "A" and color bars underneath it.

You'll know it worked when you can glance at the sheet and instantly see which parts of your week are work, which are fitness, and which are family time — without reading a single word.

Step 6 — Add a formula that totals your hours

At the bottom of one day's column, click an empty cell and type a SUM formula. In Sheets, every formula starts with `=`. If you've put the duration of each activity in plain numbers (8 for an 8-hour workday, 1.5 for a 90-minute class), the formula adds them up for you.

Example: type `=SUM(B2:B10)` and press Enter. The cell instantly shows the total. If your durations are in seconds, multiply by 24 first: `=SUM(B2:B10)*24`.

If it looks different: if your time blocks are written as text like "9–5", Sheets can't add them up — they'd need to be plain numbers in a separate "Hours" column. Ask Gemini in the side panel, "How do I add up time blocks written as text in Sheets?" if you get stuck.

You'll know it worked when the total cell shows a number that updates the moment you edit any of the time blocks above it — that's the formula doing its job.

Step 7 — Save once and forget about it

Look at the top-left of the screen for your file name. As long as you're signed in, Google Sheets saves your work automatically every few seconds — there's no "Save" button to click. If you see a small gray "Saving…" message or a checkmark next to the title, you're done.

💬 Example: just close the browser tab when you finish. Next time you open the file, your schedule will be right where you left it.

You'll know it worked when you can refresh the page or close and reopen the file and find your schedule exactly as it was.

Common mistakes

- **Mistake: asking Gemini something too vague.** "Make me a schedule" gives a generic template that won't fit your life. **Always include your real hours, real activities, and how many days — the more specific you are, the better the output.**
- **Mistake: writing time blocks as text like "9–5".** Sheets can't add text up, so your total stays at zero. **Fix: put the duration as a plain number in a separate "Hours" column (8 for an 8-hour workday, 1.5 for a 90-minute class), or ask Gemini how to convert time strings to numbers.**
- **Mistake: assuming Gemini inserted your schedule when it only chatted.** Some versions of Gemini in Sheets can only suggest, not insert. **Fix: read the side panel carefully — if you see an "Insert" button, click it; otherwise copy the suggestions into the cells yourself.**

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** A weekly schedule you actually open turns vague plans into real commitments. The color categories mean you can spot at a glance if "rest" has quietly disappeared from your week — and fix it before burnout shows up.
- **For your business or work:** If you bill by the hour or track project time, the SUM formula and color categories double as a rough time-tracking sheet. Swap the activity names for your projects and you have a one-page weekly dashboard.
- **If you're just getting started:** Don't aim for the perfect schedule in one sitting. Type in the bones of your week today — work, sleep, family — and add the rest over a few days as you notice the gaps.

Try it now

Open a new Google Sheet, open the Gemini side panel, and paste this in: "I teach three morning classes Monday, Wednesday, and Friday from 8 to 11 a.m. I work part-time Tuesday and Thursday from 1 to 6 p.m. I have family dinner every weekday at 7 p.m. Build me a weekly schedule with time blocks, three color categories (teaching, work, family), and a SUM formula

that totals hours per category." See what it gives you, change the colors to match your real life, and you've got a planner that took ten minutes to make and will save you hours of "wait, what day is it again?" by next Sunday.

How to Add an AI Step to Your Zapier Workflow

5 steps · Read online

> **In short:** In the regular Zap editor, look for the **AI by Zapier** action, type the instructions you want it to follow, and optionally hand it a small list of tools (like "send a Slack message" or "create a Google Sheet row"). No separate "agent" product to learn — it's just one step in the workflow you're already editing.

If you already use **Zapier** — the service that connects your apps so something happening in one automatically triggers something in another — there's a new way to make a Zap smarter. According to Zapier, the AI capabilities that used to live in a separate product called Zapier Agents have been folded directly into the regular Zap editor as a single **AI by Zapier** action. You drop it in like any other step, write a plain-language instruction, and pick which tools (small actions like "send an email" or "add a row to a spreadsheet") the AI is allowed to call on while doing its job.

This guide walks through that exact process, from opening an existing Zap to testing the AI step end-to-end. It's written for someone who has built a basic Zap before but has never added an AI step.

Before you start

- A **Zapier account** — a free plan works for basic Zaps, but the AI step's usage may count toward an AI actions limit depending on your plan, so check Zapier's current pricing page if you plan to run it heavily.
- An existing **Zap** (or the willingness to build a short two-step one to practice on). The AI step is just a third piece in that chain.
- Roughly **10–15 minutes** for the first run-through, including testing.
- The apps you want the AI to reach — for example Gmail, Slack, Google Sheets, or a calendar — already connected to your Zapier account.

Step 1 — Open the Zap you want to enhance

In your Zapier dashboard, find the Zap you want to add AI to and click to open it in the editor. You'll land on the visual workflow view, where each step is a card stacked vertically with arrows between them. If you've never built a Zap before, create a simple one first (a trigger plus one action) so you have something to work with. The trigger is the event that starts the Zap ("a new row in Google Sheets"), and each action is something the Zap does in another app. If your screen shows a list of Zaps instead of a workflow, click the name of the Zap you want to edit. **You'll know it worked when you see the numbered step cards and the path between them.**

Step 2 — Add the AI by Zapier action between your trigger and your final step

Click the **"+" between two existing steps** (or after your trigger if your Zap has no actions yet). A small panel opens with a list of apps. Type **"AI by Zapier"** into the search bar. When the result appears, click it. Zapier then asks which AI action you want to use — for a general-purpose step that can also call other apps, choose **"Use AI"** (the option that lets you write a custom prompt). The action is added as a new card in your workflow. If you don't find a "+" between steps, look for an **"Add step"** button below the trigger instead — Zapier's editor layout shifts occasionally. **You'll know it worked when a new card labeled "AI by Zapier" appears in your workflow, right between the cards that come before and after it.**

Step 3 — Write the prompt the AI will read each time it runs

Click the new **AI by Zapier** card to open its settings. You'll see a field labeled something like **"What should this AI do?"** or **"Prompt"** — the exact label can shift as the product changes, but it's the one big text area at the top of the card. Type the instruction in plain English, exactly as you'd explain the task to a person. Be specific about the input the AI will receive (usually data from your trigger step) and the output you want back. You can reference data from earlier steps by clicking a **field reference** button or similar icon next to the prompt box — it lets you insert variables from the trigger (like the email subject or the spreadsheet row) so the AI sees real data, not placeholders. **You'll know it worked when you can see at least one piece of data from a previous step referenced inside the text — usually shown as a small colored chip or a label like `1. Subject`. Example:** `Read the email below and tell me in one sentence whether the customer is happy, neutral, or upset. Email subject: {{1. Subject}} Email body: {{1. Body}}`

Step 4 — Tell the AI which tools it's allowed to use

Still inside the AI step, scroll to a section labeled something like **"Tools"** or **"Available actions"**. This is where you decide what the AI is allowed to do besides read the prompt. Click **"Add a tool"** (or a similarly worded button) and choose from the apps already connected to your account — for example "Gmail: Send Email", "Slack: Send Channel Message," "Google Sheets: Create Row," or "Calendar: Create Event." Add only the tools the AI actually needs for this task; more tools means more chances for the AI to choose the wrong one. Each tool you add opens a small configuration panel where you fill in the recipient, the channel, the spreadsheet, and so on — you can either set those values yourself in advance (a static "send to this address") or leave them for the AI to fill in from the prompt. If you don't see a Tools area, you may be on a simpler version of the step that only returns a text answer — in that case, skip to Step 5 and come back to tools later. **You'll know it worked when each tool you added appears as a**

sub-card inside the AI step, with its fields either pre-filled or marked for the AI to fill in.

Step 5 — Test the AI step before turning the Zap on

Click the **"Test"** or **"Test action"** button on the AI card. It runs your prompt once with a real (or sample) piece of data from your trigger and shows you exactly what the AI wrote back, plus which tools it chose to call and what it sent to them. Read the output carefully — this is your chance to catch a prompt that's too loose or a tool the AI is misusing. If the answer is off, click back into the prompt, tighten the wording (for example, add "Reply in exactly one sentence" or "Only use the Slack tool when the customer is upset"), and test again. When the output looks right, click **"Continue"** or **"Done editing"** to save, then turn the Zap on with the toggle at the top of the editor. **You'll know it worked when the test panel shows a non-empty AI response and, if you added tools, a short log of which tool ran and what it did — and your Zap's status switch shows "On."**

Common mistakes

- **Writing a vague prompt.** "Summarize this email" gives you uneven results; "Reply in one sentence saying whether the customer is happy, neutral, or upset, and explain your answer in plain English" gives you something you can rely on.
- **Giving the AI too many tools.** If you add Gmail, Slack, Sheets, and Calendar all at once, the AI has to guess which one fits. Stick to the one or two tools this step actually needs.
- **Skipping the test step.** The test is the only place you'll see what the AI actually does before it runs on real data for real people. If you don't test, you're publishing blind — and AI mistakes (wrong recipients, wrong tone) are easy to miss without that preview.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** A Zap with an AI step can quietly sort your incoming email — flagging the urgent ones, drafting short replies, or pushing the important ones into a priority folder — so your inbox doesn't eat your morning.
- **For your business or work:** You can build Zaps that read new support tickets, summarize each one, and post a short digest into a team Slack channel, without anyone manually copying text from one app to another.
- **If you're just getting started:** The easiest first Zap with AI is one trigger you trust (like "new email in Gmail") plus the AI step with just a prompt and no extra tools — that lets you see the AI's plain-text answer in the Zap history and decide from there whether to give it tools.

Try it now

Open any Zap you already have, add an **AI by Zapier** action right after it, and write this prompt in the prompt box: `Read the file under the file upload here and let me know what it's about in 2 sentences.` Then run the test. You'll see exactly how the AI step talks, what its output looks like, and whether you want to give it tools — all in under two minutes.

Build a Reusable Alexa+ Pomodoro Routine With Voice Check-Ins

7 steps · Read online

> **In short:** With Alexa+ routines you can chain a 25-minute focus timer, spoken break announcements, a 5-minute break timer, and a back-to-focus message — all from one voice phrase. Alexa+ won't loop forever on its own, so you stop the cycle manually after a few blocks.

A pomodoro is a simple productivity technique (work for a set time, take a short break, repeat) that helps most people beat procrastination and protect deep focus. The Pomodoro Technique, developed by Francesco Cirillo in the late 1980s, is named after the tomato-shaped kitchen timer he used as a university student. With Alexa+ routines, you can build a reusable cycle that announces each phase out loud and starts the next timer automatically — your hands never leave the keyboard.

Before you start

- An Alexa+ account. Amazon says Alexa+ is now available to everyone in the US, free for Prime members and available as a paid subscription without Prime; open the Alexa app to confirm your device shows the new experience, or check Amazon's Alexa+ page for the latest eligibility details.
- The Alexa app on your phone (free, iOS or Android) and an Echo device — or any Alexa-enabled speaker — signed into the same Amazon account.
- About 10 minutes for the first build, then a few seconds each time you start it. Plan on running one short test cycle (1-minute timers) before trusting it for real work.

Step 1 — Create a new routine for the focus start

Open the Alexa app, tap the **"⋯" More** tab at the bottom, then choose **"Routines."** Look for a button to create a new routine — in newer app versions it may say **"+ Create routine"** or just a **"+"** in the corner. You'll land on a routine builder screen with two clear sections: **"When this happens"** (the trigger) and **"Add action"** (what Alexa does). Name your routine something you'll remember, like "Start Pomodoro." A *routine* is just a chain of actions Alexa runs automatically when something happens — your trigger phrase, a timer, a schedule, or another routine. 💬 Example: routine name "Start Pomodoro" You'll know it worked when the routine appears in your routines list with the name you typed.

Step 2 — Set the voice trigger and the focus announcement

In the **"When this happens"** section, pick the option for a voice phrase — it might be labeled **"Voice," "Say a specific phrase,"** or **"When you say…"** Type the phrase you'll use to start a session, then move down to **"Add action"** and look for **"Alexa Says," "Announce,"** or **"Send Announcement."** Type the message Alexa will read out loud the moment you say your trigger phrase. This is the "hello, focus time" cue that replaces the need to glance at a timer. Example trigger phrase: "start pomodoro" Example announcement: "Focus block starting. Twenty-five minutes. I'll let you know when to break." If it looks different on your device, the trigger list usually lives behind a small **"+"** next to "When this happens." You'll know it worked when the saved routine shows your phrase as the trigger and your message as the first action.

Step 3 — Add the 25-minute focus timer to the start routine

Still inside "Start Pomodoro," tap **"Add action"** again and look for **"Set Timer"** or **"Wait → Timer."** Set 25 minutes (or your preferred focus length — 20 to 50 minutes is typical) and give the timer a recognizable name like **"Focus."** Naming the timer matters because the next routine will listen for that exact name. The timer begins counting down right after Alexa finishes the opening announcement, so the sequence becomes: announce → start 25-minute timer → wait. Example: 25-minute timer named exactly "Focus" If you can't spot a Timer action, scan the "Add action" categories for anything timer- or wait-related. You'll know it worked when the routine shows two actions beneath the voice trigger: your announcement and the Focus timer.

Step 4 — Build a second routine that fires when the focus timer ends

Go back to the Routines list and create another routine — name it **"Pomodoro Loop."** In **"When this happens,"** pick **"Timer"** (or **"When a timer ends"**) and select the **"Focus"** timer you just created, set to **"Ends."** This is how the chain keeps moving: when the focus timer chimes, this routine wakes up automatically. Add two actions: first, an announcement that break time has started; second, a new timer named **"Break"** set to 5 minutes (or your preferred break length — 3 to 7 minutes is common). Example announcement: "Break time. Five minutes. Step away from the screen." Example: 5-minute timer named exactly "Break" If it looks different, some app versions phrase the trigger as **"When timer named ____ ends"** in plain English. You'll know it worked when the routine list shows "Focus" timer as the trigger for "Pomodoro Loop."

Step 5 — Add the return-to-focus loop

Now you need a way to restart the focus block when the break timer ends. Two clean approaches, depending on what your app supports. **Approach A:** in the same "Pomodoro Loop" routine, look for an option to add a second **"When this happens"** condition; if it lets you, add

"Break" timer ends as a second trigger, then add the focus-start announcement plus a fresh 25-minute "Focus" timer. **Approach B (the safer one):** create a third routine called **"Back to Focus,"** trigger it with **"Break" timer ends,** and add the same focus announcement + Focus timer actions. Either way, the cycle becomes: voice → announce + Focus timer → (25 min) → Loop announces break + Break timer → (5 min) → Back to Focus announces + Focus timer → repeat. 💬 Example announcement: "Back to focus. Twenty-five minutes starting now." 💬 Example: 25-minute timer named "Focus" again If it looks different, older app versions may only allow one trigger per routine — use Approach B in that case. You'll know it worked when both "Focus" and "Break" appear as timer names somewhere across your routines, and the list shows two or three routines connected by those names.

Step 6 — Save and run one quick test cycle

Tap **"Save"** (usually a checkmark or button in the top-right corner) on every routine. Stand near your Echo and say **"Alexa, start pomodoro"** — or whatever phrase you set. You should hear the focus announcement, then a 25-minute countdown. For the first test, temporarily set both timers to 1 minute so you can confirm the loop end-to-end without waiting. Listen for the "Break time" announcement exactly when the first timer chimes, then the "Back to focus" announcement when the second timer ends. If a routine doesn't fire, the cause is almost always a spelling mismatch — "Focus" in one routine and "focus timer" in another counts as two different names. 💬 Example test: change both timers to 1 minute the first time, then change them back to 25 and 5 once the chain is proven You'll know it worked when each phase begins the moment the previous timer ends, with no further input from you.

Step 7 — Use it in a real session and know how to stop it

Say your trigger phrase at the start of your work block and ignore your phone. After each focus block you'll hear "Break time" and a short countdown begins; after each break you'll hear "Back to focus" and a new focus timer starts. The cycle repeats until you cancel it. A simple **"Alexa, stop"** ends the current timer and breaks the chain — no further announcements will follow. Honest limitation: Alexa+ won't recognize that you're "done for the day" on its own, so you'll repeat the loop as long as it helps, then stop it manually. If the spoken cues are too loud for a shared space, lower the Echo volume or set a **Do Not Disturb** schedule in the Alexa app so announcements don't disturb others. 💬 Example stop command: "Alexa, stop" You'll know it worked when your Echo goes silent and no new timer fires after you say stop.

Common mistakes

- **Mismatched timer names.** The loop breaks silently if "Focus" in routine A is "focus" or "Focus timer" in routine B. Use identical capitalization and spacing in every routine — treat the name like a password.

- **Assuming one routine can have two triggers.** Some Alexa app versions only allow one "When this happens" condition per routine. If your multi-trigger setup silently does nothing, fall back to Approach B in Step 5: create a third routine for the return-to-focus phase.
- **Skipping the break.** It's tempting to chain only focus timers for "more deep work," but the break is what makes the technique work — your brain needs the reset. Keep a real break, even if you shorten it.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** The spoken announcement removes the "is it time yet?" glance that breaks concentration. You can leave your phone in another room and still know exactly where you are in the cycle, because Alexa tells you.
- **For your work or work-from-home setup:** Run the routine during deep-work hours and pair it with a single calendar entry — "Deep work, no meetings" — so colleagues can see when you're heads-down. The routine handles the timing; the calendar handles the interruptions.
- **If you want to go further:** Add a **"Music"** action to the focus phase that plays a focus-friendly playlist (lo-fi, rain sounds, white noise) and add a **"Pause music"** or **"Set volume to 0"** action to the break phase. The same routine builder accepts both — and you'll have an audio cue layer on top of the spoken one.

Try it now

Open the Alexa app, tap **Routines**, and create one routine named **"Start Pomodoro"** with a single 1-minute timer named **"Focus."** Say **"Alexa, start pomodoro"** once. When the timer ends, you've proven the basic chain — every other step in this guide is just adding the next link.

Set Up an Alexa+ Routine to Automate Your Everyday Tasks

6 steps · Read online

By the end of this guide you'll have a working Alexa Routine: you say one short phrase, and Alexa runs several things in a row — for example the news and then the weather. A routine is simply a saved list of steps that starts on its own when something happens (Amazon calls that something an **event**). No coding needed.

Before you start

- An **Echo speaker**, **Echo Show**, or another Alexa device, plugged in and connected to your home Wi-Fi.
- The **Alexa app** on your phone or tablet, signed in with your Amazon account.
- Optional: smart-home devices (like smart bulbs or plugs) already added to the Alexa app, if you want the routine to control them.
- About **5–10 minutes**.

The menu names below come from Amazon's own help pages. The Alexa app changes often, so if a button looks a little different on your phone, look for the closest match.

Step 1 — Open Routines in the Alexa app

Open the **Alexa** app. At the bottom of the screen, tap **More**, then tap **Routines**. This is where all your routines live, and where Amazon also offers ready-made ones under **Featured**. If you can't find More at the bottom, check whether your app needs an update in your phone's app store. You'll know it worked when you see the Routines page, with or without routines already on it.

Step 2 — Start a new routine

Tap the + in the top-right corner of the Routines page. A new, empty routine opens. If the app asks you for a name at any point, type something you'll recognize later, such as **Morning Wake-Up**. You'll know it worked when you see an empty routine with a place to add an event and a place to add an action.

Example: name it `Morning Wake-Up`.

Step 3 — Choose what starts the routine

Tap **Add an event** and follow the steps in the app to choose what starts your routine. To start it with your voice, choose the option for a spoken phrase and type the words you'll say **after** the wake word — for example **good morning**. Don't type "Alexa" itself: the wake word is how you

get Alexa's attention, the phrase is what comes after it. Keep the phrase short and unusual enough that you won't say it by accident. You'll know it worked when your phrase appears as the event at the top of the routine.

💬 Example: type `good morning` as the phrase.

Step 4 — Add the first action

Tap **Add an action** and follow the steps in the app. You'll see a list of things Alexa can do — Amazon's examples include playing the news, telling you the weather, reading out your calendar and controlling compatible smart-home devices. For this routine, pick the news. Some actions ask a follow-up question (for example which device should play it); answer it and continue. You'll know it worked when the news appears as the first action in your routine.

Step 5 — Add a custom action at the end

Tap **Add an action** again and look for the **custom action**. Amazon describes it like this: you can type in anything you can normally say to Alexa. Type **what's the weather today**. One rule from Amazon's help: a custom action has to be the **last** action in the routine, so add it after everything else. You'll know it worked when your routine lists two actions: the news first, then your typed request.

💬 Example: type `what's the weather today` as the custom action.

Step 6 — Save and test it

Tap **Save**. Now walk over to your Echo and say **"Alexa, good morning."** Alexa should play the news and then tell you the weather. If nothing happens, open the routine again and check the phrase for typos, and make sure the routine is set to run on the device you're talking to. You'll know it worked when Alexa runs both actions after your phrase.

💬 Example: say `Alexa, good morning` to your Echo.

Common mistakes

- **Typing "Alexa" into the phrase:** the phrase is only what comes after the wake word. Type `good morning`, then say "Alexa, good morning".
- **Putting the custom action first:** Amazon's help says custom actions need to be the last action in a routine. Move it to the end.
- **Expecting a device you haven't connected:** a smart-home or music action only works with devices and services already added to the Alexa app.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** One phrase in the morning gets you the news and the weather while you make coffee — no tapping, no scrolling.
- **For your business or work:** In a home office, a "start work" routine can read your calendar and switch on a compatible desk lamp.
- **If you're just getting started:** Begin with a single spoken phrase and one action. Once it works, add more actions — and remember to keep any custom action last.

Try it now

Open the Alexa app, tap **More** → **Routines** → **+**, add the event phrase **test routine**, add a custom action that says **tell me a joke**, and tap **Save**. Then say "Alexa, test routine" — you'll have a working routine in about two minutes.

Build a Reusable Alexa+ Morning Routine That Runs the Same Way Every Weekday

5 steps · Read online

> **In short:** Yes — one Alexa+ routine can do news, weather, calendar and lights from a single voice phrase. App layouts vary by version, so this guide points to where things usually live rather than naming buttons we haven't seen.

By the end of this guide, you'll have one spoken phrase that does four things in a row every weekday morning, without picking up your phone. This is for people who already use Alexa+ for the basics (asking questions, setting timers) and want to make the morning automatic.

Before you start

- An **Amazon account** linked to your Alexa device, with the **Alexa app** installed on your phone.
- A working **Alexa+ setup**. Depending on your plan and region, some routine features may sit behind a paid Alexa+ tier — check Amazon's current offering if you're unsure.
- About **15 minutes** for the first build, plus a quick test.
- Optional but useful: a smart light already named in the Alexa app (e.g., "Bedroom Lamp") and a calendar (Google, Outlook or Apple) already linked inside Alexa. Routines can only call on features that are already connected.

Step 1 — Decide what your morning routine should include

Open a notes app — or grab a piece of paper — and write down the four or five things you want Alexa to do, in the order you want them to happen. A reusable routine is just a saved list of actions, so the clearer your list, the faster the rest of this build goes.

For a typical weekday, a useful starter set is: a short news briefing, today's weather, your first few calendar events, and turning on one smart light. You can always add or remove actions later — but starting with a written list keeps every later step short.

💬 Example: **News flash → Weather for my location → Read today's calendar → Turn on Bedroom Lamp**

If you'd rather plan by speaking, you can dictate the same list into a voice memo — the format doesn't matter, only the order does.

You'll know it worked when you have a written (or typed, or recorded) list of 3–6 actions, each starting with a verb like "play", "read", "turn on" or "tell me".

Step 2 — Open the Alexa app and find the Routines section

Open the Alexa app on your phone and look for a menu option labeled something like **Routines** — it's usually inside a "More" tab, a "Settings" area, or directly on the home screen. If you can't find it, try the in-app **search bar** with the word "routine"; the app's layout has changed several times, and Amazon has shipped new designs alongside Alexa+, so the exact path differs.

When you find it, tap the option to **create a new routine**. A mostly blank routine editor should open, usually with sections for a name, a trigger (what starts the routine) and a list of actions (what the routine does).

If your app shows "Alexa+ Routines", "AI Routines" or anything similar instead of plain "Routines", that's fine — pick whichever routine creator is available; the workflow is similar across them.

Example: a routine name **Weekday Morning**

You'll know it worked when you can see an empty routine with fields for a trigger and at least one action.

Step 3 — Set the trigger to a voice phrase you'll actually say

A trigger is what starts the routine — a spoken phrase, a specific time, or both. For a hands-free morning, the most useful trigger is a short **voice phrase** you say out loud. Look for a trigger option called something like "When you say", "Voice" or "Phrase", then type in the words you want.

Pick something short, distinctive, and unlikely to come up in normal conversation — avoid phrases like "good morning" on their own, because Alexa may already respond to those by default. Two or three short words work well, and you can add a **weekday time schedule** (often labeled "At a scheduled time" or "Schedule") so the same routine also runs automatically Monday through Friday.

Example: voice trigger phrase **Start my morning**

If the app doesn't show a "phrase" trigger option, look for a "Custom" trigger or an "Alexa+" tag — newer versions sometimes bury voice phrases behind a different label.

You'll know it worked when the app shows your trigger phrase written down, and the routine is now ready to accept actions.

Step 4 — Stack the actions in the order you want them to run

This is the main build. Look for a button like **Add action** inside the routine editor, then go through your written list one item at a time. Each action is its own little step — Alexa plays one, finishes, then moves to the next, in the order you add them.

Common actions to stack: **News** (pick a provider — a national broadcaster or a flash briefing), **Weather** (Alexa uses your device's home location by default), **Calendar** (read today's events — only works if you've already linked Google, Outlook or Apple Calendar inside the Alexa app's settings), and **Smart Home** → **Lights** (pick a named device like "Bedroom Lamp" and set the action to "Power on").

Keep the total under about ten actions for now. Long routines can hit the app's per-routine limit, and a five-minute morning briefing is usually plenty.

Example: action stack (copyable names for the "Add action" prompts) **1.** News → Flash briefing → [your preferred provider] **2.** Weather → Today's forecast **3.** Calendar → Read today's events **4.** Smart Home → Lights → Bedroom Lamp → Power on

You'll know it worked when the action list shows your items in the exact order you added them, with no missing pieces.

Step 5 — Save the routine and test it hands-free

Tap **Save** (or **Create**, depending on your app version) at the top or bottom of the routine editor. The routine now lives in your Alexa account and is ready to run.

Stand in the same room as your Alexa device and say your trigger phrase out loud — exactly as you typed it. Alexa should respond with the first action (usually the news briefing), wait for it to finish, then move to weather, then calendar, then the light. If you added a weekday time schedule in Step 3, the same routine will also start automatically at that time on Mondays through Fridays.

If something doesn't fire — for example, the calendar stays silent — go back to Step 4 and check that the calendar is actually linked in the Alexa app's settings. Routines can only call on features that are already connected.

Example: spoken test command **Alexa, start my morning.**

You'll know it worked when Alexa speaks the news, then the weather, then your events, then the lamp turns on — all from one spoken phrase.

Common mistakes

- **Picking a trigger phrase that overlaps with a built-in Alexa command** (like "Alexa, good morning"). Alexa may run its default response instead of yours. **Fix:** choose a longer or more unique phrase, like "Start my morning" or "Begin weekday morning."
- **Skipping the calendar or smart-light setup before testing.** A routine can't call on a feature that isn't connected yet. **Fix:** go into the Alexa app's Settings → Calendars (or Smart Home) first, link the account and name the device, then come back to the routine.
- **Adding too many actions at once.** Long routines sometimes time out or hit a per-routine limit. **Fix:** aim for 5–8 actions and put detailed updates (a longer news briefing, a full calendar readout) earlier in the order so they finish first.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** a single spoken phrase replaces four taps on your phone, and the same routine fires every weekday morning without you remembering to launch anything.
- **For your business or work:** if you start your day from a home office, the same pattern — weather, calendar, news — doubles as a two-minute standup before you open your email.
- **If you want to go further:** add a conditional step (some Alexa+ versions let a routine branch on whether it's a workday or weekend), chain a second routine that starts a coffee maker or a focus playlist, or duplicate the routine and tweak a copy for evenings.

Try it now

Open the Alexa app, find Routines, create one named "Weekday Morning", and add just two actions today: Weather and one smart light. Say your trigger phrase out loud. You'll see the workflow in five minutes — and tomorrow morning you can drop in the news and calendar steps in under two.

How to Add an Alibaba Cloud AI Chatbot to Your WordPress Site

5 steps · Read online

> **In short:** An Alibaba Cloud chatbot can handle visitor queries on your site 24/7, answering common questions like opening hours while you focus on other work.

By the end of this guide you'll have a chat bubble that greets visitors, answers basic queries, and works on every page of your WordPress site – no programming experience required.

Before you start

- **Alibaba Cloud account:** sign-up at alibabacloud.com (the free tier is enough for a simple chatbot).
- **WordPress site:** you need administrator access to the dashboard.
- **A web browser** on a computer or tablet (Chrome, Edge, or Firefox work fine).
- **A few minutes:** the whole process typically takes about 20-30 minutes.
- **Optional:** a free plugin such as "Insert Headers and Footers" makes adding code easier.

Step 1 — Create a new chatbot instance

Open your web browser, go to console.alibabacloud.com and sign in. Look for the AI chatbot or conversation AI service in the console – you can usually find it by searching for "Chatbot" or "Conversation AI" in the top-right search bar. Click the button to create a new bot or robot (it may be labeled **Create Robot**, **Create Instance**, **New Bot**, or similar). A form appears asking for a name and a brief description. After you type a name such as "FrontDeskHelper" and confirm, the platform creates a new bot and shows it in your list, typically with a status of "Running" or an indicator showing it's active. Example: `FrontDeskHelper`

You'll know it worked when the new entry appears in your bot list with an active status indicator.

Step 2 — Define the chatbot's welcome greeting

In the list of bots, click the name of the bot you just created to open its settings page. Look for a section where you can set the first message visitors see – this might be labeled **Greetings**, **Welcome Message**, **Chat Prompt**, or something similar. There's usually a text box where you can type what the bot says when someone first opens the chat. After you type a sentence like "Hi! I'm your digital assistant – ask me about opening hours or services," a preview of the message often appears below the box. Click **Save** to store the change. Example: `Hi! I'm your digital assistant – ask me about opening hours or services.`

You'll know it worked when you see a confirmation that the settings were saved successfully.

Step 3 — Choose a visual style that matches your site

While still in the bot's settings, look for options to customize how the chat bubble looks – this might be in a tab labeled **Appearance**, **Style**, **Customization**, **Theme**, or similar. You'll typically find options to pick a color (you can copy your site's primary color as a hex code, e.g., #0066CC) and possibly upload a small logo or icon for the chat bubble. The preview on the screen should update to show what the chat bubble will look like on your site. 💬 Example: set color to `#0066CC` and upload `logo.png`

You'll know it worked when the on-screen preview shows the color and icon you selected.

Step 4 — Copy the widget embed code

Return to the main bot page and look for a button to publish, deploy, or make the bot publicly available – it may be labeled **Publish**, **Deploy**, **Enable**, or similar. Once activated, a panel should appear (it might be labeled **Embed Code**, **Web Widget**, **Integration Code**, or something similar) containing a snippet of code that starts with `<script src="..."></script>`. Look for a **Copy** button next to the code box; if there isn't one, click inside the box and press Ctrl + C (or Cmd + C on a Mac) to copy it manually. 💬 Example: `<script src="https://chatbot.alibabacloud.com/widget.js"></script>` — *your actual code may differ*

You'll know it worked when you can paste the snippet into a plain-text document and see a full `<script>` tag appear.

Step 5 — Insert the code into WordPress footer

Log into your WordPress dashboard (your-site.example.com/wp-admin). You can add the chatbot code either through **Appearance** → **Widgets** (look for a widget area like **Footer** or **Footer 1**, add a **Custom HTML** block, and paste the code) OR by installing a free plugin like "Insert Headers and Footers" and going to **Settings** → **Insert Headers and Footers**, then pasting the code into the "Scripts in Footer" box. Either method makes the script load on every page of your site. Press **Update** or **Save** to confirm. 💬 Example: paste the `<script>` snippet exactly as copied

You'll know it worked when you open your website in a new browser tab (or an incognito window) and see a friendly chat bubble sitting at the bottom right of the page.

Common mistakes

- **Skipping the Save step in the greeting settings:** the message may revert to a default. Fix it by always clicking the **Save** button and watching for a confirmation.

- **Placing the widget code in the header instead of the footer:** the chat may load too early and cause page-load delays. Fix it by using the Footer widget area or the "Scripts in Footer" field of a plugin.
- **Not testing on a mobile device:** the bubble can cover navigation icons on small screens. Fix it by opening your site on a phone, checking the bubble's position, and adjusting the placement or size options in the Appearance or Style settings if available.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** Your chatbot can answer simple questions like "What are your opening hours?" so you can relax while it handles routine enquiries.
- **For your business or work:** The bot captures leads overnight, giving you contact details even when your staff are offline, which can increase bookings without extra staffing.
- **If you're just getting started:** You don't need any code – just copy, paste, and a few clicks are enough to make a professional-looking assistant appear on every page.

Try it now

Open your WordPress dashboard, go to **Appearance → Widgets**, add a **Custom HTML** block to the Footer, paste any short piece of text (like "Hello world") and click **Update**. In the next two minutes you'll see that the widget saves correctly – a quick win that shows you're ready for the chatbot code.

Every prompt and example in this pack

Every line marked 💬 in the guides above, collected in one place: the prompts you can copy and type (marked ➤), and the example labels and screen text that go with them. Each guide title links back to the guide it came from.

1122 examples from 231 guides — 492 of them prompts you can type

How to check if a suspicious message is a scam by pasting it into an AI

> open ChatGPT, Gemini, Claude, Microsoft Copilot, or Le Chat — whichever one you already have an account on.

> turn "my SSN is 123-45-6789, please call 555-0123" into "my SSN is [REDACTED], please call [REDACTED]".

> ➤ "Here's a message I just received. Can you act as a security expert and tell me whether it looks like a scam? List the specific red flags you see, and tell me whether I should click any links in it. Message: [paste here]"

> if the AI says "the sender domain doesn't match the company", check that yourself — does the "from" address really end in the company's real website, or in something like "support-service.example.com"?

> a "USPS" tracking link points to `usps-tracking.example.com/pay-now` — that is NOT usps.com, so it's a fake.

> text a family member — "Hey, I just got a weird message about my Amazon account, does this sound legit to you? [paste]"

How to Spot an AI Scam Call, Fake Email, or Deepfake Voice Today

> ➤ "Grandma, it's me, I was in an accident, please send money" → hang up → dial your grandchild's saved number.

> ➤ "Hi, this is Maria from your bank's fraud department" → hang up → look up the bank's number on your statement → dial it yourself.

> ➤ "Your package is held at customs, pay a small fee to release it" → hover the link → see it points to a domain you've never heard of → delete.

> ➤ "Pay this fee now or your account closes in five minutes" → pause → ask the ten-minute question → almost always the answer is no.

> Text your sister: "If anyone calls saying they're me and needs money, ask them for our safe word. The word is platypus."

> Realized mid-call that the "bank agent" was fake → hung up → called the number on my debit card → told them what happened → account flagged for monitoring.

What You Should Never Share With an AI Assistant: A Privacy Guide

> ➤ “What types of personal information should I never share with you?” You’ll know it worked when the assistant lists three groups such as (1) identifiers (name, address, ID numbers), (2) financial details (bank accounts, credit-card numbers), and (3) health or biometric data.

> type “Show me my last five messages” (many assistants support a simple request like this). You’ll know it worked when the assistant displays the recent prompts you entered, giving you a chance to review them.

> after selecting the message, type “Delete this message”. You’ll know it worked when the message disappears from the chat view and the history no longer shows that content.

> ➤ “Turn off chat history”. You’ll know it worked when the toggle changes color or moves to the “off” position, and the app confirms “Your chats will not be saved”.

> ➤ “Show my recent chats”. You’ll know it worked when the list only contains the recent, innocuous question you just asked.

> ➤ “Dear Support, please remove any personal identifiers from my account.” You’ll know it worked when you receive a confirmation email or a system message saying “Your request has been received”.

How to Spot a Phishing Email or Scam Text Before You Click

> if it's "Your package is delayed, confirm here: bit.ly/x9zq", just read the words. Don't tap the link.

> ➤ "Act as a fraud detector. Read the message I'm pasting next and list every red flag you can see, then tell me clearly whether it's safe to reply, click any link, or open any attachment. If you're not sure, say so."

> of what to paste: "From: Amazon Support <> — Dear customer, your account has been suspended due to unusual activity. Click here to verify: hhtp://amaz0n-secure.example.com/login — please respond within 24 hours."

> of an AI answer: "Red flags: sender domain is amaz0n-support.example.com, not amazon.com; the link is 'hhtp' (typo) and uses a zero in 'amaz0n'; urgency tactic ('within 24 hours'); generic greeting. Verdict: do NOT click, do NOT reply. Report and delete."

> of a good follow-up question to the AI: "Can you explain in one sentence what an 'urgency tactic' means, so I know what to look for next time?"

How to Spot AI Scams, Deepfakes, and Fake Content

> You see a photo of a well-known person in an unusual situation. Zoom in on their hands and face. If you notice anything unusual — extra fingers, distorted features, or inconsistent lighting — investigate further before sharing or believing it.

> You receive an urgent video message from your company's director asking for an immediate fund transfer. Pause the video and look closely at their jawline, neck, and hairline. If you notice anything unusual — a fuzzy outline, unusual shadows, or lip movements that don't quite match the audio — treat it as suspicious and verify through another channel before acting.

> You receive an urgent phone call from a friend asking for financial help. The voice sounds exactly like them, but the request is unusual or the tone feels strange in context. This is a red flag. Hang up immediately and call them back on their usual, trusted number to verify.

> A supplier sends an email with "updated bank details" for a payment, urging you to use the new account. Do not reply to that email or call the phone number listed in its signature. Instead, find the phone number from your original paper contract or the supplier's official website and call them directly to confirm the change.

> You receive an email from a supposed friend, but it uses overly formal language like "Furthermore, I require immediate assistance" rather than their usual casual style, and every sentence is perfectly structured without any contractions or slang. This unnatural perfection suggests AI involvement.

How to Spot a Deepfake Video or Voice Clone Before You Share It

> ➤ "Hey, I got a voice note from someone claiming to be you asking about gift cards. Did you actually send it? Just checking."

Build a Simple Personal Budget Spreadsheet Using Any AI Assistant

> ➤ "Design a simple monthly budget spreadsheet for a single person earning a regular salary. Include columns for Category (Rent, Groceries, Transport, Utilities, Entertainment, Savings, Other), Planned amount, Actual amount, and Difference. Add 2 example rows per category. Keep it under 20 rows total."

Decode Any Confusing Phone, Internet, or Medical Bill in 10 Minutes

> a small note on your paper — "Today's goal: figure out what each line means and which ones look off."

> keep visible — "$84.50 — Base Plan — Sept 3 to Oct 2". Black out everything else.

> prompt to copy: "Here are the line items from my phone bill. For each charge, tell me: (1) what it usually means, (2) whether it's normal or worth questioning, (3) one question I should ask the provider."

> mark "monthly plan $40" green, "regulatory fee $3.20" yellow (you don't know if it's accurate), and "international roaming $27" red (you didn't travel).

> search: type `"administrative fee"` plus the company's name into your browser to see how they explain the charge in their own words.

> message you can adapt: "Hi, on bill dated 3 October, line 'Equipment Fee — $12.00' appeared for the first time. I don't recall being notified about a new charge. Can you explain what this covers and the start date? Thank you."

> closing reply — "Thanks. Could you confirm the credit amount in writing and the date it will appear on my next statement?"

How to read and summarize a long lease or insurance policy with Gemini

> *If you don't see a chat box, look for a button labeled **"New chat"** or a **pencil icon** somewhere on the page.*

> *If the icon names don't match, try the **"+" or plus button** — most chat interfaces tuck uploads there.*

> ➤ *"Please summarize this lease in plain English. I want to know what I have to pay each month, what I'm not allowed to do, what happens if I break the rules, and how I can end the lease."*

> ➤ *"Which clauses in this document could cost me the most money or cause the biggest problems if something goes wrong? List them and quote the key sentence from each one if you can."*

> ➤ *"What does 'indemnify and hold harmless' mean in everyday language? And does this clause apply to me as the renter, or only to the landlord?"*

> *If you'd rather skip the copy-paste, take a screenshot of the summary and save it to your phone. It's not searchable later, but it's better than nothing.*

How to Set Reminders with Alexa on Your Echo for Bills, Birthdays and Errands

> ➤ "Remind me to call my mom on [day of the week] at [time]."

> ➤ "Remind me to pay the [utility company] bill every month on the [day number] at [time]."

> ➤ "Remind me that [person's name] has a birthday on [month and day], and remind me one day before at [time]."

> ➤ "Show me all of my reminders for this week."

> ➤ "Move my reminder to [task name] from [old time] to [new time]."

> ➤ "Cancel my reminder to [task name]."

How to Decode a Confusing Medical Bill with AI

> ➤ "Scan the front and back of the bill into one PDF named 'bill-jan2026.pdf'."

> ➤ "Black out my SSN, member ID, and the last four digits of my card before pasting."

> ➤ "Here's my itemized bill from a clinic visit. In plain English, please list every charge, what each one was for, what my insurance paid, and what I still owe. Flag anything that looks unusual."

> ➤ "On line 4 it says 'CPT 99213, allowed amount $84.20, patient owes $25'. What is a 99213, what does 'allowed amount' mean, and why is the patient share $25?"

> ➤ "Please re-add every line on this bill and confirm the total. I'm getting $342.10 when I add it by hand but your last answer said $298.50."

How to Read Through Insurance Policies and Bank Contracts with Claude

> there is nothing to type yet — just open the chat.

> a PDF named `home-insurance-2026.pdf` shows up as a thumbnail before you send.

> ➤ "I'm a homeowner, not a lawyer. Please summarize this home insurance policy in plain English. Cover: what am I covered for, what am I NOT covered for, my deductible, and anything that could void my coverage. Keep it under 400 words."

> ➤ "Now read it again like a skeptical friend. List every clause that could limit my payout or surprise me. For each one, quote the original wording, then explain what it actually means in plain English."

> ➤ "I've pasted two home loan offers below. Compare them on: total interest paid over 5 years, early-repayment penalties, fixed vs variable rate, and any hidden fees. Show your work in a simple table."

> paste into a note titled `home-insurance-summary-2026` so future-you can find it.

Plan a Family Weekend Getaway with DeepSeek: A Step-by-Step Guide

> just type the word **"Hi"** for now to make sure the box works.

> ➤ *"We're a family of four — two adults, a 7-year-old and a 10-year-old — based in Chicago. We want to drive somewhere within 3 hours for the weekend of 14–15 June. We love outdoorsy stuff and kid-friendly museums. Budget is medium."*

> ➤ *"Please make a day-by-day itinerary for Saturday and Sunday. For each day, give me morning, midday and afternoon activities that work for kids aged 7 and 10. Add rough drive times between stops."*

> ➤ *"Add lunch and dinner suggestions for each day — nothing too fancy, kids need to see familiar food on the menu. Estimate the total daily cost for our family of four, and give me a backup indoor plan in case it rains."*

> ➤ *"Swap the Sunday morning museum for an outdoor activity — the kids get restless indoors. Also, can you suggest a town within 2 hours of Chicago instead of 3?"*

> copy the final plan, then paste it into a new note titled **"Family weekend — 14/15 June"**.

> type *"Quick check — can you remind me of the backup plan for Sunday if it rains? I want it in one short list."*

How to plan a simple weekly meal prep with one AI-made grocery list

> ➤ "We are a household of [number] people. Plan five dinners for [number] nights. We have about [number] hours to cook on Sunday. No peanuts, and nobody likes mushrooms. We only have one oven and a slow cooker."

> ➤ "Using the rules above, make a five-night dinner plan. Reuse at least two ingredients across the week, keep the cooking to one pot or one oven tray per night, and label which items are cooked on prep day versus cooked fresh."

> ➤ "Make one grocery list for all five dinners. Add up the quantities, group items by store section, and leave out [pantry item] and [pantry item] since I already have them."

> ➤ "Meal prep template: household of [number] people, [number] dinners, [number] hours to cook on Sunday, no [food you avoid]. Plan dinners, reuse ingredients, then give one grouped grocery list."

> ➤ "Create a prep-day checklist for about [number] hours. Put long-cooking items first, then chopping, then cooling and storing. Show the estimated time for each step, and list which items go in the fridge and which go in the freezer."

> ➤ "Dinner three uses a whole bunch of cilantro for [number] people. Please cut that to one small bunch and update the grocery list to match."

> ➤ "Reformat the final grocery list as plain text with one item per line, keeping the store-section headings."

Create a soothing bedtime story routine with Alexa

> Tap `More` → `Routines`.

> Type `Bedtime Story` into the name field.

> Type `start bedtime story`.

> Tap `Skills` → search for `bedtime stories` → select a skill like `Kids Bedtime Stories` and tap `Add`.

> Tap `Alexa's Voice` and choose `Matthew`.

> Tap `Music & Audio` → search for `rain sounds` → select a track and tap `Add`.

> Say: `Alexa, start bedtime story`.

How to use Qwen Chat to plan a weekend road trip in the US without getting lost

> `Hi`
>
> `I want a weekend road trip from Portland to the Pacific Coast Highway with my partner, leaving Friday after work and returning Sunday evening. Can you plan every stop, time, and backup idea so we don’t get lost?`
>
> `Here’s what I’d like to keep: the Twelve Apostles at sunset, a short rainforest walk at Maits Rest, and a seafood dinner in Apollo Bay. Please add those and any other must-sees, plus backup ideas if a stop is closed or crowded.`
>
> `Please give me turn-by-turn directions for every driving leg, including street names and kilometres, so my partner can navigate while I drive.`
>
> `Add a backup plan for every main stop in case it’s raining or too crowded. Include indoor alternatives and shorter walks.`
>
> `Please give me one clean summary I can save or print, with every stop, time, address, and backup idea in one place.`
>
> `Please review the entire plan for anything I might have missed—toll roads, fuel stops, or time buffers—and suggest any tweaks.`

Turn messy phone photos into a family album with Google Photos AI

> Open Google Photos → sign in with your Google account → wait for your photos to load.
>
> Profile photo → **Google Photos settings** → **Privacy** → **Face Groups**: on.
>
> Tap **Collections** → **People & pets** → look through the faces.
>
> Tap a face → **Add a name** → type `Dad` → confirm.
>
> → **Album** → **Select people & pets** → tap **Select** on Mom, Dad, and Liam → **Confirm**.
>
> Open "Family 2025" → **Share** → **Create link** → paste the link into a message to Grandma.
>
> Take a few new photos of your kids → open "Family 2025" a day later → check that they've appeared.

Organize your favorite recipes with Perplexity Q&A

> Type: `My Recipe Book`

> Pumpkin Soup
> Ingredients: 1 kg pumpkin, 1 onion, 2 carrots, 400ml coconut milk, 1 tsp cumin
> Instructions: Peel and chop veggies. Sauté onion. Add pumpkin, spices, and water. Simmer 20 mins. Blend. Stir in coconut milk.

> Save this as a recipe in My Recipe Book.

> Show me all recipes with coconut milk.

> What can I cook tonight with pumpkin and coconut milk?

> https://perplexity.ai/space/12345-my-recipe-book

> What's a quick vegan dinner I can make?

Build a Simple Weekly Meal Plan With Grok Based on What's in Your Fridge

> type "Hi" to test the connection, or jump straight to Step 2 with your list ready.

> ➤ "Fridge: 2 chicken breasts, half a head of broccoli, 4 eggs, a wedge of cheddar. Pantry: rice, canned chickpeas, soy sauce, olive oil, garlic. Freezer: frozen peas. Serving 2 adults."

> ➤ "Here's what I have: [paste your list]. Build me a 7-day dinner plan for 2 adults. No seafood. Keep weeknight meals under 30 minutes. Use what I already have first, then suggest what to buy."

> ➤ "Swap Tuesday's curry for something quicker — under 20 minutes. Add a slow-cooker recipe for Sunday. And please skip mushrooms entirely; nobody here eats them."

> ➤ "Great. Now give me a shopping list of only what I'm missing, grouped by aisle (produce, dairy, pantry, frozen, meat). Quantities for 2 adults. Keep it under 25 items if you can."

> ➤ "OK, I'm ready to save this. Can you format the final 7-day plan and the shopping list as plain text I can copy into my notes app?"

Plan a Budget-Friendly City Vacation in One Afternoon

> ➤ *"I want to spend 4 days in Lisbon in mid-October. Just me, no car. My total budget including flights from the US East Coast is $1,800. I like walking, local food, neighborhoods, and one or two paid museums. I don't love big crowds. Give me a first-pass plan."*

> ➤ *"Thanks. Now break the $1,800 into lodging, food, transport within the city, attractions, and a buffer. Which two categories usually eat most of the budget for a 4-day solo trip, and which is the easiest to cut without ruining the trip?"*

> ➤ *"Rebuild the 4 days using mostly free or cheap anchors — parks, walking streets, viewpoints, free museum hours, markets. Put one paid anchor per day, and group nearby things together so I'm not crossing the city for every stop. Flag anything that's usually very crowded."*

> ➤ *"Here's the Day 2 plan you gave me: Alfama walking tour → Sé cathedral → lunch in Graça → National Tile Museum → sunset at Miradouro da Senhora do Monte → dinner in Bairro Alto. Push back on this: how much walking is that, do I need to book the museum, and what's a good rainy-day swap?"*

> ➤ *"Give me a short list of Lisbon dishes with a 'cheap-eats version' and a 'sit-down version' for each. Then give me 5 'don't do this' warnings — the kind of thing a first-timer always falls for, like taxi scams, tourist-menu restaurants, or transport passes that don't pay off for 4 days."*

> ➤ *"Now compress everything we discussed into one tight page: budget shares, 4-day plan, food list, top 5 warnings, and a 5-line packing note for October weather. Keep it tight — I want to fit this on one screen on my phone."*

Plan a Weekend Trip From a One-Line Idea With Cohere

> ➤ *"You are a practical trip planner. I travel with one other adult, no kids. We like walking, local food, and one museum or landmark per trip max. Avoid luxury recommendations. Keep each day to three time blocks: morning, afternoon, evening. Never invent specific restaurant names — describe the cuisine and neighborhood instead."*

> ➤ *"Weekend trip idea: Portland, Oregon, second weekend of October, two adults, arriving Friday evening, leaving Sunday afternoon. Build a day-by-day plan in three time blocks per day (morning, afternoon, evening). For each block, give: one main activity, one place to eat (describe the cuisine and neighborhood, don't invent names), and a backup if it rains."*

> ➤ *"Looks good overall, but tighten this: replace any block that requires a car with a public-transit option, and move any suggestion that starts before 9 a.m. to 10 a.m. or later. Keep everything else the same."*

> ➤ *"For Sunday afternoon only, give me a backup plan that works if it rains: an indoor activity, a nearby warm place for lunch, and a coffee stop I can walk to between them. Keep Saturday exactly as it is."*

> ➤ *"Now compress the whole plan — both days plus the Sunday rain backup — into a one-screen version I can read on my phone. Each item is one short line. No descriptions, no flowery language. Order: Friday evening, Saturday morning/afternoon/evening, Sunday morning/afternoon, Sunday rain backup."*

> ➤ *"Now write me a copy-paste version of the one-screen summary that I can paste into Apple Notes or Google Keep. Use plain text, no markdown bold, one item per line, with a blank line between days."*

Use ChatGPT to Plan a Road Trip with Stops, Fuel Breaks, and Drive Time

> ➤ "My partner and I are driving from Portland, Oregon to San Francisco, California on June 12, leaving around 8am. We like small towns, good coffee, and short hikes. We want to drive no more than 6 hours a day."

> ➤ "Great. Now please give me a day-by-day plan. For each day, tell me the start city, the end city, total driving hours, and one sentence on why that stop is worth it."

> ➤ "Add a fuel stop about every 3 hours of driving, and one proper meal stop per day. Just give me the town or exit name and roughly when in the day I'd hit it."

> ➤ "For each overnight stop, suggest one outdoor thing, one local food place, and one quick museum or viewpoint. Keep it short — we're not trying to cram the whole trip in."

> ➤ "Now read the plan back to me like a skeptical friend. What looks too rushed? Which day has the longest stretch between fuel stops? Anything I should double-check before I leave?"

> ➤ "Now condense the whole trip into a clean numbered list I can paste into my notes app. Keep fuel stops inline with each day. Don't add anything new."

How to scale a family recipe up or down for any number of guests

> original serves 6, you need 14 → factor = **2.33**; original serves 8, you need 4 → factor = **0.5**.

> 1 cup flour × 2.33 = about 2¼ cups; 2 tbsp butter × 1.5 = 3 tbsp.

> 1 tsp salt in the original × factor 2.33 (full math) would be ~2.33 tsp; gentler multiplier 2 → about 2 tsp is the right target.

> original 9×13 pan for 8 servings → 16 servings → use **two** 9×13 pans, or one large roasting pan.

> original bake time = 45 min → start checking at **30 min**, then every 5 min after, using a toothpick or thermometer.

> ➤ "Scaled 2× for Thanksgiving. Next time: bigger pan, 10 min less in oven, +½ tsp salt."

How to create a custom bedtime story starring your child with any AI

> nothing to type yet — just open the app and tap the new-chat button.

> `You are a kind bedtime story writer for young children. Please write in simple, gentle language with a happy ending.`

> `Please write a story starring my 6-year-old daughter Lily, her hamster named Biscuit, and their backyard with the big oak tree. Lily is shy but very curious.`

> `Please make it about 500 words long — the length of a 5-minute bedtime read — and gently show how being brave helps, without being preachy.`

> `This is lovely, but please change the ending so Lily and Biscuit fall asleep peacefully under the oak tree instead of running home.`

> tap the **share icon**, choose **"Copy link"** or **"Send to email"**, and save the story in a folder called "Bedtime stories."

How to organize a chaotic shared family calendar in one afternoon

> ➤ *"We have three iPhones and a Mac — let's use Apple iCloud Calendar so we don't have to install anything new."*

> ➤ *"Calendar name: Family. Color: orange. Description: shared with mom, dad, Mia, and Leo."*

> ➤ *"Tuesday 16:00–17:30, Soccer practice, Mia. Repeats every Tuesday. Reminder: 90 min before (popup) and 15 min before (notification)."*

> ➤ *"Saturday 14:00–16:00, Leo's birthday party at the community center. Notes: RSVP link — bring a swimsuit."*

> ➤ *"Sunday 19:00–19:10, Family calendar review, repeats weekly. Reminder: at start time."*

Turn a photo of your fridge into two simple dinner ideas with Meta AI

> a quick self-check — ask yourself, "Could a friend tell what each thing is from this picture alone?"

> ➤ "Here's what's in my fridge. Please suggest two simple dinner recipes I can make tonight in under 30 minutes. I don't eat pork."

> ➤ "I don't have an oven. Can you give me a stovetop version of the second recipe?"

> ➤ "Please make me a short shopping list of everything I'm missing from these recipes. Group it by store section."

Drafting a Basic Family-Tree Outline with AI: A Beginner's Guide

> ➤ "Me — Sara. Parents: Mom = Linda, Dad = Tom. Mom's parents: Gran = Joan, Pop = Bill. Dad's parents: Nan = Margaret, Grandpa = Alan. Siblings: brother Jake. Aunts/uncles: Aunt Mary (Mom's sister), Uncle Rob (Dad's brother). Cousins: Lily (Aunt Mary's daughter)."

> ➤ "Here's my family as I know it: me (Sara), Mom Linda, Dad Tom, brother Jake, Mom's parents Joan and Bill, Dad's parents Margaret and Alan, Aunt Mary (Mom's sister) and her daughter Lily, Uncle Rob (Dad's brother). Please draw a simple text-based family tree outline with three generations — me, parents, grandparents — using indents or a basic tree shape. Note any branches I haven't filled in. This is just a starting draft."

> ➤ "Thanks. Please move Aunt Mary to sit under Mom's parents as their daughter, and add a cousin called Lily as her child. Also use dashes and greater-than symbols (├── └──) instead of dots so it copies cleanly into my document."

> ➤ "One more version please — same tree, but plain text only, no markdown or code blocks, so I can paste it straight into my notes app without fixing the formatting."

> ➤ "Add these new people to the tree: my partner Sam, our daughter Mia, and Sam's parents Pat and Chris. Please show the in-law branch as a separate section so it doesn't get mixed up with my birth family."

Plan a 20-Minute Home Workout With Gemini (No Equipment Needed)

> no typing yet — just open the app or site.

> ➤ "Make me a 20-minute home workout. No equipment at all. I have a small living room and medium energy today — I want to actually move, but I'm not trying to set any records."

> ➤ "Please split the workout into a 3-minute warm-up, a 14-minute main set, and a 3-minute cool-down. Put each section under a clear heading."

> ➤ "My lower back is a little tight. Please avoid moves that load the spine, like burpees or sit-ups. Swap them for something gentler."

> ➤ "Rewrite the main set as a numbered list. Each line: exercise, seconds or reps, one quick cue. I need to read this while I'm working out, so keep it tight."

> no typing — screenshot the routine or paste it into your notes.

How to Troubleshoot Your Home Wi-Fi Step by Step with an AI Assistant

> ➤ "My home Wi-Fi has been cutting out for the past two days. My laptop loses connection every 20–30 minutes, but my phone stays connected fine. I haven't changed any settings. Where should I start?"

Plan a week-long trip itinerary with Copilot from a simple destination list

> type a single word first to confirm it works, like "hi".

> ➤ "I'm planning a relaxed 7-day trip for two adults in October, and we love food, walking, and quiet neighborhoods."

> ➤ "Cities I'd like to visit: Lisbon, Sintra, Porto, Coimbra. Dates: 5 to 11 October. Start in Lisbon, end in Porto. We have a rental car."

> ➤ "Can you add the approximate travel time between each city by car, and flag any day where the drive eats more than 3 hours? Suggest a faster option if one exists."

> ➤ "Please slow down Day 3 — one museum, one long lunch, and a sunset walk. We don't want to be on our feet for more than four hours."

> ➤ "Can you give me the final itinerary as a Markdown table with columns for Day, Morning, Afternoon, Evening, and Travel Time?"

Use Le Chat to Turn a Long Recipe into a Simple Shopping List

> if you're on the home screen and unsure, type anything short like "hi" first to confirm the chat box is responsive.

> prompt you can copy and adapt:
> ➤ "Group these ingredients into a shopping list by store section (produce, dairy, meat, pantry, spices, frozen). Show quantities. Give me just the list — no intro paragraph, no tips, no closing line. Use simple bullet points I can copy into my notes app."

How to Write a Personalized Bedtime Story for Your Child Tonight

> you don't need to type anything yet — just confirm the empty box is there.

> ➤ "Write a 5-minute bedtime story for my 5-year-old named Maya. Her favorite animal is a fox. Tonight she needs to feel brave because she's starting daycare tomorrow. Set it in a moonlit forest. Use simple words. End with Maya falling asleep smiling."

> ➤ "Make the fox a little funnier, and cut the part about the dark cave — Maya doesn't like caves."

> tap the speaker icon, then say to your child, "Want to hear what the fox says?"

> rename the chat "Maya's brave fox night 1."

How to build a calming bedtime routine for young kids in minutes

> ➤ "My son is [child's age] years old. We'd like him asleep by [bedtime]. He loves [favorite activity] and fights us about [tricky part] every night."

> ➤ "Create a 30-minute bedtime routine for a [child's age]-year-old, ending at [bedtime]. Put a time next to each step, count backward from bedtime, and add one gentle transition cue between steps."

> ➤ "Keep this routine the same, but shorten the bath to 8 minutes and move the story to after pajamas. Then add a calm song as the transition into the story."

> ➤ "Turn this final routine into a template. Replace each specific time with [time] and each activity with [activity], and keep the transition cues as they are."

> ➤ "Make a one-page bedtime card with six lines, one step per line, large simple words, and a short icon idea next to each step."

How to design a custom birthday card with Midjourney in 10 minutes

> ➤ "A cheerful birthday card scene with a watercolor bouquet of sunflowers and soft paper texture, warm yellow and sage green tones, [birthday style] mood."

> ➤ "...with open, uncluttered space across the top third for a message."

> ➤ "...with a tiny garden bench and a teal bicycle in the background, since [recipient's hobby] is gardening."

> ➤ "Keep the sunflower bouquet and the open space at the top, but make the light warmer and the paper texture more visible."

> type "Happy birthday, [recipient name]! Here's to a year full of sunshine." in the open space.

Track your household budget with AI: simple steps for beginners

> `Coffee $5.20, Petrol $75.00, Groceries $140.00, Electricity bill $195.00, Netflix $19.00, Takeaway dinner $45.00, Public transport $12.00.`

> ➤ `"Please categorise the following list of household expenses into clear groups (like Food, Utilities, and Transport) and show me the total spent in each group: [Paste your list here]"`

> ➤ `"Looking at these categories, can you suggest three realistic and gentle ways I could reduce my spending next week without making major lifestyle sacrifices?"`

> ➤ `"Create a simple weekly budget template for me based on these exact categories. Keep it clean so I can copy and paste it into a blank document to write in my actual spending next week."`

How to Plan a Kids' Birthday Party Without Losing Your Mind

> ➤ "Saturday, June 14, 2:00–4:00pm. Guests: 8 kids + 2 siblings."

> ➤ "Theme: dinosaur dig. Budget total $200. Food $80, decor + activities $90, surprises $30."

> ➤ "4 weeks: send invites. 2 weeks: buy decor + cake ingredients. 1 week: confirm RSVPs. Day before: set up."

> ➤ "Hi! Maya's turning 6, dinosaur-dig party, Saturday June 14, 2–4pm at our place. Please RSVP by June 7."

> ➤ "Food: mini sandwiches + grapes + juice + cake. Anchor: backyard dinosaur dig with toy fossils."

> ➤ "1:00 setup. 2:00 arrive. 2:15 snack. 2:45 dig. 3:30 cake. 3:50 bags. 4:00 done."

Create a Smart-Home Security Alert with Alexa Routines

> `Front Door Open Alert`

> `Attention, the front door has just opened.`

How to plan a multi-stop road trip with realistic driving times

➤ *"I'm starting from Denver. I'd like to visit Rocky Mountain National Park, Cheyenne, and the Black Hills in South Dakota. I have 6 days total, including travel. I can drive about 5 hours a day max, and I'd like one overnight stop roughly halfway. I have a small dog."* **You'll know it worked when** the assistant restates your starting point, your three stops, your day count, and your driving cap in plain language.

➤ *"Please build me a day-by-day plan for those 6 days. Use realistic driving times (not straight-line distance), keep each day under 5 hours behind the wheel, and pick one overnight town roughly halfway between Denver and the Black Hills. Show me where I'd stop for lunch and fuel on each driving day."* **You'll know it worked when** the response has 5–6 labeled days, each with a drive-time number (like "about 4h 20m"), an overnight town, and a meal or fuel note.

➤ *"For Day 3 (the longest one), break it down: what time should I leave, where should I stop for lunch around midday, where should I fuel up, and what time would I arrive at the overnight town?"* **You'll know it worked when** you can read the response and picture your actual morning, afternoon, and evening — start time, lunch stop, fuel stop, arrival time.

➤ *"Now go back through each driving day and add a 45-minute buffer for construction, weather, or a longer-than-planned lunch. Don't just tack it on at the end — spread it through the day."* **You'll know it worked when** every driving day in the plan has at least a half-hour of slack built in, and the longest day is still under your stated driving cap.

➤ *"For each overnight town, give me two options: one mid-range hotel/motel, and one budget campground or guesthouse. Flag any night where options look limited."* **You'll know it worked when** each overnight has at least two named options, and you've spotted the one or two nights where you should book first.

➤ *"Now give me the whole plan as a clean numbered list — one day per section, with drive time, overnight town, and one sentence on what to see or do there. I want to copy this straight into my notes."* **You'll know it worked when** you have the entire trip in one block you can paste somewhere and read at a glance, with no further editing needed.

How to Plan a Weekend Getaway Itinerary with Any AI Assistant

> ➤ *"Plan a weekend trip to Lisbon, Portugal. Dates: Friday March 13 to Sunday March 15, 2026. Two adults, no kids. We like walking neighborhoods, local food, one or two museums, and live music at night. We'd like to stay in the Alfama or Baixa area. Budget: about €80 per person per day, not counting the hotel."*

> ➤ *"Great, now write it as a day-by-day plan. For each day, give me three blocks: morning, afternoon and evening. Include a one-line reason for each pick and approximate travel time between spots. Keep the walking under 6 km per day."*

> ➤ *"Now suggest places to eat across the weekend, tied to the neighborhoods in the plan. I want: 2 breakfast spots, 2 lunch spots, 2 dinner spots and 1 coffee stop per day. Mark which cuisine each place is known for and a rough price (€, €€, €€€). Skip tourist-trap places and prefer family-run spots."*

> ➤ *"Swap the Saturday afternoon museum for an outdoor activity — we want sunshine if possible. Keep everything else the same."*

> Create a note called "Lisbon March 13–15" with two sections — "Plan" (the day-by-day) and "Eat" (the restaurant list with addresses).

How to plan a family road trip with kid-friendly stops and breaks

> name the chat *"Smith family road trip July 2026"*.

> ➤ *"Plan a 5-day family road trip from Denver to Yellowstone in July. Two kids, ages 6 and 9. We want to drive no more than 3 hours per day. Must-see: a dinosaur museum and one national park. Avoid: toll roads. Suggest kid-friendly stops every 2-3 hours and a snack plan for the car."*

> ➤ *"Now give me a day-by-day driving schedule. For each day, show departure city, arrival city, total miles, and 2 kid-friendly stops between them — a park, playground, or quirky roadside attraction. Keep each day under 3 hours of driving."*

> ➤ *"Now a snack plan for 5 days in the car, 2 kids. Give me: (a) 5 store-bought snacks easy to eat in the car, (b) 5 things to pack from home, (c) one small 'special' surprise per day. Keep it to foods that don't melt or make a mess. Format as a single list, not a table."*

> ➤ *"Update the plan: kids vetoed beef jerky and fish crackers — swap those for two similar store-bought options. The dinosaur museum is closed Tuesdays; move that day to Wednesday. Recalculate the driving schedule, leave the rest unchanged."*

> copy the final reply and paste it into *"Trip plan — final"* in your notes app, then share it with your travel partner.

> ➤ *"Plan a 3-day family road trip from [your city] to [your destination] in [month]. We have [number] kids, ages [ages]. Drive no more than 3 hours per day. Suggest one kid-friendly stop per day — park, playground, or quirky roadside attraction. Then give me 5 store-bought car snacks and 5 things to pack from home. Format as plain lists."*

Set up a shared Alexa+ household whiteboard for the whole family

> say to yourself *"I want everyone in the house to be able to read this board."* That's the goal — the next steps get you there.

> name it `Family Board` — short, obvious, and easy to remember when you say it out loud.

> ➤ *"Alexa, add 'Pick up dry cleaning on the way home' to Family Board."*

> your partner says, *"Alexa, add 'Sam has soccer practice at 4' to Family Board."* You see it on your phone within a few seconds.

> ➤ *"Alexa, what's on Family Board?"* — full readout. *"Alexa, how many items are on Family Board?"* — just the count.

> a shared line the family can memorize: *"Alexa, add [thing] to Family Board."*

How to plan a full week of family dinners and one smart shopping list

> ➤ "I'm planning dinners for next week for a family of four: two adults, a 7-year-old who won't eat mushrooms or spicy food, and a 12-year-old who is vegetarian at home. I want to cook 5 nights and use leftovers for 2. About $120 for the week."

> ➤ "Make a 7-night plan using my rules. Format it as a table: Day | Dinner | Leftover note. Keep weekday dinners to 30 minutes or less; weekends can be longer."

> ➤ "Swap Friday — we have practice until 7. Replace it with something using the same chicken from Wednesday. Keep Tuesday under 30 minutes; the soup won't work."

> ➤ "Now turn the plan into one shopping list. Group by store section (produce, dairy, meat, pantry, frozen). Merge duplicates across recipes. Give amounts in cups, grams, and tablespoons."

> ➤ "Give me 3 backup dinners I can make using only ingredients from this shopping list, plus pasta, rice, eggs, and canned tomatoes. Each one under 25 minutes."

> paste the plan and list into a note titled "Week of [date] dinners" so the family can find it from any phone.

Build a Simple Household Budget Calculator with GitHub Copilot

> in the search box, type GitHub Copilot and pick the first result whose publisher name is "GitHub."

> when the Save As window opens, type budget.py as the filename and click Save.

> ➤ "# A simple budget calculator that adds my monthly expenses and prints the total."

> Copilot might suggest three lines that look like expenses = [1200, 350, 80, 45] to set up a list, total = sum(expenses) to add them up, and print(f"Your total monthly expenses are: ${total}") to show the result.

> in the terminal, type python budget.py and press Enter.

> try replacing the list with expenses = [1500, 400, 60, 30, 25] for rent, food, phone, gym and a streaming subscription.

Set up Alexa+ voice profiles so each family member gets their own briefing

> add a profile named "Jordan" and then one named "Sam."

> phrase to say when prompted: "Alexa, what's on my schedule today?"

> ask Alexa, "Play my workout playlist." If it works, the playlist comes from the signed-in account.

> say, "Alexa, remind me to call the dentist tomorrow at nine a.m." Then ask, "Alexa, what are my reminders?"

> ➤ "Alexa, good morning. What do I have today, and what music should I hear while I get ready?"

> of a good habit: after a few weeks, ask Alexa, "What's on my calendar this week?" If you hear something you don't want said in the kitchen, remove that calendar link or switch that information off.

How to Plan a Kids Birthday Party on a Tight Budget in One Afternoon

> ➤ "You are a practical party planner who knows how to stretch a tight budget. I am planning a birthday party for my [child's age]-year-old. My total budget is [total budget] dollars, the party is at [home or park], and I expect about [number] guests. Ask me up to three questions, then build the plan in the order I list next."

> ➤ "Using the details above, split my budget into categories such as food, cake, decorations, activities, goody bags and a reserve for surprises. Show each category as a dollar amount and a percentage, and make the reserve clearly labeled."

> ➤ "Given the breakdown you just gave me, how many guests can I invite if each child costs about [dollars per child] dollars in food and goody bags? Sort the list into must invite, could invite and skip this year."

> ➤ "Make a timeline for the party day, starting at [start time] and ending at [end time]. Include setup, arrival, one activity, food, cake and cleanup. Then list the tasks I should finish the two days before the party."

> ➤ "Here are my prices, one item per line: [paste your list here]. Group them into a shopping list by store section, add up the total, and tell me how far over or under my budget I am."

> ➤ "Check your totals line by line and list any assumptions you made, such as guest count or prices. Tell me which ones I should verify myself before I buy anything."

Plan a Week of Family Dinners and a Matching Grocery List with Qwen

> leave the box empty for now and just press the new-chat button once.

> ➤ "I'm cooking dinner for a family of four (two adults, two kids ages 6 and 9). We love pasta, chicken, and Mexican flavors. Nobody eats pork, and one person is lactose intolerant. Our weekly food budget for dinners is about $120."

> ➤ "Based on that, please build me a 7-day dinner plan starting Monday. One dinner per day. For each meal list the dish, main ingredients, and rough cook time. Aim for variety — no repeats. Keep weeknight meals to 30 minutes or less."

> ➤ "Swap Wednesday — we don't have a slow cooker. Replace it with a 30-minute stovetop pasta. Also, no shellfish anywhere in the week please."

> ➤ "Now turn the full week into one shopping list, grouped by store section. Include quantities for 4 people. At the end, add a 'check your pantry' note for things people often already have (olive oil, salt, pepper, basic spices)."

> paste it into a note titled "Dinners — week of [date]" so next week you can start a fresh chat and not lose this one.

How to Use Gemini to Make Your LinkedIn Photo Look Professional at Home

> ➤ "Make this headshot look more professional with softer, even lighting and a plain light gray background. Keep my face, hairstyle, and expression exactly as they are."

> ➤ "Keep everything the same, but make the background a little warmer and lighten the shadows under my chin."

Plan a Weekend Getaway Itinerary with Grok in 10 Minutes

> type nothing yet — just open the chat and confirm the text box is ready.

> ➤ "I'm in Boston, planning a weekend trip to Portland, Maine, October 18-20. It's me and my partner, no kids. We like cozy coffee shops, short coastal walks and one really good dinner out."

> ➤ "Add: we don't mind driving up to 30 minutes for a view. We love bookstores and seafood but hate tourist-trap lobster rolls. Budget is casual — fancy once, cheap the rest. Must-do: a lighthouse."

> ➤ "Great. Now draft a full weekend itinerary, day by day, with morning, afternoon and evening suggestions. Include the lighthouse. Keep each day walkable, no back-to-back driving."

> ➤ "Drop the brewery tour — neither of us drinks. Swap the Saturday afternoon museum for a 2-hour bookstore browse. Move the lighthouse to Sunday morning so we can catch the sunrise."

> ➤ "Perfect. Now give me the final plan as a clean plain-text list — day by day, time, place, one sentence on why. No markdown, no emoji, ready to paste into Notes."

Plan a 3-day weekend trip with DeepSeek, based on your interests and budget

> nothing to copy yet — this step is just opening the app.

> ➤ "Plan a 3-day weekend trip to Lisbon, Portugal, for two adults in mid-October. We love walking neighborhoods, trying local food, and one nice museum. Budget is about €120 per person per day, not including flights. Give us a day-by-day plan with morning, afternoon, and evening ideas, plus rough costs."

> none — this step is about reading, not typing.

> ➤ "That looks great overall. Three changes: please drop the fado show on Day 1 (we're too tired after the flight) and replace it with a relaxed waterfront walk. On Day 2, swap the museum for a half-day Sintra trip by train. Also push the dinner budget up a bit — we'd rather one great meal than three average ones."

> ➤ "Perfect. Now give me a cost breakdown per person per day (hotel, food, local transport, activities) and a short packing list for October weather and a lot of walking."

> paste it into a note titled "Lisbon — Oct 17–19" and share it with your travel partner.

Organize Travel Planning Research with Perplexity's AI-powered Q&A

(No typing for this step, just observation)

➤ "Find me flights from Portland (MEL) to Nashville (BNE) for the last week of September."

➤ "What are some good mid-range hotels in Nashville city center for a family of four?"

➤ "Suggest family-friendly activities in Nashville, especially outdoor options near the river."

➤ "Create a simple 3-day itinerary for a family trip to Nashville using the information we discussed, including suggested activities."

(No typing for this step, just observation)

How to Use Amazon's Conversational Alexa+ at Home

Say clearly, "Alexa, turn on Follow-Up Mode."

➤ "I have some leftover roast pumpkin and spinach in the fridge. What is a quick, colorful lunch I can make with these in ten minutes?"

➤ "That salad sounds great, but I do not have any feta cheese. What can I use instead?"

➤ "Perfect. Add the alternative ingredients to my shopping list and set a cooking timer for fifteen minutes."

➤ "Thank you, Alexa. That's all for now."

➤ "Alexa, what's on my shopping list?" or "Alexa, what reminders do I have for today?"

Use Alexa+ to guide you through cooking recipes and manage multiple kitchen timers

N/A

➤ "Alexa+, find me a recipe for pumpkin soup."

➤ "Alexa+, start the recipe." or "Alexa+, next step." or "Alexa+, repeat that."

➤ "Alexa+, set a timer for 10 minutes for the rice." and then "Alexa+, set another timer for 25 minutes for the chicken."

➤ "Alexa+, how much time is left on the chicken timer?" or "Alexa+, pause the rice timer."

➤ "Alexa+, stop." or "Alexa+, snooze for 5 minutes."

How to Use Gemini to Plan a Week of Simple Dinners From Food You Already Have

> Tap the text box and type "Hi, I'd like help planning dinners this week using food I already have."

> ➤ "I have eggs, half a bag of rice, a can of black beans, two onions, a bag of frozen peas, and some cheese. Please plan dinners for [number] people for [number] nights, each taking about [minutes] minutes to cook."

> ➤ "Using mainly the items I listed, make a dinner plan for [number] nights. Use anything that might spoil first, and list the main ingredients for each dinner."

> ➤ "Compare the ingredients for this plan with my pantry list and give me a shopping list of only the items I still need to buy."

> ➤ "Make Wednesday's dinner faster, under [minutes] minutes, and replace the fish with something vegetarian."

Quickly compare two holiday cities using Qwen Chat

> (no typing needed yet – just open the site).

> (type your email — e.g., *alice@example.com* — and password, then hit **Enter**).

> Compare Key West and Santa Cruz Bay for a 5-day holiday in July, focusing on weather, daily cost and top attractions.

> Give me the key points as a bullet list.

> Please put the weather, cost and top attraction for each city into a two-column table.

> Tap the three-dot menu → Copy link.

How to plan a trip with AI: itinerary, budget and tips

> I'm planning a 7-day trip from Chicago to Japan. I want to spend 4 days in Tokyo and 3 days in Kyoto, love food markets, quiet temples and scenic train rides. Can you give me a day-by-day itinerary, a budget in US dollars and five local tips?

> Give me a simple outline: Day 1–2 in Tokyo, Day 3 travel to Kyoto, Day 4–7 exploring Kyoto. List one main activity per day.

> Expand the outline. Include start-time, travel time between activities, opening hours, and one food recommendation each day. Use a 24-hour clock and metric distances.

> Provide a budget estimate for a mid-range traveller in US dollars. Break it down into flights, accommodation, food, local transport and activities. Assume I'll stay in small hotels and eat at a mix of casual and nicer places.

> Give me five practical tips a local would share, like the best time of day to visit popular spots, how to pay for transport, and any festivals happening during my travel dates.

> (press Ctrl + A, then Ctrl + C, open a new document, press Ctrl + V)

How to Plan a Camping Trip with Any AI Assistant

> ➤ *"We're planning a two-night camping trip in the Blue Ridge Mountains in October for two people. One of us is a vegetarian. We're bringing a four-season tent. Can you give us a packing list broken into categories like shelter, clothing, cooking and safety?"*

> ➤ *"We're flying into Kansas City and have a car. We're looking for camping spots within a three-hour drive that are dog-friendly, have basic facilities and are good for first-time campers. What do you recommend and what's the rough driving time to each?"*

> ➤ *"For a two-night camping trip for two adults (one vegetarian), give us a simple meal plan for breakfast, lunch and dinner for both days. We have a small gas cooker, a cooler box and basic utensils. Keep it to ingredients that don't need refrigeration."*

> ➤ *"That's great. One person in our group gets travel sickness, so we need to stop every two hours on the drive. Could you suggest a realistic driving schedule from Kansas City with breaks included? Also, we're on a tight budget — can you suggest cheap meal swaps for the vegetarian options?"*

> ➤ *"Can you summarize everything we've discussed into one message — the packing list, campsite options, meal plan and driving schedule? Make it easy to read so I can copy it into my notes."*

> ➤ *"We're doing a [number]-night camping trip in [state or region] in [month] for [number] people. [Any dietary needs or special notes]. Can you give us a packing list, campsite ideas, a meal plan and a driving schedule?"*

Create AI-generated grocery shopping lists from pantry photos using Meta AI

> ➤ "Based on this photo of my pantry, what groceries do I need to buy? Please list items I might be low on or running out of."

> ➤ "Please make this list suitable for a single person for just three days." or "Could you remove the pasta and add more fresh vegetables instead?"

How to run your first open-source LLM from DeepSeek on a home PC

```
ollama run deepseek-r1:1.5b
```

```
What are three fun activities to do on a rainy weekend afternoon?
```

```
/bye
```

How to Send a Quick Voice Message to a Family Member's Echo

> name pair: "Kitchen Echo" and "Bedroom Echo."

> add "Mom" with her Amazon account email so her Echo shows up under that name.

> phrases: "Alexa, drop a voice message on the Kitchen Echo." / "Alexa, send a voice message to Mom's Echo saying dinner is ready." / "Alexa, tell the Bedroom Echo we'll leave in five minutes."

> ➤ "Hey, dinner's on the table — come down when you can."

> send "Test from the kitchen" the first time you set this up, then walk to the other Echo and confirm you heard it play.

How to plan a stress-free family road trip with Copilot

> ➤ "We're a family of four with two kids (ages 7 and 10) planning a 5-day road trip from Chicago to Denver in mid-July. We want to see Mount Rushmore on the way. Can you suggest a route with 2–3 fun stops each day that won't exhaust the kids?"

> ➤ "Great route, thanks! Now can you make us a packing checklist for the car and for the kids? July weather, minivan, two adults and two kids. Format it as a simple bulleted list I can screenshot — keep it under 20 items total."

> ➤ "Can you suggest 8 road-trip snacks that won't melt in a hot car and 5 screen-free games for a 7- and 10-year-old on a 5-hour driving day?"

> ➤ "Can you make a simple budget for a 5-day family road trip for 4 people? We need fuel, 2 hotel nights, food, attraction tickets for Mount Rushmore and one other stop, plus a buffer. Try to keep the total around $1,500."

> ➤ "Perfect. Now can you write one short summary — under 300 words — that combines the route, top 5 packing items, 3 favorite snacks, and the budget total? I'll paste this into my phone's notes app."

Plan Your Next Holiday: Create a Custom Travel Itinerary with Meta AI

> ➤ *"Plan a 5-day trip to Kyoto for two adults in early November. We like quiet temples, walking and local food. Mid-range budget, flying in and out of Osaka."*

> ➤ *"Day 2 is too packed — swap the afternoon bus tour for a slow walk through Higashiyama and a casual dinner near Gion. Keep it under ¥6,000 per person."*

> ➤ *"We're staying near Kyoto Station. Suggest three dinner spots within a 10-minute walk — one ramen, one nicer izakaya, one vegetarian-friendly. Also: what's the easiest way to get to Arashiyama from our hotel?"*

How to plan meals and a grocery budget with AI

> Pantry: ½ bag basmati rice, 1 tin diced tomatoes, 1 jar pesto, 2 tins chickpeas
> Fridge: 3 eggs, 1 lemon, 1 small onion
> Freezer: 4 chicken thighs

> Click the "New chat" button, then you'll see an empty box ready for typing.

> Here's what I have at home right now:
> Pantry: ½ bag basmati rice, 1 tin diced tomatoes, 1 jar pesto, 2 tins chickpeas.
> Fridge: 3 eggs, 1 lemon, 1 small onion.
> Freezer: 4 chicken thighs.
> Please plan 5 simple dinners for two people that use as many of these items as possible. Give me the recipes in one short paragraph each. Keep each recipe under 5 ingredients total.

> Now give me a single combined shopping list with quantities for the missing items only. Also tell me the approximate total cost in US dollars using typical supermarket prices.

> Write each dinner as a text line I can copy into my calendar. Title each event "Dinner – [recipe name]". Include the ingredients I already have plus any missing items.

Turn whatever's left in your fridge into a real recipe with Le Chat

> you don't need to type anything yet — just confirm a fresh, empty chat is ready.

> copy and adapt this — *"Here's what's in my fridge: 2 eggs, half an onion, a handful of spinach, leftover cooked rice (about 1 cup), some grated cheddar, soy sauce, and one tortilla. I don't want anything too spicy. What can I make for dinner for 1 person?"*

> ➤ *"Great idea — please give me a full step-by-step recipe for the rice omelette. I'm cooking for 1, I have about 25 minutes, only a frying pan and a spatula, and I'd like it written as numbered steps."*

> ➤ *"I don't have soy sauce — can you swap in Worcestershire sauce instead? And can you make it ready in 15 minutes instead of 25?"*

> ➤ *"Can you give me a short grocery list for next time I make this, and tell me how to store leftovers in the fridge?"*

Use Qwen Chat to create a simple meal plan for the week using ingredients you already have

> `I have chicken breast, spinach, pasta, canned tomatoes, cheese, and eggs. Please suggest a simple meal plan for dinner for 5 days using these ingredients.`

> `That's a great start! Could you also make sure to include one vegetarian option and avoid anything too spicy? I also have some rice.`

> `Day 3 sounds perfect, but could you swap the pasta dish on Day 2 for something with rice instead?`

Plan a weekend trip with Le Chat: a 4-step itinerary for any city

> type `Hi — I'm planning a weekend trip and could use a hand shaping the itinerary.`

> `I'm spending Saturday in Lisbon, Portugal, with my partner. We like walking, local food, and one big museum — no beaches. Build me a day-one itinerary with morning, afternoon, and evening, plus how we'd get between stops.`

> `Now do Sunday — quieter, more neighborhood feel, no big attractions, no repeat of any Saturday stop. After that, tell me how we'd realistically get between stops on foot, by metro, and by tram, and what's the indoor backup if it rains?`

> `Rewrite our full weekend as a numbered checklist, one block per time slot, with the address of each place. Keep it under 30 lines so it fits on one phone screen.`

How to generate AI images in Picsart: a beginner's step-by-step guide

> this step has nothing to type — just finding the right entry point.

> this step is a tap, not a typing step — the key choice is **Text to Image** for a first run.

> for a square post, choose the square option; for a phone wallpaper, choose the tall rectangle; if you see a quality choice, pick the lowest setting for a quick test.

> ➤ "A friendly poster for a Saturday morning yoga class, soft pastel colors, with the words 'Saturday Morning Yoga' clearly readable in the center, hand-drawn style."

> after the yoga poster above, send: "Make the background soft pink, change the words to 'Bring a friend!', and add a small sun in the top-right corner."

> upload a group photo, then type: "Remove the person in the red shirt on the right." Or paint over the background with the brush tool and write: "Replace this background with a sunset beach."

> not a typing step — the key choice is **JPG** for everyday sharing, **PNG** only if you need a transparent background.

Auto-write captions for your photos using Hugging Face's free image captioning tool

> the verification email is usually titled something like "Confirm your Hugging Face account".

> searching for "BLIP image captioning" may return a Space built by Salesforce, which has been one of the popular captioning demos on the site.

> a typical blurb is "A short image captioning model based on BLIP, fine-tuned on COCO" — COCO is just the name of a popular photo dataset the model learned from.

> a beach sunset photo might return something like "a sunset over the ocean with orange clouds", and a family group shot might return "a group of people smiling and standing together".

> a clear photo of a coffee cup on a wooden table might come back as "a cup of coffee on a table" — accurate, but plain.

> a simple spreadsheet column might read `beach_sunset.jpg → "a sunset over the ocean with orange clouds"`.

> a LinkedIn post becomes "Wrapped up a long week with a walk on the beach 🌅 — a sunset over the ocean with orange clouds. Felt good to breathe."

How to remove a photo background cleanly with Meta AI on your phone

> choose a clear, well-lit photo of a friend standing in front of a plain wall, or a product on a tabletop.

> `Remove the background from this photo and give me the subject on a transparent background.`

> `Zoom in around the hair — I can still see a faint gray halo. Please clean up the edges.`

> a beach sunset from your camera roll, so your friend looks like they're standing on vacation.

> `Remove the background from this photo and give me the subject on a transparent background. Keep the subject exactly the same — only the background should change.`

> `Remove the background from this photo and give me the subject on a transparent background.`

How to Write a Gemini Image Prompt That Gets Close to What You Pictured

> ➤ "Create an image of a friendly cup of coffee on a wooden table."

> ➤ "Create an image of a [animal or person] doing [one action] with [one object]."

> ➤ "...in a [place] during [time of day]."

> ➤ "...in a soft watercolor style with pale, gentle colors."

> ➤ "...lit by [light source] coming from [direction]."

> ➤ "Framed as a [shot type] from [angle]."

> ➤ "Create an image of a small brown dog with floppy ears, sitting on a porch in a quiet village at sunset, in a soft watercolor style, lit by warm evening light from the left, framed as a medium shot at eye level."

Generate unique profile pictures for social media with Midjourney

> `/imagine prompt: a cheerful fox wearing round glasses, cartoon style, bright colors`

> `/imagine prompt: [describe the person or character], smiling gently, digital art portrait, soft pastel colors, simple background --ar 1:1`

Create a multi-room music playlist with Alexa+

> Look for the house-shaped icon at the bottom of the Alexa app and tap it.

> Open the Kitchen room and look for the ··· menu in the top-right corner.

> Tap **Add to Routine** (or the equivalent option in your app version).

> Tap the voice trigger option and then tap inside the text box.

> Confirm the phrase and move to the next step. Alexa may show a summary of the phrase you've entered.

> Type "play dinner playlist" and confirm it. Later you'll say "Alexa, play dinner playlist".

> Tap the music action and then tap the option to choose a playlist.

> Select "Dinner Vibes" playlist and tick Kitchen, Lounge and Bedroom.

Sharpen Your Photos with AI Using Upscayl

> Select a file named `old_family_photo.jpg` from your `Pictures` folder.

How to create images with AI: a beginner's first try

> ➤ "Create an image of"

> ➤ "A fluffy ginger cat wearing a blue knitted jumper, sitting on a wooden park bench, bright sunny day, soft watercolour painting style."

> ➤ "Change the jumper color to yellow, and add a small friendly magpie sitting on the bench next to the cat."

How to Make Your First AI Video by Starting with a Simple Storyboard

> write something like "A calm morning in a small kitchen, with steam rising from a mug of tea."

> ➤ "Help me plan a 20-second video about [your topic]. Give me 5 numbered shots, and for each one list what is on screen, how many seconds it lasts, and any words spoken."

> ➤ "A ceramic mug of tea on a wooden table in [describe your setting], soft morning light, camera slowly zooms in, 5 seconds."

> ➤ "A ceramic mug of tea on a wooden table, soft morning light, camera slowly zooms in, 5 seconds." Try "Make the light warmer" as a follow-up adjustment if needed.

> ➤ "Same soft morning light and warm, cozy colors as before. A hand lifts the mug from the table, camera holds still, 4 seconds."

> ➤ "Shot 1 is 5 seconds, shot 2 is 4 seconds, shot 3 is 6 seconds. Place them in that order on the timeline." Use this as a reminder check rather than something you type into the generator.

Safely Rename a Batch of Photos with a GitHub Copilot Script

> `Write a Python script that renames every .jpg and .png file in the current folder to "vacation-2024-001.jpg", "vacation-2024-002.jpg", and so on. Skip files that already match this pattern.`

> `Write a Python script that lists every .jpg file in the current folder and renames them to "sample-001.jpg", "sample-002.jpg", in the order they appear. Print the new names before doing it.`

How to Summarize a Long YouTube Video in 60 Seconds with Any AI

> Your copied link will look something like youtube.com/watch?v=AbCdEfGh123 — the letters and numbers at the end are the video's ID.

> ➤ "Here's a YouTube link: [paste your link]. Summarize this video in 5 bullet points and keep it under 150 words."

> ➤ "Now pull out 3 key quotes from that video, with the speaker's name for each one. Keep each quote to one sentence."

> ➤ "In one sentence, what's the single most important takeaway from that video, written so I can send it to my manager?"

How to Ask ChatGPT for Step-by-Step Photo Editing Help in Your Phone's Editor

> ➤ "I'm editing a photo on my [phone brand] using the [app name] app. Please give me numbered steps I can follow on my own screen."

> ➤ "The photo is too dark on the left side, and I want to crop out the trash can in the corner."

> ➤ "Here is a screenshot of my editing screen. Which button should I tap to brighten the photo?"

> ➤ "Give me numbered steps to crop this photo to a square, and tell me where the crop tool usually is."

> ➤ "I can't find the red-eye tool in my app. I see a row of icons with a magic wand and a sun. What should I try?"

> ➤ "Step 3 says to tap Adjust, but my screen only shows Filters, Markup, and Edit. What's the closest option?"

Create Royalty-Free AI Music Loops for Podcasts and Videos

> `A calm, ambient electronic loop for a meditation podcast, featuring soft synth pads, a subtle bassline, and a gentle, pulsing rhythm. Focus on a peaceful and reflective mood.`

How to use Kling AI video templates in Picsart Flow

> search terms to try inside the app — `Kling`, `AI video`, `photo to video`.

> `The woman slowly turns her head to the right and smiles, with soft sunlight on her face.`

> `A young woman with short black hair, wearing a yellow raincoat, walks through a misty forest at dawn.`

> `Change the setting to a neon-lit Tokyo street at night, keep the same walking motion.`

> trim suggestion — `keep only seconds 2 through 6` (drag the handles until those seconds are highlighted).

How to Turn Your Saved Articles and Notes into a Personal Podcast with Gemini Notebook

> type a short name like "Weekend reading" or "Q3 research" into the notebook title field so you can find it later.

> paste the URL of one long article you've been putting off.

> add 4 items — a long-form article, a PDF report you downloaded last week, a Google Doc with your own notes, and one more link.

> type an optional instruction in the custom prompt box if you see one, such as "Focus on the parts about pricing strategy."

> while listening, jot down a question in the Notes section on the right so you can ask Gemini Notebook's chat about it after.

How to label AI-made videos when you post them on YouTube, TikTok and Facebook

> A clip where your cloned voice reads the narration over real footage → label it. A clip where you only used AI to brainstorm the title → no label needed on YouTube.

How to Edit Your Phone Photos with Simple Text Instructions in Meta AI

> Open WhatsApp → tap the new-chat icon → tap "Meta AI" in the contacts list.

> One landscape photo where the sky looks flat and gray — perfect for your first edit.

> ➤ "Make the sky look like a bright sunset with orange and pink clouds" — or simpler, "Remove the person on the right" or "Brighten the photo so it doesn't look so dark."

> Ask yourself — is the person really gone, or is there a faint shadow where they stood? Is the sky the color you wanted, or does it look painted on?

> First try didn't remove the person cleanly? Send: "Try again — remove the person on the right side, but keep everything else exactly the same."

> Save your favorite version, then close the chat. Your original photo is untouched on your phone, and the edited version is now saved next to it.

How to Sort and Clean Up a Messy Phone Photo Library with Gemini

> tap **New chat**, then wait for the empty text box to appear.

> open your gallery, select the 8 beach photos from last weekend, tap **Share** → **Gemini**.

> ➤ "Here are 8 photos from the same sunset. Can you group any that look like near-duplicates, and tell me which one of each group is the sharpest or best composed?"

> ➤ "Please transcribe the text in this screenshot. Format it as: store name, date, total amount, and any reference number."

> ➤ "Based on what you saw, give me a short checklist of which photos I can safely delete and which I should keep. Keep it under 5 bullet points."

> open the 8 beach photos, delete 5 based on Gemini's notes, star the best one, and paste the transcribed receipt text into your notes app.

How to Generate Images with Google Gemini: A Beginner's Guide

> ➤ "Create an image of..."

> ➤ "Create an image of a fluffy golden retriever puppy wearing a bright red collar, sitting on a sun-drenched green lawn next to a yellow tennis ball."

> ➤ "Generate a watercolour painting of a quiet beach at sunset, with soft purple and orange colors in the sky."

> ➤ "Can you make the sky in that last picture a bit more blue, and add a single sailboat in the background?"

Create Your First AI Image with Midjourney: A Beginner Walkthrough

> when asked for your email, use the one you check most often — that's where receipts and account notices will go.

> `a cozy reading nook by a window, warm lamp light, watercolor illustration, soft colors`

How to Create AI Logos with Recraft V4.1 Vector

> type a one-line description like "warm coffee shop, hand-lettered feel, soft cream and forest green" into the prompt box.

> prompt: "minimalist logo for a yoga studio, lotus flower, calm pastel palette, no text in the image."

> if you loved the lotus shape but the colors felt too cold, change "calm pastel palette" to "warm peach and sand palette" before you continue.

> paste your tightened prompt from Step 3 — for instance, "minimalist lotus logo, warm peach and sand palette, simple shapes only, no text."

> open the file in a browser tab, then zoom out until it looks tiny. If the lotus shape is still recognizable, you're good.

> `lotusyoga-logo-minimal-peach.svg`, `lotusyoga-logo-simple-mono.svg`, `lotusyoga-logo-with-text.svg`.

How to Create Custom Images with Copilot for Invites and Social Posts

> don't type anything yet — just make sure you can see the image-creation prompt box.

> ➤ "A watercolor birthday invitation background with soft pink peonies, gold confetti, and the words 'Emma turns 30' written in elegant script at the top."

> ➤ "Same image but make the peonies larger, and put the text 'Emma turns 30 — Saturday June 14' in the center."

> for the invite, ask for "A watercolor birthday invitation background with soft pink peonies and gold confetti, no text." Then you add "Emma turns 30 — Saturday June 14" yourself.

> click the **Download** button below your favorite peony image and wait for the file to appear in your Downloads folder.

> in Canva, click **"Uploads"**, drag in your downloaded peony image, drop it onto a square Instagram template, and add the text "Emma turns 30 — details in bio" on top.

Use Gemini on Your Phone to Pull Editable Text from Any Photo or Screenshot

> nothing to type yet — this step is just opening the app.

> no text needed yet, just pick the image.

> ➤ "Pull out all the text from this photo, line by line, exactly as written." — or — "Read the recipe in this image and list just the ingredients."

> paste it into Notes and you'll have a searchable copy of that faded parking sign — no more squinting at the photo.

> ➤ "Now translate that to Spanish." — or — "Shorten this list to the five most important points." — or — "Turn these ingredients into a grocery checklist with quantities."

Move Midjourney images into a Canva design without losing quality

> ➤ "Create a square social post, 1080 by 1080 pixels, with a bold headline for [your business name]." (Use this as a reminder for your own page setup; you don't type it into Canva.)

> prompt for Midjourney (type this before you download): "A quiet lighthouse on a rocky cliff at sunrise, [your chosen style], soft light, with open empty sky on the left for a headline, no text in the image."

> ➤ "Spring sale: [your offer] this weekend only" (type this into a Canva text box, not into Midjourney).

How to Turn a Messy Photo of Handwritten Notes Into Clean, Editable Text

> No typing yet. Just make sure your photo shows the whole page with all the handwriting visible.

> ➤ "Here is a photo of my handwritten notes. Transcribe every line exactly as written, keep the line breaks, and put a question mark in parentheses next to any word you cannot read."

> ➤ "Line 4 should read 'pick up dry cleaning on Thursday', not 'pick up dry cleaning on Tuesday'. Please fix that and keep everything else the same."

> ➤ "Using the corrected text above, turn it into a checklist grouped by [home tasks] and [work tasks]. Put anything with a day or time written next to it at the top of its group."

> ➤ "Transcribe this photo of handwritten [meeting or to-do] notes exactly as written. Mark unclear words with a question mark in parentheses. Then list action items, with a name next to each one if a name appears."

Build a simple weekly study plan with Meta AI in 10 minutes

> *Just open the app or website.*

> *Math exam 15 June, History essay due 20 June, Chemistry quiz 12 June, English speech 25 June*

> *Create a 7-day study plan that spreads the work evenly and includes short breaks.*

> *Move the Math block to 4 pm each day instead.*

> *For Math, list the exact chapters and topics I should study each day.*

> *Tap the share icon and choose "Copy."*

> *Paste the plan into tomorrow's calendar events.*

How to Translate and Understand Other Languages with AI

> Click the "New chat" button.

> Please translate the following Italian text into English and keep a relaxed, conversational tone:
>
> Ciao! Come stai? Spero che la giornata vada bene. Ci vediamo stasera?

> If the AI translated "Ciao! Come stai?" as "Hello! How are you?"

> Following on from the previous step, you might type:
> Could you make the greeting even more casual, like "Hey there! How's it going?" for "Ciao! Come stai?" And ensure the entire message keeps that very relaxed feel.

> Translate the following section of a legal document into plain English, maintaining a formal and precise tone, without using any legal jargon where a simpler term will suffice:
>
> [Paste the first few paragraphs of your legal document here]

> Highlight the AI's translation, press **Ctrl + C** (or **Cmd + C** on Mac), open a new Google Doc, and press **Ctrl + V** (or **Cmd + V** on Mac) to paste.

Use ChatGPT to Practice a Foreign Language Without Feeling Awkward

> name the chat *"Spanish practice — beginner"*.

> ➤ *"Please reply only in simple Spanish sentences. I'm a complete beginner. After each of my messages, correct any mistakes in a kind bullet list, then ask me a follow-up question to keep the conversation going. Keep your replies short."*

> if ChatGPT asked *"¿De dónde eres?"*, type *"Yo soy de México"* — or even the imperfect *"Yo es de México"* — so ChatGPT has something to correct, which is the whole point.

> say out loud *"Buenos días, ¿cómo estás?"* and wait for ChatGPT to answer in voice.

> ➤ *"I keep mixing up 'ser' and 'estar.' Can you give me 5 more practice sentences and tell me which one to use, with a short explanation?"*

> ➤ *"Please summarize today's lesson in 5 bullet points I can review before our next session, and list 3 things we should practice again."*

How to Build a 30-Day Plan to Learn Almost Any New Skill from Scratch

> ➤ "I want to learn beginner conversational Spanish so I can order food and have small talk on a trip to Mexico."

> ➤ "20 minutes a day on weekdays, weekends flexible, complete beginner, no paid courses."

> ➤ "I want to learn beginner conversational Spanish for a Mexico trip in 30 days. I have 20 minutes a day on weekdays, weekends are flexible, and I'm a complete beginner. Please build me a day-by-day plan that: 1) fits in 20 minutes on weekdays and up to 60 minutes on weekends, 2) focuses on speaking and listening first, 3) uses free resources only, and 4) includes a small checkpoint at the end of each week. Format as a numbered list, one entry per day."

> ➤ "Days 18–22 ask for 90 minutes each. I only have 60 minutes on weekends. Please rewrite that week with shorter sessions and remove the paid app recommendation."

> ➤ "I'll paste the plan into my calendar as 20-minute events on weekdays, and a 60-minute block on Saturday morning."

> ➤ "I'm on day 8. I skipped day 5 and day 6 because of work. Days 1–4 went well, but the 30-minute listening exercise felt too long. Can you adjust the rest of the plan so I still finish in 30 days total, and shorten the listening parts to 15 minutes?"

How to turn your messy study notes into practice quiz questions

> no typing in this step — you're just opening a clean chat.

> (a short chunk you might paste):
> ➤ "Cell biology chapter 7. Mitochondria = powerhouse of the cell, makes ATP. Double membrane: outer is smooth, inner folded into cristae. ATP made via the Krebs cycle in the matrix and the electron transport chain on the cristae. Chloroplasts are found only in plant cells and do photosynthesis. Both mitochondria and chloroplasts have their own DNA — endosymbiosis theory."

> (a prompt you can copy and adapt):
> ➤ "Turn the notes above into: (1) 5 multiple-choice questions with 4 options each, (2) 5 short-answer questions, (3) 5 flashcard-style Q&A pairs. Put the correct answer on a separate line for each one."

> (a quick fix prompt):
> ➤ "Question 3 says the answer is 1972, but my notes say 1927. Please correct it and double-check the rest for similar mistakes."

> (a paste title): "History Unit 4 practice questions — 12 March 2026"

> (a self-test routine): "10 questions, cover the answers, answer first, then check — repeat for any I missed."

How to use Qwen Chat to create personalized study flashcards for any subject

> ➤ *"Hi Qwen — I'm studying for a Year 9 biology exam on cell structure. Here's my notes: [paste your notes here, or describe: 'The main topics are animal cells vs plant cells, the function of the nucleus, mitochondria, ribosomes, cell membrane, and how osmosis works.' Please make 12 flashcards covering these."*

> ➤ *"Great, please rewrite those as a numbered list, with each one formatted exactly like this: 'Card 1 — Question: [question] | Answer: [answer]'. Use a vertical bar to separate Q and A so I can copy them straight into a spreadsheet."*

> ➤ *"Please add 6 more cards, but make them harder — focus on application and 'why' questions rather than simple definitions. Then quiz me on the first 5 cards one at a time."*

> ➤ *"I got these wrong: [list 2-3 topics]. Please make 4 more cards on those specific points, and include a tiny hint on the back of each one."*

Getting started with Z.ai: a beginner's guide to the free chatbot

> You don't need to type anything yet. Just find the message box.

> Not applicable here. You're just checking what's on screen.

> ➤ "Explain the difference between a sprain and a strain in simple words, and give me two examples of each, using [your hobby] as the example."

> ➤ "That's helpful, but I'm a complete beginner. Please rewrite it in five short sentences and avoid medical or technical words."

> ➤ "Help me write a short, friendly reminder to a neighbor about returning my ladder. Keep it under 60 words and end with a thank-you."

> Instead of pasting a real bill, try: "Here is a made-up bill for a [service type] with a $[amount] charge. Explain in simple terms what each line might mean."

Using Claude to Understand Complex Topics for Study or Work

> `Explain the concept of 'quantum entanglement' in physics.`

> `Can you explain that in simpler terms, like you're talking to a high school student?`

> `Please give me two everyday examples where this concept might apply.`

> `You mentioned 'decoherence' in the first explanation. Can you elaborate on what that means specifically?`

> `Can you summarise our conversation about quantum entanglement in three short paragraphs?`

AI Made Simple: A Gentle First Guide for Beginners

> Type **chatgpt.com** or **gemini.google.com** into your browser's address bar. Then, click "Sign up" and follow the prompts to create your free account.

> Type **Hello, how are you today?** into the chat box and press Enter.

> Instead of typing short, blunt terms like "scone recipe easy", type:
> **Could you please share a simple recipe for traditional scones that uses basic ingredients I likely have in my pantry?**

> If the recipe it gave you looks too detailed, you can type:
> **That recipe looks good, but could you please simplify it into just five clear, numbered steps?**

> **- Safe prompt: What are some gentle exercises to help improve balance at home?**

How to pick the right free AI app when you're just getting started

> ➤ "I want to draft a short email to my manager explaining why a project deadline needs to move."

> prompt to try in two tools: "Write a 150-word product description for a small handmade candle business."

> prompt: "Explain what a budget spreadsheet is to someone who has never made one."

> prompt: "Write a simple Python script that asks for your name and prints a greeting."

> After comparing results from Steps 2 through 4, note which tool you would open first if you had a real task due tomorrow.

How to study and learn faster with AI – a beginner's step-by-step guide

> Visit `https://chatgpt.com`. On the first page, click the "Sign up" button. Follow the prompts to enter your email, create a password, and verify your email address. You may also need to provide your name and date of birth. After completing the short setup, you'll land on the main chat interface. If it looks different, look for "Log In" or "Sign Up" usually in the top-right corner or center of the screen.

> Type into the message box:
> Explain photosynthesis in simple terms, like I'm a high-school student with no science background.

> Type into the message box:
> Summarize the main steps of photosynthesis in 5 bullet points.

> Type into the message box:
> Make three multiple-choice questions about the bullet-point summary of photosynthesis. Include one correct answer and three distractors for each question.

> Type into the message box:
> Here are my answers to the photosynthesis quiz: 1-B, 2-A, 3-C. Which are correct, and can you explain any mistakes?

Build a personal study-buddy flashcard page in 15 minutes with Hugging Face Spaces

> ["What is the capital of Canada?", "Ottawa"],

Using Perplexity AI for Quick Study Summaries and Exam Prep

> Choose **Academic** if you see it and you're preparing an essay on a history or science topic.

> ➤ "I am a biology student preparing for an exam. Summarize the key differences between mitosis and meiosis. Present this as a simple comparison table followed by bullet points explaining the main phases of each."

> ➤ "Based on the summary of cell division you just created, write a 5-question multiple-choice quiz. Put the answers at the very bottom of your response so I don't see them while I test myself."

The main AI assistants explained simply (and what each is best at)

> ➤ "Give me a step-by-step plan to organize my garage this weekend, including how to categorise items."

> ➤ "Read this draft email to my landlord and help me make the tone more polite but firm."

> ➤ "What are the latest updates on the local public transport extensions, and where can I read the official announcements?"

> ➤ "Translate this business greeting into polite conversational Japanese and explain any cultural etiquette I should keep in mind."

How to use Meta AI inside WhatsApp – step-by-step for beginners

> Tap the Search field at the top of your Chats, type "Suggest a quick dinner idea", and tap **Ask**.

> Type "Hi Meta AI, what can you do?" and press the send button (usually a paper plane icon).

> Type "What's a simple, healthy breakfast idea I can make in under 5 minutes?" and send it.

> Tap and hold Meta AI's breakfast recipe, then choose "Copy" from the menu that appears.

> After getting the breakfast idea, type "Can you suggest some healthy lunch ideas too, keeping the 5-minute prep time in mind?" and send.

> Open your chat with Meta AI, tap the plus sign, and type "Help me plan a picnic for four people."

ABeginner's Guide to Using ChatGPT Voice for Hands-Free Tasks

> ➤ "Hi! I'm planning a weekend trip to the Blue Ridge Mountains. Can you suggest some scenic bushwalks that are good for beginners?"

> ➤ "Those sound great! What's the best way to get to the Wentworth Falls track if I'm coming from Chicago?"

> (While ChatGPT is explaining) "ChatGPT, hold on a moment please."

> ➤ "Okay ChatGPT, tell me a short mystery story, but pause every two minutes so I can guess the suspect."

Getting started with DeepSeek for everyday help

> Copy and paste this prompt into the chat box to try it out:
> ➤ "I have a busy Saturday ahead. I need to take the dog to the vet at 9:00am (takes 1 hour), buy groceries (takes 45 minutes), and drop off a birthday present at my sister's house, which is a 20-minute drive from the vet. I also need to be home by 1:00pm for a delivery. Can you organize the perfect, stress-free schedule for me, including realistic travel times?"

Getting started with MiniMax Code: a beginner's guide

> ➤ "Help me plan five easy weekday dinners for [number] people. Keep each meal under 30 minutes and list the ingredients for each one."

> ➤ "Thanks. Make the list vegetarian, and cut it down to three dinners that need no more than five ingredients each."

> ➤ "Summarize the text below in five short bullet points for a busy reader. Text: [paste your paragraph here]"

> ➤ "List the three main assumptions behind your last answer, so I can check each one myself."

Organize your work with Claude Projects – a step-by-step beginner's guide

> `email@example.com` + `YourPassword` → press **Enter**.

> Name: Q3 Marketing Campaign
> Description: All copy, ad ideas and feedback for the upcoming quarter

> Tick "Ad copy brainstorming" and "Email subject line ideas", then click **Add**.

> Drag `CampaignBrief.pdf` from your desktop onto the upload box.

> Summarize the key ideas from all attached chats and the brief, and suggest three headline options.

> Click **Share**, then press **Copy link**.

> `Give me a quick summary of the chat and the uploaded file.`

Getting started with Kimi: a beginner's guide

> ➤ "Explain what a context window is in simple words, using a kitchen example."

> ➤ "Summarize that answer in three short bullet points I could read in under a minute."

> ➤ "Thanks. Now give me the same explanation again, but for a 10-year-old and in under 80 words."

> ➤ "Help me write a short, polite email to my landlord asking when the [repair type] will be fixed, and keep it under 100 words."

ChatGPT for Teens: Using the New College Planner and Flashcards to Study

> ➤ "Help me make a college application timeline. I'm a [grade level] student who wants to apply to [number] schools."

> ➤ "My deadline list so far is unknown, so mark those as to-confirm. I want to focus on [your state or region] schools and apply early in [month]."

> ➤ "Narrow that to the next two weeks only, and make each task take under 30 minutes."

> ➤ "Make 10 flashcards on [subject topic] from these notes. Front: a question. Back: a short answer under 15 words. Notes: [paste your notes here]."

> ➤ "Quiz me on [subject topic], one question at a time. Wait for my answer, then tell me if I'm right and explain briefly."

> ➤ "Which items on this timeline need me to confirm dates on each college's official admissions website?"

Turn one sentence into a ready-to-use study timetable with Qwen Chat

> `Start a new chat`

> `Create a 7-day study plan for my math and science exams on 15 June. I have 10 days left and must cover algebra, geometry, and the periodic table.`

> `Make the blocks 50 minutes each with 10-minute breaks. Keep weekends mostly free and add 8 hours of sleep each night.`

> `Add colour-coded labels for each subject and include the page numbers or topics for every block.`

> `Copy the plan below into your calendar: Monday 10 June, 4:00–5:00pm – 🔴 Math – Algebra (p.45-52)`

> `Give me a quick summary of hours per subject and one tip for each.`

How to build a simple study schedule in the weeks before a big exam

> For a 21-day window, write `W1 — foundation | W2 — depth | W3 — review & mock`. For 10 days, write `W1 — learn + drill | W2 — review + mock`.

> `Ch 4 — Cell biology | weight: H | weakness: H`, `Ch 7 — Statistics | weight: M | weakness: L`, `Ch 11 — Lab safety | weight: L | weakness: M`.

> a week might look like `Mon 7–8am: Ch 4 cell biology | Mon 8:30–9pm: 30 min flashcards Ch 7 | Tue 7–8am: Ch 4 problems | Wed 6:30–7:30pm: Ch 5`.

> in your daily block, write `7:00–7:45 work | 7:45–7:55 break | 7:55–8:30 work`. For the weekly self-check, write a single line: `Sun 6pm — what got done / what didn't / what moves`.

> set a 10-minute timer, answer one past-paper question on your H-weighted, H-weakness topic, then write one sentence: `Felt too short — add 20 min next week` or `Felt OK — keep as is`.

Getting Started with Alibaba's Qwen Chatbot

> ➤ "Hello Qwen! I am learning how to use your chatbot. Can you please introduce yourself in two short sentences and tell me what your name means?"

> ➤ "Could you please translate 'I would love to invite you to our community barbecue this weekend' into casual French and polite Japanese?"

> ➤ "Please organize this messy list of groceries into neat categories: apples, chicken breast, broccoli, carrots, rice, milk, cheddar cheese, and pasta."

> ➤ "Summarize this paragraph for me, keeping it to two sentences: 'The annual community fete will be held next Saturday, October 26th, from 10 am to 4 pm at the Central Park Oval. There will be food stalls, live music, face painting for kids, and a pet show. Entry is free, but donations for local charities are welcome. Please bring your own picnic blanket and water bottle.'"

Getting started with GitHub Copilot: a beginner's guide

> In the Extensions search bar, type `Copilot`.

> After clicking "Sign in", enter your GitHub username and password in the browser window.

> For the filename, type `hello.py`.

> Type `# write a function that prints hello world` and press Enter.

> Type `print_hello_world()` (using the exact function name Copilot generated) on a new line after the function definition, then press `F5`.

Getting started with Cohere: a beginner's guide

> Write a short welcome email for new customers. Keep it friendly and under 100 words.

> Make it shorter, about 60 words, and use a warmer, more personal tone.

> Summarize these three points of customer feedback: "The product was easy to use. Shipping took longer than expected. Customer service was helpful but slow to respond."

Getting started with Microsoft Copilot in everyday apps

> (No typing needed for this step, just observation.)

> `Summarize this article about recent climate change research.`

> `Summarize this email in three bullet points, focusing on key action items.`

> `Create an outline for a 5-slide presentation on how to reduce household energy consumption.`

> `What is the current time in London, UK?`

Getting started with Duck.ai: a beginner's guide to private AI chat

> ➤ "Give me three simple dinner ideas I can cook in under 30 minutes for [number] people, using [two ingredients you have]."

> ➤ "Thanks. Make these ideas shorter, and add one tip for a beginner who has never cooked [dish type]."

> ➤ "Help me write a short thank-you note to my neighbor for watering my plants while I was away."

Getting started with Claude for clear, careful help

> Enter your email address and choose the option to continue with email. You'll then be asked to check your inbox for a login link.

> Open the email from Claude and click the login link, or enter the verification code on the original device if you were asked for one.

> Click inside the message box. Your cursor will start blinking, indicating it's ready for you to type.

> Copy a long piece of text (e.g., from a news article), paste it into the message box, then type this directly below the pasted text:
> ➤ *"Please summarize the text above into three simple, easy-to-read bullet points. Highlight any action steps I need to take."*

> Type this into the message box:
> ➤ *"I need to ask my neighbor to keep their dog from barking early in the morning. Can you draft a friendly, polite, but clear note I can drop in their mailbox? I want to keep a good relationship with them, so please make sure it's not accusatory."*

How to translate and condense foreign-language articles with Copilot

> nothing to type yet — just have the empty chat window open and ready.

> just paste the article text directly into the box, no instructions yet — you'll add the ask in the next step.

> ➤ "This is in German. Please give me a 5-bullet summary in plain English, no jargon, written for a general reader."

> ➤ "Translate the paragraph about the new tax rules in full, in everyday English. Keep any proper names, dates, and numbers exactly as they are."

> nothing to type — just select the text you want and copy it somewhere you'll find it again.

How to Study Three Sources for One Exam in Gemini Notebook

> name the notebook "Final Exam — Macroeconomic Policy."

> add (1) the Chapter 12 PDF, (2) the lecture slides Google Doc, (3) the journal article link.

> ➤ "Create a study guide for my midterm on climate policy. List the 8 most-tested concepts from these sources, define each in 2 sentences, and flag any points where the three sources disagree."

> tap "Generate" beside "Audio Overview," then wait for the "Ready" badge.

> ➤ "Quiz me with 5 short-answer questions on the carbon cycle, then show me which source each answer came from."

Getting Started with ChatGPT: Your First 15 Minutes

> `myemail@example.com` – type your own email address where the form asks for it.

> `What are three quick ways to organize a weekend garden project?` – copy and paste the sentence into the box.

> `Suggest five healthy dinner ideas that use chicken and broccoli.` – copy this line exactly and press Enter.

> `Can you make those ideas vegetarian instead?` – paste this and hit Enter.

> `Explain how a basic battery charger works.` – type this into the fresh chat box and press Enter.

Translate a Foreign-Language Message in Messenger with Meta AI

> a Spanish message that says *"Oye, podemos vernos mañana a las 5?"* (you don't know what it means yet).

> type `@Meta AI` and tap the Meta AI suggestion from the pop-up list.

> `@Meta AI translate this to English: "Oye, podemos vernos mañana a las 5?"`

> Meta AI's reply reads *"Hey, can we meet tomorrow at 5?"* — that one is smooth and obvious in meaning.

> `@Meta AI can you make that sound more casual?` or `@Meta AI what does "mañana" mean on its own?`

Getting Started with Grok: Your Guide to Everyday AI Answers

> type grok.com into your browser's address bar and press Enter.

> on your phone, sign in with the same account you used on your computer, so your earlier chats appear in both places.

> type: "I have some leftover roast chicken, half a pumpkin, and some spinach. Can you suggest a simple dinner recipe I can make in under 30 minutes?"

> after receiving a recipe, type: "Could you make that a vegetarian recipe instead?"

> type: "What are the latest updates on the space mission launch from this morning? Summarize the main points in three bullet points and list your sources."

Getting started with Google Gemini for everyday life

> (keywords only): "Best parks in Chicago with barbecues"

> (a full prompt): "I am planning a family picnic in Chicago. Recommend three parks with free barbecues, shade, and nearby parking."

> ➤ "I have leftover pumpkin, baby spinach, and pasta in my cupboard. Can you suggest a simple dinner recipe I can make in 20 minutes using these ingredients?"

> follow-up prompts:
> - "Can you make that recipe dairy-free?"

How to Get Quick Summaries from Long Documents with Claude

> ➤ "Please summarize this document for me, highlighting the main points and key takeaways relevant to small businesses."

> ➤ "Can you list the top three challenges mentioned in the document and suggest potential solutions?"

Turn Messy Notes into a Polite Meeting Agenda in Five Minutes

> ➤ "Below is the email thread about our Q3 launch. Goal: 30-minute sync to unblock the design freeze. Attendees: Maria, John, Sarah."

> ➤ "Now produce the draft. Use a polite opener, list each topic with a duration in minutes and a single owner, leave a 2-minute buffer between topics, and end with a one-line confirmation request."

> ➤ "The opener feels stiff. Loosen it. Our team uses first names and avoids phrases like 'circling back'. Keep the same structure and timings."

> ➤ "Confirm each topic has exactly one owner. Add up the minutes and show the total at the end. If anything overflows, suggest what to cut."

> ➤ "Add a 'Next steps' block at the end: Maria sends the calendar invite by tomorrow morning; John brings the latest design mockup; follow-up sync the following Monday."

> a doc titled "Agenda from messy notes" with three labeled blocks: [PASTE INPUT], [STRUCTURE REQUEST], [TONE NOTES].

How to Clean Up a Flooded Email Inbox Using AI in One Afternoon

> open chatgpt.com, claude.ai, gemini.google.com, or copilot.microsoft.com.

> in Gmail, tick the checkbox at the top of the inbox. If a "Select all conversations" link appears, click it. Open the ⋯ menu and choose "Export."

> prompt: *"Here is a list of my unread emails. Group them into 5–7 folder names that make sense, and tell me which emails go in which folder. Use plain folder names a normal person would understand. Don't add explanations yet — just the list."*

> in Gmail, look in the left sidebar, scroll to "Labels," click the "+" next to it, and type "Bills & Receipts." In Outlook web, right-click "Folders" in the sidebar and choose "New folder."

> type `label:unread from:newsletter` in the search box, select all results, move them to your "Newsletters" folder in one click.

> prompt: *"Here are the remaining unread emails. Write me one short paragraph (under 100 words) telling me what I actually need to act on today, what's due this week, and what I can ignore. Start with the most urgent."*

> copy the paragraph into a new email titled "Today" addressed to yourself, and pin it at the top of your inbox.

Check your resume for ATS-friendly keywords using Hugging Face's Inference API

> Email: yourname@example.com
> Username: resumehelper
> Password: MyPassword123!

> I need help finding ATS-friendly keywords for a job application.
> Here is the job ad:
> We are looking for a digital marketing specialist with experience in SEO, Google Analytics, and content creation.
>
> Here is my resume:
> I have 3 years of experience in digital marketing, including social media management and email campaigns.

> Rewrite this sentence from my resume to include the keyword SEO:
> "I have 3 years of experience in digital marketing, including social media management and email campaigns."

Drafting Professional Presentations from Scratch Using Microsoft Copilot in PowerPoint

> Type or paste:
> Help me create a presentation about the benefits of remote work for a team of 20 software developers.

> Create an outline for a 10-minute presentation on 'How Remote Work Boosts Developer Productivity'. Include slides on flexibility, tools, and team culture.

> For a slide titled “Flexibility,” Copilot might add:
> Speaker notes: Remote work lets developers choose their most productive hours. Studies show 60% of developers report higher focus at home. Mention our recent productivity report from Q2.

> Add a quote from Satya Nadella about remote work culture to the last slide.

Digitize Handwritten Notes into Editable Text with AI

> Place your handwritten notes on a plain, uncluttered surface, like a clear desk. Position them under natural light from a window, if possible, or use a well-lit lamp to avoid casting shadows over your writing. Make sure the paper is flat and smooth, with no creases.

> Tap the "Google Keep" app icon on your home screen or app drawer (it looks like a yellow and white notepad). Alternatively, tap the "Microsoft OneNote" app icon (a blue notebook icon).

> In Google Keep, tap the plus (+) icon at the bottom of the screen, then choose the camera icon (it might be labeled 'Take photo' or 'Image'). In Microsoft OneNote, select 'Camera' from the options at the bottom, then hold your phone steady over your notes and tap the shutter button.

> In Google Keep, after your photo is captured, tap on the image to view it full screen. Then, look for a three-dot menu (⋯) in the top-right corner of the screen and tap the option labeled 'Grab image text'. In Microsoft OneNote, after taking a photo, tap the 'Text' icon that appears on the captured image to extract the text.

> Carefully read through the digitized text. If you spot a word like "flow" incorrectly appearing as "flew," tap on "flew" and type "flow" to correct it. Also, remove any extra spaces, line breaks, or unwanted characters the AI might have picked up from smudges or background textures on the paper.

> Tap the 'Save' or 'Done' button within your chosen app to store the note. Alternatively, look for a 'Share' icon (often a three-dot connection or an upward-pointing arrow) to copy the text to your phone's clipboard or send it directly to an email, a document app like Google Docs or Microsoft Word, or cloud storage like Google Drive or OneDrive.

Summarize Any Long Document or Article with AI

> Open a long email thread. Press `Ctrl+A` (Windows) or `Cmd+A` (Mac) to select the entire email body, then press `Ctrl+C` (Windows) or `Cmd+C` (Mac).

> Open your web browser and navigate to `gemini.google.com`. Log in to your account if prompted, then ensure you have a blank conversation ready.

> Type this into the chat box (do not press Enter or Send yet):
> ➤ "Please summarize the following document in three concise bullet points. Keep the language neutral and factual, avoiding any personal opinions or interpretations."

> ➤ "Please summarize the following document in three concise bullet points. Keep the language neutral and factual, avoiding any personal opinions or interpretations.

> ➤ "The third bullet point mentions 'Section 5'. Please confirm the exact wording of Section 5 from the original text and update that bullet point to be more precise. Also, can you ensure the overall tone is strictly professional?"

> Paste the finalised bullet points into a new email, a team chat application like Microsoft Teams, or a note-taking app on your phone to share or save.

How to turn a long PDF contract into a plain-English summary in 5 minutes

> ➤ "I'm uploading a contract. Please don't analyze it yet — I'll ask my questions one at a time."

> ➤ "In plain English, what is this document, who are the parties, and what is the main thing being agreed to?"

> ➤ "From this contract, list: 1) every deadline or time limit I need to know, 2) every fee, charge, or price that might apply, and 3) exactly how I cancel, including any notice period. Use bullet points."

> ➤ "What happens if I miss a payment, who covers legal fees in a dispute, can the company change the terms mid-contract, and which state's laws apply? Point me to the section for each."

> ➤ "Summarize everything we just found into a one-page checklist I can save: dates I must remember, amounts I'll be charged, and the steps to cancel. Keep it under 15 lines."

> ➤ "Cancellation clause says 30 days, fees say a charge after year one, and auto-renewal is 60 days before expiration — can you re-read sections 7, 9, and 12 and tell me if your summary matches?"

Unlock Document Insights with Gemini Notebook

> `My Research Notes on Renewable Energy`

> `What are the key challenges mentioned in the "Renewable Energy Report.pdf"?`

> `Can you summarise the solutions proposed for reducing these challenges?`

Translate Everyday Documents with DeepSeek Chat

> (After pasting your text, type this into the message box):
> Please translate this into English in a natural, easy-to-read style. Keep the layout simple and do not add extra explanations.

> Make the translation more conversational and keep the same tone as the original.

How to Prepare for a Job Interview Using a Pasted Job Post

> name it "Acme – Marketing Lead interview prep."

> JOB POSTING:
> [Paste the full job description here — responsibilities, requirements, and any "nice to haves"]
>
> ABOUT ME:
> [Paste 4–6 sentences: current role, years of experience, two recent achievements with numbers if you have them]

> ➤ "Based on the job posting and my background above, give me ten interview questions a hiring manager is most likely to ask me. Mix behavioral, technical, and situational questions. For each, add one sentence on what they're really trying to find out."

> ➤ "Now for each of those ten questions, give me two concrete talking points I could use, drawing from my background. Keep each point to one or two sentences. Flag any question where my pasted background seems thin."

> ➤ "Give me five strong questions I, the candidate, can ask back at the end of the interview. Make them specific to this role and company. Skip anything generic like 'what's the culture like'."

> pick the talking points that felt truest to your real work — maybe one about leadership, one about a measurable result, one about a hard problem you solved — and re-read them once before you walk into the interview.

Write a Resume From Scratch (Even With No Work Experience)

> section headers to copy — `Summary`, `Experience`, `Education`, `Skills`, `Projects`.

> ➤ "High school senior finishing in May 2026. Strong with customers, cash handling, and staying calm under pressure. Looking for part-time retail or front-desk work."

> (babysitting): `Cared for three children (ages 4–9) after school each day. Prepared snacks, helped with homework, and organized weekly craft activities.`

> (school project): `Led a 4-person team on a science fair project. Researched topics, delegated tasks, and presented findings to a panel of 5 judges.`

> education entry: `Lincoln High School — Expected graduation May 2027. Coursework: Business Math, Intro to Computer Science, Spanish II.`

> skills line: `Skills: Google Docs, Sheets, Canva, social media scheduling (Meta Business Suite), conversational Spanish, POS cash handling.`

> project entry: `Project: Neighborhood plant-swap app — designed a simple scheduling tool in Google Sheets, promoted via local Facebook group, coordinated 3 successful swaps with 40+ attendees.`

> cut this — "Responsible for various tasks including helping customers." Replace with — "Greeted 80+ customers daily, restocked shelves, and handled returns at a family-run grocery store."

How to Use Gemini Deep Research for Thorough Reports

> ➤ "Act as an expert researcher for a homeowner. Please conduct a deep, multi-step search of the web to investigate current trends in home solar battery storage for residential properties in the US. Focus on average cost ranges, typical lifespan, available government rebates or incentives, and environmentally friendly recycling options. Organize the report with clear headings, bullet points, and provide specific examples where possible. Include links to your sources."

> If Gemini asks, "Are you interested in global statistics or a specific country for the solar battery research?" you might reply:
> ➤ "Focus primarily on American residential properties, especially those in suburban and regional areas, not just cities."

> ➤ "Can you expand on the environmental impact of lithium-ion battery production? Also, please summarize the key points of this report in three bullet points, suitable for a quick presentation slide."

How to Organize a Messy Email Inbox Into Simple Folders in One Sitting

> tell yourself out loud, "I'm spending the next 35 minutes on this. No answering anything that needs more than 60 seconds."

> search "Amazon" and count how many emails you find. If the number is in the double digits, that's a sender you'll handle in Step 3.

> for the Amazon thread - open one message, click "unsubscribe" near the bottom, wait for the confirmation page, then select all Amazon emails (look for a checkbox at the top of the list) and click "Archive" or "Delete."

> name them "To act on," "To read later," "To keep" - exactly those three, no more. Resist the urge to add a fourth on the same day.

> a newsletter you want to read on the weekend → drag to "To read later." A package tracking update → drag to "To keep." A friend's question that needs a real answer → drag to "To act on."

> in Gmail settings, choose "Create new filter" → From: newsletter@example.com → "Apply the label: To read later." Every future issue lands in the right folder automatically, no work from you.

Practice job interview questions with Qwen before the real interview

> just type "Hi" first to confirm the chat is responsive, then move to Step 2 to set up the real practice.

> ➤ "I have an interview next week for a marketing coordinator role at a mid-size SaaS company. I have 2 years of experience in social media and email campaigns. Please act as the hiring manager and interview me one question at a time. After each answer, give me feedback on clarity, completeness, and confidence, then move to the next question."

> if Qwen asks "Tell me about a time you handled a difficult customer," you might type something like: "At my old retail job, a customer wanted to return a laptop past the 30-day window. I listened to her frustration, explained the policy, then asked my manager if we could do a store credit as a one-time exception. She agreed, and the customer left happy. I learned that sometimes bending the rules a little keeps a customer for life."

> ➤ "Before the next question, can you give me feedback on my last answer? Specifically: (1) Was it clear and easy to follow? (2) Did I actually answer what was asked? (3) Did I sound confident or unsure? (4) What is the one thing I should improve? Please be honest — I'd rather hear it from you than from a real interviewer."

> ➤ "That feedback helps. Now please ask me a follow-up question about the same story — something a real interviewer would press me on. I'll answer, you give me feedback, and then we move on."

> ➤ "Can you give me a summary of the three strongest answers from this session, plus one thing I should remember to improve next time?"

How to write a polite but firm complaint email that actually gets a reply

> ➤ "Bought a blue wool coat from Example Outfitters on March 4 (order #1234). It arrived March 10 with a torn lining. Emailed support on March 11, no reply. I'd like a replacement shipped by March 25, or a full refund."

type "I want to draft a complaint email" as your first line, just to confirm the chat is responding.

> ➤ "Please draft a polite but firm complaint email. Facts: [paste your five facts here]. Tone: calm, professional, no sarcasm, no insults. Length: under 150 words. End with one specific ask and a reasonable deadline of 5 business days. Do not invent any order numbers, dates, or names I didn't give you."

> ➤ "Make this sound more confident. I'm being reasonable, but I expect a real answer."

> ➤ "Shorten this to one ask: I want a replacement coat shipped by March 25. Remove the part about the discount."

follow-up: "Following up on my email below — I haven't received a response. I'd still like a replacement coat shipped by March 25. Please let me know either way."

Draft a Polite but Firm Refund Email with Le Chat

you don't need to type anything yet. Just click the button that starts a new chat.

> ➤ "I bought a noise-canceling headphone set from AudioBrand on October 12, order #44291, for $189. It was supposed to arrive by October 19. It arrived on October 24 in a damaged box, and the right ear cup doesn't work. AudioBrand support replied once and then stopped responding."

> ➤ "Now please turn this into a refund request email. Keep the tone polite but firm — I'm a regular customer who's been patient, but I want a real resolution, not a generic reply. Don't threaten legal action. Keep it under 200 words."

> ➤ "Please add my order number (#44291), the date I bought it (October 12), and a line asking for a full refund or a replacement within 7 business days. Also add a short closing sentence thanking them for looking into it."

> ➤ "Can you give me one more version that's shorter and more direct — about 100 words? Keep the same tone and the same ask."

your finished email might start, "Hi AudioBrand Support team, I'm writing about order #44291, a noise-canceling headphone set I purchased on October 12..."

How to Summarize and Organize a Long Meeting Transcript You Recorded

> ➤ "This is Part 1 of 3 from the [project name] weekly sync, recorded on [date]."

> ➤ "You are helping me organize a meeting transcript. Use only what is stated in the transcript and never guess. Produce four sections: Summary, Decisions, Action items (task, owner, due date), and Open questions. If an owner or date is not stated, write 'not stated.' The participants are [meeting participants]."

> ➤ "Using the transcript above, write a summary of no more than 150 words. Then list each decision that was made, with the exact sentence it came from in quotation marks."

> ➤ "Using the decisions you just listed and the transcript, list the action items. For each one give the task, the owner, and the due date. If the transcript doesn't name an owner or a date, write 'not stated.' Then quote the line where each owner's name appears."

> ➤ "List the open questions: topics that were raised but not settled. Then re-check your decisions and action items against the transcript, and tell me which ones you cannot confirm from the text."

> ➤ "Sync notes: [project name], [month] [year]"

How to Draft a Polite Follow-up Email After a Job Interview

> *Asked about handling an angry customer → I told the café story. Mentioned the new Nashville office opens in March.*

> `Subject: Thank you — Marketing Coordinator interview`

> *Hi Sarah, thank you so much for taking the time to chat with me this morning about the Marketing Coordinator role. I really enjoyed hearing how the team is planning the March launch.*

> *Our chat about managing the café's social media during the weekend rush reminded me how much I enjoy fast-paced, customer-facing work — that's exactly the energy I'd love to bring to your team.*

> *I'm excited about the role and would love to hear how the next steps look. Thanks again, Sarah — have a lovely rest of your week.*

> (final email): *Hi Sarah, thank you so much for taking the time to chat with me this morning about the Marketing Coordinator role. I especially enjoyed hearing how the team is planning the March launch. Our conversation about handling busy weekend rushes reminded me how much I love fast-paced, customer-facing work, and I'd be thrilled to bring that energy to Wynnum Co. I'm excited about the role and would love to hear how the next steps look. Warm regards, Jordan.*

How to practice for a job interview with an AI mock interviewer tonight

> just open the chat — no typing yet.

> ➤ "I'm preparing for a Senior Customer Success interview at a B2B SaaS company. Here is the job description: [paste]. My background: 4 years in support, promoted once, led a small team. Please ask me one question at a time, like a real interviewer would."

> ➤ "Ask me one question at a time. Start with: 'Tell me about a time you had to win back an unhappy customer.'"

> ➤ "Rate my answer from 1 to 5 on clarity, specificity, and impact. Give me one strength and one specific thing to improve. Be honest — I'd rather hear it from you than from an interviewer."

> ➤ "Now run a 5-question mock interview, one question at a time. Wait for my answer before moving on. Mix behavioral and role-specific questions."

> ➤ "Based on this whole session, list the three patterns that hurt my answers most, and the one question I should drill tomorrow."

Pull Names, Emails, and Phone Numbers Out of Messy Text with Cohere

> Below the pasted text, add: `Extract every person's full name, email address, and phone number from the text above. Return the result as a plain list with one contact per line, in this format: Name – Email – Phone.`

Use Alexa+ as a Hands-Free Meeting Note-Taker and Task Builder at Work

> say *"Alexa, create a note called Q2 planning sync."*

> ➤ *"Alexa, write this down: Maria will finalize the budget by Friday. John is drafting the comms. Sarah is booking the follow-up."*

> ➤ *"Alexa, pull the action items from my Q2 planning sync note and read them back to me."*

> ➤ *"Alexa, add all of those action items to my Work to-do list."*

> ➤ *"Alexa, draft a follow-up email from my Q2 planning sync note. Keep it under five sentences."*

> ➤ *"Alexa, show my note called Q2 planning sync so I can review it."*

How to build or improve your CV with AI

> 2022–2024 Café Manager, Brew House
> - Led a team of 8 during peak hours
> - Created weekly rosters and handled payroll
> - Reduced waste by 15 % through better ordering
> 2020-2022 Barista, The Daily Grind
> - Prepared coffee and served customers
> - Managed cash register and end-of-day reports
> - Maintained cleanliness and stock levels

> List:
> 2022–2024 Café Manager, Brew House
> - Led a team of 8 during peak hours
> - Created weekly rosters and handled payroll
> - Reduced waste by 15 % through better ordering
>
> Turn the list into a clean, professional CV in American English.
> Use a simple reverse-chronological layout.
> Keep it to one page.
> Use bullet points, not paragraphs.
> Do not add any made-up details.

> Rewrite every bullet point to start with a strong action verb and include a quantifiable result where possible.

> Please rewrite my CV bullet points to specifically match the keywords and skills mentioned in this job description:
>
> [Paste the full job description here, e.g., "Seeking a café manager with proven leadership skills, experience in staff rostering, and a track record of reducing operational costs and food waste."]

> Give me the final CV in plain text so I can easily copy it into Word or Google Docs for final formatting.

Turn a Messy Spreadsheet Export into Clean Data with Copilot

> type a test message like "Hi" to confirm it works.

> a typical messy row might look like `john smith,01/05/2024,yes,USA` — that's what we're going to clean.

> after pasting, type — *"Clean this CSV. Make all dates YYYY-MM-DD, capitalize names properly, remove the 'country' column, and standardize 'yes/no' to TRUE/FALSE."*

> type — *"The dates are now wrong. January 5 became 2024-05-01 instead of 2024-01-05. The original format was DD/MM/YYYY."*

> type — *"Here's a sample of my CSV. Write a Python script that cleans the full file the same way and saves the result as clean_data.csv."*

> name the new file `customers_clean_2024.csv` so it's easy to find later.

Transcribe spoken meetings or interviews into text with AI for notes

> Go to `chatgpt.com` in your web browser.

> Click the "New Chat" button in the top-left corner.

> Click the paperclip icon, then select your "Meeting_Notes_Audio.mp3" file from your Downloads folder.

> ➤ "Please transcribe this audio. If possible, identify different speakers."

> The AI displays a long block of text beginning with "Speaker 1: Welcome everyone..."

> ➤ "Can you now provide a summary of the key decisions made in the recording?"

Write a polite refund request email in 2 minutes with ChatGPT

> I purchased a faulty toaster from "Toast Heaven" online on 28 May 2024 for $55.00, order number TH98765. It only toasts on one side. I would like a polite email requesting a full refund.

> Can you make it a bit more direct and also ask for instructions on how to return the faulty item?

Use AI to Rewrite Your Resume and Catch a Recruiter's Attention

> paste into a new note titled "Resume — May 2026 — plain".

> type "Hi" first, just to confirm the chat is working.

> ➤ "Here is my resume. Rewrite it so each bullet starts with a strong action verb, keep it to one page worth of content, and only use facts I already gave you — do not add jobs, degrees, or skills I did not mention."

> ➤ "Read the resume I pasted earlier. List 5–8 things a recruiter would notice as missing, vague, or weak. For each, say what I should add or fix. Do not assume things about me that I did not tell you."

> if the AI changed "Helped customers with questions" to "Resolved complex customer escalations", only keep it if you actually handled difficult escalations — otherwise soften it back to what really happened.

> read each bullet out loud; if you stumble on a sentence, rewrite it before you save.

Generate a quick FAQ page for a small business website using Perplexity

> (Just press Enter—no typing needed yet.)

> Create a clear, well-organized FAQ page for a small eco-cleaning business called GreenShine Cleaners. Use these customer questions: “What cleaning products do you use?”, “Are your products safe for pets?”, “How do I book a cleaning session?”, “Do you offer eco-certified cleaning?”, and “What areas do you serve?”. Keep answers short, friendly, and ready to paste onto a website.

> Make the answer to “What cleaning products do you use?” shorter and more casual. Also, add a line about how customers can request a full ingredient list.

> Please organize the FAQ into a clean numbered list with bold question headings and short answers underneath each one. Make it ready to paste directly onto a website.

> (No typing needed—just highlight and copy.)

> GreenShine Cleaners – Frequently Asked Questions

Practice answers for your next job interview with Meta AI

leave the box blank for now and tap the send arrow so Meta AI knows you're ready.

➤ "I'm interviewing for a project coordinator role next week. Can you act as a friendly interviewer and ask me five common questions, one at a time? After I answer each one, give me feedback on clarity and length, then move to the next question."

(typed answer to "Tell me about yourself"): "I'm a customer support specialist with four years of experience helping SaaS users. Before that I worked in retail, where I learned how to keep calm when someone's frustrated. I'm looking for a role where I can grow into team leadership."

➤ "Please rate my last answer on three things: (1) clarity, (2) length — was it too long or too short?, and (3) tone — did it sound confident? Then give me two concrete suggestions to improve it."

➤ "Here's my revised answer. Compare it to my first one — which parts are clearer, and which sentence should I cut?"

➤ "Thanks, that was helpful. Please ask me the next interview question."

Ask any AI assistant to explain the confusing parts of a lease or contract

imagine the lease says, "Lessee shall be liable for all damages arising from Lessee's use of the premises, including but not limited to structural damage caused by Lessee, Lessee's guests, or Lessee's invitees." Copy that whole sentence — that's the paragraph you'll work with.

paste the lease paragraph above, then add this line: "Explain this in plain English, like you're talking to a friend who has never rented before. Tell me what I'd actually have to do or pay."

➤ "What am I actually agreeing to do here? What's the worst part I should be worried about? Give me one concrete example of when this clause would kick in for me."

➤ "Pretend I'm about to sign this lease tomorrow. What 5 questions should I ask the landlord — or my own lawyer — before I do? List them in plain English."

Turn Your Class Notes Into Practice Questions With Any AI Assistant

> One lecture's worth of typed notes, three photos of a whiteboard, or the last few hundred words of a Google Doc.

> Visit chatgpt.com, gemini.google.com, claude.ai, copilot.microsoft.com, or chat.mistral.ai — any of these will do.

> ➤ "Here are my notes on cellular respiration. Please create 10 practice questions that mix multiple-choice, short-answer, and one short essay. Start easy and get harder."

> ➤ "Great list. Now quiz me one at a time. After I answer, tell me if I'm right and briefly explain why. Wait for me before showing the next question."

> ➤ "Based on my answers, list the 3 topics I struggled with most and suggest one specific thing I should re-read in my notes for each."

How to Tailor Your Resume to a Specific Job Posting in 15 Minutes

> prompt: "Here is a job posting. Please read it carefully. I will paste my resume next, and I want you to compare the two."

> prompt: "From the job posting above, list the top 8–12 skills, tools, or types of experience the employer cares most about. Put them in a numbered list. If a requirement appears more than once or is mentioned in both the responsibilities and the requirements section, mark it as a high-priority keyword."

> prompt: "Here is my current resume. Compare it to the keyword list you just made. Tell me three things: (1) which keywords already appear, (2) which keywords are missing even though I probably have that experience, and (3) any keyword that appears in my resume but is not actually true for me. Use bullet points."

> prompt: "I noticed 'cross-team collaboration' is missing. Here is what I actually did: I worked with the sales team every Monday to update them on engineering timelines, and I sat in on product reviews once a week. Rewrite 2–3 resume bullet points that honestly show this. Keep each bullet to one line, start with a strong verb, and include a number if possible."

> file name: "Resume_SeniorAccountManager_AcmeCorp_March2026.docx"

How to translate a letter or document into plain English with any AI

> photograph a single A4 page top-down on a dark table, with a desk lamp to the side — not behind you, which causes glare.

> paste 200 words of a German utility letter, or attach one JPG of a Spanish rental contract.

> ➤ *"Please translate this letter into plain English. Keep the tone the same as the original (formal/polite). Keep all dates, names, addresses, account numbers, and amounts exactly as they appear — do not round or reformat them."*

> ➤ *"Now give me 3–4 short bullets: (1) what the sender wants, (2) what I need to do, (3) by when, (4) what happens if I do nothing."*

> spot-check the deadline date and the account/IBAN number first; those are the two mistakes that cause the most real-world pain.

Turn your Zoom call into meeting minutes in 5 minutes with Grok

> Open "Team Sync" in **Recordings & Transcripts** and download its transcript file.

> Type nothing yet — just leave the conversation empty for the next step.

> ➤ "Please write concise meeting minutes from these notes. Include key decisions, action items with owners, and next steps. Keep it under 200 words."

> ➤ "Add the name of the project we discussed and the deadline for the next milestone."

> Subject: Minutes from 5 June sync

Land Your Dream Job: Use AI for Resumes and Interviews

> I'm updating my resume for a Project Manager role. Here's my current experience:
>
> [Paste your current resume or job list here]
>
> Rewrite it to highlight my most relevant skills and achievements. Use strong action verbs like "led," "created," and "improved." Keep it to one page and use bullet points. Make it sound professional but easy to read.

> Here's my resume:
>
> [Paste your resume from Step 1]
>
> Here's a job description:
>
> [Paste the job description here]
>
> Rewrite my resume to highlight the skills and experiences that specifically match this job. Use keywords from the job description. Keep it to one page.

> Write a one-page cover letter for a Marketing Coordinator role at "Bright Ideas Agency". Here's my resume:
>
> [Paste your tailored resume from Step 2]
>
> Mention one specific achievement from my resume that matches the job description for a Marketing Coordinator. Keep it professional but warm, and use a friendly tone.

> I'm preparing for an interview for a Customer Service Representative role. Ask me 5 common interview questions for this position, one at a time. After I answer each one, give me specific feedback on how I can improve, being encouraging.

Automate meeting note-taking with Microsoft 365 Copilot in Teams

> ➤ "List the ideas discussed so far, including people's feedback."

> ➤ "Summarize the decisions and the next steps, and say who agreed to do what."

> ➤ "Create a table with the action items, the owner, and the due date mentioned in the meeting."

How to Get Honest Feedback on Your Resume Using Any AI Assistant

> ➤ *"New Chat"* button in ChatGPT's sidebar (left side), or tapping the text input field at the bottom of the Gemini app.

> Select and copy the text from your resume file, then paste it with a short note like: *"Here is my resume. Please review it for a [job title] application."*

> ➤ *"Here is the job listing I'm applying for: [paste the job title, responsibilities and required skills from the ad]."*

> ➤ *"Please review my resume against this job listing. Be honest and direct, like a recruiter doing a first-round screen. Tell me: 1) whether my resume matches what the employer is looking for, 2) any vague or weak wording I should fix, 3) whether I have any unexplained gaps or red flags a hiring manager might notice, and 4) whether the formatting would make it easy or hard to scan quickly."*

> ➤ *"Could you show me what a stronger version of my personal summary would look like? Please rewrite it using specific numbers or achievements where possible."*

> ➤ *"Here is my resume again and a different job listing for a [different role]. Please give me the same honest feedback."*

How to Use Copilot in Word to Turn a Long Report Into a One-Page Summary

> open `Q3-Project-Update.docx` from your Documents folder and click the **Copilot** button on the Home tab.

> ➤ *"Summarize this report into a one-page executive summary. Keep the original tone, the key numbers, and any important dates. Write it for a senior manager who has two minutes to read it."*

> ➤ *"Shorter. Cut it to about 350 words, keep all the percentages and dollar figures, and remove any section about background context. Use short bullet points under three headings: Wins, Risks, Next Steps."*

> click **"Create a new document"** (or, if you don't see that exact option, click **Insert**, then press `Ctrl+C` and paste into a fresh blank document).

> if Copilot wrote *"Revenue grew significantly,"* you change it to *"Revenue grew 18% to $4.2M, ahead of the 12% target."*

> click **File** → **Save As**, name the file `Q3-Project-Update-OnePager.docx`, and email it to your boss with the subject line *"Q3 update — 2-minute read."*

Ask Plain-English Questions About a Long PDF Using Hugging Face's Free Document Q&A

> if you don't have an account yet, click **Sign up**, enter your email, choose a password, and confirm the verification email Hugging Face sends you.

> pick a file like `apartment-lease-2024.pdf` from your Documents folder.

> type one of these after your PDF uploads: *What's the cancellation policy? How many days of vacation do part-time employees get? What's the warranty period for the battery?*

> after asking about the cancellation policy, follow up with *What happens if I cancel in the first 30 days?*

Get Plain-English Explanations of Any Contract With Claude

> ➤ "Here's the rental agreement I was sent. In plain language, what am I actually agreeing to? Highlight anything unusual or that renters often overlook."

> ➤ "[Paste section 1 here] In one paragraph, summarize what this section says and flag anything I should negotiate."

> ➤ "Can I get my security deposit back if I move out 30 days early?" or "If they change the price mid-contract, am I locked in?" or "What's the worst part of this agreement for me as the renter?"

> ➤ "Save these notes and remind me to ask the landlord about the early-termination fee before I sign."

How to Turn Your Notes into a Polished Report with AI in Minutes

> Project X Meeting - Oct 6
> Attendees: Sarah, Ben, Chloe
> Discussed:
> - Phase 1 progress (on track, small delay on marketing assets)
> - Budget review (under budget by 5%, good!)
> - Client feedback (positive on initial design, want more color options)
> Decisions:
> - Green light for Phase 2 launch planning
> - Allocate extra resources to marketing assets
> - Research additional color palettes for client
> Action Items:
> - Sarah: Send updated timeline to client by Friday
> - Ben: Prepare Phase 2 budget draft for next week
> - Chloe: Compile color options for review

> Please turn the following raw meeting notes into a concise, professional report for my team. The report should include an executive summary, key discussion points, decisions made, and a clear list of action items with owners and deadlines.
>
> [PASTE YOUR NOTES FROM STEP 1 HERE]

> ➤ "Can you make the executive summary shorter and focus only on the decisions?" or "Please add a section about budget implications using the figures I provided."

How to Triage and Clean Up an Overwhelming Inbox with Copilot

> ➤ *"Summarize my unread emails from today and group them by sender."*

> ➤ *"From my unread emails, which 5 are most urgent today, and why?"*

> click **Draft a reply**, then add to Copilot's suggestion: *"Make it warmer and add: I'll send the report by 5pm today."*

> ➤ *"List all the newsletters and automated emails in my inbox from the last 7 days."*

> ➤ *"Create a rule that moves every email from my manager into a folder called 'Manager' and marks it as important."*

Polish Your Resume Bullet Points with Le Chat in 10 Minutes

> ➤ *"I helped customers with their bills and account questions at the front desk of a phone store for about two years."*

full message to send — *"I helped customers with their bills and account questions at the front desk of a phone store for about two years. Please rewrite this as 3 strong resume bullet points a recruiter would notice. Start each one with a strong action verb."*

> ➤ *"Now give me a stronger version with measurable impact. Put any numbers you don't know in brackets like [X%] or [# of customers] — I will fill in the real numbers myself."*

> ➤ *"I like bullet #2 the best. Please make it slightly shorter and swap 'helped' for a stronger verb. Keep it to one line under 25 words."*

(next round): *"Now do the same for this bullet: 'answered phones and took messages for a real estate office'. Rewrite as one strong resume line with placeholders for any numbers."*

Draft a Calm, Professional Reply to a Frustrating Work Email with DeepSeek

type "hi" first and press Enter, just to confirm the chat is working.

paste the email, then on a new line write: "Draft a calm, professional reply that addresses the points without sounding defensive. Keep it under 150 words, and end with a clear next step."

> ➤ "I'm the project manager. The sender is a senior client who is upset about a missed deadline on the Q3 rollout. I want to keep the relationship, acknowledge the delay honestly, and propose a recovery plan. Tone should be respectful and steady, not overly apologetic."

> ➤ "Make the opening warmer — start with 'Thanks for flagging this' instead of 'I understand your concern.' Tighten the second paragraph; it repeats the first. End with a specific date for the recovery timeline."

ask "Replace 'I appreciate your patience' with something that sounds like a real person." Then add a line yourself — "I'll send the updated timeline by end of day Friday" — so the reply contains a real commitment, not a vague promise.

paste the draft, then change the recipient's first name, your signature line, and any project-specific facts (a meeting room, a ticket number, a teammate's name) before hitting send.

How to Write a Tailored Cover Letter for One Job Posting Using ChatGPT

> Just type **"Hi"** and send it, so you can see how the assistant replies.

> (your background summary): *"I'm a project manager with 6 years in healthcare IT. Led a team of 4. I also volunteer teaching kids to code on weekends. I'm applying because I want to move into renewable energy."*

> (copy and adapt this prompt):
> ➤ *"Here's the job I'm applying for: [paste the job post]. Here's a short note about me: [paste your background summary]. Please write a 3-paragraph cover letter that highlights my project management experience and why I want to move into renewable energy. Keep the tone warm but professional."*

> ➤ *"The second paragraph sounds too formal — can you make it sound more like a real person talking? Also, please add one sentence about my volunteer work teaching kids to code."*

> Paste it into a Google Doc and rename the file **"[Job title] — cover letter — [your name]"** so it's easy to find later.

> Change *"I am writing to express my interest in the position of Project Manager at your company"* to *"When I saw your opening for a Project Manager, it felt like a natural next step for me — here's why."*

Use Qwen to Write a Clear Project Update Email for Your Manager

> N/A for this step — just opening the page.

> N/A for this step — just signing in.

> Done: shipped the new onboarding flow on Tuesday. Stuck: waiting on legal review for the privacy notice. Next: design review on Friday, Maria owns the agenda.

> Turn these notes into a short project update email to my manager. Keep it under 120 words, friendly-professional tone, one short paragraph for each section (Done, Stuck, Next). No subject line needed.

> Shorter — aim for 80 words max. Drop the "Hope this helps" opener. Add that the design review is Friday at 2pm.

> N/A — this is a copy/paste action.

Practice a Job Interview With Le Chat: 5 Sample Questions and Instant Feedback

> type nothing yet — just confirm you're on a fresh, blank chat.

> You are a friendly interviewer at a mid-sized company. Ask me one common interview question at a time, wait for my answer, then give me short feedback on what was strong and what I could tighten up. After 5 questions, wrap up with three overall tips. Start with question 1.

> if the question is *"Tell me about yourself,"* a starter answer could be:
> I'm a retail supervisor with four years of experience leading a team of eight. Before that I studied business in college. I enjoy solving problems for customers on the spot, and I'm now looking for a role where I can use those skills in an office setting.

> when you reach the wrap-up, Le Chat's message will look something like:
> That's all five questions. Here are three overall tips: 1) lead with a concrete example more often, 2) keep answers around 60 seconds when spoken, 3) prepare one story you can adapt to many questions.

> Can you rewrite my answer to question 2 ("What's your greatest weakness?") as a 60-second spoken answer that names a real weakness, shows what I'm doing about it, and ends on what I'm good at?

> Here are the five questions, my drafts, Le Chat's feedback, and the polished answer to question 2 — keep all of this together so you can re-read it before the real interview.

Summarize Long Articles and Reports Using DeepSeek Chat

> `Please summarise the following article for me in 3-5 key bullet points. Highlight the main arguments and conclusions. [PASTE YOUR ARTICLE HERE]`

> `Could you make that summary even shorter, perhaps just two sentences?`

How to turn a meeting into clear notes and action items with AI

> "Act as a professional administrative assistant for a marketing team. Below is a raw meeting transcript. Please organize this text into three distinct sections:
> 1. **Summary:** A three-sentence overview of the main topics discussed.

> - *"Can you make the action items list shorter and focus only on Dave's tasks, ignoring Sarah's for now?"*

Practice Job Interview Questions with DeepSeek

> ➤ *"Act as a friendly hiring manager interviewing me for a [Customer Support Specialist] role at a mid-size company. Ask me one question at a time, wait for my answer, then give brief feedback and the next question. Keep questions realistic for this job."*

> ➤ *"Here's my answer to your last question: '[paste your answer]'. Please rewrite it to sound more confident, around 90 words, with a clear result at the end."*

> ➤ *"Give me the 8 most common interview questions for a [Customer Support Specialist] role, and a short model answer for each in plain language."*

> ➤ *"Let's do a 5-question mock interview now. No feedback between questions, just like a real interview. After the last answer, give me an overall score out of 10 and three specific things to improve."*

How to Clean Up a Messy Old Word Document with Copilot in Ten Minutes

> open `Old-Project-Summary.docx` from your Documents folder.

> ➤ "Summarize this document in 5 bullet points and tell me which sections are most inconsistent."

> ➤ "Rewrite this paragraph in the same plain, professional tone as the rest of the document. Keep it under 80 words."

> ➤ "Convert the names, dates and tasks in the highlighted text into a 3-column table called Name | Date | Task."

> ➤ "Write a 4-sentence executive summary of this document for a busy manager. Plain language, no jargon."

> rename the file to `Project-Summary-Clean-2026.docx`.

Draft a simple cover letter for a job application with DeepSeek

> `I need help drafting a cover letter for a Marketing Coordinator position.`

> `Here is the full job advertisement: [paste job ad here]. I am applying for the 'Community Engagement Officer' role at 'Green Earth Initiatives'.`

> `I want to highlight my strong project management skills and 3 years of experience in leading volunteer programmes. For example, I successfully organised a fundraising event that exceeded its target by 25%.`

> `This is a good start. Could you make the opening paragraph sound a bit more enthusiastic and ensure it clearly states my interest in their specific 'eco-friendly' projects? Also, add a sentence about my proficiency in Adobe Creative Suite.`

Use Alexa+ as a Meeting Timer and Pomodoro Helper on Work Breaks

> ➤ "Alexa, what time is it?" — a quick way to confirm the device can hear you and respond.

> ➤ "Alexa, set a 25-minute focus timer." — the most reliable form, because it uses the exact words "focus timer."

> ➤ "Alexa, start a Pomodoro." — this starts the classic 25-minute block without you naming a number.

> ➤ "Alexa, when the timer ends, tell me to stand up and stretch." — Alexa+ will speak your custom phrase at the end of the countdown.

> ➤ "Alexa, set a 5-minute break timer." — exactly the same command as Step 2, just with a different number and label.

> ➤ "Alexa, start my Morning Pomodoro routine." — fires both timers in a row without you re-stating each length.

Turn a meeting transcript into a to-do list with owners and deadlines using Cohere

> a short cleaned block looks like "Maria: We need to finalize the Q3 budget by Friday. John: I'll draft the client email. Sarah: I'll book the follow-up meeting for next Tuesday."

> this step doesn't involve typing anything new — just sign in and find the empty input area.

> paste the transcript, then add — "From the transcript above, list every action item. For each one, give: the task, the person who agreed to do it (owner), and the deadline or target date. If an owner or deadline is not stated, write 'unclear'. Format as a numbered list."

> type — "Add an owner for item 3 — it sounds like Maria mentioned she'd take it. Also give me a deadline for item 5, or mark it as unclear if none was given. Keep the same numbered format."

> paste as the description for a parent task called "Marketing sync — Oct 14," then create one subtask per numbered item, each with the owner and date filled in.

> ➤ "Hi all — pulled these action items from today's call: 1) Maria finalizes the budget by Fri 10/17; 2) John drafts the email by Wed; 3) Sarah books the follow-up. Let me know if anything's off."

Use Copilot to Write Spreadsheet Formulas Without the Tech Jargon

> ➤ *"I have a spreadsheet with column A called 'Item', column B called 'Price', and column C called 'Quantity'. I want to work out totals."*

> ➤ *"Write me a formula for cell D2 that multiplies the price (B2) by the quantity (C2)."*

> Copilot's reply might be `=B2*C2` — you'd paste that into cell **D2** and press **Enter**.

> ➤ *"That gave me #VALUE! in cell D2. Column B has dollar signs in it like '$10' instead of just numbers. Can you fix the formula?"*

> ➤ *"Now write me a formula that adds up everything in column D from row 2 down to the last row of data."*

Use Qwen to Summarize Long Policy Documents in Plain English

> Summarize this workplace health and safety policy into five plain-English bullet points for a new employee.

> Can you rewrite the section on leave entitlements as a simple step-by-step guide?

Use Qwen Chat to draft a thank-you note after a job interview

> *(Just open the app or website — no typing needed yet.)*

> Draft a professional thank-you email after a job interview for the Marketing Manager role at GreenLeaf Solutions. Keep it warm, concise, and under 150 words. Include a line thanking them for their time and expressing enthusiasm for the role.

> Make it warmer and add the interviewer's name, Sarah, and mention the team discussion about the upcoming campaign launch.

> Add Sarah's last name, Chen, and include my email, jessica.lee@example.com, at the end.

> *(Copy the text from Qwen's response and paste it into your email client.)*

> *(Paste the email into your compose window, add sarah.chen@example.com and the subject, then send.)*

Draft AI-powered Email Replies Using Hugging Face

> Let's say your API token is `hf_YOURUNIQUEKEY123` and your model is `openai/gpt-oss-120b`. You want to draft a polite and empathetic reply to a customer who is unhappy with a service.

How to Use Free AI for Your Small Business

> You don't need to type anything for this step, just get ready!

> ➤ "I run a small local bakery that specialises in sourdough bread and gluten-free treats. Write three friendly Facebook post options to announce our new weekend pastries. Keep the tone warm and inviting and include a call to action to visit the shop."

> ➤ "Draft a polite, professional reply to a customer who left a four-star review saying our shop was great but they had to wait five minutes to be served. Thank them for their feedback and let them know we are working on improving our service speed during busy periods."

> ➤ "Please summarize the following supplier terms of service into a bullet-point list of the three most important things I need to know, especially regarding delivery times and returns: [paste your text here, replacing this bracketed phrase]"

How to Write a Warm Thank-You Note After a Job Interview Tonight

> ➤ "When you described how the marketing team rebuilt the volunteer newsletter last spring, and how three volunteers ended up writing the best pieces — that stayed with me."

subject line: "Thank you — Marketing Coordinator interview, Tuesday afternoon"

> ➤ "Thank you so much for talking with me this afternoon about the Marketing Coordinator role. I enjoyed learning how your team approaches donor communications, and I'm still very interested in the position."

> ➤ "Your description of how the team rebuilt the volunteer newsletter last spring really stayed with me — especially the part about listening to the volunteers' own stories rather than just pitching them on tasks. That's something I tried to do at my last job with the parent newsletter, and I'd love to bring that approach to your team."

close: "Thanks again for your time, and for sharing so much about the role. I'm happy to answer any follow-up questions. Best, [Your full name]"

How to write a standout cover letter with AI

1. Strong communication skills
2. Experience with project management tools (e.g., Asana, Trello)
3. Ability to work with cross-functional teams

- Regularly ran weekly updates for a 10-person team, which improved overall stakeholder satisfaction by 20%.
- Successfully managed a complex product launch from start to finish using Trello, delivering the project on time and within budget.
- Presented quarterly performance reports to senior leadership, consistently praised for clarity and effective communication of results.

➤ "Write a cover letter for a Project Coordinator role at XYZ Company.
The job requires strong communication, experience with Asana or Trello, and teamwork across departments.
Use the following specific details from my experience:
- Ran weekly updates for a 10-person team, improving stakeholder satisfaction by 20%.
- Managed a product launch using Trello, delivering on time.
- Presented quarterly reports to senior leadership, praised for clarity.
Keep the tone professional but friendly, and make sure the letter is under 300 words. Address it to the hiring manager."

Edited Snippet:
...I was excited to see that XYZ Company values cross-functional collaboration, because at my current role, I regularly bring together marketing, design, and engineering teams to meet product deadlines, consistently exceeding expectations.

Final Check List:
- Is the letter addressed to a specific person (e.g., "Dear Alex Smith") if the job ad provided a name? If not, a general "Dear Hiring Manager" is fine.

Turn a Quick Brainstorm into a Clear Meeting Agenda with DeepSeek

> a brainstorm bullet list — "product launch — pricing — who's doing the demo — what is the social plan — we still owe the legal review a reply — vendor contract is stuck — hire for the support role — Q4 OKRs"

> navigate to chat.deepseek.com, sign in, then click the "New Chat" option in the left sidebar.

> ➤ "Here are our notes for the meeting. It's a 45-minute weekly product sync on Tuesday with Maria, John, Sarah, and me. Please turn these into a structured agenda with time boxes, topics, and a named owner per item. Notes: product launch, pricing decision, demo owner, social plan, legal review reply, vendor contract, support hire, Q4 OKRs."

> ➤ "Move the budget review to minute 15, give Priya ownership of the next-step list, and cut the demo recap to two minutes."

> paste the agenda into your meeting invite's description field, then write "Welcome — please read before joining" above it and the meeting link below.

How to use AI to write quick, polite emails and replies

> `Draft a polite reply to my colleague Sam about the project deadline. Mention that I'll need an extra two days and thank him for his patience.`

> If the draft starts with "Dear Mr. Sam," you might ask, `Can you change the greeting to 'Hi Sam,' and make the overall email a bit more casual?`

> If the AI's draft says "the deadline is Friday 12 May," carefully confirm this specific date and day are correct before you proceed.

> In Gmail, click the "Compose" button, then click into the large blank area of the new message window and press `Ctrl + V` (Windows/Linux) or `Command + V` (Mac) to paste the text.

How to Turn Messy Voice Memos Into Clean, Searchable Notes

> just talk out loud for two minutes about what you want to remember — meeting points, lecture notes, a story idea, anything.

> tap the transcript button, then put your phone down while it works. Do not keep talking — the recorder might still be listening.

> open the app, hit **New chat**, and leave the box empty for a moment.

> paste the transcript, then add — *"Please turn this into clean, organized notes. Use bullet points, group related ideas under clear headers, fix the grammar, and remove filler words. Keep my own wording where it matters."*

> name the note *"2026-01-15 Team meeting — Q2 ideas"* or *"2026-01-15 Shower thought: podcast about old maps"*. The more specific, the easier to find.

Use Claude to Rewrite an Angry Email So It Says What You Actually Mean

> type "Hi" and press Enter once, just to confirm the chat is working. You'll know it worked when you see an empty conversation with no previous messages and a blinking cursor in the message box.

> ➤ "This is going to my project manager. I want them to move the deadline from Friday to next Wednesday because the design files aren't ready. Keep it short — under 120 words." You'll know it worked when the new version names the right person, includes your specific ask, and reads like something you'd actually type yourself.

> ➤ "Drop the apology paragraph. I don't need to apologize — I need the refund processed by Monday." You'll know it worked when the new version reads like something a calm, confident version of you would write, and you'd be comfortable seeing it in your sent folder.

Translate a French or Spanish Email into English in Seconds with Hugging Face

> use your regular email and a password you don't reuse anywhere else.

> search for "French to English translation" if your email is in French.

> a French line like *"Bonjour, je vous écris concernant la livraison prévue vendredi."* — paste the whole email, paragraphs and all.

> leave source set to "French" or "auto-detect", and target set to "English".

> you'd get something like *"Hello, I'm writing to you regarding the delivery scheduled for Friday."* — clear, polite, ready to act on.

How to Prepare for Your Next Job Interview Using Free AI Tools

> ➤ "I am interviewing for a job. Here is the job description: [Paste Job Description]. Based on this, what are the top 5 questions the interviewer is most likely to ask me? Please explain why each question is important."

> ➤ "I want to make sure my answers align with this company's values. Here is some text from their 'About Us' page: [Paste About Us Text]. Can you identify the top 3 cultural values they care about, and suggest how I can show I have these traits?"

> ➤ "I want you to act as an interviewer for the role described earlier. Ask me one practice question at a time. After I reply, give me friendly feedback on how to make my answer stronger, then ask the next question. Let's start with the first question."

> ➤ "Here is an experience I want to share in my interview: [Type a rough, messy summary of a past work achievement]. Can you help me rewrite this using the STAR method so it sounds professional and clear?"

> ➤ "I am feeling quite nervous about my interview tomorrow. Can you give me three simple strategies to stay calm if I get asked a question I do not know the answer to?"

Ask Alexa+ to Read Your Calendar Aloud and Get a Heads-Up Before Meetings

> When asked "Which calendar should Alexa use?" choose "Work" if that's where your meetings live — not the "Holidays" or "Family" one.

> Say *"Alexa, hello"* as a quick test. You should hear a short chime and a friendly spoken reply.

> ➤ *"Alexa, what are my meetings today?"* and *"Alexa, read my schedule"* work just as well. *"Alexa, what's next on my schedule?"* gives you only the very next event.

> ➤ *"Alexa, remind me 10 minutes before my next meeting"* — Alexa+ confirms with "Okay, I'll remind you 10 minutes before [meeting name]."

> ➤ *"Alexa, good morning, what's on my calendar today and remind me 15 minutes before each meeting."* — a complete, copy-and-paste morning command.

How to Use Gemini to Keep One Project's Notes and Chats Together in One Place

> Name the notebook "[project name] for [month and year]", such as "Kitchen remodel for June."

> Paste this into a text source: "Budget: [total amount] for materials. Contractor: [contractor name], available starting [date]. Must finish before [deadline]."

> ➤ "Using my sources, what is left in the [project name] budget, and which tasks should I finish first?"

> ➤ "Summarize everything I've added so far to the [project name] notebook in five short bullet points."

Polish your emails for better clarity and tone using ChatGPT

> ➤ "Please refine this email for clarity and a professional tone. Make it concise."

> ➤ "Can you make it sound a bit warmer and shorten it to less than 100 words? Also, ensure it clearly asks for a meeting next week."

How to use Claude to draft a polite work email in 5 minutes

> ➤ "Draft a polite email to my team, Sarah and David, requesting a brief meeting next Tuesday to discuss the upcoming project milestones. We need to confirm who is responsible for each task by the end of the week."

> ➤ "That's great, but can you make it a bit more formal and add a sentence about needing everyone's input during the meeting?"

How to Draft a Polite Email Asking for a Deadline Extension with AI

> ➤ "I need to ask my manager, [manager name], to move the [project name] deadline from [original date] to [new date] because I'm waiting on data from another team."

> ➤ "Write the email in a warm, professional tone, under 120 words, with a clear subject line and one specific new date I can offer."

> ➤ "Keep the same email, but cut the apology to one short sentence and add that I've already finished [part of the work]."

> ➤ "Each time I give you a situation, write a polite deadline-extension email with a subject line, under 120 words, ending with one specific new date and no excuses."

> ➤ "List every date, name, and promise in this email so I can check each one against my notes."

How to analyze files and spreadsheets with ChatGPT

> simply click the button – no text to type yet.

> select *budget-2025.xlsx* and wait for the thumbnail to show.

> copy-paste the exact sentence above.

> copy-paste either of the two questions above.

> paste the exact sentence above and hit **Enter**.

Turn any messy meeting notes into a clear summary with Claude

> ➤ "Please summarize these meeting notes into clear bullet points. Highlight key decisions and list all action items, including who is responsible and by when. Make it concise."

> ➤ "Could you make the action items bolder and add a separate section for 'Next Steps'?" or "Please ensure all participant names are correctly spelled from my original notes."

Write marketing emails fast with Cohere’s text generation

> none needed for this step – just click.

> copy the sentence above exactly into the box.

> none needed – just read.

> copy the sentence above exactly.

> none – just use the copy-and-paste shortcuts.

Get Started with xAI's Grok to Draft Professional Emails in Seconds

> (No specific text to type for this step, as it's a selection.)

> ➤ "Act as a helpful project manager. Draft a polite email to a client, Sarah, explaining that our monthly progress report will be delayed by two days due to final data verification. Assure her we are prioritizing quality and ask if we can meet briefly on Thursday at 2:00pm to discuss the findings."

> (After uploading a relevant file) "Based on this attached project timeline, draft a quick update email to my team summarizing our key achievements this week and highlighting the next three deadlines."

> ➤ "Now, write a short, one-sentence reminder that I can copy into my calendar or task manager to prompt me to check in with Sarah if she hasn't replied by Friday morning."

Fact-Check Online Claims with Perplexity's Sources

> `Is it true that taking a cold shower every morning can cure the common cold?`

> `Can you find government health organisation statements about cold showers and colds?`

How to Ask Gemini to Explain Your Bank Statement in Plain English

> open the Gemini app, tap "New chat," and you should see an empty text box with the prompt "Ask Gemini" at the bottom.

> ➤ "I'm pasting my bank statement below — it's about 3 pages of transactions."

> ➤ "Please read the statement I just uploaded and give me a plain-English summary of what happened in November. List the top 3 things I spent money on and any fees I was charged. Keep it under 200 words."

> ➤ "Now look only at the charges that happened more than once this month, and anything that looks like a fee or service charge. For each one, tell me the name, the amount, and how many times it appeared."

> ➤ "Group all my spending from this statement into simple categories like food, transport, subscriptions, bills and other. Show me the total for each category and the percentage of my total spending. Then tell me which category grew the most compared to a normal month."

> ➤ "Turn the summary from Step 3 and the fee list from Step 4 into a short email I can send to my bank asking about the $12 monthly fee. Keep the tone polite and include the date and amount for each charge."

How to Fact-Check a Suspicious Text or Link Before Forwarding It

> ➤ "You are helping me check a message before I forward it. Look for these warning signs: urgency or pressure, requests for money, gift cards or passwords, a sender I can't verify, links that don't match the company they claim to be, and wording that feels off. Then list what you cannot tell from the text alone."

> ➤ "Here is the message I received from [who sent it]: [paste the message here]"

> ➤ "For each warning sign you found, quote the exact words from the message and explain in one sentence why it could be a concern."

> ➤ "Break down this web address into its parts and tell me which part is the actual site name: [paste the address here]"

> ➤ "Based on this message, what are the three most important claims I should confirm directly with the company before I share it?"

> ➤ "Write a short, calm message I can send to [family member name] saying I'm not sure this text is real, that we should check it with [trusted contact] first, and that they shouldn't share it yet."

How to compare two rental listings side by side with weighted pros and cons

> ➤ "Listing A — 2-bed in Eastside, $X/month, 12-month lease. — — Listing B — 1-bed + den in Northgate, $Y/month, month-to-month. Compare these two rentals."

> ➤ "Here are my priorities, weighted 1–5: 1) Commute under 30 min by transit (5). 2) Quiet street, no main road (4). 3) Utilities included in rent (3). 4) Allows my cat (5). 5) In-unit laundry (2). Score both listings against these."

> ➤ "Make a table with these rows: rent, lease length, square feet, utilities included, parking, laundry, pet policy, commute time to downtown, nearest noise source. One column for Listing A, one for Listing B, one for 'verified or missing.' If a fact isn't in the listing, write 'not stated.'"

> ➤ "Now score both listings 1–10 on each priority from Step 2, multiply by the weight, and show the totals. Add a two-sentence recommendation naming which one wins on my priorities and why."

> ➤ "List every fact in the table you marked 'not stated' and anything you had to infer. For each one, write a one-line question I can email the landlord."

> ➤ "PROMPT 1: [paste listings + intro line]. PROMPT 2: [paste weighted priorities]. PROMPT 3: [paste score-and-recommend request]."

Catch Up Fast: Summarize Long Chats in WhatsApp and Messenger with Meta AI

> ➤ *"I copied messages from a 40-person family group covering about a day's worth of chat — roughly 30 messages with photos, links and a few voice notes."*

> ➤ *"Here are the messages from my family group from yesterday. Please summarize them in 5 short bullet points, focus on any decisions or plans people made, and ignore the photos. Reply in plain English."*

> ➤ *"Great, but please make it 3 bullet points instead of 5, and add a one-line 'action items' section at the end showing what I might need to reply to."*

> ➤ *"I forward the summary to a private chat with myself called 'Catch-up notes' so I can search it later without scrolling through the original group."*

Summarize Long Articles into Key Bullet Points with Grok on X

> `Please summarise this news article into 5 clear bullet points, focusing on the main findings: [paste your article link here]`

> `Can you elaborate on the economic implications mentioned in bullet point 2?`

Summarize a long chat thread into 3 bullet points with Copilot

> `Summarize the following chat thread into exactly three short bullet points, focusing on key decisions and action items:`

> `Please make the bullet points even shorter, just focusing on who needs to do what.`

Ask Copilot to compare two product specs and list the differences

> Type or paste:
> ➤ "Hello"

> Paste:
> ➤ "Here are the specs for the first laptop: Processor: Intel Core i7-13700H, RAM: 16GB LPDDR5, Storage: 1TB SSD, Screen: 14" 2.8K OLED 120Hz, Weight: 1.4kg, Price: $2,199"

> Type:
> ➤ "Format these specs as a clean bullet-point list."

> Paste:
> ➤ "Now for the second laptop: Processor: AMD Ryzen 9 7940HS, RAM: 32GB LPDDR5, Storage: 512GB SSD, Screen: 16" 2.5K IPS 165Hz, Weight: 1.8kg, Price: $1,799"

> Type:
> ➤ "Compare these two products and list the differences in a clear table or bullet list."

> Type:
> ➤ "Which of these two products is better for video editing on a budget?"

Summarize Long Research PDFs with Cohere's Clever AI

> Your key will look like a long string of random letters and numbers, such as `a1B2c3D4e5...`

> Paste the text you copied from your PDF into the large input box on the left side of the Playground.

> output:
> - The study tested 500 participants over twelve months.

Use Claude to Pull Out the Key Points of a Long Research Paper

> N/A — no typing in this step.

> N/A — no typing in this step.

> ➤ "Please summarize this paper in plain English using five short sections: (1) the main question the research tries to answer, (2) the method they used, including who or what they studied, (3) the key findings, (4) what the authors conclude, and (5) the limits of the study the authors mention. Keep each section to 2–4 sentences."

> ➤ "In section 2 you mentioned 'a randomized controlled trial with 240 participants' — can you explain in plain words what that actually means they did, step by step?"

> N/A — no typing in this step.

Use Qwen to Translate a Short Message for a Friend

> sign in with your usual Gmail address.

> paste this short Spanish line — *"Hola María, ¿puedes venir a cenar el sábado? Te echo de menos."*

> ➤ *"Please translate this to English in a friendly tone, as if I'm writing back to my aunt."*

> ➤ *"Lovely, but can you make the second sentence a little warmer? She always signs off with love."*

> the final English reply — *"Hi María, can you come over for dinner on Saturday? I miss you."*

How to use Gemini Deep Research to plan a big purchase decision

> when the picker appears, click the dropdown that currently shows "Fast" or "Pro" and switch it to **Deep Research**.

> ➤ "I need a quiet, energy-efficient dishwasher for a small kitchen, budget roughly $700–$1,000 USD, must fit a 24-inch opening and run under 45 dB. I cook most nights for two, sometimes four. Compare the top 5 models available in my country, with pros, cons, and where each one tends to be cheapest."

> hit the "Start Research" button, then make a coffee; the first draft of the report appears inline as it finishes each section.

> open the report, jump to the "Sources" list at the bottom, and click the first three links — if any of them are dead, irrelevant, or from a brand's own press release, treat the matching claim with caution.

> ➤ "Now compare models A and B from your report on noise, energy use, and reliability over five years — which one wins for a household of two who cooks daily?"

> ➤ "Summarize this whole conversation into a checklist: top 3 dishwashers I should see in a store, what to test in person, and what to double-check on the manufacturer's site before I buy."

How to Ask ChatGPT to Explain Any AI News Headline in Plain English

> headline to try: *"Anthropic's Claude gets a 1M-token context window with extended thinking mode"*

> just open the app — no typing needed yet.

> full prompt to paste:
> Anthropic's Claude gets a 1M-token context window with extended thinking mode

> follow-up to paste:
> Now explain why this might matter to a regular person who isn't a developer or AI researcher. Give me 2-3 concrete examples.

> follow-up to paste:
> In one sentence, what does "context window" mean? Use an analogy a 10-year-old would get.

> new title: *"Claude context window — plain English"*

Research and Draft Short Social Media Captions with Perplexity

> ➤ *"I'm writing a 3-sentence Instagram caption for a small American coffee roastery. What are 5 trending topics in sustainable coffee right now in the US, with sources from 2025 or 2026?"*

> ➤ *"Tell me more about the rise of compostable coffee pods in the US. Give me 3 specific statistics or quotes from American sources I could mention in a post."*

> ➤ *"Write a 3-sentence Instagram caption for our compostable coffee pods. Tone: warm and friendly, not salesy. Mention that 1 in 3 people now look for compostable packaging, according to a 2025 survey. End with a question to invite comments."*

> ➤ *"Make sentence 2 shorter and a bit punchier. Keep the question at the end. Suggest 5 relevant hashtags."*

Compare Products with Perplexity Before You Buy

> `Compare the Google Pixel 8 vs Samsung Galaxy S24 on camera quality and battery life.`

> `Which one is generally considered better for low-light photography according to user reviews?`

> `What are the pros and cons of an OLED TV screen for watching sports, compared to a QLED screen?`

How to Compare Phone Plans and Pick the Right One Without the Jargon

> ➤ "I used 12 GB last month — mostly maps, Spotify, and one Zoom call a day."

> list: "Must-haves: at least 15 GB, hotspot, 5G. Nice-to-haves: international roaming."

> ➤ "I'll compare a Verizon postpaid plan, an AT&T-based MVNO, and a T-Mobile prepaid plan."

> ➤ "$40 plan + $6 taxes + $25 phone = $71/month total. After promo ends: $95/month."

> ➤ "I asked my neighbor: 'How's your T-Mobile signal in our building?' He said: 'Two bars, calls drop.'"

> row: "Plan A: $55/mo, 25 GB, hotspot yes, support fair. Plan B: $45/mo, 15 GB, no hotspot, support good. Pick A — hotspot is a must-have."

How to ask Alexa+ to translate a short phrase on your Echo

> ➤ "Alexa, how do I say 'Where is the bathroom?' in French?"

> ➤ "Alexa, speak Spanish for the next five minutes." Then: "Alexa, how do I say 'the check, please'?"

> ➤ "Alexa, can you say that more slowly?" — or — "Alexa, spell that in French."

> ➤ "Alexa, translate that into English." — after someone has spoken in another language near the device.

> after a translation you want to keep, open the app and search the activity feed for the first word of the phrase.

How to Compare Two Job Offers Side by Side Using AI Safely

> Offer A — "Title: Senior Marketer; Base: $X; Bonus: up to 10%; Location: 3 days office, 2 remote; Vacation: 18 days; Health: full coverage; Start: 2 weeks." Use the same shape for Offer B.

> never paste your full name plus employer combo, home address, phone number, government ID numbers (Social Security, passport), bank details, names of current coworkers or your manager, references' contact info, NDA-protected clauses from your current employer, or your past salary history.

> ➤ "Here are the facts of two job offers I'm comparing. Please build a clear side-by-side table with one column per offer and rows for: base salary, bonus, vacation, health benefits, location, working hours, and start date. At the bottom, add a short Pros and Cons summary for each." Then paste your note.

> add three rows — "Team vibe — Offer A felt warm in the interview; Offer B felt formal"; "Commute — Offer A 25 min by train; Offer B 55 min by car at peak"; "Growth — Offer A clearer path to senior; Offer B broader role but less clear ladder".

> in your assistant's settings, search for a toggle named something like "Save conversations" or "Improve the model for everyone" — switch it off if you want your offer details to stay private.

Use Grok to Explain a Confusing News Article in Plain English

> type a quick "hi" first, just to confirm everything is working, before pasting anything.

> copy the headline, byline, and the first three to five paragraphs — usually enough for a clear summary.

> paste the article, then on a new line type: *"Explain this like I'm smart but not an expert. Who is involved, what actually happened, and why does it matter?"*

> ➤ *"Who is [Name] you mentioned? Why are they important in this story?"*

> ➤ *"In two or three sentences, why should an ordinary person care about this story, and what's the most likely next development?"*

Explain a tricky school topic with Grok in five minutes

> tap the "+" or pencil icon at the top of the chat list to open a blank chat.

> ➤ *"My son is 10. Please explain the water cycle as a short story he can read on his own — about 150 words, no big words."*

> ➤ *"Can you add one short scene with a leaf falling off a tree, so the 'evaporation' part makes sense?"*

> ask your child *"So what does the sun do to the water in the puddle?"* — then type *"Did I explain the water cycle correctly to a 10-year-old?"* into Grok for a sanity check.

> tap the share icon, then paste the story into Apple Notes, Google Keep or a simple text message to yourself.

How to Fact-Check a Viral Claim or Breaking News Story with Perplexity

> `A widely shared post claims a major bank will close 200 branches next month.`

> (no typing required — just click the numbered links under the answer)

> tap **News** if you're checking a breaking story, or **Academic** if the claim is about a medical or scientific finding.

> `Who first made this claim? When and where did it originally appear?`

> instead of pasting the original post, ask `What did the bank actually announce about branch closures this month?` in your own words.

Fact-check a viral claim with Perplexity before you share it

navigate to **perplexity.ai**

➤ "Harvard study proves 5G causes memory loss"

Click the first source card to open the original article and read the opening paragraph — does it match what the headline claimed?

The article says "A small 2021 study at one university looked at this topic" — that is very different from a large, peer-reviewed government report. Look for that difference.

➤ "Is this study peer-reviewed?" or "What do other sources say about this claim?"

How to Translate Menus, Signs and Labels with Your Phone and Gemini

tap the camera icon, then choose **Take photo** if you want a still image, or **Open camera live** if you want to stream what's in front of you.

aim so that one menu section, one sign, or one product label fills most of the frame, then tap the round shutter button.

type **"Translate this menu into English. For each dish, give me the name, a short description, and flag anything containing nuts, dairy, or shellfish."**

type **"What does the small text under each item say? And which of these soups would you order if you don't like spice?"**

tap **copy**, open Notes, then paste — your translated menu is now scrollable on your own screen.

How to Use Perplexity Spaces to Organize Your Digital Research

Give your Space the name "Backyard Veggie Garden Plan" and a description like "Planning out my first home vegetable patch, focusing on organic methods."

Type: "You are an expert horticulturalist helping a beginner. When I ask questions, please keep your answers simple, focus on organic methods, and always suggest plants that grow well in warm, coastal climates."

Select a PDF file from your computer titled "Local Nursery Price List 2024.pdf" which contains prices for soil, plants, and fertilisers.

Type: "What are the best vegetables to plant this month for a warm, coastal climate, and what organic soil mix do you recommend from the price list I uploaded?"

Set Up Different Alexa+ Routines for Weekday and Weekend Mornings

> routine name — `Weekday Morning`

> name `Weekday Morning`, voice trigger *Alexa, start my weekday morning*, time **6:30 AM**, days **Mon–Fri only**

> actions — **News → Flash Briefing**, **Smart Home → Turn on "Kitchen Lights"**, **Smart Home → Turn on "Coffee Maker" plug**

> say `Alexa, start my weekday morning` and listen for the news flash within a few seconds.

> name `Weekend Morning`, time **8:00 AM**, days **Sat–Sun only**

> actions — **Music → Play "Slow Morning" playlist**, **Smart Home → Turn off "Bedroom Lights" fade-out**, **Weather → Read forecast** (skip the news flash entirely)

> on Monday morning, expect the weekday routine; on Saturday, expect the weekend one. If the wrong one fires, open that routine and check the days row.

How to Build a Simple Weekly Schedule in Google Sheets with Gemini

> name it "Spring weekly schedule" or "My week plan".

> type "Hi" as a quick first message to confirm Gemini is responding.

> ➤ "Here's my week. I work Monday to Friday, 9 a.m. to 5 p.m. I teach a yoga class Tuesday and Thursday evenings from 6 to 7:30 p.m. I hit the gym three mornings a week, around 6:30 to 7:30 a.m. on Monday, Wednesday, and Friday. Saturday morning is family breakfast from 9 to 11 a.m. Please build a weekly schedule in this sheet with rows for each day, columns for morning, midday, afternoon, and evening, and a SUM formula that totals the hours automatically."

> in cell B2 (Tuesday morning) type "Gym"; in cell C5 (Wednesday afternoon) type "Deep work block"; in cell A8 (Monday evening) type "Family dinner."

> blue for work, green for fitness, yellow for family time, gray for rest or sleep.

> type `=SUM(B2:B10)` and press Enter. The cell instantly shows the total. If your durations are in seconds, multiply by 24 first: `=SUM(B2:B10)*24`.

> just close the browser tab when you finish. Next time you open the file, your schedule will be right where you left it.

Build a Reusable Alexa+ Pomodoro Routine With Voice Check-Ins

> routine name "Start Pomodoro"
>
> trigger phrase: "start pomodoro"
>
> announcement: "Focus block starting. Twenty-five minutes. I'll let you know when to break."
>
> 25-minute timer named exactly "Focus"
>
> announcement: "Break time. Five minutes. Step away from the screen."
>
> 5-minute timer named exactly "Break"
>
> announcement: "Back to focus. Twenty-five minutes starting now."
>
> 25-minute timer named "Focus" again
>
> test: change both timers to 1 minute the first time, then change them back to 25 and 5 once the chain is proven
>
> stop command: "Alexa, stop"

Set Up an Alexa+ Routine to Automate Your Everyday Tasks

> name it `Morning Wake-Up`.
>
> type `good morning` as the phrase.
>
> type `what's the weather today` as the custom action.
>
> say `Alexa, good morning` to your Echo.

Build a Reusable Alexa+ Morning Routine That Runs the Same Way Every Weekday

> **News flash → Weather for my location → Read today's calendar → Turn on Bedroom Lamp**
>
> a routine name
>
> voice trigger phrase
>
> action stack (copyable names for the "Add action" prompts)
>
> spoken test command

How to Add an Alibaba Cloud AI Chatbot to Your WordPress Site

> `FrontDeskHelper`

> `Hi! I'm your digital assistant – ask me about opening hours or services.`

> set color to `#0066CC` and upload `logo.png`

> `<script src="https://chatbot.alibabacloud.com/widget.js"></script>` — *your actual code may differ*

> paste the `<script>` snippet exactly as copied